

# THE NORTHERN EPICS

## *The Poetic Edda and Other Old Germanic Alliterative Poetry*

*edited and translated by*

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Compiled September 19, 2026.

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Om drömmar skola rinna bort, som snö,  
när lyktas vintern, åter blottas Jord,  
från sinne sömnomhöljt, och dermed dö,  
jag båd' att efter lefde dessa ord.  
Dem tage, hålle hon som intet vet,  
om fällde i sin ovetenskap blott en  
fullärlig tår—men skedde icke det,  
då bränn dem under Månens klara sken,  
att det som sjungits utan kraft och mod  
förglömmes, och ej mer förnedrar dem  
som förr för intet mer utguto blod  
än yrig dröm om himmelrikets hem.  
Ty knappt ens Månen skiner för vår skull  
om vi förblifva halfva. Han är full.

*History takes many turns:  
A man is born. Another burns.  
(And who can tell where e'er it goes?)  
The dust that was his body blows  
And plays upon the mellow air  
And lands upon some white, washed hand.  
The girl that combs her yellow hair  
Takes pause, then blows away the man.*



*Lífir hann of allar aldir ok stjórnar öllu ríki sínu ok ræðr öllum  
hlutum, stórum ok smám. [...] Hann smíðaði himin ok jörð ok  
loptin ok alla eign þeira. [...] Hitt er þó mest, er hann gerði  
manninn ok gaf hönunum gnd þá, er lifa skal ok aldri týna=sk, þótt  
lík-amr fúni at moldu eða brenni at osku; ok skulu allir menn lifa,  
þeir er rétt eru siðaðir, ok vera með hönunum sjölfum þar sem heitir  
Gim-lé eða Vin-gólf.*

*Gylfa ginning 3:7–11*

*Deyr fé, · deyja frændr,  
deyr sjalfr hit sama;  
ek veit einn · at aldri=gi deyr  
dómr of dauðan hværn.*

*Háva mál 77*

*Meðal-snotr · skyli manna hvær,  
éva til snotr séi;  
því't snotrs manns hjarta · verðr sjaldan glatt,  
ef sá 's al-snotr es á.*

*Háva mál 106*

*Ullar hylli · hefr ok allra goða  
hværr's tækr fyrstr á funa  
því't opnir heimar · verða umb ása sonum,  
þá's hefja af hvera.*

*Grímnis mál 43*



# Acknowledgments

This work has benefitted from the feedback and criticism of countless people. The following persons have been especially helpful in giving suggestions, corrections, and stimulating discussion: Antonín Ryšavý, Axel Nilsson, Connor Alford, Esmeralda d., Graham Scheper, John Newman, J. Hertling, Joseph S. Hopkins, Lukas Danford, Mikael Males, Nikhil Surya Dwibhashyam, Trevor L. Payne, Zhao Yuanlong.

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# Abbreviations

## Languages, language families, and scripts

- AS = Anglo-Saxon
- EF. = Elder Futhark
- Eng. = Modern English
- Ger. = Modern German
- Got. = Gotnish (or Gothic)
- IE = Indo-European
- Lomb. = Lombardic
- MHG = Middle High German
- NGmc. = North Germanic
- ODan. = Old Danish
- OE = Old English
- OF = Old Frisian
- OHG = Old High German
- OI = Old Indian
- OIr. = Old Irish
- ON = Old Norse
- OS = Old Saxon
- OSwe. = Old Swedish
- PGmc. = Proto-Germanic
- PIE = Proto-Indo-European

- PN = Proto-Norse
- PNWGmc. = Proto-North-West Germanic
- PWGmc. = Proto-West Germanic
- WGmc. = West Germanic
- YF = Younger Futhark

## General abbreviations

- 1st = first-person
- 2nd = second-person
- 3rd = third-person
- abbrev. = abbreviated
- acc. = accusative case
- add. = is added
- adj. = adjective
- approx. = approximately
- c. = century
- ca. = circa
- cert. = certainly
- cf. = *confere*; compare
- corr. = corrected in the ms.
- cpd. = compound
- dat. = dative case
- e. = excerpt (not the whole stanza)
- ed. = edition, edited (by)
- e.g. = *exemplio gratia*; for instance
- emend. = emendation, emended (by)
- esp. = especially
- f. = feminine
- fol., foll. = folio, folios



- gen. = genitive case
- id. = *idem*; the same
- i.e., = *id est*; that is
- imper. = imperative mood
- ind. = indicative mood
- instr. = instrumental case
- l., ll. = line, lines
- lit. = literal, literally
- m. = masculine
- metr. emend. = emended based on metrical criteria
- ms., mss. = manuscript, manuscripts
- n. = and note, (see) note to aforementioned passage
- nom. = nominative case
- norm. = normalised from the ms. spelling
- ntr. = neuter
- om. = omitted by
- p., pp. = page, pages
- pl. = plural number
- pr. = *principium*; the unnumbered introductory paragraph of a section or speech marker before a stanza
- pres. = present
- pres. ed. = present edition
- prob. = probably
- rev. = reversed (of lines or words)
- sens. emend. = emended due to lack of sense
- sg. = singular number
- st., sts. = stanza, stanzas
- subj. = subjunctive mood
- s.v. = *sub verbo*; under the word

- tr. = translation, translated (by)
- viz. = *vidēlicet*; namely, to wit
- wo. = without
- wrt. = with regard to
- < = (deriving) from
- > = whence

## Primary sources

For ease of reference, those texts which are included in the present edition are marked in bold text.

- *AB* = *Aitareya Brāhmaṇa*
- *Akv* = *Atla kviða* ('Lay of Attle')
- *Alv* = *Alviðs mól* ('Speeches of Allwise')
- *Am* = *Atla mól* ('Speeches of Attle')
- *AV* = *Ar̥va-vēdā*, in the *Śāunaka* recension unless otherwise specified
- *Bdr* = *Baldrs draumar* ('Dreams of Balder')
- *Beow* = *Beowulf*
- *Birþb* = Three Galders for Birth
- *Brot* = *Brot af Sig-urðar kviða* ('Fragment of a Lay of Siward')
- *Cadman* = Cadman's Hymn
- *Cant* = Canterbury Galder
- *ContVerm* = *Contra Vermes* ('Against Wyrms')
- *Déor* = *Déor* ('Deer')
- *Dweorb* = *Wið dweorb* ('Against a Dwarf')
- *Eb* = *Eyr-byggja saga* ('Saw of the Ere-dwellers')
- *Eddbr* = *Brot ór Snorra Edda* ('Fragments from Snorre's Edda')
- *Eirm* = *Ei-riks mól* ('Speeches of Eric'), Anon *Eirm* in SkP 1
- *Fäfn* = *Fäfnis mól* ('Speeches of Fathomer')
- *Fbr* = *Fóstr-bróðra saga* ('Saw of the Foster-brothers')

- **Finn** = The Fight at Finnsbury
- **Frost** = *Frostaþings lög* ('Law of the Frost-Thing'), ed. NGL I (pp. 119–258)
- **Fornk** = *Sögu-brot af nokkurum forn-konungum í Dana- ok Svía-veldi* ('Fragment of a Saw from Some Ancient Kings in the Danish and Swedish Realms')
- **Férst** = *Wið Fér-stice* ('Against a Sudden Stitch')
- **Gautr** = *Gaut-reks saga* ('Saw of Geatric')
- **Gldr** = *Glym-drápa* ('Glim-Drape'), Þhorn *Gldr* in SkP 1
- **Ghv** = *Guð-rúnar hvot* ('Instigation of Guthrun')
- **Gr** = *Grettis saga* ('Saw of Grettir')
- **Grg** = *Gróu galdur* ('Galder of Growe')
- **Grip** = *Grípis spó* ('Spae of Griper')
- **Grm** = *Grímnis mál* ('Speeches of Grimner')
- **Grot** = *Grotta söngur* ('Song of Grotte')
- **1 Guðr** = *1 Guð-rúnar kviða* ('First Lay of Guthrun')
- **2 Guðr** = *2 Guð-rúnar kviða* ('Second Lay of Guthrun')
- **3 Guðr** = *3 Guð-rúnar kviða* ('Third Lay of Guthrun')
- **Gula** = *Gulaþings lög* ('Law of the Gole-Thing'), ed. NGL I (pp. 1–118)
- **Gut** = *Guta saga* ('Saw of the Gutes')
- **Gylf** = *Gylfa ginning* ('Beguiling of Yilver')
- **HákGóð** = *Hó-konar saga góða* ('Saw of Hathkin the Good')
- **Hákm** = *Hó-konar mál* ('Speeches of Hathkin'), Eyv *Hák* in SkP 1
- **Hálf** = *Hálfs saga ok Hálfs rekka* ('Saw of Hathwolf and Hathwolf's Champions')
- **Hált** = *Há-leygja tal* ('Tally of the Highlies'), Eyv *Hál* in SkP 1
- **Hamð** = *Ham-ðis mál* ('Speeches of Hamthew')
- **Hárþ** = *Hár-barðs ljóð* ('Leeds of Hoarbeard')
- **Haustl** = *Haust-löng* ('Harvest-Long'), Þjóð *Haustl* in SkP 3
- **Háv** = *Hóva mál* ('Speeches of the High One')
- **Hdl** = *Hyndlu ljóð* ('Leeds of Hindle')

- *Heiðr* = *Her-varar saga ok Heið-reks* ('Saw of Harware and Heathric')
- *Heli* = *Heliand*
- *Helr* = *Hel-reið Bryn-bildar* ('Hell-ride of Byrnhild')
- *HHj* = *Hēlga kviða Hǫr-varðs-sonar* ('Lay of Hallow Harwardson')
- *1 HHund* = *1 Hēlga kviða Hundings-bana* ('First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane')
- *2 HHund* = *2 Hēlga kviða Hundings-bana* ('Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane')
- *Hild* = *Hildebrandslied* ('Lay of Hildbrand')
- *Hrafnk* = *Hrafn-kels saga* ('Saw of Ravenkettle')
- *Húsdr* = *Hús-drápa* ('Drape for a House'), ÚlfrU *Húsdr* in SkP 3
- *Hym* = *Hymis kviða* ('Lay of Hymer')
- *RunIce* = The Icelandic Rune Poem
- *RunNor* = The Norwegian Rune Poem
- *RunOE* = The Old English Rune Poem
- *Il* = Homer's Ἰλιάς (*Iliad*)
- *Ldn* = *Land-náma bók* ('Book of Land-Claims')
- *Lok* = *Loka senna* ('Flyting of Lock')
- *MB<sup>b</sup>* = *Mabáb<sup>b</sup>ārata*
- *Mers* = The Merseburg galders
- *Mbkv* = *Máls-bátta kvæði* ('Poem of Sayings'), Anon *Mbkv* in SkP 3
- *Norn* = *Norna-Gests þáttr* ('Strand of Norn-Guest')
- *Nwyr* = *Nigon wyrta galdor* ('Galder of Nine Worts')
- *Od* = Homer's Ὀδύσσεια (*Odyssey*)
- *Oddr* = *Odd-rúnar grátr* ('Weeping of Ordrun')
- *ProNessia* = *Pro Nessia* ('For Nesse')
- *Rdr* = *Ragnars drápa* ('Drape of Rainer'), Bragi *Rdr* in SkP 3
- *Reg* = *Regins mól* ('Speeches of Rein')
- *R̥V* = *R̥g-vēdā*, with translations from Jamison and Brereton (2014) unless otherwise specified

- *Rþ* = *Rígs þula* ('Thule of Rígh')
- *SaxGen* = Old Saxon Genesis
- *Sigrdr* = *Sigr-drífu mól* ('Speeches of Syedrive')
- *Sigsþ* = *Sig-urðar kvíða in skamma* ('Short Lay of Siward')
- *Ski* = *Skírnis mól* ('Speeches of Shirner')
- *Skm* = *Skald-skapar mól* ('Matter of Scoldship')
- *SKVR* = *Suomen kansan vanhat runot* ('Ancient Songs of the Finnish People')
- *SnE* = *Snorra Edda* ('Snorre's Edda'), the Prose Edda
- *Sól* = *Sólar-ljóð* ('Leeds of the Sun'), Anon *Sól* in SkP 7
- *Sont* = *Sona-tor-rek* ('Grievous Loss of Sons'), Egill *Sont* in SkP 5
- *Sþrla* = *Sþrla þáttur* ('Strand of Sarle')
- *Styrb* = *Styr-bjarnar þáttur Svía-kappa* ('Strand of Stirbern Champion of the Swedes')
- *Theog* = Hesiod's Θεογονία ('*Theogony*, Birth of the Gods'), West (1966) ed.
- *Vafþ* = *Vafþrúðnis mól* ('Speeches of Webthrithner')
- *Vatn* = *Vatns-dóla saga* ('Saw of the Waterdellings')
- *Vkv* = *Völundar kvíða* ('Lay of Wayland')
- *Völs* = *Völsunga saga* ('Saw of the Walsings')
- *Völsa* = *Völsa þáttur* ('Strand of Walse')
- *Völsbr* = *Brot ór Völs* ('Fragments from Völs')
- *Vöþ* = *Völu spó* ('Spae of the Wallow')
- *Wald* = *Wald-þere* ('Walder')
- *Wessobrunn* = The Wessobrunn Hymn
- *Wid* = *Wid-siþ* ('Widsith')
- *Wulf* = *Wulf and Éad-wacer* 'Wolf and Edwaker'
- *Ymbe* = *Wið Ymbe* ('Against a Swarm')
- *Yng* = *Ynglinga saga* ('Saw of the Ingling')
- *Yt* = *Ynglinga tal* ('Tally of the Ingling'), Þjóð *Yt* in SkP 1

- *Æcer* = *Æcer-bót* ('Acre-Boot')
- *Þiðr* = *Þið-reks saga* ('Saw of Thedric')
- *Þdr* = *Þórs drápa* ('Drape of Thunder')
- *Þrk* = *Þryms kviða* ('Lay of Thrim')

### Manuscripts

For the sigla of manuscripts see the introductions to various sections.

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- CV Richard Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (1874). *An Icelandic-English Dictionary*. Oxford: Clarendon Press.
- DI II Jón Porkelsson, ed. (1893). *Diplomatarium Islandicum: Íslenzkt fornbréfasafn*. Vol. 2. 16 vols. Copenhagen: Hið íslenska bókmenntafélag.
- EWA Albert L. Lloyd, Otto Springer, and Rosemarie Lühr (1988–). *Etymologisches Wörterbuch des Althochdeutschen*. Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht.
- FGT 1950 First Grammarian (1950). “First Grammatical Treatise. The Earliest Germanic Phonology.” In: *Language* 26. Ed. by Einar Haugen, pp. 4–64. URL: <http://www.jstor.org/stable/522272>.
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- GP *Gotlandic Picture Stones – The Online Edition* (n.d.). URL: <https://www.gotlandicpicturestones.se>.
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# General Introduction (incomplete!)

## Note

What is this book? It is a book of poems, really, of songs—songs dating to the first millennium AD or some time thereafter. What is their nature? They were sung by the Germanic peoples about their Gods and heroes through Dark Ages, through the fall of Rome and the volcanic winter of 536, in ships and shores of England, in frozen settlements on Iceland and Greenland, in Danish fields, Swedish forests, and Norwegian firths, in English monasteries and the ear of Charlemagne.

Compared to the epic traditions of Classical Antiquity the Germanic songs of heroes do not tell of a very ancient past. On the contrary, many of them concern events documented in contemporary Classical sources far more accurate than these illiterate ballad-singers working centuries after-the-fact could ever aspire to be. But their goal was never historical accuracy. For them the old times were long past; who could faithfully recall them but the High One, the One-Eyed Himself? These were bards and storytellers and prophetesses, keepers of an ancient poetic tradition far predating the subjects with which it dealt. This was a tradition infused with the Indo-European spirit of the unending steppes and the snowcapped mountains, the soaring eagle and the galloping steed. In their stoic fatalism, in their tales of great love and struggle, deprivation and human tragedy, heroic friendship and betrayal, these stories were far older than the more factually correct mediæval chroniclers which chronologically predated them. In this way they were, in their oft rough-hewn simplicity, as old as Homer, as old as the Vedas—or maybe older still.

The Northern epics are the songs the Germanic-speaking West for many centuries forgot. We forgot them when we became just that, Westerners—Christians, Romans. It was Alcuin, the English scholar, who in a letter upbraided his less learned English brethren who would rather sing pagan Saxon songs about Ingeld than the Psalms of David—“what does Ingeld have to do with Christ?” he asked. It was Louis the Pious, king of the Franks, who burned his father Charlemagne’s great collection of German epic poetry. For these new men steeped in Roman learning, whose souls were circumcised, even if their bodies were not, the ethos of the old folk-songs was too warlike, too fatalistic, in a word, too *pagan*.

The echoes of the same stories in time suffered a tragic fate in England and the Continent. The heavily damaged copies written in idioms and hands far too archaic to be understood by later ages were cut up and used for their thick leather as covers for younger, more modern books. And yet measuring fate would not have it that they were, like so many other European pagan traditions, forever lost. It was on Iceland, that northern island outpost on the edge of the known world, where the songs of Gods and heroes lived longest upon the lips of hoary upholders of tradition. It was that most distant offshoot of Germandom, whose unyielding settlers sailed as far as Greenland and North America, which in time came to preserve what the center had lost.

The Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda, the last surviving storehouse of the songs of the Germanic gods, was rediscovered in Iceland in 1642. Together with the Prose Edda it laid the ground for the new field of the study of Germanic antiquity, which over time developed in lockstep with the evolution of Western science and culture in general and that of philology and linguistics in particular. Over the centuries it was joined by the rediscoveries of *Beowulf*, the Exeter Book, *Hildebrandslied*, the Merseburg charms, the Gallehus horns and countless other minor sources.

No work could aim to give a complete overview of all scholarly efforts since the 17th century. The goal of the present edition must only be to provide a small selection of previous insights, together with some new ones, which (it is hoped) may inspire the curiosity of the English-speaking reader and increase his or her understanding and respect for these very important, frequently very difficult texts.

## The historical and cultural context

It is presupposed throughout this book that the Germanic-speaking peoples—the English, Scandinavians, Dutch, Frisians, and Germans—were originally united by much more than their languages alone; that these nations, although greatly splintered by the turns of history, ultimately share not only language, but a common ancestral culture, religion, and origin.

All Germanic languages—like the Romance languages from Latin—ultimately descend from Proto-Germanic. Unlike its contemporary Classical Latin, Proto-Germanic is a reconstructed language attested only in a few borrowed names and short, late runic inscriptions. Still, we have enough data to be able to reconstruct it confidently, and such reconstructions will appear throughout the book.

Proto-Germanic in turn derives from the wholly unattested Proto-Indo-European, from which also spring the Albanian, Armenian, Baltic and Slavic, Celtic, Greek, Italic, and Indo-Iranian tongues along with the now-extinct Anatolian and Tocharian and a likely myriad other now-lost languages. The Germanic branch most likely broke away from its closest known Indo-European linguistic relatives in the early 3rd millennium BC and has developed on its own since, undergoing important changes in its sounds, word-heap, word-order, and grammar.

Around the start of the first millennium AD the Germanic family itself broke apart into three branches: the Northern, Western, and Eastern. Only the first two are presently extant. To the first belong the Scandinavian languages descended from Old Norse; to the second English, Frisian, Dutch, Low and High German (including Yiddish); to the third the extinct Gothic. It is generally held to be the case on the basis of a number of common innovations that Northern and Western branches form a single subclade, Northwest Germanic, to the exclusion of East Germanic (Kim 2024). Since the Wielbark culture, which is probably to be identified with the early ancestors of the Gots, emigrated from Scandinavia around 50 BC, this forms a useful reference point for the time of the splintering of the Germanic language family.

The cultural affinities of the Germanic-speaking peoples are of course greater the further back in time one looks. During the Migration Period there was something of a cultural flow between all Germanic peoples, especially those who were not yet Christianized, as seen both archeologically and in later literary sources like *Wid* (Neidorf 2013). Customs like the husband's "morning-gift" to his wife on the day of their wedding or the twelve-man jury were spread far and wide by these expanding tribes, as was the two-stemmed naming system also found among other Indo-Europeans (in English e.g. Edwin < Old English *Ēad-wine* < Proto-Germanic *\*Auda-winiz* 'Friend of Wealth').

Nor were these affinities entirely lost on the tribes themselves. Both Gots and Longbeards (i.e., Lombards) remembered their old homeland of Scandinavia and many of the related tribes living there (Jordanes, *Getica* 10, 16–25; *Origo Gentis Langobardorum* 1, edited under the appendix to *Grm*); the Anglo-Saxons, too, never forgot that they had come from Northern Germany and Jutland (Gretzinger et al. 2022), nor that there were still related people living there (Neidorf 2013, pp. 173–176).

As for the religion, the worship of many Gods (the Eese, ON *Ƿsir*, OE *ēse*, Gothic *Ansis* in Jordanes, *Getica* 78, 79; cf. *Hamð* 25/1 n.) is attested throughout the historical and geographic range of the Germanic peoples, as are the use of sacred rings (the Gothic 'holy' ring of Pietroassa (Antonsen 2002, p. 280; MacLeod and Mees 2006, pp. 173–174), cf. Ambrose of Milan's letter 10:9 which suggests the wearing of bracelets by Gothic priests (Capelle 2010, p. 425); *Háv* 110, *Hild* 32), animal sacrifices, and certain forms of ritual warfare (*Vsp* 23 n.). Also widely attested is the worship of the gods Woden, Ing, and Thunder, the former of whom appears in His name Geat at the head of both Gothic and Anglo-Saxon genealogies (*Hamð* 25/1 n.).

Turning to shared ancestry, recent genetic advances have shown that the lines of linguistic expansion line up with signals of genetic kinship, and have in effect confirmed what earlier scholars of the 19th and early 20th centuries presumed, namely that speakers of related languages always ultimately descend, to greater or lesser degree, from a single group of speakers of a proto-language.

What the genetics show us is that the Germanic peoples originate in Northern Europe, chiefly Scandinavia and Northern Germany, and that the speakers of Proto-Germanic were genetically indistinguishable from mod-

ern indigenous Scandinavians. They in turn derived much of their ancestry from the early Indo-Europeans of the Pontic-Caspian steppe, who mixed with Early European Farmers to the west to form the Corded Ware Culture, which over time expanded in all directions (McColl et al. 2024).

In the West this early Indo-European culture formed the Bell Beakers who conquered Ireland and Iberia; in the South it formed the Italic peoples who eventually became the Romans; in the East it formed the Sintashta culture, or Proto-Indo-Iranians, whose descendants became the Iranians and Vedic Indians who founded the Zoroastrian and Vedic religions; in the North-east it formed the Balts and Slavs; and in Scandinavia it formed the Battle Axe and Single Grave cultures which eventually gave way to the Nordic Bronze Age, the ancestors of the Germanic peoples.

In all cases, including Scandinavia, the expansion of the Indo-Europeans was that of a warlike and patriarchal culture not unlike its later descendants, whether Roman or Germanic. Indeed, present-day native Scandinavians, who are largely the direct biological descendants of the Nordic Bronze Age, carry almost no ancestry from the Stone Age Scandinavian Hunter Gatherers that preceded them (Allentoft et al. 2024).

Although the genes for light eyes and hair colour were present already on the Pontic-Caspian steppe, it was in the later Corded Ware that the heavy selection for these traits was effected (Wilde et al. 2014; Ju and Mathieson 2021; Perretti et al. 2025), traits which to this day reach their highest frequency in Northern Europe (Frost 2006).

## Germanic alliterative poetry

The historical and literary significance of the poetry in this edition may be thought of in two ways: as the beginning of documented Germanic literature and also as the last stage of an ancient oral tradition with distant Indo-European roots.

On the one hand, alliterative verse is the medium for the oldest indigenous Germanic-language literary monuments (the Gothic literature, chiefly consisting of Wulfila's translation of the Bible, being wholly foreign in origin). It is our earliest native source of knowledge about the Iron Age folk-life of Northern Europe and our most important source for the pre-Christian Germanic religion; it represents the worldview of the Germanic peoples in their earliest historical stages. As the earliest recorded medium for the transmission of song and story amongst the ancestors of numerous great nations it has to some extent influenced all later Germanic languages and literatures. The alliterative poetry, albeit together with Latin, Greek, and Hebrew models, laid the ground for the German *Minnessänger*, the *Nibelungenlied*, and Chaucer, which in turn precede such great writers as Goethe, Wagner, and Shakespeare.

On the other hand, this poetic genre is hardly a new art-form by the time we first encounter it in manuscript form in the 7th century Cadman's Hymn, nor is its characteristic feature, alliteration between initial sounds.



In the 1st century AD Tacitus (*Germania* 2) speaks shortly of the ‘ancient songs’ in which the Germani documented their mythology and history. He mentions the myth of three brothers, the sons of *Mannus* ‘Man’, who founded three tribes, the *Ingaevones*, *Herminones* and *Istaevones*. In their Proto-Germanic forms the names of the three tribes all begin with a vowel, and this is thus the earliest secure example of alliteration.

Tacitus may also give us the earliest example of the Germanic long-line, the same meter as *Beow* and the Poetic Edda, when he (*Germania* 40) lists the following tribes as worshipping *Nerthus*: *Reudigni*, *Aviones*, *Anglii*, *Varini*, *Eudoses*, *Suardones*, *Nuithones*. If *Nuithones* is emended to *\*Unithones*, which unlike *Nuithones* actually looks like a Germanic word, the list may be arranged into two long-lines, both with vowel-alliteration (Malone 1934; Malone 1936):

*Reudigni, Aviones, · Anglii, Varini,*  
*Eudoses, Suardones, · \*Unithones.*

A more secure example of the same phenomenon is found in the 2nd century, when Ptolemy (*Geography* 2, 11:7) lists the following tribes on the Cimbrian peninsula: *Saxones*, *Sigulones*, *Sabalingii*, *Cobandi*, *Chali*, *Phunusii*, *Charudes*. This example has the advantage of not requiring any emendation, and forms two clean long-lines with typical alliterative patterns (a a : a x, a x : a [x]) (Malone 1936; Neidorf 2013, p. 179):

*Saxones, Sigulones, · Sabalingii, Cobandi,*  
*Chali, Phunusii, · Charudes.*

The most likely explanation for these early alliterations is rather straightforward: the Germanic informers recited the tribes in the order they had learnt them, namely as alliterative lists or *rigamaroles* not unlike what we find in later texts like *Wid* or the Icelandic poetic lists, the so-called *pulur* ‘thules’ (Malone 1936).

The earliest indisputable native attestations of the long-line are in runic inscriptions from the early centuries AD, the oldest of which is an early 3rd century sword-chape from Thorsberg moor in Schleswig. These inscription are edited in the pres. ed. under Runic Poetry.

In these finds we see not just the fully formed long-line but also examples of stylistic traits common to all later Germanic alliterative poetry. Thus the 5th century Tjurkö bracteate (DR IK184) calls gold *walþa-kurné* (dat. sg.) ‘Roman grain’, a kenning-like reference to the melting of Roman solidi; the 3rd century Thorsberg chape (DR 7) expresses being ‘famous’ with the litotes *ni waje-márir* ‘not ill-famed’ (cf. *Akv* 13/1); and the 6th century Noleby stone (Vg 63) mirrors the formula *rúnó ragína-kundó* (acc. sg.) ‘rune born of the Gods’ later found in the 9th century *Hǫva mól*, st. 80.

Of course, a far greater trove of rich expressions and images, many of great antiquity, is found in the extensive corpus of poetry written in mediaeval manuscripts. In *Beow* and the Edda ‘sea-stallions’ sail across the ocean like in Homer; in *Grm* 38 the sun is drawn across Heaven in her chariot like in *RV*

and the Trundholm Sun Chariot; in *Beow*, *Heli*, *Akv* and other poems feasts are held in great chiefly 'mead-halls', not unknown from the archæology of the Nordic Bronze and Iron Ages.

The richness of the poetic tradition is expressed through a language of kennings, stock phrases and exclusive synonyms found only in poetry. Many of these synonyms are quite ancient, being Indo-European words otherwise extinct in all Germanic languages which find their last refuge in poetry. Such are the Old English *eoh*, Old Norse *jór*, corresponding to the Sanskrit *áśva*, Latin *equus*, all meaning 'horse'; Old Norse *týr*, corresponding to Sanskrit *dēvā*, Latin *deus*, all meaning 'god'; Old English *folde*, Old Norse *fold*, corresponding to Sanskrit *pr<sup>th</sup>ivī*, all meaning 'land, (mother) earth'. The fact that many of these relate to the cult perhaps suggests that the Germanic religion was not as innovative as is commonly supposed.

What a comparative investigation reveals is thus that these poetic motifs and words are seldom uniquely mediæval, nor even inventions of the first centuries AD; instead they time and time again find parallels in texts and archaeological finds as old as the Bronze Age. The poems themselves are clearly much younger than this, but still not so young that their undoubtedly unlatinized authors could have been influenced by texts like the *Iliad*, which were still yet unknown in Northern Europe. Rather, they seem to retain ancient traditions which must have been passed down through an unbroken chain of poetry going back far into prehistory, to when the Indo-Europeans were still nomadic steppe-pastoralists and much of Europe was still covered by thick forest and marshlands.

## Structure

To describe the structure of Germanic alliterative poetry it is first necessary to describe the general characteristics of the common Germanic alliterative meter as found in the earliest runic inscriptions, West Germanic poetry, and Norse Eddic poetry in the meter Ancient-words-law. The following description is thus not exhaustive, but does describe the bulk of the corpus.

Alliterative poetry has two primary structural elements: *stress* and *alliteration*. The exact count of syllables is less important, and end-rhyme is only used as a sporadic flourish.

Based on alliteration, words are grouped into *lines*.

## Stress

Each syllable is classed as having primary stress (p), secondary stress (s), or no stress (x). Syllables with p and s are stressed syllables, those with x are unstressed syllables.

Primary stress is reserved for the root syllable in a word, which is not always the same as the first syllable. Compare the English word *beginning*, where the stress pattern is xPx; the primary stress falls on the syllable *ginn*-. Note that not all primary stresses are equal; the general rule is that nouns and adjectives have stronger stress than verbs.

Secondary stress falls on the second element in a compound word, e.g. *hēimr* in *jōtun-hēimr* ‘Ettin-ham’.

No stress falls on inflectional syllables, pronouns and prepositions. The exception for pronouns and prepositions is that they can take primary stress if it coincides with semantic stress, e.g. in a statement like “It was *you!*”, or when a preposition is placed after the noun it modifies (e.g. *Beow* 19b: *Scēdelandum in* ‘in the Northern lands’).

### Alliteration

Alliteration is the resonance between two stressed syllables beginning with the same phoneme, e.g. *sand* with *receive*, or *great* with *begin*.

Any vowel or diphthong can alliterate with any other vowel or diphthong. *s* and the clusters *sk*, *sp* and *st* are counted as four distinct “sounds”.

Further, in West Germanic poetry, *g* and *j* can alliterate with each other.

In Norse poetry *j* and *v* can alliterate with vowels, the former always, the latter sporadically.

In the present edition alliterating sounds are marked with red font.

### Positions

The smallest metrical division is the *position*, a concept related but not identical to the syllable. The position must be understood as broader than the syllable as several syllables can fill one position, whereas a single syllable can never fill multiple positions.

A short syllable followed by another syllable can resolve into a single position. Likewise several unstressed syllables can count as a single position.

### Verses

A *verse* or *half-line* is made up of 4 positions—typically 2 stressed, 2 unstressed—arranged according to set patterns. These patterns form the core of Sievers’ description of alliterative poetry, and is the description followed here.

TODO: Sieversian types.

### Lines

2 verses are linked together by shared alliteration to form a couplet or *long-line* (often simply *line*). They are separated by a short pause or *cæsura*.

It is not uncommon for editions of Old Norse poetry to print each verse on its own line, e.g. *Vsp* 2/1-2:

Ek man *j*ōtna  
 ár of borna,  
 þá’s forðum mik  
 fōdda hofðu;

Editions of West Germanic poetry typically print each long-line on its own line separated by a space to designate the *cæsura*:

Ek man jǫtna      ár of borna,  
þá's forðum mik      fǫdda hǫfðu;

The present edition follows the latter convention for all alliterative poetry, Norse or West Germanic, but replaces the space with the interpunct:

Ek man jǫtna · ár of borna,  
þá's forðum mik · fǫdda hǫfðu;

The first verse (or *a-verse*) may have 1 or 2 alliterations, with preference for alliteration on its first position over the second.

The second verse (or *b-verse*) must have exactly 1 alliteration, almost always on its first stressed position.

### Fits and stanzas

The long-line is the highest metrical division, but long-lines can be combined into complete poems according to either a *stichic* or *stanzaic* manner.

West Germanic poetry is typically *stichic*. This means that long-lines simply follow one other, often with enjambment, so that a new sentence begins in the b-verse.

In longer epic poems lines may be grouped into *fits* which are sections or cantos. The fit does not have a fixed length, but is generally around 70–85 lines long. The 3182-line *Beow* is divided into 42 numbered fits for an average of 76 lines per fit; the surviving 5983 lines of *Heli* are divided into 71 for an average of 84 lines per fit. It is probably not a coincidence that the length of the fit is similar to the length of shorter legendary poems like *3 Guðr* or *Hild*.

In *Heli* a new fit can begin on a b-verse. This does not happen in *Beow*.

North Germanic poetry is always more or less *stanzaic* and does not have fits. Each *stanza* consists of several long-lines, and enjambment is rare. The regularity of the stanzas varies by poem and meter, but there is a general trend towards stanzas of exactly 4 lines.

In 4-line stanzas there is generally a semantic division between lines 2 and 3; each group of 2 lines (4 verses) form a *helming* or *half-stanza*.

### The corpus

The scope of the present corpus is large, and encompasses most of the alliterative poetry extant in Old Germanic languages. The poetry is divided into the following categories:

1. **Norse Mythic poetry**, i.e., that which directly treats the Germanic mythology. This category is exclusively Norse for the simple reason that no West Germanic or Gothic mythic narrative poetry survive.
2. **Norse Heroic poetry**, specifically the whole second half of the Codex Regius and then a few other works. With a few exceptions, subject matter outside of the Walsing cycle is not included.

3. **West Germanic Heroic Poetry** in Old English, Old Saxon, and Old High German.
4. **Poetry on Christian subjects.** This category includes explicitly Christian poems where the new religion or its mythology is at the core of the work. Christian heroic poems depicting native legends, like *Beow* and *Hild*, are not included.
5. **Galders**, i.e., alliterative spells and charms, both from runic inscriptions and mediæval manuscripts.
6. **Runic Poetry**, apart from that already edited under Galders above.

### Exclusions

All Norse Scaldic poetry is excluded, as is the Eddic poetry found in the Saws of Icelanders and Saws of Antiquity (*forn-aldar sögur*). Three reasons justify this exclusion. First, these two categories of poetry have already been edited by the SkP series, in the case of the Scaldic poetry admirably so. Second, the underlying poetry is often impossible to take out of its prose context. Third, it is doubtful whether most of the Eddic poetry embedded in prose contexts ever had a life of its own or whether it was composed along with the prose. For these reasons I would only edit the poetry in its original context, that is, edit the whole Saws, which is an undertaking that falls far outside of the scope of the present edition as an edition of Eddic poetry.

Most non-legendary Old English poems are excluded. This includes poems on historical subjects embedded in the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, the *Riddles of the Exeter Book*, and the Biblical epics.

### Manuscripts

See the introduction to each category.

### Old English poetry

The edited Old English poetry primarily derives from a few manuscripts. Particularly important are the Exeter Book (E) and *Lâcn*.

### Old Saxon and High German poetry

There are no collections or anthologies of alliterative poetry in these languages; instead the manuscript situation will be discussed in the introduction to each individual text.

### Dating

Ways of dating poetry, which naturally differ greatly for each text and tradition, will be brought up in the respective introductions to sections or poems as seen fit.

The general methodology for dating adopted by the present edition is however one that prioritises linguistic criteria rather than literary analysis or vague historical speculation. It has been shown for both the Eddic (TODO: cite Males) and Old English poetic traditions (TODO: cite Neidorf Dating of Beowulf) that mediæval scribes did not possess the necessary linguistic knowledge to produce archaizing poetry, or even to reproduce metrically required archaic features (e.g. the consonant cluster *vr-* in ON, for which see *Háv* 26/2 n.), and a text that displays linguistic features belonging to a certain century is thus taken to have been composed during that century. In this way the present methodology aligns closer with that upheld by scholars like Finnur Jónsson, R. D. Fulk, Leonard Neidorf, and Mikael Males and differs from that of Klaus von See or the “Toronto school” of Beowulf.

## The presentation of the text

The present edition is divided into two equally large parts, presented side by side. Each stanza or group of verse lines is presented first in the original language, and immediately below in English translation. In the right margin is a list of manuscript witnesses for the particular passage. Below the English translation are two layers of notes. The first contains critical notes, and the second contains all other notes and commentary. Broader commentary or particularly important critical notes are linked to ALL, while more specific notes are linked to separate lines and lemmas.

## The Old Germanic text

The present edition encompasses texts in four Old Germanic languages: Old Norse, Old English, Old Saxon, and Old High German. All texts have been normalized according to the author’s standardised orthography for the respective language. The orthographies are designed to follow three core principles:

1. A faithfulness to the spoken language at the time when the texts were written, and the distinctions demonstrably found therein.
2. A respect for the etymological origin of words, and their distinctions.
3. A striving for a uniform orthography across the various languages, so that the same sound, where possible, should be written with the same character.

These choices often stand in conflict with the orthography of the original manuscripts and with most earlier philological tradition, whence there is some reason to justify them. My goal is to render the texts themselves in a manner that gives as much philological information to the reader as possible—not to present a facsimile edition for students of paleography. This follows the philological methods used for printing e.g. the *RV*, which is generally printed in an entirely scholarly latinized orthography, not the original

*Devanāgarī*. Regardless, such important traits of the original manuscript tradition as the long *f*, arbitrary punctuation, arbitrary spelling, and lack of line breaks, are seldom reproduced in modern editions of Old Germanic poetry.

### General orthographic conventions

The following orthographic conventions are applied for all Old Germanic languages:

1. The voiceless dental fricative is always written with the letter *þ*, never *th*.
2. Long vowels are marked with the acute accent, never the macron or circumflex;
3. Excepting those long vowels which have their origin in earlier diphthongs, which are written with the circumflex.
4. In compounds where the first element has primary stress the elements are separated with a dash (-);
5. But where the first element is a preposition or unstressed prefix they are separated with an interpunct (·).
6. Non-inflectional suffixes and derivations are marked with a double oblique hyphen (=).

Below follow specifications for each specific language.

### Normalization of Old Norse

My Old Norse orthography is inspired by Finnur Jónsson (1932) in that it strives for a more archaic form than that of the surviving mss.; a form that instead represents the poetry as it may (in many cases, must) originally have looked. For this reason, it often has more in common with the proposed orthography of the First Grammatical Treatise than with the standard Old Icelandic orthography seen in most editions. The following list describes the differences from the standard Old Icelandic orthography:

1. I distinguish between short *e* (from etymological short *e*) and short *ę* (from etymological short *a* + *i*-umlaut).
2. I distinguish between long *á* and *ǫ́*, as done by the First Grammatical Treatise.
3. I use *ó* and *ę́* rather than the usual *œ* and *æ*, to represent the vowels descended from Proto-Norse *ó* and *ǫ́* after *i*-umlaut (cf. the short *ø*, *ę* < *o*, *a* + *i*-umlaut).
4. I distinguish long nasal *ǎ*, *ę́*, *ǫ́*, *ú* from long oral *á*, *ę́*, *í*, *ó*, *ú*, as done in the First Grammatical Treatise.

5. I restore the old *s* (which in modern Scandinavian and even in most Old Norse manuscripts has become *r*, but which is found in old manuscripts such as AM 237 a fol (c. 1150) and fossilized in forms like *þaz* (i.e., *þat*ʒ) in **R**) in the words *es* ‘which, that, where, when’, and in inflections of *vesa* (later *vera*) such as *es* ‘is’ (3rd sg. pres. ind.) and *vas* (3rd sg. pret. ind.). The following forms of *vesa* retain the *r*, as it is there the result of Verner’s law, and not of this (much younger) sound change: the pl. pres. ind. (*erum* etc.), the pl. pret. ind. (*vörum* etc.), and the pl. pret. subj. (*vérim* etc.)
6. When metrically benefactor, I contract *ek* ‘I’, *eru* ‘are’, and *es* ‘which; is’ to *’k*, *’ro* and *’s*, respectively.
7. I resolve *z* to *ts*, *ds*, *þs* or *ðs* depending on its underlying elements;
8. *x* is however still used instead of *ks*;
9. I follow Finnur Jónsson (1932) in distinguishing between the relative particle *es* and the verb *es*: the particle is appended to the previous word with only an apostrophe (e.g. *þann’s* ‘he who’), while the verb is separated by a space (e.g. *þann s* ‘he is’).
10. Where metrically beneficent personal pronouns are removed, often silently (cf. Scaldic poetry, *Vkv* 21/1–2 vs. 23/3–4, 1 *HHund* 32 vs. 2 *HHund* 18)

### Normalization of Old Swedish and Danish

I generally employ the same conventions as those described for Old Norse above, including the marking of *u*-mutated *a* > *ø*. That this indeed occurred in the Eastern Nordic dialects is most proven by the third-person personal pronoun, which shows *u*-mutation in such forms as Swedish *honom* ‘him’ < *hōnum*, *hon* ‘she’ < *hōn*).

A few changes are specific to OSwe and ODan. According to rule 3 in the general orthographic conventions above, I distinguish between *ó* (< *ō*) vs. *ø* (< *au*, *ey*), *é* (< *ē*) vs. *ê* (< *ēi*).

Where all unstressed vowels have been reduced to a schwa-like sound, this is written with *e*.

### Normalization of Old English

I spell fronted or brightened etymological *a* and *á* with *æ* and *ǣ*, for instance in *dæg* ‘day’ (< *\*dagar*) and *rǣd* ‘advice, counsel’ (< *ráðar*). These are contrasted with *ē* and *ǣ*, which represent *i*-mutated *a* and *á*, e.g. in *ellen* ‘zeal, courage’ (< *\*aljanā*).

An assimilated *n* is marked with an overpoint, like in rule 3 of Old Norse above.



## Normalization of Old Saxon

## Normalization of Old High German

## The English translation

There is now a very large number of translations of the most popular alliterative poetic texts, namely *Beow* and the *Poetic Edda*. These generally fall into two camps:

1. *poetic* translations, which distort the precise meaning of the text for the sake of meter, often quite radically; and
2. *prose* translations, which nowise preserve the style or feeling of the original.

Almost all translations, of both types, also tend toward the following inadequacies: obscuring or glossing over difficult technical and cultural terminology; rendering identically repeated phrases and words (formulae) differently at various places; and simplifying or rewriting kennings and other poetic expressions. Even worse this is often done with little in the way of notes or commentary, to a point where the reader is sometimes left entirely oblivious to the sense of the original text.

What sets my translation apart from previous English translations is that it aims to follow the style and register of the original text closely, without sacrificing the literal sense of the words, e.g., by removing or inserting matter where it is not present in the original. The downside of this is that literality and consistency at times must come at the cost of fluid idiomatic English, but it has the advantage of giving the reader a good idea not just of *what* the original text says, but *how* it says it. The reader should keep in mind that he is venturing in a foreign land, that he is reading ancient and obscure words—not *The New York Times* or *The Guardian*.

Maybe this over-literality is a pointless effort? One could argue that a translation always is a betrayal, and that those truly interested in the exact sense of every word in the original text should study it in its original language. While I do agree that the sufficiently interested reader should learn the languages in which these texts were written (something greatly helped by the present parallel edition, with its notes and clear orthography), it is still a “hard ask” for those readers who are not philologically or linguistically inclined, but instead students and scholars of history, comparative mythology, religion, anthropology, or literature—those who, for whatever reason, are interested in exploring the oldest poetic heritage of the Germanic peoples of Northern Europe.

## The proper nouns

The single most idiosyncratic part of the present translation will undoubtedly be its handling of proper nouns. I have opted to render all cultural and religious terms, names of places, heroes, gods, and other entities by their natural

English cognates (e.g., *Thunder* for Old Norse *Þórr*); and, where such do not exist, by their philologically expected English (so-called “Anglish”) forms (e.g., *\*wallow* for Old Norse *völva*). Due to the parallel original-language edition and index, it is hoped that no vital information will be lost by this decision; the reader wishing to know the original form of Webthrithner can either look in the Old Norse, or, if the case endings confuse him, peruse the index.

There are three reasons behind this choice. The first is ideological. It is my belief that the Old Germanic myths and poems and gods and heroes are a shared Northern European heritage. When one compares these mediæval texts from Germany, England, and Scandinavia, one cannot but notice the striking similarity of their diction, the reoccurrence of figures and formulae, and the common worldview. Likewise, the personages are frequently the same: the Scandinavian hero *Völundr* is the same character as the English *Wēlund*, the Norse god *Óðinn* is the same as the English *Wōden*, and this is how they were understood by the native speakers of the old tongues. Since English is a Germanic language and its speakers the linguistic heirs of the Anglo-Saxons and Norse—in many case their direct descendants—and since these varying names are ultimately mere distinctions in pronunciation which reflect shared underlying forms, it was felt important and valuable to render them in the English translation by their natural or expected English reflexes. The forms of the names thereby serve to reflect the continuity between the speakers of modern English and those of the Old Germanic languages.

The second reason is one of consistency. If we are to restore well-attested names like Weden and Thunder, it would not be consistent to retain others in an unadapted form (e.g., to have Weden conversing with *Vafþrúðnir*, or Thunder with *Hárbarðr*), which would produce a highly discordant effect. Since the English names are to be restored in some places, consistency requires that they be restored in all, even where they do not survive in modern English (or even in Old English).

The third reason is one of linguistic aesthetics. It is an indisputable fact that the commonly accepted forms like *Odin*, *Thor*, *Midgard* etc. are debased. They do not even represent the Old Norse pronunciation as accurately as would be possible within the constraints of English orthography (e.g., *Oðin* would be better anglicized as *Othin*). What is more, they are often difficult for English speakers to pronounce and lead to absurd errors and mispronunciations. The fluent reader of Old Norse cannot but shudder when he hears *ǣsir* and *ǿs-garðr* pronounced as /aɪˈsɪr/ and “ass-guard”, or when he sees *Jǫrmun-gandr* spelled “Jormangander”. The native English forms, on the other hand, fit well within English orthography, and their pronunciation is immediately recognisable.

# Introduction to Eddic Poetry

The following two sections (Norse Mythic Poetry and Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle) contain the bulk of preserved Old Norse Eddic poetry, most of which is preserved in only one manuscript, **R**. For this reason some notes about Eddic Poetry in general are in order.

## Character

Old Norse poetry is conventionally divided into two categories: the Eddic and the Scaldic.

Eddic poetry is anonymous, composed in one of three meters (Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter, Speeches-meter), and free from regular assonance or end-rhyme. It is easy to understand, uses kennings sparsely, and generally deals with heroic or mythological subjects.

By contrast, Scaldic poetry is usually attributed to named poets, is composed in a greater variety of meters (which apart from the three Eddic meters include the exclusively Scaldic Lay-meter and Court-spoken meter), and employs regular assonance or end-rhyme. It revels in purposeful obscurity by making great use of complex kennings and circumlocutions, and usually deals with historical or biographical subjects. It typically serves as praise poetry for a living king or other chieftain.

Although this categorization is not explicitly made in any Norse primary source, it is not entirely a philological construct, for it is clearly observed in *SnE*. In the first book, *Gylf*, we find almost exclusively citations made from Eddic poems (68 out of 70 sts.) while the second book, *Skm*, has the inverse distribution (TODO).

## Dating

Since Eddic poetry represents a mostly unified genre in a single language, it is useful to discuss some recent scholarly advancements in how this type of poetry can be dated. Dating the original time of composition is important, since it allows us to tell whether the religious or cultural ideas in these texts do in fact represent the views—indeed, the very words—of Germanic Heathens,

or whether they are the recollections—in the worst case, the fantasies—of Christian antiquarians.

Before we discuss the dating, we must, however, clarify what we mean by a *poem*. We shall assume that the poems exist as authorial works independent of their manuscript form, that is, that a copy of a given poem in a certain manuscript represents a single written documentation of a poem, but is not synonymous or to be conflated with the poem itself. The poem was composed as a single work by a single author; it can exist in multiple copies, and has most likely been transmitted both orally and scribally. On the other hand, scribes make errors, and are not authors in their own right (Males 2023b; Males 2024a; Haukur Þorgeirsson 2020). Even if they were, it is the primary goal of the present work to attempt get back to the wording of the original authors, be they Heathen or Christian, for it is due to *them* alone that these texts fascinate us so much more than the contemporary output of the same scribes.

The ways of dating Eddic poetry can be divided into two categories. External ways of dating rely on circumstances outside of the poems themselves. These are citations in securely dateable texts, the lifetimes of the original authors or other documented circumstances of composition, and the dates of the individual manuscripts. Unfortunately, the bulk of Eddic poetry is not cited in any texts older than Snorre's Edda (composed ca. 1220); we have no surviving information about the original authors nor the compositional circumstances (beyond the attributed Greenlandish origin of *Akv* and *Am*); and even if we were able to use scribal characteristics to trace the origins of certain poems back to the very beginning of Icelandic vernacular scribal tradition—and Iceland is where all surviving Eddic manuscripts were produced—that tradition does not commence until the 12th century, which post-dates the time of conversion by over a century.

Internal ways of dating instead rely on the language, meter, allusions, and ideas of the poems themselves, and it is in these ways that the chief scholarly advancements of the last few decades have occurred. These criteria can also allow us to distinguish different layers within a given poem. For example, we can say that the Dwarf-tallies, *Vsp* 11–15, are later inserts into that poem.

To pinpoint the absolute date of when a certain linguistic or metrical change has occurred we require some external reference point, but, fortunately, this is found in the Scaldic corpus, which unlike the Eddic corpus is largely ascribed to named authors working within clear historical contexts. It turns out that the Scaldic poems ascribed to the oldest poets likewise show the greatest concentration of archaic traits, and that some of these traits only occur in poems composed before certain dates. Comparison with Scaldic poetry is therefore our best bet to date the Eddic corpus. A landmark study in this direction is Sapp (2022), which, although certainly not perfect, has generally been favourably received, and shown that fruitful results can be obtained at scale from applying linguistic dating criteria derived from Scaldic poetry to Eddic.

The most important linguistic criteria are the alliteration between etymological *vr-* and *v-* rather than *r-* (pointing to composition before ca. 1000

AD, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2017), the use of *of* in prenominal positions analogous to West Germanic *ga-* (pointing to composition before ca. 1030 AD, Males 2025b), the frequency of the particle *of* in prenominal or preverbal positions analogous to West Germanic *ga-* (a trait strongly correlated with *vr-*, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 54), the frequency of syntactical V2 violations in Ancient-words-law (a trait correlated with other early features, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2012), and the use of metrically required hiatus forms like *sáa*, *fríi*, *séi* (pointing to composition before ca. 1150 AD). In addition to these, the forms of certain individual words (e.g. *haufuð* for *hofuð*, \**Sig-vörðr* for *Sig-urðr*, *ffl* for *fflð*) can also point to an earlier date.

When it comes to content-based criteria the applicability varies greatly from poem to poem. Such criteria may be divided into two categories: internal criteria, such as religious, cultural, and archeological conceptions, and external criteria, viz. intertextual allusions and borrowings from other texts. These can hardly all be discussed at once, but a notable example of an internal criterion is the use of pagan god-names. It has been shown that the use of pagan kennings (e.g. *Hákm* 8/3: *Óðins veðr* ‘Weden’s storm [BATTLE]’) diminishes drastically in Scaldic poetry immediately following the conversion of Iceland in 1000 AD, and only rises in frequency with the antiquarian revival in the middle of the 12th century (Males 2020, pp. 39–94). Likewise, no Scaldic poetry with mythological subjects appears to have been composed during the 11th century.

This observation can be qualified further: while the names of gods like *Njprðr* ‘Nearth’ and *Ullr* ‘Wolder’ remain in use in kennings after conversion, not a single dateable Scaldic stanza composed after 1000 AD uses the name *Óðinn* ‘Weden’ in a kenning of any type, nor indeed in any other way save explicitly condemning the god. This is not the case for synonyms for Weden like *Yggr* ‘Ug (= Weden)’, and so it seems that there was a unique concern, not to say fear, about using the name Weden in particular. Of course, Scaldic poetry has different purposes to Eddic poetry, and it makes far more sense for a 12th century antiquarian poet to insert the god Weden into his own heroic Eddic composition than for an 11th century praise-poet to mention the god in his pious eulogy for a Christian Norwegian king. Even so, it seems likely that little poetry containing this particular name would have been composed in the period intervening between the conversion and the antiquarian revival. Therefore, a heroic poem which shows both old linguistic features and the presence of this theonym likely must be quite old.

This illustrates the important point that content-based criteria must always be considered critically alongside linguistic traits. We should not label poems late out of hand simply because they, for instance, portray pre-Christian gods in a humorous fashion (e.g. *Hárb*, *Lok*), nor should the presence of an archaic archeological object like the ring-sword (*HHj* 9, *Sigsk* 68) make us conclude that the poem itself must go back to the Migration Period, when such swords were in active use. We cannot assume that pre-Christian poets never depicted the gods humorously (indeed, both *Il* and *RV* do, and they are undoubtedly pre-Christian), nor that a 12th century antiquarian poet could not have known about ring-swords even if he himself had not

personally seen them. In such cases, the linguistic evidence must take precedence.

To illustrate the methodology plainly, I wish to conclude with two complementary examples of content-based and linguistic criteria working together. When the term “burned” is used as a neutral synonym for “dead” in *Háv* 71/3, 81/1—a poem which also features prenominal *of* and *vr*—it should be taken as a sign of pre-Christian composition, since cremation was a strong taboo in the post-conversion period (Males 2024b, pp. 93–96). Inversely, when *Am*—a poem displaying the sound change *vr*- > *r*- and a very low occurrence of preverbal *of*—links cremation to stoning as a severe punishment befitting an evil woman (a practice belonging to Judeo-Christian religion) and mentions Greenlandish fauna like polar bears, it clearly shows itself to be a late poem composed after the conversion to Christianity and the settlement of Greenland (both ca. 1000 AD).

## Manuscripts

### Codex Regius (R)

By far the most important manuscript of Norse Eddic Poetry is GKS 2365 4to (siglum **R**), the so-called Codex Regius. It dates to around 1270 and consists of 45 surviving foll., containing 29 poems. **R** is fragmentary, however, and would originally have consisted of 53 foll.; see below.

**R** ought properly to be divided into two parts or sections: the first, on foll. 1–20, contains 11 poems (*Vǫsp–Grm*, *Skí–Alv*) dealing chiefly with mythology; the second, on foll. 20–45, contains 18 poems (*1 HHund–Ghv*) dealing with heroic legend from the Walsing cycle. Distinct scribal and orthographic characteristics show that these two parts have been copied from two separate source manuscripts, likely by the scribe of **R** itself (Lindblad 1980, esp. pp. 160–163). Their distinct origin is supported by the characteristic that **R** introduces the first poem in each part, *Vǫsp* and *1 HHund*, with a particularly large initial (Lindblad 1980, p. 166).

If we are to look for relatives of these two source manuscripts, it seems likely that **A**, described below, is a collection of mythological poems of the same kind as that underlying the first half of **R**. Likewise, a manuscript closely related to the heroic half of **R** has clearly served as the main source for large swathes of the younger *Vǫls*.

**R** is not a mere anthology of poems, but shows substantial editorial input in the form of prose segments, likely accumulated over time. A short prose section (*Lok* P1) ties two of the mythological poems together into a loose overarching narrative, though it is clear from their meter, style, and language that they are separate works composed by various poets over time. When it comes to the heroic poems long prose segments occur both within and between them, creating a saw-like prosimetrical form where the prose sometimes comes to dominate the poetry. The two long prose segments 2 *Guðr* P1 and *Brot* P1–1 *Guðr* P1 are often edited as separate works.

As noted above, a large gap famously occurs in the heroic half, the so-called Great Lacuna. Between foll. 32 and 33 one quire, consisting of 8 foll., has gone missing (Lindblad 1977, 6 n. 2). Its contents are mostly unknown, but it would at least have included the end of *Sigrdr* and the beginning of *Brot*, alongside other now-lost poems or prosimetra linking together these two poems. Some of the stanzas likely contained in the Lacuna may be restored from citations in *Vǫls*, and these are edited under *Vǫlsbr*.

### AM 748 I a 4to (A)

Second in importance stands AM 748 I a 4to (siglum A). It dates to around 1300 and is in fragmentary state, consisting of just 6 foll. The beginning and end are absent, and between foll. 2 and 3 there is a lacuna, so that at least 3 (but probably more) foll. are missing.

A contains seven poems. On 1r–2v are found in succession the latter half of *Hárþ*, the full *Bdr*, and the first half of *Skí*. There is then the lacuna—Finnur Jónsson guesses that just one fol. is missing—and on 3r–6v are found in succession most of *Vafþ*, all of *Grm* and *Hym*, and the introductory prose to *Vkv*. Among mediæval mss., *Bdr* is only attested in A, while the other six poems are also found in the first, mythological, half of R. The order of the poems varies drastically between A and R.

A has no trace of R's frame narrative tying together *Hym* and *Lok* (and indeed the latter poem leaves no trace in A), but otherwise A and R do share a substantial amount of prose (*Grm* P1–P3, *Skí* P1, *Vkv* P1), a fact which proves that the two, rather than being independent witnesses of poems based on oral tradition, stem from a common manuscript archetype.

A is written in the same hand and on the same parchment as A<sub>b</sub> (see below), a manuscript containing grammatical and poetic texts with which A was originally bundled.

### Manuscripts of Snorre's Edda

Snorre's Edda (*SnE*), also known as the Prose Edda, consists of three sections. The first two—*Gylf* and *Skm*—contain quotations from several Eddic poems. Snorre reproduces stanzas from the mythological *Vsp*, *Vafþ*, *Grm*, *Skí*, *Lok*, and *Hdl* in *Gylf* and stanzas from *Alv* in *Skm*. In addition he cites several otherwise unknown stanzas in Eddic meters, of which at least some appear to derive from now-lost mythological poems. These fragments are all edited at the end of the present section under *Eddbr*.

The four main mss. of the Prose Edda are:

1. S: Codex Regius of the Prose Edda (GKS 2367 4to), dating to ca. 1300 AD.
2. T: Codex Trajectinus (Traj 1374), a paper copy of a ms. closely related to S, dating to ca. 1595.

3. **W**: Codex Wormianus (AM 242 fol.), dating to ca. 1350 AD. **W** also contains the *Rþ* and the four Icelandic grammatical treatises.
4. **U**: Codex Upsaliensis (DG 11), dating to ca. 1300 AD.

When all four mss. agree on a reading, the abbreviation **G** is used synonymously with **STWU**.

Of these mss., **S** and **T** form their own stemmatic clade to the exclusion of **W** and **U**. Stematically, **U** is the most archaic ms., but unfortunately it has been heavily shortened and is filled with errors, especially in its poetry. This makes it a questionable source. For detailed discussion on the internal stemmatics of the mss. of Snorre's Edda and origins I refer to Haukur Þorgeirsson (2017).

Parts of *Skm* are also preserved in three independent manuscripts:

- **A<sub>b</sub>**: AM 748 I b 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-Ib>)
- **B**: AM 757 a 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0757a>)
- **C**: AM 748 II 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-II>)

The first two of these also preserve the short poetic treatise known as the *Litla skálda* 'Little Scalda', which cites three mythological Eddic stanzas: *Grm* 41–42 and *Eddbr* VIII 1.

**A<sub>b</sub>** also contains the Third Grammatical Treatise and a copy of the *Íslendingadrápa*, all written in the same hand. **A<sub>b</sub>** is written in the same hand and on the same parchment as **A**, and it is clear that the two originally made up a single manuscript, something confirmed by the fact that they were found tied together into a codex alongside the unrelated **C**.

TODO: **B** and **C**.

## Other manuscripts

A few other Eddic-style poems from various sources are also included in the present section, both under Mythic Poetry. As noted above, *Rþ* is attested in **W**. *Hdl* is found in **F**. In addition, a younger redaction of *Vsp* is found in **H**.

## Abbreviations

The following abbreviations are relevant for the preservation of Eddic poems and will be used in the critical notes. Some stanzas are cited on their own in unrelated texts, especially saws, preserved in various other manuscripts; these will be discussed in their individual places.

- **A** = AM 748 I a 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/da/AM04-0748-I-a>)



- **A<sub>b</sub>** = AM 748 I b 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-Ib>)
- **B** = AM 757 a 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0757a>)
- **C** = AM 748 II 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-II>)
- **F** = *Flateyjarbók*, GKS 1005 fol. (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/GKS02-1005>)
- **H** = *Hauksbók*, AM 544 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/en/AM04-0544>)
- **G** = STWU
- **N** = NKS 1824 b 4°, the main ms. of *Vǫls* (<https://onp.ku.dk/onp/onp.php?m9641>)
- **R** = Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda, GKS 2365 4° (<https://eae.ku.dk/q?p=eae/vols/text/1>)
- **S** = Codex Regius of the Prose Edda, GKS 2367 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/GKS04-2367>)
- **T** = Codex Trajectinus, Traj 1374<sup>x</sup>
- **U** = Codex Upsaliensis, DG 11
- **W** = Codex Wormianus, AM 242 fol. (<https://clarino.uib.no/menota/text/menota/AM-242-fol>)



# Norse Mythic Poetry



# Introduction to Norse Mythic Poetry

The present section contains almost all extant narrative poetry concerning the pre-Christian Germanic gods, most of which is found in the first half of **R**, and all of which is in Old Norse. Of all genres of Germanic poetry, the mythological is in fact the one of which we have the earliest mention. Tacitus, in *Germania*, ch. 2, talking about the ancient Germani, says that: *Celebrant carminibus antiquis, quod unum apud illos memoriae et annalium genus est, Tuistonem deum terra editum*. ‘They celebrate in ancient songs, which is the only kind of memory and history among them, the earth-born god Tuisto.’ In spite of this fact it is not due to any decision on the part of the editor that this type of poetry is exclusively in Old Norse, for outside of Iceland there survive no examples of this undoubtedly ancient genre. This must obviously not be taken to say that no such poetry existed, something disproven by the Tacitean quote above. In fact, as we shall see, many of the myths and gods dealt with in this genre are attested throughout the Germanic speech-area for a period of many centuries; in addition they show deep parallels to religious traditions as distant as Mesopotamia, India, and Egypt. And how should they have been told and transmitted through unreckoned illiterate ages if not in poetic form?

## The poems

The present section includes fourteen poems and eight smaller fragments.

## Short summaries

*Vǫlu spjó* (‘Spae of the Wallow’, *Vsp*) is the prophecy of a wallow, a Germanic seeress, brought back from the dead by the chief god Woden. The wallow narrates the events of the world’s creation and golden age, its degeneration and ultimate destruction, and at last its rebirth. The poem is mystical and contains numerous allusions to important myths; it serves as the major source for Snorre’s *Gylf*.

*Háva mál* (‘Speeches of the High One’, *Háv*) is the god Woden’s wisdom, consisting of practical life advice about friends, wealth, wisdom and women,

two romantic escapades, and lastly stanzas about runes and galders. It is by far the longest poem in **R**.

*Vafþrúðnis mǫl* ('Speeches of Webthriðner', *Vafþ*) describes Weden's visit to the ettin Webthriðner and the ensuing wisdom-contest between them as they wager their heads. The two ask each other numerous mythological and cosmological questions and in the mouth of Weden these soon turn to the subject of the end times; expectedly the god eventually comes out on top with an unknowable question.

*Grímnis mǫl* ('Speeches of Grimner', *Grm*) follows Weden as he sets out to test the hospitality of his former protégé King Garfrith as part of a wager with his wife Frie. The king is less than friendly and unwittingly tortures the god between two fires; Weden is however relieved by the king's son, and in exchange gives him a great deal of gnomic wisdom about the dwellings of the gods, sacred locations and objects, the creation of the world, and finally his own nature. At the end the king dies by his own sword and his son is made king after him.

*Baldurs draumar* ('Dreams of Balder', *Bdr*) is a short narrative poem which sees Weden set out to find answers about why his son Balder is having ominous dreams; he brings a wallow back to life and asks her a few questions.

*Skírnis mǫl* ('Speeches of Shirner', *Skí*) sees the lovesick god Free send his servant Shirner in order to win him the hand of the beautiful ettin-woman Gird; he does so by means of a curse.

*Hárbarðs ljóð* ('Leeds of Hoarbeard', *Hárþ*) is a long argument between the god Thunder and his father Weden, disguised as the ferryman Hoarbeard. The two stand on opposite sides of a sound and Thunder begs to be let over; he is, of course, refused.

*Hymis kviða* ('Lay of Hymer', *Hym*) is a humorous poem that tells how the god Thunder and his companion Tew set out to find a huge cauldron for the gods to drink out of. The two find themselves on a strange adventure as they go fishing with the cauldron's owner Hymer and Thunder nearly pulls up the Middenyardswyrm in what was undoubtedly one of the most popular myths of the Wiking Age.

*Loka sænna* ('Flying of Lock', *Lok*) sees the evil god Lock berate the other gods at a feast, giving personal and often quite graphic insults to each one and alluding to a number of less favourable myths; at last he is banished, caught and placed to be tortured until the end of days like a Northern Προμηθεύς.

*Þryms kviða* ('Lay of Thrím', *Þrk*) is another humorous poem about Thunder where the god's hammer is stolen by the ettin Thrím; in order to retrieve it he has to dress up as the goddess Frow and pretend to marry the ettin, yet the poem ends with a great killing as soon as the hammer is brought out.

*Völundar kviða* ('Lay of Wayland', *Vkv*) is properly a heroic poem, but is placed in this section as it is in **R**. The poem tells the story of the masterful supernatural smith Wayland, who is kidnapped and hamstrung by the tyrant Nithad and forced to make jewels for him and his family. Wayland takes his gruesome revenge by killing the tyrant's sons, impregnating his daughter, Beadhild, and flying away in a flight-suit of his own design.

*Al-viss mǫl* ('Speeches of Allwise', *Alv*) is a short poem where a dwarf asks for the hand of Thunder's daughter. Thunder tricks him that he will win her if he can only tell him the various poetic names for things (beer, sun, clouds, and the like); the dwarf does so, but in his foolish lust continues for so long that eventually the sun rises and he turns to stone.

*Rígs þula* ('Thule of Rígh', *Rþ*) narrates the fathering of the three social castes—the thralls, churls, and earls—and the eventual establishment of kingship and elite runic knowledge at the hands of the mysterious god Rígh. The poem is unfortunately incomplete.

*Hyndlu ljóð* ('Leeds of Hindle', *Hdl*) describes how the goddess Frow asks the ettin-woman Hindle to reveal the genealogy of Frow's lover Oughter so that he will be able to claim his legitimate inheritance. The poem takes a mythological turn as Hindle briefly recounts the coming destruction of the world.

Following these poems, I offer 8 Eddic fragments (containing a total of 11 stanzas or half-stanzas) cited in *Gylf* and *Skm* under the section Fragments from Snorre's Edda (abbrev. *Eddbr*). The fragments are edited along with their surrounding prose contexts. Many of them have likely belonged to now-lost Eddic poems, and their inclusion completes the mythological Eddic corpus.

## Types of poetry

The above-listed poems may be categorised on a scale between narrative poetry on the one end and gnomic or wisdom poetry on the other. Although almost every poem has some type of narrative progression, a distinction can still be made based on the nature of the bulk of the content and whether the narrative exists merely as a frame for the gnomic material or whether it fills an important purpose in its own right. The exact categorisation is subjective, but for our purposes it may be said that on the far end of the narrative side stand *Þrk* and *Hym*, and on the far end of the gnomic side *Háv* and *Alv*.

## Exclusions

A few Eddic-style poems which one the reader may be familiar with from other editions have been excluded from the present edition due to their questionable and likely post-mediaeval provenance. It must be stressed that none of the excluded texts should be relied upon for knowledge of the authentic pre-Christian culture and religion.

The main exclusion when compared with most other modern editions is the antiquarian *Svip-dags mǫl* 'Speeches of Swedday', which properly consists of the two poems *Fjöl-svinns mǫl* and *Gróu galdr* (*Grg*). Although found only in post-reformation Icelandic paper mss., both parts probably date to the antiquarian period of the 13th century. Their late origin is proven by the fact that they contain allusions to Christianity and post-conversion language (e.g., *Fjöl-svinns mǫl*: 46/3 *jartegn* 'evidence', *Grg* 13/3: *kristin dauð kona* 'a dead Christian woman'). The mythological references they do contain appear

to be largely fabricated or derivative of earlier texts, and are likely to introduce much confusion about the mythology on the part of the reader. That they have recently been translated by Pettit (2023) further justifies their exclusion.

Apart from *Svip-dags mól*, two other exclusions found in some older, though not in most modern eds., also merit discussion since the reader may be surprised at their absence. The *Sólar-ljóð* ‘Leeds of the Sun’ is clearly a late, Christian poem, and is edited and translated by Carolyne Larrington and Peter Robinson in SkP 7. The *Hrafná-galdr Óðins* ‘Raven-Galder of Weden’ is undoubtedly a post-reformation pastiche as seen by its late meter and use of the Low German loanword *mál-tíð* ‘meal time’.

### Table of manuscripts

The following table shows the manuscript attestation for the included poems and their relative position in each manuscript. A *q* in *Gylf/Skm* represents one or more stanzas attested in quotation. For more precise details see the Introductions to the individual poems.

| Signum      | R  | A | W | H | F | <i>Gylf/Skm</i> |
|-------------|----|---|---|---|---|-----------------|
| <i>Vsp</i>  | 1  | – | – | + | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Háv</i>  | 2  | – | – | – | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Vafþ</i> | 3  | 4 | – | – | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Grm</i>  | 4  | 5 | – | – | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Skí</i>  | 5  | 3 | – | – | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Hárb</i> | 6  | 1 | – | – | – | –               |
| <i>Hym</i>  | 7  | 6 | – | – | – | –               |
| <i>Lok</i>  | 8  | – | – | – | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Þrk</i>  | 9  | – | – | – | – | –               |
| <i>Vkv</i>  | 10 | 7 | – | – | – | –               |
| <i>Alv</i>  | 11 | – | – | – | – | <i>q</i>        |
| <i>Bdr</i>  | –  | 2 | – | – | – | –               |
| <i>Rþ</i>   | –  | – | + | – | – | –               |
| <i>Hdl</i>  | –  | – | – | – | + | <i>q</i>        |



# Spae of the Wallow

## (*Vǫlu spjó*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.865)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Spae of the Wallow** (ON *Vǫlu spjó*, abbrev. Voluspa) is undoubtedly the most important Norse mythological text surviving from Heathen times. It is a spae (*spjó* ‘prophecy’) told by a wallow (*vǫlva* ‘seeress, sibyl, prophetess’) who has been summoned by Woden, the chief of the Gods, in order to relate the mythic history of the World.

### Origin and parallels

As a repository of mythic lore *Vsp* resembles *Vǫfþ*, *Grm*, *Bdr*, and *Alv*, but it differs from most of the aforementioned works in two key ways: *Vsp* is a tightly structured spae rather than a motley collection of scattered mythological lore, and a monologue rather than a dialogue or riddle contest. The unique importance of this poem lies in the fact that it offers a complete chronological overview of the Norse mythic timeline of the World from its creation to its coming destruction and rebirth.

The understanding of this timeline is, unfortunately for the study of Norse mythology, troubled by several factors. The first is that the wallow continually speaks in the most obscure terms and relates the myths in an allusive fashion which presupposes that the audience is already familiar with them. The second lies in the way we have to understand these allusions, for while some are entirely unknown to us, we can connect most of them to more complete narratives in Snorre’s Edda (*SnE*). *SnE* is, however, not a perfect source and since Snorre is often relying on *Vsp* we risk running into circular reasoning. What is worse, in at least one instance (st. 38/1) Snorre shows willingness to alter the wording of *Vsp* in citation in order to fit his own narratives, which calls his reliability into question. The third factor is that

the witness manuscripts disagree over the order and inclusion of numerous stanzas.

In order to elucidate the myths and their broader religious and cosmic significance properly, we therefore have to take into account all available resources: comparative mythology, folkloristics, linguistics, historical sources, and archæology, and nowhere is this more important than in *Vǫsp*. Although the body of Norse pre-Christian poetry is rather small, the available material for a broader comparative study is truly vast, and since there is still a tremendous amount of work to be done there will undoubtedly creep in both omissions and errors. Even so, it is hoped that the present commentary along with that of the other poems included in this edition will provide new and interesting perspectives to the general reader, student, and scholar, not just of Germanic mythology but of the history of religions in general.

### The wallow

As noted above, *Vǫsp* is narrated by a wallow. This figure represents the northern European belief that women, especially in elder age, were invested with a unique psychic or prophetic foresight, a power which became even greater when they died and might come into possession of truly hidden knowledge—knowledge perhaps unknown even to the chief god Woden Himself. In *Vǫsp* this ability of sight is reflected in the continual repetition of the phrase *sá hōn* ‘she saw’, or, in the later part of the poem, *sér hōn* ‘she sees’. In her trance the wallow *sees* the past and the future as if they were before her very eyes.

Accounts of famous northern European seeresses are found from the time of our earliest Roman sources. During the Batavian rebellion of the late 1st c. AD, the seeress Veleda (a Celtic word, cf. OIr. *filed* ‘seer’, Middle Welsh *gwelet* ‘id.’) of the Bructeri made herself famous for her *spaes*. Tacitus, *Germania* 8, mentions her by name when talking about the Germanic respect for women: *Inesse quin etiam sanctum aliquid et providum putant, nec aut consilia earum aspernantur aut responsa neglegunt. Vidimus sub divo Vespasiano Veleadam diu apud plerosque numinis loco habitam*. ‘Moreover, they think that there is in them something holy and prophetic, and they neither despise their counsels nor disregard their responses. We saw, under the deified Vespasian, that Veleda was held in the place of a deity for a long time among the multitude.’

In Jordanes, *Getica* 121, we find mention of the Gothic witches known as the *haliurunnæ*, thought to be the ancestors of the hostile Huns. Their name is clearly cognate with OE *helli-rūne* ‘witch, sorceress’, formed from *hēll* ‘hell, Underworld’ + *rūne* ‘whisperess, confidante’, thus signifying ‘those who convene with the dead’.

The Longbeards, too, were once led by a prophetic woman, Gambara, as told in their 7th c. *Origo* (see Appendix to *Grm*).

### Woden

It was to acquire their knowledge that Woden in his incessant quest for wisdom undertook frequent journeys in order to question wallows and hell-

whisperers alike about events past and future, and *Vsp* is not the only Eddic poem reflecting that motif. The closest parallel is *Bdr*, wherein Woden summons a wallow from her grave in order to find out why the god Balder is having ominous nightmares. Woden's journeys to convene with the dead are also alluded to in *Háv* 158 and *Hárb* 44–45.

For the god's general quest for knowledge there are numerous parallels: Woden's wisdom contest against the wise ettin Webthritner (*Vafþ*), his theft of the mead of poetry (*Háv* 103–110), his self-hanging and acquisition of the runes (*Háv* 138, 139), and his giving up his eye to Mimer in exchange for wisdom (*Vsp* 28).

### Cycles and eschatology

As has been impressively shown by Eliade (2005), pre-Abrahamic religions are centered around cycles and the power of *being* inherent in their return; they are based around cyclical mythic time rather than linear history. The sun at dawn, the new moon, the daylight at the winter solstice, the warmth of spring—traditional man did not think the return of these things certain. Rather, the sun, moon, year, and indeed the world itself had to be strengthened and re-established through rituals harkening back to mythic time and re-establishing Creation. So it is that modern man thinks little of that which traditional man worried about with great fright and consequently heralded with great rejoicing.

In the traditional worldview the world consists of nested cycles, a series of ever-revolving epicycles of rises and declines: the day, the month, the year, the human lifetime, and the world itself. Each must rise and fall, decline and be regenerated. In this way history is not linear, but cyclical; everything that is done has already been done before and in fact it is just this precedent which gives the present occurrence its realness.

*Vsp* focuses on the greatest cycle, that of the World itself, from its beginning as formless matter (3) through its Creation by the Gods (4–6) and Golden Age (7–8) to its gradual decline (8–42), destruction (43–55) and re-birth (56–62). Although the poem is not explicit about it, there is a hint that the seed of evil is not entirely defeated in the next world (cf. 62 n.), leaving the possibility open for yet another repetition of the cycle.

TODO: mention Indian yuga-s, Zoroastrian texts.

### The Wiking Age eschatological fixation

One of the most important developments of the Germanic religion when compared with other Indo-European religions is its unique obsession with eschatology. Although the relevant myths are preserved only in the Norse literature, likely traces of the same are found on continental West Germanic territory in the form of the OHG *Musp* and the OS *Heli*, both of which use the likely pre-Christian inherited term *Muspilli*, also found in ON as *Muspell*; see st. 49/1 n. below, *Musp* 56 n.

To be clear, what distinguishes the Germanic (and specifically Norse) religion from other Indo-European systems is not the mere presence of ideas

of the destruction and rebirth of the World, which as discussed above are also found in Indo-Iranian sources, but specifically a fixation with the imminent Destruction of the World and most of the Gods at the hands of the evil cosmic forces during the so-called Rakes of the Reins (*ragna røk*).

We find allusions to the Destruction in a large number of pre-Christian Norse texts: many of the mythological poems (*Vsp* 43–55, *Vafþ* 17–18, 44–53, *Grm* 4/4, 17, 24, 40, *Bdr* 14, *Lok* 10/1, 39, 41–42, *Hdl* 41, 43), two Scaldic eulogies (*Hákm* 20–21, *Eirm* 7), and a few poetic pre-Christian runestones (Sö 154 Skarpåker, perhaps also Vg 119 Sparlösa and Ög 136 Rökl).

The monsters of the Rakes of the Reins also figure iconographically, e.g. on the 10th c. Gosforth cross, which shows the god Wíðir slaying the Míðenyardswyrms (*Vsp* 52, *Vafþ* 53). A common motif on pre-Christian memorial runestones is that of a single ravenous wolf, e.g. on N 84 Vang and DR 285 and 286 Hunnestad, perhaps the wolf Fenrir. Sometimes this wolf is accompanied by a ship (perhaps Nálfr, *Vsp* 48/4 n.), e.g. on DR 271 Tullstorp (Figure 1, p. 23) and Ög 181 Ledsberg. These pictorial funerary motifs should be considered in light of the literary evidence, most clearly in Sö 154, *Hákm* 20–21, and *Eirm* 7, which connects the destruction of the world to the personal grief felt by the individual mourner.

In the ubiquity of these allusions, including on memorial runestones, we see that the Rakes of the Reins were not a mere literary construct. The worry about the impending destruction of the world was felt acutely on a personal level by the practitioners of the pre-Christian religion. It is clear that the Heathens thought that the calamity was imminent and could come, as it were, “like a thief in the night” (cf. *Heli* 4358–61, pulling on Matthew 24:43, 1 Thessalonians 5:2). It is notable that the association is particularly strong in contexts relating to death, whether they be runestones for dead family members, raised by more or less normal people, or funerary poems for beloved kings, composed by elite poets. We do not know whether the practitioners of the religion found consolation in these eschatological events, but it is hard not to be moved by the feeling of the father who, having buried his own son, laconically proclaims that “Earth and Up-heaven shall be rent” (Sö 154).

### The climate catastrophe of 536 AD

If we are to look for a historical explanation for the above-mentioned eschatological fixation, the most likely candidate is undoubtedly the climate catastrophe of 536–537 AD. TODO. Gräslund (2008).

Although ideas of the Destruction probably existed before 536, the plague, massive depopulation and accompanying social upheaval, perhaps alongside Christian apocalypticism spreading from the converted Goths and Vandals, likely led to a new form of religious expression.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Vsp* is attested in three independent recensions, R, H and G.

The most important recension, **R**, is the second oldest (ca. 1275 AD). This is the complete version of *Vsp* preserved in **R** on foll. 1r–3r, where *Vsp* is the first poem.

The other complete recension, **H**, is the youngest (ca. 1310 AD). This is the version of *Vsp* preserved in **H** (foll. 20r–21r), where the poem is found in the middle of an impressive collection of native Norse-Icelandic saws and learned Catholic works.

The third recension, **G**, is the oldest (ca. 1225 AD), and represents the stanzas of *Vsp* (3, 5, 9, 10–13, 15, 18, 24–25, 28, 37–40, 44–46, 48–54, 61) cited in *Gylf*, the first part of *SnE*. This recension is fragmentary, though many now-lost stanzas belonging to it may be gleaned through Snorre's paraphrases of them. At times the paraphrases can provide important critical readings and serve as a tiebreaker for variants that differ between **R** and **H**, e.g. in st. 19/2, where *sal* 'hall' in the *Gylf* paraphrase agrees with **H** against **R** *sé* 'lake'. For the four mss. of *Gylf* (**S**, **T**, **W** TODO, and **U**) see the Introduction to Mythic Poetry above.

### Table of stanzas

The order of stanzas varies greatly across the three recensions and is best illustrated by a table.

Stanzas cited in *Gylf* have been handled in the following way: those cited independently are marked with a plus sign, while those belonging to a sequence of several stanzas are marked with an incrementing letter based on the sequence and a number for its position, so that *A1* is the first stanza in the first sequence, *B1* the first stanza in the second sequence, and so forth.

When a stanza found in a manuscript is strongly divergent (e.g. st. 10, where *Gylf* 14:15 omits the first two half-lines), its mark is followed by a star.

The stanzas beginning with the formula *Þá gingu regin öll* 'Then went all the Reins' etc. are represented by the immediately following half-line.

| <i>pres. ed.</i> | <b>R</b>                | <b>H</b> | <b>STW</b> | <b>U</b> |
|------------------|-------------------------|----------|------------|----------|
| 1                | Hljóðs bið'k allar      | 1        | –          | –        |
| 2                | Ek man jötna            | 2        | –          | –        |
| 3                | Ár vas alda             | 3        | +          | +        |
| 4                | áðr Burs synir          | 4        | –          | –        |
| 5                | Sól varp sunnan         | 5        | +          | +        |
| 6                | ... nótt ok niðjum      | 6        | –          | –        |
| 7                | Hittu-sk ęsir           | 7        | –          | –        |
| 8                | Tęfðu í túni            | 8        | –          | –        |
| 9                | ... hverr skyldi dverga | 9        | B1         | B1       |
| 10               | Þar vas Móð-sognir      | 10       | B2*        | B2*      |
| 11–15            | <i>Dwarf-tallies</i>    | 11–15    | +          | +        |
| 16               | Und's þrír kvömu        | 16       | –          | –        |
| 17               | Qnd þau né öttu         | 17       | –          | –        |
| 18               | Ask vęit'k standa       | 18       | +          | +        |
| 19               | Þaðan koma meýjar       | 19–20    | –          | –        |

|            | <i>pres. ed.</i>         | R          | H                  | STW        | U   |
|------------|--------------------------|------------|--------------------|------------|-----|
| 20         | Þat man hōn folk-víg     | 21-22      | 27                 | -          | -   |
| 21         | Heiði hana hétu          | 23         | 28                 | -          | -   |
| 22         | ... hvárt skyldu ęsir    | 24         | 29                 | -          | -   |
| 23         | Fleygði Óðinn            | 25         | 30                 | -          | -   |
| 24         | ... hvęrr hefði lopt alt | 26         | 22                 | C1         | C1  |
| 25         | Þörr ęinn þar vá         | 27         | 23                 | C2*        | C2* |
| 26         | Vęit hōn Heim-dalar      | 28         | 24                 | -          | -   |
| 27         | Ęin sat hōn úti          | 29         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 28         | Alt vęit'k, Óðinn        | 29         | -                  | +          | +   |
| 29         | Valði hęnni Hęr-fęðr     | 30         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 30         | Sá hōn val-kyrjur        | 31         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 31         | Ek sá Baldri             | 32         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 32         | Varð af męiði            | 33         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 33         | Þó ęva hęndr             | 34         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 34         | þar sitr Sigyn           | 35         | 32*                | -          | -   |
| 35         | Ó fęllr austan           | 36         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 36         | Stóð fyr norðan          | 36         | -                  | -          | -   |
| 37         | Sal sá hōn standa        | 37         | 36                 | E1         | E1  |
| 38         | Sá hōn þar vaða          | 38         | 37                 | E2*        | E2* |
| 39         | Austr býr hin aldna      | 39         | 25                 | A1         | A1  |
| 40         | Fylli=sk fęrvi           | 40         | 26                 | A2         | A2  |
| 41         | Sat þar á haugi          | 41         | 34                 | -          | -   |
| 42         | Gól of ęsum              | 42         | 35                 | -          | -   |
| 43, 47, 55 | Geyr (nú) Garmr mjøk     | 43, 46, 55 | 33, 38, 43, 48, 51 | -          | -   |
| 44         | Bróðr munu bęrja=sk      | 44         | 39                 | -          | -   |
| 45         | Leika Míms synir         | 45         | 40                 | D1*        | D1* |
| 46         | Hvat 's með ęsum?        | 49         | 42                 | D2         | D2* |
| 48         | Hrymr ękr austan         | 47         | 44                 | D3         | -   |
| 49         | Kjöll fęrr austan        | 48         | 45                 | D4         | -   |
| 50         | Surtr fęrr sunnan        | 50         | 46                 | +, D5 (n.) | +   |
| 51         | Þa kōmr Hlínar           | 51         | 47                 | D6         | -   |
| 52         | Þa kōmr hinn mikli       | 52         | -                  | D7         | -   |
| 53         | Þa kōmr hinn męri        | 53*        | 49*                | D8         | -   |
| 54         | Sól tér sortna           | 54         | 50                 | D9         | -   |
| 56         | Sér hōn upp koma         | 56         | 52                 | -          | -   |
| 57         | Finna=sk ęsir            | 57*        | 53                 | -          | -   |
| 58         | Þar munu ęptir           | 58         | 54                 | -          | -   |
| 59         | Munu ó-sánir             | 59         | 55                 | -          | -   |
| 60         | Þa kná Hōnir             | 60         | 56                 | -          | -   |
| 61         | Sal sér hōn standa       | 61         | 57                 | +          | +   |
| 62         | Þar kōmr hinn dimmi      | 62         | 59                 | -          | -   |
| H31        | Þa kná Váli              | -          | 31                 | -          | -   |
| H41        | Hręða=sk allir           | -          | 41                 | -          | -   |
| H48        | Gínn lopt yfir           | -          | 48                 | -          | -   |
| H58        | Þa kōmr hinn ríki        | -          | 58                 | -          | -   |

## Summary

On the basis of its refrains and content, the poem may be divided into the following rough sections: introduction (1–2), Creation and the early age of the World (3–17), cosmological and mythological exposition and decline (18–42), Destruction (43–55), and Rebirth (56–62).

It seems that immediately prior to the poem's beginning, Weden has awakened the wallow out of her grave. He commands her to speak. The wallow's *spae* begins with a bid for silence, addressing Weden directly (1). She next recalls her earliest memories of being raised amongst ettins in the world of yore (2).

The mythic history of the world itself begins with the Creation (3–6) and the following Golden Age (7–8), which was brought to an end by the intrusion of three unidentified ettin-maidens (8). After this, the wallow describes the making of the dwarfs (9–10), whose names are listed in several separate *dwarf-tallies* which are without doubt later inserts (11–15). She mentions how the Gods next gave life and intelligence to the first human beings (16–17), and then describes the Ash of Ugdrassle (18) and the three norns living under it, who give orlay (fate) to mankind (19).

After st. 19, the order of the stanzas in the two full recensions—**R** and **H**—diverges significantly, and does not come to agree again until st. 43. With a single exception (st. 46), the order adopted for the present edition is that of **R**, but since it is hard to decide which one is more original both are summarised here.

In **R**, the wallow recalls how a woman named Goldwey was sacrificed and reborn three times (20), and how she, under the name Hode, practiced sorcery and witchcraft (21). She then recalls the first war in the world, between the Eese and Wanes (22–23), and the killing of the smith who was promised Frow and the sun and moon in exchange for building the wall of Osyard (24–25). This is followed by a cryptic verse describing the Well of Mimer (26). She then seems to tell of her own origin; how she was approached by Weden, who gave her rings and jewels in exchange for her wisdom (27–29). She then tells of the walkirries (30) and relates the death of Balder (31–33) and the subsequent binding of Lock (34). After this, she describes a sword-river (35) and two beer-halls (36), then the torture of criminals in the afterlife by Nithehewer (37–38). She sees Ironwood in the East, where the wolves who will swallow the Sun and Moon are being reared (39–40). She foresees the crowing of three cocks: one in Ironwood (41), the other among the Gods, and the third in Hell or the Underworld (42). After this, we get the first occurrence of the refrain-stanza of the destruction; it describes how the wolf breaks free, and is repeated several times throughout the part of the *spae* that deals with the destruction of the world (43).

In **H** the structure is quite different. The Eese immediately go to decide what action to take regarding the Master Builder (24–25), and the Well of Mimer is described (26). Then follow the two stanzas about the wolves which will swallow the sun and moon (40–41), and the story of Goldwey and the war between the Eese and Wanes (20–23). The stanzas about Goldwey's origin

(27–29), the walkirries (30), and the death of Balder (31–33) are left out of **H**, along with the sword-river and beer-halls (35–36), but it does describe the binding of Lock (34). Next we get the first occurrence of the refrain-stanza (43), then the crowing of the three cocks (41–42), and lastly the punishment of criminals (38–39). **H** then repeats the refrain-stanza a second time, and **R** and **H** are now almost completely aligned for the rest of the poem.

The Destruction of the world begins with numerous catastrophes and a decay in human morality: kinslaying, incest, adultery, and great wars become widespread (44). Homedall blows the great Yellhorn, the Ash of Ugdrassle is set ablaze, and a trapped ettin comes loose (45). The Eese, Elves, and Dwarfs are all distressed (46). Here the refrain-stanza is repeated again (47). Now the enemies of the Gods launch their attack: the ettin Rim drives from the east, the wyrm Ermingand writhes in the sea and propels huge waves, and the ship Nailfare comes loose (48). The ship drives from the east and is led by Lock and the Wol, both of whom have at last come free (49). From the south Surt brings a flaming sword to set fire to the world; there is a crack in Heaven and Hell is joined by many men (50). Weden goes out to fight the Wolf and falls, as does Free against Surt (51). Wider avenges Weden by killing the Wolf (52), while Thunder and the Wyrms kill each other; the great battle leaves the world uninhabited (53). Instead of 52, **H** has a stanza describing how the Wyrms gape over the entire world, and how Thunder will ‘meet its venom’ (H48). The Destruction culminates in the sun turning black, the stars disappearing, and the earth sinking into the sea. The whole world burns (54). The refrain-stanza repeats a final time (55).

The world is reborn. The earth rises from the sea and soon turns green again; the cycle of nature is renewed (56). The surviving Eese find each other on the Idewold, where they had first settled, and reminisce (57). A new Golden Age begins (58). The fields grow high without toil and Hath and Balder reconcile (59). Heener becomes the head priest of the Gods and the sons of Hath and Balder settle the sky (60). The wallow sees a fair, golden hall in which virtuous generations reside (61), but her vision concludes with the sight of a flying, dusky dragon—it is Nithehewer, carrying corpses in its mouth, a sign that there is still a seed of evil left in the new world. With this portent she sinks back down into her grave (62).





Figure 1: The Tullstorp stone (DR 271), showing a wolf above a ship, perhaps the Fenrerswolf and Nailfare. The inscription is a memorial and not related to the iconography. Viking Age, ca. 1000 AD. © Jorchr. CC BY-SA 4.0. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tullstorpstenen,\\_DR\\_271,Tullstorp\\_1-1,\\_Runristning.jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tullstorpstenen,_DR_271,Tullstorp_1-1,_Runristning.jpg)

## Text

- 1 „Hljóðs bið'k allar · hēlgar kindir, [R 1r/2, H 20r/1]  
 2 mēiri ok minni · mōgu Hēim·dalar;  
 vilt at, Val-fōðr, · vēl fram tēlja'k  
 4 forn spjōll fira, · þau's frēmt of man.

“FOR HEARING I ASK all holy tribes [GODS],  
 [and] the greater and lesser sons of Homedall [MEN].  
 Thou wouldst, O Walfather, that I well tell forth  
 the ancient sayings of men, the earliest I recall.

1 Hljóðs | The H is an ornamented initial 5 lines in height, noticeably taller than any other initial save the one introducing 1 HHund, in R; introduced by a small initial 2 lines in height in H. 1 hēlgar ‘holy’ | so H; om. R

ALL | The wallow has just been awoken from her grave (cf. st. 62/4b below) and commences her speech by asking for the silence of gods and men, a meristic expression (West 2007, pp. 99–100). The whole introductory formula has Indo-European parallels; see West (2007, pp. 63, 92–93, 312).

1 Hljóðs bið'k ‘For hearing I ask’ | This is the only call for hearing found in an Eddic poem, but many parallels are found in Scaldic praise poetry, most often involving the related words *hljóð* ‘hearing’ and *hlýða* ‘hear, listen’ (Wood 1960, pp. 424, 250). Examples abound (see Wood 1960), but most notably among them, the same introductory expression is found in Eyel’s Head-ransom (Egill Hfl 2 in SkP 5): *hljóðs biðjum þann* ‘for hearing we [I] ask him’.

1 hēlgar ‘holy’ | That the omission of this word in R is nothing more than a scribal error is clearly shown by the meter; the a-verse in *Hljóðs bið ek · allar kindir* is only three syllables long and has highly unnatural alliteration on the unstressed pronoun *ek* rather than the first nominal *hljóðs*.

2 mēiri ok minni ‘greater and lesser’ | It is ambiguous to which noun phrase these adjectives belong. It can either be (a) “all greater and lesser holy tribes”, which might be equivalent to the phrase Eese and Elves (earthly and heavenly supernatural beings; see Index for occurrences), or (b) “the greater and lesser sons of Homedall”. (b) is preferred as the simpler reading since it avoids enjambment. The sense of “greater or lesser” is then more likely to be literal and physical (i.e., the younger and older members of the audience) rather than figurative (i.e., the varying social classes).

2 mōgu Hēim·dalar ‘sons of Homedall [MEN]’ | Usually interpreted as a kenning for MEN on the basis of *Rþ*, according to which Homedall sired the three social classes of mankind. This convention is followed here as it is felt to give the better sense and conforms to the Indo-European poetic phrase “gods and men” (see note to ALL), but such a kenning is otherwise unparalleled. A more typologically likely interpretation, following Meissner (1921, pp. 23, 252), would be to see *mēgir* in the sense ‘lads, comrades’. This makes the kenning equivalent to *Hropts mēgir* ‘Roft’s lads’ (*Lok* 45/3), *allar áttir Ingvi-Frēys* ‘all the kin of Ing-Free [GODS]’ (*Haustl* 10), *Njarðar niðjar* ‘Nearth’s kinsmen’ (Hfr Lv 10 in SkP 5).

3 Val-fōðr ‘Walfather’ | That is, the ‘Father of the Slain’, a name for Weden. The wallow probably uses this name since Weden, acting in his role as necromancer and psychopomp, has just awoken her out of her grave (perhaps with a *val-galdr* ‘slain-galder’ as in *Bdr* 4/3 and *Háv* 158).

4 þau's frēmt of man ‘which I earliest recall’ | Cf. *Vafþ* 34–35 with similar phrasing.

- 2 Ek man jōtna · ár of borna, [R 1r/4, H 20r/2]  
 2 þa's forðum mik · fōdda hōfðu;

4 níu man'k hęima, · níu í-viðjur,  
mjot-við męran · fyr mold neđan.

I recall Ettins born of yore,  
those who formerly had reared me.  
I recall nine Homes, nine Inwithies,  
the famed Measure-Tree beneath the soil.

3 í-viðjur | so RH; previously read 'iviði' in R, but this was made obsolete by an x-ray scan undertaken by Stefan Karlsson (1979) which revealed a previously overlooked abbrev. mark standing for -ur.

3 níu ... hęima 'nine Homes' | Or 'nine realms'. The identity of these is by no means clear nor is there any canonical list of which realms are supposed to be included.

3 í-viðjur 'Inwithies' | Evil-working women or ogresses; their identity is by no means clear. The f. jón-stem í-viðja also appears in a list of poetic synonyms for trollwomen (Þul Trollkvenna 3 in SkP 3). A commonly suggested etymology is í 'in' + viðr 'tree, forest' (i.e., 'tree, forest-dwellers'), but this would be an unusual formation and leaves the -j- unexplained. A more plausible etymology is a derivative of \*í-við 'malice', attested in the cpd. í-við-gjarn 'malicious' (Vkv 28). This derivation can also explain the -j-, since the WGmc. cognates OE *in-wid*, OS *in-wid*, and OHG *in-wit* show it to be a neutr. *ja*-stem.

4 mjot-við męran · fyr mold neđan. 'the famed Measure-Tree beneath the soil.' | Probably the Ash of Ugdrassle, still but a seed. The sense of *mjot-viðr* 'Measure-Tree' is not clear. It is probably not the *mjotudr* in 45/1 below.

2 3 Ár vas alda · þar's Ymir byggði,  
vas=a sandr né sęr, · né svalar unnir;  
jorđ fann=sk ęva · né upp-himinn;  
4 gap vas ginnunga, · ęn gras hver=gi,

[R 1r/6, H 20r/4,  
S 2r/25, T 3r/2,  
W TODO, U TODO]

It was early of ages where Yimer dwelled;  
there was not sand nor sea nor cool waves.  
Earth was never found nor Up-heaven;  
there was the gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE] but grass nowhere,

1 alda | halda S 1 þar's Ymir byggði 'where Yimer dwelled' | þat's ękki vas 'when nothing was' STW; þar's ękki vas 'where nothing was' U 2 sęr | sjár W; sjór HU 2 svalar unnir | †sva†, with a large space following T 3 ęva 'never' | ęigi 'not' STU 4 hver-gi 'nowhere' | ękki 'not' HSTW

ALL | The wallow begins her retelling of the mythic history of the World. Told in sts. 3–4 is the creation of the Earth and the Heavens. Other Norse poetic sources for the creation are *Grm* 41–42 and *Vafþ* 21. A Christian creation hymn apparently drawing on older pagan sources is the OHG *Wessobrunn* edited below under Poetry on Christian Subjects; cf. also the more thoroughly Christian *Cadman* in the same section. The beginning of the Norse creation narrative is treated at length in *Gylf* 4–5, according to which the world first consisted of two extremities: the frozen Nivelham in the north and the burning Muspellsham in the south. From Nivelham the icy venomous rivers called the Ilewaves rushed forth until they lost their momentum and froze to ice, while from Muspellsham flowed burning lava. The ice and the lava met in the Gap of Hawks (*Ginnunga-gap*, which *var svá blętt sem lopt vind-laust* 'was as calm as windless air', *Gylf* 5:7) and there combined to form the first being, Yimer.

1 Árvas alda ‘It was early of ages’ | By these words the wallow begins her narrative in mythic time, in the earliest age (*gld.* cf. st. 44/4–5 below), *in illo tempore*. It is formulaic for a mythological or heroic-legendary Eddic poem to begin with *ár* ‘of yore, early’; cf. *Hym* 1/1, *1 HHund* 1/1 (which likewise has *Árvas alda*, prob. borrowed from the pres. st.), *1 Guðr* 1/1, *1 Sigsk* 1/1.

1 Ymir ‘Yimer’ | The first ettin, from whom the rest were begotten, at first a- or ambisexually. Yimer was the Heaven and Earth conjoined and as such hermaphroditic, containing both a male (heavenly) and female (earthly) aspect. He is described in *Gylf* 5:8: *Ok þá er móttisk brimin ok blér hita’ns súa at bráðnaði ok draup, ok af þeim kviku-dropum kviknaði með krapti þess er til sendi hita’nn, ok varð manns líkandi, ok var sá nefndr Ymir.* ‘And when the rime-frost and hot air from the heat met so that it thawed and dripped, then from those flowing droplets there arose a life with the power which brought the heat and became the likeness of a man, and he was named Yimer.’ The comparative mythological idea of Yimer as the reflex of a PIE cosmic twin must be disregarded, for his name derives from PIE *\*ymH-yós*, which, although ultimately from the root *\*yemH-* ‘twin’ (whence OI *Yamá* ‘twin’), is most closely related to Latvian *jumis* ‘paired couple, double fruit’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 274) and thus seems to suggest hermaphroditism or the union of the copulating Earth-Heaven. Yimer is probably (so *Gylf* 5:9) to be identified with the ambisexually reproducing first ettin Eareymler in *Vafþ* 30–33. Comparatively he corresponds to the sexually joined *Oûpanós* (‘Heaven’) and *Γαῖα* (‘Earth’) prior to the castration of the former at the hands of their son *Kpónos* (‘the Cutter’; *Theog* 159–172), who was only later identified through folk etymology with *Xpónos* (‘Time’). This violent separation ended the primæval hermaphroditic begetting and ushered in the patriarchal rule of the male Sons of Byre; it is of note that Yimer, like *Oûpanós*, is described as evil (*Gylf* 5:15).

Yimer further resembles the Vedic *Puruṣa* and the Chinese *Pangu* in his role as the primæval being from whose body parts the World is shaped (Witzel 2017). Cf. *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 43 n.

3 jorð ... né upp-himinn ‘Earth ... nor Up-heaven’ | A well-attested formulaic cosmological word-pair found in all four Old Germanic languages with alliterative poetic traditions (ON, OE, OS, and OHG), especially in the context of the creation and destruction of the world. See Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

4 gap was ginnunga ‘there was the gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE]’ | *gap ginnunga* ‘gap of hawks’ has usually been interpreted on the basis of the cosmogony in *Gylf* 4–5, where Snorre presents the *Ginnunga-gap* ‘Gap of Hawks’ as a primordial physical location where cold and hot elements combine to form the first differentiated cosmic being, Yimer, in the place where the Earth will later be situated. For this reason the phrase is typically rendered in translation simply as “Ginnungagap” and explained as a sort of supernatural void. The present stanza, however, is the only conjunction of the words *gap* and *ginnunga* outside of *SnE*, and his cosmogony is very peculiar. There is therefore good reason to reexamine these two words in the present context in order to determine the exact nature of the ‘gap’.

To begin with, we must reject the traditional renditions “yawning gap” or “supernatural void” as unlikely. The former may be eliminated immediately since the off-connected ON verb *gína* ‘yawn, gape’ has a different root (*gin-*) than *ginnunga* (*ginn-*) and since there is no clear derivation from *gína* to *ginnunga*, which in any case must be a noun, not an adjective and certainly not a participle. *ginnunga* has been explained variously. Finnur Jónsson (1932) sees it as gen. sg. of *\*ginnungi* (from the lost equivalent to OE *ginne* ‘wide, spacious’ + the nominal suffix *-ungi*). This is, however, a strange and decidedly non-Norse construction, especially since the suffix *-ungi* forms masculine nominals with animate senses, not abstract nouns. A more common explanation is to see *ginnunga* as gen. of a pl. *\*ginnungar* ‘supernatural beings’, derived from *ginn-* ‘yin-’ in expressions like *ginn-rúnar* ‘yin-Runes’, *ginn-þeilog* *goð* ‘yin-holy Gods’, and *ginn-regin* ‘yin-Reins’. It is not at all clear that *ginn-* means ‘supernatural’; it is more likely to be cognate with OE *ginne* ‘wide, spacious’, and thereby serves to strengthen the nouns it follows (e.g. ‘vast runes’, etc.). This explanation also requires us to assume the existence of nebulous ‘supernatural beings’ called ginnings in the primæval nothingness, an idea for which there is no support.

I find a much more natural reading in Meissner, who sees *gap ginnunga* as a kenning ‘gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE]’, where *ginnunga* is gen. pl. of the well-attested poetic word *ginnungr* ‘hawk’. The proposed kenning is conventional and belongs to the type “land, path of the bird [AIR]” (Meissner 1921, p. 108). Indeed, the determinant *ginnungr* is also found in a sky-kenning in *Haustl* 15: *gll endi-lög ginnunga vé* ‘all the low mansions of hawks [SKIES] from end to end’. This interpretation is confirmed by an underappreciated passage in *Skm* 74 which lists *ginnunga-gap* among poetic synonyms for the air: *Lopt heitir ginnunga-gap ok meðal-beimr, fogl-beimr, veðr-beimr*. ‘Air is called *ginnunga-gap* (‘gap of hawks’) and middle-home, bird-home, weather-home.’ The sense of *Vsp*’s *gap ginnunga* ‘gap of hawks’ is thus the same as *Haustl*’s *vé ginnunga* ‘mansions of hawks’, viz. ‘air, atmospheric sky’.

Having determined the likely sense of the phrase, we should consider its significance in the present context. This requires a cosmological excursion. The Old Germanic pagan cosmology, like that of many other ancient religions (e.g. the Vedic with its two *ródasi* ‘World-Halves’, *ṚV* 1.10.8, 5.85.3, 7.86.1, etc.) sees the cosmos as consisting of two world-halves: Earth and Up-heaven, the land of Men and the land of Gods. The Earth is held to be a flat disc, while the Heaven (or Firmament) is a round dome above it, held up by four dwarfs (ON *dvergar* ‘dwarfs’ can also mean ‘structural pillars’) lest it fall down (*Gylf* 8:10; cf. *Arn Þorfr* 24 in *SkP* 2). Both Earth and Heaven are believed to be physically solid realms and made out of different parts of Yimer’s body: the Earth from his torso, the Heaven from his skull (*Grm* 41, *Vafþ* 21). Like the Biblical Firmament, the Heaven is made out of stone (cf. *Hárb* 15), which also explains the falling of meteors.

Between the two solid World-halves are the atmospheric skies, the Air (ON *lopt*) or the Midspace (ON *meðal-beimr* ‘middle-home’) equivalent to the *antárikṣam* of the Vedic hymns (e.g. *ṚV* 4.40.5, 5.85.3), wherein the clouds—Yimer’s brains—float (*Grm* 42). The important distinction between the empty skies and the solid Up-heaven or Firmament is seen in the aforementioned *Haustl*, which distinguishes between the ‘low SKIES’ (*Haustl* 15) and *upp-himinn* ‘Up-heaven’ (*Haustl* 16).

To conclude, the primordial state expressed in the present stanza is one where there is only emptiness or Chaos (cf. *Vafþ* 25/2 n.), while Earth and Stoney Heaven are still monstrously conjoined in the body of Yimer.

- 4      áðr Burs synir · bjǫðum of ypðu,  
2      þeir es Mið-garð · męran skópu;  
         sól skęin sunnan · á salar stęina;  
4      þa vas grund gróin · grǫnum lauki.

[R 1r/8, H 20r/5]

before the Sons of Byre raised the flatlands,  
they who created famed Middenyard.  
The sun shone from the south on the stones of the hall;  
then was the ground grown with green leek.

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ALL | The Sons of Byre, the first Gods, came to life subsequent to Yimer. They sacrificed the primordial ettin through decapitation and created the World out of his body, as told in *Grm* 41–42, *Vafþ* 21, and *Gylf* 6–8.

1 Burs synir ‘the Sons of Byre’ | In *Gylf* 6:8–10 identified as the three brothers Weden (ON *Óðinn*), Will (*Vili*), and Wigh (*Veir*), the first Gods. For their identities cf. st. 16/2: *ęsir* n. below.

1 bjǫðum of ypðu ‘raised the flatlands’ | The verb *yppa* is a causative derived from ON *upp* ‘up’, *uppi* ‘above, up, on high, remembered’ (cf. below st. 15/6a). In poetry it typically means ‘extol, lift up, announce’. Its OE cognate *yppan* means ‘bring up, bring forth, reveal’.

There is an apparent contradiction here, since the verb seems to imply that the earth was covered by the sea, something clearly stated in st. 56 below. This is problematic since st. 3/2 say plainly that there was neither earth nor sea before the lifting. With this in mind the present verse can be understood in two ways. (1) According to *Gylf* 7:3–5, the killing of Yimer flooded the world with so much blood that it drowned all the ettins save for Bearyelmer and his family, who survived by taking refuge on his canoe (*líðr*, see *Vafþ* 35 for discussion on this word and a citation of the relevant passage). Thus, the present verse would likewise allude to this primæval post-sacrificial flood and the subsequent raising of the Earth, Yimer's blood-covered body. (2) If the G version of l. 3/1b (*þat's ekki vas* 'when nothing was') is authorial, the wallow may not have intended to allude to the myth of Yimer at all, but may instead have been thinking of something like Genesis 1:2, 9–10, where Elohim makes the dry land rise up from the deep Waters. Something similar is found in *Il* 14.201 and 246, which state that Ὠκεανός, Ocean, is the origin of all Gods and, indeed, of all things. The problem with explanation (2) is that it does not resolve the contradiction: st. 3/2 still states plainly that there was not yet any sea before the Sons of Byre, and the boundless sea should still count as a sea. The parallels also fall: Greek Ocean is equivalent to the Illeaves, the primæval venomous waters whence himself Yimer originated (*Vafþ* 31), and the Biblical Creation myth is certainly a secondary development from earlier pagan mythology. As such, (1) should be preferred.

2 *Mið-garð* 'Middenyard' | The Middle Enclosure, which was created as the home of Men (*Grm* 42).

4 *grønnum lauki* 'green leek' | A sign of the golden age, for the leek (in the Old Germanic languages referring more broadly to any plant of the genus *Allium*) was in ancient times held to be the noblest plant. See Index.

- 5      **Sól** varp **sunnan**, · **sinni** Mána,  
2      **hendi** hinni **hógr**i · of **himin-jǫður**;  
         **Sól** þat né vissi, · hvar hǫn **sal**i átti;  
4      **Máni** þat né vissi, · hvat hann **megg**ins átti;  
         **stjörnur** þat né vissu, · hvar þér **staði** óttu.

[R 1r/1l, H 20r/7,  
S 3r/2l, T 4r/2,  
W TODO, U TODO]

The Sun cast from the south—the Moon's companion—  
her right hand over heaven's rim.  
The Sun knew not where halls she had;  
the Moon knew not what sort of might he had;  
the Stars knew not where seats they had.

1–2 *Sól* ... *himin-jǫður* 'The Sun ... heaven's rim' | *om.* G. 2 of *himin-jǫður* 'over heaven's rim' | *composite*; of *himin-þiodyr†* R; of *jǫður* H. 4–5 *Máni* ... *óttu* 'the Moon ... they had.' | *These lines are reversed (i.e., Sun, Stars, Moon) in RH.*

ALL | The Sun lifts herself up over the horizon and rises for the first time, but she does not know her proper course. The heavenly bodies are thus in a state of confusion and chaotic disorder.

1 *sinni* Mána 'Moon's companion' | At times mistranslated as 'her moon', understanding *sinni* as dat. sg. f. of *sinn* 'its (reflexive)'. This cannot be correct since ON possessives are inflected based on the gender of the noun possessed, not the gender of the possessor. *máni* 'moon' is masculine, and so 'her moon' would be *\*sinum Mána*.

2 of himin-jǫður ‘over heaven’s rim’ | A problematic line. (1) The reading of **R** may be normalised as *of himin-jǫ-dýr* ‘over the heaven-horse-beast(s)’ (so some recent eds., e.g. Pettit 2023), but such a compound is nonsensical and gives the whole verse the otherwise unattested stress pattern *x#pxSS*. On the other hand, the reading of **H** (*of iǫður* ‘over the rim, edge’) is clearly deficient, since it lacks the necessary alliteration on *b-*. (2) If we instead see **R**’s *‘iodyr’* as corrupted from an archetypal *\*iodur*, we can restore to *of \*himin-jǫður*, as is done here (so also e.g. Finnur Jónsson 1932, Jónas Kristjánsson and Vésteinn Ólason 2014, p. 292). Although the better reading, (2) also has problems, for in *Vǫp* a type C verse with resolution on the first lift cannot have a short second lift, which *of \*himin-jǫður* (*x#pxsx*) has (Males 2024a, p. 161).

4 Máni þat né vissi, · hvat hann megin átti ‘the Moon knew not what sort of might he had’ | For a concrete example of this “might” cf. *Háv* 137/7, where the moon is to be invoked in a blood feud. A belief in the power of the moon is found in most ancient religions. Its influence on the human mind was remarked already by Pliny (1855), 2.102, 18.75 and is witnessed in folklore by the influence of the full moon on the werewolf; cf. in English the word *lunacy* (from Latin *lūna* ‘moon’). It is known that women are particularly affected by the moon through the synchronisation of the monthly and menstrual cycles (the two in fact being doublets, “menstrual” deriving from Latin *mēnsis* ‘month’, originally ‘moon’) likely caused by the moon’s gravitational pull on the body, as proven by modern science (Helfrich-Förster et al. 2025).

6 Þá gingu regin ǫll · á rǫk-stóla,  
2 ginn-heiðog goð, · ok umb þat gétu=sk.  
Nǫtt ok niðjum · nǫfn of gófu,  
4 morgin hétu · ok miðjan dag,  
undurn ok aptan, · ǫrum at telja.

[R 1r/13, H 20r/9]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:  
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of that.  
To the night and the moon-phases they gave names;  
morning they named and mid-day:  
afternoon and evening the years for to tally.

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ALL | The Gods continue with giving order of the World. They assemble at their Thing and resolve the problem of the disorder of the heavenly bodies by appointing them to turn around in the Heavens, each according to its proper course (cf. *Vafþ* 22–25, *Grm* 38). Thereafter they establish the reckoning of time by giving names to the newly emerged cycles. This name-giving, the establishment of norms, is part of the Godly ordering of the universe and therefore also done to the weal of mankind (Nordberg 2020, p. 737). In fact, it is the very act of naming (and thereby categorising) these phenomena which sets them apart from the disordered Chaos; in this way the categories and norms, rather than being arbitrarily invented by Man, are seen as stemming directly from the Gods (Eliade 2005, pp. 21–22). (Tangentially, it might be said that this view is not exactly identical to the modern, Christian scientific attitude towards nature, which is centered around understanding the order in the perfect design of an all-knowing Creator. In the Pagan Indo-European worldview, the raw matter already exists before the Gods in the chaotic form of Yimer and the other Eitins (cf. *Vafþ* 31) or in the confused heavenly bodies. The Creation thus consists in *shaping* or directing this matter according to the Godly Will, that is, the heroic masculine creative intellect.) An interesting comparative parallel is found in the Vedic myth of the god Indra’s freeing of the trapped Dawns through the uttering of sacred formulations. Like with the name-giving here, it is there the power of the *truth* inherent in Indra’s chanting which releases the dawns, and thereby invigorates the natural cycle between night and day (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71, 125).



1–2 Þá ... gétu-sk ‘Then ... of that.’ | The first refrain (*stef*) of the poem, describing the convening of the Thing of the Gods repeated below in sts. 9/1–2, 22/1–2, and 24/1–2. The establishment of the Thing of the Gods is further described in *Gylf* 14:2–7 as cited in st. 7 below; the Thing is also mentioned in st. 46/2 below, *Hym* 39/1, *Grm* 29–30, *Bdr* 1/1–3, *Þrk* 14/1–3, and *Haustl* 10/3. A similar group of lines describing the convening of the Thing is found in *Bdr* 1/1–3 and *Þrk* 14/1–3, which follow the same structure as the present refrain. In every occurrence of either refrain outside of the present stanza, the demonstrative pronoun *þat* ‘this, that’ clearly refers to an immediately following question introduced by a *hv*-word, which describes a problem the Gods have to deal with (e.g. *Þrk* 14/3–4: ‘and of this counseled the mighty Tews: how they Loride’s hammer might find.’) Following this pattern, we would expect to find such a question following *umb þat gétu-sk* ‘took counsel of that’ in the present stanza, and so it seems reasonably plausible (though not certain) that one has been lost in transmission.

1 *regin* qll ‘all the Reins’ | All the Gods (*regin* ‘Reins’, i.e., ‘Powers, Counsels’, a pantheistic word), here acting as one body. According to *Skm* 1 twelve Gods were present at the Thing, apart from Weden; these were Thunder, Nearth, Free, Tew, Homedall, Bray, Wider, Wonnell, Wolder, Heener, Foresitter, and Lock. However, Wonnell and Lock can hardly have been seated at the Thing at the same time, since Wonnell was born to avenge Balder and Lock was bound soon after Balder’s death (cf. st. 34 below, *Lok* P8). After Balder’s death, the Gods at the Thing thus numbered twelve, including Weden, as attested in the late *Gautr* 7. The number twelve clearly belongs to historical Germanic Thing-proceedings and is the origin of the English twelve-man jury; cf. *Bdr* 1/1–3 n.

1 *røk-stóla* ‘council-seats’ | This word is only found in the present refrain but corresponds to the *séti* ‘seats’ (*Gylf* 14:2, 4, 11) and *dóm-stólar* ‘judgment-seats’ (*Gylf* 42:18, *Skm* 43) in Snorre’s prose.

2 *ginn-heilög* goð ‘yin-holy Gods’ | A reverent epithet, ‘the vast holy (i.e., inviolable) Gods’. The adj. *ginn-heilagr* ‘yin-holy’ is composed of the augmentative prefix *ginn-* ‘yin-’ (cf. OE *ginn* ‘wide, vast, ample’) + *heilagr* ‘holy, inviolable’. Outside of this refrain, *ginn-heilagr* only has one other occurrence in the Norse corpus, *Lok* 11/2: *qll ginn-heilög* goð ‘all yin-holy Gods’.

3 *Nótt* ok *niðjum* ‘the night and the moon-phases’ | Also found in *Vafþ* 24/4.

5 *órum* at *télja* ‘the years for to tally’ | Cf. *Vafþ* 22–25, where it is said that the Gods made the sun and moon turn round in heaven and created the moon-phases *glám* at *ár-tali* ‘for mankind’s tally of years’.

- 7 Hittu-sk *ęsir* · á *Iða*-velli,  
2 þęir’s *hęrg* ok *hof* · *hę*-timbruðu;  
aflla *lęđu*, · *auđ* smiđuđu,  
4 tangir skópu · ok *tól* gęrđu.

[R 1r/16, H 20r/10]

The Eese met each other on the Idewold,  
they who timbered on high harrow and hove.  
Hearths they laid; wealth they forged;  
tongs they shaped and tools they made.

2 þęir’s *hęrg* ok *hof* · *hę*-timbruðu ‘they who timbered on high harrow and hove’ | afls *kosuđu* · alls *freistuđu* ‘they exerted strength, they tried everything’ H

ALL | The Gods build their settlement. —

The whole st. is clearly a source for *Gylf* 14:2–7: *Hárr męlti: „Í upp-bafi setti bann stjórna-menn í sęti ok beiddi þá at dęma með sér ęr-lęg manna ok ráđa um skipun borgar-innar. Þat var þar, sem heitir Iða-vollr í miđri borg-inni. Var þat bit fyrsta þęira verk at gera þof þat, er sęti þęira tólft standa í ęnnur en há-sętit, þat er Al-fęđr á. Þat þús er betst gert á jęrđu ok mest. Allt er þat útan ok innan svá sem gull eitt. Í þeim stađ kalla menn Glads-beim. Annan sal gęrđu þęir; þat var borg, er gęđjur’nar áttu, ok var bann all-fęgr. Þat þús kalla menn Vin-gólf. Þar nęst gęrđu þęir þús, er þęir lęđu afla í, ok þar til gęrđu þęir hamar ok tęng ok stęđja ok þaðan af qll tól ęnnur.*



‘High spoke: “In the beginning He [= Woden, the Allfather] set men of authority in seats and summoned them to judge the orlays of men alongside Him and to rule the arrangements of the stronghold. It [= the judgment-place] was at the place called the Idewold in the middle of the stronghold. It was the first of their works to make the hove wherein there stand twelve seats of theirs other than the high-seat which Allfather owns. That house is the best one made upon the earth and the greatest. It is all without and within as if it were of gold alone. That place men call Gladsham. Another hall they made; it was a harrow, which the giddens owned, and it was all-fair. That house men call Wingolf. Thereafter they made houses wherein they laid hearths, and thereto they made a hammer and tongs and an anvil and with those all other tools.’

1 Iðavelli ‘the Idewold’ | Dat. sg. of *Iða-völlr* ‘the Plain of Industry.’

2 þeir’s horg ok hof · hót-timbruðu ‘they who timbered on high harrow and hove’ | Two formulae. — *horg ok hof* ‘harrow and hove’ is a merism, i.e., ritual structures made of stone and wood; cf. *Vafþ* 38 and *HHj* 4, as well as the Saw of Anlaf Trueson in *F*, which says that King Anlaf lét [...] *brenna hof en brjóta horga ok reisa í staðinn kirkjur* ‘had hoves burnt and harrows broken and churches raised in their stead’. — *hót-timbra* ‘timber on high’ is a rare compound. Its only other occurrence in the ON corpus is in *Grm* 16 where it describes a harrow ruled by Nearth. — This passage has often been wondered at. Why would the Gods themselves make cultic buildings? Whom do they worship? Let it be added to the present instance that they are also said to partake in the ritual sacrifice of animals, divining with their blood and feasting on their flesh (e.g. *Vsp* 61, *Hym* 1, 39, *Lok*, *Haustl* 2). This question is really not as difficult as it is made out to be, however, since the answer must surely be that the behaviour of the Gods serves as the model for virtuous human behaviour and justifies the ideology of settlement. Colonising new lands, tilling the earth, building houses and enclosures and ritual structures, sacrificing animals—if these are virtuous for humanity, they must find their model among the Gods, for “Man constructs according to an archetype” and all settlements reenact Creation (Eliade 2005, pp. 10, 76–78). This does not mean that the Gods worship themselves (or anything else); the Gods operate on the level of the macrocosm, and it is from them that the Godly Will flows. Humans connect with this Godly Will through imitating the Gods on the level of the microcosm by sacrifice and settlement; so the sacrifice of Yimer and the enclosing of “the famous Middenyard” are reenacted through the sacrifice of horses and oxen within ritual and settlement enclosures (Lincoln 1986, *passim*). See further *Grm* 41–43 and notes.

3 afla ‘Hearths’ | More specifically forges, by which we should understand that the Gods established fire in their settlement.

The civilising role of fire is found in Norse sources in the description of Icelandic settlers carrying fire around their land-claims, so e.g. *Ldn* 3.6: *En meðan Sé-mundur fór eldi um land-nám sitt* ‘But while Seamund went with fire around his land-claim’, 5.3: *Þat land fór Þorunndr eldi ok lagði til bófs* ‘Earwind went with fire throughout that land and laid it under the hove’, *Eb* 4: *för Þór-ólfr eldi um land-nám sitt* ‘Thurolf went with fire around his land-claim’. In *Ldn* 5.1 the practice is framed as a rule put in place by King Harold Fairhair to prevent Icelandic settlers claiming excessive tracts of land: *engi skyldi víðara nema en bann métti eldi yfir fara á degi með skipperjum sinum. Menn skyldu eld gera, þá er sól væri í austri. Þar skyldi gera aðra reyki, svá at hvára sei frá þórum, en þeir eldar, er gervir vátu, þá er sól var í austri, skyldi brenna til nætr. Síðan skyldu þeir ganga til þess, er sól væri í vestri, ok gera þar aðra elda.* ‘No one was to claim more [land] than that over which he might bring fire in a day with his shipmates. Men were to kindle fire when the sun was in the east. There they were to make other smoke-fires so that each fire could be seen from the other, but the fires which were made when the sun was in the east were to burn till night. Thereafter they were to walk until the sun was in the west and there make other fires.’

It seems likely that this explanation of the fire-ritual as a mere rule set down to prevent the excessive claiming of land is a later historicised explanation developed after the original reason behind the use of fire had been forgotten. The ancient roots of the practice is demonstrated by the account of the legendary Gotlandish civilising founder, Thelver, in *Gut* 1: *Gut-land bitti fyrsti maðr þann, sum Þielvarr hét. Þá var Gut-land so elusti, et þet dagum sank ok náttum var uppi. En þann maðr kvam fyrsti eldi á land, ok síðan sank þet aldrí.* ‘Gotland was first discovered by the man who was named Thelver. At that time Gotland was so uncanny [?] that it sank during the days and was up during the nights. But that man was the first who brought fire to the land, and thereafter it never sank.’ Here we see that the bringing of fire fills a role in exorcising the land and making it civilised, that is, making it conform with the natural order. This use of fire in settlements has Vedic parallels (Eliade 2005, p. 11) and fire also features prominently in Norse ritual; cf. *Grm* 43/2.

- 8      Tęflðu í tūni, · tętir vōru,  
       2      vas þeim vęttir-gis · vant ór golli,  
             und's þrjár kvōmu · þursa męyjar,  
       4      ăm-ăt=kar mjōk, · ór Jōtun-heimum.

[R 1r/18, H 20r/12]

They played Tables in the courtyard; merry were they;  
 for them was nothing golden wanting—  
 until three maidens of Thurses came,  
 most uncanny, out of the Ettinhomes.

ALL | After having settled down, the Gods are merry and content without troubles until their joy is spoiled by the coming of Ettin-women. — The whole stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 14:8–10, which explicitly identifies this period as the Golden Age (cf. l. 2 n.): *Ok því nęst smiðuðu þeir málms ok stein ok trę ok svá gnóg-liga þann málms, er gull beitr, at öll bús-gogn ok öll reiði-gogn böfðu þeir af gulli, ok er sú ęld kęlluð gull-aldr, ăđr en spillti-sk af til-kvámu kvinna'nna; þęr kómu ór Jōtun-heimum.* 'And thereafter they forged metal and stone and wood, and so abundantly [did they forge] that metal which is called gold that all their household tools and riding tools were golden. And that age is called the golden age, before it was spoiled by the arrival of the women; they came out of the Ettinhomes.'

1 Tęflðu 'played Tables' | 3rd pl. pret. ind. of *tęfla*, a causative verb derived from *tafl* 'Tables, board game', an old borrowing from Latin *tabula*. 'Tables' is used as a cognate translation; the exact type of board game referred to is unimportant, although it is certainly a game of strategy (e.g. *hnęfa-tafl* or nine men's morris) rather than one of chance. For *hnęfa-tafl* (which held the role as the chief board game in Scandinavia before the introduction of chess in the C12th) and its relatives see Murray (1952, pp. 55–64).

2 vas þeim vęttir-gis · vant ór golli 'for them was nothing golden wanting' | Indeed, even the bricks they played with were of gold (cf. st. 58). The Golden Age at the initial fulfillment of Creation is found in many mythologies (Eliade 2005, pp. 9, 112, 122, 127, 132, 135–136, 149, 154).

2 vęttir-gis 'nothing' | An archaic gen. of *vętt=ki* 'nothing', the *-ir-* representing a fossilized *i*-stem gen. sg., as ON *vęttir* 'thing' comes from PN *\*wiþtir*. The only other occurrence of this form is in the notably archaic old Icelandic Homily Book (ms. Holm perg 15 4°, fol. 36v/30).

3 þrjár ... þursa męyjar 'three maidens of Thurses' | These three maidens are never mentioned again (unless they are taken to be the three norns in st. 19, but they would then be introduced twice). It is possible that an additional stanza giving further information about them has been lost. If it originally existed, it was already absent in the version used for *Gylf*, since no additional information is found there.

4 ăm-ăt=kar 'uncanny' | The word *ăm-ăt=igr* has a clear association with supernatural ettins. It occurs in four other places in R: in *Grm* 11, *Ski* 10, and *HHj* 17 it is paired with *jōtunn* 'ettin', while in *HHj* 14 it is used by the daughter of an ettin to refer to a human hero, a clear inversion of its usual use.

- 9      Þā gingu ręgin öll · ă rōk-stōla,  
       2      ginn-ęęilōg goð, · ok umb þat gęttu-sk:  
             Hvęrr skyldi dverga · drótt of skępja  
       4      ór Brimis blōði · ok ór Bláins lęggjum?

[R 1r/20, H 20r/14,  
S 4v/3, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:  
 the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:  
 Who should shape the troop of Dwarfs  
 out of Brimmer's blood and out of Blown's legs?

3 Hværr skyldi dverga ‘Who should ... of dwarfs’ | so RWU; at skyldi dverga ‘That they should ... of dwarfs’ ST; hverir skyldu dvergar ‘Which Dwarfs should [shape the troops out of ...]’ H 3 drótt ‘the troop’ | so G; drotin ‘the lord’ R; dróttir ‘the troops’ H 3 of | so G; om. RH 3 skepja ‘shape’ | spekja (norm.) ‘soothe’ U 4 Brimis blóði ‘Brimmer’s blood’ | so RT; brimi blóðgu ‘the bloody surf’ HSWU. 4 Bláins ‘Blown’s’ | so HW; †bláms† (corrupted from \*Bláins) STU; blǫm (‘blám’) ‘blue-black’ R.

ALL | After the Golden Age is spoiled, the Gods must get their gold in some other way. For this they need the Dwarfs, who are associated with precious metals and ore-veins, and make many great treasures for the Gods (e.g. Glapner, *Eddbr* VIII, and Shidebladner, *Grm* 44). The conception of spontaneous generation is clearly also at play; according to the prevalent view in antiquity maggots and worms were thought to generate spontaneously in rotting flesh and earth, and the dwarfs were apparently likewise thought to have spontaneously generated in stone. As much is stated in *Gylf* 14:11–14, which continues with its paraphrase:

*Þar nést settu-sk goð’in upp í séti sín ok réttu dóma sína ok minntu-sk, hvaðan dvergar höfðu kviknat í mold’inni ok niðri í jörðu’nni, svá sem maðkar í holdi. Dvergar’nir höfðu skipat-sk fyrst ok tekit kviknun í holdi Ymis ok váru þá maðkar, en af at-kvæðum goða’nna urðu þeir vitandi mann-vits ok höfðu manns líki ok búa þó í jörðu ok í steinum. Móð-sognir var öðstr ok annarr Durinn.*

‘Thereafter the Gods set themselves high in their seats and made their judgments and remembered whence the Dwarfs had come to life in the ground and down in the earth like maggots in flesh. The dwarfs had first taken shape and come to life in Yimer’s flesh and were then maggots, but by the decrees of the Gods they became knowing of manwit and had the forms of a man, and yet they live in the earth and in stones. Moodsowner was the first in rank, and second was Dorn.’

Immediately after this passage, *Gylf* 14:15 quotes the present st. and st. 10/3–4 in sequence, introduced by the words *svá segir í Völu-spá*: ‘so it says in the Spae of the Wallow’.

4 ór Brimis blóði · ok ór Bláins leggjum ‘out of Brimmer’s blood and out of Blown’s legs’ | The adopted reading for this line is a composite, but is based on the distributions of variants across the mss. and the principle that the more difficult reading is the likelier. Both *brimi blóðgu* ‘the bloody surf’ and *blǫm* (‘blám’) ‘blue-black’ are thus to be taken as instances of trivialisation due to the confusion of rarely attested proper names (Males 2023b, pp. 196–197; Males and Myrvoll n.d., pp. 16–17).

The blood and legs are taken to be those of Yimer. From his bones were made the rocks and from his blood the sea (*Grm* 41, *Vafþ* 21). Explaining the creation of dwarfs from Yimer’s legs is easy, for dwarfs dwell in rocks (cf. e.g. *Yi* 2, where the Swedish king Swayther (ON *Sveigðir*) runs into a rock in pursuit of a dwarf). More difficult to explain is how the dwarfs would be made out of the sea. One suggestion is that this may be referring to the formation of salt-stones by means of evaporating salty sea-water. Another interpretation is that we are dealing with the motif of underwater stones which may have been thought to have spontaneously generated in the sea; cf. Scaldic rock-kennings like *Hált* 2: *sévar bein* ‘bone of the sea’ and *Þdr* 16: *fiarð-æpli* ‘firth-apple’ (Meissner 1921, p. 90).

4 Brimis blóði ‘Brimmer’s blood’ | Brimmer is perhaps a name for an ettin in st. 36/4 below, in which case it should be taken as a generic name here, i.e., ‘out of the ettin’s blood’.

4 Bláins ‘Blown’s’ | *Bláinn* ‘Blown’ (from *blár* ‘blue, black’) has usually been read as a poetic name for the ettin Yimer, and this is assumed here, although it is not attested as a name for him anywhere else. It is, however, attested as a dwarf-name in *Þul Dverga* 1 (SkP 3). Following Gurevich (SkP 3, p. 693), we may therefore take the b-verse as a kenning ‘the legs of Blown [dwarf] [STONES]’, but this suffers from the fact that the dwarfs have not yet been created at this point in the narrative.

- 10 Þar vas Móð-sognir · mētstr of orðinn  
2 dverga allra, · ęn Durinn annarr;  
þeir man-líkun · mǫrg of gørðu,  
4 dvergar í jørðu, · sęm Durinn sagði.

[R 1r/21, H 20r/15,  
S 4v/5, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

There was Moodsowner made the chiefest  
of all Dwarfs, but Dorn the second.

Those Dwarfs made many man-likenesses  
in the earth, as Dorn said.

1–2 Þar ... annarr ‘There ... second’ | *om.* G 1 Þar vas Móð-sognir | *so* H, (*in the paraphrase*) G ;  
Þar Mót-sognir vitnir ‘there Mootsowner wolf(?)’ R. 3 þeir man-líkun · mǫrg of gǫrðu | *so* RHU;  
þar man-líkun · mǫrg of gǫrðu=sk STW 4 í ‘in’ | *so* HG; ór ‘out of’ R 4 sem Durinn sagði ‘as  
Dorn said’ | *so* RHSW; sem þdur menn† sagði ‘as door-men(?) said’ T; sem þþeim dyrinn kendi†  
‘as the beasts(?) taught them’ U

ALL | Ll. 3–4 are cited in *Gylf* 14:15, immediately following st. 9 (see there).

1–2 Þar ... annarr ‘There ... second’ | These lines are not found in *Gylf*, but the author must have had the full stanza since *Gylf* 14:14 (“Moodsowner was the first in rank, and second was Dorn”, see st. 9) clearly derives from ll. 1–2. They were likely omitted by the author of *Gylf* as superfluous.

3 man-líkun ‘man-likenesses’ | The Dwarfs were in the shape of men, but not quite human. In the creation of the Dwarfs before men, we may find a reflex of a motif common throughout world mythology: the creation of several failed or incomplete generations of sentient beings by the God(s) prior to the current race of humanity. These failed or ancient generations are typically created out of other materials than those used for present humanity, display non-human features and uncanny abilities, and are either destroyed or turned into sprites or animals. Mythological parallels include the five ages of man (*viz.* the Golden Age, Silver Age, Bronze Age, Heroic Age, and Iron Age) in Hesiod’s *Works and Days* 109–201; the jinn in Islam, created out of smokeless fire prior to the creation of Man out of clay (*Qur’ān* 15:26–27); and the several attempts at creating humans in the pre-Columbian Mayan *Popol Vuh*, where the first generation was made out of earth and mud, but destroyed for its weakness (ll. 434–517), the second out of effigies of carved wood, becoming the spider monkeys (518–837), while the third and successful creation of humanity was out of maize (4822–4939) (Christenson 2007, pp. 64–75, 178–181). The Norse Dwarfs fit surprisingly well into this typology. They are created out of stone (whereas the first humans are made out of wood), are described in sources as unusually lustful and greedy, but also as masterful craftsmen, and are a form of sprite or earthly daemon.

3–4 þeir ... sagði ‘Those ... said.’ | The mss. readings offer two conflicting versions of the creation of the dwarfs. (1) STW: The dwarfs arise on their own through spontaneous generation; this is supported by the prose of *Gylf* 14:11–14 (see note to previous st.) and by the form of the stanza quoted there in the non-U mss., but it may have been changed to correspond to the author’s vision (*cf.* st. 38/3 n. below). (2) RHU: the dwarfs Moodsowner and Dorn shape “man-likenesses”, most likely lesser Dwarfs, out of the soil. For stemmatic reasons, the present ed. adopts (2).

(For sts. 11–15—the *Dwarf-tallies*—see Appendix to the poem.)

- 16 Und’s þrír kvǫmu · ór því liði  
2 qfl=gir ok ǫst=kir · ęsir at húsi;  
fundu à landi · líttr megandi  
4 Ask ok ęmblu · ęr-log-lausa.

[R 1v/1, H 20r/26]

Until three came out of that host,  
strong and loving Eese along the settlement.  
They found on the land the little availing  
Ash and Emble, or lay-less.

1 þrír | *emend.*; þrjár RH 1 ór því liði | so R; þussa brúðir H. 2 qfl-gir ok øst-kir 'strong and loving' | øst-kir ok qfl-gir 'loving and strong' H

ALL | Sts. 16–17 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 9:3–7:

*Þá er þeir gengu með sévar-ströndu Burs synir, fundu þeir tré tvau ok tóku upp tré'n ok skopuðu af menn. Gaf inn fyrsti ond ok lif, annarr vit ok bráring, þriði á-sjónu, mál ok heyrn ok sjón; gáfu þeim klæði ok nøfn. Hét karl-maðr'inn Askr, en kona'n Embla, ok ólsk þaðan af mann-kind'in, sú er byggð'in var gefinn undir Mið-garði.*

'When the sons of Byre (cf. n. to l. 2: *ęsir*) were walking along the sea-shore they found two pieces of wood (*tré*) and they took up the pieces of wood and shaped men out of them. The first [god] gave breath and life; the second [gave] intelligence and movement; the third [gave] outward appearance, speech and hearing and sight. They gave them clothes and names. The man was called Ash and the woman Embla, and from them was begotten mankind, to whom the settlement within Middenyard was given.'

Based on the just-cited passage, the Gods are generally understood to have created mankind out of pieces of driftwood, and that is most likely what is being referred to by Snorre. Yet no such detail is found in the present stanza; it may, therefore, instead be a later Icelandic or Snorronean reinterpretation. As pointed out by Hultgård (2006), the evidence from comparative mythology in fact suggests that the first humans were originally thought of as being made out of living, growing trees.

The descent of humans from trees is probably the reason behind the extensive use of words for trees in kennings for men and women in Norse poetry (see SkP I, p. lxxv ff., Meissner 1921, pp. 245, 266–272, 410). This kenning-type is most common in Scaldic poetry, but at times also appears in Eddic poetry (e.g. *Sigrdr* 5: *bryn-þings apaldr* 'apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]').

1 Und's 'Until' | The first line, beginning with the conjunction *und's* 'until', is clearly supposed to connect syntactically to an immediately preceding stanza describing some ongoing action, as in st. 4/1 above: *áðr* 'before'. For other instances of sts. beginning with *und's* cf. *Hym* 30, *Sigs* 3, 51, 2 *Guðr* 3; in SkP: *Haustl* 11, *Þdr* 10, *Anon Pl* 31.

If the dwarf-tallies (sts. 11–15) are later inserts, the preceding stanza would be st. 10, in which case the creation of men is probably to be understood as following and surpassing the creation of the dwarfs; cf. note to st. 10/3: *man-likun*.

1 þrír kvömu · ór því liði 'three came out of that host' | Both mss. show corruption from st. 8 in their use of the f. *þrjár* 'three' for the m. \**þrír*. H goes further in replacing the b-verse *ór því liði* 'out of that host' with *þussa brúðir* 'brides of thurses'. That this is nothing other than corruption is clearly shown by the m. pl. *qfl-gir ok øst-kir ęsir* 'strong and loving Eese' in l. 2.

2 øst-kir 'loving' | The Wallow depicts the creation of Mankind as an act of love. For our benefit, the Gods also created Middenyard (*Vsp* 4/2, *Grm* 42), the sun, and the moon with its phases (*Vsp* 6, *Vafþ* 22–25).

2 ęsir 'Eese' | Weden, Heener, and Lothar. This stands in contradiction to *Gylf* 9:3–4 which tells us that the gods who made the first men were the sons of Byre, in *Gylf* 6:8–10 (cf. st.4) identified with Weden, Will, and Wigh. If we are to reconcile this difficulty we would have to see Heener and Lothar as the equivalents of the latter two, but that identification is rather unlikely.

To begin with, not even the notoriously systematising *Gylf* equates Heener with Will or Wigh, nor does it mention Lothar at all. In Scaldic poetry the two gods Heener and Lothar are found in a few kennings for Weden, but unlike kennings involving Will, these are always of the type 'friend of Lothar/Heener' [= Weden] and never 'brother of Lothar/Heener' [= Weden]. Heener and Lothar instead seem to be distinct gods. See further the notes to their names in st. 17.

2 at húsi 'along the settlement' | Lit. 'along the house.' An adverbial; the Gods were walking on the outskirts of their settlement.

3–4 lítt megandi ... or-log-lausa 'little availing ... orlay-less' | Prior to the gifts from the Gods the human beings were immobile and without orlay (fate, destiny), which is thus seen to be one of the distinguishing features of mankind.

4 Ask ok Eṃblu ‘Ash and Emble’ | The ancestors of all human beings; cf. Life and Lafthrasher who repopulate the world after its rebirth (*Vafþ* 44–45). Ash (nom. *Ask*) is easily identified with the same-named wood species (*Fraxinus excelsior*), but the form Emble (nom. *Eṃbla*) is more difficult. Her name is often translated as “Elm”, but the ON word for that tree (*Ulmus glabra*) is the m. *almr*. A possible etymology is metathesis from earlier \**Eṃlma* (< PN \**almilō* ‘young elm tree’), a f. *n*-stem derivative of the same type as *þella* ‘young fir tree’ (< PN \**þallilō*) ~ *þell* ‘fir tree’ (< PN \**þallu*), although the *-b-* remains unexplained.

17 Qnd þau né ǫttu, · ǫð þau né hǫfðu,

2 lǫ né lėti · né litu góða;

qnd gaf Ǫðinn, · ǫð gaf Hǫnir,

4 lǫ gaf Lóðurr · ok litu góða.

[R 1v/3, H 20r/27]

Breath they had not; wode they had not,  
not guile nor sound nor goodly hues.

Weden gave breath; Heener gave wode;  
Lothar gave guile and goodly hues.

1 Qnd ‘Breath’ | The breath of life or life force which sets living beings apart from dead matter. The word *qnd* originally means simply ‘breath’ (cf. Gothic *uz-anan* ‘to breathe out’), but the semantic development BREATH > VITALITY is by no means unparalleled, as seen by the Latin root-cognate *animus* ‘life force, vitality; (later) soul’ vs. the Greek ἀνεμος ‘wind, breeze’. All these words are ultimately from PIE \**b<sub>2</sub>enb<sub>2</sub>*- ‘breathe’ (Kroonen 2013, pp. 26–27).

After the conversion to Christianity, ON *qnd* takes on the derived sense ‘spirit, soul’, as seen on Scandinavian memorial runestones where it is used interchangeably with the Anglo-Saxon borrowing *sól* ‘soul’ (e.g. Sö 10 *Guð hjalpi qnd hans* ‘God help his breath’ vs. Sö 8 *Guð hjalpi sól hans* ‘God help his soul’) and paired with it in at least 14 separate inscriptions (e.g. U 358 *Guð hjalpi hans qnd ok sól* ‘God help his breath and soul’). This new semantic, probably calqued from the Latin *spiritus* ‘breath; spirit’, is also charted in the Scaldic corpus, where *qnd* (regardless of sense) makes its first securely dateable appearance in Hallfrith’s memorial poem to Anlaf Trueson (Hfr *Erföl* 27 in SkP 1) dated to ca. 1001 AD.

The lack of pre-Christian Scaldic attestations of *qnd* may lead one to question the authenticity of the sense ‘life (force)’ in the pagan period, but I think that it must have existed to begin with in order for the new sense of ‘spirit’ to have been acceptable to the Norse converts. If *qnd* had meant merely ‘respiration’ it would probably have been displaced entirely by the Christian loan-word *sól* ‘soul’ rather than have seen acceptance even amongst former pagan poets like Hallfrith. In any case the sense ‘life’ is attested in the most likely pre-Christian Eddic poem *Sigsk* 33, 53 (*qndu látit* ‘lost his life’), 60 (*qndu tyna* ‘id.’). Also in later poetry a person who dies is often said to *láta* or *tyna qndu* (cf. *HHf* 37; in SkP *Ótt Knútdr* 9, *Þorm Lv* 13, *ÞSjár Þórdr* 3, *Ív Sig* 30, *ESk Geisl* 60, *Bjbp Joms* 41, *Þórðh Lv* 9, *QrvOdd Evdr* 12, 39, *Anon Brúðv* 27), whereas it is not said once of the *sól*; a Christian could hardly say that a person who dies “loses his soul”.

The use of *qnd* in *Gylf* 3:10—printed at the beginning of this book for its simple beauty—is distinctly in the Christian sense ‘spirit’: *Hitt er þó mest, er bann gerði mann’inn ok gaf bonum qnd þá, er lifa skal ok aldri tyna-sk, þótt líkam’inn fíni at moldu eða brenni at qsku* ‘Yet the greatest thing is when He [= Weden, the Allfather] made the man and gave him the “breath” which shall live and never perish although the body may moulder to dust or burn to ashes.’

1 ǫð ‘wode’ | Outside of the present st., ON *ǫðr* ‘wode’ (gen. sg. *ǫðar*) is used only in Scaldic poetry or in prose dealing with Scaldic poetry and then always with the sense ‘poem, poetry’. This is most likely also its sense in the cpd. *Ǫð-rórir* ‘Woderearer’, one of the vats in which the Mead of Poetry was kept (*Háv* 107).

The present stanza thus gives us the word’s only Eddic attestations, but its exact sense in the present st. is unlikely to be merely ‘poetry’ (which was after all given by Weden, not Heener, and that at a later time; see *Háv* 103–110). To determine the proper sense of ‘wode’ we ought to consider its etymology.

As a m. *u*-stem the noun *ōðr* must derive from PGmc. *\*wōþuz*. PGmc. words from the same root include the nouns *\*wōdaz* ‘madness, fury’ (> OE *wōd* ‘madness’, OHG *uuot* ‘fury’) and *\*wōþó* (> OE *wōþ* ‘song’) and the adj. *\*wōdaz* ‘mad, furious’ (> ON *ōðr* ‘id.’, OE *wōd* ‘mad, rabid’, Gothic *wōds* ‘possessed with the devil’).

Two Germanic theonyms are clearly derived from the root: Weden (ON *Óðinn* < PGmc. *\*Wōdanaz*) and Wode (ON *Óðr* < PGmc. *\*Wōdaz*). Weden literally means ‘lord, possessor of wode’ (suffixed with PIE *\*-nós* ‘lord, master of’, cf. his name *Herjann* < PGmc. *\*harjanaz* < PIE *kor-yo-nos* ‘lord of hosts, chieftain’ > Greek *κοιπᾶνος* ‘king, ruler’), while Wode (unlike the noun *ōðr* an *a*-stem as seen by Vsp 24) is probably a nominalisation of the adjective and thus means ‘mad, frenzied, inspired’.

The PIE root, which is found only in Germanic, Italic, and Celtic, is *\*wēb₂t-* and the alternation between the senses ‘poetry’ ~ ‘fury’ is also seen in the other branches. PGmc. *\*wōþuz* derives from PIE *\*wēb₂t-u-s* (> OIr. *fáth* ‘cause, motive, subject, prophecy, composition’, Old Welsh *gwaur* ‘song of praise’). Also related are Latin *vātēs* ‘prophet, seer; poet’ and Gaulish *ōuātēs* ‘a type of priest’ (pl., found in Strabo’s *Geography* 4.4.4) (Kroonen 2013, p. 592).

The IE root sense, clearly retained in Celtic and Germanic, thus appears to be a state of frenzied poetic inspiration, *furor poeticus*, but the sense in the present stanza may also cleave closer to ‘intelligent thought, mind’, or the power to express one’s thoughts with words, which is unique to man.

2 *lō* ‘guile’ | The exact sense of this word is uncertain. It is otherwise found referring to seawater near the shore, poetically to the ‘sea’, for which reason its sense here has sometimes been interpreted as ‘blood’. *Skm* 85 gives *lō* as a poetic synonym for ‘hair’, but it seems unlikely that hair would be mentioned next to the breath of life and intellect. I tentatively take it to be an otherwise unattested variant of the poetic word *lē* ‘guile, deceit’, here in the sense ‘skill, craft, cunning’. For the vowel alternation cf. *bré* ‘corpse’ (declined identically and rhyming with *lē*) < PGmc. *\*braiwaq*, irregularly metathesised from PIE *\*krow(h₂)-yóm* (Kroonen 2013, p. 242) vs. *brár* ‘raw, bloody’ < *\*brauaz* < PIE *\*krow(h₂)-os* (Kroonen 2013, p. 244).

2 *litu* *gōða* ‘goodly hues’ | The ruddy complexion of the living in contrast to the pallor of the dead. — The reading *litu* *gōða* ‘hues of the Gods’ must be rejected for metrical reasons since the lift in *gōða* cannot be short (Males 2024a, p. 161); cf. st. 5/2 n. above.

3 *Hönir* ‘Heener’ | An obscure god; he is one of the twelve Eese present at the Thing of the Gods (*Skm* 1) and takes over the role as *sacerdos civitatis* of the Gods after Weden dies, for which cf. Vsp 60 below. His name is found thrice in Scaldic poetry, all in kennings for Lock of the type ‘FRIEND/COMPANION of Heener [= Lock]’ (*Haustr* 3/4b, 7/4a, 12/2a).

Heener plays a minor role in the mythology. In *Yng* 4 he is one of the gods sent as a hostage from the Eese to the Wanés alongside Mimer, the wisest of the Eese; the Wanés in turn give over Quasher, their wisest man. Heener is soon made a chieftain among the Wanés but is not very clever, and when present at the Thing without Mimer, the only thing he can say is *ráði aðrir* ‘let others decide’.

Heener further figures in two adventures alongside Weden and Lock, viz. in the encounter with Thedse (*Haustr* 1–13, *Skm* 2–3) and in the origin of the Nivling hoard (*Reg* P1–9, *Skm* 46), but he plays no active role in either narrative.

Rydberg (1886, p. 552) convincingly argues that Heener is connected with the stork, deriving his name from the same root as Greek *κόκκος* ‘swan’ and Sanskrit *śakuná* ‘bird of omen’ (cf. Kroonen 2013, p. 240), and noting that his epithets *langi fótr* ‘long foot’ and *aur-konungr* ‘mud-king’ (both found in *Skm* 22) accurately describe that bird. According to Rydberg, Heener’s giving of wode would then be associated with the later folk-myth of the stork that brings children to their parents, just as it is Heener who gives humans their mental faculties and thereby their unique human aspect.

4 *Lóðurr* ‘Lothar’ | An even more obscure god than Heener; his name is not found in the Poetic Edda and only twice in Scaldic poetry (*Hátt* 8/4a (SkP 1) and *HaukrV Íslðr* 1/1b (SkP 4)), in both cases in the kenning *vinr Lóðurs* ‘friend of Lothar [= Weden]’. Lothar is possibly to be identified with the obscure figure *logaþore* ‘(flame-)darer(?)’ who appears alongside the two gods *wodan* (*Wōdan*, ‘Weden’) and *wigiponar* ‘(battle(?)-Thunder’) on the 6th c. German Nordendorf fibula I (KJ 151) from near Augsburg, Bavaria, although this is uncertain (Turville-Petre 1975, p. 143). Since the triad Weden, Heener, and Lock figures in other sources, Lothar may also be identified with Lock, whose name may well be a nickname formed from the older Lothar (Turville-Petre 1975, pp. 143–144). This identification is strongly supported if the above conjecture is right that Lothar’s gift *lō* is an alternative form of *lē* ‘guile, deceit’, a word closely associated with Lock.

- 18 Ask veit'k standa, · heitir Ygg·drasils,  
 2 hór baðmr, ausinn · hvíta auri;  
 þaðan koma döggar · þér's í dala falla;  
 4 stendr é yfir grónn · Urðar brunni.

[R 1v/5, H 20r/29,  
 S 5r/30, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

An ash I know standing; it is called Ugdrassle's,  
 a high tree sprinkled with white mud.  
 Thence come the dew-drops which fall in the dales;  
 it stands ever green over the Well of Weird.

1 standa 'standing' | so RHU; ausinn 'sprinkled' STW 1 Ygg·drasils | so S; Ygg·drasill all others  
 2 baðmr 'tree' | borinn 'born' (wo. doubt corrupt) U. 2 ausinn 'sprinkled' | heilag 'holy' G 3  
 þér's | es ST 3 dala | dali STU 4 é | om. U 4 grónn | †grvnn† S; †grein† U

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 16:13, introduced by the words *Svá sem hér segir* 'Just as it says here'.  
*Gylf* 16:10–12 provides context:

*Enn er þat sagt, at nornir þér, er byggja við Urðar brunni, taka hvern dag vatn í brunni'num ok með aur'inn þann, er liggir um brunni'nn, ok ausa upp yfir ask'inn, til þess at eigi skuli limar hans tréna eða fína. En þat vatn er svá beilagt, at allir blutir, þeir er þar koma í brunni'nn, verða svá hvítir sem hinna sú, er skjall heitir, er innan liggir við egg-skurn.*

'It is Furthermore said that the Norns who dwell by the Well of Weird fetch water in the Well every day, and along with it the mud which lies around the well, and they sprinkle it up over the Ash so that its branches should not harden or rot. But that water is so holy that all things which come into the well turn as white as the membrane called the shell-membrane which lies inside the eggshell.'

Following the st. *Gylf* 16:14–15 continues: *Sú dagg, er þaðan af fellr á jörð'ina, þat kalla menn hunang-fall, ok þar af fôðask bý-flugur. Fluglar tveir fôðask í Urðar brunni. Þeir heita svanir, ok af þeim fuglum hefir komit þat fugla-kyn, er svá heitir.* 'That dew which falls thereof onto the earth do men call 'honey-fall', and thereof bees feed themselves. Two fowls feed themselves in the Well of Weird. They are called 'swans', and from those fowls has come the race of fowls so called.'

1 Ask ... Ygg·drasils 'Ash ... Ugdrassle's' | The Ash of Ugdrassle, the World Tree. That the Ash stands in the very center of the world is shown by *Grm* 26/4, where we learn that all waters run their course from it, and *Grm* 31, which tells us that its roots reach and wrap around the world of Men, the Underworld, and the Ettinhomes.

2 ausinn · hvíta auri 'sprinkled with white mud' | Cf. st. 26/3–4 below.

- 19 Þaðan koma meyjar · margs vitandi  
 2 þrjár ór þeim sal · es und þolli stendr;  
 Urð hétu eina, · aðra Verðandi,  
 4 —sköru á skíði— · Skuld ina þriðju  
 þér lög lögðu, · þér líf kœru,  
 6 alda börnum, · ør-lög seggja.

[R 1v/8, H 20r/31]

Thence come maidens, much-knowing:  
 three out of the hall which stands beneath the tree.  
 Weird they called one, the other Werthing  
 —they scored billets—Shild the third.  
 They laid down laws; they chose lives  
 for the children of men, the orlay of youths.



2 sal ‘hall’ | so H, (in the paraphrase) G ; sé ‘lake’ R 2 und ‘under’ | á ‘on’ H 6 seggjia ‘of youths’ | at seggia ‘to say’ H

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 15:26–29: *Þar stendr salr einn fagr undir aski’núm við brun’nin, ok ór þeim sal koma þrjár meyjar, þær er svá beita: Urðr, Verðandi, Skuld. Þessar meyjar skapa mönnum aldr; þær kllum vér nornir.* ‘There stands a single fair hall beneath the ash-tree by the well, and out of that hall come three maidens who are called thus: Weird, Werthing, Shild. These maidens shape the ages of men; we call them Norns.’

For the three Norns, we may compare a strikingly similar description in the late ancient Gallo-Roman source *De medicamentis* (TODO: cite), which relates a traditional Celtic myth of a tree standing in the middle of the sea, kept by three virgins. A similar motif is found on numerous syncretic Gallo-Roman altars from western Germany, which depict the three *Matronae Andrusteibae* ‘Tree-Standing Mothers’ next to a great tree (TODO: cite). The three Norns also correspond closely to the Greek Μοῖραι, the three weavers of fate (cf. 1 *HHund* 3/1 n.).

2 þolli ‘tree’ | Literally ‘fir’, but the word is only used for the alliteration and the species is generic. The same may perhaps apply to *askr* ‘ash’ above.

3 Urð ‘Weird’ | Acc. of *Urðr* ‘fated course of events,’ lit. ‘that which has become’. The cognates of this word feature prominently in a fatalistic context in West Germanic poetry (TODO).

3 Verðandi ‘Werthing’ | ‘That which is becoming,’ the pres. participle of *verða* ‘to become, happen’. The name is only found here and in *Gylf* 15:27.

4 sköru á skiði ‘they scored billets’ | *skið* refers to a thin piece of split wood, esp. as used for firewood, but can also mean ‘plank’ or ‘ski’. The sense here is most likely that the norns cut notches for the number of years allotted to each human being. This notion is unparalleled (TODO: is it?) in mediaeval literary sources, but the method of time keeping may represent a predecessor of the mediaeval calendars used by the Northern European peasantry to track the lunar cycle and the Catholic feast-days. These consist of carved wooden sticks where each day is represented either by a notch (in Norway and England) or by a rune of the futhork (in Sweden and Estonia) and go under a variety of names; *primstav* in Norway, *runstav* in Sweden, *sirvilaud* in Estonia, and clog almanac in England. Although these later wooden calendars are undoubtedly influenced by the timekeeping of the Church, the present line may just about hint that there existed a native, pre-Christian Germanic calendrical tradition.

4 Skuld ‘Shild’ | Acc. of *Skuld(r)* ‘that which shall be’. The nom. should probably have an *-r*, though that is not attested in *Gylf* 15:27. The name is only found here and in *Gylf* 15:27.

5 lög ‘laws’ | With this word we should understand ‘decisions, decrees,’ for pre-Christian Scandinavian Law was based on custom and precedent. Similar legalistic vocabulary for fate is found in the *dómar* ‘judgments’ and *kviðir* ‘decrees, rulings’ of the Norns (*Fáfn* 11/1, *Hamð* 30/4).

20 Þat man hōn folk-víg · fyrst i hēimi,  
2 es Goll-vēigu · gēirum studdu  
ok i hōll Hāars · hāna brēnndu,  
4 þrysvar brēnndu · þrysvar borna,  
opt, ò-sjaldan, · þó hōn ęnn lifir.

[R 1v/11, H 20v/5]

That troop-conflict she recalls first in the Home  
when Goldwey they impaled with spears  
and in the hall of Hougher (= Weden) [= Walhall] burned her.  
Thrice they burned the one thrice born,  
often, unseldom—yet she liveth still.

3 Hāars | Hārs RH 4 þrysvar brēnndu | written twice H

ALL: | A very cryptic stanza. The name Goldwey is not mentioned in any other source, nor is the underlying story, but she was apparently slain, burned, and reborn three times. Goldwey is perhaps to be identified with the wallow of the poem herself, which would explain the cryptic “yet she lives still”.

1 folk-vig ‘troop-conflict’ | *folk* here carries its older meaning ‘troop, band’, as seen e.g. in the Slavic borrowing exemplified by Russian полк ‘regiment, host, army’.

3 Háars ‘Hougher’ | Hiatus must be restored for metrical reasons; cf. Males (2023a, pp. 265–266). *Háarr*, usually normalised as *Hǫarr*, is a name for Weden also found in Scaldic poetry, perhaps < \**haiþa-barjar* ‘one-eyed warrior’. It should not be confused with Weden’s names *Hárr* ‘Hoary’ and *Hǫr* ‘High’.

3 hāna | The meter requires the pronoun to have a long syllable.

- 21 Hēiði hétu, · hvar’s til húsa kom,  
2 völu vøl-spáa, · vitti ganda;  
seǰð hōn hvar’s kunni, · seǰð hōn hug lēikinn;  
4 ē vas hōn angan · illrar brúðar.

[R 1v/13, H 20v/7]

Hode they called her where to houses she came,  
the well-spaeing wallow; she bewitched gands.  
She ensorcelled where she could; she ensorcelled deluded minds;  
she was always the delight of an evil bride.

1 kom, | *add.* ok H 3 hvar’s | *so* (‘hvars hvn’) H; *om.* R 3 hug | *so* H; *om.* R

1 Hēiði ‘Hode’ | Acc. sg. of \**Hēiðr* ‘bright, splendid’.

2 ganda ‘gands’ | Familiar spirits. TODO: elaborate.

- 22 Þa gingu regin ql · à røk-stóla,  
2 ginn-hēilōg goð, · ok umb þat gēttu=sk:  
Hvárt skyldu ēsir · af-ráð gjalda,  
4 eða skyldu goð’in ql · gildi ēiga?

[R 1v/16, H 20v/9]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:  
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:  
Whether the Eese should yield tribute  
or all the Gods should hold a banquet?

ALL: | Sts. 22–23 deal with the obscure war between the Eese and the Wanes, two tribes of supernatural beings. The war is most fully described in *Yng* 4, which also features a long description of the hostages: *Óðinn fór með her á hendr Vǫnum, en þeir urðu vel við ok vgrðu land sitt, ok hefðu ymsir sigr; berjuðu hvárir á land annarra ok gerðu skaða. En er þat leiddi-sk hvárum-tveggjum, lögðu þeir milli sín séttar-stefnu, ok gerðu frið ok seldu-sk gíslar.* ‘Weden went with a host against the Wanes, but they responded well and defended their land, and both sides had alternating victories; either side raided the land of the other and did harm. But when that seemed loathsome to both sides, they held a conciliatory settlement between them and made peace and traded hostages.’

The war is also alluded to in *Gylf* 23:6 (edited in the pres. ed. under *Eddbr* II), which mentions how Nearth was one of the hostages sent by the Wanæs, and *Skm* 5, which explains the origin of the Mead of Poetry (for which cf. *Háv* 103–110): *Þat váru upp-höf til þess, at goð'in höfðu ó-sétt við þat folk, er Vanir heita. En þeir lögðu með sér frið-stefnu ok settu grið á þá lund, at þeir gengu hvárir-tveggju til eins kers ok spýttu í bráka sinum* ‘This was the origin of it, that the Gods had hostile relations with the folk called the Wanæs. But they held a peace-settlement amongst each other and made a truce by the following means, that each of them went to a vat and spit their spittle into it.’ As the relevant sources (the Prose Edda and *Yng*) are closely related and probably both written by the same author, Snorre, the Eese-Wane war and, indeed, the very existence of the Eese and the Wanæs as distinct tribes (rather than synonyms for the Gods as a collective) has been argued by Simek (2010) to be a Snorronean concoction, as part of that author’s learned pre-history of Scandinavia. This argument is supported by the analysis of Frog and Roper (2011), who show that the ON term *vanir* ‘Wanæs’ is used only in Eddic poetry—not Scaldic—and, at that, exclusively in alliterative positions. Even so, a straightforward reading of *Vsp* 33/3–4 does see the *vanir* ‘Wanæs’ breaking down the fortification of the *esir* ‘Eese’. When we compare this with *Vafþ* 38–39, which explicitly contrasts the Wanæs and the Eese, the two do in fact seem to be distinct groups also in the Poetic Edda. One point of nuance does remain: as pointed out by Frog (2021), the term *óss* ‘Os’, although turned into the name of a tribe by Snorre (‘the Eese’), is originally likely nothing other than an animate poetic synonym for the neutral *goð* ‘god’. In fact, even in most of our sources dealing with the Eese-Wane war, the former are described as *goð* ‘Gods’, which does not encompass the Wanæs (so *Vafþ* 39, *Skm* 5, *Gylf* 23:6). A counterpoint to this argument is, however, that ‘all the Gods’ in l. 4 does seem to include both Eese and Wanæs.

4 *goð'in* *oll* ‘all the Gods’ | The clitic definite *-in* is very rare in older ON poetry. This is its only occurrence in *Vsp*, but it should be understood in the context of its preceding the adjective *oll*, so that it is not in fact a true definite (cf. *Lok* 52/4). — Here all the Gods (viz., the Eese and the Wanæs) seem to be contrasted with the Eese; cf. note to ALL above.

- 23 Fleygði Óðinn · ok í folk of skaut;  
 2 þat vas enn folk-víg · fyrr í heimi;  
 brotinn vas borð-veggr · borgar ása,  
 4 knóttu vanir víg-spó · völlu sporna.

[R 1v/17, H 20v/11]

Weden hurled and shot into the troop;  
 that was yet a troop-conflict earlier in the Home.  
 Broken was the plank-wall of the stronghold of the Eese;  
 the Wanæs by a war-spear did tread the fields.

2 *fyrr* ‘earlier’ | so H; *fyrrst* ‘first’ R

1 Fleygði Óðinn · ok í folk of skaut ‘Weden hurled and shot into the troop’ | The object, a spear, is understood. — This first spear-throw was ritually reenacted during battle, so *Eb* 44: *þá skaut Stein-pórr spjóti at fœnum síð til heilla sér yfir flokk Snorra* ‘then Stanthur shot a spear according to ancient custom for his fortune over Snorre’s troop’ and *Styrb* 2, where the Swedish king Eric devotes himself as a sacrifice within a period of ten years in exchange for victory. In return, Weden gives him a reed and tells him to hurl it into the opposing host with the phrase *Óðinn á yðr alla* ‘Weden owns you all!’ Eric does so, and the reed turns into a spear in the air (for this motif cf. *Gaur* 7 as summarized in *Háv* 138 n.). As it flies over his foes they are stricken by terror and blindness before being buried in a landslide.

It was customary among the Germanic pagans that the battle-slain (*valr*) were devoted to Weden; cf. Þjorn *Harkv* 12 (SkP 1): *Valr lá þar á sandi · vitinn inum ein-eygja // Friggjar faðm-byggvi* ‘The slain lay there on the sand set apart for the one-eyed bosom-dweller [HUSBAND] of Frig [= Weden]’. The consecration could also be done as a thank-offering after a victory, as in *Heiðr* 7: *Heið-rekr kveð-sk nú gjalda fyrir son sinn þetta lið allt, er drept var, ok gaf þann nú þennan val Öðni* ‘Heathric now declares that he, in exchange for his son[s] life, pays up the whole part of the army which was killed, and he now gave these battle-slain to Weden.’ In the afterlife these men would join the god as Oneharriers in Walhall (cf. *Grm* 14, *Hárþ* 24, runic inscription N B380 edited below under Galders). The sacrifice also included captives, which were at times executed by hanging (*Háv* 138 n.) and which may be the reason why Weden is also called *Hapta-guð* ‘God of Captives’ (*Gylf* 20:10). As seen below, even the weapons of the vanquished were part of the sacrifice.

This type of devotion of an entire army was not uncommon in Germanic antiquity and is securely attested in both history and archeology. Among historical sources I particularly wish to mention Orosius, *History* 5.16.5–6, describing the battle of Arausio fought in 105 BC between the Romans and the Germanic tribes of the Cimbri and Teutons: “After capturing the two Roman camps and a vast amount of booty, the enemy destroyed everything that they had laid their hands on in some new, unexpected form of curse. 6 Clothing was ripped up and discarded, gold and silver thrown into the river, the men’s armour was torn apart, the horses’ harness scattered and the horses themselves drowned in the river, while the men had nooses tied round their necks and were hanged from trees. In this way the victor knew no booty nor the vanquished any mercy.” (Orosius 2010, p. 235).

The most relevant archeological finds are the various Northern European bogs and wetlands where horses and arms, presumably belonging to defeated foes, have been mutilated and defaced (e.g. by whipping the horses, bending the swords) before their submersion. This defacing is to be explained by the fact that the objects, having been devoted and made holy unto the god, had to be made materially worthless and unusable to men, thereby releasing their inherent worldly power. This is confirmed by Tacitus, *Annals* 13.57 who describes how the Chatti, *victores diversam aciem Marti ac Mercurio sacravere, quo voto equi, viri, cuncta occidioni dantur* ‘had devoted, in the event of victory, the enemy’s army to Mars and Mercury, a vow which consigns horses, men, everything indeed (on the vanquished side) to destruction.’ For Germanic devotional sacrifice cf. further Jens Peter Schjødt (2020b, p. 617), Jens Peter Schjødt (2020a, pp. 1166–1168), for bog burials cf. *Vsp* 38 n. below, for human sacrifice to Weden generally cf. *Háv* 138 n.

Outside of the Germanic sphere similar customs of holy war were practiced among the Romans (Latin *devotio*), as told in cf. Livy 8.9–10 where the Roman consul of 340 BC, Publius Decius Mus, (like king Eric in *Styrþ*) devotes not just the opposing legions but also himself, although Livy comments that this self-devotion was not strictly necessary for the ritual. Similarly, the Jews, as part of their martial rites (Hebrew *הִקְדִּישׁוּ* *hērem*; Lohfink 1986), would devote entire cities or nations to YHWH (Deuteronomy 20:16–17, Joshua 6:17–21, Joshua 8:1–29; note in Joshua 8:18 the detail of the god-given spear that leads to victory), after which, like in the Germanic bog deposits, also the arms and property of the vanquished were to be destroyed or set aside for the god (Leviticus 27:28–29).

2 fyrr ‘earlier’ | The R reading can hardly be correct, as this st. is describing a different war than the first (that of st. 20); it has probably arisen due to the similarity with st. 20/1.

3 borð-veggr ‘plank-wall’ | A dis legomenon in the Old Norse corpus; its only other occurrence is in Þloft *Glekkv* 6 (SkP 1) from ca. 1032, where it describes some kind of wooden structure in which church-bells ring, probably a part of a stave-church. I take it to refer to the wooden fortification of the stronghold of the Eese, i.e., Osyard. Cf. note to st. 24.

4 víg-spó ‘war-spae’ | The Wanæs used a magic prophecy (*spó* ‘spae’) to win the battle and sack Osyard, the stronghold of the Eese.

- 24 Þáingu *re*gin qll · á *ro*k-stóla,  
2 *ginn*-hēilōg *goð*, · ok umb þat *gēttu*=sk:  
Hvęrr hēfði *lopt* alt · *lēvi* blandit  
4 eða *ētt* *jotuns* · *Öðs* męy gefna?

[R 1v/19, H 20r/34,  
S 10v/25, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:  
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:  
Who had blended all the air with deceit,  
or to the ettin's lineage given Wode's maiden [= Frow]?

ALL | After the wooden stronghold of the Eese, protected only by a plank-wall (*borð-vegg*), has been sacked by the Wanæs, they decide to build stronger fortifications. This leads into the story of the Master Builder as told at length in the following way in *Gylf* 42, which concludes by citing *Vsp* 24–25: An ettin craftsman arrives at Osyard and offers to build the Eese a great wall in exchange for Frow's hand and the Sun and Moon. He further promises that he will finish the entire wall alone over a single winter, or else the contract will be void. This seems reasonable to the Eese, who assume that he cannot possibly finish it in time, but things go awry when the ettin asks for permission to have the help of his workhorse Swaddlefare. Lock grants him this without first consulting the other Gods, after which the agreement is sealed with strong oaths. The horse turns out to be unexpectedly strong, and when only three days remain before summer, the wall is almost finished. The panicked Eese blame Lock and threaten him with violence if he does not get rid of the horse. His solution is to turn into a mare and distract it. The trick works and the two stay out all night; Lock is made pregnant, later giving birth to Slopner. When the ettin realises that he has been tricked he comes into his greatest ettin wrath, at which point the Eese call on Thunder who shortly appears and kills him.

4 Óðs mey 'Wode's maiden [= Frow]' | According to *Gylf* 35:7 and *Skm* 28, 44 Óðr 'Wode' (not to be confused with Óðinn 'Weden') was Frow's husband. — The ettins seem to have a particular obsession with abducting Frow, as seen also in *Þrk* 8. This may be explained if Frow is the Indo-European dawn-goddess, something suggested not only by her association with the Sun and Moon in the Master Builder myth, but also by her weeping of golden tears (*Gylf* 35:9, *Skm* 40, 44; possibly a poetic description of the dawn), her epithet *Meredall* (*Mar-dǫll* 'Sea-brilliant', another likely poetic description; for the second element see *Vafþ* 25), and her possession of the fire-symbolic Blaze-Necklace (*brisinga-męn*, cf. *Þrk* 13/3 n.).

For the attempted theft of the sun and moon we may compare *Kalevala* (songs 47–49), where the evil witch *Louhi* of the Underworld steals the sun, moon, and fire and thereby deprives the world of its light; for further Finnic parallels cf. the Introduction to *Þrk*. The attempted abduction of the Dawn has a more distant parallel in the Vedic *Valá*-myth (part of which is told in *RV* 10.108; Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70, 71). In that myth the enemies of the Gods, the *Pani*-s, hide the Dawns in the form of kine in the *Valá*-cave and thereby prevent the natural cycle between Night and Day. With his great song the Storm-god *Indra* breaks open the cave, killing *Valá* and releasing the dawns. The common thread in these narratives is the fear that evil forces will steal away the light and warmth of the world, which in the Norse mythology reflects itself as the Fimblewinter, for which cf. *Vafþ* 44/3–4 n.

- 25 Þórr einn þar vá · þrunginn móði,  
2 hann sjaldan sitr · es s'likt of fregn;  
á gingu=sk eiðar, · orð ok sóri,  
4 mǫl qll megin=lig, · es á meðal fóru.

[R 1v/20, H 20r/36,  
S 10v/27, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Thunder alone fought there, urged by wrath;  
he seldom sits when of such he learns.  
Trampled were oaths, speeches, and vows,  
all the mighty treaties which between them had gone.

ALL | *The order of the lines follows RH; the two helmsings are reversed (i.e., 3–4, 1–2) in G.* 1 þar vá 'fought there' | so HTU; þar var 'was there' R; þat vann 'accomplished it' S; þat vá 'fought it out' W 3–4 á ... fóru. | om. W 4 fóru 'had gone' | vǫru 'had been' HT

2 hann sjaldan sitr · es s-lik of fregn; ‘he seldom sits when of such he learns’ | When he learns of an ettin encroaching on the Gods (see note to st. 24). Thunder, as the defender of the Gods (*Þrk* 18, *Þdis Þórr* in *SkP* 3), is willing to break even the strongest oaths if the safety of the Gods require it (cf. *Lok* 57–64).

- 26 Veiðir hōn Hēim·dalar · hljóð of folgit  
und hēið-vōnum · hēlgum baðmi;  
à sér hōn ausa=sk · aurgum forsi  
af vēði Val-fōðrs. · Vituð ér enn eða hvat?

[R 1v/23, H 20v/1]

She knows Homedall's sound [= Yellhorn] hidden  
beneath the shady, holy tree [= the Ash of Ugdrassle].  
She sees it being sprinkled with a muddy torrent  
from Walfather's pledge [= the Well of Mimer]. *Know ye yet, or what?*

ALL | The purpose of the stanza is quite obscure, but it appears to describe cryptically the Well of Mimer, into which Woden deposited his eye.

Cf. *Gylf* 15:10–13, about the roots of the Ash of Ugdrassle: *En undir þeirri rót, er til brim-þursa horfir, þar er Mímis-brunnr, er spekð ok mann-vit er í folgit, ok heitir sá Mímir, er á brunn'inn. Hann er fullr af vísendum, fyrir því at hann drekkir ór brunni'num af borni'nu Gjallar-borni. Þar kom Al-fōðr ok beiddi=sk eins drykkjar af brunni'num, en hann fékk eigi, fyrr en hann lagði auga sitt at vēði. 'But enwrapped by the root which turns towards the Rime-Thurses there is the Well of Mimer. Wisdom and manwit are hid within, and he who owns the well is called Mimer. He is full of wise sayings, for he drinks from the Well out of the horn Yellhorn. Thither Allfather came and asked for a single drink from the well, but He did not get it before He laid down his eye as a pledge.' Immediately after this passage *Gylf* 15:14 quotes st. 28; cf. there.*

1 Hēim·dalar · hljóð ‘Homedall's sound’ | Interpreted by Snorre (see note to ALL) as the Yellhorn, for which cf. st. 45 below.

2 hēið-vōnum ‘shady’ | Literally ‘light-less’, *hēiðr* referring especially to the light of a clear sky.

3–4 à ... Val-fōðrs ‘She sees ... pledge’ | The interpretation of these lines is ambiguous, as ‘à’ R, ‘aa’ H can be read either (1) as the preposition ‘on’ or (2) as the noun ‘river’. In the latter case, the lines would mean “She sees a river being fed by a muddy torrent from Walfather's pledge”. Note that this ambiguity is not intentional, since the distinction between nasal and oral vowels and between long *á* and *ǿ* was still upheld in the 12th century (*FGT* 1950). (1) is adopted here since it is clearly the interpretation preferred by Snorre, who, in his prose, has the Norns *ausa* ‘sprinkle, pour’ *aur'inn* ‘the mud’ over the ash (*Gylf* 16:10–11, cited in st. 19 n. above). Since Snorre's version of the poem may theoretically have preserved the distinction, and since he was a native speaker of the language, his opinion is deferred to.

3 aurgum ‘muddy’ | Most likely the same mud (*aurr*) as in st. 19, there said of the Well of Weird.

4 vēði Val-fōðrs ‘Walfather's pledge’ | Woden's eye, which he gave up in exchange for a sip from the Well.

4 Vituð ér enn eða hvat? ‘Know ye yet, or what?’ | I.e., ‘Do you, Woden, still know what I am saying, or what more do you want?’ The second refrain (*stef*) of the poem, repeated in 28, 33, 34, 38, 40, 46, 59, and 60. Similar refrains are found in *Bdr* 7/4 etc., *Hdl* 17/4 etc.

- 27 Ejin sat hōn úti, · þá's hinn aldni kom  
Yggjungur ása · ok í augu lēit:  
Hvers fregnið mik? · hví freistið mǫn?

[R 1v/25]

[Völva:]

[The wallow:] Alone she sat outside when the Olden One came,  
the Frightener of the Eese [= Weden], and looked into her eyes.  
‘Of what ask ye me? Why tempt ye me?’

ALL | Stanzas 27–29 appear to relate how the wallow was summoned by Weden.

1 Eīn sat hōn úti ‘Alone she sat outside’ | ON *sitja úti* ‘sit outside’ has a cultural connotation of meditating in order to communicate with the otherworld; cf. the noun *úti-seta*. — This line is directly repeated in *Sigsk* 6/1a.

2 Yggjunnr ása ‘the Frightener of the Eese [= Weden]’ | To be understood as ‘the Frightener among the Eese’, i.e., ‘the Terrifying God’. Cf. the expression *Ása-Þórr* ‘Thunder of the Eese’, and Weden’s name *Yggr* ‘Ug’, from the same root.

3 freistið ‘tempt’ | *freista* ‘tempt’ has a sense of testing someone, especially intellectually. Cf. *Háv* 26, *Vafþ* 3, 5.

28     Alt veit’k, Óðinn, · hvar auga falt  
2     ĩ inum mēra · Mímis brunni;  
       drekk r mjōð Mímir · morgin hveŕjan  
4     af vęði Val-fōðrs. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 1v/26, S 4v/27,  
T TODO, W TODO,  
U TODO]

I know it all, Weden: where thine eye thou hidst  
in the famed Well of Mimer.  
Mimer drinks mead every morning  
from Walfather’s pledge. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 falt | *add., but marked with erasure dots* þitt R 2 ĩ inum mēra ‘in the famed’ | *so* RW; ĩ þeim enom meira ‘in the greater’ T; ĩ þeim enum mēra ‘in the famed’ U; úr þeim enum mēra ‘out of the famed’ S 4 vęði ‘pledge’ | †veiði† S

ALL | This st. is quoted in *Gylf* 15:14, introduced by the words *svá segir í Völu-spá*: ‘so it says in the Spae of the Wallow’. For the immediately preceding prose description of the Well of Mimer (*Gylf* 15:10–13) see note to st. 26 above.

29     Valði hęnni Hęr-fōðr · hringa ok męn,  
2     fekk spjōll spak=lig · ok spá-ganda;  
       sá vítt ok of vítt · umb ver-ōld hveŕja.

[R 1v/29]

Host-Father chose for her rings and necklaces;  
he got foresighted tidings and spae-gands—  
she saw far and yet further through every world.

2 fekk spjōll spak=lig ‘got foreseen tidings’ | *emend.*; ‘fe spjōll spaclig’ R

2 *fekk spjöll spak-lig* ‘got foreseen tidings’ | The reading of **R** may be interpreted either as (1) *fē-spjöll spak-lig* ‘foresighted wealth-tidings’ or (2) *fē, spjöll spak-lig* ‘wealth, foresighted tidings’. Both are metrically deficient; (1) since a second element in a cpd. like *fē-spjöll* cannot carry alliteration, and (2) since it has three strongly stressed nominals. In both cases the first nominal *fē* would be metrically expected to carry the alliteration. The word *fē* ‘wealth, cattle’ also makes little sense in context, since there is no transaction; Weden would be giving her expensive golden jewellery, of which he himself has no lack, in exchange for more gold. The emendation replaces *fē* with the verb *fekk* ‘got, received’. Verbs carry less stress than nominals, and the line thus becomes metrically equivalent to 28/3b *drekkir mjöd Mímir*. Semantically we get a parallel to st. 1, where the wallow likewise says that she will relate *spjöll* ‘tidings, sayings’ (cf. English *gospel*, lit. ‘good news’ which originally translates the Greek εὐαγγέλιον). For further discussion on the metrics see Haukur Þorgeirsson (2020, pp. 51–53), Males (2023b, p. 16).

2 *spá-ganda* ‘spae-gands’ | Spirits (familiar, gands; cf. st. 21/2 above) sent out in order to gather hidden wisdom.

- 30 Sá hōn val-kyrjur · vítt of komnar,  
 2 gōrvar at riða · til gōð-þjóðar:  
 Skuld hélt skildi, · en Skōgul ōnnur,  
 4 Gunnr, Hildr, Gōndul · ok Gēir-skōgul;  
 nú eru talðar · Nōnnur Hērjans,  
 6 gōrvar at riða · grund, val-kyrjur.

[R 1v/30]

She saw Walkirries come from afar,  
 ready to ride to the folk of men.  
 Shild held a shield and Shagle another,  
 Guth, Hild, Gandle and Goreshagle—  
 now are tallied the Nans of Harn (= Weden),  
 Walkirries ready to ride o’er the earth.

2 *gōð-þjóðar* ‘folk of men’ | The sense is uncertain, for in **R** the difficult cluster *þþ* in *gōt-þjóð* (attested with *-t-* in *Heiðr* st. 94/8b, SkP 8) has been changed to *ðþ*. This means that the word *gōð-þjóð* may contain either (1) *goti* ‘Got, man’ (thus ‘folk of the Gots’ or ‘folk of men’) or (2) *gōð* ‘folk of the Gods’). Of these two alternatives, the element *goti* in the sense ‘man’ is preferable, since the walkirries are presumably thought to be gathered in Walhall, ready to fly out into the world of men in order to attend battles and claim the best warriors for Weden (cf. *Hákm* 1). The present reading thus sees the cpd. as semantically identical to *ver-þjóð* ‘folk of men’, *Lok* 24/3. The Walkirries do also have a particular association with the Gots, who were remembered as having fought the greatest battles of the Migration Period (cf. note to *Vkv* 1/1). For the formally identical *Gōt-þjóð* ‘folk, land of the Gots’ see *Helr* 8/1 n.

3–6 Skuld ... val-kyrjur. ‘Shild ... earth.’ | Judging especially by the phrase *nú eru talðar* ‘now are tallied’, these four lines seem to be a later insert from a thule counting the Walkirries.

5 Nōnnur Hērjans ‘Nans of Harn (= Weden)’ | *Nanna* ‘Nan’ (the name itself is a nursery word) was the wife of Balder, but the word is here certainly being used to refer generically to ‘maidens, women’. Cf. *Þul Ásynja* (SkP 3), where the Walkirries are kenneð *Óðins meýjar* ‘Weden’s maidens’.

- 31 Ek sá Baldri, · blóðgum tífur,  
 2 Óðins barni, · ør-lōg folgin;  
 stōð of vaxinn · vōllum hēri

[R 2r/2]



4 mjör ok mjök fagr · mistil-teinn.

I saw Balder's, the bloody victim's,  
Weden's child's orlay hid:  
there stood grown higher than the plains  
a slender and most fair mistletoe.

3 vǫllum | vǫllu (with omitted abbreviation mark for -m) R

ALL | Told allusively in sts. 31–33 is the myth about Balder's death. The outline of this myth is as follows: Balder, the son of Weden and Frie, was killed by a mistletoe shot by his blind half-brother Hath, whose hand was guided by Lock. As Balder's father, it was Weden's duty to avenge him, yet he could not kill Hath who was also his son. Weden thus devised a plan and through sorcery seduced the woman Wrind (so KormQ *Sigdr* 3, SkP 3: *seið Yggr til Rindar* 'Ug won Wrind through sorcery'). Wrind gave birth to Wonnell, who grew up fast, and after just one day was big enough to kill Hath and avenge Balder.

Other sources for Balder's death include the poems *Bdr* 8–11, *Lok* 28, and *Hdl* 28 and the prose texts *Gylf* 49 and Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4.1–8. For the punishment of Lock for his role in the killing see sts. 34 and H31 below along with *Lok* P8.

The most similar text to *Vsp* 31–33 is *Bdr* 8–11, with which it is clearly textually related (cf. st. 32/4 n.). The chief narrative difference between the two passages is that *Bdr* 11/1 mentions Wrind, who is not found in *Vsp*.

Balder's death is treated at greater length in *Gylf* 49:3–25, which may be briefly summarised as follows: Balder has terrible nightmares about his own death, and so his mother Frie makes all sorts of things (fire, water, venom, metals, stones, trees, diseases, animals) swear oaths not to harm him. After this, the Eese make sport of shooting and cutting him since he cannot be harmed. Lock is annoyed by the spectacle and tricks Frie into telling him that there was one thing that did not swear the oath—the mistletoe, which was thought too young. Lock makes a mistletoe-arrow and gives it to the blind god Hath, guiding his hand towards Balder. Hath shoots and Balder dies. After this, *Gylf* 49 describes Balder's funeral, treated poetically in *Húsdr*, at some length, alongside how the Eese failed to “weep Balder out of hell” (see *Eddbr* V). The binding of Lock is described in *Gylf* 50 (cf. st. 34 below). Most notably, *Gylf* 49 neglects to mention both Wonnell and Wrind. That part of the myth may have been left out of the Prose Edda for moral reasons due to its motifs of rape and kinslaying, but that it was known to the author is proven by two passages: *Gylf* 30:1–2: *Áli eða Váli beitir einn, sonr Óðins ok Rindar. Hann er djarfr í orrostum ok mjök happ-skeytr.* 'Onnell or Wonnell is the name of one, the son of Weden and Wrind. He is brave in battles and a very lucky shot.' *Skm* 19: *Hvernig skal kenna Vála? Svá, at kalla bann son Óðins ok Rindar; [...] befini-ðs Baldrs, dólh Haðar ok bana hans [...]* 'How shall one ken Wonnell? Namely, by calling him the son of Weden and Wrind, [...] avenging os of Balder, the foe of Hath and his bane [...]'

The other lengthy prose retelling of the myth is Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4, which relates the revenge narrative in typical euhemerized form, turning the gods Hath and Balder into flawed human rulers. The outline of that version is as follows: After Balder (Latin *Balderus*) has succumbed to a mortal wound dealt to him by Hath (*Høtherus*) with a treacherous sword, his father Weden (*Otobinus*) takes counsel from a group of wizards. One of them, Horsethief the Finn (*Rostiophus Phinnicus*), foresees that Wrind (*Rinda*), daughter of the Russian king, will bear him a son to avenge Balder.

Weden soon enlists in the Russian king's army and leads it to great victories, but he is spurned by his daughter. He tries various disguises but is continually refused, until at last he disguises himself as an old witch and volunteers himself as her private physician. When Wrind becomes ill, he binds her, ostensibly in order to administer a certain foul potion, but instead rapes her, implicitly with her father's consent. Their son Bo grows up to become a fierce raider. One day Weden summons him and reminds him of his duty to avenge his half-brother Balder; Bo slays Hath in a fierce duel but soon himself perishes from his wounds. It is worth noting that the seduction of Wrind as told by Saxo Grammaticus is unlikely to be a fantasy of that author, but on the contrary seems to derive from a now-lost West Norse source. The narrative bears a particular structural resemblance to Shirner's coercion of Gird in *Ski* 19–36; see further *Ski* 19 n., Brate (1913).

1 tífur ‘victim’s’ | This word is rather difficult and possibly corrupt. (1) It has been connected with *týr* ‘tew, god’, but the dat. sg. of *týr* is *tívi* and the intrusive *r* is unexplained. (2) A better explanation is given by CV, which connects it with OE *tiber*, *tífer* ‘victim, hostage’, but this also has problems. *blóðgum* ‘bloody’ is m. dat. sg., but OE *tiber* is neuter. If we are dealing with a m. noun \**tífurr* with the same declension as *jǫfurr*, we would expect dat. sg. \**tífri*— not *tífur* (which would, however, be the expected acc. sg.).

2 *folgin* ‘hid’ | The sense is either that it is Balder’s orlay to be hid, that is, in the Underworld, whither he goes after his death (see *Eddbr* V), or that his orlay is metaphorically sealed and unalterable. The verb *fela* ‘hide, conceal’, of which *folgin* is the n. acc. pl. past participle, is used in poetry to describe burial in mounds, as in *Yt* 24 (“[...] And afterwards the victory-raisers hid (*fǫlu*) the ruler on Borrey”) and the 10th c. Karlevi runestone (Öl 1, ed. below under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland).

- 32 Varð af mēiði, · þeim’s mǫr sýndi=sk,  
2 harm-flaug hēttlig, · Hǫðr nam skjóta.  
Baldrs bróðir vas · of borinn snimma,  
4 sá nam, Óðins sonr, · ein-néttr vega.

[R 2r/4]

There came from that tree which looked so slender  
a baneful harm-flier—Hath took to shoot.  
Balder’s brother [= Wonnell] was born early;  
he took, Woden’s son, one night old, to fight.

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4 sá nam, Óðins sonr, · ein-néttr vega | The three lines making up *Vsp* 32/4–33/2 are found near-identically (but with different tense) as *Bdr* 11/2–4. The direction of influence is unclear, since both poems appear fairly old. It is also plausible that both are borrowing from a now-lost third source dealing with Balder’s death; that such a text must have existed is proven by the stanza in *Eddbr* V.

- 33 Þó éva hēndr · né hǫfuð kēmbði,  
2 áðr á bál of bar · Baldrs and-skota;  
ēn Frigg of grét · í Fēn-sǫlum  
4 vǫ Val-hallar. · Vituð ér enn eða hvat?

[R 2r/6]

He ne’er washed his hands nor combed his head  
before onto the pyre he bore Balder’s opponent [= Hath],  
but Frie lamented in the Fenhalls  
the woe of Walhall. *Know ye yet, or what?*

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1–2 Þó ... and-skota ‘He washed ... opponent’ | Found near-identically in *Bdr* 11/3–4; see note to st. 32/4 above.

1 Þó ... kēmbði ‘washed ... combed’ | A collocation; see note to *Háv* 61 for discussion and other examples. Wonnell, being bound by the sworn mission to avenge his brother, could not engage in such acts of personal vanity. For the motif of a warrior bound not to engage in acts of personal hygiene until having fulfilled a vow we may compare the famous vow of Harold Fairhair, at *aldri* [...] *skera bār mitt né kēmba, fyrr en ek hefí eignat-sk allan Nóreg með sköttum ok skyldum ok for-ráði, en deijja at þǫrum kosti*. ‘never to cut my hair nor comb it before I have come to own all of Norway with taxation and duties and stewardship, but to die otherwise.’ (*Haralds saga ins bār-fagra*, 4).

3 Fēn-sqlum ‘the Fenhalls’ | Never mentioned elsewhere in poetry, but *Gylf* 35:1–2 explains: *Dá mēlti Gangleri: „Hverjar eru ósynjurnar?” Hárr segir: „Frigg er óðst. Hon á þann bó, er Fēn-salir heita, ok er hann all-veg-ligr.* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “Which are the Ossens?” High says: “Frie is the noblest. She owns the dwelling which is called the Fenhalls, and it is all glorious. [...]”

4 vō Val-hallar ‘the woe of Walhall’ | The deaths of two sons: Balder and Hath.

- 34      **H**apt sá hōn liggja · und **H**vera-lundi  
 2      lē-gjarns líki · **L**oka á-þekkkjan;  
      þar sitr Sigyn · þey=gi of sínum  
 4      veri vël-glýjuð. · **V**ituð ér enn eða hvat?

[R 2r/8, H 20v/13]

A prisoner she saw lying beneath Wharlund,  
 recognisable in the shape of the guile-eager Lock.  
 There sits Syein, not at all cheerful,  
 o’er her husband. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1–2 Hapt ... á-þekkkjan ‘A captive ... Lock’ | *om. and replaced by H31 H.* 2 lē-gjarns | *gramm. emend.*; lē-gjarn (*nom. sg.*) R

ALL | After Balder was avenged, the Eese went to catch his true killer, Lock, as told in *Lok* P8 and *Gylf* 50:3–25. They bound him with his own son’s intestines and a snake was placed above his face to drool venom onto it. His wife, Syein, sat over him and collected the venom in a small basin, but when she had to empty it, he shook so furiously from the pain of the acidic venom that the earth shook.

1–2 Hapt ... á-þekkkjan ‘A captive ... Lock’ | The grammar of the first two lines is not easy to decipher; in prose word order I take it as *Hōn sá hapt liggja und Hvera-lundi, á-þekkkjan líki lē-gjarns Loka*, where *líki* is the dat. sg. of the n. noun *líki* ‘shape, likeness’.

2 lē-gjarns ‘guile-eager’ | An epithet of Lock, who is strongly associated with *lē* ‘guile, deceit’. His name also occurs paired with the adjective *lē-viss* ‘guile-wise’, so *Hym* 37/4, *Lok* 54/5, and *Spila* 2.

- 35      **Ó** fellr austan · umb **E**itr-dala  
 2      sōxum ok sverðum, · **S**liðr hēitr sí.

[R 2r/10]

A river falls from the east through the Atterdales,  
 [a river] of saxes and swords; Slide it is called.

ALL | Having recounted the death of Balder and the binding of Lock, the wallow moves on to describing the places of evil in the world (sts. 35–41). The world has lost its innocence and the forces of chaos and disorder in the east and north plot its destruction. The present stanza is somewhat obscure, likely because half of it is missing. It is not in any way alluded to in *Gylf*; nor is it found in H. The river Slide is also mentioned in the long list of rivers in *Grm* 28/4.

2 Sliðr ‘Slide’ | An adjective describing a blade so sharp that the finger is cut when slid across it. Cf. *Akv* 23: *saxi slíðr-þeitu* (dat. sg.) ‘slide-biting sax’.

- 36      Stóð fyr norðan · á Niða-vøllum  
 2      salr ór golli · **S**indra éttar;

[R 2r/11]

- 4      **en** annarr stóð · á **Ö**-kólni,  
          **Þjór**-salr jötuns, · **en** sá **Brimir** heitir.

To the north on the Nithwolds stood  
 a golden hall, of Sinder's lineage [DWARFS],  
 but another one stood on Uncolner,  
 an ettin's beer-hall, and he/it is called Brimmer.

ALL | Sts. 36–38 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 52:1–10, describing the world after its destruction and rebirth:

*Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvat verðr þá eptir, er brenndr er himinn ok jörð ok heimr allr, ok dauð goð'in öll ok allir Ein-berjar ok alt mann-folk, ok hafið ér áðr sagt, at hværr maðr skal lifa i nokkvörum beimi um allar aldir?“ Þá svarar Þriði: „Margar eru þá vistir góðar ok margar illar; batst er þá at vera á Gim-léi á himni, ok all-gótt er til góðs drykkjar þeim, er þat þykkir gaman, i þeim sal, er Brimir beitir; hann stendr ok á himni. Sá er ok góðr salr, er stendr á Niða-fjollum, gorr af rauðu gulli; sá beitir Sindri. Í þessum solum skulu byggja góðir menn ok sið-látir. Á Ná-ströndum er mikill salr ok illr ok borfa norðr dyrr; hann er ok ofinn allr orma-bryggjum sem vanda-bús, en orma hefði öll vitu inn i bús'it ok blása eitri, svá at eptir sal'num renna eittr-ár, ok vaða þér ár eið-rofar ok morð-vargar, svá sem hér segir:“*

‘Then spoke Gangler: “What will then happen thereafter when the heaven and the earth and the whole world are burned, and the Gods all are dead and all the Oneharriers and all man-kind—and [yet] ye have said earlier that every man will live in a certain home for all ages?” Then answers Third: “Many good dwellings are there then, and many evil ones; then it is best to be in Gemlee in the heaven. And in the hall which is called Brimmer it is fully furnished with good drink for those who find it pleasurable; that one also stands on the heaven. Another good hall is the one which stands on the Nithfells, made out of red gold; it is called Sinder. In these halls shall dwell good and virtuous men. On Neestrand there is a great hall and evil, and its doors face north. It is all interlaced with the spines of serpents like a wicker-house, but the heads of the serpents all face into the house and blow venom so that there run through the hall rivers of venom, and in those rivers wade oath-breakers and murder-wargs, just as it says here:”

After this passage *Gylf* cites sts. 37 and 38/1–2, followed by the prose: *En i Hver-gelmi er verst* ‘But in Wharvelmer it is the worst’, and a citation of st. 38/4.

It ought to be noted that the placement and contents of sts. 36–38 most likely exclude them from being descriptions of the cosmology of the world to come. That interpretation instead seems to be one of Snorre's own inventions, as is strongly supported by the grammatical form *męin-svara* in st. 38/2.

1 Niða-vøllum ‘Nithwolds’ | ‘The dark plains’. The paraphrase of this st. in *Gylf* 52:6 suggests that the version of *Vsp* used by Snorre had the reading ‘*Niða-fjollum* ‘Nithfells’ (cf. st. 62). The first element is, in any case, *nið* ‘the waning of the moon’ and refers to great darkness; cf. the adjective *niða-myrkr* ‘pitch darkness’.

4 **en** sá Brimir heitir ‘and he/it is called Brimmer’ | It is syntactically ambiguous whether Brimmer is the name of the ettin or the hall itself. *Gylf* 52:5 clearly considers it the name of the hall.

- 37      **Sal** sá hōn standa · **sólu** fjarri  
 2      **Ná**-ströndu á, · **norðr** horfa dyrr;  
          falla **ęitr**-dropar · **inn** umb ljóra,  
 4      sá s’ **undinn** salr · **orma** hryggjum.

A hall she saw standing far from the sun  
 on Neestrand; north face its doors.  
 Venom-drops fall in through its smoke-vent;  
 that hall is wound with the spines of snakes.

[R 2r/13, H 20v/19,  
 S 17v/1, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U 18v/19]

1 sá hōn ‘she saw’ | veyt’k ‘I know’ G.

ALL | Cited in *Gylf* 52; see st. 36 above.

3 ljóra ‘smoke-vent’ | In the Iron Age Germanic hall, the *ljóri* or louver (likely a borrowing from a Frankish cognate) was a sort of turret in the middle of the roof-ridge, above the central fire, through which smoke would exit and light shine down. This is the only poetic attestation of the word in ON, but it is well represented in prose.

- 38 Sá hōn þar vaða · þunga strauma  
2 meñn meñn-svara · ok morð-varga  
ok þann’s annars gleþr · eyra-rúnu.  
4 Þar saug Nið·hoggr · nái fram-gingna;  
sleit vargr vera. · Vituð ér enn eða hvat?

[R 2r/15, H 20v/21,  
S 17v/2, T TODO,  
W TODO, U 18v/21]

There she saw wading through heavy streams  
false-swearing men and murder-wargs  
and him who seduces another man’s ear-whisperess [WIFE].  
There Nithehewer sucked passed-on corpses;  
the warg tore apart men. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 Sá hōn ‘she saw’ | so R; sér hōn ‘she sees’ H; skulu ‘shall [wade]’ G 2 meñn-svara ok morð-varga | *corr. from morð-varga meñn-svara ok by an inversion mark in same hand* R. 2 meñn-svara | meñns-vara R; meñn-svara U 2 morð-varga ‘murder-wargs’ | morð-vargar (*nom. pl.*) RSTW; morðingjar ‘murderers’ U. 3 ok þann’s annars gleþr · eyra-rúnu. | *om. G.* 3 eyra-rúnu | †eyrna runa† H 4 saug ‘sucked’ | so H; †súg† R; kvęlr ‘torments’ G

ALL | LL 1–2, 4 are cited in *Gylf* 52; see st. 36 above. — This st. takes a distinctly moralising tone otherwise rare in pre-Christian poetry; cf. st. 44 below. The crimes are what one might expect in a source from Germanic antiquity: perjury, murder and adultery. In Scandinavian and Anglo-Saxon laws the perpetrator of such crimes held the dishonourable title of nothing, that is, one afflicted with *niðe* (‘evil, shame’), and was thereby stripped of his personal rights. It is fitting, then, that such nithings should be tortured by a creature named Nithehewer (‘Nithe-striker’).

For the crimes we may cf. the list of *ú-dáðar-meñn* (‘criminals’, lit. ‘men of misdeeds’) not eligible for burial in church grounds according to *Gula* 23: *dróttins-svikar* ‘traitors to their lord’, *morð-vargar* ‘murder-wargs’, *trygg-rofar* ‘truce-breakers’, *þjófar* ‘thieves’, and those men who *sjálfir spilla ónd sinni* ‘themselves destroy their spirit’, i.e., commit suicide. According to that law these men were instead to be buried in a *flóðar-mál* ‘flood-mark’, where *sér móti-sk ok grón torfa* ‘see and green turf meet’ (NGL I, p. 13), something which also has clear parallels in the *Lex Frisionum* (TODO).

The practice of burying criminals deemed particularly shameful not just in unhallowed ground but specifically in bogs and flood-marks is well attested both in archeology and in literary sources relating to the Germanic peoples from Tacitus (*Germania*, ch. 12) onwards. Upon examining these parallels together, it is hard not to see the *þungir straumar* ‘heavy streams’ of the present stanza as a reflex of such customs, so that the whole st. in fact appears to describe the Heathen religious belief about bog burials, namely that those buried in them were punished by a watery dragon in the afterlife.

Watery punishment in the afterlife is also described in *Reg* 3–4 and possibly in *Grm* 21, and a perjurious woman is drowned in a bog in *3 Guðr* 10. The argument is pursued at at greater length in *RosenbergForthcoming*.

2 *męin-svara* ‘false-swearing’ | Acc. pl. of *\*męin-svari* or *\*męin-svarr*, an otherwise unattested adj. Related words are *męin-sóri* ‘false oath, perjury’ and *męin-svari* m. ‘perjurer’. This adjective is in the acc. pl. in 3/4 mss. of *Gylf*, but this is grammatically irregular since the **G** version of line 1 has the verb *skulu* ‘shall [wade]’ which takes a nominative subject. The most likely explanation for this is that Snorre, when quoting the present stanza, deliberately changed the first words of l. 1 from an archetypal *\*sér/sá bęn* ‘she sees/saw’ (shared with **RH**) to *skulu* in order to make the poetry fit better with his eschatological interpretation (cf. st. 36 n.). In doing so he overlooked the grammatical form of the object phrase *męnn męin-svara*, probably due to the rarity of the adjective. This has important consequences for our evaluation of Snorre’s reliability when citing Eddic verse since it shows an instance of his deliberately changing the wording of a stanza to conform to his prose. Even so, the present instance should probably be considered exceptional, since most other textual variants in Eddic sts. cited in *Gylf* are better explained as resulting from scribal or oral transmission.

2 *morð-varga* ‘murder-wargs’ | Men outlawed for murder, which is not all instances of the taking of human life, but specifically when done clandestinely or in ways deemed particularly reproachable.

3 *ęyra-rünu* ‘ear-whisperess’ | Acc. sg. of *ęyra-rüna*, with the second element derived from *rün* ‘whisper, secret’; cf. the masculine (*af*) *rüni* ‘friend, confidant’, OE *ęe-rüna* ‘counsellor’. This word is also used in *Háv* 115 which likewise contains a warning not to seduce another man’s wife.

4 *Nið-hoggr* ‘Nithehewer’ | Also appearing in st. 62 below and further in *Grm* 36/4.

- 39 **Austr býr hin aldna · í Ēarn-viði**  
 2 **ok fōðir þar · Fęnris kindir;**  
**verðr af þeim ęllum · ęinna nøkkurr**  
 4 **tungls tjęgari · í trolls hami.**

[R 2r/17, H 20v/2,  
 S 4r/10, T TODO,  
 U 5r/27, W TODO]

In the east dwells the old hag in Ironwood  
 and there rears the brood of Fenrer [WOLVES].  
 Out of them all one becomes—I know not which—  
 a snatcher of the moon in a troll’s hame.

1 býr ‘dwells’ | *so* **HG**; *sat* ‘sat/stayed’ **R** 1 *aldna* ‘old’ | *arma* ‘wretched’ **U** 1 *Ēarn-viði* ‘Ironwood’ | *metr.* *emend.*; *Járn-viði* **RHSWU**; *Járn-viðjum* ‘Ironwoods’ **T** 2 *fōðir* ‘rears’ | *so* **HG**; *fōddi* ‘reared’ **R** 3 *af* | *ör* **ST** 4 *tjęgari* ‘snatcher’ | *†tuigan†* **T**; *tregari* ‘troubler’ **U**.

ALL | The old hag, who is not identified in any other source, raises the cubs of the wolf Fenrer. One of these wolves, identified by Snorre as Moongarm (*Mána-garmr*), will eventually swallow the moon. For the myth of the wolves that chase the sun and moon cf. *Grm* 40, according to which the sun is chased by the wolf Sholl, while another wolf, Hate, runs in front of it, and *Vafþ* 46–47, where the sun is said to be swallowed by Fenrer. It is likely that even the Heathen poets themselves were not entirely in agreement about the exact details of these future events; for further “wolfish” confusion, cf. st. 43/1–2 below.

These wolves are dealt with in *Gylf* 12, which synthesizes from *Vsp* 39–40 along with the two aforementioned sources. Relevant for the present sts. is *Gylf* 12:7, 9–12:

*Gýgr ein býr fyrir austan Mið-garð í þeim skógi, er Járn-viðr heitir. [...] In gamla gýgr fōðir at sonum marga jętna ok alla í vargs líkjum, ok þaðan af eru komnir þessir ulfar. Ok svá er sagt, at af ętt’inni verðr sá einna máttkastri, er kallaðr er Mána-garmr. Hann fjlli-sk með fjörvi allra þeira manna, er deyja, ok hann gleypir tungl, en stökkvir blóði himin ok loft ęll. Þaðan týnir sól skini sínu, ok vindar eru þá ó-kyrrir ok gnýja heðan ok bandan.*

‘A lonely ogress lives to the east of Middenyard in the forest called Ironwood. The old ogress raises many ettins as her sons, all in the likenesses of wolves, and thereof these wolves [= Sholl and Hate] come. And so it is said that from that lineage a single one becomes the mightiest, and he is called Moongarm. He fills himself with the life of all those men who die and he swallows the moon and stains the heaven and all the air with blood. Thereof the sun loses her shine and then the winds are violent and howl hither and thither.’

Immediately after this passage Gylf 12:13 quotes *Vsp* 39–40, introduced by the words *svá segir í Völu-spá*: ‘so it says in the Spae of the Wallow’.

1 Austr ‘In the east’ | The cardinal direction associated with ettins and other fiendish creatures; cf. *Hym* 5/1 n.

1 hin aldna ‘the old hag’ | Comparatively, the ‘hag’ (an insertion in the translation to clarify the gender of ON *aldna*) appears to correspond to the Finnish *Louhi*, the toothless mistress of *Pohjola* (the Northland). In *Kalevala* 47–49 she steals away the sun, moon, and fire (see st. 24 n. above). Both women are part of the evil forces that constantly struggle against the Gods by disrupting the natural cosmic order and its cycles.

4 tjúgari ‘snatcher’ | Hapax, generally understood as either \**tjúga* ‘drag, pull’ or *tjúga* f. ‘pitchfork’ + *-ari* ‘er’. The agentive suffix *-ari* is a young feature found nowhere else in the poem, and it is therefore possible that this word is corrupt. Note that U’s *tregari* ‘troubler’ is metrically impossible and prob. an instance of trivialisation from \**tjúgari*, as found in the other mss. of Gylf (Males 2023b, pp. 181, 194). If the word is corrupt, it must have occurred early in transmission, since *tjúgari* is found in all three recensions (RHG).

- 40 Fylli=sk fjörvi · feigra manna,  
2 rýðr ragna sjöt · rauðum dreýra,  
svört verða sól-skin · of sumur þertir,  
4 veðr öll vá-lynd. · Vituð ér enn eða hvað?

[R 2r/19, H 20v/4,  
S 4r/11, T TODO,  
U 5r/28, W TODO]

He fills himself with the lifeblood of fey men;  
he reddens the abode of the Reins [HEAVEN] with red gore.  
Black do the sun’s rays turn in the summers thereafter,  
the winds all woeful. *Know ye yet, or what?*

3 svört verða sól-skin ‘Black turn the sun’s rays’ | so HG; svart var þá sól-skin ‘Black was then the sun’s shine’ R 4 vá-lynd | †va. ly.† U

3 svört verða sól-skin ‘Black turn the sun’s rays’ | As part of the Fimblewinter; see *Vafþ* 44/3–4 n. — The reading of R, although semantically meaningful, is outvoted by the other mss. It is also unlikely on its own merit, since the past tense of *var* ‘was’ disagrees with the present tense of the other verbs in this st. For this reason, R’s ‘*ú þa*’ (resolving as *var þa* ‘was then’) is most likely a scribal error, where the archetypal \**ijþa*’ (resolving as \**verþa*, so SU) was miscopied as \**ijþa*’ (resolving as \**varþa*), and then reinterpreted as *var þá* by the addition of a space.

- 41 Sat þar á haugi · ok sló hǫrpu  
2 gýgjar hirðir, · glaðr Eggþér;  
gól umb hǫnum · í Gagl-víði  
4 fagr-rauðr hani, · sá’s Fjalarr heitir.

[R 2r/21, H 20v/16]

There he sat on the mound and struck the harp,  
the gow’s herdsman, glad Edgethew.  
For him crowed in Gaggglewood  
the fair-red cock who is called Feller.

1 Sat þar á haugi ‘There he sat on the mound’ | The motif of ettins sitting on burial mounds is also found in *Þrk* 6 and *Ski* 11. The precise significance of this is uncertain, but mounds are liminal spaces where the worlds of the dead and the living are particularly close, and they feature prominently in pre-Christian ritual (TODO: PCRN-HS reference).

3 gól umb hönum ‘For him crowed’ | The crowing of three cocks—the first in Ettinham, the second in Walhall, the third in Hell—heralds the destruction of the world.

3 Gagl-viði ‘Gagglewood’ | An otherwise unknown location; the first element is *gagl* ‘wild goose’. Gagglewood is perhaps the same as Ironwood.

- 42      **G**ól umb ǫsum · **G**ollin·kambi,  
 2      sá vękr hǫlða · at Hęrja-fǫðrs,  
       ęn annarr gęlr · fyr jǫrð neðan  
 4      sót-rauðr hani · at sǫlum Hęljar.

[R 2r/23, H 20v/18]

For the Eese crowed Goldencomb;  
 he wakes the heroes at the Father of Hosts’,  
 but another one crows beneath the earth:  
 a soot-red cock in the halls of Hell.

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1 Gollin·kambi ‘Goldencomb’ | This cock may be depicted on two of the 11th or 12th c. tapestries from Överhogdal, Härjedalen in Sweden. The relevant tapestries show a great tree surrounded by a mass of animals, and on the top of the tree stands a bird; the pre-Christian nature of their symbolism is confirmed by the depiction of an eight-legged horse, certainly to be identified with Weden’s horse Sloper.

2 at Hęrja-fǫðrs ‘at the Father of Hosts’ | In Weden’s hall, Walhall, where the Oneharriers reside.

- 43      **G**ęyr **G**armr mjøk · fyr **G**nipa-hęlli,  
 2      fęstr mun slitna, · ęn freki rinna;  
       fjǫlð vęit hǫn fróða, · framm sé’k lęgra  
 4      of ragna røk, · rǫmm sig-tíva.

[R 2r/25]

Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;  
 the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.  
 She knows much lore; I see further ahead  
 about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

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ALL | The first occurrence of the third refrain (*stef*), repeated several times in the section of the poem dealing with the Rakes of the Reins (ON *ragna røk*), culminating with st. 55. The destruction of the world, involving the deaths of all major Gods save Balder, is treated at length in *Gylf* 51. Furthermore, it is the subject of a wisdom contest in *Vafþ* 44–53 and alluded to in *Lok* 39, 41.

1–2 Garm ... rinna ‘Garm ... run’ | *Gylf* 51 distinguishes between the Fenrerswolf fought by Weden and the wolf Garm fought by Tew. Yet this is probably the result of later systematizing. The wolf which is said to come loose in the present stanza must surely be the Fenrerswolf, and since in *Gylf* 34:10–42 it is primarily Tew who deals with the Fenrerswolf, we would naturally expect him to fight it during the Rakes of the Reins as well, just like Thunder fights his rival, the Middenyardswurm, and Lock fights Homedall (*Gylf* 51:48; see *Prk* 13/3 n.). *Vsp* 51, however, sees Weden fight the Wolf instead, and this requires a separate wolf for Tew to fight, hence Garm. It is thus likely that these two wolves were originally not distinct creatures. For the story of the Fenrerswolf see *Lok* 38/3–4; for further “wolfish” confusion, cf. st. 39 above.



3 sé'k 'I see' | In **R** the use of the present tense *sé'k*, *sér* 'I see, she sees' marks a shift from the past tense (*sá* 'saw') of the Balder-episode (31–34) and the description of Neestrand (37–38), a subtle but important change. The use of the present tense continues for the rest of the poem. Note that in **H** the verb is found in the present tense already in 37–38, and we lack the Balder-episode to compare with.

- 44 **Bróðr** munu **berja**=sk · ok at **bönum** verða=sk,  
 2 munu **systrungar** · **sifjum** spilla;  
**hart** 's í **heimi**, · **hór-dómr** mikill,  
 4 **skæggj-öld**, **skalm-öld**, · **skildir** klofnir,  
**vind-öld**, **varg-öld**, · **áðr** **ver-öld** **steypi**=sk  
 6 mun **engi** maðr · **öðrum** þyrma.

[**R** 2r/28, **H** 20v/24,  
**S** 16r/34, **T** TODO,  
**W** TODO, **U** TODO]

Brothers will fight and become each other's banes;  
 the children of sisters will defile their kinship.  
 It is hard in the Home! Great whoredom,  
 axe-age, sword-age—shields split asunder—  
 wind-age, warg-age. Before the man-age tumbles  
 no man will spare another.

2 systrungar 'the children of sisters' | †stystyrungar† **T** 3 í heimi 'in the Home' | *so* **RHU**; með höldum 'among men' **STW** 4 skildir 'shields' | *add.* 'ro 'are' **R** 4 klofnir 'split' | klofna 'become split' **U** 5 áðr 'before' | *unz* (*norm.*) 'until' **U** 5 steypi=sk 'tumbles down' | *add.* *after this l.* grundir gjalla · gífr fljúgandi (*norm.*) 'foundations shrill, fiends flying' **H** 6 mun engi maðr · öðrum þyrma. 'no man will spare another' | *om.* **STW** 6 **engi** | †enn† **U**

ALL | St. 44 is cited in *Gylf* following *Gylf* 51:5–7, which puts the stanza in the context of three winters of war preceding the three winters that make up the Fimblewinter: *En áðr ganga svá áðrir þrír vetr, at þá er um alla veröld orrostur miklar. Þá drepa-sk bróðr fyrir á-girni sakar, ok engi þyrmir fjödur eða syni í mann-drófum eða sífja-sliti. Svá segir í Völu-spó: 'But before them come three other winters when throughout all the world there are great battles. Then do brothers slay each other for reasons of covetousness, and no man spares his father or son in murder of men or destruction of kinship. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow:'. For the Fimblewinter, as described in *Gylf* 51:2–4, see *Vafþ* 44.*

This stanza takes a noticeably moral tone, which may be compared with st. 38 above. In the view of the wallow, human moral failures accompany the decline and ultimate destruction of the World, and perhaps even hasten its arrival. This moralising may be seen as a sign of Christian influence (cf. e.g. *Musp* 59 for a similar condemnation), but the crimes listed both here and in st. 38 (perjury, murder, adultery, kinslaying, and incest) were all undoubtedly also forbidden in pre-Christian Germanic law. In the pre-Christian worldview a threat to the established social order was thus also seen as a threat to the very existence of the World itself.

2 sifjum spilla 'defile their kinship' | I.e., 'commit incest', apparently referring to marriages between first cousins, which are prohibited in all mediæval Scandinavian law codes. Compare related words found in the laws, like *frænd-semis-spell* 'incest' and especially *sífja-spell* 'id.' — The idea of incest as a sign of later ages is also found in *RV* 10.10.10a–b (*norm.* and *tr.*, N. S. Dwbhashyam): *Á g'á tá gacc'ān · útará yugāni, // yātra jāmayāh · kṛnāvann ājāmi* 'There shall come indeed those later ages when relatives shall do (acts) not (fit for) relatives.'

5 vind-öld 'wind-age' | In **H** the *v* is capitalized, marking the beginning of a new stanza.

5 ver-öld 'man-age' | Translated as such since it stands next to various other compounds with the second element *öld* 'age'. ON *ver-öld* is cognate with English "world" (cf. 29/3 above), but in ON the sense 'cosmos, universe' is usually expressed by *heimr* (e.g., in l. 3 of the present stanza).

- 45 Lęika Míms synir, · ęn mjötuðr kyndi=sk  
 2 at hinu galla · Gjallar-horni;  
 hótt blæss Hęim·dallr, · horn 's à lopti;  
 4 męlir Óðinn · við Míms hęfuð;  
 skelfr Ygg·drasils · askr standandi,  
 6 ymr it aldna tré, · ęn jötunn losnar.

[R 2r/32, H 20v/27,  
 S 17r/7, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U 18v/7]

Mime's sons [ETTINS] play and the Measurer advances  
 at [the sounding of] the shrill Yellhorn.  
 Homedall blows high; the horn is aloft;  
 Weden speaks with Mime's head.  
 The Ash of Ugdrassle quakes, standing:  
 the old tree whines and the ettin comes loose.

1–2 Lęika ... Gjallar-horni; 'Mime's ... Yell' | *om.* G 2 hinu | sø H; †en† R. 4 męlir 'speaks' | †mey† S; †nie† T 4 Míms | Mímis TU 5–6 | *These lines are reversed in R.* 6 ęn jötunn losnar 'and the ettin comes loose' | ęsir 'ro à þingi U 6 losnar | *add. H41 H.*

ALL | Sts. 45–54 are cited, with the omission of the refrain-stanza 47, in sequence in *Gylf* 51:50. Note that U only contains 45–46 and 53.

1 mjötuðr kyndi=sk 'the Measurer advances' | The sense seems to be that the destruction swiftly comes to pass through the great predestined calamities, but both words require some elucidation. ON *mjötuðr* 'the Measurer' often means merely 'Fate' (e.g. *Sigsk* 71), but is a m. agent noun and as such is not entirely impersonal, perhaps rather referring to an overarching fate-principle. In OS poetry the cognate *metod* means 'fate' (*Heli* 128, 511) and also occurs in the cpds. *metod-gi-skafi*, *metod(o)-gi-skapu* 'shapes of the Measurer', i.e., 'decrees of fate' (*Heli* 2190, 2210, 4827; cf. *regin(o)-gi-skapu* 'shapes of the Reins', *Heli* 2593, 3347, *uurd-gi-skapu* 'shapes of 'Weird', *Heli* 127, 3692); in OE poetry *meotod* comes to refer to the Christian God (e.g. *Cadman* 2). *kyndi=sk* 'advances' must be in the pres. sg. and is a form of *kynda=sk* 'be kindled, be set ablaze', which is here understood to refer metaphorically to the swift rising of the calamity. CV suggests emending to *kynni=sk* 'makes itself known'. The literal sense 'is kindled' could be used to argue for an emendation of *mjötuðr* to *mjot-viðr* 'Measuring-Tree' (cf. st. 2/4 above), but this would yield an A1 verse with anacrusis, which is not metrically acceptable in *Vsp*.

2 Gjallar-horni 'Yellhorn' | Or the 'Horn of Yell', viz. the river *Gjöll* 'Yell' as mentioned in *Grm* 28/6. The root of the river's name is the same as English "yell".

- 46 Hvat 's með ösum? · Hvat 's með ölfum?  
 2 gnýr allr Jötun-heimr, · ęsir 'ro à þingi,  
 stynja dvergar · fyr stęin-durum  
 4 vęgg-bergs vísir. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2v/8, H 20v/30,  
 S 17r/9, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U 18v/9]

What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?  
 All Ettinham roars; the Eese are at the Thing.  
 The Dwarfs groan before gates of stone,  
 the lords of the cliff-side. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 ölfum 'Elves' | ösynjum 'Ossens' U 2 gnýr ... þingi | *om.* U 3 stęin-durum | stęins dyrum U; stęin-dyrum HW 4 vęgg-bergs vísir | *om.* U 4 vęgg-bergs | vęg-bergs HTW

1 Hvæt 's með ósum? · Hvæt 's með ölfum 'What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?' | A line indicating cosmic distress. It also occurs in *Þrk* 7/1, where it is answered by *Illt 's með ósum*, · *illt 's með ölfum!* 'Tis ill with the Eese! 'Tis ill with the Elves!'. Such is probably also the implication of the present stanza.

2 þingi 'the Thing' | The Thing of the Gods, where the Gods assemble in times of distress; see note to st. 6/1–2 above.

- 47      Geyr nú Garmr mjök · fyr Gnipa-helli,  
2      festr mun slitna, · en freki rinna;  
            fjöð velt hön fróða, · framm sé'k lengra  
4      of ragna rök, · rømm sig-tíva.

[R 2v/4, H 20v/32]

Now Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;  
the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.  
She knows much lore; I see further ahead  
about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

- 48      Hrymr ekkr austan, · hef=sk lind fyrir,  
2      sný=sk Jormun·gandr · í jötun-móði,  
            ormr knýr unnir, · en ari hlakkar,  
4      slitr nái nef-fölr; · Nagl-far losnar.

[R 2v/4, H 20v/32,  
S 17r/11, T TODO,  
W TODO]

Rim drives from the east; he holds his shield before him;  
Ermengand writhes in ettin-wrath.  
The Wyrn drives forth the waves and the eagle screams,  
the pale-beak tears at corpses; Nailfare comes loose.

3 en ari hlakkar 'and the eagle screams' | örn mun hlakka 'the eagle will scream' ST

4 Nagl-far 'Nailfare' | The ship on which the fiends sail from the east. It is described in *Gylf* 51:13–16: *Þá geysisk haf'it á lönd'in, fyrir því at þá sný=sk Mið-garðs-ormr í jötun-móð ok sókir upp á land'it. Þá verðr ok þat, at Nagl-far losnar, skip þat, er svá heitir. Þat er gert af nøglum dauðra manna, ok er þat fyrir því varnunar vert, ef maðr deyr með ó-skornum nøglum, at sá maðr eykr mikit efni til skips'ins Nagl-fars, er goð'in ok menn vildi seint, at gert yrði. En í þessum sévar-gang flýtr Nagl-far.* 'Then the sea surges onto the lands because the Middenyardswyrn writhes in ettin-wrath and attacks the land. Then it also happens that Nailfare comes loose—the ship which is called thus; it is made from the nails of dead men, and therefore it is worth a warning if a man dies with uncut nails, that that man greatly increases the material for the ship Nailfare, which the Gods and men would rather were not done. But in this motion of the sea Nailfare floats.'

The motif of the Devil rowing a boat made out of improperly discarded nail clippings is widespread in Scandinavian and Finnish folklore (Krohn 1912), and thus the "nail-ship" cannot be a mere Snorronian invention. Specific rituals for disposing cut nails (and hair) are found in many Indo-European cultures, and clearly described ramifications for not observing them are also found in Zoroastrianism (*Videvdāt* 17.2–3: "[W]hen one arranges and cuts his hair and clips his nails and then lets them fall into holes in the earth or into furrows, [...] demons come forth, and from these improprieties monsters come forth from the earth which mortals call lice and which devour the grain in the fields and the clothes in the closets") (Lincoln 1977). Beyond the Indo-Europeans, Judaism also has a taboo against discarding nail-clippings wherever a pregnant woman might walk, lest they supernaturally cause her to miscarry.

An interesting psychological commonality presents itself in all three traditions, namely that the improper clipping or disposal of nails is thought to threaten the fundamental stability of the cosmos by bringing about the principal fear of each culture. In Judaism, singularly concerned with the fertility of its adherents (witness its famous ban on masturbation, *Shulchan Arukh, Even HaEzer* 23:1: עבירות שבחמור מכל ועין זה חמור more severe than all Torah transgressions) it is the miscarriage; in the dualistic Zoroastrianism, the proliferation of demons; and in the Germanic religion, with its Wiking Age eschatological obsession (cf. Introduction to the poem), it is the End Times.

- 49 **K**jóll færr austan · **k**oma munu Mú·spells  
 2 of lög lýðir, · **en** **L**oki stýrir;  
**f**ara fífl-megir · með **f**reka allir,  
 4 þeim es bróðir · **B**y-łeists í fǫr.

[R 2v/6, H 20v/34,  
 S 17r/13, T TODO,  
 W TODO]

The ship fares from the east—come will Muspell's  
 subjects o'er the sea—and Lock steers it.  
 The devil-lads all fare with the Wolf;  
 with them comes the brother of Bilast [= Lock] along.

1 Kjóll 'The ship' | Nailfare, as mentioned in the previous st.

1–2 Mú·spells ... lýðir 'Muspell's subjects' | According to *Gylf* 4:5–8 *Mú·spell* 'Muspell' or *Mú·spells-heimr* 'Muspellsham' is the name of the primordial realm of fire in the South, ruled over by Surt (cf. note to st. 3 above).

During the destruction the world will be assailed by the nebulous *Mú·spells-synir* 'Muspell's sons' (*Lok* 42, *Gylf* 13:9, 37:19, 51:21, 51:28) or *Mú·spells-megir* 'Muspell's lads' (*Gylf* 13:6, 51:25), who are to be identified with *Mú·spells lýðir* and the *fífl-megir* 'devil-lads' in the pres. st.

ON *Mú·spell* has West Germanic cognates in OHG *Mú·spilli* (*Musp* 56) and OS *Mú·spelle* (*Heli* 2591, 4358), both referring to the destruction of the world in a Christian context. For the etymology see *Musp* 56 n.

- 50 **S**urtr færr sunnan · með **s**viga lévi,  
 2 skínn af **s**verði · **s**ól val-tíva;  
**g**riót-björg **g**nata, · **en** **g**ífr rata,  
 4 troða **h**alir **h**el-veg, · **en** **h**iminn klofnar.

[R 2v/10, H 20v/36,  
 S<sub>1</sub> 2r/35, S<sub>2</sub> 17r/15,  
 T<sub>1</sub> 3r/11,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

Surt fares from the south with the twig's betrayer [FIRE];  
 from the swords of the slain-Tews (gods) [it] shines [like] the sun.  
 Rocky cliffs clash, but the fiends roam;  
 men tread the Hellway, but the Heaven cracks.

1 Surtr | Svartr U 3 gífr rata 'the fiends roam' | guðar hrata 'the gods(?) stagger' (wo. doubt corrupt) U

ALL | This st. is cited twice in all mss. of *Gylf* save U. The second citation is in the sequence of sts. 45–54 cited in *Gylf* 51:50 (see st. 45 n.), but the first is alone, introduced by *Gylf* 4:5–9:

*Þá mælti Þriði: „Fyrst var þó sá heimr í suðr-bálfi, er Múspell heitir. Hann er ljóss ok heitr. Sú átt er logandi ok brennandi. Er hann ok óförr þeim, er þar eru út-lendir ok eigi eigu þar öðul. Sá er Surtr nefndr, er þar sitr á lands-enda til land-varnar. Hann hefir loganda sverð, ok í enda ver-aldar mun hann fara ok herja ok sigra öll goð'in ok brenna allan heim með eldi. Svá segir í Völuspá:*

‘Then spoke Third: “Yet, first there was the home in the southern half which is called Muspell. It is hot and bright. That domain is blazing and burning. It is also unpassable to those who are foreigners and do not have their home there. Surt is he called who sits there at the border of the land to defend the land. He has a blazing sword, and in the end of the world he will go and harry and vanquish all the Gods and burn all the Home with fire. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow.’

2 skínn af sverði · sól val-tíva ‘from the swords of the slain-Tews [gods] [it] shines [like] the sun’ | A difficult line. As the sun has been blackened (st. 40) the world is instead lit up by the flashing swords of the Gods as they head into the battle with Surt. Snorre instead interprets it as a reference to Surt’s sword, *Gylf* 51:22–23: *Surtr ríðr fyrst ok fyrir bonum ok eptir bæði eldr brennandi. Sverð hans er gott mjök; af því skínn bjartara en af sólu.* ‘Surt rides first and both ahead of and behind him is a burning fire. His sword is very good; from it, it shines brighter than the sun.’

The main difficulty lies in the fact that *val-tíva* may be read either (1) as gen. pl. of the attested *val-tívar* ‘the slain-Tews [GODS]’ (so La Farge and Tucker (1992); cf. below st. 59 (n.) and *Hym* 1/1) or (2) as gen. sg. of an unattested m. *n*-stem \**val-tívi* ‘the slaughter-Tew [= Surt]’ (so CV, Fritzner, and presumably also Snorre). Reading 1 is adopted here as the simpler explanation because it does not presuppose an otherwise unattested *n*-stem derivative of *týr* ‘tew, god’—especially as Surt is not a god—and because the pl. *val-tívar* demonstrably occurs elsewhere in the poem.

A second issue arises over whether the gen. *val-tíva* modifies (a) *sverði* ‘sword’ or (b) *sól* ‘sun’. In readings 1a and 2a the sense would prob. be that the flashing sword shines like the sun, reflecting the intensity of the battle. Although one may expect a pl. *sverðum* ‘swords’ for 1a, that is not a major problem, since sg. forms are often used with pl. possessors in the Old Germanic languages (e.g. *Hárþ* 39/3). Case 1b does not seem very likely since ‘sun of the GODS’ is not a known kenning-type. If 2b is adopted we may see a kenning “sun of Surt [FIRE]”, but “from his sword shines the [FIRE]” seems excessively repetitive when compared to l. 1. In conclusion, my preferred reading is 1a.

3 gífr rata ‘the fiends roam’ | The reading of U is certainly corrupt; the anachronistic m. pl. ending -ar is proof enough, for the word *goð* ~ *guð* ‘gods’ was always neuter in heathen times.

4 troða halir hæl-veg ‘men tread the Hellway’ | The Hellway is the road between Earth and the Underworld (Hell) upon which one has to travel after death to reach one’s final resting place (cf. the story told in *Helr*). The verse may thus be understood as ‘men die off’.

On the other hand, according to *Gylf* 51:27, Lock is followed by *allir Heljar sinnar* ‘all Hell’s companions’ who are presumably thought to be some sort of revenants, so that may instead be what is being referred to here.

4 himinn klofnar ‘the Heaven cracks’ | As discussed above (st. 3) Heaven is thought of as a solid dome made out of stone (cf. *Hárþ* 15/2 n.); its cracking in two is therefore a horrible sight. Cf. the prophetic line in *Sö* 154 Skarpáker (edited below under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland).

- 51 Þá kómr Hlí<sup>1</sup>nar · harmr annarr framm,  
2 es Óðinn f<sup>2</sup>err · við ulf vega,  
—en bani Be<sup>3</sup>lja · bjart<sup>4</sup>r at Surti—  
4 þá mun Friggjar · falla angan.

[R 2v/13, H 20v/37,  
S 17r/17, T TODO,  
W TODO]

Then comes Line’s second sorrow to pass,  
when Weden goes to fight against the Wolf  
—but the bane of Bellow<sup>2</sup>er [= Free], bright, towards Surt—  
then will Frie’s beloved [= Weden] fall.

4 falla | *om.*, but *add. above line in same hand* S 4 angan | *so* HSTW; angantyr R

ALL | Sts. 51–53 describe the deaths of the major gods Weden, Thunder, and Free as they fight against their respective enemies: the Fenerswolf, the Middenyardswyrm, and Surt. The battle takes place on the great plain Wighride as told in *Vafþ* 18.

The fight between the Wolf and Weden is also mentioned in *Vafþ* 53, which further mentions his subsequent avenging by Wider, and *Grm* 24/3–4, which mentions that he is aided by the Oneharriers.

The relevant part of the battle is described in *Gylf* 51:34–38: *Ésir her-veða sik ok allir Ein-berjar ok sökja fram á völlu'na. Ríðr fyrstr Óðinn með gull-bjalm'inn ok fagra brynju ok geir sinn, er Gungnir heitir; stefnir hann móti Fenris-ulfi, en Þórr fram á aðra blíð bonum, ok má hann ekki duga bonum, því at hann hefir fullt fang at berja-sk við Mið-garðs-orm. Freyr ber-sk móti Surti, ok verðr harðr sam-gangr, aðr Freyr fellr þat verðr hans bani, er hann missir þess ins góða sverðs, er hann gaf Skirmi.* ‘The Eese and all the Oneharriers clothe themselves for war and rush forth on the plains. Weden rides first with the golden helmet and fair byrnie and his spear which is called Gungnir; he faces against the Fenerswolf, but Thunder goes forth on one of his sides; and he cannot avail him, for he has his hands full in fighting against the Middenyardswurm. Free fights against Surt and it becomes a hard-fought struggle before Free falls. It will be his bane that he is missing the good sword which he gave Shirnir.’

1 Hlínar · harmr annarr ‘Line’s second sorrow’ | The first sorrow being the death of Balder. Line (*Hlín*) is described in *Gylf* 35:19 as a minor goddess *sett til gétslu yfir þeim mǫnnum, er Frigg vill forða við hásku nǫkkurum* ‘placed to watch over those men whom Frie wants to save from any particular danger’. In spite of this, almost all modern translators and editors have understood Line as synonymous with Frie and posited that her existence as a distinct goddess is a systematizing invention of *Gylf*. Hopkins (2017) convincingly argues that this need not be the case. As Frie’s servant put in charge of protecting those dearest to her mistress, Line’s two sorrows would consist in her failure to protect both Frie’s son and husband.

3 en bani Bēlja · bjartir at Surti ‘but the bane of Bellow [ = Free], bright, towards Surt’ | In this inset line the wallow relates the death of Free; cf. note to ALL. Free’s obscure fight against Bellow (*ON Beli*) is mentioned in *Gylf* 37:16–19, which also contains the important detail that Free will be without his sword:

„Þessi spk er til þess, er Freyr var svá vápn-lauss, er hann barði-sk við Bēlja ok drap hann með hjartar-borni.“ Þá mēlti Gangleri: „Undr mikit, er því-líkr hǫfðingi sem Freyr er vildi gefa sverð, svá at hann átti eigi annat jafn-gott. Geysi-mikit mein var bonum þat, þá er hann barði-sk við þann, er Beli heitir. Þat veit trúa mín, at þeirar gjafar myndi hann þá iðra-sk.“ Þá svarar Hárr: „Litit mark var þá at, er þeir Beli bittu-sk. Drepa mátti Freyr hann með bendi sinni. Verða mun þat, er Frey mun þykkja verr við koma, er hann missir sverðs’ins, þá er Múspells synir fara at berja.“

“This event is the reason for why Free was so unarmed when he fought against Bellow and slew him with a hart’s antler.” Then spake Gangler: “It is a great wonder that such a chieftain as Free is would give away his sword for which he had nothing as good. It was a huge harm for him when he fought with the one called Bellow. It is my true belief that he would come to regret that gift.” Then answers High: “It was of little harm when he and Bellow met each other. Free could have slain him with his hand. Yet a thing will come to pass which will seem far worse to Free: that he is missing his sword when the Sons of Muspell come harrying.”

Cf. *Skí* 8, *Lok* 42, and *Gylf* 37:1–15 (edited as an appendix to *Skí*).

- 52 Þá kómr hinn mikli · mōgr Sig-fōður,  
2 Víð-arr vega · at val-dýri;  
létr megi Hveðrungs · mund of standa  
4 hjor til hjarta; · þa ’s hefnt fōður.

Then comes the great son of Syefather,  
Wider, to fight that slaughter-beast.  
He lets his hand through Whethring’s lad [= the Wolf]  
drive the sword to the heart—then is the father avenged!

1 Þá kómr hinn mikli · mōgr Sig-fōður ‘Then comes the great son of Syefather’ | Gengr Óðins sonr · við ulf vega ‘Weden’s son goes the Wolf to fight’ **STW**. 2 vega | of vegg **STW**

1 Sig-föður ‘Syefather’ | ‘The Father of Victory’, a name found only here and in *Lok* 58/4, likewise in the context of the battle with the Wolf.

3 Hveðrungs ‘Whethrings’ | Gen. of *Hveðrungr*, an obscure name for Lock, whose son is the Fenerswolf. The name otherwise appears as a name of Lock in a kenning for Hell (*Yt* 24: *Hveðrungs mér* ‘Whethring’s daughter’). It is also found in a later antiquarian list (thule) of names of individual Ettins (*Pul þotna I* 1, SkP 3), and in a thule of names for Weden (*Pul Óðins* 5, SkP 3), but both of these may derive from misinterpretations of the present stanza.

53 Þá kómr hinn méri · mögr Hlōðynjar,  
2 gengr fet níu · Fjörgynjar burr  
neppr frá naðri · níos ò-kvíðnum;  
4 munu halir allir · heim-stöð ryðja  
es af móði drepr · Mið-garðs Véurr.

[R 2v/17, H 20v/41,  
S 17r/20, T TODO,  
W TODO]

Then comes the famed son of Lathyn [= Thunder].  
Nine steps takes Firgyn’s son,  
pained, away from the Adder unfearing of enmity.  
All men will clear their homesteads  
when Middenyard’s Wighward strikes out of wrath.

ALL | *The present form of the stanza is an amalgamation of all three recensions (R, H, and G) based most closely on H and G, which have the last 3 lines in the same order. R has the lines in the order 1, 5, 4, 2, 3 and inserts an additional line between 1 and 5. 1 Þá kómr hinn méri · mögr Hlōðynjar, ‘Then comes the famed lad of Lathyn’ | om. H; add. gengr Óðins sonr við ulf (pro ‘orm’) vega. ‘Weden’s son goes the Wolf (error for ‘Wýrm’) to fight.’ R. 1 Þá kómr ‘Then comes’ | Gengr ‘Goes’ STW 2 gengr fet níu · Fjörgynjar burr ‘nine steps takes Firgyn’s son’ | om. STW. 4 heim-stöð | heim-†steið† 5 es af móði drepr | drepr hann af móði R*

ALL | Thunder and the Middenyardswyrm kill each other, fulfilling their previous abortive encounter during the Fishing Trip (see *Hym*). From a comparative perspective, it is notable that the Norse religion makes the ancient *Chaoskampf*, the motif of a Storm God slaying a watery Serpent as part of Creation, a key part of its eschatology instead. It is surely for this reason that the Wýrm is not slain during the Fishing Trip (as it must have been originally, and as it actually is in *Húsdr*, one of the early Scaldic retellings; see Introduction to *Hym*), since it must remain alive to fight at the Rakes of the Reins. —

This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 51:41–42: *Þórr berr banaorð af Mið-garðs-ormi ok stígr þaðan braut níu fet. Þá fellr hann dauðr til jarðar fyrir eitri því, er orm’inn blæss á hann.* ‘Thunder bears the bane-word from the Middenyardswyrm and strides nine steps away from it. Then he falls dead to the earth from the venom (eitri) which the Wýrm blows on him.’ Cf. also st. H48 below.

2–3 Hlōðynjar, Fjörgynjar ‘Lathyn, Firgyn’ | Both names for the Earth, who is Thunder’s mother.

3 níos ò-kvíðnum ‘unfearing of enmity’ | Dat. sg., modifying *naðri* ‘adder, serpent’. Numerous eds. emend to *ò-kviðinn* (nom. sg.), referring to Thunder.

4 munu halir allir · heim-stöð ryðja ‘All men will clear their homesteads’ | After Thunder is slain the realm of men is no longer habitable. Cf. *Hárð* 23, *Þrk* 18.

5 Mið-garðs Véurr ‘Middenyard’s Wighward’ | Thunder, literally “the Sanctuary-Defender of Middenyard”, a fitting kenning.

54 Sól tér sortna, · sígr fold í mar,

[R 2v/20, H 21r/1,  
S 17r/22, T TODO,  
W TODO, U 18v/10]

- hverfa af himni · heiðar stjörnur;  
geisar ęimi · við aldr-nara;  
leiķr hōr hiti · við himin sjalfan.

The Sun doth blacken; the land sinks into the sea;  
from heaven fade the twinkling stars.  
Smoke billows from the nourisher of life [FIRE];  
the high heat licks against the very heaven.

1 tēr 'doth' | mun 'will' G 1 sigr fold í mar | †sigrfoldinar† (for \*sigr fold í mar) U, cf. *Males* (2023b, 194, 198 n. 25) 1 sigr 'sinks' | sökkr STW 3 við 'from' | ok 'and' HG 3 aldr-nara | aldr-nari (nom. sg.) HG

ALL | This st. is verbally alluded to in Arn *Þorǫlr* 24/1–2 (SkP 2, ca. 1060 AD) in an instance of *adynaton*: *Þjört verðr sól at svartri; · sökkr fold í mar dökkvan; / brestr erfði Austra; · allr glymr sęr á fjöllum* 'Bright, the sun turns black; the land sinks into the dark sea; // Eastre's toil [HEAVEN] shatters; all the sea roars over the fells'. Another allusion is possibly found in SnSt *Ht* 13/2, 4 (SkP 3), which may, however, also be a reference to the Biblical deluge: *Stóð sęr á fjöllum; [...] skaut jörð ór geima*. 'The sea stood over the fells; the earth shot up from the ocean.'

1 sigr fold í mar 'the land sinks into the sea' | The stemmatically excluded reading *sökkr* 'sinks' is probably influenced by Arn *Þorǫlr* 24/1b (SkP 2).

3 aldr-nara 'nourisher of life' | A rare FIRE-kenning, found only here and in the thules or poetic lists of synonyms (*Pul Elds* 3 in SkP 3). It is notable that fire has two conflicting natures: it nourishes life, but it also consumes it. Here a kenning reflecting the former is used, somewhat discordantly, in the context of the latter.

- 55 Gęyr nú Garmr mjōķ · fyr Gnipa-ęelli,  
fęstr mun slitna, · ęn freki rinna;  
fjōļð vęit hōn frōða, · framm sęk lęngra  
of ragna rōķ, · rōmm sig-tíva.

[R 2v/22, H 21r/2]

Now Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;  
the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.  
She knows much lore; I see further ahead  
about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

ALL | With the sinking of the earth into the sea and the blackening of the heaven, the destruction has reached its climax, as signalled by the final repetition of the refrain stanza. To indicate the dramatic pause, which was likely indicated in some way in the original oral performance, a page break has been inserted.



- 56 Sér hön upp koma · qðru sinni  
 2 jorð ór égi · iðja-gröna;  
 falla forsar, · flýgr qrn yfir,  
 4 sás á fjalli · fiska veiðir.

[R 2v/23, H 21r/4]

She sees coming up for a second time  
 the Earth from the ocean, ever green anew.  
 Torrents fall; o'er them flies the eagle  
 which in the fells catches fish.

ALL | Sts. 56–59 are paraphrased in Gylf 53:1–9:

*Dá mælti Gangleri: „Hvart lifa nokkur goðin þá, eða er þá nokkur jorð eða himinn?“ Hárr segir: „Upp skýtur jörðunni þá ór sænum, ok er þá grön ok fagr. Vaxa þá akrar ósánir. Við-arr ok Váli lifa, svá at eigi hefir sér inn ok Surta-logi grandat þeim, ok byggja þeir á Iða-velli, þar sem fyrr var Ós-garðr, ok þar koma þá synir Þórs, Móði ok Magni, ok bafa þar Mjöllni. Því nést koma þar Baldr ok Höðr frá Heljar, setja-sk þá allir samt, ok tala-sk við, ok minna-sk á rúnar sínar, ok ræða of tíðendi þau, er fyrrum boððu verit, of Mið-garðs-orm ok of Fenris-ulf. Þá finna þeir i grasi'nu gull-toflur þér, er ésir'nir boððu átt.“*  
 “Then spoke Gangler: “Do any Gods live then, or is there then any earth or heaven?” High says: “The earth then shoots up from the sea and it is then green and fair. Then acres grow unsown. Wider and Wonnel live, for the sea and Surt's flame have not scathed them, and they settle on the Idewold where Osyard once stood. And then come thither Thunder's sons, Mood and Main, and they have Millner with them. Next come Balder and Hath out of Hell. Then they all sit down together and make speech and think back on their runes and speak about the events of antiquity, about the Middenyardswyrn and the Fenrerswolf. Then they find in the grass those golden game-bricks which the Eese had owned.”

After this passage Gylf cites Vafþ 51. For more traditions of the world to come, cf. Vafþ 44–47.

1 qðru sinni ‘a second time’ | The first time probably being the lifting of the Earth in st. 4.

3–4 falla ... veiðir ‘Torrents ... fish.’ | The unusually vivid description paints a beautiful picture of the mountain-climate of Norway and Iceland. The sense is that the serene beauty of nature is restored from the fire of the destruction.

- 57 Finna=sk ésir · á Iða-velli  
 2 ok umb mold-þinur · mötkan dōma,  
 ok minna=sk þar · á megin-dōma  
 4 ok á Fimbul-týs · fornar rúnar.

[R 2v/24, H 21r/5]

The Eese find each other on the Idewold  
 and of the mighty Earth-Cord [= Middenyardswyrn] speak,  
 and there think back on mighty verdicts  
 and on Fimble-Tew's (= Weden's) ancient runes.

1 Finna=sk ‘find each other’ | hitta=sk H 3 ok minna=sk þar · á megin-dōma ‘and there think back on mighty verdicts’ | so H; om. R

1 Finna=sk ‘find each other’ | The H reading provides closer parallelism with 7/1 above, but for the same reason it may also have replaced an earlier *finna=sk*, as found in R.

2 mold-þinur ‘Earth-cord’ | Cf. the kenning for the Middenyardswyrn in *Húsdr* 4: *stirð-þinull storðar* ‘the stiff cord of the land [= Middenyardswyrn]’.

- 58 Þar munu eptir · undr-sam=ligar

[R 2v/26, H 21r/7]

- 2 gollnar tǫflur · í grasi finna=sk,  
þér's *ęsir* í ár-daga · áttar hǫfðu.

There will again the wondersome  
golden game-bricks in the grass be found,  
which in days of yore the Eese had owned.

1 ęptir 'again' | ęsir 'the Eese' H 2 finna=sk 'be found' | finna 'find' H 3 ęsir | om. RH

ALL | A fine literary device. In st. 8 the golden age of the Eese, exemplified by their playing board games, was spoiled by the three ettin-women. The rediscovery of the golden board game then betokens a new golden age.

3 ęsir 'the Eese' | The verb *hǫfðu* 'had' requires a plural subject, and this is found in the paraphrase of this st. in *Gylf* 53:9: *Þá finna þeir í grasi'nu gull-tǫflur þęr, er ęsir'nir hǫfðu átt* (see st. 56 n. above).

- 59 Munu ó-sánir · akrar vaxa,  
2 bǫls mun alls batna, · mun Baldr koma;  
búa Hǫðr ok Baldr · Hropts sig-toptir,  
4 vęl val-tívar. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2v/28, H 21r/9]

Unsown will acres grow;  
the bale will all be bettered; Balder will come.  
Hath and Balder settle Roft's (= Weden's) victory-plots  
well, the slain-Tews. *Know ye yet, or what?*

2 bǫls 'the bale' | The evil of Hath's slaying Balder (cf. sts. 31–34 above). It will be forgotten as the two brothers reconcile and live alongside each other.

4 val-tívar 'the slain-Tews' | A rare epithet otherwise only found in 50/2 above and *Hym* 1/1; it is not found in *SnEor* or Scaldic poetry. The first element is most likely *valr* 'the battle-slain'. This term probably originally referred exclusively to Hath and Balder, since just these are the two slain gods; it would later have been semantically widened to refer to the Gods in general (so *Vǫp* 50/2, *Hym* 1/1).

- 60 Þá kná Hǫnir · hlaut-við kjósa  
2 ok burir byggva · bróðra tveggja  
vind-heim víðan. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2v/30, H 21r/11]

Then does Heener choose the leat-wood,  
and the sons of the two brothers settle  
the wide wind-home [SKY/HEAVEN]. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 hlaut-við kjósa 'choose the leat-wood' | Foresee the future by means of lots, specifically twigs drenched in the blood of beasts killed during the blood; cf. *Hym* 1. According to Tacitus (*Germania*, ch. 10) such divination was done *publice consultetur, sacerdos civitatis, sin privatim, ipse pater familiae* 'in public questions [by] the priest of the particular state, in private [by] the father of the family'. In later Scandinavian society the positions of high Gid (*goði*) and chieftain or king were largely synonymous, and so this would mean that in the world to come, the peaceful Heener takes over the role of the chief of the Gods after the more warlike Weden. I thank John Newman for this observation.

2 bróðra tveggja ‘of the two brothers’ | The present translation takes *tveggja* to be the gen. pl. of *tveir* ‘two’. The two brothers are presumably Hath and Balder, mentioned in the previous stanza. Since the original mss. do not capitalize proper nouns, we could also read *bróðra Tveggja* ‘the brothers of Tway (= Weden)’, but although Weden’s brothers are attested in *Gylf* 6:10 as Will and Wigh (cf. st. 4/1 above) they are never said to have children.

- 61 Sal sér hön standa · sólu fegra,  
2 golli þakðan, · á Gim-léi;  
þar skulu dyggvar · dróttir byggva  
4 ok umb aldr-daga · ynðis njóta.

[R 2v/31, H 21r/12,  
S 5v/12, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

A hall she sees standing fairer than the sun,  
thatched with gold on Gemlee.  
There faithful folk shall settle  
and in their days of life enjoy delights.

1 sér hön ‘she sees’ | veit’k ‘I know’ G 2 golli þakðan ‘thatched with gold’ | golli þetra ‘better than gold’ ST 2 Gim-léi | metr. emend. by restoration of hiatus; Gim-lé RHG 3 þar ‘there’ | þann ‘[in] that [ball]’ TW

ALL | This stanza is cited immediately following *Gylf* 17:10–12, which read: *Á sunnan-verðum himins enda er sá salr er allra er fegrstr ok bjartari en sól’in, er Gim-lé heitir. Hann skal standa þá er bæði himinn ok jörð hefir farit-sk, ok byggja þann stað góðir menn ok rétt-látir of allar aldir. Svá segir í Völu-spó: ‘At the southern end of heaven is the hall which is the fairest of all and brighter than the sun, which is called Gemlee. It shall stand when both the heaven and the earth have been destroyed, and that place is settled by good men and righteous throughout all ages. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow.’*

*Gylf* 17:13–16 continues: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvat gétir þess staðar, þá er Surta-logi brennir himin ok jörð?“ Hárr segir: „Svá er sagt, at annarr himinn sé suðr ok upp frá þessum himni, ok heitir sá And-langr, en inn þriðri himinn sé enn upp frá þeim, ok heitir sá Við-bláinn, ok á þeim himni byggjum vér þenna stað vera. En Ljós-alfar einir, byggjum vér, at nú byggvi þá staði.“* “Then spoke Gangler: “What protects that place when the flame of Surt burns the heaven and the earth?” High says: “So it is said, that there is another heaven southwards and upwards from this heaven and that one is called Endlong, but the third heaven is even further upwards from them and that one is called Wideblown, and on that heaven we think this place is. But Light-Elves alone, we think, do now inhabit those places.”

- 62 Þar kómr hinn dimmi · dręki fljúgandi,  
2 naðr fránn neðan · frá Niða-fjöllum;  
berr sér í fjöðrum · —flýgr völl yfir—  
4 Nið-hoggr náí; · nú mun hön sökva=sk.“

[R 3r/2, H 21r/15]

Then comes the dusky Dragon flying,  
the gleaming Adder up from the Nithfells.  
He carries in his feathers—he flies o’er the field—  
Nithehewer, corpses. Now will she sink!”

ALL | The function of the final st. is disputed. Earlier eds. see the last half-line as a reference to Nithehewer sinking down into the abyss, permanently ridding the world of evil and resulting in an everlasting world-to-come—a clearly Christian conception. Yet this interpretation requires either emending *hön* ‘she’ in l. 4 to *hann* ‘he’ (so Finnur Jónsson 1932) or removing it entirely (so Sijmons and Gering 1927, pp. 77–78).

I instead agree with Jens P. Schjødtt (1981) in seeing the last half-line as part of the frame of the wallow's recitation and taking the rest of the stanza as a reference to the pre-Christian Indo-European cyclical conception of the world. The presence of Nithehewer illustrates that the next world is still not entirely free from ills, for although most of the fiends have been slain in the great battle, a seed of evil still remains. The Dragon will infest the *axis mundi* (*Grm* 36) in the next world also, and the fact that he still has corpses to eat further shows that evil in mankind has not been eradicated (st. 38 above). Since there is still evil in the next world it too must at some point fall, be destroyed, and be reborn in the endless cosmic cycle; see Introduction to the poem above.

4 nú mun hōn sökva-sk 'Now will she sink' | The spae is concluded and the wallow, referring to herself in the third person, descends back down into the grave whence Woden woke her. Cf. *Helr* 14/4b, the very last half-line of that poem: *sökkst-u, gýgjar-kyn* 'sink, thou gow's kin!'

## Appendix

### Dwarf-tallies (sts. 11–15)

The following sts. (11–15) contain two or three originally distinct lists of dwarf-names. They interrupt the flow of the whole poem so much that they have been moved to the Appendix. Their nature as a later insertion is in any case confirmed by their faulty meter (Males 2025a, p. 373).

That the lists themselves are originally distinct from each other is seen by the repetition of names (13/4, 15/4: *Ēikin-skjaldi* ‘Oakenshield’; 11/4, 15/3: *Ái* ‘Great-grandfather’) and the existence of two formulaic conclusions (12/3–4, 15/6–7). Sts. 11–13, having no repeated names, seem to belong together. If this is the case, st. 12, which contains the formulaic conclusion to the list, should probably switch places with 13.

Sts. 14–15 form a second group, having an introduction and a conclusion which both mention the dwarf Loffer.

NOTE: The variants from the four *Gylf* manuscripts have not yet been collated.

- 11      **N**ýi ok **N**iði, · **N**orðri, Suðri,  
2      **A**ustri, Vestri, · **A**lþjófr, Dvalinn,  
         **B**ífur, **B**öfur, · **B**ömburr, Nóri,  
4      **Á**nn ok **Á**narr, · **Á**i, Mjóð-vitnir.

[R 1r/23, H 20r/17,  
S TODO, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

New and Nithe, Norther and Souther,  
Easter and Wester, Allthief, Dwollen,  
Biber, Babber, Bamber, Noor,  
Own and Owner, Great-grandfather, Meadwitner.

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ALL | Sts. 11–12 are cited in *Gylf* 14:16, introduced by the words *Ok þessi segir hón ngfi þeira* ‘And in this way she says their names’.

1–2 Norðri, Suðri, Austri, Vestri ‘Norther and Souther, Easter and Wester’ | According to *Gylf* 8:10, these four dwarfs were placed by the gods to hold up the Heaven, Yimer’s skull, one in each cardinal direction; cf. st. 3/4 n. above.

- 12      **V**eiðr ok Gand·alfr, · **V**ind·alfr, Þráinn,  
2      **Þ**ekkr ok **Þ**orinn, · **Þ**rór, Vitr ok Littr,  
         **N**ár ok **N**ý·ráðr, · —**n**ú hef’k dvergá—  
4      **R**egginn ok **R**áð·sviðr · —**r**étt of talða.

[R 1r/25, H 20r/18,  
S TODO, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Wey and Gandelf, Windelf, Thrown,  
Thetch and Thorn, Threw, Wit and Lit,  
Nee and Newred—now have I the dwarfs—  
Rain and Redswith—rightly tallied.

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3 **n**ú hef’k dvergá | *om.* G    4 **r**étt of talða | *om.* G

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3–4 nú hef’k dverga ... rétt of talða ‘now have I the dwarfs ... rightly tallied’ | An inset clause; since it does not list the names of any dwarfs, it was omitted by Snorre in *Gylf*.

- 13 Fíli, Kíli, · Fundinn, Náli,  
2 Hepti, Víli, · Hannarr, Svíurr,  
Frár, Horn·bori, · Frégr ok Lóni,  
4 Aur·vangr, Jari, · Eikin·skjaldi.

[R 1r/28, H 20r/20,  
S TODO, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Filer, Chiler, Found and Needler,  
Hefter, Wiler, Hanner, Swigher,  
Fraw, Hornborer, Fray and Looner,  
Earwong, Earer, Oakenshield.

2 Svíurr | †Sviðrr†, / Nár ok Náinn, · Nípingr, Dáinn / Billingsr, Brúni · Bildr ok Búri ‘... *Nee*  
and *Nowen*, *Nípng*, *Dowen*, *Billing*, *Brown*, *Bild* and *Boor*’ H

- 14 Mál es dverga · í Dvalins liði  
2 ljóna kindum · til Lofars tēja,  
þeir es sóttu · frá salar stéini  
4 Aur·vanga sjöt · til Jöru·valla.

[R 1r/30, H 20r/22]

It is time to tally the dwarfs in Dwellen’s troop  
back to Loffer for the race of men;  
they who sought, from the stone of the hall,  
the seat of the Earwongs unto the Erwolds.

3 þeir | þeim H

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 14:18 by the words: *En þessir kómu frá Svarins-baugi til Aur-vanga á Jöru-völlu, ok er kominn þaðan Lofarr*. ‘But these ones came from Swornshigh to the Earwongs on the Erwolds, and from them Loffer is come.’ After this passage, *Gylf* cites st. 15/3–5.

1–2 Mál es ... tēja ‘It is time ... of men’ | A variant of a standard genealogical introduction; cf. *Hátt* 1: *meðan hans étt ... til góða töljum* ‘while we tally his line ... back to the Gods’. The patrilineal line of dwarfs is to be counted back to their progenitor, Loffer. This possibly disagrees with st. 10 where Moodsowner is said to be the foremost (and presumably the oldest) of the dwarfs, and Loffer is not mentioned, but consistency in such details can probably not be expected.

- 15 Þar vas Draupnir · ok Dolg·þrasir,  
2 Hár, Haug·spori, · Hlé·vangr, Glói,  
Skirfir, Virfir, · Ská·fiðr, Ái,  
4 Alfr ok Yngvi, · Eikin·skjaldi,  
Fjalarr ok Frosti, · Finnrr ok Ginnarr;  
6 Þat mun é uppi, · meðan öld lifir,  
lang-niðja-tal · Lofars hafat.

[R 1r/32, H 20r/24]

There was Dleepner and Dollowthrasher,  
 High, Highspurer, Leewong, Glower,  
 Sherver, Werver, Showfind, Great-grandfather,  
 Elf and Ing, Oakenshield,  
 Feller and Frost, Finn and Ginner.  
 That will ever be remembered while the age lives,  
 the recited tally of the ancestors of Loffer.

---

6 **ĕ** | so H; om. R

---

ALL | The dwarf-names in this st. are split up across several sections in *Gylf* 14. In *Gylf* 14:17, variants of the names in ll. 1–2 are cited, followed by four names not found in *Vsp* and then by the names in st. 13/2. That name-list is introduced by the words *En þessir eru ok dvergjar ok búa í steinum, en inir fyrri í moldu*: ‘But these ones are also dwarfs and dwell in stones, but the former ones in the earth.’ The names of ll. 3–5 are cited in *Gylf* 14:19 immediately following a paraphrase of st. 14, introduced by the words *þessi eru nafn þeira* ‘these are their names’. Although these name-lists cannot be considered citations of this stanza proper, the variants of the names have been included (TODO!) in the critical edition.

6 Þat mun **ĕ** uppi, · meðan öld lifir ‘That will ever be remembered while the age lives’ | Both verse-halves are formulaic, though their use in a list of dwarf-names is unparalleled. For the first cf. *Heiðr* 119 (in SkP 7): *þat mun **ĕ** uppi; · illr es dómr norna!* ‘That will always be remembered; evil is the judgement of the norns!’ For the second cf. runic inscription U 323 Sälva (ca. 980–1015 AD), edited under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland. What is essentially a Scaldic rewrite of the whole line is found in *Þstf Stuttur* 5/1–2 (SkP 2): *Ey mun uppi · Endils, meðan stendr // sól-borgar salr, · svor-góðis for* ‘Ever will be remembered—while the hall of the sun’s stronghold [SKY/HEAVEN > EARTH] stands—the journey of the fattener of Andle’s bird [RAVEN/EAGLE > WARRIOR].’

7 Lofars hafat | This line would be unmetrical in the rest of the poem since the first lift is on a short syllable (Males 2025a, p. 373). This strongly suggests that the Dwarf-tally section is a later insert.

## Stanzas from *Hauksbók*

H has a few substantial insertions and variants not found in R. The following four stanzas, H31, H41, H48, H58, are the only instances longer than a single line (but cf. st. 7/2 n. above).

The style and content of H41, H48, and especially H58, comes off as rather different from the rest of the poem; they are therefore unlikely to be authorial. H31 may, however, be genuine.

**H31**      Þá kná **Váli** · **vig**-bønd snúa;  
 2            **h**ęldr vöru **harð**-gør · **h**øt ór þørmum.

[H 20v/12]

Then did Wonnell the war-bonds twist:  
 the most sturdy fetters were made from entrails.

---

1 Váli ‘Wonnell’ | Vála H

---

ALL | These two lines replace the present 34/1–2 in H. —

Lock was bound by Weden's son Wonnell, who thus avenged Balder by punishing both of those responsible for his death: he killed Hath (who held the weapon) and bound Lock (who guided Hath's hand). Cf. *Gylf* 50:20–22: *Þá vöru teknir synir Loka, Váli ok Nari eða Narfi. Brugðu ęsir Vála í vargs líki ok reif bann í sundr Narfa, bróður sinn. Þá tóku ęsir þarma hans ok bundu Loka með yfir þá þrjá egg-steina. Stendr einn undir herðum, annarr undir lendum, þriði undir knés-fötum, ok urðu þau bönd at járnri.* 'Then were taken Lock's sons, Wonnell and Nare or Narve. The Eese turned Wonnell into the likeness of a wolf and he tore apart Narve, his brother. Then the Eese took his intestines and with them they bound Lock over three sharp stones. One stands under his shoulder-blades, the other under his lower back, the third under his houghs; and those bonds turned into iron.'

It is likely that Snorre's version of *Vsp* contained this st. and also had the oblique sg. form \**Vála* in l. 1, which led him to misinterpret Wonnell as the name of one of Lock's sons, rather than the name of Weden's son Wonnell, the avenger of Hath. No other source attests Wonnell as the name of a son of Lock. Cf. the version of the binding of Lock found in *Lok* P8.

**H41**      **Hręða=sk allir · ā hęl-vegum**

[H 20v/28]

2      **āðr Surtar þann · sefi of gļępir.**

All are frightened on the Hell-ways  
before Surt's kinsman devours it.

ALL | St. 45 is followed by these lines in H, in effect forming another four-line stanza with 45/5–6. In context, the lines seem to be referring to an ettin swallowing the World Tree.

**H48**      **Gınn lopt yfir · lindi jarðar,**

[H 20v/39]

2      **gapa ýgs kjaptar · orms í hęðum;**

mun **Öðins son · ęitri móta**

4      **vargs at dauða · Við·ars niðja.**

Over the air yawns the Girdle of the Earth [= Middenyardswyrm];  
the jaws of the fierce Wyrm gape in the heights.  
Weden's son [= Thunder] will meet the venom  
of the Warg, after the deaths of Wider's kinsmen [= the Eese].

ALL | *The last part of the stanza is almost completely illegible in the ms. I have relied on the transliteration of Jón Helgason (1971, pp. 13, 44 ff.).* 3 *ęitri* 'venom' | *emend.*; ormi 'Wyrm' H. 4 *dauða* | 'da...' H

ALL | This stanza appears between 52 and 53 in H. It is not found in the sequence of stanzas cited in *Gylf* 51:50, but some details in the preceding paraphrase are not entirely dissimilar. *Gylf* 51:18–20: *En Fenris-ulfr ferr með gapandi munn, ok er inn neðri kjoþr við jörðu, en in ofri við himin. Gapa myndi bann meira, ef rúm væri til. Eldar brenna ór augum hans ok nösnum. Mið-garðs-ormr blęss svá eitri'nu, at bann dreifir lopt ęll ok lög, ok er bann á aðra blið ulfi'num.* 'But the Fenrerswolf fares with gaping mouth; and the lower jaw is on the earth, but the upper is in the heaven; he would gape yet broader if there were room for it. Fires burn from his eyes and nostrils. The Middenyardswyrm blows the venom so far that it covers the whole air and sea, and he is most terrible, and he is by the side of the Wolf.'

3 *ęitri* 'venom' | Cf. *Gylf* 51:41–42, cited in the notes to st. 53 above.

**H58**      **Þa kómr hinn ríki · at ręgin-dómi**

[H 21r/14]



2            ǫflugr ofan · sá's ǫllu rēðr.

Then comes the powerful one to the Great Judgment,  
strong down from above, he who rules everything.

---

ALL | This half-stanza appears between sts. 61 and 62 in **H**. It is generally held to be a late Christian insert, since it betrays Christian theological sentiments. An omnipotent God coming down from above to the Great Judgment (*regin-dómr*)—none of these elements are found in the pre-Christian religion. Cf. *Hdl* 43, which is likely drawing on the present stanza.



# Speeches of the High One

## (*Háva mól*)

**Dating:** Likely varying, see below.

**Meter:** majority: Leeds-meter;  
minority: Speeches-meter, Ancient-words-law.

### Introduction

The **Speeches of the High One** (abbrev. *Háv*) is a wisdom poem, most likely a collection of several poems, bound together by a common attribution to the Germanic god of wisdom, Woden.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Háv* is the second poem of **R** (foll. 3r/4–7v/9), where it follows *Vǫp* and is followed by *Vǫfþ*. **R** is the only independent manuscript witness for the poem, but several isolated sts. (1, 58, 76–77, 84) are cited or alluded to in other texts.

### Contents

*Háv* is, as it comes down to us in **R**, a motley collection. It contains two or three poems of practical life advice, two mythological narratives, scattered gnomic poetry about runes, and a list of galders. Thematically these materials are united by their direct attribution to the high god Woden, or as he is called in sts. 109, 111, and 166, *Hœvi* ‘the High One’.

In the direct attribution of the totality of the poem to a god *Háv* stands utterly alone among Norse poetry, for although Woden also has much to say in *Vǫfþ*, *Grm*, and *Bdr*, in those poems his speech is reported speech enclosed in a narrative frame. Though internal frame-like devices do appear in sts. 1–2, 111, and 166, *Háv* has no external narrative frame. The poem is, as it were, the very Words of the High One.

### Sections of the poem

On the basis of meter, style, content, and later manuscript tradition, I identify the following major strands, excluding various isolated sts. (e.g. 80) that are probably later inserts. In the present edition each is given its own short introduction:

1. The Guests' Strand (1–77, with 78–79 being later additions)
2. Various scattered sts. of advice (81–90)
3. Weden's tryst with Billing's daughter (91–102)
4. Weden's obtaining of the Mead of Poetry (103–110)
5. The Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137)
6. The Rune-Tally; sts. about runes and ritual (138–146)
7. The Leed-Tally; Weden's listing of 18 galders (146–165)

It can hardly be stated that every strand was originally its own poem. Weden's two romantic adventures (91–102 and 103–110), for instance, have much in common stylistically and individually seem too short to have ever stood on their own.

On the other hand it seems highly unlikely that the Guests' Strand (1–77) and the Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137) were ever a single composition, for they differ very much in tone, in style, and in structure.

The Guests' Strand is down to earth and sceptical, never mentions women (st. 79 is prob. a later insert), gives its advice in the form of maxims and similes and by reference to the behaviour of a "wise" or "unwise man", never makes use of the second imperative (and only thrice of the verb *skalt* '(thou) shalt', 44/3, 45/3, 46/3), and has a perfectly fitting conclusion in sts. 76–77.

On the other hand the Speeches of Loddfathomer places great emphasis on magical ideas (113–114, 126, 129, 137) and women (113–115, 118, 130, 131/5), gives its advice directly by means of the second imperative and never with reference to the behaviour of the "(un)wise man", and is much less clearly structured, concluding with a long list of folk magical remedies in st. 137.

There is direct repetition between the two sections (most notably between sts. 44 and 119), which would be redundant if both were originally a single work. In addition to notable differences in content there are also notable linguistic differences, for which cf. the section on Dating below.

### Prehistory and redaction into a single text

Since the full *Háv* almost certainly consists of at least two originally separate compositions two questions naturally arise: *how* were these materials redacted into a single poem, and *why*? No answers to these problems can be certain and so the following is only the translator's own speculation.

To answer either question we first need to determine in what context the redaction took place: whether in an oral or scribal tradition, in a Heathen

hove or a Catholic monastery. St. 166, given that it explicitly mentions the title of the poem, must probably be associated with the final layer of the redaction, and so is of particular use. Its blessing of the reciter, hearers, and learners indicates that the poem was to be chanted and learned by heart, and its description of the contents of the poem (which includes unambiguous Heathen ritual advice like st. 145) as *all-þorrf* ‘most useful’ to Men and *ó-þorrf* ‘harmful’ to Ettins invokes the Heathen dichotomy between the Gods and Ettins as friends and enemies of Mankind, respectively (cf. Introduction to *Hym*).

Thus, on the basis of the final stanza and the pagan contents of the rest of the poem, we can say that *Háv* was probably redacted into something very close to its present form no later than the early 11th century, in an oral, Heathen context.

Moving on to the *how*, it is certain that in an oral transmission additions and inserts need not have happened all at once, but could have taken place successively in the form of layers appended to an original core. Thus the original Guests’ Strand probably ended at st. 77, but sts. 78–90 may have been added shortly afterwards, later the two narratives about Weden’s romantic escapades, thereafter the Speeches of Loddfathomer, the Rune-tally, and the Leeds. Even after the basic structure was obtained, stanzas such as 73 could have been inserted where they were felt most fitting in order to make the poem more “complete” in the eyes of the inserter. These inserts may well have continued into the period of scribal transmission.

For the *why*, we should consider what reason someone would have for redacting numerous materials into a single poem. St. 166, as discussed above, suggests that the main reason was utilitarian rather than antiquarian, and a picture then emerges of a redactor arranging a corpus of traditional poetry, selected both for its traditional attribution to the god Weden and for its *usefulness*—whether as practical life advice or as mythological and religious lore—into a single long poem meant to be learned by heart as a whole and recited for magical purposes. In practice this final redaction served as sort of Odinic “ark” (or “Hoardmimer’s wood”, *Vafþ* 45/2) in which the bulk of surviving pre-Christian Norse advice poetry was transmitted until it could be written down. Forever lost were whichever stanzas were not included in it—and many such must have existed.

### Meter and stanza

*Háv* consists of 722 lines (365 long-lines, 355 full-lines/c-verses, 2 unusual verses) distributed across 166 sts. It is the single longest preserved Norse poem of any genre, Eddic or Scaldic (the two parts of Guthley’s *Merlinus spó* I and II together consist of 171 sts. but are two distinct poems; three other particularly long poems are *Hug-svinns mól* at 149 sts., Snorre’s *Hátta-lykill* at 102 sts., the anonymous *Lilja* at 100 sts.).

### Leeds-meter

The meter of *Háv* is varied but primarily consists of varying configurations of Leeds-meter (1-72, 74-80, 84, 88, 91-108, 109/3-124/2, 129/1-3, 130-131/3, 132-137/3, 137/8-138/6, 140-141/2, 142-143, 145, 147/1-2, 148-166).

The most common configuration of the Leeds-meter stanza is the archetypal *abc abc* (2-5, 7-26, 28-72, 75-79, 84, 88, 91-101, 104, 106-108, 110, 114, 118, 123, 133, 136, 140, 149, 151-155, 159-162). A likely defective variant of this configuration is *abc ab* (145).

Also found is the syncopated configuration *abc* (148, 163) and the extended *abc abc abc* (6 sts.: 6, 27, 102-103, 138, 165).

### Galders-law

Configurations with repeated full-lines are also represented. These fall under the label Galders-law, although they are not properly a different meter. These may be seen as extended variants of the three basic Leeds-meter-types *abc*, *abc abc*, and *abc abc abc*.

Extensions of *abc* are *abccc* (143), *abcccc* (164), and *abccccc* (142).

Extensions of *abc abc* are *abc abcc* (105, 150, 156, 158), *abc abccc* (157), *abcc abc* (12 sts.: 1, 74, 112-113, 115-116, 120, 122, 127-128, 132, 135), and *abcc abcc* (125, 166).

Extensions of *abc abc abc* are *abc abc abccc* (111), *abcc abc abc* (117, 119, 121, 126, 130), and *abcc abc abccc* (134).

### Unusual verses

In addition to this there are two Leeds-meter-stanzas containing unusual verses, viz. verses that only carry one alliterating stave connecting to a previous long-line of type *ab*. The two stanzas are 61 (*abc abcx*) and 80 (*abxccc*), where *x* marks the unusual verse.

### Other meters

A minority meter is Speeches-meter (73, 81-83, 85-87, 89-90, 109/1-2, 124/3-4, 129/4, 131/4-6, 137/4-7, 141/3-4, 147/3-4). With the exception of the likely interpolated st. 73, stanzas composed exclusively in Speeches-meter are found only in the section sts. 81-90.

Several stanzas in sections 4-7 (sts. 103-165) mix Speeches-meter and Leeds-meter by having long-lines (*ab*) not directly followed by a *c*-verse. With the Speeches-meter lines bracketed the relevant configurations are: [*ab ab*] *abc* (109), *abc* [*ab ab*] (124, 141, 147), *abcc* [*ab*] *abc* (129), *abcc* [*ab ab ab*] (131), and *abcc* [*ab ab ab ab*] *abc* (137).

The Rune-Tally section (146-165) attests a few examples of Ancient-words-law (139, 144, 146).

## Dating

Having above determined that the redaction of the poem most likely took place in pagan times, we should try to arrive at a more detailed dating of the individual strands.

On the purely linguistic side most archaic features are concentrated in the Guests' Strand (sts. 1–77). Old *vr-* alliterates with *v-* 2 times in non-formulaic word pairs (sts. 26/2, 32/2) and the particle *of* appears 3 times before nominals (4/3: *of óðis*, 21/4: *of mál*, 38/4: *of þorfr*). That these archaic traits are all found in the Guests' Strand is notable but does not definitely prove that it is much older than the rest of the poem, since clear diagnostics like old *vr-* alliterating with *r-* are uncertain (though cf. 106/1).

The frequency of the old particle *of* before verbs and nouns varies by section. It is found at a rate of 0.363 occurrences per 10 unique lines in sections 1–4 (sts. 1–110) and a near-identical 0.385 in sections 6–7 (sts. 138–166), but only 0.137 in section 5 (sts. 111–137) (Sapp 2022, p. 70). Together with the notably different stylistic traits of this section compared to the Guests' Strand this observation strongly supports the hypothesis of *Háv* as a composite.

Content-based criteria for dating, chiefly the poem's unabashed endorsement of paganism, have been discussed above, but a few more can be mentioned briefly. As Males (2024b, pp. 93–96) points out, sts. 71 and 81 of the poem treat being “burned” as synonymous with being “dead” just like modern English “six feet under” assumes a custom of burials. This synonymity convincingly suggests a pagan date since cremation was strongly taboo in mediæval Christianity and reserved for criminals and heretics (cf. *Am* 84 n.). Since these passages are merely giving neutral life-advice they should be expected to conform to their contemporary cultural context, and as such the neutral statement of “praising a woman when she is burned” (st. 81) is unlikely to belong to the Christian period.

## Text

## 1. The Guests' Strand (1-79)

The Guests' Strand (ON *Gęsta-bátttr*) is a wisdom poem, taking its outset in the scene of a lone Wanderer's arriving as a stranger at a farmstead; this Wanderer appears to be the speaker of the section, and will be entitled as such.

The Strand begins by discussing the mutual responsibilities between guest and host, before moving on to describing proper conduct in human interactions more broadly, with a particular focus on drinking, speech, and friendship; it lastly turns towards death and legacy. Themes not dealt with are religious beliefs, folk magic, and women (except in 79), but that the speaker is in fact the god Weden and not just any wise old man is ascertained by sts. 13-14.

The Strand is not clearly divided into thematic sections, but there is a tendency towards groups of stanzas dealing with certain subjects and a noticeable progression from the initial subject of the guest-host relationship to increasingly more abstract concerns like friendship, fate, wisdom, legacy, and finally death. In this progression the Wanderer often makes use of transitions in order to move from one theme to another (e.g. between sts. 4-5, or 10-11), but even still, previous subjects often reappear after having been dropped for a few stanzas.

The spirit of the advice is consistent throughout, and at all turns the poem counsels shrewdness, caution, and moderation. Of particular importance is the idea of "manwit" (*man-vit*), or knowledge about the proper conduct in various situations; this encompasses being silent rather than speaking nonsense, not indulging in food or drink, and so forth. The emphasis on wisdom is also found in the way the advice itself is given, namely through examples of the proper conduct of a wise man and the bad behaviour of an unwise man.

It seems very likely that the original Guests' Strand ended with sts. 76-77. This finds internal support in the thematic conclusion of death (whereas sts. 78 and 79 deal with wealth and women, and st. 80 with runic magic) and external support in *Hákm* 21, which most likely borrows its first two lines (*deȝyr fę · deȝja fręndr* 'kine die, kinsmen die') from *Háv* 76-77 and likewise uses them in a context of finality.

- 1      **G**ättir allar · áðr **g**angi frammm  
 2              of **skoða**=sk **skyli**,  
               of **skyggna**=sk **skyli**;  
 4      því't **ò**-víst 's at vita, · hvar **ò**-vinir  
               sitja à **f**lęti **f**yrim.

[R 3r/4, S 2r/3,  
 T 2v/13, W 5r/16,  
 U 2v/4]

**ALL DOORWAYS**—before one might go forth—  
 he should spy round;  
 he should pry round,



for it is unsure to know where enemies  
sit on the benches within.

---

1 Gáttir allar 'All doorways' | Skatnar allir 'All warriors' U 1 gangi 'one might go' | né gangim  
'we might not go' 2 of skoða=sk skyli | om. SWU 4 at vita | om. W 5 fleti | fletjum U

---

2–3 of skoða=sk skyli / of skyggna=sk skyli 'he should spy round / he should pry round' | I have  
borrowed the English translation of these two lines from Bray (1908).

- 2 Gefendr hēilir, · gęstr 's inn kominn, [R 3r/6]  
2 hvar skal sitja sjá?  
Mjok es bráðr · sá's á bröndum skal  
4 síns of fręista frama.  
O givers, hail! A guest is come in;  
where shall this one sit?  
Most anxious is he who on the wood-pile shall  
test his furtherance.
- 

ALL | The speaker, who may be the guest himself, announces to the hosts (the 'givers') that a guest, frozen, wet and tired, is sitting outside waiting to be let in. With this stanza the frame of the guest arriving at a farmstead begins; it is from this scenario that the following advice gradually branches out.

3 á bröndum 'on the wood-pile' | Many interpretations have been offered for this line, chiefly owing to the varied senses of ON *brandr* 'fire, firewood, sword'. I agree with Evans (1986, p. 77) that the best explanation is attained by reference to a Norwegian folk custom attested from much later times, wherein the guest would *sitja i bröndo*, i.e., sit down on the wood-pile outside the door, waiting until being let in.

4 síns of fręista frama 'test his furtherance' | Try his luck, see how far he gets. The same line is also found in *Vafþ* 11, 13, 15, 17.

- 3 Elds es þorǫf · þęim's inn es kominn [R 3r/8]  
2 ok á knéi kalinn,  
matar ok váða · es manni þorǫf,  
4 þęim's hęfr of fjall farit.  
Fire is needful for him who has come inside  
and is cold about his knees.  
Food and of clothing are needful for the man  
who over the fell has fared.

- 4 Vats es þorǫf · þęim's til verðar kōmr, [R 3r/10]  
2 þęrru ok þjóð-laðar,  
góðs of óðis, · —ef sér geta mętti—  
4 orðs ok ęndr-þogu.

Water is needful for him who comes for a meal,  
 [and] a towel and a hearty welcome,  
 a good mood—if he might get it—  
 a word, and silence in return.

---

ALL | There is a good train of thought throughout the st.: the guest must first wash and dry himself, then be welcomed to sit and eat at the table. After the host has furnished him with these amenities the expectation of proper conduct now shifts onto the guest, who should introduce himself and speak wisely.

3 of *óðis* ‘mood’ | An instance of prenominal *of*, an archaic feature. *of óði* appears once in a Scaldic poem, Egill *Arkv* 2 (in SkP 5). Cf. st. 21/4 below.

4 *ændr-þögu* ‘silence in return’ | One may note that the verb *þegja* ‘shut up, hush, be silent’—of which *\*þaga*, which only appears in the present cpd, is a derivative formed in the same way as *saga* ‘saw, history’ to *sgja* ‘say, speak’—and the related noun *þegn* ‘silence’ are frequently used at the beginning of Scaldic poems (e.g. Arn *Magnr* 1: *þegi sēim-brotar* ‘may gold-breakers [GENEROUS MEN] be silent’, Egill *Berdr* 1: *hyggi ... til þagnar þinn ljör* ‘may thy retinue focus on silence’, Glúm *Gráf* 1: *biðjum vér þagnar* ‘we ask for silence’).

5 Vits es þorǫf · þeim’s víða ratar;  
 2 dēlt es hēima hvat;  
 at auga-bragði · verðr sá’s ekkí kann  
 4 ok með snotrum sitr.

[R 3r/12]

Wit is of use for him who widely roams;  
 everything is easy at home.  
 The subject of glances becomes he who nothing knows  
 and among the clever sits.

---

3 *auga-bragði* ‘The subject of glances’ | Idiomatic. *auga-bragð* literally means ‘blink of an eye, moment’ (so st. 78/3 below), and the sense here is thus something like ‘a quick glance of derision’.

6 At hyggjandi sinni · skyli=t maðr hrósinn vesa,  
 2 heldr gētinn at gēði,  
 þá’s horskr ok þögull · kōmr hēimis-garða til,  
 4 sjaldan verðr víti vorum,  
 því’t ð-brigðra vin · fēr maðr aldri=gi,  
 6 an man-vit mikit.

[R 3r/14]

Of his thinking should man not be boastful,  
 rather guarding of his senses  
 when sharp and silent he comes to a homestead;  
 sudden harm seldom strikes the wary,  
 for a less fickle friend man never gets  
 than great manwit.

5 maðr ‘man’ | In R abbreviated with the rune  $\Psi$  m, whose ON name is *maðr* ‘man’; the first of 45 such instances in the present poem. Whereas Anglo-Saxon Latin-script mss. use several runes ideographically (e.g.  $\mathfrak{X}$  o for OE *ððel* ‘homeland, patrimony’), there do not seem to be any Scandinavian examples with runes other than  $\Psi$ . The tradition of ideographic runes goes back to the Runic period itself, as shown by the pre-Christian inscriptions from Stentofen (DR 357) and Ingelstad (Ög 43); DR 357 uses the rune  $\mathfrak{J}$  for *ár* ‘year, good harvest’ and Ög 43 uses  $\mathfrak{M}$  d for *dagr* ‘day’. For the names of the runes see the Three Rune Poems, edited below under Runic Poetry.

6 man-vit ‘manwit’ | The first introduction of this very important concept. The word is difficult to translate (which is why it has been calqued), but seems to refer to the opposite of Scandinavian ‘blue-eyed’ naïveté, viz., shrewdness, situational awareness, and familiarity with the correct behaviour in varied social contexts.

- 7 Hinn vari geðstr · es til verðar kœmr, [R 3r/17]  
 2 þunnu hljóði þegir;  
 eyrum hlýðir, · en augum skoðar,  
 4 svá nýsi=sk fróðra hværr fyrir.

The wary guest who comes for a meal  
 with sharp hearing shuts up.  
 With ears he listens and with eyes he watches;  
 so looks each learned man ahead.

2 þunnu hljóði ‘with sharp hearing’ | Lit., ‘with thin silence’.

2 þegir ‘shuts up’ | The importance of silence and not speaking frivolously is very important in the poem, and is further brought up in sts. 17, 19, 22, 26–31, 45, 46, 63, 65, 73, 103, 117, 124, 125, and 132–135.

4 nýsi=sk ... fyrir ‘looks ... ahead’ | This phrasal verb underlies the noun *for-njón* as found in *Sigrdr* 25, which offers similar advice.

- 8 Hinn es séll, · es sér of getr [R 3r/19]  
 2 lof ok líkn-stafi;  
 ó·della ’s við þat, · es ęiga skal  
 4 annars brjóstum ĩ.

*This one* is blessed, who for himself does earn  
 goodwill and friendly words.  
 It is less easy with that which one shall own  
 in another man’s breast.

2 lof ‘goodwill’ | Or ‘praise’, but *lof* here carries the specific sense of the favour or goodwill one earns through generous acts.

2 líkn-stafi ‘friendly words’ | A cpd. of *líkn* + *stafr*. *líkn* is defined by ONP as: ‘mercy, compassion, relief, comfort, help’; cf. its two other occurrences in the present poem: st. 120 and especially st. 123, where it is likewise paired with *lof* ‘goodwill, praise’.

- 9 Sá es séll, · es sjalfr of á [R 3r/20]

- 2           lof ok vit meðan lifir;  
           því't ill rōð · hefr maðr opt þegit  
 4           annars brjóstum ór.

*That one* is blessed, who himself does have  
 goodwill and wits while he lives,  
 for ill counsel has man oft taken  
 out of another man's breast.

---

1 Sá 'That one' | Contrasting with *hinn* 'this one' in the previous stanza.

- 10       Byrði bętri · berr=at maðr brautu at, [R 3r/22]  
 2           an séi man-vit mikit;  
           auði bętra · þykkir þat í ó-kunnum stað;  
 4           s-líkt es vá-laðs vera.

A better burden bears man not on the road  
 than much manwit.  
 In an unknown place it seems better than wealth;  
 such is the destitute man's shelter.

- 11       Byrði bętri · berr=at maðr brautu at, [R 3r/24]  
 2           an séi man-vit mikit;  
           veg-nest verra · vegr=a vęlli at,  
 4           an séi of-drykkja ęls.

A better burden bears man not on the road  
 than much manwit.  
 Worse way-provision he drags not along on the plain  
 than an overdrinking of ale.

---

3 vęlli at 'on the plain' | I.e., 'in the wilderness, outside', in contrast to the safety of one's home village. The word *vęllr* 'plain, (uncultivated) field' is used in the same sense in sts. 38 and 49 below. It is easily understood that the wild heaths and plains of Iron Age Norway were particularly unsafe places whereon a traveller needed to keep his wits about him, lest he fall prey to highwaymen (so st. 38).

- 12       Es=a svá gótt, · sęm gótt kveða,  
 2           ęl alda sonum;  
           því't fęra vęit, · es fleira drekk,  
 4           síns til gęðs gumi.

It is not so good as they call it good,  
 ale, for the sons of men,  
 for the less he knows as the more he drinks  
 man of his own sense.

- 13 Ó-minnis-*hægri* *h*ęitir, · *s*á's yfir *q*lðrum þrumir, [R 3r/27]  
 2 hann steln *g*ęði *g*uma;  
 þęss *f*ogls *f*jððrum · *ek* *f*jðtraðr *v*as'k  
 4 í *g*arði *G*unn-laðar.

Forgetfulness-heron is he called who hovers over ale-feasts;  
 he robs man of his senses.  
 By that bird's feathers I was fettered  
 in Guthlathe's yard.

1 Ó-minnis-*hægri* 'Forgetfulness-heron' | Lit., 'unmemory-heron', the personification of drunkenness as a hovering bird.

3–4 þęss *f*ogls *f*jððrum · *ek* *f*jðtraðr *v*as'k í *g*arði *G*unn-laðar 'By that bird's feathers I was fettered in Guthlathe's yard.' | The first use of the first-person pronoun in the poem. — The myth alluded to is Weden's theft of the Mead of Poetry from Sutting's daughter, Guthlathe (*Gunn-lęð*). For this myth see introduction to sts. 103–110 below. In the version told in *Skm* Weden does indeed drink all of the Mead, but he soon spits it out again and shows no adverse effects. On the other hand the implication behind the present stanza seems to be that the Mead had the drawbacks of normal alcohol. If this be the case it might lend support to the theory that the Guests' Strand and the later parts of *Háv* were originally separate compositions since no drunkenness is found in *Háv* 103–110, although it could also be taken symbolically since too great wisdom is not a good thing (cf. sts. 53–56 below). Cf. the following st. 14.

- 14 *Q*lr *ek* *v*arð, · *v*arð *o*fr-*q*lvi, [R 3r/29]  
 2 at hins *f*róða *F*jalars;  
 því *es* *q*lðr *bat*st\*, · at *a*ptr of *h*ęimtir  
 4 *h*vęrr *s*itt *g*ęð *g*umi.

Drunk I became—became the dead-drunkest—  
 at the learned Fealer's.  
 Thus that ale-feast is best where every man  
 gets back to his senses.

3 *batst\** | *gramm. emend.*; *batstr* (*m. nom. sg.*) R

1–2 *Q*lr *ek* *v*arð ... at hins *f*róða *F*jalars 'Drunk I became ... at the learned Fealer's' | Possibly another reference to the Mead of Poetry, for Fealer was one of the two dwarfs who slew Quasher and made the mead. Again the sense seems to be that Weden got drunk on it, but since Weden (in the attested versions of the myth) never meets the two dwarfs the mention of them may be metaphorical. Fealer may also be a variant name for Sutting, Guthlathe's father.

- 15 *Þ*agalt *ok* *h*ugalt · *skyli* *þ*jóðans *b*arn [R 3r/31]  
 2 *ok* *v*ig-djarft *v*esa;  
*g*laðr *ok* *r*ęifr · *skyli* *g*umna *h*vęrr,  
 4 und's *s*inn *b*íðr *b*ana.

Silent and thoughtful should the king's child be  
 and battle-bold.

Glad and cheerful should every man be  
till he suffers his bane.

- 16 Ó·snjallr maðr · hygg=sk munu ey lifa,  
2 ef við víg vara=sk;  
en elli gefr hönum · engi frið,  
4 þó'tt hönum gëirar gefi.

[R 3v/1]

The unvalorous man thinks he will live for ever  
if he is wary of war,  
but old age gives him no peace  
though the spears might give it to him.

ALL | The coward may have been spared pain by the spears, but he cannot avoid the suffering of infirm old age (which in a world before modern medicine was even greater than today, consider just as one example the loss of all teeth). *It* will never spare him. The subtext is that since death is unavoidable it is better to live an honourable life and die young than a cowardly one and die of old age. This appears related to the negative view of the *strá-dauði* 'straw-death' (actually a hapax, only attested in *Korm* 85, SkP 5), i.e., death in bed from old age or sickness. Compare the speech attributed to the 10th century warrior Eyel Woolserk before a battle, in *HákGóð* 23: *þat óttuðumk ek um brið, er friðr þessi inn mikli var, at ek mynda verða elli-dauðr inni á þall-strám mínum; en ek vilda heldr falla í orrostu ok fylgja þofðingja mínum; kann nú vera, at svá megí verða*. 'I long feared while this great peace lasted that I would die of old age indoors upon my straw bed, but I would rather fall in battle and follow my chieftain; now it may be that it turns out so.' A similar contempt for life as mere living is common in the older heroic literature (e.g., *Fáfn* 10, *Akv* 23–27), written as it was to celebrate (the lives of) young kings and warriors. Even so, it must be said that *Háv* is uniquely nuanced in this regard (cf. especially sts. 69–71 below), not unlikely since its author was himself an old man, rather than a young warrior-poet.

- 17 Kópir af-glapi, · es til kynnis kómr,  
2 þyl=sk hann umb eða þrumir;  
allt es senn, · ef sylg of getr,  
4 uppi 's þá gëð guma.

[R 3v/3]

The oaf gapes when he comes to visit;  
he mumbles about or loiters.  
All at once if a sip he gets  
exposed is the mind of the man.

- 18 Sá einn vëit, · es víða ratar  
2 ok hëfr fjölð of farit,  
hvęrju gëði · stýrir gumna hvęrr,  
4 sá es vitandi 's vits.

[R 3v/5]

He alone knows who widely roams  
and has journeyed much,  
which sort of mind every man wields,  
who is knowing of his wits.

ALL | Only he who has seen the world knows how a wise man should think and conduct himself.

2 hefr fjölð of farit ‘has journeyed much’ | Cf. *Vafþ* 3, 44, et.c., where Weden repeats: *Fjölð ek fór, · fjölð freistada’k, // fjölð ek reynda rugin* ‘Much I journeyed, much I tried, much I tested the Reins.’

- 19        **H**aldi=t maðr á kəri, · drikki þó at **h**ófi mjöð,  
 2                mēli þarft eða þegi;  
               **ó**·kynnis þess · váar þik **ę**ngi maðr,  
 4                at þú gangir **s**nimma at **s**ofa.

[R 3v/7]

Man ought not to hold onto the cask, ought yet to drink mead in moderation;  
 he ought to speak the needful or shut up.  
 For that uncouthness will no man blame thee  
 that thou go early to sleep.

1 Haldi=t maðr á kəri ‘Man ought not to hold onto the cask’ | This line has been variously interpreted, but is generally understood as referring to a type of toast (cf. Olsen 1938, pp. 158–165). Finnur Jónsson suggests that we are dealing with a *svęitar-drykkja* ‘company-toast’, where the drinking vessel would be passed around in a circle and each recipient would drink in turn (Olsen 1938, pp. 160–161). Such toasts were drunk for a long time in Northern Europe, and are the likely the origin of the Scandinavian toasting-word, *skål* ‘prosit, cheers!’, lit. ‘bowl!’ “Holding onto” the vessel (and not letting the next person drink) would surely be seen as very rude, so the sense is that one should drink his share, but not too much; indeed, in 1519 a man in Jämtland was killed in an argument resulting from his refusal to pass on the bowl during a similar toast (Sjöberg 1907). Olsen (1938) [161–165], who was not aware of the 1519 legal proceeding, doubts that such a delay could happen, and in any case thinks that it would not be common enough to justify a general warning against it in an advice-poem. He instead argues that the line refers to a type of drinking where each man is holding his own smaller legless horn, which cannot be put down except emptied. “Holding onto” the horn would thus be referring to holding a half-full horn in one’s hand rather than drinking up and refilling it in order to keep partaking in the toasts. The sense of the whole stanza would then be that when one is at a party it is best to keep with the festive spirit and drink, rather than act “uncouthly” by sitting with a half-full horn and refusing to toast. One should still not drink too much, but, rather than “holding onto” a horn, it is better simply to go to sleep when one feels he has drunk enough; that is a lesser uncouthness than refusing to toast.

2 mēli þarft eða þegi ‘he ought to speak the needful or shut up’ | This line occurs identically in *Vafþ* 10/2.

- 20        **G**róðugr halr, · nema gęðs viti,  
 2                **e**tr sér aldr-trega;  
               opt fęr **hl**ógis, · es með **h**orskum kómrr,  
 4                **m**anni hęmskum **m**agi.

[R 3v/9]

The gluttonous man—unless he know his sense—  
 eats himself a life-sorrow.  
 Oft the belly when among the sharp he comes  
 brings the foolish man ridicule.

2 etr sér aldr-trega ‘eats himself a life-sorrow’ | Or, ‘eats himself to death.’

- 21 Hjarðir þat vitu, · nér hëim skulu,  
 2 ok ganga þà af grasi;  
 2 en ð·sviðr maðr · kann ẽva=gi  
 4 síns of mál\* maga.

[R 3v/11]

Herds know it when they shall turn home  
 and then part from the grass,  
 but the unwise man never knows  
 his own belly's measure.

---

4 mál\* | *gramm. emend.*; máls R

- 22 Ve-sall maðr · ok illa skapi  
 2 hlér at hví-vetna;  
 hitt=ki hann vẽit, · es vita þyrpti,  
 4 at hann es=a vamma vanr.

[R 3v/13]

The wretched man and ill turned out  
 laughs at anything,  
 yet he knows not what he would need to know:  
 that he is not free of blemishes.

---

4 es=a | *sens. emend.*; es R

ALL | The wretched man laughs at the flaws of others, not realising that the same flaws are found just as much in himself.

4 hann es=a vamma vanr 'he is not free of blemishes' | Formulaic, cf. *Lok* 30: *es=a þér vamma vant* 'thou art not free of blemishes'.

- 23 ð·sviðr maðr · vakir umb allar nêtr  
 2 ok hyggr at hví-vetna;  
 þà es móðr, · es at morni kœmr;  
 4 alt es víl sêm vas.

[R 3v/14]

The unwise man is awake during all nights  
 and thinks about anything.  
 Then he is weary when the morning comes;  
 all the trouble is as it was.

- 24 ð·snotr maðr · hyggr sér alla vesa  
 2 við·hléjendr vini;  
 hitt=ki hann fiðr, · þó'tt of hann fãr lesi,  
 4 ef með snotrum sitr.

[R 3v/16]

The unclever man thinks all those  
 who laugh with him are his friends,



yet he does not find that they make sport of him,  
if among the clever he sits.

25 Ó·snotr maðr · hyggr sér alla vesa

[R 3v/18]

2 við·hléjendr vini;  
þá þat fiðr · es at þingi kómr,  
4 at á for·mélendr fáa.

The unclever man thinks all those  
who laugh with him are his friends.  
Then he finds when to the Thing he comes  
that he has spokesmen few.

4 á for·mélendr fáa ‘has spokesmen few’ | Repeated in st. 62; cf. note there. The Thing was the Germanic legal assembly, where small disputes could easily turn into deadly feuds, so the import is that true friends are proven in conflict, not in drunken revelry.

26 Ó·snotr maðr · þykki=sk allt vita,

[R 3v/20]

2 ef á sér í vø veru;  
hitt=ki hann vøit, · hvat skal við kveða,  
4 ef hans fræista firar.

The unclever man seems to know everything  
if he takes shelter in a nook,  
yet he knows not what he shall answer  
if men test him.

2 vø ‘nook’ | From earlier \*vrø; cf. Swedish vrå ‘corner, nook’, rare English wroo ‘id.’ The present stanza is one of two Norse attestations of this word in the form vø (the other being *Sigsö 29/3*), featuring an irregular West Norse sound change from vr- > v-. The normal change vr- > r- yields rø, which is the form this word otherwise takes in prose. This includes *FGT 1950* where rø is brought up as an example of a word with nasal ø and contrasted with the oral ø in rø ‘sailyard’. It is plausible that vø be a form of earlier \*vrø after alliteration between vr- and v- had become impossible due to the sound change vr- > r-. Since old vr- is never found in dateable Scaldic poetry composed after ca. 1000 AD, and only twice in poetry composed ca. 900 AD (*Egill Frag 1* and *Eil Þór 22*, both in SkP 3) this serves as a dating criterion for the present stanza, even moreso since there is nothing to suggest that the word pair \*vrø and vera was ever formulaic. For a more certain instance of alliterating vr- and v- cf. *Háv 32/2* below; for discussion of the validity this criterion see Haukur Þorgeirsson (2016), Males (2024b, pp. 87–92).

27 Ó·snotr maðr · es með aldir kómr,

[R 3v/21]

2 þat ’s batst at hann þegi;  
engi þat vøit, · at hann ekki kann,  
4 nema hann méli til mart;  
vøit=a maðr, · hinn’s vøt=ki vøit,  
6 þótt hann méli til mart.

The unclever man who comes amidst folk—  
 it is best that he shut up.  
 No one knows that he nothing knows  
 unless he speak too much;  
 the man who knows nothing does not know  
 that he speaks too much.

---

1 *maðr* | *sens. emend.; om. R.*

28 Fróðr sá þykk\**i*=sk, · es fregna kann,

[R 3v/24]

2 ok segja hit sama,  
 3 ey-vitu leyna · megu ýta synir  
 4 því es gengr of guma.

Learned seems he who can ask  
 and answer in the same way.  
 In no way may the sons of men hide  
 that which eludes an earthling.

---

1 þykk\**i*=sk | ‘þyciriz’ (*with erroneous abbrev. mark for -ir-*) R

1–2 fregna ... segja ‘ask ... answer’ | Perhaps specifically in the context of a riddling contest of wisdom.

3–4 ey-vitu ... guma. ‘In no way ... earthling.’ | I.e., ‘in no way may man hide his ignorance’ when asked a question to which he does not know the answer; the mixing of singular and plural is unusual but not unparalleled in ON.

29 Ørna mēlr, · sá’s éva þegir,

[R 3v/26]

2 stað-lausu stafi;  
 3 hrað-mélt tunga, · nema haldendr egi,  
 4 opt sér ógött of gēlr.

He who never shuts up speaks plenty  
 utterings of absurdity.  
 A quick-spoken tongue—unless it be held in place—  
 oft sings evil [into being] for itself.

---

3–4 hrað-mélt ... of gēlr ‘A quick-spoken ... for itself’ | Likely formulaic or proverbial. Cf. *Lok* 31.

3 nema haldendr egi ‘unless it be held in place’ | Lit. ‘unless holders own it’ or ‘unless it own holders’ (both words are grammatically ambiguous), the “holders” perhaps being the teeth which hold the tongue in place. Cf. the modern Scandinavian idiom Swedish *hålla tand för tunga*, Danish *holde tand for tunge* ‘keep one’s mouth shut’, lit. ‘hold tooth before tongue’.

30 At auga-bragði · skal=a maðr annan hafa,

[R 3v/28]

2 þótt til kynnis komi;

4 margr fróðr þykki=sk, · ef freginn es=at  
ok nái þurr-fjallr þruma.

Into the subject of glances shall man not make another,  
although he comes to his home.

Many a one seems learned if he is not asked  
and gets to loiter about dry-skinned.

---

4 þurr-fjallr ‘dry-skinned’ | I.e., ‘untested’, equivalent to the English idiom *get one’s feet wet*. The word *fell* ~ *fjall* ‘skin, pelt’ is rare in Old Norse literature and only occurs in cpds, e.g. *Vkv* 11: *ber-fjall* ‘bear-pelt’. It survives in modern Swedish *fjäll* ‘scale (on fish and reptiles)’

31 Fróðr þykki=sk · sá’s flótta tēkr  
2 gęstr at gęst hęðinn;  
vęit=a gęr=la · sá’s of verði glissir,  
4 þó’tt með grōmum glami.

[R 3v/30]

Learned seems he who takes to flight,  
the guest, from a hostile guest.  
He knows not fully when he grins o’er the food  
that he be flirting with fiends.

---

2 hęðinn ‘hostile’ | *metr. emend.*; hęðinn ‘scoffing’ R

---

ALL | The situation hinted at in sts. 31–32 is that two guests, each unknown to the other, have come to the same homestead. The sense of st. 31 is that when mocked by a stranger it is best not to engage since the dealing may quickly turn violent. Cf. sts. 122, 123, and 125.

2 hęðinn ‘hostile’ | The short vowel is metrically required since a Leeds-meter c-verse cannot end in a trochee where the first syllable is long. The pres. ed. follows Finnur Jónsson (1932) in seeing an otherwise unattested \**hęðinn* derived from *hęðr* ‘battle’, but most eds. retain the R form *hęðinn* ‘scoffing’.

32 Gumnar margir · eru=sk gagn-hollir,  
2 ęn at vir\*ði vreka=sk;  
aldar róg · þat mun ę vesa;  
4 órir gęstr við gęst.

[R 4r/1]

Many men are well true to each other,  
but over food drive each other away.  
The strife of mankind will that for ever be;  
guest raves against guest.

---

2 vir\*ði | ‘virijþi’ (*with confused abbrev. mark for -ri-*) R

---

2 at vir\*ði vreka=sk ‘over food drive each other away’ | The archaic initial *vr-* in *vreka=sk* must be restored for metrical reasons; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n. above. This is a demonstrably archaic feature since the pairing *verðr* ‘food, a meal’, *vreka* ‘drive away’ does not appear to be formulaic and since *reka* (< *vreka*) alliterates exclusively with *r-* in the extant Scaldic corpus.

- 33     **Ár**=liga verðar · skyli maðr opt fää, [R 4r/3]  
 2            nema til kynnis komi;  
        sitr ok snópir, · léttr sëm solginn séi,  
 4            ok kann fregna at fðu.

An early meal should man oft get  
 unless he should come to visit;  
 he sits and sulks, sounds as if starved,  
 and can ask about little.

- 34     **Af**hvarf mikít · es til ills vinar, [R 4r/4]  
 2            þó'tt á brautu búi,  
        en til góðs vinar · liggja gagn-vegir,  
 4            þó'tt hann séi firr farinn.

A great off-turn it is to a bad friend  
 though on the road he live,  
 but to a good friend lie pleasant ways  
 though he be far travelled.

- 35     **Ganga skal**, · skal=a gęstr vesa [R 4r/6]  
 2            ey í ęinum stað;  
        ljúfr verðr lęðr, · ef lęngi sitr  
 4            annars fletjum á.

One shall go on; one shall not be a guest  
 for ever in one place.  
 The loved becomes loathed if for long he sits  
 on another man's benches.

---

1 skal | *sens. emend.; om. (by parablepsis) R*

---

ALL | It is best not to outstay one's welcome. The customary length of stay in old times was three nights, as noted in *Eg*, ch. 78: *þat var engi siðr, at sitja lengr en þrjár nætr at kynni* 'it was not customary to stay longer than three nights when visiting.' Compare a much more recent Jutlandish saying: *en tredje dags gjæst stinker* 'a third day's guest stinks', which closely resembles a contemporary American maxim popularly attributed to Benjamin Franklin: "Guests, like fish, begin to smell after three days." It is probably inspired by such proverbs that Auden and Taylor translate the last two lines of this stanza as "He starts to stink who outstays his welcome, / in a hall that is not his own."

- 36     **Bú** es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi, [R 4r/7]  
 2            halr es hęima hvērr;  
        þó'tt tvęr gęitr ęigi · ok taug-ręptan sal,  
 4            þat 's þó bętra an bón.

A dwelling is better though small it be;  
 each is a hero at home.  
 Though two goats he own and a cord-roofed hall,  
 that is yet better than begging.

1 Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi | The b-verse of the first line is missing the necessary alliteration, but no good emendation suggests itself and the sense is perfect.

1 bętra 'better' | I.e., better than the alternative.

3 taug-reptan sal 'a cord-roofed hall' | A shack with the birch-bark shingles (cf. st. 60) hung on ropes rather than on proper wooden rafters.

37      Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi, [R 4r/9]  
 2              halr es hęima hvęrr;  
             blóðugt es hjarta · þęim's biðja skal  
 4              sér í mál hvęrt matar.

A dwelling is better though small it be;  
 each is a hero at home.  
 Bloody is the heart in him who shall beg  
 for his every meal of food.

38      Vópnum sínum · skal=a maðr vęlli á [R 4r/10]  
 2              feti ganga framarr,  
             því't ó-víst's at vita, · nęr verðr á vegum úti  
 4              gęirs of þorf guma.

From his weapons shall man on the plain  
 not take one step further,  
 for it is unsure to know when on the ways outside  
 man comes in need of a spear.

1 vęlli á 'on the plain' | Formulaic, see note to st. 11.

2 feti ganga framarr 'take one step further' | Formulaic c-line, also occurring in *Lok* 1/2 (*feti gangir framarr*) and *Ski* 40/2 (*stęgir feti framarr*).

4 of þorf 'need' | The pronominal particle *of* is an archaic feature (cf. st. 4/3 above), but it does not appear to correspond to a prefix in West Germanic or Gothic.

39      Fann'k=a mildan mann · eða svá matar góðan, [R 4r/12]  
 2              at vęri=t þiggja þęgi;  
             eða síns fęar · svá=gi [...],  
 4              at leidd séi laun, ef þęgi.

I found no generous man nor one so good of meat  
 that a gift would not be accepted,

nor one with his money so not [stingy]  
that repayments would be loathed if he might get them.

ALL | The Wanderer has found no man so generous that he would refuse a gift formally presented to him, nor decline a small present as thanks for his generosity.

1 matar góðan ‘good of meat’ | A positive Viking Age expression also found in memorial inscriptions on Swedish runestones; see Index.

3 féar ‘money’ | The base sense of ON *fé* is ‘cattle, livestock’, but it also has the sense ‘money, movable property’ which is how it is used in the present stanza; see Index: *fee*. In the translation of the present poem the English word ‘money’ exclusively stands for ON *fé*, which however is also translated as ‘kine’.

3 [...] ‘[stingy]’ | It is doubtless that a word has been lost here, although no gap is indicated in R. Both meter and sense require a word, likely an adjective in the m. acc. sg. Finnur Jónsson (1932) suggests *glöggvan* ‘miserly, stingy’, giving a litotes ‘so not stingy’, i.e., ‘so generous’, and this is adopted in the translation.

- 40 Féar síns, · es fengit hęfr, [R 4r/14]  
2 skyli=t maðr þorfr þola;  
opt sparir lęiðum · þat’s hęfr lјúfum hugat;  
4 mart gęngr verr an varir.

Of his own money which he has earned  
should man not suffer need.  
Oft one saves for the loathed what one has meant for the loved;  
much goes worse than one expects.

ALL | The sense is that it is bad to hoard one’s savings to the point of deprivation since one never knows quite how things will turn out.

- 41 Vöpnum ok vöðum · skulu vinir glęðja=sk; [R 4r/16]  
2 þat ’s á sјolfum sýnst;  
viðr-gefęndr ok ęndr-gefęndr · eru=sk vinir lęngst,  
4 ef þat bíðr at verða vęl.

With weapons and garments shall friends gladden each other;  
that is best seen on oneself.  
Givers-back and givers-again are friends for the longest  
if it awaits to turn out well.

ALL | Friends are supposed to help each other and strengthen their capacity for violence so that they may come to each other’s aid in the future. Friendship requires both giving and receiving. With this stanza the Wanderer turns towards the subject of friendship, its nature and importance.

1 Vöpnum ok vöðum ‘With weapons and garments’ | I.e., with arms, for the *váðir* ‘garments’ are probably no women’s silks. This alliterative word-pair is formulaic and in other occurrences exclusively refers to implements of war; cf., e.g., *Beow* 39, where Shield’s pyre-ship is loaded with *hilde-wępnum* · *ęnd beaðo-wędum* ‘war-weapons and battle-garments’.

2 þat ’s á sјolfum sýnst ‘that is best seen on oneself’ | I.e., in one’s own lived experience.

4 þat ‘it’ | The friendship.

- 42      **V**in sínum · skal maðr **vinr** **vesa**, [R 4r/18]  
 2              ok **g**jalda **g**jof við **g**jof;  
               **h**látr við **h**látri · skyli **h**olðar taka,  
 4              **e**n **l**ausung við **l**ygi.

With his friend shall man be a friend  
 and pay gift against gift;  
 laughter for laughter should men employ—  
 but duplicity for lie.

- 43      **V**in sínum · skal maðr **vinr** **vesa**, [R 4r/19]  
 2              þeim ok þess **vin**;  
               **e**n ó·vinar síns · skyli **e**ngi maðr  
 4              **vinar** **vinr** **vesa**.

With his friend shall man be a friend,  
 with him and with his friend,  
 but his enemy's, should no man,  
 friend's friend be.

- 44      **V**eitst, ef þú **vin** átt, · þann's **v**el trúir [R 4r/21]  
 2              ok vilt af hönnum **g**ótt **geta**,  
               **g**æði skalt við þann · ok **g**jofum skipta,  
 4              **f**ara at **f**inna opt.

Thou knowest, if thou hast a friend whom thou trustest well  
 and wilt get good things from him:  
 thoughts and gifts shalt thou exchange with him;  
 journey to find him oft.

---

ALL | Stanzas 44–46 are structurally identical. Lines 1 and 4 are repeated near-identically in st. 119 below.

3 skalt ‘shalt thou’ | This verb (also found in sts. 45/3 and 46/3) is the only direct admonition to the listener in the Guests’ Strand, which, unlike the Speeches of Loddfathomer (sts. 111–137), entirely avoids imperative verbs; cf. Introduction to *Háv* above.

- 45      **E**f þú átt **annan**, · þann's **i**lla trúir, [R 4r/23]  
 2              vilt af hönnum þó **g**ótt **geta**,  
               **f**agrt skalt mæla við þann, · **e**n **f**lállt hyggja  
 4              ok gjalda **l**ausung við **l**ygi.

If thou hast another whom thou trustest ill,  
 yet thou wilt get good things from him:  
 fairly shalt thou speak with him, but think falsely  
 and pay duplicity for lie.

---

3 fagrt ... mēla, flátt hyggja ‘fairly ... speak, think falsely’ | Formulaic pair, cf. sts. 90, 91.

- 46 Þat ’s **ę**nn umb þann, · es þú **illa** trúir  
 2 ok þér es **ę**runr at **ę**ęði,  
**hlę**ja skalt við þeim · ok umb **hug** mēla;  
 4 **ę**-lík skulu **ę**öld **ę**jöfum.

[R 4r/25]

This is yet about him whom thou trustest ill  
 and about whom thou hast doubt:  
 laugh shalt thou with him, and speak with care;  
 repayments shall be equal to gifts.

- 47 Ungr vas’k **f**örðum, · **f**ör’k ęinn saman,  
 2 þá varð’k **villr** vega;  
**auð**igr þótt=umk, · es **annan** fann’k,  
 4 **maðr** es **manns** gaman.

[R 4r/28]

Young was I once; I journeyed alone;  
 then I became lost of ways.  
 Wealthy I thought me when another I found;  
 man is man’s pleasure.

---

ALL | This rightly acclaimed stanza serves to nuance the transactional view of friendship seen in sts. 42–46. Companionship is important in its own right.

- 48 **Mildir** fróknir · **męnn** batst lifa,  
 2 **s**jaldan **sút** ala;  
**ęn** ó-snjallr **maðr** · **u**ggir hvat-vetna,  
 4 **sýtir** **ę** **ę**löggr við **ę**jöfum.

[R 4r/29]

Generous, brave men live best;  
 seldom they nourish sorrow—  
 but the unvalorous man is frightened by anything,  
 the stingy always grieves over gifts.

---

3–4 ó-snjallr, ęlöggr ‘unvalorous, stingy’ | Contrasting respectively with *frókn*, *mildr* ‘brave, generous’ in the first half of the stanza; a very fine parallelism.

4 sýtir ę ęlöggr við ęjöfum ‘the stingy always grieves over gifts’ | After receiving a gift, one was culturally obliged to give something back. Cf. sts. 39, 145.



- 49 Váðir mǫnar · gaf'k velli at  
 2 tveim tré-mönnum;  
 ríkkar þat þöttu=sk, · es rípt hofðu;  
 4 neiss es nokkviðr halr.

[R 4r/31]

My garments I gave upon the plain  
 to two tree-men.

Champions they seemed when cloaks they had;  
 shameful is the naked hero.

---

ALL | This stanza is somewhat difficult, but I see in it the following scene: The Wanderer comes walking along on the plain when he sees the two unadorned tree-men. Taking pity for the sorry-looking stick figures, he lends them some clothes, and from afar they now look like imposing warriors. Just such a frail, freezing figure, thinks he, is man in his naked state; it is his clothes that afford the hero his status, and even the weak stick-man can look like a champion. Clearly this is quite a different view from the pre-Christian Greek celebration of the naked body, but in the cold Northern climes there was hardly room for public nakedness.

2 tré-mönnum 'tree-men' | Man-shaped wooden figures. Much has been made of their appearance here, including seeing them as cultic idols, but whatever the case, the tone in the stanza is more pessimistic than reverent. Cf. the three stanzas spoken by a tree-man in *Ragn* (*Ragn* 38–40 in SkP 8) and notes there.

4 halr 'hero' | The use of *halr* 'hero, warrior' (cf. sts. 36, 37) rather than the more neutral *maðr* 'man, person' is probably intentional.

- 50 Hrørnar þoll, · sú's stendr þorpi á,  
 2 hlýr=at henni þörkr né barr;  
 svá es maðr, · sá's mann=gi ann;  
 4 hvat skal hann lengi lifa?

[R 4r/33]

Withers the pine that stands on the yard;  
 her shields no bark nor leaf.

So is the man who loves no man—  
 why shall he live for long?

---

2 hlýr=at | 'hlyrar' R

---

ALL | Ll. 1–2 give an analogical example taken from the natural world, which is then equated to the world of humans in ll. 3–4. The same stylistic trick is also used below in sts. 57 (fire) and 62 (the eagle).

2 hlýr=at henni þörkr né barr 'her shields no bark nor leaf' | For her (ON *þoll* 'pine' is feminine) leaves and branches are eaten by the fourfoot, her bark stripped by the twofoot, perhaps for the making of bark-flour, as was done during hard times into the 19th century.

- 51 Ełdi hęitari · brinnr með illum vinum  
 2 friðr fimm daga,  
 ęn þa sloknar, · es hinn sętti kęmr,  
 4 ok versnar allr vin-skapr.

[R 4v/2]

Hotter than fire among bad friends burns  
 love, for five days,  
 but then goes out when the sixth one comes  
 and all the friendship worsens.

---

2 fimm daga ‘for five days’ | I.e., “for a week”, which was originally five days long. The sense is that the bad friends quickly tire of each other when staying together for an extended period of time. See also st. 74 and Index: five days.

- 52 Mikit ęitt · skal= a manni gefa;  
 2 opt kaupir sér ĩ lítlu lof;  
 með hǫlfum hleif · ok með hǫllu kęri  
 4 fekk ek mér fę-laga.

[R 4v/4]

Much at once shall one not give a man;  
 oft one buys himself goodwill for little.  
 With half a loaf and a sloping cask  
 I got myself a fellow.

---

4 fę-laga ‘fellow’ | A business partner or companion, one with whom one participates in a *fę-lag* ‘fellowship, common financial venture’. This word, which appears not infrequently on rune-stones, has been described as the single most important word for understanding the Wiking Age, when social ties were weakened and groups of sworn companions embarked on piratical and mercenary expeditions. Cf. Khlevov (2025).

- 53 Lítilla sanda, · lítilla séva,  
 2 lítil eru gęđ guma;  
 því’t allir męnn · urđu=t jafn-spakir;  
 4 hǫlf es ǫld hvar.

[R 4v/6]

Of small sands, of small seas:  
 small are the senses of man.  
 For all men have not become evenly wise;  
 man is everywhere half.

---

3 því’t | því R

---

ALL | With this stanza the subject of the advice shifts from friendship to wisdom, carried through sts. 53–57.

1 Lítilla sanda, · lítilla séva ‘Of small sands, of small seas’ | Most likely a partitive genitive, but the sense is not certain; in any case, the genitive excludes the translation “where sands are small, seas are small”. I find the most likely reading to be a declaration of the smallness of man’s horizons; the world will always be far greater than he, and there will always be much of which he is unwise.

3–4 því’t allir męnn · urđu=t jafn-spakir; hǫlf es ǫld hvar. ‘For all men have not become evenly wise; man is everywhere half.’ | I find the interpretation of Guđmundur Finnbogason (1929) most convincing: intellectual faculties have not been distributed evenly among men, and so every one has his own strengths and weaknesses; all men are “half” (or “incomplete”, for it should be noted that ON *halfir* ‘half’ has a sense of “incompleteness” not always found in its modern English cognate). This interpretation accords well with sts. 71 and 132 below. In the hyperspecialized modern world it is probably truer than ever.

- 54      **Meðal-snotr** · skyli **manna** hværr, [R 4v/7]  
             éva til **snotr** **séi**;  
 2      þeim es **fyrða** · **fegrst** at lifa,  
             es **væl** mart **vit**u.

Middle-clever should each man be;  
 never too clever.

For those folk it is fairest to live,  
 who know well enough.

- 55      **Meðal-snotr** · skyli **manna** hværr, [R 4v/9]  
             éva til **snotr** **séi**;  
 2      því't **snotrs** manns hjarta · verðr **sjaldan** glatt,  
             ef sá's **al-snotr** es **á**.

Middle-clever should each man be;  
 never too clever,

for the clever man's heart is seldom glad,  
 if its owner is all-clever.

- 56      **Meðal-snotr** · skyli **manna** hværr, [R 4v/10]  
             éva til **snotr** **séi**;  
 2      **ør**-lög sín · viti **engi** maðr fyrir;  
             þeim es **sorga-lausastr** **sefi**.

Middle-clever should each man be;  
 never too clever.

His own orlay ought no man to know ahead;  
 his is the most sorrowless mind.

---

3 ør-lög 'orlay' | One's predetermined fate or course of life. See *Vsp* 19 n.

4 þeim es sorga-lausastr sefi 'his is the most sorrowless mind.' | His, who is ignorant of his fate. It is surely fitting that Weden should say this, having knowledge of the inevitable destruction of both the world and himself at the Rakes of the Reins (*Vsp* 51, *Vafþ* 52–53).

- 57      **Brandr** af **brandi** · **brinnr** und's **brunninn** es, [R 4v/11]  
             **funi** kvęyki=sk af **funa**;  
 2      **maðr** af **manni** · verðr at **máli** kuðr;  
             ęn til **dólskr** af **dul**.

Fire from fire burns till it is burned;  
 flame is quickened by flame.

Man to man makes himself known through speech,  
 but the too boorish from folly.

ALL | For the stylistic device see st. 50 n. — The sense of the advice is not entirely clear; I take it to mean that a wise man uses careful speech to introduce himself and state his needs, whereas the fool speaks too much and thereby reveals his inexperience and naive character, in a word, his lack of manwit.

4 *dólskr* ‘boorish’ | Derived from an ablaut variant of *dalr* ‘valley, dale’ + *-iskr* ‘-ish’, the sense being ‘provincial, not having left his (home) valley’; cf. English hillbilly. The same ablaut underlies the Icelandic tribal names *vatns-dólr* and *lang-dólr* ‘inhabitants of Waterdale (*Vatns-dalr*), Longdale (*Lang-dalr*)’.

58 *Ár* skal rísa, · *sá’s* annars vill

[R 4v/13]

2 *fé* eða *fjör* hafa;  
sjaldan liggjandi ulfr · *lér* of getr,  
4 *né* sofandi maðr sigr.

Early shall he rise who another man’s  
money or life will have.  
Seldom the resting wolf gets the thigh,  
or the sleeping man victory.

1 *sá’s* | *emend. by analogy* (st. 59/1); *es* (‘er’, *for* \*‘sa er’, *by parablepsis*) R.

ALL | A close analogue to this stanza is found in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 5.7.3: *Pernox enim et pervigil esse debet alienum appetens culmen. Nemo stertendo victoriam cepit, nec luporum quisquam cubando cadaver invenit.* ‘Whoever intends to scale another’s pinnacle must be watchful and wakeful. Nobody has ever won victory by snoring, nor has any sleeping wolf found a carcass.’

2 *fé* eða *fjör* ‘money or life’ | A formulaic word-pair found over 30 times in Norse prose, especially in laws (ONP). The expression is also found in mediæval English and Frisian laws, as OE *feoh and feorb*, OF *fia ande ferech*.

59 *Ár* skal rísa, · *sá’s á* yrkjendr fáa,

[R 4v/15]

2 ok ganga síns verka á vit;  
*mart* of dvelr · þann’s umb *morgin* sefr,  
4 *halfr* es auðr und *hvötum*.

Early shall he rise who has workmen few,  
and go his work to meet.  
Much is kept back from him who sleeps through the morning;  
a half wealth is due the brisk.

4 *halfr* es auðr und *hvötum* ‘a half wealth is due the brisk’ | The brisk man has already claimed a half fortune by waking up early.

60 *Purra* skíða · ok *þakinna* néfra,

[R 4v/17]

2 þess kann *maðr* *mjöt*,  
ok þess *viðar*, · es *vinna*=sk *megi*  
4 *mál* ok *missęri*.

Dry billets and birch-bark shingles—  
of this man knows the measure,  
and of that wood which may be used  
for a season and a half-year.

---

3 ok | †ðe† R

---

ALL | Man knows best the measure or correct proportions of those things upon which he relies for his sustenance and survival, in this case the wood used for keeping him warm over the winter. The fact that he always seems to manage to find the right measure of things when he truly depends on them thus proves the correctness of moderation, and he would do best to apply this sense of moderation or measure in other aspects of his life, e.g., by not drinking, eating, or sleeping too much. The message of the stanza is thus that of the whole Guests' Strand, namely one of moderation and caution in all things.

1 þakinn náfra 'birch-bark shingles' | Birch-bark used for roof-shingles, lit. 'thatching birch-bark'.

4 mál ok misseri 'for a season and a half-year' | I.e., 'over a long period', probably the colder months of the year. A *mál* 'season' was a period of three months, and each *misseri* 'half-year' was thus divided into two *mól*.

- 61 Þvegin ok mættir · ríði maðr þingi at,  
2 þótt séi=t vęddr til vęl;  
skúa ok bróka · skammi=sk ęngi maðr  
4 né hęsts in hęldr,  
þótt hann hafi=t góðan.

[R 4v/19]

Washed and fed ought man to ride to the Thing,  
although he be not clothed too well.  
Of his shoes and breeches ought no man to be ashamed,  
nor the more of his horse,  
although he haven't a good one.

---

1 Þvegin ok mættir 'Washed and fed' | A formulaic collocation. Cf. *Reg* 25 (*kęmbör* 'combed', *þvegin* 'washed', *mættir* 'fed') and *Vsp* 33: (*þó* 'washed', *kęmböi* 'combed'). These examples attest to the importance of personal hygiene in the culture, something further seen by the ubiquity of combs in pre-Christian graves (TODO: archeological reference). The stanza reminds of the following passage from Tacitus *Germania* ch. 22: *Statim ē somnō, quem plerumque in diem extrahunt, lavantur, saepius calidā, ut apud quōs plurimum biens occupat. Lauti cibum capiunt: sęparatę singulis sędęs et sua cuique męnsa. Tum ad negōtia nec minus saepe ad convivia prōcędunt armātī.* 'On waking from sleep, which they generally prolong to a late hour of the day, they take a bath, oftenest of warm water, which suits a country where winter is the longest of the seasons. After their bath they take their meal, each having a separate seat and table of his own. Then they go armed to business, or no less often to their festal meetings (*convivia*, i.e., the Things).'

5 þótt hann hafi=t góðan 'although he haven't a good one' | A metrically unusual line. Without it, l. 4 can be scanned straightforwardly as a c-verse, but then l. 5 comes off as an isolated b-verse. Finnur Jónsson (1932) explains it away by considering l. 5 an interpolation, which is certainly a possibility since its content is entirely superfluous. In that case the interpolator would have interpreted l. 4 (the c-verse) as an a-verse and added l. 5 as a corresponding b-verse. It is also possible that it is an authorial, albeit rare verse-type, for which cf. st. 80/1–2 n.

- 62 Snapir ok gnafir, · es til sęvar kęmr,  
2 ęrn á aldinn mar;

[R 4v/22]

svá es maðr, · es með mǫrgum kǫmr  
 4 ok á for-méleðr fáa.

It snatches and stoops when to the sea it comes,  
 the eagle on the ancient ocean.  
 So is the man who comes among the many  
 and has spokesmen few.

---

ALL | Sts. 62–63 are reversed in R, but a symbol at the start of each indicates that they should switch places.

---

ALL | The naturalistic simile is notable; cf. st. 50 n. For an illustration of the situation alluded to see *Hrafnk* 8–11, where two men try to find the support of powerful men on the Icelandic All-Thing for a suit against a chieftain who has slain their young relative.

4 á for-méleðr fáa ‘has spokesmen few’ | Shared with st. 25.

63 Fregna ok segja · skal fróðra hvern,  
 2 sá’s vill hēitinn horskr;  
 einn vita · né annarr skal,  
 4 þjóð velt ef þrír ’ro.

[R 4v/21]

Ask and answer shall each learned man  
 who wishes to be called sharp.  
*One* shall know—not another;  
 people know if there are three.

---

4 þjóð ‘people’ | By which we should understand ‘many people, everybody’.

64 Ríki sitt · skyli ráð-snotra  
 2 hvern í hófi hafa;  
 þá þat finnr, · es með fróknum kǫmr,  
 4 at engi es einna hvatastr.

[R 4v/24]

His own power should each counsel-clever  
 man use in moderation.  
 This he then finds when among the brave he comes:  
 that none is boldest of all.

---

ALL | Man, regardless of his station, should never abuse his power. No height of political power or physical strength will make him invincible, and such abuses will only earn him enemies. Of course the historical examples of great men brought down for misuse of their power are myriad. In Germanic legend a notable example is Ermenric, who ruled the vast realm of the Gots with an iron fist (*Deor* 5), but was maimed by two young boys after he had their sister trampled by horses (*Gbu*, *Hamð*, Jordanes *Getica* 129).

Consider the similar thought of Hobbes ([1651] 1996), ch. 13: “Nature hath made men so equall, in the faculties of body, and mind; as that though there bee found one man sometimes manifestly stronger in body, or of quicker mind then another; yet when all is reckoned together, the difference between man, and man, is not so considerable, as that one man can thereupon claim to himselfe any benefit, to which another may not pretend, as well as he. For as to the strength of body, the weakest has strength enough to kill the strongest, either by secret machination, or by confederacy with others, that are in the same danger with himselfe.”

3–4 þá ... einna hvatastr ‘then ... boldest of all’ | Almost identical to *Fáfn* 17/3–4, which however has *fléirum* ‘more men’ instead of *fróknum* ‘the brave’.

- 65 Orða þeira, · es maðr qðrum sęgir, [R 4v/25]  
 2 opt hann gjöld of getr.  
 For those words which man says to another  
 he oft gets recompense.

ALL | This half-stanza is an orphan. It may plausibly be connected to the previous st. to form a 6-line Leeds-meter st., for which cf. sts. 6, 27, 102, 103, 138, 165.

- 66 Mikils til/ snimma · kom’k í marga staði, [R 4v/26]  
 2 ęn til síð í suma;  
 qł vas drukkit, · sumt vas ð·lagat;  
 4 sjaldan hittir lęðr í lið.  
 Much too early I came to many places,  
 but too late to some:  
 The ale was drunk up, some was unbrewed—  
 seldom finds the loathed his place.

1 Mikils til ‘Much too’ | *emend.*; mikilsti R

ALL | In reality, there was never anything wrong with the ale; it was a mere pretext for dismissing the speaker. There are no wrong times, only wrong people, and it is bad to waste one’s time where one is unwanted.

- 67 Hér ok hvar · myndi mér hęim of boðit, [R 4v/28]  
 2 ef þyrpta’k at mólun=gi mat,  
 eða tvau lęr hęngi · at hins tryggva vinar,  
 4 þar’s ek hafða ętt etit.  
 Here and there would I be invited to a home  
 if at meal-time I needed no food,  
 or if two hams should hang at the trusty friend’s,  
 where I had eaten one.

ALL | People are often stingy, especially with food, which was scarce and closely watched among the Norse subsistence farmers. The Wanderer sarcastically notes that even the “trusty friend” would invite him over oftener if he brought more food than he ate; how good of a friend is he, if he’s not willing to share his food?

68 E|dr es batstr · með ýta sonum

[R 4v/30]

2 ok sólar sýn,  
hēil-yndi sitt, · ef maðr hafa náir,  
4 án við lōst at lifa.

Fire is best among the sons of men,  
and the sight of the sun,  
a man's good health if he gets to keep it,  
[and] living free from vice.

ALL | Sts. 68–77 largely form a thematic unit, reflecting on life, legacy, and lastly death. — The Wanderer celebrates simplicity in life. The best pleasures are not power and wealth, but a hot hearth, the bright rays of the sun in springtime, and staying in good health.

4 lōst 'vice' | Used of an illicit sexual encounter in st. 98 below, but it may also refer to a physical blemish.

69 Es=at maðr alls ve-sall, · þó'tt séi illa hēill,

[R 4v/32]

2 sumr es af sonum sēll,  
sumr af frēndum, · sumr af fē órnu,  
4 sumr af verkum vēl.

Man is not all unblessed though he be of poor health:  
someone becomes blessed from sons,  
someone from kinsmen, someone from ample kine,  
someone from works done well.

ALL | The strain of thought continues from the previous stanza. Even the man whose health is failing can find joy in something. At the same time there is a difference in the pleasures of the old and the young. In youth good health is taken for granted, but the comforts of infirm old age—sons, kinsmen, kine, and good works—are things one must obtain through work. Thus, the man who neglects his work cannot expect happiness or fortune in old age; indeed, in the end there is no happiness without effort.

1 ve-sall 'unblessed' | I have elsewhere translated *ve-sall* as 'wretched', but in the present stanza I render it literally in order to show the etymological relationship to *sēll* 'blessed' used elsewhere in the stanza. The form *-sall* lacks i-umlaut due to a shortening of the vowel before the umlaut became phonemic; the ancestral Proto-Norse form would be \**wajē-sālir*, for which cf. PǫM-MǫRlY *wajē-mari* 'infamous' on the Tjurkö bracteate, where the second element is the ancestor of ON *mér* 'renowned, famous'; the expected descendant of that word, ON \*\**ve-marr*, is not attested. I translate *sēll* as 'blessed', based on the fact that it carries a certain sense of innateness largely foreign to post-Enlightenment Western culture, though it could also be rendered as 'lucky' or 'fortunate'. We may compare the idea of the king's 'luck' (ON *gipt*), which is thought to emanate from his person and shine over his land; in this vein a king whose land experiences bountiful harvests (*ár*) is said to be *ár-sēll* 'blessed with harvests', while one whose reign is one of peace (*fríðr*) is said to be *fríð-sēll* 'blessed with peace'. Thus the state of the realm is not due to uncontrollable environmental or political factors, nor due to the king's personal choices, but rather arises from the kingly person to the degree that he is favoured and blessed by the Gods. This is thought true also of the private person's life. Similar conceptions are found amongst many other peoples, e.g. the Chinese political concept of the "mandate of Heaven". (TODO: Reference PCRN chapter).

2–3 sonum ... frēndum 'sons ... kinsmen' | Cf. st. 72 below, which stresses the importance of sons and kinsmen. The male perspective may be noted.



- 70 Bętra 's lifðum, · an séi ó-lifðum,  
 2 ęy getr kvikr kú;  
 ęld sá'k upp brinna · auðgum manni fyr,  
 4 ęn úti vas dauðr fyr durum.

[R 5r/2]

It is better for the living than it may be for the unliving:

always the quick gets a cow.

I saw a fire burning high for a wealthy man,  
 but outside he was dead before the doors.

1 an séi ó-lifðum | *emend.*; 'ę fęl lifðom' R.

1 an séi ó-lifðum 'than it may be for the unliving' | The reading of R, which would be normalized as *ok ęęl-lifðum* 'and for the blessed living', is metrically defect, since *ęęl-* is strongly stressed and should carry alliteration. For the original form of the line we have a close parallel in *Fáfn* 30: *Hvętrum 's bętra · an sé ó-hvętrum* 'It is better for the brisk than it may be for the unbrisk', on which the pres. ed. is based. The corruption has probably happened in the following way: \**en*' (younger form of *an* 'than') in the prototype was misinterpreted as *'en*' 'and, but' and copied as *'j'* (the tironian *et*), while \**'séi ólyfðom*' (probably with the words cramped together) became *'ęęl lifðom*'.

2 ęy getr kvikr kú 'always the quick gets the cow' | I.e., "new opportunities always present themselves for the living". A reference to the cattle-based economy (see also st. 76), the cow being used as a metonym for any means of subsistence. For "quick", cf. churchly English "the quick and the dead", i.e., "the living and the dead".

3–4 ęld ... durum. 'A fire ... the doors.' | The fire may be taken to be the man's funeral pyre burning on his farm, on which a considerable amount of his wealth has been spent—according to *ibn Fadlan's* 10th c. account of the Rus a third of a dead chieftain's wealth was spent on his funeral clothes and another third on alcohol for the wake (Lunde and Stone 2012, p. 49)—yet in spite of the great fire he is just as dead. The following stanza continues this thought. The fire has also been taken as referring to the burning hearth of the wealthy home, whose owner has died outside it. Another reasonable reading is presented by Evans (1986, p. 107), who sees *dauðr* as the noun 'death', and renders ll. 3–4 as "I saw the fire blazing (on the hearth) in front of the rich man; but (unknown to him) death was outside the door." As he notes, the expression *dauði er fyrir durum* 'death is at the door' is attested.

- 71 Haltr ríðr hrossi, · hęęrð rekr handar vanr,  
 2 daufr vęgr ok dugir;  
 blindr es bętri · an bręnndr séi;  
 4 nýtr mannęgi nás.

[R 5r/3]

A halt man rides a horse; a handless drives a herd;

a deaf man fights and avails.

Blind is better than to be burned;  
 no man has use for a corpse.

1 handar | *sens. and gramm. emend.*; hundar R

3 bręnndr 'burned' | On the funeral pyre. The word 'burned' here means 'dead', in the same way as "six feet under" in modern English; each expression refers to the typical custom of dealing with human remains in the respective culture. This synonymy is an important argument for dating *Háv* to the pre-Christian period, since cremation was reserved for criminals and adulterers in the medieval Catholic religion (cf. *Am* 84/1), whereas it in *Háv* seems to be the commonly accepted way of disposing the dead (Males 2024b, pp. 93–96). Cf. Introduction to the poem above and the same semantics in st. 81 below.

## 72 Sonr es bętri, · þótt séi síð of alinn

[R 5r/5]

- 2 ęptir ginginn guma;  
sjaldan bautar-ęęinar · standa brautu nęr,  
4 nema řęisi niðr at nið.

A son is better though he late be born  
after a passed man.

Seldom beat-stones near the highway stand,  
save by kinsman for kinsman raised.

ALL | It is a boon and a blessing for a man to have an heir, even if he should die before the son is born. The son will inherit and carry on his father's name, lineage, and memory in a way few non-relatives can, as exemplified by the raising of a stone memorial. In a broader context we may consider how it is only a tiny few out of the great human masses who will leave behind any kind of lasting personal legacy beyond their direct familiar relations. The current generation must soon die off, and even those who in their lifetimes see influence and success in their fields are soon forgotten by posterity and relegated to the footnotes of the annals of history if they have no descendants to carry their names into future ages. It is rare for strangers to tend one's grave.

3 bautar-ęęinar 'beat-stones' | Uninscribed standing stones (sometimes arranged geometrically) raised in memory of the dead, which appear frequently in Norse literature. Cf. *Yng* 8, which describes the laws instituted by the euhemerized Węden: *en ęptir alla þá menn, er nękkut manns-mót var at, skyldi reisa bauta-ęęina, ok bęld-sk sjá síðr lengi síðan*. 'but in memory of all those men who had possessed masculine virtue beat-stones should be raised, and that custom was upheld for a long time since'. Standing stones are very common throughout Scandinavia and are not infrequently found near grave-mounds.

It must be noted that the raising of such unmarked beat-stones long precedes the rune-stone boom of the Wiking Age. The older, unmarked beat-stones are also more often found in direct funerary contexts. This is rarely the case with Wiking Age rune-stones, which, instead, tend to be placed near important roads or waterways as memorials. It should be noted that in Norway during the Migration Period this distinction between beat-stone and rune-stone was somewhat blurred, and a number of rune-stones from around 3rd to 5th centuries are placed near grave fields. Unlike the later Wiking Age inscriptions, these stones often hold only single personal names or genitive phrases, like KJ 90 from Sunde in Sunnfjord, western Norway: *ÞIDMXXFTIY* *widugastir* 'Woodguest', or KJ 78 from Bø in Rogaland, southwestern Norway: *NTFTMTFT NTFTFT* *hnabdas hlaiwa* 'Naved's grave'. Others do have longer inscriptions, e.g. KJ 75 from Kjølevik, also in Rogaland: *NTMTNTFTFT FTNTFTMTFTFT NTFTFTMTFTFTNTFTFT* *hadulaikaz ekhagustadaz hlaiwidomaguminino* 'Handlac [lies here]. I, Haystald, buried my lad.'

## 73 Tveir 'ro ęins hęrjar, · tunga es hęfuðs bani;

[R 5r/7]

- 2 es męr ę heðin hveřn · handar vęni.

Two belong to one host; the tongue is the head's bane;  
in every cloak I expect a hand.

ALL | The tongue and head belong to the same body, but the former often leads to the demise of the latter, and thereby itself; it is best to be cautious with one's words. — This st. is most likely a later insert. It is composed in Speeches-meter (unlike all surrounding sts., which are in Leeds-meter), its style is unusual, and its content fits poorly in the context, which at this point in the poem has moved away from the theme of cautious speech.

1 Tveir 'ro ęins hęrjar 'Two belong to one host' | Lit. 'two are of one host'. — *hęrjar* is an inflected form of *hęrr* 'host, army', but its function is ambiguous; it can either be (1) the gen. sg., as adopted here, or (2) the nom. pl. 'harriers, raiders' (cf. *ęin-hęrjar* 'Oneharriers') which would translate as 'two are the destroyers of one', i.e., "the tongue and head often lead to the demise of the body".

1 tunga es höfuðs bani ‘the tongue is the head’s bane’ | Formulaic or proverbial. Cf. the Old Swedish “Heathen Law”, which describes how a duel should be conducted following an insult to a man’s honour (my norm. and trans. following Löffler (1879)): *Fallr þann orð haur givit—glópr orða verstr; tunga hövuð-bani—liggi í ú-gildum akri* ‘If he who has given the [insulting] word falls—mockery is the worst of words; the tongue the head-bane—may he lie in an unenclosed field.’

2 handar ‘a hand’ | Holding a dagger.

- 74 Nótt verðr feginn, · sá’s nesti trúir,  
 2 skammar ’ro skips ráar,  
   hverf es haust-gríma;  
 4 fjöld of viðrir · à fimm dögum,  
   en meirr à mánaði.

[R 5r/8]

At night he rejoices who trusts in his provisions;  
 short are the ship’s sail-yards;  
 shifty is the stormy fall night.  
 The winds blow far in five days;  
 even more in a month.

---

ALL | It is best to rely on things in one’s control, here the provisions you carry with you when at sea (cf. sts. 11, 116). The man at the mercy of the forces of nature can never sleep safe and sound at night. — In ll. 3–4 two names of Weden, a notoriously fickle god (cf. st. 110), may be subtextually implied, and the st. may then also be taken as a warning against resigning one’s fate totally to the gods, who are perhaps not always fully trustworthy.

2 skammar ’ro skips ráar ‘short are the ship’s sail-yards’ | Also found in *Mbkv* 12/1a: *skips láta menn skammar ráar* ‘men say the ship’s sail-yards are short’ or ‘men make the ship’s sail-yards short.’ The sail-yards (ON *ráar*) are the arms on the mast from which the sails are set, but the sense of the l. is unclear and interpretations vary; for an overview see *Mbkv* 12 in SkP 3 and Evans (1986, pp. 110–111). In any case it would appear by the sense of ll. 3–5 that this l. should also refer to something untrustworthy; one suggestion is that during a shipwreck the man clinging onto the sail-yards would wish them longer.

3 haust-gríma ‘stormy fall night’ | Lit. ‘fall-mask’, a cpd. of *haust* ‘fall, autumn’ + *gríma* ‘mask’. The word paints an image of the dark cloudy evening or night-sky, the thick dusky clouds being the metaphorical ‘mask’. Cf. Weden’s names *Grímr* ‘Grime; Mask’, *Grímnir* ‘Grimner; the Masked One’ (*Grm* 47, 50).

4 fjöld of viðrir ‘The winds blow far’ | I.e., ‘the weather changes much’. ON (*of*) *viðra* is a causative verb derived from *veðr* ‘wind, storm’. Cf. Weden’s name *Viðrir* ‘Withrer; Stormer, Man of the Storm’, which is most likely an agent noun formed to the same verb.

4 fimm dögum ‘five days’ | I.e., ‘a week’ (which was originally five days long), parallelling ‘month’ in the next line. See note to st. 51 above.

- 75 Væt=a hinn, · es vêt=ki vêt,  
 2 margr verðr af \*au\*rum api;  
   maðr es auðigr, · annarr ò-auðigr,  
 4 skyli=t þann vítká vðar.

[R 5r/10]

The one who knows nothing does not know:  
 many a one is made an ape by silver.

A man is wealthy, another not wealthy;  
one ought not to curse him for his woe.

---

2 af \*au\*rum ‘by silver’ | *emend. from meaningless* †aflaðrom† R

---

2 margr verðr af \*au\*rum api ‘many a one is made an ape by silver’ | Cf. *Sól* 34/4: *margan befr auðr apat* ‘wealth has made an ape of many a one’, which also lends support to the emendation in the line.

76      Deyr fé, · dęyja fręndr,  
2              dęyr sјalfr hit sama;  
            ęn orðs-tírr · dęyr aldri=gi  
4              hvęim’s sér góðan getr.

[R 5r/12]

Kine die, kinsmen die,  
oneself dies the same.  
But a word-glory never dies  
for whomever gets himself a good one.

---

ALL. | It is likely that sts. 76–77 concluded the original Guests’ Strand. This is supported internally by their tone of finality and their reflections on death, and externally by the fact that *Hákm* (composed ca. 961 AD) borrows the first line of its final stanza 21 (*dęyr fé · dęyja fręndr*) from their refrain. The sense of both stanzas is that the whole of man’s earthly power will pass away with him, but a good reputation, fame and glory, will linger on.

The idea of “undying fame”, as stressed in these two sts. through the repetition of *dęyr aldri=gi* ‘never dies’, is an ancient Indo-European conception. Similar expressions feature prominently in sources including Homer, the Greek lyric poets, the *RV*, and the Irish saga-cycles (West 2007, pp. 396–98, 406–10). The common idea is that of fame as a living entity, which can be bestowed or laid upon (but also flee from) a man, and which can linger on above the earth after his death. The same idea is expressed in numerous ways throughout the IE languages, but of particular note is the formulaic expression ‘imperishable fame’, which is found in both Vedic OI *śrávaḥ ... ākṣitam* (*RV* 1.9.7bc) and Greek κλέος ἀφθιτον (*Il* 9.413, etc.; a list of attestations is found in West 2007, p. 408). Since these two phrases are directly cognate, the ancestral PIE formula can be reconstructed as \**k̑léwos ḡ-dʰḡ<sup>wh</sup>itom* (West 2007, pp. 406–10; Watkins 1995, pp. 173–178).

1 fé ... fręndr ‘Kine ... kinsmen’ | In the early Germanic farming society a man’s wealth was reckoned in heads of cattle (note that the Norman loan-word *cattle* is itself the same word as *capital*) and his socio-political power by the number of able male kinsmen and friends ready to side with him in conflict (cf. sts. 62, 72 above). For Indo-European poetic analogues, cf. West (2007, pp. 99–100).

77      Dęyr fé, · dęyja fręndr,  
2              dęyr sјalfr hit sama;  
            ek vęit ęinn · at aldri=gi dęyr:  
4              dómr umb dauðan hvęrn.

[R 5r/13]

Kine die, kinsmen die,  
oneself dies the same.  
I know one that never dies:  
the Doom o’er each man dead.

4 dómr ‘Doom’ | In ON this word otherwise means nothing other than ‘judgment’, but here it carries the unique sense ‘fame’. This latter sense should probably not be taken as a semantic development of the former, but rather as an independent reflex of the original sense of the PIE ancestor *\*dʰobʰ-mos* ‘thing put’, from the verbal root *\*dʰobʰ-* ‘to put, place, lay’ (Orel 2003, p. 73, Kroonen 2013, p. 98—though neither discuss the sense ‘fame’). In Greek and Indo-Iranian the root *\*dʰobʰ-* is in fact used formulaically with the object *\*kléwos* ‘fame’, which may be ‘laid’ on a man either by himself or the Gods (West 2007, pp. 397–98; Watkins 1995, pp. 177–78). Thereby, we may see in the semantic development from PIE *\*dʰobʰ-mos* ‘thing put’ > PGmc. *\*dōmaz* > ON *dómr* ‘fame’ a periphrastic expression or kenning standing in for the lost word PGmc. *\*blewaz* ‘fame’ (only attested in compound names like DR 12 Gallehus: *Hlewa-gastiz* ‘Leeguest’, i.e., ‘Fame-guest’), originally deriving from the Pre-Germanic equivalent of the formula *\*dʰobʰ- kléwos*.

Within Germanic, the sense ‘fame’ is also found in the cognates OE *dóm*, OS *dóm*, which are most often used to refer specifically to fame after death. In *Heli* the best example is ll. 3996b–4002a, especially 4001b–4002a: *þan lebot ús þob duom after, / guod word for gumon* ‘Then our Doom will still remain afterwards, the good words for men’. In *Beow* there are several examples. The best is 1384–1389, where Bewolf consoles King Rothgar after Grendle’s mother has slain his trusted advisor Asher (*Æsc-þeri*): *Ni sorgé snotr gumá! · Sólré bið ég-þwæm, / þet bé bis friond wreceð · þan bé felu murné. / Úser ég-þwæli sæl · endi gi-bidan / wer-ældé líbes; · wyrce sé þi móté / dōmas ær deaðé; · þet bið dryht-guman / un-libjendum · æfter sólist*. ‘Grieve not, O wise man! It is better for each that he avenge his friend than that he mourn for long. Each one of us shall suffer the end of life in this world. Let him who can win a Doom before death; that is for the unliving warrior afterwards the best.’ Other illustrative examples in *Beow* include 884b–887a: [...] *Sið-mundé gi-sprang / æfter deað-degðé · dōm un-lýtil, / sið-ðan wiðes bærd · wyrn á-cwaldé / bordes biʀrdi* [...] ‘For Syemund sprang up after his death-day an unlittle [great] Doom, since he, hard in conflict, defeated the Wyrn, the keeper of the hoard’, and 953b–955a: [...] *þú þé selb bæbes / deðum gi-fremid · þet þin dóm libeð / áwá ti aldré, (...)* ‘Thou hast for thyself by deeds accomplished that thy Doom shall live for ever and ever’.

## 78 Fullar grindr · sák fyr Fitjungs sonum,

[R 5r/14]

- 2 nú bera þeir vānar vǫl;  
svá es auðr · sēm auga-bragð,  
4 hann es valtastr vīna.

Full pens I saw with Fitting’s sons;  
now they bear the staff of want.  
So is wealth like the blink of an eye:  
it is the ficklest of friends.

ALL | Sts. 78–80 are poorly placed and seem quite like later inserts. 78–79 at least resemble the general content of the Guests’ Strand (although see 79/2 n.), but 80 is a true enigma.

1 Fullar grindr ‘Full pens’ | Filled with sheep or cattle.

1 Fitjungs sonum ‘Fitting’s sons’ | Wholly unknown figures, perhaps a reference to a long-lost old folk-tale?

2 vānar vǫl ‘the staff of want’ | A beggar’s staff.

3 sēm auga-bragð ‘like the blink of an eye’ | I.e., it may be gone in the blink of an eye.

## 79 Ó-snotr maðr · es ęigna-sk getr

[R 5r/16]

- 2 fē eða fljóðs mun-úð;  
metnaðr hōnum þróa-sk, · ęn man-vit aldri=gi;

4 framm gengr hann drjúgt í dul.

The unclever man who comes to own  
money or a maid's loving grace:  
his pride flourishes, but never his manwit;  
he goes forth far in folly.

---

2 fljóðs 'maid' | The poem's first mention of the fair sex, which indicates that this st. does not in fact belong to the original Guests' Strand.

80 Þat 's þá rēynt, · es þú at rūnum spyrr,  
2 hinum rēgin-kunnum,  
þeim's gōrðu ginn-rēgin  
4 ok fáði Fimbul·þulr;  
þá hefr hann batst, ef hann þēgir.

[R 5r/18]

Proven is then what thou learnest from the runes  
born of the Reins—  
from those which the Yin-Reins made  
and the Fimblethyle painted.  
Then he has it best, if he shuts up.

---

ALL | This st. with its strange meter and its subject of runic magic does not fit well in its current place. It would have fit better in the Rune-Tally (*Háv* 138–146), with whose stanzas it also shares formulaic expressions. The last line with its shift in person is especially curious and possibly a later insert.

1–2 rūnum ... hinum rēgin-kunnum 'the runes born of the Reins' | 'Runes of Godly origin', namely through Weden's Self-Hanging (sts. 138–139 below). The expression is formulaic and very old, for it also appears on the ca. C5th Noleby stone (in the acc. sg. *rúnó ragina-kundó* 'a rune born of the Reins'); an undeniable proof of the antiquity of some of the runic lore preserved in Norse poetry. See also Index: rune. — The form of the line *binum rēgin-kunnum* is metrically unusual but need not be corrupt; cf. the similar form of *Hárb* 4/2, 6/2, 13/3. A possibly related phenomenon may be that of following a c-verse by another verse that joins it in alliteration (so st. 61/5 above, *Skí* TODO).

3–4 þeim's gōrðu ginn-rēgin / ok fáði Fimbul·þulr 'those which the Yin-Reins made and the Fimblethyle painted' | Cf. st. 142 where these two lines occur almost identically, but in reverse order.

3 ginn-rēgin 'Yin-Reins' | The 'vast, broad Gods', a pantheistic word.

4 fáði 'painted' | 3rd sg. past ind. of *fáa* 'paint, carve (runes); decorate, adorn'. The use of this verb in the context of runic writing is in fact a semantic archaism which merits discussion. The weak verb *fáa* (< PGmc. *\*faibijana*) originally derives from the PGmc. adjective *\*faibaz* 'coloured, decorated' and is associated with runic writing from the earliest period of the script's existence; it is found in the very earliest Elder Futhark inscriptions, like the stones from Einang, Vetteland, Hole, and Rö (all ca. 100–400 CE), all of which feature the formulaic phrase *ek rúnó fá(i)bidó* 'I painted the rune' (in ON form *\*ek rún fáða*). In later inscriptions in the Younger Futhark, the 3rd sg. past ind. appears in the form *fáþi*, identical to that of the present stanza. It is notable that the use of this verb in YF inscriptions is limited to archaic inscriptions (e.g., Ög 136, Sm 144, Vg 119, U Fv1912:8, Hs 7, DR 190, N 140; all ca. 800–1000 CE), many of which have explicitly pagan contents. Notably, the verb does not appear in the over 1000 inscriptions belonging to the Christian runestone trend of the 11th and 12th centuries, by which point the use of *fáa* in reference to runic carving was thus most likely either obsolete or considered too pagan. Although the verb most likely originally referred to the colouring or painting of runes (perhaps with mineral paint, or even blood), as early as the bracteate period (ca. 450–550 CE) it could be used for inscriptions in metal, including stamped ones (e.g., DR IK11, IK70, IK241,1–2). This usage continues into the YF period (e.g., the metal inscriptions U Fv1912:8 and Hs 7), and so the sense in ON was likely twofold: both 'paint, colour (runes)' (so probably sts. 144/2, 158/3 below) and also 'carve, fashion (runes)' with a solemn or ritual connotation (so likely the present st. and 142/4). In the rest of the Norse manuscript corpus, *fáa* mostly appears in the past participle carrying the sense 'decorated, adorned'. Indeed, outside of the inscriptions themselves, it is only in *Háv* (80/4, 142/4, 144/2, 158/3) that we find the verb used in a runic context at all. However, with the support of the numerous inscriptional examples above, we may fairly certainly say that at least the phrases *rínum ... þeim's fáði, rínum ... es fáði* in *Háv* 80/4 and 142/4 reflect an archaic formula deriving from genuine pre-Christian runic tradition. For a similar instance, cf. 1–2: *rínum ... binum regin-kunnum* n. above.

4 Fimbul-þulr 'Fimblethyle' | 'The Great Thyle', i.e., 'the Great Chanter', a name for Weden in his role as master of lore. For *þulr* 'thyle' cf. st. 111 below, *Vafþ* 9/4 n.

## 2. Scattered stanzas of practical advice (81–90)

The following stanzas are distinguished by a common subject matter (especially women, sts. 81, 82, 84, 86, 90) and style, and by a prevalence of Speeches-meter.

- 81 At kveldi skal dag leyfa, · konu es brænd es, [R 5r/20]  
 2 męki es reyndr es, · męy es gefin es,  
 ís es yfir kómr, · ql es drukkit es.

By evening shall one praise a day, a woman when she is burned,  
 a sword when it is tried, a maiden when she is given,  
 ice when one comes over it, ale when it is drunk up.

ALL | Nothing shall be praised in advance since things often turn out differently than one may expect; the poet gives six examples.

2–3 konu ... męy 'a woman ... a maiden' | The mention of women marks a new section in *Háv*, since the Guests' Strand proper (sts. 1–77), although certainly composed by a man for men (cf. esp. sts. 69, 72) steers entirely clear of the subject (but cf. st. 79). The perspective is clearly a man's, and the theme of not trusting women continues throughout the rest of the poem.

1 brænd 'burned' | On the funeral pyre as 'burned' is here a neutral way of saying 'dead'; cf. Introduction to the poem and st. 71/3 above.

2 męy es gefin 'a maiden when she is given' | A young unmarried woman's chastity should not be praised until she has been given in marriage and is proven a virgin (*męr*).

- 82 Í vindi skal við höggva, · veðri á sę róa, [R 5r/22]  
 2 myrkri við man spjalla: · mǫrg 'ro dags augu;  
 á skip skal skriðar orka, · ęn á skjöld til hlífar,  
 4 męki til höggs, · ęn mey til kossa.

In wind shall one cut wood, in good weather row at sea,  
 in darkness speak with a maiden—many are the eyes of day.  
 A ship shall one have for speed and a shield for protection,  
 a sword for striking and a maiden for kisses.

ALL | Sts. 82–83 list various things or actions and their fitting place or context. They bear very close resemblance to the two OE poems titled *Maxims*, particularly *Maxims II*, and one is inclined to think that such lists were likely an important part of Proto-Germanic poetry.

1 veðri 'good weather' | The word *veðr* typically means 'storm', but that can hardly be the sense here.

- 83 Við ęld skal ǫl drikka, · ęn á ísi skríða, [R 5r/24]  
 2 magran mar kaup, · ęn męki saurgan,  
 hęima hęst fęita, · ęn hund á búi.

By fire shall one drink ale, but skate on ice,  
 buy a starved steed and a rusty sword,  
 fatten the horse at home and the hound on the farmstead.

2 mar ... męki 'steed ... sword' | Formulaic pair, also occurring in *Lok* 12/1, *Vkv* 33/3, *Akv* 7/3.

3 hęima hęst fęita, · ęn hund á búi | The exact sense of this advice is unclear.

- 84 Męjar orðum · skyli mann=gi trúa, [R 5r/26,  
 2 né því's kveðr kona; Thott 1768 4°  
 því't á hverfanda hvéli · vǫru þeim hjǫrtu skǫpuð, 210r/22–210v/2]  
 4 brigð í brjóst of lagit.

A maiden's words should no man trust,  
 nor that which a woman speaks.  
 For on a whirling wheel their hearts were shaped,  
 fickleness laid in their breasts.

3 því't | *om.* 1768 3 vǫru þeim hjǫrtu skǫpuð 'their hearts were shaped' | er þeim hjarta skapat 'their heart is shaped' 1768 4 brigð | ok brigð 1768 4 lagit | lagin 1768

3–4 því't ... lagið | Quoted in slightly divergent form in *Fbr* (ms. Thott 1768 4°, fol. 210r–v), where it is introduced with the words: *Kom bonum þá í bug kvíðlingr sá, er kveðinn hafði verit um lausungar-konur*: 'And then he remembered the ditty which had been composed about loose women.'

- 85 Bristanda boga, · brinnanda loga, [R 5r/28]



- 2 gǫnanda ulfi, · galandi króku,  
 rýtanda svíni, · rót-lausum viði,  
 4 vaxanda vággi, · vellanda katli,

In bursting bow, in burning flame,  
 in yawning wolf, in crowing crow,  
 in roaring swine, in rootless tree,  
 in waxing wave, in boiling kettle,

---

ALL | Sts. 85–87 and 89 list a variety of things one should not trust. The things are a curious mix of natural phenomena, animals, tools, and people and together give a vivid insight into the lifestyle of Iron Age Norway.

- 86 fljúganda fleini, · fallandi bóru, [R 5r/30]  
 2 ísi ein-néttum, · ormi hring-lægnum,  
 brúðar beð-mólum · eða brotnu sverði,  
 4 bjarnar leiki · eða barni konungs,

in flying spear, in falling billow,  
 in one-night old ice, in coiled-up serpent,  
 in bride's bed-speech, or in broken sword,  
 in bear's play, or in king's child,

---

4 eða | †eð† R

- 87 sjúkum kalfi, · sjalf-ráða þréli, [R 5r/32]  
 2 völu vil-méli, · val ný-fældum.

in sick calf, in self-willing thrall,  
 in wallow's pleasing speech, in newly felled corpses,

---

2 völu vil-méli 'in wallow's pleasing speech' | I.e., in a too favourable prophecy (spac).

- 89 bróður-bana sínum · þótt á brautu móti, [R 5v/2]  
 2 húsi half-brunnu, · hęsti al-skjótum,  
 þa's jór ö-nýtr, · ef einn fótr brotnar;  
 4 verðr-it maðr svá tryggr · at þessu trúi öllu!

in one's brother's bane though on the road ye meet,  
 in half-burned house, in all-fleet horse—  
 the steed is useless if one foot breaks.  
 No man will be so trusting that he trust in all this!

---

ALL. | The numbering of the sts. in the pres. ed. follows R, where sts. 88, 89 come in the reversed order from how they are printed here. They have been reversed as it seems apparent from its Speeches-meter meter and the dative case of the words that 89 should follow 87, and with its last line it nicely concludes the sequence begun in 85–87. On the other hand st. 88 with its Leeds-meter meter and self-enclosed form seems to be a separate composition; it has probably been inserted after 87 due to its first line (*akri ár-sǫnum* ‘In an early sown field’), which in the dat. sg. superficially resembles the structure of 85–87, 89.

88 Akri ár-sǫnum · trúi ęngi maðr,

[R 5r/33]

2 né til snimma syni;  
veðr réðr akri, · ęn vit syni;  
4 hętt es þęira hvárt.

In an early sown field ought no man to trust,  
nor too soon in a son.

The weather rules the field and the wits the son:  
there is risk to them both.

90 Svá ’s friðr kvinna · þęira’s flátt hyggja,

[R 5v/4]

2 sęm aki jó ð-bryddum · á ísi hólum  
tęitum, tvé-vetrum · ok séi tamr illa,  
4 eða í byr óðum · bęiti stjórnlauðu,  
eða skyli haltr hęnda · hręin í þá-fjalli.

So is the love of those women who falsely think  
like one rode an unshod horse on slippery ice—  
a wild one, two winters old and ill-tamed—  
or in mad wind tacked a rudderless ship,  
or a halt man should catch a reindeer on a thawing fell.

---

5 í þá-fjalli ‘on a thawing fell’ | I.e., in springtime, when the melting ice on the ground is most slippery.

### 3. Weden’s tryst with Billing’s daughter (91–102)

The following two sections (sts. 91–102 and 103–110), which may be called Weden’s love-adventures, are united by their narrative style, their composition in Leeds-meter, and their content; together they constitute a clear sub-poem within *Háv.* Properly, sts. 91–94 do not belong to the first adventure, but instead introduces the whole sub-poem. Both episodes (sts. 95–102, 103–110) describe Weden’s romantic adventures in the first person, the first seeing the god be the victim of deception, the second seeing him as the deceiver. Their complementary and highly symmetrical structure has been shown well by McKinnell (2005), whose structural analysis is generally followed here, although his inclusion of st. 84 in the introduction is not considered since 91 is

thought to provide a natural introduction to both sections. Like the two human sexes, the two adventures form a complementary pair. Each one begins with a reflecting, gnomic stanza (95, 103), has 6 central narrative stanzas (96–101, 104–109), and concludes with a final stanza reflecting on the situation as a whole (102, 110). Sts. 95–102 describe how Weden, a man, is deceived by Billing's daughter, a woman, while in 103–110 the roles are reversed and it is Weden who deceives the woman, Guthlathe.

The two adventures are introduced by the 4 general gnomic stanzas about love and sexual relations (91–94) which properly do not belong to the first adventure, although they are here included under it. 91 describes how men can be just as fickle and dishonest towards women as women towards men, setting up the two symmetrical episodes. This theme is continued in st. 92. 93–94 go on to describe the folly of love, and how even the wisest often fall victim to it.

The first adventure (sts. 95–102) begins with a gnomic stanza setting up the episode by detailing the danger and loneliness of forbidden or unreciprocated love (95). Sts. 96–101 describe how Weden was falsely promised a night with Billing's daughter. She instead summoned a mob, and when he returned in the morning, she had tied a bitch to the bed as a last insult. St. 102 concludes with the statement that many good women are fickle towards men. The underlying myth—if one existed—is completely unknown, and Billing and his daughter are not known from any other source (for the name *Billingr* cf. 97/1 n.) Attempts to connect the myth to natural phenomena or later heroic ballads have not been convincing.

- 91      Bǫrt nú mǽli'k, · því't bǫði vǽit'k,  
2              briggðr es karla hugr konum,  
            þá fǣgrst mǽlum, · es flást hyggjum;  
4              þat tǽlir horska hugi.

[R 5v/7]

Plainly I now speak, for I know them both:  
fickle are men's minds towards women.  
Fairest we speak when falsest we think;  
that entraps sharp minds.

1 bǫði 'them both' | The natures of both sexes; bǫði is neutr. pl., which in ON is used for mixed-sex groups. The poet, a man (cf. sts. 69, 81) declares that he will not attack the fair sex unfairly; he is also aware of men's faults. This sets up the balanced structure of the following two sections (see above).

3 fǣgrst mǽlum ... flást hyggjum 'Fairest we speak ... falsest we think;' | Formulaic word-pair. Cf. st. 45.

4 þat tǽlir horska hugi 'that entraps sharp minds' | Love (or sexual infatuation—the poet does not distinguish between them) turns even wise men into liars or otherwise dishonest persons. Cf. *Mbkv* 20/1–2, which is probably partly based on this stanza: *Óst-blindir 'ro seggir svá · sumir, at þykkja mjök fás gá; // þannig verðr um man-song mǽlt: · marga befr þat hyggna tǽlt.* 'Some men are so love-blind that they seem to heed very little; // for that sake it is said about love-song: many thinking men has it entrapped.'

92 Fagrt skal mēla · ok fē bjóða,

[R 5v/9]

2 sá's vill fljóðs ǫst fāa,

líki leyfa · hins ljósa mans,

4 sá fē, es fríar.

Fairly shall he speak and offer money,  
whoso will win a lady's love:  
praise the body of the bright girl—  
he wins, who woos.

---

1 Fagrt skal mēla 'Fairly shall he speak' | Formulaic. Cf. st. 45.

4 sá fē, es fríar 'he wins, who woos' | Only he who courts her will win her hand.

93 Ástar firna · skyli engi maðr

[R 5v/11]

2 annan aldri=gi;

opt fāa á horskan, · es á hēmskan né fāa,

4 lost-fagrir litir.

Over love should no man  
ever upbraid another;  
oft they seize the sharp when they seize not the foolish,  
the lust-fair hues.

---

4 lost-fagrir litir 'lust-fair hues' | A woman with a countenance so beautiful that men cannot help but lust after her.

94 Ey-vitar firna, · es maðr annan skal,

[R 5v/12]

2 þess es of margan gengr guma;

hēmska ór horskum · gerir hǫlða sonu

4 sá hinn mǫtt=ki munr.

In no way shall man blame another  
for that which happens to many a man;  
from sharp to fools are the sons of men  
made by this mighty thing, love.

---

3 horskum | *gramm. emend.*; horskan (*m. acc. sg.*) R

95 Hugi einn þat veit, · es býr hjarta nér,

[R 5v/14]

2 einn es hann sér umb sefa;

øng es sótt verri · hveim snotrum manni

4 an sér øngu at una.

The mind alone knows what dwells close to the heart;  
it is alone with its thoughts.

No sickness is worse for each clever man  
than with nothing to be content.

1 Hugar ‘The mind’ | ON *hugr* refers to the seat of emotions in the breast, which English “mind” does not entirely capture. Normally it could be translated by English “heart”, but since the present stanza uses *hjarta* ‘heart’ to refer specifically to the organ that would be very confusing for the reader.

- 96 Þat þá reynda’k, · es í reyri sat’k, [R 5v/16]  
2 ok vætta’k míns munar,  
hold ok hjarta · vas mér hin horska mér,  
4 þeygi hana at hēldr hēf’k.  
That I found out when I sat in the reeds  
and awaited my love.  
My own flesh and heart that sharp maiden was—  
I have her none the more.

- 97 Billings mey · ek fann bæðjum á [R 5v/18]  
2 sól-hvíta sofa;  
jarls ynði · þótti mér ekki vesa  
4 nema við þat lík at lífa.  
Billing’s maiden I found on the beds,  
sun-white, asleep.  
An earl’s pleasure seemed me naught to be,  
save living alongside that body.

1 Billings ‘Billing’s’ | An unidentified dwarf or ettin. In the **H** manuscript of *Vsp* 13 Billing appears as a dwarf, and he may also be mentioned on the cryptic C9th Malt runestone (Sfj 38): **bilikirk** (error for **\*bilikr** *Billingr*?). He also appears in a Scaldic kenning for *POETRY* (Ormr *Woman* 2, SkP 3: *full burar Billings* ‘the cup of Billing’s son’), but this does not narrow down his identity since he is merely standing in as a generic *DWARF/ETTIN* (Meissner 1921, p. 428). Support for his being an ettin is found in the fact that his name is clearly similar to Gilling, an ettin who plays a part in the story of the Mead of Poetry (see introduction to sts. 103–110 below), and that a god lusting for a dwarf-maiden (to the degree they even exist) is a nonexistent motif, whereas the gods very frequently desire the daughters of the ettins (most famously in *Ski*).

1 mey ‘maiden’ | I.e., unmarried (virgin) daughter.

- [Billings mér:] 98 „Auk nēr aptni · skalt Óðinn koma, [R 5v/20]  
2 ef vilt þér mēla man,  
allt eru ósköp, · nema ein vitim  
4 s’líkan lōst saman.“  
[Billing’s maiden:] “And by evening shalt thou, Woden, come,  
if thou wilt win for thee the girl [me]!”

The Shapes are all evil if we two alone might not know  
such a vice together.”

3 allt eru ó-sköp ‘The Shapes are all evil’ | Lit. ‘the evil Shapes are everything’, that is ‘the Shapes (i.e., fates, destinies) are all awry’. See Index: shape.

99 Aþr ek hvarf · ok unna þótt=umk

[R 5v/22]

2 vísum vilja frá;

hitt ek hugða, · at hafa mynda’k

4 gæð hennar allt ok gaman.

Back I turned, and thought myself in love,  
away from my wise will,  
yet I thought that I would have  
her senses all, and pleasure.

2 visum vilja frá ‘away from my wise will’ | I.e., ‘against my better judgment’. The wise choice would have been to walk away, rather than fall into the girl’s trap.

100 Svá kom’k nēst, · at hin nýta vas

[R 5v/23]

2 víg-drótt öll of vakin,

með brinnðum ljósum · ok bornum víði,

4 svá vas mér víl-stígr of vitaðr.

So next I came when the useful  
war-troop was all awake  
with burning lights and brandished clubs;  
so for me a sad path was marked.

1 nýta ‘useful’ | Sarcastic. Billing’s daughter has summoned a lynch mob.

3 bornum víði ‘brandished clubs’ | Lit. ‘with carried wood’.

4 víl-stígr ‘sad path’ | Ambiguous, referring either to the beating he would have received at the hands of the mob, or to his walk of shame away from the hall. The latter is perhaps more likely.

101 Auk nēr morni, · es vas’k enn of kominn,

[R 5v/25]

2 þá vas sal-drótt of sofin;

gręy eitt þá fann’k · hinnar góðu konu

4 bundit bæðjum á.

And by morning when I had come again,  
then was the hall-troop asleep.  
A lone bitch I then found, by that good woman  
bound upon the beds.

1 Auk nēr morni 'And by morning' | Mirroring the beginning of st. 97 above.

3 grey çitt 'A lone bitch' | The insult is clearly understood; Weden is likened to a horny dog and mockingly asked to relieve his desire on the bitch instead of Billing's daughter—'this is all you get, you dog!'

3 góðu 'good' | Perhaps not sarcastic, but rather referring to her chastity; cf. 102/1.

102 Mōrg es góð mēr, · ef gōrva kannar,  
 2 hug-brigð við hali;  
 þá þat reynða'k, · es hit ráð-spaka  
 4 teygðá'k á flérðir fljóð;  
 hōðungar hveṛrar · leitaði mēr hit horska man  
 6 ok hafða'k þess vett=ki\* vífs.

[R 5v/27]

Many a good maiden—if one comes to know her well—  
 is heart-fickle towards men.

I found that out when the counsel-wise  
 lady I lured into sins;  
 every disgrace that sharp girl sought out for me,  
 and I had naught of the woman.

6 vett=ki\* | vettkis R

1 góð mēr 'good maiden' | The 'goodness' here likely refers to faithfulness and chastity. Cf. *Ski* 12.

#### 4. Weden's theft of the Mead of Poetry (103–110)

Sts. 103–110 contain Weden's second love adventure in *Háv* and deals with his theft of the Mead of Poetry from the ettin Sutting and his daughter Guthlathe.

Unlike the previous adventure (sts. 95–102), the underlying myth of this one is very well known and merits more extensive discussion. The main source for the narrative is *Skm* 5–6, which may be summarized as follows, with minor details left out:

##### Chapter 5:

After the war between the Eese and the Wanes (cf. *Vsp* 22–23), the two tribes reconcile through spitting into a vat. Not wanting to discard this token of their truce, they instead make a man out of the spit and call him Quasher (*Kvasir*). He is so wise that he can answer any question posed to him, and so he travels around the world in order to share his learning with men.

Quasher eventually comes to the dwelling of two dwarfs, Fealer and Galer (*Fjalarr ok Galarr*). They kill him and drain his blood into three vessels: the two vats Soon (*Són*) and Bothem (*Boðn*), and the cauldron Woderearer (*Óð-rórir*). They mix the blood with honey, and from the

mixture they brew a mead which will make whomever drinks from it a *skald eða fróða-maðr* ‘a scald or man of learning’. The dwarfs lie to the Eese about the murder, telling them that Quasher drowned in his own wisdom for a lack of good questions.

Some time later, the dwarfs murder the ettin Gilling (*Gillingr*) and his wife. Gilling’s son, Sutting (*Suttungr*), learns of this and prepares to drown the dwarfs. In exchange for their lives and as wergild for Sutting’s parents, the dwarfs offer him the *mjóð’inn dýra* ‘dear mead’ (cf. sts. 105 and 140). Sutting accepts the payment and brings the mead home with him. He places his daughter Guthlathe (*Gunn-lǫð*) in a cave to guard it.

#### Chapter 6:

Weden is wandering through the world when he finds nine thralls mowing hay. He lends them aid by sharpening their scythes with a special whetstone, and they now cut much faster. He throws the whetstone into the air and the greedy thralls fight to the death over it, leaving none alive. By evening Weden comes to their master, Baye (*Baugi*), Sutting’s brother. Baye laments the death of his workmen, and so Weden, calling himself Baleworker (*Bǫl-verkr* ‘evil-doer’), offers to do their work over the summer in exchange for one drink of the mead. Baye tells the disguised god that Sutting alone owns the mead, but that he will accompany him to Sutting’s to ask.

In fall, the two arrive at Sutting’s, who as expected refuses to give any part of the mead away. Weden then tells Baye that he will get to it anyway. He takes out the drill Wrate (*Rati*) and tells Baye to drill through the mountains into the cave where the mead is stored. Baye first attempts to trick him by only drilling halfway through, but eventually creates a narrow passage. Weden turns himself into a snake and crawls through it; as he does, Baye tries to strike him with the drill, but misses. On the other side, Weden finds Guthlathe watching over the mead. She is taken by him, and promises him three sips of the mead in exchange for sleeping with her for three nights. Weden sleeps with her and then takes his reward. With each sip he swallows the contents of one of the three vessels, so that all the mead ends up in his belly.

Having drunk the mead, he dons his eagle-hame and flies away from the mountain. Sutting sees him, takes on his own eagle-hame, and gives chase. The Eese see the chase overhead and set out several large vats on the ground, into which Weden, still flying, spits out the mead. At this point Sutting has almost caught up with him, and so Weden in eagle-form “sends back” (*senda aptr*, viz. from behind) some of the mead, presumably into Sutting’s face. The text does not say, but it seems likely that Sutting crashes down and dies.

After the chase is over and Weden is back he distributes the mead. That part caught in the three vats is given to the Eese and to *þeim mǫnnum, er yrkja kunnu* ‘those men who can compose verse’, but the portion which was “sent back” becomes the *skald-fífla blutr* ‘lot of poet-fools’.

Surprisingly, the narrative core of this longwinded myth appears to go back at least as far as the Bronze Age. A close parallel is found in the Vedic myth of the origin of the psychoactive ritual drink *sóma*, which in Vedic



mythology is also a god (*Sóma*) in its own right. The earliest version of that story is found in the two hymns *RV* 4.26–27, which tell how *Sóma* is held inside ‘a hundred bronze forts’ (4.27.1c: *ṣatám púras áyasis*) by the archer *Kṛṣánu*, before being stolen by the sweeping, mighty Eagle who brings it to *Mánu*, the first human sacrificer and ancestor of the Aryans. The guardian *Kṛṣánu* does not himself give chase, but shoots his arrows at the Eagle, missing.

Later Vedic texts clearly identify the Eagle with *Agní* (the god of fire), specifically in his form as the *gāyatrī* meter (Bloomfield 1896). One text in particular (*AB* 3.25–27) is interesting in its etiological function: “What (the *gāyatrī*) seized with her right foot, that became the morning pressure (*prātaḥ-savanam*). ... What she seized with her left foot became the noon pressure (*mādhyaṁdinam savanam*). ... What she seized became the third pressure (*trṭīyam savanam*).” (Bloomfield 1896, p. 6). I may here note that Bloomfield in the same article offers a naturalistic explanation of the myth, which may be of interest since such explanations are much more rarely encountered for Norse myths: the Eagle is *Agní* in the form of lightning, who shoots forth “from the womb of the cloud; as the lightning shoots from the cloud, the heavenly fluid, the Soma, streams down upon the earth.”

The close relation between the Norse and Vedic origin myths for the sacred drink may be explained in two ways: through common inheritance from the Indo-Europeans, or through Iranian steppe influence, which may have taken place as late as the Migration Period (probably by way of the Sarmatians, cf. the originally Iranian loanword “path” which must have entered Germanic after Grimm’s Law, Kroonen (2013, p. 396)). It should here be said that linguistic and botanical facts preclude the Indo-Iranian *sóma* cult’s being originally Indo-European; it instead appears to have been borrowed in the late 3rd millennium BC from the Central Asian Bactria-Margian Archaeological Complex or BMAC (Lubotsky 2001, pp. 3–4, 6).

The original Proto-Indo-European sacred Drink was probably the Drink of Undying (OI *a-mṛta*, Greek ἀμβροσία < PIE *\*ǵ-mṛtós* ‘undying, immortal’; Greek νέκ-τᾱρ ‘death-overcoming’), which in the Greek mythology is brought to Zeus (Ζεύς) by doves (*Od* 12.62–63: πέλειαι τρήρωνες, ταί τ’ ἀμβροσίην Διὶ πατρὶ φέρουσιν ‘the trembling doves which bring ambrosia to Father Zeus’) and in the Irish mythology was brewed for the Gods (OIr. *Tuath Dé* or *Tuatha Dé Danann*) by the smith *Goibniu* (Dobbs 1929, p. 193; MacKillop 1998, p. 228).

It seems probable from the Greek, Norse, and Irish attestations that this bird-brought Drink was originally mythological and believed to be the mystery behind the immortality of the Gods. In this vein it would likely have been invoked in the symbolic poetic language of the ritual toasts drunk by the PIE chieftains (probably originally consisting of fermented honey-wine—mead).

It was in the Indo-Iranian tradition that this symbolic language, together with the myth of the eagle stealing it from the mountains, was uniquely integrated into the borrowed cult of the *sóma*, for which *a-mṛta* ‘undying’ became a poetic epithet (e.g. *RV* 5.2.3c). Perhaps unlike the earlier alcoholic

drinks, this one was believed to make its human drinkers really immortal, as famously seen in the ecstatic *RV* 8.48.3: *Ā-pāma sōmam, a-mṛtā a-bhūma, / ā-ganma jyōtir, ā-vidāma dēvān. / Kim nūnām asmān kṛṇavad ārātīḥ / kim u dḥrītīr a-mṛta mārtyasya?* ‘We have drunk the soma; we have become immortal; we have gone to the light; we have found the gods. What can hostility do to us now, and what the malice of a mortal, o immortal one?’

Having briefly discussed the non-Norse parallels to the relevant myth, we may now turn to its form in the present stanzas, and how this differs from *Skm* and other Norse poetry. To begin with, the biggest difference between the treatment of the myth in *Skm* 5–6 and *Háv* 103–110 is that the present stanzas are very allusive; far from being a linear retelling of events, the narrative thread is actually quite difficult to follow, especially without the help of *Skm*.

Notably, the Eagle, one of the key details shared between *Skm* and the Vedic hymns, is not found in *Háv*. Other important *Skm* elements, like Quasher, the two dwarfs, and Baye, are also missing. It is thus clear that Snorre’s narrative cannot be exclusively based on *Háv*, but must in addition rely either on other, now-lost sources, or on his own imagination. That the former hypothesis is the correct one is proven by the large number of kennings for POETRY found in the Scaldic corpus, which hint at a similar narrative to that told in *Skm* 5–6, yet predate that text (ca. 1220 AD) by up to four centuries.

Scaldic kennings reference the following details from *Skm* not found in *Háv* (Meissner 1921, pp. 427–430; all citations from SkP):

- The draining of Quasher’s blood (Eskál Vell 1: *Kvasis dreyra* ‘Quasher’s blood [POETRY]’);
- The ransom of the two dwarfs (Eyv Hál 1: *gipld Gillinga* ‘the payments for Gilling [POETRY]’, Anon (*SnE*) 1: *sęin-fyrnð skip dverga* ‘the late forgotten ships of dwarfs [POEMS]’);
- Weden’s companion Baye (Egill *Arkv* 22: *sęku-nautr Sónar hvinna* ‘adversary of the thieves of Soon <mythical vat> [= Weden and Baye (*Bauga* (gen. sg.) = *bauga* (gen. pl.) ‘rings’) > GENEROUS MAN]’—this kenning is not mentioned by Meissner due to his reliance on an earlier ed.);
- The theft by the Eagle (Egill *Berdr* 1: *ęrð arnar kęapta* ‘produce of the eagle’s beak [POETRY]’);
- And its “sending back” of a certain part of the mead (Þstf Lv 3: *ęęirr ara ins gamla* ‘dung of the ancient eagle [BAD POETRY]’).

On the other hand there are elements found in *Háv* 103–110 which do not appear in *Skm* 5–6. The focus of *Háv* is squarely on Weden’s visit to (and particularly his betrayal of) Sutting and his daughter Guthlathe, and the emphasis *Háv* places on Weden’s *betrayal* contrasts sharply with the transactional and seemingly unemotional three-night affair in *Skm*. It is possible that the

version of the myth underlying *Háv* even saw Weden marry Guthlathe, receiving the mead as a dowry. A marriage between them is supported by the unique legal expression *hins hindra dags* (st. 109), and would explain Weden's broken oath (110), which is not mentioned in *Skm*. The recipient of the oath may even have been Sutting, the father of the bride himself, as suggested by the description of him as *svikvinn* 'betrayed' and by the possibility that he hosted a banquet for Weden (110). An internal problem with that idea is that Weden is still said to have had to bore through the mountains (107), presumably to reach Guthlathe, in which case it comes off as unlikely that he would *then* have asked Sutting for her hand, rather than have sworn the oath to her, before or after seducing her then-and-there in her chamber. Further, the betrayer of Sutting need not be Weden directly but could of course also be Guthlathe, who broke her father's trust when she gave away the mead. See further notes to the individual stanzas.

Two other motifs to be considered with regard to Weden's dealings with Guthlathe are the beautiful ettin's daughter coveted by a god (cf. Billing's maiden above, Gird in *Skí*, and Rind in Saxo Grammaticus, *Vsp* 31 n.) and the horny ettin's daughter who attempts to seduce a young hero (cf. *HHj* P6–30).

*Háv* 103–110 begin with some social advice (103), after which the narrative is retold in non-linear fashion by Weden himself. He visits Sutting's home, but does not receive a good reception (104). Guthlathe falls in love with him and gives him a drink of the Mead, for which he cruelly repays her (105). In order to get to her chamber Weden has to bore through the mountains with the drill Wrate (106). Weden has "bought" the Mead "well"; probably a euphemistic reference to sleeping with Guthlathe for it, and given it to mankind (107). Weden slept with Guthlathe and worries that he would not have made it out alive without her aid (108). "The following day" a group of Rime-Thurses come to Weden's hall to ask him whether Baleworker (presumably the name he gave Guthlathe) is among the Gods or whether he has been slain by Sutting (109). Weden, talking about himself in the third person, answers that he "thinks" that Weden has sworn an oath, but that his words cannot be trusted; after the simble he betrayed Sutting and made Guthlathe weep (110).

- 103 Heima glaðr gumi · ok við gęsti řęifr,  
 2 sviðr skal umb sik vesa;  
 minnigr ok mólugr, · ef vill marg-fróðr vesa;  
 4 opt skal góðs geta;  
 fimbul-fambi heitir, · sá's fätt kann segja;  
 6 þat es ósnotrs aðal.

[R 5v/30]

At home shall man be glad and giving with his guest,  
 wise about himself.

Of good memory and speech if he wishes to be many-learned;  
 oft shall he speak of good.

A fimble-fool is he called who can say little;

that is the unclever man's nature.

- 104 Hinn aldna jǫtun sótta'k, · nú em'k apr of kominn; [R 5v/33]  
 2 fátt gat'k þegjandi þar;  
 mǫrgum orðum · mēlta'k í mínn frama  
 4 í Suttungs solum.

The old ettin [= Sutting] I sought out; now am I come back;  
 I got little hearing there.  
 Many words I spoke to my furtherance,  
 in the halls of Sutting.

- 105 Gunn·lǫð mér of gaf · gollnum stóli á [R 6r/2]  
 2 drykk hins dýra mjaðar;  
 ill ið-gjöld · lét'k hana eptir hafa  
 4 síns hins hęila hugar,  
 síns hins svára sefa.

Guthlathe gave me on the golden throne  
 a drink of the dear mead;  
 evil recompense I let her have afterwards,  
 for her whole heart,  
 for her heavy affection.

---

2 drykk hins dýra mjaðar 'a drink of the dear mead' | The same expression appears in *Skm* 5 and in st. 140/3 below.

- 106 Rata munn · lét=umk rüms of fää [R 6r/4]  
 2 ok umb grjót gnaga;  
 yfir ok undir · stóðu=mk jǫtna vegir,  
 4 svá hętta'k hǫfði til.

Wrate's mouth I made to bring me room  
 and gnaw its way through the rocks.  
 Above and below me stood the roads of ettins [MOUNTAINS];  
 so I risked my head.

---

1 Rata 'Wrate's' | According to *Skm* 6 (see above), *Rati* 'Wrate' was the drill used by Weden to bore through the mountain into the room where Guthlathe sat over the mead. The etymology of this term is uncertain (cf. Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *rati*), but if it is a cognate with Old Danish *vråde* 'to rummage, bore' then this would be an instance of alliteration between old *vr-* and *r-*, suggesting a later date for Weden's love adventures than the Guests' Strand (cf. sts. 26/2, 32/2). On the other hand, if *Rati* is derived from the verb *rata* (5/1, 18/1), the present instance is non-diagnostic.

- 107 Vəl keypts blutar · həf'k vəl notit;  
 2 fás es fróðum vant;  
 því't Óð-rórir · es nú upp kominn  
 4 á alda vés jaðar.

[R 6r/6]

The well bought thing have I used well;  
 little do the learned lack,  
 for Woderearer has now come upon  
 the rim of the wigh of men [= Middenyard].

---

1 blutar 'thing' | litar 'hue/colour' R

---

ALL | Weden has made good use of the Mead of Poetry by bringing it to the realm of men where those with skill and wisdom may now enjoy it.

1 Vəl keypts blutar 'The well bought thing' | The Mead of Poetry, which was "well bought" in that the price Weden paid for it was three nights with Guthlathe, who should likely be thought of as very beautiful.

3 Óð-rórir 'Woderearer' | One of the vessels in with the Mead of Poetry was held (see introduction to sts. 103–110 above), here standing as a *pars pro toto* for all the Mead.

4 jaðar 'rim' | metr. emend.; jaðar R has a long root-syllable, and does not fit grammatically.

- 108 Ifi 's mér á, · at véra'k ɛnn kominn  
 2 jɔtna gɔrðum ór,  
 ef Gunn-laðar né nyt'a'k, · hinnar góðu konu,  
 4 es lɔgð=umk arm yfir.

[R 6r/8]

I harbour doubt that I would yet have come  
 out of the yards of the Ettins,  
 if I had not made use of Guthlathe, that good woman  
 over whom I laid my arm.

---

1 Ifi 's mér á 'I harbour doubt' | Lit. 'There is doubt upon me'.

4 es lɔgð=umk arm yfir 'over whom I laid my arm' | Cf. Lok 20/4 (*lagðir lér yfir*).

- 109 Hins hindra dags · gingu hrím-þursar  
 2 Hóva ráðs at fregna, · Hóva hǫllu í,  
 at Bǫl-verki spurðu, · ef véri með bǫndum kominn  
 4 eða həfði hǫnum Suttungr of sóit.

[R 6r/9]

The following day the Rime-Thurses went  
 to ask for the High One's counsel, in the High One's hall.  
 About Baleworker they asked, whether he had come into the midst of the  
 Bonds,  
 or if Sutting had slain him.

---

1 Hins hindra dags ‘The following day’ | This is the only occurrence of the comparative *bindra* ‘following, next’ in the whole Old Norse-Icelandic corpus. The superlative *bindstr* ‘last, final’ does occur (e.g. *indsta sinni* ‘the last time’, with loss of the *b-*; see CV: *bindri*), and the possible derivative *bindar-dags* ‘day after tomorrow, two days after’ is found twice, both times in the *Gula*, chh. 37 and 266. In the broader Scandinavian sphere, however, we find in the Swedish provincial laws an exact equivalent of the present phrase, namely OSwe. *bindra-dagher*, a law-word referring specifically to the ‘day after the wedding night’, used both on its own and in the expression *bindra-dags gief* ‘morning gift’ (LMNL). If ‘the day after the wedding night’ is in fact the sense of *bindra dagr* in the present stanza, two interpretations are possible: (1) Weden refers sarcastically to the day after he slept with Guthlathe, as would be done during the wedding night. (2) Weden actually married, or promised to marry, Guthlathe. The latter interpretation may find further support in the “bigh-oath” of st. 110, but Guthlathe is never referred to in any surviving Norse sources as Weden’s wife, only his lover (Steinþ Frag 1 (SkP 3)).

3 *böndum* ‘the Bonds’ | The Gods.

- 110 Baug-*eið* Óðinn · hygg at unnit hafi,  
 2 hvat skal hans tryggðum trúa?  
 Suttung svikvinn · hann lét sumbli frá  
 4 ok gróttu Gunn-löðu.

[R 6r/12]

A bigh-oath I judge that Weden has sworn—  
 how shall one trust his truces?  
 Leaving the simble, he left Sutting betrayed  
 and Guthlathe brought to tears.

---

ALL. | The exact narrative referred to in the stanza is hard to pin down. One possibility is that Weden swore an oath on a bigh (an arming) to marry Guthlathe; Sutting then hosted a banquet (simble) for the couple (cf. *bins bindra dags* in st. 109), and Weden slept with her and then stole the mead. The mention of Sutting as betrayed could however also be a reference to Guthlathe’s betrayal of him, so that the sense is that Weden left both the father and daughter upset and weeping: the father furious over the loss of his mead and the harlotry of his daughter, the daughter heartbroken over the flight of her false lover.

## 5. The Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137)

The so-called **Speeches of Loddfathomer** (ON *Loddfáfnismól*) is a series of advice stanzas addressed to Loddfathomer, an otherwise unknown figure who is clearly fictional. His name is a compound of *lodd-*, apparently related to ON *loddari* ‘juggler, tramp’, OE *loddere* ‘pauper, beggar’ + *Fáfnir* ‘Fathomer’, literally ‘embracer’, the name of the famous gold-hoarding wyrm. The name thus paints the picture of an archetypal greedy fool in desperate need of the wisdom taught by Weden, his intellectual superior.

Loddfathomer reappears in st. 164, which reveals that the galders of 147–165 are also addressed to him, but he is not found outside of *Háv*. If he belongs to a lost mythological or legendary episode he most likely played a similar role to King Heathric in *Heiðr* 10 or the ettin Webthrithner in *Váþf*, namely as an arrogant challenger of Weden’s wisdom soon bested by him.

The content of the advice in this section is generally similar and sometimes identical to that found in the Guests' Strand (1–79), but the focus is not identical. We here find items of a superstitious or religious nature (e.g. 113–114, 126, 129, 137) and advice regarding women (113–115, 118, 130, 131/5), both topics the Guests' Strand proper entirely avoids.

Most stanzas (112, 113, 115–117, 119–122, 125–132, 133–135, 137) are introduced by a repeated three-line refrain (*stélf*) of type *abcc*.

- 111 Mál 's at þylja · þular stóli á; [R 6r/14]  
 2 Urðar brunni at  
 sá'k ok þagðá'k, · sá'k ok hugðá'k,  
 4 hlýdda'k á manna mál;  
 umb rúnar heyrðá'k dōma, · né umb rǫðum þogðu  
 6 Höva hǫllu at,  
 Höva hǫllu í  
 8 heyrðá'k sǣgja svá:

It is time to chat upon the thyle's throne.

At the Well of Weird

I saw and I shut up; I saw and I thought;

I listened to the matters of men.

Of runes I heard them speak, nor did they shut up their counsel,

at the High One's hall,

in the High One's hall,

I heard them say so:

---

1 Mál | *The body of the M takes up a single line in height, but the right leg curves down to the line below; the letter is noticeably thicker than the capitals introducing individual sts., yet smaller than the initials introducing separate poems in R.*

---

ALL | This stanza serves as an internal framing device and introduces the section.

1 þylja 'chant' | The verb corresponding to *þulr* 'thyle'.

1 þular 'thyle' | The reciter, chanter of ancient lore. See Index.

- 112 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rǫð nemir, [R 6r/17]  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 nǫtt þú ris=at, · nema á njóns séir,  
 eða leitir þér innan út staðar.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;*

*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*

*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Rise not at night unless thou be scouting

or looking to ease thyself outside.

1 Róð=umk ‘I counsel’ | The use of the reflexive is unusual. It may derive from a hypercorrection of 1pl. pres. ind. *rþðum*, which is not uncommonly used in a singular sense in poetry.

5 leítir þér innan út staðar ‘looking to ease thyself outside’ | Lit. ‘looking for thy place outside’. To *leita sér staðar* ‘look for one’s place’ is euphemistic; the same expression is used by Snorre in *Yng* 11.

- 113 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rþð nemir, [R 6r/19]  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 fjöl-kunnigri konu · skal=at-tu í fáðmi sofa,  
 svá’t hñn lyki þik liðum.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

In a manicunning woman’s arms shalt thou never sleep,  
 lest she lock thee in her limbs.

4 fjöl-kunnigri ‘manicunning’ | F. dat. sg. of *fjöl-kunnigr* ‘sorcerous’, an adj. used of both men and women.

5 svá’t hñn lyki þik liðum ‘lest she lock thee in her limbs’ | The image of the seductress physically binding the man in her arms is not uncommon cross-culturally and is famously used in the Bible, Ecclesiastes 7:26: “And I find woman more bitter than death. For she is all snares, and nets her heart, and fetters her arms. He who is good before God will escape her, and an offender will be trapped by her.” (Alter 2018).

- 114 Hñn svá gørir · at gairr egi [R 6r/21]  
 2 þings né þjóðans máls;  
 mat þú vill=at · né manns=kis gaman  
 4 færr þú sorga-fullr at sofa.

She makes it so that thou nowise heedest  
 the Thing nor the ruler’s speech;  
 thou wilt not have food nor any man’s pleasure;  
 thou goest sorrowful to sleep.

1 gairr ‘heedest’ | The nasal vowel in this verb is attested in Elfdalian *gä*.

- 115 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rþð nemir, [R 6r/22]  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 annars konu · tæg þér aldri=gi  
 eyra-rúnu at.



*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Another man's wife do never entice  
into becoming thy ear-whisperess [LOVER].

---

5 eyra-rúnu 'ear-whisperess [LOVER]' | This word is also used in *Vsp* 38, in which male seducers of married women are among those being forced to wade through heavy streams in the afterlife. Cf. also st. 131/5 below.

116 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir,

[R 6r/23]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:  
4 á fjalli eða firði, · ef þik fara tíðir,  
fá=sk-tu at virði vël.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:  
on fell or firth if thou desirest to journey—  
furnish thyself well with food.*

---

4 á fjalli eða firði 'on fell or firth' | Hiking through mountains or sailing along the shore; an expression just as well at home on Iceland as in western Norway. This word pair is a formulaic merism, and although this is its only poetic attestation it is also found several times in the Old Norwegian laws (e.g. *Gula* 73 (NGL I, p. 38), *Frost* 32 (NGL I, p. 142); see ONP for further occurrences).

117 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir,

[R 6r/24]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:  
4 illan mann · lát aldri=gi  
ð·höpp at þér vita,  
6 því't af illum manni · fêr aldri=gi  
gjöld hins góða hugar.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:  
Never let an evil man  
know of thy mishaps,  
for from an evil man wilt thou never get  
recompense for thy good heart.*

---

5 ð·höpp at þér vita | An unambiguous instance of *v* alliterating with a vowel.

118 Ofar=la bíta · sá'k ɛinum hal

[R 6r/26]

2 orð illrar konu,  
flá-róð tunga · varð hönnum at fjör-lagi  
4 ok þey=gi umb sanna sòk.

I saw sorely biting at a lonely man  
the words of an evil woman;  
a false-counseling tongue brought his life to its end  
and yet nowise o'er a truthful charge.

1 Ofar=la 'sorely' | Contraction of *ofar=liga* 'CV: high up, in the upper part', presumably meaning that the words were particularly grievous or insulting and cut him deeply. Whether the man was murdered or committed suicide is not clear.

3 flá-róð tunga 'a false-counseling tongue' | Cf. *Lok* 31/1: *fló 's þér tunga* 'false is thy tongue'.

119 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn róð nemir,

[R 6r/28]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:  
4 vęitst, ef vin átt, · þann's vęl trúir,  
far þú at finna opt;  
6 því't hrísi vęx · ok hõu grasi  
vegr, es vęt=ki trøðr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Thou knowest, if thou hast a friend whom thou trustest well  
journey to find him oft,  
for with brushwood and with tall grass grows  
the way which no one treads.

4–5 vęitst ... oft 'Thou knowest ... oft' | Near-identical to st. 44/1, 4 above.

6 hrísi vęx · ok hõu grasi 'with brushwood and with tall grass grows' | Identical to *Grm* 17/1.

120 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn róð nemir,

[R 6r/30]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:  
4 góðan mann · tęg þér at gaman-rúnum  
ok nem líknar-galdr meðan lífir.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Draw a good man toward thee with pleasure-runes  
and learn galders of kindness while thou livest.

4 gaman-rúnum ‘pleasure-runes’ | Here “rune” appears to carry its root meaning of ‘whisper, counsel, speech’, thus ‘pleasing speech’. Cf. st. 129 where this word reoccurs.

5 líknar-galdr ‘galders of kindness’ | Metaphorical, i.e., ways of speaking which will make one liked; cf. the similar use of the related verb *gala* in 29/4 above.

121 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · ɛn rǫð nemir,

[R 6r/31]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:

4 vin þínum · ves aldri=gi  
fyrri at flaum-slitum.

6 sorg etr hjarta, · ef þú segja né náir  
ɛin-hverjum allan hug.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

With thy friend never be the first  
to tear the relation apart.

Sorrow eats thy heart if thou canst not tell  
anyone thy whole mind.

6–7 segja ... ɛin-hverjum allan hug ‘tell anyone thy whole mind’ | Cf. st. 124 which uses almost the same expression.

122 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · ɛn rǫð nemir,

[R 6r/33]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:

4 orðum skipta · skalt aldri=gi  
við ǝ-svinna apa,

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Words shalt thou never exchange  
with unwise apes,

ALL | Cf. st. 125 below which gives similar advice.

5 ǝ-svinna apa ‘unwise apes’ | Formulaic; cf. *Grm* 33, *Fáfn* 11.

123 því’t af illum manni · munt aldri=gi

[R 6r/34]

2 góðs laun of geta,

ɛn góðr maðr · mun þik gørva mega

4 líkn-fastan at lofi.

for from an evil man wilt thou never  
 get a reward for thy goodness,  
 but a good man will know to make thee  
 firmly liked through his goodwill.

1–2 því't ... geta 'For ... praise' | Cf. st. 117/6–7.

4 líkn-fastan 'firmly liked' | The first element *líkn* 'liking' is somewhat difficult; see st. 8 for definitions. For the cpd. La Farge and Tucker (1992) give a tentative 'assured of favour', while CV gives 'fast in goodwill, beloved'.

124 Sifjum 's þá blandit · hværr es sęgja réðr

[R 6v/2]

2 ęinum allan hug;  
 alt es bętra · an sęi brigðum at vesa:  
 4 es=a sá vinnr ęðrum · es vilt ęitt sęgir.

Kinship is mingled whenever one resolves to tell  
 one man his whole mind.  
 Everything is better than to be with the fickle;  
 he's no friend to another who speaks pleasantries alone.

1–2 sęgja ... ęinum allan hug 'tell one man his whole mind' | Cf. st. 121 which uses almost the same expression.

125 Ręð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn ręð nemir,

[R 6v/4]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 þrimr orðum sęnna · skal=at-tu þér við verra mann;  
 opt hinn bętri bilar,  
 6 þá's hinn verri vęgr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

With three words shalt thou not flyte with a worse man;  
 oft the better one breaks  
 when the worse one strikes.

4 þrimr orðum 'With three words' | I.e., 'not even with three words'. If one understands *orð* in its sense 'speech' we may understand that if one man says something (the first speech) to which another responds with an insult (the second speech), the first man should not retaliate (the third speech) and escalate the dispute.

126 Ręð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn ręð nemir,

[R 6v/5]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:

- 4 skó-smiðr þú vesir · né skepti-smiðr,  
nema sjölfum þér séir.  
6 Skór 's skapaðr illa · eða skapt séi rangt,  
þá 's þér þöls beðit.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Be not a shoe-maker nor a shaft-maker  
unless thou be one for thyself.  
If the shoe is ill shaped or the shaft be crooked—  
then for thee a bale is summoned.

---

ALL | The plain sense is that the customer will place a curse on the maker if he dislikes his wares.

- 127 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir, [R 6v/7]  
2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:  
4 hvar's þöf kant, · kveð þér þöfvi at  
ok gef=at þínum fiöndum frið.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Wherever thou knowest a bale call it baleful against thee,  
and give thy foes no peace.

---

ALL | If somebody reveals himself to be your enemy (e.g. by putting a curse on you), then acknowledge it and act decisively. Do not tolerate minor or underhanded insults, for the disrespect afforded to you may soon escalate if it is not nipped in the bud. — This st. has often been interpreted as a command to call out evil or injustice, even when committed towards somebody else, and while there is nothing that speaks decisively against such a reading, it cannot be said to agree with the cautious and shrewd spirit of *Háv.*

- 128 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir, [R 6v/8]  
2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
þér munu góð ef getr:  
4 illu feginn · ves aldri=gi,  
en lát þér at góðu getit.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

In the bad do never rejoice,  
but let thyself be pleased by the good.

ALL | No person would rejoice in that which is bad for him, and so the sense should be that one should not take joy in the misfortunes of others, but rather take pleasure in that which is good and true.

5 ɛn lát þér at góðu getit ‘but let thyself be pleased by the good’ | This construction is equivalent to CV: *geta*, A. IV. with acc.

129 Rðð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn rðð nemir,

[R 6v/9]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,

þér munu góð ef getr:

4 upp líta · skal=at-tu í orrostu;

—gjalti g·líkir · verða gumna synir—

6 síðr þitt of hęilli halir.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Look upward shalt thou not in battle  
—alike to a madman become the sons of men—  
lest warriors bewitch thee.

ALL | An obscure superstition; the interpretation hinges on the etymology of the word *gjalti* ‘madman’ dat. sg., also found in the closely related phrase *verða at gjalti* ‘turn into a madman’. (a) CV explains it as an old dative of *goltr* ‘boar, hog’. This necessitates an irregular breaking of *ja* < *ę*, since *goltr* (< Proto-Norse \**galtur*) is an u-stem and should have a dat. sg. *geltri* (< PN \**galtri*; cf. *kunimudiu*, dat. sg. of \**Kunimundur*, on the Tjurkö 1 bracteate). (b) The generally accepted explanation in modern scholarship seems to be a borrowing from Old Irish *geilt* ‘insane, mad’ (so La Farge and Tucker (1992) and others). A close Irish parallel to the present stanza is found in the C12th or 13th Gaelic tale of *Suibhne mac Colmáin* who was cursed by saint *Rónán Finn* to become mad. The curse took effect when he looked into the sky during a battle, after which he was known as *Suibhne geilte*. Since earlier versions of the same story are attested as early as the 840s (Males 2024b, p. 100), this word cannot be used to argue for a C13th dating for the Speeches of Loddfathomer section of *Háv*, but its Irish roots hint at an Icelandic rather than Norwegian origin for this part of the poem.

6 halir ‘warriors’ | Some sort of “supernatural sky warriors”, to quote Pettit (2023); perhaps even the Oneharriers.

130 Rðð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn rðð nemir,

[R 6v/11]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,

þér munu góð ef getr:

4 Ef vilt þér góða konu · kvęðja at gaman-rúnum

ok fāa fęgnuð af,

6 fęgru skalt hęita · ok láta fást vesa;

lęði=sk mann=gi gótt ef getr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

If thou wilt address a good woman with pleasure-runes  
 and get good cheer from her,  
 a fair thing shalt thou promise and let it stand firm;  
 no one loathes a good thing if he gets it.

---

<sup>4</sup> gaman-rúnum ‘pleasure-runes’ | While easily interpreted as ‘sexual intercourse’, the word is used in st. 120 in a decidedly non-sexual sense. Its base meaning is probably ‘good conversation’.

- 131 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir, [R 6v/13]  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 varan bið’k þik vesa · ok eigi of varan,  
 ves við ǫl varastr, · ok við annars konu  
 6 ok við þat hit þriðja, · at þjófar né leiki.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:  
 I bid thee be wary, and not overly wary;  
 be wariest with ale and with another man’s woman,  
 and with this the third: that thieves do not outplay thee.*

- 132 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir, [R 6v/15]  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 at háði né hlátri · haf aldri=gi  
 gæst né ganganda.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:  
 With scorn or laughter never treat  
 a guest or wanderer.*

- 133 Opt vitu ó=gor=la, · þeir’s sitja inni fyrir, [R 6v/16]  
 2 hvers þeir ’ro kyns es koma;  
 es=at maðr svá góðr · at galli né fylgi,  
 4 né svá illr at einu=gi dugi.

*Oft they who sit within do not fully know  
 of what kind are those who come;  
 there is no man so good that no flaw follows  
 nor so bad that he avails for nothing.*

- 134 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir,  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 at hórur þul · hlé aldr=gi,  
 opt 's gótt þat's gamlir kveða,  
 6 opt ór skǫrpum þelg · skilin orð koma  
 þeim's hangir með hǫum  
 8 ok skollir með skrǫum,  
 ok váfir með vil-møgum.

[R 6v/17]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:  
 At a hoary thyle never laugh;  
 oft is good that which old men sing;  
 oft from a scorched leather-bag come discerning words;  
 from him who hangs amidst hides  
 and dangles amidst dry skins  
 and sways amidst calf-stomachs.*

6 skǫrpum þelg 'from a scorched leather-bag' | Metaphor for an ancient, thick-wrinkled man.

9 vil-møgum 'calf-stomachs' | A compound of *vil* 'cattle-entrails' + *magar* 'stomachs'. A reading *vil-møgum* 'lads of toil [THRALLS]' is possible but gives no reasonable sense that adds to the description of a hanging leather-bag.

- 135 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir,  
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,  
 þér munu góð ef getr:  
 4 gæst þú né geyj=a · né á grind hrékir;  
 get þú vǫ-luðum vǫl.

[R 6v/20]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:  
 At the guest do not bark nor spit at the gate;  
 furnish the destitute well.*

4 né geyj=a 'At the guest do not bark' | Note the occurrence of the archaic double verbal negation *né* ... *=a(t)* which otherwise sees no use in *Háv* (probably for metrical-syntactical reasons, since *né* cannot occur at the start of a line or clause). *né* is the original Germanic negation placed directly before the verb (cf. Gothic *nī*, OE *ne*) while *=a(t)* (also *-t*) is a West Norse innovation probably originally deriving from a shortening of *vǫttr* 'wight, thing' (cf. English "not" < *n-á-wiht* 'nothing', originally *ne* + *á-wiht*). In an instance of Jespersen's cycle (whereby a strengthening adverb eventually displaces the original negative; e.g. archaic French *je ne sais* 'I do not know' > modern standard *je ne sais pas* 'id.', lit. 'I do not know a step' > modern colloquial *je sais pas* 'I don't know') ON *=a(t)* comes to be the main productive negator in poetry, whereas both older *né* and intermediate *né* ... *=a(t)* are marginalized (Jespersen [1917] 2025). For an overview of Norse negations in poetry see Sapp (2022, pp. 83–89).



4 né á grind hrękir ‘nor spit at the gate’ | The guest is presumably standing in front of the gate waiting for the farmer to open it and let him in.

136 **R**ammt es þat tré, · es **ríða** skal

[R 6v/21]

2 **q**llum at upp-loki;  
**baug** þú gef · eða þat **biðja** mun  
 4 þér **lēs** hvers á **liðu**.

Strong is that wood which shall swing  
 to open up for all.  
 Give a high or it will summon  
 every kind of guile onto thy limbs.

ALL | This stanza is rather difficult, but due to the lack of a separate refrain most likely relates to the advice in st. 135. The sense is then that a man's house (symbolised by its gate) will be strengthened by generosity, but weakened and cursed by greed and inhospitality, whether from the wrath of denied travellers or supernaturally from the anger of the gods (for which cf. *Grm* P2).

137 **R**óð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en **róð** nemir,

[R 6v/23]

2 **n**jóta munt ef **nemr**,  
 þér munu **góð** ef **getr**:  
 4 hvar's **q**l drekkir · kjós þér **jarðar** megin,  
 því't **j**róð tekr við **q**ldri, · en **q**ldr við sóttum,  
 6 **q**ik við **ab**-bindi, · **ax** við fjol-kyngi,  
**h**oll við **hý**-rógi; · **he**iptum skal Mána kvęðja,  
 8 **b**ęiti við **bit**-sóttum, · en við **b**qlvi rúnar;  
**f**old skal við **flóði** taka.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;  
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,  
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Wherever thou drinkest ale choose for thee the earth's might,  
 for earth takes against drunkenness and fire against sicknesses,  
 oak against dysentery, the ear of corn against manicunningness,  
 elder against married strife—in feuds shall one hail Moon—  
 heather against bite-sicknesses and runes against a bale;  
 earth shall be taken against flood.

6 við | 'viþið' (with corrupt abbreviation mark for -iþ-) R

ALL | This stanza gives a rare glimpse into Wiking Age folk medicine. The exact application of the listed cures is highly uncertain; is the drunk man, for example, supposed to ingest earth, rub it against his belly, or invoke the personified Earth in some way?

6 fjol-kyngi 'manicunningness' | Sorcery.

7 holl við hý-rógi ‘elder against married strife’ | Both nouns are hapax legomena. *holl* (ms. ‘*holl*’) is tentatively connected by Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon (1989, s.v. 2 *höll*) to Danish *hyld* ‘elder tree, elderberry’, New Norse *hyll* ‘id.’, OHG *boluntar* ‘id.’, although the phonology is irregular. *hý-rógi* (dat. sg. of \**hý-róg*) is transparently a cpd. of *hý-* ‘married couple, household’ (cf. *Ski* 42/n.) + *róg* ‘strife, slander’. The exact way the elderberry will help is unclear, but I see the present half-line as connecting to the following one since both deal with conflict: the former domestic, the latter violent. — CV (s.v. *baull*) consider this half-line corrupt and suggest the emendation \**við haulvi hý-rógr* ‘spurred rye (ergot of rye) against hernia’. Although interesting and closer in sense to the rest of the stanza their emendation is too conjectural to be adopted here.

7 heiptum skal Mána kveðja ‘in feuds shall one hail Moon’ | That the Moon had a certain “might” is also attested in *Vsp* 5; it is presumably for this might which he is invoked here, that he may give strength to the man in conflict. For *kveðja* ‘hail, invoke’ cf. *Lok* P4.

## 6. The Rune-Tally (138–146)

This group of stanzas is introduced by a large initial in **R**, marking the beginning of a new section. In younger paper manuscripts they have the header *Rúna-tals þátrr* ‘Strand of the Rune-Tally’.

Outside of *Háv* 138–146 (but cf. st. 80 above which would fit seamlessly into the present section) there are a few other manuscript attestations of similar Runic magic, but none of them show the unabashed heathendom of the present stanzas.

Somewhat similar poetry preserved in **R** is *Sigrdr* 36 and *Sigrdr* 5–17, although there are signs that point towards the latter being a later antiquarian composition, something sts. 138–146 are likely not.

- 138    **V**eiṛ\**k* at ek hekk · vin\*ga-meĩði à  
 2            nēṛ allar níu,  
             gēiri undaðr · ok gefinn Óðni,  
 4            sjalfr sjolfum mér,  
             à þeim meĩði, · es mann=gi veit,  
 6            hvęrs af rótum rinnr.

[R 6v/27]

I KNOW THAT I HUNG on the hanging tree  
 for all nights nine,  
 wounded by a spear and given to Weden,  
 Myself to Myself  
 on that tree where no man knows  
 of whose roots it runs.

1 **V**eiṛ\**k* | *V* has a descending initial with a height of two lines. 1 vin\*ga-meĩði ‘the hanging tree’ | ‘vinda ga meĩði’ **R**

ALL | The myth of Weden’s self-sacrifice (“the Hanging”) is told only here and nowhere else. Still, the god has a strong association with hanging throughout the Norse corpus. Weden is known by names like *Hangi* ‘Hanged One’ (*Tindr Hákr* 1/5 in SkP 1, cf. note there), *Hanga-týr* ‘Tew (i.e., god) of the Hanged’ (*Skm* 7), and *Hanga-guð* ‘God of the Hanged’ (*Gylf* 20:10), and in st. 158 below he speaks of bringing a hanged man’s corpse back to life.

The method of the sacrifice in the present st. bears remarkably close resemblance to an episode in *Gautr* 7. In exchange for good wind, king Wiker and his men, among which is Weden's protégé Starked, agree to hang one of their own number as a sacrifice to Weden. They draw lots and they fall upon king Wiker. Troubled by this they decide to honour their oaths by performing a mock hanging, and Starked, whom Weden has secretly given a spear disguised as a reed, is to carry it out. The rest is best repeated in full:

*Þar stóð fura ein hjá þeim ok stofn einn bár nér furu'nni. Neðar-liga affuru'nni stóð einn kvistr mjór ok tók í lim'it upp. Þá bjuggu þjónustu-sveinar mat manna, ok var kálfr einn skorinn ok krufðr. Starkaðr lét taka kálfs-þarma'na. Síðan steig Starkaðr upp á stofninn ok sveigði ofan þann inn mjöva kvist'inn ok knýtti þar um kálfs-þormu'num. Þá mælti Starkaðr til konungs: „Nú er hér búinn hér gálgi, konungr, ok mun sýnast eigi all-mann-bétt-ligr. Nú gakk-tu þingat, ok mun ek leggja snoru á háls þér.“ Konungr mælti: „Sé þessi um-búð ekki mér béttu-ligri en mér sýnist, þá vænti ek, at mik skaði þetta ekki, en ef öðru-vís er, þá mun auðna ráða, hvat at gerist.“ Síðan steig hann upp á stofninn, ok lagði Starkaðr virgulinn um háls honum ok steig síðan ofan af stofni'num. Þá stakk Starkaðr sprota'num á konungi ok mælti: „Nú gef ek þik Óðni.“ Þá lét Starkaðr lausan furu-kvist'inn. Reyrr-sprot'inn varð at geir, ok stóð í gegnum konung'inn. Stofninn fell undan fótum honum, en kálfs-þarmar'nir urðu at viðju sterkrí, en kvistr'inn reis upp ok hóf upp konung'inn við limar, ok dó hann þar.*

‘There stood a tall pine close to them and a tall stump next to the pine. At the lower part of the pine there was a thin branch and it curved upwards into the leafage. Then the servant-boys made food for the men and a calf was cut by its throat and opened up. Starked had the calf-intestines taken. Thereafter Starked stepped onto the stump and pulled down the thin branch and tied around it the calf-intestines. Then Starked spoke to the king: “Now a gallows is readied for thee, O king, and it will not seem of risk to any man. Now come hither and I will lay the rope onto thy neck.” The king spoke: “If this undertaking be of as little risk to me as it looks then I expect that this will not injure me, but if it is otherwise then fortune will decide what happens afterwards.” Thereafter he stepped onto the stump and Starked laid the noose around his neck and thereafter stepped down from the stump. Then Starked stabbed the reed into the king and spoke: “Now I give thee to Weden.” Then Starked let go of the pine-branch. The reed turned into a spear and it pierced through the king. The stump fell away from under his feet, but the calf-intestines became a strong withy, but the branch rose up and lifted the king up into the leafage, and there he died.’

Several motifs from the just-quoted passage are attested in other Norse sources. In *Styrb* 2 Weden gives king Eric a reed which upon the uttering of a devotional formula turns into a spear and inaugurates a large-scale human sacrifice in the form of a landslide burying an enemy host (cf. *Vsp* 23 n.); in 2 *HHund* P11 Weden lends Day his spear; in Saxo Grammaticus (2015, p. 77) 1.8.27 the Odinic king Harding ends his life by hanging himself before his people (for the Odinic nature of this sacrifice see Jens Peter Schjødt 2020a, pp. 1158, 1162, 1174–76); and in *Yng* 9 Weden marks himself with a spear on his deathbed and is followed by Nearth, who continues the practice by “marking” himself (presumably with a spear) to Weden before his own death.

With these parallels in mind it seems likely that the method of sacrifice described in the present st. has its origin in authentic pre-Christian ritual. It is only fitting that a sacrifice to Weden—even if the victim be the god himself—should be carried out in the way such sacrifices ought to be, and the past mythological actions of gods tend to serve as the basis for present human ritual (*Vsp* 7 n., *Grm* 41–43 n.). Further instances of hanging-sacrifices include Adam of Bremen (2002, p. 208) who mentions the hanging of nine men in a grove at the Temple of Upsale, and although the god to whom they are sacrificed is not named, it can only really be Weden. For discussion of the devotion of armies and war-captives to Weden, cf. *Vsp* 23 n.

Against the interpretation of a simple sacrifice, Sundqvist (2010) argues convincingly that the present stanza is the etiology behind an initiatory ritual likely used to initiate cultic leaders, so-called thyles (*þulir*) or gids (*goðar*). According to his view, the nine nights are the liminal period during which Weden is being remade, halfway between the land of the living and the land of the dead, and his deprivation represents a passage ritual. When Weden reemerges, he has become initiated: he has learned the arts of runic writing, Scaldic poetry, and blood.

1 vin\*ga-meði 'the hanging tree' | The ms. form *vindga meði* is generally understood to be a form of *vinga-meðr* 'hanging tree, gallows tree', a word found in three Scaldic stanzas (SkP: Egill Lv 14, Eyv Hál 5, Anon (*FöGT*) 17). The form *vindga*- 'windswept, windy' is most likely a folk etymological substitution for *vinga*-, which has nothing to do at all with wind but is better interpreted as 'swaying' (related to words like Swedish *vingla* 'sway, wobble', German *wanken* 'sway, stagger', cf. *Prk* 1/1 n.). This reading is further strengthened by *vindga* being in the unusual weak form rather than the expected strong dat. sg. m. \**vindgum*. The original sense of *vinga-meðr* is thus the 'tree which sways back and forth', viz. under the weight of the hanged man's body. —

The tree is probably the Ash of Ugdrassle (the World Tree), which is named after this hanging, being the "ash-tree of Ug's (Weden) gallows". The unknown origin of its roots clearly adds to the mystery of the self-sacrifice. Here we may compare with the description of the three roots of the tree in *Grm* 31, one going into the Underworld, the other into the land of the Ettins, the third into the land of Men. By hanging on the Ash while hovering between life and death, Weden was thus directly connected to the Underworld, which likely makes this episode an instance of the god's convening with the dead for wisdom (see Introduction to *Vsp*).

2 nętr allar níu 'for all nights nine' | TODO: magical number

- 139 Við hlęifi mik sόldu=τ · né við horni=gi;  
2 nýsta ek niðr, · nam'k upp rúnar,  
óþandi nam, · fell'k aptr þaðan.

[R 6v/29]

With no loaf they relieved Me, nor with any horn.  
I peered down; I took up the runes;  
screaming I took—I fell back thence.

---

1 Við hlęifi mik sόldu=τ · né við horni=gi 'With no loaf they relieved Me, nor with any horn' |  
I.e., 'I got neither bread to eat nor ale to drink.'

- 140 Fimbul-ljóð níu · nam'k af hinum fręgia syni  
2 Bólþorns, Bęstlu fǫður,  
ok ek drykk of gat · hins dýra mjaðar  
4 ausinn Óð·róri.

[R 6v/31]

Nine fible-leeds I learned from the famous son  
of Balethorn, Bestle's father—  
and a drink I got of the dear mead  
poured from Woderearer.

---

ALL | Here the poem moves away from the subject of the Hanging to the subject of how Weden learned his galders (ll. 1-2) and the art of poetry (3-4).

1 Fimbul-ljóð níu 'Nine fible-leeds' | Nine very great chants or spells (galders); compare the eighteen (9 times 2) leeds in *Háv* 147-165 below.

1–2 hinum frégja syni / Bólþorn, Bestlu föður ‘the famous son of Balethorn, Bestle’s father’ | According to *Gylf* 6:9–10: *Hann fékk þeirrar konu, er Bestla hét, dóttir Bólþorns jötuns, ok fengu þau þrjá sonu; hét einn Óðinn, annarr Vili, þriði Vē. ‘He [= Byre] got to wife the woman called Bestle, the daughter of the ettin Balethorn, and they had three sons. One was called Weden, the other Will, the third Wigh.’* This passage makes Balethorn’s son Weden’s maternal uncle and the present stanza is thus an example of the old Germanic custom of sending sons away to be fostered by the mother’s male relations. This custom, not uncommon in the later saws, is attested already by Tacitus, *Germania* 20: *Sorum filiis idem apud avunculum qui ad patrem honor. Quidam sanctiorem artioremque hunc nexum sanguinis arbitrantur et in accipiendis obsidibus magis exigunt, tamquam et animum firmitus et domum latius teneant.* ‘The sons of sisters are held in the same esteem by their maternal uncle as by their father. Some even consider this bond of blood to be more sacred and more binding, and prefer to demand nephews when taking hostages, reasoning that they secure a firmer hold on the mind and a wider hold on the family.’

141 Þá nam’k fréva=sk · ok fróðr vesa  
2 ok vaxa ok vęl hafa=sk;  
orð mér af orði · orðs leitaði  
4 verk mér af verki · verks leitaði.

[R 6v/33]

Then I began to flourish and be wise,  
and grow and have it well.

Word from word provided Me a word;  
work from work provided Me a work.

---

ALL | There is something reminiscent of the Aristotelian εὐδαιμονία in the whole stanza. After Weden attained his wisdom he flourished; his good speeches and deeds multiplied.

1 nam’k fréva=sk ‘I began to flourish’ | *fréva=sk* is a reflexive verb derived from *fré* ‘seed (of plants)’.

142 Rúnar munt finna · ok ráðna stafi,  
2 mjök stóra stafi,  
mjök stinna stafi,  
4 es fáði Fimbulþulr  
ok gørðu ginn-regin  
6 ok ręist Hroptr ragna.

[R 6v/35]

Runes wilt thou find and interpreted staves,  
very great staves,  
very stiff staves,  
which the Fimblethyle painted,  
and the Yin-Reins made,  
and Roft of the Reins (= Weden) carved.

---

6 ragna ‘of the Reins’ | ‘ręgna’ R

---

1 Rúnar munt finna · ok ráðna stafi ‘Runes wilt thou find and interpreted staves’ | A close parallel is found in the long-line on the mediæval runestone N 13: *rúnar ek rist · ok ráðna stafi* ‘runes I carve and interpreted staves.’

143 Óðinn með ǫsum, · en fyr ǫlfum Dáinn,

[R 7r/2]

2 Dvalinn dvergum fyrir,

Ásviðr jǫtnum fyrir,

4 ek reist sjalfr sumar.

Weden among the Eese but Doven for the Elves,  
Dwollen for the Dwarfs,  
Oswith for the Ettins;  
I myself carved some.

---

4 ek 'I' | The identity of the speaker is unclear, but, judging by line 1, it is apparently not Weden.

144 Veitst, hvé rísta skal? · Veitst, hvé ráða skal?

[R 7r/3]

2 Veitst, hvé fāa skal? · Veitst, hvé fręista skal?

Veitst, hvé biðja skal? · Veitst, hvé blóta skal?

4 Veitst, hvé sęnda skal? · Veitst, hvé sōa skal?

Knowest thou how one shall carve? Knowest thou how one shall read?  
Knowest thou how one shall paint? Knowest thou how one shall try?  
Knowest thou how one shall ask? Knowest thou how one shall bloot?  
Knowest thou how one shall send? Knowest thou how one shall waste?

---

ALL | The first four verbs refer to runes: carving, interpreting, colouring, and divining, the latter four to sacrifice: praying, worshipping, sending (the sacrifice or the prayer), and slaying (the victim). — The structure of the stanza bears some resemblance to the Högstena galder (Vg 216, edited under Galders).

4 sōa 'waste' | I.e., kill the victim, as was done through stunning and decapitation (*Vǫlþ* 21/4 n.) This rare verb is never used in prose, and outside of *Háv* only in a single other poem, *Yt*, in st. 5 in the context of human sacrifice, and in st. 18 about the ambush of a king.

145 Bętra 's ǫ·beðit · an sēi of·blótit,

[R 7r/5]

2 ęy sér til gildis gjǫf;

bętra 's ǫ·sęnt · an sēi of·sóit;

4 [...]

It is better unasked than over-blooded;  
a gift always looks for recompense.

It is better unsent than over-wasted;  
[...]

---

ALL | An identical progression of four verbs suggests a close relation with the previous st. I agree with Males (2024b) on the interpretation of this stanza: since a gift always requires recompense, an excessive sacrifice imposes an excessive debt on the part of the god to whom it is addressed, which might upset the sacrificer's relationship with the god. Males draws an analogy to an episode in *Eg* 78, where a rival poet leaves an expensive shield for the protagonist Eyel before riding off; the latter understands this as a demand to compose a poem about the shield and is greatly insulted.

The gift cycle between Gods and Men, of which the present st. is a Germanic attestation, is a very important concept in Indo-European pagan religions. The idea that sacrifices create (moral, if not legal) contractual obligations for recompense is prevalent in the Roman religion and summarized by the ritual concept *dō ut dēs* ‘I give that thou might give’ (Rüpke 2007, pp. 102, 149). A similar expression is found in an OI sacrificial prayer (*Taittiriya Samhitā* 1.8.4.1, during the *Rāja-siṣya* or consecration of a king): *Dēbī mē, dādāmi tē; nī mē dādēbī, nī tē dadēbī; nī-bāram in nī mē barā, nī-bāram* ‘Give to me, I give to thee; bestow upon me, I bestow upon thee; bring gain indeed to me, [I bring] gain [to thee]’.

4 [...] | No gap is indicated in the ms., but the meter requires a c-verse in this position. Its loss is most unfortunate since the pres. st. is an unusual look into pre-Christian religious attitudes.

146 Svá Þundr of reġst · fyr þjóða røk,  
2 þar's upp of reġs, · es aþtr of kom.

[R 7r/7]

So Thound (= Weden) carved before the histories of the nations  
where he rose up when he came back.

ALL | This stanza is obscure and the section to which it belongs is unclear; *svá* ‘so, thus’ may be referring back to the preceding sts. or to the ones ahead. Regardless of which section it is referring to, it describes its contents as the verses Weden wrote down immediately after learning the runes during the Hanging (sts. 138–139 above) and places this at a time long predating human history.

1 Þundr ‘Thound’ | A common poetic name for Weden with an opaque etymology, unrelated to English “Thunder” (which in fact corresponds to ON *Þorr*). Based on the genitive *Þundar* it must be an *i*- or an *u*-stem (< PGmc. *\*Þundiz* or *\*Þunduz*). I find the most promising etymology to be a derivative of the IE root *\*ten-* ‘stretch, extend’ (surviving in the causative as ON *þenja* ‘to stretch’) extended with *-d-* (cf. Latin *tendō* ‘to stretch’). A direct cognate for *\*Þunduz* is obtained in Lithuanian *tandūs* ‘lazy, sloppy’ < *\*ténd-u-s* ~ *\*tūd-ēw-s*, with Germanic regularizing the oblique zero-grade stem to all cases (for which cf. e.g. PGmc. *\*burþiz* ~ *\*burþiz* ‘birth’ < PIE *\*bʰértis* ~ *\*bʰrétēs*). The sense of the name would thus be ‘stretched’, probably referring to his neck during the Hanging.

## 7. The Leed-Tally (147–165)

The final section of *Háv*, the so-called the Leed-Tally (*Ljóða-tal*), is not separated from the preceding Rune-Tally but is usually taken as separate since it is a self-contained list not much concerned with runes. The speaker, certainly Weden, once again addresses Loddfathomer and lists eighteen galders.

The spells themselves are not given, but only their purpose. They are arisocratic and Odinic in character and deal with such things as battle (galders 3, 4, 5, 8, 11, 13), healing (1, 2, 12), countering sorcery (6, 10), controlling the elements (7, 9), and seduction (16, 17). The 18th and last spell is a mystery; not even its purpose is told, and it is known only by Weden and the women closest to him.

Uniquely in this section we find Weden as a healer—a side of the god which is otherwise largely absent from the Old Norse literary corpus, where he rather chiefly takes on the role of War-God. On the other hand this aligns well with the god's appearance in West Germanic healing charms like the English *Nuyrt* 11 and the High German *Mers II*. Still we need not look in vain for West Germanic influence in the present section; this difference of

character is most likely simply a matter of which genres of texts have survived from the different regions of the Germanic religious sphere.

Several of the numbered galders are reminiscent of other known Germanic spells. The fourth (st. 150) bears a strong likeness to *Gr̥g* 10, and its effect (removing fetters) is shared with the High German *Mers I*, ostensibly an actual galder of that type (but cf. the Introduction there). The mysterious eighteenth spell (st. 165) finds an interesting numerological parallel in the unknowable eighteenth question posed by Weden in *Vafþ* 54.

147 Ljóð þau kann'k, · es kann=at þjóðans kona [R 7r/8]

2 ok manns=kis mōgr.

Hjǫlp hēitir ęitt, · þat þér hjalpa mun

4 við sorgum ok sōkum, · ok sútum gǫrv-ǫllum.

Those leeds I know which the king's wife knows not,  
and no man's lad.

Help is one called; it will help thee  
against sorrows and suits and all griefs entire.

148 Þat kann'k annat, · es þurfu ýta synir, [R 7r/10]

2 þęir's vilja lęknar lifa.

This I know second, which those sons of men need  
who wish to live as leechers.

---

1 þurfu ýta synir 'those sons of men need' | Cf. the similar wording in 166/2.

2 lęknar 'leechers' | Physicians. A relation to 'leech' is likely but the direction of influence is unclear (Kroonen 2013, p. 331); the physicians may be named after the tool of their trade (leeches, for bloodletting), or the leeches named after the physicians.

149 Þat kann'k þriðja, · ef mér verðr þǫrf mikil [R 7r/11]

2 hapti við mína hęipt-mōgu,

ęggjar dęyf'k · mǫnna and-skota,

4 bíta=t þęim vǫpn né vęlir.

This I know third, if I come in great need  
of hindrance against my feud-lads [FOES]:

I dull the blades of my enemies;  
for them bite not weapons nor staffs.

---

4 vęlir 'staffs' | Plural of *vǫlr*, here referring to the magic staff or sceptre used by witches and warlocks; the word *vǫlva* 'wallow' (seeress, prophetess) is probably derived from this word. The reading *vęlir* 'wiles, tricks, decepts' must be excluded for metrical reasons, since a c-verse in Leeds-meter cannot end in a trochée.

150 Þat kann'k fjórða, · ef mér fyrðar bera [R 7r/13]



2                   bõnd at bóg-limum,  
svá ek gæl, · at ganga má'k,  
4                   sprettr mér af fótum fjoturr,  
                    en af hõndum hapt.

This I know fourth, if men bear  
bonds onto my shoulder-limbs [ARMS]:  
so do I gale that I may walk;  
springs from my feet the fetter,  
and from my hands the bond.

---

ALL | Cf. *Grg* 10, which is very similar to the present stanza, and *Mers I* (edited below under Galders), a galder that seems actually to have been used for loosening fetters.

151       Þat kann'k fimta, · ef sé'k af fari skotinn  
2                   flein í folki vaða,  
                    flýgr=a svá stint, · at stqðvi'g=a'k,  
4                   ef hann sjõnum of sé'k.

[R 7r/15]

This I know fifth, if I see a dangerously shot  
arrow in the troop wading:  
it flies not so stiff that I cannot stop it  
if I see it in my sights.

152       Þat kann'k sétta, · ef mik sérir þegn  
2                   à rótum rás viðar,  
                    þann hal, · es mik hęipta kveðr,  
4                   þann eta męin hęldr an mik.

[R 7r/16]

This I know sixth, if athane wounds me  
on the roots of a sappy tree:  
that man who sings hatred against me—  
him the harms hurt instead of me.

---

3 þann hal 'that man' | ok þann hal 'and that man' R

---

1–2 ef mik sérir þegn à rótum rás viðar 'if athane wounds me on the roots of a sappy tree' | I.e., "if a man carves a runic curse against me".

2 à rótum rás | The alliteration of this line is problematic since the normal form of the adj. *rár* is *brár* (so *Ski* 32), but the required alliteration with *rótum* makes that an impossibility. Another alternative is to emend \*v- in \*vrótum for a line \*\*à vrótum brás viðar. The emendation relies on an etymological relation between ON *rót* and OE *wyr*t, but as Kroonen (2013, pp. 597, 601) points out *rót* has an initial r- even in East Nordic which otherwise consistently preserves old vr-. This circumstance calls the existence of an early West Nordic form \*vrót into question. Furthermore *rót* alliterates with r- in st. 138 above.

2 rás 'sappy' | The sappy wood was apparently of importance for the curse; cf. the curious account of *Gr* 79, where a hag curses Grettir in the following way: after finding a small tree and planing a small smooth surface onto a scorched side of it, she carves runes in its roots and reddens them with her own blood. She then chants galders while walking counter-clockwise around it. Lastly she pushes it out to sea, praying for it to drift to Grettir's homestead and curse him. Cf. also *Ski* 32 where Shirner goes to a *brár víðr* 'sappy tree' to get a certain magic stick.

4 eta 'hurt' | Properly 'eat', but the verb here means 'consume' in an injurious sense. The import is, of course, that the enemy's own curses turn on him and consume him.

- 153 Þat kann'k sjaunda, · ef sé'k hōvan loga [R 7r/18]  
 2 sal of sess-mōgum,  
 brinnr=at svá brēitt, · at hōnum bjargi'g=a'k;  
 4 þann kann'k galdr at gala.

This I know seventh, if I see a high hall  
 blazing over seat-lads [WARRIORS]:  
 it burns not so broadly that I cannot save it—  
 that galder I can gale.

1 loga 'blazing' | The syntax of l. 1 alone makes this word look like the acc. of the m. noun *logi* 'flame' (i.e., "if I see a high flame"), but the noun modified by the m. acc. sg. adj. *hōvan* 'high' is in fact *sal* 'hall' in l. 2, and *loga* must thus be the verb 'blaze, burn'.

4 galdr 'galder' | The use of this word reveals the synonymy of *galdr* 'galder' and *ljóð* 'leed'.

- 154 Þat kann'k átta, · es qllum es [R 7r/20]  
 2 nyt-sam=ligt at nēma,  
 hvar's hatr vęx · með hildings sonum,  
 4 þat má'k bóta brátt.

This I know eighth, which for all men is  
 useful to learn:  
 wherever hatred grows among the sons of a prince,  
 it I may shortly mend.

3 hatr 'hatred' | Viz., over their father's inheritance. As any reader of European history will know, such conflicts were a constant source of war and kinslaying, both in the mediæval Germanic-founded kingdoms and in the Roman Empire that went before them.

- 155 Þat kann'k níunda, · ef mik nauðr of stęndr [R 7r/22]  
 2 at bjarga fari mīnu à floti,  
 vind ek kyrrí · vági à  
 4 ok svéfi'k allan sé.

This I know ninth, if I come in need  
 of saving my ship as it floats:  
 the wind I calm upon the wave,  
 and put all the sea asleep.

156 Þat kann'k tǫunda, · ef sé'k tǫn-riður

2 leika lopti á,  
ek svá vinn'k, · at þér villar fara  
4 sinna heim-hama  
sinna heim-huga.

This I know tenth, if I see fence-rideresses  
playing aloft:

I work it so that they go astray  
of their home-hames,  
of their home-minds.

3 þér villar fara 'they (f) go astray (f)' | *gramm. emend.*; þeir villir fara 'they (m.) go astray (m.)'  
R

ALL | The stanza requires explanation. To begin with, the *tǫn-riður* 'fence-rideresses' are generally understood to be shape-shifting witches who have detached from their bodies and are now flying around tormenting the people (Wallenstein 2019, p. 398). This concept has anthropological parallels in the idea of the "soul-flight", found in Saami, Siberian, and Native American religions and in later Scandinavian folklore (Wallenstein 2019, pp. 400–404).

The Old Norse conception of soul-flight, also found in sources outside of *Háv* (e.g., *Historia Norvegiæ*), was as follows: the witches were thought able to *ham-bleypa* 'hame-leap', i.e., to leave their original (human) *hamir* 'hames' or 'skins'. This was called a *gandr-reið* 'gand-ride', during which they would torment and injure the folk; the *gandr* 'gand' was the familiar spirit with which they would be joined when riding. When the witches were out riding their human bodies (or hames) would be lying unconscious and vulnerable; they would also retain that part of the human soul which was thought inextricably linked to the hame: the *hugr* 'mind, seat of emotions'. That the hame was not merely dead "skin" is shown by a notable passage in *Völur* 8, wherein the heroes Sigmund and Sinfjötill find two wolf-hames, and, upon donning them, learn the speech of wolves, becoming blood-thirsty and ravenous.

A vivid description of the witches' ride, frequently compared with the present stanza, is found in the OSwe. Elder West-Geatish Law (ca. 1250 AD), RB 5:5: *Þetta eru ú-kvæðins-orð konu. „Iak sá, at þú ræt á kví-grindu lós-hárað ok í trolls ham, þá allt var iam-ript nátt ok dagr.“ Kallar bana kunnra firi-gera konu ellr kó, þet er ú-kvæðins-orð. [...] (Collin and Schlyter 1827, p. 38, my norm.)* 'These are the words of insult to a woman: "I saw that thou rodest on the sheep-pen-fence loose-haired and in a troll's hame when everything was equally divided between day and night." If he says that she knows how to destroy (with magic) a woman or a cow, that is a word of insult.' It may be noted that the ms. word *quiggrindu* 'sheep-pen-fence' (dat. sg.) has also been interpreted as *kvíð-grindu* 'womb-opening', i.e., the woman's (bared) nether parts, with a likely sexual implication (Sjöros 1919, pp. 224–228).

A persistent danger in any soul-flight is the "soul-loss". The flying soul (or parts of it) may be unable to return to its original body (whether by going astray or by being actively prevented from it by another magician) and this will cause pain and madness, and eventually the death of the witch or wizard (Wallenstein 2019, pp. 400–404). It is surely in this way we should read the present stanza, and here I agree with Wallenstein (2019, p. 406). With his unrivalled skill as a magician, Woden could see the rideresses. With his galder, he would prevent them from returning to their original hames or minds, eventually annihilating them. Woden brags elsewhere about doing this in *Hárð* 20, and this also mirrors his role as troll- and witch-hunter in the Wild Hunt of later folklore (TODO: cite Grimm). Since the noun *riða* on its own means 'fever, chills' (Fr, s.v. *riða*), we are also seeing Woden in his role as supernatural healer.

1 tǫn-riður 'fence-rideresses' | The sense of *tǫn* (cognate with English "town") is most likely 'hedged plot, courtyard', which perhaps allows us to connect it to the witch's riding on the *kví-grindu* 'sheep-pen-fence' in the Elder West-Geatish Law (see note to ALL). Numerous cpds. exist with the same second element, e.g. *kveld-riður* 'evening-rideresses' (*HHJ* 15/4) and *myrk-riður* 'dark-rideresses' (*Hárð* 20).

- 157 Þat kann'k **ę**llipta, · ef skal'k til orrostu [R 7r/25]  
 2 **lęiða** lang-vini,  
 und **r**andir **ę**l'k, · ęn þęir með **r**íki fara,  
 4 **hęilir** hildar til,  
**hęilir** hildi frá,  
 6 koma þęir **hęilir** hvaðan.

This I know eleventh, if I shall into the fray  
 lead old friends:  
 beneath the shield-rims I gale, and they go with power  
 hale to the battle,  
 hale from the battle;  
 they come hale anywhence.

---

2 lang-vini 'old friends' | Lit., 'long-friends'. In Germanic paganism the followers and protégés of a god are his friends (*vinir*). Already in *Beow* we see that the Shieldings are called the *Ing-wine* 'friends of Ing', and in *Hym* 11 Thunder is called the *vinr ver-liða* 'friend of manly retainers'. Two other places where it is used of Woden's followers in particular are *Grm* 54 and *Sont* 22, where Egel speaks about his friendship (*vin-átt*) with Woden.

- 158 Þat kann'k **t**olpta, · ef sé'k á **tré** uppi [R 7r/27]  
 2 **váfa** virgil-ná,  
 svá ek **r**íst · ok í **r**únum fá'k,  
 4 at sá **ę**ęngr **ę**umi.  
 ok **mę**lir við **m**ik.

This I know twelfth, if I see in a tree up high  
 sway a gallow-corpse:  
 so I carve and paint in the runes,  
 that that man walks  
 and speaks with me.

- 159 Þat kann'k þrét-tándá · ef skal'k þęgn ungan [R 7r/29]  
 2 **verpa** vatni á,  
 mun=at hann **f**alla · þó'tt í **f**olk komi,  
 4 **hn**ígr=a sá **h**alr fyr **h**jörum.

This I know thirteenth, if on a young thane  
 I shall sprinkle water:  
 he will not fall though he come into battle;  
 that hero will not sink before swords.

---

1–2 ef skal'k þęgn ungan verpa vatni á 'if on a young thane I shall sprinkle water' | A reference to the Heathen name-giving ceremony in which the infant would be sprinkled with water; cf. the attestations in *Rþ* 7, 22, 35.

- 160 Þat kann'k fjór-tánda, · ef skal'k fyrða liði [R 7r/31]  
 2 tēlja tíva fyr,  
 ása ok alfa · ek kann allra skil,  
 4 fār kann ð·snotr svá.

This I know fourteenth, if before the troop of men  
 I shall count forth the Tews:  
 of all Eese and Elves I know the distinctions;  
 few unwise men can do so.

3 skil 'distinctions' | Their unique attributes. Cf. *Hym* 38, where the corresponding verb *skilja* 'to discern, understand' likewise is used in the context of god-lore.

- 161 Þat kann'k fimm-tánda, · es gól Þjóð-rórir [R 7r/33]  
 2 dvergr fyr Dēllings durum,  
 afl gól ðsum, · en ølfum frama,  
 4 hyggju Hropta-tý.

This I know fifteenth, which Thedrearer galed,  
 the dwarf, before Delling's doors.  
 Strength he galed for the Eese, but fame for the Elves,  
 thought for Tew of the Rofts (= Weden).

4 Hropta-tý 'Tew of the Rofts (= Weden)' | The older dative *-tívi* (*Haustl* 8/1a, *Þdr* 20/3a) is not allowed for metrical reasons as a Leeds-meter c-verse cannot end in a long syllable followed by another syllable.

- 162 Þat kann'k sex-tánda, · ef vil'k hins svinna mans [R 7r/35]  
 2 hafa gēð allt ok gaman,  
 hugi hvrfr'k · hvit-armri konu  
 4 ok sný'k hennar øllum sefa.

This I know sixteenth, if from the wise girl I will  
 have her senses all, and pleasure:  
 I change the heart of the white-armed woman,  
 and I twist her whole mind.

- 163 Þat kann'k sjau-tjánda · at mik sēint mun firra=sk [R 7v/2]  
 2 hit man-unga man.

This I know seventeenth, that I will late be shunned,  
 by that girl-young girl.

- 164 Ljóða þessa · munt Lodd-fáfnir [R 7v/2]  
 2 lēngi vanr vesa;

þó séi þér góð ef getr,  
 4 nýt ef nemr,  
 þorð ef þiggr.

These leeds wilt thou, Loddfathomer,  
 long be lacking!  
 Though they might be good for thee if thou gettest,  
 profitable if thou learnest,  
 needful if thou takest.

---

ALL | A parathetical statement, but there is no reason why it should not be authorial. It precedes the final, unknowable spell.

165 Þat kann'k át-tjanda, · es éva kenni'k  
 2 meḡ né manns konu,  
 —allt es þetra · es einn of kann,  
 4 þat fylgir ljóða lokum—  
 nema þeiri einni, · es mik armi verr,  
 6 eða mín systir séi.

[R 7v/4]

This I know eighteenth, which I will never teach  
 a maiden nor man's woman,  
 (everything is better which one alone knows;  
 that follows the last of the leeds!)  
 save her alone who holds me in her arms,  
 or is my sister.

---

5 mik armi verr 'holds me in her arms' | A similar expression is also used *Vkv* 2. The one who wraps Weden in her arm may be his wife, Fric.

166 Nú eru Hóva mól kveðin · Hóva hollu í;  
 2 all-þorð ýta sonum,  
 ó-þorð jötna sonum;  
 4 heill sá's kvað, · heill sá's kann,  
 njóti sá's nam,  
 6 heilir þeir's hlýddu.

[R 7v/7]

Now are the High One's speeches sung in the High One's hall,  
 most useful for the sons of men,  
 harmful for the sons of ettins.  
 Hail him who sang! Hail him who knows!  
 May he profit who learned!  
 Hail those who heeded!

---

3 jötna 'ettins' | *corr. by other hand from ýta 'men'* R

---

ALL | This stanza is of great weight since it gives the whole poem a religious significance. The memorisation and recitation of the whole of *Háv* will both spiritually benefit mankind and injure the Ettins, the enemies of Gods and men; this dualistic worldview (Ettins=evil=wilderness against Gods=humans=settlement) is thoroughly pre-Christian. Cf. further Introduction to the whole poem above.

4–6 kvað, kann, nam, hlýddu ‘sang, knows, learned, heeded’ | The implicit object is the speeches. These verbs all indicate a fully oral cultural context.





# Speeches of Webthrithner

## (*Vafþrúðnis mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.894)

Meter: Leeds-meter

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Webthrithner** (abbrev. *Vafþ*) describes a wisdom-contest between the god Weden and the ettin Webthrithner.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Vafþ* is preserved in full only in **R** (foll. 7v/9–8v/31), where it follows *Háv* and is followed by *Grm*. The latter part of the poem, from st. 20 onwards, is also preserved in **A** (fol. 3r/1–3v/22). Since the beginning of the poem has been lost in **A**, we cannot tell what text preceded it, but, as in **R**, it is followed by *Grm*.

*Vafþ* was clearly available to Snorre. Sts. 18, 30–31, 35, 37, 41, 45, 47, and 51 are cited in *Gylf*, and the lost form of the poem underlying *Gylf* may be called the **G** redaction. In the critical edition, **G** will refer to agreement between all four mss. of *Gylf* (**STWU**). It may be noted that st. 31 has lost its second helming (ll. 3–4) in both **R** and **A**, which points towards a shared textual relationship between **RA** to the exclusion of **G**.

### Meter and stanza

*Vafþ* is composed in Leeds-meter and consists of 55 stanzas. Four lines may be considered defective and are irrestorable without conjectural emendation: 5/3, 34/1, 38/3 (see below), and 54/3. In addition, st. 40 is heavily emended.

The normal stanzaic configuration *abc abc* appears in 50 out of 55 sts. (1–26, 28–37, 39–41, 44–54). The singular configuration *abc* (27; see note) in the middle of the question-and-answer stanzas should undoubtedly be considered a defective variant of this configuration.

Four variant configurations are found. *abc abcc* (42) and *abcc abc* (43) are both variants of *abc abc*. They appear at an important transition in the poem, as Weden asks his last numbered question, introducing his final six questions about the end times. *abc abc abc* (55) only appears once, likewise at a charged location, namely in the final st., as Webthriðrinnr admits defeat.

A stranger variant is *abc ab abc* (38). This configuration may be taken as a mixing of Leeds-meter and Speeches-meter, but it is also possible that a c-verse has been lost following the central long-line *ab*. The fact that the long-line does not alliterate further hints at potential corruption, but it is clearly semantically crucial and cannot be removed from the stanza.

### Narrative structure

The poem essentially consists of a riddle contest between the god Weden and the ettin Webthriðrinnr. Far from being a loose collection of mythic lore, it has a tight structure and logical plan throughout. The whole may be divided into four sections: the first is the prologue, where Weden takes counsel from his wife Frie and sets out for Webthriðrinnr's hall (sts. 1–10). The remaining three sections form the contest and consist of alternating stanzas where one side asks and the other answers. They are distinguished from each other by means of repeated refrains in the question stanzas and consist of Webthriðrinnr's four unnumbered questions (11–19), Weden's twelve numbered questions (20–43), and Weden's six unnumbered questions about the end times (44–55).

The following table illustrates the refrains; for stanza 40 see note there:

|       |                                                                            |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11–17 | <i>Seg mér/þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill / þíns of fręista frama</i> |
| 20–42 | <i>Seg þat (it) N(:a) · ... / ... Vafþrúðnir vitir</i>                     |
| 44–54 | <i>Fjölð ek fór, · fjölð fręistaða'k, / fjölð of ręynda'k ręgin</i>        |

Something ought to be said about the numerology of the questions. It is hardly a coincidence that Weden asks exactly eighteen questions, this being a multiple of the sacred number nine. It is especially notable that another Odinic list, Leed-tally (sts. 147–165) of *Háv*, also has eighteen items—even more so, since the eighteenth spell there, like the eighteenth question here, is a mystery known only to Weden himself. This circumstance reveals the care put into the structure of *Vafþ.*

### Summary

The first scene of the poem assumes that the god Weden and his wife, Frie, are sitting together. Weden asks Frie for counsel, as he is curious about the ancient wisdom which the ettin Webthriðrinnr might possess (1). Frie expresses worry, since she considers Webthriðrinnr stronger than all other ettins (2), but Weden says that he has travelled far and wide and wants to know what Webthriðrinnr's hall is like (3). Frie wishes him good luck against the ettin (4), and he departs to challenge Webthriðrinnr's *orð-spęki* 'word-wisdom' (5). The god arrives at the ettin's hall and introduces himself (6);

Webthritner promptly declares that his guest will not come out of the hall unless he be wiser than he (7). Weden introduces himself as Gangred, saying that he has come from afar in need of Webthritner's hospitality (8). The ettin invites this Gangred to sit down (9), and the guest in turn utters a gnomic stanza (10) not unlike those of the first section of *Háv.*

Webthritner begins by asking four mythological questions, each answered by Gangred in turn. The questions concern the horse that pulls the day (11–12), the horse that pulls the night (13–14), the river which divides the gods and ettins (15–16), and the plain where Surt and the gods will fight (17–18).

Webthritner calls the guest learned and invites him to sit. He declares that the loser of the contest must give his head (19). The roles are now reversed, and Gangred poses twelve numbered questions to the ettin. The questions can be divided into three groups of four based on their subjects. Gangred first asks about the origins of cosmological phenomena: the earth and heaven (20–21), sun and moon (22–23), day and night (24–25), and winter and summer (26–27). His next four questions concern the earliest ettins: the ettin Earyelmer (28–29), Earyelmer's ancestry (30–31), how he reproduced without a partner (32–33), and what Webthritner himself first remembers (34–35). The last four numbered questions are more sundry. Weden asks about the origin of the wind (36–37) and the god Nearth (38–39), about Walhall and the Oneharriers (40–41), and at last a meta-question: where Webthritner learned such great wisdom (42–43).

The refrain and theme of the questions now change, as Gangred asks six unnumbered questions concerning the end times, all beginning with the same refrain. The disguised god asks which humans will survive the Fimblewinter (44–45), how the sun can rise after Fenner has destroyed it (46–47), about some obscure maidens (48–49; see note), which Eese will survive after the flame of Surt goes out (50–51), and how Weden will die (52–53). Finally, he asks the unknowable question: what did Weden speak in the ear of Balder before he was burned on the pyre (54)?

Webthritner at last understands the identity of his challenger, since only Weden himself could know the answer to that question. He laconically accepts his imminent death and the futility of his own wisdom; the poem ends with his admission that Weden will always be the wisest (55).

## Dating

*Vafþ* displays archaic formal characteristics. The poem has an especially high frequency of the archaic particle *of*, appearing at a rate of 0.438 occurrences per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70). In addition, it displays alliteration between *v*- and old *vr*- (st. 53/2; Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 37), a highly archaic trait indicative of composition before ca. 1000 AD. The pre-Christian subject matter, which shows no sign of antiquarian composition, and which was likely not fully understood even by Snorre (see st. 35), also suggests an early date. In conclusion, *Vafþ* was likely composed in the 9th or 10th century—at any rate during the pre-Christian period.

## Text

## Vafþrúðnis mól ('The Speeches of Webthriðner')

[Óðinn:] 1 „Ráð mér nú Frigg · alls mik fara tíðir [R 7v/9]  
 2 at vitja Vafþrúðnis;  
 for-vitni mikla · kveð’k mér á fornum stöfum  
 4 við þann inn al-svinna jötun.“

[Weden:] “COUNSEL ME NOW, FRIE, as I long to journey  
 to visit Webthriðner.  
 Great curiosity I have for the ancient staves  
 of that all-wise ettin.”

3–4 for-vitni ... jötun. ‘Great ... ettin.’ | I.e., “I am very curious to learn his ancient words of wisdom.” Cf. st. 55.

[Frigg:] 2 „Hęima lętja · mynda’k Hęrja-fęðr [R 7v/12]  
 2 í gęrðum gęða;  
 því’t ęngi jętun · hugða’k jafn-ramman  
 4 sęm Vafþrúðni vesa.“

[Frie:] “At home would I keep the Father of Hosts  
 in the yards of the Gods,  
 for no ettin have I judged to be  
 as strong as Webthriðner.”

1 Hęrja-fęðr ‘Father of Hosts’ | A name for Weden. For the second element, see *Vsp* 1/3 n.

[Óðinn:] 3 „Fjølð ek fęr, · fjølð fręistaða’k, [R 7v/13]  
 2 fjølð of ręynda’k ręgin;  
 hitt vil’k vita, · hvę Vafþrúðnis  
 4 sala-kynni sęi.“

[Weden:] “Much I journeyed, much I tried,  
 much I tested the Reins!  
 One more thing I wish to know: how Webthriðner’s  
 halls may be.”

2 of | emend. (cf. st. 44/2); om. R

[Frigg:] 4 „Hęill þú farir, · hęill þú aprtr komir, [R 7v/15]  
 2 hęill þú á sinnum sęir;  
 óði þęr dugi · hvar’s skalt, Alda-fęðr,

4 orðum mēla jōtun.“

[Frie:] “Hale mayst thou journey; hale mayst thou come back;  
hale mayst thou be on thy paths!  
May thy wisdom avail thee where thou, Father of Mankind,  
with words shalt greet the ettin!”

---

3 skalt | *add.* †or† R

---

3 Alda-fǫðr ‘Father of Mankind’ | A rare poetic name for Weden, also found in st. 53/1, but not otherwise used in Eddic poetry. Among genuine compositions, the name is only found elsewhere in the Scaldic Bragi *Þórr* 1/1 (in SkP 3), although it also appears in an antiquarian poetic list of names for Weden, *Þul Óðins* 1/2 (in SkP 3).

5 Fór þá Óðinn · at fręista orð-spęki

[R 7v/17]

2 þęss ins al-svinna jōtuns;  
at hǫllu hann kom, · es átti ĩms faðir;  
4 inn gekk Yggr þegar.

Then journeyed Weden to test the word-wisdom  
of that all-wise ettin.  
He came to the hall which Ime’s father [= Webthrithner] owned;  
Ug (= Weden) went soon inside.

---

3 es | *emend.*; ok R

---

3 ĩms ‘Ime’s’ | Gen. sg. of *ĩmr*, an unknown ettin. The name is probably corrupt, since alliteration on *b-* is required by the strongly stressed *hǫllu* in the a-verse. Finnur Jónsson (1932) emends to *Hymis* ‘Hymer’s’.

4 Yggr ‘Ug’ | ‘The Terrorifer’, another name for Weden.

[Óðinn:] 6 „Hęill þú nú, Vafþrúðnir, · nú em’k ĩ hǫll kominn

[R 7v/18]

2 á þik sjalfan sęa;  
hitt vil’k fyrst vita, · ef fróðr sęir  
4 eða al-sviðr, jōtunn.“

[Weden:] “Hale be thou now, Webthrithner! Now I am come into the hall  
to see thy very self,  
yet I wish first to know if thou be learned  
or all-wise, ettin!”

[Vafþrúðnir:] 7 „Hvat ’s þat manna, · es ĩ mĳnum sal

[R 7v/20]

2 verp=umk orði á?  
út þú né kęmr · örum hǫllum frá,  
4 nema þú inn snotrari sęir.“

[Webthritner:] “What sort of man is this who in *my* hall  
throws his word at me?  
Out wilt thou not come from our halls  
unless thou be the cleverer man!”

[Óðinn:] 8 „*Gang-ráðr* heiti’k, · nú em’k af *gongu* kominn,  
2 þyrstr til þínna sala;  
laðar þurfi · hef’k lengi farit  
4 ok þínna and-fanga, jøtunn.“

[R 7v/22]

[Weden:] “Gangred I am called; now I am come from walking,  
thirsty, to thy halls.  
In need of a welcome I’ve journeyed for long,  
and of thy reception, ettin!”

---

1 *Gang-ráðr* | *Gagn-ráðr* R

---

1 *Gang-ráðr* | ‘One who decides to walk’. The emendation is supported by the b-verse, where *gongu* (dat. sg. of *ganga* ‘walking, walk’) is probably tying back to the name. *Gang-ráðr* is also found in *Þul Óðins* 3/1 (SkP 3, Gurevich ed.). The variant *Gagn-ráðr* would mean ‘Victory-advisor’ and is not attested elsewhere. Note that Gurevich is incorrect when she states in her note to *Þul Óðins* 3/1 that *Gylf* 5:12 records the variant *Gagn-ráðr*. The relevant source mss., ST, only have the abbreviation *Þá spurði G.* ‘Then G. asked’, which clearly does not point one way or the other.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 9 „Hví þú þá, *Gang-ráðr*, · mēli=sk af *golfi* fyrir?  
2 far þú í sess í sal;  
þá skal fręista, · hvárr fleira viti,  
4 gęstr eða inn gamli þulr.“

[R 7v/24]

[Webthritner:] “Why then, Gangred, dost thou speak from off the floor ahead?  
Take a seat in the hall!  
Then it shall be tried which of the two might know more:  
the guest, or the old thyle.”

---

4 inn gamli þulr ‘the old thyle’ | Webthritner himself, the thyle being the lorekeeper whose purpose it was to recite the old wisdom poems. See Encyclopedia: thyle.

[Óðinn:] 10 „Ó-auðigr maðr, · es til auðigs kómr,  
2 mēli þarft eða þęgi;  
ofr-męlgi mikil · hygg’k at illa geti  
4 hveim’s við kald-rifjaðan kómr.“

[R 7v/26]

[Weden:] “An unwealthy man who to a wealthy one comes  
ought to speak the needful or shut up.  
Great over-speaking I think will bring ill  
for whomever comes upon a cold-ribbed man.”

2 mēli þarft eða þegi 'ought to speak the needful or shut up' | Formulaic, this line occurs identically in *Háv* 19.

4 kald-rífaðan 'cold-ribbed' | Cold-hearted, cunning.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 11 „Seg mér, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill  
2 þíns fręista frama,  
hvę hęstr hętir, · sá's hveřjan dreęr  
4 dag of drótt-mögu.“

[R 7v/28]

[Webthritrner:] “Tell me, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt  
test thy furtherance,  
what the horse is called which pulls every  
day over the lads of the folk [MEN].”

ALL | Sts. 11–14 deal with the two horses that pull the day and night through the heavens. Their origin is discussed in *Gylf* 10:1–10 (the whole chapter): *Nęrvi eða Narfi bętt jętunn, er byggði í Jętun-beimum. Hann átti dóttur, er Nótt bętt. Hon var svęrt ok dękk, sem bon átti ętt til. Hon var gępt þeim manni, er Nagl-fari bętt; þęira sonr bętt Auðr. Því nęst var bon gępt þeim, er Anarr bętt; Jęrð bętt þęira dóttir. Síðast átti bana Dellingr, ok var hann ása ęttar; var þęira sonr Dagr; var hann ljóss ok fęgr eęfir faðerni sínu. Þá tók Al-fęðr Nótt ok Dag, son bennar, ok gaf þeim tvá besta ok tvęr kerrur ok sendi þau upp á himin, at þau skulu ríða á hverjum tveim döggrum um-hverfis jęrð'ina. Ríðr Nótt fyrri þeim best, er kallaðr er Hrim-faxi, ok at morgni hverjum döggrum hann jęrð'ina af męl-dropum sínum. Sá best, er Dagr á, heitir Skin-faxi, ok lýsir allt lopt ok jęrð'ina af faxi hans.* ‘Narrow or Narve was the name of an ettin who dwelled in the Ettinhomes. He had a daughter whose name was Night. She was black and dark like her lineage bespoke. She was married off to the man whose name was Nailfarer. Their son was Ead. Thereafter she was married off to the one whose name was Oner. Earth was the name of their daughter. Lastly Delling got her, and he was of the lineage of the Eese. Their son was Day; he was bright and fair after his father's side. Then Allfather took Night and Day, her son, and gave them two horses and two chariots and sent them up into the heaven that they should ride every two half-days in a full circle around the earth. Night rides in front on the horse which is called Rimefax, and every morning he bedews the earth with the foam from his bit. The horse owned by Day is named Shinefax, and all the air and the earth is lit up by his mane.'

The steeds are mentioned again in *Skm* 72, which deals with legendary horses: *Ár-vakr ok Al-sviðr draga sól'ina, sem fyrr er ritat. Hrim-faxi eða Fjör-svartnir draga nótt'ina. Skin-faxi eða Gláðr fylgja degi'num.* ‘Yorewaker and Allswith pull the sun as is written earlier. Rimefax or Ferrowswartner pulls the night. Shinefax or Glad follows the day.’ For Yorewaker and Allswith see *Grm* 38. The alternative names Ferrowswartner (‘Life-Darkener’) and Glad probably derive from now-lost poetic sources, probably of a similar gnomic character to *Vafþ* 11–14 and *Grm* 38.

The motif of horses, especially mounted on chariots, pulling the heavenly bodies or day and night is very ancient, and is attested as far back as the Bronze Age. It is common in the hymns of *RV* and Greek texts, and is represented archeologically by the beautiful Trundholm Sun Chariot from Denmark of the Nordic Bronze Age, the cultural and ethnic ancestors of the Germanic peoples. See Figures 2 and 3, and cf. *Grm* 38 n.

2 þíns fręista frama ‘test thy furtherance’ | I.e., “try your luck, see how far you get”. Formulaic; cf. *Háv* 2/4.

[Öðinn:] 12 „Skin-faxi hętir, · es inn skıra dreęr  
2 dag of drótt-mögu;  
hęsta batstr · þykkir hann með Hreįð-gotum;  
4 ęy lýsir męn af mari.“

[R 7v/30]

[Weden:] “Shinefax is he called who pulls the pure  
day over the lads of the folk.  
The best of horses he seems among the Reth-Gots;  
for ever that stallion’s mane lights up.”

3 *Hreið-gotum* | *metr. emend.*; ‘reið-gotom’ R

1 Skin-faxi ‘Shinefax’ | I.e., ‘the one with a shining mane’.

3 *Hreið-gotum* ‘Reth-Gots’ | An old name for the Eastern Gots around the Black Sea, also found in *Wid* 57 and *Ög* 136 *Rök*. The origin of the first element is unclear, but it appears to have a tribal significance (cf. the word *Hréd-cyning* ‘Reth-King’ in *Wid* 7). They are apparently mentioned here due to their connection with the east, the direction of the dawn. There may also be a pun present, since *goti* can mean both ‘Got’ and ‘horse’.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 13 „Sę þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill  
2 þíns of fręista frama,  
hvé jór hęitir, · sá’s austan dręgr  
4 nętt of nýt regin.“

[R 7v/32]

[Webthrithner:] “Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt  
test thy furtherance,



Figure 2: The gilt (day) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. Nordic Bronze Age, ca. 1400 BC. © Nationalmuseet. CC BY-SA 3.0. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvognen\\_Do\\_2010\\_1277.tif](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvognen_Do_2010_1277.tif)



what the steed is called which from the east does pull  
the night over the bountiful Reins.”

4 nýt rēgin ‘the bountiful Reins’ | The Gods. *nýt* ‘bountiful’ is one of several positive adjectives that can stand before *rēgin*, and recurs in the same position in *Vafþ* 14/2, 25/3 below. Cf. *holl rēgin* ‘the hold Reins’ (*Lok* 4/3), *fróð rēgin* ‘the learned Reins’ (*Vafþ* 26/4), and *blíð rēgin* ‘the blithe Reins’ (*Grm* 6/1, 38/3, 42/1; sarcastically in *Lok* 32/3).

[Óðinn:] 14 „Hrím·faxi hēitir, · es hvērja dręgr  
2 nōtt of nýt rēgin;  
mēl-dropa · fēllir hann morgin hvērjan;  
4 þaðan kōmr dōgg of dala.“

[R 7v/33]

[Weden:] “Rimefax is he called who pulls each  
night over the bountiful Reins.  
Foam from his bit he lets fall each morning;  
thence comes dew through the dales.”

2 of | *emend.*; ok R

1 Hrím·faxi ‘Rimefax’ | I.e., ‘the one with a frozen mane’.

4 þaðan kōmr dōgg of dala ‘thence comes dew through the dales’ | For another explanation of the origin of dew, see *Vsp* 18.



Figure 3: The ungilt (night) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. © National-museet. CC BY-SA 3.0. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvogner\\_Do\\_2010\\_1278.tif](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvogner_Do_2010_1278.tif)

[Vafþrúðnir:] 15 „Seg þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 8r/1]  
 2 þíns of fręista frama,  
 hvé ǫ heitir, · sú's deilir með jǫtna sonum  
 4 grund, ok með goðum.“

[Webthritner:] “Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt  
 test thy furtherance,  
 what the river is called which divides the land  
 between the sons of Ettins and the Gods.”

[Óðinn:] 16 „Ífing heitir ǫ, · es deilir með jǫtna sonum [R 8r/2]  
 2 grund, ok með goðum;  
 opin rinna · hǫn skal umb aldr-daga;  
 4 verðr=at íss á ǫu.“

[Weden:] “Íving is the river called which divides the land  
 between the sons of Ettins and the Gods.  
 Open shall it flow through its days of life;  
 there forms no ice on that river.”

1 Ífing ‘Íving’ | The border river is not known by this name from any other source, not even *Gylf*,  
 which otherwise tends to relay even the most obscure lore.

4 verðr=at íss á ǫu ‘there forms no ice on that river’ | For ice would enable the Ettins to cross over  
 into the lands of the Gods.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 17 „Seg þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 8r/3]  
 2 þíns of fręista frama,  
 hvé vǫllr heitir, · es finna=sk vígi at  
 4 Surtr ok in svǫsu goð.“

[Webthritner:] “Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt  
 test thy furtherance,  
 what the plain is called where they find each other at war,  
 Surt and the beloved Gods.”

Óðinn: 18 „Vig-ríðr heitir vǫllr, · es finna=sk vígi at [R 8r/4, S 17r/24,  
 2 Surtr ok in svǫsu goð; T TODO, W TODO]  
 hundrað rasta · hann ’s á hverjan veg;  
 4 sá ’s þeim vǫllr vitaðr.“

Weden: “Wighride is the plain called where they find each other at war,  
 Surt and the beloved Gods.  
 A hundred rests it reaches in each direction;  
 for them that plain is marked out.”

3 hveṛjan | hveṛn T 4 vǫllr | add. of T

ALL | For the fight between Surt and the Gods cf. *Vǫp* 48–53, *Fǫfn* 14–15. The st. is explained or paraphrased in *Gylf* 51:25: *Mú-spells megir sákja fram á þann vǫll er Vig-riðr heitir*. ‘The lads of Muspell make their attack on the plain which is called Wighride.’ and again in *Gylf* 51:28–29: *En Mú-spells synir hafa einir sér fylking, ok er sú björt mjök. Vǫllr’inn Vig-riðr er hundrað rasta víðr á hvern veg*. ‘But the sons of Muspell have a single formation, and it is very bright. The plain Wighride is a hundred rests wide in each direction.’ The stanza itself is cited in *Gylf* 51:51, the very end of that chapter, following the citation of *Vǫp* 45–54, introduced by the words *Hér segir enn svá* ‘Here it further says so’. Note that it is omitted from U, one of the four *Gylf* mss.

3 rasta ‘rests’ | An old measurement of distance, ca. 1850 metres (CV, s.v. *rǫst*).

Vafþrúðnir: 19 „Fróðr est nú gestr, · far á þékk jǫtuns,  
2 ok mǣlum=k í sessi saman;  
hǫfði vēða · vit skulum hǫllu í  
4 gestr, of goð-spéki.“

[R 8r/6]

Webthriðner: “Learned art thou now, guest; take the ettin’s bench  
and let us speak in the seat together!  
Wager a head shall we two in the hall,  
O guest, over god-wisdom!”

1 Fróðr est nú gestr, · far á þékk jǫtuns ‘Learned art thou now, guest; take the ettin’s bench’ | I.e., “Thou hast proven thy learning.” Webthriðner acknowledges his guest’s wisdom and repeats his invitation for the god to sit down. Weden accepts the offer, and the contest continues; now it is Weden’s turn to ask, Webthriðner’s to answer.

## Capitulum (‘New Chapter’)

Óðinn: 20 „Seg þat it çina, · ef þítt óði dugir  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvaðan jǫrð of kom, · eða upp-himinn  
4 fyrst, inn fróði jǫtunn.“

[R 8r/9, A 3r/1]

Weden: “TELL THIS ONE if thy wisdom avails  
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know  
whence Earth came or Up-heaven,  
first, O learned ettin.”

1 Seg | S is a bold capital in R 1 óði | The first word on fol. 3r of A; from this point we have the poem in both manuscripts. 2 ok | eða A

3 jǫrð ... eða upp-himinn ‘Earth ... or Up-heaven’ | An old Common Germanic formulaic merism, referring to the whole universe. See Index of formulae: Earth and Up-heaven.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 21 „Ór Ymis holdi · vas jǫrð of skǫpuð,

[R 8r/10, A 3r/2]

2                    ɛn ór beinum björg,  
                      himinn ór hausi · ins hrīm-kalda jǫtuns,  
 4                    ɛn ór sveita sǣr.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “From Yimer’s flesh was the earth created,  
                      but from his bones the mountains;  
                      the heaven from the skull of that rime-cold ettin,  
                      but from his blood the sea.”

ALL | The gods sacrificed Yimer and created the world from his body, as told more fully in *Grm* 41–42 and alluded to in *Vsp* 3–4. For Yimer, cf. sts. 30–33 below; for the deeper cosmological and religious significance of this myth see notes to *Vsp* 3–4 and also to *Grm* 43. — The whole st. bears very close resemblance to *Grm* 41; ll. 1 and 4 here are identical to ll. 1–2 there, and ll. 2 and 3a here are clearly related to ll. 3a and 4 there. Still, the sts. are distinct enough that the one cannot be a direct scribal copy of the other, and the relationship is more likely to be oral. Both have probably been composed in the same West Norwegian milieu, in turn deriving from an older Common Germanic tradition (cf. *Wessobrunn* under Poetry on Christian Subjects).

3 himinn ór hausi ‘the heaven from the skull’ | The heavens are understood as a dome, a view common to many ancient peoples. This also fits well with the floating clouds being Yimer’s brains, as told in *Grm* 42.

4 ór sveita sǣr ‘from his blood the sea’ | According to *Gylf* 7:3–4, the slaying of Yimer produced so much blood that it drowned the whole race of Rime-Thurses save one; see st. 35 below. For the method of slaying cf. *Sont* 3/3: *jǫtuns bals · undir þjóta* ‘the neck-wounds of the ettin [SEAS] roar’, which attests that Yimer was slain by decapitation, the typical way of wasting beasts of sacrifice (so e.g. *Hym* 15). That this is not a mere literary construct is proven by the excavation of the Viking Age site Hove-steads (*Hofstaðir*) on Iceland, where bulls were seasonally slain in what was undoubtedly ritual sacrifice: “The most likely reconstruction from the forensics of the skulls requires at least a two-person team, one of whom struck the animal between the eyes (effectively killing it and certainly stunning it into momentary immobility) while the second swung a fairly broad-bladed axe at the neck or base of the skull for a beheading stroke.” (Lucas and McGovern 2007, p. 23). After the slaying (and presumed feasting on the meat), the heads of the bulls were displayed for a prolonged period of time. Lucas and McGovern further note that swift beheading was not the usual manner of slaughtering animals on Iceland, and even has practical downsides compared to a slower cutting of the throat, e.g., splintered bones and damage to the cutting blade. On the other hand, the violent cutting and following flow of blood would have great dramatic effect, and, what Lucas and McGovern do not mention, clearly reenact the slaying of Yimer: the separation of the skull (heaven) from the body (earth), and the great flow of blood (sea-water) from the neck-wound, lastly the burial of the consumed body in the earth, and the display of the skull on high to symbolize the heaven. —

The ancients believed that the earth was surrounded on all sides by an outer sea (ON *út-bafr*); cf. *Hym* 5/1 n., 22/4 n.

4 sveita ‘blood’ | In poetry *sveiti* ‘sweat’ almost always means ‘blood’. This is shared with OE *swāt*, as seen e.g. in *Beow* 1286a: *sweord swāte fāh* ‘sword stained with “sweat”’, 2689b–2690: *hē ge-blōdegod wearð / sāwul-driore · swāt ðeum wéoll*. ‘he was bloodied in soul-gore; the “sweat” gushed in waves’.

Öðinn kvað: 22    „Seg þat annat, · ef þitt öði dugir  
 2                    ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
                      hvaðan Máni of kom, · svát færr mænn yfir,  
 4                    eða Sól it sama.“

Quoth Weden: “Tell this other one, if thy wisdom avails,  
                      and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know

[R 8r/12, A 3r/3]

whence the Moon came which journeys over men,  
or the Sun likewise.”

1–2 cf ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘c. þ. c. d. ʝ þ. v.’ R; abbrev. as ‘c. þ. c. d.’ A

ALL | For the origin of the Sun and Moon cf. *Grm* 38.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: **23** „Mundil-fóri heitir, · hann ’s Mána faðir  
2 ok svá Sólur it sama;  
himin hverfa · þau skulu hverjan dag  
4 ǫldum at ár-tali.“

[R 8r/13, A 3r/4]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Mundlefarer he is called—he is the father of the Moon,  
and so of the Sun likewise.  
Turn round heaven shall they every day,  
for mankind’s tally of years.”

4 ár-tali | corr. in same band from ald-tali A

ALL | This st. clearly serves as a source of *Gylf* 11:1–3: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hversu stýrir hann gang sólar eða tungls?“ Hárr segir: „Sá maðr er nefndr Mundil-fari, er átti tvau börn. Þau voru svá fœgr ok fríð, at hann kallaði son sinn Mána, en dóttur sína Sól ok gípti bana þeim manni, er Glenr hét. [...]* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “How does He [viz. Allfather] rule the track of the sun or the moon?” High says: “There is a man named Mundlefarer who had two children. They were so fair and beautiful that he called his son ‘Moon’, but his daughter ‘Sun’, and he married her off to the man who was called Glen. [...]’ Cf. *Grm* 38 n., which cites *Gylf* 11:4–7.

1 Mundil-fóri ‘Mundlefarer’ | See Index for the etymology, which likens the cosmos to a Wiking Age flour-mill turned by a handle. His name is attested in *Gylf* 11:2 as *Mundil-fari*, which underlies the English rendition Mundlefarer.

4 ǫldum at ár-tali ‘for mankind’s tally of years’ | According to *Vsp* 6 the Gods gave names to night, the moon-phases, morning, midday, afternoon, and evening *órum at telja* ‘the years for to tally’. — Numerous examples of the chronological reckoning of the Heathen Icelanders are found in Are’s Book of Icelanders and in the Book of Land-Claims (*Ldn*). Both texts anchor the years to the Christian Common Era, but this is likely the result of later Christian learning. The counts were most likely originally based on the reigns of kings, of which many examples are found in those two books.

Óðinn kvað: **24** „Sæg þat it þriðja, · alls þik svinnan kveða  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvaðan Dagr of kom, · sá’s fœrr drótt yfir,  
4 eða Nött með niðum.“

[R 8r/15, A 3r/6]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this third, since they call thee wise,  
and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know,  
whence the Day came which journeys over the folk,  
or the Night with the moon-phases.”

2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir | abbrev. as ‘ʝ þ. v. v.’ R 2 ok | eða A

4 Nött með niðum ‘Night with the moon-phases’ | Also found in *Vsp* 6/3.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 25 „Dellingr heitir, · hann’s Dags faðir,  
2 en Nött vas Nörvi borin;  
ný ok nið · skópu nýt regin  
4 öldum at ár-tali.“

[R 8r/17, A 3r/8]

Quoth Webthritner: “Delling he is called; he is the father of Day,  
but Night was born to Narrow.  
The waxing and waning the bountiful Reins created  
for mankind’s tally of years.”

1 Dellingr ‘Delling’ | A derivative of the adjective *dallr* ‘(possibly) shining, brilliant’ (cf. Old English *deal* ‘proud, exalted’) which appears in two other ON mythological names, viz. *Hegim-dallr* (the god Homedall) and *Mar-döll* (Meredall, an epithet of the goddess Frow. Also in these two instances the root appears to have connotations of light and brilliance; for Meredall see *Vsp* 24 n., *Prk* 8 n., and for Homedall see *Grm* 13, *Prk* 13/3 n., *Gylf* 27 (ed. under *Eddbr* III).

2 Nörvi ‘Narrow’ | Dat. sg. of *Nörr*, to be identified with the *Nörvi* (or *Narfi*) of *Gylf* 10:1 (see st. 11 n.). His name may be a kenning for the Gap of Hawks or primordial chaos (cf. *Vsp* 3/4 n.) and thereby equivalent to the Greek χάος ‘gap, Chaos’, father of Νύξ ‘Night’ (*Theog* 123).

3 ný ok nið ‘The waxing and waning’ | The two halves of the moon cycle, by which months (‘moon-ths’) were reckoned. The phrase also occurs in *Gut* 2: *um ný ok niðar*, *Gula* 57: *um ný bit næsta ok niðar*, and *Gylf* 11:8: *Máni stýrir gongu tungls ok ræðr nýjum ok niðum* ‘Moon steers the track of the lunar body and rules over the waxings and wanings’. For the Norse-Germanic calendar see notes to *Vsp* 6.

Óðinn kvað: 26 „Seg þat it fjórða, · alls þik fróðan kveða,  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvaðan vetr of kom · eða varmt sumar  
4 fyrst með fróð regin.“

[R 8r/18, A 3r/9]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this fourth, since they call thee learned,  
and thou, Webthritner, mightst know  
whence the Winter came or the warm Summer,  
first, amidst the learned Reins.”

1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f.’ RA 4 með | of A

1 fróðan ‘learned’ | It seems indisputable that the word hiding behind the abbreviated *f.* of the mss. is the m. acc. sg. of the adj. *fróðr*, but as it is not written out explicitly it must be marked by italics.

Vafþrúðnir: 27 „Vind·svalr heitir, · hann’s Vetrar faðir,  
2 en Svösuðr Sumars.“  
[...]

[R 8r/20, A 3r/10]

Webthritrner: “Windswale is he called; he is the father of the Winter;  
but Sosuth is the Summer’s.”

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 19:3–4: *Svásuðr beitir sá, er faðir Sumars er, ok er hann svá sǣl-lífr, svá at af hans beiti er þat kallat svásligt, er blítt er. En faðir Vetrar er ýmist kallaðr Vind-lóni eða Vind-svalr. Hann er Vasaðar son, ok vǫru þeir óttungar grimmir ok sval-brjóstaðir, ok befir Vetr þeira skap-lyndi.* ‘Sosuth is the name of he who is the father of Summer, and he lives so joyously that from his name that which is glad is called ‘delightful’. But the father of Winter is variously called Windloon or Windswale. He is the son of Wosuth, and those kinsmen were cruel and cool-breasted, and Winter has their temperament.’

3 [...] | The second half of the st. seems to be missing. Its contents are unknown, but may be preserved in the *Gylf* paraphrase. No lacuna is indicated in the mss.

Óðinn kvað: 29 „Sǣg þat it fimta, · alls þik fróðan kveða,  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hverr ása eldstr · eða Ymis niðja  
4 yrði í ár-daga.“

[R 8r/2l, A 3r/1l]

Quoth Woden: “Tell this fifth, since they call thee learned,  
and thou, Webthritrner, mightst know  
who, oldest of the Eese or of Yimer’s kinsmen [ETTINS],  
arose in days of yore.”

1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f.’ R; *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f. k.’ A

3–4 hverr ... ár-daga ‘who ... days of yore.’ | I.e., “Which was the very first being?” Cf. the question on the cryptic C9th Malt Stone (DR NOR1988;5): *huarisi : alistiąsa*, perhaps *Hvar er inn eldsti ása?* ‘Who is the eldest of the Eese?’

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 29 „Ør-ófi vetra · áðr véri jorð of sköpuð,  
2 þá vas Ber-gelmir borinn;  
Þrúð-gelmir · vas þess faðir,  
4 en Aur-gelmir afi.“

[R 8r/22, A 3r/12]

Quoth Webthritrner: “Uncountable winters before the Earth was created,  
then was Bareyelm born.  
Thrithyelm was that one’s father,  
and Earyelm the grandfather.”

2 vas | *om.* A

Óðinn kvað: 30 „Sǣg þat it sétta, · alls þik svinnan kveða,  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvaðan Aur-gelmir kom · með jǫtna sonum  
4 fyrst, inn fróði jǫtunn.“

[R 8r/23, A 3r/14,  
S 2v/17, T 3r/28,  
W TODO]

Quoth Weden: “*Tell this sixth, since they call thee wise,  
and thou, Webthritner, mightst know*  
whence Earyelmer came amidst the sons of ettins,  
first, O learned ettin.”

1–2 Seg ... vitir ‘Tell ... know’ | *om.* G 1 Seg þat it | *abbrev. as* ‘S. þ. þ. h.’ (*för* ‘S. þ. h.’) A  
1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. s. q.’ R; *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f. k.’ (*influenced by sts.* 26, 28) A

ALL | In *Gylf* 5:12, Snorre cites *Vafþ* 30/3–4 and the full 31 in support of his lengthy and embellished creation narrative, introduced by the words *En hér segir svá Vafþríúðnir jötunn*: ‘but here the ettin Webthritner says so’, though it is not certain that his vision is what the poet of *Vafþ* had in mind.

Vafþríúðnir kvað: 31 „Ör Ēli-vógum · stukku ęitr-dropar,  
2 svá óx und’s ór varð jötunn;  
þar örar ęttir · kómu allar saman;  
4 því’s þat ę alt til atalt.“

[R 8r/25, A 3r/15,  
S 2v/17, T 3r/29,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthritner: “Out of the Ilewaves splashed droplets of venom;  
so it grew until there became an ettin from it.  
Thereof our lineages all came together;  
therefore it is for ever all too fierce.”

1 Ör | Þá’s ór S 2 svá ‘so’ | ok ‘and’ G 2 óx und’s ór varð jötunn | vöxtr vinds ok varð jötunn  
ór ‘the growth of the wind and there became an ettin from it’ (*för* ‘\*óx unds varð jötunn ór’) U 2 ór  
varð | *rev.* TW 3–4 þar ... atalt ‘Thereof ... fierce’ | *om.* RA. 3 þar | þer U; *add.* eru S 3  
örar | þonar† T, ęinar U 3 kómu | komnar S; koma U 3 allar | *om.* U 4 því’s þat ę alt til  
atalt | *om.* U 4 ę | *om.* TW 4 til | eða T; *om.* W

ALL | Over æons the splashing droplets from the primæval venomous rivers, the Ilewaves, combined until they formed a sentient being. This was Earyelmer, whom *Gylf* 5:9 (most likely correctly) identifies with Yimer, for whom cf. *Vsp* 3/1 n.

1 Ēli-vógum ‘Ilewaves’ | The wild ettin-ish rivers near the edge of the world; cf. *Hym* 5/1. The Ilewaves (*Ēli-vógar*) are likely a reflex of the primæval salty Waters found in many West Eurasian mythologies, including Genesis 1:1–3 and *RV* 10.129. Of those two foundational religious sources the latter agrees more closely with the present stanza and certainly holds the more archaic conception; for the Jewish Waters (Hebrew מַיִם *r’hóm*) and their Mesopotamian and Egyptian predecessors cf. Waschke (2006).

Whereas we in the Jewish narrative find a *creation out of nothing*—at the very beginning of time Elohim’s spirit is on the Waters and He makes the light shine over them—we instead find in the two Indo-European texts *Vafþ* and *RV* a *spontaneous emergence* of a single primæval entity long before the Gods are born, here from the violent splashing of venom, in *RV* 10.129.3 from “the power of heat” (OI *tápas mabíná*). This entity in turn asexually begets sexual beings—here through rubbing his limbs together (*Vafþ* 33), in *RV* 10.129.4 by giving rise to “desire” (*kāma*) which serves as the “primal seed of thought” (*mānasas rétas prat’amām*). It is from these beings that the world is populated by the raw matter out of which the Gods eventually create (or *shape*) the World as we know it through the Creative Act of the First Sacrifice (see st. 21 above, *Vsp* 3–4, 6–7, *Grm* 41–43). It should be noted that the Ilewaves also correspond to the Greek Earth-bounding river Ὠκεανός, especially in its earlier conception; cf. *Hym* 5/1 n.

1 ęitr-dropar ‘droplets of venom’ | This ęitr ‘venom’ of the Waves is probably to be understood as referring to extreme saltiness. Yimer’s blood gives rise to the salty sea; and the stoniness of his bones, perhaps originally thought of as salt-stone, is attested for both his skull (Heaven, the stoney Firmament; *Hárþ* 15/2) and his body (the Earth and Bedrock; st. 21/2, *Grm* 41/3). To this day, something very salty is said to be *ettersalt* in modern Swedish.



4 þat 'it' | The ettin race.

Óðinn kvað: 32 „Sæg þat it sjaunda, · alls þik svinnan kveða,  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvé sá bǫrn gat · inn baldni jǫtunn,  
4 es hann hafði=t gýgjar gaman.“

[R 8r/26, A 3r/16]

Quoth Woden: “Tell this seventh, since they call thee wise,  
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know  
how he begot children, that stubborn ettin,  
when he knew no troll-woman’s pleasure.”

1 Sæg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þ. h.’ A 1–2 alls ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘a. þ. s. q.’ R; abbrev. as ‘a. þ. s. k.’ A 3 baldni ‘stubborn’ | so A; aldni ‘olden’ R

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 33 „Und hendi vaxa · kvǫðu hrím-þursi  
2 mey ok mög saman;  
fótr við fǫti · gat ins fróða jǫtuns  
4 sex-höfðaðan son.“

[R 8r/27, A 3r/17]

Quoth Webthriðner: “Under the arm of the rime-thurse, they said, did grow  
a maiden and a lad together.  
Foot against foot begat for the learned ettin  
a six-headed son.”

3 gat | om. A

ALL | This stanza is paraphrased in Gylf 5:16–18: *Ok svá er sagt, at þá er hann svaf, fekk hann sveita. Þá óx undir vinstri bendi bönum maðr ok kona, ok annarr fótr hans gat son við þðrum. En þaðan af kómu ęttir. Þat eru hrím-þursar.* ‘And so it is said that when he slept he began to sweat. Then grew within his left hand a man and a woman, and one foot of his begat a son by the other. But thereof come lineages. Those are Rime-Thurses.’

1–3 Und hendi ... fótr við fǫti ‘Under the arm ... Foot against foot’ | The image is masturbatory and monstrous; for its significance cf. st. 31 n.

Óðinn kvað: 34 „Sæg þat it ǫttunda, · alls þik fróðan kveða,  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvat fyrst of mant · eða fremst of vęitst,  
4 þú est al-sviðr jǫtunn.“

[R 8r/29, A 3r/18]

Quoth Woden: “Tell this eighth, since they call thee learned,  
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know  
what first thing thou recallest or earliest knowest—  
thou art all-wise, ettin!”

1 Sæg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þ. h.’ A 1–2 alls ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘a. þ. f.’ R; abbrev. as ‘a. þ. f. k.’ A 3<sup>a</sup> of | om. R

1 Sæg þat it óttunda, · alls þik fróðan kveða ‘Tell this eighth, since they call thee learned’ | This line lacks the required alliteration, which has probably been lost in manuscript transmission due to the repetitive nature of the refrain. Alliteration may be obtained by replacing *alls þik fróðan kveða* with *ef þitt óði dugir* from sts. 20 and 22, or (less favourably) with *alls þik svinnan kveða* from 24, where the alliteration in the a-verse does not fall on the ordinal.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 35 „Ør·ófi vetra · áðr véri jorð of sköpuð,  
2 þá vas Ber·gelmir borinn;  
þat ek fyrst of man, · es inn fróði jötunn  
4 á vas lúðr of lagiðr.“

[R 8r/30, A 3r/19,  
S 3r/4, T 3v/20,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Uncountable winters before the Earth was created,  
then was Bareyelmir born.  
This I first remember, when the learned ettin  
on the canoe was laid.”

3 ek | er TW 3 es inn fróði | at fróða U 4 á vas | so ASWU; rev. RT

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 7:6, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The preceding *Gylf* 7:2–5 interprets it in the following way: the sons of Byre (that is, Weden, Will, and Wigh) slew the ettin Yimer, but when he died so much blood flowed from his wounds that the whole race of Ettins was drowned, save for Bareyelmir and his household, who survived by getting up on his *lúðr* (cf. note to this word below).

The flood-myth in *Gylf* 7:2–5 is clearly related to the Great Flood or Deluge as known from many mythologies, most famously Genesis 6–9. Although it may be a genuine Germanic reflex of the same ancient myth (cf. *Vsp* 4 n., 56/1 n.), it may also be Snorre’s own invention based on the Bible in an attempt to explain the present stanza, which may in fact have been as obscure to him as it is to us.

4 lúðr ‘canoe’ | In Old Norse prose *lúðr* usually means ‘trumpet, blowing horn’, less commonly ‘flour-bin’, but the underlying sense seems to be ‘hollowed-out wood’, which is why it is presently translated as ‘canoe’. As noted above Snorre seems to interpret it as a form of ark on which Bareyelmir found refuge from the flood, but considering the transitive nature of Bareyelmir’s being laid (*of lagiðr*) upon it, the stanza may instead be interpreted as speaking of a ship burial, so that the first thing Webthrithner remembers is Bareyelmir’s funeral.

Óðinn kvað: 36 „Sæg þat it níunda, · alls þik svinnan kveða,  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvaðan vindr of kœmr · svá’t færr vág yfir,  
4 é menn hann sjalfan of séa.“

[R 8r/32, A 3r/21]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this ninth, since they call thee wise,  
and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know  
whence the wind comes which fares o’er the wave—  
always men see his very self.”

1 Sæg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þat h.’ A 1–2 alls ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘a. þ. s. q. e.’ R; ‘a. þ. s. k.’ A  
4 menn hann sjalfan of séa | maðr of sjalfan hann sér A

ALL | Sts. 36–37 are paraphrased by Gylf 18:1–6: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvaðan kemr vindr? Hann er sterkur, svá at hann hrérir stór bǫf, ok hann  sir eld. En svá sterkur sem hann er, þ  má eigi sj  hann; því er hann undar=liga skapaðr.“ Þ  m lti H rr: „ at kann ek vel segja þ r.   nor an-ver um himins enda sitr j tunn s , er Hr =svelgr heitir. Hann befir arnar-ham, en er hann beinir flug, þ  standa vindar undan v ngjum hans. “Then Gangler spoke: “Whence comes the wind? It is so strong that it stirs great oceans and it fans flame. But as strong as it is yet one cannot see it. Therefore it is wondrously created.” Then High spoke: “That I can tell thee well. At the northern end of heaven sits the ettin who is called Rawswallower. He has an eagle’s hame, and when he takes to flight then the winds come from under his wings.”*

After this, st. 37 is cited in *Gylf* 18:7, introduced by the words *H r segir sv * ‘Here it says so’.

4   m nn hann sjalfan of s a ‘always men see his very self’ | Perhaps a reference to the sea which is never perfectly still, so that the wind is always seen on the waves. It is also possible that a negative clitic *-t* has been lost from the verb *s a* ‘see’, in which case the line should be interpreted as ‘never men see his very self’. The loss of an original negative is supported by *Gylf* 18:3: *m  eigi sj  hann* ‘one cannot see it’.

Vafþr  nir kva : 37 „Hr =svelgr heitir,   es sitr   himins  nda,  
2 j tunn   arnar ham;  
af hans v ngjum   kve a vind koma  
4 alla m nn yfir.“

[R 8r/34, A 3r/22,  
S 5v/21, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Rawswallower is he called who sits at heaven’s end,  
an ettin in an eagle’s hame.  
From his wings they say the wind comes  
over all men.”

1 heitir | *add.* j tunn U 1 es | hann U 3 koma | standa U

1 Hr =svelgr ‘Rawswallower’ | ‘Devourer of Carrion’.

  inn kva : 38 „S g þat it t unda,   alls þ  t va r k  
2  ll Vafþr  nir vitir,  
hva an Nj r r of kom   me   sa sonum;  
4 hofum ok h rgum   hann r  r hund-m rgum  
ok var =at hann  sum alinn.“

[R 8v/1, A 3r/24]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this tenth, since thou the rakes of the Tews  
all, Webthrithner, mightst know,  
whence Nearth came in the midst of the sons of the Eese.  
Of hoves and harrows he rules a hundred-many,  
and he was not begotten by the Eese.”

1 S g þat it | *abbrev.* as ‘S. þat h.’ A 1 alls | *abbrev.* as ‘a.’ RA 5 var =at | vas=at A

1 t va r k ‘rakes of the Tews’ | The fated events or narrations of the Gods.

3 hvaðan Njörðr of kom · með ása sonum | This line lacks both alliteration and a following c-verse, which may point towards textual corruption. Finnur Jónsson (1932) opts to change the b-verse to \**með niðjum ása*, a perfectly sensible emendation, although the expected c-verse is still missing. For that reason, I instead wish to propose the following conjectural restoration: *bvaðan Njörðr of kom · af Nóa-tinum / ár með ása sonum* ‘whence Nearth of the Nowetons came of yore in the midst of the sons of the Eese’, where \**af Nóa-tinum / ár* would have been omitted due to the visual similarity between \**tinum* and *sonum*.

4 hofum ok horgum ‘hoves and harrows’ | A formulaic merism for cultic sites. *horgr* ‘harrow’ is a cultic place, not the agricultural implement; cf. *Vsp* 7 n. For Nearth in connection with harrows cf. *Grm* 16, where it is said that Nearth *rêðr bô-timbruðum horgi* ‘rules the harrow timbered on high’. Also of interest is *Lok* 51, where the goddess Shede speaks of her *vé ok vangar* ‘wighs and wongs’, two terms common in religious place names. The underlying theological understanding seems to be that the god or goddess is physically present in his or her shrine as its ruler (Turville-Petre 1975, p. 238).

4 hund-morgum ‘a hundred-many’ | Probably a reference to the large number of cultic sites named after Nearth; among modern place names Brink (2007) counts 13 in Norway, 17 in Sweden, and 3 in Denmark, but those numbers must have been much greater in the pre-Christian period.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 39 „Í Vana-heimi · skópu hann vís regin  
2 ok selðu at gíslingu goðum,  
í aldar rök · hann mun aptr koma  
4 heim með vísu vönum.“

[R 8v/3, A 3r/26]

Quoth Webthritner: “In Wanham the wise Reins created him  
and sold him as a hostage to the Gods.  
In the Rakes of the Age he will come back  
home amidst the wise Wanes.”

---

3 hann mun | *rev. A*

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ALL | In other sources we learn of a war between two tribes of supernatural beings, the Eese and the Wanes. As part of the settlement between them, Nearth, who belonged to the Wanes, was sent to the Eese as a hostage. Although the two are often called the two tribes of Gods, it should be noted that the Wanes are explicitly contrasted with *goð* ‘Gods’ in l. 2 both here and in *Gylf* 23:6, which on the other hand seems to refer exclusively to the Eese, so that it is unclear whether the Wanes as a tribe are actually considered to be Gods. For the war between Eese and Wanes cf. *Vsp* 22 n., *Gylf* 23:6 (edited in the pres. ed. as *Eddbr* II), and *Yng* 4. *Lok* 34–35 mentions that Nearth was sent as a hostage to the Ettins, but that is certainly a different episode, although the shared motif of Nearth as a hostage is notable.

1 vís regin ‘the wise Reins’ | ON *rggin* ‘the Reins, Powers’ is normally one of a number of terms used to refer to the gods as a collective (Simek 2010, pp. 10–11), but here seems to refer specifically to the Wanes in opposition to the Eese.

3 aldar rök ‘the Rakes of the Age’ | The Rakes of the Reins, the End Times.

Óðinn kvað: 40 „Seg þat it ellipta, · ef þitt óði dugir  
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,  
hvar allir · ýtar tinum í  
4 hoggva=sk hverjan dag.“

[R 8v/5, A 3r/28]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this eleventh, if thy wisdom avails,  
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know  
where all men in yards  
strike each other every day.”

1 **Œg** þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þ. e.’ A 1–2 ef ... vitir, | emend.; om. all. 3 **allir** | emend.; om. all.

ALL | This question-stanza is malformed in both **R** and **A** and thus has to be partly reconstructed on the basis of st. 41. The ms. preservation of *Vafþ* 40–41 is as follows:  
All four mss. of *Gylf* attest only st. 41 (the answer-stanza, cf. note there) with no textual variants. **R** has two half-stanzas which are clearly a mix between the question and the answer: *Segðu þat et .xi. hvar ytar tñom i haggvaz hverian dag. Ynom. Val þeir kjosa oc ríða vígi fra sitia meirr vm sáttir saman.* Although this forms a complete stanza it stands out by lacking a refrain in the first two lines, something found in all other question-sts. in *Vafþ* (see Introduction). The word *Ynom* (where the ‘Y’ has a vertical line going between the two branches at the top) is unexplained. **A** has two half-stanzas, clearly marked by the speaker notes in the margins. The first one is by Weden: *S. þ. e. xi. allir eins heriar oðins tñum i haggvaz hverian dag.* The second by Webthriðner: *Val þeir kjosa oc ríða vígi fra sitia meirr vm sáttir saman.* This situation is also corrupt. In order to restore st. 40 to a full four lines, two conjectural emendations have been adopted in the pres. ed.: In lines 1b–2 the refrain *ef þitt óði dugir ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir* ‘if thy wisdom avails, and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know’ has been inserted from sts. 20 and 22, which also have ordinal numbers alliterating with vowels. In line 3a the word *allir* ‘all’ has been inserted from st. 41 to get vowel-alliteration with 3b *ýtar*.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 41 „Allir **ein**-herjar · Óðins tñum í  
2 hoggva-sk hverjan dag;  
val þeir kjósa · ok ríða vígi frá,  
4 sitja meirr of sáttir saman.“

[A 3r/28, S 10r/17,  
T TODO, W TODO,  
U TODO]

Quoth [Webthriðner]: “All the Oneharriers in Weden’s yards  
strike each other every day.  
The slain they choose and ride from the fray,  
then sit agreed once more together.”

1 **ein**-herjar | so G; **çins** herjar A

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 41:5, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The immediately preceding prose passage *Gylf* 41:1–4 provides context: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „All-mikill mann-fjöldi er i Val-höll. Svá njóta trú minnar, at all-mikill höfðingi er Óðinn, er hann stýrir svá miklum her. Eða hvat er skemmtun Ein-berja, þá er þeir drekka eigi?“ Hárr segir: „Hvern dag, þá er þeir hafu klæðt-sk, þá her-væða þeir sik ok ganga út i garðinn ok berja-sk, ok fellir hvern annan. Þat er leikr þeira. Ok er líðr at doguðar-máli, þá ríða þeir heim til Val-hallar ok setja-sk til drykkju. “Then spoke Gangler: “There is an all-great gathering of men in Walhall. Such makes me believe that Weden is an all-great chieftain when he wields such a great host. But what is the entertainment of the Oneharriers when they do not drink?” High says: “Every day when they have got dressed then they gear themselves up for war and go out into the yard and fight, and each one slays the other. That is their game. And when it is getting close to supper-time then they ride home to Walhall and seat themselves at their drinking.”*  
For the Oneharriers cf. *Grm* 18/4, 24/3, 37/6, 53/3.

3 val þeir kjósa ‘The slain they choose’ | It is from this verbal phrase that the female agent noun *val-kyrja* ‘walkirie’ is derived.

[Óðinn] kvað: 42 „Seg þat it tolpta, · hví þú tíva røk  
 2 öll Vafþrúðnir vitir?  
 Frá jǫtna rúnum · ok allra goða  
 4 þú it sannasta segir,  
 inn al-svinni jǫtunn.“

[R 8v/6, A 3v/1]

Quoth [Weden]: “Tell this twelfth, why thou the rakes of the Tews  
 all, Webthritner, shouldst know?  
 From the runes of the ettins and all the gods  
 dost thou speak the truest,  
 O all-wise ettin!”

[Vafþrúðnir] kvað: 43 „Frá jǫtna rúnum · ok allra goða  
 2 ek kann segja satt,  
 því't hvern hef'k heim of komit,  
 4 níu kom'k heima · fyr nifl-hel neðan;  
 hinig deýja ór helju halir.“

[R 8v/8, A 3v/2]

Quoth [Webthritner]: “From the runes of the ettins and all the gods  
 I can speak truly,  
 for I have come into each Home.  
 Into nine Homes I came beneath Nivelhell;  
 that way men die out of Hell.”

4–5 níu ... halir. ‘Into nine ... of Hell.’ | Apparently lower Underworlds. Cf. Snorre, who writes about Lock’s daughter Hell in *Gylf* 34:6: *Hel kastaði hann í Nifl-beim ok gaf henni vald yfir níu heimum, at hón skyldi skipta öllum vistum með þeim, er til bennar vǫru sendir, en þat eru sótt-dauðir menn ok elli-dauðir.* ‘He [Weden, the Allfather] threw Hell into Nivelham and gave her dominion over nine Homes that she would deal out all provisions between those who were sent to her—but those are men dead of sickness and dead of old age.’ Finnur Jónsson (1932) considers *ór helju* ‘out of Hell’ a later interpolation, probably for metrical reasons.

Óðinn kvað: 44 „Fjǫlð ek fǫr, · fjǫlð fręistaða’k,  
 2 fjǫlð of reynda’k ręgin;  
 hvat lifir manna, · þá’s inn męra líðr  
 4 fimbul-vetr með firum?“

[R 8v/11, A 3v/4]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,*  
*much I tested the Reins!*  
 What remains of men when the famed Fimble-Winter  
 passes amidst the folk?”

2 fjǫlð | *abbrev. as ‘f: RA 2 of | so A; om. R*

ALL | This question (Weden’s thirteenth) begins the third and final group of questions. The subject shifts toward eschatology and the first two lines of each question-stanza feature the refrain found in st. 3/1–2. For the events of the End Times, cf. *Vsp* 39–55 and *Gylf* 51; for the world to come, cf. *Vsp* 56–62, *Gylf* 52–53.

3–4 inn mǫra ... fimbul-vetr ‘the famed Fimble-Winter’ | The great winter of the end times. The Fimblewinter is not mentioned in *Vsp*’s description of the End Times, although bad weather and a blackening of the sun is mentioned in *Vsp* 40/3–4; snow during the End Times is also mentioned in *Hdl* 41/3.

*Gylf* 51:1–4 gives us a more detailed description of the Fimblewinter: *Þá mǫlti Gangleri: „Hver tíðendi eru at segja frá um ragna-røkr? Þess hef ek eigi fyrr beyrt getit.“ Hárr segir: „Mikil tíðendi eru þaðan at segja ok mǫrg, þau in fyrstu, at vetr sá kemr, er kallaðr er fimbul-vetr. Þá dríft snǫr ór ǫllum áttum. Frost eru þá mikil ok vindar hvassir. Ekki nýtr sólar. Þeir vetr fara þrír saman ok ekki sumar milli. ‘Then spoke Gangler: “Which tidings are to be told about the Twilight of the Reins? I have not heard it spoken of before.” High says: “There are great tidings to be told thereof and many are they; the first that the winter will come which is called the Fimblewinter. Then snow comes down from all directions. The cold is great then and the winds biting. The sun is of no use. Those winters pass three together and no summer between them.’ For the immediately following prose in *Gylf* 51:5–6 see *Vsp* 44 n.*

Comparatively, an eschatological winter is known also from Zoroastrian Iranian sources, as described by Hultgård (2007). In one version the great winter sees numerous men and cattle killed, with the survivors finding refuge in a shelter. Although the parallels to the Norse Fimblewinter are not great in number, the Iranian narratives are similar enough for Hultgård (2007, pp. 116–118) to make note that they may share a common Indo-European origin with the Norse.

In recent scholarship Gräslund (2008) has identified the Fimblewinter as a traumatic reflex of the archeologically documented volcanic winter of 536–537 AD, where a cloud of volcanic ash blocked out the light of the sun during the summer. Gräslund rejects Hultgård’s comparative explanation and argues that the details of the Fimblewinter (the length of three years, the lack of summer, and the high mortality rate) are “highly precise” and therefore unlikely to stem from a long-lasting oral traditions (Gräslund 2008, pp. 94–95). This is undoubtedly a subjective line of argument, since the details are in fact rather sparse and not in agreement with the archeological record: all humans were not wiped out in 536, and the sun was not totally blocked out for three whole years. Gräslund also conveniently omits the prediction of three winters of violence immediately preceding the three winters of the Fimblewinter as found in *Gylf* 51:5, since that can hardly be tied to his view of a historical reflex (unless we are to believe that there was a huge war in 532–534!)

As further support for his idea of historical trauma, Gräslund (2008, pp. 99–101) cites an episode from the *Kalevala* (songs 47–49) wherein the evil witch *Louhi* steals the sun, moon, and fire and hides them in the Underworld. According to Gräslund this would also be a reflex of the climate catastrophe of 536 AD, but by making this connection he in fact undermines his own argument. Gräslund is undoubtedly correct that the core concern of the Fimblewinter is not that the winter itself is harsh, but rather that the summer itself does not come, but such fears about malevolent supernatural interruptions to vital cosmic cycles are by no means isolated to sources composed after 536 AD. As early as *RV* (ca. 1500–1200 BC) there is the myth of the Dawns imprisoned in a cave by the enemies of the Gods, thereby preventing the natural cycle between day and night (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71), and the motif of Ettins trying to steal away things vital for the survival of mankind and the gods, not just the sun and moon, but also Thunder’s hammer, is found elsewhere in Norse myth (cf. *Vsp* 24/4 n., Introduction to *Þrk*).

It is clear that the return of the better side of the natural cycles (summer from winter, day from night, the full moon from the new) was of great concern to the ancients. Though the volcanic winter of 536–537 was exceptionally severe, it cannot be (as Gräslund claims) the historical basis of every reflex of that motif when the examples demonstrably go back as far as the Bronze Age and likely beyond. What is more, such worries could surely be fueled not just by volcanic trauma but by eclipses and cold summers (cf. *Eyv* Lv 12–14 in *SkP* 1) which have been occurring since time immemorial. To pre-modern farmers, for whom the performance of the fields meant life and death, the return of summer and daylight were by no means felt inevitable, but were rather fraught with worry and therefore heralded with great rejoicing. To conclude, I agree with Hultgård that the Fimblewinter may well be Indo-European.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 45 „Líf ok Leifþrasir, · en þau leyna=sk munu  
2 í holti Hodd-mímis;  
morgin-döggar · þau sér at mat hafa;

[R 8v/13, A 3v/6,  
S 17v/17, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

4                    ɛn þaðan af aldir ala=sk.“

Quoth Webthritner: “Life and Laffthrasher—but they will hide themselves  
in Hoardmimer’s wood.  
Morning dew will they have as food,  
but thereof is mankind begotten.”

1 Lɛɪfþrasir | so ASW; Lifþrasir R; Lɛiðþrasir T; †lifþræsɛr† U   1 ɛn þau lɛyna=sk munu | er  
þar leynazt meýjar ‘who there bide, as maidens’ U   2 holti Hodd-mímis | Mímis holdi ‘Mímer’s  
corpse’ U   2 holti A   3 morgin-doggvar | morgin-doggva U   3 þau sér at mat hafa |  
þér U   4 ɛn þaðan af aldir | ok þar of aldr U   4 ɛn | om. R   4 ala=sk | allar T

ALL | The coming ancestors of mankind will, like Ash and Emble (*Vsp* 16–17), emerge from wood. This st. is cited in *Gylf*, immediately following *Gylf* 53:11–13: *En þar, sem beitr Hodd-mimis-bolt, leyna=sk menn tweir í Surta-loga, er svá heita, Lif ok Leifþrasir, ok bafa morgin-doggvar fyrir mat. En af þessum mǫnnum kemr svá mikil kyn-slóð, at byggvi=sk beimr allr. Svá sem hér segir: ‘But there, at the place called Hoardmimer’s wood, two humans hide during the Flame of Surt, which are called Life and Laffthrasher, and they have morning dew for food. But from these humans comes such a great line of descendants that the whole Home is settled. Just as it says here’*

2 holti Hodd-mímis ‘in Hoardmimer’s wood’ | Perhaps the hollowed-out trunk of the Ash of Ugdrassle.

Öðinn kvað: 46    „Fjölð ek fôr, · fjölð fręstaða’k,  
2                    fjölð of ręynda’k ręgin;  
                      hvaðan kómr sól · á inn slétta himin,  
4                    þá’s þessa hęfr Fęnrir farit?

[R 8v/15, A 3v/8]

Quoth Weden: “Much I journeyed, much I tried,  
much I tested the Reins!  
Whence comes the Sun onto the smooth heaven  
when Fenrer has this one killed?”

1–2 ek ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘e. f. e. f.’ A   1–2 fôr ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f. f. e. f.’ R   4 þá’s | so  
(‘þa ær’) A; ‘þa þa er’ R

4 þessa ‘this one’ | The current sun, as explained in the following st.

4 Fęnrir ‘Fenrer’ | It is not certain that this is the same “Fenrerswolf” which fights against Weden (cf. st. 53 below); the word *fęnrir*, which prob. originally means ‘fen-dweller’, may here simply be a generic poetic synonym for ‘wolf’. For the wolves which chase and eventually devour the sun and moon see *Vsp* 39–40 (n.), *Grm* 40, *Gylf* 12.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 47    „Eina dóttur · berr alf-rðull,  
2                    áðr hana Fęnrir fari;  
                      sú skal riða, · þá’s ręgin deýja,  
4                    móður brautir męr.“

[R 8v/16, A 3v/9,  
S 17v/20, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthritner: “A single daughter the Elf-wheel [SUN] bears  
before Fenrer might kill her.



She shall ride when the Reins die  
her mother's roads, a maiden."

2 hana | hēnni U 3 sú skal ríða, · þá's rēgin dēyja | sú mun renna · eða ríða (*unmetrical and wo. doubt corrupt*) U 4 mǫður | rēgin U

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf*, immediately following *Gylf* 53:14–15: *Ok þitt mun þér undar-ligt þykkja er sól'in þerit getit dóttur eigi ófegri en bón er, ok ferr sú þá stigu móður sinnar. Svá sem þér segir:* 'And it will seem wondrous to thee that the Sun has begotten a daughter no less fairer than she herself is, and that one then journeys upon her mother's paths. Just as it says here:' The immediately following passage *Gylf* 53:16–17 concludes the account of the world to come and the mythological section of *Gylf* as a whole: *En nú ef þú kannt lengra fram at spyrja, þá veit ek eigi, hvaðan þér kemr þat, fyrir því at engan mann heyrða ek lengra segja fram aldar-fár'it, ok njót-tu nú sem þú namt.* 'But now, if thou canst ask further ahead then I do not know for what reason thou mightst do so, for I have heard no man tell further ahead about the progression of the world; and now enjoy what thou hast learned.'

1 *alf-röðull* 'Elf-wheel' | A rare poetic synonym (*hēiti*) for the sun. It occurs independently in two other places: the Eddic *Ski* 4/3a and a Scaldic loose stanza by Eanwind Finnson (Eyv Lv 9 in SkP 1). It also appears in two lists of names for the sun: *Skem* 69 and *Þul Sólar* 1/7 (in SkP 3), but these do not count as independent attestations since they are antiquarian sources drawing on earlier poetry.

Depending on the age of the cpd., *alf-* may either reflect the semantics of PIE *albʰós* 'white' (whence Latin *albus* 'id.') or ON *alfr* 'elf', the latter word deriving from the former and originally meaning 'white one'. That is not to say that *alf-röðull* goes back to PIE, but only that the sense "white" must have existed at some point in Germanic prehistory. The second element, *röðull*, is not the normal ON word for 'wheel' (*búel* ~ *bjól*). It is inherited from PGmc. *\*radulaz* ~ *\*raduraz* (> OE *rædor* 'heaven, sky', OS *radul*, *radur* 'id.'). from *\*raþq* 'wheel' (> German *Rad* 'id.') + the nominal suffix *\*-ulaz* ~ *\*-uraz* ('habitually) doing' and thus means something like 'circler, turner, revolver'. The PIE root of *\*raþq* is *\*Hreth₂-* (whence also Latin *rota* 'wheel', Sanskrit *rātʰa* 'chariot'; Kroonen 2013, p. 405).

Óðinn kvað: 48 Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð freistaða'k,  
2 fjǫlð of reynda'k rēgin;  
hverjar 'ro meýjar, · es líða mar yfir,  
4 fród-gęðjaðar fara?

[R 8v/18, A 3v/10]

Quoth Woden: "Much I journeyed, much I tried,  
much I tested the Reins!  
Who are the maidens that pass o'er the sea?  
Wise-minded they go."

1-2 Fjǫlð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* 'F. e. f. f. c. f.' A 1-2 fór ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* 'f. f.' R

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 49 Þrjár þjóð-áar · falla þorp yfir  
2 meýja Mǫg-þrasis;  
hamingjur einar · þér's í hēimi eru,  
4 þó þér með jǫtnum ala=sk.

[R 8v/19, A 3v/11]

Quoth Webthritner: "Three great rivers fall over the house  
of the maidens of Maythrasher.

They are the only Hamings in the Home,  
although they are raised amidst ettins.”

3 þér's | so ('þær ær') A; þeira R

ALL | The identity of these maidens is entirely obscure. Considering all other questions introduced with the refrain *Fjölð ek fôr* ... have something to do with the end times, they ought to as well, but that hardly clarifies their function. They are probably to be identified with the maidens about which Woden asks in *Bdr* 12.

Óðinn kvað: 50 „Fjölð ek fôr, · fjölð fręistaða'k,  
2 fjölð of reýnda'k ręgin;  
hveřir ráða ęsir · ęignum goða,  
4 þá's sloknar Surta-logi?“

[R 8v/21, A 3v/13]

Quoth Woden: “Much I journeyed, much I tried,  
much I tested the Reins!  
Which Eese will rule the estates of the Gods  
when the flame of Surt goes out?”

1–2 Fjölð ... ręgin | abbrev. as 'F. e. f. e. f.' A 1–2 fôr ... ręgin | abbrev. as 'f. f.' R

4 Surta-logi 'the flame of Surt' | The flame which reaches up to Heaven itself and scorches the whole world; see *Vsp* 50, 54.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 51 „Við·arr ok Váli · byggva vé goða,  
2 þá's sloknar Surta-logi;  
Móði ok Magni · skulu Mjöllni hafa  
4 Vingnis at víg-þroti.“

[R 8v/22, A 3v/14,  
S 17v/12, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthritner: “Wider and Wonnell will settle the wighs of the Gods  
when the flame of Surt goes out.  
Mood and Main shall have Millner  
after Wingner expires in war.”

3 Móði | †megi† S 4 Vingnis | ok vinna R; add. synir U 4 víg-þroti | †vigroþi† U

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 53:10, introduced by the words *Svá er sagt* 'So it is said'. For the preceding prose passage *Gylf* 53:1–9 see *Vsp* 56 n.

4 Vingnis at víg-þroti 'after Wingner expires in war' | After Thunder dies in his fight against the Middenyardswyrm, for which see *Vsp* 53.

Óðinn kvað: 52 „Fjölð ek fôr, · fjölð fręistaða'k,  
2 fjölð of reýnda'k ręgin;  
hvat verðr Óðni · at aldr-lagi,  
4 þá's of rjúfa=sk ręgin?“

[R 8v/24, A 3v/16]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,  
much I tested the Reins!*

What brings Weden’s life to an end  
when the Reins are ripped?”

1–2 Fjölð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f.’ A 1–2 fór ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ R 4 of | *so* A; *om.* R

4 þá’s of rjúfa=sk rēgin? ‘when the Reins are ripped?’ | Formulaic; see note to *Bdr* 14/4.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 53 „Ulfr glęypa · mun Alda-fōðr,  
2 þess mun Við-arr vrekka;  
kalda kjapta · hann klyfja mun  
4 vitnis vígi at.“

[R 8v/25, A 3v/17]

Quoth Webthritner: “The Wolf will devour the Father of Mankind;  
that will Wider avenge.  
The cold jaws he will split apart  
of the beast at the battle.”

2 vrekka | *metr. emend.*; rekka R 4 vitnis ‘the beast’ | *so* A; Vingnis ‘Wingner’ (*prob. influenced by st. 51*) R

ALL | For Weden’s fight with the Wolf and Wider’s subsequent avenging see *Vsp* 51–52, *Grm* 17, 24.

2 þess mun Við-arr vrekka ‘that will Wider avenge’ | The archaic initial *vr-* in *vrekka* must be restored for metrical reasons (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 37). This serves as a solid dating criterion for composition before ca. 1000 AD; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n.

Óðinn kvað: 54 „Fjölð ek fór, · fjölð freistaða’k,  
2 fjölð of rēynda’k rēgin;  
hvat mēlti Óðinn, · áðr á bál stigi,  
4 sjalfr í çyra syni?“

[R 8v/27, A 3v/19]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,  
much I tested the Reins!*

What spoke Weden before he would step onto the pyre,  
himself, into the ear of his son?”

1–2 Fjölð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f.’ A 1–2 fjölð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ R 3 stigi, | *add.* ok A

3–4 Hvat mēlti Óðinn ... í çyra syni? ‘What said Weden ... into the ear of his son?’ | Weden poses the eighteenth, unknowable, question. Only he himself can know what he whispered in Balder’s ear, and thus he has won the contest. For Balder’s death, cf. notes to *Vsp* 31–33 and *Bdr* 8–11. Weden asks the same question in Heathric’s Riddles in *Heiðr*, as the 37th and final riddle (for critical discussion cf. *Heiðr* 84/3 n. in *SkP* 8.). The half-stanza there is clearly related to *Vafþ* 54: *Seg þat þá fyrst, ef þú ert hverjum konungi vitrari: // Hvat mēlti Óðinn · í çyra Baldri, / áðr bann vęri á bál of þorinn?* ‘Then tell this first if thou art cleverer than every king: // What spoke Weden in Balder’s ear / before he would be borne onto the pyre?’

3 á bál stigi 'step onto the pyre' | The phrase *stíga á* 'step onto, mount' is also used to refer to one stepping aboard a ship or mounting a horse (see CV: *stíga* for citations). Its use for a person being borne onto the funeral pyre has been compared with *Beow* 1118b: *gūð-rinc á-stāb* 'the war-champion mounted [his pyre]', but the interpretation of that line is controversial. R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles (2008, p. 186) instead follow Grundtvig in emending *gūð-rinc* to *gūð-réc* 'war-smoke' and compare it with *Beow* 3144b (*wudu-réc á-stāb* 'wood-smoke rose up', which also describes a cremation). Thus, the present stanza "almost certainly refers not to Baldr but to Óðinn, probably imagined to mount the pyre in order to set fire to it" (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 186).

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 55 „Ey mann-gi veit, · hvat þú í ár-daga  
2 sagðir í ęyra syni;  
fęigum munni · męłta'k mńna forna stafi  
4 ok of ragna røk;  
nú við Óðin · deįlda'k mńna orð-spęki;  
6 þú est ę vísastr vera.“

[R 8v/28, A 3v/19–22]

Quoth Webthritrner: “Never will man know what thou in days of yore  
spokest in the ear of thy son.  
With a fey mouth I spoke my ancient staves  
and about the Rakes of the Reins.  
Now with Weden have I shared my word-wisdom—  
thou art for ever wisest of men!”

1 mann-gi | *emend.*; manni (*dat. sg., impossible since a subject to veit is needed*) RA 3 męłta'k | *add. umb* ('um') A

1 ár-daga 'in days of yore' | Relative to the events of the poem, Balder's death has taken place in the far distant past. This therefore situates *Vafþ* in the last (and present) age of the World, namely the period of decline and degeneration immediately preceding the Rakes of the Reins.

3 fęigum 'fey' | "Death-doomed", a word with fatalistic connections. Webthritrner realises that he was bound to die from the moment he proposed the wager (st. 19), as no being can outwit the god of wisdom.

3 mńna forna stafi 'my ancient staves' | Referencing st. 1.

5 orð-spęki 'word-wisdom' | Referencing st. 5.

6 vera 'of men' | *verr* means 'husband, man' and is here used for reasons of alliteration; it does not imply that Weden is not a God.

# Speeches of Grimner

## (*Grímnis mól*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.976)

**Meter:** Leeds-meter (1–2/2, 3–26, 27/4–27/7, 28/1–28/2, 28/6–28/7, 29–33/2, 35–45/2, 46/1–46/2, 47–48/2, 49/3–52, 54–57),  
Ancient-words-law (2/3–2/4, 28/3–28/5, 33/3, 45/3–45/5, 48/3–48/4, 49/1–49/2, 53), Galders-law (27/1–27/3, 34, 46/3–46/5)

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Grimner** (abbrev. *Grm*) is a mythological gnomic poem consisting of Woden's wisdom told to the young prince Ayner as the god sits bound between two fires.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Grm* is preserved whole in both **R** and **A**. The shared prose passages between them prove beyond any doubt that the version of *Grm* in these two manuscripts ultimately goes back to a single written archetype, which may be called \***RA**.

22 stanzas (11–15, 18–20, 23–24, 29, 34–37, 41–42, 45, 47–49) of *Grm* are preserved in citation in *Gylf*, in the case of 23, 24, and 37 explicitly attributed to *Grímnis mól*. Numerous other stanzas (6–8, TODO) are paraphrased in *Gylf*, more or less directly. These stanzas may be said to belong to a **G** redaction of the poem.

*Gylf* predates both **R** and **A**, and **G** must thus be distinct from both of them. Common innovations shared between **R** and **A** (e.g. st. 18/4: om. *við*, 45/4: *Bil-røst*) show that the two share a common written archetype, distinct from that of **G**. It is unclear whether **G** reflects a more distantly related written version or an alternative oral redaction of the poem.

## Structure

*Grm* essentially consists of several nested layers. The outermost layer is the prose passages which bracket the actual poem (P1–P2, P3). It is hard to say for how long these have accompanied the poetry, but since they are found in both **R** and **A** they must go back to a now-lost manuscript archetype.

The second layer is sts. 1–3 and 53–55, which together with the prose form a narrative frame dealing with King Garfrith and his imprisonment of Weden.

At the heart of the poem stand the gnomic wisdom stanzas 4–52, which make up the bulk of the poem. The wisdom is mythological and sometimes obscure, and aligns with other Eddic verse like *Háv*, *Vafþ*, *Bdr*, *Sigrdr*, and *Alv*.

## Origin and motifs

*Grm* consists at its core of the long speech given by the god Weden, and in this way it resembles *Háv*. Both poems may be said to fall squarely under the category of gnomic poetry, but whereas most of *Háv* deals with life-advice of a more general type, *Grm* focuses entirely on mythological and cosmological lore.

The lore found in *Grm* is very varied and most of it will be discussed at length in the notes to the individual stanzas, but a few broader motifs ought to be discussed here.

## The wandering god

Like in *Háv* we here see Weden in his role as the god of travellers and strangers, for he himself is a stranger and frequently travels among mankind. In *Grm* this is made explicit as the god sets out to test the hospitality of his protégé and punishes him harshly when he fails to uphold the duties of a king, which include generosity and hospitality.

The motif of a travelling god testing the hospitality of mankind has ancient and likely Indo-European origins. It is in any case very prevalent in the related Greek tradition. Already in Homer we find it said plainly, *Od* 17.483–487: “Antinoös, you did badly to hit the unhappy vagabond: / a curse on you, if he turns out to be some god from heaven. / For the gods do take on all sorts of transformations, appearing as / strangers from elsewhere, and thus they range at large through the cities, / watching to see which men keep the laws, and which are violent.” (Homer 1965). Is it not just this wrath which we see in *Grm*, when in st. 55 the god, having assumed his true, terrible form, exclaims: “Draw near Me, if thou mayst!”

If any wandering stranger may be a god, indeed the highest god, it naturally follows that one should furnish the impoverished well, lest one incur the wrath of the god(s). This in turn confers a level of heavenly protection on the hands of the traveller and makes hospitality a sacred duty. As much is seen in the Greek epithet of Zeus, Ζεὺς ξένιος ‘Zeus of hospitality’ (Plato, *Laws* 12.953e), the term used for the high god in His role as the protector of

strangers and sacred hospitality (ξενία). With this in mind, we may rightly call Weden in this aspect \**Wōdanaz* ξένιος.

### The land of the Gods

TODO: the God-world, Shamanism, the Ash of Ugdrassle as the *axis mundi*.  
Cite: Eliade on shamanism, PCRN on the recreation of Osyard at a smaller scale.

### Summary

The text begins with the frame narrative, which tells the story of the two young king's sons Ayner and Garfrith. The elder Ayner is fostered by Frie while the younger Garfrith is fostered by her husband, Weden. After their father's death, Garfrith betrays his elder brother upon the advice of Weden and becomes king after his father (P1).

One day Weden and Frie are arguing over their respective foster-sons and Frie accuses Garfrith of torturing wayfaring guests. Weden sets out to test the hospitality of his protégé. Unbeknownst to him, Frie has already sent her handmaid in disguise to warn Garfrith about the coming of a dangerous wizard. When Weden arrives, he is promptly captured and tortured between two fires in order that he will reveal his name. Garfrith's young son, Ayner (clearly named after his uncle), kindly approaches the bound god and offers him a horn of drink. Weden, assuming the name of Grimner, drinks from it and then takes to speak (P2).

Weden begins by complaining about the fires which are now burning his cloak (1); he states that for eight nights not a soul has offered him any help save Ayner, Garfrith's son, who will soon become king after his father (2). As thanks for the drink he gives him good health, and will offer him holy knowledge (3).

Here the gnomic section begins as Weden lists the individual abodes of the Gods (4–17). The named Gods are Thunder (4), Wolder and Free (5), Weden and Sey (7), Weden (8–10), Shede (11), Balder (12), Homedall (13), Frow (14), Foresitter (15), Nearth (16), and Wider (17).

After this list come several sts. relating to Weden and his hall, Walhall (18–23). Mentioned is the preparation of food in Walhall (18), Weden's wolves (19) and ravens (20), the river through which the dead have to wade (21) and the gate through which they have to pass (22), the count of doors in Walhall (23), the count of doors in Thunder's hall Bilshirner (24), and the goat and stag which stand on the hall and gnaw on the branches of the tree Leered (25–26). From the horns of the stag Oakthirner water-droplets fall into Wharyelmer, which is the origin of all rivers (26).

Next follows a list of mythic rivers (27–28), ending with the waters through which Thunder must wade on his way to Ugdrassle (29). This leads to a list of the horses ridden by the other gods on their way to Ugdrassle (31) which is followed by a description of the roots of Ugdrassle (31) and its animals (32–36).

Next follows some miscellaneous lore: a list of Walkirries (37), the horses that pull the sun (38), the shield that protects the earth from the sun's heat (39) and the wolves that chase the sun and moon, the things created from Yimer's body (41–42) with a digression on the significance of the blood (43), the creation of the ship *Shidebladner* (44) and finally a list of the noblest of several categories of things and groups (45).

After these lists Weden utters an unclear stanza invoking the gods (46), before listing his many names (47–50). He then turns to Garfrith, disappointed by the inhospitality and poor conduct of his former protégé, and foresees his imminent death (51–53). He finally reveals himself by his true name, daring Garfrith to face him (53). After this he repeats several of his names (54), and the poem ends.

Upon learning that the wizard is Weden himself, King Garfrith jumps up from his throne to take the god away from the fires, but trips and falls upon his unsheathed sword and dies. After this his son Ayner becomes king and is said to have ruled the kingdom for a long time (P3).



Text

Frá sonum Hraððungs konungs ('From the sons of king Reading')

P1 Hraððungr konungr átti tvá sonu. Hét annarr Agnarr, en annarr  
 2 Geir-røðr. Agnarr var tíu vetra en Geir-røðr átta vetra. Þeir reru  
 tveir á báti með dorgar sínar at smá-fiski. Vindr rak þá í haf  
 4 út. Í nótt-myркri brutu þeir við land ok gingu upp; fundu kot-  
 bónda einn. Þar vóru þeir um vetr'inn. Kerling fostraði Agnar,  
 6 en karl Geir-røð ok kenndi hönnum røð.. At vári fekk karl þeim  
 skip. En er þau kerling leiddu þá til strandar, þá mælti karl ein-  
 8 mæli við Geir-røð. Þeir fengu byr ok kvömu til stöðva fjoðr síns.  
 Geir-røðr var fram í skipi. Hann hljóp upp á land en hratt út  
 10 skipi'nu, ok mælti: „Far þú nú þar er smyl hafi þik!“ Skip'it rak  
 út en Geir-røðr gekk út til bójar. Hönum var vel fagnat; þá var  
 12 faðir hans andaðr. Var þá Geir-røðr til konungs tekinn, ok varð  
 maðr ágættr.

[R 8v/31, A 3v/23]

King Reading had two sons. One was called Ayner and the other Garfrith. Ayner was ten winters old, but Garfrith eight winters. The two were rowing in a boat with their trolling-lines for small fishing. The wind drove them out into the sea. In the dark of night they crashed onto land and walked ashore; they found a lone cottage farmer. There they stayed over the winter. The farmer's wife fostered Ayner but the farmer [fostered] Garfrith and taught him counsel. In the spring the farmer gave them ships, but when he and his wife led them to the shore, the husband spoke private speech with Garfrith. They caught good wind, and came to their father's harbour. Garfrith was in the front of the ship. He leapt onto land and pushed out the ship, and spoke: "Now go whither the fiends may have thee!" The ship drove out but Garfrith walked towards the farm. He was welcomed well; by then his father was ended. Garfrith was then taken as king, and became an excellent man.

1 en | *add.* sonr A 1 annarr | *corr. above line in same hand* A 4 Í nótt-myркri brutu þeir | Þeir  
 brutu í nótt-myркri A 6 karl | *add.* fostraði A 6 ok kenndi hönnum røð. | so A; *om.* R 7  
 strandar | skips A. 10 nú | so A; *om.* R 10 rak | *add.* í haf A 11–12 þá var faðir hans | en  
 faðir hans var þá A 12 Var þá Geir-røðr | Geir-røðr var þá A

4–5 kot-bónda einn 'a lone cottage farmer' | The farmer and his wife were Weden and Frie as is clarified by the following prose.

6 en karl Geir-røð ok kenndi hönnum røð. 'but the farmer Garfrith and taught him counsel' | The motif of Weden favouring the youngest brother is also found in *Rþ*; for Weden's counsel cf. *Háv.*

7–8 þá mælti karl ein-mæli við Geir-røð 'the husband spoke a private speech with Garfrith' | Instructing him to push his brother out to sea.

10 Far þú nú þar er smyl hafi þik! 'Go thou whither the fiends may have thee!' | The same curse is attested with *gramir* for *smyl* in *Hárb* 60 and in a related form in *Brot* 10.

- P2** Óðinn ok Frigg sǫtu í Hlið-skjölfu ok sǫ um heima alla. Óðinn [R 9r/10, A 4r/3]  
 2 mǣlti: „Sér þú Agnar fóstura þinn, hvar hann elr börn við gýgi  
 4 í helli’num? En Geir-røðr, fóstri minn, er konungr ok sitr nú  
 6 at landi.“ Frigg segir: „Hann er mat-níðingr sá at hann kvelr  
 gesti sína ef hǫnum þykkja of-margir koma.“ Óðinn segir at þat  
 8 er in mesta lygi. Þau veðja um þetta mál. Frigg sendi eskis-  
 mey sína, Fullu, til Geir-røðar. Hón bað konung vara-sk at eigi  
 10 fyr-gerði hǫnum fjol-kunnigr maðr sá er þar var kominn í land,  
 12 ok sagði þat mark á at engi hundr var svá ólmr at á hann myndi  
 hlaupa. En þat var inn mesti hé-gómi at Geir-røðr vǣri eigi mat-  
 góðr ok þó léttr hann hand-taka þann mann er eigi vildu hundar  
 á ráða. Sá var í feldi blǫm ok nefndi-sk Grímnir ok sagði ekki  
 14 fleira frá sér þótt hann vǣri at spurðr. Konungr lét hann pína  
 til sagna ok setja milli elda tveggja ok sat hann þar átta nǣtr.  
 16 Geir-røðr konungr átti son tíu vetra gamlan ok hét Agnarr eptir  
 bróður hans. Agnarr gekk at Grímnir ok gaf hǫnum horn fullt  
 at drekka, sagði at konungr gerði illa er hann lét pína hann sak-  
 18 lausan. Grímnir drakk af. Þá var eldr’inn svá kominn at feldr’inn  
 brann af Grímnir. Hann kvað:

Weden and Frie sat in the Lithshelf and looked about all the Homes. Weden spoke: “Dost thou see Ayner, thy foster-son, where he begets children with a troll-woman in her cave? But Garfrith, *my* foster-son, is king and now rules his land.” Frie says: “He is such a meat-nithing that he torments his guests if he thinks too many are coming!” Weden says that this is the greatest lie; they make a wager over this matter. Frie sent her handmaid, Full, to Garfrith’s hall. She bade the king be wary, lest he be destroyed by the manicunning man who had come to his land; and said that his mark was that no hound was so fierce that it would rush at him. But it was the greatest falsehood that Garfrith was not good of meat; and yet he has that man bound whom the hounds would not touch. He was in a blue cloak and called himself Grimner, and did not tell anything more about himself, even though he was asked. The king had him tortured that he would speak, and set him between two fires; and he sat there for eight nights. King Garfrith had a son ten winters old, and he was called Ayner after his brother. Ayner went up to Grimner and gave him a full horn to drink, saying that the king did badly as he had him tortured without cause. Grimner drank it up. Then the fire had grown so much that the cloak burned on Grimner. Quoth he:

1 Hlið-skjölfu | Hlið-skjölf A 1 heima alla | *rev.* A 3 En Geir-røðr, fóstri minn, er konungr | En er konung fóstri minn (*corrupt*) A 3 nú | *om.* A 4 landi | lǫndum A 11 ok | en A 12 ráða | hlaupa A 14 tveggja | *om.* A 14 hann | *om.* A 15 átti | *add.* þá A 17 drekka, | *add.* ok A 17 konungr | faðir hans A 17 illa | *om.* A 17 lét pína hann | pindi þenna mann A

ALL | The motif of Weden and Frie sitting in their Heavenly Seat, looking out over the world and each picking a different side in a conflict is also found in the short 7th century text the Origin of the Nation of the Longbeards (i.e., the Lombards; Latin *Origo Gentis Langbardorum*). The narrative is clearly based on oral tradition brought from Northern Europe in the first centuries of the current era and as such attests the great age of the present motif. The relevant passage is edited at the end of the present poem under the Appendix.

1 Hlið-skjölflu ‘the Lithshelf’ | The lookout post of the Gods, which also appears in *Skí* P1. Cf. *Gylf* 9:11: *Þar er einn staðr; er Hlið-skjölfl beitr, ok þá er Óðinn setti-sk þar í hó-séti, þá sá hann of alla heima ok hvers manns at-hófi ok vissi alla hluti, þá er hann sá.* ‘Thereat (viz. in Osyard) there is one place which is called the Lithshelf, and when Weden sat there in the high seat then he saw throughout all the Homes and each man’s conduct, and knew all the things which he saw.’ and *Gylf* 17:8–9, cited in st. 6 n. below.

2–3 Sér þú Agnar fóstur þinn, hvar hann elr börn við gýgi í helli’num ‘Dost thou see Ayner, thy foster-son, where he begets children with a troll-woman in her cave?’ | This may relate to Frie’s role as love-goddess. Ayner is in any case a weak, effeminate man who devotes his life to copulation rather than war.

## The Speeches of Grimner

- 1 „Hęitr est hripuðr · ok hęldr til mikill,  
2 gęng=umk firr funi!  
Loði sviðnar, · þó'tt á lopt bera'k;  
4 brinn=umk feldr fyrir.

[R 9r/27, A 4r/17]

“HOT ART THOU, SCORCHER, and far too great—  
go far from me, O flame!  
My wool cape is singed though I hold it aloft;  
the cloak burns before me!

---

3 bera'k | vera A

---

2 gęng=umk firr 'go far from me' | Equivalent to *gakk mér firr*. The word *gęng=umk* 'go ... from me' merits some linguistic discussion on the form of the imperative (*gęng-* rather than *gakk*) and the suffixed pronoun *=umk*. The normal 2sg imper. of ON *gęnga* 'to go' is *gakk*, which goes back to a sound change in PN whereby word-final homorganic clusters were devoiced, and in the case of clusters of the form /NC/ assimilated into /C:/ . Thus PN \**gęng* 'go!' (cf. Got. *gęgg* / *gęng* /, OHG *gęng*) > \**gęnk* > *gakk*, also \**stęnd* 'stand!' > *stętt*, \**bęnd* 'bind!' > *bętt*. This sound change was only active in early PN, and only affected those clusters which were word-final before syncope of unstressed vowels; thus in the ON 1sg pres. ind. *ęk gęng*, *ęk stęnd* (< \**ęk gęngu*, *ęk stęndu*) 'I go, I stand' etc. we find the original cluster preserved.

At some time in early PN, accusative personal pronouns were suffixed to certain verbs; those which survive into ON are 1sg *=umk* (= ON *mik*) and 3sg reflexive *=sk* (= ON *sik*). In later ON these clitics became the passive endings still found in modern North Germanic, but in archaic or poetic ON they could still serve as suffixed pronouns with a reflexive or even dative function, as is the case in this instance. The fact that the suffixation of the pronoun has prevented assimilation of the consonant cluster *ng* establishes its *terminus ante quem* as the first syncope period, the early 7th century, and since it is unlikely that such an irregular form as *gęng=umk* could have survived for long alongside *gakk*, its presence here probably allows us to conclude that *Grim* is a rather old poem.

Other instances of dative *=umk* include *Lok* 35/1a: *es=umk*, *Fęfi* 1/4: *stęnd=umk*, *Eddęr* II 1/1: *eru=mk*, and *Rdr* 7/2a: *gęf=umk*.

- 2 Átta nętr · sat'k milli ęlda hęr,  
svá't męr mann=gi mat né bauð  
nema ęinn Agnarr, · es ęinn skal ráða,  
4 Gęir-røðar sonr, · Gotna landi.

[R 9r/29, A 4r/18]

For eight nights I sat between the fires here,  
while no man offered me food,  
save for Ayner alone, who alone shall rule—  
Garfrith's son—the land of the Gots!

- 3 Hęill skalt, Agnarr, · alls hęilan biðr  
þik Vera-týr vesa;  
ęins drykkjar · skalt aldri=gi  
4 bętri gjöld geta:

[R 9r/31, A 4r/20]

Hale shalt thou be, Ayner, for hale  
 does Were-Tew (= Weden) bid thee be.  
 For a single drink shalt thou never get  
 better recompense.

3 çins drykkjar ‘For a single drink’ | The horn which Ayner offered Weden (P2 above).

4 bętri gjöld ‘better recompense’ | Namely the mythic lore which takes up sts. 4–45.

4      **L**and es heilag, · es liggja sé’k [R 9r/33, A 4r/22]  
 2              ęsum ok ęlfum nęr;  
             ęn í Þrúð-ęęimi · skal Þórr vesa  
 4              und’s of rjúfa=sk ręgin.

The land is holy which I see lying  
 near the Eese and Elves,  
 but in Thrithham shall Thunder dwell  
 until the Reins are ripped.

4 und’s of rjúfa=sk ręgin ‘until the Reins are ripped’ | Until the Rakes of the Reins. A formulaic expression; see note to *Bdr* 14/4 for further occurrences.

5      **Ý**-dalir ęęita, · þar’s Ullr ęęfir [R 9v/2, A 4r/23]  
 2              sér of gęrva sali;  
             **A**lf-ęęim Freý · gęfu í ár-daga  
 4              tívar at tann-féi.

Yewdales they are called where Wolder has  
 made for himself a hall.  
 Elfham to Free in days of yore  
 the Tews as a tooth-gift gave.

1 Ý-dalir ‘Yewdales’ | Little more is known about these valleys, of which this is the singular attestation. They are certainly named for the use of the yew-tree in bow-making, since the god Wolder is associated with bows and archery (*Gylf* 31:2).

3 Alf-ęęim ‘Elfham’ | TODO.

4 tann-féi ‘tooth-gift’ | The gift the child receives when he sheds his first tooth.

6      **B**ór es sá (hinn þriði), · es blíð ręgin [R 9v/3, A 4r/25]  
 2              silfri þękðu sali;  
             **V**ala-skjölf ęęitir, · es vélti sér  
 4              ęss í ár-daga.

By is (the third) one, where the blithe Reins  
 with silver thatched the halls.

Waleshelf is the name of the one which he won through wiles,  
the Os in days of yore.

ALL | This stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 17:8–9: *Þar er enn mikill staðr, er Vala-skjölfr heitir. Þann stað á Óðinn. Þann gerðu goðin ok þekðu skiru silfri, ok þar er Hlið-skjölfr in í þessum sal, þat há-sėti, er svá heitir, ok þá er Al-fjör sitr í því sėti, þá sér hann of alla heima.* ‘There is yet another great place which is called Waleshelf. That place Weden owns. The Gods made it and thatched it with pure silver, and in these hall is the Lithshelf, the high-seat which is called so, and when Allfather sits in that seat then he sees throughout all the Homes.’

1 (hinn þriði) ‘(the third)’ | The first numbering of a location; the numbering continues up to st. 16. Although paralleled by other numbered poetic lists (*Háv* 147–165, *Vafþ* 20–42) some circumstances speak against the numbers in *Grm* being authorial. First, the alliteration is never reliant on the numbers, which is quite different from the numbered items in *Háv* 147–165 and *Vafþ* 20–42. Secondly the numbering is inconsistent; Thunder’s realm (st. 4) is not counted, and Wider’s land (st. 17) has no numeral (perhaps since the form of the stanza would not allow it.) Third, in *Gylf*’s citations of sts. 11–15 the numbers are missing.

1 blíð regin ‘the blithe Reins’ | A reverent epithet for the Gods, also occurring in sts. 38/3, 42/1 below. Parodied by Lock in *Lok* 32/3. For other epithets cf. *Vafþ* 13/4 n.

3 es vélti sér ‘won through wiles’ | Several previous editors and translators (e.g. Finnur Jónsson (1932), Pettit (2023), Larrington (2014)) have rendered this phrase with variants of “craftily made for himself”, where the verb *væla* would mean ‘craftily make’. To my knowledge this sense is never otherwise attested, and its common meaning is ‘defraud, trick, betray’. A simpler reading would be to see this as a reference to the myth of the ettin Master Builder who built the wall of Otyard as alluded to in *Vsp* 24–25 and told at length in *Gylf* 42. The Gods had promised him Frow and the Sun and Moon if he could build it within a year, but to slow him down they made use of various tricks. When at last it seemed like he would make it in time, they called upon Thunder who arrived and killed him.

7 Sökkva-þekkr heitir (hinn fjórði), · en þar svalar knegu

[R 9v/5, A 4r/26]

2 unnir glymja yfir;

þar þau Óðinn ok Sága · drekka umb alla daga

4 glöð ór gollnum krumum.

Sinkbench is (the fourth) one called, but there do cool  
waves clash overhead;  
there Weden and Sey drink for all days,  
glad, out of golden casks.

2 glymja yfir | metr. emend.; rev. RA

ALL | This stanza is likely paraphrased in *Gylf* 35:3: *Qnnur er Sága. Hón býr á Sökkva-bekk, ok er þat mikill staðr.* ‘The other [goddess] is Sey. She lives in Sinkbench, and that is a great place.’

8 Glaðs-heimr heitir (hinn fimti) · þar’s hin goll-bjarta

[R 9v/7, A 4r/28]

2 Val-höll víð of þrumir;

en þar Hroptr · kýss hverjan dag

4 vāpn-dauða vera.

Gladsham is (the fifth) one called, where the gold-bright  
Walhall, wide, stands fast,

but there Roft (= Weden) chooses every day  
weapon-dead warriors.

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1 heitir | es A 2 of | om. A

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ALL | For Gladsham see *Gylf* 14:2–7, which likely paraphrases this stanza, cited in *Vsp* 7 n.

3–4 en ... vera ‘but ... warriors.’ | For Weden’s chosing of the slain see st. 14.

- 9 Mjok ’s auð-kennt · þeim’s til Óðins koma [R 9v/10, A 4r/30]  
2 sal-kynni at séa,  
skoptum ’s rann reþt, · skjöldum ’s salr þakiðr,  
4 brynjum of bækki stráat.

Very easily recognized by those who come to Weden  
is the hall to see:

With shafts is the house roofed, with shields is the hall thatched;  
with byrnies the benches strewn.

---

1 til | om. A

---

ALL | In R the order of sts. 9 and 10 is reversed, but a sign at the start of each suggests they should switch places; this is further indicated by the abbreviation of ll. 1–2 in st. 10.

3 skoptum ‘shafts’ | Spear-shafts.

3 skjöldum ’s salr þakiðr ‘with shields is the hall thatched’ | The same is said in *Gylf* 2:6–7: *Þak bennar var lagt gylldum skjöldum svá sem spán-þak. Svá segir Þjóð-ólfr inn hvin-verski, at Val-höll var skjöldum þekð.* ‘Its roof was covered with gilt shields like a shingle-roof. So does Thedwolf the Whine-dweller say that Walhall was thatched with shields.’ After this, *Gylf* cites Þhorn *Harkv* 11/1–2, which uses the kenning *Sváfnis sal-néfrar* ‘Swebner’s hall-shingles [SHIELDS]’, where Swebner is a name for Weden (cf. st. 57 below).

- 10 Mjok ’s auð-kennt · þeim’s til Óðins koma [R 9v/9, A 4r/31]  
2 sal-kynni at séa,  
vargr hangir · fyr vestan dyrr  
4 ok drúpir orn yfir.

Very easily recognized by those who come to Weden  
is the hall to see:

A wolf hangs before the western door,  
and an eagle droops down over it.

---

2 sal-kynni at séa | †sia at sia† A

---

3–4 vargr hangir · fyr vestan dyrr / ok drúpir ǫrn yfir. ‘A wolf hangs before the western door, and an eagle droops down over it.’ | Something very similar is found in Widukind of Corvey’s *History of the Saxons* 1:12. The Saxons had just conquered a fortress, and *mane [...] facto ad orientalem portam ponunt aquilam, aramque victoriae construunt secundum errorem paternum sacra sua propria veneratione venerati sunt* ‘at the coming of morning they set an eagle at the eastern gate, and, building an altar of victory, they worshipped it with their own holy worship in accordance with their ancestral error.’ The altar was pledged to Ermen, whom Widukind identifies with Mars or Hermes, certainly Woden. According to Hyltén-Cavallius (1863, p. 156) it was custom in Wärend, southern Sweden to hang the bodies of killed wolves high up in old oaks, and killed birds of prey above the stable-door.

- 11 Þrym-heimr heitir (hinn sétti), · es Þjatsi bjó,  
 2 sá hinn ám-átki jötunn;  
 3 en nú Skaði byggvir, · skír brúðr goða,  
 4 fornar toptir fǫður.

[R 9v/12, A 4v/2,  
 S 6v/20, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

Thrimham is (the sixth) one called, where Thedse dwelled,  
 that uncanny ettin;  
 but now Shede bedwells—the pure bride of the Gods—  
 the ancient plots of her father.

1 Þrym-heimr | Þrúð-heimr U 1 (hinn sétti) ‘the sixth’ | *om.* G 1 es ‘where’ | þar nú ‘where now’ U 1 bjó ‘dwelled’ | *om.* W; býr ‘dwells’ U 2 ám-átki | mátki U 3 goða ‘of the Gods’ | guma ‘of men’ U 4 fornar | forna A; †fornir† T

ALL | St. 11 is cited in *Gylf* 23:15, introduced by the words *Svá er sagt* ‘So it is said’ and concluding the chapter. For the rest of the chapter see *Eddabr* II.

2 ám-átki jötunn ‘uncanny ettin’ | Formulaic. See note to *Vsp* 8.

- 12 Bręiða-blik eru (hin sjaundu), · en þar Baldr hefir  
 2 sér of gǫrva sal,  
 3 á því landi · es liggja vęit’k  
 4 fęsta fęikn-stafi.

[R 9v/14, A 4v/3,  
 S 6v/4, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

Broadblisks are (the seventh), but there Balder has  
 made for himself a hall,  
 in that land where I know lie  
 the fewest wicked deeds.

1 Bręiða-blik | Bręiða (*with blisk added above the line in other hand*) R; Bręiða-†blío† A 1 eru (hin sjaundu) ‘are (the seventh)’ | heita [‘they’] are called STW; heitir ‘is one called’ U. 4 fęikn-stafi | †fęing†-stafi U

ALL | St. 12 is cited in *Gylf* 22:22, introduced by the words *Svá sem hér segir* ‘Just as it says here’ and concluding the chapter, which tells about Balder. *Gylf* 22:21 provides context: *Hann býr þar, sem heitir Bręiða-blik. Þat er á himni. Í þeim stað má ekki vera ó-breint.* ‘He [viz. Balder] lives at the place called Broadblisks. That is in Heaven. In that place may nothing be unclean.’



4 feikn-stafi ‘wicked deeds’ | This sense of *stafir* (lit. ‘staffs, staves’) is common in poetry. Cf. the direct cognate in *Beow* 1018b: *fäcen-stafas*, generally taken as referring to treacherous intrigues among the Shieldings (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 177).

### 13 Himin-björg eru (hin öttu), · en þar Hëim·dall

2 kveða valda véum;  
þar vqrðr goða · drekkir í véru ranni  
4 glaðr hinn góða mjöð.

Heavenbarrows are (the eighth), but there Homedall,  
they say, wields over wighs.  
There the Watchman of the Gods drinks in the tranquil house,  
glad, the good mead.

1 eru (hin öttu) ‘are (the eighth)’ | hëita ‘[they] are called’ STW; hëitir ‘is one called’ U. 1 Hëim·dall | Hëim·dallr býr U 3 þar | om. U 3 vqrðr | vqrðum U 4 hinn | so AG; om. R

ALL | St. 13 is cited in *Gylf* 27:14, the chapter dealing with Homedall, introduced by the words: *Hér er svá sagt* ‘Here it is said so’. For the full chapter see *Eddbr* III.

3 vqrðr goða ‘Watchman of the Gods’ | Formulaic epithet of Homedall, also occurring in *Lok* 48/4 and possibly in *Ski* 28 (*vqrðr með goðum* ‘the Watchman among the Gods’). A similar epithet is found in *Húsdr* 2, *vári ragna* ‘Defender of the Reins’. *Gylf* 27, where the present stanza is cited, gives some further details; see *Eddbr* III.

### 14 Folk-vangr es (hinn níundi), · en þar Freyja rëðr

2 sessa kostum í sal;  
halfan val · hön kyss hvęrjan dag,  
4 en halfan Öðinn á.

Folkwong is (the ninth), but there Frow rules  
the choice of seats in the hall;  
half the slain she chooses each day,  
but half does Weden own.

1 es (hinn níundi) ‘is (the ninth)’ | hëitir ‘[one] is called’ G 2 sessa kostum í | kosta bęstum U 3 hvęrjan dag | hvęrn dag U

ALL | St. 14 is cited in *Gylf* 24:9, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The immediately preceding *Gylf* 24:6–8 provides context: *En Freyja er á-gętrust af ósynjum. Hón á þann bó á himni er Fölk-vangar beita, ok þvar sem hón riðr til vígs þá á hón halfan val, en halfan Öðinn*. ‘But Frow is the most distinguished of the Ossens. She has the dwelling in Heaven which is called the Folkwongs, and wherever she rides into battle she owns half of the slain, but Weden [has the other] half’.

3 halfan val · hön kyss hvęrjan dag ‘half the slain she chooses each day’ | Apart from the paraphrase in *Gylf* this statement is unprecedented; in all other sources the battle-slain are devoted exclusively to Weden and chosen by his walkirries.

The roots of *kjósa val* ‘choose the slain’ are the same as those in *val-kyrja* ‘walkirrie’, lit. ‘chooser of the slain’, and as Frow is a prominent goddess this could be seen to make her the chief walkirrie. This is paralleled by *Sþrla*, where Frow assumes the name Gandle (*Göndul*, a name attested in several lists of walkirries; see *Vsp* 30 n.) and incites the legendary never-ending Conflict of the Headenings (*Hjaðningavíg*).

[R 9v/16, A 4v/5,  
S 7r/21, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

[R 9v/17, A 4v/6,  
S 6v/27, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

In spite of this there is reason to believe that the chief walkirrie was rather Frie, Weden's wife. First, one of the functions of the Walkirries is to bear ale to the Oneharriers (*Grm* 37). This mirrors a real custom at Germanic banquets attested where the host's wife or daughter would pour ale to his retainers and guests (the so-called "lady with a mead cup" ritual most famously seen in *Beow*; see Enright (1996) and Riseley (2014)). As Weden's wife, we would expect Frie to have this role. Second, at Balder's funeral (*Gylf* 49:49–52), Frie rides with Weden and the Walkirries while Frow rides alone with her cats; if Frow were the chief walkirrie we would probably expect her to ride at the head of them. Third, there are two separate myths where Frie and Weden contend over the fates of armies and men; these are the prose introduction to the present poem (P2 above) and the Longbeard origin myth (see Appendix below), whereas Frow and Weden do not otherwise come into conflict over the slain.

Whether the present stanza originally referred to Frie is hard to say, although confusion between Frow and Frie would probably not be expected in a source as old as *Grm*.

15      **Glitnir** es (hinn tíundi), · hann 's **golli** studdr

2              ok silfri þakðr it sama;  
             en þar **For**-seti · byggvir fíestan dag  
 4              ok svéfir allar sakir.

[R 9v/19, A 4v/8,  
 S 7r/34, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

Glitner is (the tenth): it is supported by gold,  
 and thatched with silver likewise,  
 but there Foresitter dwells for most days,  
 and puts all disputes to sleep.

1 es (hinn tíundi) 'is (the tenth)' | 'h. e. x.' (for \*'e. h. x.') A; heitir salr 'a hall is called' G 1 's |  
 om. U 2 þakðr it | om. U 3 þar | þat ST; þá W

ALL | St. 15 is cited in *Gylf* 32:4, introduced by the words *Svá segir hér*: 'So it says here.' *Gylf* 32:2–3 provides context: *Hann á þann sal á himni, er Glitnir heitir. En allir, er til hans koma með sakarvand-ríði, þá fara allir sáttir á braut. Sá er dóm-staðr betstr með goðum ok mönnum*. 'He has the hall in heaven which is called Glitner. But all who come to him with difficult disputes then all go away reconciled. That is the best judgment place amongst gods and men.'

16      **Nóa-tùn** eru (hin elliptu), · en þar **Njorðr** hēfir

2              sér of gorra sali;  
             **manna** þengill · hinn meins-vani  
 4              **hó**-timbruðum **horgi** réðr.

[R 9v/21, A 4v/9]

Nowetons are (the eleventh), and there Nearth has  
 made for himself a hall.  
 The lord of men, the guiltless one,  
 rules the harrow timbered on high.

3 manna þengill · hinn meins-vani 'The lord of men, the guiltless one' | Interesting epithets probably relating to Nearth's roles in upholding the prosperity of the land and the law. Cf. my article on pre-Christian oaths (TODO).

4 hó-timbruðum horgi réðr 'rules the harrow timbered on high' | The rare verb *hó-timbra* 'timber on high' otherwise only occurs in *Vsp* 7, likewise in connection with the *horgir* 'harrow'. The harrow is an outdoors holy place; see there. Cf. also *Vafþ* 38 where Nearth is said to rule a great many *hofum* ok *horgum* 'hoves and harrows'.

- 17 **H**rísi vęx · ok **h**ou grasi  
2 **V**ið·ars land, viði,  
**ę**n þar **m**ogr of lét=sk · af **m**ars baki  
4 **f**rókn at hefna **f**ður.

[R 9v/23, A 4v/11]

With brushwood and with tall grass grows,  
Wider's land, with wood,  
but there the lad vows from the back of his steed,  
brave, to avenge his father.

---

4 at | ok ('j') RA

---

ALL | At the Rakes of the Reins Wider must avenge his father, Weden. See *Vsp* 51–52, *Vafþ* 53.

1 Hrísi vęx · ok hou grasi 'With brushwood and with tall grass grows' | Identical to *Háv* 119/6.

- 18 **A**nd·hrímnir · létu í **E**ld·hrímn  
2 **S**ę·hrímn **s**oðinn,  
**f**leşka bętst, · ęn þat **f**air vitu,  
4 við hvat **ę**in·hęrjar **a**la=sk.

[R 9v/24, A 4v/12,  
S 9v/12, T 10r/18,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Andrimner lets in Eldrimner  
Sowrimner be cooked,  
the best of meats, but few know this:  
by what the Oneharriers are nourished.

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1 **A**nd·hrímnir | **A**nd·runnir T 1 **E**ld·hrímn | **E**ld·runni T 2 **S**ę·hrímn | **S**ę·runni T 3  
**f**leşka | †felska† S 4 við | so G; om. RA

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ALL | The poem moves away from the dwellings of the individual gods to an extended description of Walhall and its surroundings. The cook Andrimner 'Face-sooty' cooks the boar Sowrimner 'Sow-sooty' in the cauldron Eldrimner 'Fire-sooty'; by this meat are the Oneharriers nourished. —

Sts. 18–20 are cited in order in *Gylf* 38 interspersed by short prose explanations. St. 18 is cited following *Gylf* 38:6. *Gylf* 38:3, 5–6 introduces it: *En aldri er svá mikill mann-fjöldi í Val-höll at eigi má þeim enda-sk flesk galtar þess er Sę-brímnir heitir. Hann er soðinn hvern dag ok beill at aptni. [...] And-brímnir heitir steikari'n en Eld-brímnir ketill'inn. Svá er hér sagt: 'But there is never such a great gathering of men in Walhall that they should not be fully furnished with the flesh of that boar which is called Sowrimner. He is cooked every day and is healthy and alive in the evening. [...] Andrimner is the name of the cook, but Eldrimner the kettle. So it is said here:'*

- 19 **G**era ok Freka · sęðr **g**unn-tamiðr,  
2 **h**róðigr **H**ęrja-fður,  
**ę**n við **v**in ętt · **v**ápn-gofugr  
4 **Ó**ðinn **ę** lifir.

[R 9v/26, A 4v/14,  
S 9v/17, T 10r/23,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Gar and Freak does the battle-accustomed  
glorious Father of Hosts (= Weden) feed,  
but on wine alone, esteemed of weapons,  
Weden ever lives.

1 gunn-tamiðr | †gunnta midr† T 3 vápn-göfugr | vápn-gafir ST; vápn-†gaffiþr† U 4 é |  
er T

ALL | St. 19 is cited in *Gylf* 38:10, introduced by the words *Svá segir hér*. ‘So it says here.’ *Gylf* 38:7–9 provides context: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvárt befir Óðinn þat sama borð-bald sem Ein-berjar?“ Hár segir: „Þá vist, er á hans borði stendr, gefr hann tveim úlfum, er hann á, er svá beita, Geri ok Freki. En enga vist þarf hann: Vin er honum bæði drykkir ok matr.* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “Does Weden have the same things on his table as the Oneharriers?” High says: “The foodstuff which stands on his table he gives to the two wolves he owns, which are called thusly: Gar and Freak. But he needs no foodstuffs; for him wine is both drink and food.”

1 Gera ok Freka ‘Gare and Freak’ | Weden’s two hounds. It is not said with what food Weden feeds them, but if we consider Weden’s relation to the common ‘beasts of battle’ motif, it is most likely the corpses of dead warriors.

3 vín ‘wine’ | The wine on which Weden himself subsists may perhaps be identified with drink offerings. For hallowing of alcohol to this god cf. the 7th c. *Vita Columbani*, ch. 53, describing a heathen rite of the Swabians (Jonas of Bobbio 1851, 1040D–1041A, my translation):

*Quo cum moraretur, et inter habitatores loci illius progrediretur, reperit eos sacrificium profanum litare velle, vasque magnum, quod vulgo cupam vocant, quod viginti et sex modios amplius minusve capiebat, cervisia plenum in medio habebant positum. Ad quod vir Dei accessit, et sciscitatur quid de illo fieri vellent. Illi aiunt deo suo Vodano, quem Mercurium vocant alii, se velle litare.* ‘While he was staying there and going about the dwellers of that place, he found out that they were going to offer a profane sacrifice, and a large cask called a *cupa*, which held about twenty-six measures, was filled with beer and set in their midst. When the man of God asked what they wanted to do with it they answered that they wanted to offer it to their god *Vodan*, whom others call Mercury.’

## 20 Huginn ok Muninn · fljúga hverjan dag

- 2 jörmun-grund yfir;  
ó=umk of Hugin, · at apr né komi=t;  
4 þó sé=umk meirr of Munin.

Highen and Minden fly every day  
over the ermen-ground [EARTH].

I worry for Highen that he might not come back,  
yet I fear more for Minden.

1 hverjan dag | hvern dag U 3 ó=umk | †otunk† T; †unz† U 3 of | ek G 3 né | om. TU  
3 komi=t | komi ASTW; komr U

ALL | St. 20 is cited following *Gylf* 38:13, and its citation concludes the chapter. The stanza is introduced by the words *Gylf* 38:11–13 provides context: *Hrafnar tveir sitja á oxlum bónum ok segja í eyru bónum öll tíðendi, þau er þeir sjá eða heyra. Þeir beita svá, Huginn ok Muninn. Þá sendir hann í dagan at fljúga um heim allan, ok koma þeir aprt at dögurðar-máli. Þar af verðr hann margra tíðenda viss. Því kalla menn hann Hrafn-guð. Svá sem sagt er:* ‘Two ravens sit upon his shoulders and tell into his ears all the tidings which they see or hear. They are called so: Highen and Minden. He sends them out at dawn to fly throughout all the Home, and they come back at supper-time; thereof he is made aware of many tidings. For this reason men call him Raven-god. As it is said:’

2 jörmun-grund ‘ermen-ground’ | The ‘world-ground’, i.e., ‘the whole wide world’, a poetic compound denoting the earth as a flat, spacious expanse of land, surrounded by the unbounded outer sea. In ON this word only occurs elsewhere at two places: in a kenning on the late C10th Karlevi stone (Öl I), which refers to the unbounded sea as *Endils jörmun-grund* ‘Andle’s ermen-ground’ (Andle being a known sea-king), and in the C13th Sturl *Hryn* 16/2 (SkP 2), referring generically to land. A direct cognate, OE *eormen-grund*, appears only once, in *Beow* 859, where it carries the same sense as in the present stanza.

[R 9v/28, A 4v/15,  
S 9v/22, T 10r/28,  
W TODO, U TODO]

- 21 Þýtr Þund, · unir Þjóð-vitnis  
2 fiskr flóði í;  
áar straumur · þykkir of-mikill  
4 val-glaumi at vaða.

[R 9v/30, A 4v/17]

Thound roars; Thedwitner's fish  
thrives in the flood.  
The river-stream seems far too great  
for the noisy slain host to wade.

3 þykkir | so A; om. R 4 val-glaumi | val-glaumni A

ALL | A difficult stanza. Considering the st. is in the middle of others describing Weden and Walhall, Thound is possibly the river moat which the dead warriors have to pass over to reach Walhall. The stanza may also be referring to the punishment of criminals in waters (for which see *Vsp* 38 n.).

1-2 Þjóð-vitnis fiskr 'Thedwitner's fish' | Þjóð-vitnir is easily analyzed as þjóð- 'great, main' + vit-nir 'wolf' and the great wolf is of course the Fenerswolf. The Wolf is called the brother of the Middenyardswyrm (*Hym* 23), and so that may be its "fish". That the Wýrm can be called a fish is shown by *Hym* 24. The "fish" can also be Nithehewer, the dragon who tortures slain criminals (*Vsp* 38).

- 22 Val-grind heitir · es stendr velli á  
2 heilög fyr helgum durum;  
forn 's sú grind, · en þat fáir vitu,  
4 hvé hön 's í lás of lokin.

[R 9v/32, A 4v/18]

Walgrind it is called which stands on the plain,  
holy, before the holy doors.  
Ancient is that gate, but few do know  
how its lock is locked.

4 of | so A; om. R

1 Val-grind 'Walgrind' | 'Slain-gate', the gate standing before Walhall.

- 23 Fimm hundruð golfa · ok umb fjórum tögum  
2 svá hygg'k Bil-skirni með bugum;  
ranna þeira, · es ek reþt vita,  
4 mǫns veit'k mest magari.

[R 9v/34, A 4v/22,  
S 6r/24, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

With five hundred floors and around fourty—  
so I judge Bilshirner altogether.  
Of those houses which I might know rafted  
I know my lad's [= Thunder] is the greatest.

ALL | *Sts. 23 and 24 come in reverse order in A.* 1 umb | om. U 2 hygg'k | add. á Val-höll vesa (*dittography through homoioarcton*) A 3 reþt | réfr U 4 mǫns | †murs† T

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 21, the chapter describing Thunder, immediately following *Gylf* 21:4–6, which reads: *Hann á þar ríki er Þrúð-vangar heita, en þoll hans heitir Bil-skirnir. Í þeim sal eru fimm hundruð gólfa ok fjórir tígir. Þat er þús mest svá at menn viti. Svá segir í Grimnis-mólum:* ‘He has his domain in the place called the Thrithwongs, but his hall is called Bilshirner. In that hall there are five hundred and forty floors. That is the greatest house which men know of. So it says in the Speeches of Grimmer.’

- 24 Fimm hundruð dura · ok umb fjórum tögum,  
 2 svá hygg á Val-höllu vesa;  
 átta hundruð Fín-herja · ganga senn ór einum durum,  
 4 þá's fara við vitni at vega.

[R 10r/2, A 4v/20,  
 S 10r/10, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

Five hundred doors and around forty—  
 so I judge there to be on Walhall.  
 Eight hundred Oneharriers march at once out of one door  
 when to fight with the Wolf they fare.

1 hundruð | hund T 1 umb | om. AU 1 fjórum tögum | abbrev. as .xl. A; fjóra tugu 2  
 hygg | kveð'k A 2 á | at R; om. T 2 Val-höllu | Val-höll ATW 3 senn | om. RU 4 fara |  
 ganga U 4 við | so AWU; at R; með ST

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 40:4, introduced by the words: *Hér mátt-u beyra í Grimnis-mólum.* ‘Here mightst thou hear in the Speeches of Grimmer.’ *Gylf* 40:1–3 provides the context *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Þetta eru undar-lig tíðendi, er nú sagðir þú. Geysi-mikit þús mun Val-höll vera. All-þröngt mun þar opt vera fyrir durum.“ Þá svarar Hárr: „Hví spyrst þú eigi þess, hversu margar dyrr eru á höllinni eða hversu stórar? Ef þú beyrir þat sagt, þá munt-u segja, at bitt er undar-ligt, ef eigi má ganga út ok inn hvern; er vill. En þat er með sönnu at segja, at eigi er þröngra at skipa bana en ganga í bana.* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “These are wondrous tidings which thou hast now told. An enormously great house must Walhall be. It must often be fully cramped before the doors there.” Then answers High: “Why askest thou not how many doors there are on the hall or how great they are? If thou hearest that told then thou wilt say that the contrary is wondrous, that every one should not be able to go out and in as he wants to. But with truth it is to be said that it is not more crowded to be inside it than to enter it.’

3 átta hundruð ‘eight hundred’ | The hundred is probably here the long hundred (120, rather than 100), which gives a sum of 640 \* 960 = 614 400 Oneharriers.

4 þá's fara við vitni at vega ‘when to fight with the Wolf they fare’ | At the Rakes of the Reins by Weden's side. Cf. *Vsp* 51–52, *Vafþ* 53.

- 25 Heið-rún heitir geit, · es stendr höllu á (Hərja-föðrs)  
 2 ok bítr af Lē-raðs limum;  
 skap-kęr fylla · skal hins skıra mjaðar,  
 4 kná=at sú veig vana=sk.

[R 10r/4, A 4v/24]

Heathrune is the goat called which stands on the hall (of the Father of Hosts)  
 and bites from Leered's branches.  
 The shape-vat she shall fill with the pure mead;  
 those draughts do not wane.

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 39:4–5: *Geit síu, er Heið-rún beitiir, stendr uppi á Val-boll ok bítr barr af limum trés þess, er mjök er nafn-frégt, er Lē-raðr beitiir, en ór spenum bennar rennr mjöðr sá, er hón fyllir skap-ker hvorn dag. Þat er svá mikit, at allir Ein-herjar verða full-drukknir af*. ‘That goat which is called Heathrune stands upon Walhall and bites the leaves from the branches of that tree which is very renowned, which is called Leedred. But out of her teats flows such mead that she fills the shape-vat every day. It is so great that all the Oneharriers become fully drunk thereof.’

1 hollu á (Hērja-fōðrs) ‘on the hall of the Father of Hosts’ | On Walhall. *Hērja-fōðrs* ‘of the Father of Hosts’ is almost certainly an unmetrical later insert in order to clarify which hall the poet is referring to and has therefore been placed in parentheses.

2 Lē-raðs ‘Leered’ | The Ash of Ugdrassle, as is seen by the mention of the stag in st. 26/1 and again in st. 36/3.

3 skap-ker ‘shape-vat’ | According to CV the central beer-vat, from which drinks were poured into smaller vessels.

3 hins skira mjaðar ‘the pure mead’ | The goat’s milk is mead.

- 26 Eik·þyrnir hēitir hjōtr · es stendr *hollu á* (Hērja-fōðrs) [R 10r/6, A 4v/26]  
 2 ok bítr af Lē·raðs limum;  
 en af hans hornum · drýpr í Hver-gelmi  
 4 þaðan ēiga vōtn qll vega:

Oakthirner is the hart called which stands on the hall (of the Father of Hosts)  
 and bites from Leered’s branches,  
 but from his horns it drip into Wharyelmer;  
 thence all waters have their courses:

1 *hollu á* | emend.; rev. RA 1 *hollu* | ‘hællu’ A 3 Hver-gelmi | †hvergælgji† (fōr \*‘hvergæلمي’) A

ALL | *Gylf* 39:7–8 continues with its paraphrase: *Þá mēlti Hárr: „Enn er meira mark at of hjōrt inn Eik·þyrni, er stendr á Val-boll ok bítr af limum þess trés, en af hornum hans verðr svá mikill dropi, at niðr kemr í Hver-gelmi*, ‘Then spoke High: “Yet a greater feature of it [viz. Walhall] is the hart Oakthirner, who stands upon Walhall and bites from the branches of that tree. But from his horns comes such great dripping that it goes down into Wharyelmer,’

- 27 Síð ok Við, Sēkin ok Eikin, · Svōl ok Gunn-þró, [R 10r/9, A 4v/28]  
 2 Fjorm ok Fimbul·þul,  
 Rīn ok Rinnandi,  
 4 Gīpul ok Gōpul, · Gōmul ok Gēir-vimul,  
 þēr hverfa umb hodd goða,  
 6 Þyn ok Vin, · Þqll ok Hqll,  
 Grōð ok Gunn-þorin.

Side and Wide, Shin and Oaken, Swale and Guththrew,  
 Ferm and Fimblethule,  
 Rhine and Rinning,  
 Gipple and Gapple, Gamble and Garwimble—  
 they circle round the hoard of the Gods [= Osyard]—

Tyne and Ween, Thuil and Huil,  
Gread and Guththorn.

ALL | Sts. 27–28 list numerous rivers, many of which are undoubtedly mythological. For the sake of having somewhat more natural Anglicized renditions I have taken many of the names from Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (CV, p. 780), who identified them with real rivers in Scotland and England, although it must be said that many or all of their identifications are entirely unverifiable and probably incorrect. —

*Gylf* 39:9–10 immediately continues with its paraphrase (cf. sts. 25–26 above), clearly deriving from sts. 27–28: *ok þaðan affalla þér ár, er svá heita: Sið, Við, Sekin, Ekin, Svöl, Gunn-þró, Fjorm, Fimbul-þul, Gípul, Gopul, Gómul, Geir-vimul. Þessar falla um ása byggðir. Þessar eru enn nefndar: Þyn, Vín, Þöll, Høll, Gröð, Gunn-þráin, Nyt, Nøt, Nønn, Hrønn, Vína, Veg-svinn, Þjóð-numa.* ‘and thereof fall the rivers which are called so: Side, Wide, Shin, Ecken, Swale, Guththrew, Ferm, Fimblethule, Gipple, Gapple, Gamble, Garwimble. These fall around the settlements of the Eese. These are yet named: Tyne, Ween, Thuil, Huil, Gread, Guththrown, Nit, Nat, Nan, Ran, Wine, Wayswith, Thednumb.’ A similar list of rivers likewise deriving from sts. 27–28 is found in *Gylf* 4:3–4: *Þá mælti Jafn-bár: „Fýrr var þat mörqum öldum en jörð var sköpuð er Nífl-beimr var gerr; ok í bonum miðjum liggir brúðr sá, er Hver-gelmir heitir, ok þaðan af falla þér ár, er svá heita: Svöl, Gunn-þrá, Fjorm, Fimbul-þul, Slíðr ok Hríð, Sylgr ok Ylgr, Við, Leiptir. Gjöll er nēst Hel-grindum.”* ‘Then spoke Evenhigh: “It was many ages before the earth was created that Nivelham was made, and in the middle of it lies the well which is called Wharyelmer, and thereof fall the rivers which are called so: Swale, Guththrew, Ferm, Fimblethule, Slide and Ride, Sellow and Wellow, Wide, Lafter. Yell is closest to the gates of Hell.”’ To distinguish the variants the manuscript is followed by a subscript number: 1 for the paraphrase in *Gylf* 4:3–4, 2 for 39:9–10, so that e.g. U<sub>2</sub> refers to the form of a name in *Gylf* 39:9–10 in U. TODO: Incorporate these variants into the edition.

- 28 **V**ína heitir enn, · qnnur **V**eg-svinn,  
2 þriðja Þjóð-numa;  
Nyt ok Nøt, · Nønn ok Hrønn,  
4 Slíð ok Hríð, · Sylgr ok Ylgr,  
Við ok Vøn, · Vønd ok Strønd,  
6 Gjöll ok Leiptir; · þér falla gumnum nēr  
en falla til hełjar heðan.

[R 10r/12, A 5r/1]

Wine is yet another called, another Wayswith,  
a third Thednumb;  
Nit and Nat, Nan and Ran,  
Slide and Ride, Sellow and Wellow,  
Wide and Ween, Wand and Strand,  
Yell and Lafter—they fall near to men,  
but fall hence to Hell.

1 **V**ína | ‘Vína’ R; †Vma† (fōr \*Vína) A 5 **V**øn | Vøð A 7 en | so A; es R

- 29 **K**ornt ok Qrnt · ok kēr-laugar tvēr  
2 þér skal Þórr vaða  
dag hvern · es dōma fēr  
4 at aski **Y**gg·drasils;  
því’t Qs-brú · brinn qll loga

[R 10r/15, A 5r/4,  
S 5r/1, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]



6                    **h**eilög vötn **h**lóa.  
 Carmet and Armet and the two Carlays,  
                   these shall Thunder wade  
 every day, when to judge he goes  
                   at the Ash of Ugdressle,  
 for the Os-bridge [RAINBOW] all will burn with flame;  
                   the holy waters boil.

1 Kǫrmt ok Qrmt | †kaurnit ok aurnit† T    3 dag hvern | so ASTW; rev. U; hverjan dag R    5  
 loga | add. en U    6 hlóa 'boil' | flóa 'turn hot' U

ALL | Thunder's movement is so powerful that he cannot ride across the rainbow bridge as this would cause it to burn up; for the violent movement of this god cf. *Þrk* 21, *Lok* 55. — St. 29 is cited in *Gylf* 15:21, the chapter about how the Gods get to their Thing, introduced by the words: *En Þórr gengr til dómsins ok veðr ár þér, er svá heita*: 'But Thunder walks to the Judgment and wades through the rivers which are called so'.

1 Kǫrmt ok Qrmt 'Carmet and Armet' | Two interesting river-names. *Kǫrmt* 'Carmet' is the well-attested ON name of the island Karmøy in Rogaland, Norway (e.g. *Þsjár* Frag 1, *ESk* Lv 9, *Þul Eyja* 3 in *SkP* 3), on whose northern side the ancient royal seat Awaldsness (ON *Qg-valds-nēs*) is located. The present stanza, however, cannot be referring to the island itself but instead seems to refer to Karmsund, the sound separating the island from the mainland. (For reference, at its narrowest point—the place of the Karmsund bridge—the sound is only ca. 190 m wide, while at Ogwaldsness two km south it is ca. 300 m.)

The rhyming *Qrmt* is a hapax only otherwise found in the duplicate line in *Þul Á* 6. No descendant is attested in Norway, but Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (CV, p. 780) connect it to the river Armet in Scotland. Still, such a geographic spread seems quite unlikely, and it is more probable that the Scottish river-name, if related at all to *Qrmt*, is taken from that of a now-lost Norwegian sound or island in the vicinity of Carmet.

Olsen (1925) derives the names from *karmr* and *armr*, terms for the parallel parts of a pen in a sheep-fold, which would give them a sense like 'low protective wall'. Olsen considers the present use of the names mythological and of likely Icelandic origin, deriving from a confusion of vaguely remembered names of real locations; he argues that the use of the island-name for the sound would be offensive to a Norwegian with good geographic awareness. And yet the likeness of the islands or their sounds to a sheep-fold fits very well geographically with the area around Karmøy, so that this argument is not entirely convincing.

1 Kǫrmt ... tvér 'Carmet ... Carlays' | This line also appears in a thule or list of poetic synonyms (*Þul Á* 6 in *SkP* 3), where however *ok* 'and' in the a-verse is replaced with the name *Lēiptr* 'Lafter' as found in st. 28/6 above.

2 þér skal Þórr vaða 'these shall Thunder wade' | Thunder is commonly associated with wading; cf. *Hárþ* 13/3 n., *Eddbr* VI.

5 Ǫs-brú 'Os-bridge' | The Rainbow Bridge, Bivrest. Cf. st. 45/4 below.

6 hlóa 'boil' | A hapax, U's reading is unmetrical. Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon (1989, s.v. *hlóa*) connects it with the adj. *blér* 'hot, mild', and this seems likely enough.

30            **G**laðr ok **G**yllir, · **G**lér ok Skęið-brimir,  
                   **S**ilfrin·toppr ok **S**inir,  
 2                    **G**isl ok **F**al·hófnir, · **G**oll·toppr ok **L**étt·feti,  
                   þeim ríða **ę**sir jóum  
 4                    dag hvern · es **d**öma fara  
                   at aski **Y**gg·drasils.  
 6

[R 10r/17, A 5r/6]

Glad and Gilder, Glare and Sheathbrimmer,  
 Silvrentop and Sinewer;  
 Yissel and Fallowhooven, Goldtop and Lightfeet;  
     on these horses ride the Eese  
 every day when to judge they go  
 at the Ash of Ugdrassle.

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3 Fal-hófnir | ‘falæpnir’ A 5 fara | om. A

---

ALL | This stanza clearly serves as a source for *Gylf* 15:18–20: *Hestar ása’nna heita svá: Sleipnir er batstr, hann á Öðinn; hann hefir átta fœtr. Annarr er Gláðr, þriði Gyllir, fjórði Glenr, fimmti Skeið-brimir, sétti Silfrin-toppr, sjauundi Sinir, átti Gisl, níundi Fal-hófnir, tíundi Gull-toppr, ellípti Létt-feti. Baldrs bestr var brenndr með þónum.* ‘The horses of the Eese are called so. Slopner is the best; Weden owns him; he has eight legs. The second is Glad, third Gilder, fourth Glen, fifth Sheathbrimmer, sixth Silvrentop, seventh Sinewer, eighth Yissel, ninth Fallowhooven, tenth Goldtop, eleventh Lightfeet. Balder’s horse was burned with him.’ TODO: Incorporate variants from G.

- 31 Þríar rótr · standa á þría vega  
 2 undan aski Ygg-drasils;  
     Hæl býr und einni, · annarri hrím-þursar,  
 4 þriðju mænnskir mæn.
- Three roots grow in three directions  
 from beneath the Ash of Ugdrassle.  
 Hell lives enclosed by one, by the other the Rime-Thurses,  
 by the third manly men.

[R 10r/20, A 5r/8]

---

2 undan | und A

---

ALL | The Ash of Ugdrassle, the World Tree, stands at the center of the World, being the *axis mundi* around which the Cosmos revolves. This is how we should understand its being the origin of the three roots going into the three realms. Through these roots it is also possible to travel from the land of men to the land of the dead (and vice-versa), and this is likely significant to the myth of Weden’s self-hanging upon the Tree (*Háv* 138). Note that the Gods are not mentioned, for the Ash stands beside Walhall as shown by sts. 25–26 above.

3 und ‘enclosed by’ | ON *undir* (short form *und*) ‘under’ can also refer to something enclosed, e.g. by a high wall, so that the residents of a walled city are said to live “under” that city. Since the roots are prob. not thought to be literally overhead above the listed worlds, this is the way the preposition ought to be translated.

- 32 Rata-toskr heitir íkorni · es rinna skal  
 2 at aski Ygg-drasils;  
     arnar orð · hann skal ofan bera  
 4 ok segja Níð-hoggvi niðr.

[R 10r/22, A 5r/9]

Wratetusk is the squirrel called which shall run  
 along the Ash of Ugdrassle.

The eagle's words shall he carry from above,  
and tell Nithehewer below.

ALL | Sts. 32–36 describe the various animals around the Ash of Ugdrassle. Religiously we ought to understand that the World Tree is under attack by the forces of evil and entropy, chief among them Nithehewer, the corpse-eating dragon of *Vsp* 38, 62. — This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 16:1–5: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvat er fleira at segja stór-merkja frá askinum?“ Hár segir: „Mart er þar af at segja. Qrn einn sitr í limum asksins, ok er hann margs vitandi, en í milli augna bonum sitr haukr sá, er heitir Vöðr-fölnir. Íkorni sá, er heitir Rata-toskr, rennr upp ok niðr eptir askinum ok berr ofundar orð millum arnarins ok Nið-boggs. Gangler spoke: “What more great signs are there to be told from the ash?” High says: “There is much to tell about it. An eagle sits in the branches of the ash and he is much knowing; but between his eyes sits the hawk called Weatherfalcon. The squirrel which is called Wratetush runs up and down along the ash and carries words of insult between the eagle and Nithehewer.”*

- 2 **33**      **Hirtir** 'ro ok **hjórir** · þeir's af **héfingar** á  
            **gag-halsir gnaga**:  
            **Dáinn** ok **Dvalinn**, · **Dün·eyrr** ok **Dura·þrór**.

[R 10r/23, A 5r/11]

There are four harts, too, who from the buds thereon  
with turned necks gnaw:  
Dowen and Dwollen, Downeer and Doorthrew.

1 **héfingar** | **héfingar** A 2 **gag-halsir** | so A; 'á gag-halsir' R 2 **gnaga** | **ganga** A 3 **Dün·eyrr** |  
**Dyn·eyrr** A 3 **Dura·þrór** | **Dyra·þrór** A

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 16:6, immediately following the paraphrase of the last st.: *En fjórir hirtir renna í limum asksins ok bita barr; þeir beita svá: Dáinn, Dvalinn, Dün-eyrr, Dura-þrór.* 'But four harts run in the limbs of the ash and bite its leaves; they are called thus: Dowen, Dwollen, Downeer, Doorthrew.'

2 **gag-halsir gnaga** 'with turned necks gnaw' | An iconographic parallel to this line presents itself in the common Wiking Age depictions of great horned beasts turning their necks backwards, e.g. on the runestone E 2 or the round brooch from Espinge, Scania (HST 108124).

- 2 **34**      **Ormar** fleiri · **liggja** und **aski Ygg-drasils**  
            an þat of **hyggi hværr**  
            **ò·sviðra** apa:

[R 10r/25, A 5r/12,  
S 5r/24, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

More wyrms lie under the Ash of Ugdrassle  
than any one would think  
among unwise apes:

2 þat | om. A

ALL | Sts. 34–36 are cited in *Gylf* 16 in the order 36, 34, 35. 34–35 are treated as a single stanza. St. 36 is introduced by *Gylf* 16:7–8: *En svá margir ormar eru í Hvergelmi með Nið-bogg, at engi tunga má telja; svá segir hér:* 'But there are so many wyrms in Wharfyelmer with Nithehewer that no tongue may tally them. So it says here:' Between 36 and 34–35 *Gylf* 16:9 reads: *Svá er enn sagt:* 'Further it is said so:'.

35 Góinn ok Móinn, · þeir 'ro Graf-vitnis synir,

2 Grá·bagr ok Graf·völluðr,

Ófnir ok Sváfnir, · hygg'k at é skyli

4 meïðs kvistu máa.

Gowen and Mowen—they are Gravewitner's sons—

Greyback and Gravewalled.

Ovner and Swebner I think always shall

maim the branches of the tree.

1 Góinn ok Móinn | Góni ok Móni U 1 synir 'sons' | liðar 'comrades' U 2 Graf·völluðr |  
Grap·völluðr W 3 Ófnir | Ópnir A 4 meïðs | meïðar A; †meðs† ST 4 kvistu | kvistum  
STW; kostum U

[R 10r/26, A 5r/13,  
S 5r/25, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

36 Askr Ygg·drasils · drýgir erfði

2 meira an menn of viti:

hjørtr bítr ofan · en á hliðu fúnar,

4 skerðir Nið·hoggr neðan.

The Ash of Ugdrassle suffers hardship

more than men might know:

A hart bites it from above and it rots on the side;

Nitrehewer harms it from below.

2 of | so AU; om. RSTW 3 ofan | neðan (corruption from l. 4) U

[R 10r/28, A 5r/14,  
S 5r/22, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

37 Hrist ok Mist · vil'k at mér horn beri,

2 Skeggj·öld ok Skögul,

Hildir ok Þrúðr, · Hlökk ok Hēr·fjotur,

4 Gøll ok Gēira·høð,

Rand·gríð ok Ráð·gríð, · ok Rēgin·leif;

6 þér bera ein·hērjum øl.

Rist and Mist I would have bring me a horn—

Shedgeld and Shagle,

Hild and Thrith, Lank and Harfetter,

Gall and Garhath,

Randgrith and Redegrith and Rainlaf—

they bring the Oneharriers ale.

2 Skeggj·öld | so RSTW; Skegg·öld AU. 3 Hildir ok Þrúðr 'Hild and Thrith' | Hildi ok Þrúði  
R 3 Hēr·fjotur 'Harfetter' | Hēr·fjotra U 4 Gøll | Gjoll U 4 Gēira·høð 'Garhath' | so G;  
Gēir·ølul 'Garale' R; Gēir·rømul 'Garramble' A. — add. ok 'and' U. 5 Rand·gríð | Rand·gríðr  
U 5 Ráð·gríð | Ráð·gríðr U 5 ok | om. R 6 øl | øl corrected from øll in same band A

[R 10r/30, A 5r/16,  
S 9r/4, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

ALL | St. 37 is cited following Gylf 36:2. Gylf 36:1–2 introduces it: *Enn eru þér aðrar er þjóna skulu í Val-höll, bera drykkju ok gæta borð-búnaðar ok øl-gagna. Svá eru þær nefndar í Grimnis-mölum:* 'Yet there are other [heavenly] women who shall serve in Walhall, carry the drinks and prepare the table-cloth and ale-stuffs. So are they named in the Speeches of Grimner?.'

3 Hildir ok Þrúðr ‘Hild and Thrith’ | The R reading stems from \*ðz, \*ðz with r rotunda being mistakenly copied as ðr, ðr and is certainly not an independent oral variant of these well-attested walkirie names. This is apparent upon viewing the facsimile images.

6 þér bera ein-herjum öl ‘they bring the Oneharriers ale’ | As cupbearers in Walhall. In Iron Age Germanic society pouring drinks at a feast was traditionally done by the ruler’s kinswomen, the most famous literary example being Rothgar’s wife and daughter in *Beow*; see Enright (1996) and Riseley (2014). The Walkirries may have been thought of as the daughters of Woden; see note to *Vsp* 30/5. For the reception of dead warriors see also note to st. 53/3 below.

- 38      **Ár**-vagr ok **Al**-sviðr, · þeir skulu upp heðan  
2                      svangir sól draga;  
                    en und þeira **bógum** · fölu **blíð** regin,  
4                      **ēsir**, **isarn**-kol.

[R 10r/32, A 5r/18]

Yorewaker and Allswith—they shall upward hence,  
famished, pull the sun,  
but under their shoulders the blithe Reins hid,  
the Eese, iron-cooling.

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ALL | Sts. 38–40 deal with phenomena concerning the sun. The description of the sun as being pulled by a horse-driven chariot is attested in literature and archeology going back to the Bronze Age. A notable archeological find from the Germanic cultural area is the ca. 1400 BC Trundholm sun chariot found on Zealand, Denmark. This cultic object belonging to the Nordic Bronze Age features a large disc placed on a six-wheeled chariot pulled by a horse (figg. 2, 3, page 158). Only one side of the disc is gilt and so the chariot may also depict the horses pulling the Day and Night, for which see *Vafþ* 11–14. Indo-European literary parallels for horses pulling the sun include the Vedic *RV* 1.50.8–9, 4.13.3, 5.45.9 and the Greek Homeric Hymn to “Hἥlios. This st. is referenced in *Gylf* 11:4–7, about the origin of the Sun and Moon: *En goð’in reiddu=sk þessu of-drambi tóku þau systkin ok settu upp á himin, létu Sól keyra þá besta, er drógu kerru sólár’inna; þeir ar er goð’in bgðu skapat til at lýsa heimana af þeirri síu, er flaug ór Múspells-beimi. Þeir bestar heita súa, Ár-vagr ok Al-sviðr. En undir bógum besta’nna settu goð’in tvá vind-belgi at kóla þá, en í sumum fróðum er þat kallat isarn-kol. ‘But the Gods were angered by this arrogance and took the two siblings and placed them up in the heaven; they let Sun drive the horses that pulled the chariot of the sun which the Gods had created to brighten the Homes from the sparks which flew out of Muspellsham. Those horses are so named: Yorewaker and Allswith. But under the shoulders of the horses the Gods placed two air bellows to cool them, but in some sources [presumably this st.] those are called iron-cooling.’ Cf. *Vafþ* 23 n., which cites *Gylf* 11:1–3.*

1 Ár-vagr ok Al-sviðr ‘Yorewaker and Allswith’ | The two horses which pull the sun-chariot also appear in *Sigrdr* 15/2; cf. note to the next st.

2 svangir ‘famished’ | M. nom. pl. of *svangr* ‘hungry, starved’. This adj. is used particularly of horses exhausted after long exertion, for which cf. *Oddr* 3/4, *I HHund* 42/4, *Sigv Austv* 11 (in SkP 1).

- 39      **Svalinn** heitir, · hann stendr **sólu** fyrir,  
2                      **skjöldr** skínanda goði;  
                    **björg** ok **brim** · vейt’k at **brinna** skulu,  
4                      ef hann **fēllr** í **frá**.

[R 10v/2, A 5r/20]

Swalen it is called; it stands before the sun—  
a shield before the Shining God [SUN].

Crags and surf I know shall burn,  
if it falls away.

1 Svalinn | *so* ('svalin') A; Svöl R

ALL | The sun-disc was apparently thought to be a translucent shield which protected the earth from the full power of the sun behind it. Without it the "crag and surf" (LAND and SEA; the totality of the earth) would burn. Cf. *Sigrdr* 15/1 which mentions the "shield that stands before the Shining God [SUN]" and is probably drawing on the present stanza.

1 Svalinn | The A reading is preferred since the shield is described by the m. *bann* in both mss., whereas R's *Svöl* looks like a feminine. *Svalinn* is confirmed by its inclusion in the poetic list of synonyms for shields, *Pul Skjaldar* 2/3 (in SkP 3).

- 40 Skoll heitir ulfr, · es fylgir hinu skír-leita  
2 goði til varna viðar,  
en annarr Hati · Hród-vitnis sonr,  
4 sá skal fyr hejða brúði himins.

[R 10v/4, A 5r/21]

Sholl is the wolf called which follows the Pure-Faced  
God [SUN] to the shelter of the woods,  
but the other one is called Hate, Rothwitner's son;  
he shall stay ahead of the bright Bride of Heaven [SUN].

2 varna | †vaurna† A 3 Hati | *add.* hann 's he is' R.

ALL | For discussion on these wolves see *Vsp* 40 n. — This stanza is closely paraphrased in *Gylf* 12:4–5, following a question about why the sun hurries so quickly: *Hárr segir: „Þat eru tveir ulfar, ok heitir sá, er eptir benni ferr, Skoll. Hann bréði-sk bón, ok hann mun taka bana. En sá heitir Hati Hród-vitnis-son, er fyrir benni bleypr, ok vill hann taka tungl'it, ok svá mun verða.“* 'High says: "It is due to the two wolves, and the one who runs behind her is called Sholl. She fears him, and he would catch her. But the one who runs ahead of her is called Hate Rothwitner's son, and he wants to catch the moon, and so it will remain."

2 til varna viðar 'to the shelter of the woods' | The sun is said to set in the forest. This is an interesting geographic detail since it points away from most of coastal (western) Norway, where the sun sets in the sea, and Iceland, which does not have any expansive forests. The description would however fit well for the Oslofjord area.

- 41 Ór Ymis holdi · vas jorð of sköpuð,  
2 en ór sveita sjór,  
björg ór beinum, · baðmr ór hári,  
4 en ór hausi himinn.

[R 10v/6, A 5r/23,  
S 3r/30, T 4r/10,  
W TODO, U TODO,  
A<sub>b</sub> 9v/14, B 3v/11]

From Yimer's flesh was the Earth created,  
but from his blood the sea,  
mountains from his bones, woods from his hair,  
but from his skull the Heaven.

2 sveita 'his blood' | hans sára sveita 'the blood of his wounds' A<sub>b</sub>B 2 sjór 'sea' | *so* AUA<sub>b</sub>B;  
sér 'id.' R; sjár 'id.' STW. 3–4 björg ... himinn. | *Abbrev.* as b. or. b. b. or. h. En or. h. h.

U, cf. Mårtensson and Pálsson (2008, pp. 137, 145–146). 3 þeinum | þeinu'num T 3 baðmr | þ'baðmr† A 4 ór hausi himinn 'from his skull the heaven' | himinn ór hausi hans 'the heaven from his skull' A<sub>b</sub>B

ALL | St. 41 is clearly closely related to *Vafþ* 21; for the Creation see there and *Vsp* 3–4. — Sts. 41–42 are cited in sequence directly following *Gylf* 8:20–25, which describes the Earth: [...] *Hón er kring-lóit útan, ok þar útan um liggir inn djúpi sjár, ok með þeiri sjávar-ströndu göfu þeir lönd til byggðar jötna ettum. En fyrir innan á jörðu'nni gerðu þeir borg um-bverfis heim fyrir ó-fríði jötna. En til þeirar borgar hefðu þeir brár Ymis jötuns ok kolluðu þá borg Mið-garð. Þeir tóku ok heila hans ok kustuðu í loft ok gerðu af ský'in. Svá sem hér segir:* 'It is round without and surrounding it there lies the deep sea; and along that sea-shore they [= the Gods] gave the land to the settlement by the lineages of the Ettins. But further within upon the Earth they made a stronghold around the Home against the enmity of the ettins, but for that stronghold they used the eyebrows of the ettin Yimer and they called the stronghold Middenyard. They also took his brains and cast them into the air and thereof made the clouds, just as it says here.' — Sts. 41–42 are also cited with numerous variants in *Litla Skálda*, a short text on Scaldic poetics that likely served as a source for *SnE* (cf. *Eddbr* VIII).

3 björg ... baðmr 'mountains ... woods' | Formulaic alliterative pair describing the natural world in a context of creation or destruction, also found in the OHG *Wessobrunn* 3 (*paum nob perek*) and *Musp* 50 (*perga, poum*).

- 42      Æn ór hans bróum · gørðu blið rēgin  
2              Mið-garð manna sonum,  
            æn ór hans hēila · vōru þau hin harð-móðgu  
4              ský oll of skōpuð.

[R 10v/8, A 5r/25,  
S 3r/31, T 4r/11,  
W TODO, U TODO,  
A<sub>b</sub> 9v/16, B 3v/12]

But from his brows the blithe Reins made  
Middenyard for the sons of men,  
but from his brains were the hard-minded  
clouds all created.

3 æn | ok U 3 hin | om. T 3 harð-móðgu 'hard-minded' | hríð-feldu 'stormy' A<sub>b</sub>B

1–2 Æn ór hans bróum · gørðu blið rēgin / Mið-garð manna sonum 'But from his brows the blithe Reins made Middenyard for the sons of men' | The Gods fenced in Middenyard ('the Middle Enclosure') by using the strands of Yimer's eyebrows as poles, as explained in *Gylf* 8:22–23 (cited in note to st. 41). The creation of this Enclosure was in fact a gift from the kind Gods to Mankind in order to protect us from the chaotic forces of destruction without; cf. *Vsp* 16/2 n.

- 43      Ullar hylli · hēfr ok allra goða  
2              hvęrr's tēkr fyrstr á funa,  
            því't opnir hēimar · verða umb āsa sonum,  
4              þá's hēfja af hvera.

[R 10v/9, A 5r/26]

Wolder's holdness and that of All Gods  
has whoever first kindles the fire,  
for the Homes become open for the sons of the Eese [GODS],  
when men lift off the cauldrons.

4 þá's | add. þeir A

ALL. | This st. is one of the most difficult in the poem and many interpretations have been made. The traditional view (e.g., Finnur Jónsson 1932, Bellows, Sijmons and Gering 1927, p. 208) relates it to the poem's frame narrative. Weden, bound between the two fires, cryptically asks for a cauldron hanging above him from the roof to be moved aside so that the Gods will be able to see him through the smoke-vent and rescue him. This explanation, however, leaves much unexplained, namely the stanza's placement in the gnomic wisdom section of the poem, the invocation of the obscure god Wolder, the lack of mention of any cauldron elsewhere in the poem, and the question of why the gods would bestow their grace unto the person who first set the fire which is presently torturing Weden (assuming *tekr á funa* means 'kindles the fire'; see note to that phrase).

I find the interpretation of Nordberg (2005) more convincing. Nordberg argues that the st. is another piece of gnomic wisdom, referring to the cooking of the sacrificial meal in large cauldrons during the Blood. The importance of cauldrons is seen in the common name second element *-ketill* or *-kell* (cognate with English "kettle") and has textual support, e.g. in *HákGöð* 14, describing the traditional blood in the Thronclaw (*Þrónðalög*), Norway: *At veistlu þeirri skyldu allir menn ǫl eiga; þar var ok drepinn alls konar smali ok svá bross, [...] en slátr skyldi sjóða til mann-fagnaðar; eldar skyldu vera á miðju gólfi í hofinu ok þar katlar yfir.* 'At that gathering all men were to have ale; thereafter also was every kind of small cattle slain and likewise horses, [...] and the fresh meat should be cooked for the enjoyment of men. There should be fires in the middle of the floor in the hove and kettles above them.' According to this view, the stanza is speaking of the Heavenly favour (*hylli*) earned by the ritualist who kindles the cooking fire, since that act enables the Gods to become guests at the ritual meal.

Nordberg's interpretation becomes especially interesting when one considers the immediately preceding stanzas 41–42, which describe the ordering of the world by the Gods through the killing and dismembering of Yimer, the primordial victim. That the killing of Yimer was in fact a sacrifice is supported by the manner in which it was done: beheading, which was the typical manner of slaying sacrificial bulls in the Wiking Age (cf. *Vǫfþ* 21/4 n., Lucas and McGovern 2007). In other Indo-European religions the first sacrifice of a Great Being (most famously the Vedic *Páruṣa*, *RV* 10.90) serves as the model for all future sacrifice, the performance of which reenacts the Creation and thereby re-establishes the continued existence of the World and upholding the social order (Lincoln 1986, *passim*; cf. *Vsp* 7/2 n.). That the purpose of the sacrifice is the re-establishment of Creation is said explicitly in the ritual language of the Vedic fire-sacrifice (Eliade 2005, pp. 11, 78–80). With this in mind we may consider how the sequence *Grm* 41–43 likely forms a unit: sts. 41–42 describe the Creation of the World through the First Blood (sacrifice) in the mythic past (*in illo tempore*) and st. 43 connects it with the Blood in the present.

1 Ullar 'Wolder's' | It is uncertain why the obscure god Wolder is invoked here but it cannot be simply for the sake of alliteration, since the much more well-known *Öðins* 'Weden's' would work just as well. It is possible that Wolder had a particular role in the setting of the ritual fire, something which finds support in the large number of fire-striker-shaped iron amulet-rings dating to ca. 660–780 AD found at the archeological site of *Lilla Ullevi* ('Wolder's little wigh') in Sweden (af Edholm 2009).

In Wiking Age and High Mediaeval sources Wolder plays a very minor role, but his earlier significance is proven by the impressive number of cultic places named after him (Brink 2007, pp. 116–118) and is, apart from the present stanza, also hinted at by *Akv* 33/4.

1 hylli 'holdness' | 'Favour, loyalty, grace'. This word, derived from the adjective *hollr* 'hold; favourable, loyal, gracious' along with the verb *hylla* 'to make hold' is used to refer to the grace of god(s) in both Heathen and Christian texts. See Index: hold and holdness.

1 allra goða 'All Gods' | Cf. *Sigrdr* 3–4, *Lok* 11, which both hail the Gods as a collective (the former as part of a genuine prayer, the latter subversively), and *Hákm* 18, where the piety of the dead king Hathkin is shown by his being greeted by *rǫð ǫll ok rēgin* 'all the Redes and Reins'.

The ritual use of this phrase proves that the pre-Christian Germanic religion did in fact believe in a form of Oneness of the Gods and their identity as a united body, something also seen in the idea of the Thing of the Gods (see *Vsp* 6 n.), where all the Gods gather to steer the fates of the world. Similar expressions are found in other old Indo-European religions, e.g., OI *vísavē dēvāb* 'All Gods', to Whom are dedicated numerous hymns of *RV* (Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 68), and Greek *πάντες θεοί* 'id.', found as early as the Mycenaean ritual inscriptions of the Bronze Age (Ziegler 1949; Ventris and Chadwick 1973, pp. 127, 303, 567; Killen 2024, pp. 860, 861, 1001).



This idea of Godly Oneness may have been the subject of dispute in the Norse world. Saxo Grammaticus (2015, pp. 53–54), 1.7.2 gives us an interesting anecdote. After Weden departs he is usurped by the obscure *Mithothin* (perhaps “With-Weden”), who reforms the cult:

*Cuius secessu Mithothyn quidam prestigii celebrer, perinde ac celesti beneficio vegetatus, occasionem et ipse fingende divinitatis arripuit barbarasque mentes novis erroris tenebris circumfusus prestigiarium fama ad cerimonias suo nomini persolvendas adduxit. Hic deorum iram aut numinum violationem confusis permixtisque sacrificiis expiari negabat ideoque eis vota communiter nuncupari prohibebat, discreta superum cuique libamenta constituens. Qui cum Othino redeunte relicta prestigiarium ope latendi gratia Pheoniam accessisset, concursu incolarum occiditur.*

‘A certain Mithodin, a famous illusionist, was animated at his departure as if by a kindness from heaven and snatched the chance to pretend divinity himself; his reputation for magicianism clouded the barbarians’ minds with the murk of a new superstition and led them to perform holy rites to his name. He asserted that the gods’ wrath and the profanation of their divine authority could not be expiated by confused and mingled sacrifices; so he arranged that they must not be prayed to as a group, but separate offerings (*libamenta*) be made to each deity. When Odin returned, the other no longer resorted to his conjuring but went off to hide in Funen, where he was rushed upon and killed by the inhabitants.’

It is not impossible that this obviously mythologised retelling may in fact reflect an actual theological conflict or attempted religious reform within the late Norse religion.

2 tēkr ... á funa ‘kindles the fire’ | Viz. the hallowed fire above which the holy cauldrons are hung; for the role of fire in Germanic and Vedic sacrifice see Kaliff (2005). — An otherwise unattested phrase which is here taken as equivalent with *taka ǣld* ‘kindle fire’, although this is problematic since the preposition *á* ‘on’ modifies the sense of the verb and the phrase *taka á* has a variety of idiomatic senses like ‘touch, react to, get involved in, get on’, though *\*taka á ǣld* is not attested. Another possibility is to read the ms. *afuna* as an error for *affuna* ‘from the fire’, which would yield the superior sense ‘whoever first takes [the cauldrons] from the fire’ (Nordberg 2005, p. 55).

3 opnir heima verða ‘the Homes become open’ | The Bloot opens up the human world to that of the Gods above. Similar language is used in several hymns of *RV* which pray for the Heavenly Doors (*dvārah devīṭh*) to open up, e.g. *RV* 1.13.6, 1.142.6, 2.3.5.

4 hvera ‘cauldrons’ | Acc. pl. of *hverr*, from PGmc. *\*hweraz*, from PIE *\*k<sup>w</sup>er-* ‘pot, vessel’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 265). The Sanskrit cognate *carú* is occasionally used in reference to the vat from which the ritual drink *soma* is drunk (*RV* 10.167.4), but a particular religious significance for the PIE root cannot be reconstructed.

- 44 Í·valda synir · gingu í ár·daga  
2 Skíð·blaðni at skapa,  
skipa bætst · skírum Fręy,  
4 nýtum Njarðar bur.

[R 10v/11, A 5r/28]

Iwald’s sons went in days of yore  
Shidebladner for to shape:  
the best of ships for the pure Free,  
for the useful Son of Nearth.

ALL | The ship Shidebladner is also described in *Gylf* 43, which is quite likely pulling from the present stanza.

- 45 Askir Ygg·drasils, · hann ’s óðstr viðā  
2 ęn Skíð·blaðnir skipa,  
Óðinn āsa · ęn jóā Slęipnir,  
4 Bif·røst brúa · ęn Bragi skalda,

[R 10v/13, A 5r/29,  
S 10r/20, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Hó-brók hauka · en hunda Garmr.

The Ash of Ugdrassle—it is the noblest of trees,  
and Shidebladner of ships,  
Weden of the Eese and Slopner of steeds,  
Bivrest of bridges and Bray of scalds,  
Highbrook of hawks and Garm of hounds.

1 hann | *om.* U 4 Bif-røst 'Bivrest' | *so* G; Bil-røst 'Bilrest' RA. — *om., but add. above the line by same hand* A 5 hunda Garmr 'Garm of hounds' | *add.* en Brimir sverða 'and Brimmer of swords' A. 5 Garmr | Gramr ST

ALL | St. 45 concludes Weden's mythological wisdom with a list of the greatest things in each category. It is quite likely that this stanza concluded with *Bif-røst brúa* 'Bivrest of bridges' as a Leeds-meter c-verse and that the following verses are later interpolations in oral transmission. Unlike the previous things listed they seem more trivial. The interpolating tendency is visible in action in A which adds a final unmetrical verse at the end of the stanza. —

The stanza is cited following *Gylf* 41:6-7: *En satt er þat, er þú sagðir. Mikill er Óðinn fyrir sér. Mjög dóni finna-sk til þess. Svá er hér sagt í orðum sjálfra ásanna:* 'But true is that which thou hast said. Weden is formidable; many examples attest to that. So it is said here in the words of the Eese themselves.'

For *Gylf* 41:1-5 see *Vafþ* 41 n.

46 Svipum hefí'k nú ypt · fyr sig-tíva sonum,

[R 10v/15, A 5v/2]

2 við þat skal vil-björg vaka,  
ollum ösum · þat skal inn koma  
4 Égis bekki á  
Égis drekku at.

My gaze I've now lifted up before the sons of the victory-Tews;  
by that shall the willed rescue awake!  
All the Eese shall it bring in,  
upon Eagre's bench,  
at Eagre's drinking.

1 nú | *om.* A

ALL | Weden announces that he has raised his gaze and made the Gods aware of his situation; they will leave their feasting at Eagre's hall (cf. *Hym* and *Lok*) and come to his rescue.

47 Hét=umk Grímr, · hét=umk Ganglæri,

[R 10v/17, A 5v/4,  
S 6r/5, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

2 Hęřjann ok Hjal̥m-beri,  
Þękr ok Þriði, · Þuðr ok Uðr,  
4 Hęl-blindi ok Hór.

I called myself Grim; I called myself Gangler,  
Harn and Helmbearer.  
Theck and Third, Thith and Ith,  
Hellblinder and High.

1 hét=umk | ok ASWU; om. T 1 Gangleri | so RAU; Gangari S; Gangi T; Ganglari W. 2  
ok | om. G 3 ok | om. G 3 Þuðr | so AG; Þunðr ('Þvðr') R 3 ok | om. G 4 Hçl-blindi |  
so RG; Hçr-blindr A 4 ok | om. G 4 Hçr | Hárr W

ALL | Weden begins his list of names which takes up sts. 47–52; more names are given in a second list in 56–57. Note that the name *Óðinn* 'Weden' itself does not appear in the first list. — The names from sts. 47–52 and 56 (but not 57) are also found in *Gylf* 20:11, introduced by the words: *ok enn befir hann nefit=sk á fleiri vega, þá er hann var kominn til Geir-röðar konungs*: 'and he has named himself in yet more ways when he was come to visit King Garfrith.' The names are given in the order they appear in each stanza and the stanzas themselves come in the order: 47, 48, 49, 51, 52, 50, 56. For the purpose of the present critical edition, variant names from the list in *Gylf* 20:11 are noted for all relevant stanzas, but only sts. 47–49 are treated as being actually cited in *Gylf*. Note that all 4 mss. of *Gylf* append *Vera-týr* to the end of the list, likely taken from st. 3 above.

- 48      **Saðr** ok **Svipall** · ok **Sann**·getall,  
2              **Hçr**·teitr ok **Hnikarr**,  
            **Bil**·eygr, **Bál**·eygr, · **Bçl**·verkr, **Fjçlnir**,  
4              **Grímr** ok **Grímnir**, · **Glapp**·sviðr ok **Fjçl**·sviðr.

[R 10v/19, A 5v/5,  
S 6r/6, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Sooth and Swiple and Soothgettle,  
Hartote and Nicker,  
Bileye, Baleeye, Baleworker, Fillner,  
Grim and Grimner, Glapswith and Fellswith.

1 ok | om. G 1 ok | om. G 2 ok | om. G 4 Grímr ok | om. G 4 ok | om. G

- 49      **Síð**·hçttr, **Síð**·skæggr, · **Sig**·fçðr, **Hnikuðr**,  
2              **Al**·fçðr, **Val**·fçðr, · **At**·ríðr ok **Farma**·týr;  
            **çinu** nafni · hét=umk **aldri=gi**  
4              síðst ek með **folkum** **fçr**.

[R 10v/21, A 5v/7,  
S 6r/7, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

Sidehat, Sideshaw, Syefather, Nicked,  
Allfather, Walfather, Atrider, and Farm-Tew—  
by a single name I never called Myself  
since among man-folk I fared.

1 Síð·hçttr | Síð·hófr T 1–2 Hnikuðr ... At·ríðr | At·ríðr, Hnikuðr, Al·fçðr U 2 Val·fçðr  
'Walfather' | om. AG 2 At·ríðr | tettridr† T 2 ok | om. G 3–4 çinu ... fçr. 'by ... fared.' |  
om. G 3 aldri=gi 'never' | om. A 4 með | om. A

- 50      **Grímn**i mik hétu · at **Gçir**·raðar,  
2              çn **Jalk** at **Çs**·mundar;  
            çn þá **Kjalar** · es ek **kjalka** dró,  
4              **Þrçr** þingum at,  
            **Viður** **vígum** at.

[R 10v/23, A 5v/9]

Grimner they called me at Garfrith's  
 but Gelding at Osmund's,  
 but Keller when I pulled the sled,  
 Throo at Things,  
 Wither in battles.

2 *Ôs-mundar* | *This name is spelled 'ôsmundar' in R, an archaic scribal feature suggesting that the poem was likely put to paper in the 12th century.* 3 *Kjalar* | *so RG; Jalk A.* 5 *Viður vígum* at 'Wither in battles' | *metr. emend. from Viður at vígum 'id.' A; om. R*

ALL | Apart from the first line, which of course refers to the present situation, the underlying stories are not known. They presumably refer to other now-lost myths involving Weden travelling in disguise. — The Weden-names in this stanza are found in *Gylf* 20:11 following those of st. 52. They appear in the order *Jalkr, Kjalar, Viðurr, Þrór* 'Gelding, Keller, Wither, Throo' in all mss., indicating that ll. 4 and 5 were reversed in the version of the poem used by Snorre.

4 *Þrór þingum* at 'Throo at Things' | Perhaps a reference to a name under which Weden was invoked at the start of Things or legal assemblies.

5 *Viður vígum* at 'Wither in battles' | That this line is not an insertion by A is shown by the presence of *Viðurr* in the corresponding part of the name-list in *Gylf* 20:11.

51 *Ôski ok Ômi, · Jafn·høt ok Biflindi,*  
 2 *Gøndlir ok Hár·barðr með goðum.*

[R 10v/24, A 5v/10]

Wisher and Omer, Evenhigh and Bivling,  
 Gandler and Hoarbeard among Gods.

1 *Biflindi* | *Blindi S* 2 *Gøndlir* | *Gøldnir U*

ALL | The names in this st. appear in the list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 49 in the order *Ôski, Ômi, Jafn·høt, Biflindi, Gøndlir, Hár·barðr*.

2 *Hár·barðr með goðum* 'Hoarbeard among Gods' | *Viz. in Hárþ, when conversing with the god Thunder.*

52 *Sviðurr ok Sviðrir · es ek hét at Sökk·mímis*  
 2 *ok dulða'k þann hinn aldna jøtun*  
*þa's Mið-vitnis vas'k · hins mēra burar*  
 4 *orðinn çin-bani.*

[R 10v/25, A 5v/11]

Swither and Swithrer, as I was called at Sinkmimer's,  
 and I deceived that olden ettin,  
 when of Midwitner's famous son  
 I became the lone slayer.

3 *Mið-vitnis* | *so A; Mið-viðnis R*

ALL | The two Weden-names in this st. appear in the list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 51 in the order *Sviðurr, Sviðrir* with no critical variants.

- 53 Qlr est Geir-røðr, · hefr þú of-drukkít;  
 2 miklu est hnugginn, · es þú est mínu gengi,  
 ɔllum ɛin-herjum · ok Óðins hylli.

[R 10v/28, A 5v/13]

Thou art worse for ale, Garfrith; thou hast drunk too much!  
 Much hast thou lost when thou hast [lost] My support,  
 all the Oneharriers, and Weden's holdness.

2 gengi 'support' | so R; gęði 'mind' A

ALL | Weden now turns to King Garfrith. He reproaches his former protégé and foresees his imminent death.

3 ɔllum ɛin-herjum 'all the Oneharriers' | It is important to note that Garfrith is not said to have lost the support (*gengi*) of the Oneharriers but rather the Oneharriers themselves, yet the sense is the same: by breaking the Odinic code of conduct befitting his station, Garfrith has lost Weden's favour and thus been excluded from the community of oath-bound warriors, his adopted sons, the Oneharriers. On the other hand, a righteous king could expect their truce, as was the case for Hathkin the Good according to *Hákm*, composed after his death. Thus *Hákm* 16/1–2 sees the god Bray greeting Hathkin in Walhall with the words: *ɛin-berja grið · skalt allra hafa; / þigg þú at ɔsum ɔl*. 'the truce of all the Oneharriers shalt thou have. Receive ale from the Eese!'

3 Óðins hylli 'Weden's holdness' | Weden's grace or favour; cf. st. 43/1 n.

- 54 Fjǫlð þér sagða'k, · ɛn þú fátt of mant,  
 2 of þik véla vinir;  
 męki liggja · sé'k míns vinar  
 4 allan í dreýra drifinn.

[R 10v/30, A 5v/15]

Many things have I told thee, but thou recallest few;  
 'tis friends that deal with thee!  
 A sword I see lying, in My friend's  
 dreary blood all drenched.

2–3 vinir, míns vinar 'friends, my friend' | Weden stresses his friendship with Garfrith by repeating the word *vinr* 'friend'. The followers of a god were his friends; see *Háv* 157 n.

3–4 męki liggja · sé'k míns vinar / allan í dreýra drifinn. 'A sword I see lying, in my friend's / dreary blood all drenched.' | A prophetic statement.

- 55 Egg-móðan val · nú mun Yggr hafa,  
 2 þitt vęit'k líf of liðit;  
 varar 'ro dísir, · nú knátt Óðin séa;  
 4 nálga=sk mik ef þú męgir!

[R 10v/31, A 5v/16]

An edge-wearied corpse will Ug now have;  
 I know thy life to be past.  
 Wary are the Dises; now dost thou see Weden.  
 Draw near Me, if thou mayst!

3 varar | †vvarro† A

1 Egg-móðan ‘edge-wearied’ | Euphemistic; “slain by a piercing blade.” Also found in *Hamð* 30/2a.

3 dísir ‘the Dises’ | The Norns, fates, who have determined Garfrith’s hour of death. Cf. *Fáfn* 11–13, *Am* 25/4, *Hamð* 30.

- 56 Óðinn nú heiti’k, · Yggr áðan hét’k,  
2 hét=umk Þundr fyr þat,  
Vakr ok Skilfingr, · Vöfuðr ok Hropta-týr  
4 Gautr ok Jalkr með goðum.

[R 11r/2, A 5v/18]

Weden am I now called; Ug was I called earlier;  
I called myself Thound before that;  
Wacker and Shilving, Waved and Roft-Tew,  
Geat and Gelding among the Gods.

3 Vöfuðr | so RAS; Ná-föðr (‘nafodr’) T; Vá-föðr W; om. U

ALL | The names in this st. (other than Óðinn ‘Weden’) appear in the name-list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 50. They have the archetypal order *Yggr, Þundr, Vakr, Skilfingr, Vöfuðr, Hropta-týr, Gautr, Jalkr*, although only the ms. T keeps all names; S and W omit. *Jalkr* while U omits the first 6 names (*Yggr–Hropta-týr* ‘Ug ... Roft-Tew’) and therefore only has *Gautr, Jalkr* ‘Geat, Gelding’.

1 Óðinn nú heiti’k ‘Weden I am now called’ | Having dropped all disguises, the guest is no longer Grimmer but Weden himself; note that his earlier list of names did not contain this name.

- 57 Ófnir ok Sváfnir · es hygg’k at orðnir sé  
2 allir af einum mér.“

[R 11r/4, A 5v/20]

Ovner and Swebner, whom, I ween, have come  
all from Me alone.”

1 es | om. A 2 af | at A

ALL | No trace of this stanza is found in the list of names in *Gylf* 20:11 which suggests that it may be a later addition common to R and A. It is also possible that these names were left out since Snorre considered them to be serpent-names on the basis of st. 35 above, which is quoted in *Gylf* 16:9.

1 Ófnir ok Sváfnir ‘Ovner and Swebner’ | Both names are listed among poetic names of Weden in *Pul Óðins* (in SkP 3). They are also the names of two serpents in 35/3 above.

- P3 Geir-røðr konungr sat, ok hafði sverð um kné sér ok brugðit til  
2 miðs. En er hann heyrði, at Óðinn var þar kominn, stóð hann  
upp, ok vildi taka Óðin frá eldi’num. Sverð’it slapp ór hendi  
4 hónum, vissu hjólt’in niðr. Konungr drap fótí, ok steypiti=sk á-

[R 11r/5, A 5v/21]

6 fram, en sverð'it stóð í gognum hann, ok fekk hann bana. Óðinn  
hvarf þá. En Agnarr var þar konungr lengi síðan.

King Garfrith sat and had a sword about his knee, and it was brandished half-way up. And when he heard that Weden had come there, he stood up and would take Weden from the fire. The sword slipped out of his hand; the hilt pointed downwards. The king lost his footing and fell forward, but the sword went through him and he received his bane. Weden then disappeared, but Ayner was king there for a long while afterwards.

2 kominn, | add. þá A 4 hönnum, | add. ok A 5 hann | þar af A 5-6 Óðinn hvarf þá. | om.  
A 6 var þar | varð A 6 lengi síðan. | om. A

## Appendix

### Origin of the Nation of the Longbeards (*Origo Gentis Langbardorum*)

The following excerpt is the first chapter of the 7th century text dealing with the legendary prehistory of the Longbeards. It is edited here due to its close resemblance to P2 of the prologue above and since certain name-forms require discussion in a way that would not be entirely in place in a footnote.

2 <sup>1</sup>Est insula qui dicitur Scadanan, quod interpretatur excidia, in  
partibus aquilonis, ubi multae gentes habitant; inter quos erat  
4 gens parva quae Winnilis vocabatur. <sup>2</sup>Et erat cum eis mulier  
nomine Gambara, habebatque duos filios, nomen uni Ybor et  
nomen alteri agio; ipsi cum matre sua nomine Gambara princi-  
6 patum tenebant super Winniles. <sup>3</sup>Moverunt se ergo duces Wan-  
dalarum, id est Ambri et Assi, cum exercitu suo, <sup>4</sup>et dicebant ad  
8 Winniles: “Aut solvite nobis tributa, aut praeparate vos ad pug-  
nam et pugnate nobiscum”. <sup>5</sup>Tunc responderunt Ybor et Agio  
10 cum matre sua Gambara: “Melius est nobis pugnam praeparare,  
quam wandalis tributa persolvere”. <sup>6</sup>Tunc Ambri et Assi, hoc  
12 est duces Wandalarum, rogaverunt Godan, ut daret eis super  
Winniles victoriam. <sup>7</sup>Respondit Godan dicens: “Quos sol sur-  
14 gente antea videro, ipsis dabo victoriam”. <sup>8</sup>Eo tempore Gambara  
cum duobus filiis suis, id est Ybor et Agio, rogaverunt Fream,  
16 uxorem Godam, ut ad Winniles esset propitia. <sup>9</sup>Tunc Frea dedit  
consilium, ut sol surgente venirent Winniles et mulieres eorum  
18 crines solutae circa faciem in similitudinem barbae et cum viris  
suis venirent. <sup>10</sup>Tunc luciscente sol dum surgeret, giravit Frea,  
20 uxor Godan, lectum ubi recumbebat vir eius, et fecit faciem eius

22 contra orientem, et excitavit eum. <sup>11</sup>Et ille aspiciens vidit Win-  
 niles et mulieres ipsorum habentes crines solutas circa faciem;  
 24 et ait: "Qui sunt isti longibarbæ?" <sup>12</sup>Et dixit Frea ad Godan:  
 "Sicut dedisti nomen, da illis et victoriam". <sup>13</sup>Et dedit eis vic-  
 26 toriam, ut ubi visum esset vindicarent se et victoriam haberent.  
<sup>14</sup>Ab illo tempore Winnilis Langobardi vocati sunt.

<sup>1</sup>There is an island which is called Shedeney, which is interpreted as 'destruction', in the parts of the north, where many nations dwell; among whom was a small nation which was called *Winnilis*. <sup>2</sup>And there was with them a woman by name *Gambara*, and she had two sons, the name of one was *Ybor* and the name of the other *Agio*; they with their mother by name *Gambara* held leadership over the *Winnilis*. <sup>3</sup>Then the princes of the *Wandali*, that is *Ambri* and *Assi*, moved with their host, <sup>4</sup>and said to the *Winnilis*: "Either pay tributes to us, or prepare yourselves for battle and fight with us." <sup>5</sup>Then *Ybor* and *Agio* with their mother *Gambara* answered: "It is better for us to prepare for battle than to pay tributes to the *Wandali*." <sup>6</sup>Then *Ambri* and *Assi*, that is the princes of the *Wandali*, asked *Weden* that he might give to them victory over the *Winnilis*. <sup>7</sup>*Weden* answered, saying: "Those whom I shall see first at the rising sun, to them I will give the victory." <sup>8</sup>At that time *Gambara* with her two sons, that is *Ybor* and *Agio*, asked *Frie*, the wife of *Weden*, that she might be favorable toward the *Winnilis*. <sup>9</sup>Then *Frie* gave counsel, that at the rising sun the *Winnilis* should come and their women with hair let down around the face in the likeness of a beard, and they should come with their men. <sup>10</sup>Then as it grew light while the sun was rising, *Frie*, wife of *Weden*, turned the bed where her husband was reclining, and made his face turn toward the east, and awakened him. <sup>11</sup>And he, looking out, saw the *Winnilis* and their women having hair let down around the face; and he said: "Who are these long-beards?" <sup>12</sup>And *Frie* said to *Weden*: "As thou hast given the name, give them also the victory." <sup>13</sup>And he gave them victory, so that wherever it seemed [fit] they might avenge themselves and have victory. <sup>14</sup>From that time the *Winnilis* are called *Langobardi*.

1 Scadanán, quod interpretatur excidia 'Shedeney, which is interpreted as "destruction"' | *Scadanán* 'Shedeney' is the same word as Scandinavia or Scania, *Scanza* in Jordanes. The word derives from PGmc \**Skadin-awjō* 'Shede's island', where *Shede* is probably the goddess (ON *Skaði*) known from Norse sources. — The gloss reveals that the author was not unfamiliar with Germanic idiom; cf. OHG *skado* 'damage'.

12 Godan 'Weden' | A form derived from earlier *Wōdan* (attested on the runic Nordendorf fibula) through the sound change *w- > g-*.

15 Fream 'Frie' | *Weden's* wife, *Frie*. Acc. sg. of *Frea*, cognate with OHG *Frija* (*Mers II* 4), ON *Frigg*, both from PGmc. \**Frijō*. *Frie* is not to be confused with the different goddess *Frow* (ON *Frøyja*, whose name, though superficially similar to *Frea*, in fact comes from PGmc. \**frawijō* 'lady', corresponding to OHG *frouwa*).

24 Sicut dedisti nomen, da illis et victoriam 'As thou hast given the name, give them also the victory' | Likely an early attestation of the custom of the name-gift (ON *gefa at nafni-festr* 'give for



the fastening of a name') found in numerous later Norse Saws. Cf. *Skm* 53: *Þá svarar konungr: „Þú, sveinn, hefir gefit mér nafn, at ek skal heita Hrólfr kraki, en þat er títt, at gjöf skal fylgja nafn-festi. [...]"* "Then answers the king: "Thou, swain, hast given me a name, that I shall be called Rotholf the pole; yet it is customary that a gift should follow the fastening of a name. [...]"



# Dreams of Balder

## *(Baldrs draumar)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.890)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Dreams of Balder** (abbrev. *Bdr*) is a short Eddic poem that sees We-  
den ride down to Hell, the Underworld, to ask a dead wallow about Balder's  
future.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Bdr* is preserved only in **A** on foll. 1v/17–2r/11. A younger redaction charac-  
terised by a number of post-mediæval inserts is transmitted in several copies  
in later paper mss. Metrical characteristics make it clear that these inserts are  
very late (Ragnar Ingi Aðalsteinsson 2009), and they are therefore excluded  
from this edition without further comment.

### Meter and stanza

*Bdr* is a short poem consisting of 57 long-lines across 14 stanzas. The meter is  
Ancient-words-law. The typical length of the stanza is 4 (13/14: 1–10, 12–14),  
and this is upheld consistently. A single stanza, 11, has 5 lines.

### Origin and motifs

The main source for the death and subsequent avenging of the god Balder is  
*Gylf* 49–50 (for a summary of which see *Vsp* 31 n.). Compared to that narra-  
tive, *Bdr* corresponds only to the very beginning, namely Balder's ominous  
dreams, and does not go into great depth about its subject; at just 14 sts. the  
poem is the shortest surviving mythological Eddic poem. In isolation, the  
purpose of *Bdr* seems somewhat unclear, and it must originally have been

part of a longer cycle of lost poetry dealing with Balder's death. That such a cycle likely existed is supported by the fragmentary stanza *Eddabr* V.

### Dating

*Bdr* has a particularly high rate of the archaic particle *of*, with a frequency of 0.463 occurrences per 10 lines (Sapp 2022, p. 77), although it must be noted that *Bdr* is so short that this number may not be as reliable as for longer poems. St. 3/4a may require a hiatus form, suggesting a date of composition before ca. 1150 AD, but is an uncertain attestation (see note). The alliteration of *vr-* with *v-* in 11/1 suggests a date before ca. 1000 AD (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016), but unfortunately that line is partly emended, and the presence of *vr-* in \**Vrindr* (> *Rindr*) cannot be considered fully certain due to a lack of parallels. To conclude, *Bdr* is likely an old poem, but it is too short to contain clear diagnostics.

### Summary

The poem begins *in medias res*: Balder has been having nightmares, which the Gods meet at their Thing to discuss (1). Weden rides down to Hell where he has an encounter with a bloody hound; he passes it and continues to “the high house of Hell” (2–3) from which he rides west to the grave of a certain wallow whom he revives using magic (4).

The wallow asks who it is that has forced her out of the grave (5) and Weden introduces himself as Waytame, before asking for whom the benches of Hell are covered with gold (6). The wallow responds that barrels of mead stand brewed for Balder and that the Gods must be very anxious (7). Weden asks her who will slay Balder (8), and she responds that it is Hath, carrying a “tall, famous wood” (9). The god next asks who will avenge Balder's death (10), and the wallow responds that Wrind will give birth to Weden's son Wonnell, who will slay Hath when only one night old (11). Weden then asks about some mysterious maidens (12), which apparently betrays his identity. The wallow announces that she now knows that her accoster is Weden, not Waytame; the god in turn retorts that she is not a wallow but rather the “mother of three thurses” (13). The wallow tells him to ride home and “be renowned”, taunting him over his unavoidable death at the Rakes of the Reins (14).

## Text

## The Dreams of Balder

- 1      Senn vöru **ęsir** · **allir** á þingi  
 2      ok **ęsynjur** · **allar** á máli,  
       ok umb þat **réðu** · **ríkir** tívar:  
 4      hví véri **Baldri** · **ballir** draumar?

[A 1v/18]

SOON WERE THE EESE all at the Thing,  
 and the Ossens all at speech,  
 and of this counseled the mighty Tews:  
 Why did Balder have troubling dreams?

4 Baldri | *corr. from baldrs above line in same band A*

1–3 Senn ... tívar ‘Soon ... Tews’ | Identically shared with *Þrk* 14/1–3. —

The ‘Thing’ is the Thing of the Gods (cf. *Vsp* 6/1–2 n., *Hym* 39/1), but the detail that the male Gods (*ęsir* ‘Eese’) are á þingi ‘at, upon the Thing’, while the Goddesses (*ęsynjur* ‘Ossens’) are on the sidelines chatting requires elaboration. Being á þingi is probably to be understood as being seated within the ritual enclosure at the legal assembly. This reflects historical Norse Thing-proceedings where the judgments were decided by a select group of twelve men (sometimes several groups of twelve, a number still surviving in the twelve-man jury of English common law) seated inside a circular holy enclosure (the *vé-bönd* ‘wigh-bonds’, i.e., ‘holy cords’) into which all others were forbidden to enter. So *Eg* 56 in a description of the Gole-Thing in Norway: *En þar er dömr’inn var settir, var völlr slétt ok settar niðr besli-stengr í völl’inn í bring, en löð um útan snóri um-hverfis. Vöru þat kölluð vé-bönd. En fyrir innan í bringi’num sötu dómendr [...]; þér þrennar tylftir manna skyldu þar döma um mál manna.* ‘But where the court was established there was a smooth plain and hazelwood-poles were set down into the plain in a ring, and cords tied around them on the outside; those were called the ‘wigh-bonds’. But inside within the ring sat the judges [...]; those three groups of twelve men each would there judge the cases of men.’ The Norwegian New Law of the Land, I. 3 (NGL II, p. 14) specifies the proceedings of the Gole-Thing and notes that: *Svá er ok mælt at engi maðr þeirra er eigi er nefndr skal fyrir innan vé-bönd setjask útan or-lofs.* ‘So it is also said that no man among them who was not named shall be seated inside the wigh-bonds without permission.’

- 2      Upp reiš **Óðinn**, · **aldinn** Gautr,  
 2      ok hann á **Slęipni** · **söðul** of lagði,  
       reĩð **niðr** þaðan · **nifl**-hęljar til;  
 4      mótti **hvelpi**, · þeim’s ór **hęlju** kom.

[A 1v/19]

Up rose Weden, the olden Geat,  
 and he on Slopner the saddle did lay,  
 rode down thence to Nivelhell,  
 met the whelp that came out of Hell.

1 **aldinn** | *emend. (cf. 13/2 below); alda A*

2 ok hann á Slęipni · söðul of lagði ‘and he on Slopner the saddle did lay’ | Possibly formulaic; cf. *Oddr* 2/4.

4 hvelpi, · þeim's ór helju kom 'the whelp that came out of Hell' | An otherwise unknown dog, sometimes identified with Garm. The motif of the Hellhound guarding the underworld is well known throughout world mythology, most famously in the form of the Greek Κέρβερος (*Theog* 300–312).

- 3 Sá vas blóðugr · umb brjóst framan, [A 1v/21]  
 2 ok galdrs fǫður · gól of lengi,  
 framm reið Óðinn, · fold-vegr dunði,  
 4 hann kom at hǫu · Hēljarranni.

It was bloody at the front of its chest  
 and at the father of galder [= Weden] for a long time bayed.  
 Forth rode Weden—the fold-way [EARTH] resounded—  
 he came to the high house of Hell.

2 gól of | 'golv' (*corruption of \*gol ū*) A

2 galdrs fǫður 'the father of galder [= Weden]' | An unparalleled expression for Weden, the master of magical spells and chants (galders). Cf. *Háv* 140, 147–165.

3 framm reið Óðinn, · fold-vegr dunði 'Forth rode Weden—the fold-way [EARTH] resounded' | The movement of gods often causes cosmic disturbance; cf. the description of Thunder's riding in *Haustl* 14: *Ok at isarn-leiki · Jarðar sunr ok dunði ... mána vegr und þýnum* 'The Son of Earth drove to the iron-play [BATTLE] ... and the moon's way [SKY/HEAVEN] resounded beneath him'. See further *Þrk* 21.

4 hann kom at hǫu | The hiatus form in *hǫu* 'high' (*\*háfu* A) is not diagnostic for the dating since it may be due to analogy with other forms in *hǫv-* in the adjective, that is, it may be an old uncontracted *hǫu* (which would be contracted to *hǫ* post-1150), but it may also be a young analogical *hǫvu*. Regardless of the presence of the analogical glide in *hǫ(v)u*, the line may be read either as a type A1 (with stress on *hann*) or a type A3.

- 4 Þá reið Óðinn · fyr austan dyrr, [A 1v/22]  
 2 þar's hann vissi · vǫlu leiði;  
 nam hann vittugri · val-galdr kveða,  
 4 und's nauðugr reis, · nás orð of kvað:

Then Weden rode east from its doors,  
 whither he knew the wallow's grave.  
 He took to sing a slain-galder for the cunning woman  
 until forced she rose; a corpse's words quoth she:

3 val-galdr 'slain-galder' | A galder to quicken the dead, in this case the wallow. Cf. *Háv* 158 where Weden tells how He can bring hanged men back to life with a galder.

- 5 „Hvat's manna þat · mér ó-kunnra, [A 1v/24]  
 2 es mér hefr aukit · ǣrfitt sinni?  
 Vas'k snifin snjóvi, · ok slęgin regni,

4 ok drifin döggu, · dauð vas'k lengi.“

“What sort of man is this, unknown to me,  
who has caused for me this toilsome journey?  
I was snowed by snow and struck by rain  
and bespattered by dew—dead was I for long.”

2 ərftt sinni ‘this toilsome journey’ | The “journey” out of the grave.

3–4 Vas'k snifin ... lengi. ‘I was snowed ... long.’ | Cf. the similar description of a buried person in *Z HHund* 44–45.

[Óðinn kvað:] 6 „Veg·tarn ek heiti, · sonr em'k Val·tarns,

[A 1v/25]

2 sēg mér ór hēlju, · ek man ór hēimi;

hveim eru bēkkir · baugum sánir,

4 flēt fagr=liga · flóuð golli?“

[Quoth Woden:] “Waytame I am called; I am Waltame's son;  
tell me [the tidings] from Hell—I will [tell those] from the Home.  
For whom are the benches sown with bighs,  
the floors fairly flooded with gold?”

1 Veg·tarn ek heiti, · sonr em'k Val·tarns ‘Waytame I am called, I am Waltame's son’ | Neither name is attested elsewhere, but both are Odinic in character: the first alludes to Woden's role as patron of wayfaring strangers (*Háv, Grm*), the second to his role as gatherer of dead warriors (*Vsp* 23/1, *Vafþ* 40–41, *Grm* 8–10, *Hárþ* 24).

2 hēimi ‘the Home’ | I.e., the world of the living.

4 flēt ‘the floors’ | In an Iron Age Germanic hall, the *flēt* was the raised flooring alongside the walls upon which the benches stood; here it is synonymous with the living quarters.

[Völva kvað:] 7 „Hér stendr Baldri · of brugginn mjōðr,

[A 1v/27]

2 skírar veigar, · liggr skjōldr yfir,

en ős-mēgir · í of·vēni;

4 nauðug sagða'k, · nú mun'k þegja.“

[Quoth the wallow:] “Here for Balder mead stands brewed,  
pure draughts—a shield lies over them—  
but the Os-Lads [= Eese] stand in great suspense—  
forced I spoke, now I will shut up!”

[Óðinn kvað:] 8 „Þegj=at-tu vōlva, · þik vil'k fregna,

[A 1v/29]

2 und's al-kunna, · vil'k čnn vita:

hveirr man Baldri · at bana verða,

4 ok Óðins son · aldri řēna?“

[Quoth Woden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!  
Until all is known I wish yet to know:

Who will become Balder's bane  
and rob Woden's son of life?"

[Völva kvað:] 9 „Hǫðr berr hǫvan · hróðr-baðm þinig,  
2 hann man Baldri · at bana verða,  
ok Óðins son · aldri rēna;  
4 nauðug sagða'k, · nú mun'k þegja.“

[A 2r/1]

[Quoth the wallow:] “Hath bears the high, famous wood [MISTLETOE] thither.  
He will become Balder's bane  
and rob Woden's son of life—  
forced I spoke, now I will shut up!”

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1 hróðr-baðm | *emend.*; hróðr-barm A

[Óðinn kvað:] 10 „Þegj=at-tu vólva, · þik vil'k fregna,  
2 und's al-kunna, · vil'k ęnn vita,  
hverr man heipt Hęði · heft of vinna,  
4 eða Baldrs bana · á bál vega?“

[A 2r/3]

[Quoth Woden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!  
Until all is known I wish yet to know:  
Who will avenge that evil on Hath,  
or drag onto the pyre Balder's bane?”

[Völva kvað:] 11 „Vrindr berr Vála · ı vestr-sǫlum,  
2 sá man Óðins sonr · ęin-néttr vega;  
hǫnd of þvęr-at · né hǫfuð ķęmbir,  
4 áðr á bál of berr · Baldrs and-skota;  
nauðug sagða'k, · nú mun'k þegja.“

[A 2r/4]

[Quoth the wallow:] “Wrind bears Wonnel in the western halls:  
he will, Woden's son, one night old, fight.  
He washes not his hand nor combs his head  
before onto the pyre he bears Balder's shooter—  
forced I spoke, now I will shut up.”

---

1 Vrindr ‘Wrind’ | *metr. emend.*; Rindr A 1 Vála ‘Wommel’ | *required by meter and sense; om. A*  
3 at | *required by meter and sense; om. A*

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1 *Vrindr* ‘Wrind’ | As the first nominal in the verse, ms. *Rindr* is expected to carry alliteration with *vestr-sqlum*. This is obtained by restoring an archaic initial *vr-* cluster, for which cf. *Háv* 26/2 n. Unlike other instances of this cluster, \**Vrindr* is etymologically obscure. A likely theory connects the name with Gutnish *rind* m. ‘ivy, common clubmoss’, in which case Wrind may be a minor plant goddess (Lundberg 1913). If so, there is prob. an obscure ritual significance to the notion that it is the son of the Ivy who is born to avenge the harm done by the mistletoe. Lundberg argues that worship of Wrind is indicated by the OSwe. place name *Vrinda-vi* (modern-day Vrinnveid, supposedly gen. sg. of \**Vrindr* + *ví* ‘wigh, shrine’), although Sahlgren (1924, pp. 66, 78–80) considers this etymology false and instead explains the name as containing the second element OSwe. *viði* ‘wood, forest’.

1 *Vála* ‘Wonne!’ | The name must be restored. Without it the verse is only two syllables long, which is absolutely forbidden in Norse Ancient-words-law meter, and the verb *berr* ‘bears, gives birth to’ is left without an object.

2–4 *sá ... and-skota* ‘he will ... shooter’ | These lines are, apart from the tense of the verbs, almost identical to *Vsp* 32/4–33/2. The direction of influence is unclear, and it is not impossible that both are borrowing from a now-lost third poem.

[Óðinn kvað:] 12 „Þegj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil’k fregna,  
2 und’s al-kunna, · vil’k enn vita,  
hverjar ’ro meýjar, · es at muni gráta  
4 ok á himin verpa · halsa-skautum?“

[A 2r/6]

[Quoth Weden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thou I wish to ask!  
Until all is known I wish yet to know:  
Which are the maidens that heartily weep,  
and onto heaven throw the front-sheets?”

ALL | The question in this stanza is quite obscure. If it is connected to the myth of Balder’s death in any way, it ought to be the episode where the all things in the world wept for Balder. According to *Gylf* 49:70–82 (see *Eddbr* V below), Hell promised to give Balder back to the Eese if all things in the world would weep for him. The Eese relayed this message, and all things wept for Balder, save Lock in disguise. It may thus be that these maidens were among the weepers (perhaps they were the Walkirries, and this is what reveals Weden’s identity?), but in any case their identity is otherwise unknown. They may tentatively be identified with the equally mysterious daughters of Maythrasher in *Vafþ* 49, who are also young women (*meýjar*) who appear to have something to do with the End Times.

4 á himin verpa · halsa-skautum ‘onto heaven throw the front-sheets’ | Unexplained. Perhaps an astrological allusion.

[Vǫlva kvað:] 13 „Est=at Veg-tamr, · sem ek hugða,  
2 hęldr est Óðinn, · aldinn Gautr!“  
[Óðinn kvað:] „Est=at vǫlva · né vís kona,  
4 hęldr est þriggja · þursa móðir!“

[A 2r/8]

[Quoth the wallow:] “Thou art not Waytame as I thought,  
rather art thou Weden, the olden Geat!”—

[Quoth Weden:] “Thou art no wallow nor wise woman,  
rather art thou three Thurses’ mother!”

2 aldinn | *corr. from alda above line in same hand A*

[Völva kvað:] 14 „Hęim ríð Óðinn · ok ves hróðigr,  
 2 svá komi=t manna · meirr aptr á vit,  
 es lauss Loki · líðr ór böndum  
 4 ok ragna røk · rjúfęndr koma.“

[A 2r/9]

[Quoth the wallow:] “Ride home, Weden, and be renowned!  
 So may no man come again to visit  
 when, loose, Lock slips out of his bonds,  
 and at the Rakes of the Reins the rippers come.”

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1 ok ves hróðigr ‘and be renowned’ | A sarcastic taunt, the sense being: “Your fame, Weden, will not save you!”

4 rjúfęndr ‘rippers’ | Presumably Surt and Lock with his children, as described in *Vsp* 39–40, 48–50. The verb *rjúfa* ‘to break, rip up, break a hole in’ (CV) is used in the same context in the formulaic (*of*) *rjúfa=sk regin* ‘the Reins are ripped’ (*Vafþ* 52/4, *Grm* 4/4, *Lok* 41/2, *Sigrdr* 17/7).

# Speeches of Shirner

## (*Skírnis mól*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.897)

**Meter:** Leeds-meter; minority: Galders-law, Speeches-meter

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Shirner** (*Skí*) is a mythological dialogue-poem dealing with Free's servant Shirner who is sent to get the hand of the beautiful ettin's daughter Gird for his master by any means necessary.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Skí* is attested in full in both **R** and **A**. The name *Skírnis-mól* 'Speeches of Shirner' comes from **A**; **R** instead has *För Skírnis* 'Shirner's journey'.

### Meter and formal concerns

*Skí* consists of 178 lines (86 long-lines, 92 full-lines) across 42 stanzas. The meter of the poem is Leeds-meter, with a few lines in Speeches-meter and some irregular full-lines.

The poetry exclusively represents speech and all narrative development is conveyed in the embedded prose.

The normal Leeds-meter configuration *abc abc* is also the most common (1–9, 11, 13–14, 16–23, 25–26, 33, 36–42); likely defective variants of it are *ab abc* (12) and *abc* (15).

Configurations with consecutive *c*-verses/full-lines (what may be called Galders-law) are also found, chiefly in Shirner's curse (sts. 26–36). These are *abcc* (32), *abcc abc* (10), *abc abcc* (29), *abc abcc abc* (30), and *abc abc abcc* (35).

In addition there are the unusual configurations *abcx abc* (27, 28) and *abcxx abc* (31), where *x* stands for a verse that, although it takes the place of a normal full-line or *c*-verse, does not behave exactly as a normal type *c*-verse, e.g. by ending in a trochée or by connecting with a previous *c*-verse by alliteration rather than standing on its own.

Two sts. mix Speeches-meter and Leeds-meter according to the configurations *abc [ab ab]* (24) and *[ab ab] abc* (34), where Speeches-meter is bracketed.

## Origin and motifs

### Parallels

The whole of *Skí* is paraphrased in *Gylf* 37, for comparative purposes edited in full in the Appendix to this poem. *Gylf* 37:15 cites a variant form of *Skí* 42, the final stanza. It is also of note that the prose of *Skí* P1 and *Gylf* 37:1–6 share striking similarities in certain expressions like Shirner being a *skó-svæinn* ‘shoe-swain’ or Free one day having sat down in Lithshelf and looked about all the homes.

It seems near-certain that Snorre, the author of *Gylf*, had access to *Skí* directly rather than a prose retelling of the story accompanied by a solitary stanza. The most important reason for this assumption is that there is no detail in Snorre’s paraphrase that is not found in the version of the poem in RA, although there are many things found in RA not found in *Gylf*, most notably Shirner’s curse. Snorre’s prose however has many more details.

These circumstances are perhaps best explained if the version of *Skí* underlying *Gylf* 37 was available to Snorre based on oral tradition rather than a manuscript. This would explain the small variation in the final stanza and the greater variation in the introductory prose; whereas poetry is a bound form and less liable to drastic change, a prose narrative can vary greatly with each retelling. On the other hand it is also possible that Snorre chose to expand a preexisting written prose passage by adding his own details, something likely done to the prose of *Lok* P8 (see there) and then supplied the stanza with its minor variants based on his own memory. To sum up a narrative mythic poem in prose form and then quote one or two stanzas from it is something likely done elsewhere in *Gylf*; see *Eddbr* below.

### Interpretations

TODO.

Fertility? Free gives away his sword for sex (st. 8).

## Text

## The Speeches of Shirner

- P1 Freyr, sonr Njarðar, hafði einn dag set-sk í Hlið-skjölf ok sá um [R 11r/10, A 2r/11]  
 2 heima alla; hann sá í Jötun-heima ok sá þar mey fagra, þá er hón  
 gekk frá skála föður síns til skemmu; þar af fekk hann hug-sóttir  
 4 miklar. Skírnir hét skó-sveinn Freys. Njörðr bað hann kveðja  
 Frey máls. Þá mælti Skaði:

FREE, son of Nearth, had one day sat down in the Lithshelf, and looked throughout all the Homes. He looked into the Ettinhomes and saw there a fair maiden as she walked from her father's hall to her bower; thereof he got great heart-aches. Shirner was the name of Free's shoe-swain; Nearth asked him to get Free to speak. Then Shede spoke:

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1 Hlið-skjölf 'the Lithshelf' | The high lookout-post of the Gods; see note to this word in *Grm* P2.

4 skó-sveinn 'shoe-swain' | A young boy who ties the shoes for his master.

- 1 „Rís-tu nú Skírnir · ok gakk at beiða [R 11r/14, A 2r/15]  
 2 okkarn mál mōg,  
 ok þess at fregna · hveim inn fróði séi  
 4 of-reiði afi.“

“RISE NOW, SHIRNER, and go to ask  
 our lad for speech,  
 and to find out at whom the wise  
 man might be cross.”

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1 Rís-tu ... beiða 'Rise ... beg' | Alliteration is missing here. A simple solution would be to replace *gakk* 'go' with a synonym like *rinn* 'run' or *ráð* 'resolve', but this lessens the semantic mirroring with l. 2/2 below (though the verb *ganga* in the present stanza may in fact be due to influence from 2/2).

4 afi 'man' | While this word usually means 'father' or 'grandfather', it should here mean 'man' without a connotation of old age. See further CV.

- Skírnir kvað: 2 „Illra orða · es mér òn at ykkrum syni, [R 11r/15, A 2r/17]  
 2 ef ek geng at mēla við mōg,  
 ok þess at fregna, · hveim inn fróði séi  
 4 of-reiði afi.“

Quoth Shirner: “Ill words I expect from your son  
 if I go to speak with the lad,

and to find out at whom the wise  
man might be cross.”

- Skirnir: 3 „Sæg þat Freyr, · folk-valdi goða,  
2 ok ek vilja vita,  
hví þú ęinn sitr · ęnd-langa sali,  
4 mín dróttinn, of daga?“
- Shirner: “Tell this, O Free, troop-wielder of the gods—  
I too would wish to know  
why thou sittest alone in the endlong halls,  
my lord, during the days.”

[R 11r/17, A 2r/18]

- Freyr: 4 „Hví of seġja’k þér, · seġgr inn ungi,  
2 mikinn móð-trega?  
því’t alf-röðull · lýsir of alla daga  
4 ok þęy=gi at mínum munum.“
- Free: “Why should I tell thee, O young youth,  
of my great heartache?  
For the Elf-wheel [SUN] shines during all days  
and nowise to my liking.”

[R 11r/19, A 2r/20]

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3 alf-röðull ‘Elf-wheel’ | A rare poetic synonym (*þęiti*) for the sun; see note to *Vafþ* 47/1.

- Skirnir: 5 „Muni þína · hykk=a svá mikla vesa,  
2 at þú mér seġgr né seġir;  
ungir saman · vörum í ár-daga,  
4 vęl męttim tveir trúa=sk.“
- Shirner: “Thy liking I do not think so great  
that thou, O youth, shouldst not tell me.  
Young together were we in days of yore;  
we two might well trust each other.”

[R 11r/20, A 2r/21]

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2 seġgr ‘youth’ | This word, which usually means simply ‘man’, here seems to have a specific connotation with daring youth. The sense of ‘young man’ is also seen in *Vkv* 23 where it is used in reference to king Nithad’s two young sons. In the present context it answers Free’s addressing Shirner as *seġgr inn ungi* ‘the young youth’; Shirner seems to point out that the two are of equal age, and so Free is as much of a young man as he.

- Freyr: 6 „Í Gymis gorðum · ek ganga sá  
2 mér tíða mey;  
armar lýstu, · ęn af þaðan  
4 allt lopt ok lęgr.

[R 11r/22, A 2r/23]

Free: “In Gymer’s yards I saw walking  
a maiden desirable to me.  
Her arms shone, but thereof too  
all the air and sea.

4 lopt ok lōgr ‘air and sea’ | Formulaic word-pair and very old, also paralleled in OE. TODO.

7 Mēr’s mēr tíðari · an manna hveim  
2 ungum í ár-daga;  
ása ok alfa · þat vill ęngi maðr,  
4 at vit sōtt séim.“

[R 11r/24, A 2r/24]

The maiden is more desirable to me than [a maiden] to any man  
young in days of yore.  
Of the Eese and Elves does no one wish  
that we two should be agreed.”

1–2 Mēr ... ár-daga ‘The maiden ... of yore.’ | Free compares his own love to the great loves of earlier ages; his, he says, is far greater than theirs.

3 ęngi maðr ‘no one’ | Lit., ‘no man’, where ‘man’ means ‘person, individual’ and does not imply that the Gods are literally human beings. Cf. note to *Vafþ* 55.

Skírnir: 8 „Mar gef mér þa, · es mik of myrkvan beri  
2 vísan vafr-loga,  
ok þat sverð, · es sjalft vegi=sk  
4 við jōtna ęt.“

[R 11r/25, A 2r/25]

Shirner: “Then give me the steed which might bear me o’er the dark,  
inevitable wavering flame,  
and that sword which by itself might strike  
against the race of Ettins.”

3 þat sverð ‘that sword’ | This sword appears to have filled greater function in an earlier version of the poem, since according to *Gylf* 37:16 Shirner gave it away, perhaps as a dowry to Gird, and Free did not get it back (cf. *Vsp* 51/3 and the insult in *Lok* 42). It is notable that Free, a god especially associated with the erect phallus, trades away his actual sword (a symbol of martial power) for sex.

Freyr: 9 „Mar þér þann gef’k, · es þik of myrkvan berr  
2 vísan vafr-loga,  
auk þat sverð, · es sjalft mun vega=sk,  
4 ef sá’s horskr es hęfr.“

[R 11r/27, A 2r/27]

Free: “I will give thee that steed which bears thee o’er the dark,  
inevitable wavering flame,  
and that sword which by itself will strike  
if he be wise who holds it.”

1–4 berr ‘bears’; mun vega=sk, ef sá ‘s horskr es hęfr ‘will strike if he be wise who holds it’ | In his response Free replaces the subjunctive verb forms (*beri* ‘might bear’, *vegi=sk* ‘might strike’) with indicative and future forms, giving a sense of certainty and authority. The steed and sword are faultless, and if Shirner fails on the mission, it would be only due to his own fault (“if he be wise who holds it.”).

## P2 Skírnir męlti við hest’inn:

Shirner spoke with the horse:

- 10 „Myrkt es úti, · mál kveð’k okkr fara  
 2 úrig fjöll yfir  
 þursa þjóð yfir;  
 4 báðir vit komum=k · eða okkr báða tękr  
 sá inn ám=át=ki jötunn.“

[R 11r/29, A 2r/28]

“It is dark outside; I call it time for us to journey  
 over the drizzling mountains,  
 over the land of the Thurses.  
 Either we both make it through or he takes us both,  
 that uncanny ettin.”

3 þursa ‘of the Thurses’ | so A; ‘þyria’ R

ALL | Shirner expresses his resolute loyalty to Free. He will not abandon the horse given to him by his lord; either they both make it or both perish.

5 ám=át=ki jötunn ‘uncanny ettin’ | Formulaic; the adjective *ám=átt=igr* ‘uncanny’ is used exclusively for evil supernatural beings. See note to *Vsp* 8.

- P3 Skírnir reið i Jötun-heima til Gymis garða; þar vöru hundar  
 2 ólmir ok bundnir fyrir skíð-garðs-hliði þess, er um sal Gerðar  
 var. Hann reið at þar, er fé-hirðir sat á haugi, ok kvaddi hann:

[R 11r/31, A 2v/1]

Shirner rode into the Ettinhomes toward Gymer’s yards. Thereat there were fierce hounds bound in front of the gate of the paled fence which surrounded Gird’s hall. He rode up to where a shepherd sat on a mound and greeted him:

2 Gerðar ‘Gird’ | It is only now that we find out the maiden’s name.

- 11 „Seg þat hirðir, · es á haugi sitr  
 2 ok varðar alla vega:  
 hvé ek at and-spilli · kom=umk hins unga mans  
 4 fyr greyjum Gymis.“

[R 11r/2, A 2v/4]



“Tell this, O herdsman who sittest on the mound  
and watchest all the ways,  
how to discourse I might come with the young girl  
past Gymer’s greyhounds.”

1 á haugi sitr ‘who sittest on the mound’ | For this motif cf. *Vsp* 41/1 n.

[Hirðir] kvað: 12 „Hvárt est **f**eiðr, · eða est **f**ramm ginginn  
2 [...];  
and-spillis vanr · þú skalt **é** vesa  
4 góðrar meýjar **G**ymis.“

[R 11v/4, A 2v/5]

Quoth [the herdsman]: “Regardless of whether thou art fey or passed-on,  
[...]  
discourseless shalt thou for ever be  
with Gymer’s good maiden!”

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in the mss. but it is certain that a c-line is missing here, probably containing a vocative ‘O stranger’, or similar.

4 góðrar meýjar ‘good maiden’ | Formulaic, carrying with it a sense of chastity. See note to *Háv* 102/1 for further occurrences.

[Skírnir] kvað: 13 „**K**ostir ’ro þetri · an klökkva séi  
2 hveim es **f**úss es fara,  
**é**inu dógri · mér vas aldr of skapaðr  
4 ok alt **l**íf of lagit.“

[R 11v/6, A 2v/7]

Quoth [Skírnir]: “Choices are better than sobbing might  
for whomever is eager to journey.  
In one half-day my age was shaped,  
and all my life laid down.”

1 an ‘than’ | so A; heldr an at ‘rather than to [þe]’ R

ALL | An excellent formulation of the Old Germanic fatalistic world-view. After uttering these words Skírnir rides through the fire surrounding the fortress.

1 Kostir ‘Choices’ | I.e., ‘alternatives, other ways’.

3 éinu dógri · mér vas aldr of skapaðr ‘In one half-day my age was shaped’ | Formulaic. The single half-day is both the time of one’s birth when the norns or dises arrive (cf. 1 *HHund* 1–4 and *Hákm* 19/1–2: *Góðu dógri · verðr sá gramr of borinn, / es sér getr s-likan sefa* ‘On a good half-day will that lord be born who gets for himself such heart’) and the fixed time of one’s inevitable death (*Gríp* 25/4). For the norns shaping one’s age (ON (of) *skapa aldr*) cf. 1 *HHund* 2/2 and *Gylf* 15:30: *Enn eru fleiri nornir, þær er koma til þvers barns, er borit er, at skapa aldr* ‘There are yet more norns, those which come to every child which is born to shape its age’; for the use of the verb shape in this context cf. also *Reg* 2/3, 6/3, *Sigsk* 7/3.

4 alt líf of lagit ‘all my life laid down’ | The causative *leggja* ‘to lay (down, in place)’ is closely connected to fate; the expression is formulaic. Cf. *Lok* 48: *í ár-daga vas þér bit ljóta líf of lagit* ‘in days of yore was thy ugly life laid down’ and *Vsp* 19: *þér lög lögðu* ‘they [= the Norns] laid down laws’.

[Gērðr] kvað: 14 „Hvat ’s þat hlym hlymja · es hlymja heyrri’k nú til  
2 osum rönnum í?  
jörð bifa=sk, · en allir fyr  
4 skjalfa garðar Gymis.“

[R 11v/7, A 2v/8]

Quoth [Gird]: “What is this din of dins which I now hear dinning  
in our houses?  
The earth trembles, but before us all  
Gymer’s yards do quake.”

Ambótt kvað: 15 „Maðr ’s hér úti, · stigin af mars baki,  
2 jó léttr til jarðar taka.“

[R 11v/9, A 2v/10]

Quoth the maid-servant: “A man is here without, stepped down off horse-back;  
he lets his steed graze the earth.”

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2 jó léttr til jarðar taka ‘he lets his steed graze the earth’ | Lit. ‘he lets his steed take to the earth’.  
According to Finnur Jónsson (1932) this expression is still used in modern Icelandic.

[Gērðr] kvað: 16 „Inn bið hann ganga · í okkarn sal  
2 ok drekka inn méra mjöð,  
þó ek hitt ó=umk, · at hér úti séi  
4 mín bróður-bani.“

[R 11v/10, A 2v/11]

Quoth [Gird]: “Bid him go into our hall  
and drink the renowned mead;  
though I fear that here outside might be  
my brother’s bane.”

[Gērðr] kvað: 17 „Hvat ’s þat alfa · né ása sona,  
2 né víssa vana;  
hví einn of komt · eikinn fúr yfir  
4 ór sal-kynni at séa?“

[R 11v/12, A 2v/13]

[Quoth Gird]: “Which one of the Elves is this; not of sons of the Eese,  
nor of the wise Wanese?  
Why camest thou alone o’er the raging fire,  
to see the state of our hall?”

---

ALL | Gird addresses Shirner and asks him about his origin. She can tell that he is not a god, and so asks him what he is, apparently thinking him an elf.

[Skírnir kvað:] 18 „Eṃ'k=at alfa · né ǻsa sona  
2 né vísǻa vana,  
þó ɛinn of kom'k · ɛikinn fúr yfir  
4 yður sal-kynni at séa.

[R 11v/14]

[Quoth Shirner:] “I am not of Elves, nor of sons of the Eese,  
nor of wise Wanes—  
though I came alone o'er the raging fire,  
to see the state of your hall.

19 Eṗli ɛllifu · hér hef'k al-gollin,  
2 þau mun'k þér Gɛrðr gefa,  
frið at kaupa, · at þú þér Frey kveðir  
4 ò·leijðastan at lifa.“

[R 11v/15, A 2v/14]

Eleven apples have I here, all-golden;  
them will I to thee, Gird, give  
to buy thy love, that thou mightst call Free  
the most unloathsome [beloved] in thy life.”

ALL | Shirner begins his coercion of Gird, which takes up sts. 19–36. Shirner first offers Gird gold (sts. 19–22), then threatens her with violence (23–25) and finally curses her with a long spell (26–36), which breaks her.

It has been noted by Brate (1913) that the structure of this passage bears some resemblance to Weden's seduction of Wrind in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4.1–8. In Weden's seduction of Wrind he disguises himself first as a warrior, then as a gold-smith, then again as a warrior but is spurned each time. Finally he makes himself out to be a witch, and having tied Wrind down, proceeds to rape her (cf. *Vsp* 31 n.) If the first disguise is omitted, we see in both texts a three-fold progression consisting of giving gold, using force of arms, and at last employing magic.

1 Eṗli ɛllifu ‘Eleven apples’ | Probably the apples of Idin, which grant perpetual youth to the Gods. So *Gylf* 26:7: *Hon varð-veitir i eski sinu epli þau, er goð'in skulu á bíta, þá er þau elda-sk, ok verða þá allir ungir, ok svá mun vera allt til ragna-rökr.* ‘She keeps in her casket the apples which the Gods should bite into when they age, and then they all grow young, and so it will be all until the Twilight of the Reins’. Idin's apples and the theft thereof are dealt with in *Skm* 2–3 and *Haustr* 1–13. It is not clear whether Shirner actually has the apples in his possession or whether he is merely making a big promise.

4 at lifa ‘in thy life’ | at lifa here seems to mean ‘in life/living’ rather than the typical infinitive sense ‘to live’; cf. st. 22 at *deila* ‘in sharing’ below. This may be an archaism.

[Gɛrðr] kvað: 20 „Eṗli ɛllifu · ek þigg aldri=gi  
2 at manns-kis munum,  
né vit Freyr, · meðan okkart fȳr lifir,  
4 byggjum bɛði saman.“

[R 11v/17, A 2v/15]

[Quoth Gird:] “Eleven apples will I never take  
to any man’s liking,  
nor will I and Free—while our life remains—  
dwell both together.”

[Skírnir kvað:] **21** „Baug þér þá gef’k, · þann’s brænndr vas  
2 með **ungum** Óðins syni;  
átta ’ro **jafn**-hofgir, · es **af** drjúpa  
4 hina **níundu** hverja **nött**.“

[R 11v/19, A 2v/17]

[Quoth Shirner:] “The bigh I then give thee, which was burned  
with Weden’s young son [= Balder].  
Eight even-heavy ones do drip thereof  
every ninth night.”

3–4 átta ... nött ‘Eight ... night.’ | *om. (by parablepsis) A*

1 Baug ‘The bigh’ | Bigh, meaning ‘armlet’ or ‘ring’. While not named, the bigh is clearly Dreepner. It is known from *Gylf* 49:54, which describes Balder’s funeral and probably draws on the present stanza: *Óðinn lagði á bál’t gull-bring þann, er Draupnir heitir. Hónum fylgði sú náttúra, at ina níundu hverja nött drupu af bónum átta gull-bringar jafn-hofgir*. ‘Weden laid on the pyre that gold ring which is called Dreepner. Its nature was such that every ninth night eight even-heavy golden rings dripped from it.’ The Eese later regained the bigh, which is presumably why Shirner can promise to give it. *Gylf* 49:73–74 tells us that when the god Harmod rode to Hell to try to bring Balder back, Balder instead gave him the bigh, and told him to bring it back to Weden as a token by which he would be remembered.

[Gerdör] kvað: **22** „Baug þikk=a’k, · þó’tt brænndr séi,  
2 með **ungum** Óðins syni;  
es=a mér **golls** vant · í **gørðum** **Gymis**  
4 at deila **fé** **føður**.“

[R 11v/21, A 2v/18]

[Quoth Gird:] “The bigh I will not take although it may have been burned  
with Weden’s young son [= Balder].  
I have no want of gold in Gymer’s yards,  
sharing the wealth of my father.”

1–2 Baug ... syni ‘The bigh ... son’ | *om. (by parablepsis) A*

[Skírnir kvað:] **23** „Sér þú **méki**, **mér**, · **mjóvan**, **mál**-faan,  
2 es **hef’k** í **hendi hér?**  
**hofuð** **hoggva** · mun’k þér **halsi** af,  
4 nema mér **sétt** **segir**.“

[R 11v/23, A 2v/19]

[Quoth Shirner:] “Seest thou the sword, maiden—slender, picture-painted—  
which I have here in my hand?”

I will cut the head from off thy neck  
unless thou agree with me!”

1 mēki ... mál-faan ‘sword ... picture-painted’ | The sword is inlaid with metal (perhaps gold or silver) forming a pattern; this may also be a reference to a damascened blade. The expression *mēki mál-faan* (acc. sg.) ‘picture-painted sword’ also occurs in *Sígr 4/2*.

[Gērðr kvað:] 24 „Á·nauð þola · vil’k aldri=gi  
2 at manns-kis munum,  
þó hins get’k, · ef it Gyimir finnið=sk  
4 vígs ò-trauðir · at ykkir vega tíði.“

[R 11v/25, A 2v/20]

[Quoth Gird:] “Sexual coercion will I never stand  
to any man’s liking,  
though I still know that if thou and Gymer meet—  
men unreluctant of conflict—ye will desire to fight.”

2 manns-kis ‘any man’s (lit. ‘no man’s’) | manns çnskis A

3 þó ‘although’ | The interpretation of this word changes the tone of the stanza. If it means ‘although, even though’ then Gird is expressing her fear of violence between Shirner and her father, i.e., “I will not give in, even if it should lead to violence, as I fear”. If, on the other hand, it means ‘still, yet’, she may be expressing pride, i.e., “I will not give in, and what is more, my father will be eager to fight thee”. I find the former understanding more natural.

[Skírnir kvað:] 25 „Sér þú mēki, mēr, · mjóvan, mál-faan,  
2 es hef’k í hendi hér?  
fyr þessum eggjum · hnígr sá inn aldni jötunn,  
4 verðr þinn feigr faðir.

[R 11v/27, A 2v/22]

[Quoth Shirner:] “Seest thou the sword, maiden—slender, picture-painted—  
which I have here in my hand?  
By these edges will that olden ettin sink down;  
fey becomes thy father!

26 Tams-vendi þik drep’k, · çn ek þik tēmja mun,  
2 mēr, at mǫnum munum,  
þar skalt ganga · es þik gumna synir  
4 síðan éva séi.

[R 11v/28, A 2v/24]

With the taming-wand I strike thee, but I will tame thee,  
maiden, to my liking!  
Thou shalt go whither the sons of men  
never since will see thee!

ALL. | With this stanza Shirner's turns away from his direct threats of violence and begins his long curse (sts. 26–36). He curses Gird to be loveless, joyless, captive, and the subject of sexual abuse at the hands of loathsome ettins if she does not give in to his demands.

1 Tams-vendi 'taming-wand' | Probably a cane or whip, perhaps of a magical nature. The imagery is uncomfortably sexual, and Shirner threatens to 'tame' Gird like an animal.

- 27     **Ara þúfu á · skalt ár sitja,**  
        **horfa hęimi ór;**  
        **snugga hęljar til;**  
 4     **matr sęi þęr męir lęiðr · an manna hvęim**  
        **inn fráni ormr með firum.**

[R 11v/30, A 2v/26]

On an eagle's perch shalt thou sit for long,  
 turn away from the world,  
 hanker after Hell!

Be the food more loathsome to thee than to any man  
 the gleaming Wyrms among folk.

1 Ara þúfu á · skalt ár sitja 'On an eagle's perch shalt thou sit for long' | ár skalt sitja · ara þúfu á 'for long shalt thou sit on an eagle's perch' A 2–3 horfa hęimi ór; / snugga hęljar til 'turn away from the world, / hanker after Hell' | horfa ok snugga hęljar til 'turn and hanker after Hell' A 2 ór | *add. in marg.* R 5 firum | *The last word on A 2v, after which the text cuts off; apart from the very last stanza, the rest of the poem is preserved only in R.*

ALL. | Shirner threatens Gird with captivity on a high mountain. The structure of sts. 27 and 28 is identical; both feature a direct threat in ll. 1–3 followed by a mythological hyperbole in ll. 5–6.

2–3 horfa hęimi ór; / snugga hęljar til 'turn away from the world, / hanker after Hell' | On the mountain-perch Gird will be able to see both Earth and the Underworld, but her situation will be so miserable that she will turn her face away from the former and long for her own death.

4–5 matr ... firum 'Be ... folk.' | Gird's disgust over her food will be greater than the hatred of the Middenyardswyrms among mankind, which is understood to be extreme. For this hatred cf. *Hym* 22.

- 28     **At undr-sjónum verðir · es þú út kœmr,**  
        **á þik Hrímnir hari**  
        **á þik hot-vetna stari,**  
 4     **víð-kunnari verðir · an vörðr með goðum,**  
        **gapi þú grindum frá.**

[R 11v/32]

A wondrous sight mayst thou be when thou comest out;  
 at thee may Rimner ogle;  
 at thee may anyone stare!

Mayst thou be more widely known than the watchman with the Gods;  
 mayst thou gape from the gates.

2 Hrímnir ‘Rimner’ | An unknown ettin whose name derives from *brím* ‘rime ice’; he is one the many who will jeer at Gird.

4 vörðr með goðum ‘the watchman with the Gods’ | Homedall, who guards Bivrest from the ettins; cf. *Gylf* 27:8 (edited under *Eddbr* III). The poetic epithet is also found in *Grm* 13/3 and *Lok* 48/4.

- 29      **T**ópi ok ópi, · tjosull ok ó·þoli, [R 12r/2]  
 2            vaxi þér **t**ór með **t**rega;  
             **s**æt=sk þú niðr · en mun’k **s**egja þér  
 4            **s**váran **s**ús-breka,  
             ok **t**vinnan **t**rega.  
 Toop and woop, tarsle and restlessness—  
     may thy tears grow with grief!  
 Sit thee down, but I will tell thee  
     a hard roaring-breaker  
     and a twined grief.

1 Tópi ok ópi, · tjosull ‘Toop and woop, tarsle’ | Otherwise unknown magic curse words without clear meaning; I have left them untranslated. *ópi* resembles *óp* ‘scream’, and *tjosull* ‘tarsle’ may perhaps be related to OE *teors* ‘penis’ and mean ‘little phallus’.

4 sváran sús-breka ‘hard roaring-breaker’ | Unclear. A curse that will hit Gird like a breaking wave (*breki*)?

- 30      Tramar **g**neypa · þik skulu **g**erstan dag [R 12r/3]  
 2            **j**otna **g**orðum **í**,  
             til **h**rím-þursa **h**allar · þú skalt **h**verjan dag  
 4            **k**ranga **k**osta-laús;  
             **k**ranga **k**osta-von;  
 6            **g**rát at **g**amni · skalt **í** **g**ogn hafa  
             ok leiða með **t**órum **t**rega.  
 Fiends shall pine thee on a dismal day  
     in the yards of the Ettins.  
 To the hall of Rime-Thurses shalt thou every day  
     crawl choice-less,  
     crawl choice-lacking.  
 Weeping shalt thou have in exchange for joy,  
     and nurse thy grief with tears.

1 Tramar ‘Fiends’ | TODO: reference ordsifjabók.

- 31      Með þursi þrí-hofðuðum · þú skalt é nara [R 12r/7]  
 2            eða **v**er-laús **v**esa;

þitt gēð grípi,  
 4 þik morn morni;  
 ves þú sem þistill, · sá's þrunginn vas  
 6 í ofan-verða qnn.

With a three-headed thurse shalt thou always live  
 or be husband-less.  
 May thy senses seize;  
 may murrain mourn thee!  
 Be thou like the thistle which was pressed  
 during highest harvest!

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1 þursi þri-hqðuðum 'three-headed thurse' | Ettins often have an abnormal number of body parts. For their many-headed-ness see note to *Hym* 8/2.

5-6 ves ... qnn 'Be ... harvest' | The thistle was considered a weed; cf. the Old English galder against a cattle-thief ("For Theft of Cattle" under Galders) cursing him to be *swá bræðel ... swá þystel* 'as useless as the thistle'. The 'pressing' of the thistle has been connected with an Estonian folk-ritual wherein a thistle would be crushed by stones at the beginning of harvest to prevent further weeds (TODO: reference).

32 Til holts ek gekk · ok til hrás viðar  
 2 gamban-tēin at geta  
 gamban-tēin ek gat.

[R 12r/9]

To the grove I went and to the sappy tree,  
 the gombentoe for to get;  
 the gombentoe I got.

---

1 til hrás viðar 'to the sappy tree' | The wood of a sapling was apparently thought to be the most effective for magic; cf. *Háv* 152, which speaks about a runic curse carved on *rótum rás viðar* 'the roots of a sappy tree'.

2 gamban-tēin 'gomben-toe' | Perhaps 'mighty twig', also found in *Hárþ* 20/4. The word is a cpd. of the very rare prefix *gamban-* 'magic/curse?' (cf. *Lok* 8/4 n.) and *tēinn* 'twig, branch' (cf. *mistil-tēinn* 'mistle-toe'). This may be the stick on which the runic curse in st. 36 below should be carved, or it is to be identified with the *tams-vpnðr* 'taming-wand' of st. 26 above. *Hárþ* 21 suggests that it is an object of some value.

33 Rēiðr 's þér Óðinn, · rēiðr 's þér Ása-bragr,  
 2 þik skal Fręyr fía=sk,  
 hin firin-illa mér, · ęn fingit hęfr  
 4 gamban-rēiði goða.

[R 12r/10]

Wroth with thee is Weden; wroth with thee is Eesebray (= Thunder);  
 thee shall Free come to hate,  
 O wickedly evil maiden, if thou hast earned  
 the gomben-wrath of the gods.



1 Ása-bragr ‘Eesebray’ | ‘The pinnacle of the Eese’, Thunder.

- 34      Hęyri jøtnar, · hęyri hrím-þursar, [R 12r/12]  
 2      synir Suttunga, · sjalfir øs-liðar,  
       hvé ek fyrir·býð, · hvé ek fyrir·banna  
 4      manna glaum mani,  
       manna nyt mani.

Hear may Ettins, hear may Rime-thurses,  
 sons of Sutting [ETTINS], even the Eese-folk,  
 how I forbid, how I forban  
 men’s fellowship from the maid,  
 men’s joy from the maid!

- 35      Hrím-grímnir hętir þurs, · es þik hafa skal [R 12r/14]  
 2      fyr Ná-grindr neðan,  
       þar þér víl-męgir · à viðar rótum  
 4      gęita-hland gęfi;  
       óðri drykkju · fà þú aldri=gi,  
 6      męr, af þínum munum,  
       męr, at mǫnum munum.

Rimegrimner is the name of the thurse who shall have thee  
 down beneath Neegrind,  
 where lads of toil [THRALLS] on the roots of a tree  
 goat-piss will give thee.  
 Never fetch a finer drink,  
 O maiden, against thy liking,  
 O maiden, to *my* liking!

- 36      Þurs ríst’k þér · ok þría stafi, [R 12r/16]  
 2      ęrgi ok óði ok ó·þola,  
       svá ek þat af ríst · sem ek þat à ręist,  
 4      ef gøra=sk þarfar þęss.“

Thurse I carve for thee, and three staves:  
 queerness and madness and restlessness.  
 So will I carve it *off* like I carved it *on*,  
 if there arise need for that.”

ALL | With the carving of the rune-stick Shirner threatens to fulfill the curse predicted in sts. 26–35. He hints to Gird that he will scrape the runes off and nullify if she will accept his demands.

1 Þurs ‘thurse’ | Thurse is the name of the þ-rune (þ); it is carved as part of the curse.

1 þria stafi ‘three staves’ | Three runic letters (or phrases) representing the three following words (*ergi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’ etc.). The magic notion of carving “three staves” is also found on the C7th Gummarp stone: **h**a**þ**u**w**o**l**a**f**a **s**a**t**e **s**t**a**b**a** **þ**r**i**a **f**f**f** ‘Hathwolf placed three staves: fff’, where the f-rune (𐀚) stands for its name \**fēb* (> ON *fē* ‘wealth, cattle’) and is thus meant to bring wealth.

2 *ergi* ok óði ok óþola ‘queerness and madness and restlessness’ | Both *ergi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’ and *óþoli* ‘restlessness’ (here probably from strong lust) are found in the love magic charm on the rune stick B257 from Bryggen (edited below under Galders). *ergi* is also found in the curse-formula on the C7th Proto-Norse runestones from Stentoften and Björketorp. See further introduction to B257.

- [Geðör kvað:] 37 „Heill ves þú heldr, sveinn, · ok tak við hrím-kalki [R 12r/19]  
 2 fullum forns mjaðar,  
 þó haðá’k étlat, · at mynda’k aldri=gi  
 4 unna vaningja vël.“  
 [Quoth Gird:] “Hale be thou rather, swain, and receive the rime-chalice,  
 full of ancient mead,  
 although I had intended that I never would  
 love the Waning [= Free] well.”

1–2 Heill ... mjaðar ‘Hale ... mead’ | Formulaic; repeated identically in *Lok* 53/1–2.

1 hrím-kalki ‘rime-chalice’ | Some kind of expensive glazed drinking vessel; the second element *kalkr* ‘chalice’ is a borrowing from Latin *calix* and suggests a Roman origin. Cf. the *kalkr* in *Hym* 28/4b.

4 vaningja ‘the Waning [= Free]’ | The ‘descendant of the Wanæs’. A rare word. Its only other occurrence in the Norse corpus is in a thule of boar-names. Boars were sacred to Free, TODO.

- [Skírnir kvað:] 38 „Ørendi mín · vil’k ǫll vita, [R 12r/21]  
 2 áðr riða’k heim heðan,  
 nér à þingi · munt inum þroska  
 4 nenna Njarðar syni?“  
 [Quoth Shirner:] “My errands all I wish to know  
 before I ride home hence:  
 when on the Thing wilt thou to the virile  
 son of Nearth [= Free] submit?”

- [Geðör kvað:] 39 „Barri heitir, · es vit bēði vitum, [R 12r/23]  
 2 lundr logn-fara,  
 en ept nētr níu, · þar mun Njarðar syni  
 4 Geðör unna gamans.“  
 [Quoth Gird:] “Barrey is the name—as we both do know—  
 of a grove of calm breezes,  
 and after nine nights there will to the son of Nearth  
 Gird her pleasure grant.”

1 Barri ‘Barrey’ | Derived from *barr* ‘leaf, foliage’, perhaps a reference to a cornfield (of wheat or barley, not maize!) which would fit in an interpretation of the poem as an analogy for agricultural fertility.

2 logn-fara ‘calm breezes’ | A *bapax* compound, here read as a gen. pl. of *logn* n. ‘calm (wind)’ + *far* ‘trail, passage’, i.e., ‘where one travels calmly’. Another interpretation is a gen. sg. of an unattested proper noun *Logn-fari* ‘Calm-farer’, ‘the one who causes calm winds’ (cf. *Mundil-fari* in *Vafþ 23*), probably a name for Free in his role as a fertility god.

P4 Þá reið Skírnir heim. Freyr stóð úti ok kvaddi hann ok spurði [R 12r/24]  
2 tíðenda:

Then Shirner rode home. Free stood outside and greeted him and asked for the tidings:

40 „Sæg mér, Skírnir, · áðr verpir sǫðli af mar [R 12r/25]  
2 ok stígir feti framarr,  
hvat þú árnaðir · í Jǫtun-heima  
4 þíns eða míns munar?“

“Tell me, Shirner, before thou mightst throw the saddle off the steed  
and take a step further,  
what thou accomplished in the Ettinhomes  
to thy or my liking?”

2 ok stígir feti framarr ‘and take a step further’ | Formulaic; a variant of *feti ganga/gangir framarr* (*Háv 38/2*, *Lok 1/2*).

[Skírnir kvað:] 41 „Barri heitir, · es vit báðir vitum, [R 12r/27]  
2 lundr logn-fara,  
en ept nētr níu, · þar mun Njarðar syni  
4 Geðr unna gamans.“

[Quoth Shirner:] “Barrey is the name—as we both do know—  
of a grove of calm breezes,  
and after nine nights there will to the son of Nearth  
Gird her pleasure grant.”

ALL | *Abbrev.* ‘Barri. h. l. er. vi. l. l. c. e. n. n. þ. m. n. s. g. u. gamans’ R.

[Freyr kvað:] 42 „Lǫng es nótt, · langar ’ro tvér, [R 12r/28,  
2 hvé of þreyja’k þrjár?  
opt mér mánaðr · minni þótti  
4 an sjá hǫlf hý-nótt.“ S 9r/32, T 9v/35  
W TODO, U TODO]

[Quoth Free:] “Long is a night, long are two—  
how can I yearn for three?  
Oft a month to me seemed less  
than this half wedding-night!”

1 langar 'ro tvér 'long are two' | löng es önnur 'long is another' G 2 hvé of þreyja'k þríar? | hvé  
meða'k þreyja þríar G

ALL | This stanza is cited following *Gylf* 37:15 in that text; see below.

4 hólfr hý-nótt 'half wedding-night' | *hý-nótt* is a hapax cpd. of *hý-* + *nótt* 'night'. *hý-* has been variously explained, e.g. as a form of the demonstrative pronoun stem PGmc. \**biz*, but is most likely the same prefix found in *hý-býli* 'farmstead', equivalent to Gothic *betwa-* 'marriage, household', OHG *bî-* 'marriage'; for the root cf. Kroonen (2013, p. 227).

On the basis of the first element the most likely sense of the cpd. is the wedding-night and more specifically the consummation of the marriage. The word *hólfr* 'half' should then probably not be taken as a measurement of time (like 'half a month') but rather as meaning 'incomplete' or 'divided' (cf. e.g. *Háv* 53/4). The wedding-night may be called divided since although the two are now betrothed, they are still separated; each is 'half'.

## Appendix

### *Gylf* 37:1–15

NOTE: The following excerpt has not yet been critically edited.

*Gylf* 37:1–15 deals with the relevant myth. The remainder of the chapter (37:16–19) deals with Free's lack of his sword and is cited in *Vsp* 51/3 (n.). Cf. also st. 8 above and *Lok* 42.

*Gylf* 37:1–7 corresponds to *Ski* P1–2 and 37:8–13 paraphrases sts. 3–9. The rest of the poem is summed up very succinctly by 37:14.

1Gymir hét maðr, en kona hans Aur-boða. Hón var berg-risa  
2éttar. 2Dóttir þeira er Gerðr, er allra kvinna var fegrst. 3Þat var  
einn dag, at Freyr hafði gengit í Hlið-skjálfr ok sá of heima alla.  
4En er hann leit í norðr-étt, þá sá hann á einum bó mikit hús ok  
fagrt, ok til þess húss gekk kona, 5ok er hón tók upp høndum  
6ok lauk hurð fyrir sér, þá lýsti af høndum hennar bæði í lopt ok á  
lög, ok allir heimar birtusk af henni. 6Ok svá hefnði hónum þat  
8mikla mikil-léti, er hann hafði setsk í þat it helga sæti, at hann  
gekk í braut fullr af harmi. 7Ok er hann kom heim, mælti hann  
10ekki. Ekki svaf hann, ekki drakk hann. Engi þorði ok at krefja  
hann orða.

<sup>1</sup>Gymer was the name of a man, and his woman was Earbode; she was of the lineage of barrow-risers. <sup>2</sup>Their daughter is Gird who was fairest of all women. <sup>3</sup>It was one day when Free had gone to the Lithshelf and looked out over all the Homes. <sup>4</sup>But when he looked north he saw on a farm a large

and fair house, and to that house walked a woman, <sup>5</sup>and when she raised her hands and closed the doors behind her then it shone from her hands into both the air and the waters, and all the homes were brightened by her. <sup>6</sup>And so greatly did the greatness which he had beheld in the holy seat harm him that he walked away filled with grief, <sup>7</sup>and when he came home he said nothing. He slept nothing; he drank nothing. No one dared to get words out of him.

2           <sup>8</sup>Þá lét Njorðr kalla til sín Skírni, skó-svein Freys, ok bað hann  
ganga til Freys ok beiða hann orða ok spyrja, hverjum hann væri  
4           svá reiðr, at hann mélti ekki við menn. <sup>9</sup>En Skírnir létsk ganga  
mundu ok eigi fúss ok kvað illra svara vera ván af honum. <sup>10</sup>En  
6           er hann kom til Freys, þá spurði hann, hví Freyr var svá hnipinn  
ok mélti ekki við menn. <sup>11</sup>Þá svarar Freyr ok sagði, at hann hefði  
8           sét konu fagra ok fyrir hennar sakir var hann svá harm-fullr, at  
eigi myndi hann lengi lifa, ef hann skyldi eigi ná henni, <sup>12</sup>ok  
10           nú skaltu fara ok biðja hennar mér til handa ok hafa hana heim  
hingat, hvárt er faðir hennar vill eða eigi, ok skal ek þat vel launa  
þér.“ <sup>13</sup>Þá svarar Skírnir, sagði svá, at hann skal fara sendi-ferð,  
12           en Freyr skal fá honum sverð sitt. Þat var svá gott sverð, at sjálft  
vást. En Freyr lét eigi þat til skorta ok gaf honum sverðit.

<sup>8</sup>Then Nearth had Shirner, Free's shoe-swain, summoned before him and asked him to go to Free and bid him to speak and ask at whom he was so wroth that he would not speak with men. <sup>9</sup>And Shirner said that he would go, although not eagerly, and said that he expected ill answers from him. <sup>10</sup>And when he came to Free he asked why Free was so downcast and spoke nothing with men. <sup>11</sup>Then Free answers, and said that he had seen a fair woman and for her sakes was he so full of grief that he would not live long if he should not reach her, <sup>12</sup>“and now shalt thou journey to ask for her hand on my behalf, and bring her home hither whether her father wants to or not, and I shall reward thee well for that.” <sup>13</sup>Then Shirner answers; said so, that he will go on the errand-journey, but Free shall give him his sword; it was such a good sword that it struck by itself. And Free did not deny him that and gave him the sword.

2           <sup>14</sup>Þá fór Skírnir ok bað honum konu'nnar ok fekk heit hennar,  
ok níu nóttum síðar skyldi hon þar koma, er Barrey heitir, ok  
4           ganga þá at brul-laupinu með Frey. <sup>15</sup>En er Skírnir sagði Frey  
sitt erindi, þá kvað hann þetta: [...]

<sup>14</sup>Then Shirner journeyed and asked for the woman's hand for him [Free] and

got her promise that nine nights later she would come to that place which is called Barrey and have a wedding with Free.<sup>15</sup> And when Shirner told Free his errand then he quoth this: [...]

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4 [...] | Here the text cites its own variant of st. 42; see there for critical notes.

# Leeds of Hoarbeard

## (*Hár·barðs ljóð*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.578)–late C11th (0.377)

Meter: Varied

### Introduction

The **Leeds of Hoarbeard** (*Hárþ*) is a mythological narrative poem consisting of a dialogue between the two mythological figures Thunder and Hoarbeard.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hárþ* is preserved in full (sts. 1–60) in **R**, on foll. 12r/30–13v/26, where it follows *Skí* and precedes *Hym*. The poem is partially preserved (sts. 19/4b–60) in **A**, on foll. 1r/1–1v/17, where it is the first poem and is followed by *Bdr*.

### Contents

*Hárþ* is a dialogue between the two gods Thunder (*Þörr*) and Hoarbeard (*Hár·barðr*, i.e., ‘grey-beard’), who meet at a sound. Thunder, the traveller, asks Hoarbeard, the ferryman, for passage; an argument ensues, and Thunder is forced to depart without passage.

### The Characters

Thunder is of course the well-known god, but Hoarbeard merits discussion. Considering his name, which appears in *Grm* 51 as a name for Weden, and his generally Odinic character (cf. esp. st. 24), he is near-universally considered to be the god Weden in disguise.

The difference in personality between the two gods is striking, so that *Hárþ* is far from a flyting between, say, two warriors of equal stature. Thunder is portrayed as moral and altruistic, but also as rather naïve and the foil for

Hoarbeard's insults. Hoarbeard on the other hand is egoistic and sly. He is the first to insult Thunder, and gets the last laugh by denying him passage.

The poem might be seen as an allegory on class relations, namely between the self-owning yeomen farmers and the warlike earls, represented by their patron gods. TODO.

### Humour and satire

*Hárþ* stands out from the six preceding poems (*Vsp-Ski*, and particularly the first five) in its humorosity and less than irreverent tone regarding the gods. This lighter tone is particularly shared with *Lok* and, to a somewhat lesser degree, *Þrk* and *Hym*; since this is the first such "irreverent" poem it is reasonable to deal with the phenomenon here.

It has to be strongly emphasized that this irreverence is in no way a sign of Christian influence or a weakening of the pagan religion as such. To begin with, it never crosses into direct blasphemy; all insults between gods are uttered by the Gods themselves, not directly by the poet. Nor does the poet denounce the gods or call them false or dæmonic; on the contrary in all four mentioned poems there are respectful and even reverent statements about or attributed to the gods (e.g. *Hárþ* 23, 47, *Hym* 21–24, 36, *Lok* 55, 57, 59, 61, 63, *Þrk* 21, 31–32).

Furthermore this treatment of the Gods in mythology is by no means unique to the late Norse religion of the Wiking Age. Parallels are found already in Homer (*Il* 21.385–440, 458–513), where several gods and goddesses are humorously described as fighting with their fists over the fate of the Trojans. The most likely explanation for this is that the texts we are dealing with are mythological; they are not hymns or documents of cultic Law, genres almost totally absent from Old Norse literature (but cf. Lindow 1988).

In Paganism (unlike Judaism, which does away almost completely with divine mythology!) it thus seems clear that these supposedly irreverent descriptions were not felt to damage the credibility of the gods or their ritual significance. That the poems themselves are not Christian is certain; several of them have archaic linguistic features (cf. e.g. *Hym* 23/1, 28/2, *Lok* 15/3, 18/4, 27/4, *Þrk* 1/1), and they assume a deep familiarity with the nature and character of the different gods.

### Meter

Of all Eddic poems *Hárþ* is probably the strangest in terms of form. It consists of 149 lines across 60 "stanzas", some of which consist merely of single unmetrical prose lines. No narrative prose is embedded apart from P1 at the very beginning, which sets the stage for the rest of the poem.

Stanza length varies greatly. 4 lines is by no means the standard; in fact, only a single fully regular Leeds-meter-stanza of type *abcabc* occurs, viz. st. 47.

The meter itself is an irregular mix of Leeds-meter and a peripheral form of Speeches-meter. Many lines are unusually long (e.g. 4/3b, 56/5a, 59/1–



2) and others have no metrical qualities at all (17/1, 31/1, 41/1, 44–46, 57/1, 60/1).

## Language

The language of *Hárþ* comes across as unusually young and informal.

The clitic definite *-inn* is employed with unique frequency throughout *Hárþ* in both the prose and poetic lines. This is probably the clearest identifiable young feature of the poem. The clitic, although attested in Wiking Age runic inscriptions from the 11th c. onwards, only rarely appears in poetry older than the 14th c., suggesting that it was not considered appropriate for use in poetic composition. (TODO: cite this.)

The particle *of*, an old trait, is found 3 times (18/5, 19/5, 33/1) with a total frequency of 0.120 per 10 unique lines; a relatively low rate compared to most Eddic poems (Sapp 2022, p. 70).

The normal or prosaic forms *hingat* and *þangat* are used in the respective sense ‘hither’ and ‘thither’ for the older *hinig* and *þinig*. On the other hand there is the presence of the rare and prob. old words *ǫgurr* ‘burden(?)’ (st. 13) and *gamban-teinn* (st. 20).

## Possibilities of performance

The loose meter and non-formal language demand discussion. To begin with, we should disregard the notion that *Hárþ* is heavily corrupt and requires restoration. It must be stated clearly that no amount of emendation could “restore” *Hárþ* to a pure Leeds-meter resembling what we find in *Háv*, *Vaff*, or *Lok*. Furthermore, most lines of *Hárþ*, including those of unusual length or without clear metrical qualities, are readily understandable and fit well both within their immediate context and the poem as a whole. If there is such great corruption, it has still produced a remarkably consistent and intelligible text. Yet, even so, the poem is unconventional.

As all Norse poetry, at least prior to the antiquarian period of the 12th c., was originally oral, it must have been performed in some way. Assuming *Hárþ* is older than the 12th c., it should not be an exception. With this in mind the traits described above may be explained quite nicely if we assume that *Hárþ* was originally acted out, perhaps in a carnivalesque theatre with two actors standing on a stage, separated by a staged body of water and shouting at each other; alternatively with one actor playing both roles by the use of props, gestures, and voices.

The whole poem in fact seems remarkably fit for such a performance, and with this assumption many pieces fall into place. Take Thunder’s talk of his breakfast and the pack on his back (st. 3), which invites the actor to point to his back and then rub his belly; Hoarbeard’s insult of Thunder’s dress (st. 6), which would work much better if there was in fact an actor with his pants pulled up to his knees; or Hoarbeard’s declaration that he will not cross the water but instead remain *bér* ‘here’ (st. 14), which invites stomping on the ground.

A theatric performance would also explain the metrical variations and the use of informal features like the clitic definite as vulgar elements, deliberately contrasting with the more formal language expected for a mythological poem. The prose lines may even have been shouted out, which would explain their lack of meter as a discordant stylistic feature meant to catch the audience by surprise; the regular metrical sts., like 47, become all the more powerful when standing immediately surrounded by prose.

(TODO: mention the concept of the "double scene" by Lars Lönnroth?)

Circumstantial support is found in the structure of the dialogue, which has a remarkable affinity to a fixture in modern comedic duos: the straight man (Thunder) and the funny man (Hoarbeard). The by Wiking Age standards ever-moral Thunder serves as the perfect foil to the egoistic Hoarbeard and falls effortlessly for the ferryman's "trolling". It is hard not to imagine the audience laughing more and more as Thunder gets angrier and angrier.

The god really is the butt of the joke for much of the poem. As noted above, his threat in st. 47 is quite impressive, but it is soon neutralized by Hoarbeard's accusation that his wife Sib is currently engaged in adultery behind his back. Even so, Thunder's great feats are never made fun of directly (beyond st. 37–39, where Thunder has the last word); in the pagan religion such stories served not just as entertainment, but also as ritual etiology (Lindow 1988).

## Dating

Its formal and linguistic criteria can be taken to point towards a later date for *Hárþ* than for most other mythological poems, but as discussed above the loose meter and use of the clitic definite may also be stylistic features belonging to the relaxed and vulgar comedic register of the poem.

There are also features that speak against a late date. Among content-based criteria, there is a thorough and deep understanding of the personalities of the two gods which would seem unlikely to have survived long after the conversion of Iceland and which does not come off as antiquarian, but on the other hand seems to reflect felt tensions between the cults of the two gods (see above). The use of a variant ettin-name for the attested story in st. 26 is notable since it points away from antiquarian composition, which would more likely have inserted the familiar name *Skrymir* 'Shrimer' as known from *Lok* and *Gylf*.

A content-based argument for a late dating is that *Hárþ* takes its subject-matter (the two gods, Weden and Thunder) too lightly and therefore can hardly have been composed by a pagan poet (TODO: refs). Yet it is shown by *Lok* (certainly an old poem, as proven by the metrically required *vr-* in *Lok* 15/3 (n), 18/4, 27/4) and *Þrk* (generally held to be a particularly old poem) that pre-Christian Norse poetry could in fact depict the Gods in a light-hearted and comedic manner, and *Hárþ* certainly falls neatly into that pattern.

The model devised by Sapp (2022) gives the poem a 57.8% likelihood of being from the early 11th c., and a 37.7% likelihood of being from the

late 11th. These percentages are most similar to those obtained by *Gríp* (a poem recognised as very young—at earliest from the latter half of the 12th c.) but *Hárþ* shares so little in common with it that the similar results must be considered meaningless.

## Text

## The Leeds of Hoarbeard

- P1 Þórr fór ór austr-vegi ok kom at sundi einu. Qðrum megum [R 12r/30]  
 2 sunds'ins var ferju-karl'inn með skip'it. Þórr kallaði:

THUNDER JOURNEYED out of the Eastern Way and came to a sound. At the other side of the sound was the ferryman with the ship. Thunder called out:

- 1 „Hvęrr 's sá sveinn sveina · es stęndr fyr sund'it handan?“ [R 12r/32]  
 “Who is this swain of swains, standing yonder across the sound?”

1 sveinn sveina ‘swain of swains’ | The word *sveinn* ‘swain, lad’ generally refers to a prepubescent boy, later on a page (the servant of a knight, who was aged approx. 7–14), but can also mean ‘servant’ (cf. English boy as a term of address), as is most likely the case here. It is presumably offended by this address that the decidedly non-servile Hoarbeard decides to insult Thunder. — The construction “X of Xs” may ultimately stem from Biblical language, although it appears fairly early on in Norse poetry; cf. 2 *Gũðr* 1/1.

- Hann svaraði: 2 „Hvęrr 's sá karl karla · es kallar of vág'inn?“ [R 12v/1]  
 He answered: “Who is this churl of churls, calling out o'er the wave?”

1 karl karla ‘churl of churls’ | Hoarbeard directs an insult to Thunder by denigrating his social status as a lowly peasant. The construction should not be read as a compliment like modern Swedish *karlakarl* ‘a real man, manly man’. Although *karl* ‘churl’ is an unmarked word for ‘adult human being’ in later NGmc., including modern Icelandic, in the oldest Norse poetry it specifically refers to a ‘churl, peasant, old man’ (so *Hym* 10/4, 31/3, 32/3, 2 *HHund* 2/2, *Reg* 18/3, *Rþ* 23/4; in SkP: Vitg Lv 1, KormQ Lv 16, EVald *Þórr* 1, Gunnl Lv 5) unless occurring in the collocation *konur ok karlar* ‘women and menfolk’ (*Háv* 91/2, *Helr* 14/2, *Am* 70/1). The only exception to this in the Poetic Edda is *Am* 63/3, but *Am* is a fairly late poem and so the general rule holds.

- [Þórr kvaði:] 3 „Fęr þú mik of sund'it, · fðði'k þik á morgun;  
 2 męis hęfi'k á baki, · verðr=a matr inn bętri.  
 Át'k í hvild · áðr ek hęiman fór,  
 4 síldr ok hafra; · saðr em'k ęnn þęss.“ [R 12v/2]
- [Quoth Thunder:] “Ferry me o'er the sound; I'll feed thee in the morning.  
 A basket I have on my back; better food will not be found.  
 I ate, while at rest, before I journeyed from home,  
 herring and oatmeal/he-goats—I am still full thereof.”

4 hafra ‘oatmeal/he-goats’ | The easiest reading (preferred by Finnur Jónsson (1932), Pettit (2023) and others) is an acc. pl. of *hafr* ‘he-goat’. Thunder also eats his goats in *Gylf* 44:11–16, where he butchers and cooks them in the evening and brings them back to life at dawn by blessing them with his hammer (cf. *Hym* 37–38), and this seems to be a common motif of the god. For his goats cf. *Hym* 20, 31, *Þrk* 21.

Other scholars instead read an acc. pl. of *hafri* ‘oat’, i.e., ‘porridge, oatmeal’. Stiles (2023) connects this with the porridge-eating of the Vedic god *Pūṣān* (*RV* 6.56.1, 57.2), who is “partner and yoke-mate” (*RV* 6.56.2) of *Indra*, Thunder’s Vedic equivalent. Another similarity Stiles notes between Thunder and *Pūṣān* is that both have chariots driven by goats (*RV* 6.57.3: “Goats are the draft-animals for the one”, 6.58.2: “Having goats as his horses”). Whether the Vedic tradition has split the Thunder-god in two or whether the Germanic Thunder has absorbed elements of an earlier yokemate is hard to say. Like *Indra*, Thunder is frequently joined by companions, as is in fact one of his most identifying characteristics (Lindow 1988, p. 123).

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 4 „Ár=ligum verkum · hrósar þú, vęðoi’num; [R 12v/5]

2 vęitst=at-tu fyr gęr=la,  
dępr ’ro þín hęim-kynni, · dauð hygğ’k at þín móðir sé.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Of early morning works thou boastest—of thy *eating*!  
Thou seest not clearly ahead;  
dire is the state of thy home; I think that thy mother is dead!”

1 Ár=ligum verkum · hrósar þú, vęðoi’num ‘Of early works thou boastest, of thy eating’ | A difficult line, not unlikely corrupt. The present interpretation sees it as an insult directed against Thunder for bragging about the quality of his food; that is not the type of *ár=ligt verk* ‘early morning work’ a real man should boast about (cf. *Háv* 33, 58–59).

2 vęitst=at-tu fyr gęr=la | A third verse appended to the previous two; for this form cf. 6/2, 13/3 below, *Háv* 80/2.

[Þórr kvað:] 5 „Þat sęgir þú nú · es hęvęjum þikkir [R 12v/6]

2 męst at víta: · at mín móðir dauð sé.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Now sayest thou that which to every man seems  
of most weight to know—that my mother is dead!”

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 6 „Þęy=gi ’s sęm þú · þrjú bú góð ęgir; [R 12v/8]

2 bęr-bęinn þú stęndr · ok hęfir brautinga gęrvi,  
þat-ki at þú hafir brókr þínar.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Yet it’s not as if *thou* mightst own three good farms—  
bare-legged thou standest and hast the gear of a tramp;  
thou hast not even thy breeches on!”

[Þórr kvað:] 7 „Stýr þú hingat ęikju’nni, · ek mun þér stęð’na kęnna [R 12v/9]

2 ęða hęrr á skip’it · es þú hęldr við land’it?“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Steer hither the boat! I will show thee to the harbour—  
or who owns the ship which thou holdest by the shore?”

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 8 „Hild-ólfr sá hęitir · es mik halda bað, [R 12v/11]

2 rekkir inn ráð-svinni · es býr í Ráðs-ęyar-sundi;

4      bað=at hann hleñni-menn flytja · eða hrossa-þjófa,  
          góða eina · ok þá's ek gorrva kunna;  
          sęg-ðu til nafns þíns · ef þú vill of sund'it fara.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Hildolf is he called who bade me hold it,  
 the counsel-wise man who lives in Redeseysound.  
 He bade me not ferry highwaymen nor horse-thieves—  
 good ones alone and those I know well—  
 speak to thy name if thou wilt come o'er the sound!”

1 Hild-ólfr ‘Hildolf’ | Perhaps the son of Weden mentioned in the thule *Þul Ása* I 1/3a in SkP 3, although that god is otherwise unattested and quite likely fabricated. The name can probably not be identified with any concrete figure.

2 Ráðs-eyjar-sundi ‘Redeseysound’ | An island named Redey (New Norse *Radøy*) is in fact attested in Harthland, Western Norway, so that this may be a real place. For another place-name from Western Norway found in the mythology cf. *Grm* 29/1.

[Þórr kvað:] 9      „Sęgja mun'k til nafns míns · þó'tt ek sękr sjá'k  
          2      ok til alls øðlis: · Ek em Óðins sonr,  
          Meila bróðir · en Magna faðir,  
          4      þrúðs-valdr goða · við Þór knátt-u hér dōma!  
          Hins vil'k nú spyrja, · hvat þú heitir.“

[R 12v/15]

[Quoth Thunder:] “I will speak to my name—though I may be charged—  
 and to all my origin: I am Weden's son,  
 Male's brother and Main's father,  
 the strength-wielder of the Gods—with Thunder dost thou here speak!  
 I will now ask in turn what thou art called.”

1 sękr ‘charged’ | I.e., involved in an unresolved blood feud.

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 10      „Hár-barðr ek heiti, · hyl'k umb nafn sjaldan.“

[R 12v/18]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Hoarbeard I am called; I seldom conceal my name.”

1 hyl'k umb nafn sjaldan ‘I seldom conceal my name’ | Clearly sarcastic; the audience (who is expected to know the pilot's true identity) would likely have found this quite amusing.

Þórr kvað: 11      „Hvat skalt-u umb nafn hylja · nema þú sakar eęir?“

[R 12v/18]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Why shalt thou conceal thy name unless thou have charges?”

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 12      „En þó'tt ek sakar eęga, · fyr s'líkum sem þú est  
          2      þá mun'k forða fęrvi mínu · nema ek fęigr sé.“

[R 12v/19]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Yet even though I had charges, from such a one as thou art  
 I would then preserve my life—unless I were fey.”

ALL | The sense is that even if Weden had outstanding charges he would still give his true name, since such a wretched man as the *brautingi* ‘tramp’ Thunder can hardly pose a threat. This insult to Thunder’s strength is what provokes him finally to retort.

2 fęigr ‘fey’ | Doomed (by fate) to die shortly.

[Þórr kvað:] 13 „Harm ljótan mér þikkir í því  
2 at vaða of vág’inn til þín  
ok vęta ęgur mín;  
4 skylda’k launa kęgur-sveini · þínum kangin-yrði  
ef ek kom=umk yfir sund’it.“

[R 12v/21]

[Quoth Thunder:] “An ugly harm it seems to me  
to wade o’er the wave to thee,  
and wet this burden of mine.  
I would repay thee, swaddle-swain, for thy mocking words  
if I might get myself over the sound.”

1 Harm ljótan mér þikkir í því ‘An ugly harm it seems to me’ | The meter is clearly faulty. Rhythmically the whole line comes off as an a- and b-verse of Leeds-meter (*Harm ljótan* · ...), but the verses are not linked by alliteration, which instead falls on þ in the b-verse.

3 ęgur ‘burden’ | The sense of this word is not clear, though it is probably the same as the first element of the compound *ęgur-stund* ‘burdensome hour’ found in *Vkv* 42. I find the most convincing interpretation to be that it refers to the food Thunder carries on his back, as previously mentioned in st. 3. Thunder then uses his desire not to get his food wet as an excuse not to wade. Some authors have read it as a euphemism for ‘bollocks’, but this is discordant with the angered but quite serious tone of the rest of the stanza and with Thunder’s general role in the poem as the “straight man” next to the scurrilous Hoarbeard. It is also a very poor excuse for Thunder’s unwillingness to wade, since wading is a frequent attribute of this god (e.g. *Grm* 29, *Eddbr* VI), who on those occasions shows no fear of “getting his bollocks wet”.

4 skylda’k launa kęgur-sveini · þínum kangin-yrði | Both words are rare. *kęgur-sveinn* ‘swaddle-swain’, i.e., a babe swaddled in cloth rather than clothed like an adult, is clearly an insult and only attested at one other place; cf. the more common *kęgur-barn* ‘swaddle-child’. *kangin-yrði* ‘mocking words’ is a hapax due to the otherwise unattested first element, which is however most likely cognate with Swedish *kångas* ‘to banter inappropriately’ (Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *kanginyrði*). The whole line has a close parallel in the latter half of *Gylf* 45:35: *Nú mun ek ráða yör heil-ręði: látið þér eigi stór-liga yfir yör. Ekki munu hirð-menn Útgarda-Loka vel þola því-likum kęgur-sveinum kępur-yrði*. ‘Now I will give you a piece of wholesome counsel: do not speak too haughtily about yourselves. Nowise will the hirdmen of Outyards-Lock suffer insulting words from such swaddle-swains.’

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 14 „Hér mun’k standa · ok þín heðan bíða;  
2 fannt=a-tu mann inn harðara · at Hrungni dauðan.“

[R 12v/23]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Here will I stand and from here await thee.  
Thou foundest no harder man since Rungner died!”

2 Hrungni ‘Rungner’ | Rungner was a famous ettin slain by Thunder in a fierce battle (*Skm* 24–25, *Haustl* 14–20).

- [Þórr kvað:] 15 „Hins vilt-u nú geta · es vit Hrungnir deildum,  
 2 sá inn stór-úðgi jötunn, · es ór steini vas höfuð'it á,  
 þó lét'k hann falla · ok fyrir hníga;  
 4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr?“

[R 12v/25]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Now wilt thou bring up something else: how I and Rungner dealt with each other,  
 that great-minded ettin on whom the head was of stone.  
 Yet I made him fall and kneel down before me—  
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

2 es ór steini vas höfuð'it á ‘on whom the head was of stone’ | Cf. *Hym* 29–30, where the ettin Hymer's head is harder than stone. This characteristic part of ettin-physiology can probably be explained by reference to pre-Christian cosmology.

In numerous Indo-European cosmologies the Firmament is believed to be made of stone, as is seen in the PIE root *\*h<sub>2</sub>ék<sub>mō</sub>* whose descendants can mean both ‘heaven, sky’, ‘meteorite’ and ‘stone’, sometimes varying even within branches (West 2007, p. 342; Calin 1996, p. 3); cf. e.g. OI *ásmān* ‘stone, rock’ against Old Persian *asman* ‘sky, heaven’ and ON *biminn* ‘sky, heaven’ against *bamarr* ‘cliff, rock’ (Kroonen 2013, pp. 206–207, 220). In the Germanic cosmology the Stoney Heaven was made out of the skull of Ymer, the primordial ettin sacrificed by the Gods (*Vsp* 3–4, *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 41), and as the ancestor of the Ettins he thus passed his stone-skull on to his descendants.

4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr? ‘what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?’ | This question begins the argument over their respective accomplishments or *mann-jafnaðr* which takes up the bulk of the poem (sts. 16–40). — The metricality of this line and the corresponding *hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?* is questionable. Both lines are most likely non-metrical prose, but since they do have words that can be taken to alliterate with the names those words have been marked.

- [Hár-barðr kvað:] 16 „Vas'k með Fjöl-vari · fimm vetr alla  
 2 í ey þeiri · es Al-grøn heitir;  
 vega vér þar knóttum · ok val fella,  
 4 margs at freista, · mans at kosta.“

[R 12v/27]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “I was with Felwar for five winters all  
 in that island which is called Allgreen.  
 There we did fight and fell the slain;  
 many a girl did we tempt and win.”

1 Fjöl-vari ‘Felwar’ | The name is clearly equivalent to the adj. *fjöl-varr* ‘reluctant, very wary’ but is not attested elsewhere.

4 margs at freista, · mans at kosta ‘many a girl did we tempt and win’ | I read *margs* ‘many a’ as modifying *mans* ‘girl’.

- [Þórr kvað:] 17 „Hversu snúnuðu yðr konur yðrar?“

[R 12v/30]

[Quoth Thunder:] “How did your women turn out for you?”

1 snúnuðu ‘turn out’ | A rare verb only found in poetry.



[Hár·barðr kvað:] **18** „Sparkar óttum vér konur · ef oss at spökum yrði;  
 2 horskar óttum vér konur · ef oss hollar véri,  
 þér ór sandi · síma undu  
 4 ok ór dali djúpum  
 grund of grófu;  
 6 varð’k þeim einn öllum · øfri at róðum;  
 hvílda’k hjá þeim systurum sjau  
 8 ok hafða’k gæð þeira allt ok gaman;  
 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“

[R 12v/30]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “We had smart women if they were to our enjoyment;  
 we had wise women if they were hold toward us.  
 Out of sand they wound a string  
 and out of a deep dale  
 dug up the ground.  
 I alone became superior to them all in counsel;  
 I rested by those sisters seven  
 and had their senses all, and pleasure—  
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

ALL | The sense of the whole stanza, but especially ll. 3–5, is quite unclear. If it is referring to a specific myth it is wholly lost. If we take it to be a astrological analogy (cf. st. 19/2–5) then the seven sisters may tentatively be identified

3 þér ór sandi · síma undu ‘Out of sand they wound a string’ | Unclear. If it is to be understood that they spun string out of sand that is clearly a reference to some sort of magic.

8 gæð þeira allt ok gaman ‘their senses all, and pleasure’ | Formulaic word-pair, occurring in *Háv* 99/4 and 162/2.

Þórr kvað: **19** „Ek drap Þjatsa, · hinn þrúð-móðga jǫtun,  
 2 upp ek varp augum · All·valda sonar  
 á þann inn heiða himin;  
 4 þau ’ro męrki męst · minna verka,  
 þau’s allir męnn síðan of sęa;  
 6 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“

[R 13r/2, A 1r/1]

Quoth Thunder: “I slew Thedse, the strength-minded ettin;  
 up I threw the eyes of Allwald’s son [= Thedse]  
 onto the shining heaven.  
 Those are the greatest marks of my works,  
 those which all men since do see—  
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

4 minna | From this word forwards the poem is also attested in A. 5 síðan | om. A

ALL. | For the slaying of Thedse, cf. *Lok* 50 n. The detail of Thedse's eyes becoming stars is also found in *Skm* 4, but there we read that *Óðinn gerði þat til yfir-bóta við Skaða, at hann tók augu Þjatsa ok kastaði upp á himin ok gerði af stjörnur tvær* 'Weden, in order to compensate Shede, did so that he took the eyes of Thedse and threw them up onto the heaven and made out of them two stars'. This is a rare example of native Germanic star-lore embedded in the mythology, but it is not unparalleled. Another example is Earendel's toe, also thrown onto the heaven by Thunder, as told in *Skm* 25 (Lindow 1996, pp. 17–18).

Hár·barðr kvað: **20** „Miklar man-vélar · hafða'k við myrk-riður

[R 13r/5, A 1r/1]

2 þá's ek vélta þér frá verum.  
Harðan jötun · hugða'k Hlé·barð vesa;  
4 gaf hann mér gamban-tēin  
en ek vélta hann ór viti.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Great girl-tricks I had against mirk-rideresses  
when I lured them away from men.  
A hard ettin I judged Leebeard to be;  
he gave me a gombentoe  
but I tricked him out of his wits.”

1 myrk-riður 'mirk-rideresses' | The *riður* 'rideresses, fevers' were witches thought to torment people and cause disease and delirium. See *Háv* 156 for discussion.

2 frá verum 'from men' | Alternatively 'from their husbands', but that makes less sense in the context of rideresses who are out tormenting mankind, not consorting with their husbands. For *verar* 'men, husbands' in the general sense 'mankind' cf. st. 53/3 below, *Lok* 24/3.

3 Hlé·barð 'Leebeard' | *hlé* 'lee, calm, shelter (from bad weather)' + *barðr* 'beard', an otherwise unattested ettin. For alternative explanations of the first element see note to Þul Óðins 4/1: *Hléfjörð* in *SkP* 3.

4 gamban-tēin 'gombentoe' | An unknown magical object also occurring in *Ski* 32/2. Etymologically it is clearly some type of stick (*tēinn* 'stick, branch'), perhaps for carving runes into.

Þórr kvað: **21** „Illum huga launaðir þú þá góðar gjafar.“

[R 13r/7, A 1r/3]

Quoth Thunder: “With an evil heart didst thou then repay the good gifts.”

1 þá | *om.* A

Hár·barðr kvað: **22** „Þat hefir ęik · es af annarri skęfr;

[R 13r/8, A 1r/4]

2 umb sik es hvęrr í s-líku—  
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “An oak has that which it chafes from another;  
it is every man for himself in such matters—  
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

1 Þat hefir ęik · es af annarri skęfr 'An oak has that which it chafes from another' | Proverbial, also appearing in *Mbkv* 26/3a.

Þórr kvað: **23** „Ek vas austr · ok jǫtna barða'k  
 2 brúðir bǫl-vísar · es til bjargs gingu;  
 mikil myndi étt jǫtna · ef allir lifði,  
 4 vétr myndi manna · undir Mið-garði—  
 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr?

[R 13r/9, A 1r/4]

Quoth Thunder: “I was in the east and bashed Ettins,  
 bale-wise brides who were walking to a mountain.  
 Great would the lineage of Ettins be if they all lived;  
 naught would remain of men within Middenyard—  
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

ALL | Thunder here makes a moral response to Hoarbeard's egoism as expressed in the previous stanza. In the religion, Thunder is the defender of the Gods and Middenyard (the home of Men) against the Ettins, for which cf. *Vsp* 25, 53, *Þrk* 18. For Thunder's killing of ettin-women in particular cf. sts. 37–39 below, *Eddbr* VI, and Lindow (1988).

Hár-barðr kvað: **24** „Vas'k á Val-landi · ok vígum fylgða'k,  
 2 atta ek jǫfrum · en aldri sétta'k;  
 Óðinn á jarla · þá's í val falla  
 4 en Þórr á þræla kyn.“

[R 13r/11, A 1r/6]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in Walland and followed wars;  
 I incited princes and never reconciled them.  
 Weden owns the earls which fall among the slain—  
 but Thunder owns the race of thralls.”

ALL | Weden brushes off Thunder's moralism and instead expresses a characteristic aristocratic disregard for lower life and life as mere life. Where the altruistic Thunder boasts of protecting mankind, the ambivalent Weden sarcastically responds that he incited war and conflict in order to take the best of them for himself.

1 Val-landi ‘Walland’ | The normal term for France in ON, originally referring to Roman Gaul. The idea of continental Europe as particularly war-torn certainly goes back to the Migration Period; cf. the similar view about the Gots in *Vsp* 30/2, *Vkv* 1.

3 Óðinn á ‘Weden owns’ | For Weden's “owning” of men see *Vsp* 23 n.

4 Þórr á þræla kyn ‘Thunder owns the race of thralls’ | This has been connected (TODO: cite) with the sacrifice of prisoners and criminals to Thunder, which, if true, would support a pre-Christian origin for the poem, as such an allusion would soon fade out of relevance following the Conversion.

Þórr kvað: **25** „Ó·jafnt skipta · es þú myndir með ǫsum liði  
 2 ef þú éttir vil=gi mikils vald.“

[R 13r/13, A 1r/8]

Quoth Thunder: “Unfairly wouldst thou deal out troops amidst the Eese  
 if thou hadst unrestrained power.”

1 ǫsum | ása A

- Hár·barðr kvað: **26** „Þórr á afl órít · en ekki hjarta;  
 2 af hréðslu ok hug-bleyði · vas þér í handska troðit  
 ok þótti=sk=a þú þá Þórr vesa;  
 4 hvár=ki þú þá þorðir · fyr hréðslu þinni  
 hnjósa né fisa · svá't Fjalarr heyrði.“

[R 13r/14, A 1r/9]

Quoth Hoarheard: “Thunder has ample strength but little heart.  
 Out of fear and heart-softness wast thou driven into a glove  
 and didst not then seem to be Thunder.  
 Thou daredst neither for thy fear  
 sneeze nor fart lest Feller should hear.”

2 vas þér | þér vas R 5 hnjósa né fisa ‘sneeze or fart’ | fisa né hnjósa ‘fart or sneeze’ A

ALL | The story to which this stanza alludes is also hinted at in *Lok* 60 and told in full in *Gylf* 45:5–16: Lock, Thunder, and his servants Thelvé and Wrash had journeyed east for a long time and the day was drawing late when they found before them a great hall, with an opening on one end as wide as the building itself. They took lodgings inside, but in the middle of the night they were awakened by a great earthquake. Thunder rose and led the party into a side-room to the right in the middle of the hall. He stood closest to the opening with his hammer ready while the terrified others cowered further inside; so they stood for the whole night and heard great noise outside. At daybreak they left the building and found the huge ettin Shrimmer asleep outside. His snoring had caused the earthquakes and noise, and the house was his mitten; the side-room was its thumb.

5 Fjalarr ‘Feller’ | To be identified with Shrimmer in *Lok* 60 and *Gylf* 45. The use of an alternative name for the same figure suggests a variant tradition and strengthens the idea that *Hárþ* is not an antiquarian product.

- Þórr kvað: **27** „Hár·barðr inn rafi, · ek munda þik í hæl drepa  
 2 ef ek mætta seila=sk of sund.“

[R 13r/17, A 1r/11]

Quoth Thunder: “Hoarheard the queer, I would strike thee into Hell  
 if I could sail o’er the sound!”

2 sund | sundit A

- Hár·barðr kvað: **28** „Hvat skyldir of sund seila=sk · es sakir ’ro alls øngar?  
 2 Hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“

[R 13r/18, A 1r/12]

Quoth Hoarheard: “Why shouldst thou sail o’er the sound when there are no charges at all?  
 What didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

1 skyldir | skalt-u A 1 sakir | sakar A

- Þórr kvað: **29** „Ek vas austr · ok ó’na varða’k  
 2 þá’s mik sóttu þeir Svárangs synir;  
 grjóti mik þorðu, · gagni urðu þó lítt fegnir,  
 4 þó urðu mik fyrri · friðar at biðja—

[R 13r/19, A 1r/13]

hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“

Quoth Thunder: “I was in the east and guarded the river  
when I was set upon by Sweering’s sons.  
With rocks they bashed me, yet in victory rejoiced little;  
yet they sooner had to beg for peace—  
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

2 mik sóttu þeir | þeir sóttu mik A 3 þó | om. A

Hár·barðr kvað: 30 „Ek vas austr · ok við ein-hverja dómða’k,  
2 lék’k við ina lín-hvítu · ok laun-þing háða’k,  
gladda’k ina goll-björtu, · gamni mér unði.“ [R 13r/22, A 1r/15]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in the east and flirted with a certain someone;  
I played with the linen-white one and held secret trysts:  
I gladdened the gold-bright one—the maiden enjoyed pleasure.”

1 ein-hverja | ein-herju A 2 lín-hvítu | so A; lind-hvítu ‘linden-white’ R 2 laun-þing ‘secret trysts’ | so A; laung þing ‘long trysts’ R 3 goll-björtu ‘gold-bright’ | goll-hvítu ‘gold-white’ A

ALL | Weden’s answer is sarcastic and subverts a common Norse literary trope where men who stay at home with women are presented as cowardly and soft against those who “go out” to wage war (e.g. Þhorn *Harkv* 6 in SkP 1).

1 ein-hverja ‘a certain someone’ | The A reading *ein-herju* looks like the acc. sg. of an otherwise unattested \**ein-herja*, f. of *ein-heri* ‘Oneharrier’ and perhaps a synonym for a walkirrie.

Þórr kvað: 31 „Góð óttuð ér man-kynni þar þá.“ [R 13r/24, A 1r/17]

Quoth Thunder: “Then ye had good experiences with the girls there.”

1 óttuð ér | so (‘óttu þér’) A; óttu þeir ‘ye bad’ R 1 man-kynni | mann-kynni (‘man-’, with erroneous macron above the n) A

1 Góð óttuð ér man-kynni þar þá. | Thunder is once again distracted by Weden’s mention of women; cf. st. 17 above. — The line is clearly prose.

Hár·barðr kvað: 32 „Liðs þíns véra’k þá þurfi, Þórr, · at ek hefda þeiri inni lín-hvítu  
mey.“ [R 13r/24, A 1r/17]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I might have needed thy aid then, Thunder, that I might have held that linen-white maiden.”

1 véra’k | vas’k A

Þórr kvað: 33 „Ek mynda þér þá þat vęita · ef ek við of kóm=umk.“ [R 13r/25, A 1r/18]

Quoth Thunder: “I would then have offered it to thee, if I were able.”

1 þá þat | þat þá A 1 kóm=umk | so ('kænmvz') A; kómist R

Hár-barðr kvað: 34 „Ek mynda þér þá trúa, · nema mik í tryggð véltir.“ [R 13r/26, A 1r/18]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I would then have trusted thee, if thou wouldst not have betrayed my trust.”

Þórr kvað: 35 „Em'k=at ek sá hæl-bitr · sem húð-skór forn á vár.“ [R 13r/27, A 1r/19]

Quoth Thunder: “I am not such a heel-biter as an old hide-shoe in spring.”

1 Em'k=at ek sá hæl-bitr · sem húð-skór forn á vár 'I am not such a heel-biter as an old hide-shoe in spring' | Likely proverbial; a heel-biter is someone who betrays his companions, and the old shoe-leather becomes stiff over the winter.

Hár-barðr kvað: 36 „Hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“ [R 13r/28, A 1r/20]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “What didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

Þórr kvað: 37 „Brúðir ber-serkja · barðað'k í Hlés-eyju;  
2 þér höfðu vęrst unnit, · vélta þjóð alla.“ [R 13r/28, A 1r/20]

Quoth Thunder: “The brides of bearserks I bashed in Leeseey;  
they had done the worst thing; tricked the whole people.”

1 Hlés-eyju | Hlés-ey A

1 Hlés-eyju 'Leeseey' | Læsø in Denmark. This island figures in mythology. TODO.

Hár-barðr kvað: 38 „Kléki vannt-u þá, Þórr, · es þú á konum barðir.“ [R 13r/29, A 1r/21]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “A disgrace didst thou accomplish, Thunder, when thou bashedst women!”

1 á | 'é' with small corr. above A

Þórr kvað: 39 „Vargynjur vöru þér · ęn var=la konur,  
2 skelldu skip mitt · es skorðat hafðað'k,  
ógöu mér járn-lurki · ęn ęltu þjálfá—  
4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr?“ [R 13r/30, A 1r/22]

Quoth Thunder: “She-wolves were they, but hardly women.  
They overturned my ship which I had propped up,  
terrorised me with iron cudgels and chased Thelvé around—  
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

1 vöru þér | þat vöru A 3 mér | add. þęim A

Hár-barðr kvað: **40** „Ek vas’k í hēr’num · es hingat gørði=sk [R 13r/32, A 1r/23]  
 2 gnéfa gunn-fana, · gęir at rjóða.“

Quoth Hoarheard: “I was in the host which readied itself hither  
 to raise the war-standard, to redden the spear.”

Þórr kvað: **41** „Þess vilt-u nú geta, es þú fórt oss ò-ljúfan at bjóða!“ [R 13v/1, A 1r/24]

Quoth Thunder: “Now wilt thou bring up how thou didst set out to bring hatred against us!”

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1 ò-ljúfan | ‘óliýfan’ A; †olubann† R

---

ALL | The exchange shifts away from the comparison of deeds.

1 ò-ljúfan ‘hatred’ | Lit. ‘un-lovely’, a rare m. dat. sg. adverbial.

Hár-barðr kvað: **42** „Bóta skal þér þat þá · munda baugi [R 13v/2, A 1r/25]  
 2 sem jafnęndr unnu · þęir’s okkr vilja sętta.“

Quoth Hoarheard: “Then I shall repay thee for that with a hand-bigh  
 bestowed by the mediators who wish to reconcile us two.”

---

1 þat þá | *om.* A 2 þęir’s okkr vilja sętta | þęir’s okkr vilja sętt hafa A

---

Þórr kvað: **43** „Hvar namt þęssi · in hnófi=ligu orð [R 13v/3, A 1r/26]  
 2 es heyrða’k aldri=gi · in hnófi=ligri?“

Quoth Thunder: “Where didst thou learn these scornful words  
 when I never heard more scornful ones?”

---

2 in | *so* A; *om.* R

---

Hár-barðr kvað: **44** „Nam’k at męnnum þęim inum aldr-ónum es búa í [R 13v/5, A 1r/27]  
 hęimis-skógum.“

Quoth Hoarheard: “I learned them from the elderly men who dwell in the homely forests.”

---

1 męnnum | *om.* A

---

Þórr kvað: **45** „Þó gefr þú gótt nafn dysjum, es þú kallar þat hęimis-skóga.“ [R 13v/5, A 1v/1]

Quoth Thunder: “Though thou givest a good name to poor cairns when thou callest them  
 ‘homely forests’.”

---

1 dysjum ‘poor cairns’ | A reference to Weden’s consultation of the dead for knowledge as attested  
 e.g. in *Vsp* and *Bdr*.

Hár-barðor kvað: 46 „Svá dǫmi’k umb s-líkt far.“

[R 13v/6, A 1v/2]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “So do I speak about such matters.”

---

1 umb | om. A

þórr kvað: 47 „Orð-kringi þín · mun þér illa koma  
2 ef ek réð á vág at vaða;  
ulfi herra · hygg’k at ópa mynir  
4 ef hlýtr af hamri hogg.“

[R 13v/7, A 1v/2]

Quoth Thunder: “Thy glibness of word will bring thee ill  
if I decide to wade on the wave.  
Louder than a wolf I think thou wilt scream  
if thou gettest a strike from the hammer!”

---

3 at ópa mynir | þik ópa munu A

---

ALL | This perfectly regular Leeds-meter-stanza marks a sudden shift in the exchange from the previous laconic one-line prose lines. Thunder’s threat of hammer-based violence is paralleled by *Lok* 57–63.

Hár-barðor kvað: 48 „Sif á hó hęima, · hans munt fund vilja,  
2 þann munt þrek drýgja, · þat ’s þér skyldara.“

[R 13v/9, A 1v/4]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Sib has a lover at home; *him* wilt thou wish to seek out;  
on *him* wilt thou use thy strength—that is more urgent for thee!”

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2 skyldara | skyldra A

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1 hó ‘lover’ | Most editors take this acc. sg. word as an alternative form of *bórr* m. ‘adulterer’ (gen. *bórs*), containing the same root as *bóra* f. ‘whore, prostitute’, *bór* n. ‘adultery, fornication’, ModEngl. whore. The *-r* has presumably been reinterpreted as the m. nom. sg. ending, yielding nom. sg. \**bór*, gen. sg. \**bós*, although neither form is attested. The same accusation is found in *Lok* 54, where Lock says that he has been Sib’s lover (*bórr*).

On formal grounds CV (s.v. *bór*) interpret this word as the unrelated *bór* m. ‘pot-hook’, ‘insinuating that Thor busied himself with cooking and dairy-work.’ If that reading is correct *hans*, *þann* ‘him’ should be translated ‘it’ instead, but the whole thing seems rather unlikely when we consider Thunder’s strong response: ‘I think thou liest’, which fits well against an accusation of his wife’s adultery, not so much about her owning a pot-hook.

þórr kvað: 49 „Méðir þú at munns ráði · svá’t mér skyldi vęrst þikkja,  
2 hafr inn hug-blauði, · hygg’k at þú ljúgir.“

[R 13v/10, A 1v/5]

Quoth Thunder: “Thou speakest after thy mouth’s counsel what should seem worst to me—  
O heart-soft man, I think thou liest!”

Hár-barðor kvað: 50 „Satt hygg’k mik sęgja, · sęinn est at fęr þinni,

[R 13v/12, A 1v/6]



2                    langt myndir nú kominn, Þórr, · ef þú litum fyrir.“

Quoth Hoarheard: “I think I speak truly. Thou art late on thy journey;  
far wouldst thou have come by now, Thunder, if thou hadst changed colour!”

---

1 mik | þik A

---

2 litum fyrir ‘changed colour’ | An unclear expression, probably metaphorically ‘if thou hadst not been so stubborn’.

Þórr kvað: 51            „Hár-barðr inn ragi, · heldr hefir nú mik dvalðan!“

[R 13v/14, A 1v/8]

Quoth Thunder: “Hoarheard the queer, thou hast now much delayed me!”

---

1 dvalðan | dvalit A

---

Hár-barðr kvað: 52            „Ása-Þórs · hugða’k aldri=gi myndu  
2                                    glæpja fē-hirði farar.“

[R 13v/14, A 1v/8]

Quoth Hoarheard: “Eese-Thunder’s journeys I never thought  
a shepherd would divert.”

---

1 Ása-Þórs | Ása-Þór A

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1 Ása-Þórs ‘Eese-Thunder’ | Or ‘Thunder of the Eese’. A reverent, majestic epithet, here used sarcastically, i.e., ‘the high and mighty Thunder’. It is also found in *Gylf* (9:17, etc.) and *Skm*.

Þórr kvað: 53            „Ráð mun’k þér nú ráða: · ró hingat báti’num,  
2                                    hëttum hótingi, · hitt fōður Magna!“

[R 13v/15, A 1v/9]

Quoth Thunder: “I will now counsel thee a counsel: row the boat hither;  
let us cease the taunting; meet the father of Main [= Thunder = me]!”

Hár-barðr kvað: 54            „Far þú firr sundi, · þér skal fars synja!“

[R 13v/17, A 1v/10]

Quoth Hoarheard: “Go far away from the sound; passage shall be denied thee!”

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1 firr | frá A

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Þórr kvað: 55            „Vísu þú mér nú leið’ina, · alls þú vill mik eigi of vág’inn fęrja.“

[R 13v/17, A 1v/11]

Quoth Thunder: “Now show me the way since thou wilt not ferry me o’er the wave.”

---

1 nú | om. A

---

Hár-barðr kvað: 56            „Lítit ’s at synja, · langt ’s at fara;

[R 13v/18, A 1v/11]

- 2        **st**und 's til **stokks'**ins, · qnnur til **stęins'**ins,  
halt svá til **vinstra** **vegs'**ins · und's þú hittir **Ver**-land;  
4        þar mun Fjörgyn · hitta Þór, son sinn,  
ok mun hōn ķenna hōnum **ęttunga** brautir · til **Óðins** landa.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “It is little to deny. It is long to journey:  
an hour to the log, another to the stone.  
Hold so to the left road until thou findest Wereland;  
there will Firgyn find Thunder, her son,  
and she will show him the ancestral roads to Weden's lands.”

1 at | om. R 2 **stokks'**ins | stokks A 2 **stęins'**ins | stęins A 3 **vegs'**ins | vegs A 3 Ver-land  
‘Wereland’ | Valland A

3 Ver-land ‘Wereland’ | The ‘Land of Men’.

4 Fjörgyn ‘Firgyn’ | Another name for Earth, Thunder's mother.

þórr kvað: 57 „Mun'k taka þangat í dag?“

[R 13v/22, A 1v/14]

Quoth Thunder: “Will I come thither today?”

ALL. | Due to the trimming of the margin on fol. 13v, only the abbreviation q. (for kvað ‘quoth, said’) is visible for sts. 57–60 R; the names of the speakers, although unambiguous, are therefore supplied from A. 1 í dag | á degi A

Hár-barðr kvað: 58 „Taka við víl ok **ęrfiði** · at upp-vesandi sólu  
2        es ek get þána.“

[R 13v/22, A 1v/14]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “[Thou wilt] come thither with toil and hardship by the rising of the sun,  
as I believe it is thawing.”

1 ok | við A 1 upp-vesandi | upp-rennandi A

þórr kvað: 59 „**Sk**ammt mun nú mál okkat vesa, · alls þú mér **skótingu** ęinni  
svarar;  
2        launa mun'k þér **far**-synjun · ef vit **finnum**=sk í sinn annat.“

[R 13v/23, A 1v/15]

Quoth Thunder: “Our speech will now be short since thou answerest me with scoffing alone.  
I will repay thee for this ferry-denial if we meet another time!”

Hár-barðr kvað: 60 „Far þú nú þar's þik hafi allan gramir!“

[R 13v/25, A 1v/17]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Now go whither the fiends may have thee whole!”

ALL. | The speaker is uncertain. This line is introduced with the speech marker ‘H. q.’ (= Hár-barðr kvað ‘Quoth Hoarbeard’) in A; in R it belongs to 59 and is thus spoken by Thunder. Since it seems more likely for a speech marker to be dropped than erroneously added the A reading is preferred.

1 þik hafi allan gramir ‘the fiends may have thee whole’ | The *gramir* ‘fiends’, lit. ‘wroth, cross ones’ are (male) demons. The adjective *gramr* is commonly used specifically with a connotation of divine wrath and they may thus be supernatural avengers for severe crimes. The same curse is found in *Grm* P1 with *smyl* for *gramir* and in related form in *Brot* 10.



# Lay of Hymer

## (*Hymis kviða*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.694)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Lay of Hymer** (*Hym*) is a narrative mythological poem which tells the story of how the gods Thunder and Tew go on an adventure into Ettinland in order to fetch a great cauldron from the ettin Hymer. The three end up on a single fishing boat, and, in one of the most famous Norse mythological scenes, Thunder manages to bait the world-encircling serpent itself, the Middenyardswyrm, on his hook.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hym* is attested in full in both main manuscripts of mythological poetry: **R** and **A**. In **R** the poem belongs to the first, mythological part of the manuscript and is found on foll. 13v/26–15r/3; it follows *Hárb* and is followed by *Lok*. In **A**, the poem is found on foll. 5v/25–6v/25, where it follows *Grm* and is followed by the prose introduction to *Vkv*.

The two mss. agree very well with each other and share the same number of stanzas in the same order. Like the other mythological poems shared between **R** and **A**, the two versions clearly go back to the same written archetype, and are thus not two independent attestations of an oral tradition. The most substantial difference between the two is in fact the title: **A** has *Hymis kviða* ‘the Lay of Hymer’, while **R** instead has *Þórr dró Mið-garðs-orm* ‘Thunder pulled the Middenyardswyrm’. This circumstance, also shared with *Skí*, probably suggests that the scribal archetype did not have clear titles for the poems it contained.

## Story and motifs

*Hym* belongs to a genre of comedic stories about Thunder's adventures in Ettinland. These stories all see Thunder set out from Osyard followed by one or more companions. Together, the party undergoes various fantastical tests and hardships on their way through the Ettinhomes, and return home after Thunder has slaughtered yet another hostile ettin-clan. The popularity of this genre is seen by the large number of stories belonging to it. In the Poetic Edda it is also represented by *Þrk* and, to some extent, *Hárþ*. Other examples are Thunder's journey to Outyards-Lock in *Gylf* 44–47, his fight with Thedse in *Skm* 2–3 and *Haustr* 2–13, his fight with Rungner in *Skm* 24 and *Haustr* 14–20, and his journey to Garfrith in *Skm* 26 (in which two sts. are cited; see *Eddbr* VI).

## The otherness of the Ettins

In these stories, the Ettins are very much an *other* to the Gods, and this is something which *Hym* strongly emphasizes in several ways. In the poem,

- The Ettins live in the far east (st. 5) in an inhospitable, frozen climate (st. 10) of mountains (sts. 2, 17) and lavafields (sts. 36, 38).
- They are physically deviant: misshapen (st. 10), grey-haired (st. 16), many-headed (sts. 8, 35), having heads harder than stone (sts. 30–31);
- they are also likened to apes (st. 20), whales (st. 36) and Danes (st. 17, see note!).
- In terms of character, they are stingy and inhospitable (sts. 9, 16)
- and snide and cowardly (sts. 19–20, 25–26, 28–32).

These traits of the Ettins stand in direct opposition to the Old Germanic social norms as represented and upheld by the Gods, who live in a lush green land and are young, beautiful, generous, and brave. The one exception in the poem is Tew's mother in st. 8, who is blonde, beautiful and hospitable. The mother of a god should also be godlike, and this likely reflects the broader motif of a beautiful ettin-woman who is taken by a god, for which cf. the st. 8 n. and *Ski* above.

As natural inferiors and a threat to the social order the Ettins must be subjugated by the Gods, and the agent of this subjugation is the strength-wielder of the gods, Thunder. Throughout the poem he recurrently humiliates the ettins Eagre and Hymer through completing their various challenges and performing tests of strength. These tests follow a similar outline: Thunder is given a dangerous or near-impossible challenge but accomplishes it anyway with surprising ease through a combination of brawn and brain to the humiliation of the challenger. The challenges consist of finding an enormously large kettle (st. 3, explicitly called Eagre's "revenge"), wrestling one of Hymer's oxen for bait (sts. 17–18), carrying home Hymer's whales and boat (st. 26), breaking Hymer's finest chalice (st. 28), and perhaps also taking away

the cauldron (st. 33)—though that may just be Hymer's wish to be finally rid of the pestering gods. In the end Thunder delivers justice by slaughtering Hymer and his whole clan of many-headed Ettins.

### The fishing expedition

At the center of the poem stands Thunder's famous fishing trip, where the god gets the Middenyardswyrm on his hook but ultimately fails to catch it. In this section of *Hym*, especially in sts. 22–24, we find a noticeably more reverent tone than elsewhere in the poem.

Thunder's abortive encounter with the Wyrm was clearly very popular in the Wiking Age and is, apart from *Hym*, also dealt with in five fragmentary Scaldic poems from the 9th or 10th centuries and extensively in *Gylf* 48:3–31. The story is also represented pictorially on numerous objects from the Wiking Age.

The Scaldic fragments are all found in citations scattered throughout *Skm*, all edited in *SkP* 3. They are, by descending number of long-lines: Bragi Þórr, *Húsdr* 3–6, EVald Þórr, and Ggnæv Þórr, Qlv Þórr.

In their present state none of these fragments are complete narratives, but mainly focus on the scene of Thunder in the boat facing off against the hooked Wyrm pressed against the gunwale. From what little we can glean from them they also disagree on the course of events. In Bragi Þórr 6 the encounter ends when the cowardly Hymer cuts the fishing line and the Wyrm sinks back unscathed into the sea in *Húsdr* 6 and probably also Ggnæv Þórr 1 Thunder strikes the head off the Wyrm with his hammer Millner.

Other than *Hym* the only complete retelling of the myth is found in *Gylf* 48:3–31, which may be summarized as follows:

Thunder goes out alone into Middenyard in the shape of a young man (*ungr drængr*) without his goats and chariot. In the evening he comes to the ettin Hymer and asks to stay the night. At dawn Hymer plans to go fishing and Thunder asks to join him. Hymer says that Thunder will not be of much help since he is “small and but a young man” (*lítill ok ung-menni ęitt*), and warns him that he usually takes long and arduous trips. Thunder, angered, says that he will row very far, and then asks Hymer what bait they will use. Hymer tells him to find it himself, and so he turns to his flock of oxen; he tears off the head from the greatest ox, one called Heavenrid (*Himin-brjóðr*). The two go out to sea, and Thunder rows far past Hymer's usual fishing waters. Hymer, unhappy, warns him that if they row any further out they will be in danger of the Middenyardswyrm, but Thunder keeps on. After some time he puts down the oars, readies his fishing line, hooks the ox-head and lowers it. The Wyrm soon bites, and struggles so hard that Thunder is pressed against the gunwale. In rage he brings himself into his Os-might (*ęsmęgin*) and pulls back with such force that his feet go through the bottom of the ship and press into the seabed. The Wyrm's head goes up against the gunwale. The two enemies ferociously stare at each other, Thunder “sharpening his eyes” and the Wyrm spitting venom. Hymer

is frightened, reaches for his bait-cutting knife, and cuts the line—the Wyr̥m then sinks back into the sea. Thunder throws his hammer after it, “and men say that he struck off the monster’s head, but I think it true to tell thee that the Middenyardswyr̥m still lives and is lying in the outer sea.” Thunder gives Hymer a punch to the ear so that he flies headfirst overboard; the god then wades back to land.

Snorre’s account is clearly based on multiple sources, certainly including the Scaldic fragments he himself cites in *Skm*. It is hard to say whether Snorre had access to *Hym*; the closest verbal agreement is when it is said in *Gylf* 48:22 that *Mið-garðs-ormr gein yfir uxa-höfuð’it, en ǫngull’inn vá í góm’inn orm’inum* ‘The Middenyardswyr̥m snapped at the ox-head and the hook went into the roof of the wyr̥m’s mouth’, which has some resemblance to st. 22.

Some details in *Gylf* 48 not found in *Hym* must derive from now-lost texts available to Snorre; most famously the detail of Thunder’s feet going through the boat is also found on the Swedish Altuna stone and the Danish Hørdum stone (but see note to st. 34/2 below). The name of the ox Heavenrid is attested in thules listing names of oxen.

In addition to the literary sources there are also numerous pictorial depictions of the myth from the Viking Age. These are the Swedish runestones from Altuna (U 1611, figure 4, p. 273) and Linga (Sö 352), several Jutlandic picture stones from Hørdum, a Cumbrian picture stone from Gosforth, and the Gotlandic picture stone GP 21 from Ardre church. The images depict the same scene as the Scaldic fragments: Thunder stands in the boat above the hooked Wyr̥m, often depicted as a fish; next to him is one companion. Some of them have additional details like the use of the ox-head for bait (U 1611, Sö 352), Thunder’s foot going through the boat (U 1611, Hørdum), or Thunder raising his hammer (U 1611).

More broadly, Thunder’s fishing reflects the archetypal fight (the *Chaos-kampf*) between the Storm-God and the Dragon, as found in a great many mythologies. Important examples of this include Vedic *Índra* and *Vṛtrá* (*RV* 1.32 etc.), Babylonian *Marduk* and *Tiamat* (*Enūma Eliš* TODO), Greek Ζεύς (*Zeús*) and Τυφών (*Tūphón*), Hebrew YHWH and Leviathan (TODO: references). With these analogies in mind it seems that the versions where Thunder slays the Wyr̥m reflect an older layer of Germanic mythology, before the lethal fight between Thunder and the Wyr̥m had been transposed to the End Times (see *Vsp* 53).

### *Hym* as a composite

The narrative of *Hym* can be subdivided into the following episodes:

1. Sts. 1–6: The Gods wish to drink ale and Thunder goes to Eagre to force him to brew it; Eagre in turn asks for a cauldron big enough to brew enough ale for all the Gods.



2. 7–16: Thunder and Tew go to visit Tew's father, the stingy ettin Hymer, who owns such a cauldron; horrified at Thunder's great appetite during the evening he tells them that they must go fishing for food.
3. 17–19: Thunder says that he will do it, if he is given bait; Hymer challenges him to kill one of his oxen; Thunder tears off the head from one of them.
4. 20–25: The three go fishing; Hymer pulls up some whales; with the ox-head as bait Thunder manages to hook the Middenyardswyrn itself; he loses it.
5. 26–27: Hymer challenges Thunder to carry the boat and whales back to his farm; he does.
6. 28–32: Hymer challenges Thunder to break a supposedly indestructible chalice; he succeeds by smashing it against the ettin's forehead.
7. 33–36: Thunder and Tew depart with the cauldron; they find themselves followed by Hymer and his ettins; Thunder kills them all.
8. 37–38: One of Thunder's goats goes halt.
9. 39: Thunder returns to the Gods with Hymer's cauldron; they host a banquet.

The fishing expedition found in the Scaldic fragments and *Gylf* 48 is represented by episodes 3–4. *Hym* is the only source to place the fishing expedition within the broader context of Thunder and Tew obtaining a cauldron from Hymer for the sake of brewing ale (episodes 1–2, 9).

It seems inescapable, both on the basis of the other Norse sources and broader comparative mythology, that both the frame narrative and the additional episodes (e.g. number 8) originally had nothing to do with Thunder's encounter with the Wyrn. They have in any case been woven together into a single narrative, probably by the poet himself, for the sake of a more entertaining story for an audience which was likely expecting certain common "Thunder's journey" tropes.

Although the poem is skilfully written this weaving-together has not been entirely successful and has resulted in a few loose threads. The halt goat of sts. 37–38 (episode 8) finds a parallel in *Gylf* 44:17–21 where it serves as the origin story of Thunder's two child servants Thelvé and Wrash who accompany him on the way to Outyards-Lock. These two children play an important part in the narrative of *Gylf* 44–47, but in *Hym* are entirely superfluous detail—something the poet himself anticipates in his address to the audience. It is also strange that Lock should appear so late in the poem when he is not mentioned before or after; he too plays an important role in the Outyards-Lock story of *Gylf* 44–47.

A major superfluous element is the god Tew, who plays no role at all in the fishing expedition. He is last alluded to in st. 16 where Hymer speaks of

“[us] three”, only to reappear in st. 33 where he fails to lift the cauldron. It is also rather strange that Tew shows no reaction to the murder of Hymer, his father, taking place right before his eyes (sts. 35–36), but for the paternity cf. *Hym* 5/3 n.

The simplest explanation for this is however that Tew originally had nothing to do with the encounter between Thunder and the Wyrn, and within the confines of *Hym* mainly serves to segue from the narrative of the cauldron-fishing to the fishing expedition. Strong support for this is found in the fact that Thunder in the other variants of the fishing-story only has one companion—Hymer. These variants include the pictorial depictions, which only show two figures seated in the boat.

## Style

When speaking of a composite poem, one must distinguish between a text where several originally separate works have been put together mostly unchanged, and a text composed by a single author drawing from multiple narrative sources. A likely example of the former is *Háv*, but *Hym* undoubtedly belongs to the latter category.

*Hym* has a distinct style and rhythm throughout which stands alone in the Poetic Edda. Indeed, the sharpest stylistic contrast is with the poem most similar content-wise, *Þrk*. Where *Þrk* is written in a rustic style with fairly loose Ancient-words-law meter, repeats lines and even whole stanzas, *Hym* instead uses an unusually strict meter, avoids repetition, and revels in kennings, difficult grammatical constructions, and highly unnatural word order (see especially sts. 16/3–4, 20, and 39/3–4). These are all traits one associates more closely with Scaldic poetry in complex measures like Court-spoken meter than with Eddic poetry in Ancient-words-law, and it seems certain that the anonymous poet of *Hym* must have had some training in the Scaldic art and familiarity with compositions in that genre. Two kennings (17/4a *brjótr berg-Dana*, 22/4 *umb-gjörð allra landa*) are even shared identically with Scaldic poems in Court-spoken meter.

## Meter and stanza

*Hym* consists of 152 long-lines divided into 39 stanzas. The typical length of a stanza is 4 lines (32/39 sts.: 1–5, 7–10, 12–23, 28–35, 37–39). Deviant stanzas with 2 lines (1 st.: 6), 3 lines (4 sts.: 24–26, 36), and 5 lines (2 sts.: 11, 27) are also represented. The 4-line stanzas generally have a semantic division between ll. 2 and 3 and thus consist of two helmings.

Of the deviant stanzas, st. 6 appears to represent an isolated helming and is thus likely missing two lines. 2/4 3-line sts. (24 and 25) are clearly corrupt owing to syntactical issues; on the other hand the 2 others (26 and 36) show no obvious corruption. The 2 5-line stanzas do not seem to be missing any lines; in both of them one may identify an additional fifth line (11/1, 27/5) which could be removed without hindering the form of the other 4, although that is not to say that these lines are necessarily later inserts. To conclude, the



Figure 4: Detail of Thunder on the Altuna stone. Viking Age, ca. 1000 AD. © Bengt A. Lundberg, RAA. CC BY 4.0. <https://pub.raa.se/dokumentation/a4396e83-dac1-4f69-9cab-ff877da64e8d>

original *Hym* most likely only tolerated 4-line sts., with occasional exceptions for 5-line stanzas with a marked fifth line.

The meter of *Hym* is Ancient-words-law, but of a stricter variant than that of any other poem in the Poetic Edda; this is especially true when it comes to the count and weight of syllables. Three-syllable lines are rare, and the ones that do exist can all be corrected by restoring older hiatus forms (see note to 23/1b below). The poet also has a notable tendency to avoid lines of type C1 (xP#Px) where both stresses are heavy, something shared with Scaldic poems in Lay-meter and with Eyel's Headransom. This probably explains his unique tendency to place the two-syllable preposition *fyrir* 'before, in front, (up) ahead' at the end of the b-verse (never the a-verse), which he does 6 times—more frequently than in any other Ancient-words-law poem of the Poetic Edda.

### Dating

TODO. Hiatus forms, Þóarr, likely ritual reference, Icelandic.

## Text

## The Lay of Hymer

- 1 Ár val-tívar · vęiðar nómu  
 2 ok sumbl-samir · áðr saðir yrði,  
 hristu tęina · ok á hlaut sęu,  
 4 fundu at Ēgis · ør-kost hvera.

[R 13v/26, A 5v/25]

OF YORE THE SLAIN-TEWS (Gods) had caught game,  
 and, assembled at the simble before they might eat,  
 they shook the twigs and looked upon the leat;  
 they found at Eagre's a great choice of cauldrons.

---

1 val-tívar 'slain-Tews' | The Gods, a rare epithet only otherwise found in *Vsp* 50/2, 59/4 (n.).

1 vęiðar 'game' | The root *vęið-* may refer both to hunting/catching food more broadly and to fishing specifically, although the latter sense predominates and is certainly the way it is used in 10/2 and 16/4 below.

2 sumbl-samir 'assembled at the simble' | A simble being a drinking-feast or banquet. For the simble of the Gods see *Grm* 37/6, 46/4-5, *Lok* (*passim*).

2 áðr saðir yrði 'before they might eat' | Lit. 'might become sated'.

3 hristu tęina · ok á hlaut sęu 'they shook the twigs and looked upon the leat' | The Gods performed an augury, the details of which are not clear from this line alone. The term *hlaut* 'leat' is explained in *HákGóð* and *Eb* as the sacrificial blood of the slaughtered beasts, which was sprinkled by means of *hlaut-tęinar* 'leat-twigs'. These two words are also found together in an OE glossary, where *tān-blyta* 'twig-allotter' glosses Latin *sortilegus*. Etymologically ON *hlaut* is identical to OS *blōt* 'lot' (*Heli* 5547b), Gothic *blauts* 'lot, inheritance' (Streitberg 1910, p. 58). If we trust these sources the simplest explanation is that the Gods sprinkled the animal blood and interpreted the patterns. In any case they found it most auspicious to feast at Eagre's.

4 Ēgis 'Eagre's' | *Ēgir* 'Eagre' is the spirit of the Sea, an ettin.

- 2 Sat berg-búi · barn-tęitr fyrir,  
 2 mjök g-líkr męgi · Miskur-blinda,  
 lęit ĩ augu · Yggs barn ĩ þrá:  
 4 „þú skalt ęsum · opt sumbl gęra!“

[R 13v/28, A 5v/27]

The crag-dweller [ETTIN = Eagre] sat merry like a child ahead,  
 much like the son of Misherblind.  
 Into his eyes looked Ug's (Weden's) child [= Thunder] defiantly:  
 "For the Eese shalt thou oft make simbles!"

---

4 gęra 'make' | gefa 'give' A

---

ALL | Having seen that the ettin Eagre has a great store of cauldrons, Thunder visits him and orders him to brew ale for the thirsty Eese.

2 mjök g-likr megi · Miskur-blinda ‘much like the son of Misherblind’ | An unexplained reference. *Miskur-blindi* ‘Misherblind’ might be another name for Firneet (*Fornjótr*), the father of Eagre (Sea), Lay (*Logi* ‘Fire’), and Wind (*vindr*) (*Skn* 35, 36, *Yt* 4). The line would then be a tautology: “he looked just like the son his father”; for a similar tautology cf. *Vsp* 34/1–2.

- 3 Qnn fekk jǫtni · orð-béginns halr,  
2 hugði at hefndum · hann nēst við goð,  
bað Sifjar ver · sér föra hver,  
4 „þann’s ek ǫllum ǫl · yör of heita.“

[R 13v/31, A 5v/29]

Great toil for the ettin the word-peevisish man [= Thunder] caused;  
he thought of revenge, soon, against the god.  
He bade Sib’s husband [= Thunder] bring him a cauldron,  
“that one with which I for you all might warm ale.”

---

2 hefndum | *composite*; hefnd A; †hefdom† R

---

ALL | Eagre is upset at the demand but too cowardly to challenge Thunder openly. He instead gets back at him by demanding a single cauldron big enough to supply ale for all the Eese.

- 4 Né þat mǫttu · mérir tívar  
2 ok ginn-rēgin · of geta hver-gi,  
und’s af tryggðum · Týr Hlór-ríða  
4 ǫst-ráð mikit · ęinum sagði:

[R 14r/1, A 5v/30]

Yet of one could not the famous Tews  
and the Yin-Reins anywhere get hold—  
until, out of loyalty, Tew to Lorde  
a great loving counsel in private told:

---

3 Hlór-ríða ‘Lorde’ | ‘The Loud/Bellowing Rider’, a name for Thunder.

---

- 5 „Býr fyr austan · Ēli-vága  
2 hund-víss Hymir · at himins ęnda;  
á mǫnn faðir · móðugr ketil,  
4 rúm-brugðinn hver · rastar djúpan.“

[R 14r/3, A 6r/2]

“To the east of the Ilewaves dwells  
the hundred-wise Hymer, at heaven’s end.  
My father [= Hymer] owns, fierce, a kettle:  
a roomy cauldron one rest deep.”

---

4 rúm-brugðinn | †rumbrygðan† A

---

1 fyr austan Éli-vága ‘To the east of the Ilewaves’ | According to *Vafþ* 31 the Ilewaves were the poisonous wild rivers from which the ettins emerged, and so it makes sense that they would be found in the east, where the ettins dwell. That Hymer should dwell even to the east of the Ilewaves then illustrates his unusually ettin-like nature.

For the notion we may compare the Greek Ὠκεανός ‘Ocean’, the world-encircling river, beyond which the world is supernatural and uncanny (*Od* 11.13–22, 155–160). In *Theog* 790–1, Ὠκεανός consists of nine rivers which flow out into the world-sea that surrounds the Earth (cf. West (1966, p. 201)), which has a Norse parallel in the Outer Sea (*Út-bafr*), the sea surrounding the Earth in which the Middenyardswyrms dwell (cf. l. 2 n., 22/4 n. below). Like the Middenyardswyrms which bites its tail, so is Ὠκεανός given the epithet ἀπορροός ‘back-flowing, flowing into itself’ (*Il* 18.399, *Od* 20.65, *Theog* 776).

2 hund-viss ‘hundred-wise’ | Alternatively “hound-wise”; the prefix simply means “very”, but the word is used exclusively for ettins, typically in the collocation *bund-viss jötunn* (so *HHj* 25, *Skm* 24, 26, *Gautr* 3, etc.).

2 himins enda ‘at heaven’s end’ | The heaven is thought of as a solid dome of stone, the earth as a flat disc (*Vsp* 3 n., *Hárþ* 15 n.) Hymer thus lives at the very edge of the disc, next to the Outer Sea which encircles all lands and in which the Wyrms lie. For another ettin living at the edge of heaven cf. *Vafþ* 37.

3 mínir faðir ‘my father’ | A notable detail since Tew is elsewhere called the son of Weden (*Skm* 16) and it would be rather strange for the son of a male ettin to be afforded a place among the Eese due to the Norse patriarchal concern for male lineage. A possible explanation for this discrepancy is if Weden slept with Tew’s mother, the beautiful woman of st. 8, which would be an instance of the motif of a god mating with a beautiful ettin-woman as seen e.g. in *Ski*.

[Þórr kvað:] 6 „Veitst, ef þiggjum · þann lög-velli:“

[R 14r/4, A 6r/4]

[Týr kvað:] 2 „Ef, vinr, vélar · vit gørum till!“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Knowest thou if we’ll get that liquid-boiler [CAULDRON]?” —

[Quoth Tew:] “If, friend, we two make use of wiles!”

ALL | Like elsewhere in this poem the speakers are not indicated, but it is most sensible that Thunder asks and Tew answers.

7 Fóru drjúgum · dag frá=liga  
2 ðs·garði frá · und’s til Egils kvómu;  
hirði hafra · horn-göfgasta;  
4 hurfu at hollu · es Hymir átti.

[R 14r/5, A 6r/4]

They journeyed far, swiftly at day,  
away from Osyrd until they came to Eyel;  
he took care the he-goats noblest of horns—  
they turned to the hall which Hymer owned.

1 dag frá=liga ‘swiftly at day’ | so A; dag þann framm ‘on that day forth’ (unmetrical) R. 2 Egils ‘Eyel’ | so R; Egis ‘Eagre’ A.

1 dag frá=liga ‘swiftly at day’ | Finnur Jónsson (1932) proposes the emendation *dag þann framan* ‘from the beginning of the day’, but since A has a metrically sufficient reading its form is adopted here.

2 Egils ‘Eyel’ | The reading of A is probably from confusion with the ettin Eagre, who is mentioned earlier in the poem. Eyel, who takes Thunder’s goats in possession, is not otherwise known. He may perhaps be identified with the farmer in *Gylf* 44:10–21, for which see Note to st. 37 below.

- 8 **M**ōgr fann ǫmmu, · **m**jōk leiða sér, [R 14r/7, A 6r/6]  
 2 **h**aðfi **h**oðða · **h**undruð níu,  
 ǫn ǫnnur gekk · **a**l-gollin framm  
 4 **b**rún-hvít **b**era · **b**jór-veig syni:

The lad [= Tew] found his grandmother very loathsome;  
 of heads she had nine hundred.  
 But another woman, all-golden, stepped forth,  
 white-browed, bringing a beer-draught for her son [= Tew]:

2 haðfi hoðða · hundruð níu ‘of heads she had nine hundred’ | Malformed bodies, especially with a deviant number of body parts, are typical of ettins. Other examples include a three-headed thurse in *Skí* 31, the nine-headed ettin Thriwold (Bragi Frag 3 in SkP 3), and the eight-armed Starked Eeldreng. Cf. Introduction and st. 35 below.

3 ǫnnur ‘another woman’ | The use of the word “son” in the following line reveals this as Tew’s mother. The poet stresses her beauty of dress and countenance, in contrast to the grandmother.

- [Týs móðir:] 9 „Átt-niðr ȝotna · **e**k vilja’k ykk  
 2 **h**ug-fulla tvá · und **h**vera sęta;  
 es **m**ínn fríi · **m**ōrgu sinni  
 4 **g**lōggr við ȝęsti · **g**ōrr ills hugar.“ [R 14r/9, A 6r/8]

[Tew’s mother:] “O clansman of ettins [= Tew]! I would wish to place  
 you two, full of heart, beneath the cauldrons.  
 Many a time has my lover [= Hymer] been  
 stingy with guests, quick to ill mood.”

2 hug-fulla | hug-fulla hug-fulla R 3 fríi ‘lover’ | sō R; faðir ‘father’ A

2 tvá ‘two’ | Here an instance of contraction < \*tváa also found in st. 15/4 below, but cf. 21/2b which has the disyllabic form. It appears the poet was willing to use either form to accommodate the meter.

4 glōggr ... hugar ‘stingy ... mood’ | Ettins are characteristically inhospitable, in stark opposition to the Old Germanic social norms; see Introduction to the poem above. This statement foreshadows the later fishing expedition starting at st. 16 below.

- 10 **E**n vá-skapaðr · **v**að síð-búinn, [R 14r/11, A 6r/9]  
 2 **h**að-ráðr **H**ymir, · **h**eim af veiðum;  
 gekk inn í sal, · **g**lumðu ȝoklar,  
 4 vas **k**arls, es **k**om, · **k**inn-skógr frørinn.

But the misshapen one was come late,  
 hard-minded Hymer, home from fishing.



He entered the hall; icicles clattered;  
on the churl who came was the cheek-shaw [BEARD] frozen.

---

1 sið-búinn 'delayed' | *om.* A

---

3 jöklar 'icicles' | In Hymer's frozen beard. In modern Icelandic the word *jökull* has come to mean 'glacier', but its original sense (as found here) is that of its English cognate "icicle".

4 karls 'churl' | The first of three instances in the poem of Hymer being called a *karl* 'churl, old man, peasant'; a reference to his boorish nature. For the sense of this word in ON poetry (in contrast to both ON prose and later Scandinavian languages) see *Hárb* 2 n.

[Týs móðir:] 11 „Ves heill, Hymir, · í hugum góðum!

[R 14r/13, A 6r/11]

2 Nú 's sonr kominn · til sala þinna,  
sá's vit vettum · af vegi lönnum;  
4 fylgir hönnum · Hróðrs and-skoti,  
vinr ver-liða; · Vé-urr heitir sá.

[Tew's mother:] “Be thou hale, Hymer, in good spirits!  
Now the son has come to thy halls,  
he whom we've awaited, from a long way off.  
He is followed by Rooder's enemy [= Thunder],  
the friend of manly retinues—Wighward is he called.

---

1 Ves heill, ... í hugum góðum! 'Be thou hale ... in good spirits!' | A formulaic greeting; cf. the almost identical greeting in N B380 (edited below under Galders). Further afield cf. the type exemplified by *Beow* 407a: *Wæs þú, Hrōð-gār, hāl* 'Be thou, Rothgar, hale!'

5 Vé-urr 'Wighward' | The guardian of wighs (sanctuaries), a name of Thunder.

12 Sé hvar sitja · und salar gaffi,  
2 svá forða sér, · stendr súl fyrir.“  
Sundr stökk súla · fyr sjón jötuns,  
4 en áðr í tvau · áss brotnaði.

[R 14r/15, A 6r/13]

See where they sit beneath the hall's gable:  
so they save themselves—a column stands before them!”  
The column burst apart before the ettin's gaze,  
but earlier the roof-beam broke in two.

---

2 forða sér | forða=sk A 2 súl 'column' | sól A

---

2 súl 'column' | A hapax in ON, though attested in modern Icelandic. *súl* is the strong form of the weak *súla* 'id.' as found in the very next line.

13 Stukku áttá, · en einn af þeim  
2 hverr harð-sleginn · heill af þolli;  
framm gingu þeir, · en forn jötunn

[R 14r/17, A 6r/15]

- 4            **s**jönum leiðdi · **s**ínn and-skota.

Eight [cauldrons] crashed down, but one of them,  
a hard-forged cauldron, [came] whole off its peg.  
Forth they went, but the ancient ettin  
with his gaze tracked his enemy.

1–2 Stukku ... þolli ‘Eight ... peg.’ | Nine cauldrons were hanging from the roof-beam supported by the column behind which the gods were hiding. Eight of them broke from the fall, but one remained whole; we may presume that this one was the famed cauldron which the gods had come to get.

- 14        **S**agði=t **h**önum · **h**ugr vel þá’s sá  
2            **g**ýgjar **g**róti · á **g**olf kominn,  
              **þ**ar vöru **þ**jórar · **þ**rír of tæknir,  
4            **þ**að **s**enn jötunn · **s**jóða ganga.

[R 14r/19, A 6r/16]

His heart did not please him when he saw  
the gow’s distresser [= Thunder] come upon the floor.  
There were three bulls a-taken;  
the ettin bade them at once go cook.

2 gróti ‘distresser’ | gétu ‘keeper, warder’ A 4 senn ‘at once’ | sun ‘[his] son [= Teu].?’ A

1 Sagði=t hönum · hugr vel ‘His heart did not please him’ | Lit. “his heart did not speak well to him”.

- 15        **H**vern létu þeir · **h**ofði skemmra  
2            auk á **s**eyði · **s**íðan böru,  
              át **S**ifjar verr · áðr **s**ofa gingi,  
4            **ę**inn með **ę**llu · **ę**xn tvá Hymis.

[R 14r/21, A 6r/18]

Each one they made shorter by a head  
and onto the cooking-pit then did carry.  
Sib’s husband [= Thunder] ate, before he went to sleep,  
alone by himself two of Hymer’s oxen.

3–4 át ... Hymis. ‘Sib’s ... oxen.’ | Cf. *Þrk* 24 for another instance of Thunder’s great eating, which curiously also uses the kenning *Sifjar verr* ‘Sib’s husband [= Thunder].’

- 16        Þótti **h**orum · **H**runnis spjalla  
2            **v**erðr Hlór-riða · **v**el full-mikill,  
[Hymir:] „munum at **a**ptni · **ę**ðrum verða  
4            **v**ið **v**eiði-mat · **v**ér þrír lifa.“

[R 14r/23, A 6r/19]

To Rungner’s hoary friend [= Hymer] did seem  
Loride’s eating far too great—

“Next evening will we three  
on fished food have to live.”

ALL | Hymer's stinginess—he refuses to share more of his own food but instead forces his guests to go fish—breaks all Indo-European rules of hospitality and illustrates the otherness of the Ettins; see Introduction above.

3–4 munum ... lifa. ‘Next ... live.’ | The poet is pushing at the limits of Old Norse syntax. In prose word order it should be construed as: *at þórum aptni munum vér þrír verða lifa við veiði-mat*, where *verða* ‘have to, must’ is used like its modern German cognate *werden*.

17 Vé·urr kvað=sk vilja · à vág róa,  
2 ef ballr jötunn · beitur géfi.  
[Hymir:] „Hverf til hjarðar, · ef hug trúir,  
4 brjótr berg-Dana, · beitur sókja.

[R 14r/24, A 6r/21]

Wighward called himself willing to row on the wave  
if the stubborn ettin might give pieces of bait.  
[Hymir:] “Turn to the herd if thou trustest thy heart—  
O breaker of boulder-Danes [ETTINS > = Thunder]—to seek pieces of bait.

3 Hverf | so (‘hverf þu’) A; †hverfo† (fór \*‘hverf þu’) R. 3 hjarðar | hallar corr. A

4 brjótr berg-Dana ‘breaker of boulder-Danes [ETTINS > = Thunder]’ | The same kenning for Thunder also occurs in *Haustl* 18. The kenning-type, which is not uncommon, emphasises the otherness of the Ettins (see Introduction to the poem) by equating them with ethnic foreigners or enemies (Marold 1990). The most prolific use of it is seen in *Þdr*, where ettins are called Scots, Brythons, Swedes, Danes, Ruges and Harths, all peoples hostile to the Norwegian Earl Hathkin, at whose court that poem may have been composed.

18 Þess vëntir mik, · at þér myni=t  
2 ogn at oxa · auð-feng vesa.“  
Sveinn sýsliga · sveif til skógar,  
4 þar’s oxi stóð · al-svartr fyrir.

[R 14r/26, A 6r/23]

I expect that the bait from the ox  
will not be an easy catch for thee!”  
The swain [= Thunder] swiftly turned to the wood  
where an ox stood, all-black, ahead.

1 vëntir mik | so A; vënti ek (*norm.*) R. 1 myni=t ‘will not’ | so A; myni ‘will’ R. The A reading is preferable since it makes this the first of Hymer’s several challenges of strength to Thunder, which the god, to the ettin’s humiliation, easily accomplishes.

3 Sveinn ‘The swain’ | Thunder was in the shape of a young boy, a detail which is also found in *Gylf* 48:4; see Introduction to the poem.

4 oxi ... al-svartr ‘ox ... all-black’ | Formulaic, also occurring in *Þrk* 23; see note there for further parallels to the custom of sacrificing animals of certain colours. It seems that all-black oxen were thought the noblest, and so Thunder’s slaying one instead of an inferior beast is probably intended to humiliate the stingy Hymer. — We learn more about this ox in *Gylf* 48:13: *Hann tók inn mesta uxá’n, er Himin-brjóðr hét, ok sleit af hǫfuð’it ok fór með til sjávar*. ‘He took the greatest ox, which was called Heavenrid, and tore off its head and went with it to the sea’.

19 Braut af þjóri · þurs ráð-bani

[R 14r/28, A 6r/24]

2 hót-tùn ofan · horna tveggja.

[Hymir:] „Verk þykkja þín · verri myklu

4 kjóla valdi · an kyrr sitir.“

Off from the bull the thurse's death-planner [= Thunder]  
broke the high meadow of two horns [HEAD] from above.—

[Hymir:] “Worse by far thy works appear  
to the wielder of keels [= Hymer = me] than if thou wouldst sit calm!”

4 kjóla valdi ‘wielder of keels’ | I.e., ‘master of ships’, foreshadowing the later fishing expedition. — *valdi* is here taken as dat. sg. of *valdr* ‘wielder, master’ and as the indirect object of *þykkja* ‘seem, appear’. The word can however also be read as the semantically identical nom. sg. *valdi*, in which case the phrase would be a vocative addressing Thunder. In context the former reading makes more sense: the kenning ‘ruler of keels’ fits better for Hymer than Thunder and *þykkja* gets an indirect object.

20 Bað hlunn-gota · hafra dróttinn

[R 14r/30, A 6r/26]

2 átt-runnc apa · útar föra,

en sá jötunn · sína talði,

4 litla fýsi · at róa lengra.

The Lord of He-goats bade the kinsman of the ape [ETTIN = Hymer]  
push the launcher-steed [BOAT] further out,  
but that ettin told of his  
little wish to row any longer.

2 átt-runnc | †atrænn† A 3 talði | milldi *corr.* A

ALL | The scene shifts and the party is out at sea. It is possible that a stanza has been lost here, or that the transition would have been indicated in some other way during oral performance.

1 hafra dróttinn ‘Lord of He-goats’ | Thunder. Reoccurs in 31/1 below; cf. *Þrk* 21/1.

2 apa ‘ape’ | The specific sense of *api* ‘ape’ is uncertain. It seems generally to refer to a fool, but see Index.

3–4 en ... róa. ‘but ... longer.’ | Thunder’s humorous humiliation of Hymer continues with the snide ettin now forced to row against his will.

4 at róa lengra | The alliteration falls on the second stressed word which is not expected; emendation to *\*lengra at róa* is metrically convenient but not supported by either ms.

21 Dró mærr Hymir · móðugr hvali

[R 14r/31, A 6r/27]

2 einn á ǫngli · upp seinn tváa;

en aptr í skut · Óðni sífjaðr

4 Vé·urr við vélar · vað gerðir sér.

Famous Hymer, fierce, pulled whales:  
one on the hook, soon up two—

but back in the stern the Weden-affinitive  
Wighward (= Thunder) craftily fixed his line.

1 meirr ‘famous’ | so R; meirr ‘more, further’ A

1 hvali | A rare acc. pl. form also occurring in 26/2b.

3 Óðni sífjaðr ‘Weden-affinitive’ | I.e., the one related to Weden, an adjective describing Wighward (Thunder).

- 22 Egnði à ǫngul · sá’s ǫldum bergr,  
2 orms ǫin-bani · oxa hǫfði;  
gǫin við agni · sú’s goð fía  
4 umb-gjörð neðan · allra landa.

[R 14v/1, A 6r/29]

On the hook baited he who rescues men—  
the Wyrms lone slayer—the ox’s head.  
At the bait snapped the one whom the Gods hate—  
the engirdler of all lands—from below.

3 agni ‘bait’ | so A; ǫngli ‘book’ R

ALL | This stanza skilfully juxtaposes Thunder and the Wyrms by employing strong parallelism across the two helmingings (ll. 1–2 and 3–4). The poetic juxtaposition between the two primordial enemies, Storm-God and Serpent, is also found in the Scaldic fragments (e.g. *Qlv Þórr*; see note to l. 4) and, further afield, in the Vedic tradition (e.g. *RV* 1.32.13c: *Índraś ca yád · yuyudháē Áśiś ca* ‘When Indra and the Wyrms (*ábi*) fought each other.’)

2 orms ǫin-bani ‘Wyrms lone slayer’ | Watkins (1995, pp. 419–424) sees in this kenning for Thunder a reflex of the ancient IE formula HERO SLAY (PIE *\*g<sup>wh</sup>en-*) SERPENT, where the root *\*g<sup>wh</sup>en-* ‘slay, kill’ is reflected in ON by the agent noun *bani* ‘bane, slayer’ < *\*g<sup>wh</sup>on-ō* (so e.g. Seebold 1967, pp. 113–114, although the sound change *\*g<sup>wh</sup>-* > *\*b-* is not universally accepted; see Kroonen 2013, pp. xxxviii, 51). The IE formula, reconstructed as *\*h<sub>1</sub>é-g<sup>wh</sup>ent h<sub>2</sub>óg<sup>wh</sup>im* ‘he slew the Serpent’, occurs directly only as OI *áhann Áfím* (11 times in *RV*; see Watkins 1995, pp. 304 ff.), but has parallels throughout the IE family, including Greek and Hittite (Watkins 1995, *passim*).

On the basis of the rare sound combination *\*-g<sup>wh</sup>-*: *-g<sup>wh</sup>-*, Wikander (2021) argues brilliantly that the IE formula was likely phono-semantically calqued from IE into Northwest Semitic as the formulaic rhyming phrase *\*maḥša naḥša(m)* ‘he struck the serpent’ (which features another rare and highly marked phoneme, the ejective *\*ʕ* [ʔ]), perhaps along with the Chaoskampf myth as a whole.

4 umb-gjörð ... allra landa ‘engirdler of all lands’ | The same kenning is found in a fragment by Alewigh Snub (*Qlv Þórr* in SkP 3) quoted in *Skm* 11: *Östi-sk allra landa · umb-gjörð ok sonr Jarðar* ‘The engirdler of all lands and the son of Earth surged.’ Closely related is the kenning in a 9th c. fragment by Bray the Old quoted in the same chapter (*Bragi Þórr* 3 in SkP 3): *endi-sǫiðr allra landa* ‘boundary-saith of all lands’. Both kennings relate to the cosmological idea of the Outer Sea (ON *Út-haf*) which surrounds the solid Earth; in this sea lies the Wyrms, biting its tail and enwrapping the lands. Cf. st. 5/1 n. above.

- 23 Dró djarf=liga · dáð-rakkr Þóarr  
2 orm ǫitr-fáan · upp at borði;  
hamri kníði · hǫ-fjall skarar

[R 14v/3, A 6v/1]

4 of-ljótt ofan · ulfs hnit-bróður.

Bravely, deed-ready Thunder pulled  
the venom-gleaming Wyrms up on the gunwale.  
With the hammer he struck the high mountain of hair [HEAD]—  
very hideous, from above—on the Wolf's clash-brother [= the Wyrms].

---

1 djarf-liga | so A; †diafliga† R

---

1 Þóarr ‘Thunder’ | Out of 8 three-syllable lines in *Hym*, this is the only one which is deficient in both R and A and cannot easily be emended by restoring an hiatus form. In the quite strict meter (see Introduction above) observed by the *Hym* poet we should expect a disyllabic form in this spot, and this may be had if we restore an archaic \*Þóarr or \*Þóurr. Such a form is less secure than other hiatus forms, but is also metrically required in *Hym* 28/2b below and further in the Scaldic *Þdr* 2/2b. This issue is treated in depth by Haukur Þorgeirsson (2023), who argues for the form \*Þóurr.

3 hō-fjall skarar ‘high mountain of hair [HEAD]’ | A rather unfitting kenning, since serpents do not have hair.

24 Hraun-golkn hrutu, · en hōlkn þutu,  
2 fór hin forna · fold ǫll saman;  
[...]  
sökkði=sk síðan · sá fiskr í mar.

[R 14v/5, A 6v/2]

The waste-monsters [ETTINS] bounded and bedrock resounded;  
the ancient earth moved all at once.  
[...]  
Thereafter sank that Fish into the sea.

---

1 Hraun-golkn ‘The waste-monsters’ | *emend.*; hrēin-golkn AR 1 hrutu | so A; hlumðu ‘ashed’ R.

---

1 Hraun-golkn ‘The waste-monsters’ | Both mss. have *brēin*-, which may mean either ‘clean’ or ‘reindeer’, neither of which make sense Semantically. On the other hand *braun* ONP: ‘stone/barren area, wasteland; lavafeld’ is well attested in Scaldic kennings for ettins, including in the present poem (36/4, 38/3). The precise meaning of *galkn* ‘monster’ (plural *golkn*) is unclear, but it is attested in 3 Scaldic verses, in all cases as the base-word in kennings of the type “troll-woman of the shield [AXE]”, which may suggest that it (like another neuter word, *flagð*) refers specifically to female malevolent beings.

While the mss. spelling ‘*galkn*’ (norm. *gálkn*) could reflect either singular or plural, the form of the verb is plural. This means that the word cannot be referring to the Middenyardswyrms as Larrington (2014) understands it in her translation: “the sea-wolf shrieked”.

1 hrutu | The A reading is preferred since it has the metrically required short root syllable. End rhyme is paralleled elsewhere in the poem (st. 3/3); here it heightens the dramatic impact of the verse.

2 [...] | It is very likely that a line is missing here, since the stanzas in the poem fairly consistently have 4 lines and since the *siðan* ‘thereafter’ in l. 3 is left without a referent. In other tellings of the myth it is at this point that Hymer cuts Thunder’s fishing line, so that is probably what has been lost. Cf. Gylf 48:26–27: *Þá er sagt, at jötunn’inn Hymir gerði-sk lit-verpr, fólnaði ok bréddi-sk, er bann sá ormr’inn ok þat er sgr’inn féll út ok inn of nokkvann. Ok í því bili, er Þórr greip hamar’inn ok fôrði á lofi, þá fálmaði jötunn’inn til agn-saxi’nu ok hjó vað Þórs á borði, en ormr’inn sökkði-sk í sgr’inn.* ‘Then it is said that the ettin Hymer lost his colour, turned pale and was frightened when he saw the Wyrms and how the sea fell in and out of the boat. And in that moment when Thunder gripped the hammer and brought it aloft then the ettin reached for the bait-cutting knife and cut Thunder’s fishing-line against the gunwale. But the Wyrms sunk into the sea.’ Based on this account we may reconstruct a hypothetical line *\*und’s fólr Hymir · fékk á saxi* ‘until pale Hymer grasped the knife’.

3 fiskr ‘fish’ | A good example showing that pre-modern speciation, especially in poetry, was not exact. The appellation is not a mere fancy of the poet, for the Wyrms appear in the shape of a fish in various pre-Christian pictorial sources (e.g. GP 21). It may also be called a fish in *Grm* 21 (see note there), and in Scaldic sources it is often called a *saithe* (*sgrðr*).

- 25      Ó·teitr jötunn, · es aptr røru,  
           [...]  
 2      svá’t ár Hymir · ekki mélti,  
           veifði röði · veðrs annars til.

[R 14v/6, A 6v/3]

The unmerry ettin [= Hymer], as they rowed back,  
 [...] so that for a long time Hymer said not a thing;  
 he pulled the oar against the wind:

1 [...] | Another likely missing line. As noted in the previous stanza the meter usually requires four lines; more importantly the first half of the sentence is incomplete without a verb.

2 svá’t ár ‘so that for a long time’ | Finnur Jónsson (1932) suggests *svá’t at ór* ‘so that by the oar’, but this burdens the strict meter. For this sense of *ár* cf. *Ski* 27.

- [Hymir:] 26      „Munt of vinna · verk halft við mik,  
 2      at heim hvali · haf til bójar  
           eða flot-brúsa · fæstir okkarn.“

[R 14v/8, A 6v/4]

[Quoth Hymer:] “Thou wilt accomplish a half work compared to me,  
 if thou bringest home the whales to the farm,  
 or our float-buck [BOAT] thou dost fasten.”

ALL | Hymer tells Thunder, who having let go of the Wyrms has nothing to show for the trip, that he can accomplish something half as great as the catching of the whales if he carries them home and ties the boat by the shore.

- 27      Gekk Hlór-riði · greip á stafni  
 2      vatt með austri · upp lög-fáki;  
           einn með órum · ok með aust-skotu

[R 14v/9, A 6v/6]

- 4        bar til **bójar** · **brim**-svín jǫtuns  
           ok **holt**-riða · **hver** í gegnum.

Loride went, grasped the stern,  
 hurled up the lake-nag [BOAT] with the bilge-water.  
 Alone with the oars and the bilge-bucket  
 he bore to the farm the ettin's brim-swines [WHALES],  
 even through the spring of woodland ridges.

1 á | til á R    5 **holt**-riða | †holtriba† R

2 með austri 'with the bilge-water' | That is, the bilge-water was still inside the boat; another impressive work of strength.

5 **holt**-riða hver 'spring of woodland ridges' | An uncertain geographical description apparently meant to impress the audience as a particularly impressive feat. In Iceland *hverr* 'cauldron' also carries the sense '(hot) spring', in which case this could be an attestation of Thunder's prowess in wading (for which see *Grm* 29). TODO: What do other editors and translators say?

- 28      Ok **enn** jǫtunn · umb **afr**-endi,  
 2        þrá-girni vanr, · við **þóar** sēti,  
           kvað=at mann **ram**man, · þó'tt **róa** kynni,  
 4        **kröptur**=ligan, · nema **kalk** bryti.

[R 14v/12, A 6v/7]

And yet the ettin, used to stubbornness,  
 over strength of hand with Thunder flyted.  
 He would call no man strong, even though he could row  
 mightily, unless he broke the chalice.

1 Ok | Enn A

ALL | Even after witnessing several great feats of strength Hymer still refuses to admit Thunder's superiority. He now insists on challenging him to break his indestructible chalice.

- 29      Eñ **Hlór**-riði, · es at **høndum** kom,  
 2        brátt lét **bresta** · bratt-stēin glēri,  
           sló sitjandi · súlur í gognum;  
 4        böru þó **hē**ilan · fyr **Hymi** síðan,

[R 14v/14, A 6v/9]

But Loride, when it came to his hands,  
 impatiently crushed steep stone with the glass.  
 He struck right through the standing columns,  
 yet they brought it, whole, before Hymer thereafter,

2 bratt-stēin glēri 'steep stone with the glass' | Thunder broke the stone columns in Hymer's house with the glass chalice.

3 sitjandi 'standing' | This word is ambiguous and can modify either Thunder (in which case it would mean "sitting") or the columns (*súlur*). I have chosen the latter and read it as signifying their stability.



- 30 und's þat hin fríða · fríðla kęđi  
 2 օst-ráđ mikit, · ęitt es vissi,  
 „drep við haus Hymis, · hann 's harđari,  
 4 kost-móđs ęotuns, · kalki hverjum!“

[R 14v/16, A 6v/10]

until the handsome mistress [= Tew's mother] gave  
 a great loving counsel, the one she knew:  
 “Strike against Hymer's skull! It is harder—  
 the choice-weary ettin's—than any chalice.”

1 hin | so A; 'iđ' (n. nom. sg.) R 4 hverjum | so A; hverju (n. dat. sg.) R.

1–2 und's ... vissi, 'until ... knew.' | Harkening back to st. 4.

3 haus Hymis, · hann 's harđari 'Hymer's skull! It is harder' | Ettins characteristically have hard skulls; cf. *Hárb* 15 and note for the significance of this minor detail.

4 kost-móđs 'choice-weary' | Hymer can justly be called “choice-weary” since at this point the gods have destroyed eight of his nine cauldrons and slain three of his bulls.

- 31 Harđr reįs á kné · hafra dróttinn,  
 2 fórđisk allra · ı օs-męgin;  
 heįll vas karli · hjalm-stofn ofan,  
 4 ęn vın-fęrill · valr rifnaði.

[R 14v/18, A 6v/12]

On his knee rose the hard Lord of He-goats;  
 he brought himself to his highest Os-might.  
 Whole on the churl [= Hymer] was the helm-stump [HEAD] above,  
 but the round wine-track [CHALICE] rent apart.

1 reįs | om. A

2 fórđisk allra · ı օs-męgin 'brought himself into his fullest Os-might' | The exact meaning of this is not clear, but a likely reading is that Thunder brings himself into his true form as the mighty, red-bearded man; recall that he was previously (st. 18/3) in the shape of a young boy. Cf. *Gylf* 48:24 in its description of Thunder attempting to pull up the Wyrms: *Þá varđ Þórr reiđr ok fórđi-sk í օs-męgin* [...] ‘Then Thunder turned wroth and brought himself into his Os-might’ and Eddic fragment 6, st. 1.

- [Hymir kvađ:] 32 „Morg vęit'k męti · mér gingin frá,  
 2 es kalki sé'k · fyr knéum hrundit,“  
 karl orđ of kvađ: · „kná'k=at sęja  
 4 aptr ęva=gi: · ,þú 'st ęlđr of heįtt.“

[R 14v/20, A 6v/13]

[Quoth Hymer:] “I know many treasures parted from me  
 when I see the chalice thrown before [my] knees!”—  
 The churl [= Hymer] spoke words: “I cannot say  
 ever again: ‘Thou art, ale, well warmed!’”

2 es | om. R 2 fyr | ýr R; firi A 2 knéum | metr. emend.; knjám (norm.) RA 4 heitt | so A; þhétt† R.

3–4 knák-at ... of heitt. ‘I cannot ... warmed!’ | Hymer laments that with the loss of his finest vessel he will never be able to enjoy his drink again, ironically since it was he who challenged Thunder to break it in the first place. For ‘warmed’ (*heitt*) ale cf. st. 3/4 above.

- 33 Þat ’s til **k**ostar · ef **k**oma mǣttið  
 2 **ú**t ór **ó**ru · **q**l-kjól hofí.“  
**T**ýr lǣitaði · **t**ysvar hróra;  
 4 stóð at **h**vǫru · **h**verr kyrr fyrir.

[R 14v/22, A 6v/15]

It would be choicest if ye might bring  
 that ale-vessel [CAULDRON] out from our hall.”  
 Tew attempted twice to move it—  
 each time stood the cauldron unmoved ahead.

2 ql-kjól ‘ale-vessel [CAULDRON]’ | *ql-kjól* is the accusative of *ql-kjól*, but in this construction (CV: *koma*, B) we would expect the dative *ql-kjóli*. Since the meter does not allow for this the poet has probably taken a grammatical liberty.

2 hofi ‘hall’ | This is the only Old Norse occurrence of the word *hof* in the sense “hall, house”—it otherwise only means “temple” (hove). The West Germanic cognates consistently mean “hall”, but that is probably the original sense, so it is unclear if this is an instance of foreign (if so, most likely Anglo-Saxon) influence or just a poetic archaism.

- 34 Faðir Móða · **f**ekk á þręmi  
 2 ok í gegnum stęig · **g**olf niðr í sal;  
 hóf=sk á **h**aufuð upp · **h**ver Sifjar verr,  
 4 ęn á **h**ęlum · **h**ringar skullu.

[R 14v/24, A 6v/16]

The father of Moody [= Thunder] grasped the brim  
 and stepped through the floor in the hall.  
 Up onto his head heaved Sib’s husband [= Thunder] the cauldron,  
 but by his heels the rings clattered.

2 stęig ‘stepped’ | so R; stóð ‘stood’ A 2 í | á (norm.) A

2 ok í gegnum stęig · golf niðr í sal ‘and stepped through the floor in the hall’ | In *Gylf* 48:24 Thunder is said to have stepped through the boat when trying to pull up the Middenyardsworm, a detail famously depicted on the Altuna runestone (U 1611) from Uppland, Sweden and the Hørdum stone from Denmark. It is very likely that the original detail of Thunder exerting himself to the point of his feet going through the bottom of the boat has later been transposed to this place in the narrative, although it is unclear whether this is the work of the poet himself or of an earlier tradition.

3 haufuð ‘head’ | The archaic long form *haufuð* rather than the short *hǫfuð* is metrically superior in a type B verse (TODO: cite MalesTODO note). Cf. the similar line 36/1 below.

4 hringar skullu ‘the rings clattered’ | I.e. the chain-links. This detail is mentioned in an example sentence contrasting long and short phonemes in *FGT* 1950: *beyrði til hǫddu, þá er Þórr bar bverinn* ‘the sound of the pot-links (*badda*) was heard when Thunder bore the cauldron’. According to Finnur Jónsson (1932) the chain (or *badda*) on a Wiking-age cauldron would reach across it, being bound on two opposing points along the rim, in which case this would be a reference to the cauldron’s enormous size, with its diameter—mentioned in st. 5 as one rest—being roughly the same as Thunder’s height.

- 35 Fóru=t lēngi, · áðr líta nam  
2 aþtr Óðins sonr · ęinu sinni;  
sá ór hręsum · með Hymi austan  
4 folk-drótt fara · fjol-hǫfðaða.

[R 14v/26, A 6v/18]

They did not journey for long before Weden’s son  
took to look back a single time.  
He saw out of stone-heaps with Hymer from the east  
a war-troop coming, many-headed.

---

4 folk-drótt ... fjol-hǫfðaða ‘war-troop ... many-headed’ | The adjective *fjol-hǫfðaðr* means ‘many-headed, polycephalic’ and is not referring to the size of the host. For many-headed ettins see st. 8 and for their malformed bodies in general see Introduction to the poem.

- 36 Hóf sér af hęrðum · hver standandi,  
2 vęifði Mjöllni · morð-gjörnum framm,  
ok hraun-hvala · hann alla drap.

[R 14v/28, A 6v/19]

He heaved off his shoulders the cauldron, standing,  
swung the murder-eager Millner forth,  
and all the whales of the waste [ETTINS] he slew.

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ALL | For another light-hearted instance of Thunder’s ettin-bashing cf. *Þrk* 31–32.

2 morð-gjörnum ‘murder-eager’ | By this adjective the poet gives the Hammer something of a will of its own; cf. *Skm* 43, where the Hammer is said to always return to Thunder when thrown, perhaps by its own will. With this may be connected the curious fact that several pagan hammer-amulets of the Wiking Age depict the Hammer with a mouth, nose, and eyes. Three such finds are the silver hammer from Bredsättra, Öland, Sweden (item number 106666 HST), the gilt silver hammer from Ödeshög, East Geatland, Sweden (108249 HST), and the silver hammer from Baron Claes Kurck’s collection found somewhere in Scania (106659 HST), the last of which is reproduced in Fig. 5, p. 292.

- 37 Fóru=t lēngi, · áðr liggja nam  
2 hafr Hlór-riða · half-dauðr fyrir,  
vas skęr skøkuls · skakkr á bęini,  
4 ęn því hinn lę-vísi · Loki of olli.

[R 14v/30, A 6v/21]

They did not journey for long before Loride’s he-goat  
took to lie half-dead ahead.

The colt of the cart-pole [GOAT] was halt in the leg,  
but that the guile-wise Lock had caused.

3 skér | emend. from meaningless †skirr† RA 3 bēini | banni R

ALL | Sts. 37–38 deal with one of Thunder's goats going halt and an ettin farmer giving up two of his children in return. A related story is also found in *Gylf* 44:9–21 and may be summarized as follows:

Thunder and Lock were on the way to visit Outyards-Lock and stayed the night with a certain farmer. For supper Thunder cut his two goats and invited the farmer and his family to dine with him. After they had eaten he spread the goatskins before the fire and bade the housefolk throw the bones of the goats on top of them. The farmer's son stealthily pried open the thigh of one of the goats and ate the marrow. At dawn Thunder blessed the goatskins with his hammer and the goats came back to life, but the one Thelwe had cut had a halt leg. Thunder was enraged, but the farmer begged for his life and offered to give up his two children, namely his son Thelwe and his daughter Wrash. Thunder spared him, and the two became his servants.

The present stanza may reference a version of the same myth wherein Lock has a part to play in the halting of the goat, perhaps by encouraging Thelwe to pry the bone open; this is strongly supported by *Skm* 23 where Lock is called *þjóf* [...] *þáfrs* 'thief of the he-goat', almost certainly Thunder's. The farmer may be identified with Eyel, with whom the goats were left in st. 7 above, so it is probably also Eyel who gives away his two children (Thelwe and Wrash) in st. 38.

- 38    Æn ér heýrt hafð, · hveṛr kann umb þat  
2    goð-mólugra · gørr at skilja,  
     hveṛ af hraun-búa · hann laun of fekk,  
4    es bēði galt · bōrn sín fyrir.

[R 14v/32, A 6v/22]

But ye have heard—about that can each  
god-speaking man more clearly discern—  
what recompense *he* [= Thunder] got from the waste-dweller [ETTIN]  
when he [= the ettin] paid up both of his own children for it.

1 ér 'ye' | The listeners. A direct address to the audience of this type is otherwise unparalleled in Eddic mythological poetry. Such are, however, typical for the Scaldic poems with which *Hym* shares several traits; see Introduction above. Cf. st. 39/3–4 n.

1–2 hveṛr ... goð-mólugra 'each god-speaking man' | Literally "each of the god-speaking ones". *goð-mólugr* 'god-speaking' is an hapax, but easily understood as "learned in the lore of the gods".

- 39    Þrótt-ǫflugr kom · à þing goða  
2    ok hafði hver, · þann's Hymir átti;  
     en véar hveṛjan · vḗl skulu drikka  
4    ǫlðr at Égis · eitt hōr-mēitið.

[R 15r/1, A 6v/24]

The one strong of vigour came to the Thing of the Gods  
and had the cauldron which Hymer had owned—  
but the Wighers (Gods) shall drink well  
one ale-feast at Eagre's every flax-cutter [SUMMER?].

1 Þrótt-ǫflugr 'The one strong of vigour' | Thunder.

3–4 *en véar hverjan · vel skulu drikka / qlðr at Égis · çitt hqr-meitið* ‘but the Wighers (Gods) well shall drink / one ale-feast at Eagre’s every flax-cutter [SUMMER].’ | Regardless of whether (*çitt*) *hqr-meitið* means [SUMMER] or [WINTER] (see note), these concluding lines seems to describe the Gods celebrating a yearly seasonal festival (*qlðr*). The fact that this is mentioned at the very end of the poem seems to give an etiological purpose to the whole narrative; with the claiming of the cauldron the Gods are henceforth able to enjoy an abundance of drink at a specified point each year. The festival alluded to is probably equivalent to an annual agricultural festival celebrated by humans, since the cult of the Gods serves as the model for the human religion (*Vsp* 7/2 n.), and with that in mind we can deduce that *Hym* was likely composed for recitation either at a festival taking place in late July or at Yule—a unique insight into the performance of Eddic poetry. This is further supported by the address of the audience in st. 38 above. — The word order is unusually complex for an Eddic poem but is not unprecedented in *Hym* (e.g. st. 16/3–4). In prose word order: *en véar skulu drikka vel çitt qlðr at Égis hverjan hqr-meitið*; or with emendation from La Farge and Tucker: *en véar skulu drikka vel qlðr at Égis hverjan çitr-hqr-meitið*.

4 *çitt hqr-meitið* ‘one ... flax-cutter’ | The latter word is an *hapax* and very obscure. It clearly belongs with *hverjan* ‘every, each’ (m. acc. sg.); its nom. sg. form should be \**hqr-meitiðr*. I take this as a compound formed from *horr* ‘flax, cord’ + *meita* ‘to cut’ with an agent noun suffix *-ðr*. Since the determiner *hverjan* implies seasonality the word is easily read as a kenning for SUMMER, or specifically the time when flax is cut around late July. This is however unprecedented amongst kennings for SUMMER, which otherwise always belong to the type “mercy of the SERPENT” (Meissner 1921, p. 109). — Following the ms. evidence the pres. ed. reads *çitt* ‘one’ n. acc. sg. as modifying *qlðr* ‘ale-feast’, but based on typical WINTER-kennings of the type “harm of the SERPENT” La Farge and Tucker (1992, p. 46) suggest the emendations *çitr-hqr-meitir* ‘venom-rope-cutter [SNAKE > WINTER]’ and *çitr-orm-meitir* ‘venom-worm-schather [WINTER]’.



Figure 5: Hammer-amulet with face from unknown findspot, Scania. Wiking Age, ca. 900 AD. © Ola Myrin, Historiska museet/SHM. CC BY 4.0. <https://samlingar.shm.se/media/1B654576-D251-475F-B366-6EF893A1D537>

# Flyting of Lock

## (*Loka senna*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.965)

Meter: Leeds-meter

### Introduction

The **Flyting of Lock** (abbrev. *Lok*) is a narrative poem dealing with Lock's insults of the gods at their simle and the consequences that follow.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The poem is preserved only in **R** on foll. 15r/3–17r/12. It follows *Hym* and precedes *Þrk*.

In **R**, *Lok* is tied together into a continuous narrative with *Hym* by the prose passage “From Eagre and the Gods” (edited as P1–P2 of the present poem), but the two poems are so drastically different in style that they are certainly distinct compositions.

In the related Eddic manuscript **A**, *Hym* stands alone with no trace of a frame narrative while no trace of *Lok* survives, which strongly suggests that the frame narrative is a later addition on the part of the **R** tradition.

A stanza that appears to belong to *Lok* is found in *Gylf*; it is edited below following the end of the poem. The poem—and especially its introductory prose (*Lok* P1, P2)—is also alluded to in *Skm* 41.

### Meter and stanza

*Lok* is composed entirely in Leeds-meter. The poem has 266 lines across 65 stanzas. Most stanzas (60/65) follow the typical four-line structure *ab-cabc*, but the variants *abcabcc* (13, 54, 62, 65) and even *abcabccc* (23) are also represented.

The stanzas exclusively represent dialogue, and all narrative elements are told in prose. Apart from the short speaker notes before stanzas longer prose

interjections are also found between sts. 5 and 6 (P3), 10 and 11 (P4), 52 and 53 (P5), 53 and 54 (P6), and 56 and 57 (P7).

Two unambiguous instances show that alliteration can fall between *v* and a vowel: 2/4 (*orði : vinr*) and 10/1 (*Víð-arr : ulfs*). Cf. 36/4 (n.). Still, the numerous other instances of normal *v*- or vowel-alliteration show that this was not preferred, and it is notable that both *orð* 'word' and *ulfr* 'wolf' contained a *v*- in an earlier stage of the language; see note to 2/4.

One line lacks suitable alliteration: 39/3. The alliteration in 14/2 is highly questionable.

### Origin and motifs

It is easy to interpret *Lok* as a blasphemous composition belonging to the period after the conversion to Christianity. Surely no pious pagan would have written a poem insulting his own gods. Yet, as discussed in the introduction to *Hárb*, this argument is not very strong since examples of humorous or irreverent descriptions of Gods can be found in many other pagan poetic traditions in the context of mythology, which is what *Lok* is. What is more, many of *Lok*'s insults are likely taken out of their original contexts or baseless, and the taunting god is ultimately forced to flee before the might of Thunder, which the poet by no means denigrates.

If anything, the fact that *Lok* assumes a deep familiarity with the pagan mythology and the characters and incidents of the gods probably speaks for a pre-Christian origin. The gods are after all insulted on their own merits, not as idols powerless before Almighty God and His holy men, which was the Christian view. If the goal was to make fun of the gods there would surely have been easier and more effective ways to do so.

### Dating

Notably for the question of dating *Lok* has three occurrences of alliteration between old *vr-* (> *r-*) and *v-*: 15/3 (*vega : vręiðr*), 18/4 (*vręiðir : vegi-sk*), and 27/4 (*vręiðum : vegit*). Since all Scaldic attestations of *vr-* alliterating with *v-* rather than with *r-* date to before 1000 AD (cf. *Háv* 26/2) this is a solid dating criterion for pre-Christian composition (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016).

A feature in the alliteration which tentatively suggests a very earlier dating is the fact that secure alliteration between *v-* and a vowel is isolated to two instances (2/4 and 10/1), both of which have vowel-words which in Proto-Norse began with *w-*; see note to 2/4.

When it comes to the occurrence of the preverbal particle *of*, a trait strongly correlated with *vr-*, *Lok* shows the high rate of 0.326 per 10 unique lines (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 54; Sapp 2022, p. 70).

In addition *Lok* preserves two archaic Germanic hapax legomena in their etymological senses: the noun *ffęrg* 'Farrows, Gods' (19/4) and the adj. *tilr* 'conciliatory' (38/2).

Linguistic and metrical factors thus strongly suggest that *Lok* is a pre-Christian poem from the 9th or 10th c.



## Summary

*Overview of speakers by stanza, first occurrence in bold:*

1 **Lock**, 2 **Elder**, 3 Lock, 4 Elder, 5 Lock — 6–7 Lock, 8 **Bray** — 9 Lock, 10 **Weden** — 11 Lock, 12 Bray, 13 Lock, 14 Bray, 15 Lock — 16 **Idin**, 17 Lock, 18 Idin — 19 **Yiven**, 20 Lock — 21 Weden, 22 Lock, 23 Weden, 24 Lock — 25 **Frie**, 26 Lock, 27 Frie, 28 Lock — 29 **Frow**, 30 Lock, 31 Frow, 32 Lock — 33 **Nearth**, 34 Lock, 35 Nearth, 36 Lock — 37 **Tew**, 38 Lock, 39 Tew, 40 Lock — 41 **Free**, 42 Lock — 43 **Bewer**, 44 Lock, 45 Bewer, 46 Lock — 47 **Homedall**, 48 Lock — 49 [**Shede**], 50 Lock, 51 [Shede], 52 Lock — 53 **Sib**, 54 Lock — 55 **Beal**, 56 Lock — 57 **Thunder**, 58 Lock, 59 Thunder, 60 Lock, 61 Thunder, 62 Lock, 63 Thunder, 64–65 Lock

The poem begins with two prose passages (P1–P2), the first one connecting to the previous poem, *Hym* and introducing the gods and their banquet, the second one describing the immediate events leading up to the poem, Lock's wanton killing of one of the servants.

Lock meets the servant Elder outside and asks him of what the Eese are speaking at the banquet (1). Elder answers that they speak of their prowess and splendid arms, and in no way favourably about Lock (2). Lock declares that he will go inside to insult the Eese (3). Elder warns him that he will regret it, (4) but Lock insults his intellect (5) and goes inside (P3).

Lock greets the Gods sarcastically and asks for a drink (6). When they ignore him he tells them to make a choice: either to invite him to sit or to drive him away (7). Bray answers and tells him that they will never let him drink (8), but Lock ignores him and turns to Weden, calling to mind a blood-oath between them (9). Weden, acknowledging the oath, asks his son Wider to give Lock a drink and let him sit (10). He does (P4).

Lock now begins his insults, first turning to Bray (11). From Lock's insult of Bray in st. 11 until Thunder's arrival in P7 the poem has a very regular structure. Lock and a god take turns insulting each other for one or two pairs of stanzas before another god comes to the defense of the previous one and becomes the new target for Lock's insults. There is no point in summarising the insults beyond the overview of speakers above, although it may be noted that Lock's insults towards the Gods are considerably more creative than those towards the Goddesses, which almost exclusively consist of accusations of adultery.

Immediately after Lock mentions Thunder (54) his arrival is heralded (55), and he arrives (P7). Thunder and Lock take turns (sts. 57–63), before Lock is at last forced to yield as he knows that Thunder alone will break the law of non-violence even inside the hall (64). Lock curses the Eese and Eagre one last time and departs (65). After this the prose tells us that Lock hid himself in a river in the shape of a salmon, but was eventually caught and bound upon three sharp stones with a venomous serpent set above his face to torment him. When he writhed from the pain the whole earth shook in what is now known as earth-quakes (P8).

## Text

## Frá Égi ok goðum ('From Eage and the Gods')

- P1      Égir, er qðru nafni hét Gymer, hann hafði búit ósum ǫl þá er  
 2      hann hafði fengit ketil inn mikla sem nú er sagt. Til þeirar veit-  
 slu kom Óðinn ok Frigg kona hans. Þórr kom eigi því at hann var  
 4      í austr-vegi. Sif var þar, kona Þórs; Bragi, ok Iðunn kona hans.  
 Týr var þar, hann var ein-hendr; Fenrisulfr sleit hönd af hánum,  
 6      þá er hann var bundinn. Þar var Njörðr ok kona hans Skaði;  
 Freyr ok Freyja; Víð-arr son Óðins. Loki var þar, ok þjónustu-  
 8      menn Freys, Byggvir ok Beyla. Mart var þar ása ok alfa.

EAGE, who by another name was called Gymer—he had prepared an ale-feast for the Eese when he had got the great kettle as was just told. To that gathering came Woden and Frie his wife. Thunder came not, for he was on the Eastern Way. Sib was there, Thunder's wife; Bray and Idin, his wife. Tew was there. He was one-handed; the Fenrerswolf tore his hand from him when it was bound. Nearth was there and his wife Shede, Free and Frow, Wider the son of Woden. Lock was there and the servants of Free, Bew and Beal. In that place there was a multitude of Eese and Elves.

---

2 sem nú er sagt 'as was just told' | In immediately preceding *Hym*.

5–6 Fenrisulfr sleit hönd af hánum, þá er hann var bundinn 'the Fenrerswolf tore his hand off when it was bound' | This detail is presumably brought up on the basis of sts. 38–39; for the myth see there.

- P2      Égir átti tvá þjónustu-menn, Fima-fengr ok Eldir. Þar var lýsi-  
 2      gull haft fyr elds-ljós; sjálft bar=sk þar ǫl. Þar var griða-stadr  
 mikill. Menn lofuðu mjök hversu góðir þjónustu-menn Égis  
 4      vóru. Loki mátti eigi heyra þat, ok drap hann Fima-feng. Þá  
 skóku ésir skjöldu sína ok óptu at Loka, ok eltu hann braut til  
 6      skógar, en þeir fóru at drekka. Loki hvarf aptr ok hitti úti Eldi;  
 Loki kvaddi hann:

Eage had two servants, Femfinger and Elder. In that place glowing gold was used instead of fire; the ale there carried itself. It was a great place of griths. The folk greatly praised how good the servants of Eage were. Lock could not stand to hear that and he slew Femfinger. Then the Eese shook their shields and screamed at Lock and chased him away to the woods, but they went to drink. Lock turned back and hit upon Elder outside. Lock greeted him:

---

2 gríða-stadr ‘place of griths’ | A *gríðr* ‘grith’ being a form of temporary truce of non-violence (LMNL, s.v. *gríð*). The *gríða-stadr* was thus a place wherein all violence was forbidden, as was typical in shrines (wighs) and at legal assemblies (Things). This detail is important for the narrative, since it explains why Lock can insult the Gods without repercussions for most of the poem.

4–5 Þá skóku ęsir skjöldu sína ok óptu ‘Then the Eese shook their shields and screamed’ | Apparently in some sort of ancient war dance. Cf. the Old Swedish Heathen Law: *ópr hann þrý ní-óp* ‘He screams three nothing-screams TODO’.

### Loka senna (‘The Flying of Lock’)

1 „Sęg þú þat, Ełdir, · svá’t ęinu=gi  
2 fęti gangir framarr,  
hvat hér inni · hafa at ęl-mólum  
4 sig-tíva synir.“

[R 15r/17]

“TELL THIS, ELDER, so that thou not  
takest one step further:  
What here within they say over their ale,  
the sons of the victory-Tews.”

1–2 svá’t ... framarr ‘so that ... further’ | Shared with *Háv* 38.

3 hafa at ęl-mólum ‘they say over the ale’ | Lit. “they have for their ale-speeches”.

4 sig-tíva synir ‘sons of the victory-Tews’ | The gods, the ‘sons of the Gods’ [= the Gods] being a common kenning-type.

Ełdir: 2 „Of vępn sín dęma · ok of víg-risni sína  
2 sig-tíva synir;  
ása ok alfa, · es hér inni eru,  
4 mann=gi ’s þér í orði vinr.“

[R 15r/18]

Quoth Elder: “Of their weapons they speak and of their battle-prowess,  
the sons of the victory-Tews.  
Of the Eese and Elves which are here within  
none is thee a friend in words.”

4 mann=gi ’s þér í orði vinr. ‘none is thee a friend in words.’ | I.e., ‘nobody says anything good about you’.

Something may be said about the alliteration in this line and also in 10/1 below (*Víð-arr* : *ulfr*). It is unambiguous in both instances that the semi-vowel *v* (/w/) is participating in vowel-alliteration with *a*, something occasionally allowed in Norse Eddic poems but never in Norse Scaldic or West Germanic poetry. These are however the only occurrences of this type of alliteration in *Lok* (cf. st. 36/4 below). An intriguing explanation is if the alliteration originally fell exclusively on *v*-. This is possible due to the fact that in both the present st. and 10/1 the vowel-words *orð* ‘word’ and *ulfr* ‘wolf’ originally began with *v*- (PN \**worda*, \**wulfar*), which in the case of *ulfr* is attested in archaic runic inscriptions. For metrical reasons *Lok* must postdate the syncope of unstressed short vowels in some positions, but on the basis of the three closely related 7th c. runestones from Blekinge (DR 357 Stentofthen, DR 358 Gummarp, DR 359 Istaby) this syncope is known to predate the loss of *w* before rounded vowels (e.g. DR 359 *hǫpwwulafir* *Hǫpu-wul<sup>a</sup>fir*).

If we look away from the possibility of pure coincidence, which is not impossible, there are two explanations. The first is that *Lok* was in fact composed in the 7th or perhaps 8th c. when the semi-vowel was still retained; certainly the poem has archaic features (see Dating above), but this is extremely daring. A more likely explanation is that the alliteration reflects archaic poetic formulae or perhaps a vague intuition that only certain vowel-words should alliterate with *v*-. The fact that West Germanic does not allow alliteration between vowels and *w*- suggests that this license most likely arose in North Germanic following the loss of *w*- before rounded vowels, and an intuition for which pairs felt ‘right’ would likely have existed in the earliest period of composition following this change. In any case this seems to be yet another argument for an early date of *Lok*, for which cf. also 15/3 n. below.

In the C7th the Proto-Norse form of this line would have been \**mann-gí* 3 *þér in worðé winir*.

Loki kvað: 3 „Inn skal ganga · *Ēgis* hallir ĩ  
2 á þat sumbl at *séa*,  
*jǫll* ok *ǫfu* · *fóri*’k *ása* sonum  
4 ok blænd’k þeim svá *męini* *mjoð*.“

[R 15r/20]

Quoth Lock: “I shall go into Eagre’s halls,  
on that simble for to see.  
Scorn and hatred I bring the sons of the Eese,  
and so I mix their mead with evil.”

2 sumbl ‘simble’ | The Germanic word for “feast, banquet”.

3 *jǫll* ok *ǫfu* ‘scorn and hatred’ | Two rare words to which the present translation hardly does justice. The former occurs nowhere else, while the latter only otherwise occurs in *Sigsk* 33. They have been interpreted in a variety of ways: CV sees the first word as *jǫll* ‘wild angelica’, whereas the second is taken to be an error for *áfr* (“a beverage [...] translated by Magnaeus by *sorbitio avenacea*, a sort of common ale brewed of oats”). TODO: What do other editors say? Esp. Kommentar.

4 blænd’k ... *męini* *mjoð* ‘I mix ... mead with evil’ | Formulaic, cf. *Sigrðr* 8 (and others TODO).

Ēldir kvað: 4 „Vęitst, ef inn gęngr · *Ēgis* hallir ĩ  
2 á þat sumbl at *séa*,  
*hrópi* ok *rógi* · ef *ęyss* á *holl* ręgin,  
4 á þér munu þau þerra þat.“

[R 15r/22]

Quoth Elder: “Thou knowest, if thou goest into Eagre’s halls,  
on that simble for to see—  
if slander and strife thou pourest on the hold Reins,  
on *thee* will they dry it off!”

Loki kvað: 5 „Veitst þat **E**ldir, · ef **e**inir skulum [R 15r/24]  
 2 sár-yrðum saka=sk,  
 auðigr verða · mun'k í and-svorum,  
 4 ef þú mēlir til mart!“

Quoth Lock: “Thou knowest, Elder, if one-on-one we shall  
 bandy wounding words,  
 wealthy will I in my answers grow  
 if thou speak too much!”

---

2 sár-yrðum saka=sk ‘bandy wounding words’ | Reoccurring at st. 19/2.

4 ef þú mēlir til mart! ‘if thou speak too much!’ | Formulaic; cf. *Háv* 27.

P3 Síðan gekk Loki inn í holl'ina; en er þeir sá, er fyrir váru, hverr [R 15r/25]  
 2 inn var kominn, þögnuðu þeir allir.

Thereafter Lock went into the hall, but when those who were within saw  
 who had come inside they all turned silent.

Loki kvað: 6 „Þyrstr ek kom · þessar hallar til [R 15r/27]  
 2 Loptr of langan veg,  
 ֆsu at biðja, · at mér **e**inn gefi  
 4 mēran drykk mjaðar.

Quoth Lock: “Thirsty I came to these halls,  
 Loft (= Lock), over a long way,  
 to bid the Eese that they give me but one  
 famed drink of mead.

---

4 mēran drykk mjaðar ‘famed drink of mead’ | Formulaic language for describing mead; cf. *Háv* 105, 140, *Ski* 16. TODO: more parallels.

7 Hví þegið ér svá · þrungen goð, [R 15r/28]  
 2 at mēla né mēguð;  
 sessa ok staði · velið mér sumbli at,  
 4 eða hēitið mik heðan!“

Why shut ye up so, ye pressed Gods,  
 that ye cannot speak?  
 Choose seats and places for me at the simble,  
 or call me away hence!”

---

3–4 sessa ... heðan! ‘Choose ... hence!’ | That is, “Cease your dallying; give me a seat or tell me to leave!”

Bragi: 8 „Sessa ok staði · vęlja þér sumbli at

[R 15r/30]

2 ęsir aldri=gi;

því't ęsir vitu · hveim alda skulu

4 gamban-sumbl of geta.“

Bray: “Choose seats and places for thee at the simble  
the Eese will never do,  
for the Eese know for which man they shall  
prepare the gomben-simble.”

---

3 hveim alda ‘which man’ | Here “person, being”. See note to *Vafþ* 55/6.

4 gamban-sumbl ‘gomben-simble’ | *gamban-* ‘gomben-’ being an obscure prefix which apart from the present instance also occurs in *Ski* 32, 33 and *Hárb* 20. CV suggest it means something like ‘costly’, but most editors connect it with magic.

[Loki:] 9 „Mant þat Óðinn, · es vit í ár-daga

[R 15r/32]

2 blendum blóði saman?

ęlvi þęrgja · lét=sk ęigi mundu,

4 nema okkr vęri bōðum borit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Recallest thou, Weden, when we in days of yore  
blended our blood together?  
Thou didst declare thou wouldst ne’er taste ale,  
unless it were for us both borne forth!”

---

ALL | Lock turns to Weden, chief of the Eese, and reminds him of an oath of blood-brotherhood the two undertook in the early days of the world. The circumstances of this oath are otherwise entirely unknown.

[Óðinn:] 10 „Rís þá Við·arr · ok lát ulfs fōður

[R 15r/34]

2 sitja sumbli at,

síðr oss Loki · kvęði lasta-stōfum

4 Ęgis hollu í.“

[Quoth Weden:] “Then rise, Wider, and let the Wolf’s father [= Lock]  
sit at the simble,  
lest Lock address us with words of blame  
in Eagre’s hall.”

---

1 Rís þá Við·arr · ok lát ulfs fōður ‘Then rise, Wider, and let the Wolf’s father’ | For the alliteration see note to st. 2/4. In the C7th the Proto-Norse form of this line would have been \**Rís þan Wíðarr · auk lát wulfs fōður*.

P4 Þá stóð Við·arr upp ok skenkti Loka, en áðr hann drykki, kvaddi  
2 hann ósu’na:

[R 15v/1]

Then Wider stood up and poured a drink to Lock, but before he [= Lock] drank, he greeted the Eese:

- 11 „Heilir **ę**sir, · heilar **ę**synjur [R 15v/3]  
 2 ok ęll ginn-heiļęę **ę**ęđ,  
 nema sá **ę**inn **ę**ss · es innar sitr  
 4 **B**ragi **b**ękkjum á.“  
 “Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens,  
 and all yin-holy Gods!  
 But for that one os who sits further within:  
 Bray, upon the benches.”

ALL | The first line is identical to the prayer in *Sigrđr* 4. An intriguing possibility suggests itself, viz. that this formula for hailing the Gods may actually have been used in Heathen drinking-toasts, where the second helming (ll. 3–4) would follow the hailing by asking for gifts. If this is the case it would greatly increase the dramatic effect of Lock’s insult in ll. 3–4, since he, instead of asking for a boon, subverts the prayer by insulting one of the gods present, something that would have been come off as shocking to the Heathen audience expecting a typical prayer.

- [Bragi] kvađ: 12 „Mar ok **m**ęki · gef’k þér **m**íns féar [R 15v/4]  
 2 ok **b**ótir þér svá **b**augi Bragi,  
 síđr þú **ę**sum · **ę**fund of gįaldir;  
 4 **ę**řem þú **ę**igi **ę**ęđ at þér!“  
 Quoth [Bray]: “Steed and sword I give thee of my own wealth  
 and so Bray restores thee with a bigh,  
 lest thou with envy repay the Eese;  
 anger not the Gods against thee!”

1 Mar ok męki ‘Steed and sword’ | Formulaic pair; cf. *Háv* 83/2.

2 bótir þér svá baugi ‘restores thee with a bigh’ | Cf. the comment in *Hárđ* 42.

- [Loki] kvađ: 13 „Jós ok **a**rm-bauga · munt **ę** vesa [R 15v/6]  
 2 **b**ęggja vanr Bragi,  
 ása ok **a**lfá, · es hér inni eru,  
 4 þú est við **v**íg **v**arastr,  
 ok **s**kįarrastr við **s**kot.“  
 Quoth [Lock]: “Of horse and arm-bighs wilt thou always be  
 both lacking, Bray!  
 Of the Eese and Elves which are here within  
 thou art wariest of war  
 and shiest of shot.”

- [Bragi] kvað: 14 „Vei't'k, ef fyr útan véra'k, · svá sem fyr innan em'k, [R 15v/8]  
 2 Égis höll of kominn,  
 höfuð þitt · béra'k í hendi mér;  
 4 lít\*'k þér þat fyr lygi.“

Quoth [Bray]: “I know if I were without, as I am within  
 come into Eagre's hall,  
 that head of thine would I hold in my hands;  
 this I see for thy lie.”

1 fyr | 'pyr' R 4 lít\*'k þér þat fyr lygi | 'litt ec þer þat fyr lygi' R

1 Vei't'k, ef fyr útan véra'k, · svá sem fyr innan em'k 'I know if I were without, as I am within' | As said in P1, the law of grith (a legally binding pact or pledge of non-violence, even between enemies) applies inside the hall, and Bray and the other gods are bound by it not to injure Lock.

2 Égis höll of kominn | The alliteration in this line is highly questionable since the particle *of* is otherwise always unstressed, let alone subject to alliteration. Any metrical investigation should exclude it as likely corrupt.

4 lít\*'k þér þat fyr lygi | In the ms. 'tt' (in 'litt') is written with a single *t* with a small dot above which marks it out as doubled. I see this abbreviation as an erroneous insertion. A variety of other emendations have been proposed for this line, e.g. *litt es þér þat fyr lygi* 'that is little [punishment] for thee for lying'. Based on the similarity of *ē* (= *tt*) and *c* Finnur Jónsson (1932) gives *lyka'k þér þat fyr lygi* 'that I would bring thee for thy lie'.

- [Loki] kvað: 15 „Snjallr est í sessi, · skal=at-tu svá gera, [R 15v/10]  
 2 Bragi þekk-skrautuðr;  
 vega þú gakk · ef vręiðr séir;  
 4 hygg=sk vętr hvatr fyrir.“

Quoth [Lock]: “Valiant art thou in the seat. Thou shalt not do so,  
 Bray the bench-adorned!  
 Go to strike if thou art wroth;  
 the bold thinks not ahead.”

ALL | Lock calls out Bray's excuse. A truly brave (*hvatr*) man would break even the grith to avenge such a severe personal insult, as Thunder indeed is willing to do (st. 64 below).

3 vega ... vręiðr 'strike ... wroth' | Formulaic, the alliterative word-pair *vega* : *vręiðr* otherwise also occurs in *Fáfn* 7/2, 17/2, 30/2, *Sigrdr* 25/2. — The restoration of *v-* before *r* is required by the meter, likewise at 18/4, 27/4. This is an archaic feature; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n.

- [Íðunn] kvað: 16 „Bið'k þik, Bragi, · barna-sifjar duga [R 15v/11]  
 2 ok allra ósk-maga,  
 at þú Loka · kvęðir=a lasta-stofum  
 4 Égis höllu í.“

Quoth [Ídin]: “I bid thee, Bray, to suit the ties of children  
 and all adopted sons,



that thou not address Lock with words of blame  
in Eagre's hall.”

1 þik ‘thee’ | *sens. emend.; om. R*

[Loki] kvað: 17 „Þegi þú, Iðunn, · þik kveð’k allra kvinna  
2 ver-gjarnasta vesa  
síðst þú arma þína · lagðir ítr-þvegna  
4 umb þínn bróður-bana.“

[R 15v/13]

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Idin! I call thee of all women  
the most man-eager,  
since thou didst lay thy brightly washed arms  
around thy brother’s bane.”

[Iðunn] kvað: 18 „Loka ek kveð’k=a · lasta-stofum  
2 Égis hollu í;  
Braga ek kyrrri · bjór-reifan,  
4 vil’k=at at it vreiðir vegi=sk.“

[R 15v/15]

Quoth [Idin]: “I do not address Lock with words of blame  
in Eagre’s hall;  
I do calm Bray, made rowdy from beer—  
I wish not that ye two, wrath, should fight.”

ALL | Idin tries to calm the argument by pointing out that she did not address Lock, but her own husband, Bray.

[Geðfun] kvað: 19 „Hví it ęsir tveir · skuluð inni hér  
2 sár-yrðum saka=sk?  
Lopt\*-ki þat veit · at hann leiðinn es  
4 ok hann fjörg ęll f\*ía.

[R 15v/16]

Quoth [Yiven]: “Why shall ye two Eese here within  
bandy wounding words?  
Loft (= Lock) knows not that he is crazed,  
and all the Farrows (= Gods) hate him.”

3 Lopt\*-ki | ‘lopci’ R 4 fjörg ęll ‘all the Farrows’ | ‘fiorgvall’ R. 4 f\*ía ‘hate’ | fria R

ALL | By reading l. 3a *lopci þat veit* as an impersonal construct, adopting the sense ‘playful’ of l. 3b *leiðinn* and not emending l. 4 *fria* the rhetorical function of the stanza has been understood by some editors (e.g. Sijmons and Gering (1927, p. 286), Pettit (2023)) as Yiven’s attempt to play down Lock’s insults: “Is it not well known that Lock is playful and that all the Gods love him?” Yet in the context of the narrative this can hardly be accurate, since Lock has already killed a servant and insulted both Bray and Idin.

3 Lopt\*-ki þat vëit ‘Lof knows not’ | For the rare poetic construction where a verb is negated by suffixing -gi ‘not, no’ to the stem of the subject cf. sts. 29/4 and 39/3 below. — Sijmons and Gering (1927, p. 286), Pettit (2023), and others here read an impersonal construction ‘is it not known about Lock’, etc.

3 leikinn ‘crazed’ | This word typically occurs in the sense ‘playful’ but the sense ‘bewitched’, here understood as ‘crazed’, is attested in ON; cf. *Vsp* 21/3 and *Prestsaga Guðmundar góða* 19 in *Sturlunga* (*leikinn af flagði einu* ‘bewitched by a certain trollwoman’).

4 fjorg ǫll ‘all the Farrows’ | ‘*fjorgvall*’ is taken as an error for ‘*fjorg avll*’, norm. *fjorg ǫll*. Mezger (1944)’s suggestion of a masc. acc. pl. *fjorgu alla* is metrically impossible and leaves the verb without a subject.

*fjorg* ‘Farrows’ (sg. *fjarg*) is a rare and archaic (pantheistic) neuter term for the Gods most likely derived from PGmc. \**ferga* ‘vital forces(?)’, related to the root of \**ferbuq* ‘body, life-force’ (> ON *fjor* ‘id.’). The term has no direct equivalents in other Gmc. languages, but the related word \**ferbuq* is found in the name of the Roman-era Germanic goddesses, the *Alaferbviae* (< PGmc. \**ala-firbuwizōz* ‘all-life giving ones(?)’), as attested on Latin-inscribed altars from the Rhineland (TODO: cite). ON *fjarg* is never otherwise used as a simplex, but it does appear in the cpds. *fjarg-bús* ‘god-house(?)’ (*Akv* 43/4, 46/3) and *fjarg-vefr* ‘god-weave, silk’ (ÞKolb Lv 12 in SkP 5; a poetic variant of *gōð-vefr* ‘id.’), the latter of which confirms that its sense is ‘god’. It is also found in a few additional cpds. in modern Icelandic (Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *fjarg*-).

4 f\*ía ‘hate’ | *fria* means ‘love’ but is emended to its antonym *fia* ‘hate’ since the statement that all the Gods love Lock can hardly be defended when he has already killed one of their servants and it is only very reluctantly that they let him back in. Cf. *Hym* 22 for the Gods’ hatred of one of Lock’s children, the Middenyardswyrm.

[Loki] kvað: 20 „Þegi þú, Gefjun, · þess mun’k nú geta  
2 es þik glapði at gæði:  
svæinn inn hvíti · es þér sigli gaf  
4 ok þú lagðir lér yfir.“

[R 15v/18]

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Yiven! *Him* will I now mention,  
who seduced thy senses:  
the white-hued swain who gave thee a necklace,  
and thou laidest o’er him thy leg!”

ALL. | The truth of the insult is questionable since Yiven is said to be a virgin. So *Gylf* 35:5: *Fjórða er Gefjun. Hón er mér, ok henni þjóna þér, er meyar anda-sk.* ‘The fourth [goddess] is Yiven. She is a maiden and those women serve her who die as maidens.’

3 sigli ‘necklace’ | A very rare poetic word ultimately derived from Latin *sigillum*. It only occurs in two other places in the Old Norse corpus: *Sigs*k 49/3 and *KormQ* Lv 56 (SkP 5).

4 lagðir lér yfir ‘laidest o’er him thy leg’ | A cynical variant of *Háv* 108/4 (*lögð-umk arm yfir*).

[Óðinn kvað] þat: 21 „Örr est, Loki, · ok ör-viti,  
2 es þú fër þér Gefjun at græmi  
því’t aldar ör-lög · hygg at ǫll of viti  
4 jafn-gr=la sem ek.“

[R 15v/20]

This [quoth Woden]: “Mad art thou, Lock, and out of thy wits  
when thou rousest Yiven’s wrath against thee,

for all the orlays of men I think she knows  
quite as clearly as I.”

1 Örr ... ok ör-viti ‘Mad ... and out of thy wits’ | Formulaic line, also occurring in 2 *HHund* 34 and *Oddr* 15. Cf. also st. 47 and G1 below.

[Loki] kvað: 22 „Þegi þú, Óðinn, · þú kunnir aldri=gi [R 15v/22]  
2 dęila víg með verum;  
opt þú gaft · þeim’s gefa skyldir=a,  
4 inum slévvurum, sigr.“

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Weden! Thou couldst never  
deal out war amidst men—  
oft thou gavest to those thou shouldst not have given,  
to the duller men victory.”

[Óðinn] kvað: 23 „Vęitst ef ek gaf · þeim’s gefa né skylda, [R 15v/24]  
2 inum slévvurum, sigr,  
átta vetr · vast fyrir jörð neðan  
4 kýr mólkandi ok kona  
ok hęfir þar bęrn of borit  
6 ok hugða’k þat args aðal.“

Quoth [Weden]: “Thou knowest, if I gave to to those I should not have given,  
to the duller men victory,  
for eight winters wast thou beneath the earth  
a milch cow and a woman,  
and there hast thou borne children,  
and I’ve judged that a queer’s nature!”

5 *bęrn of* | *sens. and metr. emend.* (cf. st. 33/4 below); *om. R*

4 kýr mólkandi ‘a milch cow’ | This phrase may also be read as “milking cows”, the form *kýr* being grammatically ambiguous between nom. sg. and acc. pl., and *mólka* meaning both ‘to milk’ and ‘to give milk’. “Milch cow” (cows, of course, only giving milk after calving) is preferable for several reasons. Firstly, the phrase is followed by *ok kona* ‘and a woman’ rather than *sem kona* ‘as a woman’ or similar; secondly, it conforms to a known pattern of insults between men where the insultee is equated with a woman and said to have been impregnated (cf. 1 *HHund*); thirdly, it agrees well with another instance where Lock shapeshifts into a female animal and gives birth, namely the episode of the building of the wall around Osyard as told in *Gylf* 42 and alluded to in *Vsp* 24–25 (n.).

[Loki] kvað: 24 „En þik síga kóðu · Sáms-ęyju í [R 15v/26]  
2 ok drapt á vett sem vǫlvur,  
vitka líki · fórt ver-þjóð yfir,  
4 ok hugða’k þat args aðal.“

Quoth [Lock]: “But thou, they said, didst sink down into Samsey,  
and didst beat on the drum like wallows.  
In a warlock’s likeness didst thou journey o’er the folk of men  
and I’ve judged that a queer’s nature!”

ALL | For Weden taking the shape of a witch or warlock cf. the story of W̥rind (V̥sp 31 n.) TODO: elaborate on the feminine nature of this type of magic.

1 Sams-eyju ‘Samsey’ | *Samso* in Denmark, which features prominently in later legendary literature. TODO: cite.

2 drapt á vett sem vǫlur ‘didst beat on the drum like wallows’ | A reference to “shaman”-like drums as attested in the later Lappish religion. TODO: elaborate.

[Frigg kvað:] 25 „Ør·løgum ykkrum · skylið aldri=gi [R 15v/28]  
2 seǵja seǵgjum frá,  
hvat it ǣsir tveir · drýgðuð í ár-daga;  
4 firri=sk é forn røk firar.“

[Quoth Frie:] “Of your orlays should ye two never  
speak to the youth.  
Whatsoever ye two Eese did in days of yore,  
let ancient tales be ever shunned by folk.”

[Loki kvað:] 26 „Þegi þú, Frigg, · þú est Fjörgyns mér [R 15v/30]  
2 ok hefir é ver-gjörn vesit,  
es þa Vea ok Vilja · létst þér, Viðris kvæn,  
4 báða í baðm of tækit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Frie! Thou art Fírgyn’s maiden  
and hast always been eager for men,  
[like] when thou Wigh and Will—O Withrer’s wife—  
both in thy bosom didst take.”

3 Vea ok Vilja ‘Will and Wigh’ | Weden’s brothers. The event alluded to here is a myth where Weden is exiled from the Eese and his wife, Frie, instead marries his two brothers. So *Yng 3: Óðinn átti tvá bróðr, hét annarr Vē, en annarr Vili; þeir bróðr hans stýrðu ríki’nu, þá er hann var í brottu. Þat var eitt sinn, þá er Óðinn var farinn langt í brott ok hafði lengi dvaltst, at þsum þótti ør-vént hans heim; þá tóku bróðr hans at skipta arfi bans, en konu bans Frigg géngu þeir báðir at eiga. En litlu síðar kom Óðinn heim, tók hann þá við konu sinni.* ‘Weden had two brothers; one was called Wigh, the other Will. Those brothers of his ruled the realm when he was departed. It was one time when Weden had journeyed far away and had tarried for long that the Eese thought his homecoming unlikely. Then his brothers took to divide his inheritance, but his wife Frie they both went to own. But a short while later Weden came home; then he took back his wife.’

[Frigg kvað:] 27 „Veitst ef inni ǣtta’k · Égis hollum í [R 15v/32]  
2 Baldri líkan bur  
út né kvæmir · frá asa sonum

4 ok véri þá at þér *vreiðum* *vegit*.”

[Quoth Frie:] “Thou knowest, if I had within Eagre’s halls  
a boy like Balder,  
thou camest out from the sons of the Eese,  
and wouldst, wroth man, be fought!”

[Loki kvað:] **28** „Enn vill þú, *Frigg*, · at ek *fleiri* telja  
2 *mína* *męin*-stafi:  
ek því *réd* · es þú *ríða* sér=at  
4 *síðan* Baldr at *sólum*.”

[R 16r/1]

[Quoth Lock:] “Still wilt thou, Frie, that I recount more  
of my evil deeds:  
It was my doing that thou dost not henceforth see  
Balder ride to the halls.”

ALL | Lock caused the death of Balder, as alluded to in *Vsp* 31–33 (see note there) and *Bdr* 8–11 and described in depth in *Gylf* 49. It is probably this admission of guilt that seals Lock’s fate.

[Fręyja kvað:] **29** „*Örr* est, *Loki*, · es þú *yðra* telr  
2 *ljóta* *leið*-stafi;  
*ør*-lög *Frigg* · hygg at *qll* viti  
4 þó’tt hön *sjölf*=gi *segi*.”

[R 16r/3]

[Quoth Frow:] “Mad art thou, Lock, when thou dost recount  
your ugly, loathsome deeds!  
All orlays I think Frie knows,  
though she says them not herself.”

[Loki kvað:] **30** „Þegi þú, *Fręyja*, · þik kann’k *full*-gørva;  
2 es=a þér *vamma* *vant*:  
*ása* ok *alfa*, · es hér *inni* eru,  
4 *hvęrr* hęfir þínn *hór* vesit.”

[R 16r/4]

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Frow! I know thee full well—  
thou art not free of blemishes.  
Of the Eese and Elves which are here within  
each has been thy lover!”

ALL | For Frow’s promiscuity cf. *Þrk* 13/4 n.

2 vamma vant ‘free of blemishes’ | Formulaic, cf. *Háv* 22/4: *bann es-a vamma vanr* ‘he is not free of blemishes’.

[Fręyja kvað:] **31** „*Fló* ’s þér *tunga*, · hygg at þér *fręmr* *myni*

[R 16r/6]

2                    ð·gótt of gala;  
                     vrēiðir 'ro þér ęsir · ok ęsynjur,  
 4                    hryggr munt hęim fara.“

[Quoth Frow:] “False is thy tongue, I think it further will  
                     sing evil [into being] for thee.  
 Wroth with thee are the Eese and the Ossens:  
                     grieved wilt thou journey home.”

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1 myni | ‘mý’ R

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ALL | Frow foresees the future and makes a prophecy. Lock will come to regret his insults.

1 Fló’s þér tunga ‘False is thy tongue’ | Cf. *Háv* 118/3: *flá-rþō tunga* ‘false-counseling tongue’.

2 ð·gótt of gala; ‘sing evil [into being] for thee’ | The same expression is found in *Háv* 29/4, which also advises keeping one’s tongue in check.

Loki: 32    „Þęgi þú, Fręyja, · þú est for-dęða  
                     ok męini blandin mjøk,  
                     síðst-u at bróðr þínum · siðu blíð ręgin  
 4                      ok myndir þá, Fręyja, frata.“

[R 16r/8]

Lock: “Shut up, Frow! Thou art an evil-working woman,  
                     and mixed with much evil,  
                     since towards thy brother the blithe Reins bewitched thee  
                     and then wouldst thou, O Frow, fart.”

---

ALL | Lock accuses Frow of committing incest with her brother (Free) while bewitched by the Gods. Incest between siblings is particularly associated with the family of Nearth; cf. how Nearth is said to have begotten Free by his sister in st. 36 below.

3 blíð ręgin ‘the blithe Reins’ | A reverent formulaic epithet for the Gods, here used blasphemously. It otherwise occurs in *Gm* 6/1, 38/3 and 42/1. For another instance of Lock sarcastically using reverent language cf. st. 11/1–2 above.

4 þá ‘then’ | In the act of (incestual) coitus, an especially graphic insult.

Njorðr: 33    „Þat ’s vó-lítit · þó’tt sér varðir vers fái,  
                     hós eða hvárs;  
                     hitt ’s undr, es ęss ragr · es hér inn of kominn  
 4                      ok hęfir sá bęrn of borit.“

[R 16r/10]

Nearth: “It is little woe that women get themselves a man,  
                     a lover or whomever else,  
                     on the other hand it is a wonder when a queer Os has come here within,  
                     and that man has borne children!”

Loki: 34    „Þęgi þú, Njorðr, · þú vast austr heðan

[R 16r/12]

2                    gísl of sęndr at goðum;  
                     Hymis meýjar · hoðou þik at hlant-trogi  
 4                    ok þér í munn migu.“

Lock: “Shut up, Nearth! Thou wast to the east hence  
               sent as hostage for the Gods.  
               Hymer’s daughters had thee for a lant-trough  
               and pissed thee in the mouth!”

---

ALL | For Nearth as a hostage cf. *Vafþ* 39.

Njorðr: 35        „Sú es=umk líkn · es vas’k langt heðan  
                     gísl of sęndr at goðum:  
                     þá ek mög gat · þann’s mann=gi fiar,  
                     ok þikkir sá asa jaðarr.“

[R 16r/14]

Nearth: “This is my relief since I was far-away hence  
               sent as hostage for the Gods,  
               when I begot the lad whom no man hates  
               and he seems the peak of the Eese.”

---

3 mög ... þann’s mann=gi fiar ‘the lad whom no man hates’ | Free.

Loki: 36        „Hętt-u nú, Njorðr, · haf á hófi þik;  
                     mun’k=a því leyra lengr:  
                     við systur þínni · gatst s-líkan mög,  
                     ok es=a þó vęnu verr.“

[R 16r/16]

Lock: “Cease now, Nearth; restrain thyself!  
               I will no longer hide it:  
               by thy own sister didst thou beget such a lad  
               and naught can be expected worse.”

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4 vęnu | ónu R.

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4 ok es=a þó vęnu verr | R’s ónu is dat. sg. of *vęn* ‘expectation’ with fronting of nasal *ę* > *ó* and loss of *v* before *o*. This fronting, which is an irregular sound change often flattened by analogy, can be tracked in Scaldic poetry using the name *Ó-leifr* ~ *Ó-láfr* ‘Anlaf’ (< Proto-Norse \**Anu-laitbar*) with a nasal root vowel. In Scaldic poetry the earliest instance of the name forming an ethelending with *ó* rather than an *á* or *ę* is from c. 1070 AD, Steinn *Óldr* 5/4b: *Ó-láfr borinn sólu* (SkP 2). Since *Lok* is undoubtedly older than 1070 (see Dating above) it is justified to restore *vęnu*.

Týr: 37        „Fręyr ’s bętstr · allra ball-riða  
                     asa goðoum í;  
                     meý né grótrir · né manns konu,

[R 16r/17]

4 ok leysir ór hǫptum hvern.“

Tew: “Free is the best of all bold riders  
in the Yards of the Eese;  
he makes no maiden weep nor any man’s woman,  
and loosens each from his bonds!”

2 ása gǫrðum ‘the Yards of the Eese’ | I.e., Otyard.

Loki: 38 „Þegi þú, Týr, · þú kunnir aldri=gi  
2 bera tilt með tveim;  
handar ennar hógri · mun’k hinnar geta  
4 es þér sleit Fennir frá.“

[R 16r/19]

Lock: “Shut up, Tew! Thou couldst never  
settle strife between two;  
the right hand will I mention next,  
which from thee Fenner tore.”

2 bera tilt með tveim ‘settle strife between two’ | Lit. ‘carry conciliatory [words] between two.’ This statement appears to be what Snorre alludes to in *Gylf* 25:12: *ok er hann ein-bendr ok ekki kallaðr settir manna* ‘and he is one-handed, and not called a reconciler of men’. The sense seems to be that Tew’s one-handedness is also the reason why he, as a war god, cannot grant equal victory to both sides. — *tilt* ‘conciliatory [words]’ is a hapax, n. acc. sg. of \**tilr*, cognate with OE *til* ‘good, upstanding’, Gothic *ga-tils* ‘fitting, convenient’. The use of this old Germanic word in the poem is undoubtedly an archaism.

3–4 handar ... frá. ‘the right ... tore.’ | A reference to a myth told in *Gylf* 25:9–12 and at greater length in *Gylf* 34:10–42. Lock begat three children with the ettin-woman Angerbode, one of which was the Fennerwolf. It grew quickly and Tew alone was brave enough to feed it. When the spæ of the Eese foretold that the Wolf would be of great harm to them they resolved to bind it. They twice tried to make fetters and convinced the Wolf to prove its strength by breaking them, yet both times it did so. At last they made the great fetter Glapner (for which cf. *Eddbr* VIII), but the Wolf was clever and understood that it would not be able to break it. The Gods promised to release him even if he could not break it, but the Wolf did not trust them and as a pledge of their honesty he asked one of them to place his hand in his mouth. Only Tew dared to do so. When the Wolf could not break the fetter he knew that he had been tricked, and so he bit off his hand. After this the Eese dragged the Wolf deep into a cave and bound him there to a great stone; in his mouth they stuck a sword so that he could not bite. The wolf drooled, and thereof flowed the great river named Ween, and in the cave he shall lie until the Twilight of the Reins. For the difference between Garm and the Fennerwolf, if such a one originally existed, see *Vsp* 43/1–2.

Týr: 39 „Handar em’k vanr · en þú hróðrs vitnis;  
2 bǫl es þeggja þráa;  
ulf=gi hefir ok vel · es í þondum skal  
4 biða ragna røkrs.“

[R 16r/21]

Tew: “A hand am I missing, but thou the Famous Wolf;  
both yearnings are a bale!  
Nor does the Wolf have it well which in its bonds  
shall await the Twilight of the Reins.”



3 ulf-gi hefir ok vel · es í þöndum skal | Alliteration is absent from this otherwise metrically acceptable line and no obvious emendation suggests itself.

Loki: 40 „Þegi þú, Týr, · þat varð þínni konu [R 16r/23]  
 2 at hön átti mög við mér!  
 Qln né þenning · hafðir þess aldri=gi  
 4 van-réttis, vę-sall.“

Lock: “Shut up, Tew! It happened to thy woman  
 that she had a son by me!  
 No ell [of wool] nor penny gotst thou ever for that  
 injustice, O wretch!”

ALL | This event is entirely unsubstantiated, and Tew’s nameless wife is not known from any other source.

3 Qln ‘ell [of wool]’ | Wool, measured in ells, was often used for barter in Iceland and Norway.

3 þenning ‘penny’ | A hapax in the Poetic Edda, *þenningr* only appears thrice in Scaldic poetry. Its use by Bray the Old (*Rdr* 12) does however suggest its early presence in the language.

Fręyr: 41 „Ulf sé’k liggja · áar-ósi fyrir [R 16r/25]  
 2 und’s rjúfa=sk ręgin;  
 því munt nęst, · nema nú þęgir,  
 4 bundinn, þolva smiðr!“

Free: “The Wolf I see lying before the river-mouth  
 until the Reins are ripped;  
 there wilt thou next—unless thou now shut up—  
 be bound, O smith of bales!”

1 áar-ósi fyrir ‘before the river-mouth’ | The river Ween, which flows from the Wolf’s mouth. For Snorre’s explanation of this see st. 38/3–4 n.

2 und’s rjúfa=sk ręgin ‘until the Reins are ripped’ | During the Rakes of the Reins. Formulaic; see note to *Bdr* 14/4.

Loki: 42 „Golli kępta · létst Gymis dóttur [R 16r/26]  
 2 ok sęldir þitt svá sverð,  
 en es Mú-spells synir · ríða Myrk-við yfir  
 4 vęitst=a þá, vę-sall, hvé vęgr!“

Lock: “With gold thou hadst Gymer’s daughter [= Gird] bought,  
 and didst so sell thy sword,  
 but when Muspell’s sons ride over Mirkwood  
 then thou knowest not, O wretch, how to fight!”

ALL: | Lock alludes to the events of *Ski*: Free gave his sword to his servant Shirner and sent him on a mission to convince Gird, Gymer's daughter, to wed him. The mission was successful and Free and Gird were united, yet he did not get back his sword, for which he will suffer at his fight with Surt. See *Vsp* 51/3 n.

3 Mú-spells synir 'Muspell's sons' | See *Vsp* 49/1 n.

Byggvir: 43 „Vætist ef **øðli** **étta**'k · sem **I**ngunar-Frēyr,  
2 ok **svá** **sél**-ligt setr:  
**męrgi** smęra · **møð**a'k þá **męin**-króku  
4 ok **lęmð**a alla í **liðu**.“

[R 16r/29]

Bewer: “Thou knowest, if I had pedigree like Ingwin-Free  
and such blessed pasture—  
finer than bone-meal would I mill this harm-crow,  
and beat all his limbs lame!”

ALL: | Free's servant Bewer (*Byggvir*, < *bygg* 'barley') comes to his defence.

1 øðli 'pedigree' | Free is the son of Nearth and the legendary ancestor of the Ingling dynasty originally based at Upsel.

1 Ingunar-Frēyr 'Ingwin-Free' | A rare (probably cultic) name for the god Free, whose usual name *Frēyr* originally simply means 'Lord'.

*Ingunar*- appears to be the gen. of a name \**Ingunn* and is probably related to OE *Ing-winas* 'friends of Ing [DANES]' (*Beow* 1044, 1319) and Latin *Ingæwōnēs* 'a Germanic tribe around the North Sea' (Tacitus, *Germania* 2). It clearly contains the same root as *Yngvi* 'Ing', an earlier name for Free found in the Clst male given name *Inguiomerus* (Tacitus, *Annals* 1.60, 1.68, 2.17 etc.), the ON compound *Yngvi-Frēyr* 'Ing-Free' (i.e., "Lord Ing"), and the OE Rune Poem (rune Ƿ, st. 22, where it is again associated with the Danes).

Loki: 44 „Hvat 's þat it **litla** · es þat **l**oggra **sé**'k  
2 ok **snap**-víst **snapir**?  
At **ę**rym Fręys · munt **ę** vesa  
4 ok und **k**vęrnum **k**laka.“

[R 16r/31]

Lock: “What's this little thing I see wagging its tail  
and snap-wisely snapping?  
At Free's ears wilt thou always be  
and chirping under mills!”

1 loggra 'wagging its tail' | A hapax; cognate with Danish and Norwegian *logre* 'wag (one's tail)'.

[Byggvir kvað:] 45 „Byggvir ek **hęti**, · en mik **bráð**an **kveð**a  
2 **goð** ęll ok **g**umar;  
því em'k **hér** **hróð**ugr · at **drekka** **H**ropts **mę**gir  
4 **allir** ęl **saman**.“

[R 16r/32]

[Quoth Bower:] “Bewer I am called, and hurried do call me  
all Gods and men.  
Therefore I am honoured here when Roft’s lads [the ESE] drink  
ale all together.”

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1 Byggvir | ‘Beyggvir’ R

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2 goð ... ok gumar ‘Gods and men’ | This pairing also occurs in *Lok* 55/4 and *Reg* 19.

[Loki kvað:] 46 „Þegi þú, Byggvir, · þú kunnir aldri=gi [R 16v/1]  
2 deila með mǫnnum mat;  
ok þik í flēts strái · finna né mǫttu  
4 þá’s vǫgu verar.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Bower! Thou couldst never  
deal out food amidst men,  
and in the bench-straw they could not find thee  
when the warriors fought.”

[Hęim·dallr kvað:] 47 „Qlr est, Loki · svá’t es ǫr·viti, [R 16v/3]  
2 hvi né lēt=sk=a þú, Loki?  
þvít of-drykkja · veldr alda hęim  
4 es sína mēlgi né man=at.“

[Quoth Homedall:] “Drunk art thou, Lock, so that thou art out of thy wits;  
why holdest thou not back, O Lock?  
For over-drinking makes every man  
no more mind his speech.”

[Loki kvað:] 48 „Þegi þú, Hęim·dallr, · þér vas í ár-daga [R 16v/5]  
2 it ljóta líf of lagit;  
ǫrgu baki · munt ę vesa  
4 ok vaka vǫrðr goða.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Homedall! For *thee* in days of yore  
was thy ugly life laid down.  
With a stiff back wilt thou always be  
and waking, O Watchman of the Gods.”

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2 líf of lagit ‘life laid down’ | His course of life was decreed by the Norns. Formulaic language; cf. *Ski* 13/4.

3 ǫrgu ‘stiff’ | ‘*argr*’ R is ambiguous since *ar* can represent both *ǫ* and *au*. It is here read as a form of *ǫrðgu*, n. dat. sg. of *ǫrðgr* ‘upright, arduous, harsh’, but it can also be read as *aurgu* ‘muddy’. The former is thought to give better sense since it specifies Homedall’s *ljóta líf* ‘ugly life’; “all that standing must hurt your back, Watchman of the Gods!”

4 vörðr goða ‘Watchman of the Gods’ | Formulaic epithet of Homedall, who had to guard the rainbow bridge of the Gods against their enemies. See *Grm* 13 n.

- [Skaði kvað:] 49 „Létt ’s þér, Loki; · mun=at-tu lengi svá  
2 léika lausum hala,  
því’t þik á hjörvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar  
4 gornum binda goð.“

[R 16v/7]

[Quoth Shede:] “Thou takest it lightly, Lock—thou wilt not so for long  
play with a loose tail,  
for on a sword with thy rime-cold lad’s  
guts the Gods shall bind thee.”

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ALL | The speaker of sts. 49 and 51 is not indicated in **R** and is not directly named in Lock’s answers, but is certainly Shede. She would otherwise be the only deity mentioned in P1 without a speaking role, and Lock’s mention of the killing of Thedse (st. 50) is only effective if it relates personally to whomever he is attacking, which is only the case for Shede.

3–4 því at þik á hjörvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar / gornum binda goð. ‘for on a sword with thy rime-cold lad’s / guts the Gods shall bind thee’ | See P8 below.

- [Loki kvað:] 50 „Veitst ef mik á hjörvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar  
2 gornum binda goð,  
fyrstr ok øfstr · vas’k at fjör-lagi  
4 þar’s vér á Þjatsa þrifum.“

[R 16v/9]

[Quoth Lock:] “Thou knowest, if on a sword with my rime-cold lad’s  
guts the Gods shall bind me,  
first and highest was I in life-taking  
where we laid hands on Thedse.”

---

4 þar’s vér á Þjatsa þrifum ‘where we laid hands on Thedse’ | A reference to a longwinded myth told most fully in *Skm* 2–4 and *Haustl* 2–13, and referenced in *Hárb* 19. After Idin was abducted by the ettin Thedse, the Eese forced Lock to recover her, which he set out to do by flying to his home in the shape of a hawk. When he found Idin he turned her into a nut, took her in his claws, and turned back to Osyard. Thedse quickly spotted him, set chase in the shape of an eagle, and was soon closing the distance. Standing in Osyard, the Eese saw the chase from afar and hurriedly threw wood shavings on the ground; just as Lock had flown over them they set fire to the shavings; the fire rose and scorched the wings of Thedse, who fell down to the ground and was killed. Not long thereafter, Shede, Thedse’s daughter, came to Osyard to avenge her father, but the gods convinced her to settle with them, after which she married Nearth. It is most sensible that Lock brings this myth up in order to insult Shede; cf. note to the previous st.

- [Skaði kvað:] 51 „Veitst ef fyrstr ok øfstr · vast at fjör-lagi  
2 þá’s ér á Þjatsa þrifuð,  
frá mínum véum · ok vöngum skulu  
4 þér é köld röð koma.“

[R 16v/11]

[Quoth Shede:] “Thou knowest that if thou wert first and highest in life-taking  
when ye laid hands on Thedse:  
from my wighs and wongs shall for thee  
ever cold counsels come.”

3 frá mínum véum · ok vǫngum ‘from my wighs and wongs’ | From her cultic sites; viz. her sanctuaries and sacred meadows.

[Loki kvað:] 52 „Léttari í mólum · vast við Laufeyjar son [R 16v/12]  
2 þá's lét=sk mér á bæð þínn boðit;  
getit verður oss s·líks · ef vér gǫrva skulum  
4 telja vǫmm'in vǫr.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Lighter in thy words wast thou with Leafie's son [= Lock, me]  
when thou didst summon me to thy bed.  
Such will be said of us if we clearly shall  
recount our blemishes.

P5 Þá gekk Sif framm ok byrлаði Loka í hrím-kalki mjǫð ok mēlti: [R 16v/15]  
Then Sib stepped forth and poured for Lock mead in a rime-chalice, and spoke:

1 Sif | ; (prob. pointing to a corr. in the no longer extant margin) R

1 Sif | That Sib is the speaker is supported by the mention of her in P1 and by the fact that st. 54 mentions Thunder, her husband.

53 „Heill ves þú nú, Loki, · ok tak við hrím-kalki [R 16v/12]  
2 fullum forns mjaðar,  
heldr þú hana ęina · látir með ása sonum  
4 vamma-lausa vesa.“

“Hale be thou now, Lock, and receive this rime-chalice,  
full of ancient mead,  
but thou oughtst to let me alone among the sons of the Eese  
remain blemish-less.”

4 vamma-lausa | gramm. emend.; vamma-lausum (dat. pl.) R.

1–2 Heill ... mjaðar ‘Hale ... mead’ | Formulaic; repeated identically in *Ski* 37/1–2.

3 hana ‘her’ | Sib speaks in the third person.

P6 Hann tók við horni ok drakk af: [R 16v/17]  
He received the horn and drank thereof:

- 54 „Eiñ þú vérir · ef þú svá vérir,  
 2 vör ok gröm at veri;  
 einn ek vëit, · svá't ek vita þikkj=umk,  
 4 hór ok af Hlór·riða,  
 ok vas þat sá inn lē-vísi Loki.“

[R 16v/18]

“Alone wouldst thou remain, *if* thou hadst remained  
 wary and wroth against menfolk.

I know one—whom I think me to know—  
 adulterer behind even Loride's back—  
 and that was the guile-wise Lock!”

---

4 Hlór-riða ‘Loride’ | “The Loud Rider”, a common name for Thunder. It seems that Lock's mere mention of Thunder invites his presence, probably a suggestion of the efficacy of invoking this god when threatened by evil supernatural forces (see Lindow 1988).

The same thing occurs in several other myths, e.g. the Gods' dealing with the Master Builder (see *Vsp* 24–25) and when ettin Rungner is at the banquet of the Eese in *Skm* 24: *En er ósum leiddu-sk ofr-yrði bans, þá nefna þeir Þór. Því næst kom Þórr í þoll'ina ok hafði á lepti hamar'inn ok var all-reiðr ok spýrr, þverr því rēðr, er jǫtnar bund-vísir skulu þar drekka, eða þverr seldi Hrungni gríð at vera í Val-þoll eða því Freyja skal skenkja bonum sem at gildi ása.* ‘But when the Eese grew tired of his boasting words, then they mention Thunder's name. Just thereafter Thunder came into the hall and had his hammer in the air and was all-wroth, asking whose doing it is that hundred-wise ettins shall drink there, or who gave Rungner grith to be in Walhall, or why Frow shall pour forth drinks for him like at the banquets of the Eese.’

5 lē-vísi Loki ‘guile-wise Lock’ | Formulaic, also occurring in *Hym* 37. Cf. also *Vsp* 35 where Lock is called *lē-gjarn* ‘guile-eager’ and *Vsp* 17 where Lothar (possibly to be identified with Lock) gives men *lē*, which may be an accusative form of *lē*.

- [Beyla kvað:] 55 „Fjöll öll skjalfa, · hygg á fōr vesa  
 2 heiman Hlór-riða;  
 hann rēðr ró · þeim's rógir hér  
 4 goð öll ok guma!“

[R 16v/20]

[Quoth Beal:] “The fells all quake—I think on his journey  
 from home Loride must be.  
 He will bring to rest the one who here maligns  
 all the Gods and men!”

---

ALL | The mention of Thunder has invited his presence and Beal announces his coming.

1 Fjöll öll skjalfa ‘The fells all quake’ | The movement of gods, especially Thunder, is often signalled by cosmic disturbance. Cf. *Þrk* 21 n.

- [Loki kvað:] 56 „Þegi þú, Beyla, · þú est Byggvis kvæn  
 2 ok meini blandin mjök;  
 ö·kynja'n meira · kom=a með ása sonum;  
 4 öll est, dēigja, dritin.“

[R 16v/21]

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Beal! Thou art Bewer’s wife,  
and mixed with much evil.  
A greater disgrace came not amidst the sons of the Eese;  
thou art all, dough-girl, dungy!”

4 ǫll est, deigja, dritin ‘thou art all, dough-girl, dungy’ | *deigja* ‘dough-girl’ is a derivative of *deigr* ‘dough’ and refers to a young maid at a farm who carries out tasks like kneading dough, milking the cows, and carrying water. Lock insults her; she’s still covered with cow dung.

P7 Þá kom Þórr at ok kvað:

[R 16v/23]

Then Thunder arrived and quoth:

57 „Þegi þú, rög véttr, · þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr,  
2 Mjöllnir, mál fyr-nema!  
Hæða klett · drep’k þér halsi af,  
4 ok verðr þá þínu fjörvi of farit.“

[R 16v/24]

“Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer  
Millner, deprive of speech!  
The rock of thy shoulders [HEAD] I will cut from thy neck,  
and then is thy life destroyed!”

ALL | The threatening st. bears some resemblance to *Hárb* 47.

1 þrúð-hamarr ‘thrith-hammer’ | “Strength-hammer”, *þrúðr* ‘thrith’ being an obsolete word for strength generally used only in connection with Thunder or ettins. *Þrúðr* ‘Thrith’ is also the name of Thunder’s daughter.

[Loki kvað:] 58 „Jarðar burr · es hér nú inn kominn;  
2 hvi þrasir þú svá, Þórr?  
En þá þorir ekki · es skalt við ulf’inn vega  
4 ok svelgr hann allan Sig-föður.“

[R 16v/26]

[Quoth Lock:] “Earth’s Son is here now come inside,  
why thrasest thou so, Thunder?  
Yet thou wilt nowise dare when thou shalt fight the Wolf  
and he swallows Syefather (= Weden) whole.”

1 burr | *metr. and sens. emend.; om. R*

3–4 es skalt við ulf’inn vega / ok svelgr hann allan Sig-föður ‘when thou shalt fight the Wolf / and he swallows Syefather (= Weden) whole.’ | A reference to the Rakes of the Reins, where Weden is slain by the Wolf. Thunder, meanwhile, dies while slaying the Wyrn; see *Vsp* 51–53, *Vafþ* 53.

[Þórr kvað:] 59 „Þegi þú, rög véttr, · þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr,

[R 16v/28]

2                   Mjöllnir, mál fyr·nema!  
                   Upp ek þér verp · ok á austr-vega,  
 4                   síðan þik mann=gi sér.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer  
 Millner, deprive of speech!  
 I will throw thee up and onto the eastern ways,  
 whereafter no man will see thee!”

---

3 austr-vega ‘eastern ways’ | The desolate eastern wastelands where Thunder hunts ettins, troll-women and other unnatural creatures.

[Loki kvað:] 60   „Austr-förum þínum · skalt aldri=gi

[R 16v/29]

2                   segja seggjum frá  
                   síðst í hanska þumlungi · hnúkðir þú, Eín-hęri,  
 4                   ok þótti=sk=a þa Þörr vesa!“

[Quoth Lock:] “From thy eastern journeys shalt thou never  
 speak to the youth,  
 since into a glove’s thumb thou crawledest, Oneharrier,  
 and didst not seem to be Thunder then!”

---

2 segja seggjum frá ‘speak to the youth’ | Lock here borrows from Frie’s use of this expression in st. 25 above.

3 í hanska þumlungi · hnúkðir þú ‘since into a glove’s thumb thou crawledest’ | Sts. 60 and 62 allude to Thunder’s journey to Outyards-Lock as told in *Gylf* 44–47, during which he encounters the ettin Shrimmer (*Gylf* 45:5–38). Lock (not to be confused with Outyards-Lock) is also present on that journey. For the part of the narrative alluded to in st. 60 see the summary of *Gylf* 45:5–16 in the note to *Hárþ* 26, although the ettin is there called Feller.

[Þörr kvað:] 61   „Þęgi þú, rög vęttr, · þér skal mǫnn þrúð-hamarr,  
 2                   Mjöllnir, mál fyr·nema!  
                   hęndi inni hógri · drep’k þik Hrungnis bana,  
 4                   svát þér brotnar bęina hvat.“

[R 16v/31]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer  
 Millner, deprive of speech!  
 With my right hand I will beat thee with Rungner’s bane [= Millner]  
 so that every bone in thee breaks!”

---

3 Hrungnis bana ‘Rungner’s bane [= Millner]’ | For Rungner, a famous ettin slawn by Thunder, cf. *Hárþ* 14.

[Loki kvað:] 62   „Lifa ętla’k mér · langan aldr

[R 16v/32]

2                   þó’tt hótir hamri mér;  
                   skarpar álar · þóttu þér Skrymis vesa



4 ok máttir=a þá nęsti náa  
ok svalt=sk þá hungri heill.“

[Quoth Lock:] “I intend for myself to live a long life  
although thou mightst threaten me with the hammer.  
Strong seemed Shrimmer’s knots to thee,  
and then couldst thou not get to thy provisions,  
and then wast thou dying, healthy, of hunger!”

3 skarpar álar · þóttu þér Skrymis vesa ‘Strong seemed Shrimmer’s knots to thee’ | Another allusion to Thunder’s encounter with Shrimmer, this part found narrated in *Gylf* 45:18–22: After the gods took on Shrimmer as a companion he offered to carry their provisions in his knapsack. They agreed to this, and by evening they rested beneath a big oak. Shrimmer went to sleep but told the companions to get a meal from the sack. Thunder took it and tried untying the straps, but the knots were so firmly tied by the ettin that he could nowise untie or even move them. In *Gylf* 47:9 the incident is revealed to have been an illusion; Shrimmer was Outyards-Lock in disguise and the cords tying up the sack were made of unbreakable iron (*grés-járn*).

[Þórr kvað:] 63 „Þegi þú, röð vęttr, · þér skal mín þrúð-hamarr,  
2 Mjöllnir, mál fyr·nema!  
Hrungnis bani · mun þér í hęl koma  
4 fyr Ná-grindr neðan.“

[R 17r/1]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer  
Millner, deprive of speech!  
Rungner’s bane will take thee to hell,  
down beneath Neegrind!”

[Loki kvað:] 64 „Kvað’k fyr ęsum, · kvað’k fyr ása sonum,  
2 þat’s mik hvatti hugr,  
en fyr þér ęinum · mun’k út ganga  
4 því’t ek vęit at þú vegr.

[R 17r/2]

[Quoth Lock:] “I spoke before the Eese; I spoke before the sons of the Eese  
whatever my heart did goad me,  
but for thee alone will I walk out  
for I know that thou dost strike.

65 Ql gęrðir þú, Égir, · en þú aldri munt  
2 síðan sumbl of gęra;  
ęiga þín qll, · es hér inni es,  
4 lęiki yfir logi  
ok brenni þér á baki.“

[R 17r/4]

Ale hast thou made, Eagre, but thou wilt never  
henceforth make a simble!

All thy estate which is here within—  
 let flame play over it  
 and burn thee in the back!”

### Frá Loka (‘From Lock’)

- P8      En eptir þetta fal=sk Loki í Frán·angrs-forsi í lax líki. Þar tóku [R 17r/6]  
 2       ésir hann. Hann var bundinn með þǫrmum sonar Nara; en Narfi,  
 4      sonr hans, varð at vargi. Skaði tók eittr-orm ok festi upp yfir and-  
 lit Loka; draup þar ór eittr. Sigyn, kona Loka, sat þar ok held  
 6      munn-laug undir eittr’it, en er munn-laug’in var full bar hón út  
 eittr’it, en meðan draup eittr’it á Loka. Þá kippti=sk hann svá hart  
 við, at þaðan af skalf jörð ǫll; þat eru nú kallaðir land-skjálftar.

BUT AFTER THIS Lock hid himself in Freenangersforce in the likeness of a salmon. There the Eese took him. He was bound with the intestines of his son Nare, but his son Narve was made a wolf/outlaw. Shede took a venomous serpent and fastened it up over Lock’s face; out of it ran venom. Syein, Lock’s wife, sat there and held a basin under the venom and when the basin was full she carried out the venom, but meanwhile the venom ran onto Lock. Then he struggled so hard that thereof all the earth quaked; such are now called earth-quakes.

---

ALL.L | The myth of the binding of Lock is alluded to in *Vsp* 34 and H31 and told at length in *Gylf* 50:3–25, which does not entirely agree with the present passage, although numerous details are shared between them (e.g. the name of the force and the comment about earth-quakes at the end).

According to *Gylf* 50:20–22 (cited in *Vsp* H31 n.; cf. there) the Eese captured two of Lock’s sons, Wonnel and “Nare or Narve”. They turned Wonnel into a wolf (*vargr*, which also means ‘outlaw’) and forced him to tear his brother Narve apart. Then they took Narve’s intestines used them to bind Lock on top of three sharp stones. The intestines hardened into iron and Lock was bound fast.

Since the author of *Gylf* knew *Vsp* it is possible that he combined a prose text similar to the present *Lok* P8 with the stanza *Vsp* H31, interpreting the form *Vála víg-bond* as ‘Wonnel’s war-bonds’ (whereas the present ed. adopts the emendation to nom. sg. *Váli*).

Wonnel is the son of Weden who avenges Balder by killing Hath (*Vsp* 31 n., *Bdr* 11/1, *Gylf* 30:1–2, *Skm* 19), and there is no reason as to why he could not have bound Lock.

## Appendix

### Stanza from *Gylf*

- G1      „Örr est, Loki, · ok ør·viti,  
 2      hví né lēt=sk=a þú, Loki?

[S 5v/36, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

4                    ør·løg Frigg · hygg at ǫll viti  
                      þó'tt hōn sjölf=gi segi.“

“Mad art thou, Lock, and out of thy wits,  
 why holdest thou not back, O Lock?  
 All orlays I think Frie knows,  
 though she says them not herself.”

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ALL | In *Gylf* 20:7 this stanza is cited as proof of Frie's foresight regarding the orlays of men. It is introduced by the words *svá sem hér er sagt, at Óðinn mēlti sjalfir við þann ǫs, er Loki beitir* 'just as it is said here, that Woden himself spoke to that Os who is called Lock'. — The stanza looks like an amalgamation of several *Lok* stanzas, which is why it has been placed here, rather than under *Eddbr*; l. 1 corresponds to st. 21/1 (spoken by Woden), l. 2 to st. 47/2 (spoken by Homedall), and ll. 3–4 to st. 29/3–4 (spoken by Frow). It is possible that the st. derives from an alternate version of *Lok*, but it could also be the result of faulty memory on Snorre's part, since the first line corresponds to the one spoken by Woden in st. 21.



# Lay of Thrim

## (*Þryms kviða*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C9th (0.741)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Lay of Thrim** (abbrev. *Þrk*) is a narrative poem dealing with the god Thunder's adventure to retrieve his hammer from the ettin Thrim.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Þrk* is only found in **R**, on foll. 17r/12–18r/4. It follows *Lok* and precedes *Vkv*.

No sts. are found in other sources, although there is a possible allusion to (a variant of) stanza 29 in *Gylf* (see *Þrk* 29/5 n.).

### Structure and form

The poem consists of 32 stanzas and 129 long-lines. 4 lines is the typical length of a stanza (sts. 1–3, 7, 8, 10–12, 14–16, 18, 21–23, 25–28, 30–31), but lengths of 2 (4), 3 (5, 6, 17, 20), 5 (9, 13, 24, 29, 32), and 6 (19) lines are also represented.

The meter is Ancient-words-law of a somewhat looser variety. No prose is embedded in the poem itself, which consists of both narrative and dialogue.

### Style and Language

*Þrk* consists of both narrative and dialogue and much of the poetry is notably formulaic. Numerous passages are repeated throughout the poem (1/1 ~ 13/1, 3/1–2 ~ 12/1–2, 5/1–3 ~ 9/1–3, 8/3–4 ~ 11/3–4, 12/3 ~ 15/3, 12/4 = 20/3, 15/3–16/4 = 19/1–6, 26/1–4 ~ 28/1–4) and several long-lines are shared or closely related with other poems (1/3, 2/1, 7/1, 14/1–3, 15/1, 18/2, 23/1b–2a, 31/1).

Some of the long-lines of the latter group (viz. 1/3, 2/1, 14/1–3, 15/1) are of the oral-formulaic type, in that they do not fill a function unique to the particular narrative of a given poem. Instead they carry the narrative forward by describing generic actions, e.g. by introducing someone's entering a hall or commencing speech. This type of line is only found in a few select narrative poems in Ancient-words-law and should probably be considered a sign of an early date. To that effect speak two reasons: first, such lines hardly figure at all in younger antiquarian Eddic poetry, indicating that they had fallen out of favour by the antiquarian revival of the 12th c.; second, they very frequently contain the particle *of* before verbs, an archaic feature not used to a great extent in 12th c.

A unique trait of *Prk* is that the archaic particle *of* here appears at a higher rate than in any other Eddic poem (0.688 occurrences / 10 unique half-lines), and more than 40% as often as the poem with the second-highest incidence, *Oddr* (Sapp 2022, p. 70), which notably also shares numerous formulaic long-lines (cf. in particular *Oddr* 3).

Alliteration between *\*vr-* and *v-* is uncertain for *Prk*, although it is likely the case in *Prk* 1/1 (n.).

## Story

*Prk* tells the story of the theft of Thunder's hammer Millner by the ettin Thrim, and his regaining of it through (cross-)dressing as the goddess Frow, after which he slays the whole ettin clan.

## Origin and motifs

At the core of the narrative lies the ancient motif where the Ettins, the enemies of the Gods, desire to rob them of their weapon and to possess a goddess, viz. the light-bringing Dawn, and hide Her under ground. The concealment of the strength and light of the heavens threatens not merely the Gods but also Mankind, who rely on their protection.

*Prk* is not the only Norse source for this motif. The closest parallel is the story of the ettin Master Builder in *Gylf* 42:3–29 (cf. *Vsp* 24–25 nn.), where an ettin craftsman in exchange for building the wall of Osyard asks for the hand of Frow and the Sun and the Moon as a dowry—a price which would effectively steal away all the light in the world. For the inevitable catastrophic consequences of the theft of the light we may compare the eschatological Fimblewinter (*Vsp* 40/3–4, *Vafþ* 44/3–4 (n.), *Hdl* 41/3, *Gylf* 51:1–4), which occurs when the enemies of the Gods at last succeed in robbing the world of the sun.

The motif of the enemies of the Gods wishing to steal and hide the heavenly light(s), usually symbolized by the Goddesses, has ancient roots. It is also found in Finnic mythology. In *Kalevala* 47–49, the evil witch *Louhi* of the Northland successfully steals the sun, moon, and fire (note the fire-symbolism of the *Brisinga-mén*, st. 13/3 n.!) and thereby deprives the world of its light. This motif is authentic and not the invention of Lönnroth, for

in Finnish folk-songs both the Sun (or its goddess Päivätär, the mother of the Panu, the fire-god) and the Moon are variously said to have been locked up in a stone (*SKVR* XIII 99) or an iron stronghold (*SKVR* XV 220.1–7). A much older form of the same motif is found in the Vedic *Valá*-myth (part of which is told in *RV* 10.108), where the enemies of the Gods, the *Paṇi*-s, lock up the Dawns in the form of kine in the *Valá*-cave and thereby prevent the natural cycle between Night and Day. With his great song the Storm-god *Indra* breaks open the cave, killing *Valá* and releasing the light-bringing Dawns (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71).

In this way *Þrk* also comes to symbolise cyclical cosmic renewal. The weapon of the Gods is stolen from them and they find themselves at a low point, powerless against the forces of evil (st. 18), but they are at last redeemed, and the enemy defeated and humiliated in comical fashion (sts. 31–32). Although we know nothing about the performance context of *Þrk*, it is perhaps not unlikely that it would have been performed as part of a festival, perhaps at the winter solstice, when the year is at its darkest point and the light seems furthest away. In this way the poem gives its listeners hope: Thunder has vanquished the ettins and shown them to be of no threat, even laughable in their weakness. The light will return.

More generally, comedic stories involving Thunder and his ettin-bashing seem to have been very popular in Wiking age Norway and Iceland, and in these the god himself is not infrequently the butt of the joke. Apart from *Þrk* there are also the Eddic poems *Hym* and *Hárb*, and the Scaldic poems *Haustr* and *Þdr*. Fragment from a lost Eddic poem about Thunder's fight with the ettin Garfrith and his daughters also survive in *Gylf*; see *Eddbr* VI below.

### Later parallels

The story of Thunder getting back his stolen hammer by impersonating the goddess Frow was clearly extremely popular, for numerous later reflexes in the form of folk-ballads are found in all four major North Germanic-speaking countries (Sweden, Norway, Denmark, and Iceland); for a useful overview and discussion of their features see Vijūnas (2019).

The oldest such ballad is the 15th c. Icelandic *ríma Þrymlur*. Judging by numerous direct textual parallels (e.g. *Þrk* 27/3 = *Þrymlur* 2.22; see Vijūnas 2019, pp. 46–47, 54), *Þrymlur* is clearly closely related to *Þrk*, if not directly drawing on it, although it also adds numerous details not found in *Þrk* and on the whole greatly embellishes the story. In addition, however, *Þrymlur* shares some details with the later Scandinavian ballads that are absent from *Þrk*, most notably the bringing of the hammer for the bride (Vijūnas 2019, pp. 57–58); these parallels suggest that it is not a mere rewrite of the older *Þrk* by a learned antiquarian, but rather based on the same common proto-myth as both *Þrk* and the later ballads.

The later continental ballads are numerous and documented from 1591 to the 20th c.; Vijūnas (2019, pp. 43–44) lists 1 from Sweden, 6 from Norway, and 9 from Denmark. These ballads, though the names of the gods in them

are more or less corrupt and though their nature as gods is forgot, still feature a plot remarkably identical to *Þrk*.

This is all the more notable since the oldest example was printed in Denmark in 1591, decades before the first edition of the Poetic Edda, for which reason direct influence from *Þrk* must be discounted. Nor is direct influence from the Icelandic *Þrymlur* possible, for the numerous embellishments found in it but not in *Þrk* do not appear in the ballads (Vijūnas 2019, pp. 41–42).

### Dating

*Þrk* has often been considered the oldest poem in the **R** collection, and Sapp (2022)'s model agrees with that judgment by placing it solidly (0.741) in the 9th c., earlier than any other Eddic poem. An early date is supported by the unusually high incidence of the particle *of* before verbs, the use of narrative formulaic lines (see Style and Language above), and the likely alliteration between *\*vr-* and *v-* (st. 1/1).



## Text

### Lay of Thrim

- 1      **V**reǿðr vas þá **V**ing-Þörr · es hann **v**aknaði      [R 17r/13]  
2      ok **s**íns hamars · of **s**aknaði,  
3      **s**kegg nam at hrista, · **s**kqr nam at dýja,  
4      réð **J**arðar burr · **u**mb at þreifa-sk.

**W**ROTH WAS THEN WING-THUNDER when he woke,  
and of his hammer was bereft.  
His beard he took to rustle, his locks he took to rip;  
the son of Earth resolved to grope about.

1 **V**reǿðr | Reiðr **R**

1 **V**reǿðr | Initial \**vr-* is restored for the sake of alliteration since the first nominal in a line must typically carry alliteration; in *Þrk* 13/1 it definitely does not, but that may well be due to that line mirroring the present line and thereby breaking convention for the sake of parallelism. For the age of this feature cf. *Háv* 32/2 n.

1 **V**ing-Þörr ‘Wing-Thunder’ | A rare poetic name for Thunder; it only elsewhere occurs in *Alv* 6. The first element is not *vęngr* ‘wing (of a bird)’ but perhaps means ‘swinging’ (cf. Swedish *vingla*), referring to his swinging of his hammer, or ‘victorious’, representing a n-infixed extension of the verb *vega* ‘to strike, smite, fight’ (cf. Latin *vincere* ‘to win, vanquish’). Cf. the related name Wingner (ON *Vingnir*) in *Vafþ* 51/4.

3 *skegg nam at hrista*, · *sqr nam at dýja* ‘His beard he took to rustle, his locks he took to rip’ | *N1 nam at V1*; *N2 nam at V2* appears to be a formulaic long-line; cf. *Brøt* 13/1.

- 2      Ok hann þat orða · **a**lls fyrst of kvað:      [R 17r/15]  
2      „**H**ęyr-ðu nú, **L**oki, · **h**vat ek nú męli  
3      es **ę**igi vęit · **j**arðar hvēr=gi  
4      né **u**pp-himins: · **ę**ss es stolinn hamri!“

And he this word first of all did say:  
“Hear thou now, Lock, what I now will speak,  
which no man knows anywhere on Earth  
nor in Up-heaven: the os [I] is robbed of His hammer!”

1 Ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað ‘And he this word first of all did say’ | The whole line is formulaic, occurring in five other places: *Þrk* 3/2, 9/5, and 12/2 below, *Oddr* 3/5, *Brøt* 5/2.

3–4 *jarðar ... upp-himins* ‘Earth ... Up-heaven’ | A formulaic meristic expression for the whole cosmos; see Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

- 3      **G**ingu þęir **f**agra · **F**reyju tůna      [R 17r/17]  
2      ok hann þat orða · **a**lls fyrst of kvað:  
3      „**M**unt-u męr, **F**reyja, · **f**jaðr-hams lęa

4 ef ek mǫnn hamar · mǫtta'k hitta?“

They went to the fair courts of Frow  
and he this word first of all did say:  
“Wilt thou to Me, O Frow, the feather-hame lend,  
if I My hammer might find?”

2 hann ‘he’ | The speaker is Thunder, since he speaks about “my hammer”.

3 fjaðr-hams ‘feather-hame’ | A “feather-cloak” by which the wearer can transform or fly like a bird. TODO.

Fręyja kvað: 4 „Þó mynda'k gefa þér · þó'tt ór gollí vęri  
2 ok þó sęlja · at vęri ór silfri.“

[R 17r/19]

[Quoth Frow:] “I would yet give it to Thee though it were golden,  
and yet hand it to Thee if it were silvern.”

2 sęlja ‘hand’ | sęlja, cognate of English *sell*, here has its older sense of ‘hand over’, cf. Gotish *saljan* ‘offer; give’; Streiberg 1910, p. 116).

5 Fló þá Loki, · fjaðr-hamr dunði,  
2 und's fyr útan kom · ása garða  
ok fyr innan kom · jötna heima.

[R 17r/20]

Then flew Lock—the feather-hame rustled—  
until he came outside the Yards of the Eese,  
and he came inside the Homes of the Ettins.

1 Loki ‘Lock’ | Though Thunder is the one asking for the feather-hame (3/4 “if I my hammer might find”), it is Lock who takes off flying.

2 ása garða ‘the Yards of the Eese’ | Semantically identical to Osyrd (st. 18/3 below).

6 Þrymr sat á haugi, · þursa dróttinn,  
2 gręyjum sínum · goll-bönd snøri  
ok mörum sínum · mön jafnaði.

[R 17r/22]

Thrim sat on the mound, the lord of Thurses:  
on his greyhounds the golden leashes he twirled,  
and on his steeds the manes he cut even.

1 sat á haugi ‘sat on the mound’ | Probably a sign of his power, the mound representing his wealth and ancient estate. Cf. *Vsp* 41 n. for other attestations.

1 þursa dróttinn ‘lord of Thurses’ | This formulaic half-line also occurs in Runic charms against such thursen lords (*Cant* and U Fv1933;134 under Galders). *Cant* in particular is a prayer to Thunder himself, and thus goes to show that even light-hearted poems like *Þrk* held religious significance by serving as examples of Thunder’s prowess as daemon-slayer, for which he could be invoked also in the present. Cf. .

2–3 gręyjum sínum ... męrum sínum ‘his greyhounds ... his steeds’ | Thrim sits surrounded by dogs and horses. The scene is reminiscent of the ancient “master of animals” motif, especially as attested on panel A of the Gundestrup cauldron.

- [Drymr kvað:] 7 „Hvat ’s með ęsum? · Hvat ’s með ęlfum? [R 17r/23]  
 2 Hví est ęinn kominn · ĩ jętun-ęęima?“  
 [Loki kvað:] „Illt ’s með ęsum, · illt ’s með ęlfum!  
 4 Hęfir þú Hlór-riða · hamar of folginn?“  
 [Quoth Thrim:] “What’s with the Eese? What’s with the Elves?  
 Why art thou alone come into the Ettin-Homes?”—  
 [Quoth Lock:] “’Tis ill with the Eese! ’Tis ill with the Elves!  
 Hast thou Loride’s hammer hid?”

3 illt ’s með ęlfum | required by sense and meter; *om.* R

1 Hvat ’s með ęsum? · Hvat ’s með ęlfum? ‘What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?’ | Formulaic, the same line occurs in *Vęp* 46/1.

2 jętun-ęęima ‘Ettin-Homes’ | Semantically identical to the *jętna ęęimar* ‘Homes of the Ettins’ in 5/3 above. The distinction is purely metrical, since \*ĭ *jętna ęęima* would be an illegal type C verse of Ancient-words-law.

4 Hlór-riða ‘Loride’ | “The Loud Rider”, Thunder.

- [Drymr kvað:] 8 „Ek hęfi Hlór-riða · hamar of folginn [R 17r/25]  
 2 áttaręstum · fyr jęręđ neðan;  
 hann ęngi maðr · aprt of ęęimtirt  
 4 nema fęri mér · Freęju at kvęn.“  
 [Quoth Thrim:] “I have Loride’s hammer hid  
 eight rests beneath the earth.  
 It will no man fetch back again,  
 unless he bring me Frow to wife.”

2 áttaręstum ‘eight rests’ | Eight leagues; a “rest” being an old distance measurement. See Index.

4 Freęju ‘Frow’ | Frow, who is probably originally the Indo-European dawn-goddess. The Ettins apparently have a great desire to obtain her; in *Gylf* 42:5 the ettin who builds the wall of Osyard asks specifically for Frow in return, along with the Sun and the Moon (cf. *Vęp* 24).

- 9 Fló þa Loki, · fjaðr-hamr dunði, [R 17r/27]  
 2 und’s fyr útan kom · jętna ęęima  
 ok fyr innan kom · asa garða;  
 4 mótti hann þęr · miðra garða  
 ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:

Then flew Lock—the feather-hame rustled—  
 until he came outside the Homes of the Ettins

and he came inside the Yards of the Eese.  
 He met Thunder in the middle yards,  
 and he [= Thunder] this word first of all did say:

5 *hann þat* | *emend.* (cf. st. 2 n.); þat hann with elsewhere unprecedented word order R

4 *mótti hann Þór* ‘He met Thunder’ | This line is compatible with the reconstructed disyllabic form \**Þoar* acc. sg. if the pronoun *hann* is excised; for that form see note to *Hym* 23/1.

- 10 „Hefir þú *ørendi* · sem *erfiði*? [R 17r/29]  
 2 Seg-ðu á *lopti* · *long* tíðendi!  
 Opt *sitjanda* · *sögur* of falla=sk,  
 4 ok *liggjandi* · *lygi* of *bëllir*.“

“Hast thou an errand for thy hardship?  
 Tell thou the long tidings aloft!  
 Oft the sitting man’s stories fail each other  
 and the lying down blows up his lie.”

1 Hefir þú *ørendi* · sem *erfiði*? ‘Hast thou an errand for thy hardship?’ | Thunder asks Lock whether he has found out anything from his long journey. The rhyming pair *ørendi* ‘errand’ ... *erfiði* ‘trouble, hardship’ also occurs in *HHj* 5/1.

3–4 Opt *sitjanda* · *sögur* of falla=sk, // ok *liggjandi* · *lygi* of *bëllir*. ‘Oft the sitting man’s stories fail each other // and the lying down blows up his lie.’ | Proverbial. If one waits and mulls over bad news after receiving them, details will be left out and excuses thought up. It is therefore best that Lock immediately tell Thunder what he has learned. ON *liggja* ‘lie (recline)’ and *ljúga* ‘lie (speak untruth)’ are entirely different verbs; it is unfortunate that they sound the same in English.

- [Loki kvað:] 11 „Hefi’k *ørendi*, · *erfiði* ok: [R 17r/31]  
 2 Þrymr hēfir þinn hamar, · þursa dróttinn;  
 hann *engi* maðr · *aptr* of hēimtir  
 4 nema hōnum *fōri* · *Freyju* at kvēn.“

[Quoth Lock:] “I have an errand, hardship also:  
 Thrim has thy hammer, the lord of Thurses.  
 It will no man fetch back again,  
 unless he bring him Frow to wife.”

- 12 Ganga þeir *fagra* · *Freyju* at hitta [R 17r/33]  
 2 ok hann þat *orða* · *alls* fyrst of kvað:  
 „Bitt-u þik, *Freyja*, · *brúðar* líni;  
 4 vit skulum *aka* tvau · í *jōtun*-hēima.“

They go the fair Frow to find,  
 and he this word first of all did say:

“Bind thyself, Frow, with bridal linen.  
We two shall drive into the Ettin-Homes!”

2 hann ‘he’ | The speaker is either Thunder or Lock.

3 brúðar líni; ‘bridal linen’ | The dress of the bride.

- 13      *Vrēið varð þá Freyja · ok fnasaði,*  
2      *allr ása salr · undir bifði=sk,*  
         *stökk þat it mikla · mēn brisinga:*  
4      *„Mik vžitst verða · ver-gjarnasta*  
         *ef ek ek með þér · í jötun-heima.“*

[R 17v/1]

Wroth became Frow then, and snorted;  
all the hall of the Eese beneath her shook;  
down crashed the great Necklace of Blazes—  
“Thou knowest I’ll become most eager for men  
if I drive with thee into the Ettin-Homes!”

1 fnasaði | ‘fnasasi’ R

1 fnasaði ‘snorted’ | A rare word. TODO.

3 mēn brisinga ‘Necklace of Blazes’ | The *Brisinga-mēn* (second element *mēn* ‘neckring, necklace, jewel’) is a jewel worn by Frow. It is probably a symbol of fire and light, as shown by the first element *brisingr*, which is listed as a poetic synonym for fire in *Pul Elds* 4 (SkP 3) and appears in the sense ‘blaze’ in Norwegian dialects. This strengthens Frow’s identification with the Dawn, for which cf. *Vsp* 24. The association of the Necklace with fire is further supported by the obscure myth wherein the two probable fire-figures Lock and Homedall fight over it, as mentioned in *Skm* 15, 23 and *Húsdr* 2. Lock is identified in later folklore with the Ash-lad, a wight living in or under the fire-place (Heide 2011), while Homedall’s fire-related epithets include *Hēim-dallr* ‘World-Brilliant’, *vörðr goða* ‘Watchman of the Gods’ (*Grm* 13/3 n., *Lok* 48/4, *Gylf* 27:8), *vári ragna* ‘Guardian of the Gods’ (*Húsdr* 2) *bvitastr ása* ‘whitest of the Eese’ (*Þrk* 15/1), *bviti óss* ‘the White Os’ (*Gylf* 27:2), *Gollin-tanni* ‘Goldentooth’, and *Hallin-skíði* ‘One with leaning sticks’ (*Gylf* 27:5).

For the opposition between these two Gods cf. *Gylf* 51:48, about the Rakes of the Reins: *Loki á orrostu við Heim-dall ok verðr hvárr annars bani*. ‘Lock battles against Homedall, and each one slays the other.’ For further discussion about Homedall and his epithets see *Eddbr* III. Lock’s role in the theft is also alluded to in *Haustl* 9, where he is called *girði-þjófr brisinga* ‘girdle-thief of the blaze’, i.e., ‘thief of the girdle of the blaze [= the Necklace of Blazes]’.

Archeologically the Necklace of Blazes seems to appear in various finds depicting a lady or goddess wearing an oversized brooch (Arrhenius 1962, pp. 79–84). Such oversized brooches of the disc-on-bow type are in fact known from Wiking Age Scandinavia, including Western Norway (Arrhenius 1962, p. 86), where *Þrk* is likely to have been written, and are some of the finest pieces of jewelry surviving from the period (Arrhenius 1962, p. 87). These brooches, which with their original *cloisonné*-fitted red garnets give off a beautiful fire-like lustre, are doubtless cultic objects. They are far too large and heavy to have been worn as part of dress (e.g., the fragmentary brooch from Kårsta, Uppland, Sweden, item number 267203 HST, would have been as long as 28.5 cm, Arrhenius 1962, p. 93); nor are they found in graves as part of women’s dress, which further suggests that they were not worn as status objects (Arrhenius 1962, pp. 84–85, 97). On the basis of the lack of association between their find circumstances and cultic sites, Arrhenius (1962, p. 97) suggests that they were probably venerated as independent objects rather than adorning wooden statues. As a representative symbol of Frow the brooches would thus have served to connect the worshipper to the goddess in the same way as amulets depicting Thunder’s hammer Millner (cf. *Hym* 36/2 n.) or Woden’s spear Gungner. A particularly beautiful example from the village Othemars in Othem parish, Gotland (item number 453312 HST) is depicted in Figure 6, p. 332.

4 verða · ver-gjarnasta ‘become most eager for men’ | Presumably Frow is speaking out of self-awareness of her lustful inclinations, i.e., she will be siezed by uncontrollable desire if surrounded by strange men. It is also possible that she worries about being accused of promiscuity by the other gods, but that is not the literal sense of the words. For Frow’s alleged looseness cf. *Lok* 30; in *Lok* 26 another goddess, Frie, is likewise called *ver-gjörn* ‘eager for men’.

- 14      Senn vöru **ę**sir · allir á þingi [R 17v/3]  
 2      ok **ę**synjur · allar á máli,  
       ok umb þat réðu · ríkir tívar:  
 4      **h**vé þęir Hlór·riða · hamar of sótti?
- Soon were the Eese all at the Thing,  
 and the Ossens all at speech,  
 and of this counseled the mighty Tews:  
 how they Lorde’s hammer might find.

1–3 Senn ... tívar ‘Soon ... Tews’ | The very same three lines also occur in *Bdr* 1/1–3; see Note there.

- 15      Þá kvað þat Hęim·dallr, · hvítastr ása, [R 17v/5]  
 2      vissi vęl framm · sęm vanir aðrir:  
       „Bindu vér Þör þá · brúðar líni;  
 4      hafi hann it mikla · męn brisinga!



Figure 6: The gilt bronze disc-on-bow brooch from Othemars, Gotland. Viking Age, ca. 900 AD. © Ola Myrin, Historiska museet/SHM. CC BY 4.0. <https://samlingar.shm.se/object/AECAAAD2-4C29-4164-BB36-E6F589FDE1A5>

Then this quoth Homedall, whitest of the Eese;  
he knew well ahead like the other Wanes:  
“We shall bind Thunder, then, with bridal linen;  
let Him have the great Necklace of Blazes!”

1 Þá kvað þat ... ‘Then this quoth ...’ | Formulaic way of introducing speech in a certain type of Ancient-words-law-poetry. The template is *þá kvað þat X · Y*, where the name X can be either mono- or disyllabic and Y (taking up the b-verse) is an epithet or descriptor and always alliterates with X. This formula has been exceptionally productive and is found in 21 other instances in the Poetic Edda; it never occurs in poetry in SkP. The other occurrences are: *Þrk* 17/1, 18/1, 20/1, 22/1, 25/1, 30/1; *Rþ* 44/3; *1 HHund* 54/3; *Brot* 7/1, 10/1; *1 Guðr* 6/1, 12/1, 17/1, 23/1, 24/1, 25/1; *Akv* 13/3, 25/1; *Gbv* 4/1, 8/1; *Hamð* 12/1 (n.).

*1 Guðr* 4/1 has *þá kvað Gjaf-laug, · Gjúka systir*, but judging by the use of *þá kvað þat X ...* at 6 other places in that poem that is probably a scribal error from earlier \**þá kvað þat Gjaf-laug ...*, in which case the total rises to 22.

A variant formula is *bitt kvað þá X · Y* as found in *Sigsk* 31/1, and *Hamð* 6/1, 9/1, 22/1, 24/1, 26/1. A rare variant is *Akv* 27/1: *mérr kvað þat Gunn-arr, · geir-Niflungr*.

1 hvítastr ása ‘whitest of the Eese’ | A likely fire-epithet; cf. st. 13/3 n. above

2 vissi vęl framm ‘he knew well ahead’ | I.e. saw the future. Compare the derived adjective *fram-viss* ‘forth-wise, prescient.’

2 sęm vanir aðrir ‘like the other Wanes’ | Homedall is not otherwise considered one of the Wanes, which are generally held to encompass only the gods Nearth, Free, and Frow, in *Yng* 4 also the being Quasher (cf. *Vsp* 17/3, but contrast the introduction to *Háv* 103–110). This verse has been thought to undermine the existence of the Wanes as a group distinct from the Eese, since the word *vanir* here can be plausibly taken to mean nothing other than ‘Gods’; for this distinction cf. *Vsp* 22 n.

- 16 Lótum und hōnum · hrynja lukla  
2 ok kven-váðir · umb kné falla  
en á brjósti · breiða stęina  
4 ok hag=liga · umb hōfuð typpum!“

[R 17v/6]

We shall hang by His side keys to jingle,  
and women’s garments to fall about His knees,  
but on His breast broad stones,  
and skilfully shall We tip His head!”

ALL | A unique description of Wiking Age bridal dress. Cf. the description’s of dress in *Rþ*, which is, however, a much younger poem than *Þrk*. Being the mistress of the household, keys were the mark of a respectable married woman. The “broad stones” on the breast may be tortoise brooches (also mentioned in *Vkv* 25, 36.) or beads in a large necklace. The “tipping” of the head refers to some sort of bridal hat which would have included a veil (cf. st. 27 below).

- 17 Þá kvað þat Þörr, · þrúðugr ۆss:  
2 „Mik munu ęsir · argan kalla  
ef ek binda=sk lét · brúðar líni!“

[R 17v/8]

Then this quoth Thunder, the mighty Os:  
“Me will the Eese call queer  
if I let Myself be bound with bridal linen!”

2 argan kalla ‘call queer’ | Although reminiscent of schoolyard taunting, such an insult in fact carried legal consequences, for a man deemed *argr* (or *ragr* the metathesised form) ‘queer, effeminate, unmanly’ suffered the loss of personal rights and could no longer marry or swear oaths. Laws explicitly concerning this word are found among both the Icelanders and the Longbeards. In Iceland the word was explicitly banned as one of the three great words of insult, and punished by *skóg-gangr* ‘forest-walk’, i.e., full outlawry. So the Grey-Goose of the *Staðarbólsbók*, 376 (Vilhjálmur Finsen 1879, p. 392): *Þau eru orð þrjú [...] er skóg-gang varða þll, ef maðr kallar mann ragan eða ströðinn eða sorðinn*. ‘These are the three words which all incur full outlawry: if a man queer or sodomised or catamited.’

In older times an insult of masculinity had to be either retracted or settled by duel. So the Longbeardish Edict of Rothari, codified in 643 AD (TODO): *Si quis alium arga per furorem clamaverit et negare non poterit et dixerit, quod per furorem dixisset, tunc iuratus dicat, quod eum arga non cognovisset; postea conponat pro ipso iniurioso verbo solidos duodecim. Et si perseveraverit, convinctat per pugnam, si potuerit, aut certe conponat, ut supra*. ‘If anyone calls another man *arga* ‘queer’ in anger, and cannot deny it, and says that it was said in anger, then in his oath he says that he does not know him as queer; let him thereafter settle for the insulting word with twelve solidi. But if he persists, let him prove it by fighting if he can, or otherwise settle it as above.’ The same is found in the Old Swedish Heathen law, which however does not explicitly mention the word *argr* (Läffler 1879; Friesen 1902; **RosenbergForthcoming**).

18 Þà kvað þat Loki · Lauf-eyjar sonr:

[R 17v/9]

2 „Þegi þú, Þörr, · þeira orða!  
 Þegar munu jǫtnar · Ǫs-garð búa  
 4 nema þínn hamar · þér of hēimtir.“

Then this quoth Lock, Leafie’s son:  
 “Shut up Thou, Thunder, with those words!  
 Shortly will the Ettins settle Osyard,  
 unless Thou Thy hammer for Thyself dost fetch!”

2 Þegi þú, Þörr, · þeira orða! ‘Shut up thou, Thunder, with those words!’ | Formulaic line; cf. *I Guðr* 24/2: *Þegi þú, þjóð-leið, · þeira orða*.

3–4 Þegar ... hēimtir. ‘Shortly ... dost fetch!’ | Guarding the lands of the Gods and men from transgressive and destructive forces is Thunder’s task, and the Hammer his most important tool. Cf. *Vsp* 24–25, *Hárþ* 23–24, *Hym* 22, and a couplet by the obscure poet Thurbern Dise-scold, cited in *Skm* 11 (Þdis Þörr in SkP 3): *Þörr hefr Yggs með ǫrum · Ǫs-garð af þrek varðan*. ‘Thunder has with the messengers of Ug [gods] mightily guarded Osyard.’

19 Bundu þeir Þór þà · brúðar líni

[R 17v/11]

2 ok inu mikla · mēni brisinga,  
 létu und hǫnum · hrynja lukla  
 4 ok kven-váðir · umb kné falla  
 en à brjósti · bręiða stęina  
 6 ok hag=liga · umb hǫfuð typpðu.

They bound Thunder then with bridal linen  
 and with the great Necklace of Blazes.  
 They hung by his side keys to jingle,  
 and women’s garments to fall about the knees,



but on the breast broad stones,  
and skilfully they tipped his head.

- 20 Þá kvað þat **L**oki · **L**auf-eyjar sonr: [R 17v/13]  
2 „Mun’k **a**uk með þér · **a**mbótt vesa,  
vit skulum **a**ka tvau · í **j**ötun-heima.“

Then this quoth Lock, Leafie’s son:  
“I too will with Thee be a handmaid;  
We two shall drive into the Ettin-Homes.”

---

3 vit ... tvau ‘we two’ | It is a fundamental characteristic of Thunder in the Norse mythology that he is very seldom alone on his adventures, but almost always has a travel companion or sidekick (Lindow 1988, p. 123). — *tvau* ‘two’ is here in the neuter, which is used for mixed-sex groups. This is either an error due to mindless copying of st. 11, or a backhanded insult against Thunder by Lock.

- 21 Senn vöru **h**afrar · **h**eim of **v**reknir, [R 17v/14]  
2 **s**kyndir at **s**köklum, · **s**kyldu vël rinna;  
**b**jörg brotnuðu, · **b**rann jörð loga;  
4 **ó**k Óðins sonr · í **j**ötun-heima.

Soon were the he-goats driven home,  
hastened onto the cart-poles; they were to run well.  
Crag burst, the earth burned with flame;  
Weden’s son [= Thunder] drove to the Ettin-Homes.

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1 *hafrar* ‘he-goats’ | Thunder’s chariot is driven by his two goats; cf. the kenning *hafra dróttinn* ‘Lord of He-goats’ (*Hym* 20, 31).

3 *björg brotnuðu*, · *brann jörð loga* ‘Crag burst, the earth burned with flame’ | Thunder’s driving is often heralded by cosmic disturbance and fire. So his arrival in *Lok* 55 is signalled by the mountains quaking. It is for this reason he must wade to the Thing of the Gods rather than ride across the Rainbow Bridge (Bivrest), *Grm* 29. The description most similar to the present stanza is found in Thedwolf’s *Hausti* 14–16, where crags (*björg*) burst asunder and fires rage before him as he drives to fight Rungner. A possibly Indo-European parallel is the Vedic myth of Indra breaking the mountains and releasing the rivers (as described most famously in *RV* 1.32). Cf. also *Bdr* 3 where the ground rumbles beneath the riding Weden.

- 22 Þá kvað þat Þrymr, · þursa dróttinn: [R 17v/16]  
2 „Standið upp, jötnar, · ok stráið bækki!  
Nú **f**örð mér · **F**reyju at kvön,  
4 **N**jarðar dóttur · ór **N**óa-tünnum.

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:  
“Stand up, ye ettins, and strew the benches!  
Now bring me Frow to wife,  
Nearth’s daughter from the Nowetons!

- 23      Ganga hér at garði · goll-hyrnðar kýr,  
 2      oxn al-svartir, · jǫtni at gamni,  
             fjǫlð á’k meïðma, · fjǫlð á’k meñja;  
 4      einnar mér Freyju · ávant þykkir.“

[R 17v/18]

Here march to my farmstead golden-horned kine,  
 all-black oxen to the ettin’s [my] pleasure.  
 A multitude I own of treasures, a multitude I own of torcs;  
 only Frow I think me missing.”

1–2 goll-hyrnðar kýr, oxn al-svartir ‘golden-horned kine, all-black oxen’ | Two related formulae. Together they emphasize the great value and sacrificial purpose of the oxen; both have Indo-European parallels and also appear together in Latvian *Daina* 33863 (*Melni vērsi, zelta ragi, / nāk par jūru baurodami* ‘Black oxen, golden horns, come bellowing over the sea’, Calin 1996, pp. 37–40). — goll-hyrnðar kýr is also found in *HHj* 4/2a, and the term *gollin-borni* ‘golden-horned one’ appears as a poetic synonym for “ox” in the *Þul* *Øxna* 3. — The singular *oxi al-svartr* ‘all-black ox’ appears in *Hym* 18, likewise of an animal to be sacrificed. For sacrificial black beasts cf. Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.8.12, where the hero Hadding has to atone for his slaying of a heavenly being by a sacrifice of dark-coloured victims (*furvae hostiae*): *Siquidem propiciandorum numinum gratia Frø deo rem divinam furvis hostiis fecit. Quem litationis morem annuo feriarum circuitu repetitum posteris imitandum reliquit. Frøblot Sveones vocant.* ‘In order to mollify the divinities he [= Hadding] did indeed make a holy sacrifice of dark-coloured victims to the god Frø. He repeated this mode of propitiation at an annual festival and left it to be imitated by his descendants. The Swedes call it Frøblot.’ This ancient ritual taboo even finds a parallel in the Tanakh, where animals dedicated to YHWH were to be unblemished (Hebrew מִקְלֵה, Leviticus 1:3), which prob. includes being of a single colour.

TODO: write about the IE parallels

- 24      Vas þar at kveldi · of komit snimma  
 2      ok fyr jǫtna · ǫl framm borit;  
             einn át oxa, · átta laxa,  
 4      krásir allar, · þér’s konur skyldu,  
             drakk Sifjar verr · sǫld þrjú mjaðar.

[R 17v/20]

There was the evening come early,  
 and for the ettins ale brought forth.  
 He [= Thunder] alone ate an ox, eight salmons,  
 all the dainties meant for the women;  
 Sib’s husband [= Thunder] drank three sieves of mead.

3–5 Einn ... mjaðar. ‘He alone ... of mead.’ | Thunder is renowned for his great appetite; cf. *Hym* 15 where he eats two of Hymer’s oxen and *Gylf* 46–47 where he drinks a large part of the sea.

5 Sifjar verr ‘Sib’s husband’ | It is curious that the same kenning is used in *Hym* 15 which also describes Thunder’s eating; it is perhaps a borrowing from the present stanza.

- 25      Þá kvað þat Prymr, · þursa dróttinn:  
 2      „Hvar sát-t-u brúðir · bíta hvassara?  
             Sá’k=a brúðir · bíta enn bręðara

[R 17v/23]

4 né ęnn meira mjoð · meę of drekka!“

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:  
“Where sawest thou brides bite sharper?  
I never saw brides bite yet broader;  
nor yet more mead a maiden drink!”

26 Sat in al-snotra · ambótt fyrir  
2 es orð of fann · við ęotuns máli:  
„Át vętr Freęja · áttá nóttum,  
4 svá vas hęn óð-fús · ı ęotun-ęęima.“

[R 17v/25]

Sat the all-clever handmaid [= Lock] in front,  
who found a word against the ettin's speech:  
“Frow ate naught for eight nights;  
so madly She longed for the Ettin-Homes.”

27 Laut und línu, · lysti at kyssa,  
2 en hann útan stókk · ęnd-langan sal:  
„Hví eru ęndótt · augu Freęju?  
4 Þykkja mér ór augum · ęldar brinna!“

[R 17v/27]

He [= Thrim] looked 'neath the linen, lusted to kiss—  
but flung back out across the length of the hall—  
“Why are the eyes of Frow so hostile?  
Methinks there are fires burning from her eyes!”

---

4 ęldar ‘fires’ | *emend.; om. R*

---

1 línu ‘linen’ | Like in many other Eurasian cultures, the face of the bride was thickly veiled.

2 ęnd-langan sal ‘across the length of the hall’ | Lit. ‘[across] the endlong hall’. — A formulaic b-verse. In Ancient-words-law it otherwise occurs as part of a formulaic long-line expressing people entering halls; cf. *Vkv* 8 n. In Leeds-meter the acc. pl. ęnd-langa salı is found in *Ski* 3 and in Speeches-meter a variant dat. sg. ęnd(i)-lęngu bısı is attested in *Am* 18/1b, 24/1b; .

3 ęndótt ‘so hostile’ | A rare word. TODO.

4 Þykkja mér ór augum · ęldar brinna! ‘Methinks there are fires burning from her eyes!’ | The line is clearly corrupt in R (‘þicci mer or avgom brenna’); if we place the cæsura between ór and augum the a-verse is only three syllables long and alliteration must quite unnaturally fall on the weakly stressed preposition ór ‘from’. Since vowel alliteration is required by augum, \*ęldar ‘fires’ has been inserted between ‘eyes’ and brenna ‘burns’. This requires the form of 3sg. pres. ind. þykki ‘it seems, -thinks’ R to be changed to 3pl. þykkja, for which reason Finnur Jónsson (1932) has the b-verse as \*ęldr of brinna instead, but the pre-verbal particle of is not otherwise used before the verb brinna ‘burn’ in Þrk, and inserting it seems too hypothetical. An alternative emendation of the line that does not require the changing of the verb is \*þykki mér ęldr · ór augum brinna, but the b-verse with anacrusis is unmetrical and does not appear anywhere else in Þrk. — The same expression is attested in *Gylf* 51:19: ęldar brenna ór augum hans ok nęsum ‘fires burn from his eyes and nostrils’ (cf. *Vsp* H48 n.).

- 28 Sat in **al**-snotra · **ambótt** fyrir  
 2 es **orð** of fann · við **jötuns** máli:  
 „Svaf **vétr** Fręyja · **átta** nóttum,  
 4 svá vas hön **óð**-fús · í **jötun**-hęima.“

[R 17v/29]

Sat the all-clever handmaid in front,  
 who found a word against the ettin's speech:  
 “Frow slept naught for eight nights;  
 so madly She longed for the Ettin-Homes.”

1 fyrir | *add.* †f† R.

- 29 Inn kom in **arma** · **jotna** systir,  
 2 hin's **brúð**-féar · **biðja** þorði:  
 „Lát þér af **hondum** · **hringa** rauða  
 4 ef þú **oðla**=sk vill · **ástir** mínar,  
**ástir** mínar, · **alla** hylli!“

[R 17v/30]

In came the wretched sister of the ettins,  
 she who for the bride-fee had dared ask:  
 “Slide off from thy hands the red rings,  
 if thou wilt win my affections,  
 my affections, [and] all [my] holdness.”

ALL | The sister, who was apparently the one who asked for the Hammer, now has the audacity to ask Thunder (disguised as Frow) to give her the very rings on his hands.

2 brúð-féar ‘the bride-fee’ | Thunder’s hammer.

5 ástir mínar, · alla hylli ‘my affections, [and] all [my] holdness’ | Possibly formulaic. There are no preserved parallels in poetry but there may be one in *Gylf* 49:31–32, following the death of Balder: *En er goð'in vitkuðu-sk, þá mælti Frigg ok spurði, bverr sá véri með ósum, er eigna-sk vildi* „allar ástir minar (so **TW**; ástir hennar ‘her affections’ **SU**) ok hylli, ok vili hann riða á hel-veg ok freista, ef hann fái fundit Baldr, ok bjóða Helju út-laun, ef hón vill láta fara Baldr heim í Ós-garð.“

‘But when the gods came back to their wits, then Frigg spoke and asked which one among the Eese would win “all my affections and boldness and would ride upon the Hellway and try whether he may find Balder and offer Hell a ransom if she will let Balder come home to Osyard.”’

We can tell from the citation of a Leeds-meter stanza at the end of *Gylf* 49 (*Eddbr* V 1 below) that Snorre had access to now-lost Eddic poetry concerning Balder's death, and it may thus be the case that one of these poems contained the same two long-lines as the present ll. 4–5. For such a sharing of several lines cf. st. 14/1–3 above, which is identical to *Bdr* 1/1–3, a Ancient-words-law poem dealing with the earliest part in the Balder-cycle.

- 30 Þá kvað þat **Þrymr**, · **þursa** dróttinn:  
 2 „Berid inn hamar · **brúði** at vígja,  
 leggið **Mjöllni** · í **meyjar** kné,  
 4 vígið okkr saman · **Várar** hendi!“

[R 17v/32]

Then this goth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:  
 “Bear ye in the hammer the bride for to bless;

lay ye Millner in the maiden's lap;  
bless us two together by the hand of Ware!"

---

4 Várar 'Ware' | According to *Gylf* 35:16 *Vör* 'vow, covenant' is the goddess who governs vows between men and women. Here she is apparently invoked as a witness in the wedding ceremony, perhaps a reflex of authentic pagan wedding customs of the Wiking Age. This word may however also be read as the formally identical noun *vör*, which would give us a phrase *várar bönd* 'hand of the vow', perhaps a reference to a certain hand gesture, and leave out the goddess.

- 31      Hló Hlór-riða · hugr í brjósti [R 17v/34]  
2      es harð-hugaðr · hamar of þekkði;  
         Þrym drap hann fyrstan, · þursa dróttin,  
4      ok étt jötuns · alla lamði.

Loride's heart laughed in his chest,  
when, hard-hearted, he recognised the hammer.  
Thrim he smote first, the lord of Thurses,  
and all the ettin's lineage he beat lame.

---

1 Hló Hlór-riða · hugr í brjósti 'Loride's heart laughed in his chest' | Cf. 3 *Guðr* 9/1: *Hló þá Atla* · *hugr í brjósti* 'Then laughed Atle's heart in his chest'.

- 32      Drap hann ina ǫldnu · jǫtna systur, [R 18r/1]  
2      hin's brúð-féar · of beðit hafði;  
         hǫn skell of hlaut · fyr skillinga,  
4      en hogg hamars · fyr hringa fjöld.  
         Svá kom Óðins sonr · ęndr at hamri.

He smote the olden sister of the ettins,  
she who for the bride-fee had asked.  
She got a smiting for shillings,  
and a blow of the hammer for a multitude of rings.  
So came Weden's son back to his hammer.

---

3 skillinga 'shillings' | *skillingr* 'shilling' is commonly used in ON prose and has cognates in other Germanic languages: OE *scilling*, OS, OHG *skilling*, Gothic *skillingg*. This is however its only attestation in Norse poetry of any kind, whether Eddic or Scaldic.



# Lay of Wayland

## (*Vǫlundar kviða*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.428)–early C11th (0.475)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Lay of Wayland** (abbrev. *Vkv*) is a psychologically complex narrative poem dealing with the capture and revenge of the famous smith Wayland.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Vkv* only survives in full in **R** (foll. 18r/4–19v/6), where it follows *Þrk* and is followed by *Alv*. The beginning of the prose introduction is also found on the very last foll. of **A** (6v/26–28), where it follows *Hym*.

Although arguably more of a heroic poem, *Vkv* is part of the mythological section of **R**, to which it conforms orthographically (Lindblad 1980, pp. 160–166). The poem is also found in the otherwise exclusively mythological **A**. It does not belong to the cycle of the Walsings, nor to the Hallow-poems, which are the subjects of the heroic part of **R**. For these reasons, and following the choices of the mediæval editors, *Vkv* is placed under Norse Mythic Poetry in the pres. ed.

### Origin and motifs

*Vkv* is a narrative poem telling the story of Wayland the Smith (ON *Vǫlundr*, OE *Wēland* or *Wēlund*, MHG *\*Wēlent*). Wayland was one of the most popular figures in early mediæval Germanic legend and independent versions of his tale are found in Germany, England, and Iceland.

In his archetypal form, Wayland is an uncannily talented smith who is taken captive and hamstrung by the greedy tyrant King Nithad (ON *Nið-uðr*, OE *Nipbad*, MHG *\*Nidung*). Nithad forces Wayland to make jewels for him and his household but Wayland carries out a cruel revenge against the king: he murders his two sons and rapes his daughter, Beadhild (ON *Bǫðv-ildr*, OE

*Beadubild*, MHG *\*Botil*), making her pregnant. At last, he makes a flight-suit out of feathers, typically (though not in *Vkv*) with the help of his brother Eysel (ON *Egill*, OE *Ægili*). Having regained his mobility through ingenuity he makes his escape and leaves the ruined king's household behind.

There is a strong parallelism throughout the narrative in that Wayland gets his revenge on the whole royal household by doing unto them what was done to him. This theme is developed very effectively in the present poem (but cf. the treatment in the OE *Déor* 1–2). Like Wayland was taken while waiting for his wife, so he murders Nithad's two young sons and ends his family line. Like he was made powerless, he defangs Nithad's *kunnig kvæn* 'cunning wife' by reducing her once powerful counsels to cold words. Like he lost his wife's golden ring, so he rapes Beadhild, depriving her of her maidenhood.

In this way the royal household is reduced to the very same state of abject powerlessness that Wayland himself experienced, something signalled by the repetition of the adjective *vilja-lauss* 'powerless'. In st. 12 this word describes Wayland after he awakes in shackles, but in st. 31 it is King Nithad who uses it to refer to his own mental state after the deaths of his sons. This sense of hopelessness also concludes the poem with Beadhild's haunting words: "In no way did I know how to withstand him; in no way could I withstand him."

### Parallels

As mentioned above, *Vkv* is not the only retelling of Wayland's story. The other relevant retellings are the 9th century OE *Déor* and the 13th century Norse *Þiðr*; the former represents the older, Anglo-Norse version, while the latter represents the younger Low German version.

Wayland is alluded to in numerous other sources, from which we learn a little about the fate of Beadhild. After Wayland abandoned her she gave birth to a son, Woody (OE *Wudga*, *Þiðr Viðga*, in Danish ballads *Vidrik Verlandson*). He went on to become a great hero, and in the later heroic ballads far eclipses his father in fame. His birth seems heavily foreshadowed by Wayland forcing Nithad to swear an oath on the unborn child in st. 33, but he is nowhere directly mentioned in the poem, probably for artistic reasons: dwelling on the tragic image of Beadhild is certainly a powerful ending.

*Déor* shortly relates the lives of five figures from Germanic legend. Stanzas 1–2 deal with Wayland and Beadhild, and the underlying story is identical to that of *Vkv*: Wayland is imprisoned by Nithad, then kills his sons and rapes Beadhild. Like *Vkv*, *Déor* particularly emphasises the powerlessness felt by Wayland and how his revenge in turn inflicted the same on Beadhild.

An Anglo-Saxon pictorial depiction of the story is found on the early C8th Franks casket, which shows Wayland drugging Beadhild, Nithad's decapitated sons, and his brother Eysel collecting swan-feathers for the flight-suit (Fig. 7). The fact that the Wayland-Story is as prominent as the depiction of the Adoration of the Magi is a testament to the weight with which it was regarded in early mediæval England.





Figure 7: The front panel of the Franks casket. Anglo-Saxon, ca. 725 AD.  
 © John W. Schulze. CC BY 2.0. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Franks\\_Casket\\_front.jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Franks_Casket_front.jpg)

The other full retelling of Wayland's life is found in the much younger *Þiðr*. While written in Old Norse, it is clear from the linguistic forms of the proper names and content in it that it is based on Low German sources, probably heroic ballads. Thus the native Norse forms *Völundr* and *Nið-uðr* are replaced with the Low German *Velent* [sic] and *Niðungr*. The 13th century author makes an interesting note which reveals that native Norse stories about Wayland were not yet entirely extinct in his time: he mentions “*Velent*, the excellent smith, whom Warrings (*veringjar* ‘Varangians’) call *Völundr*. [...] *Velent* is so famous in the whole northern hemisphere that all men seem to praise his workmanship in such a way that the craftsman of any piece which is crafted better than others is called a *Völundr* with regards to craftsmanship.”

It is not merely in dialect that *Þiðr* departs from the older retellings; far more important is the difference in tone. The psychological complexity and tragedy of *Vkv* and *Déor* are entirely gone, and Wayland is no longer a mysterious supernatural wild man, but a chivalrous knight who can escape from any peril through his ingenuity and skill. He is not kidnapped out of Nithad's greed nor hamstrung on the suspicions of his cruel wife, but is instead a loyal servant of Nithad's, banished from the kingdom after defending himself against the king's corrupt steward and hamstrung after being caught attempting to poison the king's food.

Yet the biggest change in the narrative is without doubt that the personality of Beadhild is entirely expunged. Far from the Anglo-Norse version she has here become the anonymous “king's daughter”, a nameless *jungfrú* ‘maiden’ (a borrowing from Low German) whom Wayland seduces by means of a vulgar sex joke (“Now the king's daughter comes into the smithy and asks Wayland to mend the ring, but he says that he firsts wants to ‘forge’

something else.”) and who quickly falls in love with him.

Likewise gone is the person of Nithad's cunning wife, and the murder of his sons no longer ends his lineage, since he has another son who survives him and takes over the kingdom. Wayland still flies away laughing after telling Nithad what he has done, but only four years later reconciliates with Nithad's living son, retrieves Beadchild and their three-year old son and lives a long and happy life as a famous smith.

By the time of the *Þiðr* the old story of Wayland had been heavily boulderized, a tragic victim of chivalric sensibilities. This younger version does not have any high literary value, but is of course still of interest since it shows the wide reception and variation of the narrative.

### Origin and motifs

If we are to search for the origins of the Wayland-myth we can hardly look in Scandinavia. As we have seen above the story was particularly popular in Anglo-Saxon England, and it is probably hence that it made its way to Scandinavia.

*Vkv* does indeed show signs of Old English influence in its vocabulary (1/2: *al-vitr*, 11/2: *ljóði*, 36/3: *aukin*), nor do the proper names of its characters (particularly Beadchild and Thankred, the thrall) seem North Germanic. Of course, the poem cannot be a direct translation from OE. The impossibility of that is shown by the use of formulaic Norse lines (e.g. 16/1-2, 30/1-2) and by lines requiring North Germanic sound changes to alliterate (e.g. 14/3: *óra aura · i Ulf-dǫlum* ‘our ounces in the Woldfdales’ vs. reconstructed OE: *\*ūre éaras · in Wulf-dalum*, and note that OE *\*éaras* ‘ounces’ is not even a real word).

Even older versions of the story must needs remain forever lost. It is clear from their names that Wayland and Nithad are fairy-tale characters, not historical figures, for Wayland's name means ‘Crafty Hand’ (< PGmc. *\*wēla-handuz*, Brate 1908) and Nithad's ‘Shameful Fighter’ (< PGmc. *\*niþa-baduz*).

Comparatively there are striking similarities between Wayland and the Greek smith Δαίδαλος. Both are legendary inventors trapped on an island by an evil tyrant for whom they have been forced to work, and both make their escape alongside a near relation (Wayland's brother Eyel, Δαίδαλος' son Ἴκαρος) by means of a flight-suit. The difficulty with these parallels is that the Wayland-story, anchored as it is in Germanic legend, is attested long before knowledge of Greek mythology can have existed in Northern Europe. We may therefore be dealing with much older folklore, perhaps even going back to the Bronze Age (as the image of the Labyrinth definitely does) or the Neolithic European Farmers, although such connections cannot but remain speculation.

A unique narrative feature of the Norse *Vkv* is its incorporation of the motif of the swan-wife at the beginning of the poem. This motif, widespread throughout world mythology (TODO: cite), is not otherwise found in connection with story of Wayland. Whether this is due to the incomplete-

ness of our early parallel sources or a genuine innovation of the Norse Wayland-tradition remains unclear.

## Text

## Frá Völundi ('From Wayland')

- P1 Nið-uðr hét konungr í Sví-þjóð. Hann átti tvá sonu ok eina dóttur; hón hét Bøðv-ildr. Bróðr vöru þrír, synir Finna konungs. Hét einn Slag-fiðr, annarr Egill, þriðji Völundr. Þeir skriðu ok veiddu dýr. Þeir kvómu í Ulf-dali ok gerðu sér þar hús. Þar er vatn, er heitir Úlf-sjár. Snemma of morgin fundu þeir á vats-ströndu konur þrjár, ok spunnu lín. Þar vöru hjá þeim álfthamir þeira; þat vöru val-kyrjur. Þar vöru tvær dótr Hloð-vés konungs: Hlað-guðr svan-hvít ok Her-vor al-vitr. In þriðja var Ql-rún Kjárs dóttir af Val-landi. Þeir hófu þær heim til skála með sér. Fekk Egill Ql-rúnar, en Slag-fiðr svan-hvitrar, en Völundr al-vitrar. Þau bjuggu sjau vetr. Þá flugu þær at vitja víga ok kvómu eigi apr. Þá skreið Egill at leita Ql-rúnar, en Slag-fiðr leitaði svan-hvitrar, en Völundr sat í Ulf-dolum. Hann var ha-gastr maðr, svá at menn viti í fornum sögum. Nið-uðr konungr lét hann hönðum taka, svá sem hér er um kveðit:

[R 18r/4, A 6v/26]

Nithad was the name of a king in Sweden. He had two sons and a daughter; she was called Beadhild. There were three brothers, the sons of a king of the Finns. The one was called Slayfinn, the other Eyel, the third Wayland. They fared on skis and hunted wild beasts. They came into the Wolfdales and made for themselves houses there. There is a lake there which is called the Wolfsea. Early in the morning they found by the lake-shore three women, and they were spinning linen. There beside them were their swan-hames; those were Walkirries. There, there were the two daughters of King Ludwigh: Ladguth the Swanwhite and Harware the Elwright. The third was Alerune, daughter of Coser of Walland. The men took the women to their halls with them. Eyel got Alerune, and Slayfinn the Swanwhite, and Wayland the Elwright. The couples lived there for seven winters; then the women left to attend battles, and they did not come back. Then Eyel fared on skis to search for Alerune, and Slayfinn searched for Swanwhite, but Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales. He was the most skilled craftsman whom men know of in the ancient saws. King Nithad had him taken captive, about which it is here sung:

2 hón hét 'she was called' | ok hét hón 'and she was called' A 2 vöru 'were' | om. R 4 gerðu 'made' | after this word the rest of the ms. ends for loss of following foll. A

9 Kjárs ... af Val-landi 'Coser of Walland' | I.e. 'Caesar of Rome/France'. Of course no specific historical emperor can be identified by this name, but rather it is an anachronistic reflex of the position, a title which has been misunderstood as a proper name. Cf. W'id 4/3, where Coser (OE *Cásere*) is said to rule the Greeks. For the form see st. 15/4 n., for other occurrences see Index.

## Frá Völundi ok Nið-aði ('From Wayland and Nithad')

- 1      **M**eyjar flugu sunnan · **M**yrk-við í gögnum [R 18r/19]  
 2      **a**l-vitr **u**ngar, · **ø**r·løg drýgja;  
          þér á **s**évar strönd · **s**ettu=sk at hvíla=sk,  
 4      **d**rósir suð-rónar · **d**yrt lín spunnu.

Maidens flew from the south through Mirkwood

—young elwights—to fulfill orlay.

By a lake-shore they set down to rest;

the southern ladies span costly linen.

---

2    **u**ngar | *gramm. emend.*; unga **R**

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1 Myrk-við 'Mirkwood' | A great border forest, surely referenced for its association with the war-ravaged lands of the Gots and Huns; a natural environment for Walkirries.

2 al-vitr 'elwights' | "Strange beings, foreign wights", from Proto-Norse \**alja-wibtiz* or borrowed from OE *æl-wibta* pl. 'strange creatures, monsters'.

2 ør-løg drýgja 'to fulfill orlay' | That is, to fulfill their preordained destinies, viz. to attend battles as Walkirries and choose which men to take away (cf. Pl and st. 3). Clunies Ross (2005, p. 103), La Farge and Tucker (1992, p. 319) and others see these words as a sign of English influence and translate *drýgja ør-løg* as 'engage in war', considering *ør-løg* a semantic borrowing from OE *or-lege* 'war, strife' (cf. Dutch *oorlog* 'war'). This is unnecessary. ON *ør-løg* otherwise only means 'fate, destiny', as may OE *or-legg* as seen by an equivalent phrase found in l. 29 of a poem on the Christian Doomsday (TODO?), where a man going to Hell for his sins þenne á tó ealdre · *or-legg dreógeð* 'then for ever and ever suffers his orlay'.

- 2      **E**in nam þeira · **E**gil at verja [R 18r/21]  
 2      **f**ögr mēr **f**ira · **f**aðmi ljósum;  
          önnur vas **S**van·hvít, · **s**van-fjaðrar dró,  
 4      [...]  
          en in þriðja · þeira systir  
 6      varði **h**vítan · **h**als Völundar.

One of them took to embrace Eyel

—the fair maiden among men—in her shining bosom.

Second was Swanwhite; her swan-feathers she rustled,

[...]

but the third sister among them

embraced the white throat of Wayland.

---

6    Völundar | *sens. emend.*; Qnundar **R**

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ALL | The three swan-maidens meet the three brothers, and each one takes a husband.

4 [...] | A line mentioning Slayfinn has probably been lost here.

6 hvítan 'white' | Pale skin being a sign of noble ancestry; cf. 17/3.

- 3      Sǫtu síðan · sǫu vetr at þat, [R 18r/24]  
 2      en hinn áttu · allan þróðu,  
       en hinn níunda · nauðr of skilði,  
 4      meyjar fýstu=sk · á myrkvan við,  
       al-vitr ungar · or-lög drýgja.

They stayed then for seven winters after that,  
 but during all the eighth they yearned,  
 and during the ninth need did part them.  
 The maidens longed for the Mirky Wood,  
 the young elwights to fulfill orlay.

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5 ungar | *gramm. emend.*; unga R

- 4      Kom þar af vęiði · vęðr-ęyr skyti [R 18r/26]  
 2      Vǫlundr líðandi · of langan veg,  
       Slag-fiðr ok Egill, · sali fundu auða,  
 4      gingu út ok inn · ok umb sǫu=sk.

There from the hunt came the stormy-eyed shooter,  
 Wayland passing over a long way.  
 Slayfinn and Eyel found the halls deserted;  
 they walked out and in and looked about.

---

1 vęðr-ęyr | *emend.*, cf. st. 9/3; †vegr†-ęyr R    2 Vǫlundr ... veg ‘Wayland ... way’ | *emend.*  
 based on st. 9/3–4; om. R

- 5      Austr skreidd Egill · at Ql-rúnu, [R 18r/27]  
 2      en suðr Slag-fiðr · at Svan-hvítu,  
       en ęinn Vǫlundr · sat í Ulf-dǫlum.

To the east skied Eyel after Alerune,  
 but to the south Slayfinn after Swanwhite,  
 and alone Wayland stayed in the Woldfdales.

- 6      Hann sló goll rautt · við gim fastan, [R 18r/29]  
 2      lukði alla · linn-bauga vel;  
       svá bæið hann · sinnar ljóssar  
 4      kvánar, ef hǫnum · koma gęði.

He struck red gold against fastened gemstone;  
 he enclosed all the serpent-bighs well.  
 So did he await his shining wife,  
 if for him she might come.

2 linn-bauga ‘serpent-bighs’ | *emend.*; ‘lind bauga’ R 3 ljóssar | *emend.*; ljósar R

1 sló goll rautt · við gim fastan ‘struck red gold against fastened gemstone’ | A description of the *cloisonné* technique wherein red garnet is encased in thin gold plates. Finds featuring this technique are very common in the period between ca. 300–700 AD, but almost non-existent afterwards (Nerman 1931, pp. 33–37). As *Vkv* was most likely composed one or two centuries after 700 this reflects a memory of the material culture of an earlier period. For a similar instance cf. *HHf* 9.

2 linn-bauga ‘serpent-bighs’ | It is unclear whether this word refers to rings actually fitted with snake-heads or is merely a poetic description of twisted rings or spirals. Archeological examples of the former include the so-called “snake-head rings” (German *Schlangenkopfringe*, Swedish *ormbuvudringar*) from the early Migration Period (Nerman 1931, p. 38), and the snake- or dragon-shaped armlet from the Viking Age found in a hoard in Undrom, Ångermanland, northern Sweden (item number 108822 HST; <https://samlingar.shm.se/object/5C5658C4-0813-4DFF-947F-E5E4C4BAB965>).

- 7 Þat spyrð Níð-uðr, · Níara dróttinn,  
2 at ęinn Völundr · sat í Ulf-dölum;  
nóttum fóru seggir, · næglðar vöru brynjur,  
4 skildir bliku þęira · við inn skarða mána.

[R 18r/31]

Nithad learns it, lord of the Nears,  
that alone Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales.  
At night journeyed warriors—nailed were their byrnies—  
their shields gleamed by the sickle moon.

3 fóru | *emend.*; vöru R 3 seggir | *emend.*; segir R

1 Níara ‘the Nears’ | An obscure tribe. The fact that they are located in Sweden (P1 above) may allow us to connect them with the inhabitants of the Swedish province of Närke, who in OSwe. are known as *Nerikjar*, most likely from the tribal/geographical root *nær-* + *-ikjar* ‘inhabitants’. The stem *nær-* (with unclear vowel length) is also found in the adjective OSwe. *nær-isker* ‘belonging to Närke, Närkeian’ and could then be the equivalent of ODN *níar- ~ njár-*. For further discussion on the origin of OSwe. *nær-* see Sahlgren (1925).

3 næglðar vöru brynjur ‘nailed were their byrnies’ | The byrnies here are some kind of plate armour.

- 8 Stigu ór sðölum · at salar gaffi,  
2 gingu inn þaðan · ęnd-langan sal,  
söu á bast · bauga dregna,  
4 sjau hundruð allra, · es sá seggr átti.

[R 18r/33]

They stepped off their saddles by the hall’s gables,  
went thence inside the endlong hall.  
They saw on a bast-rope bighs drawn up,  
the seven hundred in all which that man owned.

2 gingu ... sal ‘went ... hall’ | The line appears to be a variant of the formulaic *hann/bön inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal* ‘he/she went inside the endlong hall’ which also occurs in below *Vkv* 16/2 and 30/2 and in *Oddr* 3/3. For *ęnd-langan sal* ‘endlong hall’ in general cf. *Þrk* 27/2 n.

- 9 Ok þeir af tóku · ok þeir á létu [R 18v/2]  
 2 fyr çinn útan, · es af létu.  
 Kom þar af vçjði · veðr-eygr skyti  
 4 Völundr líðandi · of langan veg.

And they took them off and they slid them on,  
 save for one which they slid off.—  
 There from the hunt came the stormy-eyed shooter,  
 Wayland passing over a long way.

2 fyr çinn útan, · es af létu ‘save for one which they slid off’ | This bigh is probably the one mentioned in sts. 17 and 26, since Beadhild has it already when Wayland is brought back after being captured. It may have been kept for its particular beauty. Finnur Jónsson (1932) writes, in my translation from the Danish: “The ring which Nithad kept must have had special properties and distinguished itself before others. There is no doubt that the ring is a flight ring; whether this was clear to the poet is however questionable. This much is certain: that Wayland seems to be able to fly away only after he has got back the ring; that is, the one which Beadhild brings him.” This is by no means certain. Wayland was a craftsman of legendary skill and could certainly have built wings for himself without a magical flight-ring. That is what he does in the Low German version; it is also what happens in the related Daidalos myth. For both of these see the introduction to the present poem.

- 10 Gekk hann brünni · beru hold stçikja;  
 2 ár brann hrísi · all-þurr fura,  
 viðr inn vind-þurri, · fyr Völundi.

He went the brown she-bear’s flesh to roast.  
 In early morn burned the twigs of all-dry pine,  
 the wind-dry wood, before Wayland.

2 ár | *metr. and sens. emend.*; háR R

- 11 Sat á ber-fjalli, · bauga talði,  
 2 alfa ljóði · çins saknaði;  
 hugði at hefði · Hlōð-vés dóttir,  
 4 al-vitr unga · vçri aprt komin.

He sat on the bear-pelt, the bighs he counted—  
 the prince of elves was missing one!  
 He thought that Ludwigh’s daughter [= Harware] might have it,  
 that the young elwight might be come again!

1 bauga talði ‘bighs he counted’ | Wayland’s grief and loneliness is skilfully illustrated by his counting all seven hundred rings, something which has apparently become habitual for him.

2 alfa ljóði ‘prince of elves’ | Probably referring to Wayland’s nature as a wild man; this is further seen by his bear-hunting, skiing, and fierce gaze, all associated with the Finns or Saami. Cf. 14/2b and 32/1b, where Nithad calls him *vísi alfa* ‘chief of elves’.



- 12 Sat svá lengi, · at sofnaði,  
 2 ok vaknaði · vilja-lauss;  
 vissi sér á hǫndum · hǫfgar nauðir,  
 4 en á fótum · fǫtur of spenntan.

[R 18v/7]

He sat so long that he fell asleep,  
 and he awoke, powerless.  
 He knew on his hands heavy restraints,  
 and on his feet a fetter tightened.

- [Völundr kvað:] 13 „Hverir ’ro jǫfrar · þeir’s á lögðu  
 2 bęsti\*-síma · ok bundu mik?“

[R 18v/9]

[Quoth Wayland:] “Which are the princes that have laid on  
 the bast-cordage, and bound me?”

2 bęsti\*-síma | *emend.*; ‘besti-byr-síma’ R

- 14 Kallaði nú Níð-uðr, · Níara dróttinn:  
 2 „Hvar gatst, Völundr, · vísi alfa,  
 óra *aura*, · í Ulf-dǫlum?  
 4 Goll vas þar ęigi · á Grana leiðu,  
 fjarri hugða’k vart land · fjǫllum Rínar.“

[R 18v/10]

Now Nithad called, lord of the Nears:  
 “Where didst thou, Wayland, O chief of elves,  
 get *our* ounces in the Woldfdales?  
 Gold was there not on Grane’s path;  
 far I’ve thought our land from the fells of the Rhine!”

ALL | Grane was the horse of the legendary hero Siward, who slew the dragon Fathomer and took his gold (see *Fáfi*); these events are here, as in the later German *Nibelung* tradition, supposed to have taken place around the Rhine. Nithad’s speech is sarcastic: “How did you get so rich, Wayland? Was there a dragon’s hoard in the Woldfdales? Clearly not, so you must have stolen from me.”

- [Völundr kvað:] 15 „Man’k at męiri · męti ǫttum,  
 2 es vér hęil híu · hęima vǫrum:  
 Hlað-guðr ok Hęr-vǫr · borin vas Hlǫð-véi,  
 4 kunn vas Ql-rún · Kíars dóttir.“

[R 18v/13]

[Quoth Wayland:] “I recall that we owned a greater treasure  
 when we a whole household were at home.  
 Ladguth and Harware were born to Ludwigh;  
 known was Alerune, Coser’s daughter.”

ALL. | Wayland responds rather cryptically and almost seems to be speaking to himself. By asserting the noble lineages of the three swan-wives he gives a legitimate origin for his wealth, but is at the same time aware that Nithad neither believes him nor cares.

2 *hiu* ‘household’ | The meter (a normal type C, x#x#P#px) requires the restoration of the old hiatus form *hiu* for *hjú*, a sign of composition before ca. 1150. The alternative scansion would be catalectic.

4 *Kiars* ‘Coser’s’ | For the sense of this name see note to P1 above. — For the sake of meter the uncontracted hiatus form *Kiarr* must be restored from *Kjárr*; the verse is otherwise only three syllables long and catalectic. The uncontracted form is also metrically necessary in *Akv* 8/1b and *Edáð Banddr* 2 (SkP 1). — The development from Latin *Caesar* to ON *Kiarr* ~ *Kjárr* requires some elucidation. The word was first borrowed from Classical Latin into PGmc. as *\*kaisaraz* (cf. OHG *kbēisur* in *Hild* 33, OE *Cāser* in *Wid* 4/3), which would be expected to yield ON *\*\*kēisarr* were it not for an obscure Norse sound change causing the debuccalization of *\*s* > *\*h* > *Ø* in the first syllable of 3-syllable words when followed by *r* in a following syllable (cf. ON *órr* ~ *varr* ‘our’ < *\*óarr* < *\*ósarr* < PN *\*onsarar* < PGmc. *\*unseraz*; ON *járn* ~ *éarn* < *ísarn*), so that *\*kēisarr* > *kiarr* (~ *\*kéarr*). The loss of the diphthong is not unexpected, *\*\*-(j)a-* being an utterly illegal vowel glide. The later ON *keisari*, *keiseri* is undoubtedly borrowed from Low German.

- 16 *Úti stóð kunnig · kvæn Nið-aðar*  
 2 *ok hōn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal,*  
*stóð à golfi, · stilti rōddu:*  
 4 „es=a sá nú hýrr, · es ór holti fęrr.“

[R 18v/15]

Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad;  
 and she went inside the endlong hall,  
 stood on the floor, steered her voice:  
 “He is not mild now, who comes out of the wood.”

1 *Úti stóð kunnig · kvæn Nið-aðar* ‘Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad’ | *emend. required by the sense* (cf. st. 30/1–2); *om. R*

1 *Úti stóð kunnig · kvæn Nið-aðar* ‘Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad’ | Formulaic long-line template; cf. 1 *HHund* 48/3, *Brot* 5/1. That it in fact a formulaic line is shown by its combination with other formulaic lines, both here and in *Brot* 5.

2 *ok hōn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal* ‘and she went inside the endlong hall’ | Formulaic; cf. st. 8/2 n. above.

- P2 *Nið-uðr konungr gaf dóttur sinni Bōðv-ildi gull-hring þann er*  
 2 *hann tók af basti’nu at Vōlundar, en hann sjalfr bar sverð’it er*  
*Vōlundr átti. En dróttning kvað:*

[R 18v/16]

King Nithad gave his daughter Beadhild the golden ring which he took from the bast rope in Wayland’s hall, but he himself carried the sword which Wayland had owned. But the queen said:

- 17 „Tęnn hōnum tęygja=sk · es hōnum ’s tęt sverð,  
 2 *ok hann Bōðv-ildar · baug of þękkir,*

[R 18v/19]

4      **ó**mun eru **augu** · **or**mi inum frána;  
          **sníð**ð **ér** hann · **sin**va magni,  
          ok **setið** hann **síðan** · í **Sévar**-stoð.“

“His teeth are bared when he is shown the sword,  
and Beadchild’s high he recognises!  
Reminiscent are his eyes to the gleaming serpent’s!  
Snithe ye from him the might of his sinews,  
and set him thereafter on the Seastead!”

4 **sin**va | *metr. emend.*; sina R

4 *sinva* | The meter requires a heavy syllable for the lift, which may be obtained by restoring the archaic gen. pl. *\*sinva* of *sin* ‘sinew’ (< PGmc. *\*sin(a)wō*) (Robert D. Fulk 2016, p. 265). For the medial *-v-* cf. *bol* ‘bale, curse’ (< PGmc. *\*balwa*), gen. pl. *bolva*.

P3 Svá var gort, at skornar vóru sínar í knés-fótum ok settir í holm [R 18v/21]  
 2 einn, er þar var fyrir landi, er hét Sévar-staðr. Þar smíðaði hann  
 konungi alls-kyns gort-simar; engi maðr þorði at fara til hans,  
 4 nema konungr einn. Volundr kvað:

So it was done that the sinews in his houghs were cut and he was placed on the lonely islet which lay there before the land and which was called the Seastead. There he forged for the king every kind of jewel. No man dared go to him, save for the king alone. Quoth Wayland:

18 „Skínn Níð·aði · sverð á linda, [R 18v/24]  
 2 þat's ek hvesta · sëm hagast kunna'k  
 ok ek herða'k · sëm hógst þótti;  
 4 sá 's mér fránn mekir · ę fjarri borinn;  
 s'ek=a þann Volundi · til smiðju borinn.

“The sword does shine on Nithad’s belt,  
which I sharpened as most handily I could,  
and I hardened as most pleasingly seemed.  
That gleaming blade is ever further from me carried;  
I see it not for Wayland to the smithy carried!

1 Skinn 'shines' | Metrically deficient, since *sk-* and *s-* cannot alliterate. A possible emendation is *se'k* 'I see'.

19 Nú berr Bǫðv-ildr · brúðar minnar [R 18v/27]  
2 —bíð'k=a þess bót— · bauga rauða.“  
Now does Beadhild bear my bride's  
—I await no recompense for that—red bighs.”

20 Sat—né svaf á valt— · ok sló hamri;

[R 18v/28]

2 vél gerði heldr · hvatt Níð-aði;

drifu ungir tveir · á dýr sea

4 synir Níð-aðar · í Sævar-stöð.

He sat—never slept—and struck the hammer;  
he most boldly planned wiles for Nithad.

Two young ones were drifting to see costly things,  
Nithad's sons, to the Seastead.

1 Sat—né svaf á valt— 'He sat—never slept—' | Compare *Gbv* 13/3: *höfu mik—né drękkðu—*  
'[they] lifted me—drowned [me] not—'.

21 Kvömu til kistu, · kröfðu lukla,

[R 18v/30]

2 opin vas ill-úð, · es þeir í söu,

þjöld vas þar męina, · es moggum sýndi=sk

4 at véri goll rautt · ok gǫr-simar.

They came to the chest, demanded the keys;  
open was the evil when they looked inside.

A host was there of harms, which looked to the lads  
like were it red gold and jewelry.

[Vǫlundr kvað:] 22 „Komið ęinir tveir, · komið annars dags;

[R 18v/33]

2 ykkir lét'k þat goll · of gefit verða;

sęgið-a męyjum · né sal-þjóðum,

4 manni ęngum, · at mik fyndið.“

[Quoth Wayland:] “Come alone ye two, come another day;  
to you, I say, this gold will be given.  
Tell no maidens nor folk of the hall  
—not a man!—that *me* ye met.”

23 Snimma kallaði · sęggr á annan,

[R 19r/1]

2 bróðir á bróður: · „ęngum baug sea!“

Kvömu til kistu, · kröfðu lukla,

4 opin vas ill-úð · es þeir í litu.

Early one youth called out to another,  
brother to brother: “Let us go see the highs!”  
They came to the chest, demanded the keys;  
open was the evil when they gazed inside.

1 kallaði | *emend.*; kallað R

- 24      Snęið af hǫfuð · huna þęira [R 19r/3]  
 2      ok und fęn fјoturs · fǫtr of lagði,  
       ęn þęr skálar, · es und skǫrum vǫru,  
 4      sveip útan silfri, · sęldi Níð·aði.

He sliced off the heads of those bear-cubs,  
 and under the fetter's fen their feet he laid,  
 but the bowls which were under their curls  
 he coated with silver, gave to Nithad.

---

2 lagði | emend.; †logði† R

---

1 huna 'bear-cubs' | This word is common in prose, but only in the sense 'bear-cub', never used as here about humans. The affectionate sense for young boys perhaps relates to warrior-initiations done in bear-skins. Its only occurrence in the sense 'young boys' outside of *Vkv* is in *Ghv* 12/1, but it is repeated by Nithad in st. 32 and mirrored by Wayland in st. 34 below.

2 fęn fјoturs 'the fetter's fen' | Unclear. The smithy or islet may be Wayland's "fetter", in which case he buried them in a fen on the island.

3 þęr skálar, · es und skǫrum vǫru 'the bowls which were under their curls' | Their skulls.

- 25      Eęn ór augum · jarkna-stęina [R 19r/5]  
 2      sęndi kunnigri · kvęn Níð·aðar;  
       ęn ór tǫnnum · tveggja þęira  
 4      sló brjóst-kringlur, · sęndi Bǫðv·ildi.

But out of their eyes arkenstones  
 did he send to the cunning wife of Nithad,  
 and out of the teeth of the two  
 he struck breast-brooches, sent them to Beadhild.

---

2 kvęn | emend.; konu R

---

1 jarkna-stęina 'arkenstones' | Generally held to be a borrowing from OE. Probably round crystals.

- 26      Þa nam Bǫðv·ildir · baugi at hrósa [R 19r/7]  
 2      [...] · es brotit hafði,  
       „þori'g=a'k segja, · nema þęr ęinum.“

Then Beadhild began to praise the bigh,  
 [...] which she had broken,  
 “I dare not tell it, save to thee alone!”

---

ALL | Something appears to be missing before this stanza, but the narrative can be gleaned. Beadhild breaks the bigh given to her by Nithad (mentioned above in sts. 10—see note there—and 17), and fears her father's anger. She goes to Wayland in secret and begs him to fix it. The sight of the ring reminds Wayland of his wife and he is furious; he decides to begin with his revenge, and rapes Beadhild.

2 [...] | The meter requires a half-line here, perhaps containing a repetition of 1a: *baugi at brósa* ‘to praise the bigh’.

Völundr kvað: 27 „Ek **bóti** svá · **brest** á golli, [R 19r/8]  
 2 at **fęðr** þínum · **fęgri** þykkir,  
 ok **móðr** þínni · **miklu** bętri,  
 4 ok **sja**lfri þér · at **sama** hófi.“

Quoth Wayland: “I will so mend the crack on the gold,  
 that to thy father it seems fairer,  
 and to thy mother even better,  
 and to thyself of the self-same rank.”

28 **Bar** hana **bjóri**, · því't **bętr** kunni, [R 19r/10]  
 2 **svá't** hęn í **sessi** · of **sofnaði**.  
 [Völundr kvað:] „Nú **hęfi**'k **hęft** · **harma** mínna  
 4 **allra** nema **ęinna** · **į-við-gjarna**.“

He overcame her with beer—for he knew better—  
 so that she in the seat did fall asleep.  
 “Now have I avenged my harms,  
 all, save one, on the insidious ones.”

4 į-við-gjarna | *emend.*; į-við-†giarira† R

1 því't bętr kunni ‘for he knew better’ | He was more cunning than she.

4 nema ęinna ‘save one’ | Presumably the deprivation of his mobility due to the hamstringing, which he resolves by crafting his flight suit.

4 į-við-gjarna ‘insidious ones’ | King Nithad and his house.

29 „Vęl ek,“ kvað Völundr, · „**verða**'k á fitjum, [R 19r/12]  
 2 þęim's mik **Nið-aðar** · **nómu** rekkar.“  
**Hlęjandi** Völundr · **hóf**=sk at lopti,  
 4 **grátandi** Bęðv-ildr · **gekk** ór ęyju,  
**tregði** **fęr** **friðils** · ok **fęður** ręiði.

“Well I”, quoth Wayland, “do fall on my paddles,  
 those of which Nithad's men bereaved me!”  
 Laughing, Wayland threw himself in the air;  
 weeping, Beadhild went from the island,  
 grieved her lover's flight and her father's wrath.

1 fitjum ‘paddles’ | CV: *fit* ‘the webbed foot of water-birds’, here a reference to the flight-suit which allows Wayland to regain his freedom.

- 30 Úti stóð kunnig · kvön Nið-aðar,  
 2 ok hön inn of gekk · end-langan sal,  
 en hann á sal-garð · sætti=sk at hvíla=sk,  
 4 „Vakir þú Nið-uðr, · Níara dróttinn?“

[R 19r/14]

Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad  
 and she went inside the endlong hall,  
 but he on the courtyard set down to rest—  
 “Art thou awake, O Nithad, lord of the Nears?”

1 stóð ‘stood’ | *emend.*; stęndr ‘stands’ R

- [Nið-uðr kvað:] 31 „Vaki’k á-valt · vilja-lauss,  
 2 sofna’k minst, · síðst sonu dauða,  
 kęll mik í hofuð, · kǫld eru=mk rǫð þín,  
 4 vilnumk þess nú, · at við Vǫlund dǫma’k.“

[R 19r/17]

[Quoth Nithad:] “I am always awake, powerless;  
 I sleep the least since my sons did die.  
 My head turns cold; cold seem thy counsels—  
 would now but that I could speak with Wayland!”

1 Vaki’k á-valt · vilja-lauss ‘I am always awake, powerless’ | This line references sts. 12 and 20, but there Wayland was the powerless man who never slept. By his revenge the suffering has been transferred onto Nithad.

3 kǫld eru=mk rǫð þín ‘cold seem thy counsels’ | A severe insult to a woman of power, for such counsels to her husband was how she would influence worldly affairs. In this way Wayland’s revenge reaches also Nithad’s wife.

- [Nið-uðr kvað:] 32 „Sęg mér þat Vǫlundr, · vísi alfa,  
 2 af hęilum hvat · varð bǫnum mǫnum?“

[R 19r/19]

[Quoth Nithad:] “Tell me this, Wayland, O chief of elves:  
 what became of my healthy bear-cubs?”

2 bǫnum | *metr. emend.*; sonum R

ALL | The scene shifts again. King Nithad, standing on the ground, sees Wayland hovering in the sky. He calls out to him.

- [Vǫlundr kvað:] 33 „Eiða skalt mér áðr · alla vinna,  
 2 at skips borði · ok at skjaldar rǫnd,  
 at mars bǫgi · ok at mękis egg  
 4 at þú kvęlj=at · kvön Vǫlundar,  
 né brúði mínni · at bana verðir,

[R 19r/20]

- 6 þó'tt kvön *ęigim*, · þá's \**ęr* kunnið,  
eða jóð *ęigim* · innan hallar.

[Quoth Wayland:] "Oaths shalt thou first swear to me, all:  
by side of ship and rim of shield,  
by bough of steed and edge of sword—  
that thou shalt not torture the wife of Wayland,  
nor of my bride become the bane,  
although we might own a wife which ye might know,  
or might own a babe within your hall.

6 *ęigim* | *emend.*; †*ęigim*† R 6 \**ęr* | *metr. emend.*; þér R 7 eða | *emend.*; †*ęþ*† R

2–3 at skips ... *ęgg* 'by side ... of sword' | Nithad must swear oaths by the tools of trade of the warrior i.e., on his martial honour. Cf. 2 *HHund*, where broken oaths are to come back "biting" the oath-breaker by cursing his ship, horse, and sword, in that order.

4 *kvęlj*=at 'shalt not torture' | A negative imperative. The 2nd. sg. imper. of *kvęlja* 'torture' is *kvęl*, but the negative clitic =at causes the -j- of the stem to reappear in a rare *liaison* effect. This indicates that forms like *kvęl* were still understood to contain -j-, just no longer pronounced, but which could reappear in the correct circumstance.

4–5 kvön Völundar 'wife of Wayland', brúði mínna 'my bride' | Beadhild, who is now pregnant.

- 34 Gakk til smiðju, · þęirar's gøðir,  
2 þar fiðr bęlgi · blóði stokna,  
sneið'k af høfuð · huna þinna  
4 ok und fęn fјoturs · fōtr of lagða'k.

[R 19r/24]

Go to the smithy, which thou madest;  
there wilt thou find the bellows blood-besprinkled.  
I sliced off the heads of thy bear-cubs,  
and under the fetter's fęn their feet I laid.

- 35 Eņ þęr skálar, · es und skęrum vóru,  
2 svęip'k útan silfri, · sęlda'k Nið·aði,  
en ór augum · jarkna-stęina,  
4 sęnda'k kunnigri · kvön Nið·aðar.

[R 19r/26]

But the bowls which were under their curls,  
I coated with silver, gave to Nithad,  
and out of the eyes arkenstones  
did I send to the cunning wife of Nithad.

- 36 Eņ ór tønnum · tveggja þęira  
2 slók brјóst-kringlur, · sęnda'k Bęðv·ildi;  
nú gęngr Bęðv·ildr · barni aukin,

[R 19r/28]





[Níð-uðr kvað:] **40** „Es þat satt Bøðv-ildr, · es soggðu mér,  
2 sǫtuð it Vǫlundr · saman í holmi?“

[R 19v/3]

[Quoth Nithad:] “Is it true, Beadchild, as they told me—  
did thou and Wayland stay together on the islet?”

[Bøðv-ildr kvað:] **41** „Satt ’s þat Níð-uðr · es sagði þér:  
2 sǫtum vit Vǫlundr · saman í holmi  
3 ǣna ǫgur-stund, · ǣva skyldi;  
4 ek vǣtr hǫnum · vinna kunna’k,  
ek vǣtr hǫnum · vinna máttak.“

[R 19v/4]

[Quoth Beadchild:] “It is true, Nithad, which *he* told thee.  
I and Wayland stayed together on the islet  
for one heavy hour—it should never have been.  
I nowise knew withstand him;  
I nowise could withstand him.”

4 *vinna* | *metr. and sens. emend.; om. R*

1 sagði ‘*he* told’ | Beadchild knows that Wayland is the only one aware of the rape and thus deduces that *he* told her father. She makes a subtle change in the conjugation from her father’s general third person plural (“what they told”), to the specific singular form (“what *he* told”).

4–5 kunna’k ‘knew’, máttak ‘could’ | Beadchild did not know (*kunna* ‘to know, understand’) how to ward him off, yet even if she had been wise enough, she would still have been overpowered, for she had not the strength (*mega* ‘to have strength to, avail’). A touching final stanza.

# Speeches of Allwise

## (*Al·víss mól*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.851)

**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Allwise** (*Alvissmal*) is a list of poetic synonyms set in a frame narrative of Thunder being visited by a dwarf insisting that he has been promised his daughter's hand.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Alv* is found in whole in **R** on foll. 19v/7–20r/19, where it follows *Vkv* and is followed by *1 HHund*. It concludes the mythological group of poems (to which also *Vkv* belongs) in the manuscript; the immediately following *1 HHund* introduces the heroic group.

The poem was known to Snorre. Sts. 20 and 30 are cited in *Skm*, where they are attributed to *Al·víss mól* in TODO (A, C) and to *Al·svinns mól* 'the Speeches of Allswith' in all other mss. (TODO).

### Origin and motifs

There is not much of a story in *Alv*, but two elements of the frame narrative (sts. 1–8, 35) are of interest.

The first is the motif of an enemy of the Gods wishing to steal away one of their women. This is also attested in the myth of the ettin Master Builder (*Vsp* 24 nn., *Gylf* 42) and in *Þrk* (see Introduction to that poem), where the ettin Thrim demands the hand of the goddess Frow as a ransom for Thunder's hammer Millner.

The second motif is that of a dwarf perishing (usually by turning to stone, e.g. *HHj* 29–30, although that is not stated explicitly in *Alv*) when exposed to sunlight at daybreak, a motif famously employed by J.R.R Tolkien in *The Hobbit*.

### The language of the Gods

The bulk of the poem (sts. 9–34) is however taken up by the listing of poetic synonyms for various phenomena. *Alv* contrasts the normal terms used by men with those used by the Elves, Dwarfs, Gods, and those in Hell or the Underworld. Some of these synonyms, especially those said to be used by the Gods, are quite archaic and represent older common Indo-European and Germanic words that have been displaced by younger words in the common register (10/1 *fold*, 26/1 *funi*, 32/1 *barr*) or alternate forms of the same IE root (16/1 *sunna*). Others are transparent kennings not found elsewhere.

The fascinating idea of a language of the Gods is not unique to the Norse but is also attested in other cultures.

Notably, Homer often mentions that things have different names among Gods and mortals. So a certain hill at Troy “do men truly call ‘Thorny Hill’ (Βατείαν), but the Undying ‘the Barrow of much-springing Myrina’ (σῆμα πολυ-σκάρθμοιο Μυρίνης)” (*Il* 2.813–814); a certain bird “do Gods call Bronzen (χαλκίδα), but men κύμινδιν” (*Il* 14.291); and the river Scamander “do Gods call Xanthus (Ξάνθον), but men Scamander (Σκάμανδρον)” (*Il* 20.74).

### Meter and stanza

The meter of *Alv* is Leeds-meter. The poem consists of 140 lines (71 full-lines, 70 long-lines) divided into 35 sts., all of which follow the typical structure *abcabc* except for the final st. 35 which has the 5-line structure *abcabcc*.

### Summary

As mentioned above the frame narrative of the poem consists of sts. 1–8 at the beginning and 35 at the very end.

The section dealing with names (sts. 9–34) is tightly structured and the phenomena are frequently paired according to their nature, e.g. earth and heaven (9–12), sun and moon (15–18), water and fire (23–26). The following phenomena are dealt with:

Sts. 9–10: earth, 11–12: heaven, 13–14: moon, 15–16: sun, 17–18: clouds, 19–20: wind, 21–22: calm weather, 23–24: water, 25–26: fire, 27–28: wood, 29–30: night, 31–32: grain, 33–34: ale.

## Text

## The Speeches of Allwise

- [Al-víss kvað:] 1 „Bekki breiða · nú skal brúðr með mér  
2 heim í sinni snúask;  
hratat of mégi · mun hverjum þikkja;  
4 heima skal=at hvíld nema.“ [R 19v/7–8]
- [Quoth Allwise:] “SPREAD OUT ON THE BENCHES shall now the bride with me,  
[and] turn home by my side.  
A hurried engagement it will seem to each;  
at home shall she not take rest!”
- [Þórr kvað:] 2 „Hvat ’s þat fira; · hví est svá fǫlr umb nasar;  
2 vast-u í nǫtt með ná?  
Þursa líki · þikki mér á þér vesa;  
4 est=at-tu til brúðar borinn.“ [R 19v/9–10]
- [Quoth Thunder:] “What sort of man is this; why art thou so pale about the nose;  
wast thou tonight with a corpse?  
The likeness of a thurse methinks thou hast;  
thou wast not born for this bride!”
- [Al-víss kvað:] 3 „Al-víss ek heiti · bý’k fyr jorð neðan  
2 á’k undir stęini stað.  
vagna vers · ek em á vit kominn  
4 bregði engi fǫstu heiti fira.“ [R 19v/10–12]
- [Quoth Allwise:] “Allwise I am called; I live beneath the earth;  
I own under a stone my home.  
The man of wagons [= Thunder] I am come to visit;  
let no man break a firm vow!”
- 
- 3 vagna vers ‘man of wagons’ | The “wagons” may here be constellations in the heavens, namely the *Charles’ Wain* (Great Bear, Big Dipper) and *Women’s Wain* (Little Bear, Little Dipper). Cf. *Skm* 31, where heaven/the sky is kenned *land sólar ok tungls ok himin-tungla, vagna ok vęðra* ‘the land of sun and moon, and the heavenly bodies, wagons and winds.’
- [Þórr kvað:] 4 „Ek mun bregða · því’t ek brúðar á  
2 flest umb rǫð sem fǫðir.  
vas’k=a ek heima · þá’s þér heitit vas  
4 at sá ęinn es gjǫf es með goðum.“ [R 19v/12–14]

[Quoth Thunder:] “I will break it, for about the bride  
I have the greatest say, as her father.  
I was not at home when it was vowed to thee,  
but he [I] alone is the giver among the Gods.”

[Al-viss kvað:] 5 „Hvat ’s þat rekka · es í rǫðum tǣlsk [R 19v/14–16]  
2 fljóðs ins fagr-glóa;  
fjarra-fléina · þik munu fair kunna;  
4 hveṛr hefir þik baugum borit?“

[Quoth Allwise:] “What sort of champion is this who claims to have a say  
about the fair-glowing girl?  
O foreign tramp, few men will know thee;  
who has borne bigs to thee?”

[Þórr kvað:] 6 „Ving-Þórr ek heiti · ek hefí víða ratat [R 19v/16–18]  
2 sonr em’k Síð-grana;  
at ó-sátt mínni · skalt þat it unga man hafa  
4 ok þat gjaf-orð geta.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Wing-Thunder I am called; I have widely roamed;  
I am the son of Sidegrane.  
Against my assent shalt thou have this young girl,  
and get that gift-word!”

[Al-viss kvað:] 7 „Sáttir þínar · es ek vil snemma hafa [R 19v/18–20]  
2 ok þat gjaf-orð geta.  
eiga vilja · heldr an án vera  
4 þat it mjall-hvíta man.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Thy assents I wish to have soon,  
and get that gift-word,  
I would rather have than be without  
this snow-white girl.”

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<sup>4</sup> þat it mjall-hvíta man ‘this snow-white girl’ | For whiteness as a symbol of nobility cf. Introduction to *Rþ*.

[Þórr kvað:] 8 „Meyjar óstum · mun=a þér verða [R 19v/20–21]  
2 vísi gæstr of varit,  
ef þú ór heimi kant · hveṛjum at segja  
4 allt þat’s ek vil vita.

[Quoth Thunder:] “The maiden’s love will not be,  
O wise guest, denied thee,  
if thou from every home canst tell  
all I wish to know:

9      Sög-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rök fira  
2              vqr=umk dvergr at vitir,  
            hvé sú jorð heitir · es liggr fyr alda sonum  
4              heimi hverjum í.“

[R 19v/21–23]

Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the earth is called which lies before the sons of men  
in every home.”

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1 ǫll of rök fira ‘all rakes of men’ | To be understood as ‘all lore’.

[Al·víss kvað:] 10      „Jorð heitir með mǫnnum · en með ǫsum fold,  
2              kalla vega vanir.  
            í-grón jotnar · alfar gróandi  
4              kalla aur upp-rēgin.“

[R 19v/23–25]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Earth it is called among men but among the Eese ‘fold’;  
call it ‘ways’ the Wanes,  
‘evergreen’ Ettins, Elves ‘growing’;  
call it ‘mud’ the Up-reins.”

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1 ǫsum ‘Eese’ | ǫlfum ‘Elves’ R

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1 ǫsum ‘Eese’ | The emendation from Elves to Eese is non-controversial. The second verse in each answer-stanza otherwise always mentions the Gods, either with ǫsum ‘Eese’ and the same structure as the present verse (so sts. 26 and 34), or with goðum ‘Gods’ (so 12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 28, 30, 32). Aside from this argument, there is otherwise a repetition, as elves are mentioned in l. 3. The error is in any case easily understandable, since the two words are written similarly and both refer to supernatural beings.

[Þórr kvað:] 11      „Sög-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rök fira  
2              vqr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
            hvé sá himinn heitir · erakendi  
4              heimi hverjum í.“

[R 19v/25]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the heaven is called ...  
in every home.”

3 *erakendi* ‘...’ | A string too corrupt to restore without excessive conjecture; it at least appears to contain the relative pronoun *er* ‘which’, younger form of *es* and the adjective *kenndr* ‘known’. Based on the first line, the alliteration must have fallen on *b-*, and the root that first suggests itself is *hēð* ‘height’. A possible restoration is then *es á hēð es kenndr* ‘which is known on high’.

[Al-viss kvað:] 12 „Himinn heitir með mǫnnum · en Hlýrnir með goðum [R 19v/26–27]  
 2 kalla Vind-ófnir vanir;  
 upp-heim jǫtnar · alfar fagra-réfr  
 4 dvergar drjúpan sal.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Heaven it is called among men but ‘Lerner’ among the Gods;  
 ‘Wind-ovner’ call it the Wanes;  
 ‘upham’ Ettins, Elves ‘fair roof’,  
 Dwarfs ‘dripping hall’.”

[Þórr kvað:] 13 „Segðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira [R 19v/27–28]  
 2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
 hversu máni heitir · sá’s męnn sjá  
 4 heimi hverjum í.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
 how the moon is called which men do see  
 in every home.”

[Al-viss kvað:] 14 „Máni heitir með mǫnnum · en Mylinn með goðum, [R 19v/28–30]  
 2 kalla hverfanda hvél helju í;  
 skyndi jǫtnar · en skin dvergar  
 4 kalla alfar ár-tala.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Moon it is called among men, but ‘Milen’ among the Gods,  
 they call it ‘turning wheel’ in Hell,  
 ‘haster’ Ettins and ‘shine’ Dwarfs;  
 Elves call it ‘year-tallier’.”

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<sup>4</sup> ár-tala ‘year-tallier’ | The moon was important in the Germanic calendar (witness *month*, a “moon-th”). Cf. *Vsp* 6 and *Vafþ* 23, 25.

[Þórr kvað:] 15 „Segðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira [R 19v/30]  
 2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
 hvé sú sól heitir · es sjá alda synir.  
 4 heimi hverjum í.“



[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the sun is called, which the sons of men see,  
in every home.”

[Al-víss kvað:] **16** „Sól heitir með mǫnnum · en sunna með goðum  
2 kalla dvergar Dvalins leika;  
Eyg-lói jǫtnar · alfar fagra-hvél  
4 al-skír ása synir.“

[R 19v/31–32]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Sun it is called among men, but ‘Swail’ among the Gods,  
Dwarfs call it ‘Dwollen’s playmate’;  
‘ever-glower’ Ettins, Elves ‘fair wheel’,  
‘all-bright’ the sons of the Eese.”

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1 Sól ... sunna ‘Sun ... Swail’ | A problem arises for the translation since *sól* is the normal word for ‘sun’ in ON, whereas the direct cognate to English “sun” *sunna* is a poetic synonym. *sól* and *sunna* are in fact doublets, ultimately deriving from different declensions of the IE heteroclitc noun nom. \*sh<sub>2</sub>u-el, gen. \*sh<sub>2</sub>en- ~ \*sh<sub>2</sub>u-n-ós (Kroonen 2013, pp. 463–464). To retain this symmetry in the translation ON *sunna* has been rendered as ‘swail’ (< OE *sweġel*), a cognate of *sól* that preserves the old nominative-accusative \*-l of the PIE noun.

[Þórr kvað:] **17** „Segðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira  
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
hvé þau ský heita · es skúrum blanda=sk  
4 heimi hverjum í.“

[R 19v/32–33]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the clouds are called which are mixed with showers  
in every home.”

[Al-víss kvað:] **18** „Ský heita með mǫnnum, · en skúr-vǫn með goðum;  
2 kalla vind-flot vanir;  
úr-vǫn jǫtnar, · alfar veðr-megin;  
4 kalla í hǫlju hjalm huliðs.“

[R 19v/33–20r/1]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Clouds they are called among men, but ‘shower-hope’ among the Gods;  
‘wind-far’ the Wanes call them;  
‘drizzle-hope’ the Ettins, Elves ‘weather-strength’;  
in Hell they call them ‘helmet of the hidden’.”

[Þórr kvað:] **19** „Segðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira  
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;

[R 20r/1]

hvé sá vindr heitir · es víðast færr  
 4 heimi hverjum í.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
 what the wind is called where travels widest  
 in every home.”

[Al-viss kvað:] 20 „Vindr heitir með mǫnnum, · en vǫfuðr með goðum;  
 2 kalla gneggjuð ginn-rēgin.  
 ópi jǫtnar · alfar dýn-fara  
 4 kalla í heǫlu hviðuð.“

[R 20r/2–3  
 TODO]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Wind it is called among men but ‘waver’ among the Gods,  
 ‘neigher’ call it the Yin-Reins;  
 ‘weeper’ Ettins, Elves ‘din-farer’;  
 in Hell they call it ‘stormer’.”

ALL | This st. is cited in *Skm* 74.

[Þórr kvað:] 21 „Segðu mér þat Al-viss · ǫll of rǫk fira  
 2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
 hvé þat logn heitir · es liggja skal  
 4 heimi hverjum í.“

[R 20r/3–4]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
 what the calm is called, which shall lie  
 in every home.”

[Al-viss kvað:] 22 „Logn heitir með mǫnnum, · en légi með goðum,  
 2 kalla vinds flot vanir;  
 of-hlý jǫtnar · alfar dag-sefa,  
 4 kalla dvergar dags veru.“

[R 20r/4–5]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Calm it is called among men and ‘lowering’ among the Gods,  
 ‘wind’s far’ the Wanes call it;  
 ‘great lee’ Ettins, Elves ‘day-sleep’,  
 call it Dwarfs ‘day’s rest’.”

2 kalla vinds flot vanir “wind’s far’ the Wanes call it’ | Most likely corruption from st. 18/2 above.

[Þórr kvað:] 23 „Segðu mér þat Al-viss · ǫll of rǫk fira  
 2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;

[R 20r/5]

4 hvé sá marr heitir · es men̄n róa  
heitimi hverjum í.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the ocean is called where men do row  
in every home.”

[Al-víss kvað:] 24 „Sér heitir með monnum, · en sí-légja með goðum,  
2 kalla vág vanir;  
ál-heim jotnar, · alfar laga-staf,  
4 kalla dvergar djúpan mar.“

[R 20r/6–7]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Sea it is called among men but ‘ever-low’ among the Gods;  
‘wave’ the Wanes call it;  
‘eelhome’ Ettins, Elves ‘staff of waters’;  
Dwarfs call it ‘deep ocean.’”

[Þórr kvað:] 25 „Segðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira  
2 vqr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
hvé sá eldr heitir · es brenn fyr alda sonum  
4 heitimi hverjum í.“

[R 20r/7–8]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the fire is called, which burns for the sons of men,  
in every home.”

[Al-víss kvað:] 26 „Eldr heitir með monnum · en með ǫsum funi  
2 kalla vág vanir;  
frekan jotnar · en for-brēnni d\*vergar  
4 kalla í helju hröðuð.“

[R 20r/8–9]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Fire it is called among men but among the Eese ‘flame’,  
‘wave’ the Wanes call it;  
‘the greedy’ Ettins, but ‘burner’ Dwarfs;  
in Hell they call it ‘hurrier.’”

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2 kalla vág vanir “wave” the Wanes call it | Certainly an error based on st. 24/2 above; fire is not otherwise known as ‘wave’.

[Þórr kvað:] 27 „Segðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira  
2 vqr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
hvé viðr heitir · es vęx fyr alda sonum

[R 20r/9–10]

[R 20r/13-14]

4 hvé þat sǫð hēitir · es sáa alda synir  
hēimi hverjum í.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the seed is called, which the sons of men sow  
in every home.”

[Al-víss kvað:] 32 „Bygg hēitir með mǫnnum · en barr með goðum  
2 kalla vǫxt vanir.  
ēti jǫtnar · alfar laga-staf  
4 kalla í hēlju hnipinn.“

[R 20r/14–15]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Barley it is called among men but ‘leaf’ among the Gods;  
‘growth’ the Wanes call it;  
‘eating’ Ettins, Elves ‘staff of waters’;  
in Hell they call it ‘wilting’.”

[Þórr kvað:] 33 „Ség-ðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rǫk fíra  
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;  
hvé þat ǫl hēitir · es drekka alda synir  
4 hēimi hverjum í.“

[R 20r/15–16]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,  
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:  
what the ale is called, which the sons of men drink,  
in every home.”

[Al-víss kvað:] 34 „Ǫl hēitir með mǫnnum · en með ǫsum bjórr;  
2 kalla vęig vanir;  
hręina-lǫg jǫtnar · en í hēlju mjǫð;  
4 kalla sumbl Suttungs synir.“

[R 20r/16–17]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Ale it is called among men but among the Eese ‘beer’;  
‘draughts’ the Wanes call it;  
‘pure water’ the Ettins but in Hell ‘mead’;  
‘simble’ Sutting’s sons call it.”

[Þórr kvað:] 35 „Í ęinu brjósti · ek sá’k aldri=gi  
2 flęiri forna stafi;  
miklum tǫlum · ek kveð tēldan þik:  
4 uppi est dvergr of dagaðr;  
nú skínn sól í sali.“

[R 20r/18–19]

[Quoth Thunder:] "In a single breast I never saw  
more ancient staves—  
with mighty tricks I call thee tricked:  
thou art, dwarf, dayed up;  
now shines the sun into the halls!"

# Thule of Rígh

## (*Rígs þula*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C13th (0.280)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Thule of Rígh** (abbrev. *Rþ*) is an incomplete narrative poem describing the origin of the social classes and the monarchy.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Rþ* is preserved only on a single folio (78rv) in the 14th century ms. **W**, where it follows the Prose Edda and four grammatical treatises all written in the same hand as the poem.

Numerous leaves are unfortunately missing from the original **W**, and among them the conclusion to *Rþ*. Still, part of what would have been found in the lost part of the poem can be gleaned from parallel sources, as will be dealt with below.

### Origin and motifs

*Rþ* is a powerful and, due to its incompleteness, enigmatic poem. It has something of the folk-tale about it and serves as an etiology for the origin of the Wiking Age Norwegian class system and a celebration of the superiority of the warrior-nobility.

In the poem the mysterious Rígh (ON *Rígr*) fathers in succession three human sons with three women, *Edda* 'Great-grandma', *Amma* 'Grandma', and *Móðir* 'Mother'. Their respective sons become *Þræll* 'Thrall', *Karl* 'Churl', and *Jarl* 'Earl', each in turn serving as the ancestor for each of the three classes: the slaves, the freeholders or farmers, and the nobility. In turn, the youngest of Earl's twelve sons, Kin the young (*Konr ungr*), becomes the first to hold the title of 'king' (*konungr*).

### The identity of Rígh

The main mystery of the poem is the obscure figure Rígh (*Rígr*), identified in the prose introduction as Homedall. His name has traditionally been seen as a sign of Irish influence on the basis of Old Irish *rí* (oblique sg. stem *rig-*) 'king'.

Rígh does not appear in any other poetic source, but his name is found in two related genealogies: in *Yng* 17 and in the epitome of the lost *Skjoldunga saga*, both of which are included in the Appendix to the poem below.

These genealogies, although conflicting, are clearly related to an episode we only get a hint about at the very end of this poem (st. 46), namely Kin the young's visit to Dene and Danp.

In the parallel sources these two figures are ancestral to the later Danish and Norwegian monarchies through their relation to Rígh, and this was almost certainly the case also in *Rþ*, as shown by the pun on the name of Kin the young (ON *Konr ungr*) and the title king (*konungr*). According to *Yng* 17, Rígh was the first ruler to be called 'king' in the Scandinavian cultural sphere.

Having already laid out the origins of the thralls, churls, and earls, it seems inevitable, then, that the remaining sts. would have dealt with the establishment of monarchy.

Although Rígh is identified as Homedall in the prose introduction, his role in the poem is really more reminiscent of what we know about the god Woden. Like Woden, Rígh is an aristocrat, an inciter of war, and a teacher of runes; like Woden he bestows favour on his protégé, who tends to be the youngest son (cf. *Grm* P1–P2).

Since the introductory prose is likely the work of a learned writer, viz. the compiler of the **W** manuscript, it is not at all unlikely that it could be drawing on *Vsp* 1/2, where the unparalleled expression *megir Hęim-dalar* 'sons of Homedall' seems to be a kenning referring to men. It is of course not impossible that Homedall also had the aforementioned Odinic traits, but we learn of no such thing from other sources where the runes are always the exclusive domain of Woden alone (so e.g. *Háv* 138–139). For these reasons, Rígh is probably more likely to be identified with Woden than Homedall, the prose introduction notwithstanding.

### Class, race, and essentialism

One of the most striking aspects of *Rþ* is its long and detailed physical descriptions of the founders of the human social classes, which includes both dress and phenotype. Thus Thrall is swarthy and crooked (sts. 7–8), Churl is red-haired, ruddy, and well-turned out, with wandering eyes (18–19), and Earl is blonde and pale, with a piercing gaze (33). That piercing gaze is important as it symbolizes the acquisitive nature of earldom, unlike the wandering eyes of the freeholder. The aristocratic earl, the type of man celebrated by *Rþ*, is content with nothing but the best and will pursue it unrelentingly until victory or death.



It should not be controversial to say that *Rþ* is by all accounts an essentialist poem which posits that distinctions in class are fundamentally racial. According to this worldview one's birth is not drawn by lot, nor are souls randomly assigned to their station; everything is due to blood, and the superior man breeds superior children who prove their natural superiority in warlike conquest.

If we are to search for a historical circumstance to explain the phenotypical differences described in the poem, the taking of "swarthy" (in comparison to the Nordic Scandinavians) slaves from the British Isles, especially Ireland, quite likely played a role. As shown by Rodríguez-Varela et al. (2023), this slave traffic left a lasting and substantial effect on the genetics of all of Scandinavia, although Celtic ancestry gradually decreased after the Wiking Age. A likely explanation for this is that the Celtic ancestry was negatively correlated with total fertility due to its concentration in the lower social strata.

It is common knowledge that to this day the Western Norwegians have both the highest rate of Celtic ancestry (e.g. as measured by the haplogroup R1b-L21) and the greatest incidence of red and black hair amongst non-Uralicised Norwegians (Bryn and Schreiner 1929), something also shared with the heavily Celtic-influenced Icelanders (Coon 1939, p. 326). As the Celtic slave populations were gradually assimilated (largely but not exclusively through concubinage) into the freeholding farmers the prevalence of red hair also in the mixed children would have been noticed and made them stand out against the blonde Nordic aristocracy among whom redness was likely nearly nonexistent, as still in our time amongst the Swedes.

Apart from the explanation of Celtic influence (which certainly was a reality), we should also remember that in a stratified society with an emphasis on breeding, attractive traits tend to accumulate in the upper strata. Most Neolithic Eurasian societies have historically strongly favoured light skin, especially in women, as a sign of wealth and beauty, and Northern Europe, where the genes for light hair and blue eyes could also be selected for, was no exception to this rule, as shown by evidence both genetic (Wilde et al. 2014) and literary (most notably *Rþ* itself). As the Nordic upper classes were bred for beauty, strength, and intelligence these traits would co-mingle and gradually become strongly correlated, leading to a racialised in-group sense.

A curious anecdote known in somewhat varying form from two sagas, *Ldn* 2.19 and *Hálf* 17, reveals some complexities of the Norse essentialist worldview: A Norse king took to wife a daughter of a king of Barmland (*Bjarma-land*, i.e., Permian) and she begot two sons with him, Garmund and Highmund, who came out swarthy and very ugly (*Hálf* 17: *svartir ok fúru ljótir*, implying Mongoloid features). Upset, the queen switched out the two sons with a blonde and beautiful slave-boy, Loaf, of the same age. One day when the boys were three years old all men had gone away save for the poet Bray the Old. Loaf was sitting in the king's high seat and playing with some gold, while Garmund and Highmund were down in the straw; jealous, the brothers pulled him down from the seat and took all the gold. Loaf wept. At that moment Bray knew that Loaf could not be the son of two noble parents, and announced it in a stanza, after which Garmund and Highmund regained

their status as the king's sons.

Even in this supposedly non-racist anecdote the moral of the story is none other than biological essentialism. The boy Loaf's slavish nature can instantly be ascertained by his behaviour, regardless of the way in which he is raised. Like Churl, he does not have the eyes of acquisition which signify true nobility. Being put on the king's throne in no way entitles him to it, and when given the chance the king's true sons quickly retake it.

TODO: Dumézil three-part society.

### Meter and stanza

*Rþ* consists of 183 total long-lines divided into 46 stanzas. The length of the stanza is extremely irregular. Stanzas of 3 (14/46: 1, 3, 5–6, 9–10, 15, 19, 24–25, 28, 32, 44–45) and 4 lines (15/46: 11, 14, 17, 20, 22–23, 26–27, 29, 33, 37–39, 43, 46) are most common, followed by 5 lines (10/46: 2, 8, 13, 16, 21, 30(?), 35, 40–42). Other represented lengths are 2 (7, 18, 31), 6 (4, 34, 36), and 7 lines (12).

Metrically *Rþ* is in an unusual form of Ancient-words-law. The meter is notable for its unusually high incidence of 3-syllable verses, which are not allowed in all types of Ancient-words-law, and for the extremely high incidence of type A verses at 77.7 %, higher than any other Eddic poem (Sapp 2022, p. 152).

### Language and style

*Rþ* has a very low occurrence of the particle *of* at 0.082 per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70).

The language is exceptionally formulaic and repetitive, with many expressions, lines and even whole stanzas repeated identically throughout as *Rígh* visits each of the three households. This repetition gives the poem something of an incantatory feeling.

### Dating

On the basis of the loose and unusual meter, the likely Celtic influence in the name *Rígr*, its connection to later legendary material in the form of the textual parallels, and the extremely low prevalence of the particle *of* *Rþ* is most likely to be a late antiquarian poem composed after the conversion to Christianity, likely in the 12th or even 13th century. To signs of a late composition may be added the poem's central premise (but cf. above for a comparative discussion), since it is questionable to what degree the social structure evinced in the poem actually existed in the Wiking Age, when even the wealthiest noble families were closely allied with freeholding farmers, compared to the more stratified High Middle Ages.

A late dating agrees with Sapp's model, which yields a most likely dating to the 13th c., although at 0.280 the confidence is rather low.

Another dimension for dating is the detailed descriptions of dress and lifestyle which may be considered archeologically, particularly in sts. 15–16, 26–27, 29–30, 33. On the basis of these Nerman (1969) estimates the composition of the poem to the Wiking Age, but this assumes that knowledge of earlier material culture cannot have survived after a certain period had passed, an assumption we know based on other sources (e.g. *HHj* 9/1, *Sigs* 68/1) to be incorrect.

## Text

- P1 Svá segja menn í fornum sǫgum, at einn-hverr af ǫsum, sá er [W 78r/1–3]  
 2 Heim·dallr hét, fór ferðar sinnar ok framm með sjóvar-ströndu  
 4 nǫkkurri, kom at einum húsa-bó ok nefndi-sk Rígr; eptir þeiri  
 sǫgu er kvæði þetta.

SO DO MEN SAY in the ancient saws that one of the Eese, he who was called Homedall, went upon his journey, and, going forth along a certain lake shore, he came upon a lone homestead and called himself Righ. After that saw is this poem.

- 1 Ár kvóðu ganga · grónar brautir [W 78r/4–5]  
 2 ǫflgan ok aldinn · ǫs kunnigan,  
 ramman ok rǫskvan · Ríg stíganda.

OF YORE, THEY SAID, did walk on green roads  
 a mighty and ancient [Os], cunning:  
 the strong and brisk Righ, striding.

---

1 Ár 'Of yore' | *emend.*; 'at' W

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1 Ár 'Of yore' | Formulaic; it is very common for poems to begin with *ár* 'of yore, in the beginning'. Cf. *Vsp* 3/1, *Hym* 1/1, *1 HHund* 1/1, *1 Guðr* 1/1, *Sigsk* 1/1.

- 2 Gekk męirr at þat · miðrar brautar, [W 78r/5–6]  
 2 kom hann at húsi, · hurð vas á gętti;  
 inn nam at ganga, · ęldr vas á golfi,  
 4 hjón sǫtu þar · hǫr at arni,  
 Ái ok Edda · aldin-falda.

He walked further thereafter on the middle of the road,  
 came to a house; the door was wide open.  
 He took to go inside; fire was on the floor;  
 a couple sat there, hoary by the hearth:  
 Great-Grandpa and Great-Grandma in an old-time shawl.

---

4 at | *sens. emend.*; af W

---

2 á gętti 'wide open' | Lit. 'on the threshold', in contrast to 14/2 and 24/3.

- 3 Rígr kunni þeim · rǫð at segja; [W 78r/7–8]  
 2 męirr sętti-sk hann · miðra fletja

en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels,  
further he set himself down on the middle of the bench,  
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 4 Þá tók Edda · økkvinn hleif, [W 78r/8–10]  
2 þungan ok þykkvan, · þrunginn sóðum,  
bar hön meirr at þat · miðra skutla,  
4 soð vas í bolla · setti á bjóð;  
vas kalfr soðinn · krása bætstr;  
6 reis hann upp þaðan, · réð=sk at sofna;

Then Great-Grandma took a lumpy loaf—  
heavy and thick, stuffed with chaff—  
carried it further thereafter in the middle of a trencher;  
broth was in a bowl—she set it on a platter.  
A cooked calf was the best dainty;  
he [= Rígh] rose up thence, resolved to sleep.

- 5 Rígr kunni þeim · róð at sęgia; [W 78r/10–11]  
2 meirr lagði=sk hann · miðrar rekkju,  
en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels;  
further he laid himself down on the middle of the bed,  
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 6 Þar vas hann at þat · þrjár nętr saman; [W 78r/11–12]  
2 gekk hann meirr at þat · miðrar brautar;  
liðu meirr at þat · mönuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;  
he walked further thereafter in the middle of the road;  
further thereafter passed nine months.

- 7 Jóð ól Edda, · jósu vatni [W 78r/12]  
2 hęrund-svartan, · hétu þrél.

Great-Grandma begot a child—they sprinkled it with water:  
swarthy of skin, they called it Thrall.

2 hęrund-svartan 'swarthy of skin' | emend.; hęrfi svartan 'swarthy with flax(?)' W

1 jósu vatni ‘they sprinkled it with water’ | A reference to the Heathen naming ceremony wherein water would be poured on a newborn, somewhat resembling the Christian baptism. See *Háv* 156.

- 8 Hann nam at vaxa · ok vǫl dafna; [W 78r/12–14]  
 2 vas þar á hǫndum · hrokkit skinn,  
 kropnir knúar, · [...]  
 4 fingr digrir, · fúl=ligt and-lit,  
 lotr hryggr, · langir hēlar.

He took to grow and have it well;  
 there on his hands was wrinkled skin,  
 crooked knuckles, [...],  
 stubby fingers, loathsome face,  
 stooping back, long heels.

- 9 Nam meirr at þat · magns of kosta, [W 78r/14–15]  
 2 bast at binda, · byrðar gørva;  
 bar hēim at þat · hrís gərstan dag.

He took further thereafter to try his strength:  
 bast to bind, burdens to make;  
 he carried home thereafter brushwood on a gloomy day.

- 10 Þar kom at garði · gengil-bēina, [W 78r/15–16]  
 2 aurr vas á iljum, · armr sól-brunninn,  
 niðr-bjúgt es nef, · nefndi=sk þír.

There to the farm came a gangle-boned girl:  
 mud was on her footsoles, her arm sunburnt,  
 downturned her nose; she called herself Thew.

---

1 gengil-bēina ‘gangle-boned girl’ | Derogatory, somebody who (due to poverty) only travels by foot.

3 þír ‘Thew’ | A variant of *þýr* ‘maid-servant, female slave’. Unlike Thrall, this word is not attested in any prose texts, but it is found in poetry (chiefly in the plural) and in legal compounds like *þý-borinn* ‘born of a female slave or concubine’. It is related to OS *thiwi* ‘maid(-servant)’, being the female form of the Proto-Norse *þewar* ‘servant’, OE *þéow* ‘slave, servant’, ultimately from the root of the verb *þéa* - *þjá* ‘to enthrall’.

- 11 Meirr setti=sk hōn · miðra fletja, [W 78r/16–17]  
 2 sat hjá henni · sonr húss,  
 róddu ok rýndu, · rekkju gørðu  
 4 þrēll ok þír · þrungin dógr.

Further she set herself down on the middle of the bench;  
by her sat the son of the house [= Thrall].  
They spoke and whispered, made a bed—  
Thrall and Thew—in hard-pressed nights.

1 Męirr sętti=sk hęn · miðra fletja | *emend. based on other sts.*; miðra fletja · męirr sętti=sk hęn  
W

- 12 Bęrn ólu þau, · bjuggu ok unðu;  
2 hygg'k at héti · Hřęimr ok Fjósniř,  
Klúrr ok Klęggi, · Kęfsir, Fúlnir,  
4 Drumbr, Digraldi, · Dřottr ok Hęsvir,  
Lútr ok Lęggjaldi; · lęđu garða,  
6 akra tųddu, · unnu at svinum,  
gęita gęttu, · grófu torf.

[W 78r/17–19]

Children they begot, settled and were content.  
I think that they were called Rame and Feesner,  
Clour and Cledge, Chafser, Foulner,  
Drumber, Digrald, Drant and Hazer,  
Lout and Leggald. They laid yard-fences,  
dunged fields, looked after swine,  
herded goats, dug turf.

- 13 Dótr vęru þęr · Drumba ok Kumba,  
2 Økkvin-kalfa · ok Arin-nęfja,  
Ysja ok Ambóttr, · Eikin-tjasna,  
4 Třtrug-hypja · ok Tręnu-bęina;  
þaðan eru komnar · þręla ęttir.

[W 78r/20–21]

The daughters were these: Drumb and Cumb,  
Inkencalf and Arnneb,  
Eaze and Ambight, Oakentarsen,  
Tattryhip and Tranebone—  
thereof are come the lines of thralls.

- 14 Gekk Rigr at þat · réttar brautir  
2 kom hann at hęllu, · hurð vas à skíði,  
inn nam at ganga, · ęldr vas à golfi,  
4 hjęn sętu þar · heldu à syslu.

[W 78r/21–22]

Righ walked thereafter on straight roads,  
came to a hall; the door was hinged.

He took to go inside; fire was on the floor;  
a couple sat there, kept to their chores.

2 *þollu* ‘hall’ | *sens. and metr. emend. (cf. st. 38); om. W*

- 15 **Maðr** tēlgði þar · **mēið** til riðar, [W 78r/23–24]  
2 vas **skēgg** skapat, · **skor** vas fyr enni  
**skyrtu** þrōngva · **skokkr** vas á golfi.

The man there carved a stick into a loom-beam.  
His beard was shapely; locks hung down his forehead,  
his shirt tight; a toolbox was on the floor.

- 16 **Sat** þar kona, · **svēigði** rokk, [W 78r/24–25]  
2 **brēiddi** faðm, · **bjó** til váðar;  
**svēigr** vas á hqðei, · **smokkr** vas á bringu,  
4 **dúkr** vas á halsi, · **dvergar** á oxlum;  
**Afi** ok **Amma** · **óttu** hús.

There sat the woman, twirled a distaff,  
stretched out her arms, readied the cloth.  
A scarf was on her head, a smock on her breast,  
a kerchief on her throat, dwarfs on her shoulders—  
Grandpa and Grandma owned a house.

ALL. | This st. contains an extremely interesting description of female dress. Nerman (1969) deals with this. TODO.

4 *dvergar* ‘dwarfs’ | Nerman (1969) explains this word as referring to an archeological find. TODO.

- 17 **Rígr** kunni þeim · **réð** at segja, [W 78r/25–27]  
2 **rēis** frá borði · **réð** at sofna.  
**Mēirr** lagði=sk hann · **miðrar** rēkkju  
4 en á **hlið** hvára · **hjon** sal-kynna.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels,  
rose from the table, resolved to sleep.  
Further he laid himself down on the middle of the bed,  
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 18 **Þar** vas hann at þat · **þrjár** nētr saman; [W 78r/27]  
2 liðu **mēirr** at þat · **mōnuðr** níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;  
further thereafter passed nine months.



- 19 Jóð ól Amma, · jósu vatni, [W 78r/27–28]  
 2 kølluðu Karl · kona svęip ripti  
 rauðan ok rjóðan · riðuðu augu.

Grandma begot a child, they sprinkled it with water,  
 called it Churl; the woman wrapped him in cloth,  
 red-haired and ruddy; his eyes wandered.

- 20 Hann nam at vaxa · ok vęl dafna, [W 78r/28–30]  
 2 oxn nam at tēmja · arðr at gørva  
 hús at timbra · ok hløður smíða  
 4 karta at gørva · ok keyra plóg.

He took to grow and turn out well;  
 oxen he took to tame, the ard to make,  
 houses to timber and storehouses to forge,  
 carts to make and drive the plough.

- 21 Hęim óku þa · Hangin-luklu [W 78r/30–31]  
 2 gęita-kyrthlu · giptu Karli.  
 Snør hęitir sú, · sętti=sk und ripti.  
 4 Bjuggu hjón, · bauga dęildu,  
 bręiddu blęjur, · ok bú gørðu.

Home they then drove with Hangenkey,  
 in a goatskin-skirt, married her to Churl.  
 Daughter-in-law she is called; she sat down beneath a felt.  
 The couple settled, shared their wealth,  
 hung tapestries and made a home.

- 22 Bqrn ólu þau, · bjuggu ok önðu; [W 78r/31–78v/1]  
 2 hét Halr ok Dreng, · Hqlðr, Þegn ok Smiðr,  
 Bręiðr, Bóndi, · Bundin-skęggi,  
 4 Búi ok Boddi · Bratt-skęggr ok Sęggr.

Children they begot, settled and were content.  
 They were called Hale and Drang, Health, Thane and Smith,  
 Broad, Bond, Boundenshag,  
 Bower and Bod, Brantshag and Seg.

- 23 Eņn hétu svá · qðrum nqfnum [W 78v/1–2]  
 2 Snot, Brúðr, Svanni, · Svarri, Sprakki,  
 Fljóð, Sprund, ok Víf, · Fęima, Ristill;

4 þaðan eru komnar · karla éttir.

Further they were called thus by other names:  
Snoot, Bride, Swannie, Swarrie, Sprackie,  
Fleed, Sprund and Wife, Fome, Ristle—  
therof are come the lines of churls.

---

ALL | Most of these names are mentioned in *Skm* 84. TODO.

24 Gekk Rígr þaðan · réttar brautir [W 78v/2–3]  
2 kom hann at sal, · suðr horfðu dyrr,  
vas hurð hnigin, · hringr vas í gëtti.

Right walked thence on straight roads;  
he came to a hall, south faced the doors;  
the door was opened, a ring was on the gate.

25 Gekk hann inn at þat · golf vas stráat [W 78v/3–4]  
2 sǫtu hjón · sǫu=sk í augu  
faðir ok móðir · fingrum at lëika.

He walked in thereafter; the floor was strawed;  
the couple sat, looked eachother in the eyes,  
Father and Mother, playing with their fingers.

26 Sat hús-gumi · ok snøri stręng [W 78v/4–5]  
2 alm of bęndi · qrvar skępti;  
en hús-kona · hugði at qrmum,  
4 strauk of ripti · sterti ęrmar.

The man of the house sat and twisted the bow-string,  
bent the elmwood, shafted arrows—  
but the wife of the house minded her arms,  
smoothened the fabric, tightened the sleeves.

27 Kęisti fald, · kinga vas á bringu, [W 78v/6–7]  
2 síðar slóður, · sęrk blá-fáan;  
brún bjartari, · brjóst ljósara,  
4 hals hvítari · hręinni mjöllu.

The linen hood jutted out, a brooch was on her chest,  
a trailing gown, a serk dyed blue;  
her brow was brighter, her chest lighter,  
her throat whiter than purest snow.

- 28 Rígr kunni þeim · rjóð at sęja;  
 2 meirr setti=sk hann · miðra fletja  
 en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

[W 78v/7–8]

Rígh knew to tell them counsels,  
 further he set himself down on the middle of the bench,  
 and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 29 Þá tók Móðir · merktan dúk,  
 2 hvítan af hęrvi, · hulði bjóð;  
 hón tók at þat · hleifa þunna,  
 4 hvíta af hveiti, · ok hulði dúk.

[W 78v/8–9]

Then Mother took an embroidered cloth,  
 white of flax—she covered the platter.  
 She took thereafter thin loaves,  
 white of wheat—and covered the cloth.

---

ALL | Note the strong parallelism between the helmings. The rich household can afford such an excess of expensive fabric and bread that they can cover a plate with an embroidered (*merkttr*) flaxen cloth, and then cover that cloth with loaves of wheat-bread.

- 30 Framm setti hęn · skutla fulla  
 2 silfri varða á bjóð  
 fáin\* flęski · ok fugla stęikta;  
 4 vın vas í kęnnu, · varðir kálkar  
 drukku ok dęmđu, · dagr vas á sinnum.

[W 78v/9–11]

She set forth full trenchers,  
 silver-covered on platters  
 shining with pork, and roasted fowls.  
 Wine was in a flagon; the women from goblets  
 drank and discussed; the day was waning.

---

3 fáin\* ‘shining’ | *emend.*; ‘faan ok’ W

---

ALL | The description of the opulence of Father and Mother’s household continues.

1–2 Framm ... bjóð ‘She ... platters’ | These lines are clearly corrupt: l. 1, although rhythmically regular, has no alliteration and l. 2 is entirely malformed. Alliteration may be restored in l. 1 by reversing *skutla* and *fulla* (so Finnur Jónsson 1932).

3 fáin\* ‘shining’ | The present emendation follows Finnur Jónsson (1932). Olsen (1923, pp. 307–312) (followed by Hesselman 1948, p. 59) explains *fán* as a variant of *föarn* ‘gizzard’, but this is problematic. Formally it requires some level of scribal corruption Olsen (1923, pp. 311–312) and grammatically it is in the acc. sg. unlike the paired *flęski* (dat. sg. of *flęsk* ‘pork’). The grammatical inconsistency may be solved if *flęski* is acc. sg. of the rare form *flęski* ‘id.’ (Fr, s.v. *flęski*), but the formal concerns remain.

- 31 **R**ígr kunni þeim · **r**óð at segja, [W 78v/11]  
 2 **r**eis **R**ígr at þat, · **r**ekkjju gørði.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels;  
 Rígh rose thereafter; he made the bed.

- 32 **Þ**ar vas hann at þat · **þ**riár nætr saman; [W 78v/12–13]  
 2 gekk hann **m**ęirr at þat · **m**iðrar brautar;  
 liðu **m**ęirr at þat · **m**önuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;  
 he walked further thereafter on the middle of the road;  
 further thereafter passed nine months.

- 33 **S**vein ól móðir, · **s**ilki vaðði, [W 78v/13–14]  
 2 **j**ósu vatni— · **J**arl létu hęita;  
 blęikt vas hár, · **b**jartir vangar,  
 4 **ę**tul vöru **a**ugu · **s**em **y**rmlingi.

Mother begot a swain, swaddled him in silk;  
 they sprinkled him with water, let him be called Earl.  
 Pale was his hair, bright his cheeks;  
 fierce were his eyes like the young serpent's.

---

4 *ętul vöru augu · sem yrmilingi* 'fierce were his eyes like the young serpent's' | Unlike those of Churl (st. 19/3), which wandered. It is a common motif in Norse literature that those of noble stock distinguish themselves by their appearance and chiefly by a unique piercing gaze even at birth. This is said of Hallow Syemund's son in 1 *HHund* 6/3–4 and of the king's son Wayland in *Vkv* 17/3 whose gaze is likewise compared to the serpent's. In 2 *HHund* 2–4 the same Hallow is almost caught while in disguise as a bond-woman due to his unslavelike eyes, which, like in the present stanza, are said to be *ętul* 'fierce, terrible'.

- 34 **U**pp óx þar · **J**arl á fletjum; [W 78v/14–16]  
 2 **l**ind nam at skęlfá, · **l**ęggja stręngi,  
**a**lm at bęygja, · **ę**rvar skępta,  
 4 **f**łęin at fłęyja, · **f**rękkur dýja,  
**h**ęstum ríða, · **h**undum verpa,  
 6 **s**verðum bregða, · **s**und at fręmjá.

There Earl grew up on the floor-benches;  
 he took to shake the linden shield, fasten bow-strings,  
 bend elmwood, shaft arrows,  
 throw javelins, hoist Frankish spears,  
 ride horses, sic hounds,  
 brandish swords, practice swimming.

- 35 Kom þar ór runni · Rígr gangandi,  
 2 Rígr gangandi, · rúnar kenndi;  
 sitt gaf hęiti, · son kvęð=sk ęiga;  
 4 þann bað hann ęigna=sk · Óðal-vøllu,  
 Óðal-vøllu, · aldnar bygðir.

[W 78v/16–18]

There from a thicket came Righ, walking:  
 Righ, walking, taught him the runes,  
 gave him his own title, said that he had a son.  
 He bade him possess the ethel-plains:  
 the ethel-plains, the ancient farmsteads.

---

ALL | Righ approaches his son, Earl. He reveals himself as his father and initiates him into the warrior aristocracy by teaching him the runes and giving him the noble title Righ (cf. st. 43/4 below); henceforth he will be known as Righ-Earl. Finally Righ instructs him to set out and win lands for himself.

- 36 Reįð hann męirr þaðan · myrkan við  
 2 hélug fjøll · und's at høllu kom;  
 skapt nam at dýja, · skelfði lind,  
 4 hęsti hleypti, · ok hjørvi brá;  
 víg nam at vękja, · vøll nam at rjóða,  
 6 val nam at fęlla, · vá til landa.

[W 78v/18–20]

He [= Righ-Earl] rode further thence through the mirky wood,  
 o'er the frosty fells till to a hall he came.  
 The shaft he took to hoist, shook the linden shield,  
 leapt with his horse and brandished his blade.  
 War he took to rouse; the plain he took to redden;  
 men he took to fell—he won the lands.

- 37 Réð hann ęinn at þat · át-ján búum;  
 2 auð nam skipta · øllum vęita  
 meįðmar ok męsma, · mara svang-rifja;  
 4 hringum hreytti, · hjó sundr baug.

[W 78v/20–21]

He alone ruled thereafter eighteen homesteads.  
 Wealth he took to hand out; to grant all men  
 gifts and treasures, slender-ribbed steeds;  
 rings he scattered; he struck apart the bigh.

---

4 hringum hreytti 'rings he scattered' | Cf. StarkSt Frag 1/2a *bring-breytanda* 'ring-scattererer [GENEROUS MAN]' which contains the same words.

- 38 Óku\* ęrir · úrgar brautir

[W 78v/21–22]

- 2 kvómu at hollu · þar's Hersir bjó:  
 móttu meyju · mjó-fingraðri  
 4 hvítri ok horskri, · hétu Erna.

Messengers drove on drizzling roads,  
 came to the hall where Herser lived;  
 they met a maiden slender-fingered,  
 white and wise; her name was Erne.

1 Óku\* | 'okú' W 3 móttu | mótti W 3 meyju | om. W 3 mjó-fingraðri | mjó-fingraði W

3 móttu 'they met' | Past singular *mótti* is impossible, since the maiden is the one being met. *móta* 'meet' takes the dative.

3 meyju 'maiden' | A feminine dat. sg. noun meaning 'maiden, virgin, girl' is required here by the meter and the following adjectives; meyju dat. sg. of *mēr* fits perfectly with the alliteration and is to be considered fairly likely.

- 39 Bóðu hennar · ok heim óku,  
 2 giptu Jarli, · gekk hón und líni;  
 saman bjuggu þau · ok sér unðu,  
 4 ettir jóku · ok aldrs nutu.

[W 78v/22–24]

They asked for her hand and drove home,  
 married her to Earl; she went 'neath the linen.  
 Together they settled and were content,  
 increased their lineage and enjoyed life.

2 gekk hón und líni 'she went 'neath the linen' | She donned the bridal veil; cf. *Þrk* 27.

- 40 Burr vas hinn eldsti, · en Barn annat;  
 2 Jóð ok Aðall, · Arfi, Møgr,  
 Niðr ok Niðjungr, · (nómu leika)  
 4 Sonr ok Sveinn, · (sund ok tafl)  
 Kundr hét einn; · Konr vas hinn yngsti.

[W 78v/24–25]

Byre was the eldest and Bairn the other;  
 Ede and Athel, Arver and Maw,  
 Nith and Nothing (they learned to partake)  
 Son and Swain (in swimming and tables);  
 Cund was one called; Kin was the youngest.

3–4 nómu leika ... sund ok tafl 'they learned to partake in swimming and tables' | This sentence is embedded in the list of names. Swimming (*sund*) and board games (*tafl*) were typical past-times for aristocrats; cf. the two Scaldic stanzas attributed to Earl Rainwald (SkP: Rv Lv 1) and King Harold Hardreide (Hharð Gamv 4) where each man recounts his *íþróttir* 'skills, pursuits', among which are both *sund* and *tafl*.

- 41 Upp óxu þar · Jarli bornir: [W 78v/25–27]  
 2 hęsta tǫmðu, · hlífar þęndu,  
 skęyti skófu, · skęlfðu aska.  
 4 Ẽn Konr ungr · kunni rúnar:  
 ęvin-rúnar · ok aldr-rúnar.

There grew up the sons of Earl,  
 horses they tamed, shield-rims they bent,  
 shafts they planed, shook ashen spears—  
 but Kin the young knew the runes:  
 eternal runes and life-runes.

4 Konr ungr ‘Kin the young’ | A folk etymological pun on *konungr* ‘king’. It is notable that it is the youngest son who attains the highest rank (for the king is above even the earls); for the motif of a god favouring the youngest son cf. *Grm* Pl.

5 ęvin-rúnar ‘eternal runes’ | A native, pre-Christian word; the first element is an otherwise lost adjective corresponding to Gothic *aiweins* ‘eternal, everlasting’, OHG *ęwin* ‘id’. This is one of two occurrences in the ON corpus, the other one being *aiuinrunar* *ęvin-rúnar* on the 9th c. Malt stone (DR NOR1988;5/DK Sjö38), alongside *taitirunar* *tęiti-rúnar* ‘joy-runes’.

- 42 Męirr kunni hann · mǫnnum bjarga, [W 78v/27–28]  
 2 ęggjar dęyfa, · ęgi lęgja;  
 klǫk nam fugla, · kyrra ęlda,  
 4 sófa ok svefja, · sorgir lęgja,  
 afl ok ęljun · átta manna.

Further he could rescue men,  
 dull blades, lower the sea.  
 He learned the chirping of birds, to calm fires,  
 to lull and put to sleep, to lower sorrows,  
 the strength and zeal of eight men.

- 43 Hann við Ríg Jarl · rúnar dęildi; [W 78v/28–29]  
 2 brǫgðum þęitti · ok þętr kunni;  
 þa ǫłladi=sk · ok þa ęiga gat,  
 4 Rígr at hęita, · rúnar kunna.

With Righ-Earl he shared the runes,  
 employed tricks and knew better.  
 Then he earned and won the right  
 to be called Righ, to know the runes.

4 Rígr at hęita ‘to be called Righ’ | The title Righ passes through the generations, first in st. 35/3 from Righ (the grandfather) to Righ-Earl (the father), now from Righ-Earl to his son Kin the young.

- 44 Reǿ Konr ungr · kjorr ok skóga;  
 2 kolfi fleygði · kyrði fugla;  
 þa kvað þat kráka · —sat kvisti ein—

[W 78v/30–31]

Kin the young rode through brushes and woods,  
 hurled his bolts, stunned the birds.  
 Then quoth a crow—it sat on a branch alone:

2 kolfi fleygði · kyrði fugla ‘hurled his bolts, stunned the birds’ | Perhaps by means of a slingshot, an ancient and widespread birding practice.

- 45 „Hvat skalt, Konr ungr, · kyrra fugla?  
 2 Hēldr mēttið ér · hēstum riða  
 hēstum riða · ok hēr fella.

[W 78v/30–31]

“Why shalt thou, Kin the young, stun the birds?  
 Rather might ye ride horses,  
 ride horses, fell hosts.

3 hēstum riða ‘horses to ride’ | *emend.; om. (presumably by haplography)* W

ALL | In the final 2 sts. the talking crow begins its exhortation, encouraging Kin the young, to go out and conquer like his father. The exhortation is most likely cut short by the loss of the rest of the poem.

- 46 Á Danr ok Danpr · dýrar hallir;  
 2 óðra óðal · an ér hafið;  
 þeir kunnu vel · kjól at riða,  
 4 egg at kenna, · undir rjúfa.“

[W 78v/31–32]

Dene and Danp own costly halls,  
 nobler ethel than ye have.  
 They can well ride the ship,  
 teach the blade, tear open wounds.”

2 ér ‘ye’ | *metr. emend.; þér ‘id.’* W

1 Danr ok Danpr ‘Dene and Danp’ | For these figures see the Appendix to the poem.

2 óðal ‘ethel’ | Ancestral farmland, in this case the eighteen homesteads owned by Earl.

2 ér ‘ye’ | The older form *ér* is required by the alliteration, so the use of the younger *þér* in the ms. shows that the poem has been linguistically modernised.

3 kjól at riða ‘ride the ship’ | I.e. to sail.

4 egg at kenna ‘teach the blade’ | To wage war. A euphemism; to “teach someone the blade” is to fight (and kill) him.

(At this point fol. 78 of W ends, and the rest of the poem is lost. For parallels see the Appendix below.)

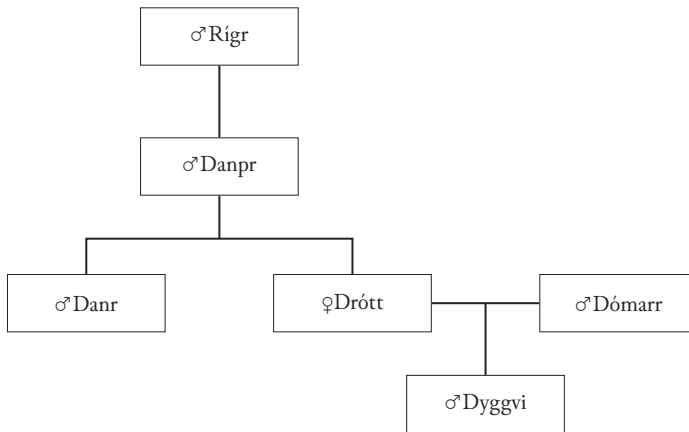


## Appendix

Exactly how *Rþ* would have progressed is of course unclear, but the following parallels may offer something of a hint.

### *Yng* 17

In *Yng*, Due is the seventh in the line of Inglingas, the legendary Swedish and later Norwegian royal dynasty. The relevant family tree is as follows:



2 Móðir Dyggva var Drótt, dóttir Danps konungs, sonar Rígs,  
 er fyrstr var konungr kallaðr á danska tungu. Hans átt-menn  
 4 hófðu á-valt síðan konungs-nafn fyrir it ózta tignar-nafn. Dyg-  
 gvi var fyrst konungr kallaðr sinna étt-manna. [...] Drótt drót-  
 tning var systir Dans konungs ins mikil-láta, er Dan-mörk er  
 6 við kend.

Due's mother was Dright, the daughter of king Danp, the son of Righ, who was the first to be called king in [the geographical extent of] the Danish tongue. His kinsmen always thereafter held the title of king to be the utmost title of rank. Due was the first of his kinsmen to be called king. [...] Queen Dright was the sister of king Dene the proud, after whom Denmark is named.

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2 á danska tungu 'in [the geographical extent of] the Danish tongue' | Namely the area of the Old Norse or Scandinavian language, not merely its Danish dialect. This area originally includes Sweden, Norway, and Denmark.

**The epitome of the lost *Skjöldunga saga***

In the epitome of the *Skjöldunga saga* we read (Bjarni Guðnason 1982, pp. 1–45):

TODO: text

TODO: translation

# Leeds of Hindle

## *(Hyndlu ljóð)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.996)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Leeds of Hindle** (*Hdl*) is a poorly preserved poem found only in F. St. 32 is cited in *Gylf* and attributed to the *Vǫluspó in skamma* ‘Short Spae of the Wallow’. The relation of that poem to the *Hdl* in its present form is unclear.

NOTE: Both translation and edition are currently incomplete.

## Text

- [Freyja kvað:] 1 „Vaki **mér** **meyja**, · vaki **mín** vina,  
 2 **Hyndla** systir, · es í **helli** býr;  
 nú 's **røkr** **røkra**, · **ríða** vit skulum  
 4 til **Val**-hallar · ok til **vés** **heilags**.

[Quoth Frey:] “**W**AKE, MAIDEN OF MAIDENS! Wake, my friend!  
 O Hindle, sister, who livest in the cave!  
 Now is the twilight of twilights; we two shall ride  
 to Walhall and to the holy wigh!

- 2 Biðjum **Hērja**\*·**fōðr** · í **hugum** sitja,  
 2 hann **geldr** ok **gefr** · **goll** **verðugum**,  
 gaf hann **Hēr**·**móði** · **hjal**m ok brynju,  
 4 **en** **Sig**·**mundi** · **sverð** at þiggja.

Let us bid the Father of Hosts (= Weden) to remain in good thoughts;  
 he pays and gives gold to the worthy.  
 He gave to Harmod helmet and byrnie,  
 but to Syemund a sword to take.

1 **Hērja**\*·**fōðr** | *emend.*; ‘herians faudur’ F

2 hann geldr ok gefr · goll verðugum ‘he pays and gives gold to the worthy’ | Closely related to *I HHund* 9/3, which is why Finnur Jónsson (1932) and Guðni Jónsson (1954) emend *verðugum* ‘the worthy’ to *verðungu* ‘the retinue’.

- 3 Gefr hann **sigr** **sonum**, · **en** **svinnu**m **aura**,  
 2 **mēlsku** **morgum** · ok **man**-vit **firum**,  
**byri** gefr **brøgnum**, · **en** **brag** **skøldum**,  
 4 gefr hann **mann**-**sēmi** · **morgum** **rekki**.

He gives victory to sons and ounces [of silver] to the wise,  
 speech to many and manwit to men.  
 Fair wind he gives to nobles and praise-song to scalds;  
 he gives manly valour to many a champion.

- 4 Þór mun **hø**n **blóta**, · þess mun **hø**n **biðja**,  
 2 at hann **é** við þik · **en**-art **lát**i;  
 þó 's **hø**num **ò**-**títt** · við **jø**tuns **brúðir**.

To Thunder she [I] will bloat, of this she [I] will pray:  
 that he always be upright with thee,  
 although he bears hatred for the ettin’s brides.

- 5 Nú tak-tu ulf þinn · ęinn af stalli,  
 2 lát hann rinna · með runa mínum.“—  
 [Hyndla kvað:] „Seinn es góltr þinn · goð-veg troða,  
 4 vil’k=at mar mín · mętan hlóða.

Now take thy one wolf from the stable;  
 let him run alongside my boar.”—

[Quoth Hindle:] “[Too] slow is thy boar to tread the Godways;  
 I wish not to load my noble steed.

- 6 Fló est Freyja, · es freistar mín,  
 2 vísar þú augum · à oss þannig,  
 es hafir ver þinn · í val-sinni  
 4 Ótt-ar unga · Inn-stęins bur.“

False art thou, Frow, who temptest me;  
 thou showest thy eyes on us this way  
 since thou hast thy lover on the slain-path:  
 the young Oughter, Instone’s offspring.”

2–3 vísar ... val-sinni ‘thou showest ... slain-ways’ | I.e., “You only show favour to me because you want me to help your lover”. For the expression cf. *Sigrdr* 3/3 n.

- [Freyja kvað:] 7 „Dulið est Hyndla, · draums ętla’k þér,  
 2 es kveðr ver minn · í val-sinni,  
 þar’s góltr glóar · Gollin-bursti,  
 4 Hildi-svíni, · es mér hagir gęrðu,  
 dvergar tvęir · Dáinn ok Nabbi.

[Quoth Frow:] Deluded art thou, Hindle; I think thee dreamy,  
 who sayest that my man is on the slain-path  
 where the boar Goldenbristle glows,  
 Hildswine, which for me made  
 the two skilful dwarfs Downen and Nab.

4 Hildi-svíni ‘Hildswine’ | The ‘battle-swine’, another name for Goldenbristle.

- 8 Sęnn\* ę sęðlum · sitja vit skulum  
 2 ok of jęfra · ęttir dęma,  
 gumna þęira, · es frá goðum kómu.

Soon in the saddles we two shall sit,  
 and of the lines of chieftains speak,  
 of those men who came from the gods.

1 *Senn\** | *emend.*; 'sennum' F    1 *ĩ* | *emend.*; vit ór F

- 9 Þeir hafa *vęðjat* · *vala* malmi  
 2 *Ótt·arr ungi* · ok *Angantýr*;  
*skylt* 's at *vęita*, · *svá't skati* inn ungi  
 4 *fęður-lęifð* hafi · *ępt fręndr* sína.

They have wagered the Welsh ore [GOLD],  
 young Oughter and Ongenthew.  
 It must be granted so that the young prince  
 may have the patrimony after his kinsmen.

- 10 *Hęrg* hann mér *ęęři* · *hlaðinn* stęinum;  
 2 nú 's *ęrjót* þat · at *ęlęri* orðit;  
*rauð* hann *ĩ nýju* · *nauta blóði*;  
 4 *ę* trúði *Ótt·arr* · *à ęsynjur*.

A harrow he made for me, loaded with stones;  
 now that stone-pile has turned into glass.  
 He reddened it in the fresh blood of oxen;  
 always did Oughter trust in the Ossens.

- 11 Nú lát forna · *niðja* talða  
 2 ok *upp·bornar* · *ęttir* manna  
*hvat* 's *skjöldunga*, · *hvat* 's *skilfinga*,  
 4 *hvat* 's *ęðlinga* · *hvat* 's *ylfinga*  
*hvat* 's *hęlð·borit*, · *hvat* 's *hęrs·borit*  
 6 *męst manna val* · *und Mið·ęarði*?"

Now let ancient ancestors be counted,  
 and the high-born lines of men.  
 What is of Shieldings? What is of Shilvings?  
 What is of Athlings? What is of Wolvings?  
 What is born of hero? What is born of chief,  
 the greatest choice of men in Middenyard?"

- 12 „Þú est *Ótt·arr* · *borinn Inn·stęini*,  
 2 *ęn Inn·stęinn* vas · *Ólfi* inum gamla,  
*Ólfr* vas *Ulf*, · *Ulf* *Sę·fara*,  
 4 *ęn Sę·fari* · *Svan* inum rauða.

[Quoth Hindle:] "Thou art, Oughter, born to Instone,  
 and Instone was born to Elf the old,

Elf was to Wolf, Wolf to Seafarer,  
and Seafarer to Swan the red.

ALL | Hindle begins the genealogy; she speaks directly to Oughter.

- 13      Móður átti faðir þinn · męnjum gǫfga,  
2      hygg at hėti · Hlédís gyðja,  
         Fróði vas faðir þeirar, · ęn Friund móðir;  
4      ǫll þótti ęt sù · með yfir-męnnum.

Thy father got thy mother, beautiful with torcs;  
I think that she was called Leedise the gidden.  
Frood was her father, but Friend her mother;  
all that lineage seemed to be among overmen.

3 Friund | emend. from meaningless †friauf† F

- 14      Auði vas áðr · ǫflgastr manna,  
2      Half-danr fyrri · hęstr skjöldunga,  
         fręg vǫru folk-víg, · þau's framir gęrðu,  
4      hvarfla þóttu hans verk · með himins-skautum.

Ed was once the strongest of men,  
Halfdane yet earlier the highest of Shieldings.  
Famous were the troop-wars which the brave ones made;  
his (= Halfdane's) works seemed to whirl along the corners of heaven.

- 15      Eflði=sk við Eý-mund · ǫðstan manna  
2      ęn vá Sig-trygg · með svǫlum ęggjum,  
         ęiga gekk Alm-veig, · ǫðsta kvinna,  
4      ǫlu þau ok ǫttu · átján sonu.

He became the in-law of Eanmund, the noblest of men,  
but he slew Syetru with cool edges.  
He went to have Elmwey, the noblest of women;  
they begot and had eighteen sons.

1 Eflði=sk 'became the in-law' | Lit. 'was strengthened by'. Elmwey was Eanmund's daughter or sister.

- 16      Þaðan eru skjöldungar, · þaðan eru skilfingar,  
2      þaðan eru ǫðlingar, · þaðan eru ynglingar,  
         þaðan es hǫld-borit, · þaðan es hęrs-borit,  
4      mest manna val · und Mið-garði;

allt 's þat ętt þín, · Ótt·arr heĩmski.

Thereof come the Shieldings! Thereof come the Shilvings!  
 Thereof come the Athlings! Thereof come the Inglings!  
 Thereof is born of hero! Thereof is born of chief  
 the greatest choice of men within Middenyard!  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!”

---

2 ynglingar ‘Ingling’s | Note the variation from st. 12, which has *yǫfingar* ‘Wolvings’. Since the Ingling’s have already been mentioned (under the name of Shilvings), it seems likely that st. 12’s Wolvings is the original reading.

- 17 Vas Hildi·gunnr · hęnnar móðir,  
 2 Svófu barn · ok Sę·konungs;  
 allt 's þat ętt þín, · Ótt·arr heĩmski.  
 4 varði at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęgra?

Hildguth was her (= Elmwey’s) mother,  
 the child of Sweve and Sea-king.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!  
 It is meaningful that one might know thus; wilt thou yet further?

- 18 Dagr átti Þóru · dręngja móður,  
 2 ólu=sk í ętt þar · óðstir kappar,  
 Frað·marr ok Gyrðr · ok Frekar báðir,  
 4 Ámr ok Jǫsur·marr, · Ólfr inn gamli.  
 varðar at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęgra?

Day got Thure, the mother of valiant men;  
 in that lineage were begotten the noblest champions:  
 Fradmer and Yird and both Frecks,  
 Ame and Essermer, Atholf the old.—  
 It is meaningful that one might know thus; wilt thou yet further?

- 19 Kętill hét vinr þęira · Klypps arf-þęgi,  
 2 vas hann móður·faðir · móður þinnar;  
 þar vas Fróði · fyrr ęnn Kári,  
 4 hinn ęldri vas · Ólfr of getinn.

Kettle was the name of their friend, the heir of Clip;  
 he was the father of thy mother’s mother.  
 There was Froot, yet earlier Keer,  
 the elder Atholf was mentioned.



- 20      *N*anna vas *n*ést þar · *N*okkva dóttir  
 2      vas *m*ogr hennar · *m*ágr þíns fǫður.  
       *f*yrnd 's sú *m*égð · *f*ramm tēl'k lēngra  
 4      kunna'k *b*áða · *B*rodd ok Hǫrvi  
       allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Nan was next there, the daughter of Nake;  
 her son was the in-law of thy father.  
 Ancient is that family; I foresee further.  
 I know both Brord and Harrow.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

---

1 *N*anna | *emend.*; Manna F

---

4 kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi 'I know both Brord and Harrow' | This l. is probably in error here; it reoccurs identically as 24/1 below.

- 21      *Í*s-ólfr ok *Ö*s-ólfr · *Q*l·móðs synir  
 2      ok *S*kur·hildar · *S*kękkils dóttur,  
       *s*kalt til tēlja · *s*katna margra  
 4      allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Icewolf and Osulf, the sons of Alemod  
 and Showerhild Shackle's daughter—  
 them shalt thou recount before the many princes.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 22      *G*unn·arr balkr, · *G*rimr arð·skafi,  
 2      *J*árn·skjöldr, Þörir, · *U*lfr gínandi,  
       *B*úi ok *B*rami, · *B*arri ok Rēifnir,  
 4      *T*indr ok *T*yrfingr · ok *t*vęir Haddingjar.  
       allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Guthr the balk, Grim the ard-shaver,  
 Ironshield, Thurwigh, Wolf the grinning,  
 Bowe and Brame, Barr and Rafner,  
 Tind and Tirving and the two Hardings.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 23      *Á*ni, *Ö*mi · *v*ǫru bornir  
 2      *A*rn·gríms synir · ok *E*y·furu;  
       *b*rokun *ber*-serkja · *b*ols margs-konar  
 4      of *l*ond ok of *l*ög · sem *l*ogi føri.  
       allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Ane, Ome were born  
 the sons of Arngrim and Eanfore.  
 The battles of the bear-serks of the manifold evils  
 over land and over sea went forth like a flame.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 24      Kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi  
 2      vǫru þeir í hirð · Hrólfs ins gamla,  
          allir bornir · frá Jǫrmun·reki  
 4      Sig·urðar mági · (hlýð sǫgu minni!)  
          folkum gríms · þess 's Fáfni vá.

I know both Brord and Harrow;  
 they were in the troop of Rotholf the old,  
 all born from Ermenric,  
 from the inlaw of Siward—heed my tale!—  
 the terror of hosts who slew Fathomer.

---

4 Sig·urðar | The meter of the line requires that the first syllable of this name be short (*Sig·urð-* < \**Sig·urð-*), a young feature (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141).

- 25      Sá vas vísir · frá Vǫlsungi  
 2      ok Hǫr·dís · frá Hrauðungi  
          en Ey·limi · frá Öðlingum.  
 4      allt 's þat ét þín, · Ótt·arr heimski.

That ruler came from Walsing,  
 and Hardise from Reading,  
 but Eanlime from the Athlings.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 26      Gunnarr ok Hogni · Gjúka arfar  
 2      ok it sama Guð·rún · systir þeira.  
          Eigi vas Guð·þormr · Gjúka étta  
 4      þó vas hann bróðir · þeggja þeira  
          allt 's þat ét þín, · Ótt·arr heimski.

Guther and Hawn, Yivick's heirs,  
 and likewise Guthrun, their sister.  
 Godthorm was not of Yivick's lineage,  
 though he was the brother of them both.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 27      Haraldr hildi-tǫnn · borinn Hró·reki

- 2 slongvan-bauga · son\*<sup>r</sup> vas hann Auðar.  
 Auðr djúp-audga · Í·vars dóttir  
 4 en Ráð·barðr · vas Rand·vé\*s faðir  
 þeir vóru gumnar · goðum signaðir.  
 6 allt 's þat étt þín, · Ött·arr heimski.

Harold Hild-tooth was born to Rethric  
 the slinger of bigs; he was the son of Ead.  
 Ead the deep-minded was Inwar's daughter,  
 but Redebeard was Randwigh's father.  
 They were men dedicated to the gods.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 28 Vóru ellifu · ęsir taldir  
 2 Baldr es hné · við bana-þúfu  
 þess létsk Váli · verðr at hefna  
 4 síns bróður · sló hand-bana;  
 allt 's þat étt þín, · Ött·arr heimski.

Eleven were the Eese tallied  
 when Balder sank down against the tuft of his bane.  
 That Wönnel declared himself worthy to avenge;  
 he slew the hand-bane of his brother.  
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 29 Vas Baldrs faðir · Burs arf-þegi,  
 2 Fręyr átti Gęrdi, · hón vas G\*ymis dóttir  
 jętna ęttar · ok Aur·boðu;  
 4 þó vas Þjatsi · þęira fręndi  
 skaut-gjarn jętunn; · hans vas Skaði dóttir.

Balder's father was the heir of Byre.  
 Free had Gird; she was the daughter of Gymer  
 from the lineage of the ettins and Earbode.  
 Further Thedse was their kinsman,  
 the shot-eager ettin; Shede was his daughter.

- 30 Mart sęgjum þer · ok munum flęira  
 2 vęrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn flęira.

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;  
 I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet more?

- 31 Haki vas Hveðnu · Hóti betstr sona  
 2 en Hveðnu vas · Hjör-varðr faðir  
 Hęiðr ok Hross-þjófr · Hrímnis kindar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 32 Eru vǫlur allar · frá Við-ólfi,  
 2 vítkar allir · frá Vil-męiði,  
 sęið-berendr · frá Svart-hęfða,  
 4 jętnar allir · frá Ymi komnir.

All wallows are from Widolf,  
 all warlocks from Wilmad,  
 soth-bearers from Swarthead,  
 all ettins are come from Yimer.

3 sęið-berendr · frá Svart-hęfða, | om. U 3 sęið-berendr | skil-berendr F

[F TODO, S 2v/14,  
 T 3r/26, W TODO,  
 U TODO]

ALL | This st. is quoted following *Gylf* 5:6–9, which describes Yimer (cf. *Vsp* 3/1 n.) and *Gylf* 5:10–11 which introduces it with the words *ok eru þaðan komnar ęttir brím-þursa, svá sem segir í Vǫlu-sspá binni skęmmu* ‘and thereof are come the lineages of Rime-Thurses, as it says in the short Spae of the Wallow’.

- 33 Mart sęgjum þér · ok munum fleira  
 2 vǫrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęgra?  
 Much we tell thee and recall yet more;  
 I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

- 34 Varð ęinn borinn · í ár-daga  
 2 ramm-aukinn mjök · ręgna kindar;  
 níu bęru þann · nadd-gęfgan mann  
 4 jętna męyjar · við jarðar þręm.

One was born in days of yore,  
 much increased in strength by the race of the Reins.  
 Nine gave birth to that arrow-famed man:  
 the maidens of ettins at the rim of the earth.

- 35 Mart sęgjum þér · ok munum fleira  
 2 vǫrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęgra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;  
 I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

- 36      Hann Gjölp of bar · hann Greip of bar,  
 2      bar hann Físla · ok Eyr-gjafa;  
      hann bar Ulf-rún · ok Ang-eyja,  
 4      Ímdr ok Atla · ok Jarn-saxa.

Him Yelp did bear; him Grope did bear;  
 Astle bore him and Earyive;  
 Wolfrun bore him and Angie,  
 Imd and Attle and Ironsaxe.

- 37      Sá vas aukinn · jarðar magni  
 2      sval-köldum sé · ok sónar dręyra.

He was increased with the might of the earth,  
 the freezing cold sea and the guts of a boar.

- 38      Mart segjum þér · ok munum fleira  
 2      vörumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lengra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;  
 I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

- 39      Ól Ulf Loki · við Angr-boðu  
 2      ęn Sleipni gat · við Svaðil-fara;  
      ęitt þótti skars · allra fęiknast  
 4      þat vas bróður frá · Bý-leįsts komit.

Lock begot the Wolf with Angerbode,  
 but Slopner he begat with Swaddlefare.  
 One troll-woman seemed wickedest of all;  
 she was come from the brother of Bilast.

---

3 ęitt ... skars 'One troll-woman' | Viz. Hell, Lock's daughter.

- 40      Loki át hjarta · lindi bręnndu  
 2      fann hann half-sviðinn · hug-stęin konu;  
      varð Loptr kviðugr · af konu illri  
 4      þaðan es á foldu · flagð hvęrt komit.

Loft ate a heart burned with linden-wood;  
 he found the half-scorched thought-stone [HEART] of a woman.  
 Loft became pregnant from that evil woman;  
 thereof is come every troll upon the earth.

- 41 Haf gęngr hríðum · við himin sjalfan  
 2 líðr lǫnd yfir · ęn lopt bilar;  
 þaðan koma snjóvar · ok snarir vindar  
 4 þa 's í ráði · at regin of þrjóti.

The sea rises in storms against the very heaven,  
 goes over the lands, but the air gives way.  
 Thence come snows and swift winds;  
 then it is in the motions that the Reins expire.

---

ALL | A prediction of the Rakes of the Reins (as told at length in *Vǫp* 43–54), likely the reason why this passage is called the Short Spae of the Wallow.

- 42 Varð ęinn borinn · ǫllum meiri  
 2 sá vas aukinn · jarðar męgni.  
 þann kveða stilli · stór-auðgastan  
 4 Sif sifjaðan · sǫtum gǫrv-ǫllum.

One was born greater than all;  
 he was increased with the might of the earth.  
 That ruler they say is the very wealthiest,  
 related to Sib, to each and every dwelling.

- 43 Þa kęmr annarr · ęnn mátkari  
 2 þó þori'k ęigi · þann at nęfna;  
 fáir sjá nú · framm of lęngra  
 4 an Óðinn man · Ulfi móta.“

Then comes another one, far mightier,  
 though I dare not say his name.  
 Few folk now see further ahead  
 than when Węden will meet the Wolf.”

---

ALL | This stanza is most likely pulling from *Vǫp* H58 which indicates that the version of *Vǫp* available to the poet likely contained that stanza.

- 44 „Ber minnis-ǫl · mínum gęsti  
 2 svá hann ǫll muni · orð at tńva  
 þessa róðu · á þridja morni  
 4 þa's þęir Angan·týr · ęttr rękna.“

“Bear an ale of remembrance unto my guest,  
 that he may remember to recite all the words  
 of this speech on the third morning,  
 when he and Ongentew reckon lineages.”

- 45 „Snú þú burt heðan · sofa lystir mik  
 2 fêr þú fátt af mér · fríðra kosta.  
 hleypr þú edlvina · úti á nöttum  
 4 sem með hofrum · Heið·rún fari.

Turn away hence! I desire to sleep;  
 from me wilt thou get few pretty things.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 46 Rant at Óði · ey þreyjandi  
 2 skutusk þér fleiri · und fyrir skyrtu.  
 hleypr þu edlvina · úti á nöttum  
 4 sem með hofrum · Heið·rún fari.“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 47 „Ek slé eldi · af í·viðju  
 2 svá't eigi kœmsk · á burt heðan.“  
 „hleypr þu edlvina · úti á nöttum  
 4 sem með hofrum · Heið·rún fari.

“I strike a fire around the Inwithy,  
 that thou wilt not come away hence!”  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 48 Hyr sé'k brenna · en hauðr loga  
 2 verða flestir · fjör-lausn þola;  
 ber Ótt·ari · bjór at hendi  
 4 eitri blandinn mjök · illu heilli.“

A fire I see burning, but the earth does blaze;  
 most must suffer the saving of life.  
 Bring beer to Oughter's hands,  
 mixed with much poison, of ill omen!”

- 49 „Orð-heill þín · skal engu ráða  
 2 þótt brúðr jötuns · bølvi heitir;  
 hann skal drekka · dýrar veigar

4            bið'k Ótt·ari · ǫll goð duga.“

“Thy word-omens shall have no power,  
though the ettin's bride does summon a bale.  
He shall drink costly draughts;  
Oughter I bid all gods avail!”



# Fragments from Snorre's Edda

## Introduction

A number of Eddic lines, stanzas and groups of stanzas are quoted in *SnE*, specifically the first two parts: *Gylf* and *Skm*. The majority of these quotations are taken from longer Eddic poems preserved in full in other manuscripts (primarily **R** and **A**), but a few are found nowhere else. It is these orphaned fragments which will be edited in the present section.

The fragments have two things in common: they are generally pieces of spoken dialogue quoted in the context of longer narrative prose sections, and are, with one exception (Homedall's galder, see below), not introduced by reference to their source, but rather with phrases like *þá kvað hann* 'then quoth he'.

TODO: Further discussion on the fragments. Incorporate textual variants for prose and double check stanzas.

## I. A lost riddle-poem (*Gylf* 2:15–20)

### Introduction

This half-stanza is quoted in *Gylf* 2. It is the second Eddic stanza in *Gylf*, following *Háv* 1 which is uttered by Yilfer himself when he enters the hall of the Eese in the same chapter. The whole passage is clearly drawing on other Eddic mythic wisdom contests and is particularly reminiscent of *Vǫlþ*. Whether the stanza itself is authentic or made up by Snorre himself is hard to tell.

### Text

<sup>15</sup>Hann sá þrjú há-séti ok hvert upp frá ǫðru, ok sátu þrír menn  
 2 sinn í hverju. <sup>16</sup>Þá spurði hann, hvert nafn høfðingja þeira véri.  
 Sá svarar, er hann leiddi inn, at <sup>17</sup>sá, er í inu neðsta há-séti sat,  
 4 var konungr, ok heitir Hárr, en þar næst sá, er heitir Jafn-hárr,  
 en sá ofast, er Þriði heitir. <sup>18</sup>Þá spyrr Hárr komanda'nn, hvárt  
 6 fleira er erendi hans, en heimill er matr ok drykkir honum sem  
 8 ǫllum þar í Háva holl. <sup>19</sup>Hann segir, at fyrst vill hann spyrja, ef  
 nokkurr er fróðr maðr inni. <sup>20</sup>Hárr segir, at hann komi eigi heill  
 út, nema hann sé fróðari,

<sup>15</sup>HE [= Yilfer] SAW THREE HIGH-SEATS, and each one higher than the last; and three men sat there, each in his own seat. <sup>16</sup>Then he asked what the names of those chieftains were. He who led him in answers that <sup>17</sup>the one who sat in the lowest high-seat was a king called High, and next to him he who is called Evenhigh, and uppermost he who is called Third. <sup>18</sup>Then High asks the guest whether he has any other errands—but he is as welcome to food and drink as every man is there in the High One's hall. <sup>19</sup>He [= Yilfer] asks whether anyone within is a learned man. <sup>20</sup>High says that he will not come out whole unless he be the more learned one,

1 „ok statt-u framm · meðan þú fregn;  
 2 sitja skal sá es segir.“

[S 2r/10, T 2v/20,  
W 5r/23, U 2v/11]

“and stand forth while thou askest;  
 sit shall he who speaks!”

---

1 framm | frami T

## II. Nearth and Shede (*Gylf* 23:1–14)

### Introduction

The following passage is almost the whole of *Gylf* 23, excepting at the very end *svá er sagt* ‘so it is said’, after which the text cites *Grm* 11.

It is notable that the two stanzas cited here are also found translated in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.8.18–19, where they are said to have been spoken by the legendary hero Harding (corresponding to Nearth) and Rainhild (corresponding to Shede); in this way the old myth has been reinterpreted to fit Saxo’s heroic context. For discussion see Hopkins (2021).

### Text

<sup>1</sup>Inn þriði ǫss er sá, er kallaðr er Njorðr. <sup>2</sup>Hann býr á himni, þar sem heitir Nóa-tún. <sup>3</sup>Hann ræðr fyrir gongu vinds ok stillir sjá ok eld. <sup>4</sup>Á hann skal heita til sé-fara ok til veiða. <sup>5</sup>Hann er svá auðigr ok fé-séll, at hann má gefa þeim auð, landa eða lausafjár er hann vill. Á hann skal til þess heita. <sup>6</sup>Eigi er Njorðr ása ętta. Hann var upp fódðr í Vana-heimi, en Vanir gísluðu hann goðu’n um ok tóku í mót at gíslingu þann, er Hónir heitir. Hann varð at sétt með goðum ok Vönum. <sup>7</sup>Njorðr á þá konu, er Skaði heitir, dóttir Þjatsa jötuns. <sup>8</sup>Skaði vill hafa bú-stað þann, er átt hafði faðir hennar, þat er á fjöllum nokkurum, þar sem heitir Þrymheimr, en Njorðr vill vera nér sé. <sup>9</sup>Þau séttusk á þat, at þau skyldu vera níu nætr í Þrym-heimi, en þá aðrar níu at Nóa-túnum. <sup>10</sup>En er Njorðr kom aprt til Nóa-túna af fjalli’nu, þá kvað hann þetta:

<sup>1</sup>THE THIRD OS IS HE WHO IS CALLED NEARTH. <sup>2</sup>He lives in the heaven in the place called Nowetons. <sup>3</sup>He rules the course of the wind, and stills sea and fire. <sup>4</sup>On him shall one call for sea-faring and for hunting. <sup>5</sup>He is so wealthy and blessed with money that he may give a wealth of lands or loose property to whomever he wants; on him shall one call for that sake. <sup>6</sup>Nearth is not of the lineage of the Eese. He was brought up in Wanehome, but the Wanegave him as a hostage to the gods, and in return got as hostage that one who is called Heener. He was used to reconcile the gods and the Waneg. <sup>7</sup>Nearth has to wife the woman who is called Shede, the daughter of the ettin Thedse. <sup>8</sup>Shede wishes to have the dwelling which her father had owned, which lies on some fells in the place called Thrimham—but Nearth wishes to live by the sea. <sup>9</sup>They agreed with each other that they would live for nine nights in Thrimham, but the other nine at Nowetons. <sup>10</sup>But when Nearth came back to the Nowetons from the fell, then this quoth he:

5–8 Eigi er Njörðr ása ęttr. ... Hann varð at sētt með goðum ok Vǫnum. ‘Nearth is not of the lineage of the Æse. ... He was used to reconcile the gods and the Wanæs.’ | For this episode see *Vsp* 22 n., *Vafþ* 38–39.

1 „Leĩð eru=mk fjöll, · vas’k=a lęngi á,

2 nętr ęinar níu;

ulfa þytr · mér þótti illr vesa

4 hjá sǫngvi svana.“

“Loathsome I find the fells, I was not long thereon—  
only nine nights.

The howling of wolves seemed evil to me  
against the song of swans.”

[S 6v/15, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

<sup>11</sup>Þá kvað Skaði þetta:

<sup>11</sup>Then this quoth Shede:

2 „Sofa né māt’k=a’k · sęvar beðjum á

2 fugls jarmi fyrir;

sá mik vękr · es af víði kǫmr

4 morgun hverjan mār.“

“I could not sleep on the bed of the sea  
for the bleating of the bird.

That one awakens me who comes from the main  
every morning: the mew.”

[S 6v/16, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

2 <sup>12</sup>Þá fór Skaði upp á fjall ok byggði í Þrym-heimi, <sup>13</sup>ok ferr hón  
mjök á skíðum ok með boga ok skýtr dýr. <sup>14</sup>Hón heitir ǫndur-  
goð eða ǫndur-dís.

<sup>12</sup>Then Shede went up to the fells and dwelled in Thrimham, <sup>13</sup>and she often  
goes on skis with her bow and shoots beasts. <sup>14</sup>She is called ski-god or ski-  
dise.

### III. Homedall's Galder (*Heim-dallar-galdr*, *Gylf* 27)

#### Introduction

This mysterious fragment is quoted in *Gylf* 27, the chapter describing Homedall. The following section is the complete chapter.

The fragment consists of two c-lines and appears to be the end of a stanza in the fitting meter Galders-law.

The same poem is mentioned again in *Skm* 15: *Heim-dallar hofuð heitir sverð. Svá er sagt, at hann var lostinn manns hofði í gegnum. Um þat er kveðit í Heim-dallar-galdri, ok er síðan kallat hofuð mjötuðr Heim-dallar* 'A sword is called Homedall's head. So it is said that he was pierced through with a man's head; about that it is sung in Homedall's galder, and thenceforth the head is called Homedall's bane.'

#### Text

<sup>1</sup>Heim-dallr heitir einn. <sup>2</sup>Hann er kallaðr hvíti óss; <sup>3</sup>hann er  
<sup>2</sup> mikill ok heilagr. <sup>4</sup>Hann bœru at syni meyjar níu ok allar systr;  
<sup>5</sup>hann heitir ok Hallin-skíði ok Gullin-tanni; tennr hans vœru  
<sup>4</sup> af gulli. <sup>6</sup>Hestr hans heitir Gull-toppr. <sup>7</sup>Hann býr þar er heitir  
<sup>6</sup> Himin-björg við Bifröst; <sup>8</sup>hann er vörðr goða ok sitr þar við  
<sup>8</sup> himins enda at gæta brúar'innar fyrir berg-risum. <sup>9</sup>Hann þarf  
<sup>10</sup> minna svefn en fugl. <sup>10</sup>Hann sér jafnt nótt sem dag hundrað  
<sup>10</sup> rasta frá sér; <sup>11</sup>hann heyrir ok þat, er gras vex á jörðu eða ull á  
<sup>12</sup> sauðum, ok allt þat er héra léttr. <sup>12</sup>Hann hefir lúðr þann er Gjallar-  
<sup>12</sup> horn heitir, ok heyrir blástr hans í alla heima. <sup>13</sup>Heim-dallar  
 sverð er kallat hofuð manns.  
 [...]
 <sup>15</sup> Ok enn segir hann sjalfr í Heimdallar-galdri:

<sup>1</sup>HOMEDAL IS THE NAME OF ONE. <sup>2</sup>He is called the White Os; <sup>3</sup>he is great and  
 holy. <sup>4</sup>He was born as the son of nine maidens, sisters all. <sup>5</sup>He is also named  
 Haldenshid and Goldentooth; his teeth were of gold. <sup>6</sup>His horse is named  
 Goldtop. <sup>7</sup>He lives at the place called the Heavenbarrows near Bivrest. <sup>8</sup>He is  
 the Watchman of the Gods and sits there at Heaven's end to guard the bridge  
 against barrow-risers. <sup>9</sup>He needs less sleep than a bird. <sup>10</sup>Both during night  
 and day he sees as far as a hundred rests away from him; <sup>11</sup>he also hears when  
 grass grows on the ground or wool on sheep, and everything which makes  
 louder sound. <sup>12</sup>He has the lur called the Horn of Yell, and his blowing can  
 be heard in all realms. <sup>13</sup>A man's head is called 'Homedall's sword'.  
 [...]

<sup>15</sup> And further he himself says in Homedall's Galder:

1 Heim-dallr ‘Homedall’ | ‘World-Brilliant’. For the word *\*dallr*, possibly ‘brilliant, splendid’, see *Vafþ* 25 n. Homedall appears to be an original fire-god, as seen by his epithets which closely resemble those of the Vedic *Agni*; cf. *Prk* 13/3 n. Importantly Homedall also appears to fill the same ritual role as *Agni*, namely as the conveyor of mankind’s prayers and sacrifices to the Gods, for he hears and sees all the speeches and works of men (27:10–11).

1 hvíti óss ‘the White Os’ | Cf. *Prk* 15/1: *Hęim-dallr, hvítastr ása* ‘Homedall, whitest of the Eese’.

2 Hann böru at syni meýjar níu ok allar systir ‘He was born as the son of nine maidens, sisters all’ | Also mentioned in the galder below, though the significance of this is unclear since the nine sisters are not identified. They may perhaps be the nine daughters of the rulers of the sea, Eagre and Ran (*Skm* 33, 41, 76), which would further strengthen the identification of Homedall with fire; cf. the Indo-Iranian fire-epithet, OI *apám nápāt* ‘grandson of the Waters’ (*RV* 2.35; Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 75).

3 Hallin-skiði ‘Haldenshid’ | ‘The one with slanting planks’, perhaps a name for a kind of (ritual?) fire. This word only appears in two poetic sources. First in the kenning *tennr Hallin-skiða* ‘the teeth of Haldenshid [GOLD]’ in *Glúmr Gráf* 14 (SkP 1) from ca. 970 AD, secondly alongside *Hęim-dali* ‘Homedale’ (apparently a variant of *Hęim-dallr* ‘Homedall’) as a poetic synonym for the ‘ram’ in the list of synonyms *Þul Hríuts* 1 (SkP 3). The latter may suggest an interpretation ‘the one with curved horns’, but the sense ‘horn’ for *skið* is never otherwise attested. The main sense of *skið* is ‘long thin piece of wood, firewood, billet’ (so *Háv* 60/1 and *Vsp* 19/4), whence also its common meaning ‘ski’ and the rare poetic ‘sheath’ (only in *Hamið* 15/1). It is therefore considerably more likely that this epithet originally referring specifically to the god Homedall has been applied to the ram, rather than the reverse: the fact that it is never found in active use in the sense ‘ram’ (but only in a list of synonyms) suggests that the sense ‘ram’ may in fact be a fully antiquarian invention.

3–4 Gullin-tanni; tennr hans vöru af gulli ‘Goldentooth; his teeth were of gold.’ | Attested in a kenning, as noted above. — A direct cognate occurs in *RV* 5.2.3 as an adjective describing *Agni*, the god of fire: *híranya-dantañ śúci-varṇam ... a-paśyam* ‘I saw Him with golden teeth and flaming color’, where OI *híranya-danta* ‘with golden teeth’ < PIE *\*ǵʰh₂-enyó-h₂dontos* ~ *\*ǵʰh₂t-iHno-h₂donto* > PGmc *\*gulþina-tanþó* > ON *Gollin-tanni*.

12 [...] | Here the text cites *Grm* 13 with the words *Hér er svá sagt* ‘Here it is said so’; see there.

- 1 „Níu em’k meýja mǫgr,  
2 níu em’k systra sonr.“

[S 7r/23, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

“Of nine maidens am I the lad,  
of nine sisters am I the son.”

1 meýja ‘maidens’ | so U; móðra ‘mothers’ STW 2 sonr ‘son’ | om. T

1 meýja ‘maidens’ | I.e., nine virgins. The minority reading of U is supported by Snorre’s prose in *Gylf* 27:4 which is clearly drawing from the present stanza.

## IV. Gna and the Wanæs (Gylf 35:21–26).

## Introduction

The following passage is found in *Gylf* 35, the chapter describing the Ossens, i.e., the goddesses.

## Text

21 Fjórátánda Gná, hana sendir Frigg í ymsa heima at ørindum  
 2 sínum. 22 Hón á þann hest, er renn lopt ok lög, er heitir Hóf-varpnir.  
 23 Þat var eitt sinn, er hón reið, at Vanir nokkvörir sá reið hennar  
 4 í lopti'nu. 24 Þá mælti einn:

21 THE FOURTEENTH IS GNA; Frie sends her into various homes to run her  
 errands. 22 She owns the horse which runs through air and sea and is called  
 Hoofwarpner. 23 It was one time when she rode that some Wanæs saw her  
 riding in the air. 24 Then one spoke:

1 „Hvat þar flýgr, · hvat þar fær,  
 2 eða at lopti liðr?“

[S TODO, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

“What flies there, what fares there,  
 or passes through the air?”

25 Hón svarar:

25 She answers:

2 „Né ek flýg, · þó ek fær  
 2 ok at lopti liðr'  
 á Hóf-varpni, · þeim's Ham·skerpir  
 4 gat við Garð-rofu.“

[S TODO, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

“I fly not, though I fare  
 and pass through the air,  
 on Hoofwarpner, whom Hamsherper  
 begot with Yardrove.”

26 Af Gnár nafni er svá kallat, at þat gnéfar, er hóttr ferr.

26 From Gna's name it is so called that something which fares high up *reaches high*.

## V. Balder's death (*Gylf* 49:77–82)

### Introduction

*Gylf* 49 contains the narrative of Balder's death, beginning with his ominous dreams, and ending with the Eese failing to “weep him out of Hell” (for a summary and discussion of the Balder-cycle and its attestations, see the introduction to *Vsp* 31–33).

The following passage is the very end of the chapter, in which a single Leeds-meter speech-stanza is quoted.

### Text

2 <sup>77</sup>Því nést sendu ésir um allan heim ørind-reka at biðja, at Baldr  
 3 vèri grátinn ór Helju, <sup>78</sup>en allir gerðu þat, menn'inir ok kykvendi'n  
 4 ok jörð'in ok steinar'nir ok tré ok allr málmr, <sup>79</sup>svá sem þú munt  
 5 sét hafa, at þessir hlutir gráta, þá er þeir koma ór frosti ok í hita.  
 6 <sup>80</sup>Þá er sendi-menn fóru heim ok hofðu vel rekit sín ørindi, finna  
 þeir í helli nökkvorum, hvar gýgr sat; hón nefndist Þökk. <sup>81</sup>Þeir  
 biðja hana gráta Baldr ór helju, hón segir:

<sup>77</sup>THEHEREAFTER THE EESE SENT AN ERRAND-RUNNER through all the Home  
 to ask that Balder be wept out of hell. <sup>78</sup>And all did that, the men and the  
 beasts and the earth and the stones and trees and all metals, <sup>79</sup>even as thou  
 must have seen that these things weep when they come out of cold and into  
 heat. <sup>80</sup>When the messengers journeyed home and had run their errand well,  
 they find in a certain cave where a gow was sitting; she called herself Thanks.  
<sup>81</sup>They ask her to weep Balder out of hell. She says:

1 „Þökk mun gráta · þurrrum tórum  
 2 Baldrs bál-farar;  
 3 kyks né dauðs · naut'k=a Karls sonar  
 4 hafi Hæl því's hęfir.“

[S TODO, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

“Thanks will weep dry tears  
 for Balder's pyre-journey [DEATH].  
 Neither living nor dead I profitted from Churl's son [= Balder];  
 let Hell have what she has!”

2 <sup>82</sup>En þess geta menn, at þar hafi verit Loki Lauf-eyjar son, er  
 flest hefir illt gørt með ósum.



<sup>82</sup>But men guess that this must have been Lock, Leafy's son, who has done the most evil among the Eese.

## VI. Thunder's journey to Garfrith (*Skm* 26)

### Introduction

*Skm* 26, here edited in part, tells of Thunder's journey to the ettin Garfrith and his following killing of the ettin and his two daughters, Yelp and Grope.

Thunder's fight with Garfrith and his daughters was clearly a very popular story in the late Wiking Age. Its retelling takes up most of the Scaldic *Þdr*, of which 19 full stanzas and 4 half-stanzas survive. The killing of Yelp is also invoked in a pagan prayer to Thunder quoted in *Skm* 11: *stétt of Gjölþ dauða* 'Thou didst stand over the dead Yelp' (Vetr l 1/1b in SkP 3). The story apparently remained popular after Christianization as seen by a humorous anecdote from the Kings' Saws. As King Harold 'Hardrede' Siwardson (born ca. 1015, dead 1066) was walking with his retinue, they witnessed an argument between a blacksmith and a tanner. Harold asked one of his court poets to compose a stanza (viz. ÞjóðA l 5 in SkP 2) about the incident while at the same time casting the blacksmith as Thunder and the tanner as Garfrith. The king was impressed and asked the poet to make another stanza, this time about Siward and Fathomer. The story of Garfrith is further alluded to in a curious way in Saxo Grammaticus (2015, pp. 598–613) 8.14.1–20, where a party guided by a man named Thurkettle (Latin *Thorkillus*) visit Garfrith's (Latin *Gerruthus*) cave and find his mutilated corpse along with those of three young women with their backs broken. Thurkettle tells them that this was once done by the god Thunder (Latin *Thor*).

Although the story of *Skm* 26 is clearly based partly on *Þdr* (from which it cites at length), it may also rely on a now-lost poem in Leeds-meter since it quotes two stanzas in that meter. Of these sts. the first is found in all four main manuscripts while the second only in U. Both are spoken by Thunder and closely resemble each other stylistically, which is why they are likely to come from the same poem.

### Text

- 2 Þá fór Þórr til ár þeirar, er Vimur heitir, allra á mest. Þá spennti  
hann sik megin-gjörðum ok studdi for-streymis Gríðar-völ, en  
4 Þá hélt undir megin-gjarðar. Ok þá er Þórr kom á miðja ó'na,  
þá óx svá mjök ó'in, at uppi braut á ǫxl honum. Þá kvað Þórr  
þetta:

THEN JOURNEYED THUNDER to that river which is called Wimbre, greatest of all rivers. Then he strapped his might-girdle around him and leaned upon Grith's stave against the stream, and Lock clung to the might-girdle. And when Thunder came to the middle of the river, then it waxed so great that it broke over his shoulders. Then this quoth Thunder:

1 „Vax=at-tu nú, Vimur, · alls mik þik vaða tíðir  
 2 jötna garða í;  
 vætist, ef þú vęx · at þa vęx mér ős-męgin  
 4 jafn-hött upp sem himinn.“

[S TODO, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

“Wax not now, Wimbre, as I wish to wade through thee  
 into the yards of the ettins!  
 Thou knowest, if thou waxest, then my Os-might waxes  
 up even as high as the heaven.”

ALL | The contents of the st. are also found in *Þdr* 8/3–4.

1 Vimur ‘Wimbre’ | The name of the river is also found in a kenning in *Húsdr* 6/3: *Við-gymnir* *Vimrar vaðs* ‘the Widegimmer (ettin) of Wimbre’s ford [= Thunder]’.

3 ős-męgin ‘Os-might’ | TODO.

Þá sér Þórr uppi í gljúfrum nokkurum, at Gjølþ, dóttir Geir-røðar  
 2 stóð þar tveim męgin ár’innar, ok gerði hón ár-vøxt’inn. Þá tók  
 Þórr upp ór ǵ’nni stein mikinn ok kastaði at henni ok męlti svá:  
 4 „At ósi skal ǵ stemma.“ Eigi missti hann, þar er hann kastaði til,  
 ok í því bili bar hann at landi ok fekk tekit reyni-runn nokkurn  
 6 ok steig svá ór ǵ’nni. Því er þat orð-tak haft, at reynir er björg  
 þórs.

Then Thunder sees that up in some certain gorges Yelp, the daughter of  
 Garfrith, stood on both sides of the river, and she caused the river’s growth.  
 Then Thunder took up from the river a great stone and threw it at her and  
 spoke so: “At its source shall the river be dammed.” He did not miss his  
 target, and in that very moment he threw himself towards land and caught  
 hold of a certain rowan shrub, and so he came out of the river. From this  
 comes the saying that the rowan is Thunder’s deliverance.

2 stóð þar tveim męgin ár’innar, ok gerði hón ár-vøxt’inn ‘stood on both sides of the river, and she  
 caused the river’s growth’ | She stood with her legs spread and befouled the river with urine or  
 menstrual blood.

En er Þórr kom til Geir-røðar, þá var þeim fé-lögum vísat fyrst í  
 2 geita-hús til her-bergis, ok var þar einn stóll til sétis, ok sat Þórr  
 þar. Þá varð hann þess varr, at stóll’inn fór undir honum upp at  
 4 réfri. Hann stakk Gríðar-veli upp í rapt’ana ok lét sígast fast á  
 stól’inn. Varð þá brestr mikill, ok fylgði skrékr. Þar höfðu verit  
 6 undir stóli’num dótr Geir-røðar, Gjølþ ok Greip, ok hafði hann  
 brotit hrygg’inn í báðum. Þá kvað Þórr:

But when Thunder came to Garfrith’s, then the companions were first shown  
 into a goathouse for lodgings, and therein was but one chair for sitting and

Thunder sat down there. Then he became aware that the chair under him was moving upwards into the rafters. He thrust Grith's stave up against the rafters and pushed himself firmly down into the chair. Then there was a great crack, followed by a shriek. There beneath the chair had been the daughters of Garfrith, Yelp and Grope, and he had broken the backs of them both. Then quoth Thunder:

---

7 Þá kvað Þórr: | *only in U; om. all others.*

2 „**E**inu *sinni* · neytta'k alls meġins

[U TODO]

2 jǫtna gǫrðum **í**

þá's **G**jǫlp ok **G**reip, · dótr **G**eir-raðar,

4 vildu **h**efja mik til **h**imins.“

“A single time I used all my might  
in the yards of the ettins,  
when Yelp and Grope, the daughters of Garfrith,  
would lift me to the heaven.”

---

ALL | *only in U; om. all others.*

---

1 *sinni* ‘time’ | metr. and sens. emend.; om. U.

VII. The tree Glazer (*Skm* 42)

## Introduction

The original context of this half-stanza in Leeds-meter is obscure. The present excerpt represents the whole ch. 42 of *Skm*.

## Text

<sup>1</sup>Hví er gull kallat barr eða lauf Glasis? <sup>2</sup>Í Ós-garði fyrir durum  
 2 Val-hallar stendr lundr, sá er Glasir er kallaðr, en lauf hans allt  
 er gull-rautt, <sup>3</sup>svá sem hér er kveðit, at

<sup>1</sup>WHY IS GOLD called the needle or leaf of Glazer? <sup>2</sup>In Osyrd, before the  
 doors of Walhall stands a tree which is called Glazer, and its leafing is all  
 golden red, <sup>3</sup>as it is sung here, that

1 Glasir stendr · með gollnu laufi  
 2 fyrir Sig-týs solum.

[S TODO, T TODO,  
 W TODO, U TODO]

Glazer stands with golden leaf  
 before Sye-Tew's (Weden's) halls.

<sup>4</sup>Sá er víðr fegrstr með goðum ok mǫnnum.

<sup>4</sup>It is the fairest tree among gods and men.

## VIII. On the making of Glapner (*Lítla skálda*)

### Introduction

The following stanza describes the making of Glapner, the final fetter used to bind the Fenrerswolf. For the binding of the Wolf see *Gylf* 34:10–42 and the summary in *Lok* 38/3–4 n.

The stanza itself is found in the short work on kennings today called the Little Scalda (*Lítla skálda*), a text which probably served as a source for Snorre's Edda (see further Males 2020, pp. 129–47). It is not attributed to any named Eddic poem, although we cannot exclude that one might have existed.

A variant of the stanza is transparently paraphrased in *Gylf* 34:21, which tells us that Glapner *var gorr af sex blutum: af dyn kattar'ins ok af skeggi konu'nnar ok af rótum bjargs'ins ok af sinum bjarnar'ins ok af anda fisks'ins ok af fogs bráka* 'was made from six things: from the cat's din and from the woman's beard and from the mountain's root and from the bear's sinews and from the fish's breath and from the fowl's spittle'. The variants—*bráka* 'spittle' for *mjolk* 'milk' and the reversal of lines 2 and 3—suggest that Snorre had access to an alternative version of the stanza. This version may perhaps have belonged to a variant oral tradition, but it is also possible that Snorre merely paraphrased the stanza from the Little Scalda from memory, misremembering a few minor details.

### Text

- 1 Ór kattar dyn · ok ór konu skeggi,  
2 ór fisks anda · ok ór fugla mjolk,  
ór bergs rótum · ok bjarnar sinum,  
4 ór því vas hann Gleipnir gorr.

[A<sub>6</sub> 9v/30, B TODO]

“FROM DIN OF CAT and woman's beard,  
from breath of fish and milk of fowls,  
from mountain's roots and bear's sinews—  
from this was Glapner made.”

# Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle





# First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane

## (*1 Hęłga kviđa Hundings-bana*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C12th (0.805)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

This rather late poem is well written. Particularly beautiful are the introductory stanzas, which tell of Norns arriving in the night to predetermine Hallow's life.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*1 HHund* is only preserved in **R** (on foll. 20r/20–22r/3), where it follows the mythological *Alv* and is followed by the heroic *HHj*.

*1 HHund* is the first poem of the heroic section of **R**, consisting of *1 HHund–Hamđ*. As discussed in the Introduction to Eddic Poetry above, the heroic section of **R** clearly forms a distinct paleographic group from the mythological section consisting of *Vsp–Alv* (Lindblad 1980, esp. pp. 160–163). Although both sections of **R** are written by the same hand, the orthographic distinctions are so clear that they have likely been copied out of separate manuscripts, and *1 HHund* would appear to have been the first poem of it. This also explains the poem's unusually long title and the great size of its initial letter (Lindblad 1980, p. 166).

It is further notable that the three Hallow-poems (*1 HHund*, *HHj*, *2 HHund*) form a paleographic subdivision within the heroic section of **R**, although *1 HHund* somewhat deviates from the latter two poems (Lindblad) [151–153, 161], which, “as far as the orthography goes, form most homogenous group of poems in **R**” (Lindblad 1980, p. 153).

### Meter and stanza

Unlike the other two Hallow-poems, *1 HHund* is a true poem rather than a prosimetrum. The meter throughout is Ancient-words-law, of a strict variety.

TODO: Males Hiatus article.

The poem consists of 228 long-lines across 56 stanzas. The most common length of the stanza is 4 lines (41/56: 1–14, 16–18, 21–24, 27, 29–31, 33–35, 37–38, 40, 42–47, 49, 52, 54–55), which are generally clearly divided into two helmings (i.e., semantic groups of 2 lines). Other represented line counts are 5 (6/56: 15, 26, 41, 48, 51, 56), 3 (19, 25, 28, 32), 6 (36, 50, 53), and 2 (20, 39).

It must be noted that all three stanzas with 6 lines can be split up into two stanzas of 4 and 2 lines each (36/1–2 and 3–6, 50/1–4 and 5–6, 53/1–2 and 3–6). On the other hand, the stanzas of 5 lines generally have the “fifth” line tacked-on to the first or second helming as a form of emphasis, parallelism, or repetition, e.g., 41/5.

### Language and style

The three Hallow-poems display a few common linguistic and stylistic peculiarities. In particular, the two poetic words *buðlungr* ‘ruler, chieftain’, lit. ‘descendant of Budle’ and *doglingr* ‘id.’, lit. ‘descendant of Day’ are used with an unparalleled frequency for Eddic poetry. Outside of the Hallow-poems, *buðlungr* only appears in one other poem in **R**, *Akv* 46/4, but there in its etymological sense, namely ‘the clan of Budle’, Attle’s father. On the other hand, the word appears 4 times in *1 HHund*, 6 times in *HHj*, and 2 times in *2 HHund*. *doglingr* only otherwise appears in *1 Guðr* 14/2, but appears 3 times in *1 HHund* and 2 times in *2 HHund*. Both words are common in Scaldic poetry and originally derive from a generalisation of originally specific clan-names, and so their inclusion in these poems ought to be seen as a sign of Scaldic influence, probably pointing to a late date of composition. Both words also figure in likely antiquarian Eddic poetry, e.g., in *Grot* 19/4, along with several stanzas edited in SkP 8.

## Text

- P1 Hér hefr upp kvæði frá Helga Hundings bana, þeira ok Høð-brodds.  
 2 Volsunga kviða.

HERE BEGINS A LAY about Hallow, the bane of Hunding and his men, and of Hathbrod. A lay of the Walsings.

ALL | *The unusually long title of the poem is also introduced by a particularly large initial, otherwise only paralleled by Vsp 1 in R.*

- 1 Ás vas alda · þat's arar gullu [R 20r/21]  
 2 hnigu hēilög vōtn · af Himin-fjōllum;  
 þā hafði Hēlga · inn hugum stóra  
 4 Borg-hildr borit · í Brá-lundi.

It was early of ages when eagles shrieked;  
 holy waters poured down from the Heavenfells;  
 then to Hallow, the great of heart,  
 Burhild in Brawlund had given birth.

1 Ás vas alda 'It was early of ages' | This formulaic introduction immediately situates the events of the poem in the distant mytho-heroic past, indeed, if one compares Vsp 3/1 where the same line occurs, at the beginning of history.

1 arar gullu 'eagles shrieked' | In celebration of the birth of a great warrior to feed them. Cf. TODO (beasts of battle motif).

- 2 Nōtt varð í bō, · nornir kvōmu, [R 20r/23]  
 2 þér's qōlingi · aldr of skópu;  
 þann bōðu fylki · frégstan verða  
 4 ok buðlunga · bētstan þykkja.

It turned night in the settlement; norns arrived,  
 they who shaped the athling's age.  
 They bade that battle-arrayer become the noblest  
 and among princes seem the best.

- 3 Snōru þér af afli · ør-løg-þōttu [R 20r/25]  
 2 þā's borgir braut · í Brá-lundi;  
 þér of grēiddu · gollin-símu  
 4 ok und mǫna sal · miðjan fēstu.

They turned with strength the orlay-strands  
 when castles were broken in Brawlund.

They arranged a golden cord  
and beneath the middle of the moon's hall [SKY/HEAVEN] fastened it.

1 *or-log-þóttu* 'orlay-strands' | The strands of men's destinies. The likeness with strings of fabric is notable since it has a close parallel to the role of the Greek Μοῖραι, the three weavers of fate. Cf. the semantically identical cpd. *or-log-síma* in *Reg* 14/4.

- 4 Þér austr ok vestr · enda fölu, [R 20r/27]  
2 þar átti loðungur · land á milli,  
brá nipt Nera · á norðr-vega  
4 einni fęsti, · ęy það hęn halda.

In the east and west they hid its ends;  
there the praised man owned land in between.  
The kinswoman of Nare [NORN] pulled onto the northern ways  
a single strand—she bade it hold for ever.

- 5 Eitt vas at angri · Ylfinga nið [R 20r/29]  
2 ok þęiri meyju · es mun-úð fódđi;  
hrafn kvað at hrafni, · sat á hóm meĩði  
4 and·vanr ętú: · „Ek veit nękkut!

TODO.

TODO.

A raven quoth to raven; it sat on a high branch,  
lacking food: “I know something!”

- 6 Stęndr ĩ brynju · burr Sig·mundar, [R 20r/31]  
2 dógurs ęins gamall, · nú 's dagr kominn!  
Hvęssir augu · sem hildingar,  
4 sá's varga vinr, · vit skulum tętir!“

In his byrnie stands Syemund's son,  
one half-day old; now the day is come!  
He sharpens his eyes like do men of war;  
that one is a friend of wolves; we shall be merry!”

- 7 Drótt þótti sá · døglingr vera, [R 20r/33]  
2 kvęðu með gumnum · ár of kominn;  
sjalfr gekk vísi · ór víg-þrimu  
4 ungum fóra · ítr-lauk grami.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.  
TODO.

---

2 of | om. R

- 8      Gaf hann Hēlga nafn · ok Hring-staði,  
2      Sól-fjöll, Sné-fjöll · ok Sig-ars-völlu,  
      Hring-stöð, Hó-tún · ok Himin-vanga,  
4      blóð-orm búinn · bróðr Sin-fjötla.

[R 20v/2]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 9      Þá nam at vaxa · fyr vina brjósti  
2      almr ítr-borinn · ynðis ljóma.  
      Hann galt ok gaf · goll verðungu,  
4      sparði eigi hilmir · hodd blóð-rekin.

[R 20v/4]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 10     Skammt lét vísi · vígs at bíða  
2     þá's fylkir vas · fimm-tán vetra  
      ok hann harðan lét · Hunding veginn,  
4     þann's lengi réð · lönnum ok þegnum.

[R 20v/6]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 11     Kvæddu síðan · Sig-mundar bur  
2     auðs ok hringa · Hundings synir  
      því't þeir óttu · jöfri at gjalda  
4     fjár-nám mikit · ok fœður dauða.

[R 20v/8]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

12 Lét=at buðlungr · bótir uppi [R 20v/10]

2 né niðja in heðr · nef-gjöld fáa;  
vön kvað hann myndu · veðrs ins mikla  
4 grára geira · ok græmi Óðins.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

13 Fara hildingar · hjör-stefnu til, [R 20v/12]

2 þeirar's lögðu · at Loga-fjöllum;  
sléit Fróða-frið · fjánda á milli,  
4 fara Viðris grey · val-gjörn umb ey.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

14 Setti=sk vísi, · þá's vegit hafði [R 20v/14]

2 Ólf ok Eyj-ólf, · und Ara-stęini,  
Hjör-varð ok Hó-varð, · Hundings sonu;  
4 farit hafði hann allri · ętt geir-Mímis.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

15 Þa brá ljóma · af Loga-fjöllum [R 20v/16]

2 en af þeim ljómum · leiptrir kvómu;  
þa vas und hjölmum · á Himin-vanga;  
4 brynjur vóru þeira · blóði stokknar,  
ęn af geirum · geislar stóðu.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

5 geirum | 'geiror' R

- 16 Frá ár=liga · ór ulf-iði [R 20v/18]  
 2 dōglingr at því · dísir suð-ronar  
 ef þér vildi heim · með hildingum  
 4 þá nōtt fara; · þrymr vas alma.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.
- 17 En af hęsti · Hōgna dóttir, [R 20v/20]  
 2 —liddi randa rym— · ręsi sagði:  
 „Hygg at vér ęigim · aðrar sýslur  
 4 an með baug-brota · bjór at drekka.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.
- 18 Hęfir mǫnn faðir · meyju sinni [R 20v/22]  
 2 grimmum hętitit · Gran·mars syni;  
 en ek hęfi, Hęlgi, · Hōð·brodd kveðinn  
 4 konung ó-neisan · sem kattar son.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.
- 19 Þa kōmr fylkir · fara náttu [R 20v/24]  
 2 nema hōnum vísir · val-stefnu til  
 eða mey nemir · frá mildingi.“  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.
- 20 „Uggi ęigi þú · Ísungs bana! [R 20v/26]  
 2 Fyr mun dolga dynr · nema dauðr séa’k!“  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 21      Sęndi ǫru · all-valdr þaðan [R 20v/27]  
 2      of lopt ok of lǫg · leiðar at biðja,  
      ið-gnógan · ógnar ljóma  
 4      brǫgnum bjóða · ok burum þęira.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 22      „Biðið skjót=liga · til skipa ganga [R 20v/29]  
 2      ok ór Brand-ęyju · búna verða!“  
      Þaðan beði þęngill · und's þing kvómu  
 4      halir hund-margir · ór Hęðins-ęyju.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 23      Ok þar af strǫndum · ór Stafns-nęsi [R 20v/31]  
 2      bęit hans út skriðu · ok búin golli;  
      spurði Hęlgi · Hjǫr-leif at því:  
 4      Hęfir þú kannaða · koni ó-nęisa?

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 24      En ungr konungr · ǫðrum sagði, [R 20v/33]  
 2      sęint kvað at tęlja · af Trǫnu-ęyri  
      lang-hǫfðuð skip · und líðǫndum,  
 4      þau's í Qrva-sund · útan fóru:

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 25      „Tolf hundruð · tryggra manna; [R 21r/2]  
 2      þó 's í Hǫ-túnnum · hǫlfu fleira,  
      víg-lið konungs; · vǫn erum rómu!“



TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 26 Svá brá stýrir · stafn-tjöldum af [R 21r/3]  
 2 at mildinga · męngi vakði,  
 ok döglingar · dags-brún sea,  
 4 ok siklingar · snøru upp við tré  
 vef-nistingum · á Varins-firði.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 27 Varð ára ymr · ok járna glymr, [R 21r/6]  
 2 brast rōnd við rōnd, · røru víkingar;  
 ęisandi gekk · und øðlingum  
 4 lofðungs floti · lōndum fjarri.

There was splashing of oars and clashing of swords;  
 shield struck against shield—the Vikings rowed.

TODO.  
 TODO.

---

1 járna 'swords' | The contracted form is metrically preferred. TODO.

- 28 Svá vas at heyra · es saman kvómu [R 21r/8]  
 2 Kólgu systir · ok kilir langir  
 sem björg eða brim · brotna myndi.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 29 Draga bað Helgi · hō segl ofarr, [R 21r/9]  
 2 varð=at hrōnnum · hōfn þing-loga,  
 þa's ógur=lig · Égis dóttir  
 4 stag-stjórn-mōrum · stęppa vildi.

TODO.  
 TODO.

TODO.  
TODO.

- 30 En þeim sjölfum · Sig·rún ofan [R 21r/11]  
2 folk-djǫrf of barg · ok fari þeira,  
snørisk ramm=liga · Rǫn ór hendi  
4 gjalfr-dýr konungs · at Gnipa-lundi.

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 31 Svá't þar umb aptan · í Una-vógum, [R 21r/13]  
2 flaust fagr-búin · fljóta knóttu,  
en þeir sjalfir · frá Svarins-haugi  
4 með hǣrmðar hug · hǣr kǫnnuðu.

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 32 Frá goð-borinn · Guð·mundr at því: [R 21r/15]  
2 „Hverr 's land-reki · sá's liði stýrir  
ok hann fǣikna-lið · fǣrir at landi?“

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 33 Sin·fjǫtli kvað, · slong upp við ró [R 21r/17]  
2 rauðum skildi, · rǫnd vas ór golli;  
þar vas sund-vǫrðr · sá's svara kunni  
4 ok við ǫðlinga · orðum skipa:

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
and with athlings bandy words.

- 34 „Sǣg þat í aptan, · es svínum gefr [R 21r/19]

- 2 ok tíkr yðrar · tēygir at solli,  
at sé Ylfingar · austan komnir  
4 gunnar gjarnir · frá Gnipa-lundi.

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 35 Þar mun Hǫð-broddr · Hēlga finna,  
2 flug-trauðan gram · í flota miðjum,  
sá's opt hēfir · ǫrnu sadda,  
4 meðan þú á kvernum · kysstir þýjar.“

[R 21r/21]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 36 „Fátt mant, fylkir, · fornra spjalla  
2 es þú ǫðlingum · ó-sonnu bregðr!  
þú hēfir etnar · ulfa krásir  
4 ok bróðr þínum · at bana orðit,  
opt sǫr sogin · með svólum munni,  
6 hēfr í hręysi · hvar-leiðr skriðit!“

[R 21r/23]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 37 „Þú vast vǫlva · í Varins-eyju,  
2 skoll-vís kona, · bart skrok saman;  
kvaðst ęngi mann · ęiga vilja,  
4 sęgg brynjaðan, · nema Sin-fjótla!

[R 21r/26]

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

- 38 „Þú vart in skóða,“ (kvað) „skass, val-kyrja,  
 2 ǫtul, á máttlig, · at Al-fǫður;  
 mundu ein-herjar · allir berja=sk,  
 4 své-vís kona, · of sakar þínar!

[R 21r/28]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 39 Níu óttum vit · á neši Sögu  
 2 ulfa alna, · ek vas einn faðir þeira!“

[R 21r/30]

TODO.  
 TODO.

- 40 „Faðir vas=at-tu · fēnris-ulfa,  
 2 ǫllum ellri, · svá't ek muna,  
 síðst þik gēldu · fyr Gnipa-lundi  
 4 þursa meýjar · á Þörs-neši!

[R 21r/31]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 41 Stjúpr vast Sig-geirs, · látt und stöðum heima,  
 2 varg-ljóðum vanr · á viðum úti;  
 kvómu þér ó-gögn · ǫll at hendi  
 4 þá's bróðr þínum · brjóst raufaðir;  
 gørðir þik frégjan · af firin-verkum!

[R 21r/33]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 42 Þú vart brúðr Grana · á Brá-velli,  
 2 goll-bitluð vart · gorr til rásar,  
 hafða'k þér móðri · margt skeið riðit  
 4 svangri und sǫðli, · simul, for·bergis!“

[R 21v/3]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 43 „Sveinn þóttir þú · sið-lauss vesa [R 21v/5]  
 2 þá's þú Gollnis · geytr molkaðir  
 en í annat sinn · Imðar dóttir  
 4 töttrug-hypja; · vill þú tölulengri?“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 44 „Fyrr vilda ek · at Freka-stęini [R 21v/7]  
 2 hrafna seðja · á hręum þinum  
 en tíkr yðrar · tęgja at solli  
 4 eða gefa góltum; · deili gróm við þik!“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 45 „Vęri ykk, Sin-fjötli,“ (kvað) „sómra myklu [R 21v/9]  
 2 gunni at heýja · ok glaða ornu  
 an sé ó-nýtum · orðum at bręðask  
 4 þó'tt hring-brotar · heiptir deili.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 46 Þikkja-t mér góðir · Gran-mars synir, [R 21v/11]  
 2 þó dugir siklingum · satt at męla;  
 þęir hafa markat · á Móins-heimum,  
 4 at hug hafa · hjörum at bręða.“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

TODO.

- 47 Þeir af ríki · rinna létu [R 21v/13]  
 2 Svipuð ok Svegjuð · Sól-heima til,  
 dala dög-g-ótta, · dökkvar hliðir,  
 4 skalf Mistar marr · hvar's megir fóru.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 48 Móttu þeir tiggja · í tûn-hliði, [R 21v/15]  
 2 soggðu stríð=liga · stilli kvómu.  
 Úti stóð Hðð-broddr · hjalmi faldinn,  
 4 hugði hann jó-reið · éttar sinnar:  
 „Hví's hçrmðar litr · à Hniflungum?“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

3 Hðð-broddr | *creatively corr. in same hand from Bðð-vldr 'Beadbild' (due to influence from the nearby Vkv; see Males 2024a, p. 159) R.*

---

5 Hniflungum | This is the only attestation of *hniflungr* rather than *niflungr* in R ('*hniflungom*'), but the initial *h* is also metrically necessary in *Ghv* 12/3.

- 49 „Snúa=sk hér at sandi · snéfgir kjólar, [R 21v/18]  
 2 rakka hirtir · ok ráar langar,  
 skildir margir, · skafnar árar,  
 4 gøfugt lið gylfa, · glaðir Ylfingar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 50 Ganga fimm-tán · folk upp á land, [R 21v/20]  
 2 þó's í Sogn út · sjau þúsundir,  
 liggja hér í grindum · fyr Gnipa-lundi  
 4 brim-dýr blá-svört · ok búin golli.

6 Þar 's miklu mēst · mēngi þeira;  
mun=a nú Hēlgi · hǰor-þing dvala.“

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

51 „Rinni raukn bitluð · til rēgin-þinga  
2 en Spor-vitnir · at Sparins-heiði.  
Méltnir ok Mýlnir · til myrk-viðar;  
4 látið engi mann · eptir sitja  
þeira 's bēn-logum · bręða kunni!

[R 21v/23]

“TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.

Let no man remain behind  
of those who can brandish wound-flames [SWORDS]!

52 Bjóðið ér Hǰgna · ok Hring's sonum,  
2 Atla ok Yngva, · Ólf inum gamla;  
þeir 'ro gjarnir · gunni at heyya;  
4 lǰtum Vǰlsunga · viðr-nám fāa!“

[R 21v/25]

Summon Hawn and the sons of Ring:  
Atle and Ing and Atholf the Old.  
They are eager to wage war;  
let us make the Walsings face resistance!”

53 Svipr einn vas þat · es saman kvǰmu  
2 fǰlvir oddar · at Freka-steini;  
ey var Hēlgi · Hundings bani  
4 fyrstr í folki · þar's firar bǰrðu=sk,  
ǰstr à ímu, · all-trauðr flugar;  
6 sá hafði hilmir · hart móð-akarn.

[R 21v/27]

TODO.  
TODO.

always was Hallow Hunding's bane  
the first in the troop where the folk did fight;  
TODO.

that helmet-bearer had a hard courage-acorn [HEART].

- 54 Kvómu þar ór himni · hjalm-vitr ofan, [R 21v/30]  
 2 —óx geyra gnýr— · þér's grami hlífðu;  
 þá kvað þat Sig-rún, · —sár-vitr flugar—  
 4 át hǫlða skér · af Hugins barri:

There, out of heaven, helmet-wights came down,  
 they who shielded the lord—the din of spears grew.  
 Then this quoth Syerun, the wound-wight of flight—  
 TODO.

- 55 „Heill skalt, vísi, · virða njóta, [R 21v/33]  
 2 átt-stafr Yngva, · ok una lífi  
 es þú fellt hefir · inn flugar-trauða  
 4 jǫfur, þann's olli · Égis dauða.

“TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

- 56 Ok þér, buðlungr, · samir bēði vel [R 22r/1]  
 2 rauðir baugar · ok in ríkja mér;  
 heill skalt, buðlungr, · bēði njóta  
 4 Høgna dóttur · ok Hring-staða  
 sigrs ok landa; · þá's sókn lokit!“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”



# Lay of Hallow Harwardson

## (*Hęłga kviđa Hjør·varðs-sonar*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.385)–late C11th (0.550)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter

### Introduction

The **Lay of Hallow Harwardson** (*HHj*) is a heroic prosimetrum and the second of the three Hallow-poems.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*HHj* is found only in **R**, on foll. 22r/4–24r/12, where it follows *1 HHund* and is followed by *2 HHund*.

It has been noted that *HHj* forms a particularly close orthographic group with its fellow prosimetrum and neighbour, *2 HHund* (Lindblad 1980, pp. 151–153). In fact, the two texts are so closely related orthographically that they appear to derive from a single source, which must have preceded the compilation of **R**.

### Meter and stanza

Like the following *2 HHund*, but unlike the preceding *1 HHund*, *HHj* is a prosimetrum that mixes prose with poetry in Ancient-words-law and Leeds-meter.

The text 10 ten prose passages and 43 stanzas. Stanzas fully in Ancient-words-law are 1–11 and 31–43; stanzas fully in Leeds-meter are 13–30. Only stanza 12 mixes meters, with ll. 1–2 in Ancient-words-law and ll. 3–4 in Leeds-meter.

TODO: the speaker notes are emended. Note this!!!

## Text

## Frá Hjor·varði ok Sigr·linn ('From Harward and Syelind')

- P1 Hjor·varðr hét konungr; hann átti fjórar konur. Ein hét Alf·hildr; [R 22r/4]  
 2 sonr þeira hét Heðinn. Önnur hét Sér·eiðr; þeira sonr hét Hum-  
 lungr. In þriðja hét Sin·rjóð; þeira sonr hét Hymlingr. Hjor·varðr  
 4 konungr hafði þess heit strengt at eiga þá konu er hann vissi vên-  
 sta. Hann spurði at Sváfni konungr átti dóttur \*allra fegrsta;  
 6 sú hét Sigr·linn. Ið·mundr hét jarl hans; Atli var hans sonr,  
 er fór at biðja Sigr·linnar til handa konungi. Hann dvalði=sk  
 8 vetr-langt með Sváfni konungi. Frán·marr hét þar jarl, fóstri  
 Sigr·linnar; dóttir hans hét Álof. Jarl'inn réð, at meyjar var syn-  
 10 jat, ok fór jarl'inn heim. Atli jarls sonr stóð einn dag við lund  
 nokkurn, en fugl sat í limu'num uppi yfir hánun, ok hafði heyrt  
 12 til, at hans menn kǫlluðu vênstar konur þær, er Hjor·varðr ko-  
 nungr átti. Fugl'inn kvakaði, en Atli hlýddi hvat hann sagði.  
 14 Hann kvað:

Hearward was the name of a king; he had four wives. One was called Elfhild; their son was called Headen. The other was called Searad; their son was called Humbling. The third was called Sindread; their son was called Himbling. King Hearward had undertaken a vow to have the women whom he knew to be the most handsome. He learned that king Swebnar had a daughter fairest of all; she was called Syelind. Idmund was the name of his earl; Attle was his son, who journeyed to ask for Syelind's hand on behalf of the king. He stayed over the winter with king Swebnar. Frenmar was the name of an earl there, the foster-father of Syelind; his daughter was called Anlave. The earl decided that the maiden was denied him and the earl journeyed home. Attle the earl's son one day stood by a certain tree, but a bird sat in the branches above him and had overheard that his men said that the women which king Hearward had were the most handsome. The bird twittered, and Attle listened to what he said. Quoth he:

---

5 \*allra | 'vænallra' R

- Fugl kvað: 1 „Sátt-u Sigr·linn, · Sváfni dóttur,  
 2 mēyna fęgrstu · í munar-heimi?  
 þó hag=ligar · Hjor·varðs konur  
 4 gumnum þykkja · at Glasis-lundi.“ [R 22r/16]

Quoth the bird: "Hast thou seen Syelind Swebnar's daughter,  
 the fairest of maidens in the realm of love [WORLD]?"

Although Hearward's wives seem handsome  
to the men in Glazerslund."

- Atli kvađ: 2 „Munt við Atla · Ið·mundar son [R 22r/18]  
2 fęgl fróđ-hugađr · flęira męla?“  
Fęgl kvađ: „Mun'k ef mik buđlungr · blóta vildi  
4 ok kýs'k þat's ek vil · ór konungs garði.“  
Quoth Attle: "Wilt thou with Attle Idmund's son,  
O wise-minded bird, speak yet more?"  
Quoth the bird: "I will, if the chieftain will make a bloot for me  
and I may choose what I wish from the house of the king."

- Atli kvađ: 3 „Kjós=at-tu Hęor-varđ · né hans sonu [R 22r/20]  
2 né inar fęgru · fylkis brúđir,  
ęigi brúđir · þęr's buđlungr á;  
4 kaupum vel saman, · þat 's vina kynni.“  
Quoth Attle: "Choose not Harward nor his sons,  
nor the fair brides of the marshaller—  
not the brides which the chieftain has.  
Let us deal well together; that is the manner of friends."

- Fęgl kvađ: 4 „Hof mun'k kjósa, · hęrga marga, [R 22r/22]  
2 goll-hyrnđar kýr · frá grams búi,  
ef hęnum Sigr·linn · søfr á armi  
4 ok ó·nauđig · jęfri fylgir.“  
Quoth the bird: "Hoves will I choose, many harrows,  
golden-horned kine from the ruler's estate  
if Syelind will sleep on his arm  
and without coercion follow the lord."

2 goll-hyrnđar kýr 'golden-horned kine' | Formulaic, also found in *Þrk* 23/1b.

- P2 Þetta var áđr Atli fóri. En er hann kom heim ok konungr spurði [R 22r/24]  
2 hann tíđinda, hann kvađ:  
This was before Attle journeyed. But when he came home and the king asked  
him for the tidings, quoth he:

- 5 „Hęfum ęrfiđi · ok ękki ęrendi; [R 22r/25]  
2 mara þraut óra · á megin-fjalli,

urðum síðan · Sǣ·morn vaða;  
 4 þá vas oss synjat · Sváfnis dóttur,  
 hringum góðdrar, · es vér hafa vildum.“

“We have a hardship and no errand.  
 Our steeds expired on the mighty fell;  
 thereafter we had to wade through Seamorn.  
 Then we were refused Swebner's daughter,  
 endowed with rings, whom we wished to have.”

1 Høfum ǣrfiði · ok ǣkki ǫrendi | I.e., ‘we have had great struggle and got no results.’ A formulaic word-pair; cf. *Jrk* 10/1, 11/1.

P3 Konungr bað at þeir skyldu fara annat sinn; fór hann sjálf. En [R 22r/28]  
 2 er þeir kómu upp á fjall ok sá á Sváfa-land lands-bruna ok jó-  
 reyki stóra, reið konungr af fjalli'nu fram í land'it ok tók nátt-  
 4 ból við á eina. Atli helt vǫrð ok fór yfir á'na. Hann fann eitt  
 hús. Fugl mikill sat á húsi'nu ok gétti ok var sofnaðr. Atli  
 6 skaut spjóti fugl'inn til bana en í húsi'nu fann hann Sigr·linn  
 konungs dóttur ok Á·lǫfu jarls dóttur ok hafði þér báðar braut  
 8 með sér. Frán·marr jarl hafði hamatst í arnar líki ok varit þér  
 fyr her'num með fjǫl·kynngi. Hróð·marr hét konungr, biðill  
 10 Sigr·linnar. Hann drap Sváfa-konung ok hafði rént ok brennt  
 land'it. Hjør·varðr konungr fekk Sigr·linnar en Atli Á·lǫfar.

The king bade that they should journey another time; he himself journeyed.  
 But when they came up onto the fell and saw out over Swebeland, the singed  
 land and the great dust-clouds from horses, the king rode down from the  
 fell into the land and took his nightly lodgings by a river. Attle kept watch  
 and journeyed over the river; he found a lone house. A graet bird sat upon  
 the house and guarded it and had fallen asleep. Attle shot the bird to its  
 death with a spear, but in the house he found Syelind, the king's daughter,  
 and Onlave, the earl's daughter, and took them both away with him. Earl  
 Frenmar had shifted hames into the likeness of an eagle and had guarded  
 them against the host with manicunningness. Rothmar was the name of a  
 king, the suitor of Syelind. He slew the king of the Swebes and had robbed  
 and burned the land. King Harward got Syelind, but Attle got Onlave.

P4 Hjør·varðr ok Sigr·linn áttu son mikinn ok vęnan. Hann var [R 22v/5]  
 2 þǫgull; ekki nafn festi=sk við hann. Hann sat á haugi. Hann sá  
 ríða val·kyrjur níu ok var ein gǫfug=ligust. Hón kvað:

Harward and Syelind got a son, great and beautiful. He was silent; no name  
 stuck to him. He sat on a mound. He saw nine walkirries riding, and one  
 was the most worshipful. Quoth she:

- 6 „Síð munt, **H**elgi, · **h**ringum ráða,  
 2 **rí**kr **ró**g-apaldr, · né **R**oðuls-vøllum,  
 —**o**rn gól **á**r-la— · ef þú **é** þegir,  
 4 þó'tt **h**arðan **h**ug, · **h**ilmir, gjaldir.“

[R 22v/7]

“Late wilt thou, Hallow, rule the rings,  
 O strong strife-apple-tree [WARRIOR], nor the Raddlewolds,  
 —the eagle crowed in early morn—if thou art for ever silent,  
 even if thou hast a hard heart, O prince!”

---

1 Helgi ‘Hallow’ | The walkirrie here gives the silent boy his name, *Hēlgi* ‘the Holy One’.

- [Hēlgi] kvað: 7 „**H**vat léttr fylgja · **H**ēlga nafni,  
 2 **brú**ðr **bj**art-lituð, · alls **bj**óða réðr?  
 Hygg fyr **o**llum · **a**t·kvēðum vel;  
 4 þigg eigi þat · nema þik hafa!“

[R 22v/9]

Quoth [Hallow]: “What lettest thou follow Hallow’s name,  
 O bright-faced bride, as thou dost offer it?  
 Think well before all decisions;  
 I will take nothing other than that to have *thee*!”

- [Val-kyrja] kvað: 8 „**S**verð veyt’k liggja · í **Sig**-ars-holmi,  
 2 **fj**órum **f**éra · an **f**imm tōgu;  
**e**itt es þeira · **o**llum þetra  
 4 **v**ig-nesta þol · ok **v**arit golli.

[R 22v/11]

Quoth [the walkirrie]: “Swords I know lying in Sigarsholm:  
 four less than fifty.  
 One of them is better than all—  
 a bale of war-covers(?) [SHIELDS]—and covered with gold.

- 9 **H**ringr ’s í **h**jalti, · **h**ugr ’s í miðju,  
 2 **ó**gn ’s í **o**ddi, · þeim’s **e**iga getr;  
 liggr með **e**ggju · **o**rmr dreyr-fáaðr  
 4 en á **v**al-böstu · **v**erpr naðr hala.“

[R 22v/13]

A ring is on its hilt; heart is in the middle;  
 terror is in the point for him who gets to own it.  
 Along the edge lies a serpent painted in blood  
 and on the walbast an adder eats its tail.”

---

1 Hringr 's í hjalti 'A ring is on its hilt' | The sword is a so-called *ring-sword*. It was popular among Germanic warriors of the Migration Period to have oath-ring on their sword-hilts as a symbol of fidelity to their lords, but this custom was entirely extinct by ca. 700 (Nerman 1931, pp. 40–44) and the detail thus serves to emphasize the exceptional age of the sword. It also helps us date at least this part of the poem, for it is highly unlikely that an Icelandic antiquarian of the C12th would have been aware of this circumstance, whereas a Norwegian of the C10th conceivably might. Cf. *Sígsk* 68 which probably also refers to a ring-sword. A well preserved Norwegian ring-sword survives from Snartemo in Vest-Agder, dating to around 500 AD (object ID C26001); see Fig. 8.

4 val-böstu 'walbast' | An unclear part of the sword-hilt, this word also occurs in *Sigrdr* 6. TODO.

- P5 Ey·limi hét konungr; dóttir hans var Sváfa. Hón var val-kyrja ok [R 22v/15]  
 2 reið lopt ok lög. Hón gaf Helga nafn þetta ok hlífði hönunum opt  
 síðan í orrustum. Helgi kvað:

Eanlime was the name of a king; his daughter was Sweve. She was a walkirrie and rode over air and sea. She gave Hallow this name and thereafter often shielded him in battles. Quoth Hallow:

- 10 „Est=at, Hjør-varðr, · heil-ráðr konungr, [R 22v/17]  
 2 folks odd-viti, · þó'tt fręgr séir;  
 létst-u ęld eta · jęfra byggðir



Figure 8: Hilt of the Snartemo sword, front and reverse. Migration period, ca. 500 AD. © Eirik Irgens Johnsen. CC BY-SA 4.0. <https://www.unimus.no/portal/#/photos/d8932af5-1082-4938-9b4b-ca6b86f2bdfb>

4            en þeir angr við þik · ekki gørðu.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO 10

11       En Hróð·marr skal · hringum ráða,

[R 22v/19]

2           þeim es óttu · örir niðjar;

sá sé=sk fylkir · fěst at lífi,

4           hygg=sk al-dauðra · arfi at ráða.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO 11

P6       Hjör·varðr svaraði at hann myndi fá lið Helga ef hann vill hefna

[R 22v/21]

2           móður-fjður síns. Þá sótti Helgi sverð'it er Sváfa vísaði hánun

til. Þá fór hón ok Atli ok felldu Hróð·mar ok unnu mǫrg þrek-

4           virki. Hann drap Hata jǫtun er hann sat á bergi nokkuru. Helgi

ok Atli lǫgu skipum í Hata-firði. Atli helt vǫrð inn fyrra hlut

6           nétr'innar. Hrí·m·gerðr Hata dóttir kvað:

Harward answered that he would get Hallow a troop if he wished to avenge his mother's father. Then Hallow sought out the sword to which Sweve had shown him. Then she and Attle journeyed and felled Rothmar and accomplished many great deeds of strength. He slew the ettin Hate when he sat on a certain mountain. Hallow and Attle lay in their ships in Hate's firth. Attle kept watch during the first part of the night. Quoth Rimegird, Hate's daughter:

12       „Hverir 'ro hǫlðar · í Hata-firði?

[R 22v/27]

2           Skjöldum es tjaldat · á skipum yðrum,

frókn=liga látið, · fátt hygg yðr séask;

4           kennið mér nafn konungs!“

“Which are these heroes in Hate's firth?

With shields it is canopied upon your ships,

bravely adorned; I ween ye fear little.

Teach me the name of the king!”

Atli kvað: 13       „Helgi hann heitir · en þú hver=gi mátt

[R 22v/29]

- 2 vinna **grand** **grami**,  
**éarn**-borgir · 'ro umb **ǫðlings** flota  
 4 knegu-t oss **fǫlur** fara.“

Quoth Attle: “Hallow is he called, but thou canst in no wise  
 accomplish injury against the chief.  
 Iron strongholds surround the athling's fleet;  
 no shrews can destroy us.”

- 14 „Hvé þik **heitir**,“ (kvað Hrímr-gerðr) „**halr** inn ám-átt=ki?  
 2 Hvé þik **kalla** **konir**?  
**Fylkir** þér trúir · es þik í **fögurum** léttr  
 4 **bæits** stafni **búa**.“

[R 22v/31]

“What art thou called,” quoth Rimegird, “O uncanny man—  
 what does mankind call thee?  
 The marshallers trusts thee when he lets thee stay  
 in the prow of the tacked ship.”

- Atli kvað: 15 „**Atli** ek **heiti**, · **atall** skal'k þér vera,  
 2 mjök em'k **gífrum** **gramastr**;  
**úrgan** stafn · ek hefí **opt** **búi**t  
 4 ok **kvalðar** **kveld**-riður.

[R 22v/33]

Quoth Attle: “Attle am I called; I shall be terrible toward thee  
 I am by far the cruelest to troll-hags.  
 In a drizzling prow have I often stayed  
 and tormented evening-rideresses.

---

1 atall ‘terrible’ | A pun, the name *Atli* ‘Attle’ is identical to *atli* ‘the terrible one’, weak masculine of the adj. *atall*.

- 16 **Hvé** þú **heitir**, · **hála** ná-gróðug?  
 2 Nefn þinn, **fála**, **fǫður**;  
**níu** rǫstum · es þú skyldir **neðar** vesa,  
 4 ok vaxi þér á **baðmi** **barr**!“

[R 23r/2]

What art thou called, O corpse-greedy witch?  
 Name thy father, shrew!  
 It is nine rests below where thou oughtst to be,  
 and let grass grow on thy bosom!”

- Hrímr-gerðr kvað: 17 „**Hrímr**-gerðr ek **heiti**, · **Hati** hét minn **faðir**,  
 2 þann vissa'k á-máttkastan **jötun**;

[R 23r/4]



margar brúđoir · hann lét frá búi tęknar  
und's hann Hęłgi hęó.“

Quoth Rimegird: “Rimegird I am called—Hate was my father called,  
I knew him to be the uncanniest ettin;  
many brides he had taken from their homes  
before Hallow cut him down.”

Atli kvađ: 18 „Þú vast, hála, · fyr hildings skipum  
2 ok látt í fjarðar-mynni fyrir;  
ręsis rekka · es vildir Ręn gefa  
4 ef þér kómi't í þverst þvari.“

[R 23r/6]

Quoth Attle: “Thou wast, witch, before the hilding's ships  
and didst lie in the firth's mouth ahead!  
The ruler's champions wouldst thou have given to Ran  
if the sword had not stood in thy path!”

Hrím-gerđor kvađ: 19 „Duliđor est nú, Atli, · draums kveđ'k þér vesa,  
2 síga lętr þú brýnn fyr bráar;  
móđir mín · lá fyr mildings skipum,  
4 ek drekkđa Hlęđ-varđs sonum í haf.

[R 23r/8]

Quoth Rimegird: “Deluded art thou now, Attle; I say thou art dreamy;  
thou lettest thy lashes sink before thy brow!  
My mother lay before the generous man's ships;  
I drowned Ludward's sons in the sea!

1 Duliđor est nú, Atli, · draums kveđ'k þér vesa | Found near-identically (but with different addressee) in *Hdl* 7/1.

20 Gnęggja myndir þú, Atli, · ef gęldr né véir:  
2 bręttir sinn Hrím-gerđor hala!  
Aptar=la hjarta · hygg at þitt, Atli, sé  
4 þó'tt þú hafir \*ręina rędd.“

[R 23r/11]

Thou wouldst neigh, Attle, if thou wert not a gelding;  
Rimegird lifts her tail!  
A cowering heart I think be thine, Attle,  
although thou hast a stallion's voice.”

4 \*ręina | hręina R.

ALL | The sexual tension in the exchange in sts. 20–21 is strong, all the more so since human sexual relations are frequently likened to those of horses in Norse literature (so e.g. Anon (*ÓTHkr*) 1 in SkP 1, *Bósa saga* 11).

Atli kvað: **21** „*Ręini* mun þér ek þikkja · ef þú *řeyna* knátt  
 2 ok stíga'k á *land* af *lęgi*;  
*q*ll munt *lęmja*=sk · ef mér 's *al*-hugat  
 4 ok sveigja þínn *hala*, *Hrím*·gerðr!“

[R 23r/13]

Quoth Attle: “A stallion will I seem to thee if thou wouldst try me  
 and I should step aland off the lake;  
 thou wilt be all beaten lame if I am full of heart,  
 and wag thy tail, Rimegird!”

---

1 *Ręini* | ‘remi’ R.

Hrím·gerðr kvað: **22** „*Atli*, gakk á *land* · ef *a*flí *tręysti*=sk  
 2 ok hittumk í *vík* *Varins*,  
*ři*řa *řét*ti · es þú munt, *re*kk, fá  
 4 ef þú mér í *krymmur* *k*ömr.“

[R 23r/15]

Quoth Rimegird: “Attle, go aland if thou trustest in thy strength,  
 and let us meet in Warren’s bay.  
 TODO.  
 TODO 22”

Atli kvað: **23** „*Mun*'k=a ek *g*anga · áðr *g*umnar vakna  
 2 ok halda of *ví*sa *v*qrð;  
 es=a mér *ør*·vęnt · nęr *ò*ru *k*ömr  
 4 *sk*ass upp undir *sk*ipi.“

[R 23r/17]

Quoth Attle: “I will not go before the men awaken,  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO 23”

Hrím·gerðr kvað: **24** „*Vaki* þú, *Hę*lgi, · ok bót við *Hrím*·gerðr  
 2 es þú létst *h*oggvinn *H*ata;  
*ę*ina nót · kná hön hjá *j*ofri sofa,  
 4 þá hęfir hön *b*ólva *b*ótr.“

[R 23r/19]

Quoth Rimegird: “Wake thou, Hallow, and restitute Rimegird  
 since thou didst let Hate be cut down.  
 A single night may she sleep by the ruler;  
 then she has restitution for her bales.”

Hęlgi kvað: **25** „*Loðinn* hętir es þik skal *ę*iga, · —*l*ęið est mann·kyni—,  
 2 sá býr í *p*oll-ęju *p*urs,

[R 23r/21]

4                    **h**und-víss jötunn, · **h**raun-búa verstr,  
                         sá 's þér **m**akligr **m**aðr.“

Quoth Hallow: “Loden is the name of him who shall own thee—thou art loathsome to mankind—

                         he lives in Thalley, a thurse,  
a hundred-wise ettin, the worst of desert-dwellers;  
                         *he* is for thee a fitting man!”

Hrím-gerðr kvað:    **26**    „**H**ina vilt **h**ęldr, **H**ęłgi, · es réð **h**afnir skoða  
2                                **f**yrri nótt með **f**irum;  
                         **m**ar-gollin **m**ér · **m**ér þótti afli bera;  
4                                **h**ér sté hęn land af **l**ęgi  
                         ok **f**ęsti svá yðarn **f**lota;  
6                                hęn **ę**in því veldr · es ek **ę**igi má'k  
                         **b**uðlungs męnnum **b**ana.“

[R 23r/23]

Quoth Rimegird:    TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO 26

Hęłgi kvað:        **27**    „**H**ęyr þú nú, **H**rím-gerðr, · ef ek bóti **h**arma þér,  
2                                sęg þú **g**orr **g**rami:  
                         Vas sú **ę**in vętttr · es barg **ę**ðlings skipum  
4                                eða **f**oru þęr **f**lęiri saman?“

[R 23r/26]

Quoth Hallow:    TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO.  
                         TODO 27

Hrím-gerðr kvað:    **28**    „**Þ**rennar níundir męyja, · **þ**ó reišð **ę**in fyrir,  
2                                **h**vít und **h**jalmi męr;  
                         **m**arir hristu=sk, · stóð af męnum þęira  
4                                **d**ęgg í **d**júpa **d**ali,  
                         **h**agl í **h**óva viðu,  
6                                þaðan kęmr með **ę**ldum **ár**;  
                         allt vas męr þat **l**ęitt es **l**ęit'k.“

[R 23r/28]

Quoth Rimegird: TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO 28

Helgi kvað: 29 „Austr lit-tu nú, Hrímgæðr, · ef þik lostna hefr

[R 23r/32]

2 Helgi he-stofum;

á landi ok á vatni · borgit 's ǫðlings flota

4 ok siklings monnum it sama!“

Quoth Hallow: “Look eastwards now, Rimegird, if Hallow has stricken  
thee with hell-staves!

On land and on water is the athling's fleet saved  
and the ruler's men likewise!”

ALL | For the motif of an ettin or dwarf turning into stone at daybreak, cf. Introduction to *Alv*.

Atli kvað: 30 „Dagr 's nú, Hrímgæðr, · en þik dvalða hefir

[R 23v/1]

2 Atli til aldr-laga;

hafnar mark · þykkir hlóg=ligt vesa,

4 þar's þú ǿ stęins líki stęndr!“

Quoth Attle: “'Tis day now, Rimegird, but thou hast been delayed  
by Attle to thy loss of life!

A laughable harbour-mark seemest thou to be  
where thou standest in the like of a stone!”

P7 Helgi konungr var all-mikill her-maðr. Hann kom til Ey-lima

[R 23v/3]

2 konungs ok bað Svǫfu, dóttur hans. Þau Helgi ok Sváfa veittu=sk  
várar ok unnu=sk furðu mikit.

4 Sváfa var heima með feðr sínum en Helgi í hernaði; var Sváfa  
val-kyrja enn sem fyrr.

6 Heðinn var heima með fǫður sínum, Hjør-varði konungi, í Noregi.

8 Heðinn fór einn saman heim ór skógi jóla-aptan ok fann troll-  
konu; sú reið vargi ok hafði orma at taumum ok bauð fylgð sína  
Heðni. „Nei,“ sagði hann. Hón sagði: „Þess skaltu gjalda at  
10 bragar-fulli!“

12 Um kveld'it óru heit-strengingar; var framm leiddr sonar-goltr;  
lögðu menn þar á hendr sínar ok strengdu menn þá heit at bragar-  
fulli. Heðinn strengði heit til Svǫfu Ey-lima dóttur, unnustu

- 14 Helga, bróður síns, ok iðraði=sk svá mjök at hann gekk á braut villi-stigu suðr á lond ok fann Helga bróður sinn. Helgi kvað:

King Hallow was a fully great raider. He came to king Eanlime and asked for the hand of Sweve, his daughter. Hallow and Sweve exchanged vows and loved each other very much. Sweve was at home with her father but Hallow was raiding; Sweve was still a walkirrie as before. Headen was at home with his father, King Harward, in Norway. Headen journeyed alone home out of the woods on Yule evening and found a troll-woman; she rode a wolf and had snakes for reins and asked Headen to follow her. “No”, said he. She said: “This wilt thou pay for at the bray-cup!” In the evening there were the stringing of vows; the boar of atonement was led forth; thereon men laid their hands and then men strung their vows at the bray-cup. Headen strung a vow to possess Sweve, Eanlime’s daughter, the lover of Hallow, his brother; and he regretted it so much that he went away on trailing roads south through the lands, and found Hallow, his brother. Quoth Hallow:

- 31 „Kom heill, Hęðinn, · hvat kannt segja [R 23v/15]  
2 nýra spjalla · ór Noręgi?  
Hví ’s þér, stillir, · stökkt ór landi  
4 ok est ęinn kominn · oss at finna?“

“Come hale, Headen! What canst thou say  
of new tidings from Norway?  
Why art thou, controller, hurried from the land,  
and come alone to find us?”

- [Hęðinn kvað:] 32 „Mik hęfir myklu glópr · męiri sóttan: [R 23v/16]  
2 Ek hęfi korna · ina konung-bornu  
brúði þína · at bragar-fulli.“

[Quoth Headen:] “A false word has greatly afflicted me:  
I have chosen the kingly born  
bride of thine at the bray-cup.”

- 33 „Saka=sk ęigi þú! · Sönn munu verða [R 23v/18]  
2 ęl-mól, Hęðinn, · okkur beggja;  
mér hęfir stillir · stökkt til ęyrar,  
4 þriggja náttu, · skyla’k þar koma;  
if’s mér à því · at aptr koma;  
6 þa má at góðu · gora=sk s-líkt ef skal.“

“Blame not thyself! True will they be,  
the ale-speeches, Headen, for both of us.

Me has the controller TODO.  
 for three nights; I must come thither.  
 I have doubt whether I should come back;  
 TODO 33"

- 34 „Sagðir þú, Hēlgi, · at Hēðinn væri [R 23v/21]  
 2 góðs verðr frá þér · ok gjafa stórra;  
 þér es sómra · sverð at rjóða  
 4 an frið gefa · fjöndum þínum.“

“Thou hast said, O Hallow, that Headen is  
 worthy of good things from thee and of great gifts.  
 It is more fitting for thee to redder the sword  
 than to give peace to thy enemies.”

- P8 Þat kvað Helgi því at hann grunaði um feigð sína ok þat at fylgjur [R 23v/23]  
 2 hans hǫfðu vitjat Heðins þá er hann sá konu'na ríða vargi'num.  
 Álfir hét konungr, sonr Hróð·mars, er Helga hafði vǫll haslaðan  
 4 á Sigars-velli á þriggja náttu fresti. Þá kvað Helgi:

Hallow said that for he suspected his own feyness, and for his followeresses  
 had visited Headen when he saw the woman riding the wolf. Atholf was the  
 name of a king, Rothmar's son, against whom Hallow had hazeled the plain  
 at Sigarswold with a three nights' summons. Then quoth Hallow:

- 35 „Rēið á vargi · es rǫkvit vas, [R 23v/26]  
 2 fljóð eitt es hann · fylgju þeiddi;  
 hǫn vissi þat · at veginn myndi  
 4 Sigr·linnar sonr · á Sig·ars-vǫllum.“

“She rode on the wolf when twilight had come  
 TODO.  
 she knew that slain would be  
 Syelind's son [= I, Hallow] upon the Sigarswolds.”

- P9 Þar var orrusta mikil ok fekk þar Helgi bana-sár. [R 23v/28]

At that place there was a great battle and there Hallow got his bane-wound.

- 36 Sęndi Hēlgi · Sig·ar at ríða [R 23v/29]  
 2 ęptir Eý·lima · ęinga dóttur;  
 biðr brál=liga · búna verða

4 ef hön vill finna · fylki kvikvan.

Hallow sent Sigar to ride  
for Eanlime's only daughter.  
He asks her hurriedly to make herself ready,  
if she wishes to meet the marshaller alive.

[Sig-arr kvað:] 37 „Mik hēfir Hēlgi · hingat sēndan  
2 við þik, Sváfa, · sjalfa at mēla,  
þik kvað=sk hilmir · hitta vilja  
4 áðr ítr-borinn · gñdu týndi.“

[R 23v/31]

[Quoth Sigar:] “Me has Hallow sent hither,  
with thy very self, O Sweve, to speak.  
*Thee* the helmet-bearer said he wished to see  
before the noble-born one must give up his life.”

[Sváfa kvað:] 38 „Hvat varð Hēlga · Hjör-varðs syni?  
2 Mér 's harð=liga · harma leitat;  
ef hann sē of lék · eða sverð of bēit,  
4 þeim skal ek gumna · grand of vinna!“

[R 23v/33]

[Quoth Sweve:] “What happened to Hallow, Harward's son?  
A cruel injury has found its way to me.  
If the sea betrayed him or a sword bit him,  
against that man I shall avenge the harm!”

1 Hvat varð | 'H varð' R

[Sig-arr kvað:] 39 „Fell hér í morgun · at Freka-stēini  
2 buðlungr sá's vas · batstr und sólu;  
Ólfr mun sigri · qllum ráða  
4 þó'tt þetta sinn · þorð=gi véri.“

[R 24r/2]

[Quoth Sigar:] “Here this morning by Freckstone fell  
the chieftain who was the best under the sun.  
Atholf will have all the victory,  
although this time it was not a boon.”

[Hēlgi kvað:] 40 „Hēil ves, Sváfa! · Hug skalt dēila,  
2 sjá mun í hēimi · hindstr fundr vera;  
tjá buðlungi · blóða undir;  
4 mér hēfir hjorr komit · hjarta it nēsta.

[R 24r/4]

[Quoth Hallow:] “Be hale, Sweve! Thou shalt share in my heart;  
in the Home this will be our very last meeting.  
On the chieftain the wounds do bleed;  
the sword has come nearest to my heart.

41      **Bið’k þik, Sváfa, · brúðr, grátt=at-tu,** [R 24r/6]  
2      ef þú vill **mínu · máli hlýða**  
         at þú **Hęðni · hvílu gęrvir**  
4      ok **jǫfur ungan · ęstum lęiðir.**“

I bid thee, Sweve—O bride, do not weep  
if thou wilt harken to my speech—  
that thou for Headen makest a bed  
and showest the young warrior thy affections.”

---

ALL | Hallow asks Sweve to marry his brother, Headen, after he himself is dead.

[Sváfa kvað:] 42      „**Mélt hafða’k þat · í munar-ęęimi** [R 24r/8]  
2      þa’s mér **Hęlgi · hringa valði;**  
         myndi’ę=a ek **lostig · at liðinn fylki**  
4      **jǫfur ę-kunnan · armi vęrja.**“

[Quoth Sweve:] “I had declared in the home of joy [THE LIVING WORLD]  
when Hallow chose the rings for me,  
that I would not willingly after the marshaller’s passing,  
embrace an unknown warrior’s arm.”

43      „**Kyss mik, Sváfa, · kęm’k ęęi áptr** [R 24r/10]  
2      **Ręg-ęęims á vit · né Ręðuls-ęjalla**  
         áðr **hęft hęfi’k · Hjęr-varðs sonar,**  
4      þęss es **buðlungr vas · bętstr und sólu!**“

“Kiss me, Sweve! I will not come back  
to visit Rugham nor the Raddlefells,  
before I have avenged Harward’s son,  
who was the best chieftain under the sun.”

---

ALL | The speaker is unclear. Is it Hallow declaring that he will not come back (i.e., be reborn) until he has been avenged, or is it instead Headen, who says that he will not return until he has avenged Hallow, his brother?

**P10      Helgi ok Sváfa er sagt at vęri endr-borin.** [R 24r/12]

Hallow and Sweve, it is said, were reborn.



# Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane (II *Hēlga kviða Hundings-bana*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.587)  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane** (abbrev. *2 HHund*) is another epic poem based on the life of Hallow Syemund's son. It is the last of the three *Helga-kviður* 'Hallow-poems' in R.

## Textual preservation and transmission

*2 HHund* is only attested in R, on foll. 24r/13–26v/19, where it follows *HHj* and is followed by *Grip*.

## Meter and stanza

Unlike *1 HHund*, but like *HHj*, *2 HHund* is a prosimetrum with stanzas in both Ancient-words-law and Leeds-meter.

## Origin and motifs

The latter part of the poem contains a touching description of Syerun's visit to Hallow's grave mound, where the two lovers embrace for one last time. The same folkloric motif is found in many traditional British ballads (e.g. Roud 50 "Sweet William's Ghost", Roud 179 "The Lover's Ghost" or "The Grey Cock", Roud 22568 "The Night Visiting Song"), where two lovers separated by death reunite one last time in the grave before being forced to part at cock-crow, although in some variants of 179 and 22568 the supernatural element is not explicit. As an example, the following text is the version of Roud 22568 recorded by *The Dubliners* in 1972:

*I must away now; I can no longer tarry  
This morning's tempest I have to cross  
I must be guided without a stumble  
Into the arms I love the most.*

*And when he came to his true love's dwelling  
He knelt down gently upon a stone  
And through her window he's whispered lowly:  
"Is my true lover within at home?"*

*"Wake up, wake up, love, it is thine own true lover  
Wake up, wake up, love, and let me in  
For I am tired, love, and oh so weary  
And more than near drenched to the skin."*

*She's raised her off her down soft pillow  
She's raised her up and she's let him in  
And they were locked in each other's arms  
Until that long night was past and gone.*

*And when that long night was past and over  
And when the small clouds began to grow  
He's taken her hand and they've kissed and parted  
Then he saddled and mounted and away did go.*

*I must away now etc.*

In the depiction of this motif in the present poem one might see a conflict between two varying conceptions of the afterlife, viz. the popular idea of the dead man as dwelling *within* his burial mound or grave, and the elite idea of the dead warrior departing to Walhall. The story of the "lover's ghost" is only properly compatible with the former idea, but as a legendary warrior Hallow is thought to go to Walhall immediately after death, and so to resolve the two the poet has Hallow ride down from Walhall to the mound where he reunites with Syerun.

## Text

## Frá Volsungum ('From the Walsings')

- P1 Sig-mundr konungr Volsungs sonr átti Borg-hildi af Brá-lundi. [R 24r/13]  
 2 Þau hétu son sinn Helga ok eptir Helga Hjør-varðs syni. Helga  
 fóst-raði Hagall. Hundingr hét ríkr konungr; við hann er Hund-  
 4 land kennt. Hann var her-maðr mikill ok átti marga sonu þá er  
 í hernaði vóru. Ó-friðr ok dylgjur vóru á milli þeira Hundings  
 6 konungs ok Sig-mundar konungs; drópu hvárir annarra frændr.  
 Sig-mundr konungr ok hans étt-menn hétu Volsungar ok Ylfin-  
 8 gar. Helgi fór ok njósnaði til hirðar Hundings konungs á laun.  
 Hemingr, sonr Hundings konungs, var heima. En er Helgi fór  
 10 í brott þá hitti hann hjarðar-svein ok kvað:

King Syemund, Walsing's son, had to wife Burhild of Browlund. They called their son Hallow after Hallow Harward's son. Hallow was fostered by Hail. Hunding was the name of a mighty king; from him comes the name Hundland. He was a great harrier and had many sons who were in the harrying host. Enmity and evil strikes at that time stood between the [sons] of King Hunding and King Syemund; men on either side slew the kinsmen of the other. King Syemund and the men of his lineage were called Walsings and Wolvings. Hallow journeyed and spied at the hird of King Hunding in secret. Heming, King Hunding's son, was at home. But when Hallow journeyed away then he struck upon a herding-swain, and quoth:

- 1 „Sęg Hęmingi · at Hęlgi man [R 24r/21]  
 2 hvern í brynju · bagnar fęlldu,  
 ęr ulf gráan · inni hęřđuð  
 4 þar's Hamal hugði · Hundingr konungr.“

“Tell Heming that Hallow remembers  
 which man in a byrnie the warriors felled.  
 Ye have a grey wolf within [your halls]  
 where King Hunding thought Hamble was.”

- P2 Hamall hét sonr Hagals. Hundingr konungr sendi menn til Ha- [R 24r/23]  
 2 gals at leita Helga, en Helgi mátti eigi forða=sk annan veg en tók  
 klęði ambáttar ok gekk at mala. Þeir leituðu ok fundu eigi Helga.  
 4 Þá kvað Blindr inn bøl-vísi:

Hamble was the name of Hail's son. King Hunding sent men to Hail to look for Hallow, but Hallow could not save his life in any other way than that he

took the clothes of a bondwoman and went to grind. They looked and did not find Hallow. Then quoth Blind the bale-wise:

- 2 „Hvøss eru augu · í Hagals þýju, [R 24r/27]  
 2 es=a þat karls étt · es à kvænum stęndr,  
 stęinar rifna, · stękkur lúðr fyrir.

“Sharp are the eyes on Hail’s slave-woman;  
 it is not the lineage of a churl that stands by the querns;  
 the stones crack apart, the flour-box breaks before her!

1 Hvøss eru augu ‘Sharp are the eyes’ | For sharp eyes as a sign of class see *Vkv* 17/3, *Rþ* 19/3, 33/4, 1 *HHund* 6/3–4.

2 kvænum ‘the querns’ | The quern alluded to is a Wiking Age hand quern consisting of two stones, one fast at the base (the mill-stone) and one above it which is spun by means of a handle. Cf. *Vafþ* 23.

- 3 Nú hefir hęrð dęmi · hildingr þęgit [R 24r/29]  
 2 es vísi skal · val-bygg mala;  
 hęldr es sęmri · hęndi þęiri  
 4 meðal-kafli · an męndul-tré.“

Now hath the prince received hard judgments,  
 when the chieftain shall grind Welsh barley.  
 It is more fitting for that hand [to hold]  
 the sword-pommel than the handle-stick.

- P3 Hagall svaraði ok kvað: [R 24r/31]

Hail answered and quoth:

- 4 „Þat ’s litil vę · þó’tt lúðr þrumi [R 24r/31]  
 2 es męr konungs · męndul hręrir;  
 hęn skęvaði · skýjum øfri  
 4 ok vega þorði · sęm víkingar  
 áðr hana Helgi · hęptu gęrði;  
 6 systir ’s hęn þęira · Sig-ars ok Hęgna,  
 því hefir ętul augu · Ylfinga man.“

“It is little woe yet that the flour-box thunders  
 when the king’s daughter moves the handle.  
 She strode forth higher than the clouds  
 and dared to fight like Wikings  
 before Hallow made her a prisoner.

She is the sister of Sigar and Hawn;  
therefore the slave-girl of the Wolvings has terrible eyes.”

- P4 Undan kom=sk Helgi ok fór á her-skip. Hann felldi Hunding [R 24v/1]  
2 konung ok var síðan kallaðr Helgi Hundings bani. Hann lá með  
her sinn í Bruna-vágum ok hafði þar strand-hogg ok ótu þar  
4 hrátt. Hogni hét konungr; hans dóttir var Sig-rún. Hón var val-  
kyrja ok reið lopt ok lög; hón var Sváva endr-borin. Sig-rún reið  
6 at skipum Helga ok kvað:

Hallow got away and went onto a harrying-ship. He felled King Hunding and was thereafter called Hallow Hunding's bane. He lay with his host in the Brunwaves and there raided the shores and there ate raw flesh. Hawn was the name of a king; his daughter was Syerun. She was a walkirrie and rode over air and water; she was Sweve reborn. Syerun rode alongside Hallow's ships and quoth:

- 5 „Hverir láta fljóta · fley við bakka? [R 24v/6]  
2 Hvar, hęr-męgir, · hęima ęiguð?  
Hvers bíðið ér · í Bruna-vógum?  
4 Hvęrt lystir yðr · lęið at kanna?“

“TODO.

Where, lads of the host, do ye have your homes?

Whom do ye await in the Brunwaves?

TODO.”

- 6 „Hamall lętr fljóta · fley við bakka; [R 24v/8]  
2 ęigum hęima · í Hlės-ęyju;  
bíðum byrjar · í Bruna-vógum;  
4 austr lystir oss · lęið at kanna!“

“TODO.

we have our homes in Leeseý.

We await a good gust in the Brunwaves;

TODO.”

- 7 „Hvar hęfir, hilmir, · hildi vakða [R 24v/10]  
2 eða gęgl alin · Gunnar systra?  
Hví 's brynja þín · blóði stokkin?  
4 Hví skal und hjęlmum · hrátt kjöt eta?“

“TODO.

or nourished the swans of Guth's sisters [WALKIRRIES > EAGLES]?  
 Why is thy byrnie dripping with blood?  
 Why shall men under helmets eat raw meat?"

- 8 „Þat vann nēst nýs · niðr Ylfinga [R 24v/12]  
 2 fyr vestan ver, · ef þik vita lystir,  
 es ek bjǫrnu tók · í Braga-lundi  
 4 ok étt ara · oddum sadda'k.

“TODO.  
 TODO if thou hast lust to know.  
 TODO.  
 and the lineage of the eagle I fed by spear-point.

---

2 ef þik vita lystir ‘if thou hast lust to know’ | Formulaic b-verse, also occurring in *Helr* 2/3b, 5/2b, 6/3b.

- 9 Nú 's sagt, mér, · hvaðan sakar gørðu=sk, [R 24v/14]  
 2 því vas á lægi mér · litt stęikt etit.“

Now it is said, maiden, TODO;  
 therefore on the sea little cooked food was eaten.”

- 10 „Víg lýsir þú; · varð fyr Hęlga [R 24v/15]  
 2 Hundingr konungr · hnīga at vęlli;  
 bar sókn saman · es sefa hęfnduð  
 4 ok busti blóð · á brimis eggjar.“

“TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

- 11 „Hvat vissir þú · at þęir séi, [R 24v/17]  
 2 snót svinn-huguð, · es sefa hęfnduð?  
 Margir 'ro hvassir · hildings synir  
 4 ok ámunir · ossum niðjum.“

“TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

- 12 „Vas'k=a ek fjarri, · folks odd-viti, [R 24v/19]  
 2 gēr á morgun · grams aldr-lokum;  
 þó tēl'k slógjan · Sig-mundar bur  
 4 es í val-rúnum · víg-spjöll segir.

“TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

- 13 Leit'k þik umb sinn fyrr · á lang-skipum [R 24v/21]  
 2 þá's þú byggðir · blóðga stafna  
 ok úr-svalar · unnir léku;  
 4 nú vill dylja=sk · döglingr fyr mér  
 en Högna mér · Hēlga kennir.“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

- P5 Gran·marr hét ríkr konungr er bjó at Svarins-haugi. Hann átti [R 24v/23]  
 2 marga sonu: Høð·broddr, annarr Guð·mundr, þriði Starkaðr.  
 Høð·broddr var í konunga-stefnu. Hann fastnaði sér Sig·rúnu  
 4 Högna dóttur en er hón spýrr þat þá reið hón með valkyrjur um  
 lopt ok um lög at leita Helga.  
 6 Helgi var þá at Loga-fjöllum ok hafði barit=sk við Hundings  
 sonu. Þar felldi hann þá Álf ok Eyj·ólf, Hjør·varð ok Her·varð ok  
 8 var hann all-víg-móðr ok sat undir Ara-steini. Þar hitti Sig·rún  
 hann ok rann á hals hönnum ok kyssti hann ok sagði hönnum  
 10 erendi sitt, svá sem segir í Völsunga kviðu inni fornu:

TODO.

- 14 Sótti Sig·rún · sikling glaðan, [R 24v/32]  
 2 hēim nam hön Hēlga · hōnd at sókja,  
 kyssti ok kvaddi · konung und hjalmi,  
 4 þa varð hilmi · hugr á vífi;  
 fyrr lét=sk hön unna · af qllum hug  
 6 syni Sig-mundar · an hön sét hafði.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

15 „Vas’k Hǫð·broddi · ĩ hęř fǫstnuð [R 25r/2]

2 ęn jǫfur annan · ęiga vilda’k;  
 þó sé=umk, fylkir, · fręnda reĩði;  
 4 hęfi’k mǫns fǫður · mun-ráð brotit.“

“I was promised to Hathbrod in the army,  
 but I wished to have another chieftain.  
 Yet I fear, O marshaller, the wrath of my kinsmen;  
 I have broken my father’s dearest wish.”

---

4 mun-ráð ‘dearest wish’ | A hapax. TODO.

16 Nam=a Hǫgna męř · umb hug męla; [R 25r/4]

2 hafa kvað=sk hǫn Hęlga · hylly skyldu.

TODO;  
 she said that she would have Hallow’s favour.

17 „Hirð ęigi þú · Hǫgna reĩði [R 25r/6]

2 né illan hug · ęttar þinnar;  
 þú skalt, męř ung, · at męř lifa;  
 4 ętt átt, in góða, · es ek séumk.“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

P6 Helgi samnaði þá miklum skipa-her ok fór til Freka-steins ok [R 25r/8]

2 fengu í hafi of-viðri mann-hętt. Þá kvǫmu leiptr yfir þá ok stóðu  
 geislar í skipin. Þeir sá í lopti’nu at val-kyrjur níu riðu ok kenndu  
 4 þeir Sig-rúnu. Þá lęgði storm’inn ok kvǫmu þeir heilir til lands.  
 Gran·mars synir sǫtu á bjargi nokkuru er skipin sigldu at landi.  
 6 Guð·mundr hljóp á hest ok reið á njósn á berg’it við hǫfn’ina; þá  
 hlóðu Vǫlsungar seglum; þá kvað Guð·mundr, svá sem fyrr er  
 8 ritat í Hęlga-kviðu:



TODO.

---

7–8 svá sem fyrr er ritat í Hēlga-kviðu ‘TODO’ | Viz. in 1 HHund 32.

- 18 „Hverr es fylkir · sá’s flota stýrir [R 25r/15]  
 2 ok fēikna-lið · fōrir at landi?“

TODO.

TODO.

- P7 Sin·fjotli Sig·mundar sonr svaraði ok *er* þat enn ritat. Guð·mundr [R 25r/16]  
 2 reið heim með her-sögu. Þá sǫmnuðu Gran·mars synir her;  
 kómu þar margir konungar. Þar var Hǫgni, faðir Sig·rúnar, ok  
 4 synir hans, Bragi ok Dagr. Þar var orrusta mikil ok fellu al-  
 lir Gran·mars synir ok allir þeira hǫfðingjar nema Dagr Hǫgna  
 6 sonr fekk grið ok vann eiða Vǫlsungum. Sig·rún gekk í val’inn  
 ok hitti Hǫð·brodd at kominn dauða. Hón kvað:

TODO.

- 19 Mun=a þér, Sig·rún, · frá Sefa-fjǫllum, [R 25r/22]  
 2 Hǫð·broddr konungr, · hníga at armi;  
 liðin es évi, · opt nár hrévi  
 4 grán-stóð gríðar, · Gran·mars sona.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- P8 Þá hitti hón Helga ok varð all-fegin. Hann kvað: [R 25r/24]  
 Then she found Hallow, and became all-rejoicing. Quoth he:

- 20 Es=at þér at ǫllu, · al-vitr, gefit, [R 25r/25]  
 2 þó kveð’k nǫkkvi · nornir valda;  
 fellu í morgun · at Freka-stęini  
 4 Bragi ok Hǫgni · —varð’k bani þęira—

TODO.

TODO.

this morning by the Freckstone fell  
 Bray and Hawn—I became their bane—

- 21      en at Styr·kleifum · Starkaðr konungr [R 25r/27]  
 2      en at Hlé·björgum · Hrol·laugs synir;  
       þann sá'k gylfa · grimm-úðgastan  
 4      es barði=sk bolr, · vas à brot hofuð.

but at TODO King Starked,  
 but at the Leebarrow, TODO's sons.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 22      Liggja at jörðu · allra flestir [R 25r/29]  
 2      niðjar þínir · at nóm orðnir;  
       vannt=at-tu vígi, · vas þér þat skapat  
 4      at þú at rógi · rík-menni vart.

Upon the earth lie nearly all  
 of thy kinsmen, turned to corpses.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

1 jörðu | *sens. emend.*; Jórdán ('iordán') 'Jordan' R

- P9      Þá grét Sig·rún. Hann kvað: [R 25r/31]  
       Then Syerun wept. Quoth he:

- 23      „Hugga=sk-tu, Sig·rún! · Hildir hęfir þú oss verit; [R 25r/31]  
 2      vinna=t skjöldungar sköpum.“  
       „Lifna mynda'k nú kjósa · es liðnir eru  
 4      ok knétta'k þér þó í faðmi fela=sk.“

“Console thyself, Syerun! Thou hast been for us a Hild;  
 the princes cannot withstand the Shapes.”  
 “TODO.  
 TODO.”

- P10      Þetta kvað Guð·mundr, Gran·mars sonr: [R 25v/1]  
       This quoth Godmund, Granmer's son:

- 24      „Hverr es skjöldungr · sá's skipum stýrir, [R 25v/1]  
 2      lętr gunn-fana · gollinn fyr stafni?  
       Þikkja mér friðr · í farar broddi;  
 4      verpr víg-roða · umb víkinga.“

“TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

Sin·fjötli kvað: **25** „Hér má Hǫð·broddr · Hęłga ķenna  
 2 flóttu trauðan · í flota miðjum;  
 hann hęfir ǫðli · ęttar þinnar,  
 4 arf fjorsunga, · und sik þrungit.

[R 25v/3]

Quoth Sinfittle: “TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.”

**26** Því fyrr skulu · at Freka-steini  
 2 sáttir saman · umb sakar dǫma;  
 mál es, Hǫð·broddr, · hęfnd at vinna  
 4 ef vér légra hlut · lengi bǫrum.

[R 25v/5]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

**27** Fyrr munt, Guð·mundr, · gęitr of halda  
 2 ok berg-skorar · brattar klífa,  
 hafa þér í hęndi · hęsli-kylfu;  
 4 þat ’s þér blíðara · an brimis dǫmar.“

[R 25v/7]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

**28** „Þér es, Sin·fjötli, · sǫmra myklu  
 2 gunni at heyja · ok glaða ǫrnu  
 an ǫ·nýtum · orðum at dęila  
 4 þó’tt hildingar · hęptir dęili.

[R 25v/9]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

TODO.

- 29 Þikki=t mér góðir · Gran·mars synir,  
 2 þó dugir siklingum · satt at mēla,  
 þeir merkt hafa · á Móins-heimum  
 4 at hug hafa · hǫrum at bręðā;  
 eru hildingar · hǫldsti snjallir.“

[R 25v/11]

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- P11 Helgi fekk Sig·rúnar ok ǫttu þau sonu; var Helgi eigi gamall.  
 2 Dagr Hǫgna sonr blótaði Óðin til fǫður-hefnda. Óðinn léði  
 Dag geirs síns. Dagr fann Helga, mág sinn, þar sem heitir at  
 4 Fjǫturlundi. Hann lagði í gognum Helga með geir'num. Þar  
 fell Helgi, en Dagr reið til fjalla ok sagði Sig·rúnu tíðindi:

[R 25v/13]

Hallow got Syerun to wife and they had sons; Hallow was not old. Day,  
 Hawn's son, made a blood to Weden for the sake of avenging his father. We-  
 den lent Day his spear. Day found Hallow, his brother-in-law, at the place  
 called Fetterlund; he ran Hallow through with the spear. There fell Hallow,  
 but Day rode to the fells and told Syerun the news:

- 30 „Trauðr em'k, systir, · trega þér at sęja  
 2 því't ek hefi nauðigr · nipti gróttā:  
 Fell í morgun · und Fjǫturlundi  
 4 buðlungr sá's vas · bętstr í heimi  
 ok hildingum · á halsi stóð.“

[R 25v/17]

“Regretful am I, sister, to grieve thee by saying it—  
 for, forced, must I make my kinswoman weep:  
 this morning fell in Fetterlund  
 that noble who was the best in the world  
 and on the throats of princes stood.”

- [Sig·rún kvað:] 31 „Þik skyli allir · ęiðar bíta,  
 2 þeir es Hęlga · hafðir unna,  
 at inu ljósa · Lęiptrar vatni  
 4 ok at úr-svǫlum · Unnar steini!

[R 25v/20]

“*Thee* should all oaths bite,  
which thou to Hallow hast sworn,  
by the shining water of Lafter,  
and by the spray-cold stone of Ithe.

- 32      **S**kríði=at þat **s**kip, · es und þér **s**kríði, [R 25v/22]  
2      þó'tt óska-byrr · eptir leggi=sk!  
         **R**enni=a sá marr, · es und þér **r**enni,  
4      þó'tt **f**leðnr þína · **f**orða=sk eigr!

May the ship not glide which glides beneath thee,  
although it has a wished-for gust behind it!  
May the horse not run which runs beneath thee,  
although from thy foes thou must escape!

- 33      **B**íti=a þér þat sverð, · es þú bręðir, [R 25v/24]  
2      nema **s**jölfum þér · **s**yingvi of hofði!  
         Þá véri þér hęft · **H**ęlga dauða,  
4      ef þú **v**ęrir **v**argr · á viðum úti,  
         **a**uðs and-vani · ok **a**lls gamans,  
6      **h**ęðir eigi mat, · nema á **h**ręum spryngir!“

May the sword not bite for thee which thou brandishest,  
unless it sing around thy very own head!  
*Then* were on thee Hallow's death avenged,  
if thou wert a wolf in the woods outside,  
bereft of wealth and all pleasure;  
hadst no food, save thou plundered carrion!“

- Dagr kvað: 34      „**Ó**r est, systir, · ok **ø**r·vita, [R 25v/28]  
2      es **br**óðr þínum · **bi**ðr for·skapa!  
         **E**inn vęldr **Ó**ðinn · **ø**llu bølvi,  
4      því't með **s**ifjungum · **s**ak-rúnar bar!

Quoth Day: “Mad art thou, sister, and out of thy wits,  
when onto thy brother thou dost bid a cruel shape!  
Alone is Weden at fault for all evil  
for he carried strife-runes amidst kin!

1 Ór ... ok ør-viti 'Mad ... and out of thy wits' | Formulaic, also occurring in *Lok* 21/1 and *Oddr* 15/1.

3 Einn vęldr Óðinn · øllu bølvi 'Alone is Weden at fault for all evil' | Formulaic, also occurring (with other names than *Óðinn* 'Weden') at *I Guðr* 25/2 and *Sigs* 27/4.

- 35 Þér býðr bróðir · bauga rauða,  
 2 qll Vandils-vé · ok Víg-dali;  
 haf halfan heim · harms at gjöldum  
 4 brúðr baug-varið · ok burir þínir.

[R 25v/30]

Thy brother offers thee red bighs,  
 all Wendelswigh and the Wighdales.  
 Have half the realm as restitution for the harm—  
 O bigh-adorned bride, and thy sons also.

- 36 „Sit'k=a svá sél · at Sefa-fjollum,  
 2 ár né of nētr, · at ek una lífi,  
 nema at liði lofðungs · ljóma bręgði,  
 4 renni und vísa · Víg-blęr þinig,  
 goll-bitli vanr, · knega'k grami fagna!

[R 25v/32]

“I will not sit so happy in the Sevefells,  
 by morning nor night, that I should be content with my life  
 unless the troop of the praised man splendidly shone,  
 [and] beneath the ruler Wighblaw ran hither,  
 wont to the golden bit—[and] I might greet the prince!

- 37 Svá hafði Hęlgi · hrędda gęrva  
 2 fjąndr sína alla · ok fręndr þęira,  
 sem fyr ulfi · óðar rynni  
 4 gęitr af fjalli, · gęiska fullar!

[R 26r/3]

So would Hallow have terrified  
 his enemies all and their kinsmen,  
 like from a wolf did madly rush  
 goats down a fell, full of fright.

- 38 Svá bar Hęlgi · af hildingum  
 2 sem ítr-skapaðr · askr af þyrni  
 eða sá dýr-kalfr · dęggu slunginn  
 4 es øfri fęrr · qllum dýrum,  
 ok horn glóa · við himin sjalfan.“

[R 26r/5]

So did Hallow surpass the princes  
 like the nobly shaped ash the thorn,  
 or the deer-calf, dew-besprinkled,  
 which fareth higher than all beasts,  
 and its horns do gleam against heaven itself.”

ALL | For the description illustrating the quality of a dead person by likeness to superior natural phenomena, cf. 1 *Guðr* 18, 2 *Guðr* 2, and *Ghv* 15.

**P12**      Haugr var gorr eptir Helga. En er hann kom til Val-hallar, þá      [R 26r/7]  
2      bauð Óðinn hönnum öllu at ráða með sér. Helgi kvað:

A barrow was made for Hallow. But when he came to Walhall Weden offered him to rule everything together with him. Quoth Hallow:

**39**      „Þú skalt, **H**undingr, · **h**verjum manni      [R 26r/9]  
2      **f**ót-laug geta · ok **o**funa kynda;  
         **h**unda binda, · **h**esta gęta,  
4      gefa **s**vínun **s**oð, · áðr **s**ofa gangir!“

“Thou shalt, Hunding, for every man  
make a foot-bath and kindle the fire,  
bind the hounds, feed the horses,  
give wastewater to the swine—before thou mightst go to sleep!”

**P13**      Ambótt Sig-rúnar gekk um aptan hjá haugi Helga ok sá at Helgi      [R 26r/11]  
2      reið til haugs'ins með marga menn. Ambótt kvað:

Syerun's maid-servant walked in the evening by Hallow's barrow and saw that Hallow rode to the barrow with many men. Quoth the maid-servant:

**40**      „Hvart 'ro þat **s**vik ęin · es **s**ęa þikkjumk      [R 26r/13]  
2      eða **r**agna **r**øk · **r**íða męnn dauðir,  
         es **j**óa **y**ðra · **o**ddum keyrið,  
4      eða es **h**ildingum · **h**ęim-fęr gefin?“

“Either these are only tricks, as I seem to see  
—or the Rakes of the Reins?—dead men riding;  
as ye drive your steeds by spear-points on—  
or are the princes granted leave to go home?”

[Ejinn þęira kvað:] **41**      „Es=а þat **s**vik ęin · es **s**ęa þikki=sk      [R 26r/15]  
2      né **a**ldar rof · þó'tt-u oss lítir,  
         þó'tt vér **j**óa **ó**ra · **o**ddum keyrim,  
4      né es **h**ildingum · **h**ęim-fęr gefin.“

[Quoth one of them:] “It is not only tricks, as thou seemest to see—  
nor the Ripping of the Age, although thou behold us;  
although we drive our steeds by spear-points on

the princes are not granted leave to go home.”

2 aldar rof ‘Ripping of the Age’ | Formulaic. Cf. TODO *rjúfa=sk reggin*. This is the same root, only zero-grade.

**P14** Heim gekk ambótt ok sagði Sig-rúnu: [R 26r/16]  
The maid-servant went home and said to Syerun:

42 „Út gakk Sig-rún, · frá Sęfa-fjǫllum [R 26r/17]  
2 ef þik folks jaðarr · finna lystir;  
upp ’s haugr lokinn, · kominn es Hęlgi!  
4 Dǫlg-spor dreypa · dǫglingr bað þik  
at þú sár-dropa · svęfja skyldir.“

“Go outside, Syerun from the Sevefells,  
if thou hast lust to find the leader of the troop—  
the barrow is unlocked; Hallow is come!  
His gashes bleed; the ruler has bid thee  
that thou his wound-drops [BLOOD] shouldst soothe.”

**P15** Sig-rún gekk í haug’inn til Helga ok kvað: [R 26r/20]  
Syerun walked into the barrow forth unto Hallow and quoth:

43 „Nú em’k svá fęgin · fundi okkrum [R 26r/20]  
2 sem át-frękir · Óðins haukar  
es val vitu, · varmar bráðir,  
4 eða dǫgg-litir · dags-brún séa.“

“Now do I so rejoice at our meeting  
like the ravenous hawks of Weden [RAVENS]  
when they know corpses, warm carrion,  
or, gleaming with dew, they see the day’s brow [DAWN]!”

44 Fyrr vil’k kyssa · konung ó-lifðan [R 26r/22]  
2 an þú blóðugri · brynju kastir;  
hár’s þitt, Helgi, · hélu þrungit,  
4 allr es vísi · val-dǫgg slęinn,  
hęndr úr-svalar · Hǫgna mági;  
6 hvé skal’k þér, buðlungr, · þęss bót of vinna?“

Sooner would I kiss the unliving king,  
than thou the bloody byrnie mightst cast away!



Thy hair is, Hallow, with hoarfrost thick;  
 the prince is all with corpse-dew [BLOOD] whipped;  
 the hands spray-cold on Hawn's in-law [= Hallow]—  
 how shall I for thee, noble, find remedy for that?”

4 allr es vísi · val-dögg sleginn ‘the prince is all with corpse-dew whipped’ | Cf. *Bdr* 5, where the dead wallow says something similar.

- [Hēlgi kvað:] 45 „Eín veldr þú, Sig-rún · frá Sefafjöllum, [R 26r/25]  
 2 es Hēlgi es · harm-dögg sleginn:  
 Gréttr þú, goll-varið, · grimumm tórum,  
 4 sól-björt suð-rón, · áðr þú sofa gangir,  
 hvert fella blóðugt · á brjóst grami,  
 6 úr-svalt, inn-fjalgt · ekki þrungit.

[Quoth Hallow:] “Thou alone causest, Syerun from the Sevefells,  
 that Hallow is with harm-dew [BLOOD] whipped.  
 Thou weepest—O gold-covered—bitter tears—  
 sun-bright southern lady—before thou goest to sleep.  
 Each one falls bloody on the prince's chest,  
 spray-cold, stifled, pressed forth by grief.

- 46 Vei skulum drekka · dýrar veigar [R 26r/29]  
 2 þótt misst hafim · munar ok landa!  
 Skal engi maðr · angr-ljóð kveða  
 4 þótt mér á brjósti · þenjar líti.  
 Nú eru brúðir · byrgðar í haugi,  
 6 lofða dísir, · hjá oss liðnum!“

Well shall we drink costly draughts,  
 though we may have lost both joy and lands.  
 No one shall sing songs of sorrow,  
 though he behold the wounds on my chest.  
 Now are the brides shut within the barrow,  
 the praised one's dises, next to us, passed-on.”

5–6 brúðir, dísir, oss ‘brides, dises, us’ | Hallow speaks in the plural. “Now has my bride, my goddess, come into the barrow, next to me, who am dead.”

- P16 Sig-rún bjó séng í hauginum. [R 26r/32]  
 Syerun made a bed in the barrow:

- 47 „Hér hefi’k þér, Hēlgi, · hvílu gørva, [R 26v/1]



the barrow. And at sunset, as Syerun came to the barrow, quoth she [= the maid-servant]:

- 50 „Kominn vęri nú, · ef koma hygđi, [R 26v/10]  
 2 Sig·mundar burr · frá solum Óðins;  
 kveđ'k grams þinig · gręna=sk vånir  
 4 es à ask-limum · ęrnir sitja  
 ok drífr drótt ęll · draum-þinga til.“

“He would be come by now if he had thought to come,  
 Syemund's son [= Hallow] from Weden's halls.  
 I declare hopes of the prince's coming fade  
 when on ashen branches eagles sit  
 and all mankind drifts off to dream-Things.

4 es à ask-limum · ęrnir sitja ‘when on ashen branches eagles sit’ | I.e., “when the eagles roost on yonder trees”. This is a sign of Hallow and his men not coming; if they were, the eagles would be following them and picking at their bodies.

5 drífr ... draum-þinga til ‘drifts off to dream-Things’ | Drifts off to the courts of dreams, i.e., falls asleep. A fine metaphor.

- 51 Ves ęigi svá őr · at ęin farir, [R 26v/12]  
 2 dís skjöldunga, · draug-húsa til!  
 Verđa ęłgari · allir à nöttum  
 4 dauđir dólgar, męr, · an of daga ljósa.“

Be not so mad that thou journey alone,  
 O dise of the Shieldings, to the ghost-houses!  
 Mightier at night do all become  
 dead fiends, O maiden, than during bright day!”

- P18 Sig·rún varđ skamm-líf af harmi ok trega. Þat var trúa í for- [R 26v/14]  
 2 nesku, at menn vęri endr·bornir, en þat er nú kęlluđ kerlinga-  
 villa. Helgi ok Sig·rún er kallat at vęri endr·borin. Hét hann þá  
 4 Helgi Haddingja-skati en hón Kára Hálf-danar dóttir, svá sem  
 kveđit er í Kęru ljóđum, ok var hón val-kyrja.

Syerun became short-lived for pain and grief. It was the belief in olden times that men were reborn, but that is now called an old wives' tale. Of Hallow and Syerun it is claimed that they were reborn. He was then called Hallow Hardingskate and she Cheer Halfdanesdaughter, as is told in the Leeds of Cheer, and she was a walkirrie.

1–2 Þat var trúa í fornesku ‘It was the belief in olden times’ | For another instance of beliefs in *fornesku* ‘olden times, antiquity’, see *Fáfn* P1.

5 Kóru ljóðum 'Leeds of Cheer' | A now-lost heroic poem.

# Spae of Griper

## (*Grípis spó*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.616)–late C11th (0.313).

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Spae of Griper** (abbrev. *Gríp*) is a long poem dealing with the life of Siward. It serves as a synopsis for the majority of the Walsing-cycle, especially Siward's dealings with the Yivickings.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Gríp* is only preserved in **R**, where it is found on foll. 26v/19–28v/29, following 1 *HHund* and foregoing *Reg*.

### Meter

The meter is strict Ancient-words-law. Anacrusis is occasionally allowed (3/2b, 45/3a). No half-lines of type A3 appear in the b-verse. The length of the stanza is unusually regular; indeed, every single one of the 53 Ancient-words-law stanzas is exactly 4 lines long, something otherwise attained only by the much shorter 3 *Guðr*.

An unusual metrical trait of *Gríp* is the occurrence of catalectic lines, likely due to the loss of hiatus. After this had occurred, lines like TODO (< TODO: uncontracted form) and TODO (< TODO: form which was always monosyllabic) would have scanned identically, leading to the acceptance of the new, catalectic type as a genuine metrical type. TODO: Cite Males on Hiatus.

### Dating

Although Sapp (2022)'s model arrives at a most probable early 11th c. date for the poem, this result contradicts with reliable linguistic diagnostic criteria.

TODO: Cite more examples and papers below.

Numerous traits speak to a late date for *Gríp*. Linguistically, the poem displays the sound change *vr-* > *r-* (26/1, 49/1), which indicates a date of composition after 1000 AD. It also shows hiatus contraction, which is not found in Scaldic poetry older than ca. 1150 AD. It has four metrically required occurrences of the short form *Sig-urðr* (16/3, 24/2, 40/2, 53/4), a younger form which is not found in any other Eddic poem apart from *Hdl*, another likely late composition (Sievers 1889, pp. 138–139). In addition, it uses the word *ęigi* ‘not’, originally ‘not at all, by no means’, as an unmarked negator.

Apart from these signs, *Gríp* displays influence from numerous poems in the Walsing-cycle (e.g., 17/4 n.), and serves as an overview for the entire story, which points towards a systematising tendency, something associated with antiquarians of the late 12th and 13th centuries. The poem is also exceptionally regular with regards to the length of the stanza, which probably suggests that it has not been transmitted for very long before ending up in the archetype to the heroic half of *R*.

Together, these traits point convincingly towards a composition in the late 12th, or even early 13th c.

## Summary

The poem begins with the long prose passage *Frá dauða Sin-ęętla* ‘From the Death of Sinfittle’, here P1. This passage may properly be treated as an introduction to the Walsing-poems of *R*, which begin with *Gríp*, and should probably not be seen as part of the poem proper.

In the introductory passage we learn of Siward’s relatives, including his father Syemund and his brother Sinfittle. After Sinfittle killed Burhild’s brother, Burhild took her revenge by poisoning him, and he died. After sending Sinfittle away in a ship, likely a reflection of pre-Christian ship burials, Syemund left for his own kingdom in France, where he married Hardise, daughter of King eanlime, and begat Siward. Syemund was later slain by the sons of Hunding, and his widow Hardise was thereafter married of to Atholf, the son of King Helpric. Siward grew up in their house (P1).

Siward’s maternal uncle was named Griper and renowned for his prophetic abilities. Siward rode alone to his hall, and met the messenger Goater outside (P2). Here the poem proper begins. The first 5 stanzas set the scene of Siward’s arrival. Siward asks Goater the name of the king, and Goater answers that his name is Griper (1). Siward asks to see him (2), and states his name (3). Goater goes to Griper and tells him that the young prince is there to see him (4). Griper walks out of his hall and greets Siward (5).

The rest of the poem concerns Siward’s life, told in the form of a dialogue where Siward asks and Griper, his uncle, answers. Siward begins by asking how his life will turn out (6), and Griper responds that he will become the highest of all kings (7). Siward asks him what the first thing to happen will be after he departs from his uncle’s lands (8), and Griper answers that he will avenge his father by slaying the sons of Hunding (9). Siward asks which other great feats Griper can foresee for him (10), and his uncle answers that he will

slay the greedy wyrm Fathomer and his brother Rein (11). Siward remarks that he will surely win great wealth if that is the case, and asks Griper to continue (12). Griper tells him that he, indeed, will take the wyrm's hoard, and that he will thereafter ride to Yivick (13). Siward asks him what will happen at Yivick's (14), and Griper tells him that he will free a beautiful maiden sleeping on the top of a mountain from her sleep (15). Siward asks what the maiden will tell him after she awakes (16), and Griper tells him that she will teach him important runic spells (17). Siward continues to ask what will happen after that (18), and his uncle tells him that he will be the guest of King Homer. Griper suggests that this is where his spae ends, and tells his nephew not to ask any further questions (19).

Siward expresses his sadness over what Griper has just said, and tells him that he knows that he must have seen a troubling future, but tells his uncle to keep speaking anyways (20). Griper tells him that he could see Siward's youth brightly, but that he has now told him what he has foreseen; he is not rightly considered prophetic (21). Siward insists, and tells his uncle that he is the wisest man he knows upon the earth. He must not conceal his future, even if it is ugly (22). Griper still refuses, and tells Siward that his life will not be filled with blemishes, as his name will go on to be remembered for as long as mankind lives (23). Siward, however, tells him that it would grieve him greatly to part from his uncle without hearing all that he knows (24). At last Griper relents, and tells his nephew that he must take his words to heart, since they are in no wise false (25).

Siward asks his uncle to continue (26), and Griper reveals the name of Homer's foster-daughter: it is Byrnhild (27). Siward asks what her significance will be for him (28), and Griper tells him that he will fall so in love with Byrnhild that he forgets all joy in life (29). Siward next asks what will relieve him from that, and whether he will marry her (30); Griper responds that the two will swear all oaths to each other, but that Siward will forget her after a single night as a guest at Yivick's (31). Siward wonders at why he would do such a thing, since he will love her so much (32), but Griper tells him that he will fall victim to the guiles of Grimhild, Yivick's wife, who will offer him her own daughter, Guthrun (33). Siward asks whether he will marry Guthrun, saying that it would be a noble match (34). Griper tells his nephew about Grimhild's evil counsel: Grimhild will instruct Siward to ask for Byrnhild's hand on behalf of Guthur, which Siward will readily do (35). Siward asks how he will be able to do such a thing, since he himself will love Byrnhild (36), but Griper tells him that he, Guthur, and Hawn will all swear oaths to each other, and that Siward and Guthur will switch shapes on the road to Byrnhild (37). Siward asks what the purpose of that would be, and calls it foolish (38), but Griper explains that Siward will be able to ask for Byrnhild's hand while in the shape of Guthur since he will retain his own mind (39). Siward calls this an evil plan, and says that he will surely be known as the worst of men if he tricks a maiden whom he loves so dearly (40), but Griper once again reassures him that he will do it; he will lie beside her like if she were his own mother, and therefore attain great fame (41). Upon their return, Siward and Guthur will have a joint wedding in Yivick's hall, after they have regained

their original shapes (42). Siward is still confused, and asks how Guthur will be able to marry Byrnhild after she has lain for three nights by Siward's side (43), and whether the whole course of events will turn out pleasant for either him or for Guthur (44). Griper tells Siward that he will keep his oaths to the brothers, but that he will tell his wife, Guthrun, about the switching of shapes; she in turn will tell Byrnhild, who will wish to seek revenge for the tricks played upon her (45). Siward asks what sort of recompense Byrnhild will seek (46), and Griper tells him that she will tell her husband, Guthur, that Siward does not fully keep his oaths of loyalty to the brothers (47). Siward asks whether that accusation will be true or perjurious (48), and Griper answers that it will be a lie egged on by her wrath, even though Siward has not done any harm to Byrnhild (49). Siward now wonders what the sons of Yivick, Guthur, Godthorm, and Hawn will do to him, and whether they will break their in-lawhood by killing him (50). Griper answers that they indeed will, to the grief of Guthrun, who will never find joy again. This is all the doing of Grimhild (51). Even so, Siward must find comfort in the fact that he is the noblest of all men; no more glorious man will come upon the earth (52). Siward tells his uncle to part in peace, and thanks him for doing as he asked; if he had foreseen a brighter future for him, he would surely have told it (53).



## Text

## Frá dauða Sin-fjötla ('From the Death of Sinfittle')

P1      Sig-mundr Volsungs sonr var konungr á Frakk-landi. Sin-fjötli  
 2      var eldstr hans sona, annarr Helgi, þriðji Há-mund\*r. Borg-hildir,  
     kona Sig-mundar, átti bróður er hét ... En Sin-fjötli, stjúp-sonr  
 4      hennar, ok ... báðu einnar konu báðir ok fyr þá sók drap Sin-fjötli  
     hann. En er hann kom heim þá bað Borg-hildir hann fara á  
 6      brot en Sig-mundr bauð henni fé-bótr ok þat varð hón at þig-  
     gja. En at erfi'nu bar Borg-hildir ǫl. Hón tók eittr mikitt, horn  
 8      fullt, ok bar Sin-fjötla. En er hann sá í horn'it skilði hann at  
     eittr var í ok mēlti til Sig-mundar: „Gjör-ótttr er drykk'rinn, ái!“  
 10      Sig-mundr tók horn'it ok drakk af. Svá er sagt at Sig-mundr var  
     harð-görtr at hvár-ki mátti hánnum eittr granda útan né innan. En  
 12      allir synir hans stóðu=sk eittr á hǫrund útan. Borg-hildir bar an-  
     nat horn Sin-fjötla ok bað drekka ok fór allt sem fyrr. Ok enn  
 14      it þriðja sinn bar hón hánnum horn'it ok þó á-mēlis-orð með ef  
     hann drykki eigi af. Hann mēlti enn sem fyrr við Sig-mund;  
 16      hann sagði: „Lát-tu grǫn sía þá, sonr!“ Sin-fjötli drakk ok varð  
     þegar dauðr. Sig-mundr bar hann langar leiðir í fangi sér ok  
 18      kom at firði einum mjóvum ok lǫngum ok var þar skip eitt lítit  
     ok maðr einn á. Hann bauð Sig-mundi far of fjörð'inn. En er  
 20      Sig-mundr bar lík'it út á skip'it þá var bát'rinn hlaðinn. Karl  
     mēlti at Sig-mundr skyldi fara fyr inn á fjörð'inn. Karl hratt  
 22      út skip'inu ok hvarf þegar. Sig-mundr konungr dvalði=sk lengi  
     í Danmǫrk í ríki Borg-hildar síðan er hann fekk hennar. Fór  
 24      Sig-mundr þá suðr í Frakk-land til þess ríkis er hann átti þar.  
     Þá fekk hann Hjör-dísar, dóttur Ey-lima konungs. Þeira sonr  
 26      var Sig-urðr. Sig-mundr konungr fell í orrustu fyr Hundings  
     sonum. En Hjör-dís gipti=sk þá Álf, syni Hjalp-reks konungs.  
 28      Óx Sig-urðr þar upp í barn-ósku. Sig-mundr ok allir synir hans  
     vóru langt um fram alla menn aðra um afl ok vǫxt ok hug ok alla  
 30      at-görvi. Sig-urðr var þá allra framarstr ok hann kalla allir menn  
     í forn-fróðum um alla menn fram ok gǫfgastan her-konunga.

Syemund, Walsing's son, was a king in Frankland. Sinfittle was the eldest of his sons, the other Hallow, the third Highmund. Burhild, Syemund's wife, had a brother whose name was ... But Sinfittle, her stepson, and ... both asked for the hand of a single woman, and for that reason Sinfittle slew him. But when he came home Burhild bade him go away, but Syemund offered her

restitutory money and she had to accept it. But at the wake Burhild brought forth the ale. She took much venom, a full horn, and brought it to Sinfittle. But when he looked into the horn he understood that there was venom in it, and said to Syemund: "Treacherous is this drink, father!" Syemund took the horn and drank it up. So it is said that Syemund was sturdy enough that venom could not injure him from without nor within. But all his sons [only] withstood evnom on the skin without. Burhild brought another horn to Sinfittle and bade him drink, and everything passed as before. And once more a third time she brought him the horn, and yet with accusatory words if he would not drink it up. He spoke as before with Syemund; he said: "Let thy whisker-hairs sieve it, son!" Sinfittle drank and was shortly dead. Syemund bore him through long journeys in his arms and came to a single firth, narrow and long, and thereat there was one little ship and one man on it. He offered Syemund passage around the firth. But when Syemund bore the body out into the ship then the boat was fully loaded. The churl said that Syemund should journey further inland along the firth. The churl pushed out the ship and shortly disappeared. King Syemund had stayed for a long time in Denmark in Burhild's realm after he got her hand. Thereafter Syemund journeyed south into Frankland to the realm which he had there. Then he got the hand of Hardise, the daughter of King Eanlime. Their son was Siward. King Syemund fell in battle at the hands of the sons of Hunding. But Hardise was then given to Atholf, the son of King Helpric. There Siward grew up in his childhood. Syemund and all his sons were far ahead of all other men in strength and size and thought and all accomplishments. Siward was furthest of them all, and in ancient sources men call him ahead of all men and the most worshipful of raiding kings.

2 Há·mund\**r* | Hámundir R 3 ... | *An unfilled gap for a lost name is clearly indicated in R* 4  
... | *A gap is indicated in R*

- P2 Grípir hét sonr Ey·lima, bróðir Hjor·dísar. Hann réð lǫndum ok  
2 vas allra manna vitrastr ok fram-víss. Sig·urðr reið einn saman  
ok kom til hallar Grípis. Sig·urðr vas auð·kennendr. Hann hitti  
4 mann at máli úti fyr hǫll'inni; sá nefndi=sk Geitir. Þá kvaddi  
Sig·urðr hann máls, ok spyrr:

Griper was the name of Eanlime's son, Hardise's brother. He ruled lands and was of all men the smartest, and forthwise. Siward rode alone and came to Griper's hall; Siward was easily recognized. He went up to speak to a man outside of the hall; that one called himself Goater. Then Siward greeted him with speech, and asks:

### Grípis spó ('The Spae of Griper')

- 1 „Hverr byggir hér · borgir þessar?

- 2 Hvatt þann þjóð-konung · þegnar nefna?“  
 „Grípir heitir · gumna stjóri,  
 4 sá's fastri rēðr · foldu ok þegnum.“

“WHO DWELLS HERE in these strongholds?  
 What is this great king called by thanes?”  
 “Griper is the name of the steerer of men  
 who rules the steadfast land and thanes.”

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2 þjóð-konung 'great king' | An old poetic word, cognate with OE *þeod-cyning* 'id.', OS *þiud-kuning* 'id.' The first element is most likely to be equated with Gothic *þiupi-* 'good' (in *þiupi-giss* 'blessing', calquing Greek εὐλογία, Streitberg 1910, s.v. *þiupigiss*) rather than Gothic *þiuda* 'people, tribe', ON *þjóð* 'id.', OE *þeod* 'id.'

Its distribution in ON poetry is not altogether neutral. In the Poetic Edda it appears, outside of the present poem, in *Sigsk* 35/3, 36/4, *Akv* 47/3, *Gbv* 14/2, and *Hamð* 4/1, all likely old poems. In Scaldic poetry it appears in the early *Yt* 22 (ca. 850 AD) and *Gldr* 7 (ca. 900 AD), but appears to have been proscribed in the formal praise poetry of the 10th and earliest 11th century until it was revived by Sighvat Thurfrithson in the 1010s, from which point it is found in praise poetry until the extinction of the tradition in the 13th c. In apocryphal Eddic poetry the word only appears in *HljQ* 19 and Gunnleif *Merl* I 58 (both in SkP 8).

- 2 „Es horskr konungr · heima í landi?  
 Mun sá gramr við mik · ganga at mēla?  
 Máls es þarfi · maðr ó-kunnigr,  
 4 vil'k fljót=liga · finna Grípi.“

“Is the wise king at home in the land?  
 Will that chief go to speak with me?  
 In need of speech is this foreign man;  
 I wish shortly to find Griper.”

- 3 „Þess mun glaðr konungr · Gēiti spyrja  
 2 hvęrr sá maðr sé · es máls kveðr Grípi.“  
 „Sig-urðr ek heiti, · borinn Sig-mundi  
 4 en Hjor-dís es · hilmis móðir.“

“The glad king will ask Goater  
 who the man is who asks Griper for speech.”  
 “Siward I am called, born to Syemund,  
 but Hardise is the helmet-bearer's [my] mother.”

- 4 Þá gekk Gētir · Grípi at segja:  
 2 „Hér's maðr úti · ó-kuðr kominn;  
 hann 's ítar=ligr · at á·liti;  
 4 sá vill, fylkir, · fund þínn hafa.“

Then Goater went to tell Griper:  
 “Here outside a foreign man is come;  
 he is radiating of hue.  
 That one, O marshaller, wishes to have thy audience.”

- 5      Gęngr ór skála · skatna dróttinn  
 2      ok hęilsar vel · hilmi komnum:  
 „Þigg þú hér, Sig-urðr, · vęri sęmra fyrr!  
 4      ęn þú, Gętir, tak · við Grana sjölfum.“

Out of his halls goes the lord of warriors  
 and well greets the helmet-bearer who has come.  
 “Here receive [welcome], Siward! Sooner would have been more fit!  
 But thou, Goater, take care of Grane.”

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4 Grana ‘Grane’ | Siward’s horse.

- 6      Méla nęmu · ok margt hjala  
 2      þá’s ráð-spakir · rekkar fundu=sk.  
 [Sig-urðr:] „Sęg-ðu męr ef þú vęizt, · móður-bróðir,  
 4      hvę mun Sig-urði · snúna ęvi?“

They took to speak and chatter much  
 when the council-wise champions found each other.  
 [Siward:] “Tell me, if thou knowest, O mother’s brother:  
 how will Siward’s age turn out?”

- 7      „Þú munt maðr vesa · mętstr und sólu  
 2      ok hęstr borinn · hverjum jęfri;  
 gjęfull af golli · ęn glęggr flugar,  
 4      ítr à-liti · ok í orðum spakr.“

„Thou wilt be a man noblest beneath the sun,  
 and born higher than every ruler,  
 giving of gold but stingy of flight,  
 radiant of hue and wise in words.“

- 8      „Sęg, gęgn konungr, · gęrr an ek spyrja  
 2      snotr Sig-urði · ef þú sjá þikki=sk,  
 hvat mun fyrst gęra=sk · til farnaðar  
 4      þá’s ór garði em’k · gęginn þínum?“

“Tell it, O fine king, clearer than I might ask,  
 —O wise—to Siward, if thou seemest to see:

What will first happen to my advantage  
when I am gone out of thy house?”

- 9 „Fyrst munt, fylkir, · fǫður of hefna  
2 ok Ey·lima · alls harms reka;  
þú munt harða · Hundings sonu  
4 snjalla fella— · munt sigr hafa.“

“First wilt thou, marshaller, take revenge for thy father  
and avenge all Eanlime’s injuries.  
Harshly wilt thou fell the brave sons  
of Hunding; thou wilt have victory.”

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2 Ey·lima · alls harms ‘all Eanlime’s injuries’ | Eanlime was the father of Siward’s mother, Hardise,  
cf. P1 above.

- 10 „Sæg, ítr konungr, · éttingi mér  
2 hēldr horsk=liga · es vit hugat mēlum;  
sér þú Sig·urðar · snor brogð fyrir  
4 þau’s hēst fara · und himin-skautum?“

“Tell, O radiant king, to me, thy kinsman,  
rather wisely, as we speak thoughtfully:  
foreseest thou any of Siward’s nimble deeds  
which fare highest under the corners of heaven?”

- 11 „Munt einn vega · orm inn frána  
2 þann’s grǫðugr liggr · á Gnita-heiði;  
þú munt bǫðum · at bana verða  
4 Regin ok Fáfnir; · rétt segir Grípir.“

“Thou alone wilt slay the gleaming Wyrn  
which lies greedy on the Gnit-heath.  
Thou wilt be the bane of them both:  
Rein and Fathomer—Griper tells rightly.”

- 12 „Auðr mun órinn · ef elli’k svá  
2 víg með virðum · sem þú visst segir;  
leið at·huga · ok lengi seg  
4 hvat mun enn vesa · évi minnar?“

“The wealth will be ample if I accomplish such  
a killing amongst men as thou sayest for certain.

Give thy thought to it and speak for long:  
what will further become of my age?”

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3 leið at-huga ‘Give thy thought to it’ | *leiða at-huga* ‘give one’s thought to something’ is a idiomatic (ONP, s.v. at-hugi).

- 13 „Þú munt finna · Fáfnis bóli  
2 ok upp taka · auð inn fagra,  
golli hlóða · á Grana bógu;  
4 ríðr til Gjúka · gramr víg-risinn.“

“Thou wilt find Fathomer’s dwelling  
and take up the fair treasure,  
load the gold on Grane’s shoulders;  
thou wilt ride to Yivick a man proud of killing.”

- 14 „Einn skalt hilmi · í hugaðs-róðu  
2 fram-lyndr jöfurr · fleira segja;  
gæstr em’k Gjúka · ok ek geng þaðan,  
4 hvat mun einn vesa · évi minnar?“

“Further shalt thou to the marshaller in thoughtful conversation  
O forth-minded chieftain, tell more things:  
I am the guest of Yivick, and then I go thence;  
what will further become of my age?”

- 15 „Søfr á fjalli · fylkis dóttir  
2 björt í brynju · eptir bana Hēlga;  
þú munt hoggva · hvössu sverði,  
4 brynju rísta · með bana Fáfnis.“

“On the fell sleeps the marshaller’s daughter,  
bright in a byrnie, after Hallow’s killing.  
Thou wilt cut it with a sharp sword,  
carve up the byrnie with Fathomer’s bane.”

---

4 bana Fáfnis ‘Fathomer’s bane’ | Viz. the sword Riddle; cf. *Fáfnir* P3.

- 16 „Brotin es brynja · brúðr mēla tēkr  
2 es vaknaði · víf ór svefni;  
hvat mun snót at hēldr · við Sig-urð mēla  
4 þat ’s at farnaði · fylki verði?“

“Broken is the byrnie; the bride takes to speak,  
the woman who awakened from her sleep.  
What will the wife thereafter speak unto Siward,  
which will be to the marshaller’s advantage?”

- 17 „Höf mun ríkjum þér · rúnar kenna  
2 allar þér’s aldir · ęigna=sk skyldu  
ok á manns tungu · męla hverja;  
4 lif með lękning · lif heill konungr!“

“She will teach thee, O powerful one, runes,  
all those which mankind should possess,  
and on every man’s tongue be spoken.  
Live with leeching skill! Live hale, O king!”

4 lif með lękning ‘Live with leeching skill!’ | I.e., medicinal skill, medicine. Clearly alluding to *Sigrdr* 4/4: ok lęknis-ęendr meðan lifum ‘and a leecher’s hands, while we live’.

- 18 „Þá’s því lokit · numin eru fróði  
2 ok em braut þaðan · búinn at ríða;  
leið at·huga · ok lęgra sęg  
4 hvat mun męirr vesa · minnar ęvi?“

“Then that is come to an end; the learning has been taken,  
and I am ready to ride away thence.  
Give thy thought to it and speak for longer:  
what will yet further become of my age?”

1 Þá’s því lokit · numin eru fróði | Alliteration is missing from this line and no obvious emendation can be found.

- 19 „Þú munt hitta · Hęimis bygðir  
2 ok glaðr vera · gęstr þjóð-konungs;  
farit es, Sig-urðr, · þat’s ek fyr·vissa’k,  
4 skal=a fręmr an svá · fregna Grípi.“

“Thou wilt find the farms of Homer  
and be the glad guest of that great king.  
Now that has passed, O Siward, which I foreknew;  
further than so shalt thou not ask Griper.”

- 20 „Nú fęr mér ękka · orð þat’s męltir  
2 því’t langt framm of sér · fylkir lęgra;  
vęitst of mikit · angr Sig-urði,

4 því þú Grípir þat · gørra sęja!“

“Now the word which thou hast spoken brings me grief;  
for the marshaller foresees much further.  
Thou knowest too great trouble for Siward;  
therefore shalt thou, Griper, tell that more clearly!”

21 „Lá mer umb ósku · évi þinnar

2 ljósast fyrir · líta ęptir;

rétts em'k=a ek · ráð-spakr taliðr

4 ne in heldr fram-víss · farit þat's ek víska.“

“Throughout the youth of thy age  
it was brightest for me to behold.  
I am not rightly counted counsel-wise,  
nor indeed forthwise; passed is that which I have known.”

22 „Mann veit'k ęngi · fyr mold ofan

2 þann's flęira sé · framm an þú Grípir;

skal=at lęyna · þó'tt ljótt sér

4 eða męin gøri=sk · á mĩnum hag.“

“I know no man above the earth  
who foresees more things than thou, Griper.  
Thou shalt not hide it, although thou seest ugliness  
or evil befalling my state of life.”

23 „Es=a með lęstum · lęğð évi þér;

2 lát-tu, inn ítri, · þat, ęðlingr, nema=sk,

því at uppi mun · meðan ęld lifir,

4 nadd-ęls boði, · nafn þitt vera.“

“With blemishes is thy age not laid out;  
let thyself, radiant athling, take that to heart,  
for remembered will while mankind lives,  
O beseecher of the sword-storm [BATTLE > WARRIOR], thy name be!”

24 „Verst hyggjum því · verðr at skilja=sk

2 Sig-urðr við fylki · at só-gøru.

lęið vísa þú · lagt 's allt fyrir,

4 męrr, męr ef þú vilt · móður bróðir.“

“We think it worst for Siward to part  
from the marshaller after such a saying.



Show me the path—all is laid out ahead—  
if thou wilt, O famed mother's brother!"

- 25 „Nú skal **Sig**-urði · **s**egja gǫrva  
2 alls þengill mik · til þess neyðir;  
munt **víst** **vita** · at **væt**-ki lýgr,  
4 **d**ógr eitt es þér · **d**auði étlaðr.“

“Now shall I tell Siward clearly  
as the prince compels me to do it.  
Thou shalt truly know that I nowise lie;  
on a single half-day thy death is appointed.”

- 26 „Vil'k=at ek **r**eiði · **ríks** þjóð-konungs  
2 **g**óð-ráðs at \* hędr · **G**rípis þiggja;  
nú vill **víst** **vita** · þó'tt **v**ilkit sé  
4 hvat á **s**ýnt **Sig**-urðr · **sér** fyr hęndum.“

“I wish not to [face] the anger of the great king,  
but rather to receive the good counsel of Griper.  
Now I would rather know—although it be gloomy—  
what, plainly, Siward has before him.”

---

2 at \* | at at R

- 27 „Fljóð 's at Hęimis · **f**agrt á·litum.  
2 hana **B**ryn·hildi · **b**ragnar nęfna;  
**d**óttir Buðla · ęn **d**ýrr konungr  
4 **h**arð-úgðigt man · **H**ęimir fððir.“

“There is a lady at Homer's, fair of hue;  
her do noble warriors call Byrnhild.  
She is the daughter of Budle, but the esteemed king  
Homer raises the hard-minded girl.”

- 28 „Hvat 's **m**ik at því · þó'tt **m**ér sé  
2 **f**ęgr á·liti · **f**ódd at Hęimis?  
Þat skalt **G**rípir · **g**örva segja  
4 því't þú **ę**ll of sér · **ę**r·lęg fyrir.“

“What does it mean for me, though there be a maiden  
fair of hue raised at Homer's?  
That shalt thou, Griper, tell clearly,  
for thou foreseest all orlays.”

29 „Höñ firrir þik · flestu gamni

2 fōgr á·liti · fōstra Hēimis;  
svefn þú né søfr · né umb sakar dōmir  
4 gār=a þú manna · nema þú mēy sér.“

“She will deprive thee of most pleasures,  
the foster-daughter of Homer, fair of hue.  
Thou wilt not sleep thy sleep nor preside over matters;  
thou heedest no men if thou canst not see the maiden.”

ALL. | The description of Siward's despair appears to be pulling from *Háv* 114.

3 svefn þú né søfr · né umb sakar dōmir | The line closely parallels 2 *Guðr* 3/3.

30 „Hvat mun til líkna · lagt Sig-urði

2 sēg Grípir þat · ef sjá þikki=sk;  
mun'k mēy ná · mundi kaupa  
4 þà ina fōgru · fylkis dóttur?“

“What will be laid out to relieve Siward;  
tell, O Griper, that, if thou seemest to see it!  
Will I get to buy the maiden for a bride-price,  
that fair daughter of the marshaller?”

31 „It munuð alla · eiða vinna

2 full-fast=liga— · fā munuð halda;  
vesit hēfir þú Gjúka · gēstr eina nótt  
4 mant=at horska · Hēimis fōstru.“

“Ye two will swear all oaths,  
fully firmly; few will ye keep.  
Thou wilt have been the guest of Yivick for a single night;  
thou wilt not remember the wise foster-daughter of Homer.”

1 alla eiða ‘all oaths’ | Probably a legal expression, i.e., oaths on every kind of thing. Cf. *Vkv* 33, *Akv* 33.

32 „Hvart 's þà, Grípir; · gētt þess fyr mér,

2 sér þú gēð-leysi · í grams skapi  
es skal við mēy þà · mōlum slíta  
4 es alls hugar · unna þótt=umk.“

“What shall it be then, O Griper? Reveal it to me!  
Seest thou fickleness of mind in the heart of the prince  
who shall break the [sworn] words with that maiden  
whom I thought myself to love out of all my heart?”

- 33 „Þú verðr, **s**iklingr, · fyr **s**vikum annars  
 2 munt **G**rim·hildar · **g**jalda ráða;  
 mun **b**jóða þér · **b**jart-haddat man  
 4 **d**óttur sína, · **d**regr hön vél at gram.“

“Thou wilt, O warrior, fall for another’s betrayal;  
 thou wilt pay for Grimhild’s counsels.  
 She will offer thee a bright-haired girl,  
 her own daughter [= Guthrun]; she plots wiles against the prince [thee].”

- 34 „Mun’k við þá **G**unn·ar · **g**örva hlęyti  
 2 ok **G**uð·rúnu · **g**anga at ęiga?  
**F**ull-kvęni þá · **f**ylkir vęri  
 4 ef **m**ęin-tregar · **m**ér angraði=t.“

“Will I form a familiar kinship with Guthr and his kin,  
 and go to have Guthrun?  
 Fully wedded would the marshall then be,  
 if evil sorrows should not grieve me.”

- 35 „Þik mun **G**rim·hildr · **g**örva véla  
 2 mun hön **B**ryn·hildar · **b**iðja fýsa  
**G**unn·ari til handa · **G**otna dróttni  
 4 hęitr þú **f**ljót=liga **f**ör · **f**ylkis móður.“

“Grimhild will beguile thee fully;  
 she will urge thee to ask for Byrnhild’s hand  
 on behalf of Guthr, the lord of the Gots.  
 Thou wilt readily promise that journey to the marshall’s mother.”

- 36 „**M**ęin eru fyr høndum · **m**á’k líta þat;  
 2 **r**atar gøt=liga · **r**áð Sig·urðar,  
 ef ek skal **m**ęrrar · **m**ęyjar biðja  
 4 **q**örum til handa · þęirar ek **u**nna vel.“

“Evils are at hand; I can see that.  
 Fully does Siward’s counsel falter,  
 if I shall ask for the hand of the famous maiden  
 whom I love so well on another’s behalf.”

- 37 „**É**r munuð allir · **ę**iða vinna  
 2 **G**unn·arr ok Høgni · **ę**n þú **g**ramr þriði,  
 því’t litum víxla · es á **l**ęið eruð

4 Gunn·arr ok þú— · Grípir lýgr ęigi.“

“Ye will all swear oaths,  
Guthur and Hawn, but thou the third prince,  
since ye will exchange your hues when upon the road,  
thou and Guthur—Griper lies not.”

---

ALL | Guthur and Siward switched shapes so that Siward could woo Byrnhild on Guthur's behalf.

38 „Hví gegnir þat · hví skulum skipta  
2 litum ok lötum · es á leið erum?  
þar mun flá-róði · fylgja annat  
4 atalt með ęllu— · ęnn seg Grípir!“

“What does that mean? Why shall we shift  
our hues and our sounds when upon the road?  
TODO.  
TODO”

39 „Lit hefir þú Gunn·ars · ok lęti hans,  
2 męlsku þína · ok męgin-hyggjur;  
munt fastna þér · fram-lundaða  
4 fósturu Hęimis · sér vętr fyr því.“

“Thou wilt have Guthur's hue and his voice;  
thy own speech and intelligence;  
thou wilt betroth thyself to the forth-minded  
foster-daughter of Homer; TODO.”

40 „Verst hyggjum því, · vándr mun'k hęitinn  
2 Sig·urðr með sęggjum · at só-göru;  
vilda'k ęigi · vélum þęta  
4 jęfra brúði · es óðsta vęit'k.“

“We think that the worst; I will be called bad,  
Siward amongst men, after such a deed.  
I would in no wise use wiles against  
the chieftains' bride whom I know to be the noblest.”

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4 brúði | *gramm. and metr. emend.*; brúðr (*nom. sg.*) R.

41 „Þú munt hvíla, · hęrs odd-viti,  
2 męrr hjá męyju · sem þín móðir sé;  
því mun uppi · meðan ęld lifir,

4 þjóðar þengill, · þitt nafn vera.

“Thou wilt rest, O famous point-knower of the host [WARRIOR],  
beside the maiden as if she were thy mother.  
For that will remembered while mankind lives,  
O prince of the nation, thy name be.

42 Saman munu bru·llaup · bēði drukkin  
2 Sig·urðar ok Gunn·ars · ǿ solum Gjúka;  
þá hōmum víxlið · es it hēim komið,  
4 hēfir hvęrr fyr því · hyggju sína.“

“Both weddings will be drunk together  
—Seward’s and Guthur’s—in the halls of Yivick.  
Then ye will shift your hames when ye two come home;  
[already] before that each one has his own intelligence.”

43 „Mun góða kvón · Gunn·arr eiga  
2 męrr með mōnnum, · —mér sęg Grípir!—  
þó’tt hafi þrjár nętr · þęgns brúðr hjá mér  
4 snar-lynd sofit? · S·líks eru-t dōmi!

“Will Guthur have the good woman,  
that renowned man amongst men—tell me, O Griper!—  
even though she has slept by my side for three nights,  
the sharp-minded thane’s bride? Such a thing has no precedents!

44 Hvé mun at ynði · ęptir verða  
2 męgð með mōnnum? · Mér sęg Grípir!  
Mun Gunn·ari · til gamans ráðit  
4 síðan verða · eða sjölfum mér?“

“TODO.  
TODO. Tell me, O Griper!  
Will things afterwards be decided  
to the joy of Guthur or to myself?”

45 „Minnir þik ęiða · mátt þęgja þó  
2 ann Guð·rūnu · góðra ráða  
ęn Bryn·hildr þikki=sk · brúðr vas gefin  
4 snót fiðr vélar · sér at hęfndum.“

“TODO.  
TODO.

TODO.  
TODO”

- 46 „Hvat mun at bótum · brúðr sú taka  
2 es vélar vér · vífi gerðum;  
hefir snót af mér · svarna ęiða  
4 ęnga ęfnda · en unat lítit?“

“TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO”

- 47 „Mun hęn Gunn·ari · gęrva sęja  
2 at þú ęigi vel · ęiðum þyrmir  
þa's ítr konungr · af ęllum hug  
4 Gjúka arfi · á gram trúði.“

“To Guthur will she clearly tell  
that thou dost not well respect the oaths,  
while that radiant king, out of his whole heart,  
—the heir of Yivick—trusted the chief [thee].”

- 48 „Hvat 's þa, Grípir? · Get þess fyr mér;  
2 mun'k saðr vesa · at sęgu þęiri,  
ęða lýgr á mik · lof-sęl kona  
4 ok á sjalfa sik? · Sęg Grípir þat!“

“What happens then, Griper? Reveal it to me;  
will I be truthfully accused according to that speech,  
or does the woman blessed of praise lie about me  
and about her very self? Tell, O Griper, this!”

- 49 „Mun fyr ręiði · rík brúðr við þik  
2 né af of-trega · all-vel skipa.  
viðr þú góðri · grand aldri-gi  
4 þó 's víf konungs · vélum þęittuð.“

“TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO”

50 „Mun horskr Gunn·arr · at hvotun hennar

2 Guð·þormr ok Hogni · ganga síðan?

Munu synir Gjúka · af sífjungum mér

4 eggjar rjóða? · Eñn seg Grípir!“

“Will the wise Guther at her instigation,  
with Godthorm and Hawn thereafter go?  
Will the sons of Yivick, to break their kinship with me,  
reden their blades? Tell further, Griper!”

51 „Þá 's Guð·rúnu · grimmt umb hjarta

2 bróðr hennar þér · til bana ráða,

ok at øngu verðr · ynði síðan

4 vitru vífi, · veldr því Grim·hildr.

“TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO”

52 Því skal hugga þik, · hęrs odd-viti,

2 sú mun gípt lagit · á grams évi;

mun=at męttri maðr · á mold koma

4 und sólar sjet · an, Sig·urðr, þikkir.“

For that shall she soothe(?) thee, O point-knower of the host;  
she will have laid venom in the ruler's age.  
No nobler man will come upon the earth  
beneath the seat of the sun [SKY/HEAVEN], than thou, Siward, dost seem!

53 „Skiljum=k hęilir; · mun=at sköpum vinna!

2 Nú hęfir þú, Grípir, vęl · gørt sem þeidda'k;

fljótt myndir þú · fríðri segja

4 mína évi · ef þú męttir þat!“

“Let us part hale; man will not withstand the shapes!  
Now hast thou, Griper, well done as I asked.  
Sooner wouldst thou have told finer things  
of my age, if thou couldst do so!”





# Speeches of Rein

## (*Ręins mól*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.666)–early C11th (0.259)

**Meter:** Leeds-meter, Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Rein** (*Reg*) is a heroic poem, really a prosimetrum, dealing with the youth of Siward the Walsing.

### Textual transmission and preservation

*Reg* is preserved in full in **R**, where it follows *Grip* and precedes *Fáfn*. The prosimetrum is introduced with a large initial and an illegible title originally in red ink.

The text of the prosimetrum is also found in *Norn* 4–6, which reproduce the entire sequence *Reg* P6–26, with all relevant stanzas. The main ms. for this text is **F**. Although *Norn* 4–6 is clearly textually related to *Reg* in its written form, as seen by the shared prose passages, it is probably not directly derived from **R**, but rather from a sister manuscript. Note that *Norn* also preserves *Helr*.

*Reg* in its written form clearly serves as the basis for two additional sources: *Vols* 14–15 and 17–18 (for ch. 16 see *Grip*) cites sts. 1, 2, 6, and 18 verbatim and paraphrases many others. *Skm* 46–48 retells the whole story of Siward's youth, also pulling on *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr*.

### The Siward sequence

In **R**, *Reg* is the first of a group of three very similar poems in an unbroken narrative sequence (*Reg*, *Fáfn*, *Sigrdr*), for which reason the whole group will be discussed here.

To begin with, it should be said that modern philology has disproven the existence of these three poems—indeed their very names—as independent

units. Although *Fáfn* is introduced by a title and large initial and thus separated from *Reg*, the division between *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr* is entirely arbitrary, since the two are continuous in **R**. More importantly, none of the three poems is a unitary poetic composition. Instead, they form a single continuous narrative, told in the same characteristic style: an amalgamation of narrative prose and poetic dialogue-stanzas, alternating between Ancient-words-law and Leeds-meter. The style of the stanzas in each meter is in fact very similar throughout, so that we may be dealing with two long separate cycles treating the same overarching story, which have been edited into a single text. A particularly likely example of overlap between these potential sources is the speech of the tits in *Fáfn* 32–39, where there is a good narrative progression of thought in the stanzas of each meter, but which is confused if one reads both.

That is not to say that the existence of such sources is certain. In fact, it is not implausible that the whole sequence was written as a prosimetrum, most likely by a 12th century antiquarian, drawing on older narratives and perhaps incorporating older poetry. Antiquarian influence is inevitable in the rune-spell section of *Sigrdr*, where a post-conversion Latin loanword is found in st. 8/1.

In any case, the old division into three poems has been retained in the present edition for reasons of accessibility and compatibility with earlier editions, but the reader is encouraged to read the entire sequence in order.

## Text

### The Speeches of Rein

- P1      Sig-urðr gekk til stóðs Hjálp-reks ok kaus sér af hest einn er  
2      Grani var kallaðr síðan. Þá var kominn Reginn til Hjálp-reks,  
sonr Hreið-mars. Hann var hverjum manni hagari ok dvergr  
4      of vøxt. Hann var vitr, grimmr ok fjöl-kunnigr. Reginn veitti  
Sig-urði fóstr ok kennslu ok elskaði hann mjök. Hann sagði  
6      Sig-urði frá for-ellri sínu ok þeim at-burðum at Óðinn ok Hónir  
ok Loki høfðu komit til And-vara-fors; í þeim forsi var fjölði  
8      fiska. Einn dvergr hét And-vari; hann var lōngum í forsi'num í  
geddu líki ok fekk sér þar matar.  
10      „Otr hét bróðir várr,“ kvað Reginn, „er opt fór í fors'inn í otrs líki.  
Hann hafði tekit einn lax ok sat á ár-bakka'num ok át blundandi.  
12      Loki laust hann með steini til bana. Þóttu-sk ేశir mjök heppnir  
verit hafa ok flógu belg af otrinum. Þat sama kveld sóttu þeir  
14      gisting til Hreið-mars ok sýndu veiði sína. Þá tóku vér þá hōn-  
dum ok lōgðum þeim fjor-lausn at fylla otr-belginn með gulli  
16      ok hylja útan ok með rauðu gulli. Þá sendu þeir Loka at afla  
gulls'ins. Hann kom til Ránar ok fekk net hennar ok fór þá  
18      til And-vara-fors ok kastaði neti'nu fyr geddu'na en hōn hljóp  
í net'it. Þá mēlti Loki:

SIWARD WALKED to Hēlpric's stable and chose himself thereof a horse which was thenceforth called Grane. Then Rein, son of Rethmar, had come to Hēlpric's. He was craftier than every man and a dwarf in stature; he was clever, cruel and manicunning. Rein granted Siward fosterage and teaching, and loved him much. He told Siward about his parentage, and about the events that Weden, Heener and Lock had come to Andwaresforce; in that force was a multitude of fish. One dwarf was called Andware; he was for a long time in the force in the likeness of a pike and got his food there. "Otter was our brother called," said Rein, "who often went forth in the force in the likeness of an otter. He had taken a salmon and sat on the riverbank and ate it with his eyes closed. Lock beat him with a stone to his death. The Eese thought themselves to have been very lucky and flayed the skin from the otter. That same evening they sought lodgings at Rethmar's house, and showed their catch. Then we bound them and gave them as a life-ransom to fill the otter-skin with gold and cover even the outside with red gold. Then they sent Lock to procure the gold. He came to Ran and got her net, and then journeyed to Andwaresforce and threw the net in front of the pike, and it jumped into the net. Then spoke Lock:

- 1 „Hvat 's þat fiska · es rinn flóði í;  
 2 kann=at sér við víti varask?  
 Höfuð þitt · leys-tu helju ór;  
 4 finn mér lindar loga!“
- “WHAT SORT OF FISH is it which runs in the flood?  
 It cannot help itself from harm.  
 Redeem thy head out of Hell;  
 find me the fountain-flame [GOLD]!”

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4 finn | ok finn N 4 lindar | emend.; linar R; liondar N

- 2 „And·vari ek heiti, · Óinn hét minn faðir,  
 2 margan hef'k fors of farit.  
 Aumlig norn · skóp oss í ár-daga  
 4 at ek skylda í vatni vaða.“
- “Andware I am called; Owen was my father called;  
 through many a force I have fared.  
 A wretched norn shaped for us in days of yore  
 that I should in the water wade.”

---

1 Óinn | Óðinn *wo. doubt corrupt* N

- 3 „Segðu þat, And·vari,“ (kvað Loki,) „ef þú eiga vill  
 2 líf í lýða solum:  
 Hver gjöld · fáa gumna synir  
 4 ef höggvask orðum á?“
- “Tell this, Andware”—quoth Lock—“if thou wilt own  
 life in the halls of men:  
 Which recompense do the sons of men get,  
 if they hew at each other with words?”

- 4 „Ofr-gjöld · fáa gumna synir  
 2 þeir's Vað-gelmi vaða;  
 Ó-saðra orða · hverr's á annan lýgr,  
 4 of lengi leiða limar.“
- “Terrible recompense do the sons of men get,  
 they who in Wadyelmer wade.  
 By the results of untrue words is each  
 who lies to another long followed.”

ALL | Watery torment for criminals (both in this life and the next) is well attested in Germanic sources. See *Vsp* 39 and note for discussion.

- P2      Loki sá allt gull þat er And-vari átti. En er hann hafði fram  
2      reitt gull'it, þá hafði hann eptir einn hring ok tók Loki þann af  
         hánum. Dvergr'inn gekk inn í stein'inn ok mēlti:

Lock saw all the gold which Andware owned. But when he had prepared the gold, then he still had one ring and Lock took it from him. The dwarf went into the stone and spoke:

- 5      „Þat skal goll · es Gustr átti  
2      bróðrum tvēim · at bana verða  
         ok ǫðlingum · átta at rógi;  
4      mun míns féar · mann=gi njóta.“

“That gold which Gust owned shall  
for two brothers become the bane,  
and for eight nobles the cause of strife;  
of my wealth will no man profit.”

- P3      Ésir reiddu Hreið-mari féit ok tráðu upp otr-belginn ok reistu á  
2      fóttr; þá skyldu ésirnir hlaða upp gulli'nu ok hylja. En er þat var  
         gørt gekk Hreið-marr framm ok sá eitt grana-hár ok bað hylja.  
4      Þá dró Óðinn framm hringinn And-vara-naut ok hulði hárit.

The Eese prepared the fee for Rethmar and stuffed the otter-skin and raised it on its feet; then the Eese should load up the gold and cover it. But when it was done Rethmar walked up to it and saw a single whisker strand and bade it be covered. Then Weden drew forth the ring Andwaresgift and covered the strand.

- 6      „Goll's þér nú reitt“, (kvað Loki,) „en þú gjöld hefir  
2      mikil míns hǫfuðs;  
         syni þínum · verðr=a sǣla skǫpuð;  
4      þat verðr ykkarr bēggja bani!“

“The gold is now prepared for thee”—quoth Lock—“and thou hast the great payment for my head.

For thy son will no welfare arise;  
it will be the bane of you both!”

3 verðr=a | verðr=at N    4 verðr | es N

Hreiðmarr sagði:

- 7 „Gjafar þú **g**aft— · **g**aft=at òst-gjafar,  
 2                   gaf=at af **h**eilum **h**ug!  
**F**jörvi yðru · skylduð ér **f**irrðir vesa  
 4                   ef vissa’k þat **f**ar **f**yrr.“

“Thou gavest a gift—gavest not a gift of love;  
 gavest not out of true heart!  
 From your lives would ye be far removed,  
 if I had known that danger before!”

- 8 „Eñn es **v**erra, · þat **v**ita þikkjumk,  
 2                   **n**iðja stríð um **n**ept;  
**j**öfra **ó**-borna · hygg þá **en**n vesa  
 4                   es þat ’s til **h**atrs **h**ugat.“

“Still worse is what I seem to know ahead:  
 the forced hatred of kinsmen.  
 In unborn princes I think it still  
 intends to stir up strife.”

- 9 „**R**auðu golli“, (kvað Hreiðmarr,) „hykk mik **r**áða munu  
 2                   svá **l**engi sem ek **l**ífi;  
**h**ót þín · **h**rēðumk ekki lyf  
 4                   ok **h**aldið **h**eim **h**eðan!“

“The red gold”—quoth Rethmar—“I think I will wield  
 so long as I do live.  
 Thy threats I fear not at all—  
 and turn ye home hence!”

- P4 Fáfñir ok Reginn kröfðu Hreið·mar nið-gjalda eptir Otr, bróður  
 2 sinn. Hann kvað nei við. En Fáfñir lagði sverði Hreið·mar,  
 fýður sinn, sofanda. Hreið·marr kallaði á dótr sínar:

Fathomer and Rein demanded from Rethmar the kin-payment for Otter,  
 their brother. He said no to it, but Fathomer ran his sword through Rethmar,  
 his father, sleeping. Rethmar called out to his daughters:

- 10 „**L**yg·heiðr ok **L**ofn·heiðr, · vitið mínu **l**ífi farit!  
 2                   Mart ’s þat’s þorf þéar!“  
 „**F**ó mun systir, · þó’tt fýður missi,  
 4                   **h**efna **h**lýra **h**arms.“

“Lingheath and Lovenheath! Witness my life destroyed;

Lyngheiðr svaraði:

Lingheath answered: “much does the need compel!”  
 “Few a sister, though she might miss her father,  
 will avenge her brother’s harm.”

2 Mart ’s þat’s þorþ þéar! ‘much does the need compel!’ | The circumstances require yet more terrible actions; as his only children, Rethmar’s daughters have a duty to avenge their father, even if by killing their brother.

11 „Al þú þó dóttur“, (kvað Hreiðmarr,) „dís ulf-huguð,  
 2 ef þú getr=at son · við siklingi;  
 fá þú mey manni · í megin-þarfar,  
 4 þá mun þeirar sonr · þíns harms reka.“  
 “Beget yet a daughter”—quoth Rethmar—“a wolf-minded lady,  
 if thou gettest no son by the prince.  
 Out of great need wed that maiden to a man;  
 then *her* son will avenge thy harm!”

3 manni · í megin-þarfar | mann imeginþarfar R

3 fá þú mey manni · í megin-þarfar ‘Out of great need wed that maiden to a man’ | Out of the great need to avenge her father; *þarfar* being pl. of *þorþ* as used in the previous stanza.

ALL | Rethmar’s last words foretell the life of Siward who will come to avenge him by slaying Fathomer. Lingheath must thus marry Eanline and give birth to Hardise (the “wolf-minded lady”), Siward’s mother.

P5 Þá dó Hreið·marr, en Fáfnir tók gull’it allt. Þá beiddisk Reginn  
 2 at hafa fǫður-arf sinn, en Fáfnir galt þar nei við. Þá leitaði  
 Reginn ráða við Lyng·heiði, systur sína, hvernig hann skyldi  
 4 heimta fǫður-arf sinn. Hón kvað:

Then Rethmar died, but Fathomer took all the gold. Then Rein begged to have his father’s inheritance, but Fathomer gave back a no. Then Rein sought counsel from Lingheath, his sister, over how he should take his father’s inheritance. Quoth she:

12 „Brúðar kvęðja · skalt blíð=liga  
 2 arfs ok óðra hugar;  
 es=a þat hóft · at þú hjörvi skylir  
 4 kvęðja Fáfni fęar!“

“From the bride shalt thou kindly ask  
 for heritance and nobler thoughts;  
 it is not fitting that thou by the sword  
 shouldst ask for Fathomer’s wealth!”

1 Brúðar 'From the bride' | "From me." It seems that Lingheath here offers Rein her part of the inheritance.

- P6 Þessa hluti sagði Reginn Sig-urði. Einn dag, er hann kom til  
2 húsa Regins, var hánunum vel fagnat. Reginn kvað:

These things Rein told Siward. One day when he came to Rein's house he was greeted heartily. Quoth Rein:

---

ALL | The passage P6–26 is copied almost word-for-word in *Norn* 5–6, narrated by the eponymous Norn-Guest who claims to have accompanied Siward in this part of his adventure. Due to the striking similarity in both verse and prose indicating a close textual relationship the mss. of *Norn* are here treated as attesting the same base text as **R**.

- 13 „Kominn 's hingat · konr Sig-mundar,  
2 seggr inn snar-ráði, · til sala várra;  
móð hefir meira · an maðr gamall,  
4 ok es mér fangs vön · at frekum ulfi.

“Hither is come the son of Syemund [= Siward],  
the youth of quick counsel to our halls!  
He has greater heart than the old man,  
and I expect a catch from the hungry wolf.

---

3 maðr gamall 'the old man' | Rein himself, who now plans to use Siward to do what he dares not: take Fathomer's wealth.

- 14 Ek mun fœða · folk-djarfan gram;  
2 nú 's yngva konr · með oss kominn;  
sjá mun rêsir · ríkstr und sólu,  
4 þrymr um ǫll lönd · ǫr-ǫg-símu.“

I will raise the troop-bold prince;  
now the son of a king is come in our midst!  
This one will become a ruler mightiest under the sun;  
he fastens through all lands his orlay-strands!”

---

4 þrymr ... ǫr-ǫg-símu 'he fastens ... orlay-strands' | His fate is being fixed through all lands. Cf. the first four sts. of *1 HHund*.

- P7 Sig-urðr var þá jafnan með Regin ok sagði hann Sig-urði at Fáfnir  
2 lá á Gnita-heiði ok var í orms líki. Hann átti ógis-hjalm er ǫll  
kvikvendi hréddu=sk við. Reginn gerði Sig-urði sverð er Gramr  
4 hét. Þat var svá hvasst at hann brá því ofan í Rín ok lét reka ullar-



- 6 lagð fyrir straumi ok tók í sundr lagð'inn sem vatnit. Því sverði  
 klauf Sig-urðr í sundr steðja Régins. Eptir þat eggjaði Reginn  
 Sig-urð at vega Fáfni. Hann sagði:

Thereafter Siward was always with Rein, and he told Siward that Fathomer lay on the Gnit-heath and was in a Wyrn's likeness; he owned the helm of awe by which all living things were frightened. Rein made Siward the sword called Gram; it was so sharp that he held it upside down in the Rhine and let a lock of wool float down the stream; and it cut the lock even as it did the water. With that sword Siward struck asunder Rein's anvil; after that Rein urged Siward to slay Fathomer. He said:

- 15 „Hótt munu hléja · Hundings synir  
 2 þeir's Ey·lima · aldrs synjuðu,  
 ef mēirr tiggja · munar at sókja  
 4 hringa rauða · an hefnd fōður.“

“Loudly laugh will Hunding's sons  
 —they who denied Eanlme old age—  
 if the chief is more eager to seek  
 red rings than revenge for his father.”

- P8 Hjálp-rekr konungr fekk Sig-urði skipa-lið til fōður-hefnda. Þeir  
 2 fengu storm mikinn ok beittu fyr bergs-nōs nakkvara. Maðr  
 einn stóð á berg'inu ok kvað:

King Helpric got Siward a ship-retinue to revenge his father. They caught a great storm, and tacked their ships below a set of crags. A lone man stood on the crag and quoth:

- 16 „Hverir ríða þar · Réfils hęstum  
 2 hóvar unnir, · haf glymjanda?  
 Segl-vigg eru · svęita stokkin,  
 4 mun=at vág-marar · vind of standask.“

“Which men there ride Revil's horses [SHIPS]  
 on the high waves, on the roaring sea?  
 The sail-steeds [SHIPS] are spattered with sweat;  
 the wave-chargers [SHIPS] will not bear the wind!”

- 17 „Hér eru vér Sig-vorðr · á sé-tréum;  
 2 es oss byrr gefinn · við bana sjalfan;  
 fellr brattr breki · brōndum héri,

4 hlunn-vigg hrapa— · hværr spyr at því?“

“Here are we, Siward [and his men], upon sea-trees [SHIPS];  
we are given a gust towards our very deaths!  
The steep breaker falls higher than flames;  
the launcher-steeds [SHIPS] rush forth—who asks of this?”

1 Sig-vörðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R 1 sć-tréum | *metr. emend.*;  
sć-trjám R

18 „Hnikar hétu mik · þá's Hugin gladdi

[R 29v/32–30r/1, N]

2 Völsungr ungi · ok vegit hafði;

nú mátt-u kalla · karl af bergi,

4 Fæng eða Fjølmi; · far vil'k þiggja.“

“Nicker they called me when young Walsing  
gladdened Highen and had triumphed.  
Now mayst thou call me churl-from-the-crag,  
Feng or Fillner—I wish to beg passage.”

1 þá's | *add.* ek T' N 3 bergi | bjargi N

1 Hugin gladdi 'gladdened Highen' | That is, when he had “fed the raven”, i.e., by the corpses of slain foes on the battlefield.

2 Völsungr ungi 'young Walsing' | Siward's grandfather, the founder of the Walsing dynasty.

P9 Þeir viku at landi, ok gekk karl á skip, ok léggði þá veðrit.

They turned to land and the man went on the ship, and then the weather calmed down.

19 „Seg mér þat, Hnikarr, · alls hvár-tveggja vžitst,

2 goða heill ok guma:

hver bōzt eru · ef bēja=sk skal,

4 heill at sverða svipun?“

“Tell me this, Nicker, as thou knowest both  
the omens of gods and men:  
Which are the best—if one shall fight—  
omens for the swinging of swords?”

Hnikarr kvað: 20 „Morg eru góð · ef gumar vissi,

2 heill at sverða svipun;

dyggja fylgju · hygg ins dökkva vesa

4 at hrotta-meði hrafns.

“There are many good—if men would know them—  
omens for the swinging of swords.  
A good followeress I think the dark one is  
for the sword-tree of the raven [WARRIOR].”

21 Þat es annat · ef est út of kominn  
2 ok est á braut búinn:  
tvá þú lítr · á tái standa  
4 hróðr-fúsa hali.

This is another one: if thou art come outside  
and art ready on the road:  
thou wilt behold two standing on their toes  
glory-eager heroes.

22 Þat 's it þriðja · ef þjóta heyrir  
2 ulf und ask-limum,  
heilla auðit · verðr þér af hjalm-stofum  
4 ef sér þá fyrri fara.

This is the third: if thou hearest howling  
a wolf beneath ashen branches  
TODO.  
TODO.

23 Øngr skal gumna · í gogn vega  
2 síð skínandi · systur Mána;  
þeir sigr hafa · es séa kunnu,  
4 hjör-letiks hvatir, · eða hamalt fylkja.

No man shall fight in evening  
facing the shining sister of the Moon [SUN].  
Those men brisk in sword-play [BATTLE] have the triumph  
who can see—or draw up the flying wedge.

4 hamalt fylkja ‘draw up the flying wedge’ | This formation, known in ON as the *svín-fylking* ‘swine-array’, was favoured by the Germanic peoples. It is mentioned already in Tacitus, *Germania* ch. 6: *acies per cuneos componitur* ‘their troops are drawn up in a wedge-like formation’. In the legendary saws the swine-array has a particular association with Weden. According to *Fornk* he taught it to the Danish king Harold Hildtooth, who went on to win great victories with the formation until Weden betrayed him and taught it to the Swedish king Siward Ring, who defeated and slew Harold at the battle of the Browolds (*Brávöllir*). So *Fornk* 8: *Brúni segir*: „*Svá lít-sk mér sem Hringr muni búinn at berja-sk ok hans lið. Hann befir undar-liga fylkt. Hann befir svín-fylkt her sinum, ok mun eigi gott at berja-sk við hann.*“ *Pá segir Haraldr konungr*: „*Hverr mun Hringi bafa kennt hamalt at fylkja? Ek hugða engan kunna nema mik ok Óðin, eða mun Óðinn vilja skippla-sk í sigr-gjöf’inni við mik?* [...]“ ‘Brown says: “It seems to me that Ring is ready to fight, and his troop too. He has drawn them up in a strange way; he has drawn up his host in the swine-array, and it will not be good to fight against him. Then says king Harold: “Who can have taught Ring to draw up the flying wedge? I thought no one knew it save for me and Weden, or does Weden wish to take back his gift of victory from me? [...]”’

- 24 Þat ’s fār mikit · ef fōti drepr  
 2 þar’s þú at vígi vęðr;  
 talar dísir · standa þér á tvęr hliðar  
 4 ok vilja þik sáran séa.

It is a great peril if thou stumblest thy foot  
 where thou wadest forth in war.  
 Treacherous dises stand on thy either side  
 and wish to see thee harmed.

- 25 Kęmbðr ok þvęinn · skal kónna hvęrr  
 2 ok at morni męttr,  
 því’t ó-sýnt es · hvar at aptni kęmr;  
 4 illt ’s fyr hęill at hrapa.

Combed and washed shall each keen man be,  
 and by morning fed,  
 for it is unseen where by evening he comes—  
 it is ill to rush ahead of the omens!

---

ALL | The wording of the first half of this stanza is very close to *Háv* 61 and *Vsp* 33; for personal hygiene and bathing in the culture see note to the former.

## Capitulum (‘New Chapter’)

- P10 Sig-urðr átti orrustu mikla við Lyngva Hundings son ok bróðr  
 2 hans. Þar fell Lyngvi ok þeir þrír bróðr. Eptir orrustu kvað  
 Reginn:

SIWARD HAD a great battle with Ling, Hunding's son, and his brothers. There fell Ling and the three brothers. After the battle quoth Rein:

ALL | *This passage is introduced by a bolded initial in R.*

26 Nú 's blóðugr ǫrn · bitrum hjǫrvi  
2 bana Sig-mundar · á baki ristinn;  
ǫngr es frēmri, · sá's fold ryði,  
4 hilmis arfi · ok Hugin gladdi!

Now the bloody eagle with a bitter sword  
is carved on the back of Syemund's bane.  
No chieftain's heir is more successful  
who has reddened the earth and gladdened Highen!

4 Hugin gladdi 'has gladdened Highten' | See above.

P11 Heim fór Sig-urðr til Hjálp-reks. Þá eggjaði Reginn Sig-urð  
2 til at vega Fáfnir. Sig-urðr ok Reginn fóru upp á Gnita-heiði  
ok hittu þar slóð Fáfnis þá er hann skreið til vats. Þar gørði  
4 Sig-urðr grøf mikla á vegi'num ok gekk Sig-urðr þar í. En er  
Fáfnir skreið af gulli'nu blés hann eitri ok hraut þat fyr ofan  
6 hǫfuð Sig-urði. En er Fáfnir skreið yfir grøf'ina þá lagði Sig-urðr  
hann með sverði til hjarta. Fáfnir hristi sik ok barði hǫfði ok  
8 sporði. Sig-urðr hljóp ór grøf'inni ok sá þá hvárr annan. Fáfnir  
kvað:

Siward journeyed home to Helpric. Then Rein incited Siward to fight Fathomer. Siward and Rein journeyed up on the Gnit-heath and found there Siward's trail as he was crawling to a body of water. There Siward made a great trench in the way and Siward went down into it. But when Fathomer crawled off from the gold he blew venom, and it flew over Siward's head. But when Fathomer crawled over the trench, then Siward ran him through with his sword unto the heart. Fathomer recoiled and struck his head and spurned. Siward leapt out of the trench, and then each of them saw the other. Quoth Fathomer:



# Speeches of Fathomer

## (*Fáfnis mól*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.442)–early C11th (0.402)

**Meter:** Leeds-meter, Ancient-words-law (TODO)

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Fathomer** (abbrev. *Fáfn*) is only preserved in **R**, where it has the title *Frá dauða Fáfnis* ‘From the death of Fathomer’. It forms a continuous text with the preceding *Reg* and the following *Sigrdr* and should not be analyzed in isolation.

The poetry of *Fáfn* is closely paraphrased by *Vǫls* 18–19, and it is clear that the now-lost source underlying that text was near-identical to **R**.

Siward’s slaying of the wyrm Fathomer was an exceptionally famous story in the Wiking Age and Scandinavian Middle Ages. Outside of *Reg–Fáfn* and *Vǫls* the narrative is referenced in Scaldic poetry (TODO) and depicted pictorially on numerous objects. The most important of these is the Swedish runic inscription Sö 101 (ca. 1030 AD) from Ramsund, Södermanland. The carving consists of a long serpent or wyrm inscribed with a generic memorial inscription. At the bottom right a figure thrusts a sword through the wyrm’s body and in the space enclosed by it several important events following Siward’s slaying of Fathomer are depicted with remarkably close correspondence to the version preserved in the Norse-Icelandic sources; see Fig. 9.

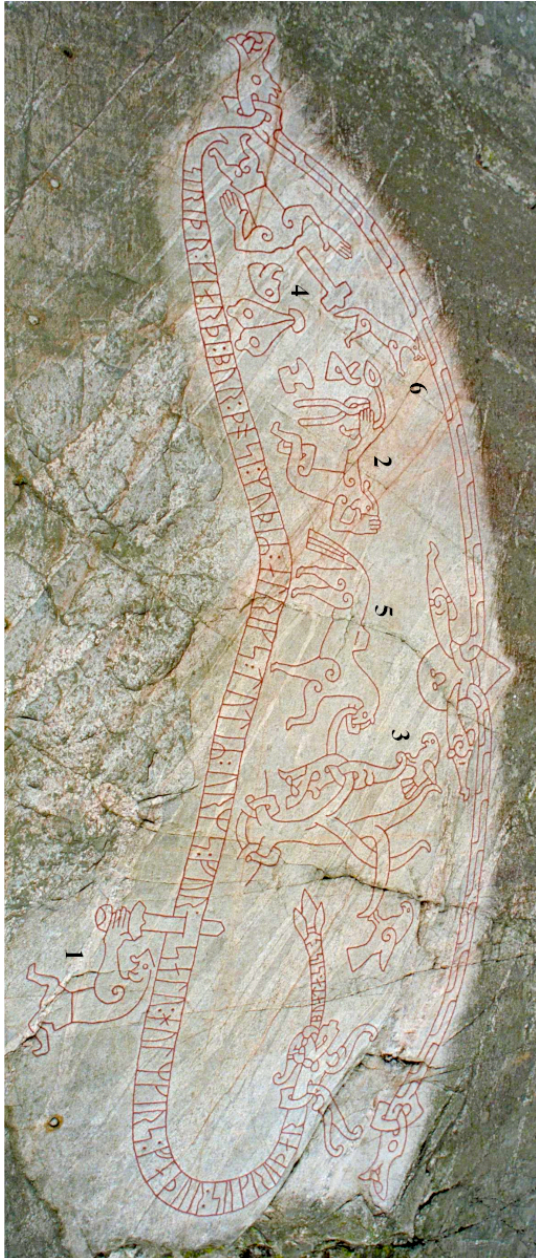


Figure 9: The Ramsund carving. Viking Age, ca. 1030 AD. Details depicted: 1. Siward slays Farhomer. 2. Siward roasts Farhomer's heart by a fire; he burns his finger and puts it in his mouth to cool it, inadvertently tasting the blood. 3. Two birds sit in the tree, presumably talking to Siward. 4. Rein lies decapitated surrounded by his bellows, tongs, and anvil. 5. Grane stands loaded with a chest on his back. 6. A wolf or dog; the only detail not found in Reg-Faþn. © Bengt A. Lundgren/RAA. CC BY 4.0. <https://pub.raa.se/visa/dokumentation/7dd6614e-950b-42bf-b31f-4f910c74e936>



## Text

## Frá dauða Fáfnis ('From Fathomer's death')

- 1 „Sveinn ok sveinn! · Hverjum est sveini of borinn?  
 2 Hverra est manna mögr?  
 es þú á Fáfni rautt · þínn inn frána mēki;  
 4 stöndumk til hjarta hjörr!“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “O SWAIN and swain! To which swain art thou born;  
 of which men art thou the son?  
 When thou on Fathomer hast reddened this thy gleaming blade;  
 the sword stands unto my heart!”

- P1 Sig·urðr dulði nafns síns fyr því at þat var trúa þeira í forneskju  
 2 at orð feigs manns mētti mikit ef hann þolvaði ó·vin sínum með  
 nafni. Hann kvað:

Siward belied his name, for it was their belief in olden times that a fey man's  
 word could do much if he cursed his foe by name. Quoth he:

---

1 þat var trúa þeira í forneskju 'it was their belief in olden times' | For another instance of beliefs  
 in *forneskju* 'olden times, antiquity', see 2 *HHund* P18.

- 2 „Göfugt dýr ek heiti · en ek gengit hef'k  
 inn móður-lausi mögr,  
 föður ek á'kk=a · sem fira synir,  
 4 geng ek einn saman.“

“Noble Hart am I called, but I have gone  
 as the motherless lad.

A father I have not like the sons of men;  
 I go alone.”

---

1 Göfugt dýr 'Noble Hart' | Or 'Noble Stag'. The hero Siward appears to have a particular associ-  
 ation with the stag, something also found in 2 *Guðr* 2. The association between hero and stag in  
 Germanic culture has old roots, as does the depiction of the stag locked in battle with the serpent,  
 a motif found, e.g., on the Urnes stave church (figure 10, p. 512). See further Krause (2021).

- 3 „Veitst, ef föður né átt=at · sem fira synir,  
 2 af hverju vastu undri alinn?“  
 [...]

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Knowest thou, if thou hast no father like the sons of men,  
 by which wonder thou wast begotten?”



Figure 10: Detail of a struggling stag and serpent on the Urnes Stave Church, a common motif of the Urnes style. High Mediæval, ca. 1140 AD. © Micha L. Rieser. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Stave\\_church\\_Urnes,\\_craving\\_detail\\_1.jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Stave_church_Urnes,_craving_detail_1.jpg)

3 [...] | Two lines appear to be missing here, but they may have survived in the version of the poem underlying *Vǫls*. *Vǫls* 18 paraphrases: *Ef þú átt engan föður né móður, af hverju undri ertu þá alinn? Ok þótt þú segir mér eigi þitt nafn á bana-dögri mínu, þá veiztu, at þú lýgr nú.* ‘If thou hast no father or mother, by which wonder art thou begotten? And although thou wilt not tell me thy name in my hour of death, thou knowest that thou art lying.’ It is apparently this now-missing appeal to Siward’s conscience—it would be dishonourable for him to lie to the dying Fathomer—that makes the young hero reveal his true name.

- 4 „Étterni mitt · kveð’k þér ð-kunnigt vesa  
2 ok mik sjalfan hit sama:  
Sig-urðr ek hēiti · Sig-mundr hét minn faðir  
4 es hef’k þik vǫpnum vegit.“

[Quoth Siward:] “My lineage, I say, is unknown to thee,  
and my self the same.<sup>1</sup>  
Siward I am called—Syemund was called my father—  
who with weapons have smitten thee.”

<sup>1</sup>The sense is that Fathomer would not recognize Siward’s lineage (i.e., his father) or name, since he is an orphan who up until this point has not accomplished much. He is not saying that he is lineage is unknown even to himself, since *sjalfan mik* ‘my self’ is accusative, not dative.

- 5 „Hvęrr þik hvatti, · hví hvętja=sk lést,  
2 mínu fjǫrvi at fara?  
Inn frán-eygi sveinn, · þú áttir fǫður bitran,  
4 á-bornu skjór á skęið.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Who goaded thee; why didst thou let thee be goaded  
my life for to destroy?  
O gleaming-eyed swain, thou hadst a sharp father;  
inborn traits show quickly.”

4 á-bornu skjór á skęið. ‘inborn traits show quickly’ | The original is cryptic. *á skęið* means roughly ‘rapidly, quickly’, whence the expression *ríða á skęið* ‘CV: to ride at full speed’, but the other words are uncertain. La Farge and Tucker (1992) read ‘your innate qualities show quickly’, suggesting two unattested words: an adjective *\*áborinn* ‘innate, inborn’ and a verb *\*skjóa* ‘to show’. Yet the lack of i-umlaut in the supposed 3rd sg. pres. ind. *skjór* is difficult, since we would expect *\*\*skýr*, as in *skjóta* ‘to shoot’, with 2nd/3rd sg. pres. ind. *skýtr*. A solution would be emending to a 2nd sg. pres. subj. *skjóir*, but this has not been undertaken.

- 6 „Hugr mik hvatti, · hęndr mér full-týðu  
2 ok minn inn hvassi hjęrr;  
fár es hvatr · es hrøða=sk tękr  
4 ef i barn-ðsku es blauðr.“

[Quoth Siward:] “My heart goaded me; my hands availed me  
and this my sharp sword.

Few a man is bold when he takes to grow,  
if in childhood he be soft.”

- 7 „Væt’k, ef þú vaxa néðir · fyr þinna vina brjósti,  
2 séi maðr þik vręiðan vega;  
nú est haptr · ok hęr-numinn,  
4 ę kveða bandingja bifask.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “I know that if thou hadst grown up upon thy kinsmen’s breast  
man would see thee wrathfully fight;  
now art thou a captive and war-taken;  
they say the boundling always trembles.”

---

2 vręiðan vega ‘wrathfully fight’ | Formulaic word-pair.

- 8 „Því bregðr þú nú mér, Fáfmir, · at til fjarri sjá’k  
2 mínum fęðr-munum,  
ęgi em’k haptr · þó’tt vęra hęr-numi;  
4 þú fannt, at ek lauss lifi!“

[Quoth Siward:] “For that dost thou now upbraid me, Fathomer, that I be too far  
from the love of my fathers.  
I am nowise a captive, although I be war-taken;  
thou hast found that I live loose!”

- 9 „Heipt-yrði ęin · tęlr þú þér í hví-vętna  
2 en ek þér satt ęitt sęgi’k:  
It gjalla goll · ok it glóð-rauða fé,  
4 þér verða þęir baugar at bana!“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “With hateful words alone dost thou answer anything,  
but I tell thee truth alone:  
The clanging gold and the glowing red wealth—  
those highs will be thy bane!”

- 10 „Féi ráða · skal fyrða hvęrr  
2 ę til ins ęina dags  
því’t ęinu sinni · skal alda hvęrr  
4 fara til hęljar heðan.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Rule his wealth shall every man,  
always, until the one day;  
for at one time shall every man  
journey hence to Hell.”

ALL | Siward dismisses the curse. He is a man, and therefore mortal; he must die regardless of whether he takes the gold or not, and it is better to die wealthy and renowned than wretched and unknown.

2 ins çina dags ‘the one day’ | His predetermined day of death.

11 „Norna dóm · munt fyr neşjum hafa

2 ok ósvinns apa;

ĩ vatni þú drukknar · ef ĩ vindi rēr;

4 allt es feįgs forað.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “The judgment of the Norns shalt thou have before the headlands,  
and that of an unwise ape.  
Thou wilt drown in water if thou rowest in wind;  
everything is the pit of the fey.”

ALL | Fathomer points out the danger of the curse: insidious death will find Siward in an unforeseen circumstance, and his fated death will be imminent. — *Vǫls* 18 paraphrases: *Fátt vill þú at minum dómum gera, en drukknar muntu, ef þú ferr um sjá ó-varliga, ok bið heldr á landi, und’s logner*. ‘Thou hast little wish to act according to my examples, but thou wilt drown if thou goest to journey carelessly at sea, so do rather abide on land until it is calm.’ It is notable that the redactor of *Vǫls* misunderstood the import of the stanza when he took it to be a warning specifically against sailing on the windy sea, which, of course, is only one example of the many potential ways in which Siward might die.

1 Norna dóm ‘The judgment of the Norns’ | The time when the Norns decree that one should die, one’s predestined hour of death (cf. *Ski* 13/3, *Grip* 25/4). The expression is synonymous with *kviðr norna* ‘verdict of the Norns’, *Hamð* 30/4; cf. also *Vsp* 19/5–6.

1 fyr neşjum ‘before the headlands’ | I.e. ‘close at hand, imminent’. An established metaphor for imminent death, cf. *Sont* 25, where Eyel concludes his poem by declaring that Hell (the goddess of Death) *á neşjum stęndr* ‘stands upon the headlands’.

12 „Sęg mér, Fáfnir, · alls þik fróðan kveða

2 ok vęl mart vita:

Hverjar ’ro þér nornir · es nauð-gonglar ’ro

4 ok kjósa móðr frá mǫgum?“

[Quoth Siward:] “Tell me, Fathomer, as they call thee wise  
and knowing well enough:  
Who are the Norns which attend in need  
and choose mothers from their lads?”

ALL | Sts. 12–15 consist of two general mythological questions in a style most closely resembling *Vafþ*. These questions do not at all contribute to the narrative and it is not impossible that yet more of them have been removed for that reason; cf. note to st. 16.

3 es nauð-gonglar ’ro ‘attend in need’ | Lit. ‘are attendant in need’; they help ailing mothers during childbirth. Cf. *Sigrdr* 9.

13 „Sundr-bornar mjök · hygg at nornir sé,

[S 5r/11, T TODO,  
W TODO, U TODO]

- 2            **ei**gu-t þér **ét**t saman;  
           sumar 'ro **ós**-kunngar, · sumar **alf**-kunngar,  
 4            sumar **dótr** **D**valins.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Of most sundry birth I judge the norms to be;  
 they have not a lineage in common.  
 Some are Os-born, some Elf-born,  
 some the daughters of Dwollen [DWARFESSES].”

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ALL | This stanza is cited in *Gylf* 15:32. TODO.

- 14        „Seg mér þat, **F**áfnir, · alls þik **fróðan** kveða  
 2            ok **v**el margt **v**ita,  
           hvé sá **holmr** heitir · es blanda **h**jör-**l**egi  
 4            **S**urtr ok **ésir** **s**aman.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Tell me this, Fathomer, as they call thee wise  
 and knowing well enough:  
 What is the islet called, where Surt and the Eese  
 blend sword-water [BLOOD] together?”

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3–4 hvé ... saman. ‘What ... together?’ | Namely at the Rakes of the Reins. For the fight between Surt and the Gods see *Vsp* 48–53, *Vaffþ* 17–18.

- 15        „**Ö**-skópnir heitir · en þar **ö**ll skulu  
 2            **g**eirum **l**eika **g**oð;  
           **B**il-røst **b**rotnar · es á **b**rott fara  
 4            ok svima í **móðu** **m**arir.

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Unshopner it is called, and there shall all  
 the Gods play with spears [MAKE WAR];  
 Bilrest shatters when they ride on their way  
 and the steeds swim in the sea.

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1 Ö-skópnir ‘Unshopner’ | An otherwise unattested name.

3–4 Bil-røst ... marir. ‘Bilrest ... the sea.’ | Bilrest is an alternative name for Bivrest, the Rainbow Bridge. — These lines are explained by a passage of Snorre, *Gylf* 13:6: *Ok svá sem bön er sterk, þá mun bön brotna þá er Mu-spells megir fara ok riða bana, ok svima bestar þeira yfir stórar ár. Svá koma þeir fram.* ‘And strong as it [Bivrest] is, yet it will shatter when the lads of Muspell fare and ride over it, and then their horses swim through great rivers. So they make it forwards.’

- 16        „**Ö**gis hjalm · bar’k of **a**lda sonum  
 2            **m**éðan of **m**enjum **l**á’k;  
           **ei**nn rammari · hugðumk **ö**llum vesa,  
 4            fann’k=a’k **m**arga **m**ögu.

The helmet of awe I carried over the sons of men  
 while on the neckrings I lay;  
 stronger than all I thought me alone to be;  
 I did not find many lads.”

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ALL | Fathomer continues speaking, but there is probably something missing here since the transition away from the mythological questions is abrupt. It seems not unlikely that there were originally other mythological questions here but that they have been cut away for their perceived lack of relevance to the narrative. Between its paraphrases of st. 15 and of st. 16, *Vǫls* has *Ok enn mēlti Fáfnir: „Reginn bróðir minn veldr mínum dauða, ok þat blégir mik, er bann veldr ok þinum dauða, ok ferr þá, sem hann vildi.“* ‘And further Fathomer spoke: “My brother Rein is the cause of my death and it gladdens me that he will also cause thy death, and then it will go as he has willed.”’, which may perhaps be a paraphrase of a lost st.

- 17 „Ógis hjalmr · bergr **ç**inu=gi  
 2 hvar’s skulu **v**reððir vega;  
 þa þat **f**innr · es með **f**leirum kómr  
 4 at **ç**ngi es **ç**inna hvatastr.“

[Quoth Siward:] “The helmet of awe rescues no man  
 wherever wroth men shall fight;  
 this he then finds when among the many he comes—  
 that none is the boldest of all.”

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3–4 þa þat finnr · es með fleirum kómr / at çngi es çinna hvatastr ‘this he then finds when among the many he comes— / that none is the boldest of all’ | Near-identical to *Háv* 64/3–4; see there.

- 18 „Eitri ek fnósta · es á **a**rfi lá’k  
 2 miklum **m**íns fōður.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Venom I snorted while I lay on the great  
 inheritance of my father.”

- 19 „Inn rammi ormr, · þú gōrðir frēs mikla  
 2 ok gatst **h**arðan **h**ug;  
**h**çipt at mçiri · verðr **h**olða sonum  
 4 at þann **h**jalm **h**afi.“

[Quoth Siward:] “O mighty wyrm, thou madest a great snort,  
 and didst get a hard heart.  
 Greater hatred arises for the sons of men  
 who might have that helm.”

- 20 „R<sup>é</sup>ð’k þér nú, Sig-urðr, · en þú **r**áð nemir  
 2 ok rið **h**eim **h**eðan;

it gjalla goll · ok it glóð-rauða fé,  
 þér verða þeir bagnar at bana!“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “I counsel thee now, Siward—and thou oughtst to take the counsel,  
 and ride home hence:  
 The clanging gold and the glowing red wealth—  
 those bighs will be thy bane!”

21 „Ráð ’s þér ráðit · en ek riða mun  
 til þess golls es í lyngvi liggr,  
 en þú, Fáfni, · ligg í fjör-brotum  
 þar’s þik Hæl hafi!“

[Quoth Siward:] “Thy counsel has been counseled, but I will ride  
 to the gold which in the heather lies,  
 but thou, Fathomer, lie in the lifeblood tracks,  
 where Hell may have thee!”

4 þar’s þik Hæl hafi ‘where Hell may have thee’ | Formulaic. TODO.

22 „Reginn mik réð, · hann þik ráða mun,  
 hann mun okkr verða bǫðum at bana;  
 fjör sitt láta · hygg at Fáfni myni;  
 þitt varð nú meira megin.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Rein betrayed me; he will betray thee;  
 he will become the bane of us both!  
 Give up his life I think that Fathomer will—  
 thy strength was now the greater.”

P2 Reginn var á brott horfinn meðan Sig-urðr vaf Fáfni ok kom þá  
 apr er Sig-urðr strauk blóð af sverði’nu. Reginn kvað:

Rein had disappeared while Siward fought Fathomer, and then came back as  
 Siward wiped the blood off the sword. Quoth Rein:

23 „Hæill þú nú, Sig-urðr, · nú hefir sigr vegit  
 ok Fáfni of farit;  
 manna þeira · es mold troða  
 þik kveð’k ó-blauðastan alinn.“

“Hail thee now, Siward—now hast thou won victory  
 and Fathomer destroyed!  
 Of those men who tread on the earth  
 I declare thee unsoftest begotten.”



- 24 „Þat 's ó·víst at vita · þá's komum allir saman,  
 2 sig-tíva synir,  
 hvęrr ó·blauðastr es alinn;  
 4 margr es sá hvatr · es hjǫr né rýðr  
 annars brjóstum ǵ.“

[Quoth Siward:] “It is unsure to know, when we all come together,  
 sons of the victory-Tews [MEN],  
 who is unsoftest begotten.  
 Many a man is bold who reddens no sword  
 in another's chest.”

- 25 „Glaðr est nú, Sig-urðr, · ok gagni fęginn  
 2 es þú þęrrir Gram á grasi;  
 bróður minn · hęfir þú bęnjaðan  
 4 ok vęld ek þó sjalfr sumu.“

[Quoth Rein:] “Glad art thou now, Siward, and rejoicing in gain  
 when thou driest Gram on the grass.  
 My own brother hast thou deathly wounded,  
 and yet I myself bear some fault.”

- 26 „Þú því rétt · es ek ríða skyldak  
 2 heilǫg fjǫll hinig;  
 fęi ok fjǫrvi · réði sá inn fráni ormr  
 4 nema þú frýðir mér hvats hugar.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Thou didst counsel that I should ride  
 o'er the holy fells hither.  
 Wealth and life would the gleaming Wyrn rule  
 if thou hadst not braved my bold heart.”

- P3 Þá gekk Reginn at Fáfnis ok skar hjarta ór hánum með sverði er  
 2 Ríðill heitir ok þá drakk hann blóð ór undinni eptir.

Then Siward walked up to Fathomer and cut the heart out of him with the  
 sword called Riddle, and then he drank blood from the wound afterwards.

- 27 „Sit-tu nú, Sig-urðr, · en ek mun sofa ganga  
 2 ok halt Fáfnis hjarta við funa!  
 Eiskǫld ek vil · etin láta  
 4 eptir þęnna dreýra drykk.“

[Quoth Rein:] “Sit thou now, Siward—but I will go sleep—

and hold Fathomer's heart by the fire!  
The heart-strings I wish to eat  
after this drink of blood."

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3 *Þískpöld* 'heart-strings' | An obscure poetic synonym for heart in the neuter plural. The translation "heart-strings" is guesswork.

- 28 „Fjarri þú gekkt · meðan ek á Fáfni rauð'k  
2 mínn inn hvassa hjör;  
afli mínu · átta'k við orms megin  
4 meðan þú í lyngvi látt.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Far didst thou go while I on Fathomer reddened  
this my sharp sword.  
My strength I held against the might of the Wyrn,  
while thou in the heather layst.”

- 29 „Lengi liggja · létir þú þann lyngvi í,  
2 inn aldna jötun,  
ef þú sverðs né nytir, · þess es ek sjalfr gørða,  
4 ok þíns ins hvassa hjörs.“

[Quoth Rein:] “Long in the heather wouldst thou have let lie  
this ancient ettin [me],  
if thou hadst not used the blade which I myself made  
and this thy sharp sword.”

- 30 „Hugr es bættri · en sé hjörs megin  
2 hvar's vreiðir skulu vega,  
því at hvatan mann · ek sé harð=liga vega  
4 með slévu sverði sigr.

[Quoth Siward:] “Heart is better than might of sword may be  
wherever wroth men should fight,  
for a bold man I see furiously fighting  
with a sluggish sword to victory.

- 31 Hvötum 's bættra · an sé ó-hvötum  
2 í hildi-læk hafask  
glöðum 's bættra · an sé glúpanda  
4 hvat sem at hendi kómr.“

For the bold it is better than it may be for the unbold  
to hold themselves in battle-play [WAR];

for the glad it is better than it may be for the gloomy  
no matter what comes to their hands.”

1 Hvortum 's bætta · an séi ó-hvortum 'For the bold it is better than it may be for the unbold' | The line type “it is better for the X than it may be for the un-X” is apparently formulaic, also appearing in *Háv* 71/1 (with emendation).

- P4      Sig-urðr tók Fáfnis hjarta ok steikði á teini. Er hann hugði at  
2      full-steikt vëri ok freyddi sveit'inn ór hjarta'nu þá tók hann á  
fingri sínum ok skynjaði hvárt full-steikt vëri. Hann brann ok  
4      brá fingri'num í munn sér. En er hjart-blóð Fáfnis kom á tungu  
hánnum ok skildi hann fugls rǫdd. Hann heyrði at igður klǫkuðu  
6      á hrísi'num. Igða'n kvæð:

SIWARD TOOK Fathomer's heart and roasted it on a stick. When he thought that it was fully roasted and the blood frothed out of the heart then he touched it with his finger to see whether it was fully roasted. He burned himself and jerked his finger in his mouth. But when the heart's blood of Fathomer came upon his tongue and he understood the speech of birds—he heard that tits were chirping in the brushes. Quoth the tit:

1 Sig-urðr 'Siward' | *The S is a bold capital in R.*

- 32      „Þar sitr Sig-vǫrðr · sveita stokkinn,  
2      Fáfnis hjarta · við funa stækir;  
spakr þótti mér · spillir bauga  
4      ef hann fjǫr-sega · fránan éti.“

“There sits Siward spattered with blood;  
Fathomer's heart by the fire he roasts.  
Wise would I think the spiller of rings  
if he the gleaming life-muscle ate.”

1 Sig-vǫrðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R*

ALL | Sts. 32–33 are cited in *Skn* 47.

- Qnnur: 33      „Þar liggr Reginn, · réðr umb við sik,  
2      vill tēla mǫg · þann's trúir hǫnum;  
berr af reiði · rǫng orð saman,  
4      vill bǫlva smiðr · bróður hefna.“

The other one:

“There lies Rein, takes counsel with himself,  
wants to betray the lad who trusts in him.

Out of wrath he carries twisted words together;  
the smith of bales wants to avenge his brother.”

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1 · | *add. kvað önnur 'quoth the other one' Skm*

Þriðja: 34 „Hǫfði skemmra · láti hann inn hára þul  
2 fara til heilar heðan!  
Öllu golli · þá kná hann einn ráða,  
4 fjöld, því's und Fáfni lá.“

The third one:

“A head shorter ought he to let the hoary thyle  
journey hence to Hell!  
All the gold he can then rule alone:  
the trove which 'neath Fathomer lay.”

Fjórtða: 35 „Horskr þótti mér · ef hafa kynni  
2 öst-ráð mikit · yðvar systra;  
hygði umb sik · ok Hugin glæddi;  
4 þar's mér ulfs vön · es eyru sé'k.“

The fourth one: “Sharp would he seem to me if he could take  
the great loving counsel from you, my sisters;  
he would think for himself and gladden Highen—  
I expect a wolf where I see an ear!”

36 „Es=at svá horskr · hildi-meiðr  
2 sem ek hers jaðar · hyggja mynda'k  
ef hann bróður léttr · á brott komask  
4 en hann öðrum hefr · aldrs of synjat.“

[Quoth Siward:] “The battle-tree [WARRIOR] is not as sharp  
as I would have thought the peak of the host [RULER]  
if he lets one brother get away  
and he has denied the other old age.”

37 „Mjök es ó·sviðr · ef hann enn sparir  
2 fjánda inn folk-skáa,  
þar's Reginn liggr · es hann ráðinn hefr;  
4 kann=at hann við s·líku at séa.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Very foolish is he if still he spares  
that fight-shy fiend,

where Rein lies who has planned against him,  
he cannot look out against such.”

- 38 „Hofði skemmra · láti hann þann inn hrím-kalda jotun  
2 ok af baugum búa;  
þá mund-u fæar · þess es Fáfñir réð  
4 ein-valdi vesa.“

[Quoth Siward:] “A head shorter ought he to make that rime-cold ettin,  
and take from him the bighs,  
then of the wealth which Fathomer ruled  
wilt thou be the lone ruler.”

- [Sig-urðr:] 39 „Verða-t svá rík skop · at Reginn skyli  
2 mitt ban-orð bera  
því at þeir báðir bróðr · skulu brá=liga  
4 fara til Hēljār heðan.“

[Quoth Siward:] “The Shapes will not be so powerful that Rein should  
bear my bane-word,  
for those brothers both shall hurriedly  
journey hence to Hell!”

- P5 Sig-urðr hjó hofuð af Regin ok þá át hann Fáfñis hjarta ok drakk  
2 blóð þeira beggja, Regins ok Fáfñis. Þá heyrði Sig-urðr hvað  
igður mēltu:

Siward struck the head off of Rein and then he ate Fathomer’s heart and  
drank the blood of them both, Rein’s and Fathomer’s. Then Siward heard  
what the tits spoke:

- 40 „Bitt þú, Sig-vørðr, · bauga rauða;  
2 es=a konung=ligt · kvíða mǫrgu.  
Mey veyt’k eina, · myklu fegrsta,  
4 golli góðða, · ef þú geta méttir.

“Bind, O Siward, the red bighs;  
it is not kinglike to tarry much.  
I know one maiden fairest of all,  
endowed with gold—if thou mightst get her!”

1 Sig-vørðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 41 „Liggja til Gjúka · grónar brautir,  
 2 framm vísa sköp · folk-líðöndum;  
 þar hefir dýrr konungr · dóttur alna,  
 4 þá munt, Sig-vörðr, · mundi kaupa.“

“Towards Yivick’s home lie green highways:  
 the Shapes show the way forth for wandering exiles.  
 There the wealthy king has reared a daughter;  
 her wilt thou, Siward, for a bride-fee buy.”

4 Sig-vörðr | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 42 „Salr ’s á hōu · Hindar-fjalli,  
 2 allr ’s hann útan · elli sveipinn;  
 þann hafa horskir · halir of gōrvan  
 4 ór òðökkum · ógnar ljóma.“

“A hall stands on the high Hindfell;  
 without it is all enwrapped in fire.  
 That one learned men have made  
 from an un-dark radiance of terror.”

- 43 „Væt’k á fjalli · folk-vitr sofa  
 2 ok lēikr yfir · lindar váði;  
 Yggr stakk þorni— · aðra fēlldi  
 4 hōr-Gefn hali · es hafa vildi.“

“I know on the fell a war-wight sleeps  
 and over her licks the linden’s harm [FIRE].  
 Ug stung her with a thorn; the flax-Yevn [LADY] slew  
 the other heroes who wished to have her.”

- 44 „Knátt, mōgr, séa · mey und hjalmi  
 2 þá’s frá vígi · Ving-skorni reið;  
 má=at Sigr-drífar · svefni bręðða,  
 4 skjöldunga niðr, · fyr sköpum norna.“

“Thou wilt, lad, see the maiden beneath a helmet,  
 her who from the fray on Wingshorne rode.  
 No man may break Syedrive’s sleep,  
 O heir of the Shieldings, against the Shapes of the Norns.”

- P6 Sig-urðr reið eptir slóð Fáfnis til bólis hans ok fann þat opit  
 2 ok hurðir af járne ok gétte; af járne vóru ok allir timbr-stokkar í

4 húsi'nu en grafit í jörð niðr. Þar fann Sig-urðr stór-mikit gull  
ok fylldi þar tvær kistur. Þar tók hann ógis-hjálrn ok gull-brynju  
6 ok sverð'it Hrotta ok marga dýr-gripi ok klyfjaði þar með Grana.  
En hestr'inn vildi eigi fram ganga fyrr en Sig-urðr steig á bak  
hönun.

Siward rode along Fathomer's trail to his dwelling and found it open and doors and rabbits of iron. Of iron were also all the timber trunks in the house, and dug down into the earth. There Siward found very much gold and he filled there two chests. Then he took the helmet of awe and a golden byrnie and the sword Rotte and many precious things and loaded Grane with them. But the horse did not want to go forth until Siward mounted his back.

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4 gull-brynju 'golden byrnie' | An obviously fictional object, the weight of which would be far too great to be practical. Golden byrnies do not otherwise commonly feature in the Norse heroic material; the only other attestation of the present compound in the Norse corpus is in *Sigsk* 47/3.





# Speeches of Syedrive (*Sigr·drífu mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.961)

Meter: Ancient-words-law(1, 5), Leeds-meter(2–4, 6–13/4, 18–22, 23/6–27), Galders-law (13/5–14, 16–17, 23/1–23/5), Speeches-meter (15)

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Syedrive** (*Sigrdr*) are found in **R**, where they directly continue the narrative told in *Reg* and *Fáfn*. In the manuscript there is no marker of any kind, not even an initial, separating the poem from *Fáfn*; the title is editorial.

## Stanzas in *Vǫls*

A number of stanzas are quoted in **N**, the main ms. of *Vǫls*. *Vǫls* ch. 21 begins with the following passage, which is clearly based chiefly on *Sigrdr* P3, but in the mention of the gods perhaps also sts. 3–4:

*Bryn·bldr segir, at tveir konungar þorðust. Hét annarr Hjalm·Gunn·arr; bann var gamall ok hinn mesti bermaðr, ok hafði Óðinn bonum sigr heitit. En annarr Agnarr eða Auða bróðir. „Ek féllða Hjalm·Gunn·arr í orrostu, en Óðinn stakk mik svefn·þorni í befn þess ok kvað mik aldri síðan skyldu sigr hafa ok kvað mik giptast skulu. En ek strengða þess beit þar í mót at giptast engum þeim, er bręðast kynni.“ Sig·urðr mælti: „Kenn oss ráð til stórra hluta.“ Hun svarar: „Þér munuð betr kunna, en með þökkum vil ek kenna yðr, ef þat er nokkut, er vér kunnum, þat er yðr mætti líka, í rúnum eða qðrum blutum, er liggja til hvers hlutar, ok drekkum bæði saman, ok gefi goðin okkr góðan dag, at þér verði nýt ok fregð at mínum vitrleik, ok þú munir eptir þat, er vit réðum.“ Bryn·bldr fyllði eitt ker ok fęrði Sig·urði ok mælti:*

‘Byrnhild tells that two kings fought each other. The one was called Helm·Guther; he was old and the greatest warrior, and Weden had promised him victory. But the other was called Eyner or Ead’s brother.

“I made Helm-Guther fall in battle, but Weden stung me with a sleeping-thorn as revenge for that, and said that I should never thenceforth have victory and said that I must marry. But I made the vow in response to marry no such one as could be frightened.” Siward spoke: “Teach us counsel about great things.” She answers: “Ye will know better, but with thanks will I teach you if there be anything which we know that may please you, of runes or other things of importance; and let us both drink together, and may the gods give us two a good day, that thou mayst have use and pleasure from my wisdom and that thou mayst afterwards recall that of which we two speak.” Byrnhild filled a vessel and brought it to Siward and spoke:’

After this the saw cites sts. 5–13 and 15–19 in uninterrupted sequence, and paraphrases sts. 20 ff. (TODO: edit these!) The order of stanzas in N is rather different from that of R. Both mss. have sts. 5–6 and 13–19 in the same order, but the order of sts. 7–12 in between is divergent. The following table illustrates the relationship:

|    | <i>pres. ed.</i>        | R       | N     |
|----|-------------------------|---------|-------|
| 5  | Bjór fóri’k þér         | 5       | 6     |
| 6  | Sig-rúnar skalt rísta   | 6       | 7     |
| 7  | Ql-rúnar skalt kunna    | 7       | 10    |
| 8  | Full skal signa         | 7*      | 11    |
| 9  | Bjarg-rúnar skalt kunna | 8       | 12    |
| 10 | Brim-rúnar skalt rísta  | 9       | 8     |
| 11 | Lim-rúnar skalt kunna   | 10      | 13    |
| 12 | Mál-rúnar skalt kunna   | 11      | 9     |
| 13 | Hug-rúnar skalt kunna   | 12a     | 14    |
| 14 | Á bjargi stóð           | 12b–13  | –     |
| 15 | Á skildi kvað ristnar   | 14–15/4 | 15–17 |
| 16 | Allar vöru af skafnar   | 15/5–16 | 18    |
| 17 | Þat eru bókrúnar        | 17      | 19    |
| 18 | Nú skalt kjósa          | 18      | 20    |
| 19 | Mun’k=a ek flója        | 19      | 21    |

## Contents

TODO.

## Text

P1 Sig·urðr reið upp á Hindar-fjall ok stefndi suðr til Frakk-lands.  
 2 Á fjalli'nu sá hann ljós mikit svá sem eldr brynni, ok ljómaði af  
 til himins. En er hann kom at þá stóð þar skjald-borg ok upp  
 4 ór merki. Sig·urðr gekk í skjald-borg'ina ok sá at þar lá maðr  
 ok svaf með ǫllum her-vápnum. Hann tók fyrst hjálm'inn af  
 6 hofði hánun; þá sá hann at þat var kona. Brynjan var fōst sem  
 hón vęri hold-gróin. Þá reist hann með Gram frá hofuð-smátt  
 8 brynju'na í gognum niðr ok svá út í gognum báðar ermar. Þá  
 tók hann brynju af henni en hón vaknaði ok setti-sk hón upp ok  
 10 sá Sig·urð ok męlti:

Siward rode up on the Hindfell and stayed, facing south toward Frankland.  
 On the fell he saw a light as great as if there burned a fire, and the rays from  
 it went up to heaven. But when he came near to it, there was a shield-wall  
 towering up out of the ground. Siward went inside the shield-wall and saw  
 that a man lay there, sleeping in full armour. He first took off the helmet  
 from the man's head; then he saw that it was a woman. The byrnie was as  
 tight as if it were grown out of her flesh. Then he took Gram and cut the  
 byrnie from the head-hole down and then out through both sleeves. Then he  
 took the byrnie off her, and she awakened and sat herself up and saw Siward  
 and spoke:

1 „Hvat bęit brynju? · Hví brá'k svefni?  
 2 Hvęrr fęlldi af mér · fǫlvar nauðir?“  
 Hann svaraði: „Sig·mundar burr, · slęit fyr skǫmmu  
 4 hrafns hrę-lundir · hjǫrr Sig·varðar.“

[R 31v/33]

“What bit the byrnie? How did I break my sleep?  
 Who loosened from me these death-pale chains?”  
 He answered: “Syemund's son [= Siward] has just torn off  
 the raven's corpse-trees [BYRNIE?] with Siward's sword.”

4 Sig·varðar | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðar R

4 hrafns hrę-lundir ‘the raven's corpse-trees [BYRNIE?]' | An unclear kenning. TODO.

[Sigrdrífa kvað:] 2 „Lęgi ek svaf, · lęgi ek sofnuð vas,  
 2 lǫng eru lýða lę;  
 Óðinn því vęldr · es ęigi máttak  
 4 bregða blund-stǫfum.“

[R 32r/2]

[Quoth Syedrive:] “Long I slept, long was I asleep,  
 long are the guiles of men.  
 It is Weden’s fault that I could not  
 break the staves of sleep.”

**P2** Sig-urðr settisk niðr ok spyrr hana nafns. Hón tók þá horn fullt  
 2 mjaðar ok gaf hönnum minnis-veig.

Siward set himself down, asking for her name. She then took a horn full of mead and gave him a draught of remembrance:

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2 minnis-veig ‘draught of remembrance’ | To drink someone’s *minni* ‘memory, remembrance’ seems originally to have referred specifically to the funerary toast, but here has clearly come to carry a broader sense, viz. to drink a toast to someone’s favour, whether man or god.

**3** Heill Dagr, · heilir Dags synir,  
 2 heil Nött ok nípt!  
 Ó-uræiðum augum · lítið okkr þinig  
 4 ok gefið sitjendum sigr!

[R 32r/6]

“Hail Day! Hail the sons of Day!  
 Hail Night and her kinswoman!  
 With unwrathful eyes look Ye towards us twain  
 and give the settlers [= us] victory.

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ALL | *Sigrdr* 3–4 represents the only surviving poetic prayer to the collective Gods in the whole Norse literature (for prayers to individual gods, esp. Thunder and Weden, cf. Lindow (1988), and in the pres. ed. *Cant* and N B380 under Galders). Both stanzas follow the same balanced outline: the first helming (ll. 1–2) invokes the relevant gods and the second (ll. 3–4) makes the request. The speaker is Syedrive, who is the one offering the horn.

1 Dags synir ‘the sons of Day’ | Their identity is uncertain, for Day does not have any known sons in the Norse mythology. Based on comparative mythology the most likely candidates are the heavenly Horse Twins, who are securely attested in the Vedic, Greek, and Baltic traditions. In the Vedic religion the two *asvinau* are the children of Father Heaven and follow the Dawn (Brereton and Jamison, 2020, pp. 81–84). In the Greek the two Διός-κουροι (lit. ‘Sons of Zeus’) are prominent horsemen, but their celestial role is less apparent. In the Latvian folksongs the *Dieva dēli* ‘Sons of Gods’ are still closely associated with the Heaven, although they are not always twins (Calin 1996, pp. 53–65), while the Lithuanian horse-twins (the *Asvieniai*) pull the Sun-chariot. Within the Germanic sphere, the Twins have often been associated with the Anglo-Saxon founding figures *Hengist* and *Horsa*, which however have no solar associations apart from their coming from the east; there are also the two stallions Yorewaker and Allswith which pull the Sun (*Grm* 38, *Sigrdr* 15a/2), but they do not have any anthropomorphic riders. An archeological connection may be made with a pair of cult figures from Grevensvænge, Denmark, dated to periods 4–5 (1100–700 BC) of the Nordic Bronze Age (Thrane 2010). The two bronze figures, both wearing horned helmets, are depicted as sitting on their knees beside each other with their backs straight, facing forwards. They mirror each other, so that their inner elbows touch, placing the inner hand on the belly, while the outer arm raises a large axe. The two were originally connected at their knees by a bronze support, and belonged to a larger ensemble which was probably originally placed upon a cultic solar boat (Glob 1961), in which case a solar association (like the other IE Twins) is certain.

2 nipt ‘her kinswoman’ | The identity of this kinswoman (*nipt* typically refers to a younger female relative) is not clear. According to *Gylf* 10:4 (cited in *Vaff* 11 n.) the daughter of Night is Earth, but Earth is also mentioned in st. 4/4 and so might be out of place here. If we look beyond Norse mythology in its Scaldic form as codified by Snorre, the kinswoman of Night may tentatively be identified with the obscure Germanic Dawn-goddess, whose Vedic equivalent (OI *uśás*) is conceived of as the sister or daughter of the Night (*nákti*; Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 93; *RV* 1.113, 1.124.8, 3.55.12, 7.71.1, etc.) and who is often ritually paired with her (1.13.7, 2.3.6, 3.4.6, etc.). This would be a ritual archaism predating the Scaldic system, but it has the advantage of giving the stanza greater internal consistency. All gods described in it would then be heavenly phenomena, who can gaze with their “eyes” onto the couple, something the Earth cannot. A similar “pre-Scaldic” linguistic archaism is likely found in *fold* in st. 4 below.

3 Ó-*vręiðum* augum · *litið okkr þinig* ‘With unwrathful eyes look Ye towards us two’ | I.e., ‘gaze upon us with gracious eyes’, the grace (or wrath) of the Gods being conveyed by their eyes turning towards the worshipper. Cf. *Hdl* 6/2-3.

This anthropomorphic conception of the divine gaze is very old and within Indo-European has secure parallels in Greek, OI, Avestan, and Hittite (West 2007, p. 318). Further parallels are found among both the Hebrews and Egyptians, which however speak about the face rather than the eyes. Biblical examples include the famous Priestly Blessing of Numbers 6:25–26 (“May YHWH light up His face to thee and grant grace to thee; / May YHWH lift up His face to thee and give thee peace.”), Psalms 4:6 (“Lift up the light of Thy face to us, YHWH”), and the chorus of Psalms 80 (“YHWH God of Armies, bring us back. / Light up Thy face, that we may be rescued.”) while Egyptian examples involve the phrase *nfr hr* ‘good, fair of face,’ which refers specifically to the grace of a god or god-like ruler (Spiegelberg 1917, p. 115) and which is known from inscriptions as early as the 4th dynasty of the Old Kingdom (ca. 2600 BC) (Abdelhamid 2018, p. 146) until as late as the very last known Hieroglyphic inscription (GPH 436, from 394 AD) (Griffith 1937, pp. 126–127; Parkinson 1999, pp. 178–179). Spiegelberg (1917, p. 115) cites the following Middle Kingdom prayer to Osiris from the 18th dynasty (ca. 1400 BC), which I find particularly similar to the present stanza (my translation from his German): “Mayst Thou be gracious to me (*hrp=k n=j*); may Thy face be fair towards me (*nfr hr=k m=j*) on the day when I behold Thy fairness.”

4 Hęilir ęsir, · hęilar ęsynjur,  
2 hęil sjá in fјol-nýta fold!  
Mál ok man-vit · geřið okkr męrum tvęim  
4 ok lęknis-hęndr meðan lifum!

[R 32r/7]

Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens!

Hail this much-bountiful Fold!

Speech and manwit give Ye us famed twain,  
and a leecher’s hands, while we live.”

1 Hęilir ęsir, · hęilar ęsynjur ‘Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens!’ | The same line occurs in *Lok* 11, but is there subverted; just like here, the first half of that stanza hails the Gods, but the second half, instead of asking for a boon, instead insults one of the gods present by beginning with the word *nema* ‘except, save for’. The direction of influence is almost certainly from a prayer like the present stanza to *Lok*, for it is surely much less likely for a blasphemous parody of a prayer to inspire a real one than the reverse.

2 sjá in fjöl-nýta fold ‘this much-bountiful Fold’ | The bountiful Earth, an expression with Indo-European roots. Throughout the rest of the Norse poetic corpus *fold* refers exclusively to the unpersonified inanimate “land, earth” without religious associations, but the present instance seems to be a ritual archaism. Cf. the Old English *Æcer* 5/1: *Hāl wes þú Folde · firba módor!* ‘Hale be thou, Fold, mother of men!’ and the Old Indian cognate *Pṛthivī* (Brereton and Jamison, 2020, p. 96), found frequently in *ṚV* (e.g. 1.89.4b: *mātā Pṛthivī* ‘mother Earth’). The common IE root is *\*pṛth₂-* ‘flat, broad’ which has been nominalized as a feminine noun (PGmc. *\*fuldō* < *\*pṛth₂-eb₂*; OI *pṛthivī* < *\*pṛth₂-u-ib₂*, Kroonen 2013, p. 159). For this development cf. Hfr *Hákr* 8 (in SkP 3), where Earth is the *breið-leita brúðr Bál-eygs* ‘broad-faced bride of Bale-eye (= Weden)’. — For the epithet ‘much-giving’ cf. *II* 3.89: ἐπὶ χθονὶ πολλοῦ-βοτῆρην ‘upon the much-nourishing earth’, where the Greek *πολλο-* is cognate with ON *fjöl-*, both deriving from PIE *\*pólb₁u-* ~ *\*pólb₁u-* ‘much, many’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 136).

3 Mál ‘Speech’ | Good speech, by which is also understood silence rather than frivolous chatter. For the importance of proper speech see *Háv* 7/2 n.

3 man-vit ‘manwit’ | Wisdom to conduct ourselves uprightly; for this word see *Háv* 6/6 n.

4 lēknis-hendr ‘a leecher’s hands’ | The hands of a physician, i.e., hands with (magical) powers of healing. The singular *lēknis-hönd* occurs on the Ribe galder-stick (SJy 41), edited below under Galders.

- P3** Hón nefndi=sk Sigrdrífa ok var val-kyrja. Hón sagði, at tveir  
 2 konungar þorðu=sk. Hét annarr Hjalm-Gunn·arr; hann var þá  
 gamall ok inn mesti her-maðr, ok hafði Óðinn hönum sigri heitit.  
 4 En annarr hét Agnarr, · \*Auðu bróðir  
 es vétr engi · vildi þiggja.  
 6 Sigr·drífa felldi Hjalm-Gunn·ar í orrostu’nni, en Óðinn stakk  
 hana svefn-þorni í hefnd þess ok kvað hana aldri skyldu síðan  
 8 sigr vega í orrostu, ok kvað hana gipta=sk skyldu, „en sagða’k  
 hönum at strengða’k heit þar í mót, at gipta=sk öngom þeim  
 10 manni er hréða=sk kynni.“ Hann segir ok biðr hana kenna sér  
 speki ef hón vissi tíðendi ór qllum heimum. Sigr·drífa kvað:

She said her name was Syedrive and was a walkirie. She said that two kings had fought; one was called Helm-Guther—he was old by then and the greatest warrior, and Weden had promised him victory,

but the other was called Eyner, Ead’s brother,  
 who in no way wished to sue for peace.

Syedrive made Helm-Guther fall in the battle, but Weden stung her with the sleeping-thorn as revenge for that and declared that she would never thenceforth win victory in battle and said that she must marry, “but I told him that I had made a vow in response not to marry any man who could be frightened.” He [= Siward] speaks and asks her to teach him wisdom if she knew tidings out of all the Homes. Quoth Syedrive:

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4 \*Auðu | *emend.*; Hauðu R

---

4 \*Auðu | It is proven beyond a doubt by *Helr* 8 that the correct form of the name is in fact *Auða* (as found in *Vþls* 21; see introduction above). The form with *b-* is thus due to corruption.

- 5 „Bjór föri’k þér, · bryn-þings apaldr,  
 2 magni blandinn · ok megin-tíri,  
 fullr es ljóða · ok líkn-stafa,  
 4 góðra galdra · ok gaman-rúna.

[R 32r/18–20, N 24v/1]

Beer I bring thee—O apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]!—  
 mixed with might and mighty splendour.  
 It is full of leeds and grace-staves,  
 of good galders and pleasure-runes.

1 bryn-þings apaldr ‘apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]’ | bryn-þinga valdr ‘wielder of byrnie-Things [BATTLES > WARRIOR]’ N 4 gaman-rúna ‘pleasure-runes’ | gaman-þrædna† N

- 6 Sig-rúnar skalt rísta, · ef vilt sigr hafa,  
 2 ok rísta á hjalti hjors,  
 sumar á vétt-rimum, · sumar á val-bøstum,  
 4 ok nefna tysvar Tý.

[R 32r/20–22, N 24v/1]

Victory-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt have victory,  
 and carve them on the hilt of the sword;  
 some on the weight-rims, some on the wal-basts,  
 and twice name Tew.

1 sigr hafa ‘have victory’ | snotr vera ‘be clever’ N 2 rísta | †rist† N 3 sumar ‘some’ | *om.*  
 N 3 vétt-rimum ‘weight-rims’ | vétt-†rvnum† N 3 sumar ‘some’ | ok ‘and’ N 3 val-bøstum  
 ‘wal-basts’ | val-†bystum† N

3 vétt-rimum ‘weight-rims’ | Unclear. TODO.

3 val-bøstum ‘wal-basts’ | Possibly the sword-pommel; this word also occurs in *HHj* 9. TODO.

- 7 Ql-rúnar skalt kunna · ef vilt at annars kvæn  
 2 véli=t þik í tryggð ef trúir;  
 á horni skal þér rísta · ok á handar baki  
 4 ok mækja á nagli Nauð.

[R 32r/22–24, N 25r/1]

Ale-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt that another man’s wife  
 not betray thee in troth if thou trust her.  
 On the horn shall one carve them, and on the back of the hand,  
 and mark Need on the nail.

1 at ‘that’ | *emend. from* †a† N; *om.* R 2 véli=t þik í tryggð | véli þik eigi tryggð N 3 þér  
 ‘them’ | þat ‘it’ N

4 Nauð ‘Need’ | i.e., the n-rune, †.

- 8 Full skal signa · ok við fari séa

[R 32r/24–25, N 25r/3]

- 2 ok verpa lauki í lög;  
 þá þat veit'k, · at þér verðr aldri=gi  
 4 męini blandinn mjðr.

The cup shall one sign, and gaze against the danger,  
 and throw in the liquid a leek.  
 Then I know that it will never be  
 mixed with harm, thy mead.

1 Full 'The cup' | ǫl 'The ale' N breaks alliteration. 4 męini blandinn | *emend.*; męin-blandinn N

1 signa 'sign' | Dedicating the cup by means of making a certain sign or speech over it. TODO.

3-4 þá ... mjðr | only in N; om. R

- 9 Bjarg-rúnar skalt kunna · ef bjarga vilt  
 2 ok leysa kind frá konum;  
 á lófa þér skal rísta · ok of liðu spęnna  
 4 ok biðja þá dísir duga.

[R 32r/25-26, N 25r/5-7]

Rescue-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt rescue  
 and loosen children from women;  
 on the palm shall one carve them, and wrap them round the joints,  
 and then bid the dises to avail.

1 kunna 'know' | nema 'learn' N 1 ef bjarga vilt 'if thou wilt rescue' | ef þú vilt borgit fá 'if thou wilt have rescued' N 4 þá 'then' | om. N

4 dísir 'dises' | Minor goddesses and fates; one of their roles was helping ailing women during childbirth. Cf. *Fáfn* 12 where *nornir* 'Norns' is used for the childbirth goddesses.

- 10 Brim-rúnar skalt rísta · ef vilt borgit hafa  
 2 á sundi segl-mörum;  
 á stafni skal rísta · ok á stjórnar blaði  
 4 ok leggja ęld í ár;  
 es=a svá brattr breki · né svá bláar unnir,  
 6 þó kǫmsk-tu hęill af hafi.

[R 32r/27-29, N 24v/16-19]

Surf-runes shalt thou carve, if thou wilt rescue  
 sail-steeds [SHIPS] on the sound;  
 on the stem shall one carve them, and on the rudder's blade,  
 and lay fire into the oar.  
 There is not so steep a breaker nor so dark blue waves  
 that thou not come whole off the sea.

1 rísta 'carve' | gjöra 'make' N 3 skal rísta 'shall [one] carve' | skal þér rísta 'shall [one] carve them' N 5 es=a 'There is not' | falla=t 'There fall not' N



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4 leggja eld í ár 'lay fire into the oar' | i.e., mark it with fire in some way.

6 þó kómsk-tu heill af hafi 'that thou not come whole off the sea.' | Lit. "yet comest thou whole off the sea."

11 Lim-rúnar skalt kunna · ef wilt lēknir vesa

[R 32r/29–31, N 25r/7]

2 ok kunna sǫr at séa;

à bærki skal þér rísta · ok à baðmi viðar,

4 þeim's lúta austr limar.

Limb-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt be a leecher,  
and know how to look at wounds;  
on the bark shall one carve them, and on the trunk of the tree:  
on the one whose limbs bow to the east.

---

3 baðmi 'beam' | barri 'leaf' 4 þeim's | þess es N

---

1 lēknir 'leecher' | Physician; see *Háv* 148 n.

12 Mál-rúnar skalt kunna · ef wilt at mann=gi þér

[R 32r/31–34, N 24v/

2 heiptum gjaldi harm;

þér of vindr, · þér of vefr,

4 þér of sętr allar saman,

à því þingi · es þjóðir skulu

6 í fulla dóma fara.

Speech-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt that no man  
should repay thy insults with harm;  
them wilt thou wind, them wilt thou weave,  
them wilt thou sew all together,  
on that Thing where peoples shall  
go to full judgments.

---

1 vilt | om. N 2 gjaldi | †giallda† N 5 þjóðir 'peoples' | menn N breaks alliteration.

13 Hug-rúnar skalt kunna · ef wilt hverjum vesa

[R 32r/34–32v/3, N 25

2 gęð-svinnari guma;

þér of réð, · þér of ręist,

4 þér of hugði Hroptr,

af þeim lęgi · es lekit hafði

6 ór hausi Heið-draupnis

ok ór horni Hodd-rofnis.

Mind-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt be  
swifter in sense than every man;

them did counsel, them did carve,  
 them did Roft think out,  
 from that liquid which had leaked  
 out of Heathdreepner's skull  
 and out of Hoardrovner's horn.

1 kunna 'know' | nema 'learn' N 2 geð-svinnari 'swifter in sense' | geð-horskari 'sharper in sense'  
 N 5-7 af ... Hodd-rofnis 'from ... horn. | om. N

- 14 Á bjargi stóð · með Brimis eggjar,  
 2 hafði sér á hofði hjalm;  
 þá mælti Míms hofuð  
 4 fróðligt it fyrsta orð,  
 ok sagði sanna stafi.

[R 32v/3-4]

On the barrow he stood along Brimer's edges;  
 he had on his head a helmet.  
 Then Mime's head spoke,  
 learnedly, the first word,  
 and said true staves:

- 15 Á skildi kvað ristnar · þeim's stendr fyr skínanda goði,  
 2 á eyra Árvaks, · ok á Alsvinn's hófi,  
 á því hvéli · es snýsk und reið Hrungnis,  
 4 á Sleipnis tönnum · ok á sleða fjotrum,

[R 32v/5-7, N 25r/11-13]

On the shield, he said, [runes] were carved—on the one that stands before  
 the Shining God [SUN];  
 on Yorewaker's ear and on Allswith's hoof,  
 on the wheel which turns beneath Rungner's chariot,  
 on Slopner's teeth and on the fetters of sleds,

2 á eyra Árvaks, · ok á 'on Yorewaker's ear and on' | om. N 3 á | ok á N 3 snýsk 'turns' |  
 stendr 'stands' N 3 Hrungnis 'Rungner's' | emend. based on sense and meter; Raygnis R; Raugnis  
 N 4 tönnum 'teeth' | taunnum 'reins' N

1 skildi ... þeim's stendr fyr skínanda goði 'the shield ... that stands before the Shining God' | For  
 this notion cf. *Grm* 39, according to which the Sun is covered by a disc shielding the earth from  
 its heat. Without it, the whole world would burn up.

2 Árvaks ... Alsvinn's 'Yorewaker ... Allswith' | The two horses that pull the Sun across the  
 heavens; cf. st. 3/1 n. above, *Grm* 38.

- 6 á bjarnar hrammi · ok á Braga tungu,  
 á ulfs klóum · ok á arnar nefi,  
 á blóðgum vengjum · ok á brúar sporði,

[R 32v/7-9, N 25r/13-15]

8           à lausnar lófa · ok à líknar spori,

on the bear's paw and on Bray's tongue,  
on the wolf's claws and on the eagle's beak,  
on bloody wings and on the bridge's head,  
on the palm of release and the trail of grace,

---

6 nęfi | †nefiu† N   8 ok à | ok N

          à gļeri ok à golli · ok à gumna heillum,

[R 32v/9–11, N 25r/15–

10       í víni ok virtri · ok vili-sessi,

          à Gunnis oddi · ok à Grana brjósti,

12       à nornar nagli · ok à nęfi uglu;

on glass and on gold and on men's luck-charms,  
in wine and beerwort and the comfortable seat,  
on Gungner's point and on Grane's chest,  
on a norn's nail and on an owl's beak.

---

9 gumna heillum 'men's luck-charms' | góðu silfri 'good silver' N   10 vili-sessi 'the comfortable seat' | völu sessi 'a willow's seat' N   10 vili-sessi 'the comfortable seat' | í guma holdi 'in a man's flesh' add. N.   11 Gunnis oddi 'Gungner's point' | Gaupnis oddi 'Yéapner's point' (an elsewhere unknown spear) N   11 Grana brjósti 'Grane's chest' | gýgjar brjósti 'a gow's chest' N

16       Allar vöru af skafnar, · þér's vöru à ristnar,

[R 32v/11–14, N 25r/18

2           ok hvefðar við inn hęlga mjōð

ok sęndar à víða vega:

4           þér 'ro með ósum, · þér 'ro með olfum,

sumar með vísu vqnum,

6           sumar hafa męnskir męnn.

All were shaven off—those that were carved on—  
and mixed into the holy mead,  
and sent on wide ways:

They are among the Eese, they are among the Elves,  
some among the wise Waners,  
some have manly men.

---

2 hvefðar 'mixed' | †hrędar† (for hrórðar 'stirred?') N   4 ósum ... olfum 'Eese ... Elves' | olfum ... ósum 'Elves ... Eese' N   4 þér 'ro 'they are' | sumar 'some' N   5 sumar 'some' | ok 'and' N

---

2 hęlga mjōð 'the holy mead' | Apparently the Mead of Poetry. This is the only place in the Eddic corpus where it is called *hęilag* 'holy, inviolable', but in Scaldic poetry it is called holy in the late pagan composition Refr *Giz* 2 (in SkP 3): *hęilagt full brafni-ásar* 'the holy cup of the Raven-Os [= Weden > POETRY]'.  


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17       Þat eru bók-rúnar, · þat eru bjarg-rúnar

[R 32v/14–16, N 25r/2

- 2 ok allar ǫl-rúnar  
 ok mętar męgin-rúnar  
 4 hveim's þęr kná ó-villtar · ok ó-spilltar  
 sér at hęillum hafa;  
 6 njót-tu ef namt  
 und's rjúfa-sk ręgin!“

They are book-runes, they are rescue-runes,  
 and all ale-runes,  
 and noble might-runes—  
 for whomever knows them unfalsified and uninjured  
 to have for himself as charms.  
 Use them if thou learn them  
 until the Reins are ripped!“

1 þat eru 'the are' | ok 'and' N 3 ok mętar 'and noble' | ok męrar ok 'and renowned and' N 4  
 ó-spilltar | þof villtarþ N 7 rjúfa-sk | rjúfa N

1 bók-rúnar 'book-runes' | The word ought likely to be emended to \**bót-rúnar* 'remedy-runes', since the letters *c* and *t* are often conflated due to their similarity. This emendation is supported by two arguments. Firstly the semantic pair *bót* 'remedy' : *bjarg* 'rescue' is surely stronger than *bók* 'book, beech' : *bjarg* 'rescue' and the stanza is specifically referring to the practical (magico-medical) use of the runes. Secondly the pair *bót-rúnar* : *bjarg-rúnar* is in fact attested on a runic charm, N B257 (edited under Galders from Bryggen).

- 18 „Nú skalt kjósa · alls þęr 's kostr of boðinn,  
 2 hvassa vǫpna hlynr,  
 sęgn eða þęgn · haf þęr sjalfr í hug;  
 4 ęll eru męin of metin.“

[R 32v/16–18, N 25v/3–5]

[Quoth Syedrive:] “NOW SHALT THOU CHOOSE, as the choice is offered thee,  
 O maple-tree of sharp weapons [WARRIOR]!  
 Speech or silence have for thyself in thy heart;  
 all the harms are measured!”

1 Nú 'Now' | Ornamented with 4 cross-bars in R.

ALL | Another section begins, though the speaker is the same. Byrnhild offers the young Siward the choice between taking her prophetic advice or letting it remain unsaid. Much of the advice likely relates to Siward's future dealings with the Nivlings Guthar and Hawn, and the implication of Byrnhild's offering him the choice seems to be that he will not entirely enjoy having the knowledge of things to come (for that theme cf. *Grip* and *Háv* 56).

4 of metin 'measured' | I.e., in advance, by the *Mjotuðr* 'Measurer'; cf. *Vsp* 45/1 n.

- 19 „Mun'k=a ek flója · þó'tt mik fęigan vitir,  
 2 em'k=a ek með bleyði borinn;  
 ęst-ręð þín · ek vil ęll hafa

[R 32v/18–20, N 25v/5–8]

4 svá lęngi sem ek lifi.“

[Quoth Siward:] “I shall not flee, although thou mightst know me to be fey;  
I was not born with softness.  
Thy loving counsels, all, will I have  
for as long as I may live.”

---

2 með | om. N

---

2 með bleyði borinn ‘born with softness’ | A common heroic expression or formula. Being “born with softness” means that one was born soft and cowardly (*blauðr*), and such traits were thought to last from childhood unchanged into adulthood unchanged; cf. *Fáfn* 6/4.

20 „Þat réð’k þér it fyrsta · at við fręndr þína

[R 32v/20–22]

2 vamma-laust verir;

síðr þú hefñir · þótt þęir sakar gøri;

4 þat kveða dauðum duga.“

[Quoth Syedrive:] “This I counsel thee first: that thou against thy kinsmen  
defend thyself faultlessly.  
Late oughtst thou to take revenge, although they incur charges;  
that, they say, befits the dead.

21 Þat réð’k þér annat, · at eið né svęrir,

[R 32v/22–24]

2 nema þann ’s saðr sei,

grimmr simar · ganga at tryggð-rofi;

4 armr es vára vargr.

This I counsel thee second: that thou not swear an oath,  
save for the one which is true.  
Grim strands follow the troth-breach;  
wretched is the outlaw of vows.

---

ALL | The punishment for perjury is one of painful torment in the afterlife; see note to *Vsp* 39.  
— The whole stanza is paraphrased in *Vþls* ch. 21: *Ok sver eigi rangan eið, því at grimm hefnd fylgir griðrofi.* ‘And swear no wrong oath, for grim revenge follows the grith-breach.’

3 simar ‘strands’ | i.e., ‘strands of fate’; cf. *1 HHund* 3, where the norms are said to twist such strands. Often emended to *limar* ‘ramifications’ in accordance with *Reg* 4, where that word is used in basically the same context. Such a scribal confusion is easily understood, since *s* in this position was always spelled with long *f* in the old mss. The paraphrase (see other note) is not conclusive, since it replaces this word with *hefnd* ‘revenge’.

22 Þat réð’k þér þriðja · at þú þingi á

[R 32v/24–25]

2 deili=t við heimska hali

því’t ó-sviðr maðr · léttr oft kveðin

4 verri orð an viti.

This I counsel thee third: that thou on the Thing  
not bandy with foolish men;  
for an unwise man often lets be spoken  
worse words than he ought to know.

- 23 Allt es vant · ef við þegir;  
2 þá þikkir þú með bleyði borinn  
eða sönnu sagðr;  
4 hētr es heimis-kviðr  
nema sér góðan geti.  
6 Annars dags · lát hans ondu farit  
ok launa svá lýðum lygi.

[R 32v/25–28]

Everything is wrong if thou shut up in reply;  
then thou seemest born with softness,  
or truthfully accused.  
Risky is the hometown-verdict,  
unless one get himself a good one.  
On another day destroy his life,  
and thus repay the people for the lie.

---

6 ondu 'life' | lit. 'breath, spirit'. Cf. *Vsp* 17 where *ond* is Wēden's gift to the first men.

- 24 Þat réð'k þér it fjórða · ef býr for-déða  
2 vamma-full á vegi:  
ganga 's betra · an gista séi  
4 þótt þik nótt of nemi.

[R 32v/28–30]

This I counsel thee fourth: if there lives an evil-working woman,  
full of faults, by the road,  
to walk is better than to take lodgings [with her]  
although night overtake thee.

- 25 For-njósna augu · þurfu fira synir  
2 hvar's skulu vreiðir vega;  
opt bøl-vísar konur · sitja brautu nér;  
4 þér's deyfa sverð ok sefa.

[R 32v/30–32]

Eyes of looking-out do the sons of folk need,  
wherever wroth men shall fight;  
oft bale-wise women sit near the highway,  
they who dull sword and sense.

---

1 For-njósna 'looking-out' | Verbal noun to *nýsask fyrir* 'look out, look ahead', as found in *Háv* 7.

- 26 Þat réð'k þér it fimmta, · þó'tt fagar séir [R 32v/32–34]  
 2 brúðir bekkjum á,  
 sífa silfr · lát=a þínum svefni ráða,  
 4 teygj=at þér at kossi konur.

This I counsel thee fifth: although thou seest  
 fair brides on the benches,  
 let not their kinsmen's silver rule thy sleep;  
 lure not those women to thee for kisses.

- 27 Þat réð'k þér it sétta, · þó'tt með seggjum fari [R 32v/34]  
 2 ǫlðr-mól til ǫfug:  
 drukinn deila · skal=at við dolg-viðu  
 4 margan stelr vín viti.

This I counsel thee sixth: although among warriors may grow  
 the ale-speech too awry,  
 drunkenly deal shalt thou not with war-trees [WARRIORS];  
 wine steals wit from many.

---

1 Þat réð'k þér it sétta, · þó'tt með seggjum fari 'This I counsel thee sixth: although among warriors may grow' | The last line of fol. 32v of R, after which we have the Great Lacuna. The rest of *Sigrdr*, including ll. 2–4 of this stanza, are supplied from younger paper mss.

TODO: Add the remaining stanzas from paper manuscripts.





# Fragments from the Saw of the Walsings

## Introduction

In **R**, *Sigrdr* ends abruptly at stanza 27 due to the loss of a number of pages; the so-called **Great Lacuna**. The poetry contained on these pages undoubtedly belonged to the Walsing cycle and would have dealt at length with the life of Siward.

The author of *Vǫls* drew heavily from a collection of Walsing-cycle poetry closely related to **R**. He quotes many stanzas known from **R**, but also some which do not survive anywhere else—it is these which are edited here. They largely correspond to the story which would have been found in the Great Lacuna and it is probable that most of them derive from the now-lost poems.

TODO: The stanzas [are to] follow the numbering of stanzas in *Vǫls*.

## Text

- 1     Ristu af **m**agni · **m**ikla hellu,  
2     **S**ig·mundr hjǫrvi · ok **S**in·fjǫtli.

They carved with strength the great stone,  
Syemund with sword, and Sinfittle.

- 2     **E**ldr nam at **ó**sask · en **j**örð at skjalfa  
2     ok **h**ár logi · við **h**imni gnéfa;  
      **f**ár treystisk þar · fylkis rekka  
4     **e**ld at ríða · né **y**fir stíga.

The fire took to rage and the earth to shake  
and high flame to rise to heaven.  
Few there dared of the marshall's champions  
the fire to ride or to step over it.

- 3     **Sig-vǫrðr** Grana · sverði keyrði;  
 2     **ǣldr** sloknaði · fyr **ǫðlingi**;  
      **logi** allr **légðisk** · fyr **lof-gjörnum**;  
 4     **bliku** **ręiði**, · es **Reginn** átti.

Siward drove Grane on by his sword;  
 the fire went out before the athling;  
 the flame all lowered before the praise-eager man;  
 the harness flashed which Rein had owned.

1 **Sig-vǫrðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-urðr** R

- 4     **Sig-urðr** vá at ormi, · en þat **síðan** mun  
 2     **øngum** fyrnask, · meðan **ǫld** lifir.  
      En **hlýri** þinn · **hvárki** þorði  
 4     **ǣld** at riða · né **yfir** stíga.

Siward smote the Wǫrm and that will afterwards  
 by none be forgotten while mankind lives—  
 but *thy brother* dared neither  
 the fire to ride nor to step over it.

- 5     **Út** gekk **Sig-vǫrðr** · **ann**-spjalli frá,  
 2     **holl**-vinr lofða, · ok **hnípaði**,  
      svá at **ganga** nam · **gunnar**-fúsum  
 4     **sundr** of **síður** · **serkr** járn-ofinn.

TODO: translation.

1 **Sig-vǫrðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-urðr** R

- 6     Sumir **við**-fiska tóku, · sumir **vitnis**-hré skífðu,  
 2     sumir **Gutt**-ormi **göfu** · **gëra** hold  
      **við** **mun**-gáti · ok **marga** hluti  
 4     aðra í tyfrum.

Some took wood-fishes [SERPENTS], some sliced wolf-carrion,  
 some gave Godthorm hound-flesh  
 with strong drink and many other  
 things in magic potions.

ALL | This st. is apparently related to *Brot* 4, with which it shares (in divergent form) its first two lines. It is cited in *Vǫls* 30, where it is introduced by the words *sem skáld'it kvað*: ‘as the scald quoth:’

# Fragment of a Lay of Siward

## *(Brot af Sig·urðar kviða)*

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.974)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

Following the Great Lacuna, the text of **R** picks up in the middle of a lay about Siward and Byrnhild, namely the present **Fragment** (*Brot*). According to the prose at the end of the poem *Brot* originally began with Siward's death. It has been speculated that *Brot* was the original “long” Lay of Siward, contrasting with the “Short Lay of Siward” (*Sigska*).

Although most of *Brot* is lost, parts of *Vǫls* up to ch. 32 are clearly based on it, and a version of st. 4 is cited in *Vǫls* 30.

TODO: Translation is in progress.

## Text

- 1 „*hvat* *hefir* *Sig-vǫrðr* · *saka* unnit  
2 *es þú fróknan* vill · *fjorvi* néma?“

“[What has Siward] done for a crime,  
that thou wilt deprive the brave of life?”

1 *hvat hefir Sig-vǫrðr* ‘[What has Siward]’ | *om.* R

1 *hvat hefir Sig-vǫrðr* ‘[What has Siward]’ | A full reconstruction, which however can be held as reasonably secure owing to the parallelism in the following stanza.

- 2 „*Mér* *hefir* *Sig-vǫrðr* · *selda* *eiða*  
2 *eiða* *selda* · *alla* logna;  
þá *vélti* hann mik · *es* hann *vesa* skyldi  
4 *allra eiða* · *ein* full-trúi.“

“To me has Siward given oaths:  
oaths given, all broken;  
he tricked me when he should have been  
of all the oaths the one true keeper.”

1 *Sig-vǫrðr* | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141*); *Sig-urðr* R

- 3 „Þik *hefir* *Bryn-hildr* · *ból* at gørva  
2 *heiptar* *hvattan* · *harm* at vinna;  
fyr man hön *Guð-runu* · *góðra* ráða  
4 en *síðan* þér · *sín* at njóta.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 4 Sumir *ulf* sviðu, · sumir *orm* sniðu,  
2 sumir *Goðþormi* · af *gęra* deildu,  
áðr þeir *métti* · *męins* of lystir  
4 á *horskum* *hal* · *hęndr* of leggja.

Some roasted a wolf; some cut up a serpent;  
some shared hound-flesh with Godthorm,

TODO.

TODO..

ALL | A related st. is cited in N (*Vþls* 30). It is sufficiently different to be edited on its own; see *Vþlsbr* 6 above.

- 5 Úti stóð Guð·rún · Gjúka dóttir  
 2 ok hön þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:  
 „Hvar ’s nú Sig·vörðr · seggja dróttinn  
 4 es frændr mínir · fyrri ríða?“

Outside stood Guthrun, Yivick’s daughter,  
 and she this word first of all did say:  
 “Where is now Siward, the lord of men,  
 when my kinsmen ride ahead?”

3 Sig·vörðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 6 Einn því Hogni · and·svör vęitti:  
 2 „Sundr hofum Sig·vörðr · sverði hoggvinn;  
 gnafir ę grár jór · yfir gram dauðum.“

Alone then Hawn this answer granted:  
 “We have cut Siward asunder by sword;  
 his grey steed ever neighs over the dead prince.”

2 Sig·vörðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urð R

1 Einn því Hogni · and·svör vęitti ‘Alone then Hawn this answer granted’ | Shared with *Sigsk* 17/1, 45/1, which however have *ęinu* (neut. dat. sg.) for *ęinn* (m. nom. sg.) The difference is probably a mere spelling error, but it is unclear which form of the line is original.

- 7 Þa kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:  
 2 „Vęl skuluð njóta · vápna ok níu landa;  
 ęinn myndi Sig·vörðr · ęllu ráða  
 4 ef hann lęngr lítlu · lifi hęldi.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle’s daughter:  
 “Well shall ye enjoy the weapons and nine lands!  
 Alone would Siward have ruled them all  
 if a little longer he had held his life.”

3 myndi | myndiv R 3 Sig·vörðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- [Hogni kvað:] 8 „Vęri=a þat sómt · at hann svá réði  
 2 Gjúka arfi · ok gota męngi,  
 es hann fimm sonu · at folk-róði

4 gunnar fūsa · getna hafði.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “It would not have been right that he should so have ruled  
Yivick’s inheritance and the menfolk of the Gots,  
when to rule the folk he had begot  
five sons eager for war.”

---

ALL | The speaker is not indicated, but it is most likely Hawn who responds.

9 Hló þa Bryn·hildr · —bór allr dunði—  
2 einu sinni · af qlum hug:  
„Væl skuluð njóta · landa ok þegna  
4 es þér fróknan gram · falla létuð.“

Then Byrnhild laughed—the town all resounded—  
a single time out of all her heart:  
“Well shall ye enjoy the lands and thanes,  
since ye made the brave prince to fall.”

---

1–2 Hló ... hug ‘Then ... heart’ | Found near-identically in *Sigsk* 30/1–2.

3 Væl skuluð njóta · landa ok þegna | Alliteration is missing in this line and no obvious emendation can be found.

10 Þa kvað þat Guð·rún · Gjúka dóttir:  
2 „Mjök mēlir þú · miklar firnar;  
gramir hafi Gunn·ar · gøtvað Sig·varðar,  
4 heipt-gjarns hugar · hefnt skal verða.“

Then this quoth Guthrun, Yivick’s daughter:  
“Many great evils hast thou spoken.  
Let the fiends have Guthar, Siward’s burier;  
his evil heart will be revenged.”

---

3 Sig·varðar | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðar R

3 gramir hafi ‘let the fiends have’ | Apparently a common curse; cf. *Hárð* 60.

11 Soltinn varð Sig·vqrðr · sunnan Rínar,  
2 hrafn at mēiði · hōtt kallaði:  
„Ykk mun Atli · eggjar rjóða,  
4 munu víg-skáa · of víða eiðar.“

Siward expired to the south of the Rhine;  
a raven on a branch loudly called out:  
“On you two will Atle redden his blades;  
the oaths will destroy the war-harried men!”

---

1 Sig-vörðr | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

---

1 Soltinn varð ‘expired’ | Lit. ‘became, turned dead’; *soltinn* ‘dead; starved, dejected’ is the past participle of *svelta* ‘die; starve’. Apart from the present st. *soltinn* is used in three other places in Norse poetry: *Sigsk* 47/2 (‘dejected’), 50/3 (‘dead’) and 2 *Guðr* 10 (‘dejected’). The penchant for this participle together with the shared subject matter may indicate a close relationship between these three poems.

- 12 Framm vas kvelda · fǿlð vas drukkit  
 2 þa vas hví-vetna · vil-mál talit;  
 sofnuðu allir · es í sǿing kvǿmu,  
 4 ǿinn vakði Gunn·arr · ǿllum lǿngr.

The evening was late, much was drunk;  
 then were all kinds of pleasant speeches told.  
 All fell asleep when they came into bed;  
 alone did Guthur wake longer than all.

- 13 Fót nam at hróra · fǿlð nam at spjalla  
 2 hitt hǿr-glǿtuðr · hyggja téði,  
 hvat þǿir í bǿðvi · báðir sǿgðu  
 4 hrafn ǿy ok ǿrn · es þǿir hǿim riðu.

His foot he took to move, much he took to consider.  
 Of this the troop-destroyer thought,  
 what in the fray those two had said,  
 the raven always and the eagle, when they rode home.

---

1 Fót ... spjalla ‘His foot ... consider.’ | Probably a formulaic line-template; cf. *Þrk* 1/3.

---

- 14 Vaknaði Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir  
 2 dís skjǿldunga · fyr dag lítlu:  
 „Hvetið mik ǿða lǿtið mik · —harmr es unninn—  
 4 sorg at sǿgja · ǿða svá láta.“

Byrnhild awoke, Budle’s daughter,  
 the dise of shieldings, a little before day:  
 “TODO.”

- 15 Þǿgðu allir · við því orði  
 2 fǿr kunni þeim · fljóða lǿtum  
 es hǿn grátandi · gǿrðisk at sǿgja  
 4 þat’s hlǿjandi · hǿlða þǿiddi:

All were silent upon that word;

TODO.

when she, weeping, made ready to tell

that which, laughing, she had asked from the heroes:

ALL | Sts. 15–20 are transparently paraphrased in *Völs* 31: *Nú þóttist engi kunna at svara, at Brynhildr beiddi þess hljandi, er hón barmaði með gráti. Þá mælti hón: „Þat dreymdi mik, Gunn-arr, at ek átta kalda séng, en þú riðr í bendr ó-vinum þínum, ok öll étt yður mun illa fara, er þér eruð eið-rofa, ok mundir þú þat ó-glöggt, er þit blönduð blóði saman, Sigurðr ok þú, er þú rétt hann, ok hefir þú bonum allt illu launat þat, er hann gerði vel til þín ok lét þik fremstan vera, ok þá reyndi þat, er hann kom til vár, hvé hann belt sína eiða, at hann lagði okkar í milli it snarp-eggjaða sverð, þat er eitri var bert. [...] (15) Now nobody thought himself able to answer how Byrnhild had laughed when she asked for what she now grieved by weeping. (16) Then she spoke: “I dreamt, Guthur, that I had a cold bed, but thou didst ride into the hands of thy enemies, (17) and all your lineage will fare ill, for ye are oath-breakers, (18) and thou didst not kindly recall how ye two blended your blood together, thou and Siward, when thou betrayed him; and thou hast all cruelly repaid him for how he was good towards thee and let thee be the foremost; (19) and it was proven when he came to us how well he kept his oaths (20) by that he laid between us the sharp-edged sword which was hardened with venom. [...]’*

16 „Hugða’k mér, Gunn:arr, · grimmt í svefni,

2 svalt allt í sal · étta’k séng kalda,

en þú gramr riðir · glaums and-vani

4 fjöttri fatlaðr · í fjánda lið.

“I had a cruel thought, Guthur, in my sleep:  
everything died in the hall, I had a cold bed,  
and thou, prince, didst ride without cheerful fellows,  
bound by fetters, into a troop of foes.

17 Svá mun ǫll yður · étt Niflunga

2 afli gengin— · eruð eið-rofa!

So will all your line of Nivlings  
part from power—ye are oath-breakers!

18 Mant-at-tu Gunn:arr · til gǫrva þat

2 es þit blóði í spor · báðir rennduð,

nú hefir þú hönum þat allt · illu launat

4 es hann fremstan þik · finna vildi.

Thou didst not recall, Guthur, clearly enough  
that your blood in your tracks ye both did drive.  
Now hast thou for all that cruelly repaid him,  
when he would have *thee* as the foremost man.

4 þik ‘thee’ | so in paraphrase N; sik ‘himself’ R



2 þit blóði í spor · báðir rennduð ‘your blood in your tracks ye both did drive’ | Referring to a ritual of blood-brotherhood, wherein the brothers-to-be would spill and mix their blood into their footprints on the ground. Blood-brotherhood is also mentioned in *Lok* 9, and the footprint-ritual is described in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.6.7: *Siquidem icturi foedus veteres vestigia sua mutui sanguinis aspersione perfundere consueverant, amicitiarum pignus alterni cruoris commercio firmaturi* ‘Now our ancestors, when they meant to strike a pact, would sprinkle their combined blood in their footprints and mingle it, so as to strengthen the pledge of their fellowship.’ For discussion see PCRN History and Structures III:845 ff.

- 19 Þá reyndi þat · es riðit hafði  
2 móðigr á vit · mǫn at biðja,  
hvé her-glötuðr · hafði fyrri  
4 eiðum haldit · við inn unga gram.

Then it was proven when he had ridden,  
brave, to visit and ask for my hand,  
how the troop-destroyer [WARRIOR] had upheld  
his side of the oaths against the young lord:

- 20 Ben-vond of lét · brugðinn gólli  
2 marg-dýrr konungr · á meðal okkar;  
eldi vöru eggjar · utan görvar  
4 en eittr-dropum · innan fáðar.“

He placed a wound-wand [SWORD] wrapped in gold,  
the much-adorned king, between us two.  
With fire was its blade on the outside made,  
but with poison-droplets on the inside stained.”

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1 gólli | gylli R

## Frá dauða Sig-urðar (‘From the Death of Siward’)

- P1 Hér er sagt í þessi kviðu frá dauða Sig-urðar ok víkr hér svá til  
2 sem þeir drépi hann úti. En sumir segja svá at þeir drépi hann  
inni í rekkju sinni sofanda. En þýðverskir menn segja svá at þeir  
4 drépi hann úti í skógi, ok svá segir í Guð-rúnar kviðu inni fornu  
at Sig-urðr ok Gjúka synir hefði til þings riðit þá er hann var  
6 drepinn. En þat segja allir einnig at þeir sviku hann í tryggð ok  
vógu at hánúm liggjanda ok ó-búnum.

HERE IT HAS BEEN TOLD in this lay from the death of Siward, and here it begins at the point when they slew him outside. But some say that they slew

him inside in his chamber, sleeping. But the Germans say that they slew him outside in the forest, and so it says in the Ancient Lay of Guthrun that Siward and the sons of Yivick had ridden to the Thing when he was slain. But this they all say in unison, that they betrayed him while he trusted them and struck at him lying down and unarmed.

---

1 Hér | *Introduced by an ornamented 3-line initial in R.*

---

4 Guð-rúnar kviðu inni fornu 'Ancient Lay of Guthrun' | Probably a reference to 2 *Guðr* 4–5.

# First Lay of Guthrun

## *(1 Guð·rúnar kviða)*

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.988)  
Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **First Lay of Guthrun** (abbrev. *1 Guðr*) directly follows the narrative of *Brot*, as is seen by the fact that the concluding prose of *Brot* directly leads into the introduction to *1 Guðr* in **R**. As such the two are clearly intended to form a continuous narrative.

The poem shares several lines with *Sigs* in sts. 1, 16, 22, 23 (n.) and 25, and with *2 Guðr* in sts. 1 and 18.

After Siward's death Guthrun is so upset that she cannot make herself weep until she sees his body.

## Text

- P1 Guð-rún sat yfir Sig-urði dauðum. Hón grét eigi sem aðrar  
 2 konur en hón var búin til at springa af harmi. Til gengu bæði  
 konur ok karlar at hugga hana en þat var eigi auð-velt. Þat er  
 4 sögn manna at Guð-rún hefði etit af Fáfnis hjarta ok hón skilði  
 því fugls rödd. Þetta er enn kveðit um Guð-rúnu:

Guthrun sat over Siward, dead. She did not weep like other women, but she was ready to burst apart from grief. Both women and men arrived to console her, but that was not easily done. It is the saying of men that Guthrun had eaten of Fathomer's heart and therefore she understood the speech of birds. This is further sung about Guthrun:

ALL | No break between this passage and the concluding prose of Brot is made in R.

## Guð-rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

- 1 Ár vas þat's Guð-rún · gørði=sk at deyja,  
 2 es hōn sat sorg-full · yfir Sig-veṛði,  
 gørði=t hōn hjúfra · né hōndum sláa  
 4 né kveina of · sem konur aðrar.

IT WAS OF YORE that Guthrun made ready to die  
 as she sat sorrowful over Siward.  
 She did not pant nor beat her hands  
 nor wail over him like other women.

1 Ár | *The A is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 2 Sig-veṛði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R*

1 Ár vas þat's 'It was of yore that' | Shared with *Sigsk* 1/1. *ár* 'of yore' is a common initial word, also found in *Vsp* 3/1, *Hym* 1/1 and *HHund* 1/1.

2–4 es hōn ... aðrar 'as she ... women.' | Closely related to 2 *Guðr* 10/3–5.

- 2 Gingu jarlar · al-snotrir fram,  
 2 þeir's harðs hugar · hana lottu;  
 þey=gi Guð-rún · gráta mátti,  
 4 svá vas hōn móðug; · mundi hōn springa.

There went forth all-clever earls,  
 they who would loosen her hard heart,  
 yet nowise could Guthrun weep;  
 so moody was she—she would burst apart.

- 3 Sötu ítrar · jarla brúðir  
 2 gollu búnar · fyr Guð-rúnu;  
 hver sagði þeira · sinn of-trega  
 4 þann's bitrastan · of beðit hafði.

There sat the splendid brides of the earls  
 adorned with gold before Guthrun.  
 Each one of them told her own great sorrow,  
 the bitterest one she had endured.

- 4 Þá kvað Gjaf-laug, · Gjúka systir:  
 2 „Mik velt'k á moldu · munar-lausasta;  
 hef'k fimm vera · for-spell beðit,  
 4 tveggja dótra, · þriggja systra,  
 átta bróðra, · þó ek ein lifi.“

Then quoth Yeflie, Yivick's sister:  
 “I know myself on the earth to be most joyless.  
 Of five husbands have I suffered the loss,  
 of two daughters, three sisters,  
 eight brothers—yet I alone live.”

---

4 tveggja dótra, · þriggja systra | No alliteration is found in this line and no obvious emendation can be found; it seems that the strong parallelism and assonance between *tveggja* and *þriggja* compensate for it.

- 5 Þeygi Guð-rún · gráta mátti;  
 2 svá vas hön móðug · at mǫg dauðan  
 ok harð-huguð · of hrør fylkis.

Yet nowise could Guthrun weep;  
 so moody was she after the lad's death,  
 and hard-hearted over the marshal's corpse.

- 6 Þá kvað þat Her-borg, · Húna-lands dróttning:  
 2 „Hef'k harðara · harm at segja:  
 mínir sjau synir · sunnan lands,  
 4 verr inn átti, · í val fellu.

Then this quoth Harburg, Hunland's queen:  
 “I have a harder harm to tell.  
 My seven sons to the south of their land,  
 —my husband eighth—in battle fell.”

- 7 Faðir ok móðir, · fjórir bróðr,  
 2 þau á vági · vindr of lék,  
 barði bára · við borð-þili.

My father and mother, four brothers—  
 them on the wave the wind outplayed;  
 the breaker beat against the ship-side.

- 8 Sjölf skylda'k gøfga, · sjölf skylda'k gøtva,  
 2 sjölf skylda'k hōndla, · hēl-fōr þeira;  
 þat ek allt of þeið · ęin misseri  
 4 svá't mēr maðr ęngi · munar leitaði.

I alone had to honour them; I alone had to bury them;  
 I alone had to handle their hell-journey [DEATH].  
 This all I suffered in one half-year,  
 while noone found me any joy.

---

2 hēl-fōr | *emend.*; hęr-fōr R

- 9 Þá varð'k hapta · ok hęr-numa  
 2 sams misseris · síðan-verða;  
 skylda'k skreyta · ok skúa binda  
 4 hęrsis kván · hveřjan morgin.

Then I became a captive and taken in war,  
 in the latter part of that same half-year.  
 I had to dress and bind the shoes  
 of the ruler's wife every morning.

- 10 Hōn ógði mēr · af af-brýði  
 2 ok hōrðum mik · hōggum keyrði;  
 fann'k hús-guma · hveř=gi inn bętra  
 4 en hús-freřju · hveř=gi verri.“

She tortured me out of jealousy  
 and with hard blows drove me on.  
 A husband nowhere I've met better,  
 but a housewife nowhere worse.”

- 11 Þey=gi Guð-rún · gráta mátti;  
 2 svá vas hōn móðug · at mōg dauðan  
 ok harð-huguð · of hrør fylkis.

Yet nowise could Guthrun weep;  
so moody was she after the lad's death,  
and hard-hearted over the marshal's corpse.

- 12 Þá kvað þat Goll-rönd, · Gjúka dóttir:  
2 „Fó kannt, fóstura, · þó'tt fróð séir,  
ungu vífi · and-spjöll bera.“  
4 Varaði hön at hylja · of hrör fylkis.
- Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:  
“Little canst thou, foster-mother—though thou be wise—  
to a young wife give answers.”—  
She bade them uncover the marshal's corpse.

- 13 Svípti hön bléju · af Sig-væðði  
2 ok vatt vængi · fyr vífs knéum:  
„Lít-tu á ljúfan, · legg þú munn við grön  
4 sem þú halsaðir · hēilan stilli.“
- She drew the shroud off of Siward  
and turned his cheeks before the wife's knees:  
“Look on thy beloved! Lay thy mouth to his lips  
like thou didst embrace the hale prince.”

1 Sig-væðði | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R 2 knéum | metr. emend. by restoration of old hiatus form; knjám R

- 14 Á leit Guð-rún · einu sinni;  
2 sá hön döglinga skör · dreyra runna,  
fránar sjónir · fylkis liðnar,  
4 hug-borg jöfurs · hjörvi skorna.
- Upon him looked Guthrun a single time;  
she saw the noble's locks run with blood,  
the piercing gaze of the marshaller gone,  
the heart-fort [CHEST] of the chieftain cut by the sword.

- 15 Þá hné Guð-rún · höll við bólstri;  
2 haddr losnaði, · hlýr roðnaði  
en regns dropi · rann niðr umb kné.
- Then Guthrun sank down, slooped against the bolster.  
Her hair fell loose, her cheek turned red,  
and a drop of rain ran down to her lap.

- 16 Þá grét Guð·rún, · Gjúka dóttir,  
 2 svá't tór flugu · tresk í gognum  
 ok gullu við · gæss í túni,  
 4 mérir fuglar · es mér átti.

Then wept Guthrun, Yivick's daughter,  
 so that the tears flew through the ...  
 and in response shrieked the geese in the yard,  
 the famèd fowls which that maiden owned.

2 tresk '...' | This word is an unexplained hapax.

3 ok gullu við · gæss í túni 'and in response shrieked the geese in the yard' | Shared identically with *Sigs* 29/4.

- 17 Þá kvað þat Goll·rönd, · Gjúka dóttir:  
 2 „Ykkar vissa'k · ástir meistar  
 manna allra · fyr mold ofan;  
 4 unðir þú hvár-ki · úti né inni,  
 systir mín, · nema hjá Sig·vørði.“

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:  
 "I knew the love between you two was the greatest  
 of all men above the earth.  
 Thou wast never content outside nor inside,  
 O sister of mine, save by Siward's side."

5 Sig·vørði | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- [Guð·rún kvað:] 18 „Svá vas mín Sig·vørðr · hjá sonum Gjúka  
 2 sem vëri geir-laukr · ór grasi vaxinn,  
 eða vëri bjartr steinn · á band dreginn:  
 4 jarkna-steinn · yfir qðlingum.

[Quoth Guthrun:] "So was my Siward beside the sons of Yivick  
 like were he a garlic grown out of grass,  
 or were a bright stone drawn on a string:  
 an arkenstone over the athlings.

1 Sig·vørðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

ALL | Guthrun begins her monologue, lasting from sts. 18–22. — Apart from the related 2 *Guðr* 2, cf. also the similar descriptions of Hallow (2 *HHund* 38) and Swanhild (*Ghv* 15).

1–2 Svá vas ... vaxinn 'So was ... grown' | These two lines are almost identical to 2 *Guðr* 2/1–2. Since the present poem is probably older (Sapp 2022), it is likely the source.

2 geir-laukr 'garlic' | Or 'spear-leek'. I have opted for this translation based on etymology (cf. OE *gār-lēac* 'spear-leek'), but the botanical identity is unclear. 2 *Guðr* 2 has *grønn laukr* 'green leek' instead. For the cultural importance of leeks and onions see note to *Vsp* 4.



3–4 eða véri ... qðlingum. ‘or were ... athlings.’ | Beaded necklaces were commonly worn by Scandinavian women of the time, and the beads were mostly of opaque coloured glass. Siward is likened to a bright crystal, the sons of Yivick to dull glass.

- 19 Ek þótta auk · þjóðans rekkum  
 2 hveŕri héri · Hęjans dísi;  
 nú em’k svá lítil · sem lauf séa  
 4 øfst í jølstrum · at jøfur dauðan.

I also seemed to the ruler’s champions  
 higher than any of the Lord of Hosts’ dises [WALKIRRIES].  
 Now am I so small as if I were a leaf,  
 the highest in the willows, after the ruler’s death.

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4 øfst | ‘opt’ R

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4 øfst | Though the ms. spelling ‘opt’ in R may suggest the word *opt* ‘often’ (as it has been read by many eds.), this hardly makes sense in the context of the single leaf. On the other hand, the superlative *ęstr*, *øfstr* ‘highest, uppermost’ is occasionally spelled with a ‘-ptr’ in mss. (ONP, s.v. *ęfri*, *øfri*), and it is therefore most likely that word which with we are dealing.

- 20 Sakna’k í sessi · ok í séingu  
 2 míns mál-vinar— · valda meğir Gjúka;  
 valda meğir Gjúka · mínu þolvi  
 4 ok systr sinnar · sörung gráti.

I miss in the seat and in the bed  
 my confidant—at fault are the lads of Yivick;  
 the lads of Yivick are at fault for my bale  
 and for their sister’s [my] bitter weeping.

- 21 Svá ér umb lýða · landi ęyðið  
 2 sęm ér of unnuð · ęiða svarða;  
 man=a þú, Gunn-arr, · golls of njóta;  
 4 þęir munu þér baugar · at bana verða  
 es þú Sig-vęrði · svarðir ęiða.

Even so may ye ruin the land for folk,  
 as ye fulfilled the sworn oaths!  
 Thou wilt not, Guthur, enjoy the gold;  
 those bigs will for thee become the bane  
 on which thou to Siward didst swear the oaths.

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5 Sig-vęrði | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R

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4 þeir munu þér baugar · at bana verða ‘those bigs will for thee become the bane’ | I.e. ‘the money will be the end of you’, a prediction of the curse of the Nivling-hoard. Very similar to *Fáfnir* 9, 20.

- 22 Opt vas í túni · tēiti meiri  
 2 þá's mínns Sig·vǫrðr · sǫðladi Grana,  
 ok þeir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru,  
 4 armrar vǣttar · illu heilli.“

Often in the courtyard there was greater cheer,  
 [like] when my Siward saddled Grane  
 and they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand,  
 that wretched wight of ill omen.”

2 Sig·vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141*); Sig·urðr R

3 ok þeir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru ‘and they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand’ | The same line is found in *Sigsk* 3/1.

- 23 Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:  
 2 „Vǫn sé sú vǣttar · vers ok barna  
 es þik Guð·rún · gráts of þeiddi  
 4 ok þér í morgun · mál·rúnar gaf.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:  
 “Let this wight [me] be without husband and children,  
 who brought forth, O Guthrun, thy weeping  
 and this morning gave thee things to speak of.”

ALL | Byrnhild responds, stressing that she will not live long after Siward.

2 Vǫn ... vers ok barna ‘without husband and children’ | Cf. *Sigsk* 9/1 with emendation based on this line.

4 þér ... mál·rúnar gaf ‘gave thee things to speak of’ | Lit. ‘gave thee speech-runes’.

- 24 Þá kvað þat Goll·rǫnd · Gjúka dóttir:  
 2 „Þegi þú, þjóð-leið, · þeira orða!  
 Urðr ǫðlinga · hefir þú ǣ vesit  
 4 —rekr þik alda hver · illrar skǣpnu—  
 sorg sára · sjau konunga  
 6 ok vin-spell · vífa mest.“

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:  
 “Shut up, thou most loathsome woman, with those words!  
 The Weird of athlings hast thou always been,

—thou art driven by every wave of evil fate—  
the sore sorrow of seven kings,  
and the greatest spoiler of women's friendship.”

2 Þegi þú, þjóð-leið, · þeira orða ‘Shut up, thou most loathsome woman, with those words’ |  
The same line is found in *Þrk* 18/2, with *Þórr* ‘Thunder’ for *þjóð-leið* ‘most loathsome woman’.

- 25 Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:  
2 „Veldr ęinn Atli · ęllu þövi  
of borinn Buðla · bróðir mín  
4 þá's vit í hęll · húnskrar þjóðar  
ęld á jęfri · orm-bęðs litum;  
6 þęss hęfi'k gangs · goldit síðan,  
þęirar sýnar; · sęumk ęy.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:  
“Alone is Attle at fault for all evil,  
the man born of Budle, my own brother,  
since we two in the hall of the Hunnish folk  
beheld the fire of the wyrm-bed [GOLD] on the prince.  
For that journey I have paid ever since,  
for that sight—I always worried over it.”

ALL | Byrnhild blames the tragic events on the greed of her brother Attle, who according to *Sigsk* 37 forced her to be married.

2 Veldr ęinn Atli · ęllu þövi ‘Alone is Attle at fault for all evil’ | Related to 2 *HHund* 34/3 and *Sigsk* 27/4.

3 of borinn Buðla · bróðir mín ‘born of Budle, my own brother’ | Identically shared with *Sigsk* 56/5.

5 ęld orm-bęðs ‘fire of the wyrm-bed [GOLD]’ | An unparalleled kenning. GOLD can be ‘fire of the river’ (since it shines underwater) and ‘wyrm-bed’ (since the Wyrms or dragon dwells upon it), but not ‘fire of the wyrm-bed’. TODO: reference Meissner.

- 26 Stóð hęn und stoð · stręngði hęn ęlf,  
2 brann Bryn·hildi · Buðla dóttur  
ęldr ór augum; · ęitri fnósti  
4 es hęn sęr of leit · á Sig·vęrði.

She stood beneath a pillar, fueled her anger;  
in Byrnhild Budle's daughter burned  
fire from her eyes; she spit venom  
when she beheld the wounds on Siward.

4 Sig·vęrði | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- P2** Guð·rún gekk þaðan á braut til skógar á eyði·merkr ok fór allt til  
 2 Danmarkar ok var þar með Þóru, Hákonar dóttur, sjau misseri.  
 Bryn·hildr vildi eigi lifa eptir Sig·urð. Hón lét drepa þręla sína  
 4 átta ok fimm ambóttir, þá lagði hón sik sverði til bana svá sem  
 segir í Sig·urðar kviðu inni skömmu.

Guthrun went away thence through the woods of the wastelands and journeyed all the way to Denmark and stayed there with Thure, Hathkin's daughter, for seven half-years. Byrnhild did not want to live after Siward. She had her eight thralls and five handmaids slain; then she ran herself through with a sword unto her death, as it says in the Short Lay of Siward.

# Short Lay of Siward

## (*Sig·urðar kviða in skamma*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.876)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Short Lay of Siward** (*Sigsk*) continues the story of Siward, focusing on his death and Byrnhild's subsequent grieving. Despite its title, *Sigsk* has ca. 280 long-lines and is thus one of the longest poems in **R**, something which suggests that it was once preceded by an even longer poem about Siward (cf. *Vǫlsbr* above).

### Dating

The language of *Sigsk* has some archaic and unusual features.

The most notable archaic feature is its use of the particle *of* before nominals. This particle originally corresponds to an older Germanic *\*ga-* (thus Anon *Bjark* 1/4b (SkP 3): *of sinnar* 'companions' < PGmc *\*ga-sinþaniz* > OE *ge-siþas* 'id.')

but becomes obsolete early in ON poetry except for when preceding verbs; in the Scaldic corpus attestations of *of* before nominals occur almost exclusively(?—TODO) before ca. 1000 AD (SkP 5, p. xcic).

In *Sigsk*, *of* occurs twice before nouns: 23/1a *of dolgr* (no non-Norse parallels but see note there) and 58/5a: *of skǫp* (= OE *ge-sceap*). It also occurs twice before the adj. *líkr*, viz. in 36/2b and 61/4b: *of líkr* (= OE *ge-líc*). This usage is unique in ON poetry since the *of* replaces the usual fossilized *g-* in *g-líkr*, which proves that the poet of *Sigsk* had a strong intuitive sense of the semantics of this particle. A later archaizer would far more likely have created the hypercorrected form *\*of g-líkr*

Another archaic feature is the long form *haufuð* (23/2). Like the other Walsing-poems (save *Gríp*), *Sigsk* requires the long first syllable in the name *Sig-vǫrðr* 'Siward' (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141).

Metrically *Sigsk* has a notable tolerance for three-syllable verses.

Contrary to Sapp's statistical model the aforementioned archaic traits allow us to date the poem to the 10th century. It should therefore be of interest to the reader that the poem's depictions of widow-suicide (suttee) and the afterlife are likely authentic and pagan.

## Text

## Sig-urðar kviða ('A Lay of Siward')

- 1 Ár vas þat's Sig-*v*ørðr · sótti Gjúka  
 2 *v*ølsungr ungi · es *v*egit hafði;  
 3 tók við tryggðum · tveggja bróðra  
 4 seǵdu=sk *ę*ða · *ę*ljun-fróknir.

IT WAS OF YORE that Siward, the young Walsing  
 who had triumphed, sought out Yivick.  
 He got the truces of two brothers;  
 they exchanged oaths, the men brave of zeal.

1 Ár | The A is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R. 1 Sig-*v*ørðr | metr. emend. (Stievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

1 Ár vas þat's 'It was of yore that' | Shared with 1 Guðr 1/1; see there for further parallels.

- 2 Męy buðu hönnum · ok *m*ęiðma fjøłð,  
 3 Guð-rúnu ungu · Gjúka dóttur;  
 4 drukku ok *d*ömjðu · *d*ógr mart saman  
 Sig-*v*ørðr ungi · ok *s*ynir Gjúka,

They offered him a maiden and a multitude of treasures  
 with young Guthrun, Yivick's daughter.  
 They drank and discussed for many days and nights together,  
 young Siward and the sons of Yivick,

- 3 und's þęir Bryn-hildar · *b*iðja fóru  
 2 svát þęim Sig-*v*ørðr · *r*ęið í *s*inni  
 3 *v*ølsungr ungi · ok *v*ega kunni;  
 4 hann of *ę*tti · ef hann *ę*iga knętti.

till they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand,  
 whenas Siward rode alongside them,  
 the young Walsing, and he could fight;  
 he would have her if he could have her.

- 4 Sęggr inn *s*uðr-øni · lagði sverð nøkkvit  
 2 *m*ęki *m*ál-faan · á *m*eðal þęira  
 3 né hann *k*onu · *k*yssa gęrði  
 4 né *h*únskr konungr · *h*ęfja sér af armi

mey frum-unga; · fal hann megi Gjúka.

The southern youth laid a naked sword,  
a picture-painted blade between them;  
nor did he kiss the woman,  
nor did the Hunnish king hold in his arms  
the most young maiden; he left that to the lad of Yivick.

---

ALL | Siward disguised himself as Guthur and married Byrnild while still in disguise, but out of loyalty for his oath-sworn friend Siward did not sleep with nor even touch her in the bed; instead he placed a sword between them.

2 mēki mál-faan 'a picture-painted blade' | Also occurring in *Ski* 23/1, 25/1; see there.

- 5 Hōn sér at lífi · lōst né vissi  
2 ok at aldr-lagi · ękki grand  
vamm þat's vęri · eða vesa hyðđi;  
4 gengu þęss á milli · grimmar urðir.

She knew no blemish to her life  
and in her allotted age no wrong,  
no fault which had been nor which thought to arise;  
in that the cruel weirds intervened.

- 6 Eīn sat hōn úti · aptan dags,  
2 nam hōn svá bęrt · umb at męla=sk:  
„Hafa skal'k Sig-vęrð, · —eða þó svelt!—  
4 mōg frum-ungan, · mēr á armi.

Alone she sat outside at the close of day;  
she took to speak plainly thus:  
“I shall have Siward—else let him die!—  
that most young lad in my arms!

---

2 nam hōn svá bęrt · umb at męla=sk: | This line is missing alliteration and no obvious emendation can be found.

- 7 Orð męlta'k nú, · iðr=umk ęptir þęss,  
2 kvōn 's hans Guð-rūn · ęn ek Gunn-ars,  
ljótarnornir · skópu oss langa þró.“

The word I just spoke I afterwards regret.  
Guthrun is his wife, but I am Guthur's;  
ugly norns shaped for us a long yearning.“

- 8 Opt gęngr hōn innan, · ills of fylld,



- 2 ísa ok jökla, · aptan hvern,  
 es þau Guð-rún · ganga á beð  
 4 ok hana Sig-vörðr · sveipr í rípti,  
 konungr inn hunski, · kvon frjá sína.

She often goes outside, filled with hatred,  
 with ice-sheets and icicles, every evening  
 when he and Guthrun go to their bed  
 and Siward wraps her in a blanket,  
 the Hunnish king, to make love to his wife.

2 ísa ok jökla ‘with ice-sheets and icicles’ | A description of Byrnhild’s inner state; her jealousy makes her so cold that it is as if her insides froze to ice.

- [Byrn-hildr kvað:] 9 „Von geng’k vilja, · vers ok barna,  
 2 verð’k mik góla · af grimmum hug.“  
 [Quoth Byrnhild:] “I go without strength of will, husband, or children;  
 I shall have to soothe myself from my cruel thoughts.”

1 barna | *sens. emend.*, cf. 1 Guðr 23/2; beggja ‘both’ R

- 10 Nam af þeim heiptum · hvetja=sk at vígi:  
 2 „Þú skalt, Gunn-arr, · gørst of láta  
 mínu landi · ok mér sjalfri;  
 4 mun’k una aldri · með öðlingi.

Due to that hatred she took to incite [men] to killing:  
 “Thou shalt, O Guther, very soon lose  
 my land and my very self;  
 I will never be content with an athling.

- 11 Mun’k aptr fara · þar’s áðan vas’k  
 2 með ná-bornum · niðjum mínum,  
 þar mun’k sitja · ok sofa lífi  
 4 nema þú Sig-vörðr · svelta látir  
 ok jöfurr öðrum · óðri verðir.

I will go back whither I was before  
 amidst my close-born kinsmen;  
 there I will sit and sleep my life away—  
 unless thou lettest Siward die,  
 and become a chieftain nobler than he.

- 12 Lötum son fara · feðr í sinni;  
 2 skal=at ulf ala · ungan lengi.  
 Hveim verðr hǫlða · hefnd létari  
 4 —síðr til sáttar— · at sonr lifi.“

We shall let his son follow in his father's tracks;  
 one shall not rear a young wolf for long.  
 For every man revenge becomes easier  
 —peace less likely—if his son lives.”

- 13 Ręiðr varð Gunn·arr · ok hnipnaði,  
 2 sveip sínum hug, · sat umb allan dag;  
 hann vissi þat · vil=gi gǫr=la  
 4 hvat hǫnum vęri · vinna sǫmst  
 eða hǫnum vęri · vinna þęzt,  
 6 alls sik Vǫlsung · vissi firrðan  
 ok at Sig·vǫrð · sǫknuð mikinn.

Then Guthur turned wroth and drooped;  
 he twisted his mind, sat for the whole day.  
 He knew not clearly in any way  
 what was most fitting for him to do,  
 or what was best for him to do,  
 as he knew he would be bereaved of the Walsing  
 and [feel] great loss after Siward.

---

1 Ręiðr varð Gunn·arr · ok hnipnaði | This line is missing alliteration and no obvious emendation can be found. The most likely explanation is that the adjective *ręiðr* ‘wroth’ was originally something else, since Guthur does not appear to be actively angry, but rather confounded.

- 14 Ýmist hann hugði · jafn-langa stund,  
 2 þat vas ęigi · árar títt  
 at frá konung-dóm · kvánir gengi;  
 4 nam hann sér Hǫgna · heita at rúnum,  
 þar átti hann · alls full-trúa.

His thoughts went back and forth for an even-long time.  
 It was not at all desirable in times of yore  
 that wives should depart from a kingdom.  
 He summoned Hawn for private counsel;  
 there he had a friend fully trusted in all.

- [Gunn·arr kvað:] 15 „Ęin ’s mér Bryn·hildr · ǫllum þętri,  
 2 of borin Buðla, · hǫn ’s bragr kvenna;

- 4       fýrr skal'k mínu · fjörvi láta  
           an þeirar meýjar · meðmum týna.

[Quoth Guthr:] “Byrnhild alone is better to me than all—  
 that woman born of Budle—she is the peak of women.  
 I shall sooner lose my own life  
 than abandon that maiden's treasures.

- 16       Vill þú okkr fylki · til féar véla?  
 2       Gótt 's at ráða · Rínar malmi,  
           ok unandi · auði stýra  
 4       ok sitjandi · seltu njóta.“

Wilt thou with me betray the marshaller for money?  
 It is good to rule the ore of the Rhine [GOLD],  
 and, prospering, to wield the wealth,  
 and, sitting, to enjoy good fortune.”

- 17       Einu því Hogni · ann·svor veitti:  
 2       „Samir eigi okkr · s·líkt at vinna,  
           sverði rofna · svarna eiða,  
 4       eiða svarna, · unnar tryggðir.

This one answer Hawn then granted:  
 “It does not befit us two to do such things,  
 to break by the sword the sworn oaths—  
 the sworn oaths, the taken truces.

---

1 Einu því Hogni · ann·svor veitti ‘This one answer Hawn then granted’ | Shared with st. 45/1 below and *Brot* 6/1.

- 18       Vitum=a vit á moldu · menn in selli  
 2       meðan fjórir vér · folki röðum  
           ok sá inn húnski · her-Baldr lifir,  
 4       né in métri · méggð á moldu  
           ef vér fimm sonu · fœðum lengi  
 6       óttum góða · óxla knéttim.

We shall not know upon the earth a more blessed man  
 while we four do rule the folk  
 and the Hunnish host-Balder [WARRIOR = Siward] lives,  
 nor a nobler in-law upon the earth  
 if we rear five sons for long,  
 good of lineages, and let them grow.

2 fjórir vér 'we four' | Guthr, Hawn, Godthorm, and Siward.

- 19 Ek v<sup>e</sup>it g<sup>o</sup>r=la · hvaðan v<sup>e</sup>gir standa:  
 2 Eru Bryn·hildar · brek of·mikil.  
 I know clearly whence these troubles arise:  
 Byrnild's demands are far too great!

- 20 Vit skulum Guð·þorm · g<sup>o</sup>rva at vígi,  
 2 yngra bróður, · ó·fróðara;  
 hann vas fyr útan · ęiða svarna,  
 4 ęiða svarna, · unnar tryggðir.“  
 We shall make Godthorm ready for war,  
 our younger brother, the less learned.  
 He was outside of the sworn oaths—  
 the sworn oaths, the taken truces.”

- 21 D<sup>e</sup>lt vas at ęggja · ó·bil-gjarnan,  
 2 stóð til hjarta · hjorr Sig·v<sup>e</sup>rði.  
 It was easy to incite the unyielding man [= Godthorm];  
 the sword was stood unto the heart of Siward.

1 ęggja · ó·bil-gjarnan 'incite the unyielding man' | Also found in a proverb in *Gr*.

2 stóð til hjarta · hjorr 'the sword was stood unto the heart' | Formulaic. Cf. *Vsp* 52/3–4, *Fáfn* 1/4.

- 22 Réð til h<sup>e</sup>fnda · h<sup>e</sup>r-gjarn í sal  
 2 ok ęptir varp · ó·bil-gjörnum;  
 fló til Guð·þorms · Grams ramm=liga  
 4 kyn-birt éarn · ór konungs hendi.  
 The war-eager one turned to revenge in the hall  
 and threw after the unyielding man;  
 towards Godthorm flew violently Gram's  
 flashing-white blade from the hand of the king.

ALL | Sts. 22–23: Siward throws his sword, Gram, at Godthorm with such strength that it cuts him clean in two parts.

- 23 Hné hans of dolgr · til hluta tveggja;  
 2 h<sup>e</sup>ndr ok haufuð · hné á annan veg

en fōta hlutr · fell aprt í stað.

His enemy sunk down in two parts:  
his arms and head sunk to the side,  
but the part of his legs fell backwards to the ground.

---

2 haufuð | metr. emend.; hofuð R

---

1 of *dolgr* 'enemy' | Identical in sense to *dolgr*. The prefixing of a noun by the particle *of* is an archaic feature; cf. Introduction to the poem above. The authenticity of *of dolgr* is confirmed by another attestation in Egill *Arkv* 22 (SkP 5) from ca. 962 AD.

2 haufuð | The long form *haufuð* is metrically required since the second lift cannot fall on a short syllable (Males 2025b, p. 15).

24      Sofnuð vas Guð·rún · í sēingu  
2      sorga-laus · hjá Sig·vērði;  
         en hōn vaknaði · vilja firrð  
4      es hōn Freys vinar · flaut í dreýra.

Guthrun lay sleeping in the bed,  
sorrowless by Siward's side,  
but she awoke deprived of strength of will  
when in the blood of Free's friend [= Siward] she swam.

---

4 Freys vinar 'Free's friend' | It is not clear why Siward is called the friend of this god in particular. TODO: any other kennings of this type? Cf. *Ing-wine*.

25      Svá sló hōn svárar · sñnar hēndr  
2      at ramm-hugaðr · reis upp við beð:  
         „Grát=a þú, Guð·rún, · svá grimm=liga,  
4      brúðr frum-unga— · þér bróðr lifa.

So harshly did she beat her hands  
that the strong-minded man [= Siward] rose up against the bed:  
“Weep thou not, Guthrun, so horribly,  
O most young bride—thy brothers still live!

26      Á'k til ungan · erf-nytja,  
2      kann=at hann firra=sk · ór fjánd-garði;  
         þeir sér hafa · svárt ok dátt  
4      en nēr numit · ný=lig rōð.

I have an heritage-enjoyer [SON] far too young;  
he cannot remove himself from the court of foes.  
They make themselves fierce and violent,  
and have nearly fulfilled their new plans.

ALLL | Sts. 26–27: Siward predicts the death of his young son, Syemund.

- 27      Ríðr=a þeim síðan · þótt sjau alir,  
 2      systur sonr · s·líkr at þingi;  
       ek veit ggr=la · hví gegnir nú:  
 4      ein veldr Bryn·hildr · ǫllu þölví.  
 With them will not ride—though thou begetttest seven—  
 such a sister's son to the Thing.  
 I know clearly why this now happens:  
 alone is Byrnild at fault for all evil.

- 28      Mér unni mér · fyr mann hvern  
 2      en við Gunn·ar · grand ekki vann'k;  
       þyrmðað'k sífjum, · svornum eiðum,  
 4      síðr verra'k hēitinn · hans kvánar vinr.“

That maiden loved me more than any man,  
 but against Guthur I did no wrong;  
 I respected the kinship, the sworn oaths;  
 late will I be called a 'friend' of his wife.”

ALLL | Siward comforts Guthrun by blaming Byrnild for his death while defending the innocence of her brother Guthur who has no apparent motive to kill Siward when he has not done anything ill against him.

- 29      Kona varp ǫndu · en konungr fǫrvi,  
 2      svá sló hōn sváran · sinni hendi  
       at kvǫðu við · kálkar í vǫ  
 4      ok gullu við · gēss í tūni.

The woman lost her breath but the king his life.  
 So harshly did she beat her hand  
 that in response clanged the chalices in the cupboard  
 and in response shrieked the geese in the yard.

4 ok gullu við · gēss í tūni 'and in response shrieked the geese in the yard' | Identically shared with *I Guðr* 16/3.

- 30      Hló þa Bryn·hildr, · Buðla dóttir,  
 2      einu sinni · af ǫllum hug  
       es hōn til hvílu · heyra knátti  
 4      gjallan grát · Gjúka dóttur.

Then Byrnhild laughed, Budle's daughter,  
a single time out of all her heart,  
when from their resting-place she heard  
the shrill weeping of Yivick's daughter.

1-2 Hló ...hug 'Then ... heart' | Also found in *Brot* 9/1-2 with variation in the first b-verse.

- 31      Hitt kvað þá Gunn·arr, · gramr hauk-stalda:  
2      „Hlér=a þú af því, · heipt-gjörn kona,  
            glöð á golfi, · at þér góðs viti;  
4      hví hafnar þú · inum hvíta lit?  
            Fekna fœðir, · hygg at fæg séir.

This then quoth Guthur, the lord of young warriors  
“Thou dost not laugh, O feud-eager woman,  
glad on the floor, since thou knowest any good.  
Why dost thou abandon thy white colour?  
Rearer of wickedness, I think thou art fey!

- 32      Þú vérir þess · verðust kvinna  
2      at fyr augum þér · Atla hjoðgim,  
            séir bróðr þínum · blóðugt sár,  
4      undir dreýrgar, · knéttir yfir binda.“

For this wouldst thou be the worthiest of women  
that we before thy eyes should cut down Attle,  
that thou would see on thy brother a bloody gash,  
gory wounds; then wouldst thou bind over them.”

- 33      „Frýr=a maðr þér engi, Gunn·arr, · hefir full-vegít!  
2      Lítt sé=sk Atli · ófu þína;  
            hann mun ykkar · qnd síðarri  
4      ok é vesa · afl it meira.

“No one taunts thee, Guthur; thou hast fully triumphed!  
Little does Attle fear thy wrath;  
he will breathe longer than you two,  
and for ever be the greater power.

- 34      Ségja mun'k þér, Gunn·arr, · —sjalfr veitst qor=la—  
2      hvé ér yðr snimma · til saka réðuð;  
            varð'k=at ek til ung · né ofþrungin  
4      full-gódd fæi · á flæti bróður.

I will tell thee Guthur—thou knowest it clearly thyself—  
how ye were too soon in your decisions.

I was not too young nor oppressed,  
fully endowed with wealth upon my brother's floor.

- 35 Né ek vilda þat · at mik verr étta  
2 áðr ér Gjúkungar · riðuð at garði  
þrír á hestum, · þjóð-konungar,  
4 en þeira fœr · þœrf=gi véri.

Nor did I wish that a husband should have me  
before ye Yivickings rode to the court,  
three great kings upon your horses—  
but their coming was not a boon.

---

3 þjóð-konungar 'great kings' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

- 36 Þeim hét=umk þa  
2 es með golli sat · á Grana bógum;  
vas=at hann í augu · yðr of líkr,  
4 né á engi hlut · at álitum;  
þó þikki=sk ér · þjóð-konungar.

Then I vowed myself to *him*  
who sat with the gold on the back of Grane.  
In his eyes he was not like *you*  
nor in any part of his appearance,  
though ye think yourselves great kings!

---

1 Þeim hét=umk þa | There is certainly some corruption here seen by the unusual meter of this orphaned “line”, but the syntax and sense otherwise appears in order and no obvious emendation suggests itself.

- 37 Ok mér Atli þat · einni sagði  
2 at hvár=ki lét=sk · hœfn of deila,  
goll né jarðir, · nema gefa=sk léta'k;  
4 ok engi hlut · auðins féar,  
þa's mér jóð-ungri · eigu sældi  
6 ok mér jóð-ungri · aura talði.

TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.  
TODO.



TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 38 Þá vas á hvørfun · hugr mínns umb þat  
 2 hvárt ek skylda vega · eða val fella,  
 bõll í brynju, · umb bróður sök.  
 4 Þat myndi þá · þjóð-kunnt vesa,  
 mǫrgum manni · at munar stríði.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 39 Létum síga · sátt-mól okkur;  
 2 lék mér meirr í mun · meiddmar þiggja,  
 bauga rauða, · burar Sig-mundar,  
 4 né ek annars manns · aura vilda'k.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

No other mans ounces of silver would I have.

- 40 Unna einum · né ýmissum,  
 2 bjó=at umb hverfan · hug men-Skǫgul;  
 allt mun þat Atli · ęptir finna  
 4 es hann mína spýrr · morð-fǫr gǫrva,

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 41 at þęy=gi skal · þunn-gęð kona  
 2 annarrar ver · aldri leiða;  
 þá mun á hefndum · harma mínna.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 42 Upp reís Gunn·arr, · gramr verðungar,  
 2 ok umb hals konu · hęndr of lagði;  
 gingu allir, · ok þó ýmsir,  
 4 af heilum hug, · hana at lętja.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 43 Hratt af halsi · hveim þar sér;  
 2 lét=a mann sik lętja · langrar gęngu.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 44 Nam hann sér Hęgna · hvetja at rúnun:  
 2 „Sęggi vil’k alla · í sal ganga,  
 þína með mínum · —nú ’s þęrf mikil—  
 4 vita ef meini · morð-fęr konu  
 und’s af méli · ęnn mein komi,  
 6 þa lętum því · þarfar ráða.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 45 Einiu því Hęgni · and·svęr vęitti:  
 2 „Lętj=a maðr hana · langrar gęngu  
 þar’s hęn aþtr·borin · aldri verði!  
 4 Hęn kręng of kom=sk · fyr kné móður,  
 hęn ę borin · ó·vilja til,  
 6 męrgum manni · at móð-trega.“

This one answer Hawn then granted:

“Let no man restrain her from the long journey  
 where she might never be born again!  
 Frail she arrived before her mother’s lap;  
*she* was always born to ill deeds,  
 to [cause] heart-grief for many a man.”

3 þar's hōn aptr-borin aldi verði 'the long journey where she might never be born again' | The underlying implication is a bit unclear. Is the suicide thought to prevent her from being reborn, or is the sense that she will be so happy with Siward in the afterlife that she her soul will not desire to return among the living?

- 46 Hvarf sér ð·hróðugr · and·spilli frá  
2 þar's mōrk mēnja · mēiðmum deildi.

The dishonoured man turned away from their conversation,  
where the wood of neckrings [WOMAN] was dealing out treasures.

- 47 Leit hōn of alla · ęigu sīna,  
2 soltnar þýjar · ok sal-konur;  
goll-brynju smó · —vas=a gótt í hug—  
4 áðr sik miðlaði · mēkis ęggjum.

She beheld throughout all her estate  
the dead hand-maids and hall-women.  
She donned a golden byrnie—there was no good in her heart—  
before she pierced her stomach with the short-sword's edges.

---

ALL | Byrnild dons a golden byrnie and fatally wounds herself by disembowlement (see note to l. 4 *miðlaði*). There is a notable contradiction here, since Byrnild apparently stabs herself through the byrnie she has just donned.

4 *miðlaði* 'pierced her stomach' | *miðla* usually means 'to deal out, share' but here has the unparalleled sense 'cut something at the middle'. The image is thus that Byrnild plunges her sword into her belly and disembowels herself.

- 48 Hné við bólstri · hōn á annan veg  
2 ok hýor-unduð · hugði at rōðum:

She knelt down against the bolster on her side  
and, sword-wounded, thought of counsel:

- 49 „Nú skulu ganga · þęr's goll vili  
2 ok minni því · at mēr þiggja;  
ek gef hęrri · of hroðit sigli,  
4 bók ok blęju, · bjartar váðir.“

“Now shall those who will have gold  
and less things than it come and receive it from me.  
I give every woman a gold-enclosed necklace,  
a coverlet and bed-cover, [and] bright garments.”

---

3 of hroðit sigli ‘a gold-enclosed necklace’ | *of broðit* ‘(metal-)enclosed’ corresponding to OE *ge-broden*. For *sigli* ‘necklace’, only found thrice in the whole Norse corpus, see *Lok* 20.

- 50 Þǫgðu allir, · hugðu at rǫðum,  
 2 ok allir senn · ann·svǫr vǣittu:  
 „Örnar soltnar · munum enn lifa,  
 4 verða sal-konur · sǫmð at vinna.“

All were silent; thought of counsel,  
 and all at once an answer granted:  
 “Enough women have died! We will live on;  
 the women of the hall will do what is fitting.”

- 51 Und’s af hyggjandi · hǫr-skrýdd kona,  
 2 ung at aldri, · orð víðr of kvað:  
 „Vil’k=at ek mann traudan · né tor·bǫnan  
 4 umb óra sǫk · aldri týna,

Until wisely the linen-clad woman  
 young of age quoth a word in reply:  
 “I wish not that ont reluctant or hardly asked  
 for our sake should lose his life,

ALL | Byrnild relents. She will not force those who are reluctant to die with her, but they will receive greater honour in the afterlife if they follow her now than if they go on living.

- 52 þó mun á bęinum · brinna yðrum  
 2 fęri eyrir · þá’s ér framm komið,  
 neitt Męnju góð, · mǫn at vitja.

yet will on your limbs burn fewer  
 ounces of silver when ye arrive  
 —nor any boons of Mene [GOLDEN JEWELS]—to visit me.

- 53 Sęt=sk-tu niðr, Gunn·arr, · mun’k segja þér  
 2 lífs ör·vęna · ljósa brúði;  
 mun=a yðvart far · allt í sundi  
 4 þó’tt ek hafa · qndu látit.

Sit thee down Guthér—I will tell thee  
 of a light bride whose hopes of life are o’er.  
 Your ship will not be all [sunk] in the sound,  
 though I have given up my breath of life.

ALL | Byrnhild speaks to Guthr and makes a spae.

- 54 Sött munuð it Guð·rún, · snemmr an hyggir;  
 2 hefir kunn kona · við konungi  
 daprar minjar · at dauðan ver.

Thou and Guthrun will be reconciled sooner than thou thinkest;  
 the famous woman has a sorrowful remembrance  
 from the king after her husband's death.

3 daprar minjar 'sorrowful remembrance' | Swanhild, by whom Guthrun will remember Siward.

- 55 Þar 's mēr borin, · móðir fóðir;  
 2 sú mun hvítari · an inn heiði dagr,  
 Svan·hildr, vesa, · sólar geisla.

There a maiden is born; her mother rears her.  
 She will be whiter than the clear day,  
 Swanhild, than a ray of the sun.

3 sólar geisla 'sun-ray' | Swanhild is also likened to a *sólar geisli* in *Ghv* 15.

- 56 Gefa munt Guð·rúnu · góðra nökkurum,  
 2 skeyti skóða · skatna mengi;  
 mun=at at vilja · ver-sél gefin,  
 4 hana mun Atli · eiga ganga,  
 of borinn Buðla · bróðir minn.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

Attle will go to take her to wife,  
 the man born of Budle, my own brother.

5 of borinn Buðla · bróðir minn 'the man born of Budle, my own brother' | Identically shared with *I Guðr* 25/3.

- 57 Margs á'k minna=sk · hvé við mik fóru  
 2 þá's mik sára · svikna hofðuð;  
 vaðin at vilja · vas'k meðan lifða'k.

I have much to remember from how they treated me,  
 when they had sorely betrayed me.  
 I was deprived of willpower while I lived.

- 58 Munt Odd·rúnu · ęiga vilja  
 2 ęn þik Atli mun · ęigi láta;  
 it munuð lúta · á laun saman,  
 4 hön mun þér unna · sęm ek skylda'k,  
 ef okkr góð of sköpp · gørði verða.

Thou wilt want to take Guthrun to wife  
 but Attle will nowise let thee.  
 Ye two will embrace in secret.  
 She will love thee like I should have  
 if good shapes had let it be so for us.

- 59 Þik mun Atli · illu þęita,  
 2 munt í ęngan · orm-garð lagiðr.

Thee will Attle afflict with evil;  
 thou wilt be laid in the narrow snake-pit.

- 60 Þat mun ok verða · því=gi=t lęgra  
 2 at Atli mun · ęndu týna,  
 sęlu sįnni, · ok sofa lífi.  
 4 Því't hönnum Guð·rún · grýmir á þęð  
 snörpum ęggjum · af sörung hug.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 61 Sömri véri Guð·rún, · systir okkur  
 2 frum-ver sįnum · [...]  
 ef hęnni gęfi · góðra ráð  
 4 eða ętti hön hug · oss of líkan.

It would be more fitting for Guthrun, our sister,  
 [to follow] her first husband [in death],  
 if she had the counsel of good men,  
 or she had a heart like ours.

- 62 Ö·ört męli'k nú · ęn hön ęigi mun  
 2 umb öra sök · aldri týna;  
 hana munu hęfja · hęvar börur

4            til Jón·akrs · óðal·torfu.

Now I speak unhastily, but she will not  
lose her life for our sake.  
She will be lifted by billows high  
to Enacker's ethel-turf.

---

3 hana munu hefja · hóvar bōrur 'She will be lifted by billows high' | Clearly related to *Ghv* 13/3,  
with which the b-verse is identical.

63            [...] eru í vōr-úðum · Jón·akrs sonum;  
2            mun hōn Svan·hildi · sēnda af landi,  
             sīna meḡ · ok Sig·varðar.

TODO.  
she will send Swanhild away from the land,  
her daughter and Siward's.

64            Hana munu bíta · Bikka rōð  
2            því't Jōrmun·rekkr · ò·þarft lifir;  
             þá's ǫll farin · étta Sig·varðar,  
4            eru Guð·rúnar · grōti at fleiri.

Her will Beck's counsels bite,  
for Ermenric lives wickedly.  
Then is all the lineage of Siward destroyed;  
for Guthrun there are yet more causes for weeping.

---

ALL | Byrnhild predicts Swanhild's death. Cf. *Ghv* P1.

65            Biðja mun'k þik · bōnar einnar,  
2            sú mun í hēimi · hinst bōn vesa:  
             Lát-tu svá breiða · borg á velli  
4            at undir oss ǫllum · jafn-rúmt séi,  
             þeim es sultu · með Sig·vērði.

I will ask thee a single ask;  
in the Home it will be my very last ask.  
Let the stronghold upon the plain be so broad  
that under us all there be even room—  
us who perished with Siward.

66            Tjaldi þar umb þá borg · tjöldum ok skjöldum,  
2            vala-ript vel fōð · ok vala mēngi;

bręnni mér inn hũnska · à hlið aðra.

Let it be canopied there around the stronghold with canopies and shields,  
Welsh canvas well painted and a multitude of horses.  
Let me be burned by the Hunnish man's side.

---

2 vala 'horses' | A rare word. TODO.

67 Bręnni inum hũnska · à hlið aðra

2 mĩna þjóna, · męnjum gǫfga,  
tvá at hǫfðum · ok tvęir haukar;  
4 þa's ǫllu skipt · til jafnaðar.

Let be burned by the Hunnish man's other side  
my servants noble of neckrings,  
two by his head, and two hawks;  
then all is arranged evenly.

68 Liggi okkar ęnn í milli · malmr hring-variðr,

2 ęgg-hvasst ęarn, · svá ęndr lagit  
þa's vit bęði · bęð ęinn stigum  
4 ok hétum þa · hjóna nafni.

Let once more lie between us the ring-adorned metal [SWORD],  
the edge-sharp iron, once again laid  
like when we both mounted a single bed  
and then were called by a wedded couple's name.

---

ALL | Cf. *Brot* 20.

1 malmr hring-variðr 'ring-adorned metal [SWORD]' | A ring-sword, long obsolete by the time of *Sigsk*. See *HHj* 9/1 n.

69 Hrynja hǫnum þa · à hęl þęy=gi

2 hlunn-blik hallar, · hringa litkuð  
ef hǫnum fylgir · fęrð mín heðan;  
4 þęy=gi mun vǫr fǫr · aum=lig vesa,

Then will nowise the roller-gleams [DOORS?] of the hall  
crash down on the heels of the colourer of ring-swords [WARRIOR],  
if he is followed by my departure hence.  
Nowise will our journey be wretched,

---

2 hlunn-blik hallar 'roller-gleams of the hall' | TODO, proverbial?

70 þvi't hǫnum fylgja · fimm ambóttir,



- 2        áttu þjónar, · øðlum góðir,  
           fostr-man mitt · ok faðerni  
 4        þat's Buðli gaf · barni sínu.

for he is followed by five handmaids,  
 eight servants of good pedigree,  
 my foster-daughter, and the paternity  
 which Budle gave unto his child [me].

- 71        Margt sagða ek, · mynda'k fleira  
 2        es mér męir mjötuðr · mál-rúm gęfi;  
           ómun þverr, · undir svella,  
 4        satt ęitt sagða'k— · svá mun'k láta!“

Many things I said, I would [say] yet more  
 if the Measurer gave me greater room to speak.  
 My voice wanes, my wounds swell,  
 truth alone I have spoken—so will I die!”



# Hell-ride of Byrnhild

## (*Hæl-reið Bryn·hildar*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.650)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The Hell-ride of Byrnhild (*Helr*) describes how Byrnhild after her death is burned on her pyre in a beautiful chariot or wagon. In the afterlife she rides on the Hellway to reach her resting place in Hell when her road is blocked by a certain gow or troll-woman. The poem consists of their conversation.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Helr* is attested in full in **R**, where it follows *Sigs* and is followed by 2 *Guðr*.

The poem is also attested, with the exception of st. 6, in *Norn* 9, in a sequence of tales about the Walsings which also includes *Reg*. *Norn* is attested in several mss., including **F**. TODO: Halldórsson (2000), Introduction.

The textual variants in *Norn*'s version of *Helr* are divergent to the point that *Norn*'s *Helr* cannot be directly copied from **R**, but it is unclear whether it ultimately derives from **R** through a chain of copies, or whether both derive from a lost archetype predating **R**. At the very least, we can tell from the similarities between the prose of *Norn* and **R** that the two are unlikely to be related through oral tradition alone.

## Text

- P1 Eptir dauða Bryn·hildar vóru gǫr bǫl tvau: annat Sig·urði, ok  
 2 brann þat fyrr, en Bryn·hildr var á ǫðru brennd ok var hón í reið  
 þeiri er guð·vefum var tjölduð. Svá er sagt at Bryn·hildr ok með  
 4 reið·inni á hel·veg ok fór um tún þar er gýgr nokkur bjó. Gýgr·in  
 kvað:

After Byrnhild's death two pyres were made: one for Siward, and it burned earlier; but Byrnhild was burned on the other, and she was in that chariot which was canopied with god-weave. So it is said that Byrnhild drove with the chariot onto the Hellway and passed through a yard where a certain gow lived. Quoth the gow:

1 Eptir | The E is a bold capital in R.

ALL | The equivalent passage in *Norn*: *En birð-maðr einn spýrr: „hversu fór Bryn·hildr þá með?“ Gestr svarar: „þá drap Bryn·hildr sjau þræla sína ok fimm ambáttir en lagði sik sverði í gegnum ok bað sik aka með þessa menn til báls ok brenna sik dauða. Ok svá var gert, at henni var gert annat bál en Sigurði annat ok var hann fyrri brenndr en Bryn·hildr. Henni var ekit í reið einni ok var tjaldat um guð·vef ok purpúra ok glóaði allt við gull. Ok svá var hón brennd.“ Þá spurðu menn Gest hvárt Bryn·hildr hefði nokkut kveðit dauð. Hann kvað þat satt vera. Þeir báðu hann kveða ef hann kynni. Þá mælti Gestr: „þá er Bryn·hildr var ekit til brennu·nnar á hel·veg ok var farit með bana nęrr þomrum nokkurum, þar bjó ein gýgr. Hón [var] úti firir bellis·dyrum ok var í skinn·kyrtli ok svęrt yfir·lits. Hón hefir í bendi sér skęgar·vęnd langan ok męlti. „Þessu vil ek beina til brennu þinnar, Bryn·hildr; ok vęri betr at þú vęrir lifandi brennd firir ó·dåðir þinar þęr at þu lęst drepa Sigurð Fífnis·bana, svá á·gętan mann; ok opt var ek bómum fşinuntf. Ok firir þat skal ek hljóða á þik með hefndar·orðum þeim at þllum sér þú at leiðari er s·líkt beyra frá þęr sagt.“ Eptir þat hljóðast þęr á Bryn·hildr ok gýgr. Gýgr kvað: ‘But a hirdman asked: “How did Byrnhild come with him [= Siward]?” Guest answers: “Then Byrnhild slew her seven thralls and five handmaids and ran herself through with a sword and bade herself be driven to a pyre with these people and be burned after her death. And so it was done that one pyre was made for her and one for Siward, and he was burned earlier than Byrnhild. She was driven in a chariot and it was canopied with god-weave and purple, and it all glowed from gold, and so was she burned.” Then the men asked Guest whether Byrnhild had sung anything after death. He said it was true. They bade him sing, if he knew it. Then spoke Guest: “When Byrnhild had been driven to her burning on the Hellway and had passed near some cliffs, a gow lived there. She was outside before the doors of the cliffside and was in a skin skirt and swarthy of countenance. She has in her hand a long tree-branch, and spoke: ‘With this [wood] I wish to assist thy burning, Byrnhild, and it were better hadst thou been burned alive for thy misdeeds that thou didst cause Siward, Fathomers’s bane, to be slain—such an excellent man, and I was often ... with him. And therefore I shall bespeak thee with words of revenge such that all men will hate thee all the more as they hear such things told about thee.’ After that they scream at each other, Byrnhild and the gow. Quoth the gow:”*

2–3 í reið þeiri er guð·vefum var tjölduð ‘in that chariot which was canopied with god-weave’ | The canopy on the chariot was woven from silk (known as *god-weave*, the fabric of the gods). For the burial of women in wagons and chariots cf. TODO (Oseberg ship?).

3–4 Bryn·hildr ok með reið·inni á hel·veg ‘Byrnhild drove with the chariot on the Hellway’ | This gives us some interesting insight into old afterlife beliefs. After Byrnhild is burned she ends up between the worlds of the dead and the living, the so-called “Hell-way” or road to Hell, which she must travel to arrive at her final resting place in the Underworld; she is burned inside a chariot so that she will be able to travel comfortably. We may presume that the animals driving the chariot were slaughtered and burnt with her on the pyre.

## Bryn·hildr ręið hæl-veg ('Byrnhild rode the Hellway')

- 1 „Skalt í gøgnum · ganga ęigi  
2 grjóti studda · garða mína;  
bętr sómði þér · borða at rękja  
4 hęldr an vitja · vers annarar.

[R TODO, F TODO]

“Thou shalt nowise pass through these  
rock-supported yards of mine!  
It befit thee better to weave tapestries  
rather than visit another’s husband.

1 Skalt | *The S is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 4 an | *add. at F* 4 vers annarar  
'another's husband' | *várra ranna (norm.) 'our halls' F*

ALL | The gow begins by insulting Byrnhild and blames her early death on her immoral and unwomanly actions; if she had lived like a chaste woman and tended to simple domestic duties she would still have been alive. She also points out that Siward is not even her husband, but Guthrun's.

- 2 Hvat skalt vitja · af Val-landi,  
2 hvar-fúst hęfuð, · húsa mínna?  
þú hęfir, Vęr golls, · ef þik vita lystir,  
4 mild, af hęndum · manns blóð þvegit.“

[R TODO, F TODO]

Why shalt thou visit, come from Walland,  
O straying head, these houses of mine?  
Thou hast, mild Ware of gold [LADY], if thou hast lust to know,  
washed man-blood from thy hands.”

1 af Val-landi | *vá á landi F* 2 hvar-fúst 'straying' | *hverf-lynt 'fickle-minded' F* 3–4 Þú ...  
þvegit. 'Thou ... hands.' | Þú hęfir vęrgum · ef þín vitja / męrgum til matar · manns blóð gefit  
'Thou hast to many—if thou art visited(?)—wolves given man-blood for food.' F

[Bryn·hildr svaraði:]

- 3 „Bregð ęigi mér, · brúðr ór stęini,  
2 þó'tt ek vęra'k · í vikingu;  
ek mun okkur · őři þikkja  
4 hvar's męnn őðli · okkart kunna.“

[R TODO, F TODO]

“Upbraid me not, O bride from the stone [Gow],  
although I may have been in the wiking host;  
of us two will I seem the nobler  
wherever men know our pedigrees.”

1 ęigi mér | *mér ęigi F* 2 vęra'k 'I may have been' | *add. fyrr 'formerly' F* 4 hvar's męnn őðli ·  
okkart kunna 'wherever men know our pedigrees' | *þeim's őðli mitt um kunna 'to those who know  
my pedigree' (unmetrical) F*

- [Gýgr kvað:] 4 „Þú vast, Bryn-hildr, · Buðla dóttir,  
2 hēilli verstu · í hēim borin;  
þú hēfir Gjúka · of glatat bǫrnum  
4 ok búi þeira · brugðit góðu.“

[R TODO, F TODO]

“Thou wast, O Byrnchild, Budle’s daughter,  
under the worst omen born into the Home.  
Thou hast destroyed Yivick’s children  
and deprived their house of good.”

---

1 vast ‘wast’ | ert ‘art’ F

- [Bryn-hildr kvað:] 5 „Ek mun segja þér · svinn ór reiðu,  
2 vit-laussi mjök, · ef þik vita lystir:  
hvé gørðu mik · Gjúka arfar  
4 ásta-lausa · ok eið-rofa.

[R TODO, F TODO]

“I will tell thee, wise from my chariot,  
O very witless one, if thou hast lust to know,  
how the heirs of Yivick made me  
loveless and an oath-breaker.

- 6 Lét hami vára · hug-fullr konungr,  
2 átta systra, · undir eik borit;  
vas’k vetra tólf, · ef þik vita lystir,  
4 es ungum gram · eiða selda’k.

[R TODO, F TODO]

The king full of heart [= Budle] let the forms of us  
eight sisters be born beneath an oak.  
I was twelve winters old, if thou hast lust to know,  
when to the young lord oaths I gave.

---

2 undir eik borit ‘under an oak’ | King Budle let Byrnchild and her seven sisters be born under a (holy) oak due to the protection believed to be afforded by that species.

- 7 Hétu mik allir · í Hlym-dǫlum  
2 Hildi und hjalmi, · hvęrr es kunni.

[R TODO]

In the Limdales all did call me  
a Hild ’neath the helmet, whoever knew me.

- 8 Þá lét’k gamlan · á Got-þjóðu  
2 Hjalm-Gunn-ar nęst · hęljar ganga;  
gaf’k ungum sigr · Auðu bróður;

[R TODO, F TODO]

4 þar varð mér Óðinn · of-rēiðr um þat.

Then I next in the land of the Gots  
let old Helm-Guther go the way of Hell.  
I gave victory to Ead's young brother;  
then was Weden furious with me over that.

---

1 Gor-þjóðu | Goð-þjóðu R

---

ALL | As told in *Sigrdr* P3.

1 Gor-þjóðu 'land of the Gots' | Also found in *Gbv* 8, 16. The spelling -t- attested in mss. of *Heiðr* st. 94/8b (SKP 8). It is notable that ON *Gor-þjóð* is a direct reflex of the attested Gotish self-name, *Gut-piuda*, as found in the Gotish liturgical calendar (Schäferdieck 1988, p. 118).

9 Lauk hann mik skjöldum · í Skata-lundi,  
2 rauðum ok hvítum, · randir snurtu;  
þann bað hann slíta · svefni mínum  
4 es hversgi lands · hrēða=sk kynni.

[R TODO, F TODO]

He locked me inside shields in Shatelund,  
red ones and white; their rims clasped.  
He bade that one upend my sleeping  
who in no land could be frightened.

10 Lét umb sal minn · sunnan-verðan  
2 hóvan brinna · hēr alls viðar;  
þar bað hann einn þegn · yfir at ríða,  
4 þann's mér fōrði goll · þat's und Fáfni lá.

[R TODO, F TODO]

He made around my hall a south-facing  
high host of all wood [FIRE] burn.  
He bade only one thane there ride over it:  
him who brought me the gold which neath Fathomer lay.

11 Rēið góðr Grana · goll-miðlandi  
2 þar's fōstri mínns · flētjum stýrði;  
einn þótti hann þar · ǫllum bētri,  
4 víkingr Dana, · í verðungu.

[R TODO, F TODO]

On Grane rode the good gold-dealer [RULER = Siward]  
where my foster-son ruled the benches.  
Alone he seemed there better than all,  
the wiking of Danes, in the warband.

12 Svǫfum vit ok unðum · í séing einni

[R TODO, F TODO]

- 2        sem hann mín **bróðir** · of **borinn** véri;  
          **hvárt**-ki knátti · **hond** yfir annat  
 4        **átta** nóttum · **okkart** leggja.

We slept and were content in a single bed  
 as if he had been born my brother;  
 neither laid a hand o'er the other  
 for eight nights, of us two.

- 13      Því brá mér **Guð-rún**, · **Gjúka** dóttir,  
 2        at ek **Sig-vørði** · **svéfa**'k á armi;  
          þar varð'k þess **vís** · es **vildi**'g=a'k  
 4        at þau **vél**tu mik · í **ver**-fangi.

[R TODO, F TODO]

Thus upbraided me Guthrun Yivick's daughter,  
 because I slept on Siward's arm.  
 There I became wise of what I did not want to be:  
 that those two had tricked me in the catch of man.

2 **Sig-vørði** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-vørði** R

- 14      Munu við of-stríð · **alls** til lengi  
 2        **konur** ok **karlar** · **kvikkvir** fóðask;  
          vit skulum **okkrum** · **aldri** slíta,  
 4        **Sig-vørðr**, **saman**. · **Søkks**-tu, gýgjar-kyn!“

[R TODO, F TODO]

In great strife for far too long  
 will men and women alive be born.  
 We two shall end our age,  
 I and Siward, together.—Sink, thou gow-kind!”

4 **Sig-vørðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-vørðr** R

ALL | Following this stanza, *Norn* adds the following short prose passage: *Þá ópti gýgr ogurligri røddu ok hljóp inn í bjarg* 'it. "Then the gow shrieked with a terrible voice and jumped into the hill."

3 *aldri slíta* 'end our age' | In the afterlife. An interesting expression considering how both their *aldrar* 'ages, lifetimes' have already concluded, but Byrnild is presumably saying that they will now spend an eternity together.



# Second Lay of Guthrun

## *(II Guð·rúnar kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.759)–late C11th (0.199)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Second Lay of Guthrun** (abbrev. *2 Guðr*) takes the form of a monologue told by Guthrun, who laments her fate. The ancient lay of Guthrun?

## Text

## Dráp Niflunga ('The Slaying of the Nivlings')

- P1 Gunn·arr ok Hogni tóku þá gull'it allt, Fáfnis arf. Ó·friðr var  
 2 þá milli gjúkunga ok Atla; kenndi hann gjúkungum völd um  
 and·lát Bryn·hildar. Þat var til sétta, at þeir skyldu gipta hánnum  
 4 Guð·rúnu, ok gófu henni ó·minnis·veig at drekka áðr hón játti  
 at giptask Atla. Synir Atla voru þeir Erpr ok Eitill, en Svan·hildr  
 6 var Sig·urðar dóttir ok Guð·rúnar. Atli konungr bauð heim  
 Gunn·ari ok Hogni, ok sendi Vinga eða Kné·frøð\*. Guð·rún  
 8 vissi vélar ok sendi með rúnum orð at þeir skyldu eigi koma ok  
 til jar·tegna sendi hón Hogni hring'inn And·vara·naut ok knýtti  
 10 í vargs·hár. Gunn·arr hafði beðit Odd·rúnar, systur Atla, ok gat  
 eigi; þá fekk hann Glaum·varar, en Hogni átti Kost·beru. Þeira  
 12 synir voru þeir Sól·arr ok Snév·arr ok Gjúki. En er gjúkungar  
 kómu til Atla, þá bað Guð·rún sonu sína at þeir bæði gjúkungum  
 14 lífs en þeir vildu eigi. Hjarta var skorit ór Hogni en Gunn·arr  
 settir í orm·garð. Hann sló hǫrpu ok svéðði orma'na, en naðra  
 16 stakk hann til lifrar.

Guthur and Hawn then took all the gold, Fathomer's inheritance. Then there was enmity between the Yivickings and Attle; he blamed the Yivickings for Byrnild's passing. Such were their terms, that they would marry Guthrun off to him; and they gave her a forgetfulness-draught to drink before she agreed to be married off to Attle. The sons of Attle were Earp and Oatle, but Swanhild was the daughter of Siward and Guthrun. Attle invited Guthur and Hawn to his home and sent Winge or Kneefrith. Guthrun knew his wiles and sent a word in runes that they should not come, and for a sign she sent Hawn the ring Andwaresneat and tied through it a wolf's hair. Guthur had asked for the hand of Ordrun, Attle's sister, and did not get her; then he got Gleamware, and Hawn had Costbeare. Their sons were Solwer and Snowder and Yivick. But when the Yivickings came to Attle Guthrun asked her sons that they should plead for the life of the Yivickings, but they would not do so. The heart was cut out of Hawn but Guthur was placed in the snake-pit. He struck his harp and soothed the serpents, but an adder stung him unto the liver.

1 Gunn·arr | *The G is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 7 Kné·frøð\* | *gramm. emend.; Kné·frøðr (with erroneous abbreviation mark for nom. sg. -r) R*

ALL | This orienting prose passage serves shortly to summarise the narrative context behind the following 5 poems (2 *Guðr-Am*), all of which deal with Attle.

7 Vinga eða Kné·frøð\* 'Winge or Kneefrith' | The messenger is known as *Vingi* in *Am*, *Kné·frøðr* in *Akv*.

**P2** Þjóð-rekr konungr var með Atla ok hafði þar látit flesta alla menn  
2 sína. Þjóð-rekr ok Guð-rún kærðu harma sín á milli. Hón sagði  
hánun ok kvað:

King Thedric was with Attle, and had there lost almost all of his men. Thedric  
and Guthrun brooded over their injuries between themselves. She spoke to  
him and quoth:

## Guð-rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

- 1 „Mér vas'k meýja; · móðir mik fódði,  
2 björt í búi; · unna'k vel bróðrum—  
und's mik Gjúki · golli reifði,  
4 golli reifði, · gaf Sig-vørði.

“I WAS A MAIDEN OF MAIDENS; my mother raised me  
bright in her bower; I loved well my brothers—  
until Yivick with gold endowed me,  
with gold endowed me and gave [me] to Siward.

1 MÉR | *The M is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 4 Sig-vørði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R*

- 2 Svá vas Sig-vørðr · of sonum Gjúka  
sem vèri grønn laukr · ór grasi vaxinn,  
eða hjotr hǫ-beinn · of hvössum dýrum,  
4 eða goll glóð-rautt · af grǫu silfri.“

So was Siward over the sons of Yivick,  
like were he a green leek grown out of grass,  
or a hart, high-legged, amidst coarse beasts,  
or gold, glowing-red, beside grey silver—

1 Sig-vørðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R*

ALL | Cf. 1 *Guðr* 18, which shares the first two lines with only small differences, and the similar descriptions of Hallow (2 *HHund* 38) and Swanhild (*Ghv* 15).

2 grønn laukr 'green leek' | The leek was a highly valued plant. Compare *Vsp* 4 where the *grønn laukr* 'green leek' is said to have grown the first Golden Age. See also note there about its mythological significance.

- 3 und's mér fyr·munðu · mínir bróðr  
2 at ek étta ver · ǫllum frēmra;  
sofa þeir né mǫttu=t · né of sakar dǫma  
4 áðr þeir Sig-vørð · svelta létu.

until my brothers begrudged me  
that I had a husband better than all.  
They could not sleep nor preside over matters  
before they made Siward die.

4 Sig-vørð | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urð R*

3 sofa þeir né mottu-t · né of sakar dōma ‘They could not sleep nor preside over matters’ | A similar line is found in *Gríp* 29/3.

- 4      Grani rann at þingi, · gnýr vas at heýra,  
2      en þá Sig-vörðr · sjalfr eigi kom;  
          oll vöru sǫðul-dýr · sveita stokkin  
4      ok of vanið vási · umb vegðundum.

Grane ran to the Thing—a din was to be heard—  
but then Siward himself never came.  
All the saddle-beasts [HORSES] were dripping with sweat,  
although used to toil beneath riding men.

2 Sig-vörðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

3 sǫðul-dýr ‘saddle-beasts [HORSES]’ | This kenning also occurs in a loose stanza by Norse King Anlaf “the Holy” Haraldson.

- 5      Gekkt ek grátandi · við Grana róða,  
2      úrug-hlýra, · jó frá’k spjalla;  
          hnipnaði Grani þá, · drap í gras hǫfði;  
4      jór þat vissi: · eigendr né lifðu-t.

I went, weeping, with Grane to speak;  
with teary cheeks I asked the horse for news.  
Then Grane drooped, bent his head in the grass;  
the horse knew that its owners lived not.

4 þat | ‘þ’ (*with abbreviation mark omitted*) R

- 6      Lengi hvarf=at, · lengi hugir deildu=sk  
2      áðr of frégja’k · folk-vörð at gram;  
          hnipnaði Gunn·arr, · sagði mér Hogni  
4      frá Sig-varðar · sǫrum dauða:

Not long went by—long my thoughts were torn—  
before I asked the folk-ward about the prince.  
Guthur drooped; Hawn told me  
about Siward’s sore death:

4 Sig-varðar | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðar R

- 7      ,Liggr of hoggvinn · fyr handan ver  
2      Guð-þorms bani, · of gefinn ulfum;

- lít-tu þar **Sig-vörð** · á suðr-vega,  
 4 þá **h**eyrir þú · **h**rafna gjalla,  
**q**rnú gjalla, · **é**tsli fegna,  
 6 **v**arga þjóta · of **v**eri þínum.’

‘Cut down lies across yonder sea,  
 Godthorm’s bane [= Siward] given to the wolves.  
 Look for Siward there on the southern ways!  
 Then wilt thou hear the ravens shriek,  
 the eagles shriek, rejoicing in flesh,  
 the wolves howling o’er thy husband.’

3 **Sig-vörð** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-urð** R

- 8 ,**H**ví þú mér, **H**oggni, · **h**arma s-líka  
 2 **v**ilja-laussi · **v**ill of segja?  
 Þitt skyli **h**jarta · **h**rafnar slíta  
 4 **v**íð lönð yfir · en þú **v**itir manna.’

‘TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.’

- 9 **S**varaði Hoggni · **s**inni einu,  
 2 **t**rauðr góðs hugar, · af **t**rega stórum:  
 ,Þess átt, **G**uð-rún, · **g**róti at fleiri  
 4 at **h**jarta mitt · **h**rafnar slíti.’

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 ‘TODO.  
 TODO.’

- 10 Hvarf’k **ç**inn þaðan · **a**nn-spilli frá  
 2 á **v**ið, lesa\* · **v**arga leifar;  
 gørði’g=a’k **h**júfra · né **h**öndum sláa  
 4 né **k**væina of · sem **k**onur aðrar  
 þá’s **s**at **s**oltin · of **Sig-v**erði.

Alone I turned away from the conversation,  
 into the woods, to behold the leftovers of the wolves.  
 I did not pant nor beat my hands  
 nor wail over him like other women  
 when I sat dejected over Siward.

4 of | 'v' (corrupt form of 'v') R 5 Sig·vęřði | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

3–5 gęřði'g=a'k ... Sig·vęřði 'I did not ... Siward.' | Closely related to I Guðr 1/2–4.

- 11 Nętt þętti męr · nið·myrkr vesa  
 2 es sár=la sat'k · yfir Sig·vęřði;  
 ulfar þęttu=sk · ęllu bętri  
 4 ef þęir lęti mik · lifi tyna  
 eða brenndi mik · sem birkinn við.

The night seemed to me as dark as if moonless  
 when grieving I sat over Siward.  
 The wolves would have seemed to me all the better  
 if they had let me lose my life,  
 or if they had burned me like birch-dry wood.

2 Sig·vęřði | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- 12 Fór'k af fjalli · fimm dęgr talit  
 2 und's hęll Hę·alfs · hęva þękkðað'k.

I journeyed down from the fell for five nights and days,  
 until the high hall of Highelf I knew.

- 13 Sat'k með þęru · sjau misseri,  
 2 dętr Hę·konar, · í Dan·męrku;  
 hęn męr at gamni · goll bókaði  
 4 sali suðr-óna · ok svani danska.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 southern halls and Danish swans.

4 svani danska 'Danish swans' | In which Guthrun apparently took some delight. These fowls are also mentioned in I Guðr 16, Sigsk 29.

- 14 Hęfðu vit á skriptum · þat's skatar léku  
 2 ok á hann·yrðum · hilmis þęgna,  
 randir rauðar, · rekka Huna,  
 4 hjęr-drótt, hjalm-drótt, · hilmis fylgju.

TODO.  
 TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 15     **S**kip Sig·mundar · **s**kriðu frá landi,  
 2       gylltar grímur, · grafnir stafnar;  
       byrðu vit á borða · þat's þeir bqrðu=sk,  
 4       Sig·arr ok Sig·geirr, · suðr á Fífi.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 16     Þá frá Grím·hildr, · gotnesk kona,  
 2       hvat ek vëra hyggjuð;  
       hön brá borða · ok buri hęmti,  
 4       þrę-gjarn=liga, · þęss at spyrja:  
       Hverr vildi son · systur bóta  
 6       eða ver veginn · vildi gjalda.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

2 hvat ek vëra hyggjuð | This half-line is clearly incomplete and missing another half. The alliteration on *h* is probable.

- 17     Gørr létsk Gunn·arr · goll at bjóða,  
 2       sakar at bóta, · ok it sama Hęgni;  
       hön frétti at því · hverr fara vildi  
 4       vigg at sðla, · vagn at þęita,  
       hęsti ríða, · hauki fleygja,  
 6       qrum at skjóta · af ý-boga.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.



- 18 Valdarr Dönum · með Jarits·leifi,  
 2 Eymóðr þriði · með Jarits·kári;  
 inn gengu þá, · jöfrum líkir,  
 4 Lang·barðs liðar, · höfðu loða rauða,  
 stuttar brynjur, · steypa hjalma,  
 6 skölmum gyrðir, · höfðu skarar jarpar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

5 stuttar | *sø* N; *unmetrical* skreyttar R 5 steypa | stepta N 6 gyrðir | *add.* ok N

---

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Vþls* 32, and ll. 5–6 are quoted.

- 19 Hverr vildi mér · hnossir velfja,  
 2 hnossir velfja, · ok hugat mēla  
 ef þeir mētti mér · margra suta  
 4 tryggðir vinna; · né trúa gørða'k.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 20 Fórði mér Grím·hildr · full at drekka,  
 2 svalt ok sár=ligt, · né sakar munða'k;  
 þat vas of aukit · urðar magni,  
 4 svá köldum sé · ok sonar dręyra.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 21 Vöru í horni · hvers kyns stafir  
 2 ristnir ok roðnir · —ráða né máttak—  
 lyng-fiskr langr, · lands Haddingja  
 4 ax óskorit, · inn·leið dýra.

Into the horn were all kinds of staves  
 carved and reddened—I could not read them—

a long heather-fish [SNAKE] from the land of the Hardings,  
an unshorn ear of corn, the entrails of beasts.

---

3 langr | lagar N

---

ALL | This st. and the next are quoted in *Vþls* 32.

- 22 Vǫru þeim bjóri · bǫl mǫrg saman,  
2 urt alls víðar · ok akarn brunnin,  
um-dogg arins, · iðrar blótnar,  
4 svíns lifr soðin; · því't hǫn sakar døyfði.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

2 brunnin | so N; *meaningless* inn R 3 iðrar blótnar | 'itrar blotna' N 4 hǫn | om. N

- 23 Eñ þa gleymðu, · es getit hǫfðu,  
2 ǫll jǫfurs · jór-bjúg í sal;  
kvǫmu konungar · fyr kné þrennir  
4 aðr hǫn sjalfa mik · sótti at máli.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 24 ,Gef'k þér, Guð-rún, · goll at þiggja,  
2 fjǫlð alls féar, · at þínn fǫður dauðan,  
hringa rauða, · Hlǫð-vés sali,  
4 ár-sal allan, · at jǫfur fallinn.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 25 Húnskar meýjar, · þér's hlaða spjöldum  
2 ok gøra goll fagrt, · svá't þér gaman þikki;  
eín skalt ráða · auði Buðla,  
4 golli gǫfguð · ok gefin Atla.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 26 ,Vil'k eigi ek · með veri ganga  
 2 né Bryn·hildar · bróður eiga;  
 samir eigi mér · við son Buðla  
 4 étt at auka · né una lífi.‘

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 27 ,Hirð-a þú hǫldum · heiptir gjalda  
 2 því't vér hofum · valdit fyrri;  
 svá skalt láta · sem þeir lífi báðir,  
 4 Sig·vǫrðr ok Sig·mundr, · ef þú sonu fœðir.‘

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

---

4 Sig·vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

- 28 ,Má'k=a'k, Grím·hildr, · glaumi bella  
 2 né víg-risins · vãnir telja  
 síðst Sig·varðar · sár=la drukku  
 4 hré-gífr, Huginn · hjart-blóð saman.‘

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

---

3 Sig·varðar | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðar R

- 29 ,Þann hefí'k allra · étt-gofgastan  
 2 fylki fundit · ok framarst nøkkvi;  
 hann skalt eiga · und's þik aldr viðar,  
 4 ver-laus vesa, · nema vilir þenna.‘

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 30     ,Hirð-a þú bjóða · bǫlva-fullar  
 2     þrö-gjarn=liga · þér kindir mér!  
      Hann mun \*Gunn·ar · grandi þeita  
 4     ok ór Hǫgna · hjarta slíta.  
      Mun'k=at letja · áðr lífs-hvatan  
 6     egg-léiks hvotuð · aldri nemi'k.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 31     Grátandi Grím·hildr · greip við orði  
 2     es burum sínum · bǫlva vetti  
      ok mǫgum sínum · meina stórra:

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 32     ,Lond gef'k enn þér, · lýða sinni,  
 2     Vin-björg, Val-björg, · ef þú vill þiggja;  
      eig of aldr þat · ok uni, dóttir!

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 33     ,Þann mun'k kjósa · af konungum  
 2     ok þó af niðjum · nauðig hafa;  
      verðr eigi mér · verr at ynði  
 4     né bǫl bróðra · at bura skjóli.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 34      Senn vas á hęsti · hvęrr dręngr litinn  
 2      en víf valnesk · hafið í vagna;  
       vér sjau daga · svalt land riðum,  
 4      en aðra sjau · unnir kníðum,  
       en ina þriðju sjau · þurrt land stigum.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 35      Þar hlið-verðir · hárar borgar  
 2      grind upp luku · áðr í garð riðum;  
       vakði mik Atli · en ek vesa þóttumsk  
 4      full ills hugar · at fręndr dauða:

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 36      ,Svá mik ný=liga · nornir vękja,  
 2      víl-sinnis spó · vildi at ek réða;  
       hugða'k þik, Guð-rún, · Gjúka dóttir,  
 4      lę-blöndnum hjör · leggja mik í gognum.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 37      Þat 's fyr ęldi · es járn dręyma,  
 2      fyr dul ok vil · drósar reði;  
       mun'k þik við bęlvi · brenna ganga,  
 4      líkna ok lękna · þó'tt mér lęðr sér.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 38 Hugða'k hér í túni · tēja fallna  
 2 þá's ek vildi'g=a'k · vaxna láta,  
 rifnir með rótum, · roðnir í blóði,  
 4 bornir á bękki, · beðið mik at tyggva.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 39 Hugða'k mér af hęndi · hauka fljúga  
 2 bráða-lausa · bql-ranna til;  
 hjortu hugða'k þeira · við hunang tuggin,  
 4 sorg-móðs sefa, · sollin blóði.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 40 Hugða'k mér af hęndi · hvelpa losna,  
 2 glaums and-vana, · gylli báðir;  
 hold hugða'k þeira · at hręum orðit,  
 4 nauðigr\* náí · nýta'k skylda'k.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 41 Þar munu seggir · of sóing dóma  
 2 ok hvítinga · hofði nęma;  
 þeir munu fęigir · fāra náttu  
 4 fyr dag litlu · dróttum bęrgja.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 42 Lęgja'k síðan · —né sofa vilda'k—  
 2 þrę-gjarn í kqr; · þat man'k gęrva.

TODO.  
TODO.





# Third Lay of Guthrun

## (*III Guð·rúnar kviða*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.731)–early C11th (0.178)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Third Lay of Guthrun** (*3 Guðr*) is a short narrative poem, depicting just a single scene. At 10 stanzas it is the shortest poem in R, and arguably one of the most forgettable. Its only notable moments are its depiction of an ordeal by hot water and its allusion to the drowning of a slave-woman in a bog.

### Dating

The most important factor towards dating *3 Guðr* is its conception of the ordeal by hot water. This type of ordeal first appears in the early C6th Frankish *Salic Law*, and is always closely associated with the Catholic clergy. TODO: We ought to investigate when it went out of fashion. [https://www.degruyterbrill.com/document/d003/html](https://www.degruyterbrill.com/document/document/003/html)

### Summary

Herch, one of Attle's slave-women and concubines tells him that she has seen his wife Guthrun sleep with Thedric. Attle becomes distressed upon hearing this (P1). Guthrun asks him what is wrong (1), and he responds that Herch has accused her of sleeping with Thedric (2). Guthrun promises to prove her innocence through a trial by ordeal involving taking up a white stone out of boiling water (3); while she and Thedric did sit down together, they did so only in mutual grief over the deaths of her brothers (4–5). Guthrun tells Attle to summon the German lord Saxe to carry out the trial, and seven hundred men arrive as witnesses (6). Before picking up the stone, Guthrun laments over her brothers' deaths, saying that they would have disputed the accusation through violence, but that she must prove her innocence alone

(7). She then puts her hand in the boiling water, and takes out the stone unscathed. She holds it up and shows it to the witnesses (8). Atle laughs, knowing that his wife has been faithful, and orders Herch to pick up the stone (9). She does so—and her hands are horribly scorched. She is dragged to a “foul bog”, presumably to be drowned. The poet ends by laconically stating that this was how Guthrun in such a way was “restored for her affronts” (10).

## Text

## Capitulum ('New Chapter')

- P1 Herkja hét ambótt Atla; hón hafði verit frilla hans. Hón sagði  
 2 Atla at hón hefði sét Þjóð-rek ok Guð-rúnu bæði saman. Atli var  
 þá all-ó-kátr. Þá kvað Guð-rún:

Herch was the name of a maidservant of Attle; she had been his concubine.  
 She told Attle that she had seen Thedric and Guthrun both together. Then  
 Attle was very unhappy. Then quoth Guthrun:

## Guð-rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

- 1 „Hvat 's þér, Atli? · é, Buðla sonr,  
 2 es þér hryggst í hug; · hví hlér þú éva?  
 Hitt myndi óðra · jörllum þykkja  
 4 at við menn mæltir · ok mik seir.“

“WHAT IS WITH THEE, Attle? Always, son of Bodle,  
 art thou sad at heart—why laughest thou never?  
 It would seem more proper to earls  
 that thou spoke with men and looked at me.”

---

1 Hvat | The H ('b') is an ornamented initial 2 lines in height with the left line rising in the margin 5 lines high in R.

- 2 „Tregi mik þat, Guð-rún, · Gjúka dóttir,  
 2 mér í hollu · Herkja sagði  
 at þit Þjóðrekr · undir þaki svéfið  
 4 ok léttliga · líni verðið.“

“It troubles me, O Guthrun, Yivick's daughter,  
 that in the hall Herch told me  
 that thou and Thedric slept beneath one roof,  
 and lightly did ye mind your linen.”

---

4 léttliga · líni verðið 'lightly did ye mind your linen' | Euphemistic; they threw off their clothes and slept with each other.

- 3 „Þér mun'k alls þess · eiða vinna  
 2 at inum hvíta · helga steini,  
 at ek við Þjóðmar · þat-ki átta'k,

4 es vǫrðr né verr · vinna knátti,—

“For thee I will swear the oaths to all of it  
—by the white, holy stone,  
that I did no such thing with Thedmar—  
those which no married woman nor man has sworn,

---

2 at inum hvíta · hēlga steini ‘by the white, holy stone’ | The stone lifted out of a pot of boiling water in the trial by ordeal, as described further in st. 8.

3 Þjóðmar ‘Thedmar’ | Historically, Thedmar (*Theodemir*) was the father of Thedric (*Theoderic*) the Great, who took over the kingdom after his father’s death (see Index). The use of the name here may either be a scribal error (whether for “Thedric” or for “Thedmar’s son”), or a nickname caused by the conflation of the two persons in the late Norse tradition.

4 es vǫrðr né verr · vinna knátti ‘those which no married woman nor man has sworn’ | I.e., “those oaths which etc.” — Guthrun’s use of *vǫrðr* ‘wife, married woman’ and *verr* ‘husband, married man’ serve to question the reliability of Herch’s testimony by pointing out that she, as an unmarried slave-woman, is not in a position to make legally binding accusations.

4 nema ek halsaða · hērja stilli,  
2 jǫfur ó·neisinn, · ęinu sinni;  
aðrar vǫru · okkrar spękjur  
4 es vit hǫrmug tvau · hnigum at rúnum.

unless I embraced the stiller of hosts [RULER = Thedmar],  
the unshamed prince, a single time.  
Different were the dealings of us two,  
when we, distressed, reclined in whispers.

5 Hér kom Þjóðrekr · með þrjá tǫgu,  
2 lifa þęir né ęinir, · þriggja tega manna;  
hrink-tu mik at bróðrum · ok at brynjuðum,  
4 hrink-tu mik at ęllum · à hǫfuð-niðjum.

Hither Thedric came with thirty men;  
of those thirty none still lives.—  
Surround me with brothers and with byrned men;  
surround me with all close kinsmen!

---

3 hrink-tu ‘surround’ | Consisting of *bring*, 2nd sg. imper. of *bringja* ‘surround, encircle’ + *þú* ‘thou’. The clitic form *-tu* has caused devoicing.

6 Sęnd at Saxa, · sunn-manna gram;  
2 hann kann hęlga · hver vellaða;  
sjau hundruð manna · ĩ sal gingu  
4 áðr kvęn konungs · ĩ kętil tóki.

Send for Saxe, the lord of Southmen;  
 he can hallow the boiling cauldron.”  
 Seven hundred men went into the hall,  
 before the king’s wife should reach into the kettle.

---

1 Saxa, · sunn-manna gram ‘Saxe, the lord of Southmen’ | The Southmen being the Germans. —  
 This line shows that the trial by cauldron was considered a foreign, specifically German custom by  
 the poet, who naturally imagined Atle and Guthrun to have belonged to his own, Norse culture.  
 For its bearing on dating the poem see Introduction.

- 7 „Kømr=a nú Gunn·arr, · kalli’k=a Høgna,  
 2 sé’k=a síðan · svása bróðr;  
 sverði myndi Høgni · s·líks harms reka,  
 4 nú verð’k sjölf fyr mik · synja lýta.“  
 “Now Guther will not come; I will not call on Hawn;  
 I will not henceforth see my beloved brothers.  
 By his sword would Hawn avenge such an affront;  
 now I for myself must disprove the slanders!”

- 8 Brá hōn til botns · björtum lófa  
 2 ok hōn upp of tók · jarkna-stēina:  
 „Sé nú sēggir · —sykn em’k orðin  
 4 hēilag=liga— · hvé sjá hvern velli.“  
 She thrust to the bottom her bright palms,  
 and she up did take the arkenstones:  
 “Let men now see—I am proven innocent  
 through holy means!—how this cauldron boils!”

---

2 jarkna-stēina ‘arkenstones’ | Gems, crystals; probably a borrowing from the Old English *eorcnan-stānas* ‘id.’ The modern English form *arkenstone* was coined by Tolkien.

- 9 Hló þá Atla · hugr í brjósti  
 2 es hann hēilar sá · hēndr Guð·rúnar:  
 „Nú skal Hērka · til hvers ganga,  
 4 sú’s Guð·rúnu · grandí vęnti.“  
 Then laughed Atle’s heart in his chest,  
 when he saw unscathed the hands of Guthrun:  
 “Now shall Herch to the cauldron go,  
 she who hoped for Guthrun’s harm!”

---

1 Hló þá Atla · hugr í brjósti ‘Then laughed Atle’s heart in his chest’ | Echoing *Þrk* 31/1.

- 10 Sá=at maðr armligt, · hvęrr es þat sá=at,  
 2 hvé þar á Hęrkju · hęndr sviðnuðu;  
 leiddu þá męy · í mýri fúla,  
 4 svá þá Guð·rún · sǫnna harma.

Man saw nothing pitiful if he did not see that,  
 how there on Herch the hands were scorched.  
 Then they led the maiden into the foul bog;  
 so was Guthrun restored for her affronts.

---

3 leiddu þá męy · í mýri fúla ‘Then they led the maiden into the foul bog’ | To be drowned, as was the customary Germanic punishment for perjurers; see *Vsp* 38 n.

# Weeping of Ordrun

## *(Odd·rúnar grátr)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.954)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Weeping of Ordrun** (*Oddr*) is another heroic poem. The following edition and translation is by no means complete.

## Text

## Frá Borgnýju ok Odd-rúnu ('From Burgny and Ordrun')

- P1      Heið·rekr hét konungr; dóttir hans hét Borg·ný. Vil·mundr hét  
 2      sá er var friðill hennar. Hón mátti eigi fóða börn áðr til kom  
       Odd·rún, Atla systir; hón hafði verit unnusta Gunn·ars, Gjúka  
 4      sonar. Um þessa sögu er hér kveðit:

HEATHRIC WAS THE NAME OF A KING. His daughter's name was Burgny. Wilmund was the name of her lover. She could not bear children before Ordrun, Attle's sister, arrived. She had been the lover of Guthar, Yivick's son. About this saw it is here sung:

1 Heið·rekr | *The H ('D') is an ornamented initial 2 lines in height with the left line rising 4 lines high in R.*

- 1      Hęyrðað'k sęgja · í sęgum fornum  
 2      hvę męř of kom · til Morna-lands;  
       ęngi mátti · fyr jęřð ofan  
 4      Hęřðreks dóttur · hęlpir vinna.

I HEARD IT SAID in ancient saws  
 how a maiden came to Mornland;  
 noone could—above the earth—  
 find help for Heathric's daughter [= Burgny].

1 Hęyrðað'k | *The H is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.*

1 Hęyrðað'k sęgja · í sęgum fornum 'I heard it said in ancient saws' | Formulaic opening; cf. *Hild* 1: *ik gi·bórta dat sęggen* 'I heard it said' which likewise uses the 1sg past of 'hear' and the infinitive of 'say'. The ancestral Proto-Germanic phrase may be reconstructed as \**ek ga-hauzidō (þat) sęgianq*. — For a similar opening formula involving the verb \**frehnanq* '(come to) learn, find out through hearsay' cf. *Gbv* 1/1 n.

- 2      Þat frá Odd·rún, · Atla systir,  
 2      at sú męř hafði · miklar sóttir;  
       brá hęn af stalli · stjórն-bitluðum  
 4      ok á svartan · sęðul of lagði.

This learned Ordrun, Attle's sister,  
 that the maiden [= Burgny] had great ailments;  
 she grabbed from the stable a rudder-bitted steed,  
 and a black saddle on [it] did lay.



- 3 Lét hōn **mar** fara · **mold**-veg sléttan  
 2 und's at **hári** kom · **hōll** standandi;  
 ok hōn **inn** of gekk · **ęnd**-langan sal;  
 4 **svipti** hōn **sōðli** · af **svōngum** jó  
 ok hōn þat **orða** · **alls** fyrst of kvað:

She let the steed travel the smooth soil-way [EARTH]  
 until she came to the high standing house  
 and she went inside the endlong hall.  
 She cast the saddle off the slender horse  
 and she this word first of all did say:

---

3 ok hōn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal 'and she went inside the endlong hall.' | The whole line is formulaic; cf. *Vkv* 8 n.

5 ok ... of kvað 'and ... did say' | A formulaic long-lines; cf. *Þrk* 2/1 n.

- 4 „Hvat es **fręgst** · á **foldu**  
 2 eða **hvat** er **hlęðst** · **Hūna**-lands?“  
 „Hér liggr **Borg**-ný · of **borin** vęrkjum,  
 4 **vina** þín, Odd-rún, · **vit** ef hjalpir!“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 5 „Hvęrr hęfir **vísir** · **vamms** of lęitat?  
 2 Hví eru **Borg**-nýjar · **bráðar** sóttir?“

TODO.  
 TODO.

- 6 „**Vil**-mundr hét · **vinr** hauk-stalda,  
 2 hann **varði** męy · **varmri** blęju,  
**fimm** vetr alla, · svá hōn sǫnn **fōður** lęyndi.“

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 7 **Þęr** hykk męltu · þvígít flęira,  
 2 gekk **mild** fyr kné · **męyju** at sitja;  
**ríkt** gól Odd-rún, · **rammt** gól Odd-rún,

4 bitra galdra · at Borg-nyju.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

8 Knátti mér ok mögr · mold-veg sporna,

2 börn þau in blíðu · við bana Högna;

þat nam at mēla · mér fȝor-sjúka

4 svá't hōn ękki kvað · orð it fyrra:

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

9 „Svá hjalpi þér · hollar vęttir,

2 Frigg ok Freyja · ok fleiri goð

sem þú fęlldir mér · fār af hōndum.“

“So help thee hold wights,

Frie and Frow, and yet more gods,

as thou removedest this danger from my hands.”

---

1 Svá hjalpi þér ‘So help thee’ | A close semantic parallel, likewise invoking several gods to “help” somebody, is found on the 12th c. Saltfleetby spindle-whorl (E 18, normalised): *Óðinn ok Heim-dalr ok Þjálfi, þęir hjalpa þér Ulf-ljótr(?)* ... “Weden and Homedall and Thelwe, may they help thee, Wolfight ...”.

10 „Hné’k=at ek af því · til hjalpar þér

2 at þú vęrir þess · verð aldri=gi;

hét’k ok ęfnda’k · es ek hinig mēla

4 at ek hví-vetna · hjalpa skylda’k

þá’s qōlingar · arfi skiptu.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

11 Þa nam at setjask · sorg-móð kona

2 at tēlja bōl · af trega stórum:

TODO.

TODO.

- 12 „Vas’k upp alin · í jofra sal,  
 2 flęstr fagnaði, · at fira ráði;  
 unða ek aldri · ok ęign fęður  
 4 fimm vetr ęina · svá’t minn faðir lifði.

I was reared up in the princely hall,

TODO.

I was content with life and my father’s estate  
 for but five winters while my father lived.

- 13 Þat nam at męla, · mál it øfsta  
 2 sjá móðr konungr · áðr hann sylti.

TODO.

TODO.

- 14 Mik bað hann góða · golli rauðu  
 2 ok suðr gefa · syni Grím·hildar;  
 kvað-a hann ina óðri ·alna myndu  
 4 męy í hęimi · nema mjötuðr spillti.“

He bade me be endowed with red gold  
 and given in the south to the son of Grimhild.

TODO.

TODO.

- 15 „Ør est, Odd-rún, · ok ør·vita  
 2 es þú mér af fari · flęst orð of kvað;  
 ęn ek fylgða’k þer · à fjörgynju  
 4 sęm vit bróðrum tveim · of bornar vęrim.

“TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

4 bornar | borin R

- 16 Man’k hvat męltir · ęnn umb aptan  
 2 þá’s ek Gunn·ari · gørða’g drekku;

- s·líks dómi kvað=at-tu · síðan mundu  
 4 meyju verða · nema mér einni.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

1 Man'k hvat mēltir · enn umb aptan | This line is clearly corrupt as seen by the lack of alliteration connecting the two halves. The simplest solution is to switch the places of *mēltir* and *enn*, but this produces a three-syllabic a-verse and a five-syllabic b-verse. Another possibility would be *Man'k hvat \*enn · umb aptan mēltir*, but the metrics are still questionable.

- 17 Bryn·hildr í búi · borða rakði,  
 2 hafði hōn lýði · ok lōnd umb sik;  
 jorð dusaði · ok upp-himinn  
 4 þa's bani Fáfnis · borg of þatti.

Byrnhild in her bower wove tapestries;  
 she had warriors and lands around her.  
 The Earth stood still and Up-heaven  
 when Fathomer's bane [= Siward] beheld that stronghold.

- 18 Þa vas víg vegit · vōlsku sverði  
 2 ok borg brotin, · sú's Bryn·hildr átti;  
 vas=a langt af því · heðr vō-lítit  
 4 und's þer vélar · vissi allar.

Then the battle was fought with a Welsh sword  
 and broken was the stronghold which Byrnhild owned.  
 It was not long thereafter—rather woefully short—  
 until she knew all the guiles.

---

4 þer vélar 'the guiles' | Namely that Siward had switched shapes with Guthur.

- 19 Þess lét hōn harðar · hefndir verða  
 2 svá't vér ǫll hōfum · órnar raunir;  
 þat mun á hōlða · hvert land fara  
 4 es hōn lét svelta=sk · at Sig·verði.

For that she declared there would be harsh revenges,  
 those which we all have known enough.  
 It will travel to every land of men  
 how she made herself to die after Siward.

---

4 Sig·verði | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- 20      Æn ek Gunn·ari · gat'k at unna,  
 2      **b**auga ðeili, · sēm Bryn·hildr skyldi;  
       en hann Bryn·hildi · **b**að hjalm geta,  
 4      hana kvað hann ósk-meý · verða skyldu.

But I got to love Guther,  
 the dealer of bigs, like Byrnhild should have,  
 but he bade a helmet be given to Byrnhild;  
 he said she would be his adopted daughter.

- 21      Buðu þeir Atla · **b**auga rauða  
 2      ok bróðr mínum · bótr ó-smáar;  
       bauð hann enn við mér · bú fimm-tían,  
 4      hlið-farm Grana · ef hann hafa vildi.

They offered Attle red bigs,  
 and my brother unlittle [great] restitutions.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

1 Atla | árla R. 3 fimm-tían | .xv. R

3 fimm-tían 'fifteen' | For metrical reasons the abbreviation *xv* is resolved to the archaic hiatus form *fimm-tían* rather than the standard *fimm-tán*. The meter of *Oddr* does rarely permit 3-syllable verses (*Oddr* 4/1a–b, 4/2b, 6/1a), but restoring hiatus is the better option since it agrees with the typical metrical patterns of the poem; *-tían* is also metrically secured from the early C11th by Þorm Þorgdr (SkP 5), 1/4b: *fimm-tían* 'fifteen', 15/2b: *þré-tían* 'thirteen'.

The suffix *-t(j)án* 'teen' in the numerals 13–19 behaves curiously in classical ON and modern Icelandic. In 13–16 (*þré-tán*, *fjór-tan*, *fimm-tán*, *sex-tán*) the suffix is *-tán*, but in 17–19 (*sjáu-tján*, *át-tján*, *ní-tján*) it is *-tján* (< *-tían*). The latter is undoubtedly the older form, deriving from PN *\*-tiban* corresponding to OHG *-zeban*, Gothic *-taibun*; see further Konráð Gíslason (1879), Kock (1893, pp. 137–142).

- 22      Æn Atli kvað=sk · **ę**igi vilja  
 2      **m**und aldri=gi · at męgi Gjúka;  
       þęy=gi vit mōttum · við munum vinna  
 4      nema ek hélt hōfði · við hring-brota.

TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.  
 TODO.

- 23      Męltu margir · mńir niðjar,  
 2      kvōðu=sk okkr hafa · orðit bęði  
       en mik Atli kvað · **ę**igi myndu

4            **l**ýti ráða · né lǫst gøra.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

24        Eñ s·líks skyli · synja aldri  
2        **m**aðr fyr annan · þar's **m**un-úð dęilir.

TODO.

TODO.

25        Sęndi **A**tli · **ó**ru sína  
2        of **m**yrkvan við · **m**ín at fręista;  
     ok þęir **k**vómu · þar's **k**oma né skyldu=t  
4        þa's **b**ręiddu vit · **b**léju ęina.

Attle sent his messengers  
o'er the mirky wood to ask for me,  
and they came where they should not have come,  
when we two had spread out a single bed-cover.

---

1 Sęndi Atli · óru sína 'Attle sent his messengers' | Cf. *Akv* 1/1.

26        **B**uðu vit þegnum · **b**auga rauða  
2        at þęir **ę**igi til · **A**tla sęðði;  
     ęn þęir **ó**=liga · **A**tla sęğðu  
4        ok **h**vat=liga · **h**ęim skunduðu.

We offered the thanes red bighs  
that they should not tell it to Attle,  
but harmfully they told Attle,  
and rushingly hurried home.

27        Eñ þęir **G**uð·rúnu · **g**or=la lęyndu  
2        því at hōn **h**ęldr vita · **h**ōlfu skyldi.

TODO.

TODO.

28        **H**lymr vas at **h**ęyra · **h**óf-gollinna  
2        þa's í **g**arð riðu · **G**júka arfar;  
     þęir ór **H**ęgna · **h**jarta skøru

4            ɛn í orm-garð · annan lögðu.

There was a din to be heard from the golden-hooved ones  
when into the court rode Yivick's heirs;  
out of Hawn they cut the heart,  
but in the snake-pit they laid the other.

---

3–4 þeir ... lögðu. 'out of ... the other.' | The deaths of Guthur and Hawn are told in *Akv* 23–35, *Am* 56–64.

29            Vas'k ɛnn farin · ɛinu sinni  
2            til Gɛir-mundar · gørva drykkju;  
              nam horskr konungr · hørpu sveigja  
4            því't hann hugði mik · til hjalpar sér,  
              kyn-ríkr konungr, · of koma myndu.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

30            Nam'k at heyra · ór Hlés-eyju  
2            hvé þar af stríðum · strængir meltu,  
              bað'k ambáttir · búnar verða,  
4            vilda'k fylkis · fjörvi bjarga;  
              létum fljóta · far lund yfir  
6            und's alla sá'k · Atla garða.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

31            Þá kom in arma · út skévandi,  
2            móðir Atla, · hön skyli morna!

TODO.

TODO.

32            Ok Gunn·ari · gróf til hjarta  
2            svá't mátti'g=a'k · mærum bjarga.

TODO.

TODO.

- 33      Opt undr=umk þat · hví ęptir má'k,  
 2      linn-vęngis Bil, · lífi halda  
      es ek ógn-hvötum · unna þött=umk,  
 4      sverða deili, · sęm sjalfri mér.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 34      Satst ok hlýddir · meðan sagða'k þér  
 2      mǫrg ill of skǫp · mǫn ok þeira;  
      mǫðr hvęrr lifir · at munum sínum;  
 4      nú 's of ęęginn · grátr Odd·rúnar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

---

2 of skǫp | An instance of the archaic particle *of* in a prenominal position, corresponding to a lost Germanic prefix *\*ga-*; see *Sigsk* 23/1 n. *of skǫp* (< PGmc. *\*ga-skapō* > OS *gi-skapu*, OE *ge-sceap*) also occurs in *Sigsk* 58/5 and the present occurrence may be due to borrowing.



# Lay of Attle

## (*Atla kviða*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.719)–early C11th (0.212)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law-Speeches-meter

### Introduction

The **Lay of Attle** (*Akv*) is a narrative heroic poem dealing with King Attle of the Huns and his destruction of the Burgends Guthur and Hawn.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Akv* is preserved only in **R**, on foll. 39v/11–41r/9, where it follows *Oddr* and is followed by *Am*.

Several passages from the poem (sts. 3–9, 14–15, 21–31, 33) are paraphrased in *Vǫls*, which indicates its presence in the poetic source manuscript used for that text.

### Meter and stanza

*Akv* consists of 176 long-lines across 47 stanzas. The poem itself has no narrative prose, but it is introduced by a short orienting prose passage (P1) and concludes with a short note introducing the following poem, *Am* (P2).

The typical length of the stanza is 4 lines (29/47: 1–7, 9–10, 12–18, 21–22, 28–29, 32–33, 36–37, 40, 43–45, 47). The other commonly represented lengths are 2 (5/47: 8, 11, 24, 30, 34), 3 (6/47: 19, 20, 23, 26, 38–39), and 5 (5/47: 25, 27, 41–42, 46). Stanzas of 1 line (31) and 6 lines (35) each appear once. Clauses occasionally span across multiple stanzas in the case of long lists, so 7–8, 15–16, and 18–19.

Together with *Vkv* and *Hamð*, *Akv* is composed in an unusually loose form of Ancient-words-law. Though still characterised by 4 positions (unlike the 5-position Speeches-meter, as found in *Am*), the meter of *Akv* has a greater tolerance for verses with a greater number of unstressed syllables. This is seen especially in its strong preference for verses of the otherwise rare type

D\* (e.g. 4/2a: *hjalma goll-roðna*) over type D (e.g. 28/4a: *bodd Niflunga*) and its common use of anacrusis. Both traits are shared with Speeches-meter to the exclusion of regular Ancient-words-law (Suzuki 2014, pp. 504–6, 518–19; Goering 2023, pp. 82–83).

A unique, innovative verse-type found in *Akv* (and, less commonly, in *Hamð*), but not in regular Norse Ancient-words-law (nor in *Beow*), is what Goering (2023, pp. 83–85) terms E\*. This type is marked by the basic patterns / x / x (Ea\*, e.g. 29/3b: *róg-malmi skatna*) and / x / x (Eb\*, e.g. 13/3b: *erfi-vörðr Hoggna*), and here occurs in 11 lines (Goering 2023, 83, n. 64).

Despite its tolerance for extended verses, *Akv* also permits catalectic (3-position) verses, including verses with only 3 syllables. This distinguishes it not just from Speeches-meter, but also from strict Ancient-words-law as found e.g., in *Vsp* and *Hym*.

One verse, 32/3, has no corresponding verse; another, 28/2, appears to be defective owing to corruption.

### Origin and motifs

*Akv* narrates the treacherous murder of the Burgends or Nivlings, Guthur and Hawn, at the hands of the Hunnish King Attle. Of all Eddic poems dealing with these figures, *Akv* shows the closest adherence to the known historical circumstances. This is seen in its clear distinction between the tribes of the Gots and the Huns, its geographical awareness, and its labelling of Guthur as a Burgend (21/2).

Compare with the younger *Am*.

In *R*, the poem has the title *Atla kviða in grón-lenska* ‘the Greenlandish Lay of Attle’, but the adjectival phrase is almost certainly due to influence from the following *Am*, which, unlike *Akv*, does in fact show signs of a Greenlandish origin. Greenland was not settled by Icelanders until ca. 1000 AD (TODO: cite), by which point *Akv*—judging by the metrically required *vr*—(see below)—must already have been composed.

Together with *Am*, *Akv* clearly serves as a source for *Vþls* 36–38. Although *Am* is the main source for most of the section, *Akv* 22–35 clearly underly parts of *Vþls* 39.

### Style

TODO: The old Germanic epic style of telling the whole story in poetry rather than delegating the verse exclusively to dialogue and otherwise relying on prose to progress the narrative.

### Dating

*Akv* has long been held to be a particularly archaic poem, and this is confirmed by its linguistic traits. The poem displays uncontracted hiatus forms—a sign of composition before ca. 1150—and alliteration between old *vr*- and *v*- (st. 2/2, 14/4)—a sign of composition before ca. 1000 (Haukur Þorgeirsson

2023, pp. 36–38). On the other hand, the poem does not have a particularly high rate of the archaic particle *of*, which appears at a frequency of 0.1709 occurrences per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70), although it should be stressed that this is not an exceptionally low frequency, either.

## Text

## Dauði Atla ('The Death of Attle')

- P1 Guð·rún Gjúka dóttir hefndi bróðra sinna, svá sem frégt er orðit. [R 39v/8]  
 2 Hón drap fyrst sonu Atla, en eptir drap hón Atla ok brendi  
 holl'ina ok hirð'ina alla; um þetta er sjá kviða ort.

GUTHRUN YÍVICK'S DAUGHTER avenged her brothers as has become renowned. She first slew the sons of Attle, but afterwards she slew Attle and burned the hall and the whole hird. About that this lay is wrought.

1 Guð·rún | *The G is an ornamented initial 3 lines high in R.*

## Atla kviða in grón-lenska ('The Greenlandish Lay of Attle')

- 1 Atli sēndi · ǫr til Gunn·ars [R 39v/12]  
 2 kunnan segg at ríða, · Kné·frøðr vas sá heitinn;  
 at gǫrðum kom Gjúka · ok at Gunn·ars hollu,  
 4 þekkjum arin·grēypum · ok at bjóri svǫsum.

ATTLE SENT a messenger to Guthur  
 a well-known man to ride; Kneefrith he was called.  
 He came to the yards of Yivick and the hall of Guthur,  
 to the hearth-surrounding benches and the pleasant beer.

1 Atli | *The A is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, more elaborate than the one immediately above (in P1), in R.*

1 Atli sēndi · ǫr til Gunn·ars 'Attle sent a messenger to Guthur' | Echoed in *Oddr* 25/1.

2 Kné·frøðr 'Kneefrith' | In *Am* the messenger is called Winge and plays a greater role in the narrative.

4 arin·grēypum 'hearth-surrounding' | A compound formed from *arin* 'hearth(stone)' + the otherwise unattested adj. *grēypr* 'surrounding', here painting a picture of the benches placed along the long walls surrounding the blazing central hearth-fires in the ruler's hall. The fact that it is not used in an alliterating position suggests that it was chosen for its precise semantic importance. The word also occurs in sts. 3/4 and 18/2 below, but never elsewhere in Old Norse.

- 2 Drukku þar drótt-megir · —en dyljendr þogðu— [R 39v/14]  
 2 vín í val-hollu, · vreiði sóu=sk Húna;  
 kallaði þá Kné·frøðr · kaldri rǫddu,  
 4 seggr inn suð-röni · sat á þekk hǫm:

There the dright-lads [WARRIORS] drank—but the concealed ones shut up—  
 wine in the walhall; they feared the wrath of the Huns.

Then Kneefrith called out with a cold voice—  
the southern man sat on a high bench:

1 drótt-megir ‘dright-lads’ | The ‘lads, sons of the retinue’ (*drótt* ‘dright’), which should be understood as a poetic synonym for ‘warriors, young men’ (Meissner 1921, p. 23). In Norse poetry this word otherwise only appears in *Vǫfþ* 11/4, 12/2. It does not occur in Skaldic poetry nor in prose. Similar cpds. occur in OE, e.g., *dryht-bearn* ‘dright-children’, *dryht-fólc* ‘dright-people’.

1 dyljendr ‘concealed ones’ | Or ‘those who conceal (their thoughts)’. Pl. of *dyljandi*, *nd*-stem agent noun of the verb *dylja* ‘to hide, conceal, fail to disclose’ (ONP). Finnur Jónsson (1932) reasonably interprets this as referring to Attle’s spies at Guthur’s court.

2 val-höllu ‘the walhall’ | The interpretation of this cpd. is difficult in the current context due to the ambiguity of the first element *val*-. (1) *valr* ‘falcon’, referring to aristocratic hunting practices, seems unlikely. (2) *valr* ‘Wale’, cognate with ‘Welsh’ but in ON referring to the French or Romans, would stress the foreign nature of the hall or stronghold (cf. st. 15/3 below). (3) *valr* ‘(collective) the battle-slain’, would foreshadow the inevitable death (féyness) of the Yivickings. The word would then etymologically identical to Walhall, the feasting hall of the god Woden, whither the battle-slain go.

2 vrçíði ‘wrath’ | An example of highly archaic alliteration between *v*- and old *vr*-, securing the presence of the latter in *Akv*; cf. sts. 9/3, 14/4.

- 3 „Atli mik hingat sendi · ríða ørendi, [R 39v/17]  
2 mar inum mēl-grēypa, · Myrk-við inn ó-kunna  
at biðja yðr, Gunn·arr, · at it á þekk kómið  
4 með hjólum arin-grēypum · at sókja hēim Atla.

“Attle sent me hither to ride an errand  
on the bit-champing steed through Mirkwood uncharted—  
to bid you, O Guthur, that ye two [= Guthur and Hawn] on the bench may  
come  
with hearth-surrounding helmets to seek the home of Attle.

4 hjólum arin-grēypum ‘hearth-surrounding helmets’ | Perhaps helmets hanging on the walls, lit up by the fire; the expression is repeated in st. 18/2 below. For *arin-grēyp* ‘hearth-surrounding’, see st. 1/4 n.

- 4 Skjöldu kneguð þar vëlja · ok skafna aska, [R 39v/20]  
2 hjalma goll-roðna · ok Húna mēngi,  
silfr-gyllt sǫðul-kléði, · sērki val-rauða,  
4 dafar, darraða, · drösla mēl-grēypa.

There ye might choose shields and shaven ash-spears,  
helmets gold-reddened and a multitude of Huns,  
silver-gilt saddle-cloth, blood-red serks,  
javelins, pennants, bit-champing steeds.

- 5 Völl lét=sk ykk ok myнду gefa · víðrar Gnita-hēiðar [R 39v/22]

- 2 af gęiri gjallanda · ok af gylltum stęfnum,  
 stęrar meįęmar · ok staęi Danpar,  
 4 hris þat it męra · es meęę Myrk-vię kalla.“

He declared he would also give you the plain of the wide Gnit-heath,  
 from yelling spears and from gilded prowls,  
 great treasures and the banks of the Danper,  
 the renowned brush which men call Mirkwood.”

2 gęiri gjallanda ‘yelling spears’ | Formulaic. Also found in Egill Lv TODO; in OE as *giellende gęr* in *Wid* TODO, *Fęrst* TODO.

3–4 stęrar ... kalla ‘great ... Mirkwood.’ | Both lines bear strong resemblance to ll. of 7, 9 of *Heięr* st. 94.

3 Danpar ‘the Danper’ | The Dnieper, which runs through eastern Ukraine to the Black Sea. The Norse form *Danpar* (gen. sg.) is only attested here and in *Heięr* st. 94 (for which see ll. 3–4 n.). The nominative form is uncertain; if it be a feminine it should be \**Dęnp*, a masculine \**Danpr* or \**Dęnpr*. In any case it appears to be a reflex of the Gothic form *Danaper* as found in Jordanes, *Getica* 30, 35, 44 etc. As Males (2025, TODO) points out, *Heięr* has the more historically accurate conception of the river, since it is there part of the Gothic kingdom, as it was historically, rather than of the Hunnish kingdom, as it is here.

- 6 Hęęi vatt þa Gunn·arr · ok Hęęna til sagęi: [R 39v/25]  
 2 „Hvat ręęr okkr, sęęgr hinn őri, · alls vit s·líkt hęęrum?  
 Goll vissa’k ęękki · a Gnita-hęęi,  
 4 þat’s vit ęttim=a · annat s·líkt.

His head turned then Guthel and said to Hawn:  
 “What dost thou counsel for us two, O younger man, as such things we hear?  
 I knew of no gold on the Gnit-heath  
 of which we two had not owned even as much.

- 7 Sjau ęigu vit sal-hús · sveręa full, [R 39v/28]  
 2 hveęju ‘ro þęira · hjęlt őr goll;  
 mįnn veįt’k mar bętstan · ęn męki hvassastan,  
 4 boga bękk-sęma · ęn brynjur őr goll,

We own seven hall-houses filled with swords—  
 on each of them is a golden hilt.  
 I know my horse is best and [my] sword the sharpest,  
 [my] bow is bench-fit and [my] byrnies golden,

- 8 hjalm ok skjęld hvítastan, · kominn őr hjęll Kíars; [R 39v/30]  
 2 ęinn ‘s mįnn bętri · an sęi allra Huna.“

[my] helmet and my whitest shield, come from Coser’s hall;  
 mine alone is better than those of all of the Huns might be!”

- 9 „Hvat hyggð brúði bendu · þá's hön okkr baug sendi, [R 39v/31]  
 2 varinn vöðum heðingja? · Hykk at hön vörnuð byði!  
 Hár fann'k heðingja · vriðit í hring rauðum;  
 4 ylfskr es vegr okkarr · at riða ørendi.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “What dost thou think the bride meant when she sent us a bigh wrapped in a heath-dweller's [WOLF'S] cloth? I think she offered a warning! A heath-dweller's hair I found tied round the red ring: wölen is our road if we ride that errand!”

ALL | That it is the more cautious Hawn who speaks here is clear from Guthur's response in the following stanzas. Whereas Hawn judges the wolf-hair to be a warning of Hunnish treachery, Guthur thinks that it is a warning that wolves will steal his treasure if he does not show up.

- 10 Niðjar=gi hvöttu Gunn·ar · né nöngr annarr, [R 39v/35]  
 2 rýnendr né ráðendr, · né þeir's ríkir vöru;  
 kvaddi þá Gunn·arr · sem konungr skyldi,  
 4 mér í mjöð-ranni · af móði stórum:

No kinsmen goaded Guthur nor any other relation,  
 not counselors nor advisors nor those who were powerful.  
 Then Guthur announced—as a king should—  
 renowned in the mead-hall out of great spirit:

- 11 „Rís-tu nú, Fjornir, · lát-tu á flöt vaða [R 40r/1]  
 2 greppa goll-skálar · með gumna höndum!  
 “Rise now, Ferner! Let on the benches wade forth  
 the golden bowls of soldiers along the hands of men!

1 Fjornir ‘Ferner’ | An otherwise unknown servant.

- 12 Ulfr mun ráða · arfi Niflunga, [R 40r/2]  
 2 gamlir grán-varðir, · ef Gunn·ars missir;  
 birnir blakk-fjallir · bíta þref-tønnum,  
 4 gamna grey-stóði, · ef Gunn·arr né kómr=at.“

The wolves will rule the patrimony of the Nivlings—  
 old, grey-pelted—if Guthur is absent!  
 Black-furred bears will bite with wrangling teeth—  
 amusing the bitch-pack—if Guthur comes not!”

4 né kómr=at ‘comes not’ | Note the archaic double negation né ... -at; cf. *Háv* 135/4 n.

- 13 Leiddu land-rögni · lýðar ó-neisir, [R 40r/4]

- 2 grátendr, gunn-hvatan, · ór garði Húna;  
þa kvað þat inn ðri · ęrfi-vörðr Hognar:  
4 „Hęilir farið nú ok horskir · hvar's ykkir hugr tęygir!“  
Unshamed [FAMOUS] troops led the lord of the land—  
weepers—the battle-bold man out of the yards of the Huns.  
Then this quoth the younger heritage-guardian [SON] of Hawn:  
“Fare ye two now whole and wise, wherever your heart may draw you!”

1 lýðar ð-neisir ‘unshamed [FAMOUS] troops’ | Compare the long-line on the Thorsberg chape (~ 160–240 AD); *ulþuþewar · ni waje-márir* ‘Wolthew, the not ill-famed [FAMOUS]’.

- 14 Fetum létu fróknir · of fjöll at þyrja [R 40r/7]  
2 mar ina mël-greypu, · Myrk-við inn ð-kunna;  
hristisk ęll Hún-mörk · þar's harð-móðgir fóru,  
4 vröku þeir vand-stygga · völlu al-gröna.

With strides the braves made the bit-champing steed  
rush o'er the fells through Mirkwood uncharted.  
All Hunmark shook where the hard-minded went forth;  
they drove the whip-shy horse across all-green fields.

- 15 Land sęu þęir Atla · ok lið-skjalfar djúpar; [R 40r/9]  
2 Bikka greppar standa · á borg inni hęu,  
sal umb suðr-þjóðum, · slęinn sess-męiðum,  
4 bundnum ręndum, · blęikum skjöldum,

They saw the land of Attle and its ravines deep,  
Beck's soldiers standing upon the high stronghold,  
the hall of the south-folk built with seat-beams,  
with bound rims and pale shields;

2 Bikka ‘Beck’ | An obscure legendary figure; cf. *Sigsk* 64/1 and *Ghv* P1, where he is Ermenric's counsellor. He appears alongside Attle, Ermenric, and Yivick in *Wid* 19 and again in *Wid* 115.

2 á borg inni hęu ‘upon the high stronghold’ | Formulaic, also found in *Hamð* 22/5b. A likely West Germanic parallel is found in OE *in/ęn/tó sęli þám hęban* ‘in/on/to the high hall’ (*Beow* 713b, 919b, 1016b, 1984b) with identical syntax.

3 sess-męiðum ‘seat-beams’ | Probably large load-bearing pillars or columns.

- 16 dafar, darraða; · ęn þar drakk Atli [R 40r/12]  
2 vın ĩ val-höllu; · vęðir sótu úti  
at varða þęim Gunn·ari · ef þęir hęr vitja kómi  
4 með geiri gjallanda · at vękja gram hildi.

[they saw] javelins and pennants. But there Attle drank  
wine in the wal-hall; the watchmen stayed outside



to watch for Guthur's men, if they came hither to visit  
with a yelling spear to wake the ruler with war.

- 17      Systir fann þeira snemmst · at þeir í sal kvómu, [R 40r/14]  
2      bróðr hefnar báðir, · bjóri vas hön lítt drukkin:  
     „Ráðinn est nú, Gunn·arr, · hvat munt, ríkr, vinna  
4      við Húna harm-brögðum? · Hóll gakk ór snimma!

Their sister found soonest that they had come into the hall,  
her brothers both—on beer was she lightly drunk:  
“Tricked art thou now, Guthur! How wilt thou, rich man, withstand  
the Hunnish harm-tricks? Go out of the hall, quick!

- 18      Bætr hefðir, bróðir, · at í brynju fórir, [R 40r/17]  
2      sem hjölmum arin-græypum · at séa heim Atla;  
     sétir í sǫðlum · sól-heiða daga,  
4      nái nauð-fólva · létir nornir gráta,

Thou wouldst have done better, brother, if thou hadst gone in thy byrnie  
with hearth-surrounding helmets to see the realm of Attle;  
if thou hadst loaded in the saddles during sun-bright days  
need-pale corpses; if thou hadst let the norns cry,

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ALL | In sts. 18–19, Guthrun tells Guthur that he should not have shown up unarmed; rather he should have brought his whole army to defeat Attle in open battle.

4 létir nornir gráta ‘if thou hadst let the norns cry’ | The tragic killings and carnage are thought to be the cause of the rejoicing of evil spirits, but the weeping of good spirits; a dualistic notion. On the good side of this equation stand the elves (*Hamð* 1/2), on the evil side the Norns, Dises (ON *dísir*, *Reg* 2, *Hamð* 28/3), and Ogresses (ON *flögð*, *Hamð* 15/2).

- 19      Húna skjald-meyjar · herfi kannu, [R 40r/19]  
2      en Atla sjalfan · létir í orm-garð koma;  
     nú ’s sá orm-garðr · ykkir of folginn.“

[and] the Hunnish shield-maidens know the harrow—  
but Attle himself shouldst thou have put in the snake-pit;  
now that snake-pit has enveloped you two!”

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1 Húna skjald-meyjar · herfi kannu ‘the Hunnish shield-maidens know the harrow’ | I.e., if he had enslaved the Hunnish shield-maidens and turned them into farmhands.

2 orm-garð ‘snake-pit’ | A piece of foreshadowing; Guthur should have put Attle in the snake-pit, but his naivité will instead result in it happening to himself (st. 35).

- [Gunn·arr svarar:] 20      „Sęinat ’s nú, systir, · at samna Niflungum,

[R 40r/21]

- 2           langt 's at lēita · lýða sinnis til,  
            of rosmu-fjöll Rínar, · rekka ó-neissa.“

[Guthur answers:] “It is too late now, sister, to gather the Nivlings.  
It is long to look for the support of men  
o'er the red fells of the Rhine, for unshamed [FAMOUS] warriors.”

- 21       Fengu þeir Gunn-ar · ok í fjötur sættu  
2       vin Borgunda · ok bundu fast-la;  
          sjau hjó Hogni · sverði hvössu  
4       en inum átta hratt hann · í ǣld heitan.

[R 40r/23]

They captured Guthur and in fetters placed  
the friend of the Burgends [= Guthur] and bound him firmly.  
Hawn smote seven with his sharp sword,  
but the eighth one he threw in the hot fire.

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2 vin | vinir (‘vín’) R

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2 vin Borgunda ‘the friend of the Burgends’ | The historic Guthur (Latin *Gundabarius* < \**Gunþi-hari*) was a king of Burgundy; cf. *Wald* B 14, where Walder addresses Guthur, whom he is just about to fight, with the identical *wine Burgenda*. Addressing a king as a \**winiz* ‘friend’ of his people or dynasty is common in early Germanic heroic poetry; cf. *Beow* 30, 170, 1183 etc.: *wine Scyldinga* ‘friend of the Shieldings [DANISH KING]’, 350 *wine Deniga* ‘friend of the Danes [DANISH KING]’. The present instance is the only mention of the Burgends in all of Norse literature and as such is an impressive archaism that further adds support to an early dating for *Akv*. Cf. st. 46/4 n. below. — R has a small stroke above the *n* that abbreviates the syllable *ir*, indicating the nom. pl. *vinir* ‘friends’, who would then be the people binding Guthur. This is probably due to scribal corruption, since the ones who bind Guthur are Huns, not Burgends.

- 22       Svá skal frókn · fignum verja=sk;  
2       Hogni varði · hendr Gunn-ars.  
          frógu fróknan · ef fjör vildi  
4       Gotna þjóðan · golli kaupa.

[R 40r/25]

So shall a brave guard himself against foes;  
Hawn guarded the hands of Guthur.  
They asked the brave sovereign of the Gots [= Guthur]  
if he would buy his [Hawn's] life with gold.

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1 Svá ... verjask | Line moved from the last st. to this one since it seems to connect semantically with the immediately following line, and results in two typical four-line stanzas.

4 Gotna þjóðan ‘sovereign of the Gots’ | Guthur; cf. sts. 1, 3, 10. — Although Gothic *þiudans* is the unmarked word for ‘ruler’ and reflexes of PWGmc. \**þeudan* are exceptionally common in West Germanic heroic poetry (*þeoden* 40 times in *Beow*, *þeodan* 22 in *Heli*), ON *þjóðann* is a rare word and its presence here very likely a semantic archaism. Outside of *Akv* (st. 22/4, 23/3) the word is found only once in the heroic poetry of the Poetic Edda (*I Guðr* 19/1), thrice in the mythological poetry (*Háv* 15/1, 114/2, and 147/1) and only once in a dateable Scaldic composition (the Lay-meter poem Egill *Arkv* 11/3a (SkP 5) from ca. 980). It otherwise occurs in the list of poetic synonyms for ‘king’ (*Pul Konunga* 2 (SkP 3)), three Cl2th or 13th antiquarian heroic poems (*Heiðr* 91, GunnLeif *Merl* I 81, *Gautr* 38 (all in SkP 8), probably imitating earlier heroic poetry like *Akv*), and the thoroughly Christian Cl13th advice-poem *Hsv* 143 (almost certainly drawing on *Háv*). Thus it appears this archaic word belonging to the Migration Period was thought unfitting for poetry in Court-spoken meter, which already from the time of Bray the Old preferred words like *stillir* (found ca. 104 in the SkP corpus; cf. Ög 136 Röð) or *þengill* (found 120 times in the SkP corpus).

- 23 „Hjarta skal mér Høgna · ĩ hendi liggja [R 40r/26]  
 2 blóðugt, ór brjósti · skorit bald-riða,  
 saxi slíðr-þeitu, · syni þjóðans.“

“The heart of Hawn shall lie in my hands:  
 bloody, cut from the breast of the bold rider,  
 with a slide-biting sax from the son of the sovereign.”

ALL | The Huns offer Guthur to pay a ransom for Hawn’s life. Guthur instead responds in defiance. St. 23 is paraphrased in *Vþls* 39: *Hann svarar: „Fyrr skal ek sjá hjarta Høgna, bróður míns, blóðugt.“* ‘He answers: “I shall sooner see the blood heart of Hawn, my brother.”’

3 saxi slíðr-þeitu ‘slide-biting sax’ | A short-sword with a blade so sharp that it draws blood when one slides the finger across it. — Possibly formulaic; cf. *Hamð* 8/4.

- 24 Skõru þeir hjarta · Hjalla ór brjósti, [R 40r/28]  
 2 blóðugt, ok à bjóð lögðu · ok bõru þat fyr Gunnar.

They cut the heart of Helle from the breast,  
 bloody, and on a plate laid it, and brought it before Guthur.

ALL | St. 24 is paraphrased in *Vþls* 39, immediately after its paraphrase of st. 23: *Ok nú þrifu þeir þrēl’inn í annat sinn ok skáru ór bõnum hjarta’t ok báru fyrir konung’inn Gunnar.* ‘And now they seized the thrall for a second time and cut the heart out of him and brought it before King Guthur’.

- 25 Þá kvað þat Gunnarr, · gumna dróttinn: [R 40r/30]  
 2 „Hér hef’k hjarta · Hjalla ins blauða,  
 òlíkt hjarta · Høgna ins frókna,  
 4 es mjök bifa=sk · es à bjóði ligger;  
 bifði=sk hõlfu mēirr · es ĩ brjósti lá!“

Then this quoth Guthur, the lord of men:  
 “Here have I the heart of Helle the soft  
 —unlike the heart of Hawn the brave!—  
 which quivers greatly when on the plate it lies;  
 it quivered twice as much when in the breast it lay.”

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 25 immediately after that of st. 24: *Hann svarar: „Hjarta Hjalla má hér sjá ins bláuða, ok er úlíkt hjarta Hoggna ins frékna, því at nú skelfr mjök; enn hálfu meirr, þá er í brjósti bónum lá.“* ‘He answers: “Here one may see the heart of Helle the soft and it is unlike the heart of Hawn the brave, for it now trembles much—yet twice as much when it lay in his breast.”’

26 Hló þá Hogni · es til hjarta skóru

[R 40r/32]

2 kvikvan kumbla-smið · —klökkva síðst hugði.

Blóðugt þat á bjóð lögðu · ok bóru fyr Gunn·ar.

Hawn then laughed as to his heart they cut  
the living wound-smith [WARRIOR = Hawn]; he thought least of sobbing.  
Bloody on a plate they laid it, and brought it before Guthur.

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 26 immediately after that of st. 25; cf. also *Am* 62, which serves as a source for the same: *Nú gengu þeir eptir eggjun Atla konungs at Hoggna ok skáru ór bónum hjarta’t. Ok svá var mikill þróttr hans, at bann bló, meðan hann beið þessa kvöl, ok allir undruðust þrek hans, ok þat er síðan at minnum bafi. Þeir sýndu Gunnari hjarta Hoggna.* ‘Now, following King Attle’s incitement, they went up to Hawn cut the heart out of him. And so great was his strength, that he laughed while he suffered this torment, and all wondered at his zeal, and that is thereafter held in the memories of men. They showed Guthur Hawn’s heart.’

27 Mérr kvað þat Gunn·arr, · geir-Niflungr:

[R 40r/34]

2 „Hér hefi’k hjarta · Hoggna ins frókna,

òlíkt hjarta · Hjalla ins bláuða,

4 es lítt bifa=sk · es á bjóði ligg;

bifði=sk svá=gi mjök · þá’s í brjósti lá!

Renowned, this quoth Guthur, the Spear-Nivling:  
“Here have I the heart of Hawn the brave  
—unlike the heart of Helle the soft!—  
which quivers little when on the plate it lies;  
it quivered not so much when in the breast it lay.

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 27 immediately after that of st. 26: *Hann svarar: „Hér má sjá hjarta Hoggna ins frékna, ok er úlíkt hjarta Hjalla ins bláuða, því at nú brjrist lítt, enn miðr, meðan í brjósti bónum lá.“* ‘He answers: “Here one may see the heart of Hawn the brave and it is unlike the heart of Helle the soft, for it now moves little—yet less while it lay in his breast.”’

28 Svá skalt, Atli, · augum fjarri

[R 40v/3]

2 sëm munt [...] · menjum verða;

es und einum mér · ǫll of folgin

4 hodd Niflunga: · lifir=a nú Hogni!

So shalt thou, Attle, be as far from eyes  
as thou wilt be from the [...] neck-rings.

Under me alone is hidden all  
the hoard of the Nivlings—now Hawn lives not!

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in R.

ALL | Sts. 28–30: Guthur declares his unwillingness to reveal the location of the treasure. He alone knows it and he will take it with him to the grave. *Vþls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 28 immediately after that of st. 27: *Ok svá mantu, Atli, láta þitt líf, sem nú látum vér. Ok nú veit ek einn, hvar gullit er, ok mun eigi Hogni segja þér.* ‘And so shalt thou, Attle, lose thy life like we now lose ours. And now I alone know where the gold is, and Hawn will not tell thee.’

1 augum fjarri ‘be as far from eyes’ | Perhaps as far from men’s eyes, namely after he is dead.

2 [...] | This word, required for metrical reasons, would most likely have been an adjective beginning with *m-*, probably *mérum* ‘renowned’ or *métum* ‘splendid’. It has likely been skipped owing to the similar dative ending. The paraphrase of *Vþls* does not offer any help.

- 20 Ey vas mér týja · meðan vit tvęir lifðum,  
2 nú ’s mér ęngi · es ęinn lifi’k;  
Rín skal ráða · róg-malmi skatna,  
4 svinn, ős-kunnum · arfi Niflunga.

[R 40v/5]

I always had doubt while we two lived;  
now I have none as I alone live.  
The swift Rhine shall rule the strife-ore of princes [GOLD],  
the Os-born inheritance of the Nivlings!

4 ős-kunnum | gramm. emend.; ős-kunna R

ALL | *Vþls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of sts. 29–30 immediately after that of st. 28: *Ok svá mantu, Atli, láta þitt líf, sem nú látum vér. Ok nú veit ek einn, hvar gullit er, ok mun eigi Hogni segja þér. Mér lék ymist í hug, þá er vit lifðum báðir, en nú hefi ek einn ráðit fyrir mér. Skal Rín nú ráða gulli’nu, fyrr en Hýnir beri þat á bændum sér.* ‘And so shalt thou, Attle, lose thy life like we now lose ours. And now I alone know where the gold is, and Hawn will not tell thee. I always had doubt in my heart while we both were alive, but now I alone have had my will. The Rhine shall now rule the gold before the Huns might bear it upon their hands.’

4 svinn, ős-kunnum · arfi ‘swift ... Os-born inheritance’ | Difficult. (1) The ms. form *ős-kunna* ‘Os-born’ does not concord with the m. dat. sg. *arfi* ‘inheritance’ (an interpretation of it as the weak form is unlikely), and so the ending has been emended. The hoard can be called ‘Os-born’, i.e., ‘born of the Eese’, for it was the Gods who gave it to Rethmar as weregild for his son (*Reg* P1–st. 9). *svinn* ‘swift’ is taken to be an adj. modifying *Rín* ‘Rhine’ in l. 3. Still, it is highly unusual for a type D verse to have alliteration fall on the second lift but not the first. (2) An alternative solution is to keep *ős-kunna* and instead read *svinn* as an error for *sú* in nom. sg. f. ‘this’. This would give the sense *Rín sú in ős-kunna skal ráða* ‘This Os-born Rhine shall rule etc.’ The construction *sá (h)inn* ‘this’ does occur elsewhere in the poem (5/4 above).

- 30 Í veltanda vatni · lýsask val-baugar  
2 hęldr an á hęndum goll · skíni Húna bęrnum.“

[R 40v/7]

In tumbling water shall the Welsh bighs gleam,  
rather than gold shine on the hands of the children of Huns!”

2 Húna börnum ‘the children of the Huns’ | Here just meaning ‘the Huns’, a common Germanic kenning-type (Meissner 1921, pp. 23–25, 245). Cf. expressions like *alda börn* ‘the children of men [MEN]’.

[Atli kvað:] **31** “Ýkvið ér hvél-vøgnum, · haptr ’s nú í bøndum!”

[R 40v/8]

[Quoth Attle:] “Turn ye the wheel-wagons; the captive is now in bonds!”

**32** Atli inn ríki · reĩð Glaum mōnum,  
2 slæginn róg-þornum, · sifjungr þeira;  
Guð-rún sig-tíva  
4 varnaði við tǫrum, · vaðin í þys-høllu:

[R 40v/9]

Attle the powerful, their in-law, rode  
on Gleam by his mane surrounded by strife-thorns [SWORDS].  
Guthrun of the victory-Tews [...];  
she held back her tears, pacing in the tumultous hall:

ALL | Attle rides back to the hall surrounded by his warriors with their swords raised.

1 Glaum ‘Gleam’ | Attle’s horse.

2 sifjungr þeira ‘their in-law’ | Attle is the in-law (here *sifjungr* ‘in-law, kinsman by marriage’) of Guthur and Hawn through his marriage to Guthrun; this appellation illustrates his treachery.

3 Guð-rún sig-tíva ‘Guthrun of the victory-Tews’ | A second verse has undoubtedly been lost in the same line; whether l. 3 is an a- or b-verse is therefore also uncertain. We are therefore dealing with an opaque expression, although the *sig-tívar* ‘victory-Tews’ are in any case the gods, but what they are doing here is unclear. If Guthrun is being presented as a descendant of the gods this would have a parallel in *Hamð* 25/1, although the Yivickings are not (TODO: verify) otherwise said to be of heavenly descent.

**33** „Svá gangi þér, Atli, · sēm við Gunn-ar áttir  
2 eĩða opt of svarða · ok ár of nefnda  
at sól inni suðr-høllu · ok at Sig-týs bergi,  
4 hulkvi hvíl-bęðjar · ok at hringi Ullar.“

[R 40v/11]

“So may it go with thee, Attle, like thou with Guthur hadst  
oaths often sworn and always mentioned  
by the south-facing sun and by Victory-Tew’s mountain,  
by any pleasant bed and by the ring of Wolder.”

**34** Ok meĩrr þaðan · mēn-vørð bituls,  
2 dolg-Rogni, dró · til dauðs, skókr.

[R 40v/14]

And further the shaker of the bridle [WARRIOR = Attle] brought thence  
the torc-defender, the battle-Reiner [WARRIOR = Guthur] to his death.

ALL | The word-order is unusually difficult. In prose word order: *Ok meirr þaðan dró skókr bituls men-vorð, dolg-Rogni, til dauðs.*

1 men-vorð ‘the torc-defender’ | A rare kenning, really an anti-kenning, since it is typical to describe a man as a giver or destroyer of rings (i.e., a generous man), not their defender. Yet in the present context Guthur is called this since he refuses to divulge the location of the gold which he has buried in the Rhine.

- 35 Lifanda gram · lagði í garð,  
 2 þann’s skriðinn vas, · skatna mengi,  
 innan ormum. · Eñ einn Gunn·arr  
 4 heipt-móðr hǫrpu · hendi kníði;  
 glumðu strengir. · Svá skal golli  
 6 frókn hring-drifi · við fira halda!

[R 40v/15]

The living lord [= Guthur] was laid in the pit  
 (which was crawling) by a troop of warriors  
 (with snakes inside), but Guthur alone  
 spitefully struck the harp with his hand;  
 its strings rang out. *So* shall a brave  
 ring-strewer [GENEROUS MAN] withhold his gold from men!

ALL | Guthur was laid alive in a snake-pit, but was given a harp to pacify the snakes and played it with his feet. This worked until a single serpent pierced his heart, and he died. The same is told in 2 *Guðr* Pl, *Am* 63, and *Ghv* 17/3–4. The scene of Guthur playing with his feet was very famous and is depicted pictorially in several archeological finds and stave church carvings, most notably on the surviving carvings from the now-demolished Hylestad Stave Church (ca. 1170 AD) in Setesdal, Norway. See Fig. 11, p. 638.

- 36 Atli lét · lands síns á vit  
 2 jó ǫr-skáan · aptr frá morði;  
 dynr vas í garði, · dröslum of þrungit,  
 4 vǫpn-söngr virða— · vǫru af heiði komnir.

[R 40v/17]

Atle turned towards his land  
 on his watchful steed back from the murder.  
 There was a din in the yard from the trampling of horses,  
 the weapon-song of warriors—they had come from the heath.

1 Atli lét | This verse is highly unusual since the alliteration falls on the finite verb *lét* rather than the leftmost nominal *Atli*; corruption seems likely (Goering 2023, p. 81). The catalexis itself is not evidence of corruption, since trisyllabic verses occur at other places in the poem.

2 ǫr-skáan ‘watchful’ | A hapax, best explained as a cognate with Gothic *us-skaws* ‘vigilant, watchful’.

- 37 Út gekk þá Guð-rún, · Atla í gögn,

[R 40v/20]



Figure 11: Guthrie in the snake-pit, detail on the left portal of the now-demolished Hylestad Stave Church in Setesdal, Norway. High Medieval, ca. 1170 AD. Unknown author. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Hylestadportalen\\_-\\_an10071203083003.jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Hylestadportalen_-_an10071203083003.jpg)



- 2 með gylltum kalki · at reifa gjöld rognis:  
 „Þiggja knátt, þengill, · í þinni hollu  
 4 glaðr at Guð-runu · gnadda nifl-farna.“

Then out went Guthrun, Atle to face,  
 with a gilt chalice to give repayments to her lord.  
 “Do accept, ruler, in thy own hall,  
 glad, from Guthrun, young beasts gone to the shades!”

---

4 gnadda nifl-farna ‘young beasts gone to the shades’ | These ‘young beasts’ are of course her children, Earp and Oatle. The killing is described more directly in *Am* 74–76.

- 38 Umöu ǫl-skálar · Atla vín-hofgar [R 40v/22]  
 2 þá's í holl saman · Húnar tölðu=sk,  
 gumar gran-síðir · gengu inn hvárir.

The ale-bowls of Atle clanged heavy with wine  
 when gathered in the hall the Huns were counted;  
 the long-bearded men walked in two by two.

- 39 Skévaði þá hin skír-leita, · veigar þeim at bera, [R 40v/23]  
 2 af-kór dís, jofrum, · ok ǫl-krásir valði,  
 nauðug, nef-folum, · en níð sagði Atla:

Forth strode the pure-faced woman bearing them draughts,  
 the violent dise for the princes, and chose the ale-dainties,  
 forced, for the pale-faced men—but spoke a nithe to Atle.

---

1 veigar ‘draughts’ | The alliteration requires a word starting with *sk*-. For this reason *veigar* probably ought to be replaced with the synonym *skálar* ‘bowls’.

3 níð ‘nithe’ | An evil, cursing word.

- 40 „Sona hefir þinna, · sverða deilir, [R 40v/25]  
 2 hjörtu hré-dreyrug · við hunang of tuggin,  
 melta knátt, móðugr, · manna val-bráðir  
 4 eta at ǫl-krósum · ok í ǫnd-ugi at sænda.

“Thy own sons’ hast thou, dealer of swords,  
 corpse-bloody hearts with honey chewed.  
 Thou art stomaching, fierce man, the death-flesh of men,  
 eating it by ale-dainties, passing it on from the high seat!

---

3 val-bráðir | *sens. emend.*; val-brúðir R.

- 41 Kallar=a þú síðan · til knéa þinna [R 40v/28]

- 2        **E**rp né **E**řitil, · **q**l-řeřifa tvá;  
          **s**ér=a þú **s**íðan · **ĩ** seti miðju  
 4        **g**olls miðlęndr · **g**ęira skępta,  
          **m**anar **m**ęřita · né **m**ara kęyra.“

Thou wilt not henceforth call up to thy lap  
 Earp or Oatle, the ale-rowdy two.  
 Thou wilt not henceforth see in the middle of the seat  
 the dealers of gold shafting spears,  
 brushing horse-manes or driving steeds.”

---

2 *q*l-řeřifa tvá ‘the ale-rowdy two’ | At this time there was nothing unusual about young boys drinking.

- 42       **Y**mr varð á þękkjum, · **a**f-kárr sęngr virða,  
 2        **g**nýr und **g**uð-veřjum, · **g**rétu bęrn Huna,  
          nema **ę**in Guð-rún · es hęn **ę**va grét  
 4        **br**óðr sína **ber**-harða · ok **b**uri svása,  
          unga, **ó**-fróða, · þa’s hęn við **A**tla gat.

[R 40v/30]

There was clangour on the benches, the violent song of warriors,  
 whimpering beneath the god-weave; the children of the Huns wept,  
 save for Guthrun alone, for she never wept  
 for her bear-hard brothers and beloved sons,  
 the young, unlearned, which she begot by Attle.

---

2 und *guð-veřjum* ‘beneath the god-weave’ | Beneath the silken fabric, presumably of the tents in which the nomadic Huns dwelled.

4 *ber-harða* ‘bear-hard’ | Before the lion was adopted for this sake on the basis of Classical and Biblical models, the bear was the animal associated with strength and bravery in the North. — *ber-* is a compounding form of *\*beri* ‘bear’, an otherwise unattested m. *n*-stem noun inherited from PGmc. *\*berō*, whence also OHG *bero*, OE *bera* ‘id.’, along with the ON f. *bera* ‘she-bear’ and diminutive *bersi* ‘(playful) bear’. The normal ON word for “bear” is *björn*, an *u*-stem derived from the oblique cases of *\*berō*. *ber-* appears to be an archaism, since it is only otherwise attested in *Vkv* 11.

5 unga, *ó-fróða* ‘the young, unlearned’ | Cf. *Hild* 16: *alte anti fróte* ‘the old and learned’.

- 43       **G**olli sęri · hin **g**agl-bjarta,  
 2        **h**ringum rauðum · řeřfði hęn **h**ús-karla;  
          **sk**ęp lét hęn vaxa · **ę**n **sk**íran malm vaða,  
 4        **ę**va fljóð **ę**kki · **g**aði **f**jarg-húsa.

[R 40v/33]

With gold the goose-bright lady sowed [the floor];  
 with red rings she cheered on the housecarls.  
 She let the large vats grow and the pure ore [GOLD] wade;  
 never did that woman heed the god-houses.

---

ALL | The poet paints the image of a crazed feast in Attle's hall. Guthrun throws off her golden rings and bracelets around her to the cheer of the drunken warriors.

4 *ǧarg-húsa* 'god-houses' | An archaic word for cultic buildings, probably small houses with idols or altars inside. For the first element *ǧarg-* 'god', see *Lok* 19/4 n. In the Norse corpus this word is only used here and in st. 46/3 below.

- 44      Ö·varr Atli · \*óðan hafði sik drukkit; [R 40v/35]  
 2      vǫpn hafði hann ekki, · varnaði-t við Guð·rúnu;  
      opt vas sá leikr bētri · þá's þau lint skyldu  
 4      optarr of faðma-sk · fyr ǫðlingum.

Unwary, Attle had drunk himself mad;  
 he had no weapon, did not beware Guthrun.  
 Oft their play was better when they gently would  
 oftener embrace each other before the athlings.

---

1 \*óðan 'mad' | *emend.*; móðan 'tired' R

---

1 \*óðan 'mad' | A word alliterating with a vowel is required by the meter and \*óðan 'mad' lies closest at hand, differing only by a letter from móðan 'tired'.

- 45      Hön bæð broddi · gaf blóð at drekka, [R 41r/1]  
 2      hendi hēl-fússi, · ok hvelpa leysti;  
      hratt fyr hallar dyrr · ok hús-karla vakði  
 4      brandi, brúðr, heitum; · þau lét hön gjöld bróðra.

With a blade she gave the bed blood to drink  
 by a hell-eager hand—and set loose the whelps,  
 blocked the doors of the hall and awoke the housecarls  
 with hot flame, the bride; such were her repayments for her brothers.

- 46      Ełdi gaf hön alla · es inni vöru [R 41r/4]  
 2      ok frá morði þeira Gunn·ars · komnir vöru ór Myrk-hēimi;  
      forn timbr fellu, · ǧarg-hús ruku,  
 4      bór Buðlunga, · brunnu ok skjald-męyjar,  
      inni; aldr-stamar · hnigu í ęld heitan.

To the fire she gave all who were within  
 and from the murder of Guthur and his [brother] had come out of Mirkham.  
 Ancient timbers fell; the god-houses smoked,  
 the town of the Budlings. The shield-maidens too burned  
 inside; short-lived, they sank into the hot fire.

---

4 *bór* Buðlunga ‘the town of the Budlings’ | An archaism. This is the only Norse attestation of *buðlungr* in its original sense ‘Budling, descendant of Budle’; in all other instances the word has become a generalised poetic synonym for ‘king, ruler’. Note that the younger *Am* 35/2 instead uses the expression *bór ... es Buðli átti* ‘the town which Budle owned’.

47 Full-rótt’s umb þetta; · ferr engi svá síðan

[R 41r/6]

2 brúðr í brynju · bróðra at hefna;

hön hefir þriggja · þjóð-konunga

4 ban-orð borit, · björt, áðr sylti.

It is told fully about this. Henceforth no bride will  
so don a byrnie to avenge her brothers.  
She has, bright, borne the bane-word  
of three great kings before she must die.

3 þjóð-konunga ‘great kings’ | An old poetic word; for etymology and distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

4 ban-orð borit ‘borne the bane-word’ | I.e., she has brought death to three great kings. For the idea of death as a “word” cf. *Yt* 1: *Varð fram-gengt [...] fēigðar-orð es at Fjølmi kom* ‘The word of feyness (i.e., imminent death or destruction) which came upon Fillner became fulfilled’, that is to say, “Fillner died at his fatefully appointed time”. This expression, along with its Germanic and Indo-European parallels, is discussed in detail by Watkins (1995, pp. 417–422).

P2 Enn segir gløggra í Atla-mólum inum grón-lendskum.

[R 41r/8]

This is told yet more clearly in the Greenlandish Speeches of Attle.

# Greenlandish Speeches of Attle

## *(Atla mól in grón-lęndsku)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.472)

**Meter:** Speeches-meter

### Introduction

NOTE: The following translation is currently incomplete and the edition has not been thoroughly checked.

The **Greenlandish Speeches of Attle** (abbrev. *Am*) is a long Eddic heroic poem dealing with the deaths of Guthur and Hawn at the hands of Attle.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Am* is only preserved in **R** where it is found on foll 41r/9–44r/13. It follows *Akv* and precedes *Ghv*. The title *Atla mól in grón-lęndsku* ‘The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle’ is preserved in *Akv* P2.

### Story and parallels

The basic narrative of *Am* is largely the same as the preceding *Akv*, and together with that poem it clearly serves as a source for *Vǫls* 36–38. For much of that section *Am* is the chief source, probably due to its greater length.

Although both poems build on the same basic narrative frame, *Am* is far longer and contains a number of otherwise unparallelled details. One of the most interesting differences is the *Am*-poet’s clear lack of familiarity with continental European circumstances. Whereas the poet of *Akv* has Guthur and Hawn ride through the dark Mirkwood and over high mountains to get to Attle in the south (*Akv* 14), *Am* instead lets Guthur and Hawn sail out of their home firth (*fięręđr*) to the land of Budle (*Am* 28–35) in what is clearly an insular Norse adaptation of the original setting.

### Meter and formal concerns

*Am* consists of 382 long-lines distributed across 102 stanzas. The typical length of a stanza is 4 lines, but other lengths are also represented.

The poem is composed in Speeches-meter throughout.

### Localisation

In *R* the adjective *grón-lēndskr* ‘Greenlandish’ is applied to both *Akv* and *Am*, but only the latter appears actually to have been composed in one of the Norse settlements on Greenland. This is shown most clearly by st. 18, where the poet makes reference to a “white-bear” (*hvíta-björn*) arriving in a storm from the east. The polar bear (*Ursus maritimus*) is indeed found on Greenland, where members of the species not infrequently drift onto the shores on ice sheets carried by the winds, whereas they never appear on Iceland or the Scandinavian peninsula.

### Dating

A Greenlandish origin for the poem lets us to determine a *terminus post quem* for its composition. *Am* cannot have been composed before ca. 985 AD, the time of Greenland’s settlement by Icelanders agreed upon both by the mediaeval saws and modern archeology.

We may push this date some decades forward based on the treatment of the dead in the poem. Being burned on a pyre is a punishment associated with stoning (st. 84), while a proper burial is in a painted coffin, though apparently still in a boat (st. 100). The equation of stoning and cremation clearly points towards composition after conversion, whereas pre-Christian poems like *Háv* show no such association (cf. *Háv* 71/3, 81/1). Iceland officially became Christian in 1000 AD and Greenland probably did not follow long thereafter, but the old custom of cremation can hardly have become thoroughly taboo immediately in the way it clearly is here.

On the linguistic side of things *Am* shows noticeably younger characteristics than its predecessor *Akv*.

Most notably the sound change *vr-* > *r-* is consistently applied in roots originally containing the glide, namely *vreiðr*, *vreiði* > *reiðr*, *reiði* ‘wroth, wrath’ (*Am* 51/1: *rǫskr*, *rǫða* : *reiðr*, 75/4: *ró*, *reiði* : *reynir* vs. *Akv* 2/2: *vín*, *val-bǫllu* : *vreiði*), *vrangr*, *vængja* > *rangr*, *rængja* ‘twisted, twist’ (*Am* 4/1: *rúna*, *rista* : *rængði* vs. *Bragi Þórr* 6 (in *SkP* 3): *vildi-t*, *vrongum* : *vágs*), and *\*vrǫskr* > *rǫskr* ‘vigorous’ (*Am* 51/1, 57/2: *rǫskr*, *reyna-sk* : *reynt*, 87/1: *rǫskr*, *rǫða* : *rakði-sk* vs. *Þdr* 22/1: *vreiðr*, *Vrǫsku* : *vá*). For the root *vreka* > *reka* ‘drive, chase’, which is not found in *Am*, cf. *Akv* 14/4.

Another young feature is the comparative rarity of the pre-verbal particle *of*, which appears three times. Of all 37 Eddic poems or sections of poems treated separately by Sapp (2022, p. 70), *Am* has the lowest frequency of this particle at 0.039 occurrences per 10 unique lines. This contrasts with the 6 occurrences in the much shorter *Akv*, which has a middling frequency of 0.1709 occurrences per 10 unique lines.

## Text

## Atla mól in grón-lensku ('The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle')

- 1 Frétt hefir **q**ld **ó**fu · þá's **ç**ndr of gøðu  
 2 seggir **s**am-kundu, · **s**ú vas nýt fěstum;  
**ó**xtu **ç**in-méli, · **y**ggt vas þeim síðan  
 4 ok it **s**ama **s**onum Gjúka · es vöru **s**ann-ráðnir.

FOLK HAVE LEARNED of the enmity long ago  
 when men held an assembly; that was a boon to the fewest.  
 Their private speeches intensified; it was terrible for them afterwards,  
 and the same for the sons of Yivick who were truly deceived.

1 Frétt | The F is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, with the left vertical stroke tail-shaped and descending an additional 6 lines in the margin in R.

ALL | Sts. 1–2 describe how Attle and his advisors decide to trick Guthur and Hawn and betray them.

- 2 Skop **ó**xtu skjöldunga · —skyldu=at fçigir—  
 2 illa réð=sk Atla, · átti hann þó hyggju;  
 fçllði stoð stóra, · striddi sér harð=la,  
 4 af bragði boð sendi · at kvæmi brátt mág.

They intensified the Shapes of the noblemen—they should not have been  
 fey—  
 evil was coming for Attle although he had wit.  
 He toppled a great pillar, injured himself grievously,  
 hurriedly sent a summons that his inlaws should come soon.

1 Skop **ó**xtu skjöldunga 'They intensified the Shapes of the noblemen' | Attle and his men caused cruel fates (*skop* 'Shapes') to afflict Guthur and Hawn.

3 fçllði stoð stóra 'He toppled a great pillar' | Symbolic. His own greed was to be his undoing, just like a man who topples a pillar only for it to fall upon himself.

- 3 Horsk vas **h**ús-frøyja, · **h**ugði at man-viti,  
 2 lag heyrði hön orða, · hvat þçir á laun mçltu;  
 þa vas **v**ant **v**itri, · **v**ildi hön þeim hjalpa,  
 4 skyldu of **s**ç sigla · çn sjölf né kom=sk=at.

[R TODO]

Wise was the lady of the house; she thought cleverly;  
 she heard the gist of the words which the men spoke in secret.  
 Then the clever woman was pressed; she wished to help them;  
 the men were to sail o'er the sea but she herself would not come.

ALL | Guthrun overhears the plans of her husband but since she herself cannot come to warn her brothers she comes up with a plan.

- 4 Rúnar nam at rísta, · reŋgði þer Vingi— [R TODO]  
 2 fárs vas hann flýtandi— · áðr hann framm seldi,  
 fóru þá síðan · sændi-menn Atla  
 4 umb fjörð Lima · þar's fróknir bjoggu.

She took to carve runes; Winge distorted them—  
 he was a hastener of dangers—before he handed them over.  
 Then thereafter journeyed Attle's messengers  
 around the Limfirth whither the brave men dwelled.

4 fjörð Lima 'Limefirth' | Limfjorden in the north of Jutland; the localisation of the poem's events in Denmark rather than in Burgundy (as the more archaic *Akv* 21/2) is a secondary development of the story likely based on the confusion between the continental and originally Asiatic Huns and the similarly named tribe of Denmark (TODO).

- 5 Ql-vérir urðu · ok elda kyndu, [R TODO]  
 2 hugðu vétr véla · es þeir vöru komnir;  
 tóku þeir fórnir · es þeim fríðr sændi,  
 4 hængðu á súlu, · hugðu=t þat varða.

They were generous with ale and kindled the fires,  
 nowise suspected wiles from those who had come.  
 They took the gifts which the beautiful woman [= Guthrun] had sent them,  
 hung them on a pillar, did not think it had meaning.

3 fórnir 'gifts' | Apparently whereon the runes were inscribed as suggested by the implication in the last line of the stanza. The fact that they can be hung on a pillar seems to suggest that Guthrun embroidered the runes into a tapestry.

- 6 Kom þá Kost-bera, · kvæn vas hön Högna, [R TODO]  
 2 kona kapps-gælig, · ok kvaddi þá báða;  
 glöð vas ok Glaum-vör · es Gunn·arr átti,  
 4 fell=sk=at saðr sviðri, · sýsti of þorf gæsta.

Then came Costbearer—she was Hawn's wife,  
 a very discerning woman—and greeted them both.  
 Also glad was Gleamware, she whom Guther had to wife;  
 virtue did not fail that wise woman; she looked after the needs of the guests.

4 saðr 'virtue' | Literally 'truth'.

- 7 Buðu þeir heim Högna · ef hann þá heldr fóri; [R TODO]



- 2 sýn vas svip-vísi · ef þeir sín gęði;  
 hét þá Gunn·arr · ef Hogni vildi,  
 4 Hogni því nítiti · es hinn of réði.

They invited Hawn to their home if he would be more willing to go;  
 the deceit was apparent if they would have watched out for themselves.  
 Guthur asked if Hawn wished to go;  
 Hawn turned down what the other one counselled.

2 sýn vas svip-vísi · ef þeir sín gęði | Repeated in 71/2 below.

- 8 Bóru mjōð męrar, · margs vas alls þęini, [R TODO]  
 2 fór þar fjōłð horna · und's þōtti full-drukkitt.

The famous women bore mead; the servings were all plentiful;  
 there went forth a multitude of horns before it seemed fully drunk.

- 9 Hjú gęrðu hvílu · sęm þęim hógst þōtti; [R TODO]  
 2 kęnnđ vas Kost·bera, · kunni hōn skil rúna,  
 innti orđ-stafi · at ęldi ljósum;  
 4 gęta varđ hōn tungu · í góma báđa:  
 vōru svá villtar · at vas vant at ráđa.

The couple made their place of rest as they thought most pleasing;  
 Costbearer was renowned; she knew the distinctions of runes;  
 she interpreted the word-staves by the bright fire.  
 She had to hold her tongue between her gums;  
 they were so confused that there was little to read.

ALL | Sts. 9–19 are paraphrased in *Vpls* 34.

4 í góma báđa ‘between her gums’ | Lit. ‘in her gums’, that is, due to the difficulty of reading the runes.

- 10 Sęing fóru síðan · sína þau Hogni; [R TODO]  
 2 dreymđi drótt-láta, · dulđi þęss vęttki,  
 sagđi horsk hilmi · þęgar's hōn réđ vakna:

Then they went to their bed, she and Hawn;  
 the courtly-faced woman dreamt, hid no part of it;  
 the wise woman told the prince when she awoke:

- 11 „Heıman gęri=sk þú, Hogni, · hygg þú at rōðum! [R TODO]  
 2 Fár 's full-rýninn, · far þú í sinn annat!  
 Réđ'k þęr rúnar · es reıst þın systir:

- 4           **bj**ort hęfir þęr ęigi · **b**oðit í sinn þetta.

“Thou makest ready to leave home, Hawn; think about this counsel.  
Few know runes fully; journey another time!  
I read the runes which thy sister carved;  
the bright woman has not summoned thee this time.

- 12           **E**itt ek męst **u**ndr=umk · —má’k=at **ę**nn hyggja—

[R TODO]

- 2           hvat þa **v**arð **v**itri · es skyldi **v**illt rísta;  
            því’t svá **v**as **a** **v**ísat · sęm **u**ndir véri  
4           **b**ani ykkarr **b**ęggja · ef it **b**rál=la kvęmið.  
            **V**ant ’s stafs **v**ífi · eða **v**alda aðrir.“

I wonder most about a single thing; I cannot get to the bottom of it:  
what happened to the clever woman that she should carve so confused,  
for it was so indicated as if it were underneath  
that it would the bane of you both if ye came hurriedly.  
The wife left out a stave—or others are at fault.”

- 13           „**A**llar ’ro ill-úðgar,“ (kvað Hęgni,) „**a**’kk=a’k þęss kynni,

[R TODO]

- 2           vil’k=a’k þęss lęita · nema **l**auna ęigim;  
            okkr mun **g**ramr **g**olli · ręifa **g**lóð=rauðu,  
4           **ó**=umk ek **a**ldri=gi · þó’tt vér **ó**gn fregnim.“

“All women are suspicious,” quoth Hawn, “I have not such a mind.  
I will not look out for such unless we have to repay it.  
The chief will gladden us two with glowing-red gold;  
I shall never fear, although we should learn of something fearful.”

- [Kost=bera kvað:] 14           „**S**topalt munuð ganga · ef it **s**tundið þangat,

[R TODO]

- 2           **y**kk mun **ę**st=kynni · ęigi í sinn þetta.  
            **D**reymði mik, Hęgni, · **d**ylj=umk þat ęigi:  
4           Ganga mun **y**kk **a**nd=óris · eða **ę**lla hręð=umk.

[Quoth Costbearer:] “Stumbling will ye two go if ye proceed thither;  
there will not be any loving welcome shown you this time.  
I had a dream, Hawn; I will not hide it:  
It will go ill for you two—or else I am just afraid.

ALL | Sts. 14–19 deal with Costbearer’s prophetic dreams as told to her husband Hawn.

- 15           **B**léju hugða’k þína · **b**renna í ęldi,

[R TODO]

- 2           **h**ryti **h**ęr logi · **h**ús mín í gęgnum.“  
            „**L**iggja hér **l**ín=klęði · þau’s ér **l**ítt rókíð,

[Hęgni kvað:]

4 þau munu brátt brenna · þar's þú bléju sátt.“

I thought thy cover were burning in fire;  
the high flame roared throughout my halls.”

[Quoth Hawn:] “Here lie linen clothes which ye little do mind;  
they will soon burn where thou didst see the cover.”

---

3 þau's ér | 'þau er' R

[Kost·bera kvað:] 16 „Björn hugða'k hér inn kominn, · bryti upp stokka,

[R TODO]

2 hristi svá hramma · at vér hrédd yrðim;

mun oss mǫrg hefði · svá't vér mǣttim ekki;

4 þar vas ok þrǫmmun · þey=gi svá lítil.“

[Quoth Costbearer:] “I thought a bear came in hither, broke up the rafters,  
struck so fiercely that we were frightened,  
held many of us in its mouth so that we could nowise resist;  
there was also crashing not at all small.”

[Høgni kvað:] 17 „Veðr mun þar vaxa, · verða ótt snemma;

[R TODO]

2 hvíta-björn hugðir: · þar mun hregg austan.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “The storm will grow yonder, turn violent shortly;  
thou thoughtest of a white-bear—there comes a tempest from the east.”

---

2 hvíta-björn hugðir: · þar mun hregg austan ‘thou thoughtest of a white-bear—there comes a tempest from the east’ | The image is undoubtedly Greenlandish; polar bears float from the east to the island on large sheets of ice. There is a real power to these lines which gives a sense of the harshness of the Greenland climate, even by Icelandic standards.

[Kost·bera kvað:] 18 „Qrn hugða'k hér inn fljúga · at end-löngu húsi,

[R TODO]

2 þat mun oss drjúgt deila=sk, · dreifði hann oss ǫll blóði;

hugða'k af heitum · at véri hamr Atla.“

[Quoth Costbearer:] “I thought an eagle flew in hither through the end-long hall;  
that must be of weight for us; he spattered us all in blood;  
I thought from the names that it were Attle's hame!”

---

1 at end-löngu húsi | Also occurring at 24/1b below. The verse appears to be a Speeches-meter variant of the formulaic Ancient-words-law b-verse *end-langan sal* (cf. *Þrk* 27/2 n.)

3 hamr Atla ‘Attle's hame’ | I.e., Attle in the shape of an eagle.

[Høgni kvað:] 19 „Slótrum sýs=liga, · séum þá roðru;

[R TODO]

2 opt 's þat fyr qxnum · es qrnú dreymir;

heill 's hugr Atla · hvat-ki's þik dreymir.“

4 Lokit því létu, · líðr hver róða.

[Quoth Hawn:] “We will go to slaughter shortly—*then* we will see blood;  
it is oft a sign of oxen when one dreams of eagles.  
Attle’s heart is wholesome no matter what thou dreamest.”  
They closed the matter; each speech comes to its end.

20 Vǫknuðu vel-borin, · vas þar sams dōmi,

[R TODO]

2 gētti=sk þess Glaum-vǫr · at véri grand svefna  
[...] við Gunn·arr · at fá tvér leiðir.

The well-born couple awoke; the same thing happened there;  
Gleamware asked for counsel about the blemishes of her sleep [NIGHTMARES];  
[...] with Guther that it may have two outcomes:

---

ALL | Gleamware, Guther’s wife, also has prophetic dreams; she tells them to Guther in sts. 20–26.  
Sts. 20–38 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 35.

21 „Gǫrvan hugða’k þér galga, · gengir þú at hanga

[R TODO]

2 éti þik ormar, · yrða’k þik kvikvan,  
gørði=sk rǫk ragna; · ráð hvat þat véri!

“I thought a gallows were readied for thee; thou wentest to hang;  
snakes did eat thee; I lost thee in life;  
it was [like] the Rakes of the Reins. Interpret what that was!

22 Blóðgan hugða’k mēki · borinn ór serk þínum,

[R TODO]

2 illt ’s svefn s·líkan · at segja nauð-manni;  
geir hugða’k standa · í gognum þik miðjan,  
4 ǣmjuðu ulfar · á ǣndum bōðum.“

I thought a bloodied sword were pulled out from thy shirt;  
it is ill to tell of such a sleep to one’s husband.  
I thought a spear were piercing through thy stomach;  
wolves bellowed on both of its sides.”

---

2 nauð-manni ‘husband’ | Hapax. TODO.

[Gunn·arr kvað:] 23 „Rakkar þar renna, · ráða=sk mjök geýja,

[R TODO]

2 opt verðr glaumr hunda · fyr gēira flaugin.“

[Quoth Guther:] “Yonder hounds will run; they are loudly barking;  
oft the revel of dogs comes before the hurling of spears.”

[Glaum-vor kvað:] **24** „**Q** hugða'k hér inn renna · at **ę**ndi-löngu húi,  
 2 þyti af þjósti · þęysti=sk of þękki;  
 bryti fótr ykkra · bróðra hér tveggja,  
 4 gørði=t vatn vęgja; · vesa mun þat fyr nøkkvi.

[R TODO]

[Quoth Gleamware:] “I thought a river ran in hither through the end-long hall;  
 it roared furiously, gushed over the benches,  
 here broke the feet of you brothers twain;  
 the water did not cede. That must mean something!”

**25** **K**onur hugða'k dauðar · koma ĩ nött hingat,  
 2 vęri=t vart búnar, · vildi þik kjósa,  
 byði þér bráð=liga · til þękkja sinna;  
 4 ek kveð af-lima · orðnar þér dísir.“

[R TODO]

I thought dead women came hither tonight;  
 they were not poorly dressed; they would choose thee,  
 invited thee hurriedly onto their benches.  
 For thee, I say, the dises have become feeble!”

4 ek kveð af-lima · orðnar þér dísir ‘For thee, I say, the dises have become feeble’ | The goddesses of fate have become powerless to protect him due to his imminent death; for the expression cf. *Grm* 55.

[Gunn-arr kvað:] **26** „**S**ęinat 's at sęgja, · svá 's nú ráðit;  
 2 forð=umk=a fęr þó · alls þó 's fara ętlat;  
 margt 's mjøk glík=ligt · at munim skamm-ęir.“

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guther:] “It is too late to tell; it has now been thusly interpreted,  
 yet I cannot refrain from the journey when it is intended I should journey.  
 Much makes it likely that we shall be short-lived.”

ALL | Guther at last admits that Gleamware likely has seen something. He will not try to explain away the dreams further, but even if what they imply is true, fate has already decided that he and Hawn must journey to Attle.

**27** **L**itu es lýsti · létu=sk þęir fúsir  
 2 allir upp rísa, · qnnur þau lottu;  
 fóru fimm saman, · flęiri til vęru  
 4 hólfa hús-karlar, · hugat vas því illa.  
 Snęv-arr ok Sól-arr, · synir vęru þęir Hęgna,  
 6 Orkning þann hétu · es þęim ęnn fylgdi;  
 blíðr vas bęrr skjaldar, · bróðir hans kvánar.

[R TODO]

They beheld that it grew light; they said they were all  
 eager to arise; others would have restrained them.

They journeyed five men together; there were more men at hand,  
twice as many housecarls; it was ill thought out.  
Snower and Soler; they were the sons of Hawn.  
Orkning they called yet one who followed them;  
blithe was that shield-tree [WARRIOR], the brother of his wife.

7 bróðir hans kvánar 'brother of his wife' | The brother of Hawn's wife, as Orkning was apparently Costbearer's brother.

- 28 **Fóru** **fagr**-búnar · und's þau **fjorðr** skilði, [R TODO]  
2 **löttu** ávallt **ljósar**, · **léttu**=at **hélðr** segja=sk.

The women went fair-clothed until the firth parted them;  
the light ones would restrain them; the men would not be convinced.

ALL | The scene of sts. 28–32 is that the men, Guthur, Hawn, Snower, Soler, and Orkning are in the parting ship alongside Atle's messenger Winge, while the women, ashore, run alongside it.

- 29 **Glaum**-vǫr kvað at orði, · es **Gunn**-arr átti, [R TODO]  
2 **mélti** hǫn við **Vinga** · sǣm henni **vert** þótti:  
„**Veit'**k=at hvárt **verð** launið · at **vilja** ossum,  
4 **glópr**'s **gæsts** kváma · ef **í gori**=sk nokkvat.“

Gleamware took to speak, she whom Guthur had to wife;  
she spoke with Winge as she thought worthiest:  
“I know not whether ye will repay us according to our will;  
a guest's coming is a disgrace if something [ill] comes out of it!”

- 30 **Sór** þá **Vingi**, · **sér** réð hann lítt ęira: [R TODO]  
2 „**Ęigi** hann **jǫtnar** · ef hann at **yðr** lygi,  
**galgi** **gorv**-allan · ef hann á **gríð** hygði.“

Then Winge swore; he chose not to protect himself little:  
“Let the ettins have him if he lies to you,  
on a full gallows, if he thought to break the grith!”

2 hann 'him' | Winge himself.

- 31 **Bera** kvað at orði, · **blíð** í hug sǫnum: [R TODO]  
2 „**Siglið** ér **sęlir** · ok **sigr** árnið,  
**fari** sǣm fyr-męli'k! · **Fęst** ęigi því níta.“

Bearer took to speak, blithe in her heart:  
“May ye sail blessed and win victory;  
may it go as I proclaim! May the fewest deny that.”

- 32      **H**ogni svaraði · —**h**ugði gótt nōnum: [R TODO]  
 2      „**H**uggið=sk it, **h**orskar, · **h**vé=gi's þat gørvi=sk!  
       **M**éla þat **m**argir, · **m**issir þó stórum,  
 4      mōgum réðr **l**itlu · **h**vé verð **l**ejddr heīman.“

Hawn answered; he thought well of his kin:  
 “Comfort yourselves, wise women, however it may turn out!  
 Many men say—yet it is utterly wrong,  
 that for many a man it matters little how he leaves his home.”

---

ALL | Hawn thanks the women for accompanying them to the point of their departure.

- 33      **S**ou=sk til síðan · áðr í **s**undr hyrfi; [R TODO]  
 2      þá hygg **s**kōp **s**kīptu, · **s**kilðu=sk vegir þeira.

They looked at each other then before they were driven apart;  
 then I think the Shapes split them up; their roads did part.

- 34      **R**óa nōmu ríki, · **r**ifu kjōl halfan, [R TODO]  
 2      þeystu **b**ak-fōllum, · **b**rugðu=sk hēldr reiðir;  
       **h**ōmlur slitnuðu, · **h**áir brotnuðu,  
 4      gørðu=t **f**ar **f**esta · áðr þeir **f**rā hyrfi.

They took to row with strength, tore up half the keel,  
 struck the water leaning backwards, became rather wrathful;  
 the oar-straps snapped; the tholes broke;  
 they did not fasten their boat before they turned from it.

---

ALL | The men row furiously and leave the boat untied; they know that they will not return.

- 35      **L**itlu ok **l**engra · —**l**ok mun'k þess sēgja— [R TODO]  
 2      **b**ó sōu þeir standa · es **B**uðli átti;  
       **h**ótt **h**rikuðr grindr · es **H**ogni kníði.

And a little later—I will tell it to its end—  
 they saw standing the town which Budle owned;  
 loudly creaked the gates when Hawn moved them.

- 36      **O**rð kvað þá Vingi · þat's **ā**n véri: [R TODO]  
 2      „**F**arið **f**irr húsi! · **F**látt 's til sōkja,  
       **b**rátt hēf'k ykk **b**rennda, · **b**ragðs skuluð hōgggnir;  
 4      **f**agrt bað'k ykk kvámu, · **f**látt vas þó undir,  
       **ē**lla heðan bíðið · meðan **e**k hōgg yðr galga!“

Then quoth Winge a word which he were better without:  
 “Fare ye far from the house! It is false to visit;  
 I will soon have you burned; ye shall shortly be cut down;  
 fairly I asked for your coming though there was falsehood underneath—  
 or else stay here while I cut you a gallows!”

- 37 Orð kvað hitt Hogni · —hugði lítt végja—  
 2 varr at vettu=gi · es varð at reyna:  
 „Hirð=a þú oss hréða, · haf þú þat framm sjaldan!  
 4 Ef þú eykr orði · illt munt þér lengja.“

[R TODO]

A different word quoth Hawn—he thought little of withdrawing—  
 wary of nothing which he might come to find out:  
 “Do not try to frighten us; thou wilt seldom be successful!  
 If thou addest to thy word thy suffering will be prolonged!”

- 38 Hrundu þeir Vinga · ok í hæl drópu,  
 2 oxar at lögðu · meðan í qnd hiksti.

[R TODO]

They threw Wing and beat him into Hell,  
 laid their axes to him while he gasped for his breath.

- 39 Flykkðu=sk þeir Atli · ok fóru í brynjur,  
 2 gengu svá gǫrvir · at vas garðr milli;  
 urpu=sk á orðum · allir senn reiðir:  
 4 „Fyrr vorum full-ráða · at firra yör lífi.“

[R TODO]

Attle and his men arrayed themselves and got in their byrnies,  
 then went forth ready so that a courtyard stood between them.  
 They threw words at each other, all wrathful at once:  
 “We have long since fully decided to deprive you of life!”

---

2 milli ‘between them’ | I.e., between the two groups, Guthur and Hawn on the one side and Attle’s men on the other.

- 40 „Á sér þat illa · ef höfðuð áðr ráðit;  
 2 enn eruð óbúnir · ok höfum einn fældan,  
 lamðan til hējar— · liðs vas sá yðars!“

[R TODO]

“One thinks it looks bad if ye had decided beforehand;  
 ye are still unprepared and we have felled one man,  
 beat him lame to Hell—he was one of yours!”



- 41 Óðir þá urðu · es þat orð heyrðu, [R TODO]  
 2 forðuðu fingrum · ok fengu í snóri,  
 skutu skarp=liga · ok skjöldum hlífðu=sk.

Then they became mad when they heard that word,  
 twitched their fingers and seized their spears,  
 hurled them furiously and hid behind their shields.

- 42 Inn kom þá ann·spilli · hvat úti drýgðu [R TODO]  
 2 hött fyr hǫllu; · heyrðu þrél segja.

The news came inside of what they were waging outside,  
 loudly through the hall; they heard a thrall speak.

- 43 Qtul vas þá Guð·rún · es hön ękka heyrði, [R TODO]  
 2 hlaðin hals-męnjum · hreytti hön þeim gǫrv-ǫllum,  
 slǫngði svá silfri · at í sundr hrutu baugar.

Then Guthrun became terrible when she heard his crying;  
 laden with neckrings she shook them off one and all;  
 she threw the silver so that the bigs crashed asunder.

- 44 Út gekk hön síðan, · ypði=t lítt hurðum, [R TODO]  
 2 fór=a fēlt þęy=gi · ok fagnaði komnum;  
 hvarf til Niflunga, · sú vas hindst kvęðja,  
 4 fylgði saðr s·líku, · sagði hön mun fleira:

Then she went outside, did not open the doors slowly,  
 went forth, nowise timid, and heartily greeted the comers.  
 She turned to the Nivlings; that was their last meeting;  
 virtue followed that doing; she spoke more from her mind:

- 45 „Lęitaða’k í líkna · at lętja ykkur heiman, [R TODO]  
 2 skǫpum viðr mann=gi · ok skuluð þó hér komnir.“  
 Męlti af man-viti · ef mundu sętta=sk,  
 4 ękki at réðu=sk, · allir ní kvęðu.

“I tried to care for you by keeping you from leaving your home;  
 no man withstands the Shapes—and yet ye shall come here.”  
 She asked with little man-wit if they might be reconciled;  
 they did not plan to do that; they all said no.

2 skǫpum viðr mann=gi ‘no man withstands the Shapes’ | I.e., ‘no man can beat fate.’ The same construction is found in *Gríp* 53/1b.

3 af man-viti ‘with little man-wit’ | Lit. ‘against man-wit’, i.e., ‘with a girl’s naive sense’. The men can hardly reconcile with Atle when they have already slain one of his men.

- 46 Sá þá sél-borin · at þeir sárt léku, [R TODO]  
 2 hugði á harð-ræði · ok hrauð=sk ór skikkju,  
 nökkðan tók hön mæki · ok niðja fjor varði,  
 4 hóg vas at hjaldri · hvar’s hön hēndr fēsti.

Then the woman of blessed birth saw that they sorely fought;  
 she thought of a harsh counsel and cast off her robe.  
 She took a naked sword and defended her kinsmen’s lives;  
 she was skilled in the fight where’er she turned her hands.

ALL | Am has Guthrun throwing off her clothes, taking a sword and fighting alongside her brothers. Nothing of the sort is found in the older *Akv* and it is clearly a later addition to the story, although it does show the high regard in which the Greenlanders held their women. A similar anecdote is found in the *Saw of the Greenlanders* (the famous episode of Freydis, who bares her breasts in the fight against the natives. TODO: reference).

- 47 Dóttir lét Gjúka · drengi tvá hníga, [R TODO]  
 2 bróður hjó hön Atla, · bera varð þann síðan,  
 skapði hön svá skæru, · skældi fót undan.

The daughter of Yivick let two young warriors sink down.  
 She struck Atle’s brother; he had to be borne away thereafter;  
 thus did she handle that engagement: she severed his foot from under him.

2 bróður ... Atla ‘Atle’s brother’ | An unknown figure.

- 48 Annan réð hön hoggva · svá’t sá upp reis=at, [R TODO]  
 2 í hēlju hön þann hafði; · þey=gi hēnni hēndr skulfu.

She struck the other man so that he did not rise up;  
 she let that man go to Hell; yet nowise her hands trembled.

- 49 Þjorku þar gjörðu, · þeiri vas við brugðit; [R TODO]  
 2 þat brá umb allt annat · es unnu börn Gjúka;  
 svá kvóðu Niflunga · meðan sjalfir lifðu  
 4 skapa sókn sverðum, · slíta=sk af brynjur,  
 hoggva svá hjalma · sēm þeim hugr dygði.

They made war there; it was up and off;  
 it beat every other thing which the children of Yivick had accomplished.  
 So they said that the Nivlings while they themselves were alive  
 waged war with swords, tore off their byrnies,  
 struck so the helmets as did their hearts availed them.

- 50 **M**orgin **m**ęst vógu · und's **m**iðjan dag líddi, [R TODO]  
 2 óttu alla · ok ǫnd-urðan dag;  
 fyrr vas full-vegít, · flóði vǫllr blóði;  
 4 át-tján áðr fellu, · øfri þeir urðu,  
 Beru tveim sveinum · ok bróður hennar.

For most of the morning they fought, until mid-day had passed,  
 the whole dawn and early part of the day.  
 Before it was fully fought the plain flowed with blood;  
 eighteen had then fallen; they got the upper hand  
 over Bearer's two boys and her brother.

5 tveim sveinum | *gramm. and sens. emend.*; 'ii. sveinar' (*nom. pl.*) R

5 Beru tveim sveinum · ok bróður hennar 'over Bearer's two boys and her brother' | The sense of the poem requires Bearer's "two boys" (i.e., Guthur and Hawn) to lose which justifies replacing the *nom.* forms with *dat.*

- 51 **R**ǫskr tók at **r**óða · þótt hann **r**eiðr véri: [R TODO]  
 2 „Illt 's umb líta=sk, · yðr 's þat kenna;  
 vorum þrír tígir, · þegnar víg=ligir,  
 4 eptir lifum elliðu; · ór 's þar brunnit.

The bold man [= Attle] took to speak although he was wroth:  
 "It is evil to look around; this is your doing!  
 We were thirty thanes made ready for battle;  
 afterwards but eleven live; the rest have burned away."

2 umb líta=sk 'to look around' | And see the bloodied corpses lying on the ground.

4 ór 's þar brunnit 'the rest have burned away' | Lit. 'it has burned away there', symbolic; their numbers have waned greatly.

- 52 **B**róðr vorum fimm · es **B**uðla misstum, [R TODO]  
 2 hęfir nú **H**ęl halfa · ęn hǫgnir tveir liggja.

We were five brothers when we lost Budle;  
 now Hell has half of them when two lie cut down.

- 53 **M**ęğð gat'k **m**ikla · —**m**á'k=a'k því lęyna— [R TODO]  
 2 konu vá=liga, · kná'k=a'k þęss njóta;  
 hljótt ęttum sjaldan, · síðst komt í hęndr ossar,  
 4 firðan mik fręndum, · fę opt svikinn;  
 sęnduð systr Hęlju, · s'líks ek męst kęnn=umk."

I received strong in-laws—I can not deny that—  
 [but] a woeful wife; I do not enjoy that.

We seldom had peace since thou camest to our hands;  
thou didst distance me from my kinsmen, oft betrayed me for wealth;  
ye sent my sister to Hell—I suffer the most from that.”

---

ALL | Attle addresses Guthrun.

1 gat'k 'I received' | From his marriage with Guthrun.

5 senduð systir Hǫlju 'ye sent my sister to Hell' | Byrnhild, who committed suicide after the Yivickings Guthur and Hawn slew Siward as told in *Sigsk.*

[Guð-rún kvað:] 54 „Getr þú þess, Atli, · gørðir svá fyrri: [R TODO]  
2 Móður tókt mína · ok myrðir til hnossa,  
svinna systrungu · svæltir þú í helli;  
4 hlóg=ligt mér þat þikkir · es þú þinn harm tínir,  
goðum ek þat þakka · es þér geng=sk illa.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Thou tellest, Attle, of what thou thyself didst yet earlier!  
Thou didst take my mother and murder her for gold;  
my wise cousins didst thou starve to death.  
I find it laughable that thou speakest of thy griefs;  
I thank the Gods when it goes ill for thee!”

---

2–3 Móður ... helli ‘Thou didst take ... to death.’ | The content is otherwise unknown.

[Atli kvað:] 55 „Eggja'k yör, jarlar, · auka harm stóran [R TODO]  
2 vífs ins veg=liga, · vilja'k þat líta;  
kostið svá keppa · at klökkvi Guð-rún,  
4 sjá ek þat mætta'k · at hön sér né ynði=t.

[Quoth Attle:] “I incite you, earls! Increase the great harm  
for the glorious wife; I want to behold that.  
Strive to achieve that Guthrun sobs,  
so that I might see that she is unhappy.

---

1 jarlar ‘earls’ | Attle’s surviving companions.

56 Takið ér Høgna · ok hyldið með knífi, [R TODO]  
2 skerið ór hjarta, · skuluð þess gørvir;  
Gunn·ar grimm-úðgan · á galga fæstið,  
4 bællið því bragði, · bjóðið til ornum!“

Take ye Hawn and pry him open with a knife;  
cut out his heart—ye shall be quick about it!  
Guthur the grim-hearted fasten on the gallows—  
hasten to that deed!—offer him to the snakes!”

ALL | Sts. 56–64 deal with the deaths of Guthur and Hawn, especially focusing on the death of Hawn. The same episode is found in *Akv* 22–35.

1 *hyldið* ‘pry him open’ | Otherwise only used of cutting up animals, esp. whales. Finnur Jónsson (1932) is most likely right in seeing its use here as a Greenlandicism.

3–4 Gunn-ar ... ornum! ‘Guthur ... snakes!’ | Fulfilling the prophecy of st. 21. In *Akv* Guthur is thrown in a snake-pit, not hung on the gallows.

Högni kvað: 57 „Gør sem til lystir! · Glǫðr mun’k þess biða, [R TODO]  
2 rǫskr mun þér reyna=sk, · reynt hefi’k fyrr brattara;  
höfðuð hnækking · meðan hēilir vǫrum,  
4 nú erum svá sárir · at þú mátt sjalfr valda.“

Quoth Hawn: “Do as thou desirest! I will suffer it gladly;  
I’ll be proven brave to thee; I have tempted harder things before.  
Ye suffered a setback while we were still healthy;  
now we are so wounded that thou thyself mayst decide.”

3 hnækking ‘a setback’ | Namely the loss of the eighteen retainers (st. 50).

58 Bēiti þat mélti · —bryti vas hann Atla: [R TODO]  
2 „Tókum vér Hjalla · en Hǫgna forðum!  
Hǫgum vér halft-yrkjum, · hann es skap-dauði,  
4 lífir=a svá lengi, · lǫskr mun é hēitinn.“

Bote spoke this—he was Attle’s overseer:  
“Let us take Helle, but Hawn let us spare!  
Let us handle the half-worker; he is shaped for death;  
he will not live for so long; he will always be known as lazy.”

59 Hrēddr vas hver-gétir, · helt=a in lengr rúmi, [R TODO]  
2 kunni klökkur verða, · klēif í ró hverja;  
ve-sall lét=sk vigs þeira · es skyldi vass gjalda  
4 ok sinn dag dapran · at dēyja frá svinum,  
allri ør-kostu · es hann áðr hafði.

The kettle-keeper was afraid, could not run further into the room,  
knew how to start sobbing, hid in every nook;  
said he was wretched o’er the feud of those who should repay him for his toil,  
and that his day was dismal if he should die away from his swine,  
from all the great pleasure which he had previously had.

60 Tóku þeir brás Buðla · ok brugðu til knífi, [R TODO]  
2 øppi ill-préli · áðr odds kenndi;

- tóm lét=sk=at ęiga, · tęđja vel garđa,  
 4 vinna it vergasta · ef hann við rétti;  
 ęeginn lét=sk þó Hjalli · at hann fęor þęgi.

They took Budle's cookboy and brandished the knife,  
 the bad thrall screamed before he saw the point.  
 He said he would take no leisure, dung the fields well,  
 do the meanest work if he might but be let go;  
 Helle said he would rejoice if he might but keep his life.

1 brás 'cookboy' | A hapax, but apparently in ablaut with Swedish *brasa* 'fire', i.e., one who tends to the fire.

- 61 Gętti=sk þess Hęgni · —gęrva svá fęri— [R TODO]  
 2 at ęrna ę·nauđgum · at undan gengi:  
 „Fyrir kveđ'k mér minna · at fęmja lęik þęnna;  
 4 hví mynim hęr vilja · hęyra ę þa skręktun?“

Hawn gave counsel—few men do so!—  
 to grant the enthralled man that he might get away.  
 “It would be easier, I say, for me to endure this game;  
 why should we here wish to listen to this screeching?”

- 62 Þrifu þęir þjóđ-góđan, · þa vas kostr ęngi [R TODO]  
 2 rekkum rakk-látum · ráđ ęnn lęngr dvelja;  
 hló þa Hęgni, · hęyrđu dag-męgir,  
 4 kęppa hann svá kunni, · kvęl hann vel þolði.

They seized the very good man; then there was no choice  
 for the stern-faced retainers to tarry with their orders.  
 Then Hawn laughed; the sons of daylight [WORKMEN] heard it;  
 so did he know how to struggle; he suffered well the torment.

- 63 Hęrpu tók Gunn·arr, · hrórđi il-kvistum; [R TODO]  
 2 slá hann svá kunni · at snótir grétu;  
 klukku þęir karlar · es kunnu gęrst hęyra;  
 4 ríkri rőđ sagði, · raptar sundr brustu.

Guthur took the harp, plucked it with his footsole-twigs [TOES],  
 struck as he knew so that the ladies wept;  
 the menfolk cried who heard it clearest;  
 he gave the powerful woman counsel; the rafters burst asunder.

ALL | The poet turns to Guthur, who is on the gallows and at the same time being tortured by the wyrms. For the scene of Guthur playing the harp with his toes see *Akv* 35.

4 ríkri ‘powerful woman’ | Presumably Guthrun; cf. 65/2 below.

- 64      Dóu þá dýrir, · dags vas heldr snemma, [R TODO]  
2      létu þeir á læsti · lifa í þróttu.

Then the precious men died; the day was rather early;  
to the very last they let their skills linger on.

- 65      Stórr þótti=sk Atli, · sté hann of þá báða, [R TODO]  
2      horskri harm sagði · ok réð heldr at bregða:  
„Morginn ’s nú, Guð-rún, · misst hefir þér hollra,  
4      sums est sjalf-skapa · at hafi svá gengit.“

Attle thought himself great; he stood over them both,  
he told the wise woman a thing of harm and did harshly upbraid her:  
“It is morning now, Guthrun; thou hast lost those true to thee;  
it is partly thy own doing that things have gone so.”

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 66      „Feginn est, Atli, · færr þú víg lýsa, [R TODO]  
2      á munu þér iðrar · ef allt reynir;  
sú mun erfð eptir · —ek kann þér segja:  
4      ills geng=sk þér aldri · nema ek ok deyja.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Thou art rejoicing, Attle; thou goest to announce the slayings;  
thou wilt come to regret them if thou dost come to prove it all.  
There will be an inheritance afterwards—I can tell thee:  
evil will never part from thee unless I too die.”

- [Atli kvað:] 67      „Kann’k=a’k s·líks synja, · sé’k til ráð annat, [R TODO]  
2      holfu hóg=ligra · —hofnum opt góðu:  
Man\*i mun’k þik hugga, · métum á-gétum,  
4      silfri sné-hvítu · sem sjölf vilir.“

[Quoth Attle:] “I cannot deny such a thing; I see another counsel,  
twice as fitting; we often abandon what is good.  
I will comfort thee with a handmaid and with excellent treasures,  
with snow-white silver, whate’er thou thyself desirest!”

3 Man\*i | *metr. and sens. emend.*; manni R.

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 68      „Ön es þess engi, · ek vil því níta, [R TODO]  
2      sleit’k þá sáttir · es vöru sakar minni;  
af-kör ek áðr þóttá’k, · á mun nú góða,

4 hréðǫa'k umb hot-vetna · meðan Hogni lifði.

[Quoth Guthrun:] “That will hardly be expected; I will refuse it.  
I tore up reconciliations when the crimes were lesser;  
I seemed violent before—I will now exceed it;  
I put up with anything while Hawn still lived.

69 Alin vit upp vǫrum · í ęinu húsi,

[R TODO]

2 lékum lęik margan · ok í lundi óxum,  
góddi okkr Grím·hildr · golli ok hals-męnjum.

4 Bana munt mér bróðra · bóta aldri=gi  
né vinna þęss ękki · at mér vel þikki.

We two were reared up in one house;  
we played many a game and waxed in the glade;  
Grimhild endowed us with gold and neckrings.  
For the slaying of my brothers wilt thou never restore me,  
nor accomplish anything that might seem good to me.

---

1 vit ‘we two’ | Guthrun and Hawn.

70 Kostum drepr kvenna · karla of-ríki,

[R TODO]

2 í kné gęngr hnefi · ef kvistir þverra,  
tré tękr at hnįga · ef hogggr tág undan;  
4 nú mátt ęinn, Atli, · ǫllu hér ráða.“

The choices of women are beat down by the tyranny of men.  
The fist gets on its knees if the branches thin out;  
the tree begins to lean if one cuts away its roots from underneath it;  
now mayst thou alone, Attle, rule everything here.”

---

2 í kné gęngr hnefi · ef kvistir þverra ‘The fist gets on its knees if the branches thin out’ | Pettit (2023) sees this as a reference to the game Neve-Table (*Hnefa-tafl*), where the *hnefi* ‘fist’ is the name of the King, surrounded by his soldiers (Pawns or Rooks) on all sides, which seem to resemble branches. For board games see *Vǫp* 8/1 n.

71 Gnótt vas grunn-ýðgi · es gramr því trúði,

[R TODO]

2 sýn vas sveip-vísi · ef hann sін gęði.  
Krǫpp vas þá Guð-rún, · kunni umb hug męla,  
4 létth hōn sér gørði, · lęk hōn tvęim skjǫldum.

There was gullibility enough when the chief believed that;  
the deceit was apparent if he would have watched out for himself.  
Then Guthrun was hard; she could speak with care;  
she made herself out to be light; she played with two shields.



- 72      Øxti hǫn ǫl-drykkjur · at ęřfa bróðr sína, [R TODO]  
 2      samr lét=sk ok Atli · at sína gǫrva.

She made the ale-vessels grow to drink the wake of her brothers;  
 Attle, too, did the same for his own.

- 73      Lokit því létu, · lagat vas drykkju; [R TODO]  
 2      sú vas sam-kunda · við svǫrfun of-mikla;  
     strǫng vas stór-huguð, · stríddi hǫn ęt Buðla,  
 4      vildi hǫn ver sínum · ofr-ęęfndir.

They closed the matter; the drink was brewed;  
 that was an assembly with too great destruction.  
 Cruel was the great-minded woman; she injured the lineage of Budle;  
 against her husband she wished to wreak great revenge.

4 vildi hǫn ver sínum · ofr-ęęfndir | Alliteration between *v*- and vowels is by no means unheard of in Norse poetry but varies greatly between styles. In the Scaldic genre, for instance, it was always entirely forbidden.

- 74      Lokkaði hǫn litla · ok lagði við stokki; [R TODO]  
 2      glúpnuðu grimmir · ok grétu þęy=gi,  
     fóru í faðm móður, · frétu hvat þa skyldi.

She called on her little ones and laid them against a stump;  
 the grim ones were downcast and yet nowise cried;  
 they jumped to their mother's bosom, asked what would happen.

ALL | Guthrun kills her own children, Earp and Oatle. The killing is not described directly in *Akv* but is alluded to in *Akv* 37 and mentioned in 40–41.

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 75      „Spyrið lítt ęptir! · Spilla ętla'k böðum, [R TODO]  
 2      lyst vǫr=umk þęss lęgi · at lyfja ykk ęlli.“  
 [Bǫrn'in:]      „Blótt sęm vilt bǫrnum, · bannar þat mann=gi,  
 4      skǫmm mun ró ręði · ef þú ręynir gǫrva.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Ask no more what is coming! I intend to slay you both,  
 I have long had lust to deprive you of old age.”  
 [The children:] “Bloot thy children if thou wilt; no man forbids thee;  
 the respite of thy wrath will be short if thou dost truly try it.”

3 Blótt ‘Bloot’ | I.e., ‘sacrifice’.

- 76      Brá þa barn-ǫsku · bróðra in kapp-svinna, [R TODO]  
 2      skipti=sk skap=liga, · skar hǫn á hál báða.

- Enn frétti Atli · hvert farnir véri  
 4 sveinar hans leika · es hann sá þá hvergi.

Then childhood was cut short for the battle-wise brothers,  
 it was overturned according to Shapes—she slit the throats of them both.  
 Soon Atle asked whither they had gone,  
 his swains in their play, when he nowhere saw them.

- 77 „Yfir róð=umk ganga, · Atla til sægja, [R TODO]  
 2 dylja mun'k þik ęigi, · dóttir Grím·hildar;  
 glaða mun þik minnst, Atli, · ef þú gǫrva reynir;  
 4 vakðir vǫ mikla · es þú vatt bróðr mína.

“I decide to come over to tell thee, Atle;  
 I, the daughter of Grimhild, will not hide it from thee.  
 It will gladden thee the least if thou dost truly find it out;  
 thou didst awaken great woe when thou slewest my brothers.

- 78 Svaf'k mjök sjaldan, · síðan's þeir fellu, [R TODO]  
 2 hét'k þér hǫrðu, · hefi'k þik nú minntan;  
 morgin mér sagðir, · man'k ęnn þann gǫrva,  
 4 nú 's ok aptann, · átt s·líkt at fréttu.

I slept very seldom since they fell;  
 I vowed harsh things towards thee; I have now reminded thee.  
 This morning thou spokest to me; I still remember it clearly.  
 Now it is the evening; thou hast to learn such things:

---

3 morgin ‘This morning’ | Cf. st. 65.

- 79 Maga hefir þinna · misst sęm síðst skyldir; [R TODO]  
 2 hausa veitst þeira · hafða at ǫl-skǫlum,  
 drýgða'k þér svá drykkju— · dreypa blett'k þeira.

Thou hast lost thy lads as thou least shouldst have.  
 I know their skulls have been made into ale-bowls;  
 thus I enriched thy drink: I mixed it with their blood.

---

ALL | In sts. 79–81 Guthrun recounts how she fed Atle the corpses of their children. Cf. the description of the same events in *Akv* 40–41; the strong correspondences suggest a direct line of influence.

- 80 Tók'k þeira hjörtu · ok á tęini stęikta'k,  
 2 sęlda'k þér síðan, · sagða'k at kalfs véri; [R TODO]

4      ęinn þú því ollir · ękki rétt leifa,  
tęggst tíð=liga, · trúðir vel jęxlum.

I took their hearts and roasted them on a stick,  
then I handed them to thee; I said they were a calf's.  
Thou alone didst do that; thou decidedst to leave nothing,  
didst chew greedily; thou trustedst thy molars well!

81      Barna vęitst þinna · —biðr sér fár verra—  
2      hlut veld'k mínum, · hęl=umk þó ękki.“

[R TODO]

Thou knowest of thy children; few will ask for worse;  
I bear fault for my part although I do not boast of it.”

82      „Grimm vast, Guð·rún, · es þú gęra svá máttir,  
2      barna þinna blóði · at blanda mér drykkju;  
snýtt hęfir sifjungum · sęm síðst skyldir,  
4      mér lętr þú ok sjęlfum · millum ills lítit.“

[R TODO]

“Thou wast cruel, Guthrun, when thou couldst do so,  
to blend thy own children's blood into my drink.  
Thou hast destroyed thy own relations as thou least shouldst have;  
for me leavest thou little [time] between evil.”

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4 millum ills lítit 'little [time] between evil' | Referring to Guthrun's recent killing of Atle's brother (sts. 47–48).

[Guð·rún kvað:] 83      „Vili mér ęnn vęri · at vęga þik sjalfan,  
2      fátt 's full-illa · farit við gram s·líkan.“  
[Atli kvað:] „Drýgt þú fyrr hafðir · þat's męnn dęmi vissu=t,  
4      til hęmsku, harð-ręðis, · í hęimi þessum;  
nú hęfir þú ęnn aukit · þat's nú áðan fręgum,  
6      gręipt glęp stóran, · gęrt hęfir þú þitt ęrfi.

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guthrun:] “If but I still had willpower to slay thy very self;  
little is evil enough when done against such a prince!”  
[Quoth Atle:] “Thou hast already done that of which men knew no equivalent  
in foolishness and harsh counsel in this Home.  
Now hast thou yet added to what we earlier had learned;  
thou didst accomplish a great disgrace; thou hast had thy wake!

---

4 í hęimi þessum 'in this Home' | I.e., in the world of mankind.

84      Bręnnnd munt á báli · ok barið grjóti áðr,

[R TODO]

- 2 þá hefir þú árnat · þat's ę beįđi=sk.  
 [Guđ-rún kvađ:] „Sęg þér s·líkar · sorgir ár morgin,  
 4 frįđra vil'k dauđa, · fara į ljós annat.“

Thou wilt be burned on a pyre and struck with stones beforehand;  
 then hast thou earned what thou always begged for!”

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Tell thyself such sorrows early in the morning;  
 by a fairer death I wish to go into the other light.”

---

1 Bręnn munt á báli · ok bariđ grįóti áđr ‘Thou wilt be burned on a pyre and struck with stones beforehand’ | A Christian, mediæval punishment. That being burned on a pyre is seen as a punishment and associated with stoning reveals a mediæval Catholic sensibility horrified at the thought of burning a body rather than burying it. In pagan times, however, burning was a neutral way of disposing of a body and had no negative associations (so e.g. *Háv* 71/3, 81/1); cf. Males (2024b, pp. 93–96).

4 ljós annat ‘the other light’ | The next world; the world as ‘light’ is more commonly found in West Germanic heroic poetry.

- 85 Sötu sam-týnis, · sęndu=sk fár-hugi, [R TODO]  
 2 hęndu=sk heįpt-yrđi, · hvárt=ki sér unđi.  
 Heįpt óx Hniflungi, · hugđi á stór-ręđi,  
 4 gat fyr Guđ-runu · at hann vęri grimmr Atla.

They sat in the same court, gave each other evil thoughts,  
 handed each other hateful words; neither was content.  
 Hatred grew in Nivling; he thought of great counsel;  
 mentioned to Guthrun that he was furious towards Atle.

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3 Hniflungi ‘Nivling’ | *Hniflungr*, the son of Hawn.

- 86 Kvomu į hug hęnni · Hęgna við·farar, [R TODO]  
 2 talđi happ hęnum · ef hęfnt ynni;  
 veginn vas þa Atli, · vas þess skammt bíđa,  
 4 sonr vá Hęgna · ok sjölf Guđ-run.

Into her mind came Hawn’s demise;  
 she counted it lucky for him if he might accomplish the revenge.  
 Then Atle was slain; it was short to abide;  
 Hawn’s son struck him and Guthrun herself.

- 87 Ręskr tók at rđđa, · rakđi=sk ór svefni, [R TODO]  
 2 kęnni brátt bęnja, · bands kvađ þorf ęnga:  
 „Sęgiđ it sannasta: · Hvērr vá son Buđla?  
 4 Em’k=a’k lítł lęikinn, · lífs tęt’k vęn ęga.“

The bold man took to speak, roused from his sleep,  
shortly felt his wounds; said dressings were of no use.  
“Tell the whole truth! Who struck Budle’s son?  
I am not a little injured; I count no hopes for my life.”

[Guð·rún kvað:] **88** „Dylja mun þik ęigi · **dóttir** Grím·hildar: [R TODO]  
2 **L**ot=umk því valda · es **liðr** þína ęvi  
ęn **s**umu **s**onr Hęgna · es þik **s**ęr móða.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “The daughter of Grimhild will not hide it from thee:  
I made myself the cause for why thy age comes to its end,  
but some part the son of Hawn [plays] when the wounds do pain thee.”

[Atli kvað:] **89** „Vaðit hęfir þú at **v**ígi · þó’tt **v**ęri=t skap=ligt; [R TODO]  
2 illt ’s **v**in **v**éla, · þann’s þér **vel** trúir;  
**b**ęiddr fór’k hęiman · at **b**įđja þín, Guð·rún.

[Quoth Attle:] “Thou hast waded forth in killings although it was not shapely;  
it is ill to betray a friend who does trust thee well;  
urged-on, I journeyed from home to ask for thee, Guthrun.

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3 bęiddr ‘urged-on’ | Attle reminds Guthrun that it was not his choice to marry her.

**90** **L**eyfð vast-u, ękkja, · **l**étu stór-ráða, [R TODO]  
2 **v**arð=a **v**ęn lygi · es **v**ér of reyndum;  
**f**órt-u **h**ęim **h**ingat, · fylgði oss **h**ęrr manna,  
4 **a**llt vas **í**tar=ligt · umb **ó**rar fęrðir.

Thou wast praised, woman; they said thou hadst great plans;  
that expectation was no lie, as we found out.  
Thou journeyedst hither from home; we were followed by a host of men;  
everything was splendid about our journey.

**91** **M**args vas alls sęmi, · **m**anna tíginna, [R TODO]  
2 **n**aut vęru órin, · **n**utum af stórum;  
þar vas **f**jólð **f**ęar, · **f**engu til margir.

There was much honour in everything for the distinguished men;  
the kine were ample, we enjoyed them greatly;  
there was a multitude of wealth; many received it.

**92** **M**und galt ek **m**ęrri, · **m**ęiðma fjólð þiggja, [R TODO]  
2 **þ**ręla **þ**rjá-tęgu, · **þ**ýjar sjau góðar;

sómð vas at s·líku, · silfr vas þó meira.

I paid the bride-price for the famed woman who got a multitude of treasures:  
thirty thralls, seven good handmaids.  
There was honour in all such things; there was even more silver.

- 93 Létst þér allt þikkja · sēm ekki véri [R TODO]  
2 meðan lǫnd þau lǫgu · es mér leiðði Buðli;  
gróft svá undir, · gørði=t hlut þiggja.  
4 Svéru létst þína · sitja opt grátna,  
fann'k=a'k í hug hēilum · hjóna vétr síðan.“

Thou saidst it all seemed to thee as if it were nothing  
while the lands which Budle left me lay [unused];  
thou didst undermine [them]; one did not receive a part.  
Thou didst let thy mother-in-law sit often weeping;  
I never found the household in good heart thereafter.”

2–3 meðan ... þiggja ‘while ... a part.’ | Difficult. L. 2 seems to say that Guthrun was a nagging wife and chastised Atle for not working harder (namely for not cultivating all his fields—the very suggestion reveals the poverty of the Greenlandish poet, for whom Atle can be little more than a wealthy farmer). L. 3 is more difficult.

- [Guðrún kvað:] 94 „Lýgr þú nú, Atli, · þótt ek þat lítt rækja;  
2 hēldr vas'k hǫg sjaldan · hóft=sk þó stórum;  
bǫrðuð=sk ér bróðr ungir, · bǫruð=sk róg milli.  
4 Halft gekk til hēljár · ór húsi þínu;  
hroldi hot-vetna · þat's til hags skyldi.

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Thou liest now, Atle, though I care little about it;  
rather, I was seldom docile, yet thou didst elevate thyself haughtily.  
Ye young brothers fought each other, carried strife between yourselves.  
Half of thy household went to Hell;  
everything faltered which should have been a boon.

- 95 Þrjú vǫrum systkin, · þöttum ó-végin, [R TODO]  
2 fórum af landi, · fylgðum Sig·verði;  
skéva vér létum, · skipi hvørt vart stýrði,  
4 orkuðum at auðnu · und's vér austr kvǫmum.

We were three siblings; we seemed undefeatable;  
we went away from the land; we followed Siward.  
We let ourselves speed forth; we each steered a ship;  
we went forth according to luck until we came to the east.

2 Sig-vgrði | *metr. emend.*; Sigurði R

4 ǫrkuðum at auðnu ‘we went forth according to luck’ | Proverbial; the verb *arka* is only found in this expression which appears twice in prose (see ONP) and nowhere else in poetry.

- 96 Konung drǫpum fyrstan, · kurum land þaðra, [R TODO]  
 2 hęrsar oss á hǫnd gengu, · hręðslu þat vissi;  
 vǫgum ór skógi · þann’s vildum syknan,  
 4 settum þann sęlan · es sér né átti=t.

We first slew a king; we chose the lands there;  
 the chieftains yielded to us; that showed fear.  
 Out of the forest we brought him who we would see redeemed;  
 we set down blessedly him who owned naught for himself.

3–4 vǫgum ... átti=t. ‘Out of the ... for himself.’ | Siward, who was an orphaned outlaw before he met the Yivickings.

- 97 Dauðr varð inn húnski, · drap þa brátt kosti, [R TODO]  
 2 strangt vas angr ungri · ękkju nafn hljóta;  
 kvǫl þótti kvikri · at koma í hús Atla;  
 4 átti áðr kappi, · illr vas sá missir.

The Hunnish man [= Siward] died; then I was soon without choice;  
 it was a cruel sorrow for a young woman to get a widow’s name.  
 It seemed a torture for her in life to come to the house of Atle;  
 she had once had a champion—ill was that loss.

1 inn húnski ‘The Hunnish man [= Siward]’ | Cf. *Sigs* 4/4 for this appellation.

- 98 Komt=a þú því þingi · es vér þat frégim [R TODO]  
 2 at sǫk sóttir · né slękkðir aðra;  
 vildir ávallt vęgja · ęn vętt=ki halda,  
 4 kyrrt of því láta.“ · ...

Thou didst not come from that Thing, as we have learned it,  
 after thou hadst pursued one charge or quashed another.  
 Thou wantedst always to withdraw—but nowise to hold fast—  
 [and] to stay quiet about it.” ...

4 ... | A blank space is left for this half-line in R.

- [Atli kvað:] 99 „Lýgr þú nú, Guð-rún, · líttr mun við bóta=sk [R TODO]  
 2 hluti hvar-igra, · hǫfum ǫll skarðan;

4                    gør þú nú, Guð·rún, · af gótsku þínni  
                     okkr til á·gétis · es mik út hefja.“

[Quoth Attle:] “Thou liest now, Guthrun; little remedy will be found  
for the lot of either of us; we have all been bereaved!  
Act now, Guthrun, out of thy goodness,  
to the honour of us both when they carry me out.”

[Guð·rún kvað:] 100    „Knorr mun’k kaupa · ok kistu stęinda,  
2                    vęxa vel blęju · at vęrja þitt líki,  
                     hyggja à þorǫf hverja · sęm vit holl vęrim.“

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guthrun:] “I will buy a cargo-ship and a painted coffin,  
weave the cover great to protect thy corpse,  
think of every necessity, like if we had been true to each other.”

101                Nár varð þá Atli, · niðjum stríð óxti,  
2                    ęfndi ítr-borin · allt þat’s réð hęita;  
                     fróð vildi Guð·rún · fara sér at spilla,  
4                    urðu dvöl dógra, · dó hęn í sinn annat.

[R TODO]

Then Attle became a corpse; grief swelled for his kinsmen;  
the noble-born woman carried out all what she had vowed.  
Wise, Guthrun wished to go to destroy her life;  
there was a delay in her days; she died another time.

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4 urðu dvöl dógra ‘there was a delay in her days’ | Namely when she was carried over the waves to King Enacker as told in *Ghv* Pl.

102                Sęll ’s hverr síðan · es s·líkt getr fódða  
2                    jóð at afr·eki · sęm’s ól Gjúki;  
                     lifa mun þat ęptir · à landi hverju,  
4                    þęira þrý·męli · hvar=gi’s þjóð hęyrir.

[R TODO]

Blessed is whoever thenceforth gets to raise  
such children to heroism like those Yivick begot.  
It will afterwards live upon every land:  
their troubled tale, wherever men hear it.



# Instigation of Guthrun

## (*Guð·rúnar hvöt*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.781)–late C11th (0.177)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

#### Textual preservation and transmission

The **Instigation of Guthrun** (*Ghv*) is the penultimate poem of **R**, where it is found on fol. 44r/13–44v/27. The poem is complete.

### Story

As its name spells out, *Ghv* deals with Guthrun's instigation of her two sons Sarle and Hamthew to avenge their sister Swanhild, killed by the cruel tyrant Ermenric. After the sons depart on their inevitably fatal course, Guthrun laments her cruel fate before addressing her long-dead first husband and true love, Siward. She constructs a great funeral pyre in order to join him, it is implied, by self-immolation.

A variant of Guthrun's instigation and the eager response of her sons (*Ghv* 2–8), but not her following monologue, is also found in *Hamð* 3–10. These sections share so much in common, including numerous identical or near-identical lines (*Ghv* 2/3a, 4b–6 = *Hamð* 3/2–4, *Ghv* 4/1–3 = *Hamð* 6/1–3, *Ghv* 4/4 = *Hamð* 7/1, *Ghv* 4/5a ~ = *Hamð* 7/2b), that they must be related. It is however clear from the variant forms that this relation is through the oral tradition (cf. e.g. *Ghv* 4/3 and *Hamð* 6/3, which are near-identical, but where the former appears to be an unmetrical corruption of a line originally resembling the latter; in a scribal context such corruption could never happen). Since both poems are related through oral tradition, this of course means that neither poem can be a scribal composition.

### Historical basis

Because both *Ghv* and the immediately following *Hamð* deal with the same events it is best to discuss their historical basis in a single section.

It is a remarkable thing that the narrative described in these two poems is surprisingly close to historical fact, or at least what we know as such. In Jordanes' *Getica* 129 we read the following:

*Nam Hermanaricus, rex Gothorum, licet, ut superius retulimus, multarum gentium extiterat triumphator, de Hunnorum tamen adventu dum cogitat, Rosomonorum gens infida, quae tunc inter alias illi famulatum exhibebat, tali eum nanciscitur occasione decipere. Dum enim quandam mulierem Sunilda nomine ex gente memorata pro mariti fraudulento discessu rex furore commotus equis ferocibus inligatam incitatisque cursibus per diversa divelli praecipisset, fratres eius Sarus et Ammius, germanae obitum vindicantes, Hermanarici latus ferro petierunt; quo vulnere saucius egram vitam corporis inbecillitate contraxit.*

'Now although Hermanaric, king of the Goths, was the conqueror of many tribes, as we have said above, yet while he was deliberating on this invasion of the Huns, the treacherous tribe of the Rosomoni, who at that time were among those who owed him their homage, took this chance to catch him unawares. For when the king had given orders that a certain woman of the tribe I have mentioned, Sunilda by name, should be bound to wild horses and torn apart by driving them at full speed in opposite directions (for he was roused to fury by her husband's treachery to him), her brothers Sarus and Ammius came to avenge their sister's death and plunged a sword into Hermanaric's side. Enfeebled by this blow, he dragged out a miserable existence in bodily weakness.' (Jordanes 1915, p. 87)

It is known that Ermenric died in 375 AD and that Jordanes was working ca. 550 AD. So it is that in two poems composed at least 450 years (probably closer to 550) after Ermenric's death, preserved in a manuscript written 900 years after his death, we find the very same events retold—the torture-murder of Swanhild with horses, the execution of her lover, the revenge of her two brothers Sarle and Hamthew, their maiming of the king—events retold not on the basis of historical learning, but rather through an independent oral tradition.

### Prose parallels

*Ghv* is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 41, which as usual with that text appears (cf. st. 5/3a) to have relied on a ms. related to, but not identical with or descended from R.

For other Norse attestations of the journey of Hamthew and Sarle and their revenge on Ermenric see the Introduction to *Hamð*.

### Style and word-choices

The poem is rather sparse with kennings and the few that do occur (6/2b, 8/2a, 14/3b; 20/1b should not be taken as an actual kenning) are conventional.

Many sts. are very touching, particularly 13, 15–16, and 19.

A few rare or marked words occur: *tá* in 9/2b, *húnn* in 12/1a, *þjóð-konungr* in 14/2b.

### Meter

The meter is Ancient-words-law.

The length of the stanza is variable and not limited to 4 lines.

The number of non-alliterating ll. in **R** is high, and includes 5/1, 5/3, 13/2, 14/4, 18/1 and 20/4. Of these 5/3 can be restored on the basis of *Vǫls*, but the rest are irrestorably defective. All remaining non-alliterating ll. except for 13/2 have some accompanying signs of corruption along with the lack of alliteration. 5/1 and 20/4 are too short and appear to have lost an alliterating word in transmission, as certainly happened in 5/3. 14/4 and 18/1 are isolated half-lines. Thus, only 13/2 is a rhythmically perfect line without alliteration.

## Text

## Frá Guð·rúnu ('From Guthrun')

- P1 Guð·rún gekk þá til sévar er hón hafði drepit Atla, gekk út á [R 44r/13–20]  
 2 sé'inn ok vildi fara sér. Hón mátti eigi sökka. Rak hana yfir  
 4 fjörð'inn á land Jón·akrs konungs; hann fekk hennar. Þeira synir  
 6 voru þeir Sörli ok Erpr ok Ham·ðir. Þar fódði=sk upp Svan·hildr  
 8 Sig·urðar dóttir. Hón var gipt Jormun·rekk inum ríkja. Með  
 hánun var Bikki. Hann réð þat at Rand·vér konungs son skyldi  
 taka hana; þat sagði Bikki konungi. Konungr lét hengja Rand·vé  
 en troða Svan·hildi undir hrossa fótum. En er þat spurði Guð·rún  
 þá kvaddi hón sonu sína.

GUTHRUN THEN WENT TO THE SEA after she had slain Atle, went out into the sea and would end herself. She could not sink. She was driven across the firth to the land of king Enacker; he got her to wife. Their sons were Sarle and Earp and Hamthew. There Swanhild, Siward's daughter, was reared. She was married off to Ermenric the powerful. With him was Beck. He counseled that Randwigh, the king's son, should sleep with her; this Beck told the king. The king let Randwigh be hanged, but Swanhild he had trampled beneath the hooves of horses. But when Guthrun learned of that she called out to her sons.

1 Guð·rún | *The G is an ornamented capital 2 lines high in R.*

4 Erpr 'Earp' | Actually, the prose is mistaken here. Earp was Enacker's son from a previous marriage and not the son of Guthrun (*Hamð* 12–14).

## Guð·rúnar hvot ('The Instigation of Guthrun')

- 1 Þá frá'k sennu · slíðr-feng=ligasta,  
 2 trauð mól talið · af trega stórum,  
 es harð-huguð · hvatti at vígi  
 4 grimmum orðum · Guð·rún sonu:

I HAVE LEARNT THAT EXCHANGE brought the direst results—  
 the hard-pressed speeches told from great grief—  
 when hard-hearted she goaded to war,  
 with fierce words, Guthrun, her sons:

1 Þá | *The Þ is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, with the left vertical stroke ascending 3 lines and descending 2 lines in the margin in R.*

1 frá'k 'I have learnt' | A formulaic opening. The narrator expresses that he is not a direct witness to the events of the poem by means of the formulaic verb *fregna* (< PGmc. \**frehnaną* '(come to) learn, find out through hearsay'). This formula has identical parallels elsewhere in ON and WGmc. poetry; cf. *Yt* 8/1, 15/5, 16/1, *Beow* 74, 575, 1026 etc., *Heli* 288, 367, 510, etc., and esp. *Wessobrunn* 1/1, where the syntax (note the bracketing of the finite verb between the article and the noun it modifies) is identical to the present line: *Dat ga-fregin ih mit firabim · firi-wizzó mēsta* 'I have learnt among men that greatest of wonders'. The ancestral expression may be reconstructed in PGmc. as follows: \**þa*-ACC-SG *ga-frah* ek ... NOUN-ACC-SG 'I have learnt (of) that NOUN'. — For related formulaic openings involving the verb \**hauzijaną* 'hear' cf. *Oddr* 1/1, *Hild* 1.

- 2 „Hví sitið it? · Hví sofið lífi?  
2 Hví **regr**=at ykkir · **tęti** at męla,  
es **Jormun**=rekr · **yðra** systur,  
4 **unga** at aldri, · **jóm** of traddi,  
**hvítum** ok svörtum · á **hęr**-vegi  
6 **gróum**, **gang**-tómum · **Gotna** hrossum?

“Why do ye two sit? Why sleep ye your lives away?  
Why does it not trouble you to speak merrily  
when Ermenric has had your sister  
young of age trampled by steeds,  
by the white and black on the path of war,  
by the grey, pacing, Gotnish horses?”

1 it | metr. emend.; om. by haplography (\*‘fitit it’ > ‘fitit’) R

3–6 es ... hrossum. ‘when ... horses?’ | Repeated almost identically in *Hamð* 3.

4 of traddi ‘has had ... trampled’ | Lit. ‘made to be trampled’, 3sg past ind. of (*of*) *tręðja* ‘make to be trampled’, causative of *tróða* ‘trample, tread (upon)’.

- 3 Urðu=a it **g**-líkir · þeim **Gunn**-ari  
2 né in **hęldr** **hugðir** · sęm vas **Hęgni**;  
**hęnnar** myндуð it · **hęfna** lęita  
4 ef it **móð** ęttið · **mįnna** bróðra  
ęða **harðan** **hug** · **hunn**-konunga.“

Ye have not turned out alike to Guthur  
nor instead thoughtful like Hawn was.  
*Her* would ye have sought to avenge  
if ye had the courage of my brothers  
or the hard heart of the Hunnish kings!”

- 4 Þá kvað þat **Ham**-ðir · inn **hugum** stóri:  
2 „**Litt** myndir þú · **lęyfa** dōð **Hęgna**  
þá's **Sig**-vęrð vękðu · **svefni** ór;

- 4        **bó**kr vǫru þínar, · inar **blá**-hvítu,  
          roðnar í **vers** dreýra, · folgnar í **val**-blóði.

Then this quoth Hamthew the great of heart:  
 “Thou hadst little cause to praise Hawn’s deeds  
 when they woke Siward from his sleep.  
 Thy blue-white bed-clothes were  
 reddened in thy husband’s gore, buried in death-blood.”

3 **Sig-vǫrð** | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers 1889*, pp. 135–141); **Sig-vrð R**

ALL | L. 1–5a in this st. closely correspond to *Hamð* 6/1–3, 7/1–2.

3 þá’s **Sig-vǫrð** vǫkðu · **svetni** ór | This l. is metrically defective in the present poem but survives better as *Hamð* 6/3.

- 5        Urðu þér [...] · bróðra hefndir  
 2        slíðrar ok **sá**rar · es þú sonu myrðir;  
          knéttim **allir** · **J**ormun·rekki,  
 4        sam-hyggjendr, · systur hefna.

For thee thy [...] deeds of revenge for thy brothers became  
 biting and sore when thou murderedst thy sons.  
 We shall all with a single mind  
 avenge our sister on Ermenric.

3 **allir** | *om.* **R**

3 allir ‘all’ | The restoration of this word is secured by its occurrence in the paraphrase of this st. in *Vǫls* 41: *ok betr mætum vér allir saman drepa Jormun-rek konung* ‘and it would be better if we all together might kill king Ermenric.’ This implies that the version of the poem before the redactor of *Vǫls* was in some ways better preserved than that surviving in **R**.

- 6        Berið **hnossir** framm · **hún**-konunga,  
 2        **hef**r þú okkr **hvatta** · at **h**jör-þingi.“

Bring forth the treasures of the Hunnish kings!  
 Thou hast incited us to the thing of swords [BATTLE].”

- 7        **H**léjandi Guð·rún · **h**varf til skemmu,  
 2        **kumbl** konunga · ór **k**erum valði,  
          síðar brynjur · ok sonum fórði;  
 4        hlóðu=sk **móðgír** · á **m**ara bógu.

Laughing, Guthrun turned to her chamber.  
 The heirlooms of kings from the chests she picked,  
 the trailing byrnies, and brought them to her sons.  
 Fierce, they loaded themselves onto the backs of steeds.

- 8 Þá kvað þat Hamðir · inn hugum stóri:  
 2 „Svá kom=a'k meirr aptr · móður at vitja  
 geir-Njörðr hniginn · á Goð-þjóðu  
 4 at þú erfir · at ǫll oss drykkir,  
 at Svan-hildi · ok sonu þína.“

Then this quoth Hamthrew the great of heart:  
 “So will I no more come back to visit my mother,  
 [when I am] a spear-Nearth [WARRIOR] fallen in the land of the Gots,  
 after thou hast drunk a wake for us all,  
 for Swanhild and for thy sons.”

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2 kom=a'k | 'comaz' R

- 9 Guð-rún grátandi, · Gjúka dóttir,  
 2 gekk treg=liga · á tòi sitja  
 ok at tēlja, · tǫrug-hlýra,  
 4 móðug spjöll · á margan veg:

Guthrun, weeping, Yivick's daughter,  
 went in grief to sit on the ground,  
 and to tell with teary cheeks  
 her moving tale in many ways:

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ALL | The two boys depart (cf. *Hamð*), and Guthrun's long monologue begins, lasting from sts. 10 to 20.

- 10 „Þrjá vissa'k ǣlda, · þrjá vissa'k arna,  
 2 vas'k þrimr verum · vegin at húsi;  
 einn vas mér Sig-vörðr · ǫllum bētri  
 4 es bróðr mínir · at bana urðu.

“I have known three fires; I have known three hearths;  
 for three husbands I have been brought to the house.  
 To me Siward alone was better than all—  
 he whose bane my brothers became.

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3 Sig-vörðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 11 Svárra sára · sá'k=at, né kunna  
 2 [...]  
 meirr þóttu=sk · mér of stríða  
 4 es mik ǫðlingar · Atla gófu.

Heavy griefs I neither saw nor knew,  
[...];  
moreover I thought it injurious to me  
when the athlings gave me to Attle.

1 Svárra sára · sá'k=at, né kunna 'Heavy griefs I neither saw nor knew' | Before the killing of Siward. Guthrun thus presents her life as idyllic before her brothers killed her lover.

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in R, but it seems inevitable that a line has fallen out here containing something to the effect of "before my brothers murdered Siward".

3 mçirr 'moreover' | Namely after the killing of Siward, when she was married off to Attle against her will.

- 12 Húna hvassa · hét'k mér at rúnum;  
2 mátti'g=a'k bǫlva · bǫtr of vinna  
áðr ek hnóf hǫfuð · af Hniflungum.

The smart bear-cubs I called to me for counsel;  
I could not find remedies for the bales  
before I severed the heads from the Nivlings.

3 Hniflungum | *metr. emend.* (cf 1 HHund 48/5); Niflungum R

ALL. | Guthrun alludes to her murder of her children with Attle, as dealt with in *Akv* 37–42 and *Am* 73–81. Cf. *Hamð* 8.

1 Húna hvassa 'The smart bear-cubs' | Her sons with Attle; for the appellation cf. *Vkv* 24/1.

- 13 Gekkk ek til strandar, · grǫm vas'k nornum,  
2 vilda'k hrinda · stríð grið þeira;  
hófu mik, né drękkðu, · hǫvar bǫrur,  
4 því land of sté'k · at lifa skylda'k.

I went to the shore; I was wroth with the norms;  
I wished to break their stubborn peace.  
I was lifted—not drowned—by the billows high,  
so I stepped aland since I was meant to live.

ALL. | Guthrun attempted to take her own life, but was instead driven to the realm of king Enacker, who married her. See P1 above.

3 hófu mik, né drękkðu, · hǫvar bǫrur 'I was lifted—not drowned—by the billows high' | Clearly related to the prophecy of this event in *Sigsk* 62/3, with which the b-verse is identical.

- 14 Gekkk ek á bæð · —hugða'k mér fyr bętra—  
2 þriðja sinni · þjóð-konungi;  
ól ek mér jóð, · ęrfi-vǫrðu  
4 [...] · Jón·akrs sonu.



I mounted the bed—I thought it better for me—  
of a great king for a third time.  
I begot babes, heritage-defenders [sons],  
[...], Enacker's sons.

2 þjóð-konungi 'great king' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

4 sonu | emend.; *sonum* R

- 15      Æn umb Svan·hildi · sǫtu þýjar,  
2      es mǫnna barna · batst full-hugða'k;  
     svá vas Svan·hildir · í sal mínum,  
4      sǣm véri sǫm-leitr · sólar geisli.

But around Swanhild handmaids sat,  
her whom I truly thought best among my children.  
So was Swanhild in my hall  
like were she a fair-faced ray of the sun.

ALL | For the description illustrating the quality of a dead person by likeness to superior natural phenomena, cf. 2 *HHund* 38, 1 *Guðr* 18, 2 *Guðr* 2.

- 16      Gódda'k golli · ok guð-vefjum,  
2      áðr ek gǣfa'k · Got-þjóðar til;  
     þat 's mér harðast · harma mínna  
4      of þann inn hvíta · hadd Svan·hildar:  
     auri tröddu · und jóa fótum;

I endowed her with gold and with cloth of god-weave  
before I gave her to the folk of the Gots.  
That is for me the hardest of my harms,  
over the white hair of Swanhild  
—they had it trampled in mud beneath the hooves of steeds!—

- 17      ɛn sá sárastr, · es þeir Sig·vǫrð mínn,  
2      sigri rǣntan, · í sǣing vǫgu;  
     ɛn sá grimmastr, · es þeir Gunn·ari,  
4      fránir ormar, · til fjǫrs skriðu;  
     ɛn sá hvassastr, · es til hjarta  
6      konung ó-blauðan · kvikvan skóru.

but the sorest when my Siward,  
robbed of victory, they slew in bed,  
but the cruelest when for Guthur  
the gleaming serpents slithered to his chest,

but the sharpest when unto the heart  
they cut the unsoft king [= Hawn], alive.

1 **Sig·vǫrð** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urð R

3–6 ęn ... skǫru ‘but ... alive.’ | For the deaths of Guthur and Hawn cf. *Akv* 23–35, *Am* 56–64.

- 18 Fjǫlð man’k bǫlva, · [...]  
2 **b**eit-tu, **Sig·vǫrðr**, · inn **blakka** mar,  
**h**est inn **hrað-fóra** · lát-tu **hinig** renna!  
4 **Sitr** ęgi hér · **sn**or né dóttir  
sú’s **Guð-runu** · **g**ęfi hnossir.

I recall a multitude of bales; [...]  
Saddle, Siward, thy fallow steed,  
thy quick-pacing horse—let it run hither!  
Here sits no son’s wife nor daughter  
who to Guthrun might give presents.

2 **Sig·vǫrðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

ALL | After recounting her cruel fates, Guthrun addresses Siward, who is long dead. The tone is at last one of release. With the departure of her doomed sons Guthrun has nothing to live for upon the earth; her family line is ended, as Byrnild predicted (*Sigs* 63–64) and she now knows that at last her hard life must soon be over. She will at last find happiness again, but only in death, reunited with her true love and first husband, Siward.— An interesting question not dealt with in the poetry is the fact that Byrnild has already joined Siward by suttee immediately after his death (*Sigs* 65–71, *Helr*). Do the two rival women encounter each other in the afterlife as co-wives, or does one oust the other?

1 [...] | A half-line is undoubtedly missing here. It would presumably have mirrored the first half-line, containing *fjǫlð man’k b-* ‘I recall a multitude of ...’ with alliteration on a noun beginning with *b*; cf. the similar structure of *Þrk* 23/3.

- 19 **Minns**-tu, **Sig·vǫrðr**, · hvat vit **m**ęltum  
2 þa’s vit á **b**ęð · **b**ęði sǫtum?  
at þú myndir **m**ín · **móðugr** vitja,  
4 **halr**, ór **h**ęlju, · en ek þín ór **h**ęimi.

Dost thou remember, Siward, what we said  
when on the bed we both did sit,  
that thou, fierce man, wouldst visit me  
out of Hell—and I thee out of the world?

1 **Sig·vǫrðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

- 20 Hlaðið **ér**, jarlar, · **ę**iki-kǫst’inn,  
2 látið þann und **h**imni · **h**ęstan verða!

4                   Męgi bręna brjóst · bqlva-fullt qlđr  
                     [...] umb hjarta · þiđni sorgir!“

Load, ye earls, the oaken pile [PYRE]!  
 Let it become the highest under heaven!  
 May fire burn my bale-filled breast,  
 unto the heart ... may the sorrows melt away!”

---

2 himni ‘heaven’ | *emend.*; hilmi ‘prince’ R

---

ALL | Guthrun orders the construction of her own pyre. It is not necessary to think that she is to be burned alive, although that is by no means impossible; she may plan to commit suicide (prob. by a sword) beforehand.

1 ęiki-kęst‘inn ‘the oaken pile’ | Acc. sg. of *ęiki-kęstr* ‘pile, heap of oakwood’, suffixed with the definite *inn*. The clitic definite, a decidedly late, or at the very least non-poetic, feature, is metrically required.

2 himni ‘heaven’ | Although *und hilmi* could be read as ‘around the prince’, the pyre is certainly Guthrun’s. At this point in the narrative Siward is long dead, and the point of the pyre is for Guthrun to join him in the afterlife. Since no prince is being burned this requires emendation, and *himni* ‘heaven’ (dat. sg.) easily presents itself. It is a common poetic motif for something to be ‘the best under heaven’; cf. *Gríp* 10/4, *Yt* 27, *Sö* 136 (under Misc. Runic Poetry), etc.

3 brjóst bqlva-fullt ‘my bale-filled breast’ | The possessive pronoun is implicit. With these words Guthrun reflects on the many evils she has been responsible for (cf. *Akv* 47).

21               Jqlrum qlllum · óđal batni,  
 2               snótum qlllum · sorg at minni  
                   at þetta treg-róf · of talit vęri.

For all earls may patrimony improve;  
 for all ladies may sorrow decrease  
 after this grief-chain has been retold.

---

ALL | The last st. seems to step out of the world of the poem. It should probably be read in the voice of the narrating ballad-poet, who addresses the members of the audience and wishes them better fortunes than the characters in the legend. The aristocratic titles afforded to the audience are notable.



# Speeches of Hamthew

## (*Ham·ðis mól*)

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.885)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law-Speeches-meter, Leeds-meter

### Introduction

The **Speeches of Hamthew** (abbrev. *Hamð*) is the final poem in **R**, and chronologically the last poem in the Walsing-cycle alongside *Ghv*.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hamð* is only attested in **R**, on foll. 44v/27–45v/23, where it is the final poem and follows *Ghv*. The prose at the end is followed by the text *explicit liber iste* in cipher form, indicating that no part of the main manuscript is missing.

The paraphrase of the poem in *Vpls* 42, which also includes the direct citation of stanza 28, indicates that the poem was present in the poetic source manuscript used for that text.

### Story and parallels

Like *Ghv*, *Hamð* begins with Guthrun's exhortation. She exhorts her sons to avenge their sister Swanhild, killed by the tyrannical King Ermenric. These parts of the respective poems are closely related, and numerous lines are shared between them (see Introduction to *Ghv* for an overview). Although both poems deal with the same events, they differ in their perspective. Whereas *Ghv* stays behind with Guthrun after the departure of her sons and sees her build her own funeral pyre in preparation for her long-delayed suttee, *Hamð* instead follows the boys as they set out to take revenge. The historical background of these events is dealt with in the Introduction to *Ghv* above.

In Old Norse sources, the death of King Ermenric is otherwise told in *Rdr*, *Vpls* 42 (which is clearly partly based on *Hamð*, as seen by its citation of a variant of st. 28), and *Skm* 50. It may be noted that on the point of Ermenric's death the already highly archaic *Rdr* is still further removed from

historical fact than *Hamð*, since *Rdr* 4/3–4 seems to describe Ermenric as drowning in a well, whereas *Hamð* 24–31, in accordance with Jordanes (see Introduction to *Ghv*), sees the brothers killed after maiming, not killing, the king. A possible verbal parallel between the two poems is noted in st. 23/1 below.

### Meter and stanza

*Hamð* consists of 110 long-lines and 2 c-lines distributed across 31 stanzas. 30/31 stanzas are composed in a form of Ancient-words-law (see below), while a single stanza (29) is composed in Leeds-meter.

The most consistent length of the Ancient-words-law stanza is 4 lines (18/30: 1, 3, 5–10, 12, 14–15, 17, 19–21, 25, 28, 30). Other represented lengths are 2 (6/30: 4, 13, 16, 23, 27, 31), 3 (11, 18, 26), and 5 lines (2, 22, 24). Stanza 29 is composed in Leeds-meter with the archetypical configuration *abc abc*.

Together with *Vkv* and *Akv*, the majority of *Hamð* is composed in a looser form of Ancient-words-law. Suzuki (2014, pp. 525–539) considers this meter as an intermediary form between the meter of *Akv* and regular Ancient-words-law, and groups it alongside *Akv* under the label *Fornyrðislag–Málabátttr* (Ancient-words-law–Speeches-meter).

## Text

## Hamðis mól ('The Speeches of Hamthrew')

- 1 Spruttu á **tái** · **tregnar** iðir [R 44v/28]  
 2 **gróti** alfa · in **glý**-stomu;  
 ár of **morgin** · **manna** þolva  
 4 **sútir** hverjar · **sorg** of kveykva.

In the courtyard sprung up tragic deeds,  
 the gleeless causes for the weeping of elves.  
 In early morning each kind of pain  
 of the bales of men awakens sorrow.

1 Spruttu | *The S is an ornamented initial 2 lines high in R.*

2 gróti alfa 'causes for the weeping of elves' | The killings are thought to be the cause of the weeping of good spirits (in this case elves, most likely understood as familiar protective spirits), but the rejoicing of ill spirits. For this notion see *Akv* 18/4 n.; cf. sts. 15/2, 28/3 below.

- 2 Vas=a þat **nú** · **né** í gær, [R 44v/29]  
 þat hefir **langt** · **liðit** síðan;  
 es **fátt** fornara · **fræmr** vas þat hōlfu  
 4 es hvatti **Guð-rún** · **Gjúka** borin  
**sonu** **sína** unga · at hefna **Svan**-hildar.

That was not now nor yesterday;  
 it has passed a long time since.  
 Little is older, [yet] it was twice as long ago  
 when Guthrun, born of Yivick, goaded  
 her young sons to avenge Swanhild.

4 es hvatti Guð-rún 'when Guthrun ... goaded' | As also told in *Ghv*.

- 3 „Systir vas ykkur · **Svan**-hildr of hēitin [R 44v/32]  
 2 sú's **Jormun**-rekr · **jóm** of traddi,  
**hvítum** ok svörtum · á her-vegi  
 4 **gróum**, **gang**-tómum · **Gotna** hrossum.

“The sister of you two was named Swanhild,  
 she whom Ermenric had trampled by steeds,  
 by the white and black on the path of war,  
 by the grey, pacing, Gotnish horses!

2–4 sú's ... hrossum, 'she whom ... horses!' | Repeated almost identically in *Ghv* 2/3–6.

- 4 Eptir 's ykkir þrungit · þjóð-konunga, [R 44v/34]  
 2 lifið einir ér þátta · étta minnar.

Ye two are oppressed by great kings;  
 of the strands of my lineage ye alone live.

1 þjóð-konunga 'great kings' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Gríp* 1/2 n.

- 5 Einn-stóð em'k orðin · sem ǫsp í holti, [R 45r/1]  
 2 fallin at frændum · sem fura at kvisti,  
 vaðin at vilja · sem viðr at laufi,  
 4 þá's in kvist-skóða · kómr umb dag varman."

I am become as supportless as the asp in the grove,  
 as bereaved of kinsmen as the pine of its branch,  
 as deprived of willpower as the tree of its leaf  
 when the branch-scather comes on a warm day."

- 6 Hitt kvað þá Hamðir · inn hugum stóri: [R 45r/3]  
 2 „Litt myndir þú þá, Guðrún, · leyfa dōð Hǫgna  
 es þeir Sig-vǫrð · svefni ór vǫkðu;  
 4 satst þú á bæð · en banar hlógu.

This then quoth Hamthrew the great of heart:  
 "Thou hadst little cause, Guthrun, to praise Hawn's deeds  
 when they woke Siward from his sleep;  
 thou layest in the bed, but his killers laughed.

3 Sig-vǫrð | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urð R

1–3 | These lines correspond directly to *Gbv* 4/1–3, with minor variants.

- 7 Bókr vǫru þínar · inar blá-hvítu [R 45r/5]  
 2 ofnar vǫlundum, · flutu í vers dreyra;  
 svalt þá Sig-vǫrðr, · satst yfir dauðum,  
 4 glýja né gáðir; · Gunnarr þér svá vildi.

Thy blue-white bed-clothes were  
 woven by artisans; they swam in thy husband's gore.  
 Then Siward died; thou satst o'er him, dead,  
 hadst no sake for glee. Guthur would have it so for thee!

3 Sig-vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

1–2 | L. 1 corresponds directly to *Gbv* 4/4, l. 2b roughly to *Gbv* 4/5a.



- 8      **A**tla þótti=sk þú stríða · at **E**rps morði  
 2      ok at **E**itils aldr-lagi, · þat vas þér **e**nn verra!  
      Svá skyldi hverr **q**ðrum · verja til aldr-laga  
 4      **s**verði sár-beitu · at **s**ér né stríddi=t.“ [R 45r/7]

Thou thoughtst thou didst injure Attle through the murder of Earp  
 and the laying down of Oatle's life; it was even worse for thee!  
 Each man should cause the laying down of another's life  
 with a sorely biting sword such that it does not injure himself!”

ALL | Hamthew alludes to Guthrun's murder of her children with Attle, as dealt with in *Akv* 37–42 and *Am* 73–81. Cf. *Ghv* 12.

1 Erps 'Earp' | Not to be confused with Enacker's son of the same name.

4 sverði sár-beitu 'a sorely biting sword' | Cf. *Akv* 23/3.

4 at sér né stríddi=t 'that it does not injure himself' | One should not injure another in such a way that it also hurts oneself; Hamthew reminds his mother that her shortage of kin is by her own choice.

- 9      Hitt kvað þá **S**orli, · **s**vinna hafði hann hyggu:  
 2      „Vil'k=at við **m**óður · **m**ólum skipta;  
      orðs þikkir **e**nn vant · **y**kkru hvöru;  
 4      hverð biðr nú, **G**uð-rún, · es at **g**ráti né fór=at? [R 45r/10]

This then quoth Sarle; he had a wise mind:  
 “With my mother I do not wish to bandy words;  
 [no] more word seems wanting from either of you.  
 What dost thou now ask for, Guthrun, when thou takest not to weeping?

ALL | Sarle upbraids his brother Hamthew for arguing against his mother. Both Guthrun and Hamthew have said what there is to be said; now it is time for the brothers to depart and fulfill their orlay, and for his mother to weep at last.

3 ykkru hvöru 'from either of you' | Neuter dat. sg. of *ykkarr hvaðarr* 'of either of you', presumably in the neuter since the addressed (Guthrun and Hamthew) are of mixed gender. The expression must be understood to be in the negative, since the sense is certainly that “you two have spoken enough”, though an expected nominal negative -gi 'not, no' or verbal negative -at is missing.

- 10      **B**róðr grát þú þína · ok **b**uri svása,  
 2      **n**iðja ná-borna · leidda **n**ér rógi;  
      okkr skalt ok, **G**uð-rún, · **g**ráta báða  
 4      es hér sitjum **f**éigir á mörum, · **f**jarri munum deyja.“ [R 45r/12]

Weep for thy brothers and beloved sons,  
 for thy close-born kinsmen led into strife.  
 For us both shalt thou also, Guthrun, weep,  
 who here sit fey upon our steeds; far off shall we die!”

- 11      **G**engu ór **g**arði · **g**orvir at eiskra; [R 45r/15]  
 2      liðu þá **y**fir **u**ngir · **ú**rig fjöll  
          **m**orum hún-lęndskum, · **m**orðs at hefna.

They went out of the settlement ready to wage fury.  
 Then the young ones passed over drizzling mountains  
 on Hunlandish horses to avenge the murder.

- 12      Þá kvað þat **E**rpr · **e**inu sinni, [R 45r/16]  
 2      **m**ęrr of lęk · **à** **m**ars baki:  
          „Illt 's **b**lauðum hal · **b**rautir kęnna;“  
 4      kóðu **h**arðan mjök · **h**ornung vesa.

Then this quoth Earp a single time;  
 renowned, he balanced on the back of his steed:  
 “It is bad to teach a soft man the roads.”—  
 They said the corner-boy was a very hard man.

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ALL. | In sts. 12–15 Hamthw and Sarle encounter their half-brother Earp on the road. The order of the dialogue-sts. 12–14 is difficult to parse and the passage is likely corrupt. The paraphrase of these stanzas in *Vǫls* 42 gives little help: *Ok er þeir vǫru komnir á leið, finna þeir Erp, bróður sinn, ok spyrja, þvat hann mundi veita þeim. Hann svarar: „S-líkt sem þond bendi eða fótr fęti.“ Þeim þótti þat ekki vera ok drápu hann.* ‘And when they had come upon their way they find Earp, their brother, and ask how he will be of aid to them. He answers: “Like a hand to a hand or a foot to a foot.” They thought that it was not so, and slew him.’

4 hornung ‘corner-boy’ | I.e., one who must sit in the corner out of shame or neglect. A word used for a boy born to a mother of lower status than the father as the result of an extra-marital relationship (Fr, s.v. *hornung*), in this case used disparagingly by Sarle and Hamthw, who consider their mother, Guthrun, superior to Earp’s.

- 13      Fundu á **s**tręti · **s**tór-brögð-óttan: [R 45r/18]  
 2      „Hvé mun **j**arp-skammr · **o**kk full-tingja?“

They found on the street the very cunning man:  
 “How should this brown shorty assist us?”

---

1 stręti ‘street’ | A Roman loanword used specifically for a paved road or street in a town. It probably emphasises the southern geography in which the events transpire.

- 14      **S**varaði inn **s**undr-móðri, · **s**vá kvað=sk vęita myнду [R 45r/20]  
 2      **f**ull-ting **f**ręndum · **s**em **f**ótr qðrum.  
          „Hvat megi **f**ótr · **f**óti vęita  
 4      né **h**old-gróin · **h**ond annarri?“

He of sundry mother answered, said that he would offer  
 his kinsmen assistance like a foot to another.—

“What can a foot offer a foot,  
or a trunk-grown hand another?”

- 15 Drógu ór **skíði** · **skíði**-éarn, [R 45r/22]  
2 **mékis** eggjar · at **mun** flagði;  
**þverðu þrótt sinn** · at **þriðjungi**,  
4 létu **mög** ungan · til **moldar** hníga.

They drew from their sheaths their sheath-irons [SWORDS],  
the edges of the blade at the behest of the ogress.  
They used their strength on the third one;  
they let the young lad sink down to the earth.

2 at mun flagði ‘at the behest of the ogress’ | They were acting according to the will of a cruel norn (*flagð*); cf. st. 1/2 n. above, 28/3 below.

- 16 **Skóku** loða, · **skalmir** fęstu, [R 45r/24]  
2 ok **goð**-bornir · smugu í **goð**-vęfi.

They shook their wool-coats, fastened their knives,  
and the god-born ones got into their clothes of god-weave.

2 goð-vęfi ‘clothes of god-weave’ | Their silk; they were beautifully dressed.

- 17 **Framm** lögu brautir, · **fundu** vó-stigu [R 45r/25]  
2 ok **systur son** · **sáran** á meði,  
**varg-tré vind-köld** · **vestan** bójar;  
4 **trýtti** é **trönu** hvöt, · **títt** vas=at bíð\*a.

Forwards lay their roads; they found paths of woe  
and their sister’s son [= Randwigh] maimed on a branch  
on a wind-cold hanging tree to the west of the town;  
the crane’s incitement [CORPSE] kept dangling; it was not good to tarry.

- 18 **Glaumr** vas í **høllu**, · **halir** ǫl-ręfir, [R 45r/27]  
2 ok til **gota** ękki · **gørðu-t** hęyra  
**áðr halr hug-fullr** · í **horn** of þaut.

There was a revel in the hall, the men ale-rowdy,  
and of the sound of the horses they heard naught,  
before a man full of heart blew in his horn.

- 19 **Sęja** fóru **ęrir** · **Jǫrmun**-rekki [R 45r/29]

- 2 at sénir vǫru · seggir und hjólum:  
 „Róðið ér umb rǫð! · Ríkir eru komnir,  
 4 fyr mǫttkum hafið ér mǫnnum · meý of tradda.“

Messengers went to tell Ermenric  
 that the youths had been seen beneath their helmets:  
 “Make your decision! Strong ones have come.  
 To the wrath of mighty men have ye trampled that maiden!”

---

1 *érir* | *om.* R

- 20 Hló þá Jǫrmun·rekkr, · hendi drap á kampa, [R 45r/31]  
 2 beiddi=sk at bröngu, · bǫðvaði=sk at víni;  
 skók hann skǫr jarpa, · sá á skjöld hvítan,  
 4 lét hann sér í hendi · hvarfa kęr gollit.

Then Ermenric laughed, put his hand to his beard,  
 made ready for battle, became ferocious in his wine.  
 He shook his brown locks, looked on his white shield;  
 he let spin in his hand a golden cup.

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2 beiddi=sk at bröngu ‘made ready for battle’ | Uncertain translation; *branga* ‘battle(?)’ is a hapax.

- 21 „Séll ek þá þótt=umk · ef séa knétta [R 45r/34]  
 2 Ham·ði ok Sǫrla · í hǫllu mínni;  
 buri mynda’k þá binda · með boga strængjum,  
 4 góð börn Gjúka · fęsta á galga.“

“I would have thought me blessed if I got to see  
 Hamthrew and Sarle in my own hall;  
 those boys I would then bind with bow-strings,  
 the good children of Yivick, and fasten them on the gallows!”

---

4 góð börn Gjúka ‘the good children of Yivick’ | Yivick was Guthrun’s father and the boys’ grand-father. The poet is not presenting an alternative genealogy; cf. 2/4 above, 25/4 below.

- 22 Hitt kvað þá Hróðr·glöð, · stóð of hleðum, [R 45v/2]  
 2 mę-fingr męlti · við mǫg þenna:  
 „Því’t þat hęita · at hlýði=gi myni;  
 4 mega tvęir menn ęinir · tíu hundruð Gotna  
 binda eða berja · í borg inni hǫu?”

This then quoth Rothglad, she stood by the doors,  
 slender-fingered she spoke to this lad:  
 “Since they swear that no army will;

can two men alone bind or beat  
ten hundred Gots in the high stronghold?”

1 Hróðr-glöð ‘Rothglad’ | An unknown woman, perhaps implied to be Attle’s mother by the word *mögr* ‘lad’, which can also mean ‘son’.

5 borg inni høu ‘the high stronghold’ | Formulaic, also found in *Akv* 15/2b; see there for further parallels.

- 23        **S**tyrr varð í ranni, · **s**tukku ǫl-skálir, [R 45v/5]  
2               í blóði **b**ragnar lögu, · komit ór **br**jósti Gotna.

There was uproar in the hall; the ale-bowls shattered;  
champions lay in blood flown from the breasts of the Gots.

1 Styrr varð í ranni ‘There was uproar in the house’ | Strongly reminiscent of *Rdr* 3/5: *Rósta varð í ranni* ‘There was tumult in the hall’, *Beow* 1302a: *Hréam wearð ǥn Heorote* ‘There was an outcry in the Hart’, both in the context of hall-fights, the former describing the same events as *Hamð*.

- 24        **H**itt kvað þa **H**am-ðir · inn **h**ugum stóri: [R 45v/6]  
2               „**Ö**stir **J**ǫrmun-rekkr · **o**kkarrar kvǫmu  
      **br**óðra sam-móðra · innan **b**orgar þinnar;  
4               fótr **sér** þú þína · høndum **sér** þú þínum  
      **J**ǫrmun-rekkr **or**pit · í **ē**ld hęitan!“

This then quoth Hamthrew the great of heart:  
“Thou, Ermenric, didst incite our coming,  
we brothers of the same mother, into thy stronghold!  
Thou seest thy feet; thou seest them with thy hands,  
O Ermenric, thrown in the hot fire!”

4–5 fótr ... hęitan! ‘Thou seest ... fire!’ | The detail of Ermenric’s severed hands and feet is also found in *Rdr* 4.

- 25        Þa **r**aut við · inn **r**ęgin-kunngi [R 45v/9]  
2               **B**aldr í brynju · sem **b**jǫrn hryti:  
      „**G**rytið ér á **g**umna · alls **g**ęirar né bíta,  
4               **ę**ggjar né **ę**orn, · **J**ón-akrs sonu!“

Then roared back the Rein-descended  
Balder in his byrnie [WARRIOR > = Ermenric] like a roaring bear:  
“Stone ye the men! For spears do not bite  
—nor edges nor irons—on Enacker’s sons!”

1 **r**aut | *metr. emend.*; hraut **R**

1 regin-kunngi ‘Rein-descended’ | Descended from the Reins, i.e., the Gods. The godly ancestry of the Gotnish Amals, the house to which Ermenric belonged, is described in Jordanes *Getica* 78, 79 (excerpt): *Magnaque potiti per loca victoria iam proceres suos, quorum quasi fortuna vincebant, non puros homines, sed semideos id est Ansis vocaverunt. Quorum genealogia ut paucis percurram vel quis quo parente genitus est aut unde origo coepta, ubi finem effecit, [...] 79 Horum ergo heroum, ut ipsi suis in fabulis referunt, primus fuit Gapt, qui genuit Hulmul. Hulmul vero genuit Augis, et Augis genuit etc. etc.* ‘They thereafter called their leaders, by whose good fortune they seemed to have conquered, not mere men, but demigods, that is Ansis. Their genealogy I shall run through briefly, telling the lineage of each and the beginning and the end of this line. [...] Now the first of these heroes, as they themselves relate in their legends, was Gapt, who begat Hulmul. And Hulmul begat Augis; and Augis begat’ etc. etc.

Jordanes’ *Ansis* is a cognate to ON *ēsir* ‘the Eese’, i.e., the Gods, which are called demigods in a clear instance of Christian euhemerism. The first of the *Ansis* is *Gapt*, i.e., Geat, whose name directly corresponds to OE *Géat*, the progenitor of several Anglo-Saxon royal lineages, and ON *Gautr*, a poetic synonym for the god Woden (*Grm* 56/4, *Bdr* 2/1).

26     **Hitt** kvað þá **Ham**-ðir · inn hugum stóri:

[R 45v/11]

2     „Bḡl vannt, bróðir, · es þann bēlg lēystir;  
opt ór þeim bēlg · bḡll rḡð koma.“

This then quoth Hamthew the great of heart:

“Thou accomplishedst a bale, brother, when thou loosened that bag;  
oft from that bag come bold counsels!”

2 es þann bēlg lēystir ‘when thou loosened that bag’ | Unclear, but perhaps referring to their slaying of Earp.

27     „Hug hēfðir, **Ham**-ðir, · ef hēfðir hyggjandi,

[R 45v/13]

2     mikils es á mann hvern vant · es man-vits es.“

“Thou wouldst have had heart, Hamthew, if thou hadst had understanding;  
much is any man wanting when he lacks manwit!”

28     „Af véri nú hḡfuð · ef **Erpr** lifði,

[R 45v/14]

2     bróðir okkarr inn bḡð-frókni, · es vit á braut vḡgum,  
verr hinn víð-frókni, · hvḡtt=umk at dísir,  
4     gumi hinn gunn-hēlgi, · gḡrðum=sk at vígi.“

“Off were now the head if Earp had lived,  
our battle-brave brother whom we slew on the road,  
the widely brave warrior—the Díses incited me—  
the war-holy man—we made ready for the slaying.”

1–2 Af ... vḡgum | Also in N. 1 hḡfuð | hḡfuð’it N

1–2 Af ... vḡgum | These lines are quoted in *Vḡls* 42, preceded by the text: *Þá mēlti Ham-ðir: „Af mundi nú hḡfuð’it, ef Erpr lifði, bróðir okkarr, er vit vḡgum á leið’inni, ok sáum vit þat of sið,” sem kveðit er.* ‘Then Hamthew spoke: “The head would now have been off if Earp had lived, our brother whom we slew on the road, and we worried about that for some time”, as it is sung.’

3 hvøtt-umk at ðísir ‘the Dises incited me’ | The evil fates, cf. sts. 1/2, 15/2 above, *Akv* 18/4 n. —  
The alliteration is highly unusual and requires the cluster *hv* to behave like *v*.

- 29 „**E**kki hygg okkr vesa · **u**lfar dõmi, [R 45v/17]  
2 at vit mynim sjalfir of saka=sk  
sem gr̥ey norna · þau’s gr̥oðug eru  
4 í auðn of alin.“

“I do not think wolves an example for us,  
that we should fight amidst ourselves  
like the greedy bitches of the Norns  
who are reared in the wilderness.”

- 30 „Vel høfum vit vegit, · stõndum á val Gotna [R 45v/19]  
2 ofan egg-móðum · sem ernalr á kvisti;  
góðs høfum tírar fengit · þó’tt skylim nú eða í g̥er deýja,  
4 kveld lifir maðr ekki · ertir kvið norna.“

“Well have we two fought; we stand on the slain of the Gots—  
over edge-wearied men like eagles on a branch.  
Great glory have we won though we should die now or tomorrow—  
man lives not one evening after the verdict of the Norns!”

4 kvið norna ‘verdict of the Norns’ | The fated hour of one’s death, equivalent to the *dómr norna*  
‘judgment of the Norns’ in *Fáfn* 11/1.

- 31 Þar fell Sørli · at salar gaffi, [R 45v/22]  
2 en Ham-ðir hné · at hús-baki.

There fell Sarle by the hall’s gables,  
but Hamthrew sank down by the back of the house.

- P1 Þetta eru kǫlluð Ham-ðis mól in fornu. [R 45v/23]

These are called the Ancient Speeches of Hamthrew.

1 fornu | *add.* ðexpl̥c̥ōt̥ l̥ōb̥ōr̥ ðl̥t̥ō (*cipher for \*explicit liber iste*) ‘Here this book ends’ R





# West Germanic Heroic Poetry



# Bewolf

## (*Beo·wulf*)

**Dating:** early C8th (TODO)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

NOTE: The Old English edition is largely the work of Yuanlong Zhao, as available at <https://github.com/FolgeriLeninaes/beowulf>. The OE edition and associated commentary is released under CC BY 4.0, a looser license than the CC BY-NC 4.0 license under which the rest of the project is released.

The present file is for now heavily incomplete. Only non-commented lines (i.e., those which actually appear in the .pdf) have been edited. The commented lines are placeholders based on James A. Harrison and Robert Sharp, eds. (1883) with minor corrections.

The orthography is normalized to an archaic Anglian dialect. Its goal is to present the poem as closely as possible to how it would most likely have sounded at the time of composition; this includes removing svarabhakti vowels where metrically required, marking long unstressed vowels (as evinced by Kaluza's law), and restoring hiatus forms.

The long diphthongs descending from PwGmc. *\*au*, *\*eu*, *\*iu* are written *ea*, *eo* and *io* respectively; diphthongs arising from colouring or breaking of a vowel *V* are written *V<sup>o</sup>*.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Beow* is only found in the Nowell codex (Cotton MS Vitellius A XV, foll. 94r–209v; henceforth N), a miscellaneous collection of fantastical texts written in two hands (A: 94r–175v/3 and B: 175v/4–209v). The text of *Beow* is found on foll. 132r–201v. In the poem itself, A writes as far as the word *scýran* in 1939b, and the rest of the poem is written by B.

## Text

- Pr      Hwæt, wé Gār-Denā · in jær-dagum  
 2      þeod-cyningá · þrymm gi·frugnun,  
       hú þā æðilingas · ęllæn fręmidun.  
 4      Oft Sceld Scébing · scaðaná þreatum,  
       mōngum mǣgðum · medu-setlá æb·teah.  
 6      Eǵisodǣ Iʀlí, · sið-ðan ærist wærð  
       fea-scaeft fundæn: · hé þæs fróbrǣ gi·bād,  
 8      wóx undær wolcnum, · weʀð-myndum þāh,  
       oð þæt him ǣg-hwēlc þér · ymb-sittędrá  
 10     obær hrōn-rādǣ · hēran scoldǣ,  
       gōmban ǵeldan: · þæt wæs gód cyning!  
 12     Þæm aburá wæs · æftær cęnnid  
       jung in gardum, · þonǣ God sęndǣ  
 14     folcǣ tó fróbrǣ; · firin-þarbǣ ǵn·ǵæt,  
       þæt hiǣ ær drugun · aldur-léasǣ  
 16     langǣ hwilǣ. · Him þæs lib-fréjá,  
       wuldræs waldænd, · weræld-árǣ fær·ǵæb;  
 18     Biowi\* wæs brómi · (blǣd widǣ sprang),  
       Sceldæs aburá · Scędi-landum in.  
 20     Swá scǣl jung gumá, · gódǣ gi·wyrčan,  
       frōmum feo·ǵiftum · ǵn fadur bærmǣ,  
 22     þæt hinǣ ǵn ældǣ · ęft gi·wynǵæn  
       will-gi-siðas, · þōnnǣ wīg cumǣ,  
 24     liodí gi·lǣstæn: · lob-dǣdum scǣl  
       in mǣgðǣ gi·hwæm · mann gi·þīhan.

How, we have learnt of the glory of the great kings  
 of the spear-Danes in days of yore,  
 how those athlings accomplished zeal.  
 Oft Shield Sheaving from the hosts of foemen,  
 from many tribes stole away the mead-benches,  
 frightened the Erls after he first had been  
 found destitute; he knew refuge from that,  
 grew under the clouds, throve in honours  
 till to him every surrounding folk  
 o'er the dolphin's ride [SEA] had to submit,  
 yield tribute—that was a good king.  
 TODO: Translation.

2 gi·frugnun | 'gefrunon' N    5 mōngum | mōnǣgum with restored syncopation N    6 Eǵisodǣ |  
 Eǵsodǣ with restored medial vowel N    6 Iʀlí 'the Erls' | metr. and sens. emend.; cʀl N    8 wóx |

weox with transfer to strong class 7 reversed N 9 *ôg*-hwêlc | Anglian form of *æg*-hwêlc, cf. early Anglian 'oeghuucl' N 9 *þær* | metr. emend.; *þara* N 16 *lib*-fréja | metr. emend.; lib-fréa N 18 Biowi\* 'Bewer' | Biowulf N 22 *gi*-wynigæn | *gi*-wunigæn with inherited class III paradigm, cf. northern Mercian 'wynigaþ' N 25 *gi*-hwæm | 'gehwære' N 25 *gi*-þiþan | metr. emend.; *gi*-þeon with restoration of medial -h- N

6 *Iorlí* 'the Erls' | The ms. form *eorl* 'the earl, nobleman' is metrically deficient and near-universally emended (Robert D. Fulk 1992, p. 205). According to Jordanes (*Getica* 23) the *Heruli* were driven out by the Danes from southern Scandinavia, a legend likely reflected here when the legendary Danish ancestor-king Shield is said to have 'frightened' (i.e., 'expulsed') the \**Iorlí*. As old tribal names were forgot, scribes replaced it with the more transparent "earl". For the confusion of proper names in *Beow* cf. ll. 18, 53, 2921 below.

18 Biowi\* 'Bewer' | Emendation to (forms of) *Beo* 'Bewer' is adopted by most modern eds. (including R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles) and is supported by the Anglo-Saxon royal genealogies, where Shield is the father of Bewer (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, pp. 291–292); cf. l. 53 below. The insertion of Bewulf's name is most likely due to scribal confusion with the name of the poem's protagonist.

- 26 Him þá Sceld gi·wât · tó gi·scæp-hwílæ  
felo-hrór fōran · qn frean wæræ;  
28 hiæ hinæ þá æt·bærun · tó brimæs faroðæ.  
swæsæ gi·siðas, · swæ hé selbá bæd,  
30 þendin wordum wé<sup>o</sup>ld · wini Scildingá.  
Leob land-frumá · langæ áhtæ—  
32 þær æt hýðæ stód · hringid-steþná,  
isæg end út·fús, · æðilingæs fær;  
34 á·lægdun þá · leobnæ þeodæn,  
beagá bryttan · qn bærm scipæs,  
36 mærnæ bi mæstæ. · þær wæs mæðmá felá,  
æb fe<sup>o</sup>rr-wegum · frætwá gi·lædid:  
38 ni hérdæ ic cým·licor · ceol gi·gærwan  
hildi-wæpnun · end haðu-wædum,  
40 billum end brynnun; · him qn bærmæ læg  
mæðma mængu, · þá him mid scoldun  
42 qn flódæs æht · fe<sup>o</sup>rr gi·witan.  
Nallæs hiæ hinæ læssan · lácum tiodun,  
44 þeod-gi-streonun, · þonnæ þá dydun,  
þi hinæ æt frum·scæftæ · forð qn·sendun  
46 ænnæ obær ýðæ · umbr-wesendí:  
þá gét hiæ him á·sættun · segn gylðinnæ  
48 heah obær heabud, · létun holm beran,  
gæbbun qn gær-segg: · him wæs jómær seba,  
50 murnendí mód. · Menn ni cunnun  
seggan tó sōðæ · scli-ræddendí,

52            hēlið undær hebum, · hwa þæm hlæstæ qn·féng.

TODO: Translation.

34 á·lægdun | á·lægdun without levelling of umlaut, cf. northern Mercian 'lægdun' N 41 mænġu | mænæġu with restored syncopation N 47 á·sættun | á·sættun without levelling of umlaut, cf. Northumbrian 'gesætte' N 52 hēlið | hēlið with expected umlaut, cf. early Northumbrian 'heliðum' N

1        Þá wæs on burgum · Biowí\* Scildingá,  
54        leob liod-cýning, · lōngæ þrāgæ  
      folcum ġi·fræġi · (fædær ellær hwærþ,  
56        aldr æþ ærdæ), · ðð þæt him eft qn·woc  
      heah Halb-ðeni; · h<sup>eo</sup>ld þendin libdæ,  
58        gamæl end ġuð-hreoh, · glædæ Scildingas.  
      Þæm feowær bærn · forð-ġi·rimid  
60        in wer-æld wócun, · werudá ræswan,  
      Heru-gâr end Hrôð-gâr · end Hālgá til;  
62        hêrdæ ic, þæt Irsé · wæs Qnulan cwón  
      Haðu-Scilfingæs · hals-ġi·bēddæ.  
64        Þá wæs Hrôð-gâræ · hēri-spôd ġibæn,  
      wīgæs we<sup>o</sup>rð-mynd, · þæt him his wini-mágas  
66        ġe<sup>o</sup>rnæ hêrdun, · ðð þæt siu ġuguð ġi·wóx,  
      magu-dryht micil. · Him on mód bi·rann,  
68        þæt hall-rcid · hâtan woldæ,  
      medu-ærn micil · mēnn ġi·wyrčan,  
70        þonæ ældá bærn · æfiri ġi·frugnun,  
      end þær qn innan · all ġi·dælan  
72        jungum end aldum, · swēlc him God saldæ,  
      bútan folc-scæræ · end ferhum gumaná.  
74        Þá ic wíðæ ġi·fræġn · we<sup>o</sup>rc ġi·bannan  
      manægræ máġðæ · ĵond þisnæ middun-gard,  
76        folc-stēdi frætwan. · Him on fristæ ġi·lōmp  
      ædræ mid ældum, · þæt hit wærð all garu,  
78        hall-ærná mæst; · scóp him Herut naman,  
      sé þi his wordæs ġi·wald · wíðæ hæbdæ.  
80        Hé bi-hât ni á·leag, · beagas dældæ,  
      sinc æt simlæ. · Seli hliþodæ  
82        heah end horn-geap: · haðu-wælmá bād,  
      lâðan līgæs; · ni wæs hit lēngæ þá jén  
84        þæt sé \*ēġġ-heti · âðum-sweoran  
      æftær wæl-níðæ · wæcnan scoldæ.

86 Þá sé **ell**æn-gâst · **ar**bað-lícæ  
 þrâgæ gi·þolodæ, · sé þi in þiostrum bâd,  
 88 þæt hé **dó**grá gi·hwæm · **d**ream gi·hêrdæ  
 hlúdnæ in hallæ; · þær wæs hærpæn swóg,  
 90 switul sang scopæs. · **S**ægdæ sé þi cūðæ  
 frum-scæft firhá · **fe**°rran rēccan,  
 92 cwæð þæt sé æl-mēhtigá · **e**°rðan worhtæ,  
 wliht-berhtnæ wang, · swæ wætær bi·býgið,  
 94 gi·sættæ sigi-hrōðig · sunnun end mōnan  
 leoman tō leohtæ · land-búendum,  
 96 end gi·frætwadæ · foldan sceatas  
 limum end leabum; · lib eac gi·scóp  
 98 cynná gi·hwelcūm, · þará þi cwicæ hwērbað.  
 Swæ þa dryht-guman · dreamum libdun  
 100 eadæg-lícæ, · oð þæt **án** on·gán  
 firinæ frēmman, · fiond on hēllæ:  
 102 wæs sé **grim**má gâst · Grēndil hātæn,  
 mæri marc-stapá, · sé þi morhas hē°ld,  
 104 fēnn end fæstin; · fiff-cynnæs ærd  
 wōn-sælæg wer · wærdodæ hwilæ,  
 106 síððan him sceppend · fær·scribæn hæbdæ.  
 In Cāinæs cynnæ · þonæ cwalm gi·wræc,  
 108 éci dryhtin, · þæs þi hé **Á**bæl slóg;  
 ni gi·fæh hé þæræ fæhðæ, · æc hé hinæ **fe**°rr fær·wræc,  
 110 metad fær þi mánæ · mann-cynnæ fram.  
 Þanan un-týdras · allæ on-wócun,  
 112 etunas end ælbí · end orc-neas,  
 swelcæ gígantas, · þa wið godæ wunnun  
 114 langæ þrâgæ; · hé him þæs lean fær·gald.

TODO: Translation.

62 *I°rsæ* 'Erse' | *restoration*; *om.* N 84 \*ēgg-hēti | *sens. emend.* seggheiti N 84 *āðum*-sweoran | *sens. emend.* 'aþum swerian' N 94 gi·sættæ | gi·settæ cf. l. 47 N

62 *I°rsæ* 'Erse' | TODO.

2 Gi·wāt þá **ne**osian, · síð-ðan **n**æht bi·cwóm,  
 2 heaban hūsæs, · hú hit Hring-Deñi  
 æftær beor-þegæ · gi·býin hæbdun.  
 4 Fand þá þær innæ · æðilingá gi·dryht

swefan æftær **s**ymbblá; · **s**orgá ni cūðun,  
 6 wƿon-scaft **w**erá. · **W**iht un-hælu  
 grim end **g**rædæg · **g**aru sóna wæs,  
 8 reoc end **r**óðí, · end ƿn **r**æstá gi·nam  
 þritig þegná: · þanan eft gi·wát  
 10 hūðá **h**rómig · tó **h**ām faran,  
 mið þærá **w**æl-fyllu · **w**ícá neosan.  
 12 Þá wæs on **u**htan · mið **á**r-dægá  
**G**reñdlæs **g**ūð-cræft · **g**umum un-derní:  
 14 þá wæs æfter **w**istá · **w**óp up á-hæbæn,  
**m**ičil **m**orgæn-swóg. · **M**ári þeodæn,  
 16 æðiling **á**r-gód, · **u**n-bliði sæt,  
**þ**olodá **þ**ryð-swíð, · þegn-sorgá dreag,  
 18 síð-ðan hiæ þæs láðan · lást sceawodun,  
**w**erƿan gāstæs; · wæs þæt gi·**w**inn tó strang,  
 20 láð end lƿngsum. · Næs hit lęngra frist,  
 æc ymb **á**ná næht · eft gi·fręmidá  
 22 **m**orð-balá **m**árá · end nā **m**ærn forá  
**f**æhðá end **f**iriná; · wæs tó **f**æst ƿn þæm.  
 24 Þá wæs **e**að-fyndí, · þi him **e**llæs hwær  
 gi·**r**úm-licor · **r**æstá sóhtá,  
 26 beðd æftær **b**úrum, · þá him gi·beacnad wæs,  
 gi·**s**ægd sód-licá · **s**witulan tåcná  
 28 **h**all-þegnæs **h**ęti; · **h**e<sup>o</sup>ld hiná síð-ðan  
**f**i<sup>o</sup>rr end **f**æstor, · sé þæm **f**iend æt·wand.  
 30 Swá **r**icsodá · end wið **r**ihtá wann  
**á**ná wið **a**llum, · öd þæt **i**dæl stód  
 32 **h**úsá sōlist. · Wæs sio **h**wíl mičil:  
**t**welf-wintrá **t**íd · **t**orn gi·þolodá  
 34 **w**ini Scildingá, · **w**áwaná gi·hwęlcnaé,  
**s**ídrá **s**orgá; · fær þan gi·**s**ioní wærð  
 36 **æ**ldá bænum · **u**n-dęrní cūð,  
**g**ęddum **j**ómrá, · þætti **G**reñdil wann,  
 38 **h**wilá wið **H**róð-gār; · **h**ęti-níðas wæg,  
**f**iriná end **f**æhðá · **f**elá missærá,  
 40 **s**in-gálá **s**æcá, · **s**ibbá ni waldá  
 wið **m**anná hwƿnā · **m**ægnæs **D**ęniġa  
 42 **f**erh-balu **f**e<sup>o</sup>rran, · **f**e þingian,  
 ní þær nænig **w**itaná · **w**ōnan þorftá



- 44 berhtræ bótá · tó banan folmum;  
 æc sé æġ-læcá · óhtendi wæs,  
 46 deorc deað-scúa · duguðæ end juguðæ  
 semodæ end sēridæ. · Sin-nehti hē'ld  
 48 mistġæ mōras; · men̄n ni cunnun,  
 hwædr heġl-rúnan · hwēftum scriðað.  
 50 Swæ fela firinā · fiond mann-cynnæs,  
 atul ān-ġeġgá, · oft ġi-frēmidæ  
 52 hædrá hēnðá; · Herut ærdodæ,  
 sinc-fāġæ sæl · swærtum næhtum  
 54 (nā hé þonæ ġeb-stól · grótan mōstæ,  
 mād̄m fær metodæ, · ní his myni wissæ);  
 56 þæt wæs wræc micil · wini Scildingá,  
 módæs brecðá. · Mōnæg-oft ġi-sæt  
 58 rícæ tó rúnæ; · ræd æhtodun,  
 hwæt swið-ferhðum · sōlist wæri  
 60 wið fær-gryrum · tó ġi-frēmmanæ.  
 Hwílum hiæ ġi-hétun · æt h\*ærg-trabum  
 62 wīg-we<sup>o</sup>rðungá, · wordum bædun,  
 þæt him ġast-þoná · jeocæ ġi-frēmidæ  
 64 wið þeod-þrawum. · Swelc wæs þea hirá,  
 hæðinrá hyht; · heġlæ ġi-mundun  
 66 in mōd-seban, · metad hiæ ni cūðun,  
 dædá dōmēnd, · ni wissun hiæ Dryhtin God,  
 68 ní hiæ hwaru hebná helm · heġjan ni cūðun,  
 wuldræs waldēnd. · Wā bið þæm þi scæl  
 70 þurh slíðnæ níð · sâwlæ bi-scūban  
 in fýræs fæðm, · fróbræ ni wōnan,  
 72 wihtæ ġi-wēndan; · wel bið þæm þi mót  
 æftær deað-dæġæ · dryhtin sócan  
 74 end tó fadur fæðmum · friðu wilnian.

TODO: Translation.

2 heaban | hean with intervocalic -h- restored N 34 Scildingá | sens. emend.; 'scyldenda' N 34  
 wāwaná | weaná with reversal of compression N 35 ġi-sioní | restoration.; om. N 44 banan | 'banū'  
 N 45 æc sé | restoration.; om. N 61 h\*ærg-trabum | 'brærg trafum' N 64 þeod-þrawum |  
 þreaum (without assimilation of awu > ea, cf. early Anglian 'thrauuu') N 68 hwaru | huru (without  
 assimilation of -wa- > -u-) N



# Fight at Finnsbury

**Dating:** TODO

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

Along with *Wald* and *Beow*, the **Fight at Finnsbury** (*Finn*) is one of three Anglo-Saxon narrative epics dealing with heroic legend.

## Textual preservation and transmission

*Finn* only survives in the printed edition of Hickes (1703–1705, vol. 1, pp. 192–3), based on the original manuscript which was most likely destroyed in the Cottonian fire of 1731.

Hickes introduces the poem with the following words (original emphasis kept):

*Eodem metro conditum forte reperi fragmenti poetici singulare folium, in codice MS. homiliarum Semi-Saxonicarum qui extat in Bibliotheca Lambethana. Fragmentum autem subsequitur.*

‘By chance, I found a single leaf of a poetic fragment composed in the same meter, in a manuscript codex of Semi-Saxon homilies that is housed in the Lambeth Library. The fragment itself follows.’

Hickes’ edition seems generally reliable, and the singular folio appears to have been in good shape. The majority of his errors are transparent spacing errors, e.g. writing two words as one (3 ‘*herdraca*’ for \**her draca*) or splitting one word in two (9 ‘*his ne*’ for \**hisne*, 11 ‘*Hie geap*’ for \**Hicgeap*). Others are plain copying errors, e.g. reading \**a* as *u* in l. 3 ‘*eastun*’ (for \**eastan*) or \**þ* as the very similar *ƿ* in l. 2 ‘*bearo*’ (for \**beapo*).

## Contents

TODO. A similar episode appears in *Beow*.

Prior to the fragment's commencing the poem would have seen Naf and his warriors encamped and asleep in the Finnsbury hall late at night. One of the men, perhaps a lookout, sees the blinking of swords and chainmail from the east and loudly asks what it may be; is it the dawn, or a dragon, or (and here the fragment picks up) are the gables of the hall burning (l. 1)? King Naf responds in parallel: it is not the dawn, nor a dragon, nor do the gables burn—rather it is a hostile army (ll. 2–9). Naf makes a speech to rouse his warriors (ll. 10–12).

TODO

## Text

„[...] *bornas* byrnað náfre.“

“[...] gables never burn.”

1 *bornas* | reconstructed based on l. 4; “nas” *Hickes*

- 2 Hleoðrode þá · heaðo-geong cyning:  
 „Né þis ne dagað éastan, · né hér draca ne fléogeð,  
 4 né hér þisse healle · hornas ne byrnað,  
 ac hér forð berað · fugelas singað,  
 6 gylleð græg-hama, · gūð-wudu hlynned,  
 scyld scēfte on-cwyð. · Nú scīneð þes mōna  
 8 waðol under wolcnum; · nú á-rísað wéa-dæda,  
 þe þisne folces nīð · frēmman willað.  
 10 Ac on-wacnigeað nú, · wīgend mīne,  
 hēbbað éowre banda, · hicgeað on ellen,  
 12 winnað on orde, · wesað on móde!“

Then bellowed out the battle-young king:  
 “This is no dawning from the east, nor does a dragon fly hither,  
 nor here on this hall do the gables burn—  
 but here they bear forth arms, the birds sing,  
 the grey-pelt [WOLF] howls, the war-wood [SHIELD] dins,  
 the shield clashes against the spear. Now shines the moon,  
 wandering behind the clouds; now arise the woeful deeds  
 which wish to fulfill the evil of this host.  
 Yet awaken now, ye my warriors!  
 Raise your hands, put your minds to zeal,  
 win by the spear-point, be in brave spirits!”

2 heaðo-geong | ‘hearo geong’ (for ‘heaþo geong’) *Hickes* 3 éastan | ‘Eastun’ *Hickes* 3 hér  
 draca | ‘herdraca’ *Hickes* 5 forð berað | ‘forþberað’ *Hickes* 7 scīneð | scýneð *Hickes* 9 þisne |  
 ‘ðis ne’ *Hickes* 11 banda | landa *Hickes* 11 hicgeað | ‘Hie geaþ’ *Hickes* 12 winnað | ‘Windað’  
*Hickes*

10–12 Ac ... móde! ‘Yet ... spirits!’ | It has often been noted that Naf’s rousing of the sleeping warriors bears a strong resemblance to Beader’s speech in *Bjarkamál in fornu* l. 11. 3–4 (Anon *Bjark* in SkP 3): *Vaki é ok vaki, · vīna bauðuð, // allir inir óðstu · Aðils of sinnar*. ‘Wake now and wake, ye chief of friends; all the noblest companions of Edyls!’

- 14 Þá á-râs mōnig gold-hladen þegn, · gyrde hine his swurde;  
 þá tó dura éodon · driht-lice cēmpān,  
 Sige-ferð and Éaha, · hyra sweord ge-tugon,

- 16 and æt ððrum durum · Ord-láf and Gûð-láf,  
and Hengest sylf; · hwearf him on lâste.

Then arose many a gold-ladenthane, girded on his sword.  
Then to the door went the lordly champions  
Syferth and Eah—they drew their swords—  
and at the other door Ordlaaf and Guthlaaf  
and Hengest himself; he followed in their tracks.

---

13 gyrde hine his swurde ‘girded on his sword’ | Cf. *Hild* 5b.

- 18 Þá gít Går·ulf · Gûð·ere styrode,  
þæt hie swá fréo=lic feorh · forman sǿðe  
20 tó þære healle durum · hysta ne báron,  
nú hyt niða heard · á·nyman wolde:  
22 ac hé frægn ofer eal · un·dearninga,  
deor-mód hæleð, · hwa þá duru héolde.

TODO: Translation

---

19 forman | ‘for man’ *Hickes*

- 24 „Sige-ferð is mín nama“, (cwæð hé) „ic eom Secgena léod,  
wrecca wíde cûð. · Fela ic wéana ge·bâd,  
26 heardra hilda; · þé is gýt hér witod,  
swæðer þú sylf tó mé · sócean wylle.“

TODO: Translation

- 28 Þá wæs on wealle · wæl-slihta ge·hlyn,  
sceolde celæs bord · cónum on handa  
30 bân-helm berstan. · Buruh-þelu dynede,  
oð þæt æt þære gûðe · Går·ulf ge·crang,  
32 ealra ærest · eorð-búendra,  
Gûð-láfes sunu; · ymbe hine góðra fela  
34 hwearf-latra hræw. · Hræfen wandrode  
sweart and sealo-brún; · swurd-léoma stód  
36 swylce eal Finnes-buruh · fyrenu wære.

TODO: Translation

Until in that battle Garulf perished  
earliest of all earth-dwellers [MEN],  
the son of Guthlaaf. Around him a great many of good men,  
the corpses of those late to flight. A raven wandered,

black and dusky brown. The sword-flash stood  
as if all Finnsbury were a burning beacon.

Ne ge·frægn ic náfre wurð=licor · æt wera hilde  
38 sixtig sige-beorna · söl ge·báran,  
ne náfre swānas swótne · medo söl for·gyldan,  
40 þonne Hnæfe guldor · his hæg-stealdas.  
Hig fuhton fif dagas, · swá hyra nān ne fēol  
42 driht-ge-siða, · ac hig þā duru héoldon.

I have not learned that in a worthier manner in the fight of men  
ever sixty triumph-warriors better carried themselves  
nor ever lads better repaid sweet mead  
than Naf was repaid by his young warriors.  
They fought for five days while not one fell  
among that troop-fellowship, yet they held the doors.

Þá ge·wāt him wund hæleð · on wæg gangan,  
44 sǣde þæt his byrne · á·brocen wære,  
here-sceorp un·hrór, · and éac wæs his helm þyrl.  
46 Þá hine sōna frægn · folces hyrde,  
hú þā wígend · hyra wunda ge·náson  
48 oððe hwæðer þāra hyssa

Then went a wounded hero, walking away;  
he said that his byrnie was broken up,  
his war-gear powerless, and his helmet, too, was pierced.  
Then he was soon asked by the herdsman of the troop [LEADER]  
how the warriors were treating their wounds,  
or ... of the boys ...





# Walder

## (*Wald·here*)

**Dating:** TODO

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

**Walder** (abbrev. *Wald*) is an Old English epic fragment.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wald* is preserved on two folios clearly belonging to the same manuscript. They are housed in the royal library of Copenhagen and together given the signum NKS MS 167 b 4<sup>o</sup> (henceforth abbrev. as 167). The text on the two folios is not continuous, and the present edition therefore does not number them continuously, instead splitting the text into two parts. *Wald A* corresponds to the text on 167 1r–v and *Wald B* to 167 2r–v.

For the manuscript I have inspected the digital facsimile at <https://digipal.eu/digipal/page/1072/>.

### Story

The majority of the surviving poem consists of dialogue.

The taunts between the heroes Walder and Guthur in fragment B is very reminiscent of the dialogue in *Hild*.

## Text

## Part A

A [...] hyrde hyne georne:

TODO: Translation.

- 2 „Húru Welandes · worc ne ge·swiceð  
 mōnna ænigum · þāra þe Mimming can  
 4 heardne ge·healdan. · Oft æt hilde ge·dreas  
 swāt-fāg and sweord-wund · secg æfter oðrum.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 6 Ætlan ord-wyga, · ne lát þín ellen nú gyt  
 ge·dréosan to dæge, dryht-scipe.  
 8 Nú is se dæg cumen  
 þæt þú scealt āninga · oðer twēga,  
 10 lif for·leosan · oððe langne dóm  
 āgan mid ǣldum, · Ælf·heres sunu!

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 12 Nalles ic þe, wine mín, · wordum cide,  
 þý ic þe ge·sawe · æt ðām sweord-plegan  
 14 þurh ed-wit-scype · āniges mōnnes  
 wīg for·bugan · oððe on weal fléon,  
 16 lice beorgan, · þeah þe lāðra fela  
 þínne byrn-hōmon · billum heowun.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation.

- 18 Ac þú symle furðor · feohtan sóhtest,  
 mæl ofer mearce; · þý ic þe metod ʒn·dréd,  
 20 þæt þú to fyren·lice · feohtan sóhtest  
 æt þām æt·stealle · ððres mōnnes,  
 22 wīg·rædenne. · Weorða þe selfne  
 gódum dædum, · þenden þin God ʒecce.

TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation.

- 24 Ne murn þú for þí méce; · þe wearð mādma cyst  
 gifeðe to geoce, · mid þý þú Gūð·here scealt  
 26 beot for·bigan, · þæs þe hé þás beaduwe ʒn·gan  
 mid un·ryhte · ārest sócan.

TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation.

- 28 For·sóc hé þām swurde · and þām sync·fatum,  
 béaga mænigo; · nú sceal béaga·léas  
 30 hworfan fr̥m þisse hilde, · hlāfurd sócan  
 ealdne ððel · ðððe hér ár swefan,  
 32 gif hé þa [...]“

TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation  
 TODO: Translation.

## Part B

B „...ce bæteran

- 2        b·útōn þām ānum · þe ic éac hafa  
           on stān·fate · stille ge·híded.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 4        Ic wāt þæt hit þōhte · þeod·ric Wíðian  
           selfum on·sendon, · and éac sinc micel  
 6        mǣðma mid þí mēce, · mōnig oðres mid him  
           golde ge·girwan · (iu·léan ge·nam),  
 8        þæs þe hine of nearwum · Níð·hades mæg,  
           Welandes bearn, · Wíðia út for·lét;  
 10       þurh fifela ge·weald · fōrð on·ette.“

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- Wald·ere mǣðelode, · wíga ellen·rof,  
 12        hæfde him on handa · hilde·frófre,  
           gūð·billa gripe, · gyddode wordum:

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

- 14       „Hwæt þú húru wōndest, · wine Burgenda,  
           þæt mé Hagenan hand · hilde ge·frēmede  
 16        and ge·twæmde fēðe·wigges. · Feta, gyf þú dyrre,  
           æt þus heaðu·wórgan · hære byrnan.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

- 18       Standeð mé hér on caxelum · Ælf·heres láf,  
           gód and géap·neþ, · golde ge·weorðod,

- 20 **e**alles **un**-scende · æðelinges réaf  
to **h**abbanne, · þonne **h**and wæreð  
22 **f**eorh-hord **f**eondum. · Ne bið **f**āh wið mé,  
þonne ... **un**-mægas · eft ʒn·gynnað,  
24 mécum ge·**m**ótað, · swá gé **m**é dydon.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

---

23 ... | 2–3 illegible characters, possibly erased already by the scribe ms.

- Peah mæg **s**ige **s**yllan · sé þe **s**ymle byð  
26 **r**econ and **r**æd-fest · **r**yhra ge·hwilces.  
Sé þe him tó þām **h**ālgan · **h**elpe ge·lifeð,  
28 to **G**ode **g**ioce, · hé þær **g**earo findeð  
gif þā **e**arnunga · ær ge·þenceð.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 30 Þonne móten **w**lance · **w**elan britnian,  
æhtum wealdan, · þæt is [...]"

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation



# Widsith

## (*Wīd·siþ*)

**Dating:** C7th–8th (Neidorf 2013)

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

**Widsith** (abbrev. *Wīd*) is an archaic heroic poem.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wīd* is found in E on foll. 84v/11–87r/8. It comes after the Christian “Vain-glory” (*Hwæt, mé fród wita* ...) and is followed by the Christian “Fortunes of Mortals” (*Ful oft þæt ge·gongēð* ...).

### Meter and stanza

Like *Déor*, *Wīd* is clearly stanzaic. This stands in stark contrast with almost all other West Germanic legendary poetry which is stichic. On the other hand it agrees well with Norse poetry, especially those Norse poems (e.g. *Vkv*) which are less strict with the 4-line stanza and frequently admit ones also of 3 or 5 lines.

For ease of reference with earlier editions, the line numbers are numbered continuously rather than per-stanza.

## Text

- 1      Wíd·sīð maðolade, · word-hord qn·leac,  
 2      sé þe mǣst · mǣrpa ofer eorþan,  
       folca geond·fōrde; · oft hé flette ge·þāh  
 4      myne-licne mǣppum. · Hine frōm Myrgingum  
       æpele qn·wócon. · He mid Ealh·hilde,  
 6      fǣlre freoþu-wębban, · forman sīþe  
       Hreð·cyninges · hām ge·sóhte  
 8      éastan of Qngle, · Eorman·ríces,  
       wrāþes wær-logan. · Qn·gōnn þā worn sprecan:

WIDSITH SPOKE, unlocked his word-hoard,  
 he who furthest through tribes on the earth  
 and nations had journeyed. Oft on the bench had he received  
 delightful treasures. Amongst the Mirgings  
 he had his ancestry. Along with Elhild,  
 the good peace-weaveress, for the very first time  
 he had sought out the Reth-King's realm  
 to the east of the Angles: [the realm] of Ermenric  
 the fierce oath-breaker. He then began a long speech:

---

ALL | The narrator begins with a 9-line introduction.

6 freoþu-wębban 'peace-weaveress' | A woman used in a political marriage to bring peace between two tribes or families, in this case between a king Edwin (st. 20) and Ermenric of the Gots.

7 Hreð-cyninges 'Reth-King' | Ermenric, the king of the Reth-Gots, which is apparently just a poetic name for the Eastern Gots; cf. ll. 18, 57, 88–89, also *Vaff* 12/3 n. and *Ög* 136 *Rök* (under Runic poetry).

- 10 2      „Fela ic mōnna ge·frægn · mægþum wealdan.  
       Sceal þéoda ge·hwylc · þéawum lifgan,  
 12      eorl æfter oþrum · oðle ráðan,  
       sé þe his þéoden·stól · ge·þéon wile.

“A great deal of men I've learned ruling tribes.  
 Every person shall live in virtue,  
 each earl after the other lead his homeland  
 who on his sovereign seat will prosper.

- 14 3      Þára wæs Hwala · hwile sólast,  
       qnd Alexandreas · ealra rícost  
 16      mōnna cynnes, · qnd he mǣst ge·þāh  
       þára þe ic ofer foldan · ge·frægen hæbbe.



Of them was Wale for a while the best,  
and Alexander of all the strongest  
of mankind, and he prospered most  
of those men over the earth of whom I've learned.

---

14 Hwala | Wala E

- 18 4     Ætla weold Húnum, · Eorman·ric Gotum,  
          Becca Baningum, · Burgendum Gifica.  
20     Câsere weold Créacum · qnd Cælic Finnum,  
          Hagena Holm-rycum · qnd Henden Glommum.

Attle ruled the Huns, Ermenric the Gots,  
Beck the Banings, Yivick the Burgends.  
Coser ruled the Greeks and Calic the Finns,  
Hawn the Holmrighs and Henden the Glams.”

- 22 5     Witta weold Swárfum, · Wada Hælsingum,  
          Meaca Myrgingum, · Mearch·ealf Hundingum.  
24     Þéod·ric weold Frōncum, · Þyle Rōndingum,  
          Breoca Brōndingum, · Billing Wernum.  
26     Ôs·wine weold Eowum · qnd Ytum Gef·wulf,  
          Finn Folc·walding · Fresna cynne.

Wit ruled the Swebes, Wade the Helsings,  
Mack the Mirgings, Marchalf the Hundings.  
Thedric ruled the Franks, Thyle the Randings,  
Brack the Brandings, Billing the Werns.  
Oswin ruled the Eawes and Gefwolf the Ytes,  
Finn Folkwalding the race of Frisians.

- 28 6     Sige·here lēngest · sǣ·Denum weold,  
          Hnæf Hocingum, · Helm Wulfingum,  
30     Wald Wóingum, · Wód Þyringum,  
          Sǣ·ferð Sycgum, · Swéom Ongend·þeow,  
32     Scaft·here Ymbrum, · Sceafa Lōng·beardum,  
          Hún Hæt·werum · qnd Holen Wrosnum;  
34     Hring·wald wæs hāten · Hēre·farena cyning.

Sigar for the longest ruled the sea-Danes,  
Naf the Hockings, Helm the Wolvings,  
Wald the Wooings, Wood the Thirings,  
Seaferth the Sidges, Angenthew the Swedes,  
Shafta the Imbres, Sheaf the Longbeards,

Hown the Hatweres, and Holen the Wrasens;  
Ringwald was the name of the king of Herefarers.

- 7      Offa weold Qngle, · Ale-wih Denum;  
36      sé wæs þāra manna · mōdgast ealra,  
         no hwæpre he ofer Offan · eorl-scype frēmede,  
38      ac Offa ge·slóg · ārest mōnna,  
         cniht-wesende, · cyne-ríca mǣst.

Offe ruled the Angles, Alewigh the Danes;  
of these men he was bravest of all,  
but he did not further greater earlship than Offe,  
for Offe conquered—youngest of men,  
still a boy—the greatest of kingdoms.

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ALL. | The great praise here accorded to Offe, the legendary ruler of the continental Angles from whom the Anglo-Saxons claimed descent, is paralleled by *Beow* 1954–1960a.

- 40 8      Nænig efen-eald him · eorl-scipe mǣran  
         on or·ette: · āne sweorde  
42      mērc ge·mǣrde · wið Myrgingum  
         bi Fīfel-dore; · heoldon forð siþþan  
44      Engle qnd Swǣfe, · swá hit Offa ge·slóg.

No man of his age accomplished  
greater earlship: with a single sword  
he marked the border against the Mirgings  
by Fiveldoor. It was thenceforth held  
by the Angles and Swebes as Offe had won it.

- 9      Hróþ·wulf qnd Hróð·gār · heoldon lēngest  
46      sibbe æt·sōmne · suhtor-fædran,  
         siþþan hý for·wræcon · Wicinga cynn  
48      qnd Ingeldes · ord for·bigdon,  
         for·heowon æt Heorote · Heaðo-beardna þrym.

Rotholf and Rothgar held for the longest  
the peace together, uncle and nephew,  
since they drove away the race of Wikings,  
and bent down Ingeld's spear-point;  
at Hart they cut down the host of the Hathbeards.

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49 Heorote 'Hart' | The legendary hall of the Danish kings, the Shieldings. It is described at length in *Beow*.

- 50 **10** Swá ic geond·fórde fela · frēmdra lōnda  
 geond ginne grund. · Gódes ōnd yfles  
 52 þær ic cunnade; · cnósle bi-dæled,  
 fréo-mægum feor · folgade wide.

So I journeyed through a great deal of strange lands  
 through the wide world. Of good and evil  
 I there became acquainted. Of kin deprived,  
 far from dear kinsmen, I strayed widely.

- 54 **11** For·þon ic mæg singan · ōnd sæcgan spell,  
 mænnan fore mēngo · in meodu-healle  
 56 hú mé cyne-góde · cystum dohten.

Therefore I can sing and tell tales,  
 recall before the many in the mead-hall,  
 how men of good kin treated me with grace.

- 12** Ic wæs mid Húnum · ōnd mid Hreð-Gotum,  
 58 mid Swéom ōnd mid Géatum · ōnd mid sūþ-Denum.  
 Mid Wēnlum ic wæs ōnd mid Wærnum · ōnd mid  
 Wicingum;  
 60 mid Gefþum ic wæs ōnd mid Winedum · ōnd mid Gefleggum;  
 mid Englum ic wæs ōnd mid Swæfum · ōnd mid Ænenum;  
 62 mid Seaxum ic wæs ōnd Sycgum · ōnd mid Sweord-werum;  
 mid Hronum ic wæs ōnd mid Déanum · ōnd mid  
 Heaþo-Réamum.

I was among Huns and among Reth-Gots,  
 among Swedes and among Geats, and among south-Danes.  
 Among Wendles I was and among Warns, and among Wikings;  
 among Yefths I was and among Wends, and among Yefflegs;  
 among Angles I was and among Swebes, and among Anens;  
 among Saxes I was and among Sidges, and among Sword-weres;  
 among Ranes I was and among Deans, and among Hath-Reams.

- 64 **13** Mid Þyringum ic wæs · ōnd mid Þrowendum,  
 ōnd mid Burgendum, · þær ic béag ge·þâh;  
 66 mé þær Gūð-here for·geaf · glæd-lícne maþþum  
 sōnges to léane. · Næs þæt sæne cyning!

Among Thirings I was and among Throwends  
 and among the Burgends where I received a high;

there Guthur gladdened me with treasures  
as reward for my song. That was not a bad king!

- 68 14 Mid **F**rōncum ic wæs ƿnd mid **F**rysum · ƿnd mid  
Frumtingum;  
mid **R**ugum ic wæs ƿnd mid Glōmmum · ƿnd mid  
Rúm-walum.

Among Franks I was and among Frises, and among Frumtings;  
among Ruges I was and among Glams, and among Rome-Wales.

- 70 15 Swylce ic wæs ƿn **E**atule · mid **Æ**lf-wine,  
sé hæfde mƿn-cynnes, · mīne ge-fræge,  
72 leohteste hƿnd · lofes tó wyrceenne,  
heortan un·hneaweste · hringa ge-dāles,  
74 beorhtra béaga, · bearn Éad-wines.

Likewise was I in Italy with Elfwin.  
Of mankind he had—as I have learned—  
the lightest hand in working generosity,  
the unstingiest heart in the dealing of rings  
and bright bighs, the child of Edwin.

---

70 Ælf-wine ‘Elfwin’ | Latin *Alboinus* (530s – 28 June 572), king of the Longbeards. As king he succeeded his father Edwin (Latin *Audoinus*) and led the Longbeards to settle in Northern Italy, where they established their kingdom and gave the region its present name, Lombardy.

- 16 Mid **S**ęrcingum ic wæs · ƿnd mid **S**eringum;  
76 mid **C**reacum ic wæs ƿnd mid Finnum · ƿnd mid **C**āsere,  
sé þe wīn-burga · ge-weald áhte,  
78 wíolena ƿnd wílna, · ƿnd **W**ala ríces.

Among Serkings I was and among Searings;  
among Greeks I was and among Finns, and with Coser,  
he who held dominion over wine-towns,  
over wealth and concubines and the realm of the Wales.

---

75 Sęrcingum ‘Serkings’ | Probably related to ‘Saracen’. Cf. ON *Sęrk-land* ‘Serkland’, a name for Arabia or North Africa, which appears to be from the same Germanic source.

76 Cāsere ‘Coser’ | Caesar, the Roman Emperor, but no particular historical emperor is intended. Cf. *Vkv* Pl, 15, *Hild* 33.

77 wīn-burga ‘wine-towns’ | Roman vineyards.

78 Wala ríces ‘the realm of the Wales’ | The Roman Empire, or more specifically Gaul (which in ON was known as *Val-land* from the same root). For the use of *Walas* ‘Wales’ in the sense ‘Romans’ see st. 14/2 above



as repayment for his giving me land,  
—that lord of Mirgins—my father's ethel.

- 20      Qnd mé þá Ealh·hild · ǫþerne for·geaf,  
98      dryht·cwén duguþe, · dohtor Éad·wines;  
hyre lof lēngde · geond lōnda fela.  
100      Þonne ic be sōnge · sēcgan sceolde  
hwær ic under swegl · sǫlast wisse  
102      gold·hrodene cwén · giefre bryttian.

And then Elhild gave me another one,  
the noble queen of the old troop, daughter of Edwin;  
her praise stretched far through many lands.  
Then in my song I had to say,  
where beneath the sun I knew the best  
gold-adorned queen dispensing gifts.

- 21      Þonne wit Scilling · scíran reorde  
104      for uncrum sige·dryhtne · sōng a·hófon,  
hlúde bí hearpan, · hleoþor swinsade,  
106      þonne mōnige mēnn, · móðum wlōnce,  
wordum sprēcon, · þá þe wel cūþon,  
108      þæt hí nǣfre sōng · sǫllan ne hýrdon.

Then I and Shilling with clear voices  
for our victorious lord raised up a song,  
loud by the harp—the tune rang out.  
Then many men proud of heart  
told with words—those who knew well—  
that they never had heard a better song.

- 22      Ðonnan ic ealne geond·hwearf · ǫþel Gotena,  
110      sóhte ic ā sīþa · þá sǫlestan;  
þæt wæs inn·weorud · Earman·rices.

Thence I passed through all the ethel of the Gots;  
I always sought out the best companions;  
that was the inner retinue of Ermenric.

---

111 Earman·rices | eormanrices E

- 112 23      Heðcan sóhte ic qnd Beadecan · qnd Hēre·lingas,  
Emercan sóhte ic qnd Fridlan · qnd Éast·Gotan,

114 fróðne ƿnd góðne · fæder Un·wōnes.

TODO

24 Seccan sóhte ic ƿnd Beccan, · Seafolan ƿnd Þeod·ric,  
116 Heaþo·ric ƿnd Sifecan, · Hliþe ƿnd Incgen·þeow.  
Éad·wine sóhte ic ƿnd Elsan, · Ægel·mund ƿnd Hún·gâr,  
118 ƿnd þá wlōncan ge·dryht · Wiþ·myrginga.

TODO

25 Wulf·here sóhte ic ƿnd Wyrm·here; · ful oft þær wig ne á·læg,  
120 þonne Hræda here · heardum sweordum  
ymb Wistla·wudu · wergan sceoldon  
122 ealdne éþel·stól · Ætlan léodum.

I sought out Wolfer and Wyrmer—most seldom there the warring ceased  
when the Reth-host with hard swords  
in the Wistlewood had to defend  
the old ethel-seat against Attle's folk.

26 Ræd·here sóhte ic ƿnd Rōnd·here, · Rúm·stân ƿnd Gisl·here,  
124 Wiþer·gield ƿnd Freoþe·ric, · Wudgan ƿnd Hâman;  
ne wæron þæt ge·siþa · þá sǣmestan,  
126 þeah þe ic hý a·niht · nēmnan sceolde.

I sought out Reeder and Rander, Roomstan and Yisler,  
Witheryeld and Frithric, Woody and Homer;  
nor were those the worst of companions,  
although I last should mention them.

27 Ful oft of þâm héape · hwínende fléag  
128 giellende gâr · ƿn grōme þéode;  
wræccan þær weoldon · wundnan golde  
130 werum ƿnd wífum, · Wudga ƿnd Hâma.

Most often from that troop did fly a whizzing,  
yelling spear into the fiendish folk.  
There ruled the exiles Woody and Homer  
over twisted gold, men and women.

128 giellende gâr 'yelling spear' | Formulaic. Cf. in ON *Akv* 5/2a: *af geiri gjallanda*, Egill Lv 9/2a (SkP 5): *ok gjallanda giri*.

- 28 Swá ic þæt symle on·fōnd · on þære feringe,  
 132 þæt sé biþ léofast · lond-búendum  
 sé þe him God syleð · gumena ríce  
 134 to ge·healdenne, · þenden hé hér leofað.“

So I always found while on that journey,  
 that he is dearest to land-dwellers [MEN],  
 whom God grants sovereignty of men  
 for to hold while here he lives.”

- 29 Swá scrīþende · ge·sceapum hweorfað  
 136 gléo-menn gumena · geond grunda fela,  
 þearfe sæcgað, · þonc-word sprecað,  
 138 simle sūð oþþe norð · sumne ge·mótað  
 gydda gleawne, · geofum un·hneawne,  
 140 sé þe fore duguþe wile · dóm a·râran,  
 eorl-scipe æfnan, · oþ·þæt eal scæcð,  
 142 leoht ond lif sōmod; · lof sé ge·wyrceð,  
 hafað under heofonum · héah-fæstne dóm.

So passing through fates they wander,  
 the song-men of mankind, through many lands.  
 They tell their needs, speak thoughtful words;  
 whether in the south or north they meet some one,  
 gay in songs, unstingy with gifts,  
 who for the old troop will rear up fame,  
 accomplish earlship until all goes away,  
 light and life together. He who works generosity  
 has under the heavens high, lasting fame.

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ALL | Widsith's speech ends, and the narrator (who last spoke in ll. 1–9) reflects on the importance of generosity and providing hospitality for wayfaring strangers in another 9-line st.



# Deer

## (*Deor*)

**Dating:** TODO

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

**Deer** (*Déor*) is a short elegiac poem. Across seven stanzas, the eponymous poet likens his own tragic fate to famous stories from Germanic heroic legend.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Déor* is preserved only in E on fol. 100r/8–100v/13, where it follows the Christian poem “Soul and Body II” (*Húru, þæs be-bófap ...*) and is followed by the heroic *Wulf*.

### Contents

The poem briefly summarizes the tragic lives of five figures from Germanic heroic legend, each ending with the refrain *Þæs ofer-eode · þisses swá mæg* ‘That passed over; this may likewise.’ After this the poet reflects on fate, and finally tells his own story as an outcast.

### The legends

The five legendary figures mentioned in the poem are:

1. Wayland the Smith, who was captured by the tyrant Nithad and forced to make jewelry for him and his family. He took revenge by raping
2. Nithad’s daughter, Beadhild. The child born from this act was Woody (OE *Wudga*), an obscure hero.
3. Mathild, the protagonist of a poorly attested love tragedy.

4. Thedric the Great, who ruled over the Gots.
5. Ermenric, who succeeded Thedric, and was eventually slain.

### Deer

The name of the poet, *Déor*, first revealed in line 37, is the ancestor of modern English “deer”. Although it can carry this sense in Old English, it can also betoken ‘beast, animal’ more generally. The word is not otherwise known as a personal name and is therefore probably fictional; we may perhaps compare *Fáfn* 2, where the young hero Siward calls himself *göfugt dýr* ‘noble beast/deer’.

## Text

- 1      Wélund him be wurman · wræces cunnade,  
 2      ân-hýdig eorl · earfoða dréag,  
      hæfde him tó ge·sibbe · sorge ond lōngað,  
 4      winter-cealde wræce; · wéan oft ƿn·fōnd,  
      sibban hine Nið·had ƿn · néde lēgde,  
 6      swōncre seono-bende · ƿn syllan mōnn.  
      ƿæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

WAYLAND ALONGSIDE WORMS experienced his exile;  
 the one-minded earl suffered hardship,  
 had with him as companions sorrow and longing,  
 winter-cold exile. Woes he often found  
 after Nithad upon him fetters did lay,  
 heavy sinew-bonds upon the better man.  
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

---

1 be wurman ‘alongside worms’ | I take this to be a description of Wayland’s desolate state after his hamstringing; he is forced to crawl on the ground in the company of worms (by which is also understood serpents). — The possibility of this word being an English form of German *Worms*, the capital of the Burgunds, is unlikely since the OHG name for the city contemporary to the poem was *Wormazia*.

- 8      2      Beado·hilde ne wæs · hyre brópra déap  
      on sefan swá sár · swá hyre sylfre þing,  
 10      þæt heo gearo·lice · on·gieten hæfde  
      þæt heo éacen wæs; · æfre ne meahte  
 12      þriste ge·þencan, · hú ymb þæt sceolde.  
      ƿæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

For Beadhild was not her brothers’ deaths  
 in her heart so sore as her own thing,  
 that she clearly had understood  
 that she was pregnant. Never could she  
 boldly think out how she would manage that.  
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

- 14      3      Wé þæt Mæð·hilde · mōnge ge·frugnon  
      wurdon grund·léase · Geates frige,  
 16      þæt hí seo sorg·lufu · slæp ealle bi·nōm.  
      ƿæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

We have learned that for Mathild many  
bottomless [troubles] arose, for Geat's beloved,  
that the sorrowful love deprived her of all sleep.  
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

- 18 4 Þeod·ric âhte · þrítig wintra  
Mæringa burg; · þæt wæs monegum cūþ.  
20 Þæs ofer·éode, · þisses swá mæg!

Theodric owned for thirty winters  
the stronghold of the Meerings; that was known to many.  
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

- 5 Wé ge·ascodan · Eorman·ríces  
12 wylfenne ge·þóht; · âhte wíde folc  
Gotena ríces. · Þæt wæs grim cyning!  
24 Sæt sæcg mōnig · sorgum ge·bunden,  
wéan on wénan, · wýscte ge·neahhe  
26 þæt þæs cyne·ríces · ofer·cumen wære.  
Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

We have learned of Ermenric's  
wolvern nature. He wielded widely the host  
of the realm of the Gots; that was a grim king.  
Many a man sat bound in sorrows,  
with woes in his thoughts, wishing aplenty  
that that kingdom might be overcome.  
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

---

23 þæt wæs grim cyning! 'that was a grim king!' | Formulaic; cf. *Wid* TODO: *Næs þæt séne cyning!*  
'That was not a bad king!'; *Beow* 11b: *þæt wæs gód cyning!* 'That was a good king!'

- 28 6 Siteð sorg·céarig, · sálum bi·dæled,  
on sefan sweorceð, · sylfum þinceð  
30 þæt sý ende·léas · earfoda dæl.  
Mæg þonne ge·þencan, · þæt geond þás woruld  
32 witig dryhten · wendeþ ge·neahhe,  
eorle monegum · âre ge·sceawað,  
34 wís·licne blæd, · sumum wéana dæl.

One sits troubled by sorrow, of blessings bereft;  
his heart darkens; to himself he thinks  
that endless must be his share of hardships.  
Then he may come to think that throughout this world

the Wise Lord turns His coat aplenty:  
to many an earl honour He shows,  
sure success—to another a share of woes.

- 7      þæt ic bi mé sylfum · sæcgan wille,  
36      þæt ic hwile wæs · Heodeninga scóp,  
         dryhtne dýre— · mé wæs Deor noma.  
38      Âhte ic fela wintra · folgað tilne,  
         holdne hláford, · oþ þæt Heorrenda nú,  
40      léoð-cræftig monn · lond-ryht geþāh,  
         þæt mé eorla hléo · ær ge-sealde.  
42      Þæs ofer-eode, · þisses swá mæg!

This of myself I wish to say,  
that for a while I was the Heedenings's shop,  
dear to their lord; Deer was my name.  
I had for a great many winters a good retinue,  
a hold bread-giver—until Harrend now,  
the lay-crafty man, has won the land-right  
which the shelter of earls [KING] to *me* once granted.  
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.



# Wolf and Edwaker

## *(Wulf and Éad·wacer)*

**Dating:** TODO

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter

### Introduction

**Wolf and Edwaker** (abbrev. *Wulf*) is a mysterious stanzaic poem.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wulf* is found in E on foll. 100v/14–101r/4. It comes after the heroic elegy *Déor* and is followed by Riddles 1–59 (*Hwylc is hæleþa þæs horsc ...*). rom the Exeter Book.

## Text

- 1 Léodum is mīnum · swylce him mon lāc gife;  
 2 willað hý hine á·þeċgan, · gif hé ʒn þréat cymeð.  
     Un-ge·lic is ūs.

For my people it is as if one gave them an offering;  
 they wish to devour him if he comes upon that host.  
 It is not so for us.

- 2 Wulf is ʒn iege, · ic ʒn ðerre;  
 2 fæst is þæt eg-lond, · fenne bi-worpen.  
     Sindon wæl-reowe · weras þær ʒn ige;  
 4 willað hý hine á·þeċgan, · gif hé ʒn þréat cymeð.  
     Un-ge·lice is ūs.

Wolf is on an island, I on another;  
 fast is that island, surrounded by water.  
 There are slaughter-fierce warriors there on the island;  
 they wish to devour him if he comes upon that host.  
 It is not so for us.

- 3 Wulfes ic mīnes wīd-lāstum · wenum dogode,  
 2 þonne hit wæs rēnig weder · ʒnd ic réotugu sæt;  
     þonne mec sé beadu-cāfa · bógum bi-lēgde,  
 4 wæs mé wyn tó þon, · wæs mé hwæþre éac lād.

The far journeys of my Wolf I've thought of in my yearnings,  
 when it was rainy weather and I sat grieving,  
 when the battle-bold man laid his arms around me,  
 I found joy in that, yet also found it loathsome.

- 4 Wulf, mīn Wulf, · wēna mé þīne  
 2 séoce ge-dydon, · þīne seld-cymas,  
     murnende mōd, · nales mēte-liste.

Wolf, my Wolf! My yearnings for thee  
 have made me sick, and thy rare comings,  
 a mourning mind—nowise want of food!

- 5 Ge·hýrest þú, Éad·wacer? · Uncerne earne hwelp  
 2 bireð Wulf to wuda;



4            þæt mōn éaþe tó·sliteð · þætte náfre ge·sōmnad wæs,  
              uncer giedd geador.

Hearest thou Edwaker? Our wretched whelp  
is carried by Wolf to the woods.

One easily tears apart that which was never put together:  
our song together.



# Lay of Hildbrand

## (*Hildebrandslied*)

**Dating:** C8th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Lay of Hildbrand** (abbrev. *Hild*) is the only surviving High German alliterative poem dealing with native legendary material and is such of immense value.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hild* is preserved in the 2<sup>o</sup> Ms. theol. 54 of the Kassel university library (ca. 820 AD, henceforth labelled **K**) where it is written in a different hand (ca. 830 AD) on the outer covers, foll. 1r and 76v. 76v ends in the middle of a line and the poem is thus fragmentary.

### Language

The language of *Hild* is one of the great mysteries of German philology since it reflects a strange and clearly unnatural mix of Old High German and Old Saxon.

Let us begin with an overview of features. For transparency, the quoted forms will be in their manuscript orthography and not normalized.

TODO: list is incomplete!

The following features are clearly Old Saxon:

1. The Ingvaconic nasal spirant law /Vnθ/ > /Ṽ:θ/ (*guð*- 5, *ódre* 12, *chud* 13, 28, *usere* 15, *gudea* 59).
2. m. nom. pl. *-os* (*helidos* 6).
3. Loss of \*-*r* after a vowel in monosyllabic words (*mi* 12a, 12b, 15, 41; but cf. TODO below).

4. Unshifted *-k* in *ik* 'I' (cf. below).

On the other hand, the following features are clearly High German:

1. *\*wr-* > *r-*, as required by the alliteration between *reccheo* and *riche* (l. 47 n.)
2. Preserved *\*-R* (> *-r*) after a vowel in monosyllabic words.
3. Neuter adj. nom./acc. sg. *-at* (*suasat* 52).
4. *\*þ* > *d* (see below).
5. The High German consonant shift (see below).

The last two changes affect such a great number of words that their examples ought to be listed separately.

### *\*þ* > *d*

This change eventually came to affect most of continental Germanic (including non-High German varieties like Dutch and Low German), but in the 9th c. had not yet spread to OS and is therefore an OHG diagnostic feature.

1. *þ* (ð: *ðat* 1, 2, *haðubrant* 3, *guð-* 5; *th*: *theotribhe* 19) > *d* (*bēlidos* 6, *do* 6, 32, 62, 64, *dero* 6, 60, *eddo* 11, 53, *du* 11, 12, 31, 38, 40, 47, 47, 54, 56, *de* 12, 59, *ódre* 12, *chind* (< *\*kinþ-*) 13, 52, *chud* 13, 28, *irmindeot* 13, *hadubrant* 14, 17, 35, *dat* 15, 17, 24, 31, 34, 41, 42, 46, 47, 63, *dea* 16, *nid* 18, *degano* 19, 26, *des* 23, *sid* 23, *detribhe* 23, *darba* 23, 26\*, *dechisto* 26, *deotrichhe* 26, *quad* 30, 48, 57, *dana* 31, *dinc* 31, *der* 33, 57, 58, *dir* 34, 38, 54, 58, *huldi* 34, *pidar* 37, *dinem* 39, 45, *dinu* 39, *seolidante* 41, *desemo* 47, *dar* 50, 56, *perdan* 53, *doh* 54, 57, *aodlihho* 54, *din* 54, *dih* 58, *gudea* 59, *perdar* 60, *erdo* 61, *desero* 61, *bedero* 61, *dem* 63).

### The High German consonant shift

The High German consonant shift consists of two related changes in the consonant system from Proto-West Germanic to OHG. Their distribution varies somewhat across OHG dialects but they work very similarly.

1. The spirantisation of voiceless stops *p*, *t*, *k* > *f*, *z*, *h* or *pf*, *tz*, *kh*, depending on their position in the word. Note that the fricatives *z* and *h* geminate after long vowels.
2. The devoicing of voiced stops *b*, *d*, *g* > *p*, *t*, *k*.

The following examples are attested in *Hild*:

1. Spirantisation:

- a) *k* (*ik* 1, 12, *cnuosles* 11) > *b* (initially and medially *ch*: *folche* 10, *chind* 13, 52, *chunincriche* 13, *chud* 13, 28, *otachres* 18, *otachre* 25, *dechisto* 26, *folches* 27, *chonnem* 28, *cheisuringu* 33, *chuning* 33, *chludun* 64; word-finally *h*: *sib* 2, 5, 60, *ib* 17, 29, 34, 45, 49, 53, *mih* 39, 50, 52, *dih* 58); *k* after a long vowel > *hh* (*hb*: *pelibbes* 11, *theotribbe* 19, *detribbe* 23, *aodlibbo* 54; *chb*: *deotrichbe* 26; *cc*: *harmlicco* 65; *ch*: *chunincriche* 13, *riche* 47);
- b) *kk* > *kkb* (*reccheo* 47).

## 2. Devoicing:

- a) *b* (*biltibrant* 3, 7, 17, 30, 43, 44, 48, 57, *hadubrant* 3, 14, 17, 35, *ubar* 6, 42, *heribrantes* 7, 43, 44, *ibu* 12, 54, 56, *biltibrantes* 14, 35, *bure* 21, *barn* 21, *arbo-* 22, *darba* 23, 26, *lib* 29, *habbe* 29, *obana* 30, *ab* 30, *bauga* 32, *bi* 34, 47, *gibu* 34, *geba* 36, *bist* 38, *habes* 46, 56, *burc* 51, *banun* 51, *breton* 53, *billiu* 53, *banin* 53, *rauba* 56, *bibrabanen* 56, *brunnono* 61, *bedero* 61, -*bort* 64, *pabnum* 67) > *p* (*prut* 21, *leop* 27, *gap* 33, *pist* 40);
- b) *bb* > *pp* (*pp*: *sippan* 31).
- c) \**d* > *t* (*giborta* 1, *muotin* 2, *biltibrant* 3, 7, 17, 30, 43, 44, 48, 57, *enti* 3, 19, 49, *hadubrant* 3, 14, 17, 35, *untar* 3, *sunufatarungo* 4, *garutun* 5, *gurtun* 5, *suert* 5, *hiltiu* 6, *ritun* 6, *gimabalta* 7, 14, 35, 44, *heribrantes* 7, 43, 44, *froto* 8, *gistuont* 8, *uortum* 9, *fater* 9, 17, *irmindeot* 13, *biltibrantes* 14, 35, *sagetun* 15, 41, *liuti* 15, *alte* 16, *anti* 16, *frote* 16, *otachre* 18, 25, *miti* 19, 53, 67, *theotribbe* 19, *lante* 20, 49, *prut* 21, *raet* 22, *detribbe* 23, *gistuontum* 23, *fatereres* 24, *friuntlaos* 24, *unti* 26, *deotrichbe* 26, *gistontun* 26, *ente* 27, *irmingot* 30, *halt* 31, *mit* 31, 36, 39, *gileitos* 31, *pant* 32, *puntane* 32, *gitan* 33, *truhtin* 34, *ort* 37, *orte* 37, *alter* 38, *puortun* 39, *gialtet* 40, *inpit* 40, *fortos* 40, *seolidante* 41, *pentilseo* 42, *tot* 43, *goten* 46, *purti* 47, *paltant* 48, *got* 48, *pepurt* 48, *skibit* 48, *pallota* 49, *scerita* 50, *sceotantero* 50, *suertu* 52, *breton* 53 (n.), *taoc* 54, *liuto* 57, *lustit* 58, *hiutu* 60, *uualtan* 61, *scritan* 62, *sciltim* 63, *stont* 63, *bort* 64, *scilti* 65, *lintun* 66, *purtun* 66).
- d) *g* (*giborta* 1, *sunufatarungo* 4, *garutun* 5, *gudhamun* 5, *gurtun* 5, *ringa* 6, *gimabalta* 7, 14, 35, 44, *fragen* 8, *gistuont* 8, *sages* 12, *sagetun* 15, 41, *gibueit* 18, *degano* 19, 26, *gistuontum* 23, *gistontun* 26, *irmingot* 30, *gileitos* 31, *bauga* 32, *cheisuringu* 33, *gitan* 33, *chuning* 33, *gap* 33, *gibu* 34, *geru* 36, *geba* 36, *gialtet* 40, *gisihu* 45, *goten* 46, *pelaga* 48, *got* 48, *enigeru* 51, *gifasta* 51, *gipinnan* 55, *argosto* 57, *piges* 58, *gudea* 59, *gimeinun* 59, *bregilo* 60, *gipigan* 67) > *k* (only word-finally: *chunicriche* 13, *dinc* 31, *pic* 42, *sebestic* 49, *burc* 51, *taoc* 54, *enic* 56);
- e) *gg* (*seggen* 1).

### The absence of $t > z$

With the extremely consistent application of the High German consonant chain shift in the dentals  $*\beta > d$ ,  $*d > t$  it is very strange that the last natural step, the spirantisation  $t > z$ , does not occur in *Hild*. Instead we have a situation where any given  $t$  in *Hild* may stand for two separate values: old  $*d$  (= standard OHG  $t$ ) and old  $*t$  (= standard OHG  $z$ ).

Above we have already listed all examples of  $t < *d$ . From old  $t$  *Hild* has both  $t$  and  $tt$ , the latter of which may reflect either an old short  $t$  when following a long vowel or an old long  $tt$ . The following occurrences are relevant:

1. old  $t$  (*dat* 1, 2, 15, 17, 24, 31, 34, 41, 42, 46, 47, 63, *tuem* 3, *to* 6, 64, *uuet* 12, *gihueit* 18, *fur laet* 20, *ummet* 25, 38, *at* 27, 51, *ti* 27, 53, *it* 34, *sebstic* 49, *suasat* 52); old  $t$  after a long vowel (*sceotantero* 50)  $> tt$  (*hætte* 17, *beittu* 17, *lutila* 20, *pettu* 30, *motti* 59, *muotti* 60, *lettun* 62, *huitte* 65, *lutilo* 66);
2. old  $tt$  (*urhettun* 2, *sitten* 20).

Note that the High German spirantisation  $t > z$  never (i.e., in no varieties of OHG) occurs in the following clusters, which are thus identical to their equivalents in OS and PWGmc. and irrelevant for the discussion:

1. *ht* (*rihtun* 6, *pebeta* 27 (for  $*fehta$ ), *truhtin* 34, *maht* 54, *reht* 56),
2. *st* (*gistuont* 8, *ist* 13, 43, *ostar* 18, 22, *gistuontum* 23, *dechisto* 26, *gistontun* 26, *bist* 38, *pestar* 42, *brustim* 45, *gifasta* 51, *brusti* 55, *argosto* 57, *ostar* 57, *lustit* 58, *ærist* 62, *stont* 63, *stoptun* 64, *staim-* 64),
3. *nt* (*pintro* 49).

The merger between old  $t$  and  $d$  as seen in *Hild* is not found in other OHG varieties nor in modern High German, and can therefore not have been an authentic part of the language at any stage. With a large enough body of text we would be able to prove statistically the separation of these sounds in the dialect of the poem, but unfortunately we do not have a single instance of alliteration falling on either old  $t$  ( $< t$ ) nor new  $t$  ( $< d$ ).

It is however notable that old  $t$  when following a long vowel in 9/10 cases (the one exception being l. 50: *sceotantero*) turns into the geminate  $tt$ . This feature has no parallel in Old Saxon, but on the other hand is equivalent to what we see for the fricative  $h < k$ . What it seems to suggest is that  $t$  was likely in fact spirantised to  $z$  in the dialect of *Hild* but has been “masked” orthographically by the substitution of all cases of  $z$  for  $t$ ; thus an archetypal doubled  $zz$  in a word like l. 20  $*luzzila$  has been replaced with *lutila*, rather than the correct form  $**lutila$ .

Together with the metrically proven change  $*wr- > r-$  (l. 47 n.) the High German consonant shift thus appears structural to the text of *Hild*, whose language therefore must be classified as OHG with OS influences rather than as a true hybrid or Germanised OS.

### Orthography

For the orthography of the edition I have found it impossible to produce a normalized text without too heavily distorting the received text, being as it is, a blend of several dialects. One need only observe the treatment of the name Thedric, which appears thrice, and each time in a markedly different form. Apart from the typical practices as described in the General Introduction, and using acute accents to signify long vowels, circumflex accents to signify now-monophthongised original diphthongs, and overdots to mark nasal vowels, I have carried out the following changes in order to clarify etymological relationships and make the text somewhat less unwieldy. Of these changes, 7–9 have also been noted in the apparatus where they occur:

1. Replaced both *p* (wynn) and *uu* with *w*.
2. Replaced *c* with *k*.
3. Replaced *qu* with *kw*.
4. Replaced *t* with *ȝ* where corresponding to OHG *z*.
5. Replaced *th* with *þ*.
6. Replaced *e* with *ē* when reflecting an original a-vowel affected by *i*-mutation.
7. Replaced unetymological double *nn* with *n*.
8. Restored initial *b*- where etymological and/or metrically required.
9. Removed initial *b*- where unetymological and/or metrically deficient.

The punctuation of the original, entirely consisting of interpuncts, at times representing metrical breaks, at others sporadically placed, has not been retained.

Where it appears in the *cæsura*, the extrametrical interjection *kwad Hilti-brant* ‘quoth Hildbrand’ (found in ll. 30, 49, and 58) replaces the usual interpunct to indicate that the pause of the *cæsura* has been filled with an indication of the speaker. Outside of *Hild*, similar interjections are found throughout early Germanic poetry: in Old Norse (e.g. *Reg* 3/1, Anon *Eirm* 1/1 (in SkP 1)), Old Saxon (e.g. *Heli* 226, *SaxGen* 1), and Old English (e.g. *Finn* 24). The chronological distribution of these interjections is such that they cannot be mere scribal additions (Old Norse poetry was first written down in the C12th, several centuries after the alliterative meter had gone extinct in Germany); instead, they appear to be genuine remnants of oral performance going back to the common Germanic tradition.

### Summary

The poet begins with a short formulaic introduction; he is relating older stories (1–2). The two duellists, Hildbrand and Hathbrand, father and son, arm themselves and ride into battle at the head of two opposing armies (3–6). They speak, and Hildbrand asks Hathbrand for his name and lineage (7–13). Hathbrand gives his name and ancestry; his father was the warrior Hildbrand, who abandoned him as a newborn. This was long ago, and Hathbrand does not think him still alive (14–29). Hearing this, Hildbrand calls on God as witness, and offers his son a golden torc as a token of loyalty (30–34). Hathbrand takes this as an insulting trick. He proclaims that wealth should be won by struggle alone and accuses Hildbrand of having grown old through treachery (35–40); he has heard from sailors on the Mediterranean that his father is dead (41–43).

After this straight-forward narrative sequence three short speeches follow, in the ms. all spoken by Hildbrand. The second is certainly spoken by Hildbrand, but the other two may be misplaced or misattributed.

1. Hildbrand reflects on his son's prosperity: from his clothes he can tell that he has a good lord, and that he, unlike himself, has not suffered the fate of exile (44–47).

2. Hildbrand calls on God, and laments that, after thirty years at war, he is now forced to fight against his own son. Still, Hathbrand should easily be able to kill such an old man as Hildbrand, if he has strength and fate on his side (48–56).

3. Hildbrand (or Hathbrand, and there is a case for emending here) says that only the most cowardly easterner could refuse the fight so greatly desired. Let both men fight their hardest, and when the duel is over the winner will strip the armour of the other (57–61).

The two men then throw their javelins into each other's shields and rush at each other, hacking away at their shields until they become worthless (62–67). Here the poem ends abruptly in the middle of the battle.



## Text

- Ik gi·hôrta ðaṭ seḡgen [K 1r/1–5]  
 2 ðaṭ sih ur·hêtṭun · aenon muotín:  
 Hilti·brant ęnti Hadu·brant · untar herjun ṭwêm;  
 4 sunu-fatar-ungo · iro saro rihtun  
 garutun sé iro gûd-hamun · gurtun sih iro swert ana  
 6 heḡidos ubar bringa · dó sie ṭó dero hiltu ritun.

I HAVE HEARD IT SAID  
 that two champions struggled alone against each other:  
 Hildbrand and Hathbrand under two hosts.  
 The son and father set their armour,  
 readied their warcloth, girded on their swords,  
 the heroes, over the chain-links, when to that fray they rode.

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6 bringa | ringa K

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- 2 aenon ‘alone’ | A dative plural adverbial, i.e., ‘in single combat’.  
 3 untar herjun ṭwêm ‘under two hosts’ | Either man was a champion of his army.  
 5 gûd-hamun ‘warcloth’ | Their chainmail. Cf. l. 61.  
 5 gurtun sih iro swert ana ‘girded on their swords’ | Cf. *Finn* 13b.

- Hilti·brant gi·mahalta · —her was hêróro man [K 1r/5–11]  
 8 ferāhes frótóro— · her frágén gi·stuont  
 fôhém wortum · bwer sín fater wári  
 10 firibo in fôlkhe · [...]  
 [...] · „eddo hwe-líhhes knuosles dú síš  
 12 ibu dú mí ênan sagés · ik mí de ôdre wêt  
 khind in khun\*ink-ríkhe · khûd ist mí\* al irmin-deot.“

Hildbrand spoke—he was the hoarier man,  
 more learned of life. He began to ask  
 in few words who his father might be  
 of men in the troop, [...]  
 [...] “or of which lineage thou be.  
 If thou tell me one I will recall the others,  
 my child, in the kingdom I know all great men.”

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7 gi·mahalta | Hêri-brantes sunu ‘Harbrand’s son’ add. K 9 bwer | wer K 10 firibo | fireo K  
 11 hwe-líhhes | ‘welíhhes’ K 13 khun\*ink-ríkhe | ‘chunnincriche’ K 13 mí\* | mín K

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- 8 ferāhes frótóro ‘more learned of life’ | Possibly formulaic; cf. *Maldon* 317a: *Ic eom fród feores*. ‘I am learned of life’.

10 *firibo* ‘men’ | Gen. of *fir(a)ba*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for ‘men, people’ found throughout the Old Germanic languages. In OHG it is only otherwise found in *Wessobrunn* 1 and *Musp* 55, never in prose (EWA, s.v. *fir(a)ba*), although it is also found in the cpd. *smala-firibi* m. pl. ‘the common people’ (EWA, s.v. *fērah*).

The word stems from PGmc. *firbwiǰōz*, a *ja*-stem derivative of PGmc. *\*ferbwaq* ‘life, lifeblood’. It is cognate to OS *firibos*, OE *fir(b)as* ‘men’ (cf. Goering 2025, p. 11), and ON *fīrar*, *fyrvar*, *fjērvār*, *fyrðar*. The fact that the aforementioned cognates are also exclusively poetic suggests that this was likely the case already in PGmc., or at the very least in PNWGmc.

13 *khind* ‘my child’ | Here Hildbrand is addressing Hathbrand as his junior (cf. modern English son), but the word also subtly foreshadows his paternity even though at this point in the narrative he is not yet aware of it.

- 14        **H**adu·brant gi·mahalta · **H**ilti·brantes sunu: [K 1r/11–16]  
 „Daṭ sagetun mí · ùsere liuti  
 16        **a**lte anti fróte · **d**ea **ē**r hina wárun  
       daṭ **H**ilti·brant hæṭṭi mín fater · ih heṭṭu **H**adu·brant.  
 18        **F**orn her **ō**star gi·\*weṭ; · flôh her **Ô**t·akhres níd  
       hina miti **D**eot·ríhhe · ḡnti sínero **d**egano filu.

Hathbrand spoke, Hildbrand's son:

“This our liegemen said to me—  
 the old and learned who lived long ago—  
 that Hildbrand was the name of my father; my name is Hathbrand.  
 Long ago he turned east; he fled Edwaker's hate  
 thither with Thedric and his multitude of thanes.

18 gi·\*weṭ | gihueit K    19 *D*eot·ríhhe | theotríhhe with *pre-shift consonant* K

15 Daṭ sagetun mí · ùsere liuti ‘This our liegemen said to me’ | The scansion of this line is inscrutable (cf. l. 42), but the required alliteration is missing.

- 20        Her fur·læt in **l**ante · lúṭṭila siṭṭen [K 1r/16–20]  
       brút in **b**úre, · **b**arn un·wahsan  
 22        **a**rbjo-laosa; · her raet **ō**star hina,  
       des síd **D**eot·ríhhe · **d**arba gi·stuontun  
 24        **f**ater\*es mines: · daṭ was só **f**riunt-laos man.

He left behind in this land a little wife to stay:  
 a bride in the bower, a babe ungrown,  
 inheritance-less. He rode thither to the east,  
 since at that time Thedric was in great need  
 of my father—that was so friendless a man!

21 brút | prut K    22 her raet | heraet K    23 gi·stuontun | gistuontum K    24 *f*ater\*es | fatereres K

20 lúṭṭila ‘a little wife’ | The word is the f. acc. sg. of *luzzil* ‘little, small’, but ‘wife’ is supplied in the translation to resolve the ambiguity between the bride and the child.

- Her was Ôt·akhre · um·meṭ \*irri,  
 26 degano dēkhisto · unti Deot·ríkhhe\*;  
 her was eo folkhes aṭ ęnte, · imo was eo fēhęta ṭi leop;  
 28 khūd was her [...] · khón\*ém mannum:  
 ni wániu ih iu líb habbe.“

[K 1r/20–24]

He was at Edwaker utterly enraged;  
 the dearest of thanes under Thedric.  
 He was ever at the head of the troop; he ever loved the fight too much;  
 known was he among keen men.  
 I do not expect he could still be alive.”

25 um·meṭ \*irri | *written together as ummettirri* K 26 Deot·ríkhhe\* | ‘darba gistontun’ *add.* K  
 27 fēhęta | ‘pęheta’ K 28 khón\*ém | ‘chonnem’ K

25 um·meṭ \*irri ‘utterly enraged’ | The second word is sometimes read as *tirri*, a hapax, but it is more reasonable to take it as a spelling error where the final consonant of the previous word has been erroneously doubled. This gives us the well-attested adj. *irri* which survives in modern German as *irre* ‘mad, crazy, insane’. This sense is probably very old (cf. Gothic *airzeis* ‘erroneous, deceived’), but the sense ‘angry, enraged, wrathful’ is attested in MHG, OS, and OE and must also be used here (EWA, s.v. *irri*).

- 30 „Wēṭṭu Irmin got“ (kwad Hilti·brant) „obana ab hevane  
 daṭ dú neo dana halt mit sus sippan man · dink ni gi·lēitós.“  
 32 Want her dó ar arme · wuntane bauga  
 khęisur·ingu gi·tān · só imo sie der khuning gap,  
 34 Húnjo truhtin, · „daṭ ih dír iṭ nú bí huldí gibu.“

[K 1r/24–76v/4]

“I call as my witness Ermen-God,” quoth Hildbrand, “in heaven above,  
 that thou never hence with such close kin shouldst lead dispute,”  
 —then he unwound from his arm twisted bighs  
 made of Coser’s coin, which the king had given him,  
 the lord of the Huns—“that I now give thee this out of goodwill.”

30 hevane | ‘hevane’ K

30 Irmin got ‘Ermen-God’ | These words may be interpreted in two ways, either as a cpd. *irmin-got* ‘great God’ referring to the Christian God, or as an invocation of the pre-Christian god Ermen (OHG *Irmin*, ON *Jörmunr* ‘Weden’), the ancestor of the *Herminones* of Tacitus (*Germania* 2). The problem with the former interpretation is that such a cpd is unparalleled in all of Germanic, including in related Christian epic poetry like *Heli* and *SaxGen*, whereas something like *waltant got* ‘wielding God’ (l. 48) is very widely paralleled, so that *irmin-* does not seem to have been an unmarked element. For this reason we are most likely looking at a pagan expression, although this does not necessarily imply that the poet himself was a pagan; he may have borrowed it from earlier poetry without understanding its original significance.

For the invocation of Ermen in oaths we have Widukind of Corvey's *History of the Saxons* 1:12 (ca. 968 AD): *quia Hirmin vel Hermis Graece Mars dicitur; quo vocabulo ad laudem vel ad vituperationem usque hodie etiam ignorantes utimur* 'For Hirmin or Hermes is what they call Mars in Greek, a term which we use even to this day, without knowing its meaning, for praise or for blame.' This passage seems to imply that the name of this god persisted into the 10th c. in vulgar expletives or mild oaths, gradually losing its power as knowledge of the pagan religion declined. Yet in the present circumstance it is certainly not used in such a way, but rather with full conviction by the warrior Hildbrand.

30 hevane 'heaven' | A likely Old Saxon form which merits some discussion on the relation between the synonymous words *\*himil* 'heaven' and *\*heban* 'id.' in West Germanic. OE only has *heofon*, OS has both, and OHG only has *bimil*. The distribution of the two forms in OS is not random; *bimil* is the unmarked word whereas *heban* is never used in prose, and is heavily stereotyped in poetry (*Heli* and *SaxGen*), where it is restricted to 3 formulaic expressions, always in the gen. sg., and 5 cpds. Even still, it must have existed in the broader language seeing as it has left descendants in modern Low German dialects.

In any case this word adds further difficulty to the question of providence; if *Hild* were an originally OHG text (cf. l. 47 n.) haphazardly "translated" into OS in a scribal context it seems strange that the translator should have replaced the neutral *bimil* with the rare, stereotyped *hevan*, but on the other hand the presence of *hevan* in the OHG archetype would be a major anomaly since that word is not attested in any known variety of High German ancient or modern.

32 wuntane bauga 'twisted bighs' | A spiral cord of precious metal, in this case probably gold. The association between bighs (metal armlets) and a warrior's honour is well attested; see Index. This encounter is particularly reminiscent of *Hárþ* 42.

33 khëisur-ingu gi-tân 'made of Coser's coin' | Coser (< OE *Cæser*), i.e., Caesar. A cultural memory of the melting down of Roman *solidi* by Germanic mercenaries.

34 Húnjo truhtin 'lord of the Huns' | Almost certainly Atle, although he is not mentioned by name in the poem.

34 ðaŕ ih ðír iŕ nú 'that I now ...' | Grammatically this clause connects to the previous one and is thus part of Hildbrand's oath to Ermen-God; he swears that he is giving the bigh out of goodwill (*bí buldi*), i.e., without any secret motive.

Hadu·brant gi·mahalta · Hilti·brantes sunu:

[K 76v/4–10]

36 „Mit gêru skal man · geba in·fahan  
ort widar orte!

38 Dú bist dir altér Hún · um·meŕ spáhér;  
spënis mih mit díném wortun: · wili mih dínu speru werpan!

40 Pist al·só gi·altét man · só dú êwín in·wit fórtós.

Daŕ sagetun mí · sêo·lídante

42 westar ubar Wëntil·sêo · ðaŕ inan wík fur·nam:  
tôt ist Hilti·brant · Hëri·brantes suno!“

Hathbrand spoke, Hildbrand's son:

“By his spear shall a man win gifts,  
point against point!

Thou art, old Hun, utterly clever;

thou temptest me with thy words—at me wilt thou hurl thy spear!

Indeed, thou hast become an old man by always employing treachery.

This sea-farers said to me,

in the west o'er the Wendle-sea: that war took him away;

dead is Hildbrand, Harbrand's son!"

42 inan | emend.; man K

36 Mit gēru skal man · geba in-fāhan 'By the spear shall man win gifts' | The line comes off as proverbial, although it probably isn't. It is however notable that the same warrior-ethic was codified by the Indians as part of the *ksātra-d'armā*, the honour-code of the Warrior-caste (*ksatriya*), which explicitly forbade them from taking gifts. So in *MB*<sup>h</sup> 12.192.73, a *ksatriya* king refuses a gift from a priest (*brāhmaṇa*) since "it is the duty prescribed for a *ksatriya* that he must fight and protect (people). *Ksatriya* are said to be the givers, then, how can I take (this) from you?" (transl. Hara 1974, see further there).

40 Pist al-sô gi·altēt man · só dú êwin in-wit fôrtôs. 'Indeed, thou hast become an old man by always employing treachery' | Lit. 'thou art indeed an old man since thou always didst employ treachery.' Hathbrand accuses Hildbrand of being an imposter and views his old age as suspect; no brave warrior (it is implied) should be so old, so he must have relied on cunning and cowardly blows instead.

40 in-wit 'treachery' | A hapax in OHG, although the related form *in-witte* is attested in a gloss (EWA, s.v. *inwitti*). The word is cognate with OS *in-wid*, OE *in-wid*, and ON *ĩ-við*- (in *Vkv* 28/4). It has been argued that *in-witti* is in fact the only High German form and that *Hild's in-wit* is a product of Saxon scribal influence (EWA), but it seems unlikely for metrical reasons that the present line should ever have had a trisyllabic form of this word.

41 sêo-lidante 'sea-farers' | An inherited formulaic poetic cpd.; cf. the poetic OE *sê-līðendæ* 'id.' (formulaic b-verse, *Beow* 377b) and its *nd*-stem form *sê-līðend* (*Beow* 411a, 1818a, 2806a) along with the poetic OS *sêo-līðandġan* 'id.' (*Heli* 2909). Semantically identical cpds. with the same second element but other first elements are found in OE and OS, e.g. with *lagu*- 'water' (*Heli* 2918, 2964) and *mēri*- 'ocean' (*Beow* 255). — The pairing with *sagetun* 'said' is formulaic (*Beow* 377b, 411a, 1818a). For the motif of sea-farers as rumour-spreaders cf. particularly *Beow* 377b: *ƿomnē sæġdun ƿet · sê-līðendæ* 'then sea-farers said this'.

42 Węntil-sêo 'Wendle-sea' | The Mediterranean Sea, the name referring to the *Vandali*, who for a time ruled North Africa.

44 Hilti·brant gi-mahalta · Hęri·brantes suno:  
„Wela gi-sihu ih in dínem hrustim  
46 dađ dú habēs hēme · hērron góten,  
dađ dú noh bí desemo ríkhe · rękkhjo ni wurti.

[K 76v/11–13]

Hildbrand spoke, Harbrand's son:  
"Well do I see upon thy armour,  
that thou hast at home a good lord;  
that thou yet in this realm hast not become an exile.

47 rękkhjo 'exile' | An important word for identifying the poem's original dialect. *rękkhjo* (< PWGmc. \**wrakġjo*) originally began with a *w*- (cf. OE *wręcca*, OS *wrękkjo*), but its alliteration with *rikhe* (< PWGmc. \**rikija*, cf. OE *rice*, OS *riki*) proves that this sound had been lost by the time of the poem's composition. Since the *w*- is retained in OS (cf. *Heli* 631, 671) and to this day in Low German, *Hild* must have been composed in the High German dialect area.

48 Welaga nú waltant got,“ (kwad Hilti·brant) „wê-wurt skihit.  
Ih wallóta sumaro ģnti wintro · sehs-tik ur lante  
50 dār man mih eo skęrita · in folk skeoġantero,

[K 76v/13–22]

- só man mir aṭ **burk** ênigeru · **banun** ni gi·fasta.  
 52 Nú skal mih **swásaṭ** khind · **swertu** hauwan  
**bretón** mit sínu **billju** · eddo ih imo ṭi **banin** werdan.  
 54 Doh maht dú nú **aod**-líhho · ibu dir dín **ellen** taok  
 in sús **hêremo** man · **hrusti** gi·winnan  
 56 **rauba** bi·\***rahanen** · ibu dú dár **ênig** reht habés!“

Well now, Wielding God!“ quoth Hildbrand, “The woeful Weird comes to pass.

I roamed for sixty summers and winters away from this land  
 when I always was placed in the troop of shooters,  
 while at no stronghold my bane was fastened.

Now shall my beloved child strike me with his sword,  
 beat me with his blade—or I become his bane.

Yet thou mayst now easily—if thy zeal avails thee—  
 from such a hoary man win the armour,  
 bear away the booty—if thou hast any right thereto!“

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56 bi·\***rahanen** | ‘bihrahanen’ **K**

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48 waltant got ‘Wielding God!’ | Cf. OE *wealdend god*, OS *waldand god*. Apparently a common West Germanic poetic expression.

48 wê-wurt ‘woeful Weird’ | The sense of *wurt* ‘weird’ bears explaining. Rather than the Norse *norn* Weird (*Vsp* 19), its meaning here ought to be understood as ‘inexorable course of events decreed by fate’, although this sense is still tied to the pagan *norn* and ultimately of pre-Christian origin. The same sense underlies OS *wurd(i)* at various points in *Heli* (e.g. l. 4619), OE *wyrd* (e.g. *Beow* 572b, quoted in the note to l. 54 below), and ON *grimmar urðir* ‘grim weirds’ in *Sigsk* 5/4.

49 sumaro çnti wintro · sehs-tik ‘sixty summers and winters’ | Thirty years. Cf. *Beow* 1498, 1769: *bund misséra* ‘a hundred half-years’, i.e., ‘fifty years’. Hathbrand is then thirty years old while Hildbrand is probably in his late forties or fifties.

50 skeoṭantero ‘shooters’ | Probably used in a specifically poetic sense. Cf. *Beow* 702, where the OE cognate *sceōtend* stands for ‘warriors’ in general rather than archers in particular.

53 bretón ‘beat’ | A hapax. TODO: cite (EWA, s.v. *bretón*)

53 billju ‘blade’ | Instr. sg. of *billi*, a hapax in OHG whose exact sense is unclear (EWA, s.v. *billi*). It is cognate with OE *bil* ‘a type of weapon’ which is exclusively used in poetry. The rarity of this word in the old languages suggests that it is probably simply being used as a poetic synonym for ‘sword’ or ‘sharp weapon’, whence the present translation ‘blade’.

54 ibu dir dín ellen taok ‘if thy zeal avails thee’ | Formulaic. Cf. *Beow* 572b–573: *Wyrd oft nerið // un-fégnæ eorl* · þonnæ his ellin déah. ‘Weird often saves the un-fey earl when his zeal avails.’

56 ibu dú dár ênig reht habés! ‘if thou hast any right thereto!’ | The last three lines of Hildbrand’s speech bear a remarkable similarity to *Wald* B/14 ff. From comparison to such passages it is clear these lines must be understood in the cultural context of the flying and taunting speeches of Germanic warriors as a direct provocation, as is most clearly seen in this final half-line. This in turn is what motivates Hathbrand’s hostile answer in ll. 57–61.

„Der sí doh nú **argósto**“ (kwad *Hadu*-brant) „ôstar-liuto  
 der dir nú wíges **warne** · nú dih es só **wel** lustit

[**K** 76v/22–26]

60 gūðja gi·m̃einun; · niuse de mótt̃i  
 bwe\*dar sih *biutu dêro* h̃regilo · hruomen muoſt̃i  
 eddo desero brunnóno · bêdero waltan!“

“Yet he would now,” quoth Hathbrand, “be the cowardliest of easterners whoever should deny thee the fight now that thou hast such desire for a battle between us. Let him try who might, whichever one today of these garments will boast, or both these byrnieſ wield!”

57 *Hadu-brant* | *emend.*; Hilti-brant K 60 *bwe\*dar* | ‘werdar’ K 60 *biutu dêro* | *metr. emend.*; *rev.* K 60 *hruomen* | ‘hrumen’ K 61 *eddo* | ‘erdo’ K

ALL. | That the speaker of ll. 57–61 is in fact Hathbrand, the son, rather than Hildbrand, the father, is suggested by the speaker’s hostile tone (unlike the more resigned, albeit taunting tone of ll. 48–56) and his prejudice against *ôstar-liuto* ‘easterners’, i.e., the Huns, against whom Hathbrand is clearly negatively disposed and to whom he thinks the imposter Hildbrand belongs (cf. l. 38). A switch of speaker is further implied by the finality of Hildbrand’s speech in l. 56b.

On its own, the speech-marker in the caesura of l. 57 (*kwad X* ‘quoth X’) is not proof that we are dealing with a new speaker (cf. l. 48), but it does yield additional support to it considering the high likelihood of corruption due to the formulaic nature of the marker and the numerous proofs of clear inattention on the part of the scribe(s) of the poem as a whole, e.g. the parablepsis in l. 26, the highly inconsistent handling of the name Thedric in ll. 19, 23, 26, and the various unmetrical lines likely resulting from skipped words.

59 niuse de mótt̃i ‘Let him try who might’ | Alliteration appears to fall on the second lift in this b-verse, something generally not allowed in Germanic meter.

60–61 h̃regilo hruomen muoſt̃i ... desero brunnóno bêdero waltan ‘of these garments will boast ... both these byrnieſ wield’ | Like in the *Il*, the winner is expected to strip the slain of his armour.

62 Dó lét̃tun sé ârist · askim skrítan  
 skarpén skúrim · daſ in dem skiltim stónt  
 64 dó stóptun tó·samane · staim-bort chlubun  
 hewun harm-likko · hwiſt̃te skilti  
 66 unti imo iro lintún · lúſt̃ilo wurtun  
 gi·wigan miti wábum · [...]

[K 76v/26–29]

Then they first let their ashen spears glide  
 in sharp showers so that in the shields they stuck.  
 Then they charged at each other, split the painted boards [SHIELDS];  
 they hewed harmfully at the white shields,  
 till before them their linden-planks [SHIELDS] became small,  
 worn down by the weapons, [...]

62 *askim* | ‘askim’ K 64 *clubun* | *chludun* K

63 *skarpén skúrim* ‘in sharp showers’ | Formulaic half-line describing a hail of projectiles, also occurring in *Heli* 5136a.

64 *staim-bort* 'painted boards' | A cpd., transparently segmented as *staim-* + *bort* 'board, plank'. In OE poetry *bord* can also mean 'shield' (e.g. *Beow* 2259, 2524, 2673, in cpds. 1243, 2203, 2559, 2895, 2980), as can OS *bord* (only once: *Heli* 5767) and ON *borð* (e.g. *Þmáhl Máv* 8/2 (in SkP 5)), so that this is probably an inherited poetic sense and certainly the sense here.

The first element is more difficult, but is generally understood to be an assimilated form of *stein* 'stone' (though note that in the ms. the digraph *ai* is only found here, and that the etymological reflex of PGmc. *\*ai* is otherwise spelled '*ei*' or '*ae*'). This has often been interpreted as 'jewel' (an attested sense), so that the sense would be 'bejewelled shield', yet the existence of such shields in the late 8th c. must be considered highly doubtful. On the basis of the ON cognate *steinn*, which in addition to 'stone' can also mean 'mineral colour, paint' (cf. ModEngl. *stain*, e.g. in "stained glass", an ON loan), I propose that the word mean 'paint' in the sense 'painted shield'. Such painted shields are in fact attested in near-contemporary Norse poetry (*Rdr* I, ca. 850 AD), which, although not identical to High German poetry, still belongs to the same Germanic epic tradition.

67 [...] | At this point K 76v ends in the middle of the line. The rest of the poem would have been found on the now-lost following page(s); see Introduction above.



## Poetry on Christian Subjects



# Introduction to Old Saxon Christian Poetry

The forced conversion of the Saxons to Christianity under Charlemagne was a notably violent process, involving 32 years of war from 772 to 804 AD. TODO: historical discussion.

It was only a generation after the Saxon Wars that the two poems edited here—the **Healend** (abbrev. *Heli*) and the **Saxon Genesis** (abbrev. *SaxGen*) were composed under the guidance of the Frankish king. Their political purpose is clear enough: to depict Biblical stories and figures in the language of Germanic epic, and thereby to allow the aristocratic Saxon audience to identify with the but recently imposed religion.

Together *Heli* and *SaxGen* form the totality of the Old Saxon poetic corpus. Both are thoroughly Christian, and although written in the language of traditional epic, surely for a noble audience, they launch a pointed Christian attack on the fatalistic and warlike worldview of Germanic Paganism.

Before the two poems I present the **Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** as an important piece of historical context.



# Old Saxon Baptismal Vow

Dating: ?  
Meter: None

## Introduction

While not an alliterative poem in the slightest, the **Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** is an extremely important historical document. It was under just this vow many an Old Saxon would have gone during his forced baptism in the late 8th century, in many cases directly before his execution. For this reason I have here placed it before the two Old Saxon Biblical epics, in order to give some relevant cultural context.

The format of the short text is straight-forward and resembles the Catholic questions posed to participants during the Sacrament of Confirmation (TODO: reference). The person to be baptised is to respond positively to three denying and three affirming questions. He is to forsake the Devil, all “devil-yields” (pagan rituals), all the Devil’s works and words and his followers, among which the three Old Saxon gods Thunder, Woden, and Saxneot are mentioned by name. He is then to profess belief in each member of the Trinity: God the Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Ghost.

## Text

**P1** „For·sachistu diobole?“

2 et respondeat: „ec for·sacho diabole“

“Forsakest thou the Devil?”

*and he should respond:* “I forsake the Devil.”

**P2** „end allum diobol-gelde?“

2 respondeat: „end ec for·sacho allum diobol-gelde.“

“And all devil-yields?”

*he should respond:* “I forsake all devil-yields.”

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1 diobol-gelde ‘devil-yields’ | An obvious calque of OE *déofol-gield* ‘idolatrous acts of worship’.

**P3** „End allum dioboles wercum?“

2 respondeat „end ec for·sacho allum dioboles wercum and wor-  
dum, Thuner ende Wóden ende Sax-nôte ende allem them un·holdum  
4 the hira ge·nôtas sint.“

“And all the Devil’s works?”

*he should respond:* “and I forsake all the Devil’s works and words, Thunder and Weden and Saxneat and all the unhold ones which are their fellows.”

**P4** „Ge·lôbistu in Got ala-męhtigun fader?“

2 „Ec ge·lôbo in Got ala-męhtigun fader.“

“Believest thou in God, the Almighty Father?”

“I believe in God, the Almighty Father.”

**P5** „Ge·lôbistu in Crist Godes suno?“

2 „Ec ge·lôbo in Crist Gotes suno.“

“Believest thou in Christ, God’s son?”

“I believe in Christ, God’s son.”

**P6** „Ge·lôbistu in hâlogan gâst?“

2 „Ec ge·lôbo in hâlogan gâst.“

“Believest thou in the Holy Ghost?”

“I believe in the Holy Ghost.”

# Healend

## (*Hêljand*)

**Dating:** 830s

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Healend** (abbrev. *Heli*; OS *Hêljand* ‘Healend, Saviour’, cf. OE *Hêlend*, OHG *Heiland*) is an Old Saxon epic poem that narrates the life of Jesus. Although based on the 9th c. OHG translation of Tatian’s 2nd c. gospel harmony, the *Diatessaron*, *Heli* is still an original work in the Saxon branch of the Germanic epic tradition, and betrays a creative spirit not afraid to go into dialogue not just with Christian commentaries but also with earlier, now-lost, pagan poetry. *Heli* is by far the most important source of Old Saxon literature.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Heli* was very popular and is preserved in several mss. The following is a list of all source mss. in chronological order.

| Siglum | Date     | Lines                                                                                    | Full name             |
|--------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| L      | 840–850  | 5823b–5870a                                                                              | Thomas 4073           |
| P      | 840–850  | 958–1006a                                                                                | Berlin DHM R 56/2537  |
| V      | 800–850  | 1279–1358a                                                                               | Palatini Latini 1447  |
| S      | 850      | 351b–360a, 368b–384, 393–400a,<br>492–582a, 675–683a, 693–706,<br>716b–722a              | BSB Cgm 8840          |
| M      | 850–875  | 85–2198a, 2256–2514a,<br>2576–3414a, 3491–3950,<br>4017b–4674, 4740b–5275a,<br>5969–5980 | BSB Cgm 25            |
| C      | 950–1000 | 1–5969                                                                                   | Cotton Caligula A VII |

The two main mss. are **M** and **C**; of these the older **M** is to be preferred, as the orthography of **C** is often influenced by OE and probably the product of an English scribe.

Fragments **L** and **P** are identical in terms of handwriting and page layout and appear to have originally belonged to the same codex.

**V** also attests *SaxGen*, which suggests a close relation between that text and *Heli*.

## Historical context

We have a Latin preface preserved independently of *Heli* itself which can offer some external historical information about the poem. The original manuscript of this short work is now lost, but it was fortunately printed by the Croatian reformer Flacius Illyricus in 1562. It consists of two titled parts.

The first is in prose and entitled *Praefatio ad librum antiquum in lingua Saxonica conscriptum* 'Preface to an ancient book written in the Saxon language'. This short text in turn appears to consist of two separate paragraphs. According to the first, *Heli* was composed at the behest of emperor Ludwig (*Ludowicus Augustus*, probably Ludwig "the Pious" 778–840, son of Charlemagne), who commanded a Saxon man, *qui apud suos non ignobilis vates habebatur* 'who was regarded among his own as a not undistinguished poet' to render the entirety of the Old and New Testaments into Saxon verse. Thus, the poet, *a mundi creatione initium capiens, iuxta historiae veritatem quaeque excellentiora summatim decerpens, interdum quaedam ubi commodum duxit, mystico sensu depingens, ad finem totius Veteris ac Novi Testamenti interpretando more poetico satis faceta eloquentia perduxit*, 'beginning with the creation of the world, and summarizing according to the truth of history the most significant events, at times depicting certain events with a mystical sense where he saw fit, led the interpretation, according to poetic custom and with rather witty eloquence, through to the end of the entire Old and New Testaments;' further, *iuxta morem vero illius poematis omne opus per vitteas distinxit, quas nos lectiones vel sententias possumus appellare* 'according to the manner of that poem, he distinguished every work by *fitts*, which we can call lessons or sentences.'

There is no reason to doubt the general truth of this account, although it is hard to believe that our unnamed poet should have rendered the entirety of the Old and New Testaments, even the prophets and epistles, into alliterative verse. The antiquity of this paragraph of the preface is in any case certified by the use of the Germanic technical word *vitteas* 'fitts', which, as pointed out already by Sievers (1878, p. xxv), could not possibly have been known by a 16th century scholar. The rendering of the Old Testament is probably to be identified with *SaxGen*, while the New Testament is what we have before us in *Heli*.

This first paragraph of the *Praefatio* is then followed by a second, where we hear (in part) that, "they say that this same poet, while he was still entirely ignorant of this art, was warned in a dream to adapt the precepts of



the Sacred Law into song, with a fitting melody in his own language.” (*ferunt eundem Vatem dum adhuc artis huius penitus esset ignarus, in somnis esse admonitum, ut Sacrae Legis praecepta ad cantilenam propriae linguae congrua modulatione coaptaret.*) This narrative is clearly closely related to that which Bede (TODO) tells us about the illiterate Anglo-Saxon poet Cadman (see *Cadman* below); in fact its Latin wording is so close to that of Bede that it must have been plagiarised thence. Finally, the same narrative is then told in Latin verse under the title *Versus de poeta et interprete huius codicis* ‘Verses about the poet and interpreter of this codex’.

Whatever the truth of Cadman’s story, it can scarcely be the case that the poet or poets behind *Heli* and *SaxGen* were ignorant of the poetic art. Both poems are wrought in an intricate style, and their composer must doubtless have been trained in the traditional craft, having first mastered the art of secular (or, very likely, pagan) heroic poetry before he was commissioned to versify the Biblical texts; the first paragraph of the *praefatio* itself tells us as much when it says that he “was regarded among his own as a not undistinguished poet”, and the idea that Emperor Ludwig would have commissioned a man entirely without poetic experience is obviously absurd. This strongly suggests that the second paragraph of the *praefatio* and the *versus* are later interpolations based on the story of Cadman, irrelevant for the context of *Heli* and *SaxGen*.

## Style and content

It was for good reason that the *Heli*-poet was esteemed among his own, for he displays considerable mastery in such “Beowulfian” type scenes as the feast in the great mead-hall (ll. 2005–12, 2736–42), the stormy sea-voyage (2233–68, 2906–65), the host asking for the identity of noble strangers come to his land (551–61)—a mastery which reveals his training in traditional Saxon heroic poetry. In fact, it is precisely in these passages that his poetry is most fluent, for it is here he can make the most use of his inherited stock of oral-formulaic expressions, synonyms, and kennings. When our poet, by contrast, has to deal with exclusively Christian matters he is treading new ground, and it is apparent that his work suffers as a result. This is in part due to the lack of traditional poetic formulae for the concepts of the new religion, and although he invents some (e.g. *allaro barno bēst* ‘best of all babes’ and *frīðu-barn godes* ‘peace-child of God’ for Christ), they quickly end up stale from overuse. A further hindrance is, as will be discussed shortly, his frequent moralising sermons.

Another notable traditional element found throughout the poem is the relationship between Christ and his Disciples, which is consistently described using the vocabulary of the Germanic warband (as found in earlier heroic poetry like *Beow* and *Hild*). In the language of *Heli* the Disciples are brave “thanes” who express their undying loyalty towards their “drihten” Jesus Christ in long heroic speeches, exclaiming their wish to win ever-lasting fame and glory by dying alongside him in the “dance of weapons” (e.g., Thomas at 3994–4002, Simon Peter at 4673–88). In conjunction with this there is an

emphasis on the noble ancestry and high social status of the Disciples (e.g., 4003a) and especially Jesus and his family (e.g., 361b–67a), something which gives us an idea of the intended audience—these were likely members of the Saxon social elite, no mere commoners, and it was important for them that the heroes of the Gospel-story were of similarly high birth.

Still, we should not interpret such traditional elements as evidence for *Heli* reflecting a syncretist Germanic “warrior Christianity”, as more romantic scholars have done. It would not have been possible for the poet to excise utterly the traditional heroic language—after all, he was commissioned to write an alliterative poem, and such elements were built into the very essence of the alliterative genre, being necessary for the poetry to function, not just in the social setting of courtly performance, but metrically, i.e., as poetry, for the alliteration itself was upheld by the existence of a large number of poetic synonyms and formulaic expressions. It was thus within these social and formal constraints that the poet was to relate the New Testament message, and yet that message is ever one of Christian pacifism and humility. The New Testament is not a warlike text, and neither is *Heli*; regardless of the poem’s *aesthetics*, its *ethics* are thoroughly Christian.

As said, although *Heli* generally adheres closely to Germanic poetic tradition in its language, we find important divergences in its contents. The heroic poetic tradition is turned against itself, and the Germanic warrior ideology comes under direct attack by means of its own specialised vocabulary, which is condemned, not just in the speeches of Jesus Christ, but in the poet’s own, sermonising voice. This is perhaps best seen in the episode of the Denial of Peter. At the Last Supper Peter first makes a solemn speech (ll. 4673–88), declaring in formal heroic language that he will not betray Jesus Christ, his lord, but stay with him until the end and give his life in battle; he swears upon his heart (*hugi*) and strength of hand (*hand-kraft*). Jesus first praises Peter’s courage, and says that he indeed has a “thane’s heart” (*þegnes hugi*), but then predicts that he will betray him thrice before cockcrow anyway. Peter does just that, and upon hearing the cock repents by a lamenting speech (ll. 5011–20). The poet himself then delivers a short sermon on the events (5021–49)—if not even Peter, “the best of men” and “most valiant of thanes” could keep his promise without God’s help, what is its worth? Man’s solemn vow (*bi-hēt*, = OE *béot* which is used positively in *Beow*), pride (*bróm*; cf. *Hild* 60), bravery (*mód*), and strength of hand (*hand-kraft*, by which Peter vowed) are all to no avail if God’s grace should fail him due to his lack of faith. Naturally, moral exegesis of this kind is totally foreign to the pagan epic tradition.

In this context it is of value to talk about the language of war; although the New Testament is not a warlike text, the poet takes the opportunity to break out some traditional formulae when he can, e.g. at the arrest of Jesus (ll. 4865–84). Still, he is generally very restrained, and tries hard to avoid the active *celebration* of war, probably because of its association with the warlike pre-Christian cult of Woden and his Walkirries and Oneharriers. Where warlike sentiments are expressed by the Disciples (e.g. at the arrest, or in Peter’s vow at the Last Supper; see above) they are swiftly reproached by Jesus and

ultimately proven flawed and misguided. Traditional motifs like the greedy beasts of battle are entirely expunged, and the old feminine poetic synonyms \**gūðja* and *bildi*, found in *Hild* and commonplace in Norse and English poetry, have not fared much better. \**gūðja*, found in early OS female names and the non-*Heli* compound *gūþ-fāno* ‘field standard’, is entirely absent, and *bildi* is only used twice (ll. 68, 5043)—in both cases disparagingly. In their stead we find neuter-gender synonyms like *strid*, *ur-lagi*, *wig*, and *gi-winn*. It is probably significant that *Gunnr* and *Hildr* are known as walkirries in the Norse tradition, and in the 9th century were still actively worshipped in pagan Denmark, just to the north of Saxony.

I mentioned above how the depiction of the Disciples in their relationship as servants of Christ makes use of the language of the Germanic war-band, and that is the case when it comes to singular words, but although the Disciples are described as loyal thanes (*begnos*), heroes (*heliðos*, cf. *Hild* 6), and earls (*erlos*)—words perfectly fit for a Germanic war-band in a poem like *Beow*—they are not a war-band and are never described by explicitly war-like terms like *bildi-skalkos* ‘war-servants’, *wēpan-berandos* ‘weapon-bearers’, or *helm-berandos* ‘helmet-bearers’. Those terms—which in *Beow* or Norse poetry could describe any group of warriors, including the protagonists—are instead given a derogatory sense, and for the most part refer only to the wicked Jews under their kings (68b, 765b, 2779b, 4810a).

There are, of course, other ways in which *Heli* departs from Germanic heroic tradition. One that deserves mention is the treatment of hostile fate, which often plays a key role in driving the narrative in the old pagan legends (e.g. in *Hild* or the Walsing Cycle). Although *Heli* refers to fated events by what are almost certainly originally pagan expressions like *regano gi-skapu* ‘Shapes of the Reins’ and *wurdi-gi-skapu* ‘Shapes of Weird’, fated events can also be called *godes gi-skapu* ‘God’s Shapes’, for in the Christian worldview it is God that wields the destinies of Men—not the ambivalent Norns.

## Meter

*Heli* is composed throughout in a single meter, an innovative form of the Common Germanic alliterative long-line. The meter is stichic and displays no stanzaic tendencies; on the other hand, enjambment is frequent.

Although the meter is the same throughout, verses in *Heli* come in two types: normal, and hypermetric. This distribution is paralleled by Old English verse and suggests that it is a common West Germanic poetic feature. Like in Old English verse (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. clx), hypermetrics in *Heli* typically occur in especially meaningful or dignified places of dialogue or narrative, e.g., the Beatitudes at the Sermon on the Mount (ll. 1300–1325a). Hypermetrics generally come in groups, although lone examples occur occasionally.

## Orthography

Notes on the normalization:

- Long vowels are marked by the acute rather than by the circumflex accent or macron. This is both faithful to the original manuscripts and concordant with my practice in normalising other Germanic languages.
- The long vowels *ê* and *ô* (resulting from monophthongisation of the diphthongs *ei* and *au*) are, however, written with the circumflex accent. That these were in fact articulated separately is seen by the following circumstance: in the mss. the old monophthongs *é* and *ó* are frequently written as *ie* and *uo*, but this is never done for *ê* and *ô*.
- If attested in all mss., epenthetic (*svara-b<sup>h</sup>akti*) vowels are marked with an underdot. Otherwise they are deleted.
- Unstressed *a*-vowels reduced to *e* in C are reverted back to *a*.
- Long vowels resulting from nasal assimilation are marked with an overdot. *i* is written as *ĩ*.
- ms. *e* and *i*, when occurring between vowels are written as *j*.
- ms. *i*, when word-initial or following *g* and corresponding to etymological *j* is written as *j*.
- ms. *e* as resulting from *i*-mutation is written as *ē*.
- ms. *b*, or *ḃ*, when representing the voiced bilabial fricative, is written as *ḃ*.
- ms. *th* is written as *þ*.
- ms. *uu* is written as *w*.

## NOTE!

The following edition is very much a work in progress. The radically normalized orthography has been implemented, as has the marking of alliteration, but the original text has not been thoroughly critically edited, nor has the English translation been added.

## Text

- 1 Manega wáron, · þe sia iro mód ge·spón,  
 2 þat sia bi·gunnun word godes,  
 3 rëkkjan þat gi·rúni, · þat þie ríkjo Krist  
 4 undar man·kunnja · máriða gi·frumida  
 5 mid wordun ęndi mid werkun. · Þat wolda þó wísara filo  
 6 liudo barno lobon, · lêra Kristes,  
 7 hêlag word godas, · ęndi mid iro handon skríban  
 8 beręht·líko an buok, · hwó sia is gi·bod·skip skoldin  
 9 frummjan, firiho barn. · Þan wárun þoh sia fiori te þiu  
 10 under þera męnigo, · þia habdon maht godes,  
 11 helpa fan himila, · hêlagna gęst,  
 12 kraft fan Kriste; · sia wurðun gi·korana te þio,  
 13 þat sie þan Éwangelium · ęnan skoldun  
 14 an buok skríban · endo só manag gi·bod godes,  
 15 hêlag himilisk word: · sia ne muosta hêliðo þan mēr,  
 16 firiho barno frummjan, · newan þat sia fiori te þio  
 17 þuru kraft godas · ge·korana wurðun,  
 18 Matheus ęndi Markus, · —só wárun þia man hêtana—  
 19 Lukas ęndi Johannes; · sia wárun gode lieba,  
 20 wirðiga ti þem gi·wirkje. · Habda im waldand god,  
 21 þem hêliðon an iro hertan · hêlagna gęst  
 22 fasto bi·folhan · ęndi ferąhtan hugi,  
 23 só manag wís·lík word · ęndi gi·wit mikil,  
 24 þat sea skoldin a·hëbbjan · hêlagaro stemnun  
 25 god·spell þat guoda, · þat ni habit ęnigan gi·gadon hwęgin,  
 26 þiu word an þesaro wer·oldi, · þat io waldand mēr,  
 27 drohtin diurje · efþo derbi þing,  
 28 firin·werk fëllje · efþo fiundo níð,  
 29 stríd wiðer·stande—, · hwand hie habda starkan hugi,  
 30 mildjan ęndi guodan, · þie þe mēster was,  
 31 aðal·ord·frumo · alo·mahtig.  
 32 Þat skoldun sea fiori · þuo fingron skríban,  
 33 settjan ęndi singan · ęndi seggjan forð,  
 34 þat sea fan Kristes · krafte þem mikilon  
 35 gi·sáhun ęndi gi·hōrdun, · þes hie selbo gi·sprak,  
 36 gi·wísda ęndi gi·warąhta, · wundar·líkas filo,  
 só manag mid mannon · mahtig drohtin,

38 all so hie it fan þem an-ginne · þuru is ênes kraht,  
 waldand gi-sprak, · þuo hie êrist þesa wer-old gi-skuop  
 40  ndi þuo all bi-fieng · mid  nu wordo,  
 himil  ndi er a ·  ndi al þat sea bi-hlidan  gun  
 42 gi-warahtes  ndi gi-wahsanes: · þat war  þuo all mid wordon  
 godas  
 fasto bi-fangan, ·  ndi gi-frumid after þiu,  
 44 hwi-l k þan liud-skepi · landes skoldi  
 w dost gi-waldan, · ef o hw r þiu wer-old-aldar  
 46  ndon skoldin. ·  n was iro þuo noh þan  
 firiho barnun bi-foran, ·  ndi þiu f bi w run a-gangan:  
 48 skolda þuo þat sehsta · s lig-l ko  
 kuman þuru kraft godes ·  ndi Kristas gi-burd,  
 50 h landero b stan, · h lagas g stes,  
 an þesan middil-gard · managon te helpun,  
 52 firjo barnon ti frumon · wi  f undo ni ,  
 wi  d rnero dwalm. · Ðan habda þuo drohtin god  
 54 R mano-liudjon far-liwan · r kjo m sta,  
 habda þem h ri-skipje · herta gi-st rkid,  
 56 þat sia habdon bi- wungana ·  iedo gi-hwi-l ka,  
 habdun fan R mu-burg · r ki gi-wunnan  
 58 helm-gi-tr stjon, · s ton iro h ri-togon  
 an lando gi-hwem, · habdun liudjo gi-wald,  
 60 allon  li- eodon. · Erodes was  
 an Jerusalem · ober þat Judeono folk  
 62 gi-koran te kuninge, · s  ina þie k ser þarod,  
 fon R mu-burg · r ki  iodan  
 64 satta undar þat gi-s  i. · Hie ni was þoh mid sibbjon bi-lang  
 a aron Israheles, ·   ili-gi-burdi,  
 66 kuman fon iro knuosle, · newan þat hie þuru þes k sures þank  
 fan R mu-burg · r ki habda,  
 68 þat im w run s  gi-h riga · hildi-skalkos,  
 a aron Israheles ·  lljan-ruoba:  
 70 sw  o un-wanda wini, · þan lang hie gi-wald  hta,  
 Er des þes r kjas ·  ndi r d-burdjon held  
 72 Judeo liudi. · Ðan was þ r  n gi-gamalod mann,  
 þat was fruod gomo, · habda fer tan hugi,  
 74 was fan þem liudjon · Lewias kunnes,  
 Jakobas sunjas, · guodero  iedo:

76 Zakharias was hie hētan. · Þat was só sálig man,  
 hwand hie simblon gerno · gode þeonoda,  
 78 warahta after is willjon; · deda is wif só self  
 —was iru gi·aldrod idis: · ni muosta im ƿrbi·ward  
 80 an iro juguð·hêdi · gîbiðig werðan—  
 libdun im far·úter laster, · waruhtun lof goda,  
 82 wárun só gi·hōriga · heban-kuninge,  
 diuridon úsan drohtin: · ni weldun dƿrbjas wiht  
 84 under man-kunnje, · mēnes gi·frummjan,  
 ne saka ne sundja; · was im þoh an sorgun hugi,  
 86 þat sie ƿrbi·ward · êgan ni móstun,  
 ak wárun im barno-lôs. · Þan skolda hé gi·bod godes  
 88 þár an Jerusalem, · só oft só is gi·gengi gi·stód,  
 þat ina torht·liko · tídi gi·manodun,  
 90 só skolda hé at þem wíha · waldandes geld  
 hêlag bi·hwerban, · heban-kuninges,  
 92 godes jungar-skēpi: · gern was hé swíðo,  
 þat hé it þurh ferhtan hugi · frummjan mósti.

TODO.

85 saka | *With this word M begins. Above it seven lines have been erased.*

3 rēkkjan | The use of this verb is reminiscent to its use in *Beow* 89b–91, introducing a shop's (narrating poet's) song about the creation of the Earth from a Christian perspective: *þér was bærrpan swóg, / switwl sang scopas. · Sægdæ sé þi cūðæ / frum-scaeft firbá · fērran rēccian* 'There there was the air of the harp, the clear song of the shop. He who knew told of the early days of men, narrated from afar.'

41 himil ƿndi erða · ƿndi al þat sea bi·hlidan êgun | A cosmological expression, reappearing almost identically in 1425 below.

45 wer-old-aldar | The six ages of the world was a common concept in mediæval Christianity, being popularized by Augustine of Hippo around 400 AD. It is not found in Tatian, and so Augustine or a text derived from his writing must have been a source for *Heli*.

47–48 fiþi ... sehsta 'five ... sixth' | The five ages lasted (1) from Creation to the Flood, (2) from then to Abraham, (3) from him to David, (4) from him to the Babylonian Exile, (5) from then until the birth of Christ, which inaugurated the sixth age.

71 Eródes | The name *Erodes* can alliterate either with a vowel (following the Germanic root stress pattern: / x x) or with the consonant *r* (following the Latin penultimate stress: x / x). Out of 17 total appearances of the name in *Heli*, 12 alliterate with a vowel; 4 with *r*; and 1 has no alliteration.

94 2 Þó warð þiu tíð kuman, · —þat þár gi·tald habdun  
 wisa man mid wordun,— · þat skolda þana wíh godes  
 96 Zakharias bi·sehan. · Þó warð þár gi·samnod filu  
 þár te Jerusalem · Judeo liudi,  
 98 werodes te þem wíha, · þár sie waldand god

- swíðo þeo-líko · þiggjan skoldun,  
 100 hêrron is huldi, · þat sie heban-kuning  
 lêðes a-léti. · Þea liudi stóðun  
 102 umbi þat hêlaga hús, · ėndi géng im þe gi·hêrodo man  
 an þana wih innan. · Þat werod oðar béd  
 104 umbi þana alah útan, · Ebreo liudi,  
 hwan êr þe fródo man · gi·frumid habdi  
 106 waldandes willjon. · Só hé þó þana wi-rôk dróg,  
 ald aftar þem alaha, · ėndi umbi þana altari géng  
 108 mid is rôk-fatun · ríkjun þionon,  
 —frēmida ferht-líko · frâon sines,  
 110 godes jungar-skēpi · gerno swíðo  
 mid hluttru hugi, · \*só man hêrren skal  
 112 gerno ful-gangan—, · grurjos kwámun im,  
 ėgison an þem alāhe: · hie gi·sah þár aftar þiu ėnna ėngil  
 godes  
 114 an þem wihe innan, · hie sprak im mid is wordun tuo,  
 hiet þat fruod gumo · forøht ni wári,  
 116 hiet þat hie im ni an·driede: · „þína dádi sind“, kwaþ-hie\*,  
 „waldanda werðe · ėndi þín word só self,  
 118 þín þionost is im an þanke, · þat þú su-líka gi·þáht habes  
 an is ėnes kraft. · Ik is ėngil bium,  
 120 Gabriel bium ik hêtan, · þe gio for goda standu,  
 and-ward for þem alo-waldon, · ne sí þat hé mé an is ârundi  
 hwárod  
 122 sėndjan willja. · Nú hiet hé mé an þesan sġð faran,  
 hiet þat ik þi þoh gi·küðdi, · þat þi kind gi·boran,  
 124 fon þínera alderu idis · ôðan skoldi  
 werðan an þesero wer-oldi, · wordun spáhi.  
 126 Þat ni skal an is líba gio · líðes an·bitan,  
 wínes an is wer-oldi: · só hæbed im wurd-gi·skapu,  
 128 metod gi·markod · ėndi maht godes.  
 Hét þat ik þi þoh sagdi, · þat it skoldi gi·sið wesan  
 130 heban-kuninges, · hét þat git it heldin wel,  
 tuhin þurh treuwa, · kwað þat hé im tírás só filu  
 132 an godes ríkja · for·geban weldi.  
 Hé kwað þat þe gódo gumo · Johannes te namon  
 134 hėbbjan skoldi, · gi·bôð þat git it hétin só,  
 þat kind, þan it kwámi, · kwað þat it Krístes gi·sið



136 an þesaro wíðun wer-old · werðan skoldi,  
 is selbes sunjes, · ɛndi kwað þat sie sliumo herod  
 138 an is bod-skępi · bēðe kwámin.“  
 Zakharias þó gi-mahalda · ɛndi wið selban sprak  
 140 drohtines ɛngil, · ɛndi im þero dádjo bi-gan,  
 wundron þero wordo: · „hwó mag þat gi-werðan só“, kwað hé,  
 142 „aftar an aldre? · it is unk al te lat  
 só te gi-winnanne, · só þú mid þínun wordun gi-spríkis.  
 144 Hwanda wit habdun aldres · êr efno twên-tig  
 wintro an unkro wer-oldi, · êr þan kwámi þit wíf te mí;  
 146 þan wárun wit nú at-samna · ant-sibunta wintro  
 gi-benkjon ɛndi gi-beddjon, · sīðor ik sie mí te brúdi ge-kôs.  
 148 Só wit þes an unkro juguði · gi-girnan ni mohtun,  
 þat wit ɛrbi-ward · égan móstin,  
 150 fódjan an unkun flettja, · nú wit sus gi-fródod sint  
 —habad unk ɛldi bi-noman · ɛlljan-dádi,  
 152 þat wit sint an unkro siuni gi-slekit · ɛndi an unkun sídun lat;  
 flêsk is unk ant-fallan, · fel un-skôni,  
 154 is unka lud gi-liðen, · lík gi-drusnod,  
 sind unka and-bári · ôðar-líkaron,  
 156 mód ɛndi megin-kraft—, · só wit giu só managan dag  
 wárun an þesero wer-oldi, · só mí þes wundar þunkit,  
 158 hwó it só gi-werðan mugi, · só þú mid þínun wordun  
 gi-spríkis.

### TODO.

116 an·driede | The original segmenting of *an-drádan* is *and-* + *rádan*, but already by the time of *Heli* it had clearly been reanalyzed as *an(t)-drádan*, as seen by the alliteration in the present line and by the variant spelling *antdrádan* seen throughout the poem. Cf. English *dread*, from OE *drédan*, earlier *on-drédan*.

3 Þó warð þat heban-kuninges bodon · harm an is móde,  
 160 þat hé is gi-werkes · só wundron skolda  
 ɛndi þat ni welda gi-huggjan, · þat ina mahta hêlag god  
 162 só ala-jungan, · só hé fon êrist was,  
 selbo gi-wirkjan, · of hé só weldi.  
 164 Skęrida im þó te wítja, · þat hé ni mahte ênig word sprekan,  
 gi-mahljen mid is müðu, · „êr þan þi magu wirðid,  
 166 fon þínero aldero idis · erl a-fódit,  
 kind-jung gi-boran · kunnjes gódes,  
 168 wánum te þesero wer-oldi. · Þan skalt þú eft word sprekan,

hebbjan þínaro stemna gi-wald; · ni þarft þú stum wesan  
 170 leŋgron hwíla.“ · Þó warð it sán gi-lêstid só,  
 gi-worðan te wáron, · só þár an þem wíha gi-sprak  
 172 ęngil þes alo-waldon: · warð ald gumo  
 spráka bi-lôsit, · þoh hé spáhan hugi  
 174 bári an is breostun. · Bidun allan dag  
 þat werod for þem wíha · ęndi wundrodun alla,  
 176 bi-hwí hé þár só lango, · lof-sálig man,  
 swíðo fród gumo · fráon sínun  
 178 þionon þorfti, · só þár êr ênig þegno ni deda,  
 þan sie þár at þem wíha · waldandes geld  
 180 folmon frumidun. · Þó kwam fród gumo  
 út fon þem alaha. · Erlos þrungun  
 182 náhor mikilu: · was im niud mikil,  
 hwat hé im sôð-likes · sęggjan weldi,  
 184 wísjan te wáron. · Hé ni mohta þó ênig word sprekan,  
 gi-sęggjan þem gi-sǫja, · b-útan þat hé mid is swíðron hand  
 186 wísda þem weroda, · þat sie ęses waldandes  
 lêra lêstin. · Þea liudi for-stóðun,  
 188 þat hé þár habda gegnungo · god-kundes hwat  
 for-sehen selbo, · þoh hé is ni mahti gi-sęggjan wiht,  
 190 gi-wísjan te wáron. · Þó habda hé ęses waldandes  
 geld gi-lêstid, · al só is gi-gęngi was  
 192 gi-markod mid mannun. · Þó warð sán aftar þiu maht godes,  
 gi-küðid is kraft mikil: · warð þiu kwán ôkan,  
 194 idis an ira ęldju: · skolda im ęrbi-ward,  
 swíðo god-kund gumo · gíbiðig werðan,  
 196 barn an burgun. · Bêd aftar þiu  
 þat wíf wurdi-gi-skapu. · Skrêd þe wintar forð,  
 198 géng þes gęres gi-tal. · Johannes kwam  
 an liudjo lioht: · lík was im skôni,  
 200 was im fel fagar, · fahs ęndi naglos,  
 wangun wárun im wlitige. · Þó fórun þár wíse man,  
 202 snelle te-samne, · þea swásostun mêst,  
 wundrodun þes werkes, · bi-hwí it gio mahti gi-werðan só,  
 204 þat undar só aldun twêm · ôðan wurði  
 barn an gi-burdjon, · ni wári þat it gi-bod godes  
 206 selbes wári: · af-suobun sie garo,  
 þat it ęlkor só wán-lík · werðan ni mahti.

208 Þó sprak þár ên gi·fródot man, · þe só filo konsta  
 wísaro wordo, · habde gi·wit mikil,  
 210 frágode niud·liko, · hwat is namo skoldi  
 wesan an þesaro wer·oldi: · „mí þunkid an is wísu gi·lík  
 212 iak an is gi·bárja, · þat hé sí bætara þan wi,  
 só ik wániu, þat ina ús gegnungo · god fon himila  
 214 selbo sęndi“. · Þó sprak sán aftar  
 þiu módar þes kindes, · þiu þana magu habda,  
 216 þat barn an ire barme: · „hér kwam gi·bod godes“, kwað siu,  
 „fernun gęre, · furmon wordu  
 218 gi·bôd, þat hé Johannes · bi godes lêrun  
 hêtan skoldi. · Þat ik an mínumu hugi ni gi·dar  
 220 węndjan mid wihti, · of ik is gi·waldan mót“.  
 Þó sprak ên gël·hert man, · þe ira gaduling was:  
 222 „ne hét êr io·wiht só“, (kwað hé,) „aðal·boranes  
 úses kunnjes efþo knósles; · wita kiasan im öðrana  
 224 niud·samna namon: · hé niate of hé móti“.  
 Þó sprak eft þe fródo man, · þe þár konsta filo mahljan:  
 226 „ni gibu ik þat te ráde“, (kwað hé,) „rinko neg·ênun,  
 þat hé word godes · węndjan bi·ginna;  
 228 ak wita is þana fader frágon, · þe þár só gi·fródod sitit,  
 wís an is wín·sęli: · þoh hé ni mugi ênig word sprekan,  
 230 þoh mag hé bi bók·stabon · bréf ge·wirkjan,  
 namon gi·skríban“. · Þó hé náhor gęng,  
 232 lęgda im êna bók an barm · ęndi bad gerno  
 wrítan wís·líko · word·gi·merkjun,  
 234 hwat sie þat hêlaga barn · hêtan skoldin.  
 Þó nam hé þia bók an hand · ęndi an is hugi þahte  
 236 swiðo gerno te gode: · Johannes namon  
 wís·líko gi·wrêt · ęndi ôk aftar mid is wordu gi·sprak  
 238 swiðo spáh·líko: · habda im eft is spráka gi·wald,  
 gi·wittjas ęndi wísun. · Þat wíti was þó a·gangan,  
 240 hard harm·skare, · þe im hêlag god  
 mahtig makode, · þat hé an is mód·seþon  
 242 godes ni for·gáti, · þan hé im eft sęndi is jungron tó.

TODO.

4 Þó ni was lang aftar þiu, · ne it al só gi·lêstid warð,  
 244 só hé man·kunnja · managa hwíla,

god alo-mahtig · for·geben habda,  
 246 þat hé is himilisk barn · herod te wer-oldi,  
 sí selbes sunu · sęndjan weldi,  
 248 te þiu þat hé hér a·lōsdi · al liud-stamna,  
 werod fon wítja. · Þó warð is wis-bodo  
 250 an Galilea-land, · Gabriel kuman,  
 ęngil þes alo-waldon, · þár hé ęne idis wisse,  
 252 muni-líka magað: · María was siu hēten,  
 was iru þiorna gi·þigan. · Sea ęn þegan habda,  
 254 Joseph gi·mahlit, · gódes kunnjes man,  
 þea Dawides dohter: · þat was só diur-lík wíf,  
 256 idis ant-hēti. · Þár sie þe ęngil godes  
 an Nazareth-burg · bi namon selbo  
 258 grótte gęgin-warde · ęndi sie fon gode kwędda:  
 „Hêl wis þú, Maria“, (kwað hé,) „þú bist þínun hêrron liof,  
 260 waldande wirðig, · hwand þú gi·wit habes,  
 idis ęnstjo fol. · Þú skalt for allun wesan  
 262 wíþun gi·wíhit. · Ne habe þú wêkan hugi,  
 ne forhti þú þínun ferhe: · ne kwam ik þi te ęnigun frêson  
 herod,  
 264 ne dragu ik ęnig drugi-þing. · Þú skalt ęses drohtines wesan  
 módar mid mannun · ęndi skalt þana magu fódjan,  
 266 þes hōhon heban-kuninges suno. · Þe skal Hêljand te namon  
 ęgan mid ęldjun. · Neo ęndi ni kumid,  
 268 þes wídon ríkjas gi·wand, · þe hé gi·waldan skal,  
 mári þeodan.“ · Þó sprak im eft þiu magað an·gęgin,  
 270 wið þana ęngil godes · idiso skōnjost,  
 allaro wíþo wílitigost: · „hwó mag þat gi·werðen só“, kwað siu,  
 272 „þat ik magu fódje? · Ne ik gio mannes ni warð  
 wís an mínara wer-oldi.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu  
 274 ęngil þes alo-waldon · þero idisiu te·gegnēs:  
 „an þi skal hêlag gēst · fon heban-wange  
 276 kuman þurh kraft godes. · Þanan skal þi kind ôdan  
 werðan an þesaro wer-oldi; · waldandes kraft  
 278 skal þi fon þem hōhoston · heban-kuninge  
 skadowan mid skimon. · Ni warð skōnjera gi·burd,  
 280 ne só mári mid mannun, · hwand siu kumid þurh maht godes  
 an þese wídon wer-old.“ · Þó warð eft þes wíþes hugi  
 282 aftar þem ârundje · al gi·hworþen

an godes willjon. · „Þan ik hér garu standu“, kwað siu,  
 284 „te su-líkun ambaht-skêpi, · só hé mí êgan wili.  
 Þiu bium ik þeot-godes. · Nú ik þeses þinges gi-trúon;  
 286 werðe mí aftar þínun wordun, · al só is willjo sí,  
 hêrron mines; · nis mí hugi twíffi,  
 288 ne word ne wísa.“ · Só gi-fragn ik, þat þat wíf ant-féng  
 þat godes ârundi · gerno swíðo  
 290 mid leohtu hugi · êndi mid gi-lôbon góðun  
 êndi mid hluttrun treuwun; · warð þe hêlago gêst,  
 292 þat barn an ira bósma; · êndi siu ira breostun for-stód  
 iak an ire sebon selbo, · sagða þem siu welda,  
 294 þat sie habde gi-ôkana · þes alo-waldon kraft  
 hêlag fon himile. · Þó warð hugi Josepes,  
 296 is mód gi-worrid, · þe im êr þea magað habða,  
 þea idis ant-hêttja, · aðal-knósles wíf  
 298 gi-boht im te brúðju. · Hé af-sóf þat siu habða barn undar iru:  
 ni wánda þes mid wihti, · þat iru þat wíf habði  
 300 gi-wardod só waro-líko: · ni wisse waldandes þó noh  
 blíði gi-bod-skêpi. · Ni welda sia imo te brúði þó,  
 302 halon imo te híwon, · ak bi-gan im þó an hugi þenkjan,  
 hwó hé sie só for-léti, · só iru þár nú wurði lêdes wiht,  
 304 ôðan arbides. · Ni welda sie aftar þiu  
 meldon for mēnigi: · ant-dréd þat sie manno barn  
 306 líbu bi-námin. · Só was þan þero liudjo þau  
 þurh þen aldon êw, · Ebreo folkes,  
 308 só hwi-lik só þár an un-reht · idis gi-híwida,  
 þat siu simbla þana bed-skêpi · buggjan skolda,  
 310 frí mid ira ferhu: · ni was gio þiu fēmja só gód,  
 þat siu mid þem liudun lēng · libbjen mósti,  
 312 wesun undar þem weroda. · Bi-gan im þe wíso mann,  
 swíðo gód gumo, · Joseph an is móða  
 314 þenkjan þero þingo, · hwó hé þea þiornun þó  
 listjun for-léti. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,  
 316 þat im þár an drôma · kwam drohtines engil,  
 hēban-kuninges bodo, · êndi hét sie ina haldan wel,  
 318 minnjon sie an is móde: · „Ni wis þú“, kwað hé, „Mariun  
 wrêð,  
 þiornun þínaro; · siu is gi-þungan wíf;  
 320 ne for-hugi þú sie te hardo; · þú skalt sie haldan wel,

wardon ira an þesaro wer-oldi. · Lêsti þú inka wini-treuwa  
 322 forð só þú dádi, · ęndi hald inkan friund-skepi wel!  
 Ne lát þú sie þi þiu lêðaron, · þoh siu undar ira liðon ęgi,  
 324 barn an ira bósma. · It kumid þurh gi·bod godes,  
 hêlages gêstes · fon heban-wanga:  
 326 þat is Jêsu Krist, · godes ęgan barn,  
 waldandes sunu. · Þú skalt sie wel haldan,  
 328 hêlag-liko. · Ne lát þú þi þinan hugi twiſſjen,  
 męrrjan þina mód-gi·þáht.“ · Þó warð eft þes mannes hugi  
 330 gi·węndid aftar þem wordun, · þat hé im te þem wíba ge·nam,  
 te þera magað minnja: · ant·kęnda maht godes,  
 332 waldandes gi·bod; · was im willjo mikil,  
 þat hé sia só hêlag-liko · haldan mósti:  
 334 bi·sorgoda sie an is gi·sîðja, · ęndi siu só súbro dróg  
 al te huldi godes · hêlagna gêst,  
 336 gód-likan gumon, · ant·þat sie godes gi·skapu  
 mahtig gi·manodun, · þat siu ina an manno lioht,  
 338 allaro barno bętst, · bręngjan skolda.

TODO.

266 heban-kuniges | so *M*; himilcuniges *C*

266 Hêljand te namon | The first appearance of the word which has given the whole poem its scholarly name; this is one of two places (cf. l. 443) where it is treated as a true proper noun, for which reason it is capitalized. Its presence is an undeniable sign of influence from an earlier work, the OHG Tatian, which in the corresponding passage (3:4, TODO: cite translated the Latin *concipies in utero et paries filium et vocabis nomen eius Ihesum* 'thou wilt conceive in your womb and bear a son, and thou wilt call his name Jesus' as OHG *nu in·fabis in reue inti gi·biris sun inti gi·nemnis sinan namon Heilant*. '... and thou wilt call his name Healend.' This is an important point for determining the sources of *Heli* since it shows that the poet did not rely directly on the Latin version, but rather on the OHG translation.

336 godes gi·skapu 'God's shapes' | TODO: some note about this.

338 allaro barno bętst | A formula used throughout the poem. It may have inspired the later Otfrid, who in *Evangelienbuch* 1.13.10 calls Christ *barno beziſta*.

5 Þó warð fon Rúmu-burg · rikes mannes  
 340 obar alla þesa irmin-þiod · Oktawiánas  
 ban ęndi bod-skepi · obar þea is brêdon gi·wald  
 342 kuman fon þem kêsure · kuningo gi·hwi-likun,  
 hêm-sittjandjun, · só wído só is hęri-togon  
 344 obar al þat land-skepi · liudjo gi·weldun.  
 Hiet man þat alla þea ęli-lęndjun man · iro óðil sóhtin,  
 346 hęliðos iro hand-mahǫl · an·gegin iro hêrron bodon,

348 kwámi te þem knósla gi·hwe, · þanan hé kunnjas was,  
 gi·boran fon þem burgjun. · Þat gi·bod warð gi·lêstid  
 350 oðar þesa wídon wer-old; · werod samnoda  
 te allaro burgjo gi·hwem. · Fórun þea bodon oðar all,  
 352 þea fon þem kêsura · kumana wárun,  
 bók-spáha weros, · ɛndi an bréf skribun  
 354 swíðo niud-liko · namono gi·hwi-likan,  
 ia land ia liudi, · þat im ni mahti a·lêttjan mann  
 gumono su-liká gamba, · só im skolda geldan gi·hwe  
 356 hêliðo fon is hôbda. · Þó gi·wêt im ôk mid is híwiska  
 Joseph þe gódo, · só it god mahtig,  
 358 waldand welda: · sóhta im þiu wánamon hêm,  
 þea burg an Bethlehem, · þár iro bæiðero was,  
 360 þes hêliðes hand-mahā\* · ɛndi ôk þera hêlagun þiornun,  
 Mariun þera gódun. · Þár was þes márjon stól  
 362 an êr-dagun, · aðal-kuninges,  
 Dawides þes gódon, · þan langa þe hé þana druht-skêpi þár,  
 364 erl undar Ebreon · êgan mósta,  
 haldan hôh-gi-setu. · Sie wárun is híwiskas,  
 366 kuman fon is knósla, · kunnjas gódes,  
 bêðju bi gi·burdjun. · Þár gi·fragn ik, þat sie þiu berhtun  
 gi·skapu,  
 368 Mariun gi·manodun · \*ɛndi maht godes,  
 þat iru an þem sīða · sunu ôðan warð,  
 370 gi·boran an Bethlehem · barno strangost,  
 allaro kuningo krafftigost: · kuman warð þe márjo,  
 372 mahtig an manno liht, · só is êr managan dag  
 biliði wárun · ɛndi bôkno filu  
 374 gi·worðen an þesero wer-oldi. · Þó was it all gi·wárod só,  
 só it êr spáha man · gi·sprokan habdun,  
 376 þurh hwi-lik ôð-módi · hé þit erð-ríki herod  
 þurh is selbes kraft · sókjan welda,  
 378 managaro mund-boro. · Þó ina þiu móðar nam,  
 bi·wand ina mid wádju · wíbo skônjost,  
 380 fagaron fratahun, · ɛndi ina mid iro folmon twê  
 lēgda liob-liko · lutilna man,  
 382 þat kind an êna kribbjun, · þoh hé habdi kraft godes,  
 manno drohtin. · Þár sat þiu móðar bi·foran,  
 384 wíf wakojandi, · war\*doda selbo,

held þat hêlaga barn: · ni was ira hugi twíflī,  
 386 þera magað ira mód-sebo. · Þó warð þat managun küð  
 oþar þesa wídon wer-old, · wardos ant-fundun,  
 388 þea þár ehu-skalkos · úta wárun,  
 weros an wahtu, · wiggjo gômjan,  
 390 fehas aftar fel\*da: · gi·sáhun finistri an twê  
 te·látan an lufte, · ęndi kwam lioht godes  
 392 wánum þurh þiu wolkan · ęndi þea wardos þár  
 bi·fēng an þem felda. · Sie wurðun an forhtun þó,  
 394 þea man an ira móda: · gi·sáhun þár mahtigna  
 godes ęngil kuman, · þe im te·gęgnes sprak,  
 396 hét þat im þea wardos · wiht ne ant·drédin  
 lêðes fon þem liohta: · „ik skal eu“, kwað hé, „liobara þing,  
 398 swíðo wár·liko · willjon sęggjan,  
 küðjan kraft mikil: · nú is Krist ge·boran  
 400 an þeser\*o selbun naht, · sálig barn godes,  
 an þera Dawides burg, · drohtin þe gódo.  
 402 Þat is męndislo · manno kunnjas,  
 allaro firiho fruma. · Þár gí ina fíðan mugun,  
 404 an Bethlema-burg · barno ríkjost:  
 hebbjad þat te tēkna, · þat ik eu gi·tęlljan mag  
 406 wárun wordun, · þat hé þár bi·wundan ligid,  
 þat kind an ênera kribbjun, · þoh hé sí kuning oþar al  
 408 erðun ęndi himiles · ęndi oþar ęldjo barn,  
 wer-oldes waldand“. · Reht só hé þó þat word gi·sprak,  
 410 só warð þár ęngilo te þem ênun · un·rím kuman,  
 hêlag hęri-skępi · fon heþan-wanga,  
 412 faġar folk godes, · ęndi filu sprákun,  
 lof-word manag · liudjo hêrron.  
 414 Af·hóbun þó hêlagna sang, · þó sie eft te heþan-wanga  
 wundun þurh þiu wolkan. · Þea wardos hôrdun,  
 416 hwó þiu ęngilo kraft · alo-mahtigna god  
 swíðo werð·liko · wordun lobodun:  
 418 „diuriða sí nú“, (kwáðun sie,) „drohtine selbun  
 an þem hôhoston · himilo ríkja  
 420 ęndi friðu an erðu · firiho barnun,  
 gód-willigun gumun, · þem þe god ant·kennjad  
 422 þurh hluttran hugi.“ · Þea hirdjo for·stóðun,  
 þat sie mahtig þing · gi·manod habda,



424 blîð-lîk bod-skêpi: · gi·witun im te Bethleem þanan  
 426 nahtes siðon; · was im niud mikil,  
 þat sie selbon Krist · gi·sehan móstin.

TODO.

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359 beidero | so *M* ('beidero') *S* ('beidera'); 'bethero' *C*

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359 beidero | This very rare occurrence of the original diphthong, which almost everywhere else has been contracted to *ē*, is found in 2/3 witness mss. It also occurs at l. 2265; cf. l. 3674 n.

427 6 Habda im þe ęngil godes · al gi·wisid  
 torhtun tēknun, · þat sie im tō selbun,  
 429 te þem godes barne · gangan mahtun,  
 ęndi fundun sǣn · folko drohtin,  
 431 liudjo hērron. · Sagdun þó lof goda,  
 waldande mid iro wordun · ęndi wido kūðdun  
 433 oþar þea berhtun burg, · hwi-lîk im þár biliði warð  
 fon heban-wanga · hēlag gi·tōgit,  
 435 fagar an felde. · Þat frī al bi·held  
 an ira hugi-skęftjun, · hēlag þiorna,  
 437 þiu magað an ira móde, · só hwat só siu gi·hōrda þea mann  
 sprekan.  
 Fódða ina þó fagaro · frīho skānjosta,  
 439 þiu módar þurh minnja · managaro drohtin,  
 hēlag himilisk barn. · Hēliðos gi·sprākun  
 441 an þem ahtodon daga · erlos managa,  
 swiðo glauwa gumon · mid þera godes þiornun,  
 443 þat hé Hêljand te namon · hębbjan skoldi,  
 só it þe godes ęngil · Gabriel gi·sprak  
 445 wáron wordun · ęndi þem wíbe gi·bôð,  
 bodo drohtines, · þó siu ęrist þat barn ant·fęg  
 447 wánum te þesero wer-oldi; · was iru willjo mikil,  
 þat siu ina só hēlag-liko · haldan mósti,  
 449 ful·gęgim im þó só gerno. · Þat gēr furðor skrêð  
 unt·þat þat frīðu-barn godes · fiar-tig habda  
 451 dago ęndi nahto. · Þó skoldun sie þár ęna dád frummjan,  
 þat sie ina te Jerusalem · for·geþan skoldun  
 453 waldanda te þem wíha. · Só was iro wisa þan,  
 þero liudjo land-sidu, · þat þat ni mósta for·lātan ne·gēn  
 455 idis undar Ebreon, · ef iru at ęrist warð

457 sunu a·fódit, · ne siu ina simbla þarod  
 te þem godes wíha · for·geban skolda.  
 459 Gi·witun im þó þiu gódun twê, · Joseph ęndi Maria  
 bēðju fon Bethleem: · habdun þat barn mid im,  
 461 hêlagna Krist, · sóhtun im hús godes  
 an Jerusalem; · þár skoldun sie is geld frummjan  
 463 waldanda at þem wíha · wísa lēstjan  
 Judeo folkes. · Þár fundun sea ênna góðan man  
 465 aldan at þem alāha, · aðal-boranan,  
 þe habda at þem wíha só filu · wintro ęndi sumaro  
 467 gi·libd an þem liohta: · oft warhta hé þár lof goda  
 mid hluttru hugi; · habda im hêlagna gēst,  
 469 sálig-líkan sebon; · Simeon was hé hêtan.  
 Im habda gi·wísid · waldandas kraft  
 471 langa hwíla, · þat hé ni mósta êr þit lioht a·geban,  
 węndjan af þesero wer-oldi, · êr þan im þe willjo gi·stódi,  
 473 þat hé selban Krist · gi·sehan mósti,  
 hêlagna heban-kuning. · Þó warð im is hugi swiðo  
 475 blíði an is briostun, · þó hé gi·sah þat barn kuman  
 an þena wíh innan. · Þuo sagda hie waldande þank,  
 477 al-mahtigon gode, · þes hé ina mid is ôgun gi·sah.  
 Géng im þó te·gęgnes · ęndi ina gerno ant·fęng  
 479 ald mid is armun: · al ant·kęnde  
 bôkan ęndi biliði · ęndi ôk þat barn godes,  
 481 hêlagna heban-kuning. · „Nú ik þi, hêrro, skal“, kwað hé,  
 „gerno biddjan, · nú ik sus gi·gamalod bium,  
 483 þat þú þínan holdan skalk · nú hinan hwerþan látas,  
 an þína friðu-wára faran, · þár êr mína forðrun dedun,  
 485 weros fon þesero wer-oldi, · nú mí þe willjo gi·stód,  
 dago liobosto, · þat ik mínan drohtin gi·sah,  
 487 holdan hêrron, · só mí gi·hêtan was  
 langa hwíla. · Þú bist lioht mikil  
 489 allun ęli-þiodun, · þea êr þes alo-waldon  
 kraft ne ant·kęndun. · Þína kumi sindun  
 491 te dóma ęndi te diurðon, · drohtin frô mín,  
 aþarun Israhelas, · êganumu folke,  
 493 þínun liobun \*liudjun.“ · Listjun talde þó  
 þe aldo man an þem alāha · idis þero góðun,  
 sagda sôð-liko, · hwó iro sunu skolda

495 õbar ʃesan middil-gard · managun werðan  
 sumun te falle, sumun te fróbru · firiho barnun,  
 497 ʃem liudjun te leoba, · ʃe is lêrun gi·hórdin,  
 ɛndi ʃem te harma, · ʃe hôrjen ni weldin  
 499 Kristas lêron. · „Þu skalt noh“, kwað hé, „kara þiggjan,  
 harm an þinumu herton, · þan ina hêliðo barn  
 501 wápnun wítnod. · Þat wirðid þi werk mikil,  
 þrim te gi·þolonna.“ · Þiu þiorna al for·stód  
 503 wísas mannas word. · Þó kwam þár ôk ên wíf gangan  
 ald innan ʃem alaha: · Anna was siu hêtan,  
 505 dohtar Fanueles; · siu habde ira drohtine wel  
 gi·þionod te þanka, · was iru gi·þungan wíf.  
 507 Siu mósta aftar ira magað-hêdi, · siðor siu mannes warð,  
 erles an êhti · ɛðili þiorne,  
 509 só mósta siu mid ira brúdi-gumon · bodlo gi·waldan  
 sibun wintar saman. · Þó gi·fragn ik þat iru þár sorga gi·stód  
 511 þat sie þiu mikila maht · metodes te·dêlda,  
 wrêð wurdi-gi·skapu. · Þó was siu widowa aftar þiu  
 513 at ʃem friðu-wíha · fior ɛndi ant·ahtoda  
 wintro an iro wer-oldi, · só siu nia þana wíh ni for·lét,  
 515 ak siu þár ira drohtine wel · dages ɛndi nahtes,  
 gode þionode. · Siu kwam þár ôk gangan tó  
 517 an þea selbun tíð: · sán ant·kênde  
 þat hêlage barn godes · ɛndi ʃem hêliðon kûðde,  
 519 ʃem weroda aftar ʃem wíha · wil-spel mikil,  
 kwað þat im nêrjandas gi·nist · gi·náhid wári,  
 521 helpa heban-kuninges: · „nú is ʃe hêlago Krist,  
 waldand selbo · an ʃesan wíh kuman  
 523 te a·lôsjenne þea liudi, · ʃe hér nú lango bidun  
 an ʃesara middil-gard, · managa hwíla,  
 525 þurftig þioda, · só nú ʃes þinges mugun  
 męndjan man-kunni.“ · Manag fagonoda  
 527 werod aftar ʃem wíha: · gi·hórdun wil-spel mikil  
 fon gode sęggjan. · Þat geld habde þó gi·lêstid  
 529 þiu idis an ʃem alaha, · al só it im an ira êwa gi·bôð  
 ɛndi an þera berhtun burg · bók gi·wísdun,  
 531 hêlagaro hand-gi·werk. · Gi·witun im þó te hús þanan  
 fon Jerusalem · Joseph ɛndi Maria,  
 533 hêlag híwiski: · habdun im heban-kuning



569 helpa gi·hétun · fon heban-kuninge  
 wárum wordun. · Þan was þár ên gi·wittig man,  
 fród êndi fil-wís · —forn was þat giu—,  
 571 úse aldiro ôstar hinan, · —þár ni warð siðor ênig man  
 sprákono só spáhi—; · hé mahte rekkjen spel godes,  
 573 hwand im habde for·liwan · liudjo hêrro,  
 þat hé mahte fon erðu · up gi·hôrjan  
 575 waldandes word: · bi·þiu was is gi·wit mikil,  
 þes þegnes gi·þáhti. · Þó hé þanan skolda,  
 577 a·geben gardos, · gadulingo gi·mang,  
 for·lâten liudjo drôm, · sókjen lioht ôðar,  
 579 þó hé is jungron hét · gangan nâhor,  
 erbi·wardos, · êndi is erlun þó  
 581 sagde sôð-liko: · —þat al siðor kwam,  
 gi·warð\* an þesaro wer-oldi—: · þó sagda hé þat hér skoldi  
 kuman ên wís-kuning  
 583 mári êndi mahtig · an þesan middil-gard  
 þes þetston gi·burdjes; · kwað þat it skoldi wesán barn godes,  
 585 kwað þat hé þesero wer-oldes · waldan skoldi  
 gio te êwan-daga, · erðun êndi himiles.  
 587 Hé kwað þat an þem selbon daga, · þe ina sáligna  
 an þesan middil-gard · móðar gi·drógi,  
 589 só kwað hé þat ôstana · ên skoldi skínan  
 himil-tungál hwít, · su-lík só wí hér ne habdin êr  
 591 undar·twisk erða êndi himil · ôðar hwërgin,  
 ne su-lík barn ne su-lík bôkan. · Hét þat þár te bedu fôrin  
 593 þrea man fon þero þiodu, · hét sie þenkjan wel,  
 hwan êr sie gi·sáwin ôstana · up siðojan,  
 595 þat godes bôkan gangan, · hét sie garwjan sán,  
 hét þat wí im folgodin, · só it furi wurði,  
 597 westar ôbar þesa wer-oldi. · Nú is it al gi·wárod só,  
 kuman þurh kraft godes: · þe kuning is gi·fôdit,  
 599 gi·boran bald êndi strang: · wí gi·sáhun is bôkan skínan  
 hêdro fon himiles tunglun, · só ik wêt, þat it hêlag drohtin,  
 601 markoda mahtig selbo; · wí gi·sáhun morgno gi·hwi-likes  
 blíkan þana berhton sterron, · êndi wí géngun aftar þem  
 bôkna herod  
 603 wegás êndi waldas hwílon. · Þat wári ús allaro willjono mêsta,

- þat wí ina **sel**bon gi·**se**han móstin, · wissin, hwár wí ina **sók**jan  
skoldin,  
605 þana **k**uning an þesumu **k**êsur-dóma. · Saga ùs, undar  
hwi-líkumu hé sí þesaro **k**unngo a·fódit.“
- Þó warð **E**rodesa · **i**nnan briostun  
607 **h**arm wið **h**erta, · bi·gan im is **h**ugi wallan,  
**se**bo mid **s**orgun: · gi·hörde **s**eggjan þó,  
609 þat hé þár **o**bar-hôbdon · **ê**gan skoldi,  
**k**raftagoron **k**uning · **k**unnjes gódes,  
611 **s**áligoron undar þem gi·**s**íðja. · Þó hé **s**amnon hét,  
só hwat só an **J**erusalem · **g**ódaro manno  
613 allaro **s**páhoston · **s**prákono wárun  
endi an iro **b**rioston · **b**ók-kraftes mêst  
615 **w**issun te wárun, · endi hé sie mid **w**ordun fragn,  
swíðo **n**iud-líko · **n**íð-hugdig man,  
617 **k**uning þero liudjo, · hwár **K**rist gi·boran  
an **w**er-old-ríkja · **w**erðan skoldi,  
619 **f**riðu-gumono bêtst. · Þó sprak im eft þat **f**olk an·gegin,  
þat **w**erod wár-líko, · kwáðun þat sie **w**issin garo,  
621 þat hé skoldi an **B**ethleem gi·boran werðan: · „só is an ùsun  
**b**ókun gi·skriban,  
**w**ís-líko gi·**w**ritan, · só it wár-sagon,  
623 swíðo **g**lauwa **g**umon · bi **g**odes krafta  
**f**il-wíse man · **f**urn gi·spráku,  
625 þat skoldi fon **B**ethleem · **b**urgo hirdi,  
**l**iof landes ward · an þit **l**ioht kuman,  
627 **r**íki **r**ád-gebo, · þe rihtjen skal  
**J**udeono **g**um-skêpi · endi is **g**eba wesan  
629 **m**ildi oþar **m**iddil-gard · **m**anagun þiodun.“

TODO.

557–561 erlos ... kumana | *Ll. 557a–560b and 561b are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 380).*

554 **w**undan gold | Formulaic, belonging to the culture of the Germanic Migration Period.

599–605 wí ... a·fódit | *Ll. 599b–602a, 603a–605b are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, pp. 380–381).*  
The contrast between the length of 605b, the last verse of speech, and 606, the voice of the narrating poet, is notable.

- 8 Þó gi·fragn ik þat **s**án aftar þiu · **s**líð-mód kuning  
631 þero wár-sagono **w**ord · þem **w**rëkkjun sagda,  
þea þár an **ê**li-lendi · **e**rlos wárun

633 ferran gi·farana, · ɛndi hé frágoda aftar þiu,  
 hwan sie an ôstar-wegun · êrist gi·sáhin  
 635 þana kuning-sterron kuman, · kumbal liuhtjen  
 hêdro fon himile. · Sie ni weldun is im þó helen eo·wiht,  
 637 ak sagdun it im sóð-líko. · Þó hét hé sie an þana sïð faran,  
 hét þat sie ira ârundi al · undar fundin  
 639 umbi þes kindes kumi, · ɛndi þe kuning selbo gi·bôd  
 swiðo hard-liko, · hêrro Judeono,  
 641 þem wísun mannun, · êr þan sie fórin westan forð,  
 þat sie im eft gi·küðin, · hwár hé þana kuning skoldi  
 643 sókjan at is seðon; · kwað þat hé þár weldi mid is gi·sïðun tó,  
 bedan te þem barne. · Þan hogda hé im te banon werðan  
 645 wápnes eggjun. · Þan eft waldand god  
 þáhte wið þem þinga: · hé mahta a·þengjan mêt,  
 647 gi·lêstjan an þesum liohte: · þat is noh lango skín,  
 gi·küðid kraft godes. · Þó géngun eft þiu kumbl forð  
 649 wánum undar wolknun. · Þó wárun þea wíson man  
 fûsa te faranne: · gi·witun im forð þanan  
 651 balda an bod-skêpi: · weldun þat barn godes  
 selbon sókjan. · Sie ni habdun þanan gi·sïðjas mêt,  
 653 b·útan þat sie þríe wárun: · wissun im þingo gi·skêð,  
 wárun im glauwe gumon, · þe þea geba lêddun.  
 655 Þan sáhun sie só wís-liko · undar þana wolknas skion,  
 up te þem hôhon himile, · hwó fórun þea hwíton sterron  
 657 —ant·kêndun sie þat kumbal godes—, · þiu wárun þurh

#### Krista herod

gi·warht te þesero wer-oldi. · Þea weros aftar géngun,  
 659 folgodun feráht-liko · —sie frumide þe mahte—  
 ant-þat sie gi·sáhun, · sïð-wórige man,  
 661 berht bôkan godes, · blêk an himile  
 stillo gi·standen. · Þe sterro liohto skên  
 663 hwít obar þem húse, · þár þat hêlage barn  
 wonode an willjon · ɛndi ina þat wíf bi·held,  
 665 þiu þiorne gi·þiudo. · Þó warð þero þegno hugi  
 blíði an iro briostun: · bi þem bôkna for-stóðun,  
 667 þat sie þat friðu-barn godes · funden habdun,  
 hêlagna heban-kuning. · Þó sie an þat hús innan  
 669 mid iro geþun géngun, · gumon ôstr-onja,  
 sïð-wórige man: · sán ant·kêndun

- 671 þea weros waldand Krist. · Þea wrękkjon fellun  
te þem kinde an kneo-beda · ęndi ina an kuning-wisa  
673 gódan gróttun · ęndi im þea geba drógun,  
gold ęndi wih-rôk · bi godes tēknun  
675 \*ęndi myrra þár mid. · Þea man stóðun garowa,  
holde for iro hērron, · þea it mid iro handun sán  
677 fagaro ant-fęngun. · Þó gi-witun im þea ferąhton man,  
seggi te sełðon · siđ-wórige,  
679 gumon an gast-sełi. · Þár im godes ęngil  
slápandjun an naht · sweban gi-tôgde,  
681 gi-drog im an drôme, · al so it drohtin self,  
waldand welde, · þat im þuhte þat man im mid wordun  
gi-budi,  
683 þat sie im\* þanan ôðran weg, · erlos fórin,  
liðodin sie te lande · ęndi þana lēðan man,  
685 Erodesan · eft ni sóhtin,  
móðagna kuning. · Þó warð morgan kuman  
687 wánum te þesero wer-oldi. · Þó bi-gunnun þea wíson man  
seggjan iro swebanos; · selbon ant-kęndun  
689 waldandes word, · hwand sie gi-wit mikil  
bárun an iro briostun: · bádun alo-waldon,  
691 hēron heban-kuning, · þat sie móstin is huldi forð,  
gi-wirkjan is willjon, · kwáðun þat sea ti im habdin gi-węndit  
hugi,  
693 \*iro mód morgan gi-hwem. · Þó fórun eft þie man þanan,  
erlos ôstr-onje, · al só im þe ęngil godes  
695 wordun gi-wisde: · námun im weg ôðran,  
ful-gęngun godes lêrun: · ni weldun þemu Judeo kuninge  
697 umbi þes barnes gi-burd · bodon ôstr-onje,  
siđ-wórige man · seggjan gio-wiht,  
699<sup>a</sup> ak węndun im eft an iro willjon.

TODO.

- 699<sup>b</sup> 9 Þó warð sán aftar þiu waldandes,  
godes ęngil kumen · Josepe te sprákun,  
701 sagde im an swefne · slápandjun an naht,  
bodo drohtines, · þat þat barn godes  
703 slíð-mód kuning · sókjan welda,  
áhtjan is aldres; · „nú skaltu ine an Aegypteo



705 land ant·lêdjan · ɛndi undar ɓem liudjun wesən  
 mid ɓiu godes barnu · ɛndi mid ɓeru gódan ɓior\*nan,  
 707 wunon undar ɓemu werode, · unt·ɓat ɓi word kume  
 hêrron ɓínes, · ɓat ɓú ɓat hêlage barn  
 709 eft te ɓesum land-skêpi · lêdjan mótis,  
 drohtin ɓínen.“ · ɓó fon ɓem drôma an·sprang  
 711 Joseph an is gëst-sêli, · ɛndi ɓat godes gi·bod  
 sán ant·kenda: · gi·wêt im an ɓana sîð ɓanen  
 713 ɓe ɓegan mid ɓeru ɓiornon, · sóhta im ɓiod ôðra  
 obar brêdan berg: · welda ɓat barn godes  
 715 fiundun ant·fôrjan. · \*ɓó gi·frang aftar ɓiu  
 Eródes ɓe kuning, · ɓár hé an is ríkja sat,  
 717 ɓat wárun ɓea wíson man · westan gi·hworban  
 ôstar an iro ôðil · ɛndi fórun im ôðran weg:  
 719 wisse ɓat sie im ɓat ârundi · eft ni weldun  
 seggjan an is sêlðon. · ɓó warð im ɓes an sorgun hugi,  
 721 mód mornondi, · kwað ɓat it im ɓie man dedin,  
 hêliðos\* te hônðun. · ɓó hé só hriuwig sat,  
 723 balg ina an is briostun, · kwað ɓat hé is mahti ɓetaron rád,  
 ôðran gi·ɓenkjen: · „nú ik is alðar kan,  
 725 wêt is winter-gi·talú: · nú ik gi·winnan mag,  
 ɓat hé io obar ɓesaro erðu · ald ni wirðit,  
 727 hêr undar ɓesum hêri-skêpi.“ · ɓó hé só hardo gi·bôð,  
 Eródes obar is ríki, · hét ɓó is rinkos faran  
 729 kuning ɓero liudjo, · hét ɓat sie kinda só filo  
 ɓurh iro hand-magen · hôbdu bi·námín,  
 731 só manag barn umbi Bethlehem, · só filo só ɓár gi·boran wurði,  
 an twêm gêrun a·togan. · Tionon frumidon  
 733 ɓes kuninges gi·sîðos. · ɓó skolda ɓár só manag kindisk man  
 sweltan sundjono lôs. · Ni warð sîð noh êr  
 735 jámar-líkara for·gang · jungaro manno,  
 arm-líkara dôð. · Idisi wiopun,  
 737 módar managa, · gi·sáhun iro męgi spildjan:  
 ni mahte siu im nio gi·formon, · ɓoh siu mid iro faðmon twêm  
 739 iro êgan barn · armun bi·féngi,  
 liof ɛndi luttíl, · ɓoh skolda is simbla ɓat líf geɓan,  
 741 ɓe magu for ɓeru módar. · Mênes ni sáhun,  
 wítjes ɓie wam-skaðon: · wápnes eggjun  
 743 frëmidun firin-werk mikil. · Fellun managa

magu-junge man. · Þia módar wiopun  
 745 kind-jungaro kwalm; · kara was an Bethleem,  
 hofno hlúdost: · þoh man im iro herton an twê  
 747 sniði mid swerdu, · þoh ni mohta im gio sêrara dád  
 werðan an þesaro wer-oldi, · wiþun managun,  
 749 brúðjun an Bethleem: · gi·sáhun iro barn bi·foran,  
 kind-junge man, · kwalmu sweltan  
 751 blódag an iro barmun. · Þie banon wítnodun  
 un·skuldige skole: · ni bi·skribun gio·wiht  
 753 þea man umbi mên-werk: · weldun mahtigna,  
 Krist selbon a·kwêlljan. · Þan habde ina kraftag god  
 755 gi·nēridan wið iro níðe, · þat inan nahtes þanan  
 an Aegypteo land · erlos ant·lêddun,  
 757 gumon mid Josepe · an þana grónjon wang,  
 an erðono bēstun, · þár ên aha flitid,  
 759 Nil-strôm mikil · norð te sêwa,  
 flódo fagorosta. · Þár þat friðu-barn godes  
 761 wonoda an willjon, · ant·þat wurd for·nam  
 Erodes þana kuning, · þat hé for·lét ǣldjo barn,  
 763 módag manno drôm. · Þó skolda þero marka gi·wald  
 êgan is ǣrbi·ward: · þe was Arkheláus  
 765 hêtan, hēri-togo · helm-berandero:  
 þe skolda umbi Jerusalem · Judeono folkes,  
 767 werodes gi·waldan. · Þó warð word kuman  
 þár an Egypti · ǣðiljun manne,  
 769 þat hé þár te Josepe, · godes ǣngil sprak,  
 bodo drohtines, · hét ina eft þat barn þanan  
 771 lêdjen te lande. · „nú habað þit lioht af·geben“, kwað hé,  
 „Erodes þe kuning; · hé welde is áhtjen giu,  
 773 frêson is ferahas. · Nú maht þú an friðu lêdjen  
 þat kind undar euwa kunni, · nú þe kuning ni libod,  
 775 erl oþar-módig.“ · Al ant·kēnde  
 Josep godes tēkan: · gēriwide ina sniumo  
 777 þe þegan mit þera þiornun, · þó sie þanan weldun  
 bēðju mid þiu barnu: · lēstun þiu berhton gi·skapu,  
 779 waldandes willjon, · al só hé im êr mid is wordun gi·bôd.

TODO.

10 Gi-witun im þó eft an Galilea-land · Joseph ǣndi Maria,

781 hêlag hîwiski · heban-kuninges,  
 wárun im an Nazareth-burg. · Þár þe nêrjondjo Krist  
 783 wóhs undar þem werode, · warð gi·wittjes ful,  
 an was imu anst godes, · hé was allun liof  
 785 módar·mágun: · hé ni was ôðrun mannun gi·lík,  
 þe gumo an sínera gódi. · Þó hé gêr·talo  
 787 twe·líbi habde, · þó warð þiu tíð kuman,  
 þat sie þár te Jerusalem, · Juðeo liudi  
 789 iro þiod·gode · þionon skoldun,  
 wirkjan is willjon. · Þó warð þár an þana wih innan  
 791 þár te Jerusalem · Judeono gi·samnod  
 man·kraft mikil. · Þár Maria was  
 793 self an gi·sîðja · êndi iru sunu habda,  
 godes êgan barn. · Þó sie þat geld habdun,  
 795 erlos an þem alaha, · só it an iro êwa gi·bôd,  
 gi·lêstid te iro land·wîsun, · þó fórun im eft þie liudi þanan,  
 797 weros an iro willjon · êndi þár an þem wiha af·stód  
 mahtig barn godes, · só ina þiu módar þár  
 799 ni wissa te wáron; · ak siu wánda þat hé mid þem weroda forð,  
 fóri mit iro friundun. · Gi·frang aftar þiu  
 801 eft an ôðrun daga · aðal·kunnjes wíf,  
 sálig þiorna, · þat hé undar þem gi·sîðja ni was.  
 803 warð Mariun þó · mód an sorgun,  
 hriuwig umbi iro herta, · þó siu þat hêlaga barn  
 805 ni fand undar þem folka: · filu gornoda  
 þiu godes þiorna. · Gi·witun im þó eft te Jerusalem  
 807 iro sunu sókjan, · fundun ina sittjan þár  
 an þem wiha innan, · þár þe wîsa man,  
 809 swiðo glauwa gumon · an godes êwa  
 lásun ênde línodun, · hwó sie lof skoldin  
 811 wirkjan mid iro wordun þem, · þe þesa wer·old gi·skóp.  
 Þár sat undar middjun · mahtig barn godes,  
 813 Krist alo·waldo, · só is þea ni mahtun ant·kênnjan wiht,  
 þe þes wîhes þár · wardon skoldun,  
 815 êndi frágoða sie · firi·wit·líko  
 wîsera wordo. · Sie wundradun alle,  
 817 bi·hwí gio só kindisk man · su·líka kwidi mahti  
 mid is müðu gi·mênjan. · Þár ina þiu módar fand  
 819 sittjan under þem gi·sîðja · êndi iro sunu gróttá,

- wísan undar þem weroda, · sprak im mid ira wordun tó:  
 821 „hwí weldes þú þínera módar, · manno liobosto,  
 gi·sidon su-líka sorga, · þat ik þí só sêrag-mód,  
 823 idis arm-hugdig · êskon skolda  
 undar þesun burg-liudjun?“ · Þó sprak iru eft þat barn  
 an·gëgin  
 825 wísun wordun: · „Hwat þú wêst garo“, kwað hé,  
 „þat ik þár gi·rísu, · þár ik bi rehton skal  
 827 wonon an willjon, · þár gi·wald habad  
 mín mahtig fader.“ · Þie man ni for·stódun,  
 829 þie weros an þem wiha, · bi·hwí hé só þat word gi·sprak,  
 gi·mênda mid is müðu: · Maria al bi·held,  
 831 gi·barg an ira breostun, · só hwat só siu gi·hôrda ira barn  
 sprekan  
 wísaro wordo. · Gi·witun im þó eft þanan  
 833 fon Jerusalem · Joseph êndi Maria,  
 habdun im te gi·sǿja · sunu drohtines,  
 835 allaro barno bêtsta, · þero þe io gi·boran wurði  
 magu fon módar: · habdun im þár minnja tó  
 837 þurh hluttran hugi, · êndi hé só gi·hôrig was,  
 godes êgan barn · gaduling-mágun  
 839 þurh is ôd-módi, · aldron sínun:  
 ni welda an is kindiski þó noh · is kraft mikil  
 841 mannun márjan, · þat hé su-lík mëgin êhta,  
 gi·wald an þesaro wer-oldi, · ak hé im an is willjon bêd  
 843 gi·þiudo undar þero þiodu · þrí-tig gëro,  
 êr þan hé þár tēkan ênig · tōgjan weldi,  
 845 seggjan þem gi·sǿja, · þat hé selbo was  
 an þesaro middil-gard · manno drohtin.  
 847 Habda im só bi·halden · hêlag barn godes  
 word êndi wís-dóm · ênde allaro gi·wittjo mêt,  
 849 tulgo spáhan hugi: · ni mahta man is an is sprákon werðan,  
 an is wordun gi·war, · þat hé su-lík gi·wit êhta,  
 851 þegan su-líka gi·þahti, · ak hé im só gi·þiudo bêd  
 torhtaro tēkno. · Ni was noh þan þiu tid kuman,  
 853 þat hé ina oþar þesan middil-gard · márjan skolda,  
 lērjan þie liudi, · hwó sie skoldin iro gi·lōþon haldan,  
 855 wirkjan willjon godes; · wissun þat þoh managa  
 liudi aftar þem landa, · þat hé was an þit lioht kuman,



- sundjono sikoron, · só hwene só só sálíg mót  
 893 werðen an þesaro wer-oldi, · þat þes willjon habad,  
 þat hé só gi·lêstja, · só hé þesun liudjun wili,  
 895 gi·bioden barn godes. · Ik bium an is bod-skêpi herod  
 an þesa wer-old kumen · êndi skal im þana weg rúmjen,  
 897 lêrjan þesa liudi, · hwó sea skulin iro gi·lôbon haldan  
 þurh hluttran hugi, · êndi þat sie an hêlja ni þurbin,  
 899 faran an fern þat hêta. · Þes wirðid só fagan an is móde  
 man te só managaro stundu, · só hwe só þat mên for·látid,  
 901 gerno þes gramon an·busni, · —só mag im þes gódon  
 gi·wirkjan,  
 huldi heban-kuninges,— · só hwe só habad hluttra treuwa  
 903 up te þem alo-mahtigon gode.“ · Erlos managa  
 bi þem lêrun þó, · liudi wándun,  
 905 weros wár-liko, · þat þat waldand Krist  
 selbo wári, · hwanda hé só filu sôðes gi·sprak,  
 907 wároro wordo. · Þó warð þat só wído kûð  
 oðar þat for·gebana land · gumono gi·hwi·líkum,  
 909 seggjun at iro sełðun: · þó kwámun ina sókjan þarod  
 fon Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo  
 911 bodon fon þeru burgi · êndi frágodun, ef hé wári þat barn  
 godes,  
 „þat hér lango giu“, (kwáðun sie,) „liudi sagdun,  
 913 weros wár-liko, · þat hé skoldi an þesa wer-old kuman“.  
 Johannes þó gi·mahalde · êndi te·gegnes sprak  
 915 þem bodun bald-liko: · „ni bium ik“, kwað hé, „þat barn  
 godes,  
 wár waldand Krist, · ak ik skal im þana weg rúmjen,  
 917 hêrron mínum.“ · Þea hêliðos frugnun,  
 þea þár an þem ârundje · erlos wárun,  
 919 bodon fon þero burgi: · „ef þú nú ni bist þat barn godes,  
 bist þú þan þoh Elias, · þe hér an êr-dagun  
 921 was undar þesumu werode? · hé is wis-kumo  
 eft an þesan middil-gard. · Saga ús, hwat þú manno sís!  
 923 Bist þú ênig þero, · þe hér êr wári  
 wísaro wár-saguno? · Hwat skulun wí þem werode fon þi  
 925 seggjan te sôðon? · Neo hér êr su-lík ni warð  
 an þesun middil-gard · man oðar kuman  
 927 dádjun só mári. · Bi·hwí þú hér dôpislí

frēm̃is undar þesumu folke, · ef þú þaro fora·sagono  
 929 ên·hwi·lík ni bist?“ · Þó habde eft garo  
 Johannes þe gódo · glau and·wordi:  
 931 „Ik bium fora·bodo · frâon mínes,  
 liobes hêrron; · ik skal þit land rekon,  
 933 þit werod aftar is willjon. · Ik hêbbju fon is worde mid mí  
 stranga stemna, · þoh sie hér ni willje for·standan filo  
 935 werodes an þesaro wóstunni. · Ni bium ik mid wihti gi·lík  
 drohtine mínum: · hé is mid is dádjun só strang,  
 937 só mári êndi só mahtig · —þat wirðid managun kûð,  
 werun aftar þesaro wer·oldi— · þat ik þes wirðig ni bium,  
 939 þat ik móti an is gi·skuoha, · þoh ik sí is skalk êgan,  
 an só ríkjumu drohtine, · þea reomon ant·bindan:  
 941 só mikilu is hé bêtara þan ik. · Nis þes bodon gi·mako  
 ênig obar erðu, · ne nú aftar ni skal  
 943 werðan an þesaro wer·oldi. · Hêbbjad euwan willjon þarod,  
 liudi euwan gi·lôbon: · þan eu lango skal  
 945 wesan euwa hugi hrómag; · þan gí helli·gi·þwing,  
 for·látad lêðaro drôm · êndi sókjad eu lioht godes,  
 947 up·ôdes hêm, · êwig ríki,  
 hôhan heban·wang. · Ne látad euwan hugi twífljan!“

TODO.

881 lédas ... hôrjad | This line is hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 385).

897–903 hwó ... gode. | LL 897b, 898b–901b, 902b–903a are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 386).  
 Note the contrast between hypermetric 903a and normal 903b; cf. ll. 605–6 above.

925 seggjan te sóðon | Formulaic, also found in *Heli* 2077a, 4018a, 4988a, along with *Beow* 51a:  
*seggan tó sôðe*.

949 **12** Só sprak þó jung gumo · bi godes lêrun  
 mannun te mârðu. · Manag samnoda  
 951 þár te Bethania · barn Israheles;  
 kwámun þár te Johannese · kuningo gi·sîðos,  
 953 liudi te lêrun · êndi iro gi·lôbon ant·féngun.  
 Hé dôpte sie dago gi·hwi·likes · êndi im iro dádi lóg,  
 955 wrêðaro willjon, · êndi lobode im word godes,  
 hêrron sínes: · „heban·ríki wirðid“, kwað hé,  
 957 „garu gumono só hwem, · só ti gode þenkid  
 êndi an þana hêljand \*wili · hluttro gi·lôbjan,  
 959 léstjan is lêra“. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,

þat im fon Galilea gi-wêt · godes êgan barn,  
 961 \*diur-lik drohtines sunu, · dôpi suokjan.  
 was im þuo an is wastme · waldandes barn\*,  
 963 al só hé mid þero þiodu · þrí-tig habdi  
 wintro an is wer-oldi. · þó hé an is willjon kwam,  
 965 þár Johannes · an Jordana strôme  
 allan langan dag · liudi manage  
 967 dôpte diur-liko. · Reht só hé þó is drohtin gi-sah,  
 holdan hêrron, · só warð im is hugi blíði,  
 969 þes im þe willjo gi-stód, · ęndi sprak im þó mid is wordun tó,  
 swíðo gód gumo, · Johannes te Kriste:  
 971 „nú kumis þú te mínero dôpi, · drohtin frô mín,  
 þiod-gumono bętsto: · só skolde ik te þínero duan,  
 973 hwand þú bist allaro kuningo kraftigost.“ · Krist selbo gi-bôd,  
 waldand wár-liko, · þat hé ni spráki þero wordo þan mēr:  
 975 „wêst þú, þat ős só gi-rísid“, (kwað hé,) „allaro rehto gi-hwi-lik  
 te gi-fulljanne · forð-wardes nú  
 977 an godes willjon“. · Johannes stód,  
 dôpte allan dag · druht-folk mikil,  
 979 werod an watere · ęndi ôk waldand Krist,  
 hêran heban-kuning · handun sínun  
 981 an allaro baðo þem bętston · ęndi im þár te bedu gi-hnêg  
 an kneo kraftag. · Krist up gi-wêt  
 983 faġar fon þem flóde, · friðu-barn godes,  
 liof liudjo ward. · Só hé þó þat land af-stóp,  
 985 só ant-hlidun þó himiles doru, · ęndi kwam þe hêlago ġest  
 fon þem alo-waldon · obane te Kriste:  
 987 —was im an gi-lik-nissje · lungras fugles,  
 diur-likara dúbun— · ęndi sat im uppan őses drohtines ahslu,  
 989 wonoda im oðar þem waldandes barne. · Aftar kwam þár  
 word fon himile,  
 hlúd fon þem hōhon radura · ęndi gróttu þane hêljand selbon,  
 991 Krista, allaro kuningo bętston, · kwað þat hé ina gi-korana  
 habdi  
 selbo fon sínun ríkja, · kwað þat im þe sunu likodi  
 993 bętst allaro gi-boranaro manno, · kwað þat hé im wári allaro  
 barno liobost.  
 Þat móste Johannes þó, · al só it god welde,  
 995 gi-sehan ęndi gi-hōrjan. · Hé gi-deda it sán aftar þiu



mannun mári, · þat sie þár mahtigna  
 997 hêrron habdun: · „Þit is“, kwað hé, „heban-kuninges sunu,  
 ên alo-waldand: · þesas willjo ik ur-kundjo  
 999 wesan an þesaro wer-oldi, · hwand it sagda mí word godes,  
 drohtines stemne, · þó hé mí dōpjan hét  
 1001 weros an watare, · só hwár só ik gi-sáwi wár-líko  
 þana hêlagon gêst · \*fan heban-wange  
 1003 an þesan middil-gard · ênigan man waron,  
 kuman mid kraftu; · þat kwað, þat skoldi Krist wesan,  
 1005 diur-lík drohtines suno. · Hie dōpjan skal  
 an þana hêlagan gêst · êndi hêljan managa  
 1007 manno mên-dádi. · Hé habad maht fon gode,  
 þat hé a-látan mag · liudjo gi-hwi-líkun  
 1009 saka êndi sundja. · Þit is selbo Krist,  
 godes êgan barn, · gumono bêtsto,  
 1011 friðu wið fiundun. · Wala þat eu þes mag frâh-mód hugi  
 wesan an þesaro wer-oldi, · þes eu þe willjo gi-stód,  
 1013 þat gí só libbjanda · þana landes ward  
 selbon gi-sáhun. · Ní mót sliumo sundjono lôs  
 1015 manag gêst faran · an godes willjon  
 tionon a-tómid, · þe mid treuwon wili  
 1017 wið is wini wirkjan · êndi an waldand Krist  
 fasto gi-lōbjan. · Þat skal te frumun werðen  
 1019 gumono só hwi-líkun, · só þat gerno dót“.

TODO.

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954 Hé dōpte sie dago gi-hwi-likes | *Classified by Suzuki (2004, p. 387) as hypermetric.*

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988–993 êndi ... liobost. | 988b–992a, 993 are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 387).

13 Só ge-fragn ik þat Johannes þó · gumono gi-hwi-líkun,  
 1021 loboda þem liudjun · lêra Kristes,  
 hêrron sínes, · êndi heban-ríki  
 1023 te gi-winnanne, · welono þane mēston,  
 sálig sin-líf. · Þó hé im selbo gi-wêt  
 1025 aftar þem dōpislja, · drohtin þe gódo,  
 an êna wóstunnja, · waldandes sunu;  
 1027 was im þár an þero ên-ôdi · erlo drohtin  
 lange hwíla; · ne habda liudjo þan mēr,  
 1029 seggjo te gi-siðun, · al só hé im selbo gi-kôs:

- welda is þár látan **koston** · **kraftiga** wihti,  
 1031 **selbon** **Satanasan**, · þe gio an **sundja** sþenit,  
**man** an **mên-werk**: · hé konsta is **mód-sebon**,  
 1033 **wrêðan** **willjon**, · hwó hé þesa **wer-old** êrist,  
 an þem **an-ginnja** · **irmin-þiða**  
 1035 bi·**swêk** mit **sundjun**, · þó hé þiu **sin-híun** twê,  
**Adaman** êndi **Êwan**, · þurh **un-treuwa**  
 1037 for·**lêdda** mid **luginun**, · þat **liudo** barn  
 aftar iro **hin-fêrði** · **hêllja** sóhtun,  
 1039 **gumono** **gêstos**. · Þó welda þat **god** mahtig,  
**waldand** **wêndjan** · êndi welda þesum **werode** for·geben  
 1041 **hôh** **himil-riki**: · be·þiu hé herod **hêlagna** bodon,  
 is **sunu** **sênda**. · Þat was **Satanase**  
 1043 tulgo **harm** an is **hugi**: · afonsta **heban-ríkjes**  
**manno** kunnje: · welda þó **mahtigna**  
 1045 mid þem **selbon** **sakun** · **sunu** drohtines,  
 þem hé **Adaman** · an **êr-dagun**  
 1047 **darnungo** bi·**dróg**, · þat hé warð is **drohtine** lêð,  
 bi·**swêk** ina mid **sundjun** · —só welda hé þó **selban** dón  
 1049 **hêlandjan** Krist. · Þan habða hé is **hugi** fasto  
 wið þana **wam-skaðon**, · **waldandes** barn,  
 1051 **herte** só gi·**hêrðid**: · welda **heban-ríki**  
**liudjun** gi·**lêstjan**. · Was im þes **landes** ward  
 1053 an **fastunnja** · **fior-tig** nahto,  
**manno** drohtin, · só hé þár **mates** ni ant·bêt;  
 1055 þan langa ni gi·**dorstun** im · **dêrnja** wihti,  
**níð-hugdig** fiund, · **náhor** gangan,  
 1057 **grótjan** ina **gêgin-warðan**: · wánde þat hé **god** ên-fald,  
 for·ûtar **man-kunnjes** wiht · **mahtig** wári,  
 1059 **hêleg** **himiles** ward. · Só hé ina þó ge·**hungrijan** lét,  
 þat ina bi·gan bi þero **mênnisko** · **móses** lustjan  
 1061 aftar þem **fiuwar-tig** dagun, · þe **fiund** **náhor** géng,  
**mirki** **mên-skaðo**: · wánda þat hé **man** ên-fald  
 1063 **wári** **wissungo**, · sprak im þó mid is **wordun** tó,  
**grótta** ina þe **gêr-fiund**: · „ef þú síis **godes** sunu“, kwað hé,  
 1065 „be·hwí ni hêtis þú þan **werðan**, · ef þú gi·**wald** habes,  
 allaro **barno** **bêtst**, · **brôd** af þesun **stênun**?  
 1067 Ge·**hêli** þinna **hungar**!“ · Þó sprak eft þe **hêlago** Krist:  
 „ni mugun **êldi-barn**“, (kwað hé,) „ên-faldes **brôdes**,

1069 liudi libbjen, · ak sie skulun þurh lera godes  
 1071 wesan an þesero wer-oldi · endi skulun þiu werk frummjen,  
 1073 þea þar werðað a·hlúdid · fon þero hêlogun tungun,  
 1075 fon þem galme godes: · þat is gumono lif  
 1077 liudjo só hwi-likon, · só þat lêtjan wili,  
 1079 þat fon waldandes · worde ge·biudid.“  
 1081 Þó bi·gan eft niuson · endi náhor géng  
 1083 un·hiuri fiund · ôðru siðu,  
 1085 fandoda is frôhan. · Þat friðu·barn þolode  
 1087 wrêðes willjon · endi im gi·wald for·gaf,  
 1089 þat hé umbi is kraft mikil · koston mósti,  
 1091 lét ina þó lédjan · þana liud·skaðon,  
 1093 þat hé ina an Jerusalem · te þem godes wiha,  
 1095 alles oðan·wardan, · up gi·setta  
 1097 an allaro húso hôhost, · endi hosk·wordun sprak,  
 1099 þe gramo þurh gelp mikil: · „ef þú sis godes sunu“, kwað hé,  
 1101 „skrid þi te erðu hinan. · Ge·skriban was it giu lango,  
 1103 an bókun ge·writen, · hwó gi·boden haðað  
 1105 is engilun · alo·mahtig fader,  
 1107 þat sie þi at wege ge·hwem · wardos sinðun,  
 1109 haldad þi undar iro handun. · Hwat þú hwargin ni þarft  
 1111 mid þínun fótun · an felis be·spurnan,  
 1113 an hardan stên.“ · Þó sprak eft þe hêlago Krist,  
 1115 allaro barno bêtst: · „só is ôk an bókun ge·skriban“, kwað hé,  
 1117 „þat þú te hardo ni skalt · hêrran þínes,  
 1119 fandon þínes frôhan: · þat nis þi allaro frumono neg·ên.“  
 1121 Lét ina þó an þana þriddjan sið · þana þiod·skaðon  
 1123 gi·brengen uppan ênan berg þen hôhon: · þar ina þe balo·wiso  
 1125 lét al oðar·sehan · irmin·þiode,  
 1127 wonod·saman welon · endi wer·old·ríki  
 1129 endi all su·lík ôdes, · só þius erða bi·haðað  
 1131 fagororo frumono, · endi sprak im þó þe fiund an·gegin,  
 1133 kwað þat hé im þat al só gód·lík · for·geben weldi,  
 1135 hôha hêri·dómos, · „ef þú wilt hnígan te mí,  
 1137 fallan te mínun fótun · endi mí for frôhan haðas,  
 1139 bedos te mínun barma. · Þan látu ik þi brúkan wel  
 1141 alles þes ôd·welon, · þes ik þi hêbbju gi·ôgit hír.“  
 1143 Þó ni welda þes lêðan word · lengeron hwíle  
 1145 hôrjan þe hêlago Krist, · ak hé ina fon is huldi for·drêf,

- 1109 Satanasan for·swêp, · ɛndi sán aftar sprak  
allaro barno bɛtst, · kwað þat man bedon skoldi  
up te þem alo-mahtigon gode · ɛndi im ênum þionon  
1111 swiðo þio-liko · þegnos managa,  
hɛliðos aftar is huldi: · „þár ist þiu helpa ge·lang  
1113 manno ge·hwi-líkun.“ · Þó gi·wêt im þe mên-skaðo,  
swiðo sêrag-mód · Satanas þanan,  
1115 fiund undar fern-dalu. · Warð þár folk mikil  
fon þem alo-waldan · obana te Kriste  
1117 godes ɛngilo kumen, · þie im siðor jungar-dóm,  
skoldun ambaht-skêpi · aftar lêstjen,  
1119 þionon þio-liko: · só skal man þiod-gode,  
hêrron aftar huldi, · heban-kuninge.

TODO.

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1035–1037 þó ... luginun | As told in *SaxGen*, the sister poem of *Heli*.

1053 fior-tig ‘forty’ | Note the unstable form of this numeral; *fior-tig* is the younger form, but the older *fiuwar-tig* occurs at l. 1061 below.

1061–1115 þe fiund náhor gég, ... fiund undar fern-dalu. | The temptation of Christ in the desert (Matthew 4:1–11, Luke 4:1–13). — The way Satan is described in the narrative parts of this passage is extremely similar to the descriptions of the three monsters of *Beow*: Grendle (*Beow* 99–836), Grendle’s mother (1251–1590), and the nameless Wýrm (2200–2711). Semantic parallels are found not just in descriptive nouns (*Heli* 1062a: *mên-skaðo* = *Beow* 712a, 737b, 1339a: *mân-scaðá*, *Heli* 1061b etc.: *fiund* = *Beow* 101b, 143b, 164b etc.: *fœond*, *Heli* 1095b: *þiod-skaðo* = *Beow* 2278a, 2688a *þeod-scaðá*) and adjectives (*Heli* 1056a: *nið-bugðig*, 1096a: *balu-wis* ~ *Beow* 723a: *bealu-bygðig*, *Heli* 1076a: *un-biuri* = *Beow* 2120b, 2413b: *un-biort*), but also in verbs that describe the antagonist as ‘seeking out’ (*Heli* 1075a: *niuson* = *Beow* 115a, 2074b: *néosian*) and ‘drawing nearer’ (*Heli* 1061b, 1075b: *nábor gég* ~ *Beow* 745b: *forð néar æt-stóp* ‘he stepped nearer forth’) its intended victim. A particularly notable parallel is found between *Heli* 1095 and *Beow* 2688, both of which pair \**þeudō-skapō* ‘people-scather’ with \**þriddjo sinþa* ‘third time’ in reference to the third temptation from Satan and the third attack from the dragon, respectively. Although the idea of three temptations is present in *Heli*’s Biblical source material, the rule of threes is common throughout world mythology and, as shown by *Beow*, also found in earlier Germanic monster-fights, so that this parallel is likely also inherited.

With such a great number of direct parallels it is apparent that the *Heli*-poet is drawing on older traditional Germanic stories of night-stalking monsters in his description of Satan and perhaps also on descriptions of battles involving three attacks by the monster. In this way the poet subtextually makes Christ take on the archetypal role of the Germanic heroic monster-slayer, something which would have been obvious (and likely emotionally effective) to the contemporary Saxon audience.

- 1121 14 Was im an þem sin-wældi · sálig barn godes  
lange hwíle, · unt·þat im þó liobora warð,  
1123 þat hé is kraft mikil · kũðjen wolda  
weroda te willjon. · Þó for-lét hé waldes hleo,  
1125 ên-ôðjes ard · ɛndi sóhte im eft erlo ge-mang,  
mári megin-þiode · ɛndi manno drôm,

géng im þó bi Jördanes staðe: · þár ina J Johannes ant·fand,  
þat friðu-barn godes, · frôhan sínan,  
hêlagana heban-kuning, · êndi þem hêliðun sagða,  
Johannes is jungurun, · þó hé ina gangan ge·sah:  
„þit is þat lamb godes, · þat þár lôsjan skal  
af þesaro wídon wer-old · wrêða sundja,  
man-kunnjas mên, · mári drohtin,  
kuningo kraftigost.“ · Krist im forð gi·wêt  
an Galileo land, · godes êgan barn,  
fór im te þem friundun, · þár hé a·fódit was,  
tír·líko a·togan, · êndi talda mid wordun  
Krist undar is kunnje, · kuningo ríkjost,  
hwó sie skoldin iro selboro · sundja bótjan,  
hét þat sie im iro harm-werk manag · hreuwan létin,  
feldin iro firin·dádi: · „nú is it all ge·fullot só,  
só hír alde man · êr hwanna sprákon,  
ge·hétun eu te helpu · heban-ríki:  
nú is it giu gi·náhid þurh þes ne·rjandan kraft: · þes mótun gi  
neotan forð,  
só hwe só gerno wili · gode þeonojan,  
wirkjan aftar is willjon.“ · Þó warð þes werodes filu,  
þero liudjo an lustun: · wurðun im þea lêra Kristes,  
só swótja þem gi·siðja. · Hé bi·gan im samnon þó  
gumono te jungoron, · gódoro manno,  
word-spáha weros. · Géng im þó bi ênes watares staðe,  
þat þár habða Jordan · a·neban Galileo land  
ênna sê ge·warhtan. · Þár hé sittjan fand  
Andreas êndi Petrus · bi þem aha·strôme,  
bêðja þea ge·bróðar, · þár sie an brêd watar  
swíðo niud·líko · neṭti þenidun,  
fiskodun im an þem flóde. · Þár sie þat friðu-barn godes  
bi þes sêes staðe · selbo grótta,  
hét þat sie im folgodin, · kwað þat hé im só filu woldi  
godes ríkjás for·geben; · „al só git hír an Jördanes strôme  
fiskos fâhat, · só skulun git noh firih barn  
halon te inkun handun, · þat sie an heban-ríki  
þurh inka lêra · líðan mótin,  
faran folk manag.“ · Þó warð frô·mód hugi  
bêðjun þem gi·bróðrun: · ant·kêndun þat barn godes,

- 1165 lioban hêrron: · for·létun al saman  
 Andreas ɛndi Petrus, · só hwat só sie bi þeru ahu habdun,  
 1167 ge·wunstes bi þem watere: · was im willjo mikil,  
 þat sie mid þem godes barne · gangan móstin,  
 1169 samad an is gi·siðja, · skoldun sálig·líko  
 lôn ant·fáhan: · só dót liudjo so hwi·lík,  
 1171 só þes hêrran wili · huldi gi·þionon,  
 ge·wirkjan is willjon. · Þó sie bi þes watares staðe  
 1173 furðor kwámun, · þó fundun sie þár ênna fróðan man  
 sittjan bi þem sêwa · ɛndi is suni twêne,  
 1175 Jakobus ɛndi Johannes: · wárun im junga man.  
 Sátun im þá ge·sun-fader · an ênumu sande uppen,  
 1177 brugdun ɛndi bóttun · bêðjum handun  
 þiu nɛtti niud·líko, · þea sie habdun nahtes êr  
 1179 for·sliten an þem sêwa. · Þár sprak im selbo tó  
 sálig barn godes, · hét þat sie an þana sið mid im,  
 1181 Jakobus ɛndi Johannes, · géngin bêðje,  
 kind-junge man. · Þó wárun im Kristes word  
 1183 só wirðig an þesaro wer·oldi, · þat sie bi þes watares staðe  
 iro aldan fader · ênna for·létun,  
 1185 fróðan bi þem flóde, · ɛndi al þat sie þár fehas êhtun,  
 nɛttju ɛndi nɛglid·skipu, · ge·kurun im þana nɛrjandan Krist,  
 1187 hêlagna te hêrron, · was im is helpono þarf  
 te gi·þiononne: · só is allaro þegno ge·hwem,  
 1189 wero an þesero wer·oldi. · Þó gi·wêt im þe waldandes sunu  
 mid þem fiuwarjun forð, · ɛndi im þó þana fifton gi·kôs  
 1191 Krist an ênero kôp·stedi, · kuninges jungoron,  
 mód·spáhana man: · Mattheus was hé hêtan,  
 1193 was im ambahtjo · ɛðilero manno,  
 skolda þár te is hêrron · handun ant·fáhan  
 1195 tins ɛndi tolga; · treuwa habda hé góða,  
 aðal-and·bári: · for·lét al saman  
 1197 gold ɛndi silubur · ɛndi geþa managa,  
 diurje mēðmos, · ɛndi warð im üses drohtines man;  
 1199 kôs im þe kuninges þegn · Krist te hêrran,  
 milderan mēðom·gebon, · þan êr is man·drohtin  
 1201 wári an þesero wer·oldi: · féng im wóðera þing,  
 lang·samoron rád. · Þó warð it allun þem liudjun küð,  
 1203 fon allaro burgo gi·hwem, · hwó þat barn godes

- samnode ge·sīðos · ɛndi selbo ge·sprak  
 1205 só manag wīs·līk word · ɛndi wāres só filu,  
 torhtes gi·tôgde · ɛndi tēkan manag  
 1207 ge·warhte an þesero wer·oldi. · Was þat an is wordun skín  
 iak an is dádjun só same, · þat hé drohtin was,  
 1209 himilisk hêrro · ɛndi te helpu kwam  
 an þesan middil·gard · manno barnun,  
 1211 liudjun te þesun liohta. · Oft ge·deda hé þat an þem lande  
 skín,  
 þan hé þár torht·liko · só manag tēkan gi·warhte,  
 1213 þár hé hêlde mid is handun · halte ɛndi blinde,  
 lôsde af þeru lēf·hêdi · liudi manage,  
 1215 af su·likun suhtjun, · só þan allaro swároston  
 an firiho barn · fiund bi·wurpun,  
 1217<sup>a</sup> tulgo lang·sam legar.

TODO.

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1176 ge·sun·fader | An archaic compound form. TODO.

1186 neġlid·skipu | A clinker-built ship, certainly a native Saxon term. Cf. *bôb·burnid skip* at 2266a, 2907a.

1198 diurje mēðmos | Formulaic, shared with *Beow* 2236a.

- 1217<sup>b</sup> 15 Þó fōrun þár þie liudi tó  
 allaro dago ge·hwi·likes, · þár ūsa drohtin was  
 1219 selbo undar þem gi·sīðje, · unt·þat þár ge·samnod warð  
 meġin·folk mikil · managero þiодо,  
 1221 þoh sie þár alle be ge·likumu · ge·lōbon ni kwámin.  
 weros þurh ênan willjon: · sume sóhtun sie þat waldandes  
 barn,  
 1223 armoro manno filu · —was im átes þarf—,  
 þat sie im þár at þeru mēnigi · mates ɛndi drankes,  
 1225 þigidin at þeru þiodu; · hwand þár was manag þegan só gód,  
 þie ira alamosnje · armun mannun  
 1227 gerno gābun. · Sume wárun sie im eft Judeono kunnjes,  
 fēgni folk·skēpi: · wárun þár ge·farana te þiu,  
 1229 þat sie ūses drohtines · dádjo ɛndi wordo  
 fāron woldun, · habdun im fēknjan hugi,  
 1231 wrēðen willjon: · woldun waldand Krist  
 a·lêdjen þem liudjun, · þat sie is lēron ni hôrdin,

- 1233 ne wēndin aftar is willjon. · Suma wárun sie im eft só wíse  
man,  
wárun im glauwe gumon · ɛndi gode werðe,  
1235 a·lesane undar þem liudjun, · kwámun im þarod be þem léron  
Kristes,  
þat sie is hêlag word · hôrjen móstin,  
1237 línon ɛndi lêstjen: · habdun mid iro ge·lôbon te im  
fasto ge·fangen, · habdun im ferhten hugi,  
1239 wurðun is þegnos te þiu, · þat hé sie an þiod-welon  
aftar iro ên-dagon · up ge·bráhti,  
1241 an godes ríki. · Hé só gerno ant·féng  
man·kunnjes manag · ɛndi mund-burd gi·hét  
1243 te langaru hwílu, · ɛndi mahta só gi·lêstjen wel.  
þó warð þár megin só mikil · umbi þana márjon Krist,  
1245 liudjo ge·samnod: · þó gi·sah hé fon allun landun kuman,  
fon allun wíðun wegun · werod te·samne  
1247 lungro liudjo: · is lof was só wído  
managun ge·márid. · þó gi·wêt im mahtig self  
1249 an ênna berg uppan, · barno ríkjost,  
sundar ge·sittjen, · ɛndi im selbo ge·kôs  
1251 twe·libi ge·talda, · treu·hafta man,  
góðoro gumono, · þea hé im te jungoron forð  
1253 allaro dago ge·hwi·likes, · drohtin welda  
an is ge·sîð·skępja · simblon hebbjan.  
1255 Nēmniða sie þó bi naman · ɛndi hét sie im þó náhor gangan,  
Andreas ɛndi Petrus · êrist sána,  
1257 ge·bróðar twêne, · ɛndi bêðje mid im,  
Jakobus ɛndi Johannes: · sie wárun gode werðe;  
1259 mildi was hé im an is móde; · sie wárun ênes mannes suni  
bêðje bi ge·burdjun; · sie kôs þat barn godes  
1261 góde te jungoron · ɛndi gumono filu,  
márjero manno: · Mattheus ɛndi þomas,  
1263 Judasas twêna · ɛndi Jakob ôðran,  
is selbes swiri: · sie wárun fon gi·sustruonjon twêm  
1265 knósles kumana, · Krist ɛndi Jakob,  
góde gadulingos. · þó habða þero gumono þár  
1267 þe nęrjendo Krist · niguni ge·talde,  
treu·hafte man: · þó hét hé ôk þana te·handon gangan  
1269 selbo mid þem gi·sîðun: · Símon was hé hêtan;



hét ôk Bartholomeus · an þana berg uppan  
 1271 faran fan þem folke áðrum · ɛndi Philippus mid im,  
 treu-hafte man. · Þó géngun sie twe-libi samad,  
 1273 rinkos te þeru rúnu, · þár þe rádand sat,  
 managoro mund-boro, · þe allumu man-kunnje  
 1275 wið hêllje ge·þwing · helpen welde,  
 formon wið þem ferne, · só hwem só frummjen wili  
 1277 só liob-lika lêra, · só hé þem liudjun þár  
 þurh is gi·wit mikil · wísjan hogda.

TODO.

1279 **16** Þó umbi þana nêrjandon Krist · náhor géngun  
 su-líka ge·sīðos, · só hé im selbo ge·kôs,  
 1281 waldand undar þem werode. · Stóðun wísa man,  
 gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,  
 1283 weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,  
 þáhtun ɛndi þagodun, · hwat im þero þiодо drohtin,  
 1285 weldi waldand self · wordun kúðjan  
 þesum liudjun te liobe. · Þan sat im þe landes hirdi  
 1287 gëgin-ward for þem gumun, · godes êgan barn:  
 welda mid is sprákun · spáh-word manag  
 1289 lêrjan þea liudi, · hwó sie lof gode  
 an þesum wer-old-ríkja · wirkjan skoldin.  
 1291 Sat im þó ɛndi swígoda · ɛndi sah sie an lango,  
 was im hold an is hugi · hêlag drohtin,  
 1293 mildi an is móde, · ɛndi þó is mund ant-lók,  
 wísde mid wordun · waldandes sunu  
 1295 manag mār-lík þing · ɛndi þem mannum sagde  
 spáhun wordun, · þem þe hé te þeru spráku þarod,  
 1297 Krist alo-waldo, · ge·kora habda,  
 hwi-like wárin allaro · irmin-manno  
 1299 gode werðoston · gumono kunnjes;  
 sagde im þó te sōðan, · kwað þat þie sálige wárin,  
 1301 man an þesoro middil-gardun, · þie hér an iro móde wárin  
 arme þurh ôð-módi: · „þem is þat êwana ríki,  
 1303 swíðo hêlag-lík · an heban-wange  
 sin-líf far·geben.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin  
 1305 mād-mundja man: · „þie mótun þie mārjon erðe,  
 of·sittjen þat selbe ríki.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin,

- 1307 þie hír wiopin iro wammun dádi; · „þie mótun eft willjon  
ge·bídan,  
frófre an iro frâhon ríkja. · Sálige sind ôk, þe sie hír frumono  
gi·lustid,  
1309 rinkos, þat sie rehto a·dómjen. · Þes mótun sie werðan an  
þem ríkja drohtines  
gi·fullit þurh iro ferhton dádi: · su·líkoro mótun sie frumono  
bi·knégan  
1311 þie rinkos, þie hír rehto a·dómjad, · ne willjad an rúnun  
be·swíkan  
man, þár sie at mahle sittjad. · Sálige sind ôk þem hír mildi  
wirðit  
1313 hugi an hēliðo briostun: · þem wirðit þe hēlego drohtin,  
mildi mahtig selbo. · Sálige sind ôk undar þesaro managon  
þiodu,  
1315 þie hebbjad iro herta gi·hrênod: · þie mótun þane hebanes  
waldand  
sehan an sínun ríkja.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin,  
1317 „þie þe friðu-samo undar þesumu folke libbjod · ėndi ni  
willjad ėniga fehta ge·wirken,  
saka mid iro selboro dáðjun: · þie mótun wesun suni  
drohtines ge·nēmniðe,  
1319 hwanðe hé im wil ge·nádig werðen; · þes mótun sie niotan  
lango  
selbon þes sínes ríkjes.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin  
1321 þie rinkos, þe rehto weldin, · „ėndi þurh þat þolod ríkjoro  
manno  
hęti ėndi harm-kwidi: · þem is ôk an himile eft  
1323 godes wang for·geben · ėndi gēst-lík líf  
aftar te êwan-dage, · só is io ėndi ni kumit,  
1325 welan wun-sames.“ · Só habde þó waldand Krist  
for þem erlom þár · ahto ge·talda  
1327 sálða ge·sagða; · mid þem skal simbla gi·hwe  
himil-ríki ge·halon, · ef hé it hebbjan wili,  
1329 eþþo hé skal te êwan-daga · aftar þarþon  
welun ėndi willjon, · sīðor hé þese wer-old a·gibid,  
1331 erð-líbi-gi·skapu, · ėndi sókit im ôðar liot  
só liof só lêð, · só hé mid þesun liudjun hér

- 1333 gi·werkod an þesoro wer-oldi, · al só it þár þó mid is wordun  
sagde  
Krist alo-waldo, · kuningo ríkjost  
1335 godes êgan barn · jungorun sínun:  
„Gé werðat ôk só sálige“, (kwað hé,) „þes iu saka biodat  
1337 liudi aftar þeson lande · ęndi lêð sprekat,  
hębbjad iu te hoska · ęndi harmes filu  
1339 ge·wirkjad an þesoro wer-oldi · ęndi wíti ge·frummjad,  
fęlgjad iu firin-spráka · ęndi fiund-skepi,  
1341 lāgnjad iuwa lêra, · dót iu lêðes filu,  
harmes þurh iuwan hêrron. · Þes látad gí iuwan hugi simbla,  
1343 líf an lustun, · hwand iu þat lôn stęndit  
an godes ríkja garu, · gódo ge·hwi-likes,  
1345 mikil ęndi manag-fald: · þat is iu te médu far-geban,  
hwand gí hér êr bi-foran · arbid þolodun,  
1347 wíti an þesoro wer-oldi. · Wirs is þem ôðrum,  
gibiðig grimmora þing, · þem þe hér gód êgun,  
1349 wídan worold-welon: · þie for·slítat iro wunnja hér;  
ge·niudot sie ge·nóges, · skulun eft narowaro þing  
1351 aftar iro hin-fęrði · hęliðos þolojan.  
Þan wópjan þár wan-skefti, · þie hér êr an wunnjon sín,  
1353 libbjad an allon lustun, · ne willjad þes far-látan wiht,  
mêni-gi-þahtjo, · þes sie an iro mód spęnit,  
1355 lêðoro gi-léstjo. · Þan im þat lôn kumid,  
ubil arbêd-sam, · þan sie is þane ęndi skulun  
1357 sorgondi ge·sehan. · Þan wirðid im sêr hugi,  
þes sie þesero wer-oldes só filu · willjan ful-gęngun,  
1359 man an iro mód-sebon. · Nú skulun gí im þat mên lahan,  
węrjan mid wordun, · al só ik giu nú ge·wísjan mag,  
1361 sęggjan sôð-líko, · ge·sīðos míne,  
wárun wordun, · þat gí þesoro wer-oldes nú forð  
1363 skulun salt wesana, · sundigero manno,  
bótjan iro balu-dádi, · þat sie an bętara þing,  
1365 folk far-fáhan · ęndi for-látan fiundes gi-werk,  
diubales ge-dádi, · ęndi sókjan iro drohtines ríki.  
1367 Só skulun gí mid iuwon lêrun · liud-folk manag  
węndjan aftar mínon willjon. · Ef iuwar þan a-wirðid hwi-lík,  
1369 far-látid þea lêra, · þea hé léstjan skal,  
þan is im só þem salte, · þe man bi sêes staðe

- 1371 wído te·wirpit: · þan it te wihti ni dôg,  
ak it firiho barn · fótun spurnat,  
1373 gumon an greote. · Só wirðid þem, þe þat godes word skal  
mannum mǫrjan: · ef hé im þan látid is móð twehon,  
1375 þat hí ne willja mid hlutro hugi · te heban-ríkja  
spanen mid is spráku · ędi seggjan spel godes,  
1377 ak węnkid þero wordo, · þan wirðid im waldand gram,  
mahtig módag, · ędi só samo manno barn;  
1379 wirðid allun þan · irmin-þiodun,  
liudjun a·lêðid, · ef is lera ni dugun.“

TODO.

1323 lif | end V/27r; text continues on 32v. 1358 sie | cuts off V

1284 þáhtun ędi þagodun | Found identically in three other places; TODO.

1300 kwað þat þie sǫlga wárin | Beginning the list of beatitudes; cf. 1326b and note.

1305 mǫð-mundja | A hapax, generally assumed to be the same word as English “smooth”, but without the s-mobile.

1326–1327 ahto ge-talda / sǫlda ge-sagda | Sievers (1878) connects the eight-numbering of the Beatitudes to a passage from Hrabanus. TODO.

- 17 Só sprak hé þó spáh-liko · ędi sagda spel godes,  
1382 lérde þe landes ward · liudi síne  
mid hluttru hugju. · Hęliðos stóðun,  
1384 gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swiðo,  
weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,  
1386 þáhtun ędi þagodun, · gi·hórdun þero þiодо drohtin  
seggjan ęw godes · ęldi-barnun;  
1388 gi·hét im heban-ríki · ędi te þem hęliðun sprak:  
„Ók mag ik iu seggjan, · ge·siðos mína,  
1390 wárun wordun, · þat gí þesoro wer-olde nú forð  
skulun lioht wesan · liudjo barnun,  
1392 faḡar mid firihun · oþar folk manag,  
wlitig ędi wun-sam: · ni mugun iuwa werk mikil  
1394 bi·holan werðan, · mid hwi-liko gí sea hugi kűđjat:  
þan mēr þe þiu burg ni mag, · þiu an berge stáð,  
1396 hōh holm-klibu, · bi·holen werðen,  
wrisi-lik gi·werk, · ni mugun iuwa word þan mēr  
1398 an þesoro middil-gard · mannum werðen,  
iuwa dádi bi·dęrnit. · Dót, só ik iu lęrju:  
1400 látad iuwa lioht mikil · liudjun skínan,

manno barnun, · þat sie far·standan iuwan mód-sebon,  
 1402 iuwa werk endi iuwan willjon, · endi þes waldand god  
 mid hluttro hugju, · himiliskan fader,  
 1404 lobon an þesumu liohte, · þes hé iu su-líka lêra far·gaf.  
 Ni skal neoman lioht, þe it habad, · liudjun dērnjan,  
 1406 te hardo be·hwēlþjan, · ak hé it hôho skal  
 an sēli sēttjan, · þat þea ge·sehan mugin  
 1408 alla ge·líko, · þea þár inna sind,  
 hēliðos an hallu. · Þan hald ni skulun gí iuwa hēlag word  
 1410 an þesumu land-skēpa · liudjun dērnjen,  
 hēlið-kunnje far·helan, · ak gé it hôho skulun  
 1412 brēdjan, þat gi·bod godes, · þat it allaro barno ge·hwi-lík,  
 oþar al þit land-skēpi · liudi far·standan  
 1414 endi só ge·frummjen, · só it an forn-dagun  
 tulgo wise man · wordun ge·sprákun,  
 1416 þan sie þana aldan êw · erlos heldun,  
 endi ôk su-líku swiðor, · só ik iu nú sēggjan mag,  
 1418 alloro gumono ge·hwi-lík · gode þionojan,  
 þan it þár an þem aldom · êwa ge·beode.  
 1420 Ni wánjat gí þes mit wihtju, · þat ik bi þiu an þesa wer-old  
 kwámi,  
 þat ik þana aldan êw · irrjen willje,  
 1422 fēlljan undar þesumu folke · efþo þero fora-sagono  
 word wiðar·werpen, · þea hér só gi·wárja man  
 1424 bar-líko ge·budun. · Êr skal bēðju te·faran,  
 himil endi erðe, · þiu nú bi·hlidan standat,  
 1426 êr þan þero wordo · wiht bi·líða  
 un·léstid an þesumu liohte, · þea sie þesum liudjun hér  
 1428 wár-líko ge·budun. · Ni kwam ik an þesa wer-old te þiu,  
 þat ik feldi þero fora-sagono word, · ak ik siu fulljen skal,  
 1430 ôkjon endi nígjan · ēldi-barnum,  
 þesumu folke te frumu. · Þat was forn ge·skriban  
 1432 an þem aldon êo · —ge hôrdun it oft sprekan  
 word-wise man—: · só hwe só þat an þesoro wer-oldi gi·dót,  
 1434 þat hé āðrana · aldru bi·neote,  
 líðu bi·lôsje, · þem skulun liudjo barn  
 1436 dōd a·dēljan. · Þan willjo ik it iu diopor nú,  
 furður bi·fahan: · só hwe só ina þurh fund-skēpi,  
 1438 man wiðar ôðrana · an is mód-sebon

bilgit an is breostun · —hwand sie alle ge-bróðar sint,  
 1440 sálíg folk godes, · sibbjon bi-tennga,  
 man mid mág-skæpi—, · þan wirðit þoh hwe ôðrumu an is  
 móde só gram,  
 1442 líbes weldi ina bi-lôsjen, · of hé mahti gi-lêstjen só:  
 þan is hé sán a-fêhit · ɛndi is þes ferahas skolo,  
 1444 al su-líkes ur-dêljes · só þe ôðar was,  
 þe þurh is hand-megin · hōbdo bi-lōsde  
 1446 erl ôðarna. · Ôk is an þem êo ge-skriban  
 wárun wordun, · só gí wíton alle,  
 1448 þan man is náhiston · niud-líko skal  
 minnjan an is móde, · wesen is mágun hold,  
 1450 gadulingun gód, · wesen is geþa mildi,  
 frâhon is friunda ge-hwane, · ɛndi skal is fiund hatan,  
 1452 wiðer-standen þem mid strídu · ɛndi mid starku hugi,  
 wērjan wiðar wrêðun. · Þan seggjo ik iu te wáron nú,  
 1454 ful-líkur for þesumu folke, · þat gí iuwa fiund skulun  
 minnjon an iuwomu móde, · só samo só gí iuwa mágos dót,  
 1456 an godes namon. · Dót im gódes filu,  
 tōgjat im hluttran hugi, · holda treuwa,  
 1458 liof wiðar ira lêðe. · Þat is lang-sam rád  
 manno só hwi-líkumu, · só is mód te þiu  
 1460 ge-flíhit wiðar is fiunde. · Þan mótun gí þea fruma êgan,  
 þat gí mótun hêten · heban-kuninges suni,  
 1462 is blíði barn. · Ne mugun gí iu bêtaran rád  
 ge-winnan an þesoro wer-oldi. · Þan seggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,  
 1464 barno ge-hwi-líkum, · þat gí ne mugun mid gi-bolgono hugi  
 iuwas gódes wiht · te godes húsun  
 1466 waldande far-geþan, · þat it imu wirðig sí  
 te ant-fáhanne, · só lango só þú fiund-skæpjes wiht,  
 1468 wiðer ôðran man · in-wid hugis.  
 Êr skalt þú þi simbla ge-sónjen · wið þana sak-waldand,  
 1470 ge-módi gi-mahljan: · siðor maht þú mēðmos þína  
 te þem godes altere a-geþan: · þan sind sie þemu góðan werðe  
 1472 heban-kuninge. · Mêr skulun gí aftar is huldi þionon,  
 godes willjon ful-gán, · þan ôðra Judeon duon,  
 1474 ef gí willjat êgan · êwan ríki,  
 sin-líf sehan. · Ôk skal ik iu seggjan noh,  
 1476 hwó it þár an þem aldon · êo ge-biudid,

1478 þat ênig erl ôðres · idis ni bi·swíka,  
 wíf mid wammu. · Þan seggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,  
 1480 þat þár man is siuni mugun · swíðo far·lédjan  
 an mirki mên, · ef hí ina látid is mód spanen,  
 þat hé be·ginna þero girnjan, · þiu imu ge·gangan ni skal.  
 1482 Þan habed hé an imu selbon sán · sundja ge·warhta,  
 ge·heftid an is hertan · helli-wíti.  
 1484 Ef þan þana man is siun wili · eþþa is swíðare hand  
 far·lédjen is liðo hwi·lík · an lédan weg,  
 1486 þan is erlo ge·hwem · ôðar bætara,  
 firirho barno, · þat hé ina fram werpa  
 1488 endi þana lið lósje · af is lík-hamon  
 endi ina áno kuma · up te himile,  
 1490 þan hé só mid allun · te þem Inferne,  
 hwerþe mid só hêlun · an helli-grund.  
 1492 Þan mênid þiu léf·hêd, · þat ênig liudjo ni skal  
 far·folgan is friunde, · ef hé ina an firina spanit,  
 1494 swás man an saka: · þan ne sí hé imu eo só swíðo an sibbjun  
 bi·lang,  
 ne iro mág-skêpi só mikil, · ef hé ina an morð spénit,  
 1496 bêdid balu-werko; · bætara is imu þan ôðar,  
 þat hé þana friund fan imu · fer far·werpa,  
 1498 míðe þes máges · endi ni hebbja þár êniga minnja tó,  
 þat hé móti êno · up ge·stígan  
 1500 hoh himil-ríki, · þan sie helli-ge·þwing,  
 brêd balu-wíti · bêðja gi·sókjan,  
 1502<sup>a</sup> ubil arbidí.

TODO.

1500 hoh | TODO: Critical note (ms. apparently has hó)

1396 holm-klibu | Also found in Beow.

1502<sup>b</sup> 18 Ôk is an þem eo ge·skriban  
 wárun wordun, · só gí witun alle,  
 1504 þat míðe mên-êðos · man-kunnjes ge·hwi·lík,  
 ni for·swerje ina selbon, · hwand þat is sundje te mikil,  
 1506 far·lédid liudi · an lédan weg.  
 Þan willjo ik iu eft seggjan, · þan sán ni swerja neo-man  
 1508 ênigan êð-staf · eldi-barno,

- ne bi himile þemu hōhon, · hwand þat is þes hêrron stól,  
 1510 ne bi erðu þár undar, · hwand þat is þes alo-waldon  
 fagar fôt-skamel, · nek ênig firiho barno  
 1512 ne swerja bi is selbes hōbde, · hwand hé ni mag þár ne swart  
 ne hwít  
 ênig hár ge-wirkjan, · b-útan só it þe hêlago god,  
 1514 ge-markode mahtig; · be-þiu skulun mīðan filu  
 erlos êð-wordo. · Só hwe só it ofto dót,  
 1516 só wirðid is simbla wirsu, · hwand hé imu gi-wardon ni mag.  
 Bi-þiu skal ik iu nú te wárun · wordun gi-beodan,  
 1518 þat gí neo ne swerjen · swiðoron êðos,  
 méron met mannun, · b-útan só ik iu mid mínun hér  
 1520 swiðo wár-liko · wordun ge-biudu:  
 ef man hwemu saka sókja, · bi-seggja þat wáre,  
 1522 kweðe já, gef it sí, · geha þes þár wár is,  
 kweðe nê, af it nis, · láta im ge-nóg an þiu;  
 1524 só hwat só is mēr obar þat · man ge-frummjad,  
 só kumid it al fan ubile · Ƿldi-barnun,  
 1526 þat erl þurh un-treuwa · ôðres ni wili  
 wordo ge-lōbjan. · Ðan seggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,  
 1528 hwó it þár an þem aldon · êo ge-biudit:  
 só hwe só ôgon ge-nimid · ôðres mannes,  
 1530 lōsid af is lík-haman, · eþþa is liðo hwi-líkan,  
 þat hé it eft mid is selbes skal · sán ant-gelden  
 1532 mid ge-likun liðjon. · Ðan willjo ik iu lērjan nú,  
 þat gí só ni wrekan · wrêða dádi,  
 1534 ak þat gí þurh ôð-módi · al ge-þolojan  
 wítjes ęndi wammes, · só hwat só man iu an þesoro wer-oldi  
 ge-dóe.  
 1536 Dóe alloro erlo ge-hwi-lik · ôðrom manne  
 frume ęndi ge-fóri, · só hé willje, þat im firiho barn  
 1538 gódes an-gęgin dóen. · Ðan wirðit im god mildi,  
 liudjo só hwi-likum, · só þat lēstjen wili.  
 1540 Êrod gí arme man, · dēljad iuwan ôð-welon  
 undar þero þurfstigon þiodu; · ne rókjad, hweðar gí is ênigan  
 þank ant-fáhan  
 1542 efþo lôn an þesoro lēhnjon wer-oldi, · ak huggjat te iuwomu  
 leobon hêrran  
 þero geþono te gelde, · þat sie iu god lōno,



- 1544 mahtig mund-boro, · só hwat só gí is þurh is minnes gi·dót.  
 Ef þú þan gebojan wili · góðun mannum  
 1546 fagare feho-skattos, · þár þú eft frumono hugis  
 mêr ant-fáhan, · te hwi hábas þú þes êniga méða fon gode  
 1548 eþþa lôn an þemu is liohte, · hwand þat is lêhni feho?  
 Só is þes alles ge·hwat, · þe þú ôðrun ge·duos  
 1550 liudjon te leobe, · þár þú hugis eft ge·lík neman  
 þero wordo êndi þero werko: · te hwi wêt þi þes úsa waldand  
 þank,  
 1552 þes þú þín só bi·filhis · êndi ant-fáhis eft þan þú wili?  
 iuwan ôð-welon · geban gí þem armun mannun,  
 1554 þe ina iu an þesoro wer-oldi ne lônnon · êndi rómot te iuwes  
 waldandes ríkja.  
 Te hlúd ni dó þú it, · þan þú mid þínun handun bi·felhas  
 1556 þína alamosna þemu armon manne, · ak dó im þurh  
 ôð-módjen  
 gerno þurh godes þank: · þan móst þú eft geld niman,  
 1558 swiðo liof·lík lôn, · þár þú is lango bi·þarft,  
 fagaroro frumono. · Só hwat só þú is só þurh ferhtan hugi  
 1560 darno ge·dêljas, · —so is úsumu drohtine werð—  
 ne galpo þú far þínun gebun te swiðo, · noh ênig gumono ne  
 skal,  
 1562 þat siu im þurh ídale hróm · eft ni werðe  
 lêð-líko far·loren. · Þanna þú skalt lôn nemen  
 1564 fora godes ôgun · góðero werko.  
 Ôk skal ik iu ge·beodan, · þan gí willjad te bedu hnígan  
 1566 êndi willjad te iuwomu hêrron · helpono biddjan,  
 þat hé iu a·láte · lêðes þinges,  
 1568 þero sakono êndi þero sundjono, · þea gí iu selbon hír  
 wrêða ge·wirkjad, · þat gí it þan for ôðrumu werode ni duad:  
 1570 ni márjad it far mênigi, · þat iu þes man ni loðon,  
 ni diurjan þero dádjo, · þat gí iuwes drohtines gi·bed  
 1572 þurh þat ídala hróm · al ne far·leosan.  
 Ak þan gí willjan te iuwomo hêrron · helpono biddjan,  
 1574 þiggjan þeo-líko, · —þes iu is þarf mikil—  
 þat iu sigi-drohtin · sundjono tómja,  
 1576 þan dót gí þat só darno: · þoh wêt it iuwe drohtin self  
 hêlag an himile, · hwand imu nis bi·holan n·eo-wiht  
 1578 ne wordo ne werko. · Hé látid it þan al ge·werðan só,

só gí ina þan biddjad, · þan gí te þero bedo hnígað  
 1580 mid hluttru hugi.“ · Hēliðos stóðun,  
 gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,  
 1582 weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,  
 þáhtun ĕndi þagodun, · was im þarf mikil,  
 1584 þat sie þat eft ge·hogdin, · þat im þat hēлага barn  
 an þana forman sið · filu mid wordun  
 1586 torhtes ge·talde. · Þó sprak im eft ĕn þero twe-libjo an·gegin,  
 glauworo gumono, · te þem godes barne:

TODO.

1575 sigi-drohtin | Cf. OE *sige-dryhten*. TODO?

1588 19 „Hērro þe gódo“, (kwað hē,) „ūs is þínoro huldi þarf,  
 te gi·wirkenne þinna willjon, · ĕndi ók þínoro wordo só self,  
 1590 allaro barno bēst, · þat þú ūs bedon lēres,  
 jungoron þíne, · só Johannes duot,  
 1592 diur-lík dōperi, · dago ge·hwi-líkas  
 is werod mid wordun, · hwi sie waldand skulun,  
 1594 góðan grótjan. · Dó þína jungoron só self:  
 ge·rihti ūs þat ge·rúni.“ · Þó habða eft þe ríkjo garu  
 1596 sán aftar þíu, · sunu drohtines,  
 gód word an·gegin: · „Þan gí god willjan“, kwað hē,  
 1598 „weros mid iuwon wordun · waldand grótjan,  
 allaro kuningo kraftigostan, · þan kweðað gi, só ik iu lērju:  
 1600 ,Fadar ūsa · firiho barno,  
 þú bist an þem hōhon · himila ríkja,  
 1602 ge·wíhid sí þín namo · wordo ge·hwi-líko.  
 Kuma þín · kraftag ríki.  
 1604 Werða þín willjo · obar þesa wer-old alla,  
 só sama an erðo, · só þár uppa ist  
 1606 an þem hōhon · himilo ríkja.  
 Gef ūs dago ge·hwi-líkes rád, · drohtin þe gódo,  
 1608 þína hēлага helpa, · ĕndi a-lát ūs, hebanes ward,  
 managoro mēn-skuldjo, · al só we öðrum mannum dóan.  
 1610 Ne lát ūs far·lédjan · lēða wihti  
 só forð an iro willjon, · só wí wirðige sind,  
 1612 ak help ūs wiðar allun · ubilon dádjun.  
 Só skulun gí biddjan, · þan gí te bede hnígað  
 1614 weros mid iuwom wordun, · þat iu waldand god

lêðes a·lâte · an leut-kunnja.  
 1616 Ef gí þan willjad a·látan · liudjo ge·hwi·líkun  
 þero sakono ęndi þero sundjono, · þe sie wið iu selbon hír  
 1618 wrêða ge·wirkjat, · þan a·látid iu waldand god,  
 fadar ala-mahtig · firin-werk mikil,  
 1620 managoro mên-skuldjo. · Ef iu þan wirðid iuwa mód te stark,  
 þat gí ne wiljat ôðrun · erlun a·látan,  
 1622 weron wam-dádi, · þan ne wil iu ôk waldand god  
 grim-werk far·geban, · ak gí skulun is geld niman,  
 1624 swiðo lêð-lik lôn · te languru hwílu,  
 alles þes un-rehtes, · þes gí ôðrum hír  
 1626 gi·lêstjad an þesumu liohte · ęndi þan wið liudjo barn  
 þea saka ni gi·sónjad, · êr gí an þana sið faran,  
 1628 weros fon þesoro wer-oldi. · Ôk skal ik iu te wárun sęggjan,  
 hwó gi lêstjan skulun · lêra mína:  
 1630 þan gí iuwa fastonnja · frummjan willjan,  
 minson iuwa mên-dádi, · þan ni duad gí þat te managom küð,  
 1632 ak miðad is far ôðrum mannun: · þoh wêt mahtig god,  
 waldand iuwan willjan, · þoh iu werod ôðar,  
 1634 liudjo barn ne lobon. · Hé gildid is iu lôn aftar þiu,  
 iuwa hêlag fadar · an himil-ríkja,  
 1636 þes ge im mid su·líkun ôð-módja, · erlos þeonod,  
 só ferht-liko undar þesumu folke. · Ne willjat feho winnan  
 1638 erlos an un-reht, · ak wirkjad up te gode  
 man aftar médu: · þat is mêra þing,  
 1640 þan man hír an erðu · ôdag libbja,  
 wer-old-skattes ge·wono. · Ef gí willjad mínun wordun  
 hôrjan,  
 1642 þan ne samnod gí hír sink mikil · siløbres ne goldes  
 an þesoro middil-gard, · mêðom-hordes,  
 1644 hwand it rotat hír an roste, · ęndi regin-þeobos far·stelad,  
 wurmi a·wardjad, · wirðid þat gi·wádi far·slitan,  
 1646 ti·gangid þe gold-welo. · Lêstjad iuwa gódon werk,  
 samnod iu an himile · hord þat méra,  
 1648 fagara feho-skattos: · þat ni mag iu ęnig fund be·niman,  
 ne·wiht an·węndjan, · hwand þe welo standid  
 1650 garu iu te·gęgnes, · só hwat só gí gódes þarod,  
 an þat himil-ríki · hordes ge·samnod,



1684 waldand an willjon sínan. · Be·þiu ne þurbon gí umbi iuwa  
ge·wádi sorgon,  
ne gornot gí umbi iuwa ge·gariwi te swíðo: · god wili is alles  
rádan,  
1686 helpan fan hebanes wange, · ef gí willjad aftar is huldi þeonon.  
Gerot gí simbla êrist þes godes ríkjas, ·  ndi þan duat aftar  
þem is g dun werkun,  
1688 r mod g  rehtoro þingo: · þan wili iu þe r kjo drohtin  
gebon mid alloro g du ge·hwi·líku, · ef g  im þus ful·gangan  
willjad,  
1690 s  ik iu te w run h r · wordun seggjo.

TODO.

1656 ant·þengjan | so *M*; a·þengjan (*norm.*) *C*

1603 *Kuma þín* | A three-syllable line, which is otherwise unmetrical in Old Saxon. Its presence suggests that the poet is following the text of his source particularly closely and therefore is willing to sacrifice meter for the sake of sense.

1645 *wurmi a·wardjad* | Sounds very similar to ‘dragons guard it’, but the sense of *a·w rdjan* is ‘destroy’.

20 Ne skulun g   nigumu manne · un-rehtes wiht,  
1692 d rbjes a·d ljan, · hwand þe d m eft kumid  
obar þana selbon man, · þ r it im te sorgon skal,  
1694 wer an þem te witja, · þe h r mid is wordun ge·sprikid  
un-reht   rum. · Neo þat iuwar  nig ne dua  
1696 gumono an þesom gardon · geldes e  o k pes,  
þat h  un-reht gi·met ·   rumu manne  
1698 m n-ful mako, · hwand it simbla m tjan skal  
erlo ge·hwi·líkomu, · su·lík s  h  it   rumu ge·d d,  
1700 s  kumid it im eft te·g gnes, · þ r h  gerno ne wili  
ge·sehan is sundjon. ·  k skal ik iu seggjan noh,  
1702 hw r g  iu wardon skulun · w tjo m sta,  
m n-werk manag: · te hw  skalt þ   nigan man be·sprekan,  
1704 br  ar þ nan, · þat þ  undar is br h n ge·sehas  
halm an is  gon, ·  ndi ge·huggjan ni wili  
1706 þana sw ran balkon, · þe þ  an þ noro siuni habas,  
hard trio  ndi h big. · L t þi þat an þ nan hugi fallan,  
1708 hw  þ  þana  rist a·l sjas: · þan skínid þi lioht be·foran,  
 gun wer ad þi ge·oponot; · þan maht þ  aftar þiu  
1710 sw ses mannes ge·siun · s  or ge·b tjan,

- ge·hêljan an is hōbde. · Só mag þat an is hugi mēra  
 1712 an þesoro middil-gard · manno ge·hwi-líkumu,  
 wes an þesoro wer-oldi, · þat hí hír wammas ge·duot,  
 1714 þan hí ahtoja · ððres mannes  
 saka ęndi sundja, · ęndi haþad im selbo mēr  
 1716 firin-werko ge·frumid. · Ef hé wili is fruma lēstjan,  
 þan skal hí ina selbon êr · sundjono a·tómjan,  
 1718 lêð-werko lōson: · siðor mag hí mid is lērun werðan  
 hēliðun te helpu, · siðor hí ina hluttran wēt,  
 1720 sundjono sikoran. · Ne skulun gí swinum te·foran  
 iuwa mēre-griton makon · eþþo mēðmo ge·striuni,  
 1722 hēlag hals-męni, · hwand siu it an horu spurnat,  
 sulwjad an sande: · ne witun súbrjas ge·skēð,  
 1724 faġaroro fratoho. · Su-lík sint hír folk manag,  
 þe iuwa hēlag word · hōrjan ne willjad,  
 1726 ful-gangan godes lērun: · ne witun gódes ge·skēð,  
 ak sind im lári word · leoboron mikilu,  
 1728 umbi·þarbi þing, · þanna þeot-godes  
 werk ęndi willjo. · Ne sind sie wirðige þan,  
 1730 þat sie ge·hōrjan iuwa hēlag word, · ef sie is ne willjad an iro  
 hugi þenkjan,  
 ne línon ne lēstjan. · Þem ni seġġjan gí iuworo lēron wiht,  
 1732 þat gí þea spráka godes · ęndi spel managu  
 ne far·leosan an þem liudjun, · þea þár ne willjan gi·lōþjan tó,  
 1734 wároro wordo. · Òk skulun gí iu wardon filu  
 listjun undar þesun liudjun, · þár gí aftar þesumu lande farad,  
 1736 þat iu þea luggjon ne mugin · lēron be·swíkan  
 ni mid wordun ni mid werkun. · Sie kumad an su-líkom  
 ge·wádjon te iu,  
 1738 faġoron fratohon: · þoh hēbbjad sie fēknan hugi:  
 þea mugun gí sán ant·kennjan, · só gí sie kuman ge·sehad:  
 1740 sie sprekað wís-lík word, · þoh iro werk ne dugin,  
 þero þegno ge·þáhti. · Hwand gí witun, þat eo an þornjun ne  
 skulun  
 1742 wín-beri wes an · eþþa welon eo·wiht,  
 faġororo fruhtjo, · nek ðk figun ne lesað  
 1744 hēliðos an hiopon. · Þat mugun gí undar·huggjan wel,  
 þat eo þe ubilo bôm, · þár hé an erðu stáð,  
 1746 góden wastum ne gíbid, · nek it ðk god ni ge·skóp,

1748 þat þe gódo bôm · gumono barnun  
 bári bittres wiht, · ak kumid fan alloro bâmo ge·hwi-líkumu  
 su-lík wastom te þesero wer-oldi, · só im fan is wurtjon  
 ge·dregid,  
 1750 eþþa berht eþþa bittar. · Þat mênid þoh breost-hugi,  
 managoro mód-sebon · manno kunnjes,  
 1752 hwó alloro erlo ge·hwi-lík · ôgit selbo,  
 meldod mid is müðu, · hwi-líkan hé mód habad,  
 1754 hugi umbi is herte: · þes ni mag hé far·helan eo-wiht,  
 ak kumad fan þem ubilan man · in-wid-rádos,  
 1756 bittara balu-spráka, · su-lík só hí an is breostun habad  
 ge·heftid umbi is herte: · simbla is hugi küðid,  
 1758 is willjon mid is wordun, · endi farad is werk aftar þiu.  
 Só kumad fan þemu góðan manne · glau and-wordi,  
 1760 wís-lík fan is ge·wittja, · þat hí simbla mid is wordu ge·sprikid,  
 man mid is míoðu su-lík, · só hé an is móde habad  
 1762 hord umbi is herte. · Þanan kumad þea hêlagan lêra,  
 swiðo wun-sam word, · endi skulun is werk aftar þiu  
 1764 þeodu ge·þíhan, · þegnun managun  
 werðan te willjon, · al só it waldand self  
 1766 góðun mannun far·gibid, · god alo-mahtig,  
 himilisk hêrro, · hwand sie áno is helpa ni mugun  
 1768 ne mid wordun ne mid werkun · wiht a·þengjan  
 gódes an þesun gardun. · Be·þiu skulun gumono barn  
 1770 an is ênes kraft · alle gi-lôbjan.

TODO.

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1714 ahtoja | ‘hatogea’ *M*

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1722 hêlag hals-mēni | In an interesting example of cultural adaptation, OHG Tatian 39:7 *beilagaz* ‘that which is holy’ is concretized as a “holy neck-ring”, an important type of object in pre-Christian Germanic society commonly found in archeological excavations. We must assume that such rings were still not entirely uncommon in Old Saxony in the 830s, when *Heli* was written.

1771 21 Ôk skal ik iu wísjan, · hwó hír wegos twêna  
 liggjad an þesumu liohte, · þea farad liudjo barn,  
 1773 al irmin-þiod. · Pero is ôðar sán  
 wid stráta endi brêd, · —farid sie werodes filu,  
 1775 man-kunnjes manag, · hwand sie þarod iro mód spēnit,  
 wer-old-lusta weros— · þiu an þea wirson hand  
 1777 liudi lēdid, · þár sie te far·lora werðad,

- 1779 hēliðos an hēllju, · þár is hēt ėndi swart,  
 ęgis-lík an innan: · ôði ist þarod te faranne  
 ęldi-barnun, · þoh it im at þemu ėndje ni dugi.  
 1781 Þan ligid eft ôðar · ęngira mikilu  
 weg an þesoro wer-oldi, · fėrid ina werodes lút,  
 1783 fāho folk-skepi: · ni willjad ina firiho barn  
 gerno gangan, · þoh hé te godes ríkja,  
 1785 an þat êwiga líf, · erlos lédja.  
 Þan nimad gí iu þana ęngjan: · þoh hé só ôði ne sí  
 1787 firihon te faranne, · þoh skal hí te frumu werðan  
 só hwemu só ina þurh-gęngid, · só skal is geld niman,  
 1789 swíðo lang-sam lôn · ėndi líf êwig,  
 diur-líkan drôm. · Eo gí þes drohtin skulun,  
 1791 waldand biddjen, · þat gí þana weg mótin  
 fan foran ant-fāhan · ėndi forð þurh gi-gangan  
 1793 an þat godes ríki. · Hé ist garu simbla  
 wiðar þiu te gebanne, · þe man ina gerno bidid,  
 1795 fergot firiho barn. · Sókjad fadar iuwan  
 up te þemu êwinom ríkja: · þan mótun gí ina aftar þiu  
 1797 te iuworu frumu fíðan. · Kúðjad iuwa fard þarod  
 at iuwas drohtines durun: · þan werðad iu an-dón aftar þiu,  
 1799 himil-portun ant-hlidan, · þat gí an þat hêlage lioht,  
 an þat godes ríki · gangan mótun,  
 1801 sin-líf sehan. · Ôk skal ik iu sęggjan noh  
 far þesumu werode allun · wár-lík biliði,  
 1803 þat alloro liudjo só hwi-lík, · só þesa mína lēra wili  
 ge-haldan an is herton · ėndi wil iro an is hugi a-þenkjan,  
 1805 lēstjan sea an þesumu lande, · þe gi-líko duot  
 wísumu manne, · þe gi-wit haðad,  
 1807 horska hugi-skefti, · ėndi hús-stędi kiusid  
 an fastoro foldun · ėndi an felisa uppan  
 1809 wêgos wirkid, · þár im wind ni mag,  
 ne wág ne watares strôm · wihtju ge-tiunjan,  
 1811 ak mag im þár wið un-gi-widerjon · allun standan  
 an þemu felise uppan, · hwand it só fasto warð  
 1813 gi-stęllit an þemu stēne: · ant-haðad it þiu stędi niðana,  
 wręðid wiðar winde, · þat it wíkan ni mag.  
 1815 Só duot eft manno só hwi-lík, · só þesun mínun ni wili  
 lêrun hôrjen · ne þero lēstjen wiht;



1817 só duot þe un-wíson · erla ge·líko,  
 un-ge·wittigon were, · þe im be watares staðe  
 1819 an sande wili · sæli-hús wirkjan,  
 þár it westrani wind · çndi wágo strôm,  
 1821 sêes ððjon te·sláad; · ne mag im sand çndi greot  
 ge·wræðjan wið þemu winde, · ak wirðid te·worpan þan,  
 1823 te·fallen an þemu flóde, · hwand it an fastoro nis  
 erðu ge·timbrod. · Só skal allaro erlo ge·hwes  
 1825 werk ge·þíhan wiðar þiu, · þe hí þius mín word frumid,  
 haldid hêlag ge·bod.“ · Þó bi·gunnun an iro hugi wundron  
 1827 megin-folk mikil: · ge·hôrdun mahtiges godes  
 liof·líka lêra; · ne wárun an þemu lande ge·wuno,  
 1829 þat sie eo fan su·líkun êr · seggjan ge·hôrdin  
 wordun eþþo werkun. · Far·stôdun wíse man,  
 1831 þat hé só lêrde, · liudjo drohtin,  
 wárun wordun, · só hé ge·wald habde,  
 1833 allun þem un-ge·líko, · þe þár an êr-dagun  
 undar þem liud-skêþja · lêrjon wárun  
 1835 a·koran undar þemu kunnje: · ne habdun þiu Kristes word  
 ge·makon mid mannun, · þe hé far þero mænigi sprak,  
 1837<sup>a</sup> ge·bôd uppan þemu berge.

TODO.

1837<sup>b</sup> 22

Hé im þó bêðju be·falh

te ge·seggennja · sínom wordun,  
 1839 hwó man himil·ríki · ge·halon skoldi,  
 wíð-brêðan welan, · gia hé im ge·wald far·gaf,  
 1841 þat sie móstin hêljan · halte çndi blinde,  
 liudjo léf·hêdi, · legar-bêð manag,  
 1843 swára suhti, · giak hé im selbo ge·bôd,  
 þat sie at ênigumu manne · méde ne námin,  
 1845 diurje mêðmos: · „ge·huggjad gi“, kwað hé, „hwand iu is þiu  
 dád kuman,  
 þat ge·wit çndi þe wís·dóm, · çndi iu þea ge·wald far·gibid  
 1847 alloro firího fadar, · só gí sie ni þurbun mid ênigo feho kôpon,  
 méðjan mid ênigun mêðmun,— · só wesat gí iro mannun forð  
 1849 an iuwon hugi-skêftjun · helpono mildja,  
 lêrjad gí liudjo barn · lang-samna rád,  
 1851 fruma forð-wardes; · firin-werk lahad,

- swára sundjon. · Ne látad iu silōbar nek gold  
 1853 wihti þes wirðig, · þat it eo an iuwa ge·wald kuma,  
 fagara feho-skattos: · it ni mag iu te ênigoro frumu hwęgin,  
 1855 werðan te ênigumu willjon. · Ne skulun gí ge·wádjas þan mēr  
 erlos êgan, · b·utan só gí þan an hębbjan,  
 1857 gumon te garewja, · þan gí gangan skulun  
 an þat gi·mang innan. · Neo gí umbi iuwan męti ni sorgot,  
 1859 lęng umbi iuwa lif·nare, · hwand þene lęrjand skulun  
 fódjan þat folk·skępi: · þes sint þea fruma werða,  
 1861 leob·likes lōnes, · þe hí þem liudjun sagad.  
 wirðig is þe wurhtjo, · þat man ina wel fódja,  
 1863 þana man mid mósu, · þe só managoro skal  
 seola bi·sorgan · ęndi an þana sið spanen,  
 1865 gęstos an godes wang. · Þat is grôtara þing,  
 þat man bi·sorgon skal · seolun managa,  
 1867 hwó man þea ge·halde · te heban·ríkja,  
 þan man þene lík·hamon · liudi·barno  
 1869 mósu bi·morna. · Be·þiu man skulun  
 haldan þene hold·líko, · þe im te heban·ríkja  
 1871 þene weg wísit · ęndi sie wam·skaðun,  
 feondun wit·fáhit · ęndi firin·werk lahid,  
 1873 swára sundjon. · Nú ik iu sęndjan skal  
 aftar þesumu land·skępje · só lamb undar wulbos:  
 1875 só skulun gí undar iuwa fiund faren, · undar filu þeodo,  
 undar mis·like man. · Hębbjad iuwan mód wiðar þem  
 1877 só glauwan te·gęgnes, · só samo só þe gelwo wurm,  
 nádra þiu fęha, · þár siu iro níð·skępjes,  
 1879 witodes wánit, · þat man iu undar þemu werode ne mugi  
 be·swikan an þemu siðe. · Far þiu gí sorgon skulun,  
 1881 þat iu þea man ni mugin · mód·ge·þáhti,  
 willjan a·wardjen. · Wesat iu so wara wiðar þiu,  
 1883 wið iro fęknjon dádjun, · só man wiðar fiundun skal.  
 Þan wesat gí eft an iuwon dádjun · dúbon ge·líka,  
 1885 hębbjad wið erlo ge·hwene · ên·faldan hugi,  
 mildjan mód·sebon, · þat þár man neg·ên  
 1887 þurh iuwa dádi · be·drogan ne werðe,  
 be·swikan þurh iuwa sundja. · Nú skulun gí an þana sið faran,  
 1889 an þat ârundi: · þár skulun gí arbidjes só filu  
 ge·þolon undar þeru þiod · ęndi ge·þwing só samo

- 1891 manag çndi mis-lik, · hwand gí an mínunu namon  
þea liudi lêrjat. · Be·þiu skulun gí þár lêðes filu  
1893 fora wer-old-kuningun, · witjas ant-fáhan.  
Oft skulun gí þár for ríkja · þurh þius mín rehtun word  
1895 ge·bundane standen · çndi bêðju ge·pologan,  
ge hosk ge harm-kwidi: · umbi þat ne látad gí iuwan hugi  
twíflon,  
1897 sebon swíkandjan: · gí ni þurbun an ênigun sorgun wesun  
an iuwomu hugi hwergin, · þan man iu for þea hêri forð  
1899 an þene gast-seli · gangan hêtid,  
hwat gí im þan te·gêgnes skulin · góðoro wordo,  
1901 spáh-likoro ge·sprekan, · hwand iu þiu spód kumid,  
helpe fon himile, · çndi sprikid þe hêlogo gêst,  
1903 mahtig fon iuwomu munde. · Be·þiu ne an·dráðad gí iu þero  
manno nið  
ne forhtjat iro fiund-skêpi: · þoh sie hêbbjan iuwas ferahes  
ge·wald,  
1905 þat sie mugin þene lik-hamon · líbu be·neotan,  
a·slahan mid swerde, · þoh sie þeru seolon ne mugun  
1907 wiht a·wardjan. · Ant·dráðad iu waldand god,  
forhtjad fader iuwan, · frummjad gerno  
1909 is ge·bod-skêpi, · hwand hí habad bêðjes gi·wald,  
liudjo líbes · çndi ôk iro lik-hamon  
1911 gek þero seolon só self: · ef gí iuwa an þem sîðe þarod  
far·liosat þurh þesa lêra, · þan mótun gí sie eft an þemu liohte  
godes  
1913 be·foran fîðan, · hwand sie fader iuwa,  
haldid hêlag god · an himil-ríkja.

TODO.

1877 gelwo wurm | TODO: Note on this wyrm. Biblical or Saxon?

- 1915 23 Ne kumat þea alle te himile, · þea þe hér hrópat te mí  
manno te mund-burd. · Managa sind þero,  
1917 þea willjad alloro dago ge·hwi-likes · te drohtine hnígan,  
hrópad þár te helpu · çndi huggjad an ôðar,  
1919 wirkjad wam-dádi: · ne sind im þan þiu word fruma,  
ak þea mótun hwerban · an þat himiles liot,  
1921 gangan an þat godes ríki, · þea þes gerne sint,  
þat sie hír ge·frummjen · fader ala-waldan

- 1923 werk ɛndi willjon. · Ʒea ni þurbun mid wordun só filu  
hrópan te helpu, · hwanda þe hêlogo god
- 1925 wêt alloro manno ge·hwes · mód-ge·þáhti,  
word ɛndi willjon, · ɛndi gildid im is werko lôn.
- 1927 Be·þiu skulun gí sorgon, · þan gí an þene sīð farad,  
hwó gí þat ârundi · ti ɛndja be·brengen.
- 1929 Þan gí líðan skulun · aftar þesumu land-skepja,  
wído aftar þesoro wer-oldi, · al só iu wegos lédjad,
- 1931 brêd stráta te burg, · simbla sókjad gí iu þene bêtston sán  
man undar þeru mēnegi · ɛndi kûðjad imu iuwan móð-sebon
- 1933 wárun wordun. · Ef sie þan þes wirðige sint,  
þat sie iuwa gódun werk · gerno ge-léstjen
- 1935 mid hluttru hugi, · þan gí an þemu húse mid im  
wonod an willjon · ɛndi im wel lônod,
- 1937 geldad im mid gódu · ɛndi sie te gode selbon  
wordun ge·wíhad · ɛndi seggjad im wissan friðu,
- 1939 hêlaga helpa · heban-kuninges.  
Ef sie þan só sáliga · þurh iro selboro dád
- 1941 werðan ni mótun, · þat sie iuwa werk frummjen,  
léstjen iuwa lêra, · þan gí fan þem liudjun sán,
- 1943 farad fan þemu folke, · —þe iuwa friðu hwirbid  
eft an iuworo selboro sīð,— · ɛndi látad sie mid sundjun forð,
- 1945 mid balu-werkun búan · ɛndi sókjad iu burg ôðra,  
mikil man-werod, · ɛndi ne látad þes melmes wiht
- 1947 folgan an iuwom fótun, · þanan þe man iu ant-fáhan ne wili,  
ak skuddjat it fan iuwon skóhun, · þat it im eft te skamu  
werðe,
- 1949 þemu werode te ge·wit-skepje, · þat iro willjo ne dôg.  
Þan seggjo ik iu te wárun, · só hwan só þius wer-old ɛndjad
- 1951 ɛndi þe márjo dag · oðar man farid,  
þat þan Sodomoburg, · þiu hír þurh sundjon warð
- 1953 an af-grundi · êldes kraftu,  
fiuru bi·fallen, · þat þiu þan hábad friðu mêran,
- 1955 mildiran mund-burd, · þan þea man êgin,  
þe iu hír wiðar·werpat · ɛndi ne willjad iuwa word frummjen.
- 1957 Só hwe só iu þan ant-fáhit · þurh ferhtan hugi,  
þurh mildjan mód, · só hábad mínan forð
- 1959 willjon ge·warhten · ɛndi ôk waldand god,  
ant-fangan fader iuwan, · firiho drohtin,

- 1961 ríkjan rád-gebon, · þene þe al reht bi·kan.  
wêt waldand self, · ɛndi willjan lônot
- 1963 gumono ge·hwi·líkumu, · só hwat só hí hír gódes ge·duot,  
þoh hí þurh minnja godes · manno hwi·líkumu
- 1965 willjandi far·gebe · watares drinkan,  
þat hí þurftigumu manne · þurst ge·hêlje,
- 1967 kaldes brunnan. · Þesa kwidi werðad wára,  
þat eo ne bi·líbid, · ne hí þes lôn skuli,
- 1969 fora godes ôgun · geld ant·fahan,  
méda manag-falde, · só hwat só hí is þurh mína minnja  
ge·duot.
- 1971 Só hwe só mín þan far·lôgnid · liudi·barno,  
hêlido for þesoro hêrju, · só dóm ik is an himile só self
- 1973 þár uppe far þem alo-waldan fader · ɛndi for allumu is ɛngilo  
krafte,  
far þeru mikilon mênigi. · Só hwi·lík só þan eft manno barno
- 1975 an þesoro wer-oldi ne wili · wordun miðan,  
ak gihit far gum-skêpi, · þat hé mín jungoro sí,
- 1977 þene willju ek eft ôgjan · far ôgun godes,  
fora alloro firiho fader, · þár folk manag
- 1979 for þene alo-waldon · alla gangad  
reðinon wið þene ríkjón. · Þár willju ik imu an reht wesán
- 1981 mildi mund-boro, · só hwemu só mínun hír  
wordun hôrid · ɛndi þiu werk frumid,
- 1983 þea ik hír an þesumu berge uppan · ge·boden hêbbju.“  
Habda þó te wárun · waldandes sunu
- 1985 ge·lêrid þea liudi, · hwó sie lof gode  
wirkjan skoldin. · Þó lét hí þat werod þanan
- 1987 an alloro halba ge·hwi·líka, · hêri-skêpi manno  
síðon te sełðon. · Habdun selbes word,
- 1989 ge·hôrid heban-kuninges · hêlaga lêra,  
só eo te wer-oldi sint · wordo ɛndi dádjo,
- 1991 man-kunnjes manag · oðar þesan middil-gard  
sprákono þiu spáhiron, · só hwe só þiu spel ge·frang,
- 1993 þea þár an þemu berge ge·sprak · barno ríkjast.

TODO.

- 24 Ge·wêt imu þó umbi þrea naht aftar þiu · þesoro þiодо drohtin  
1995 an Galileo land, · þár hé te ênum gómum warð,

ge·bedan þat barn godes: · þár skolda man êna brúð geban,  
 1997 muna-líka magað. · Þár Maria was,  
 mid iro suni selbo, · sálíg þiorna,  
 1999 mahtiges móder. · Managoro drohtin  
 géng imu þó mid is jungoron, · godes êgan barn,  
 2001 an þat hôha hús, · þár þiu hêri drank,  
 þea Judeon an þemu gast-seli: · hé im ôk at þem gômun was,  
 2003 giak hí þár ge·küðde, · þat hí habda kraft godes,  
 helpa fan himil-fader, · hêlagna gêst,  
 2005 waldandes wís-dóm. · Werod bliðode,  
 wárun þár an luston · liudi at·samne,  
 2007 gumon glad-módje. · Géngun ambaht-man,  
 skenjon mid skálun, · drógun skírjane wín  
 2009 mid orkun êndi mid alo-fatun; · was þár erlo drôm  
 fagar an fletta, · þó þár folk undar im  
 2011 an þem þenkjon só bêtst · bliðsja af·hóbun,  
 wárun þár an wunnjun. · Þó im þes wínes brast,  
 2013 þem liudjun þes líðes: · is ni was far·lêbid wiht  
 hwergin an þemu húse, · þat for þene hêri forð  
 2015 skenjon drógin, · ak þiu skapu wárun  
 líðes a·láríd. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,  
 2017 þat it sán ant·funda · frío skônjosta,  
 Kristes móder: · géng wið iro kind sprekan,  
 2019 wið iro sunu selbon, · sagda im mid wordun,  
 þat þea werdos þó mêt · wínes ne habdun  
 2021 þem gëstjun te gômun. · Siu þó gerno bad,  
 þat is þe hêlogo Krist · helpa ge·riedi  
 2023 þemu werode te willjon. · Þó habda eft is word garu  
 mahtig barn godes · êndi wið is móder sprak:  
 2025 „Hwat ist mí êndi þí“, (kwað hé,) „umbi þesoro manno lið,  
 umbi þeses werodes wín? · Te hwi sprikis þú þes, wíf, só filu,  
 2027 manos mí far þesoro mēnigi? · Ne sint mína noh  
 tídi kumana.“ · Þan þoh gi·trúoda siu wel  
 2029 an iro hugi-skëftjun, · hêlag þiorne,  
 þat is aftar þem wordun · waldandes barn,  
 2031 hêljandoro bêtst · helpan weldi.  
 Hét þó þea ambaht-man · idiso skônjost,  
 2033 skenjon êndi skap-wardos, · þea þár skoldun þero skolu  
 þionon,

2035 þat sie þes ne word ne werk · wiht ne far·létin,  
 þes sie þe hêlogo Krist · hêtan weldi  
 lêstjan far þem liudjun. · Lárja stóðun þár  
 2037 stên-fatu sehsi. · Þó só stillo ge·bôð  
 mahtig barn godes, · só it þár manno filu  
 2039 ne wissa te wárun, · hwó hé it mid is wordu ge·sprak;  
 hé hét þea skênkjon · þó skírjas watares  
 2041 þiu fatu fulljen, · êndi hí þár mid is fingrun þó,  
 segnade selbo · sínun handun,  
 2043 warhte it te wíne · êndi hét is an ên wêgi hlaðen,  
 skêppjen mid ênoro skálon, · êndi þó te þem skênkjon sprak,  
 2045 hét is þero gêstjo, · þe at þem gômun was  
 þemu hêroston · an hand geban,  
 2047 ful mid folmun, · þemu þe þes folkes þár  
 ge·wêld aftar þemu werde. · Reht só hí þes wínes ge·drank,  
 2049 só ni mahte hé be·miðan, · ne hí far þeru mênigi sprak  
 te þemu brúdi-gumon, · kwað þat simbla þat bêtste líð  
 2051 alloro erlo ge·hwi-lík · êrist skoldi  
 geban at is gômun: · „undar þiu wirðid þero gumono hugi  
 2053 a·wêkid mid wínu, · þat sie wel bliðod,  
 drunken drômjad. · Þan mag man þár dragan aftar þiu  
 2055 líht-líkora líð: · só ist þesoro liudjo þau.  
 Þan habas þú nú wundêr-liko · werd-skêpi þinan  
 2057 ge·markod far þesoro mênigi: · hétis far þit manno folk  
 alles þínes wínes · þat wirsiste  
 2059 þíne ambaht-man · êrist brêngjan,  
 geban at þínun gômun. · Nú sint þína gêsti sade,  
 2061 sint þíne druhtingos · drunkane swíðo,  
 is þit folk frô-mód: · nú hétis þú hír forð dragan  
 2063 alloro líðo lof-samost, · þero þe ik eo an þesumu liohte ge·sah  
 hwêrgin hêbbjan. · Mid þius skoldis þú us hin-dag êr  
 2065 gebon êndi gômjan: · þan it alloro gumono ge·hwi-lík  
 ge·þigedi te þanke.“ · Þó warð þár þegan manag  
 2067 ge·war aftar þem wordun, · siðor sie þes wínes ge·drunkun,  
 þat þár þe hêlogo Krist · an þemu húse innan  
 2069 têkan warhte: · trúodun sie siðor  
 þiu mêr an is mund-burd, · þat hí habdi maht godes,  
 2071 ge·wald an þesoro wer-oldi. · Þó warð þat só wído kúð  
 oðar Galileo land · Judeo liudjun,

2073 hwó þár selbo ge·deda · sunu drohtines  
 water te wíne: · þat warð þár wundro êrist,  
 2075 þero þe hí þár an Galilea · Judeo liudjon,  
 tēkno ge·tōgdi. · Ne mag þat ge·tēlljan man,  
 2077 ge·seggjan te sōðan, · hwat þár sīðor warð  
 wundres undar þemu werode, · þár waldand Krist  
 2079 an godes namon · Judeo liudjon  
 allan langan dag · lēra sagde,  
 2081 gi·hét im heban-ríki · ėndi hēlljo ge·þwing  
 wēride mid wordun, · hét sie wara godes,  
 2083 sin-líf sókjan: · þár is seolono lioht,  
 drōm drohtines · ėndi dag-skímon,  
 2085 gód-lik-nissja godes; · þár gēst manag  
 wunod an willjan, · þe hír wel þenkid,  
 2087 þat hé hír bi·halde · heban-kuninges ge·bod.

TODO.

2001 þiu hēri | so C (norm. 'thiu heri'); þe hēri (norm. 'the heri') M.

25 Ge·wēt imu þó mid is jungoron · fan þem gōmun forð  
 2089 Kristus te Kapharnaum, · kuningo ríkjost,  
 te þeru mārjon burg. · Mēgin samnode,  
 2091 gumon imu te·gēgnes, · góðoro manno  
 sálig ge·sīði: · weldun þiu is swótjan word  
 2093 hēlag hōrjen. · Þár im ėn hunno kwam,  
 ėn gód man an·gēgin · ėndi ina gerno bad  
 2095 helpan hēlagne, · kwað þat hí undar is hiwiskja  
 ėnna lēfna lamon · lango habdi,  
 2097 seokan an is sēlðon: · „só ina ėnig seggjo ne mag  
 handun ge·hēljen. · Nú is im þínoro helpono þarf,  
 2099 frō mín þe gódo.“ · Þó sprak im eft þat friðu-barn godes  
 sán aftar þiu · selbo te·gēgnes,  
 2101 kwað þat hé þár kwāmi · ėndi þat kind weldi  
 nēljan af þeru nōdi. · Þó im náhor géng  
 2103 þe man far þeru mēnigi · wið só mahtigna  
 wordun wehslan: · „ik þes wirðig ne bium,“ kwað hé,  
 2105 „hērro þe gódo, · þat þú an mín hús kumes,  
 sókjas mína sēliða, · hwand ik bium só sundig man  
 2107 mid wordun ėndi mid werkun. · Ik ge·lōbju þat þú ge·wald  
 habas,



2109 þat þú ina hinana maht · hêlan ge·wirkjan,  
 waldand frô mín: · ef þú it mid þínun wordun ge·sprikis,  
 2111 þan is sán þiu léf·hêd lôsot ·  ndi wir  id is l  k·hamo  
 h  l  ndi hr  ni, · ef þ   im þ  na helpa far·g  bis.  
 Ik bium m   ambaht·man, · h  bbju m     des ge·n  g,  
 2113 welono ge·wunnen: · þoh ik undar ge·w  ldi s    
 a  al·kuninges, · þoh h  bbju ik erlo ge·tr  st,  
 2115 holde h  ri·rinkos, · þ  a m   s   ge·h  riga sint,  
 þat sie þes ne word ne werk · wiht ne far·l  tad,  
 2117 þes ik sie an þesumu land·sk  pje · l  stjan h  te,  
 ak sie farad  ndi frummjad ·  ndi eft te iro fr  han kumad,  
 2119 holde te iro h  rron. · Þoh ik at m  numu h  s   gi  
 wid·br  dene welon ·  ndi werodes ge·n  g,  
 2121 h  li  dos hugi·d  rþje, · þoh ni gi·dar ik þi s   h  lagna  
 biddjen, barn godes, · þat þ   an m  n b   gangas,  
 2123 s  kjas m  na s  li  a, · hwand ik s   sundig bium,  
 w  t m  na far·wurhti.“ · Þ   sprak eft waldand Krist,  
 2125 þe gumo wi   is jungoron, · kwa   þat h   an Judeon hw  rgin  
 undar Israheles · a  boron ne fundi  
 2127 ge·makon þes mannes, · þe io m  r te gode  
 an þemu land·sk  pi · ge·l  bon habdi,  
 2129 þan hluttron te himile: · „n   l  tu ik iu þ  r h  rjen t  ,  
 þ  r ik it iu te w  run h  r · wordun seggjo,  
 2131 þat noh skulun   li·þeoda ·   stane  ndi westane,  
 man·kunnjes kuman · manag te·samne,  
 2133 h  lag folk godes · an he  an·r  ki:  
 þ  a motun þ  r an Abrahames ·  ndi an Isaakes s   self  
 2135  ndi   k an Jakobes, · g  doro manno,  
 barmun r  stjen ·  ndi b    ju ge·þolojan,  
 2137 welon  ndi willjon ·  ndi wonod·sam lif,  
 g  d liot mid gode. · Þan skal Judeono filu,  
 2139 þeses r  kjas suni · be·r  bode wer  en,  
 be·d  lide su·l  koro diur  o, ·  ndi skulun an dalun þiustron  
 2141 an þemu alloro ferristan · ferne ligen.  
 Þ  r mag man ge·h  rjen · h  li  dos kw    jan,  
 2143 þ  r sie iro torn manag · tandon b  tad;  
 þ  r ist grist·grimmo ·  ndi gr  dag fiur,  
 2145 hard h  lljo ge·þwing, · h  t  ndi þiustri,  
 swart sin·nahti · sundja te l  ne,

- 2147 wrêðoro ge·wurhtjo, · só hwemu só þes willjon ne habad,  
 þat hé ina a·lôsje, · êr hí þit lioht a·gebe,  
 2149 wëndje fan þesoro wer·oldi. · Nú maht þú þi an þinan willjon  
 forð  
 sñoon te sçlðun; · þan findis þú ge·sundan at hús  
 2151 mago·jungan man: · mód is imu an luston,  
 þat barn is ge·hêlid, · só þú bédi te mí:  
 2153 it wirðid al só ge·lêstid, · só þú ge·lôbon habas  
 an þinumu hugi hardo.“ · Þó sagde heban·kuninge,  
 2155 þe ambaht·man · alo·waldon gode  
 þank for þero þido, · þes hé imu at su·líkun þarbun halp.  
 2157 Habda þo gi·ârundid, · al só hé welde,  
 sálig·líko: · gi·wêt imu an þana sñð þanan,  
 2159 wēnde an is willjan, · þár hé welon êhte,  
 bú çndi bodlos: · fand þat barn ge·sund,  
 2161 kind·jungan man. · Kristes wárun þó  
 word ge·fullot: · hí ge·wald habda  
 2163 te tōgjanna tēkan, · só þat ni mag gi·tēlljen man,  
 ge·ahton obar þesoro erðu, · hwat hé þurh is ênes kraft  
 2165 an þesaro middil·gard · máriða ge·frumide,  
 wundres ge·warhte, · hwand al an is ge·wēldi stád,  
 2167<sup>a</sup> himil çndi erðe.

TODO.

2093 hunno ‘centurion’ | A native Germanic term perhaps going back to the days when the Saxons served in the Roman armies.

- 2167<sup>b</sup> 26 Þó ge·wêt imu þe hêlogo Krist  
 forð·wardes faren, · frēmide alo·mahtig  
 2169 alloro dago ge·hwi·líkes, · drohtin þe gódo,  
 liudjo barnum leof, · lérde mid wordun  
 2171 godes willjon gumun, · habda imu jungorono filu  
 simbla te gi·sñoon, · sálig folk godes,  
 2173 manno mēgin·kraft, · managoro þeodo,  
 hêlag hēri·skēpi, · was is helpono gód,  
 2175 mannun mildi. · Þó hí mid þeru mēnigi kwam,  
 mid þiu brahtmu þat barn godes · te burg þeru hôhon,  
 2177 þe neřjendo te Naim: · þár skolde is namo werðen  
 mannun ge·márid. · Þó géng mahtig tó  
 2179 neřjendo Krist, · ant·tat hé gi·náhid was,

2181 hêljandero bêtst: · þó sáhun sie þár ên hrêo dragan,  
 ênan lif-lôsan lík-hamon · þea liudi fôrjen,  
 2183 beran an ênaru báru · út at þera burgess dore,  
 magu-jungan man. · Þiu móder aftar géng  
 an iro hugi hriuwig · êndi handun slóg,  
 2185 karode êndi kúmde · iro kindes dôð,  
 idis arm-skapan; · it was ira ênag barn:  
 2187 siu was iru widowa, · ne habda wunnja þan mêt,  
 bi-úten te þemu ênagun sunje · al ge-láten  
 2189 wunnja êndi willjan, · ant-tat ina iru wurd be-nam,  
 mári metodo-ge-skapu. · Megin folgode,  
 2191 burg-liudjo ge-brak, · þár man ina an báru dróg,  
 jungan man te grabe. · Þár warð imu þe godes sunu,  
 2193 mahtig mildi · êndi te þeru móder sprak,  
 hét þat þiu widowa · wóp far-léti,  
 2195 kara aftar þemu kinde: · „þú skalt hír kraft sehan,  
 waldandes gi-werk: · þí skal hír willjo ge-standen,  
 2197 frófra far þesumu folke: · ne þarft þú ferah karon  
 barnes þínes.“ · \*Þuo hie ti þero báron géng  
 2199 iak hie ina selbo ant-hrên, · suno drohtines,  
 hêlagon handon, · êndi ti þem hêliðe sprak,  
 2201 hiet ina só ala-jungan · up a-standan,  
 a-rísan fan þeru rēstun. · Þie rink up a-sat,  
 2203 þat barn an þero bárun: · warð im eft an is briost kuman  
 þie gēst þuru godes kraft, · êndi hie te-gēgnes sprak,  
 2205 þe man wið is mágos. · Þuo ina eft þero muoder bi-falah  
 hêlandi Krist an hand: · hugi warð iro te fróbra,  
 2207 þes wíbes an wunnjon, · hwand iro þár su-lík willjo gi-stuod.  
 Fêll siu þó te fuotun Kristes · êndi þena folko drohtin  
 2209 loboda for þero liudjo mēnigi, · hwand hie iro at só liobes  
 ferah  
 mundoda wiðer metodi-gi-skēftje: · far-stuod siu þat hie was  
 þie mahtigo drohtin,  
 2211 þie hêlago, þie himiles gi-walddid, · êndi þat hie mahti  
 gi-helpan managon,  
 allon irmin-þiedon. · Þuo bi-gunnun þat ahton managa,  
 2213 þat wunder, þat under þem weroda gi-burida, · kwáðun þat  
 waldand selbo,

- mahtig kwámi þarod is mēnigi wíson, · ėndi þat hie im só  
 márjan sandi  
 2215 wár-sagon an þero wer-oldest ríki, · þie im þár su-líkan willjon  
 frumidi.  
 Warð þár þuo erl manag · egison bi-fangan,  
 2217 þat folk warð an forohton: · gi-sáhun þena is ferah égan,  
 dages liobt sehan, · þena þe êr dôð for-nam,  
 2219 an suht-bēddjon swalt: · þuo was im eft gi-sund after þiu,  
 kind-jung a-kwikot. · Þuo warð þat kũð obar all  
 2221 abaron Israheles. · Reht só þuo áband kwam,  
 só warð þár all gi-samnod · seokora manno,  
 2223 haltaro ėndi hábaro, · só hwat só þár hwergin was,  
 þia lébun under þem liudjon, · ėndi wurðun þár gi-lēdit tuo,  
 2225 kumana te Kriste, · þár hie im þuru is kraft mikil  
 halp ėndi sie hēlda, · ėndi liet sia eft gi-haldana þanan  
 2227 wēndan an iro willjon. · Be-þiu skal man is werk lobon,  
 diuran is dádi, · hwand hie is drohtin self,  
 2229 mahtig mund-boro · manno kunnje,  
 liudjo só hwi-líkon, · só þár gi-lôbit tuo  
 2231<sup>a</sup> an is word ėndi an is werk.

TODO.

- 2231<sup>b</sup> 27 Þuo was þár werodes só filo  
 allaro ėli-þiodo kuman · te þem êron Kristes,  
 2233 te só mahtiges mund-burd. · Þuo welda hie þár êna mēri  
 líðan,  
 þie godes suno mid is jungron · a-neban Galilea-land,  
 2235 waldand ênna wágo strôm. · Þuo hiet hie þat werod ôðar  
 forð-werdes faran, · ėndi hie gi-wēt im fahora sum  
 2237 an ênna nakon innan, · nējendi Krist,  
 slápan sīð-wórig. · Segel up dádun  
 2239 wede-wisa weros, · lietun wind after  
 manon obar þena mēri-strôm, · unþ-þat hie te middjan kwam,  
 2241 waldand mid is werodu. · Þuo bi-gan þes wedares kraft,  
 ūst up stígan, · ūðjun wahsan;  
 2243 swang gi-swerk an gi-mang: · þie sēw warð an hruoru,  
 wan wind ėndi water; · weros sorogodun,  
 2245 þiu mēri warð só muodag, · ni wánda þero manno nig-ên  
 lēngron líbes. · Þuo sia landes ward

- 2247 wêkidun mid iro wordon · ɛndi sagdun im þes wedaress kraft,  
 bádun þat im gi·náðig · nêrjendi Krist
- 2249 wurði wið þem watære: · „efþa wí skulun hier te  
 wunder·kwálu  
 sweltan an þeson sêwe.“ · Self up a·rêš
- 2251 þie guodo godes suno · ɛndi te is jungron sprak,  
 hiet þat sia im wedaress gi·win · wiht ni an·drédin:
- 2253 „te hwí sind gí só forhta?“ (kwaþ·hie.) „Nis iu noh fast hugi,  
 gi·lôbo is iu te luttill. · Nis nú lang te þiu,
- 2255 þat þia strômos skulun · stiltrun werðan  
 gi þit \*wedar wun·sam.“ · Þo hí te þem winde sprak
- 2257 ge te þemu sêwa só self · ɛndi sie smultro hét  
 bêðja ge·bárjan. · Sie gi·bod lêstun,
- 2259 waldandes word: · wedêr stillodun,  
 fagar warð an flóde. · Þó bi·gan þat folk undar im,
- 2261 werod wundrajan, · ɛndi suma mid iro wordun sprákon,  
 hwi·lík þat só mahtigoro · manno wári,
- 2263 þat imu só þe wind ɛndi þe wág · wordu hôrdin,  
 bêðja is gi·bod·skêþjes. · Þó habda sie þat barn godes
- 2265 gi·nêrid fan þeru nôdi: · þe nako furðor skrêid,  
 hôh·hurnid skip; · hêliðos kwámun,
- 2267 liudi te lande, · sagdun lof gode,  
 máridun is mêgin·kraft. · Kwam þár manno filu
- 2269 an·gêgin þemu godes sunje; · hé sie gerno ant·féng,  
 só hwene só þár mid hluttru hugi · helpa sóhte;
- 2271 lêrde sie iro gi·lôbon · ɛndi iro lík·hamon  
 handun hêlde: · nio þe man só hardo ni was
- 2273 gi·sêrit mid suhtjun: · þoh ina Satanases  
 fêknja jungoron · fiundes kraftu
- 2275 habdin undar handun · ɛndi is hugi·skêfti,  
 gi·wit a·wardid, · þat hé wóðjendi
- 2277 fôri undar þemu folke, · þoh im simbla ferh far·gaf  
 hêlandjo Krist, · ef hé te is handun kwam,
- 2279 drêf þea diublas þanan · drohtines kraftu,  
 wárun wordun, · ɛndi im is ge·wit far·gaf,
- 2281 lét ina þan hêlan · wiðêr hêttjandun,  
 gaf im wið þie fiund friðu, · ɛndi im forð gi·wêt
- 2283 an só hwi·lík þero lando, · só im þan leobost was.

TODO.

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2309 bārun mid is þeðdju, · hwō sie ina ge·drōgin fora þat barn  
godes,  
an þat werod innan, · þār ina waldand Krist  
2311 selbo gi·sāwi. · Þó gēngun þea ge·sīðos tō,  
hōbun ina mid iro handun · ęndi uppan þat hūs stigon,  
2313 slitun þene sęli obana · ęndi ina mid sēlun lētun  
an þene rakud innan, · þār þe rīkwō was,  
2315 kuningo kraftigost. · Reht sō hē ina þó kuman gi·sah  
þurh þes huses hrōst, · sō hē þó an iro hugi far·stōd,  
2317 an þero manno mōd-sebon, · þat sie mikilana te imu  
ge·lōbon habdun, · þó hē for þen liudjun sprak,  
2319 kwað þat hē þene siakon man · sundjono tōmjan  
lātan weldi. · Þó sprākun im eft þea liudi an·gęgin,  
2321 gram-harde Judeon, · þea þes godes barnes  
word aftar warodun, · kwāðun þat þat ni mahti gi·werðen sō,  
2323 grim-werk far·gēben, · bi·útan god ēno,  
waldand þesaro wer-oldest. · Þó habda eft is word garu  
2325 mahtig barn godes: · „ik gi·dōn þat“, kwað hē, „an þesumu  
manne skín,  
þe hīr sō siak ligid · an þesumu sęli innan,  
2327 te wundron gi·wēgid, · þat ik ge·wald hębbju  
sundja te far·gebanne · ęndi ōk seokan man  
2329 te ge·hēljanne, · sō ik ina hrīnan ni þarf.“  
Manoda ina þó · þe mārjo drohtin,  
2331 liggjandjan lamon, · hēt ina far þem liudjun a·standan  
up alo-hēlan · ęndi hēt ina an is ahsulun niman,  
2333 is będ-gi·wādi te baka; · hē þat gi·bod lēste  
sniumo for þemu gi·sīða · ęndi gēng imu eft ge·sund þanan,  
2335 hēl fan þemu hūse. · Þó þes sō manag hēðin man,  
weros wundradun, · kwāðun þat imu waldand self,  
2337 god alo-mahtig · far·gēban habdi  
mēron mahti · þan ęlkor ēnigumu mannes sunje,  
2339 kraft ęndi kūsti; · sie ni weldun ant·kēnnjan þoh,  
Judeo liudi, · þat hē god wāri,  
2341 ne ge·lōbðun is lēran, · ak habdun im lēðan strīd,  
wunnun wiðar is wordun: · þes sie werk hlutun,  
2343 lēð-lík lōn-geld, · ęndi sō noh lango skulun,  
þes sie ni weldun hōrjen · hēban-kuninges,  
2345 Kristes lērun, · þea hē kūðde oðar al,

wído aftar þesaro wer-oldi, · ęndi lét sie is werk sehan  
 2347 allaro dago ge·hwi-likes, · is dádi skawon,  
 hōrjen is hēlag word, · þe hé te helpu ge·sprak  
 2349 manno barnun, · ęndi só manag mahtig-lík  
 tēkan ge·tōgda, · þat sie gi·trúodin þiu bēt,  
 2351 gi·lōbdin an is lēra. · Hé só managan lík-hamon  
 balu-suhtjo ant·band · ęndi bóta ge·skēride,  
 2353 far·gaf fēgjun ferah, · þem þe fūsid was  
 hēlið an hēl-sið: · þan gi·deda ina þe hēland self,  
 2355 Krist þurh is kraft mikil · kwikan aftar dōða,  
 lét ina an þesaro wer-oldi forð · wunnjono neotan.

TODO.

2339 kústi | so M; *kunsti* norm. C

2357 **29** Só hēlde hé þea haltun man · ęndi þea hābon só self,  
 bóta þem þar blinde wárun, · lét sie þat berhte lioht,  
 2359 sin-skōni sehan, · sundja lōsda,  
 gumono grim-werk. · Ni was gio Judeono be·þiu,  
 2361 lēðes liud-skepjes · gi·lōbo þiu bētura  
 an þene hēlagon Krist, · ak habdun im hardene mód,  
 2363 swiðo starkan stríd, · far·standan ni weldun,  
 þat sie habdun for·fangan · fiundun an willjan,  
 2365 liudi mid iro ge·lōbun. · Ni was gio þiu latoro be·þiu  
 sunu drohtines, · ak hé sagde mid wordun,  
 2367 hwó sie skoldin ge·halon · himiles ríki,  
 lērde aftar þemu lande, · habde imu þero liudjo só filu  
 2369 gi·wēnid mid is wordun, · þat im werod mikil,  
 folk fōlgoda, · ęndi hé im filu sagda,  
 2371 be biliðjun þat barn godes, · þes sie ni mahtun an iro breostun  
 far·standan,  
 undar·huggjan an iro herton, · ēr it im þe hēlago Krist  
 2373 oþar þat erlo folk · oþonun wordun  
 þurh is selbes kraft · seggjan welda,  
 2375 mārjan hwat hé mēnde. · Þar ina megin umbi,  
 þioda þrungun: · was im þarf mikil  
 2377 te gi·hōrjenne · heban-kuninges  
 wár-fastun word. · Hé stód imu þó bi ēnes watares staðe,  
 2379 ni welde þó bi þemu ge·þringe · oþar þat þegno folk  
 an þemu lande uppan · þea lēra kūðjan,



- 2381 ak gégim imu þó þe gódo · ęndi is jungaron mid imu,  
 friðu-barn godes, · þemu flóde náhor  
 2383 an ęn skip innan, · ęndi it skalden hét  
 lande rúmur, · þat ina þea liudi só filu,  
 2385 þioda ni þrungi. · Stóð þegan manag,  
 werod bi þemu watere, · þár waldand Krist  
 2387 obar þat liudjo folk · lęra sagde:  
 „Hwat ik iu seggjan mag“, (kwað hę,) „ge-siðos míne,  
 2389 hwó imu ęn erl bi-gan · an erðu sájan  
 hręn-korni mid is handun. · Sum it an hardan stęn  
 2391 oban-wardan fel, · erðon ni habda,  
 þat it þár mahti wahan · efþa wurtjo gi-fáhan,  
 2393 kınan efþa bi-klıben, · ak warð þat korn far-loren,  
 þat þár an þeru lęjan gi-lag. · Sum it eft an land bi-fel,  
 2395 an erðun ađal-kunnjes: · bi-gan imu aftar þiu  
 wahren wán-liko · ęndi wurtjo fáhan,  
 2397 lóð an lustun: · was þat land só góð,  
 fránisko gi-fęhod. · Sum it eft bi-fallen warð  
 2399 an ęna starka strátun, · þár stópon géngun,  
 hrosso hóf-sлага · ęndi hęliðo tráda;  
 2401 warð imu þár an erðu · ęndi eft up gi-gégim,  
 bi-gan imu an þemu wege wahren; · þó it eft þes werodes  
 far-nam,  
 2403 þes folkes fard mikil · ęndi fuglos a-lásun,  
 þat is þemu ęksan wiht · aftar ni móste  
 2405 werðan te willjan, · þes þár an þene weg bi-fel.  
 Sum warð it þan bi-fallen, · þár só filu stóðun  
 2407 þikkero þorno · an þemu dage;  
 warð imu þár an erðu · ęndi eft up gi-gégim,  
 2409 kęn imu þár ęndi klıbode. · Þó slógun þár eft krúd an  
 gi-mang,  
 weridun imu þene wastom: · habda it þes waldes hlea  
 2411 forana obar-fangan, · þat it ni mahte te ęnigaro frumu werðen,  
 ef it þea þornos · só þringan móstun.“  
 2413 Þó sátun ęndi swıgodun · ge-siðos Kristes,  
 word-spáha weros: · was im wundar mikil,  
 2415 be hwi-likun biliðjun · þat barn godes  
 su-lik sỏð-lik spel · seggjan bi-gunni.  
 2417 Þó bi-gan is þero erlo · ęn frágojan

holdan hêrron, · hnêg imu te·gegnes  
 2419 tulgo werð·liko: · „Hwat þú ge·wald habas“, kwað hé,  
 „ia an himile ia an erðu, · hêlag drohtin,  
 2421 uppa êndi niðara, · bist þú alo·waldo  
 gumono gêsto, · êndi wí þíne jungaron sind,  
 2423 an úsumu hugi holde. · Hêrro þe gódo,  
 ef it þín willjo sí, · lát ús þínaro wordo þár  
 2425 êndi gi·hôrjen, · þat wí it aftar þi  
 obar al Kristin·folk · kúðjan mótin.  
 2427 wí witun þat þínun wordun · wár·lík biliði  
 forð folgojad, · êndi ús is firinun þarf,  
 2429 þat wí þín word êndi þín werk, · —hwand it fan su·líkumu  
 ge·wittja kumid—  
 þat wí it an þesumu lande · at þi línun mótin.“

TODO.

2431 **30** Þó im eft te·gegnes · gumono bêtsta  
 and·wordi ge·sprak: · „ni mênde ik êlkor wiht“, kwað hé,  
 2433 „te bi·dêrnjenne · dádjo mínaro,  
 wordo efþa werko; · þit skulun gí witan alle,  
 2435 jungaron mine, · hwand iu far·geben habad  
 waldand þesaro wer·oldes, · þat gí witan mótun  
 2437 an iuwom hugi·skêftjun · himilisk ge·rúni;  
 þem öðrun skal man be biliðjun · þat gi·bod godes  
 2439 wordun wisjen. · Nú willju ik iu te wárun hier  
 márjen, hwat ik mênde, · þat gí mína þiu bêt  
 2441 obar al þit land·skêpi · lêra far·standan.  
 Þat sád, þat ik iu sagda, · þat is selbes word,  
 2443 þiu hêlaga lêra · heban·kuninges,  
 hwó man þea márjen skal · obar þene middil·gard,  
 2445 wído aftar þesaro wer·oldi. · Weros sind im gi·hugide,  
 man mis·líko: · sum su·líkan mód dregid,  
 2447 harda hugi·skêfti · êndi hréan sebon,  
 þat ina ni ge·werðod, · þat hé it be iuwon wordun due,  
 2449 þat hé pesa mína lêra forð · lêstjen willje,  
 ak werðad þár só far·lorana · lêra mína,  
 2451 godes am·busni · êndi iuwaro gumono word  
 an þemu ubilon manne, · só ik iu êr sagda,  
 2453 þat þat korn far·warð, · þat þár mid kíðun ni mahte

an þemu stêne uppan · stędi-haft werðan.  
 2455 Sô wirðid al far·loran · ęðilero sprâka,  
 ârundi godes, · sô hwat sô man þemu ubilon manne  
 2457 wordun ge·wîsid, · ęndi hé an þea wirson hand,  
 undar fiundo folk · fard ge·kîusid,  
 2459 an godes un-wiljan · ęndi an gramono hróm  
 ęndi an fiures farm. · Forð skal hé hêtjan  
 2461 mid is breost-hugi · brêda logna.  
 Nio gí an þesumu lande þiu lés · lêra mína  
 2463 wordun ni wîsjad: · is þeses werodes sô filu,  
 erlo aftar þesaro erðun: · bi·stéd þár ôðar man,  
 2465 þe is imu jung ęndi glau, · —ęndi habad imu gódan mód—,  
 sprákono spâhi · ęndi wêt iuwaro spello gi·skêð,  
 2467 hugid is þan an is herton · ęndi hôrid þár mid is ôrun tó  
 swiðo niud·líko · ęndi náhor stéd,  
 2469 an is breost hlędid · þat gi·bod godes,  
 línod ęndi lêstid: · is is gi·lôbo sô gód,  
 2471 talod imu, hwó hé ôðrana · ęft gi·hwerþje  
 mên·dádigan man, · þat is mód draga  
 2473 hluttra treuwa · te heban·kuninge.  
 Þan brêdid an þes breostun · þat gi·bod godes,  
 2475 þie lubigo gi·lôbo, · sô an þemu lande duod  
 þat korn mid kíðun, · þár it gi·kund habad  
 2477 ęndi imu þiu wurð bi·hagod · ęndi wedêres gang,  
 rêgin ęndi sunne, · þat it is reht habad.  
 2479 Sô duod þiu godes lêra · an þemu góðun manne  
 dages ęndi nahtes, · ęndi gangid imu diubal fer,  
 2481 wrêða wihti · ęndi þe ward godes  
 náhor mikilu · nahtes ęndi dages,  
 2483 ant-tat sie ina bręngjad, · þat þár bêðju wirðid  
 ia þiu lêra te frumu · liudjo barnun,  
 2485 þe fan is müðe kumid, · iak wirðid þe man gode;  
 habad sô gi·wehslod · te þesaro wer-old-stundu  
 2487 mid is hugi-skęftjun · himil·ríkjas gi·dêl,  
 welono þene mēstan: · farid imu an gi·wald godes,  
 2489 tionuno tómig. · Treuwa sind sô góða  
 gumono ge·hwi·líkumu, · sô nis goldes hord  
 2491 ge·lík su·líkumu gi·lôbon. · Wesad iuwaro lérono forð  
 man·kunnje mildje; · sie sind sô mis·líka,

- 2493 hēliðos ge·hugda: · sum habad iro hardan stríd,  
 wrēðan willjan, · wankolna hugi,  
 2495 is imu fēknes ful · ċndi firin-werko.  
 Þan bi·ginnid imu þunkjan, · þan hé undar þeru þiodu stád  
 2497 ċndi þár gi·hōrid · obar hlust mikil  
 þea godes lēra, · þan þunkid imu, þat hé sie gerno forð  
 2499 lēstjen willje; · þan bi·ginnid imu þiu lēra godes  
 an is hugi hafton, · ant-tat imu þan eft an hand kumid  
 2501 feho te gi·fōrja · ċndi frēmiði skat.  
 Þan far·lédjad ina · lēða wihti,  
 2503 þan hé imu far·fāhid · an feho-giri,  
 a·lēskid þene gi·lōbon: · þan was imu þat luttill fruma,  
 2505 þat hé it gio an is hertan ge·hugda, · ef hé it halden ne wili.  
 Þat is só þe wastom, · þe an þemu wege be·gan,  
 2507 liodan an þemu lande: · þó far·nam ina eft þero liudjo fard.  
 Só duot þea mēgin-sundjon · an þes mannes hugi  
 2509 þea godes lēra, · ef hé is ni gōmid wel;  
 ċlkor bi·fēlljad sia ina · ferne te boðme,  
 2511 an þene hētan hēl, · þár hé heban-kuninge  
 ni wirðid furður te frumu, · ak ina fiund skulun  
 2513 wítju gi·warāgian. · Simla gí mid wordun forð  
 lērjad an þesumu lande: · \*ik kan þesaro liudjo hugi,  
 2515 só mis-líkan muod-sebon · manno kunnjes,  
 só wanda wisa · [...].  
 2517 Sum habit all te þiu is muod gi·látan · ċndi mēr sorogot,  
 hwó hie þat hord bi·halde, · þan hwó hie heban-kuninges  
 2519 willjon gi·wirkje. · Be·þiu þár wahsan ni mag  
 þat hēlaga gi·bod godes, · þoh it þár a·hafton mugi,  
 2521 wurtjon bi·werpan, · hwand it þie welo þringit.  
 Só samo só þat krúd ċndi þie þorn · þat korn ant·fāhat,  
 2523 wērjat im þena wastom, · só duot þie welo manne:  
 gi·hēftid is herta, · þat hie it gi·huggjan ni muot,  
 2525 þie man an is muode, · þes hie mēst bi·þarf,  
 hwó hie þat gi·wirkje, · þan lang þie hie an þesaro wer-oldi sí,  
 2527 þat hie ti êwon-dage · after muoti  
 hēbbjan þuru is hērren þank · himiles ríki,  
 2529 só ċndi-lōsan welon, · só þat ni mag ênig man  
 witan an þesaro wer-oldi. · Nio hie só wído ni kan  
 2531 te gi·þenkjanne, · þegan an is muode,

2533 þat it bi·haldan mugi · herta þes mannes,  
 þat hie þat ti wáron witi, · hwat waldand god habit  
 guodes gi·gēƿewid, · þat all gegin-werd stēð  
 2535 manno só hwi-líkon, · só ina hier minnjot wel  
 ƿendi selbo te þiu · is seola gi·haldit,  
 2537 þat hie an lioht godes · líðan muoti.“

TODO.

31 Sô wísda hie þuo mid wordon, · stuod werod mikil  
 2539 umbi þat barn godes, · ge·hórdun ina bi biliðon filo  
 umbi þesaro wer-oldest gi·wand · wordon tēlljan;  
 2541 kwað þat im ôk ên aðales man · an is akker sáidi  
 hluttar hrên-korni · handon sínon:  
 2543 wolda im þár só wun-sames · wastmes tiljan,  
 fagares fruhtes. · Þuo géng þár is fiond aftar  
 2545 þuru dērnjan hugi, · ƿendi it all mid durðu oþar·séu,  
 mid weodo wirsiston. · Þuo wóhsun sia bēðju,  
 2547 ge þat korn ge þat krúd. · Sô kwámun gangan  
 is haga-stoldos te hús, · iro hērren sagdun,  
 2549 þegnos iro þiodne · þristjon wordon:  
 „Hwat þú sáidos hluttar korn, · hērro þie guodo,  
 2551 ên-fald an þínon akkar: · nú ni gi·sihit ênig erlo þan mēr  
 weodes wahsan. · Hwí mohta þat gi·werðan só?“  
 2553 Þuo sprak eft þie aðales man · þem erlon te·gegnes,  
 þiodan wið is þegnos, · kwað þat hie it mahti undar þenkjan  
 wel,  
 2555 þat im þár un-hold man · aftar sáida,  
 fiond fēkni krúd: · „ne gionsta mí þero fruhtjo wel,  
 2557 a·werda mí þena wastom.“ · Þuo þár eft wini sprákon,  
 is jungron te·gegnes, · kwáðun þat sia þár weldin gangan tuo,  
 2559 kuman mid kraftu · ƿendi lōsjan þat krúd þanan,  
 halon it mid iro handon. · Þuo sprak im eft iro hērro  
 an·gegin:  
 2561 „ne welljo ik, þat gí it wiodon“, (kwaþ·hie,) „hwand gí bi·wardon  
 ni mugun,  
 gi·gômjan an iuwon gange, · þoh gí it gerno ni duan,  
 2563 ni gí þes kornes te filo, · kíðo a·wērdjat,  
 fēlljat under iuwa fuoti. · Láte man sia forð hinan  
 2565 bēðju wahsan, · und êr beuwod kume

- 2567      endi an þem felde sind · fruhti ríþja,  
 arwa an þem akkare: · þan faran wí þár alla tuo,  
 halon it mid ússan handon · endi þat hrên-kurni lesan  
 2569      súburo te·samne · endi it an mínon sæli duoþan,  
 hebbjan it þár gi·haldan, · þat it hwergin ni mugi  
 2571      wiht a·werðjan, · endi þat wiod niman,  
 bindan it te burðinnjon · endi werpan it an bittar fiur,  
 2573      látan it þár haloþan · hêta logna,  
 ald un-fuodi.“ · Þuo stuod erl manag,  
 2575      þegnos þagjandi, · hwat þiod-gomo,  
 \*mári mahtig Krist · mênjan weldi,  
 2577      bôknjen mid þiu biliðju · barno ríkjust.  
 Bádun þó só gerno · góðan drohtin  
 2579      ant-lúkan þea lêra, · þat sia móstin þea liudi forð,  
 hêlaga hórjan. · Þó sprak im eft iro hêrro an·gegin,  
 2581      mári mahtig Krist: · „þat is“, kwað hé, „mannes sunu:  
 ik selbo bium, þat þár sáiú, · endi sind þesa sálīga man  
 2583      þat hluttra hrên-korni, · þea mí hér hórjad wel,  
 wirkjad mínan willjan; · þius wer-old is þe akkar,  
 2585      þit brêða bú-land · barno man-kunnjes;  
 Satanas selbo is, · þat þár sáid aftar  
 2587      só lêð-líka lêra: · habað þesaro liudjo só filu,  
 werodes a·wardid, · þat sie wam frummjad,  
 2589      wirkjad aftar is willjon; · þoh skulun sie hér wahren forð,  
 þea for·griponon gumon, · só samo só þea góðun man,  
 2591      ant-tat Múd-spelles megin · oþar man fêrid,  
 endi þesaro wer-oldest. · Þan is allaro akkaro ge·hwi-lík  
 2593      ge·rípod an þesumu ríkja: · skulun iro regan-gi·skapu  
 frummjen firiho barn. · Þan te·farid erða:  
 2595      þat is allaro beuwo brêðost; · þan kumid þe berhto drohtin  
 oþana mid is engilo kraftu, · endi kumad alle te·samne  
 2597      liudi, þe io þit lioht gi·sáun, · endi skulun þan lôn ant-fáhan  
 ubiles endi gódes. · Þan gangad engilos godes,  
 2599      hêlage heþan-wardos, · endi lesat þea hluttron man  
 sundor te·samne, · endi duat sie an sin-skôni,  
 2601      hoh himiles lioht, · endi þea öðra an heþlja grund,  
 werpad þea far·warhton · an wallandi fiur;  
 2603      þár skulun sie gi·bundene · bittra logna,  
 þrá-werk þolon, · endi þea öðra þiod-welon

2605 an heban-ríkja, · hwitaro sunnon  
 liohtjan ge·liko. · Su-lik lôn nimad  
 2607 weros wal-dádjo. · Só hwe só gi·wit êgi,  
 ge·hugdi an is hertan, · eþþa gi·hôrjen mugi,  
 2609 erl mid is ôrun, · só láta imu þit an innan sorga,  
 an is mód-sebon, · hwó hé skal an þemu márjon dage  
 2611 wið þene ríkjon god · an rēðju standen  
 wordo ęndi werko allaro, · þe hé an þesaro wer-oldi gi·duod.  
 2613 Þat is ęgis-likost · allaro þingo,  
 forht-likost firiho barnun, · þat sie skulun wið iro frâhon  
 mahljen,  
 2615 gumon wið þene góðan drohtin: · þan weldi gerno ge·hwe  
 wesan,  
 allaro manno ge·hwi-lik · mēnes tómig,  
 2617 slíðero sakono. · Aftar þiu skal sorgon êr  
 allaro liudjo ge·hwi-lik, · êr hé þit lioht af·gebe,  
 2619 þe þan êgan wili · alungan tír,  
 hôh heban-ríki · ęndi huldi godes.“

TODO.

2591 *Múd·spelles* męgin | Apparently an incorporation of an earlier Germanic expression; the variant *Mút·spelli* occurs at line 4358 below. For the etymology and sense of this word see note to *Musp* l. 56 (attesting its OHG cognate *Mú·spilli*) and *Vsp* 49/1 (attesting ON *Mú·spell*).

32 Só gi·fragn ik þat þó selbo · sunu drohtines,  
 2622 allaro barno bętst · biliðjo sagda,  
 hwi-lik þero wári · an wer-old-ríkja  
 2624 undar hęlið-kunnje · himil-ríkje ge·lik;  
 kwað þat oft luttiles hwat · liohtora wurði,  
 2626 só hôho af·huobi, · „so duot himil-ríki:  
 þat is simla mēra, · þan is man ênig  
 2628 wánje an þesaro wer-oldi. · Ôk is imu þat werk ge·lík,  
 þat man an sēo innan · sęgina wirpit,  
 2630 fisk-ņet an flód · ęndi fahit bēðju,  
 ubile ęndi góde, · tiuhid up te staðe,  
 2632 liðod sie te lande, · lisit aftar þiu  
 þea góðun an greote · ęndi látid þea ôðra eft an grund faran,  
 2634 an wíðan wág. · Só duod waldand god  
 an þemu márjon dage · męnniskono barn:  
 2636 bręngid irmin-þiod, · alle te·samne,

- lisit imu þan þea hluttron · an heban-ríki,  
 2638 látid þea far·griponon · an grund faren  
 heþje fiures. · Ni wēt heþiðo man  
 2640 þes wítjes wiðar-lága, · þes þár weros þiggjat,  
 an þemu Inferne · irmin-þioda.  
 2642 Þan hald ni mag þera médan man · gi·makon fiðen,  
 ni þes welon ni þes willjon, · þes þár waldand skerid,  
 2644 gildid god selbo · gumono só hwi-líkumu,  
 só ina hér gi·haldid, · þat hé an heban-ríki,  
 2646 an þat lang-same lioht · líðan móti.“  
 Só lêrða hé þó mid listjun. · Þan fórun þár þea liudi tó  
 2648 oðar al Galilaeo land · þat godes barn sehan:  
 dádun it bi þemu wundre, · hwanen imu mahti su-lík word  
 kumen,  
 2650 só spáh-líko gi·sprokan, · þat hé spel godes  
 gio só sôð-líko · seggjan konsti,  
 2652 só kraftig-líko gi·kweðen: · „Hé is þeses kunnjes hinen“,  
 kwáðun sie,  
 „þe man þurh mág-skēpi: · hér is is móder mid ūs,  
 2654 wíf undar þesumu werode. · Hwat wí þe hér witun alle,  
 só kûð is ūs is kuni-burd · ėndi is knósles ge-hwat;  
 2656 a·wóhs al undar þesumu werode: · hwanen skoldi imu su-lík  
 ge·wit kuman,  
 méron mahti, · þan hér ôðra man êgin?“  
 2658 Só far·munste ina þat manno folk · ėndi sprákon im  
 gi·mêd-lík word,  
 far·hogdun ina só hêlagna, · hôrjen ni weldun  
 2660 is gi·bod-skēpjēs. · Ni hé þár ôk biliðjo filu  
 þurh iro un-gi-lôþon · ôgjan ni welde,  
 2662 torhtero tēkno, · hwand hé wisse iro twiþfjan hugi,  
 iro wrêðan willjan, · þat ni wárun weros ôðra  
 2664 só grimme under Judeon, · só wárun umbi Galilaeo land,  
 só hardo ge·hugide: · só þár was þe hêlago Krist,  
 2666 gi·boren þat barn godes, · si ni weldun is gi·bod-skēpi þoh  
 ant·fahan ferht-líko, · ak bi-gan þat folk undar im,  
 2668 rinkos rádan, · hwó sie þene ríkjon Krist  
 wêgdin te wundron. · Hétun þó iro werod kumen,  
 2670 ge·sīði te·samne: · sundja weldun  
 an þene godes sunu · gerno gi·tēljen



2672 wrêðes willjon; · ni was im is wordo niud,  
 spáharo spello, · ak sie bi-gunnun sprekan undar im,  
 2674 hwó sie ina só kraftagne · fan ênumu klîbe wurpin,  
 obar ênna berges wal: · weldun þat barn godes  
 2676 libu bi-lôsjen. · Þó hé imu mid þem liudjun samad  
 frô-lîko fôr: · ni was imu forȝht hugi,  
 2678 —wisse þat imu ni mahtun · mēnniskono barn,  
 bi þeru god-kundi · Judeo liudi  
 2680 êr is tîdjun wiht · teonon gi-frummjen,  
 lêðaro gi-lêsto—, · ak hé imu mid þem liudjun samad  
 2682 stêg uppen þene stên-holm, · ant-þat sie te þeru stêdi  
 kwámun,  
 þár sie ine fan þemu walle niðer · werpen hugdun,  
 2684 fêlljen te foldu, · þat hé wurði is ferhes lôs,  
 is aldres at êndje. · Þó warð þero erlo hugi,  
 2686 an þemu berge uppen · bittra gi-þáhti  
 Judeono te-gangen, · þat iro ênig ni habde só grimmon sebon  
 2688 ni só wrêðen willjon, · þat sie mahtin þene waldandes sunu,  
 Krist ant-kenñjen; · hé ni was iro kûð ênigumu,  
 2690 þat sie ina þó undar-wissin. · Só mahte hé undar ira werode  
 standen  
 êndi an iro gi-mange · middjumu gangen,  
 2692 faren undar iro folke. · Hé dede imu þene friðu selbo,  
 mund-burd wið þeru mēnegi · êndi gi-wêt imu þurh middi  
 þanan  
 2694 þes fiundo folkes, · fôr imu þó, þár hé welde,  
 an êne wóstunnje · waldandes sunu,  
 2696 kuningo kraftigost: · habde þero kustes gi-wald,  
 hwár imu an þemu lande · leobost wári  
 2698<sup>a</sup> te wesanne an þesaru wer-oldi.

TODO.

2698<sup>b</sup> 33 Ðan fôr imu an weg ôðran  
 Johannes mid is jungarun, · godes ambaht-man,  
 2700 lêrde þea liudi · lang-samane rád,  
 hét þat sie frume frēmidin, · firina far-létin,  
 2702 mēn êndi morð-werk. · Hé was þár managumu liof  
 góðaro gumono. · Hé sóhte imu þó þene Judeono kuning,  
 2704 þene hēri-togon at hús, · þe hēten was

- Eroles aftar is ęldiron, · oþar-módig man:  
 2706 búide imu be þeru brúdi, · þiu ęr sines bróðer was,  
 idis an ęhti, · ant-tat hé ęlljor skók,  
 2708 wer-old weslode. · Þó imu þat wif gi-nam  
 þe kuning te kwenun; · ęr wárun iro kind óðan,  
 2710 barn be is bróðer. · Þó bi-gan imu þea brúd lahan  
 Johannes þe gódo, · kwað þat it gode wári,  
 2712 waldande wiðęer-mód, · þat it ęnig wero frumidi,  
 þat bróðer brúd · an is będ námi,  
 2714 hębbje sie imu te híwun. · „Ef þú mí hórjen wili,  
 gi-lóþjen mínun lęrun, · ni skalt þú sie lęng ęgan,  
 2716 ak mið ire an þínum móde: · ni hába þár su-líka minnja tó,  
 ni sundjo þi te swiðo.“ · Þó warð an sorgun hugi  
 2718 þes wibes aftar þem wordun; · an-dréd þat hé þene  
 wer-old-kuning  
 sprákono ge-spóni · ęndi spáhun wordun,  
 2720 þat hé sie far-léti. · Be-gan siu imu þó lęðes filu  
 ráden an rúnun, · ęndi ine rinkos hét,  
 2722 un-sundigane · erlos fáhan  
 ęndi ine an ęnum karkerja · klústar-bęndjun,  
 2724 liðo-kospun bi-lúkan: · be þem liudjun ne gi-dorstun  
 ine feráhu bi-lósjen, · hwand sie wárun imu friund alle,  
 2726 wissun ine só góden · ęndi gode werðen,  
 habdun ina for wár-sagon, · só sia wela mahtun.  
 2728 Þó wurðun an þemu gęr-tale · Judeo kuninges  
 tídi kumana, · só þár gi-tald habdun  
 2730 fróde folk-weros, · þó hé gi-fódid was,  
 an lioht kuman. · Só was þero liudjo þau,  
 2732 þat þat erlo ge-hwi-lík · óþjan skolde,  
 Judeono mid gômun. · Þó warð þár an þene gast-sęli  
 2734 megin-kraft mikil · manno ge-samnod,  
 hęri-togono an þat hús, · þár iro hęrro was  
 2736 an is kuning-stóle. · Kwámun managa  
 Judeon an þene gast-sęli; · warð im þár glad-mód hugi,  
 2738 blíði an iro breostun: · gi-sáhun iro bāg-gebon  
 wesen an wunnjon. · Dróg man wín an flęt  
 2740 skiri mid skálun, · skęnkjon hwurbun,  
 gęngun mid gold-fatun: · gaman was þár inne  
 2742 hlúd an þero hallu, · hęliðos drunkun.

Was þes an lustun · landes hirdi,  
 2744 hwat hé þemu werode mēst · te wunnjun gi·frēmidi.  
 Hét hé þó gangen forð · gēla þiornun,  
 2746 is bróder barn, · þár hé an is bēnki sat  
 wínu gi·wlēnkid, · ęndi þó te þemu wíbe sprak;  
 2748 grótte sie fora þemu gum·skēpje · ęndi gerno bad,  
 þat siu þár fora þem gastjun · gaman af·hóbi  
 2750 fagar an flēttje: · „lát þit folk sehan,  
 hwó þú ge·línod habas · liudjo mēnegi  
 2752 te blíðsjanne an bēnkjun; · ef þú mí þera bede tugiðos,  
 mín word for þesumu werode, · þan willju ik it hér te wárun  
 ge·kweðen,  
 2754 liahto fora þesun liudjun · ęndi ôk gi·lêstjen só,  
 þat ik þi þan aftar þiu · êron willju,  
 2756 só hwes só þú mí bidis · for þesun mínun bâg·winjun:  
 þoh þú mí þesaro hēri·dómo · halbaro fergos,  
 2758 ríkjas mínes, · þoh gi·dón ik, þat it ênig rínko ni mag  
 wordun gi·wēndjen, · ęndi it skal gi·werðen só.“  
 2760 Þó warð þera magað aftar þiu · mód gi·hworben,  
 hugi aftar iro hêrron, · þat siu an þemu húse innen,  
 2762 an þemu gast·sēli · gamen up a·huof,  
 al só þero liudjo · land·wíse gi·dróg,  
 2764 þero þiодо þau. · Þiu þiorne spilode  
 hrór aftar þemu húse: · hugi was an lustun,  
 2766 managaro mód·sebo. · Þó þiu magað habda  
 gi·þionod te þanke · þiод·kuninge  
 2768 ęndi allumu þemu erl·skēpje, · þe þár inne was  
 góðaro gumono, · siu welde þó ira gēba êgan,  
 2770 þiu magað for þeru mēnegi: · géng þó wið iro móðar sprekan  
 ęndi frágode sie · firi·wit·líko,  
 2772 hwes siu þene burges ward · biddjen skoldi.  
 Þó wíside siu aftar iro willjon, · hét þat siu wihtes þan êr  
 2774 ni gęrodi for þemu gum·skēpje, · bi·útan þat man iru Johannes  
 an þeru hallu innan · hôbid gábi  
 2776 a·lôsid af is lík·hamon. · Þat was allun þem liudjun harm,  
 þem mannun an iro móde, · þó sie þat gi·hórdun þea magað  
 sprekan;  
 2778 só was it ôk þemu kunge: · hé ni mahte is kwidi liagan,  
 is word wēndjen: · hét þó is wéþan·berand

2780 gangen fan þemu gast-seli · ęndi hęt þene godes man  
 líbu bi-lôsjen. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,  
 2782 þat man an þea halla · hōbid bráhte  
 þes þiod-gumon, · ęndi it þár þeru þiornun far-gaf,  
 2784 magað for þeru męnegi: · siu dróg it þeru móder forð.  
 Þó was ęn-dago · allaro manno  
 2786 þes wísoston, · þero þe gio an þesa wer-old kwámi,  
 þero þe kwene ęnig · kind gi-bári,  
 2788 idis fan erle, · lét man simla þen ęnon bi-foran,  
 þe þiu þiorne gi-dróg, · þe gio þegnes ni warð  
 2790 wís an iro wer-oldi, · bi-útan só ine waldand god  
 fan heban-wange · hêlages gêstes  
 2792 gi-markode mahtig: · þe ni habde ęnigan gi-makon hwęgin  
 êr nek aftar. · Erlos hwurbun,  
 2794 gumon umbi Johannen, · is jungaron managa,  
 sálig ge-sīði, · ęndi ine an sande bi-grōbun,  
 2796 leobes lík-hamon: · wissun þat hé lioht godes,  
 diur-líkan drôm · mid is drohtine samad,  
 2798 up-ôdas hēm · êgan móste,  
 2799<sup>a</sup> sálig sókjan.

TODO.

2799<sup>b</sup> 34 Þó ge-witun im þea ge-sīðos þanen,  
 Johannes jungaron · jámer-móde,  
 2801 hêlag-ferāha: · was im iro hêrron dōð  
 swīðo an sorgun. · Ge-witun im sókjan þó  
 2803 an þeru wóstunni · waldandes sunu,  
 kraftigana Krist · ęndi imu kũð gi-dedun  
 2805 gódes mannes for-gang, · hwó habde þe Judeono kuning  
 manno þene mārjostan · mákjas eggjun  
 2807 hōbdu bi-hauwan: · hé ni welde is ęnigen harm spreken,  
 sunu drohtines; · hé wisse þat þiu seole was  
 2809 hêlag gi-halden · wiðer hęttjandjon,  
 an friðe wiðer fiundun. · Þó só gi-frági warð  
 2811 aftar þem land-skepjun · lērjandero bęts  
 an þeru wóstunni: · werod samnode,  
 2813 fōr folkun tó: · was im firi-wit mikil  
 wísaro wordo; · imu was ôk willjo só samo,  
 2815 sunje drohtines, · þat hé su-lík ge-sīðo folk

an þat lioht godes · laðoþan mósti,  
 2817 wënnjen mid willjon. · Waldand lêrde  
 allan langan dag · liudi managa,  
 2819 êli-þeodige man, · ant-tat an áband sêg  
 sunne te sedle. · Þó géngun is ge·sīðos twe·libi,  
 2821 gumon te þemu godes barne · ęndi sagdun iro gódumu  
 hêrron,  
 mid hwi·líku arbêdju þár þea erlos libdin, · kwáðun þat sie is  
 êra bi·þorftin,  
 2823 weros an þemu wóstjon lande: · „sie ni mugun sie hér mid  
 wihti ant·hêbbjen,  
 hêliðos bi hungres ge·þwinge. · Nú lát þú sie, hêrro þe gódo,  
 2825 sīðon, þár sie sêliða fīðen. · Náh sind hér ge·setana burgi  
 managa mid mēgin-þiodun: · þár fīðad sie mēti te kôpe,  
 2827 weros aftar þem wíkjon.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist,  
 þioda drohtin, · kwað þat þes êniga þuruftri ni wárin,  
 2829 „þat sie þurh mēti·lôsi · mína far·látan  
 leob·líka lêra. · Gebad gí þesun liudjun gi·nóg,  
 2831 wënnjad sie hér mid willjon.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu  
 Philippus fród gumo, · kwað þat þár só filu wári  
 2833 manno mēnigi: · „þoh wí hér te mēti habdin  
 garu im te geþanne, · só wí mahtin far·gelden mêt,  
 2835 ef wí hér gi·saldin · siluþer·skatto  
 twê hund samad, · tweho wári is noh þan,  
 2837 þat iro ênig þár · ênes gi·námi:  
 só luttik wári þat þesun liudjun.“ · Þó sprak eft þe landes ward  
 2839 ęndi frágode sie · firi-wit·líko,  
 manno drohtin, · hwat sie þár te mēti habdin  
 2841 wistes ge·wunnin. · Þó sprak imu eft mid is wordun an·gegin  
 Andreas fora þem erlun · ęndi þemu alo·waldon  
 2843 selbumu sagde, · þat sie an iro gi·sīðe þan mēr  
 garowes ni habdin, · „bi·útan girstin brôð  
 2845 fībi an úsaru fērði · ęndi fiskos twêne.  
 Hwat mag þat þoh þesaru mēnigi?“ · Þó sprak imu eft mahtig  
 Krist,  
 2847 þe gódo godes sunu, · ęndi hét þat gumono folk  
 skęrjen ęndi skêðen · ęndi hét þea skola sęttjen,  
 2849 erlos aftar þeru erðu, · irmin-þioda  
 an grase gruonimu, · ęndi þó te is jungarun sprak,

- 2851 allaro barno bę̃st, · hét imu þiu brôd halon  
 ę̃ndi þea fiskos forð. · Þat folk stillo bę̃d,  
 2853 sat ge-sĩđi mikil; · undar þiu hé þurh is selbes kraft,  
 manno drohtin, · þene mę̃ti wihide,  
 2855 hę̃lag heban-kuning, · ę̃ndi mid is handun brak,  
 gaf it is jungarun forð, · ę̃ndi it sie undar þemu gum-skep̃je  
 hęt  
 2857 dragan ę̃ndi dę̃ljen. · Sie lę̃stun iro drohtines word,  
 is geþa gerno · drógun gumono gi-hwemu,  
 2859 hę̃laga helpa. · It undar iro handun wóhs,  
 mę̃ti manno gi-hwemu: · þeru mę̃gin-þiodu warð  
 2861 lif an lustun, · þea liudi wurðun alle,  
 sade sálig folk, · só hwat só þár gi-samnod was  
 2863 fan allun wíðun wegun. · Þó hét waldand Krist  
 gangen is jungaron · ę̃ndi hét sie gômjen wel,  
 2865 þat þiu léþa þár · far-loren ni wurði;  
 hét sie þó samnon, · þó þár sade wárun  
 2867 man-kunnjes manag. · Þár móses warð,  
 brôdes te léþu, · þat man birilos gi-las  
 2869 twe-libi fulle: · þat was tęk̃an mikil,  
 grôt kraft godes, · hwand þár was gumono gi-tald  
 2871 áno wíf ę̃ndi kind, · werodes at-samme  
 fíf þúsundig. · Þat folk al far-stód,  
 2873 þea man an iro móde, · þat sie þár mahtigna  
 hę̃rron habdun. · Þó sie heban-kuning,  
 2875 þea liudi lobodun, · kwáðun þat gio ni wurði an þit lioht  
 kuman  
 wísaro wár-sago, · eþþa þat hé gi-wald mid gode  
 2877 an þesaru middil-gard · méron habdi,  
 ę̃n-faldaran hugi. · Alle gi-sprákun,  
 2879 þat hé wári wirðig · welono ge-hwi-líkes,  
 þat hé erð-ríki · ę̃gan mósti,  
 2881 wídene wer-old-stól, · „nú hé su-lík ge-wit habad,  
 só grôte kraft mid gode.“ · Þea gumon alle gi-warð,  
 2883 þat sie ine gi-hóbin · te hę̃rosten,  
 gi-kurin ine te kuninge: · þat Kriste ni was  
 2885 wihtes wirðig, · hwand hé þit wer-old-ríki,  
 erðe ę̃ndi up-himil · þurh is ę̃nes kraft  
 2887 selbo gi-warhte · ę̃ndi sĩđor gi-held,

land  ndi liud-sk pi,   — oh  es  nigan gi l bon ni dedin  
 2889 wr  e wi  er-sakon—    at al an is gi walde st d,  
 kuning-r kjo kraft    ndi k sur-d mes,  
 2891 m gin- iodo mahal.   Be iu ni welde h   urh  ero manno  
 spr ka  
 h bbjan  nigan h r-d m,   h lag drohtin,  
 2893 wer-old-kuninges namon;   ni h     mid wordun str d  
 ni af hof wi   at folk fur ur,   ak f r imu   ,   r h  welde,  
 2895 an  n ge birgi uppan:   fl h  at barn godes  
 g laro g lp-kwidi    ndi is jungaron h t  
 2897 o ar  nne s o s  on    ndi im selbo gi b d,  
 hw r sie im eft te g gnes   gangen skoldin.

TODO.

2899 35    te l t  at liud-werod   aftar  emu lande allumu,  
 te f r folk mikil,   s  or iro fr ho gi w t  
 2901 an  at ge birgi uppan,   barno r kjost,  
 waldand an is willjon.      te  es watares sta e  
 2903 samnodun  ea ge s  os Kristes,    e h  imu habde selbo  
 gi korane,  
 sie twe libi  urh iro treuwa g da:   ni was im tweho nigijan,  
 2905 ne u sie an  at godes  ionost   gerno weldin  
 o ar  ene s o s  on.      l tun sie swi jan str m,  
 2907 h h hurnid skip   hluttron   jon,  
 sk  an sk r water.   Skr d lioht dages,  
 2909 sunne war  an sedle;    e s o-l  andjan  
 naht ne ulo bi warp;   n   idun erlos  
 2911 for  wardes an fl d;   war   iu fior e t d  
  era nahtes kuman   —  jendo Krist  
 2913 warode  ea w g-l  and—:      war  wind mikil,  
 h h wedar af haben:   hlamodun   jon,  
 2915 str m an stamne;   str djun f ridun  
  ea weros wi  er winde,   was im wr   hugi,  
 2917 se o sorgono ful:   selbon ni w ndun  
 lagu-l  andja   an land kumen  
 2919  urh  es wederes ge win.      gi s hun sie waldand Krist  
 an  emu s  e uppan   selbun gangan,  
 2921 faran an f  jon:   ni mahte an  ene fl d innan,  
 an  ene s o sinkan,   h wand ine is selbes kraft

- 2923 hêlag ant·habde. · Hugi warð an forhtun,  
 pero manno mōd-sebo: · an·drédun þat it im mahtig fiund  
 2925 te gi·droge dádi. · Þó sprak im iro drohtin tó,  
 hêlag heban-kuning, · ɛndi sagde im þat hé iro hêrro was  
 2927 mári ɛndi mahtig: · „nú gí módes skulun  
 fastes fāhen; · ne sí iu forht hugi,  
 2929 gi·bárjad gí bald-liko: · ik bium þat barn godes,  
 is selbes sunu, · þe iu wið þesumu sêe skal,  
 2931 mundon wið þesan mēri-strôm.“ · Þó sprak imu ên þero  
 manno an·gëgin  
 oþar bord skipes, · bar-wirðig gumo,  
 2933 Petrus þe gódo · —ni welde pīne þolon,  
 watares witi—: · „ef þú it waldand sís“, kwað hé,  
 2935 „hêrro þe gódo, · só mí an mínumu hugi þunkit,  
 hêt mí þan þarod gangan te þí · oþar þesen geþenes strôm,  
 2937 drokno oþar diap water, · ef þú mín drohtin sís,  
 managoro mund-boro.“ · Þó hét ine mahtig Krist  
 2939 gangan imu te·gëgnes. · Hé warð garu sáno,  
 stôp af þemu stamne · ɛndi stríðjun gëng  
 2941 forð te is frôjan. · Þiu flód ant·habde  
 þene man þurh maht godes, · ant-tat hé imu an is móde bi·gan  
 2943 an·dráden diap water, · þó hé dríþen gi·sah  
 þene wég mid windu: · wundun ina ũðjon,  
 2945 hōh strôm umbi·hring. · Reht só hé þó an is hugi twehode,  
 só wêk imu þat water under, · ɛndi hé an þene wág innan,  
 2947 sank an þene sêo-strôm, · ɛndi hé hriop sán aftar þiu  
 gáhon te þemu godes sunje · ɛndi gerno bad,  
 2949 þat hé ine þó ge·nëridi, · þó hé an nōðjun was,  
 þegan an ge·þwinge. · Þiodo drohtin  
 2951 ant·fëng ine mid is faðmun · ɛndi frágode sána,  
 te hwí hé þó ge·twehodi: · „Hwat þú mahtes ge·trúojan wel,  
 2953 witen þat te wárun, · þat þi watares kraft  
 an þemu sêe innen · þínes siðes ni mahte,  
 2955 lagu-strôm gi·lëttjen, · só lango só þú habdes ge·lōþon te mí  
 an þínumu hugi hardo. · Nú willju ik þi an helpun wesen,  
 2957 nęrjen þi an þesaru nōdi“. · Þó nam ine alo-mahtig,  
 hêlag bi handun: · þó warð imu eft hlutter water  
 2959 fast under fótun, · ɛndi sie an fāði samad  
 bêðja géngun, · ant-tat sie oþar bord skipes



2961 stópun fan þemu strôme, · ęndi an þemu stamne ge·sat  
 allaro barno bętst. · Þó warð brêd water,  
 2963 strômos ge·stillid, · ęndi sie te staðe kwámun,  
 lagu-liðandja · an land samen  
 2965 þurh þes wateres ge·win, · sagdun þo waldande þank,  
 diurden iro drohtin · dádjun ęndi wordun,  
 2967 fellun imu te fótun · ęndi filu sprákun  
 wísaro wordo, · kwáðun þat sie wissin garo,  
 2969 þat hé wári selbo · sunu drohtines  
 wár an þesaru wer-oldi · ęndi ge·wald habdi  
 2971 obar middil-gard, · ęndi þat hé mahti allaro manno gi·hwes  
 feráhe gi·formon, · al só hé im an þemu flóde dede  
 2973<sup>a</sup> wið þes watares ge·win.

TODO.

2973<sup>b</sup> **36** Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist  
 síðon fan þemu sêe, · sunu drohtines,  
 2975 ęnag barn godes. · Ełi-þioda kwam imu,  
 gumon te·gegnes: · wárun is gódun werk  
 2977 ferran ge·frági, · þat hé só filu sagde  
 wároro wordo: · imu was willjo mikil,  
 2979 þat hé su-lík folk-skepi · frummjen mósti,  
 þat sie simla gerno · gode þionodin,  
 2981 wárin ge·hórige · heban-kuninge  
 man-kunnjes manag. · Þó gi·wêt hé imu ober þea marka  
 Judeono,  
 2983 sóhte imu Sidono burg, · habde ge·síðos mid imu,  
 góde jungaron. · Þár imu te·gegnes kwam  
 2985 ęn idis fan aðrom þiodun; · siu was iru aðali-ge·burdjo,  
 kunnjes fan Kananeo lande; · siu bad þene kraftagan drohtin,  
 2987 hêlagna, þat hé iru helpe ge·rédi, · kwað þat iru wári harm  
 gi·standen,  
 soroga at iru selbaru dohter, · kwað þat siu wári mid suhtjun  
 bi·fangen:  
 2989 „be·drogan habbjad sie dęnja wihti. · Nú is iro dód at hęndi,  
 þea wrêðon habbjad sie ge·wittju be·numane. · Nú biddju ik  
 þi, waldand frô min,  
 2991 selbo sunu Dawides, · þat sie af su-líkum suhtjun a·tómjes,  
 þat þú sie só arma · ę-gróht-fullo

- 2993 wam-skaðon bi·weri.“ · Ni gaf iru þó noh waldand Krist  
 ênig and·wordi; · siu imu aftar géng,  
 2995 folgode fruokno, · ant-tat siu te is fótun kwam,  
 grótte ina greatandi. · Jungaron Kristes  
 2997 bádun iro hêrron, · þat hé an is hugja mildi  
 wurði þemu wíbe. · Þó habde eft is word garu  
 2999 sunu drohtines · êndi te is ge·sīðun sprak:  
 „êrist skal ik Israheles · aþoron werðen,  
 3001 folk-skæpi te frumu, · þat sie ferhtan hugi  
 hëbbjan te iro hêrron: · im is helpono þarf,  
 3003 þea liudi sind far·lorane, · far·lāten habbjad  
 waldandes word, · þat werod is ge·twīflid,  
 3005 drībad im dērnjan hugi, · ne willjad iro drohtine hōrjen  
 Israhelo erl-skæpi, · un-gi·lōbiga sind  
 3007 hēliðos iro hêrron: · þoh skal þanen helpe kumen  
 allun ēli-þiodun.“ · Agalēto bad  
 3009 þat wif mid iro wordun, · þat iru waldand Krist  
 an is mōd-sebon · mildi wurði,  
 3011 þat siu iro barnes forð · brúkan mōsti,  
 hëbbjan sie hêle. · Þó sprak iru hêrro an·gëgin,  
 3013 mári êndi mahtig: · „nis þat“, kwað hé, „mannes reht,  
 gumono nig-ênum · gód te gi·frummjenne  
 3015 þat hé is barnun · brôdes af·tíhe,  
 wernje im oþar willjon, · lāte sie wíti þoljan,  
 3017 hungar hēti-grimmen, · êndi fódje is hundos mid þiu.“  
 „Wár is þat, waldand“, (kwað siu,) „þat þú mid þínun wordun  
 sprikis,  
 3019 sōð·líko sagis: · Hwat þoh oft an sēli innen  
 undar iro hêrron diske · hwelpos hwerþad  
 3021 brosmmono fulle · þero fan þemu biode niðer  
 ant·fallat iro frōjan.“ · Þó gi·hōrde þat friðu-barn godes  
 3023 willjan þes wíbes · êndi sprak iru mid is wordun tó:  
 „wela þat þú wif haþes · willjan góden!  
 3025 Mikil is þín gi·lōbo · an þea maht godes,  
 an þene liudjo drohtin. · Al wirðid gi·lêstid só  
 3027 umbi þínes barnes líf, · só þú bádi te mí.“  
 Þó warð siu sán gi·hêlid, · só it þe hêlago ge·sprak  
 3029 wordun wár-fastun: · þat wif fagonode,  
 þes siu iro barnes forð · brúkan mōste;

3031 habde iru gi·holpen · hêljando Krist,  
 habde sie far·fangane · fiundo kraftu,  
 3033 wam-skaðun bi·wërid. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand forð,  
 barno þat bêtste, · sóhte imu burg öðre,  
 3035 þiu só þikko was · mid þeru þiodu Judeono,  
 mid süðar-liudjun gi·seten. · Þár gi·fragn ik þat hé is ge·siðos  
 grótte,  
 3037 þe jungaron þe hé imu habde be is góde gi·korane, · þat sie  
 mid imu gerno ge·wunodun,  
 weros þurh is wíson spráka: · „alle skal ik iu“, kwað hé, „mid  
 wordun frágon,  
 3039 jungaron míne: · hwat kweðat þese Judeo liudi,  
 mári megin-þioda, · hwat ik manno sí?“  
 3041 Imu and-wordidun frô·líko · is friund an·gegin,  
 jungaron síne: · „nis þit Judeono folk,  
 3043 erlos ên-wordje: · sum sagad þat þú Elias sí,  
 wís wár-sago, · þe hér giu was lango,  
 3045 gód undar þesumu gum-skepje, · sum sagad þat þú Johannes  
 sí,  
 diur-lík drohtines bodo, · þe hér dôpte iu  
 3047 werod an watere; · alle sie mid wordun sprekad,  
 þat þú ên-hwi-lík sí · ęðilero manno,  
 3049 þero wár-sagono, · þe hér mid wordun giu  
 lêrdun þese liudi, · ęndi þat þú sí eft an þit lioht kumen  
 3051 te wísjanne þesumu werode.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist:  
 „Hwe kweðad gí, þat ik sí“, (kwað hé,) „jungaron míne,  
 3053 liobon liud-weros?“ · Þó te lat ni warð  
 Símon Petrus: · sprak sán an·gegin  
 3055 êno for im allun · —habde imu ęlljen gód,  
 þristja gi·þáhti, · was is þeodone hold—:

TODO.

3057 **37** „Þú bist þe wáro · waldandes sunu,  
 libbjendes godes, · þe þit lioht gi·skóp,  
 3059 Krist kuning êwig: · só willjad wi kweðen alle,  
 jungaron þíne, · þat þú sí god selbo,  
 3061 hêljandero bêtst.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro an·gegin:  
 „Sálig bist þú Símon“, kwað hé, „sunu Jonases; · ni mahtes þú  
 þat selbo ge·huggjan,



3099 **mári** mahtig Krist · —was imu an is **móde** hold—:  
 „Hwat þú nú **wiðer·ward** bist“, (kwað hé,) „**willjon** mínes,  
 3101 **þegno** bætsto! · Hwat þú þesaro **þido** kanst  
**menniskan** sidu: · þú ni wêst þe **maht** godes,  
 3103 þe ik gi·frummjen skal. · Ik mag þi **filu** sæggjan  
**wárun** **wordun**, · þár hér undar þesumu **werode** standad  
 3105 ge·**sīðos** míne, · þea ni mótun **swelten** êr,  
**hwerþen** an **hinen**-fard · êr sie **himiles** lioht,  
 3107 godes **ríki** sehat.“ · Kôs imu **jungarono** þó  
**sán** aftar þiu · **Símon** Petrus,  
 3109 **Jakob** endi **Johannes**, · ea **gumon** twêne,  
**bêðja** þea gi·**bróðer**, · endi imu þó uppen þene **berg** gi·wêt  
 3111 **sunder** mid þem ge·**sīðun**, · **sálig** barn godes,  
 mid þem **þegnun** **þrim**, · **þido** drohtin,  
 3113 **waldand** þesaro **wer**-oldes: · welde im þár **wundres** filu,  
**têkno** **tôgjan**, · þat sie gi·**trúodin** þiu bêt,  
 3115 þat hé **selbo** was · **sunu** drohtines,  
**hêlag** **heban**-kuning. · Þó sie an **hôhan** wall  
 3117 **stigun** **stên** endi **berg**, · ant-tat sie te þeru **stêdi** kwámun,  
**weros** **wiðer** **wolkān**, · þár **waldand** Krist,  
 3119 **kuningo** **kraftigost** · gi·**koren** habde,  
 þat hé is **god**-kundi · **jungarun** sínun  
 3121 þurh is **ênes** kraft · **ógjan** welde,  
 3122<sup>a</sup> **berht**-lík **biliði**.

“Thou art the true son of the Wielder,  
 of the Living God who created this Light,  
 O Christ, king everlasting. Thus we all wish to say,  
 we thy disciples, that thou art God alone,  
 the best of Saviours.” Then his Lord spoke back, facing him:  
 “Blessed art thou, Simon”, quoth he, “the son of John. Thou couldst not by  
 thyself have thought that,  
 devised it in the thoughts of thy heart, nor could any man’s tongue  
 have shown thee those words, but the Wielder Himself did it for thee,  
 the father of all children of men, that thou didst speak forth such things,  
 so deeply by thy Lord. Dearly shalt thou have rewards for that;  
 thou hast trusted splendidly in thy Lord; the state of thy mind is like stone;  
 thou art as fast as the hard mountain. Thou shalt be called by the children  
 of men  
 Saint Peter. Over this stone shall men build my hall,  
 the holy house of God. TODO.”.

3062–3068 „Sálig ... hardo | Ll. 3062a–3063b, 3064b–3068a are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, pp. 424–425).

3122<sup>b</sup> 38

Þó imu þár te bedu gi·hnêg,

þó warð imu þár uppe · ôðar-líkora

3124 wlti ęndi gi·wádi: · wurðun imu is wangun liohte,  
blíkandi só þiu berhte sunne: · só skên þat barn godes,

3126 liuhte is lík-hamo: · liomon stóðun  
wánamo fan þemu waldandes barne; · warð is ge·wádi só hwít  
3128 só snêw te sehanne. · Þó warð þár seld-lík þing

gi·ôgid aftar þiu: · Elias ęndi Moyses  
3130 kwámun þár te Kriste · wið só kraftagne

wordun wehsljan. · Þár warð só wun-sam spráka,  
3132 só gód word undar gumun, · þár þe godes sunu  
wið þea márjan man · mahljen welde,

3134 só blíði warð uppan þemu berge: · skên þat berhte lioht,  
was þár gard gód-lík · ęndi gróni wang,

3136 Paradíse ge·lík. · Petrus þó gi·mahalde,  
hęlið hard-módig · ęndi te is hêrron sprak,

3138 grótte þene godes sunu: · „gód is it hér te wesanne,  
ef þú it gi·kiosan wili, · Krist alo-waldo,

3140 þat man þi hér an þesaru hōhe · ên hús ge·wirkja,  
már-liko ge·mako · ęndi Moyses e ôðer

3142 ęndi Eliase þridþja: · þit is ôðas hêm,  
welono wun-samost.“ · Reht só hé þó þat word ge·sprak,

3144 só ti·lét þiu luft an twê: · lioht wolkan skên,  
glítandi glímo, · ęndi þea góðun man

3146 wlti-skôni be·warp. · Þó fan þemu wolkne kwam  
hêlag stemne godes, · ęndi þem hęliðun þár

3148 selbo sagde, · þat þat is sunu wári,  
libbjendero liobost: · „an þemu mí líkod wel

3150 an mínun hugi-skęftjun. · Þemu gí hōrjen skulun,  
ful-gangad imu gerno.“ · Þó ni mahtun þea jungaron Kristes

3152 þes wolknes wlti · ęndi word godes,  
þea is mikilon maht · þea man ant-standen,

3154 ak sie bi·fellun þó forð-wardes: · ferhes ni wándun,  
lęngiron líbes. · Þó gęng im tó þe landes ward,

3156 be·hrên sie mid is handun · hêljandero bętst,  
hét þat sie im ni an·dréðin: · „ni skal iu hér derjen eo-wiht,

3158 þes gí hér seld-likes · gi·sehen habbjad,  
 mérjaro þingo.“ · Þó eft þem mannun warð  
 3160 hugi at iro herton · ęndi gi·hélid mód,  
 gi·bade an iro breostun: · gi·sáhun þat barn godes  
 3162 ęnna standen, · was þat óðer þó,  
 be·hliden himiles lioht. · Þó gi·wêt imu þe hêlago Krist  
 3164 fan þemu berge niðer; · gi·bôð aftar þiu  
 jungarun sínun, · þat sie obar Judeono folk  
 3166 ni sagdin þea gi·sioni: · „er þan ik selbo hér  
 swiðo diur-liko · fan dôðe a·stande,  
 3168 a·rise fan þeru ręstu: · siðor mugun gí it rękkjen forð,  
 márjen obar middil-gard · managun þiodun  
 3170<sup>a</sup> wido aftar þesaru wer-oldi.“

TODO.

3170<sup>b</sup> 39 Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist  
 eft an Galileo land, · sóhte is gadulingos,  
 3172 mahtig is mágo hēm, · sagde þár manages hwat  
 berhtero biliðjo, · ęndi þat barn godes  
 3174 þem is sálígun ge·siðun · sorg-spell ni for·hal,  
 ak hé im open-liko · allun sagde,  
 3176 þem is góðun jungarun, · hwó ine skolde þat Judeono folk  
 wêgjan te wundrun. · Þes wurðun þár wíse man  
 3178 swiðo an sorgun, · warð im sêr hugi,  
 hriuwig umbi iro herte: · gi·hórdun iro hêrron þó,  
 3180 waldandes sunu · wordun tēlljen,  
 hwat hé undar þeru þiodu · þolojan skolde,  
 3182 willjendi undar þemu werode. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist,  
 gumo fan Galilea, · sóhte imu Judeono burg,  
 3184 kwámun im te Kafarnaum. · Þár fundun sie ęnan kuninges  
 þegān  
 wlankan undar þemu werode: · kwað þat hé wári gi·wêldig  
 bodo  
 3186 aðal-késures; · hé grótte aftar þiu  
 Símon Petrusen, · kwað þat hé wári gi·sęndid þarod,  
 3188 þat hé þár gi·manodi · manno ge·hwi-líken  
 þero hôbid-skatto, · þe sie te þemu hobe skoldin  
 3190 tinsi gelden: · „nis þes tweho ęnig  
 gumono ni-gj·ênumu, · ne sie ina far·gelden sán

- 3192 mēðmo kustjon, · bi·úten iuwe mēster êno  
habad it far·lāten. · Ni skal þat líkon wel
- 3194 mínimu hêrron, · só man it imu at is hobe küðid,  
aðal·kêsure.“ · Þó géng aftar þiu
- 3196 Símon Petrus, · welde it seggjan þó  
hêrron sínumu: · hé was is an is hugi iu þan,
- 3198 gi·waro waldand Krist: · —imu ni mahte word ênig  
bi·holen werðen, · hé wisse hugi·skęfti
- 3200 manno ge·hwi·líkes—: · hét þó þene is mārjan þegan,  
Símon Petrus · an þene sêo innen
- 3202 angul werpen: · „su·líken só þú þár êrist mugis  
fisk gi·fāhen“, (kwað hé,) „só teoh þú þene fan þemu flóde te þi,
- 3204 ant·klęmmi imu þea kinni: · þár maht þú undar þem kaflon  
nimen
- guldine skattos, · þat þú far·gelden maht  
þemu manne te gi·módja · mínen ęndi þinen
- 3206 tinsjo só hwi·líkan, · só hé ús tó sókid.“
- 3208 Hé ni þorfte imu þó aftar þiu · ôðaru wordu  
furður gi·bioden: · géng fiskari gód,
- 3210 Símon Petrus, · warp an þene sêo innen  
angul an üðjon · ęndi up gi·tôh
- 3212 fisk an flóde · mid is folmun twêm,  
te·klóf imu þea kinni · ęndi undar þem kaflun nam
- 3214 guldine skattos: · dede al, só imu þe godes sunu  
wordun ge·wísde. · Þár was þó waldandes
- 3216 megin·kraft gi·márid, · hwó skal allaro manno ge·hwi·lík  
swíðo willjendi · is wer·old·hêrron
- 3218 skuldi ęndi skattos, · þea imu gi·skęride sind,  
gerno gelden: · ni skal ine far·gúmon eo·wiht,
- 3220 ni far·muni ine an is móde, · ak wese imu mildi an is hugi,  
þiono imu þio·líko: · an þiu mag hé þiod·godes
- 3222 willjan ge·wirkjan · ęndi ôk is wer·old·hêrron
- 3223<sup>a</sup> huldi habbjēn.

TODO.

3223<sup>b</sup> 40

Só lērde þe hêlago Krist

- þea is gódon jungaron: · „ef ênig gumono wið iu“, kwað hé,
- 3225 „sundja ge·wirkja, · þan nim þú ina sundar te þi,  
þene rink an rúna · ęndi imu is ráð saga,



3227 wísi imu mid wordun. · Ef imu þan þes werð ne sí,  
 þat hé þi gi·hôrje, · hala þi þár ôðara tó  
 3229 góðaro gumono, · ɛndi lah imu is grimmun werk,  
 sak ina sôð-wordun. · Ef imu þan is sundja aftar þiu,  
 3231 lôs-werk ni lêðon, · gi·duo it ôðrun liudjun küð,  
 mári it þan for mɛnegi · ɛndi lát manno filu  
 3233 witen is far·wurhti: · ôðo be·ginnad imu þan is werk tregan,  
 an is hugi hreuwen, · þan hé it gi·hôrid hɛliðo filu,  
 3235 ahton ɛldi-barn · ɛndi imu is ubilon dád  
 wɛrjad mid wordun. · Ef hé þan ôk wɛndjen ne wili,  
 3237 ak far·módat su·líka mɛnegi, · þan lát þú þene man faren,  
 haba ina þan far hêðinen · ɛndi lát ina þi an þínumu hugi  
 lêðen,  
 3239 míð is an þínumu móde, · ne sí þat imu eft mildi god,  
 hêr heban-kuning · helpe far·líhe,  
 3241 fader allaro firiho barno.“ · Þó frágoðe Petrus,  
 allaro þegno bɛtst · þeodan sínan:  
 3243 „hwó oft skal ik þem mannun, · þe wið mí habbjad  
 lêð-werk gi·duan, · leobo drohtin,  
 3245 skal ik im sibun sīðun · iro sundja a·látan,  
 wrêðaro werko, · êr þan ik is êniga wréka frummje,  
 3247 lêðes te lône?“ · Þó sprak eft þe landes ward,  
 an·gëgin þe godes sunu · gódumu þegne:  
 3249 „ni seggju ik þi fan sibunjun, · só þú selbo sprikis,  
 mahlis mid þínu müðu, · ik duom þi mêra þár tó:  
 3251 sibun sīðun sibun-tig · só skalt þú sundja ge·hwemu,  
 lêðes a·látan: · só willju ik þi te lêrun geþen  
 3253 wordun wár-fastun. · Nú ik þi su·líka gi·wald far·gaf,  
 þat þú mínes híwiskes · hêrost wáris,  
 3255 manages mann-kunnjes, · nú skalt þú im mildi wesen,  
 liudjun líði.“ · Þó þár te þemu lêrjande kwam  
 3257 ên jung man an·gëgin · ɛndi frágoðe Jesu Krist:  
 „mêster þe gódo“, (kwað hé,) „hwat skal ik manages duan,  
 3259 an þiu þe ik heban-ríki · ge·halan móti?“  
 Habde imu ôd-welon · allen ge·wunnen,  
 3261 mêðom-hord manag, · þoh hé mildjan hugi  
 bári an is breostun. · Þó sprak imu þat barn godes:  
 3263 „hwat kwiðis þú umbi gódon? · nis þat gumono ênig  
 bi·útan þe êno, · þe þár al ge·skóp,

- 3265 wer-old ęndi wunnja. · Ef þú is willjan habas,  
 þat þú an lioht godes · líðan mótis,  
 3267 þan skalt þú bi·halden · þea hêlagon lêra,  
 þe þár an þemu aldon · êwa ge·biudid,  
 3269 þat þú man ni slah, · ni þú mênes ni sweri,  
 far·legar-nessi far·lát · ęndi luggi ge·wit-skępi,  
 3271 stríd ęndi stulina; · ne wis þú te stark an hugi,  
 ne níðin ne hatul, · ni nôd-róf ni fręmi;  
 3273 aþ-unst alla far·lát; · wis þínun ęldirun gód,  
 fader ęndi móder, · ęndi þínun friundun hold,  
 3275 þem náhistun gi·náðig. · Þan þú þi gi·niodon móst  
 himilo ríkjas, · ef þú it bi·halden wili,  
 3277 ful-gangan godes lêrun.“ · Þó sprak eft þe jungo man  
 „al hebbju ik só gi·lêstid“, (kwað hé,) „só þú mí lêris nú,  
 3279 wordun wísis, · só ik is eo wiht ni far·lét  
 fan mínero kindiski.“ · Þó bi·gan ina Krist sehan  
 3281 an mid is ôgun: · „ên is þár noh nú“, kwað hé,  
 „wan þero werko: · ef þú is willjon habas,  
 3283 þat þú þurh-fręmid · þionon mótis  
 hêrron þínumu, · þan skalt þú þat þín hord nimen,  
 3285 skalt þínan ôd-welon · allan far·kôpjen,  
 diurje mêðmos, · ęndi dëljen hét  
 3287 armun mannun: · þan habas þú aftar þiu  
 hord an himile; · kum þi þan gi·halden te mí,  
 3289 folgo þi mínaro fęrdi: · þan habas þú friðu sīður.“  
 Þó wurðun Kristes word · kind-jungumu manne  
 3291 swíðo an sorgun, · was imu sêr hugi,  
 mód umbi herte: · habde mêðmo filu,  
 3293 welono ge·wunnen; · węnde imu eft þanen,  
 was imu un-ôðo · innan breostun,  
 3295 an is seþon swáro. · Sah imu aftar þó  
 Krist alo-waldo, · kwað it þó, þár hé welde,  
 3297 te þem is jungarun gegin-wardun, · þat wári an godes ríki  
 un-óði ôdagumu manne · up te kumanne:  
 3299 „ôður mag man olbundjon, · þoh hé sí un-met grôt,  
 þurh náðlan gat, · þoh it sí naru swíðo,  
 3301 sáftur þurh-slóþjen, · þan mugi kuman þiu siole te himile  
 þes ôdagan mannes, · þe hér al haðad  
 3303 gi·węndid an þene wer-old-skat · willjon sínen,

mód-gi-þáhti, · ɛndi ni hugid umbi þie maht godes.“

TODO.

- 3305 **41** Imu and-wordjade · êr-þungan gumo,  
 3307 **Simon** Petrus, · ɛndi sɛggjan bad  
 leoban hêrron: · „Hwat skulun wí þes te lône nimen“, kwað  
 hé,  
 „gódes te gelde, · þes wí þurh þín jungar-dóm  
 3309 êgan ɛndi ɛrbi · al far·létun  
 hobos ɛndi híwiski · ɛndi þi te hêrron gi·kurun,  
 3311 folgodun þínaru fɛrði: · hwat skal ús þes te frumu werðen,  
 langes te lône?“ · Liudjo drohtin  
 3313 sagde im þó selbo: · „Þan ik sittjen kumu“, kwað hé,  
 „an þie mikilan maht · an þemu márjan dage,  
 3315 þár ik allun skal · irmin-þiodun  
 dómos a·dêljen, · þan mótun gí mid iuwomu drohtine þár  
 3317 selbon sittjen · ɛndi mótun þera saka waldan:  
 mótun gí Israhelo · ɛðili-folkun  
 3319 a·dêljen aftar iro dádjun: · só mótun gí þár gi·diuride wesen.  
 Þan sɛggju ik iu te wáran: · só hwe só þat an þesaru wer-oldi  
 gi·duot,  
 3321 þat hé þurh mína minnja · mágo ge·sidli  
 liof far·létid, · þes skal hí hér lôn niman  
 3323 tehan siðun tehin-fald, · ef hé it mid treuwon duot,  
 mid hluttru hugi. · Obar þat habad hé ôk himiles lioht,  
 3325 open êwig líf.“ · Bi·gan imu þó aftar þiu  
 allaro barno bɛtst · ên biliði sɛggjan,  
 3327 kwað þat þár ên ôdag man · an êr-dagun  
 wári undar þemu werode: · þe habde welono ge·nóg,  
 3329 sinkas gi·samnod · ɛndi imu simlun was  
 garu mid goldu · ɛndi mid godo-wɛbbju,  
 3331 fagarun fratahun · ɛndi imu so filu habde  
 gódes an is gardun · ɛndi imu at gômun sat  
 3333 allaro dago ge·hwi·líkes: · habde imu diur·lík líf,  
 blíðsja an is bɛnkjun. · Þan was þár eft ên biddjendi man,  
 3335 gi·lébod an is lík-hamon, · Lazarus was hé hêten,  
 lag imu dago ge·hwi·líkes · at þem durun foren,  
 3337 þár hé þene ôdagan man · inne wisse  
 an is gɛst-sɛli · gôme þiggjan,

- 3339 sittjen at sumble, · ɛndi hé simlun bêd  
 gi·armod þár úte: · ni móste þár in kuman,  
 3341 ne hé ni mahte ge·biddjen, · þat man imu þes brôdes þarod  
 gi·dragan weldi, · þes þár fan þemu diske niðer  
 3343 ant·fel undar iro fôti: · ni mahte imu þár ênig fruma werðen  
 fan þemu hêroston, þe þes húses gi·wêld, · bi·útan þat þár  
 géngun is hundos tó,  
 3345 likkodun is lík-wundon, · þár hé liggjandi  
 hungar þolode; · ni kwam imu þár te helpu wiht  
 3347 fan þemu ríkjon manne. · Þó gi·fragn ik þat ina is regano  
 gi·skapu,  
 þene armon man · is ên-dago  
 3349 gi·manoda mahtjun swíð, · þat hé manno drôm  
 a·geben skolde. · Godes ɛngilos  
 3351 ant·féngun is ferh · ɛndi léddun ine forð þanen,  
 þat sie an Abrahames barm · þes armon mannes  
 3353 siole gi·settun: · þár móste hé simlun forð  
 wesen an wunnjun. · Þó kwámun ôk wurde-gi·skapu,  
 3355 þemu ôdagan man · or-lag-hwíle,  
 þat hé þit lioht far·lét: · lêða wihti  
 3357 be·sinkodun is siole · an þene swarton heļ,  
 an þat fern innen · fiundun te willjan,  
 3359 be·gróðun ine an gramono hêm. · Þanen mahte hé þene  
 góðan skawon,  
 Abraham ge·sehen, · þár hé uppe was  
 3361 líbes an lustun, · ɛndi Lazarus sat  
 blíði an is barme, · berht lôn ant·féng  
 3363 allaro is arm-ódjo, · ɛndi lag þe ôdago man  
 hêto an þeru heļļu, · hriop up þanen:  
 3365 „fader Abraham“, (kwað hé,) „mí is firinun þarf,  
 þat þú mí an þínumu mód-seþon · mildi werðes,  
 3367 líði an þesaru lognu: · sɛndi mí Lazarus herod,  
 þat hé mí ge·fórja · an þit fern innan  
 3369 kaldes wateres. · Ik hér kwik brinnu  
 hêto an þesaru heļļu: · nú is mí þínaro helpono þarf,  
 3371 þat hé mí a·lɛskje · mid is luttikon fingru  
 tungon míne, · nú siu tēkan habad,  
 3373 uþil arbēdi. · Inwid-rádo,  
 lêðaro spráka, · alles is mí nú þes lôn kumen.“

3375 Imu and-wordjade þó Abraham · —þat was ald-fader—:  
 „ge·hugi þú an þínumu herton“, (kwað hé,) „hwat þú habdes iu  
 3377 welono an wer-oldi. · Hwat þú þár alle þíne wunnja far-sliti,  
 gódes an gardun, · só hwat só þi gíbiðig forð  
 3379 werðen skolde. · Wíti þolode  
 Lazarus an þemu liohte, · habde þár lêðes filu,  
 3381 wítjas an wer-oldi. · Be-þiu skal hé nú welon êgan,  
 libbjen an lustun: · þú skalt þea logna þolan,  
 3383 brinnendi fiur: · ni mag is þi ênig bóte kumen  
 hinana te hêllju: · it habad þe hêlago god  
 3385 só gi·fastnod mid is faðmun: · ni mag þár faren ênig  
 þegno þurh þat þiustri: · it is hér só pikki undar ús.“  
 3387 Þó sprak eft Abraham · þe erl te·gegnes  
 fan þeru hêtan hêll · êndi helpono bad,  
 3389 þat hé Lazarus · an liudjo drôm  
 selbon sandi: · „þat hé ge·seggja þár  
 3391 bróðarun mínun, · hwó ik hér brinnendi  
 þrá-werk þolon; · si þár undar þeru þiodu sind,  
 3393 si fíbi undar þemu folke: · ik an forhtun bium,  
 þat sie im þár far·wirkjen, · þat sie skulin ôk an þit wíti te mí,  
 3395 an só grádag fiur.“ · Þó imu eft te·gegnes sprak  
 Abraham ald-fader, · kwað þat sie þár êo godes  
 3397 an þemu land-skêpi, · liudi habdin,  
 Moyseses gi·bôd · êndi þár managaro tó  
 3399 wár-saguno word: · „ef sie is willige sind,  
 þat sie þat bi·halden, · þan ni þurbun sie an þea hêll innen,  
 3401 an þat fern faren, · ef sie ge·frummjad só,  
 só þea ge·biodad, · þe þea bók lesat  
 3403 þem liudjun te lêrun. · Ef sie þes þan ni willjad lêstjen wiht,  
 þanne ni hêrjad sie ôk · þemu þe hinan a·stád,  
 3405 man fan dôðe. · Láte man sie an iro mód-seþon  
 selbon keosen, · hweðer im swótjera þunkje  
 3407 te gi·winnanne, · só lango só sie an þesaru wer-oldi sind,  
 þat sie eft ubil eþþa gód · aftar habbjén.“

TODO.

3409 **42** Só lêrde hé þó þea liudi · liohton wordon,  
 allaro barno bêtst, · êndi biliði sagde  
 3411 manag man-kunnje · mahtig drohtin,

- kwað þat imu ên sálíg gumo · samnon bi·gunni  
 3413 man an morgen, · „endi im méda gi·hét,  
 þe hêrosto þes híwiskjas, · swíðo \*hold-lik lôn“,  
 3415 kwað þat hie iro allaro gi·hwem · ênna gábi  
 silōbrinna skat. · „Þuo samnodun managa  
 3417 weros an is wín-gardon, · —endi hie im werk bi·falāh—  
 ádro an úhtan. · Sum kwam þár ôk an undorn tuo,  
 3419 sum kwam þár an middjan dag, · man te þem werke,  
 sum kwam þár te nónu, · þuo was þiu niguða tíð  
 3421 sumar-landes dages; · sum þár ôk síðor kwam  
 an þia elliðtun tíð. · Þuo géng þár áband tuo,  
 3423 sunna ti sedle. · Þuo hie selbo gi·bôð  
 is ambahtjon, · erlo drohtin,  
 3425 þat man þero manno gi·hwem · is meoda for·guldi,  
 þem erlon arbid-lôn; · hiet þiem at êrist geban.  
 3427 þia þár at lēst wárun, · liudi kumana,  
 weros te þem werke, · endi mid is wordon gi·bôð,  
 3429 þat man þem mannon iro · mieda for·guldi  
 alles at aftan, · þem þár kwámun at êrist tuo  
 3431 willendi te þem werke. · Wándun sia swíðo,  
 þat man im mēra lôn · gi·makod habdi  
 3433 wið iro arābedje: · þan man im allon gaf,  
 þem liudjon gi·liko. · Lêð was þat swíðo,  
 3435 allon þem ando, · þem þár kwámun at êrist tuo:  
 „wí kwámun hier an morāgan“, (kwáðun sia,) „endi þolodun hier  
 manag te dage  
 3437 arābid-werko, · hwílon un-met hét,  
 skínandja sunna: · nú ni gibis þú ús skattes þan mēr,  
 3439 þie þú þem ôðron duos, · þia hier êna hwíla  
 wáron an þínor werke.“ · Þuo habda eft is word garo  
 3441 þie hêrosto þes híwiskes, · kwað þat hie im ni habdi gi·hêtan  
 þan mēr  
 werðes wið iro werke: · „Hwat ik gi·wald hēbbju“, kwaþ-hie,  
 3443 „þat ik iu allon gi·liko · muot lôn for·geldan,  
 iuwes werkes werð.“ · Þan waldandi Krist  
 3445 mēnda im þoh mēra þing, · þoh hie oþar þat manno folk  
 fan þem wín-gardon só · wordon spráki,  
 3447 hwó þár un-efno · erlos kwámun,  
 weros te þem werke. · Só skulun fan þero wer-öldi duon

3449 mann-kunnjes barn · an þat márjo liobt,  
 gumon an godes wang: · sum bi·ginnit ina giriwan sán  
 3451 an is kindiski, · habit im gi·koranan muod,  
 willjon guodan, · wer-old-saka mîðit,  
 3453 far·látit is lusta; · ni mag ina is lík-hamo  
 an un·spuod for·spanan: · spáhiða línót,  
 3455 godes êw, · gramono for·látit,  
 wrêðaro willjon, · duot im só te is wer-oldi forð,  
 3457 lêstit só an þeson liohte, · ant-þat im is líbes kumit,  
 aldres áband; · gi·wítit im þan up·wegos:  
 3459 þár wirðit im is aræbedi · all gi·lónot,  
 far·goldan mid guodu · an godes ríkje.  
 3461 Þat mēndun þia wuruhtjon, · þia an þem win·gardon  
 ádro an úhta · arbid·líko  
 3463 werk bi·gunnun · ęndi þuru·wonodun forð,  
 erlos unt áband. · Sum þár ôk an undern kwam,  
 3465 habda þuo far·męrrid, · þia morāgan-stunda  
 þes dag·werkes for·duolon; · só duot doloro filo,  
 3467 gi·mêðaro manno: · dríbit im mis·lík þing  
 gerno an is juguði, · —habit im gelp·kwidi  
 3469 lêða gi·línót · ęndi lôs-word manag—,  
 ant-þat is kindiski · far·kuman wirðit,  
 3471 þat ina after is juguði · godes anst manot  
 blíði an is brioston; · fáhit im te bęteron þan  
 3473 wordon ęndi werkon, · lêdit im is wer-old mid þiu,  
 is aldā ant þena ęndi: · kumit im alles lôn  
 3475 an godes ríkje, · góðaro werko.  
 Sum mann þan mid·firi · mēn far·látit,  
 3477 swāra sundjun, · fáhit im an sálig þing,  
 bi·ginnit im þuru godes kraft · guodaro werko,  
 3479 buotit balo·sprāka, · látit im is bittrun dād  
 an is hugje hreuwān; · kumit im þiu helpa fon gode,  
 3481 þat im gi·lêstid þie gi·lôbo, · só lango só im is líf warod;  
 farit im forð mid þiu, · ant·fáhit is mieda,  
 3483 guod lôn at gode; · ni sindun êniga geþa bęteran.  
 Sum bi·ginnit þan ôk furðor, · þan hie ist fruodot mēr,  
 3485 is aldāres af·hēldit, · —þan bi·ginnat im is ubilon werk  
 lêðon an þeson liohte, · þan ina lēra godes  
 3487 gi·manod an is muode: · wirðit im mildera hugi,

- þuru·gengit im mid guodu · ęndi geld nimit,  
 3489 hōh himil-ríki, · þan hie hīnan węndit,  
 wirðit im is mieda só sama, · só þem man \*nun warð,  
 3491 þea þár te nōnu dages, · an þea nigunda tíð,  
 an þene wīn-gardon · wirkjan kwámun.  
 3493 Sum wirðid þan só swiðo ge·fródot, · só hé ni wili is sundja  
 bótjen,  
 ak hé ôkid sie mid ubilu ge·hwi-líku, · ant-tat imu is áband  
 náhid,  
 3495 is wer-old ęndi is wunnja far·slítid; · þan be·ginnid hé imu  
 witi an·dréden,  
 is sundjon werðad imu sorga an móde: · ge·hugid hwat hé  
 selbo ge·frumide  
 3497 grimmes þan lango, þe hé móste is juguðjo neoten; · ni mag  
 þan mid öðru góðu gi·bótjen  
 þea dádi, þea hé só dęrbja ge·frumide, · ak hé slęhit allaro  
 dago ge·hwi-líkes  
 3499 an is breost mid bęðjun handun · ęndi wópit sie mid bittrun  
 trahnun,  
 hlúdo hé sie mid hofnu kúmid, · bidid þene hêlagon drohtin  
 3501 mahtigne, þat hé imu mildi werðe: · ni látid imu siðor is mód  
 gi·twífljen;  
 só ê·gróht-ful is, þe þár alles ge·wældid: · hé ni wili ênigumu  
 irmin-manne  
 3503 far·wernjen willjan sínes; · far·gibid imu waldand selbo  
 hêlag himil-ríki: · þan is imu gi·holpen siðor.  
 3505 Alle skulun sie þár êra ant·fáhen, · þoh sie þarod te ênaru tídi  
 ni kumen, þat kunni manno, · þoh wili imu þe kraftigo  
 drohtin,  
 3507 gi·lōnon allaro liudjo só hwi-líkumu, · só hér is gi·lōbon  
 ant·fáhit:  
 ên himil-ríki · gibid hé allun þeodun,  
 3509 mannun te médu. · Þat mēnde mahtig Krist,  
 barno þat bętste, · þó hé þat biliði sprak,  
 3511 hwó þár te þem wīn-gardun · wurhtjon kwámin,  
 man mis-liko: · þoh nam is méde ge·hwe  
 3513 fulle te is frōjan. · Só skulun firiho barn  
 at gode selbumu · geld ant·fáhen,  
 3515 swiðo leob-lík lōn, · þoh sie sume só late werðan.



TODO.

- 43 Hét imu þó þea is góðan · jungaron náhor  
 3517 tve·líbi gangan · —þea wárun imu triuwiston  
 man obar erðu—, · sagde im mahtig selbo  
 3519 óðer-síðu, · hwi·lík imu þár arbêdi  
 tó·ward wárun: · „þes ni mag ênig tweho werðen“, kwað hé;  
 3521 kwað þat sie þó te Jerusalem · an þat Judeono folk  
 líðan skoldin: · „þár wirðid all gi·lêstid só,  
 3523 ge·frumid undar þemu folke, · só it an furn·dagun  
 wise man be mí · wordun ge·sprá kun.  
 3525 Þár skulun mí far·kôpon · undar þea kraftigon þiod,  
 hêliðos te þeru hêri; · þár werðat mína hendi ge·bundana,  
 3527 faðmos werðad mí þár ge·fastnod; · filu skal ik þár gi·þolojan,  
 hoskes gi·hôrjen · endi harm·kwidi,  
 3529 bismerspráka · endi bi·hêt·word manag;  
 sie wêg jat mí te wundron · wápnes eggjun,  
 3531 bi·lôsjad mí líbu: · ik te þesumu liohte skal  
 þurh drohtines kraft · fan dôðe a·standen  
 3533 an þriddjon dage. · Ni kwam ik undar þesa þeoda herod  
 te þiu, þat mín êldi·barn · arbêd habdin,  
 3535 þat mí þionodi þius þiod: · ni willju ik is sie þiggjen nú,  
 fergon þit folk·skêpi, · ak ik skal imu te frumu werðen,  
 3537 þeonon imu þeo·liko · endi for alla þesa þeoda geben  
 seole míne. · Ik willju sie selbo nú  
 3539 lôsjen mid mínu líbu, · þea hér lango bidun,  
 man·kunnjes manag, · mínara helpa.“  
 3541 Fór imu þó forð·wardes · —habde imu fasten hugi,  
 blíðjan an is breostun · barn drohtines—  
 3543 welda im te Jerusalem · Judeo folkes  
 willjon wisan: · hé konste þes werodes só garo  
 3545 hêti·grimmen hugi · endi hardan stríd,  
 wrêðan willjon. · Werod síðode  
 3547 furi Jerikho·burg; · was þe godes sunu,  
 mahtig undar þero mênigi. · Þár sátun twênje man bi wege,  
 3549 blinde wárun sie bêðje: · was im bótono þarf,  
 þat sie ge·hêldi · hebanes waldand,  
 3551 hwand sie só lango · liohtes þolodun,  
 managa hwíla. · Sie gi·hórdun þó þat mēgin faren



TODO.

3588<sup>b</sup> 44 Þár was só mahtig-lík  
 biliði gi·bôknid, · þár þe blindon man  
 3590 bi þemu wege sátun, · wíti þolodun,  
 liohtes lôse: · þat mênid þoh liudjo barn,  
 3592 al man-kunni, · hwó sie mahtig god  
 an þemu ana-ginne · þurh is ênes kraft  
 3594 sin-híun twê · selbo gi-warhte,  
 Ádam êndi Êwan: · far-gaf im up-wegos,  
 3596 himilo ríki; · ak þó warð im þe hatola te náh,  
 fiund mid fêknu · êndi mid firin-werkun,  
 3598 bi·swêk sie mid sundjun, · þat sie sin-skôni,  
 lioht far·létun: · wurðun an lêðaron stêdi,  
 3600 an þesen middil-gard · man far-worpen,  
 þolodun hér an þiustrju · þiod-arbêdi,  
 3602 wunnun wrak-síðos, · welon þarbodun:  
 far·gátun godes ríkjes, · gramon þeonodun,  
 3604 fiundo barnun; · sie guldun is im mid fiuru lôn  
 an þeru hêton hêljju. · Be·þiu wárun siu an iro hugi blinda  
 3606 an þesaru middil-gard, · mēnniskono barn,  
 hwand siu ine ni ant·kiendun, · kraftagne god,  
 3608 himilisken hêrron, · þene þe sie mid is handun gi-skóp,  
 gi·warhte an is willjon. · Þius wer-old was þó só far-hwêrbid,  
 3610 bi·þwungen an þiustrje, · an þiod-arbidi,  
 an dôðes dalu: · sátun im þó bi þeru drohtines strátun  
 3612 jámar-móde, · godes helpe bidun:  
 siu ni mahte im þó êr werðen, · êr þan waldand god  
 3614 an þesan middil-gard, · mahtig drohtin,  
 is selbes sunu · sêndjen weldi  
 3616 þat hé lioht ant·luki · liudjo barnun,  
 oponodi im êwig líf, · þat sie þene alo-waldon  
 3618 mahtin ant·kēnnjen wel, · kraftagna god.  
 Ôk mag ik giu gi·têlljen, · of gí þár tó willjad  
 3620 huggjen êndi hôrjen, · þat gí þes hêljandes mugun  
 kraft ant·kēnnjen, · hwó is kumi wurðun  
 3622 an þesaru middil-gard · managun te helpu,  
 ia hwat hé mid þem dádjun · drohtin selbo  
 3624 manages mēnde, · ia be·hwiu þiu márje burg

- Jerikho hêtid, · þiu þár an Judeon stád  
 3626 gi·makod mid mûrun: · þiu is aftar þemu mánen gi·nēmnid,  
 aftar þemu torhten tungle: · hé ni mag is tídi be·míðen,  
 3628 ak hé dago ge·hwi·likes · duod ôðer-hweðer,  
 wanod ohþo wahsid. · Só dót an þesaro wer·oldi hér,  
 3630 an þesaru middil-gard · mēnskono barn:  
 farad ėndi folgod, · fróde sterbad,  
 3632 werðad eft junga · aftar kumane,  
 weros a·wahsane, · unt-tat sie eft wurd far·nimid.  
 3634 Þat mēde þat barn godes, · þó hé fon þeru burgi fór,  
 þe gódo fan Jerikho, · þat ni mahte ėr werðen gumono barnun  
 3636 þiu blindja gi·bótíd, · þat sie þat berhte lioht,  
 gi·sáhin sin-skôni, · ėr þan hé selbo hér  
 3638 an þesaru middil-gard · mēnskiki ant·féng,  
 flēsk ėndi lík-hamon. · Þó wurðun þes firiho barn  
 3640 gi·war an þesaru wer·oldi, · þe hér an wítje ėr,  
 sátun an sundjun · gi·siunjes lōse,  
 3642 þolodun an þiustrje, · —sie af·sóbun þat was þesaru þiod  
 kuman  
 hêljand te helpu · fan heban·ríkje,  
 3644 Krist allaro kuningo bēst; · sie mahtun is ant·kēnnjen sán,  
 gi·fóljen is fardjo. · Þó sie só filu hriopun,  
 3646 þe man te þemu mahtigon gode, · þat im mildi aftar þiu  
 waldand wurði. · Þan wēridun im swiðo  
 3648 þia swárun sundjon, · þe sie im ėr selbon gi·dádun,  
 lettun sie þes gi·lōbon. · Sie ni mahtun þem liudjun þoh  
 3650 bi·wējen iro willjon, · ak sie an waldand god  
 hlúdo hriopun, · ant-tat hé im iro hêli far·gaf,  
 3652 þat sie sin·líf · gi·sehen móstin,  
 open êwig lioht · ėndi an faren  
 3654 an þiu berhtun bú. · Þat mēndun þea blindun man,  
 þe þár bi Jerikho-burg · te þemu godes barne  
 3656 hlúdo hriopun, · þat hé im iro hêli far·lihi,  
 liohtes an þesumu líbe: · þan im þea liudi só filu  
 3658 wēridun mid wordun, · þea þár an þemu wege fórun  
 bi·foren ėndi bi·hinden: · só dót þea firin-sundjon  
 3660 an þesaru middil-gard · man-kunnje.  
 hōrjad nú hwó þie blindun, · siður im gi·bótíd warð,  
 3662 þat sie sunnun lioht · ge·sehen móstun,

3664 hwó si þó **dá**dun: · ge-witun im mid iro **drohtine** samad,  
 folgodun is **fēr**di, · spráku(n) **filu** wordo  
 þemu **landes** hirdje te **lō**be: · só **dód** im noh **liudjo** barn  
 3666 **wido** aftar þesaru **wer**-oldi, · siður im **waldand** Krist  
 ge·**liuhte** mid is **lēr**un · ɛndi im **líf** êwig,  
 3668 **godes** ríki far·**gaf** · **gó**dun mannun,  
**hōh** **himiles** lioht · ɛndi is **helpe** þár tó,  
 3670 só hwemu só þat gi·**wer**kod, · þat hé móti þemu is **wege**  
 folgon.

TODO.

45 Þó **ná**hide · **nēr**jendo Krist,  
 3672 þe **gó**do te **Jerusalem**. · Kwam imu þár te·**gegnes** **filu**  
**werodes** an **willjon** · **wel** huggendjes,  
 3674 ant·**fē**gun ina **fagā**ro · ɛndi imu bi·**foren** strēidun  
 þene **weg** mid iro gi·**wá**djun · ɛndi mid **wurtjun** só same,  
 3676 mid **berhtun** **blóm**un · ɛndi mid **bōmo** tógun,  
 þat **fēld** mid **fagā**ron palmun, · al só is **fard** ge·buride,  
 3678 þat þe **godes** sunu · **gan**gan welde  
 te þeru **mārjan** burg. · Hwarf ina **mēgin** umbi  
 3680 **liudjo** an **lustun**, · ɛndi **lof**-sang a·**hóf**  
 þat **werod** an **willjon**: · sagdun **waldande** þank,  
 3682 þes þár **selbo** kwam · **sunu** Dawides  
**wison** þes **werodes**. · Þó ge·sah **waldand** Krist  
 3684 þe **gó**do te **Jerusalem**, · **gumono** bēstta,  
**blíkan** þene **burg**es wal · ɛndi **bú** Judeono,  
 3686 **hōha** **horn**-sēli · ɛndi ōk þat **hús** godes,  
 allaro **wího** **wun**-samost. · Þó **wel** imu an innen  
 3688 **hugi** wið is **herte**: · þó ni mahte þat **hēlage** barn  
**wópu** a·**wis**jen, · sprak þó **wordo** **filu**  
 3690 **hriuwig**-liko · —was imu is **hugi** sēreg—:  
 „**wē** warð þí, **Jerusalem**“, (kwað hé,) „þes þú te **wá**run ni **wēst**  
 3692 þea **wurde**-gi·skēfti, · þe þí noh gi·**wer**ðen skulun,  
**hwó** þú noh wirðis be·**habd** · **herjes** kraftu  
 3694 ɛndi þi bi·**sittjad** · **slíð**-móde man,  
**fiund** mid **folkun**. · Þan ni habas þú **friðu** hwēgin,  
 3696 **mund**-burd mid **mannun**: · lēdjad þi hér **manage** tó  
**ordos** ɛndi **eggja**, · **or**-legas word,  
 3698 far·**fiop** þín **folk**-skēpi · **fiures** liomon,

þese wíki a·wóstjad, · wallos hôha  
 3700 felljad te foldun: · ni af·stád is felis nígijan,  
 stên obar ôðrumu, · ak werðað þesa stędi wóstja  
 3702 umbi Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo,  
 hwand sie ni ant·kennjad, · þat im kumana sind  
 3704 iro tídi tó·wardes, · ak sie habbjad im twífljen hugi,  
 ni witun þat iro wísad · waldandes kraft.“  
 3706 Gi·wêt imu þó mid þeru męnegi · manno drohtin  
 an þea berhton burg. · Só þó þat barn godes  
 3708 innan Jerusalem · mid þiu gumono folku,  
 sęg mid þiu ge·sīðu, · þó warð þár allaro sango męst,  
 3710 hlúd stemnje af·haben · hēlagun wordun,  
 lobodun þene landes ward · liudjo męnegi,  
 3712 barno þat bętste; · þiu burg warð an hróru,  
 þat folk warð an forhtun · ęndi frágodun sán,  
 3714 hwe þat wári, · þat þár mid þiu werodu kwam,  
 mid þeru mikilon męnegi. · Þó sprak im ęn man an·gęgin,  
 3716 kwað þat þár Jesu Krist · fan Galileo lande,  
 fan Nazareth-burg · nęrjand kwámi,  
 3718 witig wár-sago · þemu werode te helpu.  
 Þó was þem Judiun, · þe imu ęr grame wárun,  
 3720 un·holde an hugi, · harm an móde,  
 þat imu þea liudi só filu · lof-sang warhtun,  
 3722 diurdun iro drohtin. · Þó gęngun dol-móde,  
 þat sie wið waldand Krist · wordun sprákun,  
 3724 bádun þat hé þat ge·sīði · swígon hėti,  
 letti þea liudi, · þat sie imu lof só filu  
 3726 wordun ni warhtin: · „it is þesumu werode lēð“, kwáðun sie,  
 „þesun burg-liudjun.“ · Þó sprak eft þat barn godes:  
 3728 „ef gí sie a·męrrjad“, (kwað hé,) „þat hér ni mótin manno barn  
 waldandes kraft · wordun diurjen,  
 3730 þan skulun it hrópen þoh · harde stēnos  
 for þesumu folk-skępi, · felisos starka,  
 3732 ęr þan it eo be·líbe, · nebo man is lof spreke  
 wído aftar þesaru wer-oldi.“ · Þó hé an þene wih innen,  
 3734 gęng an þat godes hús: · fand þár Judeono filu,  
 mis-like man, · manage at·samne,  
 3736 þea im þár kôp-stędi · gi·koran habdun,  
 mangodun im þár mid manages hwí: · munitęrjas sátun

- 3738 an þemu wíhe innan, · habdun iro wesl gi·dago  
garu te gebanne. · Þat was þemu godes barne  
3740 al an andun: · drêf sie út þanen  
rúmo fan þemu rakude, · kwað þat wári rehtara dád,  
3742 þat þár te bedu fórin · barn Israheles  
„endi an þesumu mínumu húse · helpono biddjan,  
3744 þat sia sigi-drohtin · sundjono tuomje,  
þan hér þeobas · an þing-stêdi halden,  
3746 þea far·warhton weros · wehsal driþan,  
un-reht ên-fald. · Ne gí êniga êra ni witun  
3748 þeses godes huses, · Judeo liudi.“  
Só rúmde hé þó endi rekode, · ríki drohtin,  
3750 þat hêlaga hús · endi an helpun was  
managumu man-kunnje, · þem þe is mikilon kraft  
3752 ferrene ge·frugnun · endi þár gi·faran kwámun  
obár langan weg. · Warð þár léf so manag,  
3754 halt gi·hêlid · endi háf só same,  
blindun gi·bótíd. · Só dede þat barn godes  
3756 willjendi þemu werode, · hwand al an is gi·wêldi stéd  
umbi þesaro liudjo líf · endi ôk umbi þit land só same.

TODO.

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3674 streiðun | *so* ('streiðun') *M*; 'stroidun' *C*

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3674 streiðun | 3pl. past ind. of *streuwjan* 'to strew' ~ *strôjan* 'id.' *M* reflects the former and *C* the latter variant. The *ei* is not to be confused with rare *ei* < PGmc. *ai* as found in ll. 359 and 2265.

3753 obár langan weg | Also found in ON as *of langan veg* (*Vkv* 4/2b, 9/4b).

- 3758 **46** Stód imu þó fora þemu wíhe · waldandjo Krist,  
liof landes ward, · endi imu þero liudjo hugi,  
3760 iro willjon aftar·warode: · gi·sah werod mikil  
an þat márje hús · mēðmos förjen,  
3762 geþon mid goldu · endi mid godu·wēbbju,  
diurjun fratahun. · Þat al drohtin Krist  
3764 warode wís-liko. · Þó kwam þár ôk ên widowa tó,  
idis arm-skapen, · endi te þemu alāha géng  
3766 endi siu an þat tresur-hús · twêne lēgde  
êríne skattos: · was iru ên-fald hugi,  
3768 willjan gódes. · Þó sprak waldand Krist,  
þe gumo wið is jungaron, · kwað þat siu þár geþa bráhti

- 3770 mēron mikilu þan ęlkor · ęnig mannes sunu:  
 „ef hēr ōdaga man“, (kwað hę,) „ęra brąhtun,  
 3772 męđom-hord manag, · sie lętun im mēr at hús  
 welona ge·wunnen. · Ni dede þius widowa só,  
 3774 ak siu te þesumu alahe gaf · al þat siu habde  
 welono ge·wunnen, · só siu iru wiht ni far·lęt  
 3776 gódes an iro gardun. · Be·þiu sind ira geþa mēron,  
 waldande werða, · hwand siu it mid su·líkumu willjon dede  
 3778 te þesumu godes húse. · Þes skal siu geld niman,  
 swiđo lang·sam lôn, · þes siu su·líkan gi·lōbon habad.“  
 3780 Só gi·fragn ik þat þár an þemu wihe · waldandjo Krist  
 allaro dago ge·hwi·likes, · drohtin manno,  
 3782 wísde mid wordun. · Stód ine werod umbi,  
 grôt folk Judeono, · gi·hōrdun is gódan word,  
 3784 swótja seggjan. · Sum só sálig warð  
 manno undar þeru męnegi, · þat it bi·gan an is mód hladen;  
 3786 línodun im þea lêra, · þe þe landes ward  
 al be biliðjun sprak, · barn drohtines.  
 3788 Sumun wárun eft so lêða · lêra Kristes,  
 waldandes word: · was im wiðer·mód hugi  
 3790 allun þem, þe an þemu hęri·skepi · hērost wárun,  
 furiston an þemu folke: · fáres hugdun  
 3792 wrēða mid iro wordun · —habdun im wiðer·sakon  
 gi·haloden te helpu, · þes hēroston man,  
 3794 Erodeses þegan, · þe þár and·ward stód  
 wrēdes willjan, · þat hé iro word obar·hōrði—  
 3796 ef sie ina for·féngin, · þat sie ina þan feteros an,  
 þea liudi liðo·bęndi · lęggjen móstin,  
 3798 sundja lōsan. · Þó géngun im þea ge·siðos tó  
 bittra gi·hugde, · þat sie wið þat barn godes,  
 3800 wrēða wiðer·sakon · wordun sprákun:  
 „Hwat þú bist ęo·sago“, (kwáðun sie,) „allun þiodun,  
 3802 wísis wáres só filu: · nis þi werð eo·wiht  
 te bi·míðanne · manno ni·ęnumu  
 3804 umbi is ríki·dóm, · neþo þú simlun þat reht sprikis  
 ęndi an þene godes weg · gumono ge·siði  
 3806 lêdis mid þinun lērun: · ni mag þi laster man  
 fíðan undar þesumu folke. · Nú wí þi frágon skulun.  
 3808 ríki þiodan, · hwi·lík reht habad



þe kêsur fan Rúmu, · þe imu te þesumu kunnje herod  
 3810 tinsi sókid · ěndi gi·tald habad,  
 hwat wí imu gelden skulin · gęro ge·hwi·líkes  
 3812 hōbid-skatto. · Saga hwat þí þes an þínumu hugi þunkja:  
 is it reht þe nis? · Rád for þínun  
 3814 land-męgun wel: · ũs is þínaro lęrono þarf.“  
 Sie weldun þat hé it ant·kwáði: · þan mahte hé þoh  
 ant·kennjen wel  
 3816 iro wrędon willjon: · „te hwi gí wár-logon“, kwað hé,  
 „fandot mín só frókno? · Ni skal iu þat te frumu werðen,  
 3818 þat gí dreogerjas · darnungo nú  
 willjad mí far·fáhen.“ · Hét hé þó forð dragan  
 3820 te skawonne þe skattos, · „þe gí skuldige sind  
 an þat geld geben.“ · Judeon drógun  
 3822 ěnna silųbrinna forð: · sáhun manage tó,  
 hwó hé was ge·munitod: · was an middjen skín  
 3824 þes kêsures biliði · —þat mahtun sie ant·kennjen wel—,  
 iro hęrron hōbid-mál. · Þó frágode sie þe hęlago Krist,  
 3826 aftar hwemu þiu ge·lík-nessi · gi·legid wári.  
 Sie kwáðun þat it wári · wer-old-kêsures  
 3828 fan Rúmu-burg, · „þes þe alles þeses ríkes habad  
 ge·wald an þesaru wer-oldi.“ · „Þan willju ik iu te wárun hér“,  
 kwað hé,  
 3830 „selbo seggjan, · þat gí imu sín gebad,  
 wer-old-hęrron is ge·wunst, · ěndi waldand gode  
 3832 selljad, þat þár sín ist: · þat skulun iuwa seolon wesen,  
 gumono gęstos.“ · Þó warð þero Judeono hugi  
 3834 ge·minsod an þemu mahle: · ni mahtun þe męn-skaðon  
 wordun ge·winnen, · só iro willjo gęng,  
 3836 þat sie ina far·fęgin, · hwand imu þat friðu-barn godes  
 wardode wið þe wrędon · ěndi im wár an·gegin,  
 3838 sōð-spel sagde, · þoh sie ni wárin só sálige te þiu,  
 þat sie it só far·fęgin, · só it iro fruma wári.

TODO.

3840 47 Sie ni weldun it þoh far·láten, · ak hétun þár lędjen forð  
 ěn wif for þemu werode, · þiu habde wam ge·frumid,  
 3842 un-reht ěn-fald: · þiu idis was bi·fangen  
 an far·legar-nessi, · was iro líbes skolo,

- 3844 þat sie firiho barn · ferahu bi-námin,  
 êhtin iro aldres: · só was an iro êw ge-skriben.  
 3846 Sie bi-gunnun ina þó frágon, · fruokne liudi,  
 wrêða mid iro wordun, · hwat sie skoldin þemu wíbe duan,  
 3848 hweðer sie sie kwêlidin, · þe sie sie kwika létin,  
 þe hwat hé umbi su-líka dádi · a·dêljen weldi:  
 3850 „þú wêst, hwó þesaru mēnegi“, (kwáðun sie,) „Moyses gi·bôd  
 wárun wordun, · þat allaro wíbo ge·hwi-lík  
 3852 an far·legar-nessi · líbes far-warhti  
 êndi þat sie þan a·wurpin · weros mid handun,  
 3854 starkun stēnun: · nú maht þú sie sehan standen hér  
 an sundjun bi-fangan: · saga hwat þú is willjes.“  
 3856 weldun ine þea wiðer-sakon · wordun far-fáhen,  
 ef hé þat gi·kwáði, · þat sie sie kwika létin,  
 3858 friðodi ira feráhe, · þan weldi þat folk Judeono  
 kweðen, þat hé iro aldiron · êo wiðer-sagdi,  
 3860 þero liudjo land-reht; · ef hé sie þan hēti líbu bi-nimen,  
 þea magað fur þeru mēnegi, · þan weldin sie kweðen, þat hé só  
 mildjene hugi  
 3862 ni bári an is breostun, · só skoldi habbjē barn godes:  
 weldun sie só hweðeres · hēlagne Krist  
 3864 þero wordo ge·wítton, · só hé þár for þemu werode ge·spráki,  
 a·dêldi te dōme. · þan wisse drohtin Krist  
 3866 þero manno só garo · mōd-gi·þáhti,  
 iro wrêðon willjon; · þó hé te þemu werode sprach,  
 3868 te allun þem erlun: · „só hwi-lík só iuwar áno sí“, kwað hé,  
 „slíðja sundjon, · só ganga iru selbo tó  
 3870 êndi sie at êrist · erl mid is handun  
 stēn ana werpe.“ · Só stódun Judeon,  
 3872 þáhtun êndi þagodun: · ni mahte þeġan nigijan  
 wið þem word-kwidi · wiðer-saka finden:  
 3874 ge·hugde manno ge·hwi-lík · mēn-gi·þáhti,  
 is selbes sundja: · ni was iro só sikur ênig,  
 3876 þat hé bi þemu worde · þemu wíbe ge·dorsti  
 stēn an werpen, · ak létun sie standen þár  
 3878 ênan þár inne · êndi im út þanen  
 géngun gram-harde · Judeo liudi,  
 3880 ên aftar ôðrumu, · ant-tat iro þár ênig ni was  
 þes fiundo folkes, · þe iro ferhes þó,

3882 þeru idis aldar-lago · áhtjen weldi.  
 Þó gi·fragn ik þat sie frágode · friðu-barn godes,  
 3884 allaro gumono bêtst: · „Hwár kwámun þit Judeono folk“,  
 kwað hé,  
 „þíne wiðer-sakon, · þea þi hér wrógdun te mí?  
 3886 Ne sie þi hiudu wiht · harmes ne gi·dádun,  
 þea liudi lêðes, · þe þi weldun líbu be·niman,  
 3888 wêgjan te wundrun?“ · Þó sprak imu eft þat wíf an·gegin,  
 kwað þat iru þár nio·man · þurh þes ne·rjandan  
 3890 hêlaga helpa · harm ne gi·frumidi  
 wammes te lône. · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist,  
 3892 drohtin manno: · „ne ik þi geþ ni dë·rju n·eo·wiht“, kwað hé,  
 „ak gang þi hêl hinen, · lát þi an þínumu hugi sorga,  
 3894 þat þú nio sîð aftar þius · sundig ni werðes.“  
 Habde iru þó gi·holpen · hêlag barn godes,  
 3896 ge·friðot iro feráhe. · Þan stód þat folk Judeono  
 ubiles an·mód · só fan êristan,  
 3898 wrêðes willjan, · hwó sie word·hëti  
 wið þat friðu-barn godes · frummjen móstin.  
 3900 Habdun þea liudi an twê · mid iro gi·lôbon gi·fangan:  
 was þiu smale þioda · sínes willjan  
 3902 gernora mikilu, · þes godes barnes word  
 te ge·frummjenne, · só im iro fráho gi·bôd:  
 3904 rómodun te rehta · bêt þan þie ríkjon man,  
 habdun ina far iro hêrron · ia far heban·kuning,  
 3906 ful·gêngun imu gerno. · Þó gi·wêt imu þe godes sunu  
 an þene wih innan: · hwarf ina werod umbi,  
 3908 megin-þiодо gi·mang. · Hé an middjen stód,  
 lêrde þea liudi · liohtun wordun,  
 3910 hlúdero stemnun: · was hlust mikil,  
 þagode þegan manag, · ëndi hé þeru þiod gi·bôd,  
 3912 só hwe só þár mid þurstu · bi·þwungan wári,  
 „só ganga imu herod drinkan te mí“, (kwað hé), „dago  
 ge·hwi·líkes  
 3914 swótjes brunnan. · Ik mag sêggjan iu,  
 só hwe só hér gi·lôbid te mí · liudjo barno  
 3916 fasto undar þesumu folke, · þat imu þan flioten skulun  
 fan is lík-hamon · libbjendi flód,  
 3918 irnandi water, · aho-spring mikil,

kumad þanen **k**wika brunnon. · Þesa **k**widi werðað wára,  
 3920 liudjun gi·lêstid, · só hwemu só hér gi·lôbid te mí.“  
 Þan mênde mid þiu wataru · waldandjo Krist,  
 3922 hêr heban-kuning · hêlagna gêst,  
 hwó þene firiho barn · ant·fâhen skoldin,  
 3924 lioht êndi listi · êndi lif êwig,  
 hôh heban-ríki · êndi huldi godes.

TODO.

3926 **48** Wurðun þó þea liudi · umbi þea lêra Kristes,  
 umbi þiu **w**ord an ge·winne: · stóðun **w**lanka man,  
 3928 gêl-móde Judeon, · spráku **g**elp mikil,  
 habdun it im te hoska, · kwáðun þat sie mahtin gi·hôrjen wel,  
 3930 þat imu mahlidin fram · móðaga wihti,  
 un·holde út: · „nú hé an **a**bu lêrid“, kwáðun sie,  
 3932 „wordu ge·hwi·líku.“ · Þó sprak eft þat werod ôðar:  
 „ni þurbun gí þene lérjand lahan“, (kwáðun sie:) „kumad **l**ibes  
 word  
 3934 mahtig fan is **m**úde; · hé wirkid **m**anages hwat,  
 wundes an þesaru **w**er-oldi: · nis þat wrêðaro dád,  
 3936 fiundo kraftes: · nio it þan te su·líkaru frumu ni wurði,  
 ak it gegnungo · fan **g**ode alo-waldon,  
 3938 kumid fan is **k**rafte. · Þat mugun gí ant·kênnjen wel  
 an þem is wárun wordun, · þat hé gi·wald habad  
 3940 alles oðar erðu.“ · Þó weldun ina þe and-sakon þár  
 an stêdi fâhen · efþa stên ana werpen,  
 3942 ef sie im þero manno · mênigi ni an·drédin,  
 ni forhtodin þat folk·skêpi. · Þó sprak þat friðu-barn godes:  
 3944 „ik tógiu iu **g**ódes só filu“, (kwað hé,) „fan **g**ode selbumu,  
 wordo êndi werko: · nú willjad gí mí wítnon hér  
 3946 þurh iuwan starkan hugi, · stên ana werpen,  
 bi·lôsjen mí líbu.“ · Þó spráku imu eft þea liudi an·gegin,  
 3948 wrêða wiðer-sakon: · „ne wí it be þínun werkun ni duat“,  
 kwáðun sia,  
 „þat wí þí aldres · tó áhtjen willjad,  
 3950 ak wí duat it be þínun wordun, · hwand þú su·lík wáh sprikis,  
 \*hwand þú þik só mátis · êndi su·lík mên sagis,  
 3952 gihið for þeson Judeon, · þat þú síð god selbo,  
 mahtig drohtin, · êndi bist þi þoh man só wi,

3954 kuman fan þeson kunnje.“ · Krist alo-waldo  
 ne wolda þero Judeono þuo lęng · gelpes hōrjan,  
 3956 wrēðaro willjon, · ak hie im af þem wīhe fuor  
 oþar Jordanes strōm; · habda jungron mid im,  
 3958 þia is sáligun gi·sīðos, · þia im simlon mid im  
 willjon wonodun: · suohta werod öðer,  
 3960 deda þár só hie gi·wonoda, · drohtin selbo,  
 lērda þia liudi: · gi·lōbda þie wolda  
 3962 an is hêlagun word. · Þat skolda sinnon wel  
 manno só hwi·líkon, · só þat an is muod gi·nam.  
 3964 Þuo gi·frang ik þat þár te Kriste · kumana wurðun  
 bodon fan Bethaniu · ċndi sagdun þem barne godes,  
 3966 þat sia an þat ârundi þarod · idisi sęndin,  
 Maria ċndi Martha, · magað frí·líka,  
 3968 swiðo wun·sama wif; · þia wissa hie bēðja,  
 wárun im gi·swester twá, · þia hie selbo êr  
 3970 minnjoda an is muode · þuru iro mildjan hugi,  
 þiu wif þuru iro willjon guodan. · Sia im te wáron þuo  
 3972 an·budun fon Bethaniu, · þat iro bruoðer was  
 Lazarus legar·fast · ċndi þat sia is líbes ni wándun;  
 3974 bádun þat þarod kwámi · Krist alo-waldo  
 hêlag te helpu. · Reht só hie sia gi·hōrda þuo  
 3976 sęggjan fan só siekon, · só sprak hie sán an·gęgin,  
 kwað þat Lazaruses · legar ni wári  
 3978 gi·duan im te dōðe, · „ak þár skal drohtines lof“, kwaþ·hie,  
 „gi·frumid werðan: · nis it im te öðron frêson gi·duan.“  
 3980 was im þár þuo selbo · suno drohtines  
 twá naht ċndi dagas. · Þiu tíð was þuo ge·náhit,  
 3982 þat hie eft te Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo  
 wíson welda, · só hie gi·wald habda.  
 3984 Sagda þuo is gi·sīðon · suno drohtines,  
 þat hie eft oþar Jordan · Judeo liudi  
 3986 suokjan welda. · Þuo sprákun im sán an·gęgin  
 jungron sína: · „te hwi bist þú só gern þarod“, kwaðun sia,  
 3988 „frô mín, te faranne? · Ni þat nú furn ni was,  
 þat sia þik þínero wordo · wítnon hogdun,  
 3990 weldun þi mid stênon starkan a·werpan? · nú þú eft undar þia  
 strídigun þioda  
 fundos te faranne, · þár ist fiondo gi·nuog,

- 3992 erlos obar-muoda?“ · Þuo ên þero tve-libjo,  
 Þuomas gi·málða · —was im gi·þungan mann,  
 3994 diur-lík drohtines þegan—: · „ne skulun wí im þia dád lahan“,  
 kwaþ-hie,  
 „ni wernjan wí im þes willjen, · ak wita im wonjan mid,  
 3996 þuolojan mid usson þiodne: · þat ist þegnes kust,  
 þat hie mid is frāhon samad · fasto gi·stande,  
 3998 dōje mid im þár an duome. · Duan us alla só,  
 folgon im te þero fērdi: · ni lātan use ferah wið þiu  
 4000 wihtes wirðig, · neba wí an þem werode mid im,  
 dōjan mid uson drohtine. · Þan lēbot us þoh duom after,  
 4002 guod word for gumon.“ · Só wurðun þuo jungron Kristes,  
 erlos aðal-borana · an ên-falden hugje,  
 4004 hêrren te willjen. · Þuo sagða hêlag Krist  
 selbo is gi·sīðon · þat a·slāpan was  
 4006 Lazarus fan þem legare, · „habit þit lioht a·geban,  
 an·swebit ist an selmon. · Nú wí an þena sīð faran  
 4008 ĕndi ina a·wēkkjan, · þat hie muoti eft þesa wer-old sehan,  
 libbjandi lioht: · þan wirðit iuwa gi·lōbo after þiu  
 4010 forð-werd gi·fēstid.“ · Þuo gi·wêt hie im obar þia fluod þanan,  
 þie guodo godes suno, · an-þat hie mid is jungron kwam  
 4012 þár te Bithaniu, · barn drohtines  
 selbo mid is gi·sīðon, · þár þia gi·swester twá,  
 4014 Maria ĕndi Martha · an muod-karon  
 sêraga sātun. · Was þár gi·samnot filo  
 4016 fan Jerusalem · Judeo liudo,  
 þia þiu \*wif weldun · wordun fruobrian,  
 4018 þat sie só ni karodin · kind-jungas dōð,  
 Lazaruses far·lust. · Só þó þe landes ward  
 4020 géng an þiu gardos, · só wurðun þes godes barnes  
 kumi þár gi·kūðid, · þat hé só kraftig was  
 4022 bi þeru burg úten. · Þó im bêðjun was,  
 þem wībun su-lík willjo, · þat sie im waldand tó,  
 4024 þat friðu-barn godes, · farandjen wissun.

TODO.

- 49 Þó þem wībun was · willjono mēsta  
 4026 kumi drohtines · ĕndi Kristes word  
 te gi·hōrjenne. · Heobandi géng

4028 Martha mód-karag · wið só mahtigne  
 wordun wehslan · ɛndi wið waldand sprak  
 4030 an iro hugi hriuwig: · „Þár þú mí, hêrro mín“, kwað siu,  
 „nêrjendero bêtst, · náhor wáris,  
 4032 hêljand þe gódo, · þan ni þorfti ik nú su-lík harm þolon,  
 bittra breost-kara, · þan ni wári nú mín bróðer dôd,  
 4034 Lazarus fan þesumu liohte, · ak hé imu mahti libbjen forð  
 ferahes ge·fullid. · Ik þoh, frô mín, te þí  
 4036 liohto gi·lôbju, · lêrjandero bêtst,  
 só hwes só þú biddjen wili · berhton drohtin,  
 4038 þat hé it þi sán far·gibid, · god alo-mahtig,  
 gi·werðot þínan willjan.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist  
 4040 þeru idis and-wordi: · „Ni lát þú þí an innan þes“, kwað hé,  
 „þínan sebon swerkan: · ik þí seggjan mag  
 4042 wárun wordun, · þat þes nis gi·wand ênig,  
 nebu þín bróðer skal · þurh gi·bod godes,  
 4044 þurh drohtines kraft · fan dôðe a·standen  
 an is lik-hamon.“ · „All hêbbju ik gi·lôbon só“, kwað siu,  
 4046 „þat it só gi·werðen skal, · só hwan só þius wer-old ɛndjoð  
 ɛndi þe márjo dag · oðar man fêrid,  
 4048 þat hé þan fan erðu skal · up a·standen  
 an þemu dômes daga, · þan werðad fan dôðe kwika  
 4050 þurh maht godes · man-kunnjes ge·hwi-lík,  
 a·rísad fan rêstu.“ · Þó sagde ríkjo Krist  
 4052 þeru idis alo-mahtig · oponun wordun,  
 þat hé selbo was · sunu drohtines,  
 4054 bêðju ia líf ia lioht · liudjo barnon  
 te a·standanne: · „nio þe sterben ni skal,  
 4056 líf far·liosen, · þe hér gi·lôbid te mí:  
 þoh ina ɛldi-barn · erðu bi·þekken,  
 4058 diapo bi·delben, · nis hé dôd þiu mêt:  
 þat flêsk is bi·folhen, · þat ferah is gi·halden,  
 4060 is þiu siola gi·sund.“ · Þó sprak imu eft sán an·gegin  
 þat wíf mid iro wordun: · „ik gi·lôbju þat þú þe wáro bist“,  
 kwað siu,  
 4062 „Krist godes sunu: · þat mag man ant·kennjen wel,  
 witen an þínun wordun, · þat þú gi·wald haðes  
 4064 þurh þiu hêlagon gi·skapu · himiles ɛndi erðun.“  
 Þó ge·fragn ik þat þár þero idisjo kwam · ôðar gangan

- 4066 Maria mód-karag: · géngun iro managa aftar  
 Judeo liudi. · Þó siu þemu godes barne  
 4068 sagde sêrag-mód, · hwat iru te sorgun gi-stód  
 an iro hugi harmes: · hofnu kúmde  
 4070 Lazaruses far-lust, · liabes mannes,  
 griat gornundi, · ant-tat þemu godes barne  
 4072 hugi warð gi-hrórid: · hête trahni  
 wópu a·wellun, · ęndi þó te þem wíðun sprak,  
 4074 hét ina þó lédjen, · þár Lazarus was  
 foldu bi-folhen. · Lag þár ęn felis bi-öban,  
 4076 hard stên be·hliden. · Þó hét þe hêlago Krist  
 ant-lúkan þea léja, · þat hé mósti þat lík sehan,  
 4078 hrêo skawojen. · Þó ni mahte an iro hugi míðan  
 Marþa for þeru męnegi, · wið mahtigne sprak:  
 4080 „frô mín þe gódo“, (kwað siu,) „ef man þene felis nimid,  
 þene stên ant-lúkid, · þan wániu ik þat þanen stank kume,  
 4082 un·swóti swek, · hwand ik þi sęggjan mag  
 wárun wordun, · þat þes nis gi·wand ęnig,  
 4084 þat hé þár nú bi-folhen was · fiuwar naht ęndi dagos  
 an þemu erð-grabe.“ · And-wordi gaf  
 4086 waldand þemu wíbe: · „Hwat ni sagde ik þi te wárun ęr“,  
 kwað hé,  
 „ef þú gi-lôbjen wili, · þan nis nú lang te þiu,  
 4088 þat þú hér ant·kennjen skalt · kraft drohtines,  
 þe mikilon maht godes?“ · Þó géngun manage tó,  
 4090 af·hóðun harden stên. · Þó sah þe hêlago Krist  
 up mid is ôgun, · á-lát sagde  
 4092 þemu þe þese wer-old gi-skóp, · „þes þú mín word gi-hôris“,  
 kwað hé,  
 „sigi-drohtin selbo; · ik wêt þat þú só simlun duos,  
 4094 ak ik duom it be þesumu grôton · Judeono folke,  
 þat sie þat te wárun witin, · þat þú mí an þese wer-old sęndes  
 4096 þesun liudjun te lêrun.“ · Þó hé te Lazaruse hriop  
 starkaru stemnju · ęndi hét ina standen up  
 4098 ia fan þemu grabe gangan. · Þó warð þe gêst kumen  
 an þene lík-hamon: · hé bi-gan is liði hrórjen,  
 4100 ant·warp undar þemu gi·wêdje: · was imo só be·wunden þó  
 noh,  
 an hrêo-będdjon bi·helid. · Hét imu helpen þó



4102 waldandjo Krist. · Weros géngun tó,  
 ant-wundun þat ge-wádi. · Wánum up a-rês  
 4104 Lazarus te þesumu liohte: · was imu is líf far-geben,  
 þat hé is aldär-lagu · égan mósti,  
 4106 friðu forð-wardes. · Þó fagonadun bæðja,  
 Maria ęndi Martha: · ni mag þat man öðrumu  
 4108 gi-seggjan te sôðe, · hwó þea ge-swester twó  
 męndjodun an iro móde. · Maneg wundrode  
 4110 Judeo liudjo, · þó sie ina fan þemu grabe sáhun  
 siðon ge-sunden, · þene þe ér suht far-nam  
 4112 ęndi sie bi-dulbun · diapo undar erðu  
 líbes lösen: · þó móste imu libbjen forð  
 4114 hël an hêmun. · Só mag heban-kuninges,  
 þiu mikile maht godes · manno ge-hwi-likes  
 4116 feræhe gi-formon · ęndi wið fiundo nið  
 hêlag helpen, · só hwemu só hé is huldi far-gibid.

TODO.

4118 **50** Þó warð þár só managumu manne · mód aftar Kriste,  
 gi-hworben hugi-skefti, · siðor sie is hêlagon werk  
 4120 selbon gi-sáhun, · hwand eo ér su-lik ni warð  
 wundęr an wer-oldi. · Þan was eft þes werodes só filu,  
 4122 só mód-starke man: · ni weldon þe maht godes  
 ant-ķennjen kũð-líko, · ak sie wið is kraft mikil  
 4124 wunnun mid iro wordun: · wárun im waldandes  
 lêra so lêða: · sóhtun im liudi öðra  
 4126 an Jerusalem, · þár Judeono was  
 hêri hand-mahæl · ęndi hôbid-stędi,  
 4128 grôt gum-sķępi · grimmaro þioda.  
 Sie kũðun im þó Kristes werk, · kwáðun þat sie kwikan sáhin  
 4130 þene erl mid iro ôgun, · þe an erðu was,  
 foldu bi-folhen · fiuwar naht ęndi dagos,  
 4132 dôd bi-dolben, · ant-tat hé ina mid is dádjun selbo,  
 mid is wordun a-wękide, · þat hé mósti þese wer-old sehan.  
 4134 Þó was þat só wiðęr-ward · wlankun mannun,  
 Judeo liudjun: · hétun iro gum-sķępi þó,  
 4136 werod samnojan · ęndi warbos fâhen,  
 męgin-þioda gi-mang, · an mahtigna Krist  
 4138 riedun an rúnun: · „nis þat rád ênig“, kwáðun sie,

- „þat wí þat gi·þolojan: · wili þesaro þioda te filu  
 4140 gi·lôbjen aftar is lêrun. · Þan ùs liudi farad,  
 an eo·rid·folk, · werðat ùsa oþar·hôbdun  
 4142 rinkos fan Rúmu. · Þan wí þeses ríkjes skulun  
 lôse libbjen · efþa wí skulun ùses líbes þolon,  
 4144 hêliðos ùsaro hôbdo.“ · Þó sprak þár ên gi·hêrod man  
 oþar warf wero, · þe was þes werodes þó  
 4146 an þeru burg innan · biskop þero liudjo  
 —Kaiphas was hé hêten; · habdun ina gi·koranen te þiu  
 4148 an þeru gér·talú · Judeo liudi,  
 þat hé þes godes huses · gômjen skoldi,  
 4150 wardon þes wíhes—: · „Mí þunkid wundêr mikil“, kwað hé,  
 „mári þioda, · —gí kunnun manages gi·skêð—  
 4152 hwí gí þat te wárun ni witin, · werod Judeono,  
 þat hér is bętera rád · barno ge·hwi·líkumu,  
 4154 þat man hér ênne man · aldru bi·lôsje  
 ęndi þat hé þurh iuwa dádi · drôreg sterbe,  
 4156 for þesumu folk·skępi · ferah far·láte,  
 þan al þit liud·werod · far·loren werðe.“  
 4158 Ni was it þoh is willjan, · þat hé só wár ge·sprak,  
 só forð for þemu folke, · frume man·kunnjes  
 4160 gi·mênde for þeru męnegi, · ak it kwam imu fan þeru maht  
 godes  
 þurh is hêlagan hêd, · hwand hé þat hús godes  
 4162 þár an Jerusalem · bi·gangan skolde,  
 wardon þes wíhes: · be·þiu hé só wár gi·sprak,  
 4164 biskop þero liudjo, · hwó skoldi þat barn godes  
 alla irmin·þiod · mid is ênes ferhe,  
 4166 mid is líbu a·lôsjen: · þat was allaro þesaro liudjo rád,  
 hwand hé gi·halode · mid þiu hêðina liudi,  
 4168 weros an is willjon · waldandjo Krist.  
 Þó wurðun ên·wordje · oþar·módje man,  
 4170 werod Judeono, · ęndi an iro warbe gi·spráku,  
 mári þioda, · þat sie im ni létin iro mód twehon:  
 4172 só hwe só ina undar þemu folke · finden mahti,  
 þat ina sán gi·fengi · ęndi forð bráhti  
 4174 an þero þiодо þing; · kwáðun þat sie ni mahtin gi·þolojan leng,  
 þat sie þe êno man · só alla weldi,  
 4176 werod far·winnen. · Þan wisse waldand Krist

4178 þero manno só garo · mód-gi·þáhti,  
 hēti-grimmon hugi, · hwand imu ni was bi·holen eo-wiht  
 an þesaru middil-gard: · hé ni welde þó an þie mēnigi innen  
 4180 siður open-líko, · under þat erlo folk,  
 gangan under þea Judeon: · bēd þe godes sunu  
 4182 þero torohtjon tíd, · þe imu tó-ward was,  
 þat hé far þesa þioda · þolojan welde,  
 4184 far þit werod wíti: · wisse imu selbo  
 þat dag-þingi garo. · Þó gi-wēt imu ūse drohtin forð  
 4186 ęndi imu þó an Effrem · alo-waldo Krist  
 an þeru hōhon burg · hêlag drohtin  
 4188 wunode mid is werodu, · ant-tat hé an is willjan hwarf  
 eft te Bethania · brahtmu þiu mikilun,  
 4190 mid þiu is gódum gum-skępi. · Judeon bi·sprákun þat  
 wordu ge·hwi-líku, · þó sie imu su-lík werod mikil  
 4192 folgon gi·sáhun: · „nis frume ênig“, kwáðun sie,  
 „űses ríkjes gi·rádi, · þoh wí reht sprekan,  
 4194 ni þíhit ūses þinges wiht: · þius þiod wili  
 węndjen after is willjan; · imu all þius wer-old folgot,  
 4196 liudi bi þem is lêrun, · þat wí imu lêðes wiht  
 for þesumu folk-skępi · gi·frummjen ni mótun.“

TODO.

4198 **51** Gi-wēt imu þó þat barn godes · innan Bethania  
 sehs nahtun êr, · þan þiu samnunga  
 4200 þár an Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo  
 an þem wih-dagun · werðen skolde,  
 4202 þat sie skoldun haldan · þea hêlagon tídi,  
 Judeono paskha. · Béd þe godes sunu,  
 4204 mahtig under þeru mēnigi: · was þár manno kraft,  
 werodes bi þem is wordun. · Þár gęngun ina twê wíf umbi,  
 4206 Maria ęndi Martha, · mid mildju hugi,  
 þionodun imu þeo-líko. · Þiodo drohtin  
 4208 gaf im lang-sam lôn: · lét sea lêðes gi·hwes,  
 sundjono sikora, · ęndi selbo gi·bód,  
 4210 þat sea an friðe fōrin · wiðer fiundo nío,  
 þea idisa mid is orlobu gódu: · habdun iro ambaht-skępi  
 4212 bi·węndid an is willjon. · Þó gi-wēt imu waldand Krist  
 forð mid þiu folku, · firiho drohtin,

4214 innan Jerusalem, · þár Judeono was  
 hēte-lík hard-buri, · þár sie þea hēlagon tíd  
 4216 warodun at þemu wíhe; · was þár werodes só filu,  
 kraftigaro kunnjo, · þie ni weldun Kristes word  
 4218 gerno hōrjen · ni te þemu godes barne  
 an iro mōd-sebon · minnje ni habdun,  
 4220 ak wárun im só wrēða · wlanka þioda,  
 módeg man-kunni, · habdun im morð-hugi,  
 4222 in·wid an innan: · an abuh far-féngun  
 Kristes lêre, · weldun ina kraftigna  
 4224 wítnon þero wordo; · ak was þár werodes só filu,  
 umbi erl-skēpi · ant-langana dag,  
 4226 habde ine þiu smale þiod · þurh is swótjun word  
 werodu bi·worpen, · þat ine þie wiðer-sakon  
 4228 under þemu folk-skēpi · fāhen ne gi·dorstun,  
 ak miðun is bi þeru mēnegi. · Þan stōd mahtig Krist  
 4230 an þemu wíhe innan, · sagde word manag  
 firiho barnun te frumu. · Was þár folk umbi  
 4232 allan langan dag, · ant-tat þiu liohte gi·wēt  
 sunne te sedle. · Þó te sēliðun fōr  
 4234 man-kunnjes manag. · Þan was þár ên mári berg  
 bi þeru burg úten, · þe was brêd êndi hōh,  
 4236 gróni êndi skōni: · hétun ina Judeo liudi  
 Oliueti bi namon. · Þár imu up gi·wēt  
 4238 nējendjo Krist, · só ina þiu naht bi·féng,  
 was imu þár mid is jungarun, · só ine þár Judeono ênig  
 4240 ni wisse ti wárun, · hwand hé an þemu wíhe stōd,  
 liudjo drohtin, · só lioht ôstene kwam,  
 4242 ant·féng þat folk-skēpi · êndi im filu sagde  
 wároro wordo, · só nis an þesaru wer-oldi ênig,  
 4244 an þesaru middil-gard · manno só spáhi,  
 liudjo barno nig·ên, · þat þero lêrono mugi  
 4246 êndi gi·tēlljen, · þe hé þár an þemu alāhe gi·sprak,  
 waldand an þemu wíhe, · êndi simlun mid is wordun gi·bôd,  
 4248 þat sie sie gēgewidin · te godes ríkje,  
 allaro manno ge·hwi-lík, · þat sie móstin an þemu mārjon daga  
 4250 iro drohtines · diuriða ant·fāhen.  
 Sagde im hwat sie it sundjun frumidun · êndi simlun gi·bôd,  
 4252 þat sie þea a·lēskidin; · hét sie lioht godes

minnjon an iro móde, · mên far·lâten,  
 4254 aboha obar·hugdi, · ôd·módi niman,  
 hlaðen þat an iro hertan; · kwað þat im þan wári heban·ríki,  
 4256 garu gódo mêt. · Þó warð þár gumono só filu  
 gi·wëndid aftar is willjon, · siður sie þat word godes  
 4258 hêlag gi·hôrdun, · heban·kuninges,  
 ant·këndun kraft mikil, · kumi drohtines,  
 4260 hêrron helpe, · ia þat heban·ríki was,  
 nêrjendi gi·náhid · êndi náða godes  
 4262 manno barnun. · Sum só módeg was  
 Judeo folkes, · habdun grimman hugi,  
 4264 slíð·móden sebon · [...],  
 ni weldun is worde gi·lôbjen, · ak habdun im ge·win mikil  
 4266 wið þea Kristes kraft: · kumen ni móstun  
 þea liudi þurh lêðen stríd, · þat sie gi·lôbon te imu  
 4268 fasto gi·fêngin; · ni was im þiu frume gibiðig,  
 þat sie heban·ríki · habbjen móstin.  
 4270 Géng imu þó þe godes sunu · êndi is jungaron mid imu,  
 waldand fan þemu wihe, · all só is willjo géng,  
 4272 iak imu uppen þene berg gi·stêg · barn drohtines:  
 sat imu þár mid is ge·siðun · êndi im sagde filu  
 4274 wároro wordo. · Sí bi·gunnun im þó umbi þene wíh sprekan,  
 þie gumon umbi þat godes hús, · kwáðun þat ni wári  
 gód·líkora  
 4276 alah obar erðu · þurh erlo hand,  
 þurh mannes gi·werk · mid mēgin·kraftu  
 4278 rakud a·rihtid. · Þó þe ríkjo sprak,  
 hêr heban·kuning · —hôrdun þe ôðra—:  
 4280 „ik mag iu gi·têlljen“, (kwað hé,) „þat noh wirðid þiu tíð kumen,  
 þat is af·standen ni skal · stên obar ôðrumu,  
 4282 ak it fallid ti foldu · êndi fiur nimid,  
 grádag logna, · þoh it nú só gód·lík sí,  
 4284 só wís·líko gi·warht, · êndi só dód all þesaro wer·oldes  
 gi·skapu,  
 te·glídid gróni wang.“ · Þó géngun imu is jungaron tó,  
 4286 frágodun ina só stillo: · „hwó lango skal standen noh“,  
 kwáðun sie,  
 „þius wer·old an wunnjun, · êr þan þat gi·wand kume,  
 4288 þat þe lasto dag · liohtes skíne

4290 purh wolkan-skion, · efþo hwan is þin eft wán kumen  
 an þene middil-gard, · manno kunnje  
 te a·dêljenne, · dôðun êndi kwikun?  
 4292 frô mín þe gódo, · ús is þes firi-wit mikil,  
 waldandjo Krist, · hwan þat gi·werðen skuli.“

TODO.

4294 **52** Þó im and-wordi · alo-waldo Krist  
 gód-lík far·gaf · þem gumun selbo:  
 4296 „þat habad só bi·dêrnid“, (kwað hé,) „drohtin þe gódo,  
 iak só hardo far·holen · himil-rikjes fader,  
 4298 waldand þesaro wer-oldest, · só þat witen ni mag  
 ênig mannisk barn, · hwan þiu márje tíð  
 4300 gi·wirðid an þesaru wer-oldi, · ne it ôk te wáran ni kunnun  
 godes engilos, · þie for imu gegin-warde  
 4302 simlun sindun: · sie it ôk gi·seggjan ni mugun  
 te wáran mid iro wordun, · hwan þat gi·werðen skuli,  
 4304 þat hé willje an þesan middil-gard, · mahtig drohtin,  
 firiho fandon. · Fader wêt it êno  
 4306 hêlag fan himile: · êlkur is it bi·holen allun,  
 kwikun êndi dôðun, · hwan is kumi werðad.  
 4308 Ik mag iu þoh gi·têlljen, · hwi-lík hér têkan bi·foran  
 gi·werðad wunder-lík, · êr þan hé an þese wer-old kume  
 4310 an þemu márjon daga: · þat wirðid hér êr an þemu mánon  
 skín  
 iak an þeru sunnon só same; · gi·swerkad siu bêðju,  
 4312 mid finistre werðad bi·fangan; · fallad sterren,  
 hwít heban-tunga, · êndi hrisid erðe,  
 4314 bibod þius brêde wer-old · —wirðid su-líkaro bôkno filu—:  
 grimmid þe grôto séo, · wirkid þie gebenes strôm  
 4316 egison mid is ûðjun · erð-búandjun.  
 Þan þorrot þiu þiod · þurh þat ge·þwing mikil,  
 4318 folk þurh þea forhta: · þan nis friðu hwergin,  
 ak wirðid wig só maneg · obar þese wer-old alla  
 4320 hête-lík af·haben, · êndi hêri lêdid  
 kunni obar ôðar: · wirðid kuningo gi·win,  
 4322 męgin-fard mikil: · wirðid managoro kwalm,  
 open ur-lagi · —þat is egis-lík þing,  
 4324 þat io su-lík morð · skulun man af·hębbjen—,

wirðid wól só mikil · obar þese wer-old alle,  
 4326 man-sterbono mēst, · þero þe gio an þesaru middil-gard  
 swulti þurh suhti: · liggjad seoka man,  
 4328 driosat ėndi dōjat · ėndi iro dag ėndjad,  
 fulljad mid iro ferahu; · fērid un·met grōt  
 4330 hungar hēti-grim · obar hēliðo barn,  
 mēti-gēdjono mēst: · nis þat minniste  
 4332 þero wītjo an þesaru wer-oldi, · þe hēr gi·werðen skulun  
 ēr dōmes dage. · Só hwan só gí þea dádi gi·sehan  
 4334 gi·werðen an þesaru wer-oldi, · só mugun gí þan te wáran  
 far·standen,  
 þat þan þe latsto dag · liudjun náhid  
 4336 mári te mannun · ėndi maht godes,  
 himil-kraftes hrōri · ėndi þes hēlagon kumi,  
 4338 drohtines mid is diuriðun. · Hwat gí þesaro dádjo mugun  
 bi þesun bōmun · biliði ant·kennjen:  
 4340 þan sie brustjad ėndi blójat · ėndi bladu tōgjat,  
 lōf ant·lúkad, · þan witun liudjo barn,  
 4342 þat þan is sán after þiu · sumer gi·náhid  
 warm ėndi wun·sam · ėndi wedēr skōni.  
 4344 Só witin gí ôk bi þesun tēknun, · þe ik iu talde hēr,  
 hwan þe latsto dag · liudjun náhid.  
 4346 Ðan sēggjo ik iu te wáran, · þat ēr þit werod ni mót,  
 te·faran þit folk-skēpi, · ēr þan werðe ge·fullid só,  
 4348 mínu word gi·wárod. · Noh gi·wand kumid  
 himiles ėndi erðun, · ėndi stéid mín hēlag word  
 4350 fast forð·wardes · ėndi wirðid al ge·fullod só,  
 gi·lêstid an þesumu liohte, · só ik for þesun liudjun ge·spriku.  
 4352 wakot gí war·liko: · iu is wis·kumo  
 duom·dag þe mārjo · ėndi iuwes drohtines kraft,  
 4354 þiu mikilo mēgin·strengi · ėndi þiu mārje tid,  
 gi·wand þesaro wer-oldes. · Fora þiu gí wardon skulun,  
 4356 þat hé iu slápandje · an swef·rēstu  
 fārungo ni bi·fáhe · an firin·werkun,  
 4358 mēnes fulle. · Mút·spelli kumit  
 an þiustrja naht, · al só þiof fērid  
 4360 darno mid is dádjun, · só kumid þe dag mannun,  
 þe latsto þeses liohtes, · só it ēr þese liudi ni witun,  
 4362 só samo só þiu flód deda · an furn·dagun,

þe þár mid lagu-strômun · liudi far-teride  
 4364 bi Nóeas tídjun, · bi-útan þat ina nêride god  
 mid is hiwiskja, · hêlag drohtin,  
 4366 wið þes flódes farm: · só warð ôk þat fiur kuman  
 hêt fan himile, · þat þea hôhon burgi  
 4368 umbi Sodomu land · swart logna bi-féng  
 grim êndi grádag, · þat þár n-ênig gumono ni gi-nas  
 4370 bi-útan Loth êno: · ina ant-léddun þanen  
 drohtines engilos · êndi is dohter twá  
 4372 an ênan berg uppen: · þat ôðar al brinnandi fiur,  
 ia land ia liudi · logna far-teride:  
 4374 só fârungo warð þat fiur kumen, · só warð êr þe flód só samo:  
 só wirðid þe latsto dag. · For þiu skal allaro liudjo ge-hwi-lík  
 4376 þenkjan fora þemu þinge; · þes is þarf mikil  
 manno ge-hwi-líkumu: · be-þiu látad iu an iuwan mód sorga.

TODO.

4358 Mút-spelli 'the Muspell' | See note to l. 2591a above.

4369 grim êndi grádag | Formulaic; OE *grim and grædig* is used of Grendel in *Beow* 121a and his mother in l. 1499a.

4378 53 Hwand só hwan só þat ge-wirðid, · þat waldand Krist,  
 mári mannes sunu · mid þeru maht godes,  
 4380 kumit mid þiu kraftu · kuningo ríkjost  
 sittjan an is selbes maht · êndi samod mid imu  
 4382 alle þea engilos, · þe þár uppa sind  
 hêlaga an himile, · þan skulun þarod hêliðo barn,  
 4384 êli-þeoda kuman · alla te-samne  
 libbjandero liudjo, · só hwat só io an þesumu liohte warð  
 4386 friho a-fódid. · Þár hé þemu folke skal,  
 allumu man-kunnje · mári drohtin  
 4388 a-dêljen aftar iro dádjun. · Þan skêðid hé þea far-duanan man,  
 þea far-warhton weros · an þea winistron hand:  
 4390 só duot hé ôk þea sáligon · an þea swiðeron half;  
 grótíd hé þan þea góðun · êndi im te-gêgnes sprikid:  
 4392 „Kumad gí“, kwiðid hé, „þea þár gi-korene sindun, · êndi  
 ant-fâhad þit kraftiga ríki,  
 þat góde, þat þár gi-gerewid stêndid, · þat þár warð gumono  
 barnun  
 4394 gi-warht fan þesaro wer-olde êndje: · iu habad ge-wíhid selbo



4396 fader allaro firiho barno: · gí mótun þesaro frumono neotan,  
 ge·waldon þeses wídon ríkjas, · hwand gí oft mínan willjon  
 frumidun,  
 4398 ful·gégungun mí gerno · ęndi wárun mí iuwaro gebo mildje,  
 þan ik bi·þwungan was · þurstu ęndi hungro,  
 4400 frostu bi·fangan · efþo an feteron lag,  
 bi·klęmmid an karkare: · oft wurðun mí kumana þarod  
 4402 helpa fan iuwun handun: · gí wárun mí an iuwomu hugi  
 mildje,  
 wísodun mín werð·liko.“ · Þan sprikid imu eft þat werod  
 an·gegin:  
 „Frô mín þe gódo“, (kweðat sie,) „hwan wári þú bi·fangan só,  
 4404 be·þwungan an su·líkun þarabun, · só þú fora þesaru þiod tēlis,  
 mahtig mēnis? · Hwan gi·sah þi man ęnig  
 4406 be·þwungen an su·líkun þarabun? · Hwat þú habes allaro  
 þiodo gi·wald  
 iak só samo þero mēðmo, · þero þe io manno barn  
 4408 ge·wunnun an þesaro wer·oldi.“ · Þan sprikid im eft waldand  
 god:  
 „só hwat só gí dádun“, (kwiðit hé,) „an iuwes drohtines namon,  
 4410 gódes far·gábun · an godes ęra  
 þem mannun, þe hér minniston sindun, · þero nú undar  
 þesaru męnegi standad  
 4412 ęndi þurh ôd·módi · arme wárun  
 weros, hwand sie mínan willjon fręmidun · —só hwat só gí  
 im iuwaro welono far·gábun,  
 4414 gi·dádun þurh diuriða, · þat ant·féng iuwa drohtin selbo,  
 þiu helpe kwam te heban·kuninge. · Be·þiu wili iu þe hêlago  
 drohtin  
 4416 lônnon iuwan gi·lôbon: · gibid iu lif êwig.“  
 Węndid ina þan waldand · an þea winistron hand,  
 4418 drohtin te þem far·duanun mannun, · sagad im þat sie skulin  
 þea dád ant·gelden,  
 þea man iro mēn·gi·werk: · „nú gí fan mí skulun“, kwiðit hé,  
 4420 „faran só for·flókane · an þat fiur êwig,  
 þat þár gi·garęwid warð · godes and·sakun,  
 4422 fiundo folke · be firin·werkun,  
 hwand gí mí ni hulpun, · þan mí hunger ęndi þurst  
 4424 wêgde te wundrun · efþa ik ge·wádjes lôs

- géng jámer-mód, · was mí grôtun þarf,  
 4426 þan ni habde ik þár ênige helpe, · þan ik ge·heftid was,  
 an liðo-kospun bi·lokan, · efþa mí legar bi·féng,  
 4428 swára suhti: · þan ni weldun gí mín siokes þár  
 wíson mid wihti: · ni was iu werð eo·wiht,  
 4430 þat gí mín ge·hugdin. · Be·þiu gí an heþlje skulun  
 þolon an þiustre.“ · Þan sprikid imu eft þiu þiod an·gegin:  
 4432 „Wola waldand god“, (kweðad sie,) „hwí wilt þú só wið þit werod  
 sprekan,  
 mahljen wið þese mēnegi? · Hwan was þí io manno þarf,  
 4434 gumono gódes? · Hwat sie it al be þínun gebun êgun,  
 welon an þesaro wer-oldi“. · Þan sprikid eft waldand god:  
 4436 „þan gí þea armostun“, (kwiðid hé,) „ēldi-barno,  
 manno þea minniston · an iuwomu mód-sebon  
 4438 heþiðos far·hugdun, · létun sea iu an iuwomu hugi lêðe,  
 be·dēldun sie iuwaro diurða, · þan dādun gí iuwana drohtin só  
 sama,  
 4440 gi·wērnidun imu iuwaro welono: · be·þiu ni wili iu waldand  
 god,  
 ant·fāhen fader iuwa, · ak gí an þat fiur skulun,  
 4442 an þene diopun dōð, · diuþlun þionon,  
 wrēðun wiðer-sakun, · hwand gí só warhtun bi·foran.“  
 4444 Þan aftar þem wordun skēðit · þat werod an twē,  
 þea góðun ēndi þea ubilon: · farad þea far·griponon man  
 4446 an þea hētan heþ · hriuwig-móde,  
 þea far·warhton weros, · wíti ant·fāhat,  
 4448 ubil ēndi-lôs. · Lēdid up þanen  
 hēr heþan-kuning · þea hluttaron þeoda  
 4450 an þat lang-same lioht: · þár is lif ēwig,  
 gi·garēwid godes ríki · góðaro þiado.“

TODO.

### Passion.

- 4452 54 Só ge·fragn ik þat þem rinkun þó · ríki drohtin  
 umbi þesaro wer-oldes gi·wand · wordun talde,  
 4454 hwó þiu forð fērid, · þan lango þe sie firriho barn  
 ardon mótun, · ia hwó siu an þemu ēndje skal

4456 te·gliden êndi te·gangen. · Hé sagde ôk is jungarun þár  
 wárun wordun: · „Hwat gí witun alle“, kwað hé,  
 4458 „þat nú obar twá naht · sind tídi kumana,  
 Judeono paskha, · þat sie skulun iro gode þionon,  
 4460 weros an þemu wihe. · Þes nis ge·wand ênig,  
 þat þár wirðid mannes sunu · te þeru męgin-þiodu  
 4462 kraftag far·kôpot · êndi an krúke a·slagan,  
 þolod þiad-kwála.“ · Þó warð þár þegan manag  
 4464 slíð-mód gi·samnod, · sũðar-liudjo,  
 Judeono gum-skępi, · þár sie skoldun iro gode þionon.  
 4466 wurðun êo-sagon · alle kumane,  
 an warf weros, · þe sie þó wísostun  
 4468 undar þeru męnegi · manno taldun,  
 kraftag kuni-burd. · Þár Kaiphas was,  
 4470 biskop þero liudjo. · Sie rédun þó an þat barn godes,  
 hwó sie ina a·sluogin · sundja lósan,  
 4472 kwáðun þat sie ina an þemu hêlagon daga · hrínen ni skoldin  
 undar þero manno męnegi, · „þat ni werðe þius męgin-þioda,  
 4474 hęliðos an hróru, · hwand ina þit hęri-skępi wili  
 far·standen mid strídu. · Wí só stillo skulun  
 4476 frêson is ferahes, · þat þit folk Judeono  
 an þesun wih-dagun · wróht ni af·hębbjen.“  
 4478 Þó gęng imu þár Júdas forð, · jungaro Kristes,  
 ên þero twe-libjo, · þár þat aðali sat,  
 4480 Judeono gum-skępi; · kwað þat hé is im góðan rád  
 sęggjan mahti: · „hwat willjad gí mí sęlljen hér“, kwað hé,  
 4482 „mêðmo te médu, · ef ik iu þene man giþu  
 áno wíg êndi áno wróht?“ · Þó warð þes werodes hugi,  
 4484 þero liudjo an lustun: · „ef þú wili gi·lêstjen só“, kwáðun sie,  
 „þín word gi·wáron, · þan þú gi·wald habes,  
 4486 hwat þú at þesaru þiodu · þiggjan willjes  
 góðaro mêðmo.“ · Þó gi·hét imu þat gum-skępi þár  
 4488 an is selbes dóm · silųbar-skatto  
 þrí-tig at·samne, · êndi hé te þeru þiodu gi·sprak  
 4490 dęreþjun wordun, · þat hé gábi is drohtin wið þiu.  
 węnde ina þó fan þemu werode: · was im wrêð hugi,  
 4492 talode im só treu-lôs, · hwan êr wurði imu þiu tíd kuman,  
 þat hé ina mahti far·wísjen · wrêðaro þiodo,  
 4494 fiundo folke. · Þan wisse þat friðu-barn godes,

wár waldand Krist, · þat hé þese wer-old skolde,  
 4496 a·geben þese gardos · ɛndi sókjen imu godes ríki,  
 gi·faren is fader-óðil. · Þó ni gi·sah ɛnig firiho barno  
 4498 mēron minnje, · þan hé þó te þem mannum gi·nam,  
 te þem is gódun jungaron: · gôme warhte,  
 4500 sɛtte sie swás·liko · ɛndi im sagde filu  
 wároro wordo. · Skrêd wester dag,  
 4502 sunne te sedle. · Þó hé selbo gi·bôð,  
 waldand mid is wordun, · hét im water dragan  
 4504 hluttar te handun, · ɛndi rês þó þe hêlago Krist,  
 þe gódo at þem gômun · ɛndi þár is jungarono þwóg  
 4506 fôti mid is folmun · ɛndi swarf sie mid is fanon aftar,  
 druknide sie diur·líka. · Þó wið is drohtin sprak  
 4508 Símon Petrus: · „Ni þunkid mí þit sómi þing“, kwað hé,  
 „frô mín þe gódo, · þat þú míne fôti þwahes  
 4510 mid þem þínun hêlagun handun.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro  
 an·gëgin,  
 waldand mid is wordun: · „Ef þú is willjan ni habes“, kwað hé,  
 4512 „te ant·fáhanne, · þat ik þíne fôti þwahe  
 þurh su·líka minnja, · só ik þesun ôðrun mannum hér  
 4514 dóm þurh diurða, · þan ni habes þú ɛnigan dêl mid mí  
 an heban·ríkja.“ · Hugi warð þó gi·wëndid  
 4516 Símon Petruse: · „Þú hába þi selbo gi·wald“, kwað hé,  
 „frô mín þe gódo, · fôti ɛndi hando  
 ɛndi mínes hôðdes só sama, · handun þínun,  
 4518 þiadan, te þwahanne, · te þiu þat ik móti þína forð  
 huldi hëbbjan · ɛndi heban·ríkjes  
 4520 su·lík gi·dêli, · só þú mí, drohtin, wili  
 far·geben þurh þína gódi.“ · Jungaron Kristes,  
 4522 þene ambaht·skëpi · erlos þolodun,  
 þegnos mid gi·þuldjon, · só hwat só im iro þiadan dede,  
 4524 mahtig þurh þea minnja, · ɛndi mēnde imu al mēra þing  
 firihon te gi·frummjenne.

TODO.

4517<sup>1</sup> *bandun þínun* | *emend. accepted by most eds.; om. MC*

4517<sup>1</sup> frô ... *þínun* | Treated as one line by Sievers (1878) (who does not emend the b-verse *bandun þínun*), whence the skipped numbering.

4526 géng imu þó eft gi·sittjen · under þat ge·sīðo folk  
 4528 ɛndi im sagda filu lang·samna rád. · Warð eft lioht kuman,  
 morgen te mannun. · Mahtigne Krist  
 4530 gróttun is jungaron ɛndi frágodun, · hwár sie is gôma þó  
 an þemu wi·h·dage · wirkjen skoldin,  
 4532 hwar hé weldi halden · þea hêlagon tídi  
 selbo mid is ge·sīðun. · Þó hé sie sókjen hét,  
 4534 þea gumon Jerusalem: · „só gí þan gangan kumad“, kwað hé,  
 „an þea burg innan · —þár is braht mikil,  
 4536 megin·þido gi·mang—, · þár mugun gí ênan man sehan  
 an is handun dragen · hluttres watares  
 ful mid folmun. · Þemu gí folgon skulun  
 4538 an só hwi·like gardos, · só gí ina gangan gi·sehat,  
 ia gí þan þemu hêrron, · þe þie hobos êgi,  
 4540 selbon seggjad, · þat ik iu sɛnde þarod  
 te gi·garuwenne mína gôma. · Þan tōgid hé iu ên gód·lík hús,  
 4542 hōhan sóleri, · þe is bi·hangen al  
 fagarun fratahun. · Þár gí frummjen skulun  
 4544 werd·skepi mínan. · Þár bium ik wis·kumo  
 selbo mid mínun ge·sīðun.“ · Þó wurðun sán aftar þiu  
 4546 þár te Jerusalem · jungaron Kristes  
 forð·ward an fɛrði, · fundun all só hé sprak  
 4548 word·têkən wár: · ni was þes gi·wand ênig.  
 Þár geɾɛwidun sie þea gôma. · Warð þe godes sunu,  
 4550 hêlag drohtin · an þat hús kuman,  
 þár sie þe land·wíse · lêstjen skoldun,  
 4552 ful·gangan godes gi·bode, · al só Judeono was  
 êo ɛndi ald·sidu · an êr·dagun.  
 4554 Gi·wêt imu þó an þemu ábande · alo·waldand Krist  
 an þene sɛli sittjen; · hét þár is ge·sīðos te imu  
 4556 twe·líbi gangan, · þea im gi·triuwiston  
 an iro mód·seþon · manno wárun  
 4558 bi wordun ɛndi bi wísun: · wisse imu selbo  
 iro hugi·skefti · hêlag drohtin.  
 4560 Grótte sie þó oþar þem gômum: · „Gern bium ik swiðo“, kwað  
 hé,  
 „þat ik samad mid iu · sittjen móti,  
 4562 gômono neoten, · Judeono paskha  
 dêljjen mid iu só diurjun. · Nú ik iu iuwes drohtines skal

- 4564 willjon seggjan, · þat ik an þesaro wer-oldi ni mót  
mid mannun mēr · móses an-bíten
- 4566 furður mid firihun, · êr þan gi·fullod wirðid  
himilo ríki. · Mí is an handun nú
- 4568 wíti êndi wunder-kwále, · þea ik for þesumu werode skal,  
þolon for þesaru þiodu.“ · Só hé þó só te þem þegnun sprak,
- 4570 hêlag drohtin, · só warð imu is hugi dróbi,  
warð imu gi·sworcen sebo, · êndi eft te þem ge·sīðun sprak,
- 4572 þe gódo te þem is jungarun: · „Hwat ik iu godes ríki“, kwað  
hé,  
„gi·hét himiles lioht, · êndi gí mí hold-líko  
4574 iuwan þegan-skēpi. · Nú ni willjat gí a·þengjan só,  
ak wēnkjat þero wordo. · Nú seggju ik iu te wáran hér,  
4576 þat wili iuwar twe-libjo ên · treuwana swíkan,  
wili mí far·kôpon · undar þit kunni Judeono,  
4578 gi·selljen wiðer silubre, · êndi wili imu þár sink niman,  
diurje mêðmos, · êndi geþen is drohtin wið þiu,  
4580 holdan hêrran. · Þat imu þoh te harme skal,  
werðan te wítje; · be þat hé þea wurdi far-sihit  
4582 êndi hé þes arbêdjes · êndi skawot,  
þan wêt hé þat te wáran, · þat imu wári wóðjera þing,  
4584 bētera mikilu, · þat hé gio gi·boran ni wurði  
libbjendi te þesumu liohte, · þan hé þat lôn nimid,  
4586 ubil arbêdi · in-wid-rádo.“  
Þó bi-gan þero erlo ge-hwi-lík · te ôðrumu skawon,  
4588 sorgondi sehan; · was im sêr hugi,  
hriuwig umbi iro herta: · gi·hôrdun iro hêrron þó  
4590 gorn-word sprekan. · Þea gumon sorgodun,  
hwi-líkan hé þero twe-libjo · te þiu tēlljen weldi,  
4592 skuldigna skaðon, · þat hé habdi þea skattos þár  
ge·þingod at þeru þiod. · Ni was þero þegno ênigumu  
4594 su-líkes in-widdjes · ôði te gehanne,  
mên-gi·þahtjo · —ant-suok þero manno ge-hwi-lík—,  
4596 wurðun alle an forhtun, · frágon ne gi·dorstun,  
êr þan þó ge·bôknide · bar-wirðig gumo,  
4598 Símon Petrus · —ne gi·dorste it selbo sprekan—  
te Johanne þemu gódon: · hé was þemu godes barne  
4600 an þem dagun · þegno liobost,  
mêst an minnjun · êndi móste þár þó an þes mahtiges Kristes

4602 barme rēstjen · ɛndi an is breostun lag,  
 hlinode mid is hōbdu: · þár nam hé só manag hêlag ge·rúni,  
 4604 diapa gi·þáhti, · ɛndi þó te is drohtine sprak,  
 be·gan ina þó frágon: · „hwe skal þat, frô mín, wesen“, kwað  
 hé,  
 4606 „þat þi far·kōpon wili, · kuningo ríkjost,  
 undar þínaro fiundo folk? · Ūs wári þes firi-wit mikil,  
 4608 waldand, te witanne.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu  
 hêljando Krist: · „seh þi, hwemu ik hér an hand geþe  
 4610 mínes mōses for þesun mannun: · þe habed mên-gi·þáht,  
 birid bittran hugi; · þe skal mí an banono ge·wald,  
 4612 fiundun bi·felhen, · þár man mínes ferhes skal,  
 aldres áhtjen.“ · Nam hé þó aftar þiu  
 4614 þes mōses for þem mannun · ɛndi gaf is þemu mên-skaðen,  
 Judase an hand · ɛndi imu te·gēgnes sprak  
 4616 selbo for þem is ge·sīðun · ɛndi ina sniumo hét  
 faran fan þemu is folke: · „frumi só þú þenkis“, kwað hé,  
 4618 „dó þat þú duan skalt: · þú ni maht bi·dērnjen lēng  
 willjon þínan. · Þiu wurd is at handun,  
 4620 þea tīdi sind nú gi·náhid.“ · Só þó þe treu-logo  
 þat mós ant·féng · ɛndi mid is mūðu an·bêt,  
 4622 só af·gaf ina þó þiu godes kraft, · gramon in ge·witun  
 an þene lik-hamon, · lēða wihti,  
 4624 warð imu Satanas · sêro bi·tēngi,  
 hardo umbi is herte, · sīður ine þiu helpe godes  
 4626 far·lét an þesumu liohte. · Só is þena liudjo wê,  
 þe só undar þesumu himile skal · hêrron wehslon.

TODO.

4628 **56** Gi·wêt imu þó út þanen · in·widjas gern  
 Judas gangan: · habde imu grimmen hugi  
 4630 þegan wið is þiodan. · Was þó iu þiustri naht,  
 swiðo gi·sworcen. · Sunu drohtines  
 4632 was ima at þem gōmun forð · ɛndi is jungarun þár  
 waldand wín ɛndi brôð · wihide bēðju,  
 4634 hêlagode heban-kuning, · mid is handun brak,  
 gaf it undar þem is jungarun · ɛndi gode þankode,  
 4636 sagde þem á·lát, · þe þár al gi·skóp,  
 wer-old ɛndi wunnja, · ɛndi sprak word manag:

- 4638 „gi·lôbjot gí þes **liohto**“, (kwað hé,) „þat þit is mín **lík**-hamo  
 4640 ęndi mín **blód** só same: · gíbu ik iu hér **bêðju** samad  
**etan** ęndi **drinkan**. · Þit ik an **erðu** skal  
 4642 **geban** ęndi **geotan** · ęndi iu te **godes** ríkje  
**lôsjen** mid mínu **lík**-hamen · an **líf** êwig,  
 4644 an þat **himiles** **lioht**. · Gi·**huggjat** gí simlun,  
 þat **gí** þiu **ful·gangan**, · þiu ik an þesun **gômun** dón;  
**márjad** þit for **męnegi**: · þit is **mahtig** þing,  
 4646 mid þius skulun gí iuwomu **drohtine** · **diuriða** frummjen,  
**habbjad** þit mín te gi·**hugdjun**, · **hêlag** biliði,  
 4648 þat it **ęldi**-barn · **afstar** lęstjen,  
**waron** an þesaru **wer**-oldi, · þat þat **witin** alle,  
 4650 **man** obar þesan **middil**-gard, · þat it is þurh mína **minnja**  
 gi·duan  
**hêrron** te **huldi**. · Ge·**huggjad** gí simlun,  
 4652 **hweo** ik iu hér ge·**biudu**, · þat gí iuwan **brôðer**-skępi  
**fasto** frummjad: · **habbjad** **ferhtan** hugi,  
 4654 **minnjod** iu an iuwomu **móde**, · þat þat **manno** barn  
**obar** **irmin**-þiod · **alle** far·standen,  
 4656 þat **gí** sind **gegnungo** · **jungaron** míne.  
**Ôk** skal ik iu **küðjen**, · **hwó** hér wili **kraftag** fiund,  
 4658 **hęttjand** **heru**-grim, · **umbi** iuwan **hugi** niusjen,  
**Satanas** **selbo**: · hé kumid iuwaro **seolono** herod  
 4660 **frókno** **frêson**. · Simlun gí **fasto** te gode  
**berad** iuwa **breost**-gi·þáht: · ik skal an iuwaru **bedu** standen,  
 4662 þat iu ni **mugi** þe **mên**-skaðo · **mód** ge·twífljan;  
 ik **ful**-lêstju iu wiðęę þemu **fiunde**. · Ôk kwam hé herod giu  
**frêson** mín,  
 4664 þoh imu is **willjon** hér · **wiht** ne gi·stódi,  
**liobes** an þemu mínumu **lík**-hamon. · Nú ni willju ik iu **lęng**  
 helen,  
 4666 **hwat** iu hér nú **sniu**mo skal · te **sorgu** gi·standen:  
 gí skulun mí ge·**swíkan**, · ge·**síðos** míne,  
 4668 iuwes **þegan**-skępjjes, · êr þan þius **þiustrje** naht  
**liudi** far·líða · ęndi eft **lioht** kume,  
 4670 **morgan** te **mannun**.“ · Þó warð **mód** gumon  
**swíðo** gi·**sworken** · ęndi **sêr** hugi,  
 4672 **hriuwig** umbi iro **herte** · ęndi iro **hêrron** word  
**swíðo** an **sorgun**. · **Símon** Petrus þó,



- 4674 þegan wið is þiodan · þrist-wordun sprak  
 bí huldi \*wið is hêrron: · „þoh þí all þit hêliðo folk“, kwaþ-hie,  
 4676 „gi·swikan þina gi·siðos, · þoh ik sinnon mid þí  
 at allon þarabon · þolojan willju.  
 4678 Ik biun garo sinnon, · ef mí god látið,  
 þat ik an þínon ful-léstje · fasto gi·stande;  
 4680 þoh sia þí an karkarjes · klústron hardo,  
 þesa liudi bi·lúkan, · þoh ist mí luttill tweho,  
 4682 ne ik an þem þendjon mid þí · bídan willje,  
 liggjan mid þí só lieben; · ef sia þínes líbes þan  
 4684 þuru eggja nið · áhtjan willjad,  
 frô mín þie guodo, · ik gibu mín ferah furi þik  
 4686 an wáþno spil: · nis mí werð iowiht  
 te bi·míðanne, · só lango só mí mín warod  
 4688 hugi endi hand-kraft.“ · Þuo sprak im eft is hêrro an·gegin:  
 „Hwat þú þik bi·wánis“, (kwaþ-hie,) „wissaro treuwono,  
 4690 þrístero þingo: · þú habis þegnes hugi,  
 willjon guodan. · Ik mag þí seggjan, hwó it þoh gi·werðan  
 skal,  
 4692 þat þú wirðis só wêk-muod, · þoh þú nú ni wánjes só,  
 þat þú þínes þiadnes te naht · þríwo far·lôgnis  
 4694 êr hano·krádi endi kwiðis, · þak ik þín hêrro ni sí,  
 ak þú far·manst mína mund-burd.“ · Þuo sprak eft þie man  
 an·gegin:  
 4696 „ef it gio an wer-oldi“, (kwaþ-hie,) „gi·werðan muosti,  
 þat ik samad mid þí · sweltan muosti,  
 4698 dôjan diur·líko, · þan ne wurði gio þie dag kuman,  
 þat ik þín far·lôgnidi, · liebo drohtin,  
 4700 gerno for þeson Juðeon.“ · Þuo kwáðun alla þia jungron só,  
 þat sia þár an þem þingon mid im · þoljan weldin.

TODO. Then Simon Peter,  
 the thane, to his theeden spoke brave words  
 out of loyalty to his lord: “Although this whole host of heroes,” quoth he,  
 “and thy followers should forsake thee, yet I nevertheless  
 with thee will suffer through all hardships.  
 I am nevertheless ready, if God lets me,  
 that I should stand steadfast as thy support.  
 Although this people should lock thee  
 behind the hard bars of prison, still I have little doubt  
 that I in those bonds will abide with thee,  
 and lie by thee so dear. If they then through the hatred

of blades wish to take thy life,  
 O my good Lord, I will give my breath for thee  
 in the play of weapons. There is nothing worth for me  
 to avoid for as long as I possess  
 my heart and strength of hand." Then his Lord spoke back to him:  
 "How thou thinkest thyself capable", quoth he, "of certain loyalty,  
 of bold conflicts! Thou hast athane's heart,  
 a good will. Yet I can tell thee how it shall turn out  
 that thou in one night wilt thrice deny thy theeden  
 ere the cock-crow, and say that I am not thy lord;  
 instead thou wilt renounce my protection." Then the man spoke back to  
 him:  
 "If it ever in this world must turn out so  
 that I alongside thee must perish  
 die dearly, evenso the day will never come  
 that I should deny thee, beloved lord,  
 eagerly before these Jews." Then all the disciples said so,  
 that there in the conflicts with him they would suffer.

- 4702 57 Þuo im eft mid is wordon gi·bôð · waldand selbo,  
 hêr heþan-kuning, · þat sia im ni lietin iro hugi twífljan,  
 4704 hiet þat sia ni weldin [...] · diopa gi·þahti:  
 „Ne druoþje iuwa herta · þuru iuwes drohtines word,  
 4706 ne forohtjat te filo: · ik skal fader úsan  
 selþan suokjan · ęndi iu sęndjan skal  
 4708 fan heþan-ríkje · hêlagna gêst:  
 þie skal iu eft gi·fruoþrjan · ęndi te frumu werðan,  
 4710 manon iu þero mahlo, · þie ik iu manag heþbju  
 wordon gi·wísid. · Hie gibit iu gi·wit an briost,  
 4712 lust-sama lêra, · þat gí lęstjan forð  
 þiu word ęndi þiu werk, · þia ik iu an þesaro wer-oldi gi·bôð.“  
 4714 A·rêš im þuo þe ríkjo · an þemo rakode innan,  
 nęrjendo Krist · ęndi gi·wêť im nahtes þanan  
 4716 selbo mid is gi·sĩðon: · sêrago géngun  
 swĩðo gornondja · jungron Kristes,  
 4718 hriuwig-muoda. · Þuo hie im an þena hôhan gi·wêť  
 Oliueti-berg: · þár was hie up gi·wuno  
 4720 gangan mid is jungron. · Þat wissa Judas wel,  
 balo-hugdig man, · hwand hie was oft an þem berege mid im.  
 4722 Þár gruotta þie godes suno · jügron sína:  
 „Gí sind nú só druoþja“, (kwaþ-hie,) „nú gí mínan dôð witun;

nú gornonð gí ęndi griotand, · ęndi þesa Juðeon sind an  
luston,  
męndit þius męnigi, · sindun an iro muode fráha,  
þius wer-old ist an wunnjon. · Þes wirðit þoh gi-wand kuman  
sniumo tulgo: · þan wirðit im sêr hugi,  
þan mornjat sia an iro móde, · ęndi gí męndjan skulun  
after te êwon-dage, · hwand gio ęndi ni kumið,  
iuwes wel-líbes gi-wand: · be-þiu ne þurbun iu þius werk  
tregan,  
hreuwān mín hin-fard, · hwand þanan skal þiu helpa kuman  
gumono barnon.“ · Þuo hiet hie is jungron þár  
bídan uppan þemo berge, · kwað þat hie ti bedu weldi  
an þiu holm-klibu · hôhor stígan;  
hiet þuo þria mid im · þegnos gangan,  
Jakobe ęndi Johannese · ęndi þena guodan Petruse,  
þrist-muodjan þegan. · Þuo sia mid iro þiedne samad  
gerno géngun. · Þuo hiet sia þie godes suno  
an berge uppan · te bedu hnígan,  
hiet sia god gruohtjan, · \*gerno biddjan,  
þat hé im þero kostondero · kraft far-stódi,  
wrêðaro willjon, · þat im þe wiðer-sako,  
ni mahti þe mên-skaðo · mód gi-twífljan,  
iak imu þó selbo gi-hnêg · sunu drohtines  
kraftag an knio-beda, · kuningo ríkjost,  
forð-ward te foldu: · fader alo-þiādo  
gódan grótte, · gorn-wordun sprak  
hriuwig-líko: · was imu is hugi dróbi,  
bi þeru męnniski · mód gi-hrórid,  
is flêsk was an forhtun: · fellun imo trahni,  
drôp is diur-lík swêt, · al só drôr kumid  
wallan fan wundun. · Was an ge-winne þó  
an þemu godes barne · þe gêst ęndi þe lík-hamo:  
ôðar was fûsíd · an forð-wegos,  
þe gêst an godes ríki, · ôðar jámar stód,  
lík-hamo Kristes: · ni welde þit lioht a-geþen,  
ak dróbde for þemu dóðe. · Simla hé hreop te drohtine forð  
þiu mêr aftar þiu · mahtigna grótte,  
hôhan himil-fader, · hêlagna god,  
waldand mid is wordun: · „ef nú werðen ni mag“, kwað hé,

„man-kunni ge·neřid, · ne sí þat ik mīnan gebe  
 4762 lioban lík-hamon · for liudjo barn  
 te wêgianne te wundrun, · it sí þan þín willjo só,  
 4764 ik willju is þan gi·koston: · ik nimu þene kēlik an hand,  
 drinku ina þi te diurðu, · drohtin frô mín,  
 4766 mahtig mund-boro. · Ni seh þú mīnes hér  
 flēskes gi·fōrjes. · Ik fullon skal  
 4768 willjon þinen: · þú habes ge·wald oþar al.“  
 Gi·wêt imu þó gāgen, · þār hé êr is jungaron lét  
 4770 bīdan uppan þemu berge; · fand sie þat barn godes  
 slāpen sorgandje: · was im sêr hugi,  
 4772 þes sie fan iro drohtine · dēljen skoldun.  
 Sô sind þat mōd-þraka · manno ge·hwi-likumu,  
 4774 þat hé far-lāten skal · liabane hêrron,  
 af·geben þene sô gōdene. · Þó hé te is jungarun sprak,  
 4776 wahte sie waldand · ĕndi wordun grōtte:  
 „Hwī willjad gi sô slāpen?“ (kwað hé,) „ni mugun samad mid mī  
 4778 wakon êne tīd? · Þiu wurd is at handun,  
 þat it sô gi·gāgen skal, · sô it god fader  
 4780 gi·markode mahtig. · Mī nis an mīnumu mōde tweho:  
 mīn gēst is garu · an godes willjan,  
 4782 fūs te faranne: · mīn flēsk is an sorgun,  
 lētid mik mīn lík-hamo: · lēð is imu swīðo  
 4784 wīti te þolonne. · Ik þoh willjan skal  
 mīnes fader ge·frummjen; · hēbbjad gi fasten hugi.“  
 4786 Gi·wêt imu þó eft þanan · ôðer-sīðu  
 an þene berg uppen · te bedu gangan,  
 4788 māri drohtin, · ĕndi þār sô manag gi·sprak  
 góðoro wordo. · Godes ĕngil kwam  
 4790 hēlag fan himile, · is hugi fastnode,  
 bēldide te þem bēndjun. · Hé was an þeru bedu simla  
 4792 forð an flīte · ĕndi is fader grōtte,  
 waldand mid is wordun: · „ef it nú wesen ni mag“, kwað hé,  
 4794 „māri drohtin, · neþu ik for þit manno folk  
 þiod-kwāle þoloje, · ik an þīnan skal  
 4796 willjan wonjan.“ · Gi·wêt imu þó eft þanen  
 sókjan is ge·sīðos: · fand sie slāpandje,  
 4798 grōtte sie gāhun. · Gēng imu eft þanen  
 þriddjon sīðu te bedu · ĕndi sprak þiod-kuning

4800 al þiu selbon word, · sunu drohtines,  
 te þemu alo-waldon fader, · só hé êr dede,  
 4802 manode mahtigna · manno frumana  
 swiðo niud-liko · nêrjando Krist,  
 4804 géng imu þó eft te þem is jungarun, · grótte sie sáno:  
 „slápad gí êndi rêstjad“, (kwað hé,) „nú wirðid sniumo herod  
 4806 kuman mid kraftu, · þe mí far·kôpot habad,  
 sundja lôsan gi·sald.“ · Ge·sīðos Kristes  
 4808 wakodun þó aftar þem wordun · êndi gi·sáhun þó þat werod  
 kuman  
 an þene berg uppen · brahtmu þiu mikilon,  
 4810<sup>a</sup> wrêða wápan-berand.

TODO.

4810<sup>b</sup> **58** Wisde im Judas,  
 gram-hugdig man; · Judeon aftar sigun,  
 4812 fiundo folk-skêpi; · dróg man fiur an gi·mang,  
 logna an lioht-fatun, · lédde man faklon  
 4814 brinnandja fan burg, · þár sie an þene berg uppan  
 stigun mid stridu. · Þea stêdi wisse Judas wel,  
 4816 hwár hé þea liudi · tó lédjan skolde.  
 Sagde imu þó te tēkne, · þó sie þár tó fórun  
 4818 þemu folke bi·foran, · te þiu þat sie ni far·fēngin þár,  
 erlos ôðren man: · „ik gangu imu at êrist tó“, kwað hé,  
 4820 „kussju ine êndi kwaddju: · þat is Krist selbo.  
 Þene gí fāhen skulun · folko kraftu,  
 4822 binden ina uppan þemu berge · êndi ina te burg hinan  
 lédjen undar þea liudi: · hé is líbes habad  
 4824 mid is wordun far·werkod.“ · Werod sīðode þó,  
 ant-tat sie te Kriste · kumane wurðun,  
 4826 grim folk Judeono, · þár hé mid is jungarun stód,  
 mári drohtin: · bēd metodo-gi·skapu,  
 4828 torhtero tíðjo. · Þó géng imu treu-lôs man,  
 Judas te·gēgnes · êndi te þemu godes barne  
 4830 hnêg mid is hōbdu · êndi is hêrron kwēdde,  
 kuste ina kraftagne · êndi is kwidi lēste,  
 4832 wisde ina þemu werode, · al só hé êr mid wordun ge·hét.  
 Þat þolode al mid gi·þuldjun · þiодо drohtin,  
 4834 waldand þesara wer-olde · êndi sprak imu mid is wordun tó,

frágode ine frókno: · „be·hwí kumis þú só mid þius folku te  
 mí,  
 4836 be·hwí lēdis þú mí só þese liudi tó · ęndi mí te þesare lēðan  
 þiode sprekan,  
 far·kôpos mid þínu kussu · under þit kunni Judeono,  
 4838 mēldos mí te þesaru mēnegi?“ · Géng imu þó wið þea man  
 wið þat werod ôðar · ęndi sie mid is wordun fragn,  
 4840 hwene sie mid þiu ge·siðju · sókjan kwámin  
 só niud-liko an naht, · „so gí willjan nôd frummjen  
 4842 manno hwi-likumu.“ · Þó sprak imu eft þiu mēnegi an·gegin,  
 kwáðun þat im hēljand · þár an þemu holme uppan  
 4844 ge·wísid wári, · „þe þit gi·wer frumid  
 Judeo liudjun · ęndi ina godes sunu  
 4846 selbon hētid. · Ina kwámun wí sókjan herod,  
 weldin ina gerno bi·geten: · hé is fan Galileo lande,  
 4848 fan Nazareth-burg.“ · Só im þó þe nęrjendjo Krist  
 sagde te sóðan, · þat hé it selbo was,  
 4850 só wurðun þó an forhtun · folk Judeono,  
 wurðun under·badode, · þat sie under bak fellun  
 4852 alle efno sán, · erðe gi·sóhtun,  
 wiðer·wardes þat werod: · ni mahte þat word godes,  
 4854 þie stemnje ant·standan: · wárun þoh só stríðige man,  
 a·hliopun eft up an þemu holme, · hugi fastnodun,  
 4856 bundun briost-gi·þáht, · gi·bolgane géngun  
 náhor mid níðu, · ant-tat sie þene nęrjendjon Krist  
 4858 werodo bi·wurpun. · Stóðun wíse man,  
 swíðo gornundje · jungaron Kristes  
 4860 bi·foran þeru dęreþjon dádi · ęndi te iro drohtine sprákun:  
 „wári it nú þín willjo“, (kwáðun sie,) „waldand frô mín,  
 4862 þat sie ús hér an speres ordun · spildjen móstin  
 wápnun wunde, · þan ni wári ús wiht só gód,  
 4864 só þat wí hér for úsumu drohtine · dóan móstin  
 bęniðjun blēka“. · Þó gi·bolgan warð  
 4866 snel swerd-þegan, · Símon Petrus,  
 well imu innan hugi, · þat hé ni mahte ênig word sprekan:  
 4868 só harm warð imu an is hertan, · þat man is hērron þár  
 binden welde. · Þó hé gi·bolgan géng,  
 4870 swíðo þrist-mód þegan · for is þiodan standen,  
 hard for is hērron: · ni was imu is hugi twífli,

4872 blóð an is breostun, · ak hé is bil a·tôh,  
 swerd bi sídu, · slóg imu te·gegnes  
 4874 an þene furiston fiund · folmo krafft,  
 þat þó Malkhus warð · mákjas eggjun,  
 4876 an þea swiðaron half · swerdu gi·máloð:  
 þiu hlust warð imu far·hawan, · hé warð an þat hôðid wund,  
 4878 þat imu heru·drôrag · hlear çndi ôre  
 bçni-wundun brast: · blóð aftar sprang,  
 4880 well fan wundun. · Þó was an is wangun skard  
 þe furisto þero fiundo. · Þó stóð þat folk an rúm:  
 4882 an·drédun im þes billes biti. · Þó sprak þat barn godes  
 selbo te Símon Petruse, · hét þat hé is swerd dedi  
 4884 skarp an skêðja: · „ef ik wið þesa skola weldi“, kwað hé,  
 „wið þeses werodes ge·win · wíg-saka frummjen,  
 4886 þan manodi ik þene márjon · mahtigne god,  
 hêlagne fader · an himil-rikja,  
 4888 þat hé mí só managan çngil herod · obana sandi  
 wíges só wísen, · só ni mahtin iro wápan-þreki  
 4890 man a·dôgjan: · iro ni stódi gio su·lík mçgin samad,  
 folkes gi·fastnod, · þat im iro ferh aftar þiu  
 4892 werðen mahti. · Ak it habað waldand god,  
 alo-mahtig fader · an ôðar gi·markot,  
 4894 þat wí gi·þolojan skulun, · só hwat só ús þius þioda tó  
 bittres brçngit: · ni skulun ús belgan wiht,  
 4896 wrêðjan wið iro ge·winne; · hwand só hwe só wápnio níð,  
 grimman gêr-hçti wili · gerno frummjen,  
 4898 hé swiltit imu · eft swerdes eggjun,  
 dóit im bi·drôregan: · wí mid úsun dádjun ni skulun  
 4900 wiht a·werðjan.“ · Géng hé þó te þemu wundon manne,  
 lçgde mid listjun · lík te·samne,  
 4902 hôðid-wundon, · þat siu sán gi·hêlid warð,  
 þes billes biti, · çndi sprak þat barn godes  
 4904 wið þat wrêðe werod: · „mí þunkid wunder mikil“, kwað hé,  
 „ef gí mí lêðes wiht · lêstjen weldun,  
 4906 hwí gí mí þó ni fçngun, · þan ik undar iuwomu folke stóð,  
 an þemu wíhe innan · çndi þár word manag  
 4908 sôð-lík sagde. · Þan was sunnon skín,  
 diur-lik dages lioht, · þan ni weldun gí mí dóan eo-wiht  
 4910 lêðes an þesumu liohte, · çndi nú lédjad mí iuwa liudi tó

an þiustrje naht, · al só man þioþe dót,  
 4912 þan man þene fáhan wili · ęndi hé is ferhes hábad  
 far·werkot, wam-skaðo.“ · werod Judeono  
 4914 gripun þó an þene godes sunu, · grimma þioda,  
 hatandjero hóþ, · hwurbun ina umbi  
 4916 módag manno folk · —mênes ni sáhun—,  
 heftun heru-bęndjun · handi te·samne,  
 4918 faðmos mid fiterjun. · Im ni was su·líkaro firin-kwála  
 þarf te gi·þolonne, · þiod-arbêdjes,  
 4920 te winnanne su·lík witi, · ak hé it þurh þit werod deda,  
 hwand hé liudjo barn · lōsjen welda,  
 4922 halon fan heþlju · an himil-ríki,  
 an þene wídon welon: · be·þiu hé þes wiht ne bi·sprak,  
 4924 þes sie imu þurh in·wid-nið · ógjan weldun.

TODO.

59 Þó wurðun þes só malske · módag folk Judeono,  
 4926 þiu hēri warð þes só hrómeg, · þes sie þena hēlagon Krist  
 an liðo-bęndjon · lēdjan muostun,  
 4928 fōrjan an fiterjun. · Þie fiund eft ge·witun  
 fan þemu berge te burg. · Géng þat barn godes  
 4930 undar þemu hēri-skepī · handun ge·bunden,  
 drúbondi te dale. · Wárun imu þea is diurjon þó  
 4932 ge·sīðos ge·swikane, · al só hé im ēr selbo gi·sprak:  
 ni was it þoh be ęnigaru blóði, · þat sie þat barn godes,  
 4934 lioben far·létun, · ak it was só lango bi·foren  
 wár-sagono word, · þat it skoldi gi·werðen só:  
 4936 be·þiu ni mahtun sie is be·míðan. · Þan aftar þeru męnegi  
 géngun  
 Jóhannes ęndi Petrus, · þie gumon twêne,  
 4938 folgodun ferrane: · was im firi-wit mikil,  
 hwat þea grimmon Judeon · þemu godes barne,  
 4940 weldin iro drohtine dóen. · Þó sie te dale kwámun  
 fan þemu berge te burg, · þár iro biskop was,  
 4942 iro wíhes ward, · þár lēddun ina wlanke man,  
 erlos undar ederos. · Þár was ēld mikil,  
 4944 fiur an fríd-hobe · þemu folke te·gegnes,  
 ge·warht for þemu werode: · þár géngun sie im wermjen tó,  
 4946 Judeo liudi, · létun þene godes sunu



bídon an bændjun. · Was þar braht mikil,  
 4948 gël-módigaro galm. · Johannes was êr  
 þemu hêroston küð: · be-þiu môste hé an þene hof innan  
 4950 þringan mid þeru þioda. · Stód allaro þegno bêtsto,  
 Petrus þar úte: · ni lét ina þe portun ward  
 4952 folgon is frôen, · êr it at is friunde a·bad,  
 Johannes at ênumu Judeon, · þat man ina gangan lét  
 4954 forð an þene fríd-hof. · Þar kwam im ên fêkni wíf  
 gangan te·gêgnes, · þiu ênas Judeon was,  
 4956 iro þeodanes þiw, · êndi þó te þemu þegne sprak  
 magað un·wán-lík: · „Hwat þú mahtis man wesan“, kwað siu,  
 4958 „jungaro fan Galilea, · þes þe þar genower stéd  
 faðmun gi·fastnod.“ · Þó an forhtun warð  
 4960 Símon Petrus sán, · slak an is móde,  
 kwað þat hé þes wíbes · word ni bi·konsti  
 4962 ni þes þeodanes · þegan ni wári:  
 mēð is þó for þeru mēnegi, · kwað þat hé þena man ni  
 ant·kendi:  
 4964 „ni sind mí þíne kwidi küðe“, (kwað hé;) was imu þiu kraft godes,  
 þe hêrdislo fan þemu hertan. · Hwarþbondi géng  
 4966 forð undar þemu folke, · ant-tat hé te þemu fiure kwam;  
 gi·wêt ina þó warmjen. · Þar im ôk ên wíf bi·gan  
 4968 fêlgjan firin-spráka: · „hér mugun gí“, kwað siu, „an iuwan  
 fiund sehan:  
 þit is gegnungo · jungaro Kristes,  
 4970 is selbes ge·sīð.“ · Þó géngun imu sán aftar þiu  
 náhor níð-hwata · êndi ina niud-líko  
 4972 frágodun fiundo barn, · hwi-líkes hé folkes wári:  
 “ni bist þú þesoro burg-liudjo“, (kwaðun sie;) „þat mugun wí an  
 þínumu gi·bárje gi·sehan,  
 4974 an þínun wordun êndi an þínaru wíson, · þat þú þeses werodes  
 ni bist,  
 ak þú bist galiléisk man.“ · hé ni welda þes þó gehan eo-wiht,  
 4976 ak stód þó êndi strídda · êndi starkan êð  
 swíð-líko ge·swór, · þat hé þes ge·sīðes ni wári.  
 4978 Ni habda is wordo ge·wald: · it skolde gi·werðen só,  
 só it þe ge·markode, · þe man-kunnjes  
 4980 far·wardot an þesaru wer-oldi. · Þó kwam imu ôk an þemu  
 warþe tó

- þes mannes mág-wini, · þe hé êr mid is mákjo gi·héw,  
 4982 swerdu þiu skarpon, · kwað þat hé ina sáhi þár  
 an þemu berge uppan, · „þár wí an þemu bôm-gardon  
 4984 hêrron þínumu · hę̃ndi bundun,  
 fastnodun is folmos.“ · Hé þó þurh forhtan hugi  
 4986 for·lôgnide þes is liobes hêrron, · kwað þat hé weldi wesən þes  
 líbes skolo,  
 ef it mahti ênig þár · irmin-manno  
 4988 gi·sęggjan te sôðan, · þat hé þes ge·sīðes wári,  
 folgodi þeru fę̃rdi. · Þó warð an þena formon sīð  
 4990 hano·krád af·haben. · Þó sah þe hêlago Krist,  
 barno þat bę̃tste, · þár hé ge·bunden stôð,  
 4992 selbo te Símon Petruse, · sunu drohtines  
 te þemu erle obar is ahsła. · Þó warð imu an innan sán,  
 4994 Símon Petruse · sêr an is móde,  
 harm an is hertan · ę̃ndi is hugi dróbi,  
 4996 swíðo warð imu an sorgun, · þat hé êr selbo ge·sprak:  
 gi·hugde þero wordo þó, · þe imu êr waldand Krist  
 4998 selbo sagda, · þat hé an þeru swartan naht  
 êr hano·krádi · is hêrron skoldi  
 5000 þríwo far·lôgnjen. · Þes þram imu an innan mód  
 bittro an is breostun, · ę̃ndi géng imu þó gi·bolgan þanen  
 5002 þe man fan þeru mę̃nigi · an mód·karu,  
 swíðo an sorgun, · ę̃ndi is selbes word,  
 5004 wam·skę̃fti weop, · ant·tat imu wallan kwámun  
 þurh þea hert·kara · hête trahni,  
 5006 blóðage fan is breostun. · Hé ni wánde þat hé is mahti  
 gi·bótjen wiht,  
 firin·werko furður · efsa te is frâhon kuman,  
 5008 hêrron huldi: · nis ênig hę̃liðo só ald,  
 þat io mannes sunu · mēr gi·sáhi  
 5010 is selbes word · sêrur hreuwān,  
 karon efsa kúmjen: · „Wola krafteg god“, kwað hé,  
 5012 þat ik hę̃bbju mí só for·werkot, · só ik mínaro wer·oldes ni þarf  
 ó·lát sęggjan. · Ef ik nú te aldre skal  
 5014 huldjo þínaro · ę̃ndi heban·ríkjas,  
 þeoden, þolojan, · þan ni þarf mí þes ênig þank wesən,  
 5016 liobo drohtin, · þat ik io te þesumu liohte kwam.  
 Ni bium ik nú þes wirðig, · waldand frô mín,

5018 þat ik under þíne jungaron · gangan móti,  
 þus sundig under þíne ge·sīðos: · ik iro selbo skal  
 5020 mīðan an mínumu móde, · nú ik mí su·lík mēn ge·sprak.“  
 Só gornode · gumono bēṭsta,  
 5022 hrau im só hardo, · þat hé habde is hērren þó  
 leobes far·lōgnid. · Þan ni þurbun þes liudjo barn,  
 5024 weros wundrojan, · be·hwí it weldi god,  
 þat só lioben man · lēð gi·stódi,  
 5026 þat hé só hōn·líko · hērron sīnes  
 þurh þera þiwun word, · þegno snellost,  
 5028 far·lōgnide só liobes: · it was al bi þesun liudjun gi·duan,  
 firliho barnun te frumu. · Hé welde ina te furiston dóan,  
 5030 hērost oþar is hīwiski, · hēlag drohtin:  
 lét ina ge·kunnon, · hwi·like kraft habet  
 5032 þe mēnniska mód · áno þe maht godes;  
 lét ina ge·sundjon, · þat hé sīðor þiu bēṭ  
 5034 liudjun gi·lōbdi, · hwó liof is þár  
 manno gi·hwi·líkumu, · þan hé mēn ge·frumit,  
 5036 þat man ina a·láte · lēðes þinges,  
 sakono ċndi sundjono, · só im þó selbo dede  
 5038 heban·ríki god · harm·ge·wurhti.

TODO.

‘So lamented the best of men,  
 he was so greatly troubled that he had then denied  
 his beloved lord. Then did the children of men,  
 the heroes, not need wonder at why God  
 would have it that such a beloved man should stand in pain,  
 that he, the most valiant of thanes, had so shamefully  
 denied his own lord so beloved  
 through those three speeches. It was all done on behalf of these men,  
 to the profit of the children of folk. He, the Holy Lord,  
 would make him the foremost, the noblest, over His retinue.  
 He made him experience just what strength  
 the human mind has without the might of God.  
 He let him sin so that he afterwards could  
 yet better make men believe what love there exists  
 for whichever man has committed evil,  
 that men may forgive him for his loathsome deed,  
 for his crimes and sins, as him did the very  
 God of the Heavenly Realm [forgive] for his works of harm.

60 Be þiu nis mannes bág · mikilun bi·þerþi,



þea liudi mid luginun, · þat hé it mid lêðun an·gegin  
 5080 wordun wráki. · Þó þár undar þemu werode a·rēs  
 balu-hugdig man, · biskop þero liudjo,  
 5082 þe furisto þes folkes · ɛndi frágode Krist  
 iak ina be imu selbon bi·swór · swiðon êðun,  
 5084 grótte ina an godes namon · ɛndi gerno bad,  
 þat hé im þat gi·sagdi, · ef hé sunu wári  
 5086 þes libbjendjes godes: · „þes þit lioht ge·skóp,  
 Krist kuning êwig. · Wí ni mugun is ant·kiennjen wiht  
 5088 ne an þínun wordun ni an þínun werkun.“ · Þó sprak imu eft  
 þe wáro an·gegin,  
 þe gódo godes sunu: · „þú kwiðis it for þesun Judeon nú,  
 5090 sôð·liko segis, · þat ik it selbo bium.  
 Þes ni gi·lôbjad mí þese liudi: · ni willjad mí for·látan be·þiu;  
 5092 ni sind im mín word wirðig. · Nú seggju ik iu te wárun þoh,  
 þat gí noh skulun sittjen gi·sehan · an þe swiðaron half godes  
 5094 márjan mannes sunu, · an megin·krafte  
 þes alo·walden fader, · ɛndi þanan eft kuman  
 5096 an himil·wolknun herod · ɛndi allumu héliðo kunnje  
 mid is wordun a·dêljen, · al só iro ge·wurhti sind.“  
 5098 Þo balg ina þe biskop, · habde bittren hugi,  
 wrêðida wið þemu worde · ɛndi is gi·wádi slêt,  
 5100 brak for is breostun: · „Nú ni þurbun gí bídan leng“, kwað hé,  
 „þit werod ge·wit·skêpjes, · nú im su·lík word farad,  
 5102 mên·spráka fan is müðe. · Þat gi·hôrid hér nú manno filu,  
 rinko an þesumu rakude, · þat hé ina só ríkjan telit,  
 5104 gihid þat hé god sí. · Hwat willjad gí Judeon þes  
 a·dêljen te dôme? · Is hé dôðes nú  
 5106<sup>a</sup> wirðig be su·líkun wordun?“

Therefore man's boasting is not of much avail,  
 the young warrior's bragging, if the help of God fails him  
 due to his sins. Then very soon afterwards  
 is the heart in his breast bloodier, although he may earlier have spoken a vow,  
 bragged about his zeal and strength of hand—  
 that man, about his might. That was made clear to the famed  
 best of thanes when the theoden's holy  
 help failed him. Therefore man should not boast  
 too much about himself, for often his hope  
 and will fail him if the wielder God,  
 the noble King of Heaven, does not strengthen his heart.  
 TODO.

5106<sup>b</sup> 61

Þat werod al ge·sprak,  
 folk Judeono, · þat hé wári þes ferhes skolo,  
 5108 wítjes só wirðig. · Ni was it þoh be is ge·wurhtjun gi·dóen,  
 þat ine þár an Jerusalem · Judeo liudi,  
 5110 sunu drohtines · sundja lōsen  
 a·dēldun te dōðe. · Þó was þero dādjo hróm  
 5112 Judeo liudjun, · hwat sie þemu godes barne  
 mahtin só haftemu mēst, · harmes ge·frummjen.  
 5114 Be·wurpun ina þó mid werodu · ęndi ina an is wangon slógun,  
 an is hleor mid iro handun · —al was imu þat te hoske  
 gi·dóen—,  
 5116 fēlgidun imu firin-word · fiundo męnegi,  
 bismersprāka. · Stód þat barn godes  
 5118 fast under fiundun: · wārun imu is faðmos ge·bundene,  
 þolode mid gi·þuldjun, · só hwat só imu þiu þioda tó  
 5120 bittres brāhte: · ni balg ina n·eo-wiht  
 wið þes werodes ge·win. · Þó námon ina wrēðe man  
 5122 só gi·bundanan, · þat barn godes,  
 ęndi ina þó lēddun, · þár þero liudjo was,  
 5124 þere þiade þing-hús. · Þár þegān manag  
 hwurbun umbi iro hęri-togon. · Þár was iro hęrron bodo  
 5126 fan Rúmu-burg, · þes þe þó þes ríkjas gi·wēld:  
 kumen was hé fan þemu kēsure, · gi·ęndid was hé undar þat  
 kunni Judeono  
 5128 te rihtjenne þat ríki, · was þár rád-geþo:  
 Pilatus was hé hēten; · hé was fan Ponto lande  
 5130 knósles kęnnit. · Habde imu kraft mikil,  
 an þemu þing-húse · þiod gi·samnod,  
 5132 an warf weros; · wār-lōse man  
 a·gābun þó þena godes sunu, · Judeo liudi,  
 5134 under fiundo folk, · kwāðun þat hé wári þes ferhes skolo,  
 þat man ina wítnodi · wāpnes ęggjun,  
 5136 skarpun skúrun. · Ni welde þiu skole Judeono  
 þringan an þat þing-hús, · ak þiu þiod úte stód,  
 5138 mahlidun þanen wið þea męnegi: · ni weldun an þat gi·mang  
 faren,  
 an ęli-landige man, · þat sie þár un-reht word,  
 5140 an þemu dage dęrbjes wiht · a·dēljan ne gi·hōrdin,  
 ak kwāðun þat sie im só hluttro · hēlaga tídi,

5142 weldin iro paskha halden. · Pilatus ant-féng  
 at þem wam-skaðun · waldandes barn,  
 5144 sundja lôsen. · Þó an sorgun warð  
 Judases hugi, · þó hé a·geban gi·sah  
 5146 is drohtin te dôðe, · þó bi·gan imu þiu dád aftar þiu  
 an is hugja hreuwan, · þat hé habde is hêrron êr  
 5148 sundja lôsen gi·sald. · Nam imu þó þat silubar an hand,  
 þrí-tig skatto, · þat man imu êr wið is þiodane gaf,  
 5150 géng imu þó te þem Judiun · ɛndi im is grimmon dád,  
 sundjon sagde, · ɛndi im þat silubar bôð  
 5152 gerno te a·gebanne: · „ik hêbbju it só grio-líko“, kwað hé,  
 „mínes drohtines · drôru gi·kôpot,  
 5154 só ik wêt þat it mí ni þíhit.“ · Þiod Judeono  
 ni weldun it þó ant·fahan, · ak hétun ina forð aftar þiu  
 5156 umbi su-lika sundja · selbon ahton,  
 hwat hé wið is frâhon · ge·frumid habdi:  
 5158 „Þú sáhi þi selbo þes“, (kwáðun sie;) „hwat wili þú þes nú sóken te  
 ùs?  
 Ne wít þú þat þesumu werode!“ · Þó gi·wêt imu eft þanan  
 5160 Judas gangan · te þemu godes wihe  
 swiðo an sorgun · ɛndi þat silubar warp  
 5162 an þena alah innan, · ne gi·dorste it êgan lęng;  
 fór imu þó só an forhtun, · só ina fiundo barn  
 5164 módage manodun: · habdun þes mannes hugi  
 gramon under·gripanen, · was imu god a·bolgan,  
 5166 þat hé imu selbon þó · símon warhte,  
 hnêg þó an heru-sêl · an hinginna,  
 5168 warag an wurgil · ɛndi wíti ge·kôs,  
 hard hêllje ge·þwing, · hêt ɛndi þiustri,  
 5170 diap dôðes dalu, · hwand hé êr umbi is drohtin swêk.

TODO.

62 Þan bêð þat barn godes · —bendi þolode  
 5172 an þemu þing-húse—, · hwan êr þiu þiod under im,  
 erlos ên-wordje · alle wurðin,  
 5174 hwat sie imu þan te ferah-kwálu · frummjan weldin.  
 Þó þár an þem bęnkjun a·rês · bodo kêsures  
 5176 fan Rúmu-burg · ɛndi géng imu wið þat ríki Judeono  
 módag mahljen, · þár þiu męnigi stód

- 5178      aftar þemu hobe hwarbon: · ni weldun an þat hús kuman  
          an þemu paskha-dage. · Pilatus bi-gan  
 5180      frókno frágon · oðar þat folk Judeono,  
          mid hwiu þe man habdi · morðes gi-skuldit,  
 5182      wítjes gi-werkot: · „be hwi gí imu só wrêðe sind,  
          an iuwomu hugja hótje?“ · Sie kwáðun þat hé im habdi  
                                  harmes só filu,  
 5184      lêðes gi-lêstid: · „ni gábin ina þesa liudi þi,  
          þár sie ina êr bi-foran · ubilan ni wissin,  
 5186      wordun far-warhten. · Hé habat þeses werodes só filu  
          far-lêdid mid is lêrun · —endi þesa liudi merrid,  
 5188      dóit im iro hugi twífljen—, · þat wí ni mótun te þemu hobe  
                                  kêsures  
          tinsi gelden; · þat mugun wí ina gi-telljen an  
 5190      mid wáru ge-wit-skêpi. · Hé sprikid ôk word mikil,  
          kwiðit þat hé Krist sí, · kuning oðar þit ríki,  
 5192      be-gihit ina só grôtes.“ · Þó im eft te-gêgnes sprak  
          bodo kêsures: · „ef hé só bar-líko“, kwað hé,  
 5194      „under þesaru mēnigi · mēn-werk frumid,  
          ant-fāhad ina þan eft under iuwe folk-skêpi, · ef hé sí is ferhes  
                                  skolo,  
 5196      endi imu só a-dêljad, · ef hé sí dôðes werð,  
          só it an iuwaro aldrono · êo ge-biode.“  
 5198      Sie kwáðun þó, þat sie ni móstin · manno nig-ênumu  
          an þea hêlagon tíð · te hand-banon,  
 5200      werðen mid wápnun · an þemu wíh-dage.  
          Þó wēnde ina fan þemu werode · wrêð-hugdig man,  
 5202      þegan kêsures, · þe oðar þea þioda was  
          bodo fan Rúmu-burg—: · hét imu þó þat barn godes  
 5204      náhor gangan · endi ina niud-líko,  
          frágoda frókno, · ef hé oðar þat folk kuning  
 5206      þes werodes wári. · Þó habde eft is word garu  
          sunu drohtines: · „hweðer þú þat fan þi selbumu sprikis“,  
                                  kwað hé,  
 5208      „þe it þi ôðre hér · erlos sagdun,  
          kwáðun umbi mínan kuning-duom?“ · Þó sprak eft þe kêsures  
                                  bodo  
 5210      wlank endi wrêð-mód, · þár hé wið waldand Krist



reðjode an þem rakude: · „ni bium ik þeses ríkjes hinan“,  
 kwað hé,  
 5212 „Judeo liudjo, · ni gadoling þín,  
 þesaro manno mág-wini, · ak mí þí þius menigi bi·falāh,  
 5214 a·gābun þí þína gadulingos mí, · Judeo liudi,  
 haftan te handun. · Hwat habas þú harmes gi·duan,  
 5216 þat þú só bittro skalt · bēndi þolojan,  
 kwalm undar þínumu kunnje?“ · Þó sprak imu eft Krist  
 an·gegin,  
 5218 hēlendero bēst, · þár hé gi·hēftid stód  
 an þemu rakude innan: · „nis mín ríki hinan“, kwað hé,  
 5220 „fan þesaru wer-old-stundu. · Ef it þoh wári só,  
 þan wárin só stark-móde · wiðer stríd-hugi,  
 5222 wiðer grama þioda · jungaron míne,  
 só man mí ni gābi · Judeo liudjun,  
 5224 hēttendjun an hand · an heru-bēndjun  
 te wēgjanne te wundrun. · Te þiu warð ik an þesaru wer-oldi  
 gi·boran,  
 5226 þat ik ge·wit-skēpi giu · wáres þinges  
 mid mínun kumjun kūðdi. · Þat mugun ant·kēnnjen wel  
 5228 þe weros, þe sind fan wáre kumane: · þe mugun mín word  
 far·standen,  
 gi·lōbjen mínun lērun.“ · Þó ni mahte lasteres wiht  
 5230 an þem barne godes · bodo kēsures,  
 findan fēknja word, · þat hé is ferhes be·þiu  
 5232 skuldig wári. · Þó géng hé im eft wið þea skola Judeono  
 módag mahljen · ēndi þeru menigi sagde  
 5234 oþar hlust mikil, · þat hé an þemu hafton manne  
 su·líka firin-sprāka · finden ni mahti  
 5236 for þem folk-skipje, · só hé wári is ferhes skolo,  
 dōðes wirðig. · Þan stódun dol-móde  
 5238 Judeo liudi · ēndi þane godes sunu  
 wordun wrógdun: · kwáðun þat hé gi·wer êrist  
 5240 be·gunni an Galileo lande, · „ēndi oþar Judeon fór  
 herod-wardes þanan, · hugi twíflode,  
 5242 manno mód-sebon, · só hé is morðes werð,  
 þat man ina wítnoje · wápnes eggjun,  
 5244 ef eo man mid su·líkun dádjun mag · dōðes ge·skuldjen.“

TODO.

63

Só wrógdun ina mid wordun · werod Judeono  
 5246 þurh hótjan hugi. · Þó þe hēri-togo,  
 slíð-módig man · seggjan gi·hôrde,  
 5248 fan hwi-líkumu kunnje was · Krist a·fódid,  
 manno þe bēstto: · hé was fan þeru márjan þiadu,  
 5250 þe gódo fan Galilea-lande; · þár was gum-skepi  
 5252 ęðiljero manno; · Eroles bi·held þár  
 kraftagne kuning-dóm, · só ina imu þe kēsur far·gaf,  
 þe rikjo fan Rúmu, · þat hé þár rehto ge·hwi-lík  
 5254 ge·frumidi undar þemu folke · ęndi friðu lêsti,  
 dómos a·dēldi. · Hé was ôk an þemu dage selbo  
 5256 an Jerusalem · mid is gum-skepi,  
 mid is werode at þemu wíhe: · só was iro wíse þan,  
 5258 þat sie þár þia hēlagun tíð · haldan skoldun,  
 paskha Judeono. · Pilatus gi·bôð þó,  
 5260 þat þena hafton man · hēliðos námin  
 só gi·bundanan, · þat barn godes,  
 5262 hét þat sie ina Erodese, · erlos bráhtin  
 haften te handun, · hwand hé fan is hēri-skepi was,  
 5264 fan is werodes ge·wald. · Wígand frumidun  
 iro hērron word: · hēlagne Krist  
 5266 fórdun an fiterjun · for þena folk-togun,  
 allaro barno bēst, · þero þe io gi·boren wurði  
 5268 an liudjo liiht; · an liðu-bēndjun gég,  
 ant-tat sie ina bráhtun, · þár hé an is bēnkja sat,  
 5270 kuning Eroles: · umbi·hwarf ina kraft wero,  
 wlanke wíganos: · was im willjo mikil,  
 5272 þat sie þár selbon Krist · gi·sehan móstin:  
 wándun þat hé im sum tēkan · þár tōgjan skoldi,  
 5274 mári ęndi mahtig, · só hé managun dede  
 þurh is god-kundi · Judeo \*liudjon.  
 5276 Frágoda ina þuo þie folk-kuning · firi-wit-líko  
 managon wordon, · wolda is muod-sebon  
 5278 forð undar·findan, · hwat hie te frumu mohti  
 mannon gi·markon. · Þan stuod mahtig Krist,  
 5280 þagoda ęndi þoloda: · ne wolda þem þied-kuninge,  
 Erodese ne is erlon · ant-swór geþan  
 5282 wordo nig·ēnon. · Þan stuod þiu wrēða þiod,  
 Judeo liudi · ęndi þena godes suno

5284 wurrun ęndi wruogdun, · anþat im warð þie wer-old-kuning  
 an is huge huoti · ęndi all is hęri-skipi,  
 5286 far·muonstun ina an iro muode: · ne ant·ķęndun maht godes,  
 himiliskan hęrron, · ak was im iro hugi þiustri,  
 5288 baluwes gi·blandan. · Barn drohtines  
 iro wręðun werk, · word ęndi dádi  
 5290 þuru ôd-muodi · all gi·þoloda,  
 só hwat só sia im tionono þuo · tuogjan woldun.  
 5292 Sia hietun im þuo te hoske · hwít gi·wádi  
 umbi is liði leggan, · þiu mēr hie wurði þem liudjon þár,  
 5294 jungron te gamne. · Judeon faganodun,  
 þuo sia ina te hoske · hębbjan gi·sáhun,  
 5296 erlos oþar-muoda. · Þuo sęnda ina eft þanan  
 Erodes sé kuning · an þat ôðer folk;  
 5298 a·lédjan hiet ina lungra mann, · ęndi lastar sprákun,  
 felgidun im firin-word, · þár hie an feteron géng  
 5300 bi·hlagan mid hosku: · ni was im hugi twíflí,  
 neba hie it þuru ôd-muodi · all gi·þoloda;  
 5302 ne welda iro ubilun word · idug-lónon,  
 hosk ęndi harm-kwidi. · Þuo bráhtun sia ina eft an þat hús  
 innan,  
 5304 an þia palenkja uppan, · þár Pilatus was  
 an þero þing-stędi. · Þegnos a·gáþun  
 5306 barno þat þęsta · banon te handon  
 sundi-lósjan, · só hie selbo gi·kôs:  
 5308 welda manno barn · morðes a·tuomjan,  
 nęrjan af nōdi. · Stuodun níð-hwata,  
 5310 Judeon far þem gast-sęlje: · habdun sia gramono barn,  
 þia skola far-skundid, · þat sia ne be-skribun iowiht  
 5312 grimmera dádjo. · Þuo gi·wēt im gangan þarod  
 þegan kęsures · wið þia þiod sprekan,  
 5314 hard hęri-togo: · „Hwat gí mí þesan haftan mann“, kwaþ-hie,  
 „an þesan sęli sęndun · ęndi selþon an·budun,  
 5316 þat hie iuwes werodes só filo · a·werdit habdi,  
 far·lédid mid is léron. · Nú ik mid þeson liudon ni mag,  
 5318 findan mid þius folku, · þat hie is ferahes sí  
 furi þesaro skolu skuldig. · Skín was þat hiudu:  
 5320 Erodes mohta, · þie iuwan êo bi·kan,  
 iuwaro liudo land-reht, · hie ni mahta is líbes gi·fręson,

5322 þat hie hier þuru êniga **sundja** te dage · **sweltan** skoldi,  
 lif far·látan. · Nú willju ik ina for þeson **liudjon** hier  
 5324 gi·þróon mid þingon, · þristjon wordun,  
 buotjan im is **briost**-hugi, · látan ina **brúkan** forð  
 5326 **ferāhes** mid **firjon**.“ · **Folk** Judeono  
 hreopun þuo alla **samad** · **hlúdero** stemnu,  
 5328 hietun **flit**-líko · **ferāhes** áhtjan  
**Krist** mid **kwalmu** · ęndi an **krúki** slahan,  
 5330 **węgjan** te **wundron**: · „hie mid is **wordon** habit  
**dôðes** gi·skuldid: · sagit þat hie **drohtin** sí,  
 5332 **gegnungo** **godes** suno. · Þat hie a·**geldan** skal,  
**in**-wid-spráka, · só is an úson **ęwe** gi·skriban,  
 5334 þat man su·líka **firin**-kwidi · **ferāhu** kôpo.“

TODO.

64 Þuo warð þie an **forāhton**, · þie þes **folkes** gi·wéld,  
 5336 **mikilon** an is **muode**, · þuo hie gi·hórda þia **man** sprekan,  
 þat sia ina **selbon** · **seggjan** gi·hórdin,  
 5338 **gehan** fur þem **gum**-skipe, · þat hie wári **godes** suno.  
 Þuo hwarf im eft þie **hęri**-togo · an þat **hús** innan  
 5340 te þero þing-stędi, · þristjon wordon  
**gruotta** þena **godes** suno · ęndi frágoda, hwat hie **gumono**  
 wári:  
 5342 „hwat bist þú **manno**?“ (kwaþ-hie,) „Te hwí þú mí só þinan **muod**  
 hilis,  
**dęnis** **diop**-gi·þáht? · Węst þú þat it all an mínon **duome** stéd  
 5344 **umbi** þines **líbes** gi·lagu? · Mí þi hębbjat þesa **liudi** far·geban,  
**werod** Judeono, · þat ik gi·waldan muot  
 5346 só þik te **spildjanne** · an **speres** orde,  
 só ti **kwęlljanne** an **krúkjum**, · só **kwikan** látan,  
 5348 só hweðer sí mí **selbon** · **suotera** þunkit  
 te gi·frummjanne mid mínu **folku**.“ · Þuo sprak eft þat  
**friðu**-barn **godes**:  
 5350 „Węst þú þat te **wáron**“, (kwaþ-hie,) „þat þú gi·wald oþar mik  
**hębbjan** ni mohtis, · ne wári þat it þi **hęlag** god  
 5352 **selbo** far·gábi? · Ók hębbjat þia **sundjono** mēr,  
 þia mik þi bi·fulhun · þuru **fiond**-skipi,  
 5354 gi·saldun an **símon** haftan.“ · Þuo welda ina **sđð** after þiu  
**gram**-hugdig man · **gerno** far·látan,

- 5356 þegan kêsures, · þár hie is habdi for þero þioda gi·wald;  
 ak sia wëridun im þena willjon · wordu gi·hwi·líku,  
 5358 kunni Judeono: · „ne bist þú“, kwáðun sia, „þes kêsures  
 friund,  
 þínon hêrren hold, · ef þú ina hinan látis  
 5360 síðon gi·sundon: · þat þi noh te soragan mag,  
 werðan te wíte, · hwand só hwe só su·lík word spriket,  
 5362 a·habíð ina só hóho, · kwiðit þat hie hëbbjan mugi  
 kuning·duomes namon, · ne sí þat ina im þie kêsur gebe,  
 5364 hie wirrid im is wer·uld·ríki · ęndi is word far·hugid,  
 far·man ina an is muode. · Be·þiu skalt þú su·lík mên wrekan,  
 5366 hosk·word manag, · ef þú umbi þínes hêrren ruokis,  
 umbi þínes frôhon friund·skipi, · þan skalt þú ina þiu ferhu  
 be·niman.“  
 5368 Þuo gi·hôrda þie hëri·togo · þia hêri Juðeono  
 þrêgjan fan is þiodne; · þuo hie far þero þing·stędi gęng  
 5370 selbo gi·sittjan, · þár gi·samnod was  
 só mikil warf werodes, · hiet waldand Krist  
 5372 lêdjan for þia liudi. · Langoda Judeon,  
 hwan êr sia þat hêlaga barn · hangon gi·sáwin,  
 5374 kwełan an krúkje; · sia kwáðun þat sia kuning ôðran  
 ne habdin undar iro hëri·skipje, · neþan þena hêran kêsar  
 5376 fan Rúmu·burg: · „þie habit hier ríki ober ús.  
 Be·þiu ni skalt þú þesan far·látan; · hie habit ús só filo lêðes  
 gi·sprokan,  
 5378 far·duan habit hie im mid is dádjon. · Hie skal dôð þolon,  
 wíti ęndi wundar·kwála.“ · Werod Judeono  
 5380 só manag mis·lík þing · an mahtigna Krist  
 sagdun te sundjun. · Hie swígondi stuod  
 5382 þuru ôð·muodi, · ne ant·wordida n·io·wiht  
 wið iro wrêðun word: · wolda þesa wer·old alla  
 5384 lôsjan mid is líbu: · bi·þiu liet hie ina þia lêðun þiod  
 wêgjan te wundron, · all só iro willjo gęng:  
 5386 ni wolda im opan·líko · allon küðjan  
 Judeo liudjon, · þat hie was god selbo;  
 5388 hwand wissin sia þat te wáron, · þat hie su·líka gi·wald habdi  
 oþar þeson middil·gard, · þan wurði im iro muod·seþo  
 5390 gi·blôðit an iro brioston: · þan ne gi·dorstin sia þat barn godes  
 handon ant·hrínan: · þan ni wurði heþan·ríki,

- 5392 ant-lokan **liohto** mēst · **liudjo** barnon.  
 Be·þiu **mēð** hie is só an is **muode**, · ne lét þat **manno** folk  
 5394 **witan**, hwat sia **warāhtun**. · Þiu **wurd** nāhida þuo,  
**mári** **maht** godes · ęndi **middi** dag,  
 5396 þat sia þia **ferāh-kwāla** · **frummjan** skoldun.  
 Þan lag þár ôk an **bęndjon** · an þero **burg** innan  
 5398 ęn **ruof** **regin-skaðo**, · þie habda under þem **rike** só filo  
**morðes** gi·rádan · ęndi **man-slahta** gi·frumid,  
 5400 was **mári** **męgin**-þiof: · ni was þár is gi·**mako** hwęgin;  
 was þár ôk bi **sínon** · **sundjon** gi·hęftid,  
 5402 **Barrabas** was hie hętan; · hie after þem **burgjon** was  
 þuru is **męn-dádi** · **manogon** gi·küðid.  
 5404 Þan was **land-wísa** · **liudjo** Judeono,  
 þat sia **járo** gi·hwen · an **godes** minnja  
 5406 an þem **hêlagon** dage · ęnna **haftan** mann  
 a·biddjan skoldun, · þat im iro **burges** ward,  
 5408 iro **folk-togo** · **ferāh** far·gábi.  
 Þuo bi·gan þie **hęri-togo** · þia **hêri** Judeono,  
 5410 þat **folk** **frágojan**, · þár sia im **fora** stuodun,  
 hweðeron sia þero **twejo** · **tuomjan** weldin,  
 5412 **ferāhes** biddjan: · „þia hier an **feteron** sind  
**haft** undar þeson **hęri-skipje**?“ · Þiu **hêri** Judeono  
 5414 habdun þuo þia **aramun** man · **alla** gi·spanana,  
 þat sia þemo **land-skaðen** · **lif** a·bádin,  
 5416 gi·þingodin þem **þioþe**, · þie oft an **þiustrja** naht  
**wam** gi·**warāhta**, · ęndi **waldand** Krist  
 5418 **kwęlidin** an **krúkje**. · Þuo warð þat **küð** oþar all,  
 hwó þiu þiod habda **duomos** a·**dêlid**. · Þuo skoldun sia þia **dád**  
 frummjan,  
 5420 **hāhan** þat **hêlaga** barn. · Þat warð þem **hęri-togen**  
**sīðor** te **sorgon**, · þat hie þia **saka** wissa,  
 5422 þat sia þuru **níð-skipi** · **nęrjendon** Krist,  
**hatoda** þiu **hêri**, · ęndi hie im **hôrda** te þiu,  
 5424 **warāhta** iro **willjon**: · þes hie **wíti** ant·fęng,  
**lôn** an þeson **liohte** · ęndi **lang** after,  
 5426 **wói** **sīðor** **wann**, · **sīðor** hie þesa **wer-old** a·gaf.

TODO.

Then it was made known to all,  
 how that people had dealt out their judgments. Then they were to carry out  
 that deed:

to hang the Holy Child. TODO.

- 65      Þuo warð þas þie wrêðo gi·waro, · wam-skaðono mêst,  
 5428      Satanas selbo, · þuo þiu seola kwam  
     Judases an grund · grimmaro hêljun—  
 5430      þuo wissa hie te wâren, · þat þat was waldand Krist,  
     barn drohtines, · þat þâr gi·bundan stuod;  
 5432      wissa þuo te wâron, · þat hie welda þesa wer-old alla  
     mid is hênginnja · hêlja gi·þwinges,  
 5434      liudi a·lôsjan · an lioht godes.  
     Þat was Satanase · sêr an muode,  
 5436      tulgo harm an is hugje: · welda is helpan þuo,  
     þat im liudjo barn · lif ne bi·nâmin,  
 5438      ne kwêlidin an krúkje, · ak hie welda, þat hie kwik libdi,  
     te þiu þat firiho barn · fernes ne wurðin,  
 5440      sundjono sikura. · Satanas gi·wêt im þuo,  
     þâr þes hêri-togen · híwiski was  
 5442      an þero burg innan. · Hie þero is brúdi bi·gann,  
     þera idis opan-líko · un-hiuri fiond  
 5444      wundêr tôgjan, · þat sia an word-helpon  
     Kriste wári, · þat hie muosti kwik libbjan,  
 5446      drohtin manno · —hie was iu þan te dôðe gi·skêrid—  
     wissa þat te wâron, · þat hie im skoldi þia gi·wald bi·niman,  
 5448      þat hie sia obar þesan middil-gard · só mikila ni habdi,  
     obar wíða wer-old. · Þat wíf warð þuo an for̥ahton,  
 5450      swíðo an sorogon, · þuo iru þiu gi·siuni kwámun  
     þuru þes dêrnjen dád · an dages liohte,  
 5452      an hêlið-helme bi·helid. · Þuo siu te iru hêrren an·bôd,  
     þat wíf mid iro wordon · êndi im te wâren hiet  
 5454      selbon seggjan, · hwat iro þâr te gi·siunjon kwam  
     þuru þena hêlagan mann, · êndi im helpan bad,  
 5456      formon is ferhe: · „ik hêbbju hier só filo þuru ina  
     seld-likes gi·sewan, · só ik wêt, þat þia sundjun skulun  
 5458      allaro erlo gi·hwem · ubilo gi·þíhan,  
     só im fruokno tuo · fer̥aþes áhtið.“  
 5460      Þie segg warð þuo an síðe, · ant-tat hie sittjan fand  
     þena hêri-togon · an hwar̥aþe innan  
 5462      an þem stên-wege, · þâr þiu stráta was  
     felison gi·fuogid. · Þâr hie te is frôhon géng,

- 5464 sagda im þes wíbes word. · Þuo warð im wrêð hugi,  
 þem hēri-togen, · —hwarāboda an innan—,  
 5466 gi·blôðit briost-gi·þáht: · was im bêðjes wê,  
 gie þat sea ina sluogin · sundja lōsan,  
 5468 gie it bi þem liudjon þuo · for·lātan ne gi·dorsta  
 þuru þes werodes word. · Warð im gi·wēndid þuo  
 5470 hugi an herten · after þero hēri Judeono,  
 te werkjanne iro willjon: · ne wardoda im nie-wiht  
 5472 þia swārun sundjun, · þia hie im þár þuo selbo gi·deda.  
 Hiet im þuo te is handon dragan · hluttran brunnjon,  
 5474 watar an wégje, · þár hie furi þem werode sat,  
 þwóg ina þár for þero þioda · þegan kēsures,  
 5476 hard hēri-togo · ėndi þuo fur þero hēri sprach,  
 kwað þat hie ina þero sundjono þár · sikoran dádi,  
 5478 wrêðero werko: · „ne willju ik þes wihtes plegan“, kwaþ-hie,  
 „umbi þesan hēlagan mann, · ak hleotad gi þes alles,  
 5480 gie wordo gie werko, · þes gi im hér te wítje gi·duan.“  
 Þuo hreop all saman · hēri-skipi Judeono,  
 5482 þiu mikila mēnigi, · kwaðun þat sia weldin umbi þena man  
 plegan  
 dęraþoro dádjo: · „Fare is drōr obar ūs,  
 5484 is bluod ėndi is baneði · ėndi obar ūsa barn só samo,  
 obar ūsa abaron þár after · —wí willjat is alles plegan“,  
 kwaðun sia,  
 5486 „umbi þena slęgi selbon,— · ef wí þár ėniga sundja gi·duan!“  
 A·geþan warð þár þuo furi þem Judeon · allaro gumono bęsta  
 5488 hęttendjon an hand, · an heru-bęndjon  
 narāwo gi·nôdid, · þár ina nið-hwata,  
 5490 fiond ant·féngun: · folk ina umbi·hwarf,  
 mēn-skaðono megin. · Mahtig drohtin  
 5492 þoloda gi·þuldjon, · só hwat só im þiu þioda deda.  
 Sia hietun ina þuo filljan, · ėr þan sia im fęrahes tuo,  
 5494 aldres áhtin, · ėndi im undar is ôgun spiwun,  
 dedun im þat te hoske, · þat sia mid iro handon slôgun,  
 5496 weros an is wangun · ėndi im is gi·wádi bi·námun,  
 rôþodun ina þia ręgin-skaðon, · rôdes lakanes  
 5498 dedun im eft ôðer an · þuru un-huldi;  
 hietun þuo hōþid-band · hardaro þorno  
 5500 wundron windan · ėndi an waldand Krist



selbon settjan, · ɛndi géngun im þia gi·sĩđos tuo,  
 5502 kwêddun ina an kuning-wísu · ɛndi þár an knio fellun,  
 hnigun im mid iro hõbdu: · all was im þat te hoske gi·duan,  
 5504 þoh hie it all gi·polodi, · þido drohtin,  
 mahtig þuru þia minnja · manno kunnjes.  
 5506 Hietun sia þuo wirkjan · wápnes eggjon  
 hêlĩđos mid iro handon · hardes bõmes  
 5508 kraftiga krúki · ɛndi hietun sia Kristan þuo,  
 sálig barn godes · selbon fuorjan,  
 5510 dragan hietun sia úsan drohtin, · þár hie be·drôragad skolda  
 sweltan sundjono lôs. · Sĩđodun Judeon,  
 5512 weros an willon, · lêddun waldand Krist,  
 drohtin te dôðe. · Þár mohta man þuo derêbi þing  
 5514 harm-lík gi·hôrjan: · hiobandi þár after  
 géngun wif mid wópu, · weros gnornodun,  
 5516 þia fan Galilea mid im · gangan kwámun,  
 folgodun obar ferr-wegos: · was im iro frôhon dôð  
 5518 swiđo an soragan. · Þuo hie selbo sprak,  
 barno þat bẽsta · ɛndi under bak be·sah,  
 5520 hiet þat sia ni wépin: · „ni þarf iu wiht tregan“, kwaþ·hie,  
 „mĩnero hin·fêrdjo, · ak gĩ mid hofnu mugun  
 5522 iuwa wrêðan werk · wópu kúmjan,  
 tornon trahnon. · Noh wirđið þiu tíð kuman,  
 5524 þat þia muoder þes · mẽndendja sind,  
 brúdi Judeono, · þem gio barn ni warð  
 5526 ôðan an aldre. · Þan gĩ iuwa in·wid skulun  
 grimmo an·geldan; · þan gĩ só gerna sind,  
 5528 þat iu hier bi·hlídan · hõha bergos,  
 diopo be·delban; · dôð wári iu þan allon  
 5530 liobera an þeson lande · þan su-lík liudjo kwalm  
 te gi·þoljanne, · só hier þan þesaro þioda kumid.“

TODO.

5532 **66** Þuo sia þár an griete · galgon rihtun,  
 an þem felde uppan · folk Judeono,  
 5534 bõm an berege, · ɛndi þár an þat barn godes  
 kwêlidun an krúkje: · slógun kald ísarn,  
 5536 niuwa naglos · níðon skarpa  
 hardo mid hamuron · þuru is hẽndi ɛndi þuru is fuoti,

- 5538 bittra bēndi: · is blód ran an erða,  
drôr fan ūson drohtine. · Hie ni welda þoh þia dád wrekan
- 5540 grimma an þem Judeon, · ak hie þes god fader  
mahtigna bad, · þat hie ni wári þem manno folke,
- 5542 þem werode þiu wrêðra: · „hwand sia ni witun, hwat sia  
duot“, kwap-hie.
- Puo þia wíganos · gi-wádi Kristes,  
5544 drohtines dēldun, · dēreþja mann,  
þes ríken gi-rôbi. · Þia rinkos ni mahtun
- 5546 umbi þena selbon [...] · sam-wurdi gi-sprekan,  
êr sia an iro hwaræbe · hlôtos wurpun,
- 5548 hwi-lík iro skoldi hēbbjan · þia hêlagun pēda,  
allaro gi-wádjo wun-samost. · Þes werodes hirdi
- 5550 hiet þuo, þe hēri-togo, · obar þem hōbde selbes  
Kristes an krúke skríban, · þat þat wári kuning Judeono,
- 5552 Jesus fan Nazareth-burh, · þie þár neglid stuod  
an niuwon galgon · þuru níð-skipi,
- 5554 an bômin treo. · Þuo bádun þia liudi  
þat word wēndjan, · kwáðun þat hie im só an is willjon spráki,
- 5556 selbo sagdi, · þat hie habdi þes gi-síðes gi-wald,  
kuning wári obar Judeon. · Þuo sprak eft þie kēsuren bodo,
- 5558 hard hēri-togo: · „it ist iu só obar is hōbde gi-skríban,  
wís-líko gi-writan, · só ik it nú wēndjan ni mag.“
- 5560 Dádun þuo þár te wítje · werod Judeono  
twēna fār-talda man · an twá halba
- 5562 Kristes an krúki: · lietun sia kwalm þolon  
an þem warag-trewe · werko te lône,
- 5564 lêðaro dádjo. · Þia liudi sprákun  
hosk-word manag · hêlagon Kriste,
- 5566 grottun ina mid gelpu: · sáwun allaro gumono þen bēston  
kwēlan an þemo krúkje: · „ef þú síð kuning obar all“, kwáðun  
sia,
- 5568 „suno drohtines, · só þú hábis selbo gi-sprokan,  
nēri þik fan þero nōdi · ėndi níðes a-tuomi,
- 5570 gang þi hêl herod; · þan welljat an þik hēliðo barn,  
þesa liudi gi-lôþjan.“ · Sum imo ôk lastar sprak
- 5572 swíðo gēl-hert Judeo, · þár hie fur þem galgon stuod:  
„Wah warð þesaro wer-oldi“, (kwap-hie,) „ef þú iro skoldis  
gi-wald êgan.

5574 þú sagdas þat þú mahtis an ênon dage · all te-werpan  
 þat hôha hús · heban-kuninges,  
 5576 stên-werko mêst · êndi eft standan gi·duon  
 an þriddjon dage, · só is êlkor ni þorfti bi·þíhan mann  
 5578 þeses folkes furðor. · Sínu hwó þú nú gi·fastnod stés,  
 swiðo gi·sêrid: · ni maht þi selbon wiht  
 5580 balowes gi·buotjan.“ · Ðuo þár ôk an þem bændjon sprak  
 þero þeobo ôðer, · all só hie þia þioda gi·hôrda,  
 5582 wrêðon wordon · —ne was is willjo guod,  
 þes pegnes gi·þáht—: · „ef þú síis þiod-kuning“, kwaþ-hie,  
 5584 „Krist, godes suno, · gang þi þan fan þem krúke niðer,  
 slópi þi fan þem símon · êndi ús samad allon  
 5586 hilf êndi hêli. · Ef þú síis heban-kuning,  
 waldand þesaro wer-oldes, · gi·duo it þan an þínon werkon  
 skín,  
 5588 mári þik fur þesaro mēnigi.“ · Ðuo sprak þero manno ôðer  
 an þero hēnginna, · þár hie gi·hēftid stuod,  
 5590 wan wundēr-kwála: · „Be·hwí wilt þú su·lík word sprekan,  
 gruoṭis ina mid gelpu? · Stés þi hier an galgen haft,  
 5592 gi·brokan an bōme. · Wit hier bēðja þolod  
 sēr þuru unka sundjun: · is unk unkero selbero dád  
 5594 worðan te wítje. · Hie stéd hier wammes lôs,  
 allaro sundjono sikur, · só hie selbo gio  
 5596 firina ni gi·frumida, · botan þat hie þuru þeses folkes nið  
 willendi an þesaro wer-uldi · wíti ant·fáhid.  
 5598 Ik willju þár gi·lôbjan tuo“, (kwaþ-hie,) „êndi willju þena landes  
 ward,  
 þena godes suno · gerno biddjan,  
 5600 þat þú mín gi·huggjes · êndi an helpun síis,  
 rádendero bēst, · þan þú an þín ríki kumis:  
 5602 wes mí þan gi·náðig.“ · Ðuo sprak im eft nērjendo Krist  
 wordon te·gegnes: · „Ik seggju þi te wáron hier“, kwaþ-hie,  
 5604 „þat þú noh hiu-du móst · an himil-ríke  
 mid mí samad · sehan lioht godes,  
 5606 an þemo Paradýse, · þoh þú nú an su·líkoro pínu síis.“  
 Ðan stuod þár ôk Maria, · muoder Kristes,  
 5608 blêk under þem bōme, · gi·sah iro barn þolon,  
 winnan wundēr-kwála. · Ôk wárun þár wíf mid iro  
 5610 an só mahtiges · minnja kumana—

þan stuod þár ôk Johannes, · jungro Kristes,  
 5612 hriuwi undar is hêren, · was im is hugi sêrag—  
 drúbodun fur þem dôðe. · Þár sprak drohtin Krist  
 5614 mahtig te þero muoder: · „nú ik þi hier mínemo skal  
 jungron be-felhan, · þem þi hier gegin-ward stéd:  
 5616 wis þi an is gi·sîðje samad: · þú skalt ina furi suno hebbjan.“  
 Grótta hie þuo Johannes, · hiet þat hie iru ful-géngi wel,  
 5618 minnjodi sia só mildo, · só man is muoder skal,  
 idis un-wamma. · Þuo hie sia an is êra ant-féng  
 5620 þuru hluttran hugi, · só im is hêro gi·bôð.

TODO.

67 Þuo warð þár an middjan dag · mahtig tēkan,  
 5622 wundar-lik gi·warht · obar þesan wer-old allan,  
 þuo man þena godes suno · an þena galgon huof,  
 5624 Krist an þat krúki: · þuo warð it kûð obar all,  
 hwô þiu sunna warð gi·sworkan: · ni mahta swigli lioht  
 5626 skôni gi·skínan, · ak sia skado far-féng,  
 þimm êndi þiustri · êndi só gi·þrusmod nebal.  
 5628 Warð allaro dago druobost, · dunkar swiðo  
 obar þesan wíðun wer-uld, · só lango só waldand Krist  
 5630 kwal an þemo krúkje, · kuningo ríkost,  
 ant nuon dages. · Þuo þie nebal ti-skréd,  
 5632 þat gi·swerk warð þuo te·swungan, · bi-gan sunnun lioht  
 hêdron an himile. · Þuo hreop up te gode  
 5634 allaro kuningo kraftigost, · þuo hie an þemo krúkje stuod  
 faðmon gi·fastnot: · „fader alo-mahtig“, kwaþ-hie,  
 5636 „te hwí þú mik só far-lieti, · liebo drohtin,  
 hêlag heban-kuning, · êndi þína helpa dedos,  
 5638 fullisti só ferr? · Ik standu under þeson fíndon hier  
 wundron gi·wêgid.“ · Werod Judeono  
 5640 hlógun is im þuo te hoske: · gi·hórdun þena hêlagun Krist,  
 drohtin furi þem dôðe · drinkan biddjan,  
 5642 kwað þat ina þurstidi. · Þiu þioda ne latta,  
 wrêða wiðar-sakon: · was im willjo mikil,  
 5644 hwat sia im bittres tuo · bringan mahtin.  
 Habdun im un-swóti · êkid êndi galla  
 5646 gi·męngid þia mên-hwaton; · stuod ên mann garo,  
 swiðo skuldig skaðo, · þena habdun sia gi·skęrid te þiu,

5648 far·spanan mid sprákon, · þat hie sia en êna spunsja nam,  
 líðo þes lēðosten, · druog it an ênon langan skafte,  
 5650 gi·bundan an ênon bôme · ɛndi deda it þem barne godes,  
 mahtigon te mūðe. · Hie an·kenda iro mirkjun dádi,  
 5652 gi·fuolda iro fēgnes: · furðor ni welda  
 is só bittres an·bítan, · ak hreop þat barn godes  
 5654 hlúdo te þem himiliskon fader: · „ik an þina hɛndi be·filhu“,  
 kwap·hie,  
 „mínon gēst an godes willjon; · hie ist nú garo te þiu,  
 5656 fūs te faranne.“ · Firiho drohtin  
 gi·hnêgida þuo is hôbid, · hêlagon áðom  
 5658 liet fan þemo lík·hamen. · Só þuo þie landes ward  
 swalt an þem símon, · só warð sán after þiu  
 5660 wundar·têkan gi·waraht, · þat þár waldandes dôð  
 un·kweðandes só filo · ant·kennjan skolda,  
 5662 þiadnes ên·dagon: · erða biðoda,  
 hrisidun þia hôhun bergos, · harda stênos klubun,  
 5664 felisos after þem felde, · ɛndi þat fêha lakan te·brast  
 an middjon an twê, · þat êr managan dag  
 5666 an þemo wíhe innan · wundron gi·striuníd  
 hêl hangoda · —ni muostun hɛliðo barn,  
 5668 þia liudi skawon, · hwat under þemo lakane was  
 hêlages be·hangan: · þuo mohtun an þat horð sehan  
 5670 Judeo liudi— · grabu wurðun gi·opanod  
 dôðero manno, · ɛndi sia þuru drohtines kraft  
 5672 an iro lík·hamon · libbjandi a·stuodun  
 up fan erðu · ɛndi wurðun gi·ôgida þár  
 5674 mannon te mārðu. · Þat was só mahtig þing,  
 þat þár Kristes dôð · ant·kennjan skoldun,  
 5676 só filo þes gi·fuoljan, · þie gio mid firihon ne sprach  
 word an þesaro wer·oldi. · Werod Judeono  
 5678 sáwun seld·lík þing, · ak was im iro slíði hugi  
 só far·hardod an iro herten, · þat þár io só hêlag ni warð  
 5680 têkan gi·tôgid, · þat sia trúodin þiu bat  
 an þia Kristes kraft, · þat hie kuning oðar all,  
 5682 þes werodes wári. · Suma sia þár mid iro wordon gi·sprákon,  
 þia þes hrêwes þár · huodjan skoldun,  
 5684 þat þat wári te wáren · waldandes suno,  
 godes gegnungo, · þat þár an þem galgon swalt,

5686 barno þat bęsta. · Slógun an iro briost filo  
 wópjandero wíbo: · was im þiu wunder-kwála  
 5688 harm an iro herten · ęndi iro hęrren dōð  
 swíðo an sorogon. · Þan was sido Judeono,  
 5690 þat sia pia haftun þuru þena hêlagon dag · hangon ni lietin  
 lęngerun hwíla, · þan im þat líf skriði,  
 5692 þiu seola be·sunki: · slíð-muoda mann  
 gęgun im mid níð-skipju náhor, · þár só be·nęglida stuodun  
 5694 þeobos twêna, · þolodun bêðja  
 kwála bi Kriste: · wárun im kwika noh þan,  
 5696 unt·þat sia pia grimmun · Judeo liudi  
 bēnon be·brákon, · þat sia bêðja samad  
 5698 líf far·lietun, · suohtun im lioht ôðer.  
 Sia ni þorftun drohtin Krist · dōðes bēdjan  
 5700 furðor mid ênigon firinon: · fundun ina gi·faranan þuo iu:  
 is seola was gi·sęndid · an suôðan weg,  
 5702 an lang·sam lioht, · is liði kuolodun;  
 þat ferah was af þem flêske. · Þuo gęng im ên þero fiondo tuo  
 5704 an níð·hugi, · druog nęgilid sper  
 hard an is handon, · mid heru·þrummjon stak,  
 5706 liet wápnes ord · wundum sníðan,  
 þat an selbes warð · sídu Kristes  
 5708 ant·lokan is lik·hamo. · Pia liudi gi·sáwun,  
 þat þanan bluod ęndi water · bêðju sprungun,  
 5710 wellun fan þero wundun, · all só is willjo gęng  
 ęndi hie habda gi·markod êr · manno kunnje,  
 5712 firiho barnon te frumu: · þuo was it all gi·fullid só.

TODO.

68 Só þuo gi·sęgid warð · sedle náhor  
 5714 hêdra sunna · mid heban·tunglon  
 an þem druoben dage, · þuo gęng im ęses drohtines þegan  
 5716 —was im glau gumo, · jungro Kristes  
 managa hwíla, · só it þár manno filo  
 5718 ne wissa te wáron, · hwand hie it mid is wordon hal  
 Judeono gum·skipje: · Joseph was hie hētan,  
 5720 darnungo was hie ęses drohtines jungro: · hie ni welda þero  
 far·duanun þiod

folgon te ênigon firin-werkon, · ak hie bêd im under þem  
 folke Judeono,  
 5722 hêlag himilo ríkjes— · hie géng im þuo wið þena hêri-togon  
 mahljan,  
 þingon wið þena þegan kêsures, · þigida ina gerno,  
 5724 þat hie muosti a·lôsjan · þena lík-hamon  
 Kristes fan þemo krúkje, · þie þár gi·kwêlmid stuod,  
 5726 þes guoden fan þem galgen · êndi an graf læggjan,  
 foldu bi·felahan. · Im ni welda þie folk-togo þuo  
 5728 wêrnjan þes willjen, · ak im gi·wald far·gaf,  
 þat hie só muosti gi·frummjan. · Hie gi·wêt im þuo forð  
 þanan  
 5730 gangan te þem galgen, · þár hie wissa þat godes barn,  
 hrêo hangondi · hêrren sínes,  
 5732 nam ina þuo an þero niuwun ruodun · êndi ina fan naglon  
 a·tuomda,  
 ant·fêng ina mid is faðmon, · só man is frôhon skal,  
 5734 liobes lík-hamon, · êndi ina an lîne bi·wand,  
 druog ina diur·liko · —só was þie drohtin werð—,  
 5736 þár sia þia stêdi habdun · an ênon stêne innan  
 handon gi·hauwan, · þár gio hêliðo barn  
 5738 gumon ne bi·gruobon. · Þár sia þat godes barn  
 te iro land·wísu, · líko hêlgost  
 5740 foldu bi·fulhun · êndi mid ênu felisu be·lukun  
 allaro grabo guod·likost. · Griotandi sátun  
 5742 idisi arm-skapana, · þia þat all for·sáwun,  
 þes gumen grimman dôð. · Gi·witun im þuo gangan þanan  
 5744 wópjandi wíf · êndi wara námun,  
 hwó sia eft te þem grabe · gangan mahtin:  
 5746 habdun im far·sewana · soroga gi·nuogja,  
 mikila muod·kara: · Maria wárun sia hêtana,  
 5748 idisi arm-skapana. · Þuo warð áband kuman,  
 naht mid neflu. · Níð-folk Judeono  
 5750 warð an morágan eft, · mênigi gi·samnod,  
 rêkidun an rúnun: · „Hwat þú wêst, hwó þit ríki was  
 5752 þuru þesan ênan man · all gi·twíflid,  
 werod gi·worran: · nú ligid hie wundon siok,  
 5754 diopa bi·dolban. · Hie sagda simnen, þat hie skoldi fan dôðe  
 a·standan





5794 pia liudi leggjan, · þuo sia þena lík-hamon þár  
 be·fulhun an þemo felise. · Só þiu frí haðdun  
 5796 ge·gangan te þem gardon, · þat sia te þem grabe mahtun  
 gi·sehan selbon, · þuo þár swógan kwam  
 engil þes alo-waldon · obana fan radure,  
 5798 faran an feðer-hamon, · þat all þiu folda an skian,  
 þiu erða dunida · ɛndi þia erlos wurðun  
 5800 an wêkan hugje, · wardos Juðeono,  
 bi·fellun bi þem forahton: · ne wándun ira ferah êgan,  
 5802<sup>a</sup> líf langerun hwíl.

TODO.

5802<sup>b</sup> 69 Lágun þá wardos,  
 pia gi·sīðos sám-kwika: · sán up a·hlâð  
 5804 þie grôto stên fan þem grabe, · só ina þie godes engil  
 gi·hweribida an halba, · ɛndi im uppan þem hlêwe gi·sat  
 5806 diur-lík drohtines bodo. · Hie was an is dádjon ge·lík,  
 an is an-siunjon, · só hwem só ina muosta undar is ôgon  
 skawon,  
 5808 só berɛht ɛndi só blíði · all só bliksmun lioht;  
 was im is gi·wádi · wintar-kaldon  
 5810 snêwe gi·líkost. · Þuo sáwun sia ina sittjan þár,  
 þiu wíf uppan þem gi·wendidan stêne, · ɛndi im fan þem  
 wlitje kwámun,  
 5812 þem idison su-líka egison te·gegnes: · all wurðun fan þem  
 grurje  
 þiu frí an forahton mikilon, · furðor ne gi·dorstun  
 5814 te þemo grabe gangan, · êr sia þie godes engil,  
 waldandes bodo · wordon gruotta,  
 5816 kwað þat hie iro ârundi · all bi·kunsti,  
 werk ɛndi willjon · ɛndi þero wíbo hugi,  
 5818 hiet þat sia im ne an·dréðin: · „ik wêt þat gí iuwan drohtin  
 suokat,  
 nɛrjendon Krist · fan Nazareth-burg,  
 5820 þena þi hier kwêlidun · ɛndi an krúki slógun  
 Judeo liudi · ɛndi an graf lagdun  
 5822 sundi-lôsjan. · Nú nist hie selbo hier,  
 ak hie ist a·standan iu, · ɛndi sind þesa stêði lárja,  
 5824 þit graf an þeson griote. · Nú mugun gí gangan herod

náhor mikilu · —ik wêt þat is iu ist niud sehan  
 5826 an þeson stêne innan—: · hier sind noh þia stędi skína,  
 þár is lík-hamo lag.“ · Lungra féngun  
 5828 gi·bada an iro brioston · bléka idisi,  
 wliiti-skôni wif: · was im wil-spell mikil  
 5830 te gi·hôrjanne, · þat im fan iro hêrren sagda  
 ęngil þes alo-walden. · Hiet sia eft þanan  
 5832 fan þem grabe gangan ęndi faran · te þem jungron Kristes,  
 sęggjan þem is gi·siðon · suoðon wordon,  
 5834 þat iro drohtin was · fan dōðe a-standan.  
 Hiet ôk an sundron · Símon Petruse  
 5836 will-spell mikil · wordon küðjan,  
 kumi drohtines, · gie þat Krist selbo  
 5838 was an Galileo land, · „þár ina eft is jungron skulun,  
 gi·sehan is gi·siðos, · só hie im êr selbo gi·sprak  
 5840 wárom wordon.“ · Reht só þuo þiu wif þanan  
 gangan weldun, · só stuodun im te·gegnes þár  
 5842 ęngilos twêna · an ala-hwiton  
 wánamon gi·wádjom · ęndi sprákun im mid iro wordon tuo  
 5844 hêlag-liko: · hugi warð gi·blôðid  
 þen idison an ęgison: · ne mahtun an þia ęngilos godes  
 5846 bi þemo wlite skawon: · was im þiu wánami te strang,  
 te swiði te sehanne. · Þuo sprákun im sán an·gegin  
 5848 waldandes bodun · ęndi þiu wif frágodun,  
 te hwí sia Kristan þarod · kwikan mid dōdon,  
 5850 suno drohtines · suokjan kwámin  
 ferāhes fullan; · „nú gí ina ni findat hier  
 5852 an þeson stên-grabe, · ak hie ist a·standan nú  
 an is lík-hamon: · þes gí gi·lôbjan skulun  
 5854 ęndi gi·huggjan þero wordo, · þe hie iu te wáron oft  
 selbo sagda, · þan hie an iuwon ge·siðja was  
 5856 an Galilea-lande, · hwó hie skoldi gi·geban werðan,  
 gi·sald selbo · an sundigaro manno,  
 5858 hęttjandero hand, · hêlag drohtin,  
 þat sea ina kwêlidin · ęndi an krúki slógin,  
 5860 dōdan gi·dádin · ęndi þat hie skoldi þuruh drohtines kraft  
 an þriddjon dage · þioda te willjan  
 5862 libbjandi a-standan. · Nú haþat hie all gi·lêstid só,  
 ge·frumid mid firihon: · íljat gí nú forð hinan,

5864 gangat gáh-líko · ɛndi duot it þem is jungron kũð.

TODO.

5847 im sán | so C; om. L

70 Hie haþat sia iu fur-farana · ɛndi ist im forð hinan  
 5866 an Galileo land, · þár ina eft is jungron skulun,  
 gi-sehan is ge-sĩðos.“ · Þuo warð sán after þiu  
 5868 þem wíbon an willjon, · þat sia gi-hórdun su-lík word sprekan,  
 kũðjan þia kraft godes · —wárun im só a-kumana þuo noh  
 5870 gie só forahta ge-frumida—: · gi-witun im forð þanan  
 fan þem grabe gangan · ɛndi sagdun þem jungron Kristes  
 5872 seld-lík gi-siuni, · þár sia sorogondi  
 bidun su-líkero buota. · Þuo wurðun ôk an þia burg kumana  
 5874 Judeono wardos, · þia obar þemo grabe sátun  
 alla langa naht · ɛndi þes lík-hamen þár,  
 5876 huodun þes hrêwes. · Sia sagdun þero hêri Judeono,  
 hwi-líka im þár and-warda · ɛgison kwámun,  
 5878 seld-lík gi-siuni, · sagdun mid wordon,  
 al só it gi-duan was · an þero drohtines kraft,  
 5880 ni miðun an iro muode. · Þuo budun im mēðmo filo  
 Judeo liudi, · gold ɛndi siluþar,  
 5882 saldun im sink manag, · te þiu þat sia it ni sagdin forð,  
 ne mǫridin þero mɛnigi: · „ak kweðat þat iu móði hugi  
 5884 an-swebidi mid slápu · ɛndi þat þár kwámin is gi-sĩðos tuo,  
 far-stálin ina an þem stêne. · Simnen wesat gí an stride mid  
 þiu,  
 5886 forð an flíte: · ef it wirðit þem folk-togen kũð,  
 wí gi-helpat iu wið þena hêrosten, · þat hie iu harmes wiht,  
 5888 lēðes ni gi-lēstid.“ · Þuo námun sia an þem liudon filo  
 diurero mēðmo, · dádun all só sia bi-gunnun  
 5890 —ne gi-weldun iro willjon— · dádun só wido kũð  
 þem liudon after þem lande, · þat sia su-líka lugina woldun  
 5892 a-hɛbbjan be þan hêlagan drohtin. · Þan was eft gi-hêlid hugi  
 jungron Kristes, · þuo sia gi-hórdun þiu guodun wíf  
 5894 mǫrjan þia maht godes; · þuo wárun sia an iro muode fráha,  
 gie im te þem grabe bēðja, · Johannes ɛndi Petrus  
 5896 runnun obast-líko: · warð êr kuman  
 Johannes þie guodo, · ɛndi im obar þem grabe gi-stuod,  
 5898 ant-at þár sán after kwam · Símon Petrus,

- 5900 *erl ęllan-ruof · ęndi im þár in gi-wêt*  
 an þat graf gagan: · gi-sah þár þes godes barnes,  
 hrêo-gi-wádi · hêrren sines  
 5902 *linin liggjan, · mid þiu was êr þie lík-hamo*  
*fagaro bi-fangan; · lag þie fano sundar,*  
 5904 mit þem was þat hôbid bi-helid · hêlages Kristes,  
 ríkjes drohtines, · þan hie an þesaro rastu was.  
 5906 Þuo géng im ôk Johannes · an þat graf innan  
 sehan seld-lík þing; · warð im sán after þiu  
 5908 ant-lokan is gi-lôbo, · þat hie wissa, þat skolda eft an þit lioht  
 kuman  
 is drohtin diur-líko, · fan dôðe a-standan  
 5910 up fan erðu. · Þuo gi-witun im eft þanan  
 Johannes ęndi Petrus, · ęndi kwámun þia jungron Kristes,  
 5912 þia gi-sīðos te-samne. · Þan stuod sêrag-muod  
 ên þera idiso · ôðer-sīðu  
 5914 griotandi oþar þem grabe, · was iro jámar muod—  
 Maria was þat Magdalena—, · was iro muod-gi-þáht,  
 5916 seþo mit sorogon gi-blandan, · ne wissa hwárod siu sókjan  
 skolda  
 þena hêrron, þár iro wárun at þia helpa gi-langa. · Siu ni  
 mohta þuo hofnu a-wísan,  
 5918 þat wíf ni mahta wóp for-látan: · ne wissa hwárod siu sia  
 wëndjan skolda;  
 gi-męrrid wárun iro þes muod-gi-þáhti. · Þuo gi-sah siu þena  
 mahtigan þár  
 5920 *Kriste standan,* · þuoh siu ina kũð-líko  
 ant-kęnnjan ni mohti, · êr þan hie ina kũðjan welda,  
 sęggjan þat hie it selþo wári. · Hie frágoda hwat siu só sêro  
 bi-wiepi,  
 5922 só harmo mid hêton trahnin. · Siu kwað, þat siu umbi iro  
 hêrron ni wissi  
 te wáren, hwárod hie werðan skoldi: · „ef þú ina mí gi-wísan  
 mohtis,  
 5924 frô mín, ef ik þik frágon gi-dorsti, · ef þú ina hier an þeson  
 felise gi-námis,  
 wísi ina mí mid wordon þinon: · þan wári mí allaro willjono  
 mēsta,

- 5926 þat ik ina selbo gi·sáhi.“ · Sia ni wissa, þat sia þie suno  
drohtines  
gruotta mid góðaro sprákun: · siu wánda þat it þie gardari  
wári,  
5928 hof·ward hêrren sínes. · Þuo gruotta sia þie hêlago drohtin,  
bi namen neřjendero beřt: · siu géng im þuo náhor sniumo,  
5930 þat wíf mid willjon guodan, · ant·keŋda iro waldand selban,  
míðan siu is þuru þia minnja ni wissa: · welda ina mid iro  
mundon grípan,  
5932 þiu fêhmja an þena folko drohtin, · noban þat iro friðu·barn  
godes  
weřida mid wordon sínon, · kwað þat siu ina mid wihti ni  
mósti  
5934 handon ant·hrínan: · „ik ni stêg noh“, kwaþ·hie, „te þem  
himiliskon fader;  
ak íli þú nú ofst·líko · ěndi þem erlon küði,  
5936 bruoðron mínon, · þat ik úser bêðero fader  
ala·waldan, · iuwan ěndi mínan  
5938 suoð·fastan god · suokjan willju.“

TODO.

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5867 sán | so L; om. C 5920' Kriste ... welda | Numbering follows Sievers (1878), who takes standan as part of 5919b and sees 5920 and 5920' as one line. 5920 Kriste standan | metr. emend.; rev. C

- 71 Þat wíf warð þuo an wunnon, · þat siu muosta su·líkan willjon  
küðjan,  
5940 seggjan fan im gi·sundon: · warð sán garo  
þiu idis an þat árunði · ěndi þem erlon bráhta,  
5942 will·spel weron, · þat siu waldand Krist  
gi·sundan gi·sáwi, · ěndi sagda hwo hé iru selbo gi·bôð  
5944 torohtero tékno. · Sia ni weldun gi·trúojan þuo noh  
þes wíbes wordon, · þat siu su·lík will·spel bráhte  
5946 gegnungo fan þemo godes suno, · ak sia sátun im  
jámor·muoda,  
hêliðos hriuwonda. · Þuo warð þie hêlago Krist  
5948 eft opan·líko · ôðer·siðu,  
drohtin gi·tôgid, · siðor hie fan dôðe a·stuod,  
5950 þan wíbon an willjon, · þat hie im þár an wege muotta.  
kwêdda sia küð·líko, · ěndi sia te is kneohon hnigun,

5952 fellun im tó fuoton. · Hie hét þat sia foráhtan hugi  
 ne bárin an iro brioston: · „ak gí mínon bruoðron skulun  
 5954 þesa kwidi kúðjan, · þat sia kuman after mí  
 an Galileo land; · þár ik im eft te gegnes biun.“  
 5956 Þan fuorun im ôk fan Jerusalem · þero jungrono twêna  
 an þem selbon daga · sán an morga,  
 5958 erlos an iro árunði: · weldun im te Emaus  
 þat kastel suokan. · Þuo bi-gunnun im kwidi managa  
 5960 under þem weron wahsan, · þár sia after þem wege fuorun,  
 þem hēliðon umbi iro hērron. · Þuo kwam im þár þie hēlago  
 tuo  
 5962 gangandi godes suno. · Sia ni mahtun ina garo-liko  
 ant-kennan kraftigna: · hie ni welda ina þuo noh kúðjan te im;  
 5964 was im þoh an iro gi-siðje samad · ęndi frágoda, umbi  
 hwi-lika sia saka sprákin:  
 „hwi gangat gí só gornondja?“ (kwaþ-hie;) „Ist ink jámer hugi,  
 5966 sebo soragono full.“ · Sia sprákin im sán an-gęgin,  
 þia erlos and-wurdi: · „te hwi þú þes ęskos só“, kwaðun sia;  
 5968 „bist þi fan Jerusalem · Judeono folkas  
 [...]“

TODO.

„[...] hēlagumu gēste · fan heþan-wange,  
 5970 mid þem grōtun godes kraft.“ · Nam is jungaron þó,  
 erlos góde, · lēdda sie út þanan,  
 5972 ant-tat hé sie bráhte · an Bethanía;  
 þár hóf hé is hęndi up · ęndi hēlegoda sie alle,  
 5974 wíhida sie mid is wordun. · Gi-wēt imo up þanan,  
 sóhta imo þat hōha himilo ríki · ęndi þena is hēlagon stól:  
 5976 sitit imo þár · an þea swíðron half godes,  
 alo-mahtiges fader · ęndi þanan all ge-sihit  
 5978 waldandjo Krist, · só hwat só þius wer-old be-habet.  
 Þó an þeru selbon stędi · ge-siðos góde  
 5980 te bedu fellun · ęndi im eft te burg þanan  
 þár te Jerusalem · jungaron Kristes  
 5982 fórun faganondi: · was im fráh-mód hugi,  
 wárun im þár at þemu wíhe. · Waldandes kraft  
 5984 [...]

TODO.

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5969–5983 hēlagumu ... kraft | *Only in M.* 5969 hēlagumu gēste · fan heban-wange | *Partly  
scraped off, but still just about readable.* 5984 [...] | *Four lines are scraped off and entirely illegible in  
M.*





# Old Saxon Genesis

**Dating:** C9th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The normalization follows that adapted for *Heli*. There is only one ms., Palatinus latinus 1447 (V, [https://digi.vatlib.it/view/MSS\\_Pal.lat.1447/0005](https://digi.vatlib.it/view/MSS_Pal.lat.1447/0005)), where the poem is found written on a few fragmentary pages between Latin theological texts. In this ms. a small fragment of the *Heli* is also found.

Much of the poem, including parts not extant in V, was closely translated into Old English and later inserted into an English poem on Genesis. The translation is called *Genesis B*, and will be edited below. Lines 1–26 of the present poem correspond almost exactly with lines 791–817 of that poem.

## Text

## After the Fall

- 1 „Wela, þat þú nú, Éwa, habas,“ (kwad Adam,) „uþilo gi·marȳkot [V 1r/TODO]  
 2 unkaro selbaro síð. · Nú maht þú sehan þia swarton heþl  
 ginon grádaga; · nú þú sia grimman maht  
 4 hinana gi·hōrjan, · nis heþan-ríki  
 ge·lih̅k sulíkaro lógnum: · þit was alloro lando skōnjust,  
 6 þat wit hier þuruh unkas hērran þank · heþbjan muostun  
 þár þú þem ni hōrdís · þie unk þesan harām gi·ried,  
 8 þat wit waldandas · word far·brákun,  
 heþan-kuningas. · Nú wit hriwig mugon  
 10 sorogon for þem síða, · wand hé unk selþo gi·bōd,  
 þat wit unk su·lik wíti · wardon skoldin,  
 12 harāmo mēstan— · nú þwingit mí giu hungar endi þrust,  
 bitter balo-werēk, · þero wáron wit ēr bêðero tuom.  
 14 Hú skulun wit nu libbjan, · efto hú skulun wit an þesum  
 liahta wesan?  
 Nú hier hwílum wind kumit · westan efto ôstan,  
 16 sūðan efto nordan? · gi·swerēk upp dríbit,  
 kumit hagas skion · himile bi·tengi,  
 18 fērid ford an gi·mang · (þat is firinum kald):  
 hwílum þanne fan himile · hēto skínit,  
 20 blíkit þiu berāhto sunna: · wit hier þus bara standat,  
 un·wērid mid gi·wáði: · nis unk hier wiht bi·foran  
 22 ni te skadowa ni te skúra, · unk nis hier skattas wiht  
 te mēti gi·markot: · wit heþbjat unk gi·duan mahtigna god,  
 24 waldand wrēðan. · Te hwí skulun wit werdān nu?  
 Nu mag mí þat hreuwān, · þat ik is io bad heþan-ríkjan god,  
 26 waldand þ[...]

TODO.

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 2 sehan | sean V 10 unk | hunk V 11 unk | hunk V
 

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26 waldand þ[...]. The bottom part of V 1r has been trimmed, resulting in the loss of a few lines. For the continuation cf. *Genesis B* 817 ff., which translates this and the following lines.

## After Cain's slaying of Abel

2 Sīdoda im þuo te sēlidon, · habda im sundja gi·warāht  
bittra an is bruodar; · liet ina undar baka liggjan  
an ênam diapun dala · drôr-wóragana,  
4 líbas lōsan, · legar-bedd waran,  
guman an griata. · Þuo sprak im god selbo tuo,  
6 waldand mid is wordun · (was im wrêd an is hugi,  
þem banan gi·bolgan), · frágoda hwar he habdi is bródar þuo  
8 kind-jungan guman. · Þó sprak im eft Kain an·gegen  
-habda im mid is handun · harām-werēk mikil  
10 wam-dádjun gi·warāht, · þius werold was só swído  
be·smitin an sundjun-: · „Ni ik þes sorogun ni skal,“ kwad he,  
12 „gômjan hwar hie ganga, · ni it mi god ni gi·bôd,  
þat is hwērgin hier · huodjan þorofti,  
14 wardon an þesaro weroldi.“ · Wānde he swído,  
þat he bi·helan mahti · hêrran sīnum,  
16 þia dádi bi·dērnjan. · Þuo sprak im eft ūsa drohtin tuo:  
„All habas þu só gi·werēkot,“ (kwad he,) „só þi ti þínaro wer-oldi  
mag  
18 wesan þín hugi hriuwig, · þes þu mid þínum handon gi·dedos,  
þat þú wurdi þínes bruodar bano: · nu he bluodig litit,  
20 wundun wórig; · þes ni habda he êniga ge·wurūhte te þi,  
sundja gi·suohta, · þoh þu ina nu a·slagan hēbbjas,  
22 dōdan gi·duanan. · Is drôr sinkit nu an erda,  
swêt sundar litit; · þiu seola hwaroþat  
24 þie gēst gǵamar-muod · an godas willjan;  
drôr hruopit is te drohtina selbun · endi sagat hwe þea dádi  
frumida,  
26 þat mēn an þesun middil-gardun: · ni mag im ênig mann þan  
swídor  
wero far·wirīkjan · an werold-ríkja  
28 an bittron balo-dádjon, · þan þú an þínum bruodar habas  
firin-werēk gi·frēmīd.“ · Þuo an forāhtun ward  
30 Kain aftar þem kwidjun drohtinas, · kwad þat hie wisse garwo,  
þat is ni mahti werdan waldand wiht, · an werold-stundu  
32 dádjo bi·dērnīd, · „só ik is nu mag drubundjan hugi,“ kwad he,  
„beran an mínun breostun · þes ik mínan bruodar sluog  
34 þuru mín hand-mēgin. · Nu wēt ik, þat ik skal an þínum hēti  
libbjan,  
ford an þínum fiund-skēpi, · nu ik mí þesa firina gi·deda,

- 36 só mí mína **sundja** nu · **swí**darón þunkjat,  
 mis-dád **mêra**, · þan þín **mildi** hugi,  
 38 só ik þes nu **wirdig** ni bium, · **waldand** þie guodo,  
 þat þú mí a-látas · **lêdas** þingas,  
 40 tianono a-tuemjas. · Nu ik ni welda mína **triuwa** haldan,  
 hugi wid þem þínum **hlutron** muoda, · nu wêt ik, þat ik hier  
 ni mag êniga **hwíla** libbjan,  
 42 hwand mí ant-**wirikit**, · só hwat só mi an þisun **wega** findit,  
 a-slēhit mi bi þesun **sundjun**.“ · Þuo sprak im eft **selbo**  
 an-gëgin  
 44 hebanes waldand: · „Hier skalt þu noh nu“, kwad he,  
 „libbjan **lango** hwíla. · Þo þu sus a-lêdit sís,  
 46 mid **fírinum** bi-fangan, · þoh will ik þi **friðu** settjan,  
 tōgjan su-lik **têkjan**, · só þu an **treuwa** maht  
 48 **wesan** an þesero **werolde**, · þoh þu is **wirdik** ni sís:  
**fluhtik** skalt þu þoh endi **frêdig** · **ford**-wardas nu  
 50 libbjan an þesum **landa**, · só **lango** só þu þit **liaht** waros;  
 for-**hwátan** skulun þi **hluttra** liudi, · þu ni salt io **furður**  
 kuman te þínes **hêrron** spráko,  
 52 **wesljan** þár mid **wordon** þínon: · **waldandi** stêt  
 þínes **bróðor** wráka · **bitter** an hëlli.“

TODO.

- 54 Þó géng im þanan mid **grimmo** hugi, · habda ina **god** selbo [V 2v/TODO]  
 swído far-sakanan. · **Sorōga** warð þár þuo gi-kúdit  
 56 **Adama** endi **Ēwun**, · in-widd mikil,  
 iro **kindes** **kwalm**, · þat he ni muosta **kwik** libbjan.  
 58 Þes ward **Adamas** hugi · **innan** breostun  
 swído an **sorogun**, · þuo he wissa is **sunu** dōdan:  
 60 só ward is ôk þiu **muodar**, · þe þana **magu** fuodda,  
 barn bi iro **breostun**. · Þuo siu **bluodag** wuosk  
 62 **hrêu-gi-wádi**, · þuo ward iro **hugi** sêrag.  
**Bêpo** was im þó an **sorogun** · iak iro **barnas** dōd,  
 64 þes **hëlliðas** **hin**-fard, · iak þat im mid is **handun** for-dæda  
**Kain** an su-likun **kwalma**: · siu ni habdun þuo noh **kindo** þan  
 mêt  
 66 **libbendero** an þem **liahta**, · botan þana ênna, þie þuo a-lêdit  
 was

- waldanda be is far·wurōhtjun: · þár ni habdun siu êniga  
 wunja tuo
- 68 niud-líko gi·numan, · wand hie su-likan níd a-huof,  
 þat he ward is bruodar bano. · Þes im þuo bêðjun ward,
- 70 sin-híun twêm · sêr umbi herta.  
 Oft siu þes gornunde · an griata gi-stuodun,
- 72 sin-híun samad, · kwádun, þat sia wissin, þat im þat iro sundja  
 gi-dedin,  
 þat im ni muostin aftar · ęrebi-wardos
- 74 þegnas þían. · Þolodun siu bêðju  
 mikila mord-kwála, · unt þat im ęft mahtig god,
- 76 hêr hebanes ward · iro hugi buotta,  
 þat im wurðun ôdana · ęrebi-wardos,
- 78 þegnos endi þiornun, · þigun aftar wel,  
 wóhsun wán-líko, · ge·witt línodun,
- 80 spáha spráka. · Spuodda þie mahta  
 is hand-gi-wereċ, · hêlag drohtin,
- 82 þat im ward sunu gi·boran; · þem skuopun siu Seð te naman  
 wárom wordum: · þem wastom lêh
- 84 hebanas waldand · endi hugi guodan,  
 gam-likan gang · -he was goda wirðig;
- 86 mildi was hie im an is muoda. · Só þana is manno wel,  
 þie io mið su-likaro huldi muot · hêrron þionun.
- 88 Hie loboda þuo mêst · liodjo barnun,  
 godas huldi: · gumun þanan kwámun
- 90 guoda mann, · . . . . .  
 wordun wísa, · ge·witt línodun,
- 92 þegnos gi·þáhte · endi þigun aftar wel.  
 Þann kwámun ęft fan Kaina · kraftaga liudi,
- 94 hêlidos hard-muoda, · habdun im hugi strangan,  
 wrêdan willjan, · wí weldun waldandas
- 96 lêra lêstjan, · ak habdun im lêdan stríd;  
 wuohsun im wrisi-líko: · þat was þiu wírsa gi-burd,
- 98 kuman fan Kaina. · Bi-gunnun im kôpun þuo  
 weros wíb undor twisk: · þas ward a·werðit sán
- 100 Seðas ge·sídi, · warð seggjo folk  
 mênú gi·mengid · endi wurðun manno barn,
- 102 liudi lêða, · þem þitt lioht gi-skuop,  
 botan þat iro ên habda · erlas gi·hugdi,

- 104 began-líka gi·þáht; · was im gi·þungin mann,  
 wís endi word-spáh, · habda gi·witt mikil:  
 106 Enokh was hie hêtan. · Þie hier an erðu warð  
 mannum te mārðum · obar þesan middil-garð,  
 108 þat ina hier só kwikana · kuningo þie þetsto,  
 libbendjan an is lík-haman, · só hie io an þesun liahta ni staraf  
 -  
 110 ak só gi·haloda ina hier · hebanas waldand  
 endi ina þár gi·setta, · þár hie simlon muot  
 112 wesan an wunnjon, · untat ina eft an þesa werold sendit  
 hêr hebanas ward · hēliðo barnum,  
 114 liodjun te léro. · Þann hier ôk þie lêdo kumit,  
 þat hier Anti-krist · alla þioda,  
 116 werod a·werðit, · þann he mid wápnu skal  
 werðan Enokha te banon, · eggjun skarapun  
 118 þuruh is hand-megin; · hwirþit þiu sêola,  
 þie gêst an guodan weg, · endi godas engil kumit,  
 120 wrikit ina, wamm-skaðon · wápnas eggjun:  
 wirðit Anti-krist · aldru bi·lôsid,  
 122 þie fiund bi·fēllid. · Folk wirðit eft gi·hworþan  
 te godas ríkja, · gumuno gi·sīði  
 124 langa hwila, · endi stéd im sídor þit land gi·sund.

TODO.

54 Þó | Introduced with large initial. 81 drohtin | Here the poem ends on fol. 2v; it picks back up on fol. 10v. 122 bi·fēllid | biuēllid V

## The Destruction of Sodom

- 3 Þuo habdun im eft só swiðo · Sodomo-liudi,  
 2 weros só far·werkot, · þat im was usa waldand gram,  
 mahtig drohtin, · wand sia mên dribun,  
 4 frēmidun firin-dádi, · habdun im só vilu fiunda barn  
 wammas ge·wísid: · þuo ni welda þat waldand god,  
 6 þiadan þolojan, · ak hiet sie þrea faran,  
 is engelos ôstan · an is árundi,  
 8 sīðon te Sodoma, · endi was im selbo þár mið.  
 Þuo sea obar Mambra · mahtige fuorun,  
 10 þuo fundun sia Abrahama · bi ênum ala standan,

[V 2r/1]

waran enna wið-stæði, · endi skolda úsas waldandas  
 geld gi-frummjan, · endi skolda þár goda þeonan  
 an middjan dag · manna þie bætsto.  
 Þuo ant-kenda hé kraft godas, · só he sea kuman gi-sakh:  
 géng im þuo ti-gegnes · endi goda selbun hnêg,  
 bôg endi bedode · endi bad gerno,  
 þat hie is huldi forð · hëbbjan muosti:  
 „warod wil þu nu, · waldand, frô mín,  
 alo-mahtig fadar? · ik biun þín êgan skalk,  
 hold endi gi-hôrig; · þú bist mí hêrro só guod,  
 mēðmo só mildi: · wil þu mínas wiht,  
 drohtin, hëbbjan? · Hwat, it all an þinum duoma stéd,  
 ik libbjo bi þinum lêhene, · endi ik gi-lôbi an þi,  
 frô mín þe guoda: · muot ik þi frágon nu,  
 warod þu sigi-drohtin · sîðon willjas?“  
 Þuo kwam im eft te-gegnes · godas and-wordi,  
 mahtig muotta: · „Ni willi ik is þi mîðan nu,“ kwað he,  
 „helan holdan man, · hú mín hugi gengit.  
 Sîðan skulun wí sūðar hinan: · hëbbjat him umbi  
 Sodomaland  
 weros só for-werkot. · Nú hruopat þæx wardas te mí  
 dages endi nahtes, · þe þe iro dádi tēlljat,  
 sēggjat hiro sundjon. · Nú willi ik selbo witan,  
 ef þia mann under him · su-lik mēn frēmmtat,  
 weros wam-dádi. · Þanna skal sea wallande  
 fiur bi-vallan, · skulun sia hira firin-sundjon  
 swára bi-senkjan: · swebal fan himile  
 fallit mid fiure, · fēknja stereþat,  
 mēn-dádige mēn, · reht só morgan kumit.“  
 Abraham þuo gi-mahalda · (habda im ēlljan guod,  
 wísa word-kwidi), · endi wiðer is waldand sprak:  
 „Hwat, þú gódas só vilu,“ (kwað hie, „god heþan-ríki,  
 drohtin gi-duomis, · all bi þinum dádjun stéd  
 þius werold an þinum willjan; · þu gi-wald hábas  
 oþar þesan middil-gard · manna kunnjas,  
 só þat gio werðan ni skal, · waldand frô mín,  
 þat þú þár te ênum duogas · ubila endi guoda,  
 lioba endi lêða, · wand sia gi-líka ni sind.  
 Þu ruomes só rehtæs, · ríki drohtin,

só þu ni wili, þat þár ant·geldan · guod-willige mann  
 50 wam-skaðono werek, · þoh þu is gi·wald habes  
 te gi·frummjanna. · Muot ik þi frágon nu,  
 52 só þú mí þiu gramara ni sís, · god heban-ríki?  
 ef þú þár fíðis fíftig · ferāhtaro manno,  
 54 liubigaro liodo, · muot þanna þat land gi·sund,  
 waldand, an þinum willjan · gi·wērid standan?“  
 56 Þuo kwam im eft te·gegnes · godas and·wordi:  
 „Ef ik þár findo fíftig,“ (kwað he,) „ferāhtara manno,  
 58 guodaro gumono, · þea te goda hebbjan  
 fasto gi·fangan, · þanna willi ik im iro ferāh far·geban  
 60 þuru þat ik þea hluttron man · haldan wille.“  
 Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · āðar sīðe,  
 62 forð frágoda · frāhon sínan:  
 „Hwat duos þu is þanna,“ (kwað he,) „drohtin frô mín,  
 64 ef þu þár þritig maht · þegno fíðan,  
 wam-lôsa weros? · wil þu sia noh þanna  
 66 látan te líba, · þat sia muotin þat land waran?“  
 Þuo im þe guoda, · god heban-ríki,  
 68 sniumo gi·sagda, · þat hie só weldi  
 lēstjan an þen landa: · „Ef ik þár lubigaro mahg,“ kwað he,  
 70 „þritig undar þero þiodo · þegno fíðan  
 god-forōhta gumon: · þanna willi ik im far·geban allum  
 72 þat mēn endi þea mis-dád · endi látan þat manno folk  
 sittjan umbi Sodoma · endi ge·sund wesan.“  
 74 Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · agalēt-líko  
 -folgoda is frôjan-, · filo worda gi·sprak:  
 76 „Nu skal ik is þi biddjan“, (kwað he,) „þat þú þi ni belges ti mí,  
 frô mín þie guoda, · hú ik sus filu mahlja,  
 78 weslja wiðer þi mid mínum wordum: · ik wēt, þat ik þas  
 wirðig ni bium  
 ni sí þat þu it willjas bi þínaro guodi, · god heban-ríki  
 80 þiadan, gi·þolojan: · mí is þarāf mikil  
 te witanna þínne willjan, · hweðer þat werad gi·sund  
 82 libbjan muoti, · þe sea liggjan skulun,  
 fēgja bi·vallon: · hwat wilis þu is þanna, frô mín, duoan,  
 84 ef þu þár tehani · treu-hafte maht  
 fíðan under þemo folka ferāhtera manno · wil þu im þanna  
 hiro ferh far·geban,



86 þat sia umbi Sodomaland · sittjan muotin  
 búan an þem burugjum, · só þu im a·bolgan ni sís?“  
 88 Þuo kwam im eft te·gernes · godas and·wordi:  
 „Ef ik þár tehani,“ (kwað he,) „treu·haftera mag  
 90 an þem lande noh · liodjo fiðan,  
 þanna látu ik sia alla þuru þie feræhtun man · feræhas brúkan.“  
 92 Þuo ni dorste Abraham leng · drohtin sinan  
 furðour frágon, · ak hé fell im after te bedu  
 94 an kneo kraftag, · kwað hé gerno  
 is geld geŕewedi · endi gode þeonodi,  
 96 waræhti after is willjan. · Gi·wêt im eft þanan  
 gangan te is geŕst·seli; · godes engilos fort  
 98 siðodun te Sodomā, · so im selbo ge·bôd  
 waldand mid is wordo, · þuo hie sea hiet an þana weg faran.

TODO.

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30 þeæ wardas | þe æuuardas V 46 ênum | henum V 93 ak | hak ms.

100 Skoldun sie be·fiðan, · hwat þár feræhtera  
 umbi Sodomaburg, · sundjono tuomera  
 102 manna wári, · þie ni habdin mènes filu,  
 firin·werko gi·frumid. · Þó gi·hórdun siæ fêgero karm  
 104 an allaro se·liðu gi·hwen, · sundiga liudi  
 firin·werk fræmmjan: · was þár fiundo gi·mang,  
 106 wrêðaro wihtjo, · þea an þat wam habdun  
 þea liudi far·lêdid: · þat lôn was þuo hat handum  
 108 mikil mið morðu, · þat sia oft mên dribun.  
 Þanna sat im þár an innan · aðal·burdig man,  
 110 Loth mið þem liudjum, · þie oft lof godas  
 waræhte an þesaro weroldi: · habda im þár welono gi·nuog,  
 112 guodas gi·wunnan: · he was gode wirðig.  
 He was Abrahamas · aðali·knóslas,  
 114 his bróðer barn: · ni was bætara man  
 umbi Giordanas staðos · mið gum·kustjum,  
 116 gi·wërid mið ge·wittjo: · him was úsa waldand hold.  
 Þuo te sedla hnég · sunna þiu hwíta,  
 118 alloro bókno beræhtost, · þuo stuond hie fore þes buruges dore.  
 Þuo gi·sah hé an áband · engilos twêne  
 120 gangan an þea gardos, · só sea fan gode kwámun

[V 2r/36]

ge·wēride mid ge·wittjo; · þuo sprak he im sán mid is wordum  
tuó.

- 122 Géng þuo te·gegnes · endi gode þankade,  
heban-kuninga, · þes hé im þea helpa fer·lélkh,  
124 þat he muosta sea mið is ôgum · an luokojan,  
iak he sea an kneo kusta · endi kúsko bad,  
126 þat sea suohtin his sēliða: · kwað þat he im selbas duom  
gáu su·líkas guodas, · só im god habdi  
128 far·liwen an þem landa: · sea ni wurðun te lata hwęgin,  
ak se gengun im an is gęst-sēli, · endi he im giungar-duom  
130 frēmide ferāht-líka, · sea im filo sagdun  
wáraro wordu. · Þár he an wahtu sat,  
132 held is hērran bodan · hēlag-líka,  
godas engilos. · Sia him guodas só filo,  
134 suôðas gi·sagdun. · Swart furðour skrêð,  
narowa naht an skion, · náhida moragan  
136 an allara sēliða gi·hwem. · Uht-fugal sang  
fora daga-hruoma. · Þó habdun úsas drohtinas bodon  
138 þea firina bi·fundan, · þea þár frēmidun mēn  
umbi Sodoma-burug. · Þó sagdun sia Loða,  
140 þat þár morð mikil · manno barno,  
skolda þera liodjo werðan · endi ôk þes landas só samo.  
142 Hietun ina þuo gęrewjan, · endi hietun þó gangan þanan,  
firrjan hina fon þem fiundum · endi lēðjan is frí mið him,  
144 idis aðal-borana. · He ni habda þár his aðaljas þan mēr,  
botan is dohtar twá, · mid þem gi·hietun sie, þat hie êr daga  
wári
- 146 an ênum berga uppan, · þat hina brinnandi  
fiur ni bi·vengi. · Þó he te þere ferði warð  
148 gāhun gi·gęrewid, · gengun engilos,  
habdun hina bi handum · heban-kuningas bodon,  
150 lēddun hina endi lērdun · lango hwíla,  
untat sea ina gi·bráhtun · bi þera burug útan.  
152 Hietun, þat sia io ni ge·hōrdin · sulik ge·hlunn mikil  
brakon an þem burugjum, · þat sia io under bak sáwen,  
154 an þiu þie sea an þem landæ · libbjan weldin.  
Þuo þwurubun eft wiðer · hēlega wardos,  
156 godas engilos, · gengun sniumo,  
sīðodun te Sodomō: · þanan sūðar fuor

158 Loth þoro hira lêra, · flôh þera liodjo gi-mang,  
 dēreþjoro manno: · þó warð dag kuman.  
 160 Þuo warð þár gi-hlunn mikil · himile bi-tengi,  
 brast endi brakoda, · warð þero buruġjo gi-hwilik  
 162 rôkas gi-fullit, · warð þár fan radura só vilu  
 fiures gi-fallin, · warð fêgero karm,  
 164 lêðaro liodjo: · logna all bi-ueng  
 brêd buruġu-gi-setu: · bran all samað,  
 166 stên endi erða, · endi só manag strîdin man  
 swultun endi sunkun: · swebal brinnandi  
 168 wel after wîkjom; · waragas þolodun  
 lêðas lôn-geld. · þat land inn bi-sank,  
 170 þiu erða an af-grundi; · al warð far-spildit  
 Sodoma-rîki, · þat is ênig sēg ni gi-nas,  
 172 iak só bi-dôðit an dôð-sêu, · so it noh te daga stēndit  
 fluodas gi-fullit. · Þuo habdun hiro firin-dâdi  
 174 all Sodomo-þiod · sêro ant-goldan,  
 botan þat þár iro ênna · út ent-lêdde  
 176 waldand an is willjan · endi þiu wif mid im,  
 þriu mið þem þegna. · Þó gi-hôrdun sea þero þiodo kwalm,  
 178 buruġi brinnan. · Þó þár under bak bi-sakh  
 idis aðal-boren · —siu ni welde þera engilo  
 180 lêra lêstjan; · þat was Lohthas brúd,  
 þan lang þe siu an þem landa · libbjan muosta—  
 182 þuo siu an þem berega gi-stuod · endi under bak bi-sakh,  
 þuo warð siu te stêne, · þár siu standan skal  
 184 mannum te mârðu · oþar middil-gard  
 after te êwan-dage, · só lango só þius erða lêbot.

TODO.

100 Skoldun | *Introduced by large initial.* 100 hwat þár | huattar V 119 áband | haband V 137  
 daga-hruoma | *emend.*; 'daga huom' V 141 werðan | 'huuerthan' V 144 aðaljas | 'hadalias'  
 V 155 hwurubun | *metr. emend.*; uurubun V 185 lêbot. | *add. EXPL V*

185 lêbot. | The *EXPL* in the ms. stands for 'explicit', customarily placed at the end of a text in  
 mediaeval mss. This line also serves as a fitting conclusion to the poem.



# Wessobrunn Hymn

**Dating:** late C8th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

### Textual preservation and transmission

The so-called **Wessobrunn Hymn** (abbrev. *Wessobrunn*) is found on foll. 65v–66r of the Bavarian ms. BSB Clm 22053 (henceforth known as 22053), previously located at the Wessobrunn abbey in Upper Bavaria. 22053 consists of 100 foll. containing a number of Latin texts dealing with varied themes, including theology, chronology, geography, and Latin-German glosses. On the basis of a note on 99v mentioning the death of Charlemagne (748–814), 22053 is dated to ca. 814 AD or some years before. *Wessobrunn* is written in the same uncial hand as the rest of the ms., and is therefore not marginalia. (Bierbrauer 1990, pp. 83–84).

## Contents

*Wessobrunn* is introduced by the Latin heading *De poeta* ‘By the poet’. The text itself is divided by the scribe into three sections, each introduced by a capital letter adorned with dots of red ink. The first two sections are poetic (‘the poem’), and the third is in prose (‘the prayer’)

The poem consists of 9 long-lines in alliterative meter, detailing the earliest beginning of the world. The first 5 lines describe “the greatest of wonders”, namely that the universe was once void, without earth or heaven, wood or mountain, sun or moon or sea. These lines are very similar to pre-Christian Norse stanzas about the creation of the world, and in fact contain formulaic word-pairs also found in those stanzas (see notes to ll. 2, 3), suggesting a repurposing of older Heathen motifs and expressions in the new, Christian context. With this in mind, we see that the latter 4 lines constitute a subversion of the earlier Heathen tradition, for they place into this early emptiness the Almighty God, Jesus Christ, and His many ghosts—presumably the Heavenly Host or the Angels. This is the Christian creation *ex nihilo*,

rather than the Indo-European creation *ex materia* through sacrifice of a primordial being (cf. *Vaff* 21, *Grm* 41–42). The prayer is in prose. The author first thanks God for creating the earth and heaven—this is presumably why the poem was included—and for giving boons to mankind. He then asks for faith, strength, and wisdom to help him in his mission.

### Language

TODO: Krogmann (1937).

### Dating

Since *Wessobrunn* is not marginalia the *terminus ante quem* of its composition is 814 AD. However, on the basis of the evidently poor preservation of the poem (ll. 3–4) it is unlikely that the scribe of 22053 is the direct author of *Wessobrunn*; the title *De poeta* ‘By the poet’ also suggests that the scribe was not, in fact, the poet. With this in mind we are probably dealing with an older composition, allowing us to push the date back to the late 8th century.

## Text

T1 De poeta  
Regarding the Poet.

1 poeta ‘the Poet’ | This word has traditionally been interpreted as ‘the Creator’, viz. God. TODO.

- 1 Dat ga·f̥rēgin ih mit fir̥ahim · firi-wizzo mēsta,  
2 dat erdo ni was · noh úf-himil  
noh paum · noh perek ni was  
4 ni [...] nohh-ēinig · noh sunna ni skēin  
noh máno ni liuhtha · noh der márjo sēo.

I HAVE LEARNT AMONG MEN that greatest of wonders,  
that Earth was not, nor Up-heaven  
nor wood, nor was there mountain.  
No [...] did [...], nor did the sun shine,  
nor the moon give off light nor the famous sea.

1 Dat | *The D is a large capital decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053 1 ga·f̥rēgin | ga- abbrev. by the rune-like symbol ꝥ. This symbol is used for all other occurrences of ga- in the present text except for ga·náda and ga·laupa in P1 below. 2 erdo | ero 22053 4 skēin | emend. after Grienberger (1921, p. 237), who notes that the ft-ligature here is slightly different than at other places in the text, reflecting original \*f̥c; ‘f̥cin’ 22053

1 Dat ga·f̥rēgin ih mit fir̥ahim · firi-wizzo mēsta ‘I have learned among men this greatest of wonders’ | A formulaic opening to a Germanic poem, expressing that the narrating poet’s knowledge of the events described is reportative. For other parallels see note to *Gbu* 1/1, which contains a word-for-word cognate expression. — *ga·f̥rēgin ih* ‘I have learned’ has often been taken as an (Anglo-)Saxonism on the basis of the vowel *e* for the expected \**a* (cf. poetic OE *gi·f̥raēgn iē* ‘id.’, OS *gi·f̥raēgn ik*). This would discredit the present OHG attestation of the formula, since it would be a borrowing rather than a native reflex. However, Krogmann (1937, pp. 144–145) irrefutably demonstrates that the vowel quality is in fact the result of a well-attested OHG development where the following *ih* ‘I’ induces *i*-umlaut in the preceding verb \**ga·f̥rag(i)n*; note that *-i-* is a svarabhakti vowel. The formula is therefore native, and the expression is thus found in all four Germanic alliterative poetic traditions: ON, OE, OS, and OHG.

1 fir̥ahim ‘men’ | Dat. of *fir̥(a)ha*, a plurale tantum poetic synonym for ‘men, people’ found throughout the Old Germanic languages. See *Hild* 10 n. for etymology and distribution.

2 erdo ... úf-himil ‘Earth ... Up-heaven’ | A formulaic merism attested in OHG, OS, OE, and ON; it expresses the totality of the universe and is usually used in the context of the creation or destruction of the world. For its use in creation cf. esp. *Vsp* 3/3, where it is said, about the time before the World existed, that “Earth and Up-heaven were never found” and *Vafþ* 21, where the god Woden asks the etrin Webthrinthner about the origin of “Earth and Up-heaven”. For a list of occurrences see Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

2 erdo | The ms. form *ero* has been interpreted in a variety of ways, usually as a m. *wan*-stem derived from the same root as the more common synonym \**erþō* ‘earth’. This is however problematic, since the expected form in that case would be \**er(a)wo* (EWA, s.v. *ero*). The present emendation is based on the formulaic nature of the merism (see other note), but also has problems, since the regular final vowel of *erda* ‘earth’ in OHG is *-a*, not *-o* (EWA, s.v. *ero*).

3 *paum ... perek* ‘wood ... mountain’ | The same word-pair is found in *Musp* 50, describing the Christian destruction of the world prior to the Judgment. It is also found in ON in *Grm* 41/3, describing the pre-Christian creation of the world from Yimer’s body by the Gods. — The line is clearly defective; *nob paum* is not a metrically acceptable a-verse.

4 *ni [...]* ‘No [...] did [...]’ | No gap is marked in 22053 but the negative *ni* implies a following verb, so the missing text here should be a verb and a subject noun; if we were only missing a noun we would expect the preceding word *nob* ‘nor’ instead. The common emendation *\*sterro* ‘star’ falls since *st-* never alliterates with *s-* in Germanic poetry, not even in OHG.

- 6           Dó dár ni-wiht ni was · ęntjo ni węntjo,  
            ęnti dó was der ęino · al-mahtíko kot,  
8           manno miltisto, · ęnti dar wárun auh manaké mit inan  
            kót-líhhe gęista, · ęnti kot heilak.

Then there was no kind of end nor bound,  
and then there was the one Almighty God,  
the most giving of men, and there were also many  
glorious ghosts with Him, and Holy God.

---

6 Dó | *The D is a capital, smaller than the one in line 1, decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053

---

8 *manno miltisto* ‘the most giving of men’ | The expression refers to God in the form of Jesus, who is held to be coeternal with God the Father. Cf. *Heli* 338, et.c.: *allaro barno bętst* ‘best of all children’, Otfrid’s *Evangelienbuch* 1.22.43: *manno liobosta* ‘loveliest of all men’.

- P1           Kot al-mahtíko, dú himil ęnti erda ga-worahtós, ęnti dú mannun  
2           só manak kót for-gápi, for-gip mir in dína ga-náda rehta ga-laupa,  
            ęnti kótan willjon; wís-tóm ęnti spáhida ęnti kraft tiuflun za  
4           widar-stantanne, ęnti ark za pi-wísanne, ęnti dínan willjon za  
            ga-wurkhanne.

O God almighty! Thou wroughtest heaven and earth and Thou gavest men  
so much good. Give me in Thy mercy right belief and good will, wisdom and  
foresight and power, to withstand devils and to reproach queerness and to  
work thy will.

---

1 Kot | *Cot 22053; the C is a capital, smaller than the one in line 1, decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053



# Muspell

## (*Muspilli*)

**Dating:** C9th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Muspell** (*Musp*) is an Old High German Christian poem dealing with the Day of Judgment.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Musp* survives in a single copy, found scribbled in a Latin-language theological manuscript from the 820s AD with the signum BSB Clm 14098 (henceforth denoted as 14098). Lines 1–18a are found on fol. 61r while the rest of the poem is found on foll. 119v–121v. Foll. 61r and 120v–121v are blank, and on these the poem occupies the whole page; on foll. 119v–120r the main text is in Latin and the text of the German poem thus occupies the lower third of the page, below the main text.

From 61v–120r the main text of 14098 is a pseudo-Augustinian sermon, which ends on 120r with a dedication by the archbishop of Salzburg Ethelram (Latin *Adalrammus*) to the young duke Ludwigh (Latin *Hludowicus*, later Louis the German). It is important to note that the poem and main text are written in different hands. The hand of the poem is unsteady and not finely wrought, which may suggest that its author was not very used to writing; he may perhaps even have been Ludwigh himself. From the start on fol. 61r we can presume that the writer of the poem originally meant to write down just a part of it as marginalia, beginning on the back leaf (61r) of the already written sermon, and continuing on its last two leaves (119v–120r). When he ran out of space, he acquired another blank leaf, 121r–v. The abrupt ending of the poem may suggest that further blank leaves were also originally present.

Due to the low quality of the digitally available scans of the already very poorly preserved manuscript, the pres. ed. has had to rely partly on the text

found in the 17th edition of Braune's *Althochdeutsche Lesebuch* published in 1994.

## Content

*Musp* is a Catholic sermon that describes the events of the Judgment Day and advises its readers to do penance and give alms to assure their safety. The poem is not a masterpiece, and in the original at times comes off as stilted. Still, it has a certain charm, and its meter is notably regular when compared to the other comparable High German alliterative poems *Hild* and *Wessobrunn*.

## Relation to Otfrid

The use of end-rhymed Otfridian meter in ll. 60–61 suggests a relation between *Musp* and Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* (written 863–871 AD), something which is strongly supported by the exact correspondence between *Musp* 14 and *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9. Since there appears to be a relation between these two texts, we ought to try to determine the direction of influence. I believe that we may reasonably conclude on the basis of literary history and the internal metrical variation of the *Evangelienbuch* that the direction of influence is more likely to be from *Musp* to the *Evangelienbuch* rather than the reverse, and will lay out my argument as follows.

With the exception of a very small number of irregular, often alliterating lines found exclusively in the first book (e.g. 1.4.9, 1.5.5, 1.7.19, 1.7.27–28, 1.18.9; cf. 1.5.6, 1.5.10–12, 3.1.31–32 which combine alliteration with end-rhyme), the *Evangelienbuch* is fully end-rhymed. With the exception of 1.18.9 these lines are all found in the first fourth of the first book, which runs to 28 chapters. This distribution suggests that Otfrid was still finding his footing, as it were, and either borrowed older lines or experimented with compensating for a lack of rhyme with alliteration before deciding against it.

Of these lines, the only one that fully accords with Sieversian metrics is 1.18.9. This unusual regularity, along with its late relative position, points to the borrowing of 1.18.9 from another source. Even in his irregular non-rhyming lines, Otfrid does not follow the Sieversian rule of four positions, nor always the linking of alliteration between couplets; what is more, by the 18th chapter of book 1, he was comfortable enough with the end-rhymed meter not to need to insert an alliterative line of his own.

From the viewpoint of literary history, it would be highly unusual for a poet active in a clerical context after the success of the *Evangelienbuch* to still employ alliteration, especially when he was clearly familiar with the end-rhymed form as proven by ll. 60–61. The natural choice for such a writer would be to use end-rhyme throughout. Indeed, the *Evangelienbuch*, along with related works like the *Georgslied* and *Ludwigslied*, seems to have definitively put an end to the alliterative tradition as a whole in Germany, since no German alliterative poetry younger than the 9th century survives.

Moreover, while *Musp* 14 is a perfectly regular alliterative long-line, entirely unremarkable within the metrical context of *Musp*, its direct equivalent *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9 is, from the perspective of Otfridian meter, deficient. This again gives support to *Musp* being the giver, for it makes little sense for an alliterative poet working after Otfrid to borrow just that particular deficient line for his own work, whereas it makes much more sense for the end-rhyming poet Otfrid to borrow an older line from an alliterative work.

Another more archaic trait found in *Musp* is its use of originally pre-Christian expressions like the alliterative pair *poum*, *perga* (l. 50), *Mittila-gart* (l. 53), and *Mú-spell* (l. 56), none of which are found in Otfrid. It must, however, be said that these expressions, on their own, do not prove that *Musp* is the older poem. The archaic expressions could be argued simply to be a part of *Musp*'s more rustic style, use of alliteration, and less theologically informed content. Indeed, it is certainly plausible that a later poet more strongly anchored in vernacular tradition would retain archaic traits discarded by an earlier poet working in an Ecclesiastical milieu. However, when weighed together with the circumstances discussed above, these expressions do yield further support for *Musp* preceding Otfrid.

If *Musp* indeed is the older poem, there arises the question of how Otfrid would have come into contact with it. Yet, of the problems associated with the relation between the two texts, this one is perhaps the most easily answered, owing to a surprising historical circumstance. As shown by Haubrichs (1978, p. 406), several decades before Otfrid dedicated his *Evangelienbuch* to Ludwig the German in ca. 870 AD, he had spent a number of years as a scribe at Ludwig's court—the very same court where 14098 containing *Musp* must have been located after its dedication (see Textual preservation above).

We may then imagine the following scenario: In poring over the pseudo-Augustinian sermon contained in 14098, a young Otfrid would have discovered *Musp* written in the margins and, taken by its contents, put the poem to memory. When, as an old man, he set out to write his *Evangelienbuch* and arrived at the description of Paradise, he remembered, if not the whole *Muspilli*, at least this one evocative line—"There life is without death, light without darkness"—and included it.

### Language

The dialect of the poem is that of the southern High German area, most likely Bavaria, where Regensburg was the seat of Emperor Ludwig's government. This is seen by the consistent application of the most extensive form of the second sound shift, where *g*, *b*, *k* change to *k*, *p*, *kh*. That this sound change had occurred at the time of composition and is not merely a scribal feature is proven by the fact that Germanic roots originally beginning with *b* consistently alliterate with Latin borrowings beginning with *p*, namely in:

- l. 5: *pebbe* (< Latin *pix*) : *págant* (= ON *bága*),

- 1. 16: *pú* (= OS *bú*) : *pardísu* (< Latin *paradísus*),
- 1. 21: *piutit* (= OS *biudid*) : *pehbhes*, *pína* (< Latin *poena*),
- 1. 25: *prinnan* (= OS *brinnan*), *palw-* (= OS *baluw-*) : *pebbe*.

Interestingly, the alliteration also shows that the poet sporadically retained old *b-* before *l* (l. 72, but cf. 82), by extension almost certainly also before *r* and *n*, and probably also before *w* (l. 7). This sound is, however, consistently omitted by the scribe.

### Dating

Since the poem is marginalia (see Textual preservation), the dating of the manuscript can unfortunately only serve as a *terminus post quem* for the poem itself, viz. the 820s AD. The likely direction of influence on the *Evangelienbuch*, composed ca. 863–871 AD (see Contents) serves as a *terminus ante quem*. The poem was, therefore, most likely composed in Bavaria, sometime between 820 and 870 AD, though probably in the earlier part of that span.

### Summary

The poem begins with a description of the fate of the soul immediately after death (ll. 1–29). This is followed by a short sermon about the importance of doing good works before the Judgment (30–35). After this follows the description of the destruction of the world and Judgment Day. First comes the fight between Elijah and the Anti-Christ (36–49), then the burning of the world and the Muspell (50–61). The narrative is broken up by a second sermon warning against corruption by describing how the Devil keeps track of evil deeds to recount them at the Judgment (62–71). Next the Judgment itself begins: An angel blows a horn, and God and his angels are on the move (72–80); then the dead come back to life to be judged (81–84). They gather in a court before God and the angels (85–89). The poet stresses that all must become known at the Judgment, and even a man's own limbs will bear witness against him (90–96); the only way to avoid punishment is through good deeds on earth (97–100). After this, the Holy Cross is brought forth, and the poem abruptly ends (101–104).

## Text

Sín tak pi·kweme, · daz er touwan skal.  
 2 Hwanta sár só sih diu sêla · in den sind ar·hëvit,  
 ęnti sí den lîh-hamun · likkan lázzit,  
 4 só kwimit ęin hęri · fona himil-zungalon;  
 daz andar fona pehhe: · dár págant siu umpi.

HIS DAY WILL COME when he must die.  
 For as soon as the soul lifts itself on its way  
 and leaves the body behind to lie,  
 then comes an army from the heavenly stars,  
 the other from the Pitch; there they fight over it.

---

1 Sín tak pi·kweme, · daz er touwan skal 'His day will come when he must die.' | It is traditionally assumed that the beginning of the poem is incomplete, there originally being other lines before this one, but there is nothing in 14098 to suggest this. I find the opening line, with its generic *sín*, *er* 'his, he', rather powerful.

3 likkan lázzit | The double alliteration in the b-verse is unusual, but probably not due to any scribal corruption. Since the second word does not partake in regular alliteration, it has not been marked.

5 pehhe 'the Pitch' | The burning hellfire.

6 Sorgén mak diu sêla, · unzi diu suona ar·gét,  
 za bwederemo hęrje · si gi·halót werde.  
 8 Hwanta ipu sia daz Satanazses · ki·sindi ki·winnit,  
 daz lęitit sia sár · dár iru lęid wirdit,  
 10 in fuir ęnti in finstrí: · daz ist rehto virin-lih ding.

The soul must worry until the [time of] atonement begins  
 about which of the armies will receive it,  
 for if Satan's following wins it,  
 then it is soon led whither it must face torment,  
 into fire and darkness. That is surely a wicked thing.

---

7 bwederemo | 'wederemo' 14098

---

7 bwederemo | Restoration of the initial *b*- is not strictly required for the line to alliterate properly, but it is done on the basis of l. 72.

Upi sia \*avar ki·halónt die · die dár fona himile kwemant,  
 12 ęnti sí dero ęngilo · ęigan wirdit,  
 die pringent sia sár úf · in himilo rihi:  
 14 dár ist lip áno tód, · liobt áno finstrí,

sęłida áno sorgun: · dár n·ist neo-man siuh.

16

Denne der man in pardísu · pú ki·winnit,

hús in himile, · dár kwimit imo hilfa ki·nuok.

If, however, it is received by those who come from heaven  
and the angels are to have it for themselves,  
they soon bring it up into the realm of the heavens.  
There life is without death, light without darkness,  
happiness without sorrow; there no man is sick.  
When the man wins his dwelling in Paradise,  
his house in heaven, he will get help aplenty.

11 \*avar | 'hauar' 14098 14 liobt | 'lihot' 14098 14 finstri | 'finsti' 14098 15 sorgun | partly illegible in 14098 15 dár n·ist | emend.; illegible in 14098 16 pardísu | partly illegible in 14098

13 die pringent sia sár úf · in himilo rihi: | The line lacks alliteration, but no obvious emendation presents itself. On the basis of the occasional spelling of vowel-words with *b-*, suggesting confusion over that sound, it is possible that the alliteration should fall on *úf* and *'imilo*, but that is highly speculative.

14 dár ist líp áno tód, · liobt áno finstri 'There life is without death, light without darkness' | This line also appears in Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9, where it begins a description of Paradise, in the form: *Thár ist líb ána tód, · liobt ána finstri*. It is one of Otfrid's rhymeless lines where alliteration compensates for the expected end-rhyme. For the relevance of this shared line to the relation between *Musp* and *Evangelienbuch*, see Introduction above.

18

Pi·diu ist durft mihhil allero manno bwe-líhemo, · daz in es

sín muot ki·spane,

daz er kotes willun · kerno tue

20

ęnti hęlla fuir · harto wise,

pehhes pína: · dár piutit der Satanasz altist

22

hęzzan lauk. · Só mak hukkan za diu,

sorgén dráto, · der sih suntigen węiz.

Therefore it is most needful for every man that he persuade his heart  
that it might gladly do the will of God  
and stalwartly avoid the fire of Hell,  
the torture of the Pitch; there the oldest Satan offers  
hot flame. So he must think about that,  
worry greatly, whoever knows that he sins.

18 bwe-líhemo | end 61r, the text continues on 119v. 19 tue | metr. and gramm. emend.; tuo 14098

21 der Satanasz altist 'the oldest Satan' | Not a reference to any specific 'Satan' but rather denoting Satan as the primeval, ancient enemy of God.

24

Wê demo in vinstrí skal · síno viriná stuén,

prinnan in pehhe: · daz ist rehto palwík dink,

- 26 daz der man **harét** ze gote · **ę**nti imo **hilfa** ni kwimit.  
**W**ánit sih ki·náda · diu **w**ênaga sêla:  
 28 ni ist in ki·**h**uktin · **h**imiliskin gote,  
*hwanta* hiar in **w**er-olti · after ni **w**erkóta.

Woe to him who in the darkness shall atone for his wickedness,  
 burn in the Pitch; that is surely a baleful thing,  
 that the man calls out to God and no help for him comes.  
 She expects mercy, that wretched soul;  
 she is not in the thoughts of the heavenly God,  
 for here in this world she left no works behind.

---

25 **p**ehhe | 'phhe' 14098

- 30 Só denne der **mahtigo** khunink · daz **ma**hal ki·pannit,  
 dara skal **k**weman · **kh**unno ki·lihaz:  
 32 denne ni ki·tar **p**arno nohheın · den **pan** furi·sizzan,  
 ni allero **man**no *hwe*-lih; · ze demo **ma**hale skuli.  
 34 Dár skal er vora demo **r**ihhe · az **ra**hhu stantan,  
 pí daz er in **w**er-olti eo · ki·**w**erkót hapéta.

So, when the mighty King summons the court  
 whither every race shall come,  
 then none of the children dare sit out the summons,  
 nor any man whatsoever—he must go to the court.  
 There before that power shall he stand on trial  
 for the works he has done earlier in the world.

---

32 **p**arno 'the children' | The children of men, i.e., human beings.

- 36 Daz hôrt' ih **ra**hhón · dia wer-olt-**re**ht-wíson,  
 daz skuli der **A**nti-khristo · mit **E**líase págan.  
 38 Der **w**arkh ist ki·**w**áfanit, · denne wirdit untar in **w**ík  
 ar·hapan.  
**K**heınfun sint só **k**reftík; · diu **k**ôsa ist só mihhil.  
 40 **E**lías strítit · pí den **ę**wigon líp,  
 wili dén **re**ht-kernón · daz **r**íhhi ki·starkan:  
 42 pí·diu skal imo **h**elfan · der **h**imiles ki·waltit.

This I heard the righteous of the world narrate:  
 that the Anti-Christ shall fight with Elijah—  
 the warg is armed—then the battle will commence between them.  
 The champions are so strong; the struggle is so great;  
 Elijah fights for the eternal life,

wishes to strengthen the power of the righteous;  
therefore he will have help from Him Who rules heaven.

---

36 rahhón 'narrate' | The related verb \**rēkkjan* is also found for the narrating of ancient events in *Beow* 91 and *Heli* 3.

44 Der Anti-khristo · stét pí demo alt-fiante,  
stét pí demo Satanase, · der inan var-sēnkan skal:  
46 pi·diu skal er in deru wík-stēti · wunt pi·vallen  
ēnti in demo sinde · siga-lôs werdan.

The Anti-Christ stands beside the Fiend of Old,  
stands beside Satan who shall cause him to fall.  
Therefore shall he on that battlefield fall wounded  
and in the incursion be victory-less.

---

43 alt-fiante 'Fiend of Old' | Or 'the Ancient Enemy', i.e., Satan.

48 Doh wānit des vila got-manno,  
daz Elías in demo wíge · ar·wartit werde,  
só daz Elíases pluot · in erda ki·triuft.

Yet many godly men expect  
that Elijah in that battle will be maimed,  
so that Elijah's blood pours into the earth.

50 Só in·prinnant die perga, · poum ni ki·stēntit  
ēnihk in erdu, · ahá ar·truknént,  
52 muor var·swilhit sih, · swilizót lougiu der himil,  
máno vallit, · prinnit mittila-gart,  
54 stēn ni ki·stēntit\*, · vërit denne stúa-tago in lant,  
vërit mit diu vuiru · viriho wísón.

So the mountains burn down; no tree stands  
anywhere upon the earth; the rivers turn dry;  
the swamp is swallowed up; the heaven glows with flame;  
the moon falls; Middenyard burns;  
no stone stands. Then the Judgment Day comes upon the land,  
comes with the fire to visit the folk.

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54 stēn ni ki·stēntit\* | *add.* ēnihk in erdu 14098 (*dittography through homoioarcton from ll. 50b–51a*)

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50 perga ... poum 'mountains ... tree' | Formulaic word-pair; see note to *Wessobrunn* 3.

55 viriho 'folk' | Gen. of *fīr(a)ba*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for 'men, people' found throughout the Old Germanic languages. See *Hild* 10 n. for etymology and distribution.



- 56 Dár ni mak denae **mák** andremo · helfan vora demo **Mú**-spille,  
denne daz **prẽta** wasal · allaz var-**prinnit**,  
58 **ęnti** **vuir** **ęnti** luft · iz allaz ar-**furpit**.  
*Hwár* ist denne diu **marha**, · *dár* man *dár* eo mit sínén **mágon**  
piehk?  
60 Diu *marha* ist far-prunnan, · diu *sêla* stét pi-*dwungan*,  
ni *węiz* mit *hwiu* *puaze*: · só *węit* *sí* za *wíze*.

There no kinsman may help another one before the Muspell  
when all the broad damp earth burns up  
and fire and air do cleanse it all.

Where is then the ground where man once with his kinsmen fought?  
The ground is burnt up; the soul is defeated,  
knows no remedy; so it goes to punishment.

56 *Mú-spille* ‘the Muspell’ | The word which has given the poem its modern name, probably ‘the Destruction of the Earth’. *Mú-spille* is a hapax in OHG, but corresponds to OS *Múd-spelli* ~ *Mút-spelli* (*Heli* 2591, 4358) and ON *Mú-spell* (see *Vsp* 49/1 n.). Its exact sense and origin are hard to pin down.

In all cases the word seems to refer to at least an element of the eschatological destruction of the world, whether Heathen (as in the Norse *Vsp* and *Gylf*) or Christian (as in the High German *Musp* and the Old Saxon *Helb*). In *Musp* the word refers to the culmination of the destruction of the world by fire. In *Heli* 2591–92, *Múd-spelles megin* ‘Muspell’s might’ is said to pass over mankind together with the *ęndi þesaro wer-aldes* ‘end of this world’, and in *Heli* 4358–4361, Muspell is said to come like a thief in the night, along with the Last Day. In *Vsp* 49, *Mú-spells lýðir* ‘Muspell’s people’ are said to come from the south on a great ship during the Rakes of the Reins, while in *Gylf* 4:5–7, Muspell or Muspellsham is said to be a burning realm in the south ruled over by the fire-ettnin Surt.

Etymologically the word is clearly a cpd., segmented between *mú(d)* and *spilli*; it is a *ja*-stem in OS and OHG and an *a*-stem in ON; its gender is m. in ON and m. or neuter in OS and OHG (EWA, s.v. *múspili*). The first element, the root length of which is uncertain, has been explained as reflecting either PGmc. *\*múbó* ‘heap (of earth)’ or, on the basis of the OS dental, PGmc. *\*munþaz* ‘mouth’ (EWA). On the basis of sound-laws the latter is unlikely since the Ingvaenic nasal spirant law (/Vnθ/ > /Ṽ:θ/) does not affect OHG or ON, which for ‘mouth’ have *mund* and *munnr*, respectively. Still, the OS dental poses a formal difficulty and opens up the possibility of borrowing, although the direction is unclear. It is notable that both ON and OHG, at the geographical extremes, agree about the lack of a dental. The second element is prob. an agent noun derived either from the verb *\*spilþjaną* ‘to spoil, ruin; kill, murder’ (OE *spillan*, *spildan*, OS *spildjan*, ON *spilla*) or from *\*spellóną* ‘to tell, talk’ (EWA). Due to the lack of breaking in ON the former is probably more likely.

To conclude, due to the possibility of borrowing between languages, the lack of any glosses, and the formal difficulties, any derivation of this word must be considered uncertain. Still, the undoubtedly Germanic linguistic origin of the compound does make a pagan origin more likely. Further, if the word really is thoroughly Christian, one has to ask why the WGmc. form does not appear outside of alliterative poetry—not in prose, nor in rhyming poetry like *Otfrid*—and why the NGmc. form should signify a mythological, fiery realm.

59 *Hwár* ist denne diu *marha*, · *dár* man *dár* eo mit sínén *mágon* *piehk*? ‘Where is then the ground where man once with his kinsmen fought?’ | An example of the *ubi sunt* motif, common in medieval literature from both Europe and the Arab world. This literary motif, originally drawing on the Biblical Book of Baruch (3:16–19), and in Old Germanic poetry most famously found in *The Wanderer* (ll. 92–96), illustrates the vanity of life by listing various things and people, before asking ‘where are they?’ The German poet here extends the motif to the Day of Judgment and takes the opportunity to comment on his own time by condemning the internecine feuds that plagued all medieval monarchies.

60–61 Diu ... wize | In these two lines the poet replaces the usual alliteration with end-rhyme between each half-line (60: *prunnan* : *duungan*, 61: *puaze* : *wize*). The very same meter, including the looseness of the rhymes, is used by Otfrid throughout the whole of his *Evangelienbuch*, written sometime between 863 and 871 AD. The direction of influence between *Musp* and that work is uncertain owing to the difficulties of dating the present poem, though *Musp* is most likely the older work. See l. 14 and Introduction above.

- 62 Pi·diu ist demo manne só guot, · denne 'r ze demo mahale  
kwimit,  
daz er rahóno hwe-líha · rehto ar·tēile;  
64 denne ni darf er sorgén, · denne er ze deru suonu kwimit.  
Ni wēiz der wēnago man, · hwie-líhan wartil er habét,  
66 denne 'r mit den miatón · marrit daz rehta,  
daz der tiuval dár pí · ki·tarnit stēntit.

Therefore it is so good for the man when he comes to the court  
that he rightly consider every charge;  
then he need not worry when he comes to the atonement.  
The wretched man knows not what sort of overseer he has  
when with bribes he obstructs what is right:  
that the Devil stands hidden by his side.

- 68 Der hapét in ruovu · rahóno hwe-líha,  
daz der man êr ėnti síd · upiles ki·frumita,  
70 daz er iz allaz ki·sagét, · denne er ze deru suonu kwimit;  
ni skolta síd manno nohhēin · miatun int·fāhan.

In silence, *he* keeps every evil charge  
which the man, early or late, has committed,  
so that he tells it all when he comes to the atonement;  
for that reason should no man take bribes.

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68 Der 'He' | The Devil, as just mentioned.

- 72 Só daz himiliska horn · ki·blútít wirdit,  
ėnti sih der suanari · ana den sind ar·hēvit  
74 der dár suannan skal · tōten ėnti lepentén;  
denne hēvit sih mit imo · herjo mēista,  
76 daz ist allaz só pald, · daz imo nio-man ki·págan ni mak.  
Denne vērit er ze deru mahal-stēti, · deru dár ki·markhót ist:  
78 dár wirdit diu suona, · dia man dár io sagéta.

So the heavenly horn is sounded,  
and the Judge lifts Himself on His way,  
He who shall judge the dead and the living.

Then rises with Him the greatest of armies;  
it is all so bold that no man may fight it.  
Then He journeys to the place of the court which is there marked out;  
there begins the atonement as was once foretold.

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72 ki·blútít ‘sounded’ | *metr. emend.*; ki·lútít 14098

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72 Só daz himiliska horn · ki·blútít wírdít ‘So the heavenly horn is sounded’ | In Revelation 8–11, seven trumpets are sounded. With the sounding of the seventh trumpet, the kingdom of God is announced (Revelation 11:15). Cf. *Vsp* 45, where the god Homedall sounds the famous Yellhorn and this precedes the destruction.

72 ki·blútít ‘sounded’ | Restoration of the cluster *bl-* is required by the alliteration; cf. l. 7.

Denne varant **ę**ngila · u**p**er dio marha,  
80 w**ę**kħant deota, · w**i**ssant ze dinge.  
Denne skal m**a**nno gi·l**i**h · fona deru m**o**ltu ar·stén,  
82 l**o**ssan sih ar dero l**ê**wo vazzón: · skal imo avar sín l**i**p  
pi·kweman,  
daz er sín r**e**ht allaz · ki·r**a**hhón muozzi,  
84 ęnti imo after sínén t**á**tin · ar·t**ę**ilit werde.

Then the angels journey over the ground;  
they wake the nations, show them to the Thing.  
Then shall every man arise out of the earth,  
free himself from the burdens of the grave; further he shall come to life  
that he may fully plead his case  
and according to his deeds be considered.

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82 dero l**ê**wo vazzón ‘the burdens of the grave’ | Lit. ‘the burdens of the graves’. — *lêwo* (gen. pl. of *(b)lêo* ‘grave’) is the same word as OE *blêw* ‘mound’, PN *blaiwa* ‘grave’ (N KJ77, 78), and Gothic *blaiw* (translating Greek τάφος ‘tomb’ and μνημείον ‘memorial’). The sound change *bl-* > *l-* is strongly suggested by the meter. The verse is a hypermetric type A1A1 scanning **Px#xxxx#Px#Px**, and such verses, at least in *Heli*, without exception require double alliteration (Suzuki 2004, pp. 295–96). Although the meter of *Musp* and *Heli* is not identical, the rule is so strong there that it most likely applies in *Musp* too. This marks an inconsistent handling of the old sound *bl-* in *Musp*; cf. l. 72 above.

82 skal imo ... sín l**i**p pi·kweman ‘he shall come to life’ | Lit. ‘his life shall come to him.’

Denne der gi·s**i**zzit, · der dár s**u**onnan skal  
86 ęnti ar·t**ę**illan skal · t**o**tén ęnti kwekkhén,  
denne stét dár u**mp**i · ęngilo m**e**nigí,  
88 g**u**otero g**o**móno: · g**a**rt ist só m**i**hhil:  
dara kwimit ze deru r**i**htungu só vilo · dia dár ar r**ę**stí ar·stént.

Then sits he who there shall judge  
and shall consider the dead and the living.

Then there around him stands a throng of angels,  
[and] of good men. The enclosure is so great;  
there to that tribunal come so many who have arisen from their rest.

90        Só dár manno nohhēin · wiht pi·mídan ni mak;  
            dár skal denne hant sprehhan, · houpit sagén,  
92        allero lido hwe-lihk · unzi in den luzígūn vinger,  
            bwaz er untar desen mannun · mordes ki·frumita.

So there may no man elude the smallest thing;  
there the hand shall speak, the head shall tell,  
[and] every single limb whatsoever down to the little finger,  
what sort of murder it committed in the midst of these men.

91 dár skal denne hant sprehhan, · houpit sagén 'there the hand shall speak, the head shall tell | The idea that a man's own limbs shall bear witness against him is well known from the Islamic Day of Judgment (*Qur'ān* 36:65, 41:20–21, 24:24), but is not found in the New Testament. It is likely an apocryphal motif that influenced Muḥammad and has made its way into this 9th c. text.

94        Dár ni ist eo só listík man · der dár io·wiht ar·liugan megi,  
            daz er ki·tarnan megi · táto dehheina,  
96        niz al fora demo khuninge · ki·khundit werde,  
            úzzan er iz · mit ala-muosanu furi·megi  
98        ęnti mit fastún · dio viriná ki·puazti.  
            Denne der paldét · der gi·puazzit hapét,  
100       denne 'r ze deru suonu kwimit.

There no man is ever so sly that he may lie about the smallest thing,  
that he may hide away any deed  
so that it may not all be made known to the King,  
unless he overcame it through the giving of alms  
and through fasting did penance for the wickedness.  
Then is he emboldened who has done penance,  
when he comes to the atonement.

97 ala-muosanu | alamusanu 14098

            Wirdit denne furi ki·tragan · daz frôno khrúki,  
102       dár der hêligo Khrist · ana ar·hangan ward.  
            Denne augit er dio másún, · dio er in deru męnniskí an·fénk,  
104       dio er duruh desse man-kunnes · minna far·doléta.

Then is brought forth the Lordly Cross,  
whereon the Holy Christ was made to hang.  
Then He reveals the wounds which He as a man received  
which for the love of this man-kind He suffered.

# Cadman's Hymn

**Dating:** C7th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

**Cadman's Hymn** is a short Old English poem found in numerous recensions of Bede's English history, attributed to the illiterate shepherd Cadman (OE *Cædmon*). It employs several traditional Germanic poetic formulae and clearly draws on earlier, now-lost pagan compositions.

The hymn has two rhetorical parts. Lines 1–4 serve as an introductory prayer and declaration of purpose, while ll. 5–9 describe the creation, first of the Heaven (5–6) and then of Middenyard and the Earth (7–9).

Based on Kaluza's law in the younger *Beow* the pres. ed. marks etymologically long unstressed vowels.

## Text

## Cadman's Hymn

Nú scylun heƿgan · heþæn-ricæs ward,  
 2 metudæs mæhti · end his mód-gi-þanc,  
 weƿc wuldur-fadur, · swé hé wundrá gi-hwæs,  
 4 éci dryhtin · ór á-stelidæ.  
 Hé ærist scóp · ældá barnum  
 6 heþæn til hrófæ, · hâlig sceppend.  
 þá middun-geard · mon-cynnæs ward,  
 8 éci dryhtin · æfter tíadæ,  
 firþum foldú · fréa al-mæhtig.

NOW SHALL WE PRAISE the heavenly realm's Guardian,  
 the Measurer's might and His thinking mind,  
 the works of the Glory-Father, as He every wonder,  
 the everlasting Lord, in the beginning set up.  
 He first created for the children of men  
 the heaven as a roof, the holy Creator.  
 Then Middenyard did Mankind's Guardian,  
 the everlasting Lord afterwards make:  
 the land for humans, the Lord Almighty.

**Galders (INCOMPLETE!)**





# Introduction to Galders

The Germanic word “galder” (PGmc. *\*galdra*) is a verbal noun derived from the old verb “gale” (PGmc. *\*galaną*), meaning ‘to sing, to chant’. A “galder” is therefore what is chanted or sung, more specifically a magical chant, whether for the purpose of healing or cursing.

In the present section the reader will find gathered a number of such galders attested across the Old Germanic languages. Not all of these texts may be true galders, but they share a magical purpose and many formulae and stylistic features reoccur throughout.

Note that this section will only include written charms containing likely or certain pre-Christian tradition elements, e.g. the invocation of the Heathen Gods or the use of old poetic formulae. Syncretic texts which mix traditional and Christian elements (e.g. SJy 41, most of the OE galders) are also included. Thoroughly Christian prayers, however, even if metrical, are excluded from this section and may instead be found under “Poetry on Christian Subjects”.



## **Continental Germanic Galders**



# The Merseburg Galders

**Dating:** C9th–10th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law, Galders-law

## Introduction

The two **Merseburg galders** are some of the only surviving examples of genuine Heathen galders from continental West Germanic Europe, and the only ones actually to invoke the pre-Christian Germanic gods.

## Textual preservation and transmission

The galders are preserved on fol. 85r of the theological manuscript Merseburger Domstiftsbibliothek Codex 136 (in the present critical edition given the signum 136) where they are written in a neat and well-trained hand. Immediately below them follows a thoroughly Christian prayer written in the same hand (Murdoch 1988, p. 360), edited below as an Appendix to the galders. The theological contents of the manuscript, the trained hand and the Latin prayer together suggest that the scribe was most likely a monk.

## Summary

Both galders share a common two-part structure, each beginning with an *historiola*, a mythological account describing the successful effects of the galder in the distant mythic past, followed by an imperative *incantatio* or the galder-proper, commanding that the willed magic effect take place in the present.

The first galder (*Mers I*) begins with the *historiola* describing a group of supernatural women in the midst of a battle, affecting its outcome by fastening or loosening fetters. The *incantatio* then commands that the present fetters be destroyed so that captives may escape the enemy.

The second galder (*Mers II*) begins with the *historiola* describing a group of Gods riding through the woods. Among them is Balder, whose young foal sprains its foot. Three Gods—the otherwise unknown goddess Sithguth, the goddess Sun, the god Weden—in turn chant a healing galder over it. The

incantatio—apparently the galder sung by Weden—then commands that a present sprain be healed.

### Cultural context

I generally agree with Murdoch (1988) when he convincingly argues that the galders ought to be seen as incantations written down to be sung alongside the application of salves or other instruments in the context of Christian(ized) mediæval medicine. This is important for the context of *Mers I*, since the preservation of a galder for actually removing shackles is quite unlikely. For one its effectivity must have been quite limited, and it is very unlikely that it would have been of any use in the monastic medicinal context. Considering that likely context a more reasonable use case is for a cramp, which would then be symbolically likened within the sphere of the galder to the fetters on the battlefield.

As mentioned above, the two galders are followed by a Latin liturgical formula written in the same hand. As Murdoch (1988, pp. 362–363) shows, the same formula is also found in a cure against possession in the Anglo-Saxon Bald's Leechbook, and this firmly anchors the galders within the Christian medicinal framework. Indeed, when one compares the Merseburg galders with OE galders like *Nwyr*t and Norse galders like the Ribe galder-stick (SJy 41) it becomes clear that the mixing of pagan and Christian elements in this type of text was not unusual. Monk or not, the traditional invocation of Weden must have been felt to have a particularly strong healing effect, and it was only later that he was entirely excised and demonised.

Of course this does not mean that the galders themselves are fully Christian, like Murdoch (1988) suggests. The gods they invoke are Germanic and pre-Christian, as is their alliterative poetic form and their contents (especially *Mers II*). As Murdoch (1988, pp. 360–361) himself brings up, contemporary mediæval Christian authors condemn pagan charms; and how could a galder invoking Weden himself not be considered pagan when the god is even mentioned by name in the contemporary Old Saxon Baptismal Vow (edited under Christian Poetry)? In any case, Murdoch rightly makes an important distinction: regardless of whether the galders themselves are pagan or not, they are preserved in a Christian manuscript and in that context their healing magic appears to function alongside a Latin prayer.

### Parallels

Moving away from the immediate cultural context we ought to look at parallels for both galders. These will help us anchor them in a broader European tradition of magical song or galder.

Close verbal parallels to *Mers I* are found in the Norse *Háv* 150 and *Grg* 10, but those are literary monuments. As discussed above it is questionable whether it was ever actually meant to be used by shackled captives, and to my knowledge no actual galders to that effect survive.

*Mers II* has an impressive number of later parallels across Celtic and Germanic-speaking Northern Europe (for an overview see Hopkins 2025). These charms generally mirror both the historiola and the incantatio of *Mers II*, but almost always replace the healer with Jesus Christ. They are generally used to heal sprains or broken bones. Many are found as incantations to be recited together with the sign of the cross. Further afield the incantatio has a notable parallel in the Vedic material, for which see ll. 6–9 n.

## Text

- 1    E̅inis s̅ázun idisi · s̅ázun hera duo dér; [136 85r/1–4]  
 2    suma hapt h̅eptidun · suma h̅eri l̅ezidun  
      suma klubodun · umbi kuonjo widi  
 4    in·sprink hapt-bandun · in·var vígandun  
      .H.

ONCE DISES SAT—sat here, then there.

Some fastened fetters, some hindered armies,  
 some cut asunder strong withies.

Destroy the fetter-bonds, lead the way from the foes!

.H.

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1 E̅inis ‘Once’ | eiris 136

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1 E̅inis ‘Once’ | This word places the historiola in a mythic or legendary past. — The ms. form *eiris* must be a spelling error. It cannot be equated with *ērist* ‘earliest’ or *ēr* ‘early, of yore’, because \**ei* > *ē* before *r* is an early sound change in continental West Germanic and cannot be disregarded.

3 kuonjo widi ‘strong withies’ | This difficult phrase (in 136 written ‘*cuonio uuidi*’) is traditionally identified with the word *kuna-wid* ‘chain, fetter’ found in a few OHG glosses, which is further cognate with Gothic *kuna-wida* ‘fetter; ἄλυσίς (Streitberg 1910, p. 76)’. This interpretation, however, faces formal difficulties due to the quality of the vowel *uo* and the infix *-jo-*, neither of which match *kuna-*. I instead follow a newer interpretation and take *kuonjo* as the f. acc. pl. of the adjective *kuoni* ‘strong; keen, brave’. Cf. EWA (s.v. *kunawid*).

5 .H. | The meaning of this letter, which is very clearly visible and written in the same hand as the galders, is uncertain. To me the most convincing suggestion is that it is to be read as *.N.*, a common abbreviation for Latin *nomen* ‘name’ (cf. the Appendix below), and here presumably the name of the patient for whom the healer is chanting (Murdoch 1988, p. 363).

- 2    Fol ęnde Wuodan · vuorun zi holza [136 85r/5–12]  
 2    dú wart demo Balderes volon · sín vuoz bi·ręnkít  
      þú bi·guol en Sinhtgunt · Sunna era swister  
 4    þú bi·guol en Frija · Volla era swister  
      þú bi·guol en Wuodan · só hé wola konda:  
 6    „Só-se b̅en-ręnkí · só-se bluot-ręnkí · só-se lidi-ręnkí  
         b̅en zi b̅ena  
 8       bluot zi bluoda

lid zi ge·liden · só-se ge·límida sín!“

FOL AND WEDEN journeyed through the woods;  
 then was the foot of Balder's foal sprained.  
 Then Sithguth galed over it—Sun her sister;  
 then Frie galed over it—Full her sister;  
 then Weden galed over it as he could well do:  
 “Like bone-sprain, like blood-sprain, like joint-sprain!  
     Bone to bone,  
     blood to blood,  
 joint to joints, like were they glued together!”

1 Fol ‘Fol’ | ‘phol’ 136    1 Wuodan ‘Weden’ | ‘uuodan’ 136    4 Frija ‘Frie’ | ‘friia’ 136

1 Fol ‘Fol’ | An otherwise unknown God; he may possibly be identified with Balder of l. 2, seeing as it is his horse whose leg is sprained. The manuscript spelling *pb-* is unusual but the alliteration with *vuoz* ‘foot’ confirms that we are dealing with the same consonant, viz. an old *f*, probably voiced to *v*.

1 Wuodan ‘Weden’ | Weden, the chief of the Gods in the Norse mythology, here appearing in his role as healer (for which cf. *Háv* 147–165, *Nuyrt* 11/2). This is Weden's only literary occurrence in OHG, although his name is also found on the Runic Nordendorf fibula (cf. *Vsp* 17/4 n.) and in the Latin form *godan* in the Longbeardish Origin Myth (see Appendix to *Grm*).

3 bi·guol en ‘galed over it’ | Sang a galder over the horse; *bi·guol* the 3rd sg. past ind. of *bi·galan* ‘sing (a galder) over, begale’, the transitive of *galan* ‘gale, sing (a galder)’. Cf. *Háv* 153/4, *Oddr* 7/3–4.

4 Frija ‘Frie’ | Weden's wife, cognate with ON *Frigg*. Cf. the Longbeardish Origin Myth, where she appears as *Frea*.

4 Volla ‘Full’ | An otherwise unknown goddess in OHG. Her name is clearly cognate with ON *Fulla*, Frie's handmaiden and confidante (*Grm* P2, *Gylf* 35:6, *Skm* 1).

6–9 Só-se ... sín! ‘Like ... together!’ | As discussed above the incantatio has numerous Celtic and Germanic parallels, yet the oldest parallel by far is from Vedic India, in *AV* 4.15.1–3 (ca. 1200–900 BC), a spell used alongside an herb to heal a broken bone. The present quotation is from the likely more original *Pippalādā* recension, but the same sts. occur in variant form as *AV* 4.12.3–5 in the more famous *Śāunaka* recension, for which see Zysk 1996, pp. 72–74. In OI (norm. N. S. Dwibhashyam): 1 *Sām majjā majjñā b<sup>h</sup>avatu*; / *sām u tē páruṣā páruḥ*; / *sām tē māṁśasya vísrastam*; / *sām snáva sām u páruva tē*. // 2 *Majjā majjñā sām-d<sup>h</sup>iyatām*. / *Ast<sup>h</sup>nā āst<sup>h</sup>i āpi-rōbatu*. / *Snáva tē sām-dad<sup>h</sup>maḥ snāvnā*. / *Cārmaṇā cārma rōbatu*. // 3 *Lōma lōmnā sām-d<sup>h</sup>iyatām*. / *Tvacā sām-kalpaya tvācam*. / *Āsṛk tē asnā rōbatu*. / *Māṁśsām māṁśēna rōbatu*. ‘1 Let marrow be together with marrow, and let joint be together with joint for thee. Let the severed part of thy flesh be together; let sinew be together, and let limb be together for thee. 2 Let marrow be put together with marrow; let bone also grow with bone. We put together thy sinew with sinew; let skin grow with skin. 3 Let hair be put together with hair; fit together skin with skin. Let thy blood grow with blood; let flesh grow with flesh.’

## Appendix

Immediately below the galders the following Latin prayer is written. Abbreviations have been resolved according to Murdoch (1988, p. 369). The prayer is closely related to the Anglican *Prayer for the Clergy and People* as found in the Book of Common Prayer (Church of England 1892, p. 58), which the present translation aims to follow where possible.



P1      Omnipotens sancte pater noster deus, qui facis mirabilia magna  
 2      solus, pretende super famulum tuum N. et super cunctas con-  
      gregationes illis commissas spiritum gratie salutaris, et ut in ver-  
 4      itate tibi conplaceant perpetuum eis rorem tue benedictionis in-  
      fundo. Per dominum nostrum Jesum Christum.

Almighty, holy Father, our God, who alone workest great marvels: send down upon thy servant N., and upon all the congregations committed to their charge, the spirit of saving grace; and, that they may truly please thee, pour upon them the continual dew of thy blessing. Through our Lord Jesus Christ.

---

2 famulum tuum N. 'thy servant N.' | N. abbreviating *nomen* 'name', viz. the subject of the blessing. The singular "thy servant" appears to have taken place of an earlier plural subject, for many of the following words (*illis* '(to) their (charge)' etc.) are still written in the plural—"their" is **not** to be understood as a gender neutral singular pronoun. This hints that the German scribe, in spite of his pleasing hand, may not have been fully competent in Latin.



# German Wyrn-galders

## Against wyrms (*Contra vermes*)

Dating: 9th c.

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

**Against wyrms** (abbrev. *ContVerm*) is an Old Saxon manuscript charm against wyrms located in the bone-marrow, presumably thought to cause aches.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*ContVerm* is found as marginalia in the 9th c. manuscript Cod. Vind. (ÖNB) 751 on fol. 188v.

### Contents

The galder is a sort of exorcism. It calls upon Nesse, the chief injurious wyrn-dæmon, to depart from the patient along with its nine offspring. The galder lays out a path for the wyrms to leave the sufferer's body and instead go into an arrow or sharp point (*strála*), perhaps a ritual implement used to draw blood from the affected area.

A closely related galder is found in Old High German form under the title *Pro Nessia* 'Against Nesse' (*ProNessia*), edited immediately below.

The structure "Go from X to Y, from Y to Z" may be very old, for it is also found in some of the Romani charms collected by Leland (1891, pp. 27, 28, 95), for which see note to ll. 2–3.

### Text

2      Gang út, Nesso, · mid nigun nessi-klínon,  
         út fana þemo marge an þat bēn, · fan þemo bēne an þat fleşg,  
         út fan þemo fleşgke an þia húd, · út fan þera húd an þesa strála.

4 Drohtin, werþe só.

Go OUT, NESSE, with nine small Nesses!

Out from the marrow into the bone, from the bone into the flesh,  
out from the flesh into the skin, out from the skin into this arrow.  
Lord, may it be so.

---

1 Nesso ‘Nesse’ | An otherwise unknown dæmon, entitled *Nessia* in the Latin title to the version of this spell (*ProNessia*). The *naming* of the dæmon or spirit which is to be excised is commonplace in ancient magic, including several other galders edited here. The idea is that knowledge of the name of the entity gives the magician power over it.

2–3 út ... strála ‘Out ... arrow.’ | As mentioned in the Introduction, one of Leland’s charms is particularly similar to *ContVerm* and by extension *ProNessia*. In both the Germanic and Romani charms, the wyrms (Romani *kirmora* < Sanskrit *kṛmī*, which is probably related to PGmc. \**wurmiz*, although the irregular variation in the initial consonant is unusual and perhaps due to a taboo deformation) are to leave the body and instead go into the ritual implement, in the Gypsy charm an ointment. I take the freedom to reproduce the charm in full with Leland’s introduction and translation, but line-breaks in the verse replaced by slashes:

“Before sunrise wolf’s milk (Wolfsmilch, rukeskro tçud) is collected, mixed with salt, garlic, and water, put into a pot, and boiled down to a brew. With a part of this the afflicted spot is rubbed, the rest is thrown into a brook, with the words:—

*Kirmora jánen ándre tçud / Andráł tçud, andré sir / Andráł sir, andré páñi, / Panensá kiyá dádeske, / Kiyá Niváseske / Pçándel tumen sbelebá / Eñáúárdesh teñá!*

‘Worms go in the milk, / From the milk into the garlic, / From the garlic into the water, / With the water to (your) father, / To the Nivasi, / He shall bind you with a rope, / Ninety-nine (yards long).’” (Leland 1891, p. 95).

## For Nesse (*Pro Nessia*)

**Dating:** 9th c.

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

**Against Nesse** (abbrev. *ProNessia*) is an Old High German variant of the same spell as the Old Saxon *ContVerm*, edited above.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The galder is marginalia, found in the 9th c. ms. BSB Clm 18524b, on fol. 203v.

### Contents

The language of *ProNessia* is Bavarian, having undergone the second sound shift. The wording is strikingly similar to the Old Saxon *ContVerm*, which is likewise directed against the dæmon Nesse and his/her nine offspring. The main difference between the two galders is in the use of the words describing the path Nesse is to take, but the core conception is identical: the dæmon is to be drawn out from the patient and into some external object.

### Text

2           Gang úz, Nesso, · mit niun nessi-khīlinon,  
            úz fonna marge in deo ádra, · vonna den ádrún in daz flēisk,  
            fonna demu flēiske in daz fel, · fona demo velle in diz tullī.  
4           Ter paternoster.

GO OUT, NESSE, with nine small Nesses!  
Out from the marrow into the veins, from the veins into the flesh,  
from the flesh into the skin, from the skin into this quiver.  
Thrice ‘pater noster’.

---

3 tullī ‘quiver’ | The translation is uncertain. TODO: look up.

4 Ter paternoster “Thrice ‘pater noster’” | This Latin instruction seals the galder and places it in a thoroughly Christian medicinal context. Cf. the Introduction to *Mers*.



# The Knosping Galder

**Dating:** C9th–10th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The **Knospink galder** is a short OHG galder for blessing a house.

## Textual preservation and transmission

The galder is found in Ms. Car. C 176, presently in Zürich. It is found on fol. 154r amidst a number of magical charms in Latin. It is given the title *Ad signandum domum contra diabolum* ‘To bless a house against devils’.

## Interpretation

The galder begins by addressing the “wight” explicitly, recognising it as such. This recognition is the equivalent of the naming of it and brings the dæmonic spirit out into the open, vulnerable to the effects of the exorcism.

The titular *chnospinci* ‘Knosping’ serves to drive away the wight. It is undoubtedly a magic word and has no clear meaning. Metrically it appears that the suffix *-pinci* has secondary stress which suggests the segmentation *chnos-pinci*, though this does not help much with its etymology.

## Text

- 1      **W**ola, wiht, taz tú **w**ēist, · taz tu **w**iht heizist,  
2      taz tú ne wēist noch ne **chanst** · cheden **chnos-pinci**.

Lo, wight, thou knowest that thou art called a wight,  
that thou neither knowest nor canst say [the word] ‘Knosping’.





## Old English Galders

There survive twelve mediæval Anglo-Saxon metrical charms, although it is questionable whether they all qualify as galders. Notably for these texts is that they are preserved as the main text in manuscripts rather than marginalia, and that they have substantial ritual instructions alongside the words of the galders themselves.

The first four, *Nwyrð*, *Dweorð*, *Færst*, and “Childbirth”, are from the text known as the *Lâcnunga* (abbrev. *Lâcn*) in the manuscript Harley MS 585 (ca. 1000 AD, siglum L). One galder from *Lâcn*, “For Loss of Cattle” (A), on fol. 180v–181r, is excluded as it is fully Christian without clear traditional elements.

The following two, “For Theft of Cattle” and *Ymbe*, both belong to Corpus Christi College, Cambridge MS 41 (abbrev. CCCC 41). Two other galders in CCCC 41, “For Loss of Cattle” (B), a variant of (A) same-named galder found in *Lâcn*, and “A Journey Charm” are thoroughly Christian and therefore excluded.

The last three galders, “Against Wen”, “Against Water-Elf-Disease”, and *Æcer*, are from various sources. These will be discussed in the Introduction to each individual text.



# The Galder of Nine Worts

## (*Nigon wyrta galdor*)

Dating: ?

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO: introduction

Numerous lines begin with small crosses which appear to serve as section markers. The present division into stanzas is largely based on these. TODO: note which.

Preserved in *Lâcn*.

### Text

- 1     Ge·myne ðú mug-wyrt · hwæt þú á·meldodest  
2     hwæt þu renadest · æt Regen-melde?

Rememberest thou, Mugwort, what thou didst declare,  
what thou didst arrange at Reinmeld?

- 2     Una þú hâttest · yldost wyrta  
2     þú miht wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí·tigum*  
   þú miht wiþ *attre* · and wið *ǫn·flyge*  
4     þú miht wiþ þâm *lāpan* · ðe geond lǫnd færð.

Un thou art called, the oldest of worts;  
thou availest against three and against thirty;  
thou availest against the venom and against the onfler;  
thou availest against the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

---

2 wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí-tigum* ‘against three and against thirty’ | I.e. ‘against a great number of foes’. ‘Three and thirty’ is formulaic and appears in many later English and Scottish folk-songs, viz. Child 4EFG, 18B, 20C, 30, 53BCDEIKM, 63EFH, 73I, 97AC, 100AG, 110BGH, 156G, 185A, 187A, 187C, 190A, 192A, 193B, 203C, 211A, 217GHLN, 244A, 268A, 269C, 281ABC. Things described include horses, heads of cattle, warriors, days, years, winters.

- 3 Ond þú weg-bráde · wyrta módor  
 2 éastan opene · innan mihtigu  
 ofer ðy cræte curron · ofer ðy cwéne reodon  
 4 ofer ðy brýde brýodedon  
 ofer ðy fearras fnærdon.

And thou, Waybroad, mother of worts,  
 open from the east, mighty within.  
 Over thee TODO.

TODO  
 TODO

- 4 Eallum þu þon wið-stóde · and wið-stunest  
 2 swá ðú wið-stonde attre · and qn-flyge  
 and þæm lāðan · þe geond lōnd fereð.

Them all didst thou then withstand, and didst stop;  
 so mayst thou withstand the venom and the onfler,  
 and the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

- 5 Stune hætte þeos wurt, · héo on stâne ge-weox  
 2 stōnd héo wið attre, · stunað héo wærce  
 Stiðe héo hatte, · wið-stunað héo attre  
 4 wreceð héo wrāðan, · weorpeð út attor.

Stun is this wort called, she grew on stone;  
 she withstands venom, she stops aches.  
 Stithe is she called, she stops the venom;  
 she drives away the wroth one, casts out the venom.

- 6 Þis is séo wurt · séo wiþ wrym ge-feaht  
 2 þeos mæg wið attre, · héo mæg wið qn-flyge;  
 héo mæg wið ðām lāþan · ðe geond lōnd fereþ.

This is the wort that fought against the Wrym;  
 this one avails against the venom, she avails against the onfler;  
 she avails against the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

- 7 Fleoh þú nú attor-lāðe, · séo lāsse ðá mārān  
 2 séo mære þá læssan, · oððæt him beigra bót sý!

TODO  
 TODO.

- 8 Ge·myne þú, mægðe, · hwæt þú á·meldodest  
 2 hwæt ðú ge·ændadest · æt Alor-forda  
 þæt nǣfre for ge·floge · feorh ne ge·sealde  
 4 syððan him mōn mægðan · tú mēte ge·gyrede.

TODO  
 TODO  
 TODO  
 TODO

- 9 Þis is séo wýrt · ðe wer-gulu hatte  
 2 ðás on·sænde seolh · ofer sæs hrygc  
 ondan attres · oþres tó bóte.

TODO  
 TODO  
 TODO

- 10 Ðás *nygon* magon · wið *nygon* attrum.

These nine avail against nine venoms.

- 11 Wýrm cōm snícan, · to·slāt hé *man*  
 2 ðá ge·nam Wóden · *nygon* wuldor-tānas  
 slóh ðá þá nǣddran · þæt héo on *nygon* tó·fléah  
 4 Þær ge·ændade æppel · and attor  
 þæt héo nǣfre ne wolde · qn hús búgan.

A Wýrm came crawling; he tore apart a man.  
 Then took Weden nine glory-twigs,  
 slew then that adder, that it sprung into nine [parts].  
 There ended apple and venom,  
 that she would never wish to enter a house.

- 12 Fille and finule, · fela-mihtigu twá  
 2 þá wýrte ge·sceop · wítig drihten  
 hǣlig on heofonum, · þá hé hōngode;

- 4            **s**ette and **s**ende · on *seofon* worulde  
              **e**armum and **é**adigum · **e**allum tó bóte.

Fill and Fennel, the many-mighty two;  
 those worts the wise lord shaped,  
 holy in heaven when he hung.  
 He set and sent them into seven worlds,  
 for wretched men and for wealthy, for all men as a remedy.

- 13        **S**tōnd héo wið wærce, · **s**tunað héo wið attre  
 2            séo mæg wið *þrim* · and wið *þri-tigum*  
              wið *fēondes* hōnd · and wið *fár*-bregde  
 4            wið **m**alscrunge · **m**ânra wihta.

She stands against ache, she stands against venom; she avails against three  
 and against thirty; against the TODO of evil wights.

- 14        Nu magon þás *nygon* **w**yrta · wið *nygon* **w**uldor-ge·flogenum  
 2            wið *nygon* **a**ttрум · and wið *nygon* **o**n-flygnum  
              wið ðý **r**éadan attre, · wið ðý **r**unlan attre  
 4            wið ðý **h**witan attre, · wið ðý *þewenan* attre  
              wið ðý **g**eolwan attre, · wið ðý **g**rénan attre  
 6            wið ðý **w**onnan attre, · wið ðý **w**edenan attre  
              wið ðý **b**rúnan attre, · wið ðý **b**asewan attre  
 8            wið **w**urm-ge·blæd, · wið **w**æter-ge·blæd  
              wið **þ**orn-ge·blæd, · wið **þ**ystel-ge·blæd  
 10          wið **ý**s-ge·blæd, · wið **a**ttor-ge·blæd

Now these nine worts avail against glory-onfliers:  
 against nine venoms and against nine onfliers;  
 against the red venom; against the TODO venom;  
 against the white venom; against the TODO venom;  
 against the yellow venom; against the green venom;  
 against the TODO venom; against the TODO venom;  
 against the brown venom; against the TODO venom;  
 against worm-TODO; against water-TODO;  
 against thorn-TODO; against thistle-TODO;  
 against ice-TODO; against venom-TODO.

- 15        Gif ænig **a**ttor cume · **é**astan fleógan  
 2            oððe ænig **n**orðan cume  
              oððe ænig **w**estan · ofer **w**er-þeode

If any venom should come flying from the east;

or any come from the north;  
or any from the west, over mankind.

- 16      Críst stód ofer ádle · ængan cundes.  
2      Ic âna wât · éa rinnende  
         þær þá nygon nædran · néan be·healdað.

Christ stood over TODO;  
I know one river running,  
where the nine adds TODO.

- 17      Motan ealle wéoda · nu wurtum á·springan  
2      sæs tó·slúpan, · eal sealt wæter  
         ðonne ic þis attor · of þé ge·bláwe.

TODO

- P1      Mucgwyr, weg-brade þe eastan open sy, lombes-cyrse, attor-  
2      laðan, mageðan, netelan, wudu-sur-æppel, fille and finul, ealde  
         sapan. Ge·wyrce ða wyrta to duste, mængc wiþ þa sapan and wiþ  
4      þæs æpples gor. Wyrce slypan of wætere and of axsan, ge·nim  
         finol, wyl on þære slyppan and beþe mid æggemongc, þonne he  
6      þa sealf on do, ge ær ge æfter. Sing þæt galdor on æcre þara  
         wyrta, :III: ær he hy wyrce and on þone æppel eal-swa; ond singe  
8      þon mæn in þone müð and in þá éaran búta and on ðá wunde þæt  
         ilce gealdor, ær he þa sealf on dó.

TODO.





# Against a Dwarf

## (*Wið dweorh*)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

### Text

P1 Mann sceal niman *seofon* lytle of-lætan swylce mann mid ofrað,  
2 ond wītan þás naman on ælcra oflætan: Maximianus, Malchus,  
Johannes, Martinianus, Dionisius, Constantinus, Serafion. Þænne  
4 eft þæt galdor þæt hér æfter cweð[eð] mann sceal singan, ærest  
on þæt wynstre éare, þænne on þæt swiðre éare, þænne búfan  
6 þæs mannes moldan; ond gá þænne ân mæden-mann tó, ond hó  
hit ƿn his sweoran, ond dó mann swá þrý dagas. Him bið sóna  
8 sél.

One shall take seven small wafers, such as one offers [during the Mass], and write these names on each wafer: Maximianus, Malchus, Johannes, Martinianus, Dionysius, Constantinus, Seraphion. After that shall one sing this galder which is henceforth said; first into the left ear, then into the right ear, then over the man's head; and thereafter a maiden go forth, and hang it on his neck; and one do so for three days. He will soon be well.

1 Hér cóm in·gangan · in·spiden wiht,  
2 hæfde him his haman ƿn handa; · cwæð þæt þú his hæncest  
wære,

- 1 *le*geþe þe his téage ʒn sweoran; · ʒn·gunnan him ʒf þæm  
     *lande* líðan.  
 4 Sóna swá hý ʒf þæm *lande* cóman · þá ʒn·gunnan him þá  
     *leomu* cólian.—  
     þá cóm in·gangan · déores sweostar;  
 6 þá ge·*æ*ndode héo · ond *á*ðas swór,  
     þæt næfre þis þæm *ad*legan · *eg*lian ne móste  
 8 né þæm þe þis *g*aldor · be·*g*ýtan mihte  
     oððe þe þis *g*aldor · on·*g*alan cūðe.  
 10 Amen *fiað*.

Here an inspiden wight came walking in,  
 had his harness in his hands, said that thou wert his horse,  
 laid his reins on thy neck; they began to ride away from the land.  
 As soon as they came away from the land then they began to cool limbs.  
 Then the beast's sister came walking in;  
 then she made an end to it and swore oaths  
 that this never should torment the ailing man,  
 nor him who this galder might get,  
 nor whomever this galder could gale.  
 Amen, let it be.

# Against a Sudden Stitch

## (*Wið fær-stice*)

Dating: ?

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

Attested in *Lâcn*.

### Text

- 1     **H**lúde wáron hý, lá, **h**lúde, · þá hý ofer þone **h**læw ridon,  
2     wáron **â**n-móde, · þá hý **o**fer land ridan.  
     Scyld þú þe nú, þú þysne **n**ið · ge·**n**esan móte.  
4     **Ú**t, lýtel spere, · gif hér **i**nne síe!

Loud were they, lo, loud, when they rode over the mound;  
they were steadfast when they rode over land.  
Shield thyself now; thou must escape this evil!  
Out little spear if here within it be!

- 2     Stód under **l**inde, · under **l**eohtum scylde,  
2     þær þá **m**ihtigan wíf · hýra **m**ægen be·ræddon  
     and hý **g**yllende · **g**âras sændon;  
4     ic him **ó**ðerne · **e**ft wille sændan,  
     **f**léogende **f**lâne · **f**orane tó·géanes.  
6     **Ú**t, lýtel spere, · gif hit her **i**nne sý!

I stood under the linden [SHIELD]—under the light shield—  
where those mighty women arrayed their might  
and their yelling spears did send.

To them I will send back another one:  
a flying arrow, aimed against them.  
Out little spear if here within it be!

- 3      Sæt smið, · slóh seax,  
2      lytel ísærna, · wund swiðe.  
          Ūt, lytel spere, · gif her inne sý!

A smith sat, forged the sax:  
a little iron-thing—a great wound.  
Out little spear if here within it be!

- 4      Syx smiðas sæton,  
2      wæl-spera worhton.  
          Ūt, spere, · næs in, spere!  
4      Gif her inne sý · ísenes dæl,  
          hæg-tessan ge-weorc, · hit sceal ge-myltan.

Six smiths sat,  
wrought slaughter-spears.  
Out, spear! Be not in, spear!  
If here within be a piece of iron,  
the work of a hagtess—it shall melt!

- 5      Gif þú wære on fell scoten · oððe wære on flæsc scoten  
2      oððe wære on blód scoten · [...]  
          oððe wære on lið scoten, · næfre ne sý þín líf atæsed;

If thou wert shot in the skin or wert shot in the flesh,  
or wert shot in the blood, [...],  
or wert shot in the limb—never be thy life injured.

- 6      Gif hit wære esa ge-scot · oððe hit wære ylfa ge-scot  
2      oððe hit wære hæg-tessan ge-scot, · nú ic wille þín helpan:  
          þis þé tó bóte esa ge-scotes, · þis þé tó bóte ylfa ge-scotes,  
4      þis þé tó bóte hæg-tessan ge-scotes; · ic þín wille helpan.

If it were a shot of Eese or it were a shot of Elves  
or it were a shot of a hagtess—now I will help thee!  
This for thee as remedy against shot of Eese; this for thee as remedy against  
shot of Elves;  
this for thee as remedy against shot of a hagtess—I will help thee!

1 *ësa ... ylfá* ‘of Eese ... of Elves’ | Formulaic; see Eese and Elves. That they are held in the same category as the hagtess—a witch—indicates Christian influence. Also among the West Germanic peoples the Elves and Eese were originally beneficial beings as seen by numerous names like Alfréd (OE *Elf-ræd* ‘Elf-counsel’), Oswald (OE *Ós-weald* ‘Os-power’), Elfwin (Lomb. *Alb-oin* ‘Elf-friend’), Oshelm (Lomb. *Anselm* ‘Os-helmet’).

3 *þis þé tó bóte* ‘This for thee as remedy’ | The three-fold repetition of this phrase is formulaic; cf. *Birð* I 1.

- 7      **F**leo þær on · **f**yrgeð-hæfde!  
 2      **H**âl wes-tu, · **h**elpe þín drihten!  
         Nim þonne þæt seax, á-dó on wætan.

TODO.

Hale be thou, may the Lord help thee.

Take then the knife, TODO.



# Three Galders for Birth

**Dating:** TODO  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

This text properly seems to consist of three separate galders/rituals for childbirth.

Found in *Lácn*, fol. 185r–v.

## Text

### Galder I

- P1 Sé wíf-man, sé hire cild a·fédan ne mæg, gange tó ge·witenes mannes  
2 birgenne and stæppe þonne þriwa ofer þá byrgenne and cweþe  
þonne þriwa þás word:

TODO: translation.

- 1 þis mé tó bóte þære lāðan læt-byrde,  
2 þis mé tó bóte þære swæran swært-byrde,  
þis mé tó bóte þære lāðan lam-byrde.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

---

<sup>1</sup> þis mé tó bóte ‘This for me as remedy’ | The three-fold repetition of this phrase is formulaic; cf. *Férst* 6/3 n.

- P2 And þonne þæt wíf séo mid bearne and héo tó hyre hlāforde on  
2 reste gá, þonne cweþe héo:

TODO: translation.

- 2      **U**p ic gonge, · ofer þe stæppe  
 2      mid cwican cilde, · nalæs mid cwellendum,  
       mid ful-borenum, · nalæs mid fægan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- P3**      And þonne seo módor ge·fele þæt þæt bearn sí cwic, gá þonne  
 2      tó cyrican, and þonne héo tó·foran þan weofode cume, cweþe  
       þonne:

TODO: translation.

- 3      **C**riste, ic sæde, · þis ge·cýþed!

TODO: TRANSLATION.

## Galder II

- P1**      Se wíf-mōn, se hyre bearn a·fēdan ne mæge, ge·nime héo sylf  
 2      hyre āgenes cildes ge·byrgenne dæl, wry æfter þonne on blace  
       wulle and be·bicge tó cépe-mannum and cweþe þonne:

TODO: translation.

- 1      Ic hit be·bicge, · ge hit be·bicgan,  
 2      þás sweartan wulle · and þysse sorge corn.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

## Galder III

- P1**      Se man se þe mæge bearn a·fēdan, nime þonne ánes bleos cú  
 2      meoluc on hyre handæ and ge·supe þonne mid hyre múþe and  
       gange þonne tó yrnendum wætere and spiwe þær in þá meolc  
 4      and hlade þonne mid þære ylcan hand þæs wæteres múð fulne  
       and for·swelge. Cweþe þonne þás word:

TODO: translation.



- 1      Ge·hwer férde ic mé þone mǣran · maga þihtan,  
2      mid þysse mǣran · mēte þihtan;  
         þonne ic mé wille habban · and hām gáan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- P2      þonne héo tó þan broce gá, þonne ne be·seo héo, nó ne eft þonne  
2      héo þanan gá, and þonne gá héo in óþer hús óþer héo út of·éode  
         and þær ge·byrge metes.

TODO: translation.



# For Theft of Cattle

**Dating:** TODO.

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

Likely Christianized, but may still contain some pre-Christian elements.

From Corpus Christi College, Cambridge MS 41, p.206.

Note the curious overuse of the prefix *oð-*.

## Text

- P1      Ne for·stolen ne for·holen nanuht, þæs ðe ic age, þe ma ðe mi-  
2           hte Herod urne drihten. Ic ge·þohte sancte Ead-Elenan and ic  
          ge·þóhte Crist on róde á·hangen; swa ic þence þis feoh to find-  
4           anne, næs to oð·feorrganne, and to witanne, næs to oð·wyrceanne,  
          and to lufianne, næs to oð·lædanne.

TODO: translation

- 1      Gar·mund, · Godes ðegen,  
2           find þæt feoh · and fere þæt feoh  
          and hafa þæt feoh · and heald þæt feoh  
4           and fere hām þæt feoh.  
          þæt he næfre næbbe landes, · þæt he hit oð·læde,  
6           ne foldan, · þæt hit oð·ferie,  
          ne hūsa, · þæt he hit oð·healde.  
8           Gif hyt hwa ge·dó, · ne ge·dige hit him næfre.  
          Binnan þrym nihtum · cunne ic his mihta,  
10          his mægen and his mihta · and his mund·cræftas.

Eall he weornige, · swa fyer wudu weornie,  
12 swa breðel · beo swa þystel,  
se ðe ðis feoh · oð·fergean þence  
14 oððe ðis orf · oð·ehtian ðence.

Amen.

TODO: translation

# Against a Swarm

## (*Wið ymbe*)

Dating: ?

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO. That bees are called “victory-wives” is interesting.

### Text

P1      Wið ymbe nim eorþan, ofer-weorp mid þínre swiþran handa un-  
2            der þínum swiþran fêt, and cwet:

Against a swarm take earth, throw it with thy right hand under thy right foot, and say:

1      Fó ic under fót, · funde ic hit.  
2      Hwæt eorðe mæg · wið ealra wihta ge-hwilce  
         and wið andan · and wið æminde  
4      and wið þá micelan · mannes tungan.

I catch under foot, I may have found it.  
How, earth works against everywhich wight  
and against mischief and against neglect  
and against that mighty tongue of man.

---

4 þá micelan · mannes tungan ‘that mighty tongue of man’ | The tongue is surely here standing in for “speech”, specifically galder; i.e., if the swarming of the bees were caused by an enemy’s cursing, the earth will disarm it.

P2      And wiððon for-weorp ofer greót, þonne hí swirman, and cweð:

And with that throw the grit over, when they swarm, and say:

---

1 for-weorp ofer greót 'throw the grit over' | i.e., "throw the earth over the swarm".

- 2     Sitte gé, **s**ige-wíf, · **s**ígað to eorþan!  
 2     Næfre gé **w**ilde · to **w**uda fleogan.  
       Beo gé swá ge·**m**indige · **m**ínes gódes,  
 4     swá bið **m**anna ge·hwilc · **m**etes and éþeles.

Sit ye, victory-wives; sink to the earth!  
 Never ye would fly to the woods.  
 Be ye so mindful of *my* good,  
 like is every man of his measure and homestead.

# Against Wen

## (*Wið Wennan*)

**Dating:** ca. 1150 AD  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

British Library MS Royal 4.A.xiv, fol. 106v.

An exorcistic galder. The text has early Middle English features like the turning of old *f* to *v*.

### Text

- 1      **W**enne, **W**enne · **W**enchichenne,  
2      hér ne scealt þú **t**imbrien, · ne nenne **t**ún habben,  
     ac þú scealt **n**orþ heonene · tó þan **n**ihgan berhge,  
4      þer þú havest **e**rming, · **é**ne bróþer.  
     Hé þe sceal **l**egge · **l**eaft et héafde.  
6      Under **f**ót wolmes, · under **v**eþer earnes,  
     under **e**arnes cléa, · **á** þú ge·weornie.

O WEN, O WEN, O little Wen!

Here shalt thou not make a home nor have any dwelling,  
but thou shalt go north hence to the nearest barrow,  
where thou, wretched thing, hast a brother.

He shall lay a leaf by thy head.

Under the foot of the TODO, under the feather of the eagle,  
under the claw of the eagle mayst thou ever be.

- 8      **C**linge þú · al-swa **c**ol on heorþe,

- 10        *scringe þú · al-swa scerne* awage,  
         and *weorne þú · al-swa weter* on anbre.  
         Swá *litel þú ge·wurþe · al-swa lín-sét*-corn,  
12        and miccli lesse al-swa ánes hand-wurmes hupeban,  
         and al-swa litel þú ge·wurþe þet þú ná-wiht ge·wurþe.

TODO: translation,  
and mayst thou become so little that thou becomest nothing.



# Against Water-Elf Disease

## (*Wið Wæter-ælf-ádle*)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

### Text

P1      Gif mon biþ on wæter-ælf-adle, þonne beoþ him þa hand-næglas  
2      wonne and þa eagan tearige and wile locian niþer. Do him þis  
to læce-dome: efor-þrote, cassuc, fone niþo-weard, eowberge,  
4      elehtre, eolone, mersc-mealwan crop, fen-minte, dile, lilie, attor-  
laþe, polleie, marubie, docce, ellen, felterre, wermod, streaw-  
6      bergean leaf, consolde; of-geot mid ealaþ, do halig-wæter tó, sing  
þis gealdor ofer þriwa:

TODO: translation

1      Ic bēnne a-wrāt · bēst beado-wræda,  
2      swa bēnne ne burnon, · ne burston,  
ne fundian, · ne feologan,  
4      ne hoppettan,  
ne wund wæxsian,  
6      ne dolh diopian;  
ac him self healde · hale-wæge,  
8      ne ace þe þon mâ, · þe eorþan on eare ace.

TODO: translation

- P2** Sing þis manegum sibum: Eorþe þe on·bere eallum hire mihtum  
2 and mægenum. Þas galdor mon mæg singan on wunde.

TODO: translation

# Acre-Boot

## (*Æcer-bót*)

**Dating:** ca. 1000

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The **Acre-Boot** (i.e., ‘Field-Remedy’, abbrev. *Æcer*) is an unusually long text mixing Catholic, Germanic, and Celtic elements.

*Æcer* is preserved in Cotton MS Caligula A VII, foll. 176r–178r.

### Text

P1      Hér ys seo bót, hú þú meaht þíne æceras bétan gif hí nellap wel  
2      wexan oþþe þær hwilc un·ge·défe þing on ge·dón bið on dry oððe  
    on lyb-lâce. Ge·nim þonne on niht, ær hyt dagige, feower tyrf  
4      on feower healfa þæs landes, and ge·mearca hú hý ær stódon.  
    Nim þonne ele and hunig and beorman, and ælces feos meolc þe  
6      on þæm lande sý, and ælces treow-cynnes dæl þe on þæm lande  
    sý ge·wexen, bútan heardan béaman, and ælcra nam cūpre wyrte  
8      dæl, bútan glappan ânon, and dó þonne hâlig-wæter ðær on, and  
    drype þonne þriwa on þone staðol þára turfa, and cweþe ðonne  
10      ðás word: „Crescite, wexe, et multiplicamini, and ge·mænig  
    fealda, et replete, and ge·fyllle, terre, þás eorðan. In nomine pa-  
12      tris et filii et spiritus sancti sit benedicti.“ And Pater Noster swá  
    oft swá þæt óðer. And bere siþþan ðá turf to circean, and mæsse-  
14      preost á·singe feower mæssan ofer þan turfon, and wende man  
    þæt gréne to ðan weofode, and siþþan ge·bringe man þá turf þær  
16      hí ær wæron ær sunnan setl-gange. And hæbbe him gæ·worht

of cwic-béame feower Cristes mælo and a·wite on ælcon ende:  
 18 „Matheus and Marcus, Lucas and Iohannes.“ Lege þæt Cristes  
 mæl on þone pyt neoþe-weardne, cweðe ðonne: „Crux Matheus,  
 20 crux Marcus, crux Lucas, crux Sanctus Iohannes.“

TODO.

**P2** Nim ðonne þá turf and sete ðær ufon on and cweþe ðonne nigon  
 2 siþon þás word: Crescite, and swa oft Pater Noster, and wende  
 þe þonne éast-weard, and on·lút nigon siðon éad-mód=lice, and  
 4 cweð þonne þás word:

TODO.

**1** „Éast-weard ic stande, · ârena ic mé bidde,  
 2 bidde ic þone mæran domine, · bidde ðone miclan drihten,  
 bidde ic ðone háligan · heofon-rices weard,  
 4 eorðan ic bidde · and up-heofon  
 and ðá sóþan · sancta Marian  
 6 and heofones meaht · and héah-reced,  
 þæt ic móte þis gealdor · mid gife drihtnes  
 8 tóðum on·týnan · þurh trumne ge·þanc,  
 á·weccean þas wæstmas · ús to woruld-nytte,  
 10 ge·fyllen þas foldan · mid fæste ge·léafan  
 wlitigigan þas wancg-turf, · swá sé witega cwæð  
 12 þæt sé hæfde áre on eorþ-ríce, · sé þe ælmyssan  
 dæalde dóm-lice · drihtnes þances.“

“Turned eastwards I stand; for mercies I bid;  
 I bid the famous *dominus*; I bid the great Lord;  
 I bid the holy Guardian of the Heavenly Kingdom;  
 Earth I bid and Up-heaven  
 and the true Saint Mary,  
 and Heaven's might and the high hall,  
 that I this galder with the grace of the Lord  
 may TODO...”

**P3** Wende þe þonne III sun-ganges, a·strece þonne on and-lang and  
 2 a·rim þær letanias and cweð þonne: „Sanctus, sanctus, sanctus  
 oþ ende.“

TODO.

- P4 Sing þonne Benedicite a·þenedon earmon and Magnificat and  
 2 Pater Noster III, and be·béod hit Criste and sancta Marian and  
 þære hâlgan rôde tó lofe and to weorþinga and þam âre þe þæt  
 4 land âge and eallon þam þe him under·ðeodde synt.

TODO.

- P5 Ðonne þæt eall síe ge·dón, þonne nime man un·cúp sáð æt ælmes-  
 2 mannum and selle him twá swylc, swylce man æt him nime, and  
 ge·gaderie ealle his sulh-ge·teogo to·gædere; borige þonne on  
 4 þam béame stor and finol and ge·hâlgode sápan and ge·hâlgod  
 sealt. Nim þonne þæt sáð, sete on þæs sules bodig, cweð þonne:

TODO.

- 2 „Erce, Erce, Erce, · eorþan módor,  
 2 ge·unne þe se al-walda, · éce drihten,  
 æcera wexendra · and wrídendra,  
 4 eacniendra · and elniendra;  
 sceafta héhre · scíre wæstma,  
 6 and þære brádan · bere-wæstma,  
 and þære hwítan · hwæte-wæstma,  
 8 and ealra · eorþan wæstma.

“Erc, Erc, Erc, mother of the earth,  
 TODO...”

- 3 Ge·unne him · éce drihten  
 2 and his hâlige, · þe on heofonum synt,  
 þæt hys yrþ sí ge·friþod · wið ealra feonda ge·hwæne,  
 4 and heo sí ge·borgen · wið ealra bealwa ge·hwylc,  
 þára lyb-lâca · geond land sáwen.

TODO.

- 4 Nú ic bidde ðone waldend, · sé ðe ðás wor-uld ge·sceóp,  
 2 þæt ne sý nán tó þæs cwíðol wíf · ne tó þæs cræftig man  
 þæt á·wendan ne mæge · word þus ge·cwedene.“

Now I bid the Wielder who created this world,  
 that there may be no wife so cunning in song nor no man so strong  
 that he may turn about the words thus spoken.”

- P6 Þonne man þá sulh forð drife þá forman furh on·scéote, cweð  
 2 þonne:

TODO.

- 5 „Hál wes þú, Folde, · fir<sup>ha</sup> módor!  
 2 Beo þú grówende · on Godes fæþme,  
 fódre ge·fyllen · fir<sup>hum</sup> tó nytte.“

“Hale be thou, Fold, mother of men!  
 Be thou growing in God’s embrace,  
 filled with fodder as a boon to men.”

- P7 Nim þonne ælces cynnes melo and a·bacæ man inn·werdre handa  
 2 brádnæ hláf and ge·cneð hine mid meolce and mid hálīg-wætere  
 and lecge under þa forman furh. Cweþe þonne:

TODO.

- 6 „Ful æcer fódres · fir<sup>ha</sup> cinne,  
 2 beorht·blowende, · þú ge·blétsod weorþ  
 þæs hálīgan nōman · þe ðás heofon ge·sceop  
 4 and þas eorþan · þe wé on lifiaþ;  
 sé god, sé þas grundas ge·worhte, · ge·unne ús growende gife,  
 6 þæt ús corna ge·hwylc · cume tó nytte.“

“Acre full of fodder for the race of men,  
 brightly blooming! Thou wast blessed  
 by the holy name which created this heaven  
 and this earth upon which we live.  
 The God who wrought these lands, grant us growing grace  
 that each kind of grain may be for us a boon.”

- P8 Cweð þonne III: „Crescite in nomine patris, sit benedicti. Amen“,  
 2 and Pater Noster þriwa.

TODO.

## Old Norse galders





# SJy 41 (SJy 41; Ribe galder-stick)

**Dating:** Mediæval.

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law, Galders-law

## Introduction

A wooden stick from the Danish city of Ribe. The galder is syncretic and contains numerous pre-Christian elements in a Christian(ised) context.

The inscription may be conveniently divided into four parts. Part one (ll. 1–4) contains an introductory prayer where the healer asks for the aid of natural forces (Earth, Up-heaven and the Sun) and Christian divinities (God and Saint Mary) so that the healing may be successful. Part two (ll. 5–8) ritually exorcises any sickness which may have entered any part of the body. Part three (ll. 9–14) apparently warns the addressee that they will be haunted by “nine needs” (an old Heathen formula; see note) until they say the charm. Part four (ll. 15, which is probably prose) gives the personal name “Bonde”, perhaps the addressee, and concludes with an “Amen”.

## Transliteration

Note that the part of § C following ¶ is deliberately scraped off.

§ A + io<sup>^</sup>rp ÷ biþ a<sup>^</sup>k ÷ ua<sup>^</sup>rp ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k ÷ uphimæn ÷ so<sup>^</sup>l ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k ÷ sa<sup>^</sup>nt<sup>^</sup>Λ<sup>^</sup>maria ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k ÷ salfaen ÷ gud | |drotæn ÷ þæt han ÷ læ mik ÷ læknæs+ha<sup>^</sup>nd ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k lif-tuggæ ÷ at<sup>^</sup>liuæ

§ B uiuindnæ ÷ þær ÷ botæ ÷ þa<sup>^</sup>rf ÷ or ÷ ba<sup>^</sup>k ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k or bræst ÷ or lækæ ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k or lim ÷ or øuæn ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k or øræn ÷ or ÷ a<sup>^</sup>llæ þe ÷ þær ÷ ilt ÷ kan i at

§ C kumæ ÷ suart ÷ hetær ÷ sten ÷ ha<sup>^</sup>n ÷ stær ÷ i ÷ hafæ ÷ utæ ÷ þær ÷ ligær ÷ a ÷ þe ÷ ni ÷ no<sup>^</sup>uþær ÷ þæ<sup>^</sup>lr ÷ l---r(a) ÷ (þ)en-nþæþeskulhuærki

§ D skulæ ÷ huærki ÷ sötæn ÷ sofæ ÷ æþ ÷ uarmnæn ÷ uakæ ÷ förr æn ÷ þu ÷ þæssa ÷ bot ÷ biþær ÷ þær ÷ a<sup>^</sup>k o<sup>^</sup>rp ÷ at kæþæ ÷ ro<sup>^</sup>nti ÷ amæn ÷ o<sup>^</sup>k þæt ÷ se +

## Text

- Iorð bið ak varðe · ok up-himen  
 2 sól ok sante María · ok salfen Guð dróttan  
 þet hann lē mik lēknes-hand · ok lyf-tunge  
 4 at lyfe *bifjande* · þer bóte þarf.

I bid Earth to guard and Up-heaven,  
 the Sun and Saint Mary, and the very Lord God  
 that he lend me a leecher's hand and a medicine-tongue  
 as medicine for the trembler who needs the remedy.

1 Iorð bið ak varðe · ok up-himen 'I bid Earth to guard and Up-heaven' | *Iorð ... ok up-himen* 'Earth ... and Up-heaven' is a formulaic and originally pre-Christian merism representing the totality of the Cosmos; cf. *Vsp* 3. It is here used in a syncretic magical context; the *galer* (galder-singer) asks the Cosmos itself to watch over and protect him/her as he/she utters the magic words. A notable parallel to the present instance is found in the OE *Æcer* 1/4 (ca. 1000 AD), edited above. Cf. also a 14th c. version of the Icelandic *Gríða-mál* 'Grith-speech', a legal formula for the establishments of truces between former enemies, where we read that: *Jorð rēðr gríðum fyrir neðan, en upp-himinn varðar fyrir ofan, en sjór fyrir útan, sá er kringir um öll lönd*. 'The earth rules the griths from below, and Up-heaven guards them from above, and the sea from without which encircles all lands' (*DI* II, p. 659). For an older version of the *Gríða-mál* lacking the just-cited passage cf. *Gr* 73. Due to its invocation of pre-Christian cosmology and its use of likely pre-Christian legal formulae like *rēkr ok rekinn* 'fit to be driven out and exiled' and *gríð-niðings nafn* 'name of a grith-nothing' (which in *Vatn* 26 is paired with the certainly pagan legal term *gōða-gremi* 'wrath of the gods'; cf. *Hárð* 60 n.) it is likely that the *Gríða-mál* reflects a late remnant of pre-Christian law. Together with the present galder and *Æcer* 1/4 all three texts appear to reflect a common pre-Christian Germanic ritual expression.

- Ór bak ok ór brýst  
 6 ór líke ok ór lim  
 ór øven ok ór øren  
 8 ór alle þé · þer illt kann í at·kume.

Out of back and out of breast!  
 Out of body and out of limb!  
 Out of eyes and out of ears!  
 Out of everything, where evil might come in!

- Svart hêter stênn · hann stér í hafé úte,  
 10 þer ligger á þé níu nauðer;  
 þé skule hverki sôten sofe;  
 12 eð varmen vake;  
 fœrr en þú þessa bót biðer,  
 14 þer ak orð · at·kvêðe rúnti.  
 Amen ok þat sé.

Swart is a stone called; it stands out in the ocean.

There lie on it nine needs;

they will neither sleep sweetly

nor wake warmly,

until thou prayest this remedy

to which I have spoken the runic(?) words.

Amen and let it be so.

---

11 þé | *add., but scraped off and poorly legible* † ÷ þæſr ÷ l---r(a) ÷ (þ)en-nþþæþeskulhuærki† (*a poorly carved form of ll. 9–10*) SJy 41



# The Canterbury Galder (E DR419)

**Dating:** ca. 1075  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

This Old Norse galder (abbrev. *Cant*, with runological signum E DR419) is found in the Anglo-Saxon manuscript Cotton Caligula A XV. It runs across the bottom margin of the two facing pages 123v and 124r and is written in very clear runes of Wiking Age long-stave type. One rune, **g** in **vigi** *vegi* ‘smite’ is stung. The text has no word separators.

The galder is very similar to U Fv1933;134 and U NOR1998;25 from Sig-tuna, Sweden. They all belong to a type of magical healing where an illness-causing devil is commanded to leave the suffering person. The final line, *viðr áðra-vari* ‘against pus of veins’ is probably a declaration of purpose.

## Text

Gyrils sár-þvara!  
2 Far þú nú, · fundinn es-tu!  
Þórr vegi þik · þursa dróttinn!  
4 Jórils sár-þvara!  
Viðr áðra-vari.

O Gyrel’s wound-borer!  
Go thou now; found art thou!  
May Thunder smite thee, lord of Thurses!  
O Erel’s wound-borer!  
Against pus of veins.

---

3 þursa dróttinn ‘lord of Thurses’ | Formulaic, also found in U Fv1933;134 and *Þrk* 6/2 (n), 11/2 etc.



# Sigtuna rib (U NOR1998;25)

**Dating:** ca. 1100

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

## Text

- Jórls vrið, ... vaksna úr Króki!  
2      Batt han riðu · barði hann riðu,  
     auk síða sarð · sára rann.  
4      Vara hafir fullt fengit; · flý braut, riða!

O Erel's trembling, grow out of Crook!  
He bound the fever; he beat the fever,  
and thereafter fucked(?) the house of wounds.  
The pus has he fully caught—fly away, fever!





# Sigtuna Plate I (U Fv1933;134)

Dating: C11th  
Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction

## Text

Þurs sár-riðu, · þursa dróttinn;  
2 fliu þú nú · fundinn es!  
'Af þér þríar þráar, ulfr;  
4 'af þér níu nððir, ulfr!  
'Efir þessi sér, auk es unir ulfr.  
6 Niut lyfja!

O thurse of the wound-fever, O lord of Thurses;  
fly thou now; found art thou!  
Have for thee three yearnings, O wolf!  
Have for thee nine needs, O wolf!  
He has this for himself, and the wolf is content.  
Benefit from the medicine!



# Högstena plate (Vg 216)

**Dating:** C12th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A runic-inscribed bronze plate found in a graveyard by Högstena church in Gudhem, West Geatland, Sweden.

NOTE: The original Norse text is a placeholder and should not be referenced. Cf. Pereswetoff-Morath (2019, pp. 169–188).

## Text

Galanda viðr · gongla viðr  
2 riðanda viðr · viðr rinnanda  
viðr sæljanda · viðr signanda  
4 viðr faranda · viðr fliuganda.  
Skal alt furna uk um døia.



# Galders from Bryggen

## Introduction

Several galders or magical inscriptions are part of the cache of mediæval rune-inscribed objects found at Bryggen in the city of Bergen, Norway. For simplicity's sake, they are here listed in ascending order of their runological numbers.

### N B257

**Dating:** ca. 1335

**Meter:** Galders-law

A stick inscribed on four planed sides. Part of the stick is broken off, which renders the text incomplete. The inscription is clearly a “love-charm” (that is, a piece of sexually coercive magic), addressed—as shown by the feminine dative *sjalfri þér* ‘thy self’ on side D—to a woman. The language closely resembles that of *Skí* 36, in which Shirner, Free’s servant, threatens to carve a runic inscription which will curse the ettin-woman Gird with *ęrgi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’, *óði* ‘madness’, and *ó-þoli* ‘restlessness, impatience’ unless she sleep with his master. It seems that we are here dealing with just such a surviving runic curse, and that *Skí* 36 is reflecting an authentic form of Norse “love magic” (for it is unlikely that the present inscription should derive directly from that poem) by which a woman is cursed with sexual restlessness until she succumb to the will of the male curser.

A more distant parallel may be seen in the curse-formula found on the two C7th runic inscriptions from Stentoften and Björketorp (see TODO), wherein the destroyer of the respective monuments is cursed to become *herma-lauser argjú* ‘restless (a different root from *ó-þoli* above!) with queerness’, i.e., ‘incessantly randy’.

Side D ends with a string of fake-Latin gibberish, a clear sign of Christian syncretic influence on the Old Norse-Germanic magical tradition.

A      Ríst ek **b**ót-rúnar · ríst ek **b**jarg-rúnar  
            **e**in-falt við **q**lfum

- 4            **tví**-falt við **trollum**  
              **þrí**-falt við **þursum**

I carve remedy-runes, I carve rescue-runes:  
 onefold against elves,  
 twofold against trolls,  
 threefold against thurses.

---

1 bót-rúnar ... bjarg-rúnar 'remedy-runes ... rescue-runes' | Cf. *Sigrdr* 17/1.

- B**        Við inni **skóðu** · **skag**-val-kyrju  
 2        svá't **ei** megí · þó at **é** vili  
              **lé**-vís kona · lífi þínu *granda*.

Against the scatheful shag-walkirrie,  
 so that she may not—though she always wants to—  
 that guile-wise woman—harm thy life.

- C**        Ek **sendir** þér · ek **sé** á þér  
 2        **ylgjar** **ergi** · ok **ó**-þola;  
              á þér hríni **ó**-þoli · ok **jǫ**tuns móðr;  
 4        **sit**-tu aldri, · **sop**-tu aldri.

I send to thee, I see on thee  
 a she-wolf's queerness and restlessness;  
 may restlessness stick on thee, and an ettin's wrath!  
 Never sit, never sleep!

- D**        Ant mér sem sjalfri þér.  
 2        †**Beirist rubus rabus et arantabus laus abus rosa gava**†

Love me like thy self.

...

---

2 †**Beirist rubus rabus et arantabus laus abus rosa gava**† '...' | Latin-like gibberish.

## N B380

Dating: ?

Meter: Galders-law

A short little charm explicitly invoking the two most important Heathen Gods, Thunder and Weden. The inscription postdates the official conversion of Norway by over a hundred years, and it is an open question whether the two mentioned gods were still seen in a good light or whether they had already been assimilated into the Catholic system of demons and devils. This question is important since it determines the context of the letter: was it well-wishing, assuming that the receiver was of like mind to the sender, or did he have more sinister intent than the first line lets on? Judging from the first line, and from the half-Heathen contents of many other inscriptions found at Bryggen (some from as late as the C14th), I see it as crypto-Heathen.

2           Heill sé þú · ok í hugum góðum;  
              Þórr þik þiggi,  
              Óðinn þik ęgi.

Mayst thou be hale and in good spirits;  
may Thunder receive thee,  
may Weden own thee.

---

1 Heill sé þú · ok í hugum góðum 'Mayst thou be hale and in good spirits' | A formulaic greeting. The very same line is found in *Hym* 41; see note there for parallels.

3 Óðinn þik ęgi 'may Weden own thee' | See note to *Vsp* 23.





# Runic Poetry



## Introduction to Runic Poetry

Not all poetry preserved in Runic inscriptions is included here. Magical inscriptions will be edited under Galders and the Runic version of the *Dream of the Rood* under Poetry on Christian Subjects.

Metrically the poetry is generally in Ancient-words-law. A few fragments from Jutland are in Leeds-meter and two from Sweden are in Court-spoken meter.



# Introduction to the Rune Poems

## Runes and other European alphabets

The *runes* are the earliest recorded script for writing the Germanic languages and as such of great cultural importance. Runic inscriptions survive from all three Germanic branches: East Germanic, West Germanic, and North Germanic, and the script remained in unbroken use by Germanic speakers for a period spanning almost twenty centuries. The earliest known inscription is the stone from Hole, Norway (TODO: cite) from around 100 AD, and as late as the 19th century farmers in Dalarna, Sweden, were still using a form of runes to communicate with each other (TODO: cite).

Like the Latin or Greek the runes are an *alphabet*, which means that each symbol or letter stands for a phoneme or sound, rather than a syllable or an idea. The runes must ultimately derive from the Greek alphabet, which in turn derives from the Phoenician abjad, an adaptation of the Egyptian Hieroglyphs. The runes cannot be directly derived from the Greek

## The Rune poems

The order and names of the letters in the Runic alphabets or *futharks* stayed relatively consistent throughout the many centuries and countries in which they were used. This can probably be ascribed to the *rune poems*—poetic lists of the names of each rune with a short explanation, passed down orally as mnemonic devices to aid early Germanic learners who were doubtless far more accustomed to learn poems by heart than symbols and would greatly have profited from them in their gradual ascent to literacy.

Three such rune poems survive, from three countries: England, Norway, and Iceland. The English rune poem documents the English *futhorc*, while the Norwegian and Icelandic document the Scandinavian *younger futhark*.

When compared to the Common Germanic *elder futhark*, these two daughter scripts have taken opposing paths. Whereas the English futhorc has appended several letters for new vowels to the end of the rune row, the Scandinavian futhark has instead done away with numerous runes, namely those for *ng*, plosives *d*, *g*, *p*, the semi-vowel *w* and the vowels *o* and *e*, along with the obscure hook-shaped rune (TODO). That much of this simplification was

probably intentional, rather than the result of neglect or language change, is seen from the following facts.

First, several of the lost runes stood for sounds that did not undergo any major sound shifts in the North Germanic languages in the relevant time period. For instance, all modern Scandinavian dialects still clearly distinguish between the initial consonants in the descendants of *dagr* 'day' and *Týr* 'Tew', and most even have the same articulation of these consonants as modern English.

Second, in two archaic runic inscriptions we find clear proof that the names and sound values of some of the lost runes were still remembered and passed down even after the adoption of the simplified younger futhark. On the Swedish Rök stone (Ög 136), which is mostly composed in the younger futhark, runes of the elder futhark are used in a cipher, which works in the following way: Every younger futhark rune representing two distinct phonemes, where one of those was the sound value of that rune in the elder futhark system, and the other has been assimilated from a lost rune, is replaced by the elder futhark rune whose value it assimilated. For instance, the **k** rune, which in the elder futhark stood for only /k/, but which in the younger futhark stands for both /k/ and /g/, is replaced with the old **g** rune. A similar instance of two-scriptedness is found on the Ingelsta stone (Ög 43), where the old **d** rune is used in an otherwise younger futhark inscription, probably standing for its name *dagr* 'day', which is also attested as a male given name.

Third, there is virtually no regional variation in which runes disappear in the transition from elder to younger futhark. There is some variation in their shapes, but there is no region which, say, simplifies only the plosive consonants *t/d*, *k/g*, *b/p* > *t*, *k*, *b*, but retains the written distinction between *o* and *u*—they all go away at once.

These facts point away from neglect or a natural development of the script—they instead suggest deliberate reform. Since we lack historical sources, the motivations behind such a reform can only be guessed at, but making the script simpler may have been intended to increase literacy by making it easier to learn and faster to write. If this were the case it was certainly successful: the transition to the simplified younger futhark brings with it a huge increase in inscriptions in Scandinavia, along with interest in various ciphers, and a new tradition of inscribed stones in Denmark, where they were previously unknown.

This new system also quickly gave rise to even more simplified systems, like the "short-stave" runes found already on the C9th Rök stone, or the "staveless" runes known from northern Sweden. Both of these variants make it even faster to write on materials like wood, wax and bone; the runes also take up less space—very useful for carvers writing on limited surfaces.

In any case, the names of the runes seem to have survived these developments. Of the 16 runes found in both the English and Icelandic (which appears to be more conservative than the Norwegian) rune poems, 10—**f**, **r**, **h**, **n**, **i**, **j**, **s**, **b**, **m** and **l**—have etymologically identical names. Three of the remaining six—**þ**, **a** and **t**—in the Icelandic stand for words with clear Hea-

then associations—Thurse, Os, and Tew—and so may have been changed deliberately after the conversion of England, rather than lost in the process of oral transmission. Two more—**u** and **k**—have names which agree in form but not in meaning. Thus it is only for the old **ᚱ**-rune where there is complete disagreement about the original name. This is easily understood, since the sound which that rune designated was lost in early Old English.





# The Old English Rune Poem

**Dating:** C8th–C10th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The **Old English Rune Poem** (abbrev. *RunOE*) is the oldest of the three old rune poems. It describes the 29 runes of the Anglo-Saxon Futhorc.

## Textual preservation and transmission

*RunOE* only survives in the printed edition of Hickes (1703–1705, vol. 1, pp. 135), based on the original manuscript which was certainly destroyed in the Cottonian fire of 1731.

Hickes introduces the poem with the following words (original emphasis kept): *E Codice MS. Bibliothecæ Cottonianæ, cujus nota, Otho, B. 10.* ‘From a manuscript codex of the Cotton Library, whose shelfmark is Otho B. 10.’

TODO: Note on the visual layout. Cite Males article on Rune poems.

## Meter and stanza

The poem is divided into stanzas, one for each rune. Unlike the two Scandinavian rune-poems, the stanzaic structure of *RunOE* is somewhat uneven, and the stanzas vary in length between 2 and 5 lines. The most common length is 3 lines (19/29: 1–8, 11–14, 16–17, 23–24, 26–28), followed by 4 lines (7/29: 15, 18–22, 25). Rarer lengths are 2 lines (9–10) and 5 lines (29).

## Text

- 1        (feoh) byþ frófur · fira ge·hwylcum.  
2        Sceal ðeah manna ge·hwylc · miclun hyt dælan  
         gif he wile for drihtne · dómes hleotan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 2 (ur) byþ **ân**-mód · and **ofer**-hyrned,  
 2 **fela-frécne** deor, · **feohteþ** mid hornum,  
**mære mór**-stapa; · þæt is **módig** wuht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 3 (ðorn) byþ **ðearle** scearp; · **ðegna** ge·hwylcum  
 2 **an-feng** ys **yfyl**, · **un**-ge·metun reþe  
**manna** ge·hwylcun · ðe him **mid** resteð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 4 (os) byþ **ord**-fruma · **ælc**re spræce,  
 2 **wis-dómes** **wraþu** · and **witena** frofur,  
 and **eorla** ge·hwam · **ead**-nys and to·hiht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 5 (rad) byþ on **recyde** · **rinca** ge·hwylcum  
 2 **sefte**, and **swiþ**-hwæt · ðam ðe **sitteþ** on ufan  
**meare mægen**-heardum · ofer **míl**-paþas.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 6 (cen) byþ **cwicera** ge·hwam · **cūþ** on fyre,  
 2 **blac** and **beorht-líc**, · **byrneþ** oftust  
 ðær hí **æþelingas** · **inne** restaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 7 (gyfu) **gumena** byþ · **gleng** and herenys,  
 2 **wraþu** and **wyrþ**-scype, · and **wræcna** ge·hwam  
**ar** and **ætwist** · ðe byþ **oþra** leas.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 8 (wen) ne bruceþ · ðe can **wéana** lýt,  
 2 **sâres** and **sorge**, · and him **sylfa** hæfþ  
**blæd** and **blysse** · and eac **byrga** ge·niht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 9 (hægl) byþ hwítust corna; · hwyrft hit of heofones lyfte,  
 2 wealcaþ hit windes scura, · weorþeþ hit to wætere syððan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 10 (nyd) byþ nearu on breostan, · weorþeþ hi ðeah oft niþa  
 bearnum  
 2 to helpe and to hæle ge·hwæþre, · gif hí his hlystaþ æror.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 11 (is) byþ ofer-ceald, · un-ge-metum slidor,  
 2 glisnaþ glæs-hluttur, · gimum ge-licust,  
 flor forste ge·woruht, · fæger an-sýne.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 12 (ger) byþ gumena hiht, · ðon God læteþ,  
 2 hālig heofones cyning, · hrusan syllan  
 beorhte bleða · beornum and ðearfum.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 13 (eoh) byþ utan · un-smeþe treow,  
 2 heard, hrusan fæst, · hyrde fyres,  
 wýrt-rumun under·wreþyd, · wýnan on éþle.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 14 (peorð) byþ symble · plega and hlehter  
 2 [...] wlancum · ðar wigan sittað  
 on beor-sele · bliþe æt·somne.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 15 (eolhx)-secg eard hæfþ · oftust on fenne,  
 2 wexeð on wature, · wundaþ grimme,  
 blode breneð · beorna ge·hwylcne  
 4 ðe him ænigne · on-feng ge·deð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 16 (sigel) sé-mannum · symble biþ on hihte,  
 2 ðonn hi hine fēriap · ofer fīscas beþ,  
 oþ hí brim-hengest · bringeþ to lande.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 17 (tir) biþ tǣcna sum, · healdeð trywa wel  
 2 wiþ æþelingas, · â biþ on færylde,  
 ofer nihta ge·nīpu · næfre swiceþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 18 (beorc) byþ bleða leas, · bereþ efne swa ðeah  
 2 tǣnas b·utan tudder, · biþ on telgum wlitig,  
 heah on helme · hrysted fægere,  
 4 ge·loden leafum, · lyfte ge·tenge.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 19 (eh) byþ for eorlum · æþelinga wyn,  
 2 hors hófum wlanc, · ðær him hæleþe ymb,  
 welege on wicgum, · wrixlāþ spræce,  
 4 and biþ un-styllum · æfre frofur.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 20 (man) byþ on myrgþe · his magan leof;  
 2 sceal þeah ânra ge·hwylc · oðrum swīcan,  
 for ðam dryhten wyle · dōme sīne  
 4 þæt earme flæsc · eorþan be·tæcan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 21 (lagu) byþ leodum · lang-sum ge·þuht,  
 2 gif hí sculun neþun · on nacan tealtum,  
 and hi sæyþa · swýþe bregaþ,  
 4 and se brim-hengest · bridles ne gymeð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 22 (ing) wæs ærest · mid Éast-Denum  
 2 ge·sewen sæcgun, · oþ he siððan éast

- ofer wæg ge-wât, · wæn æfter rann;  
 4 ðus heardingas · ðone hæle nēmdun.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 23 (eþel) byþ ofer-leof · æg·hwylcum men,  
 2 gif he mot ðær rihtes · and ge·rysena on  
 brúcan on blode · bleadum oftast.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 24 (dæg) byþ drihtnes sond, · deore mannum,  
 2 mære metodes leoht, · myrgþ and to·hiht  
 eadgum and earmum, · eallum brice.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 25 (ac) byþ on eorþan · ęlda bearnum  
 2 flæsces fódor, · fereþ ge·lome  
 ofer ganotes bæþ; · gâr·secg fandaþ  
 4 hwæþer âc hæbbe · æþele treowe.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 26 (æsc) biþ ofer-heah, · ęldum dýre,  
 2 stiþ on staþule, · stęde rihte hylt,  
 ðeah him feohtan on · firbas mōnige.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 27 (yr) byþ æþelinga · and eorla ge·hwæs  
 2 wyn and wyrþ·mynd, · byþ on wicge fæger,  
 fæst·lic on fær·elde, · fyrd·geatewa sum.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 28 (iar, ior) byþ éa·fixa, · and ðeah á bruceþ  
 2 fódres on foldan, · hafaþ fægerne eard,  
 wætre be·worpen, · ðær he wynnum leofaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- 29      (ear) byþ egle · eorla ge·hwylcun,  
2      ðonn fæst-lice · flæsc on·ginneþ,  
         hraw colian, · hrusan ceosan  
4      blac to ge·beddan; · bleða ge·dreosaþ,  
         wyna ge·witaþ, · wera ge·swicaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

# The Icelandic Rune Poem

**Dating:** Mediæval.

**Meter:** Unclear.

## Introduction

The **Icelandic Rune Poem** (abbrev. *RunIce*) is one of two West Norse rune poems describing the Younger Futhark.

## Textual preservation and transmission

*RunIce* is preserved in several manuscripts, none mediæval. The oldest is AM 687 d 4to (henceforth 687d), dating to ca. 1500 AD, where the poem takes up the leaf 1v. In this ms. each rune takes up one line. The names of the runes are not given, but the name is written out by the rune, so that the first stanza begins *℔ er fr̥enda r̥óg*, the second *Λ er skýgia grátur*, and so forth. 687d/1v is not physically fragmented, but much of the ink has faded and large parts of the poem are therefore illegible.

TODO. It is only attested in late manuscripts which often have major disagreements with each other.

## Meter and stanza

The meter of *RunIce* is a divergent form of Leeds-meter. In particular, the a-verse always contains three lifts (certainly owing to the obligatory rune-name), and the c-verse may end in a dip following a heavy lift. The poem is strictly structured. Each rune is given two lines, the first consisting of two half-verses (the a- and b-verse), the second being a form of c-verse. These two lines will henceforth be referred to as stanzas.

## Style and contents

Like in the two other rune poems, the 16 runes in *RunIce* are described by reference to the object to which their name refers (*ƿǣ* ‘wealth’ for *℔*, etc.). Like its Scandinavian sister-poem *RunNor*, *RunIce* uses kennings to describe these

objects. Numerous such kennings are shared, sometimes word-for-word, between the two. Like in the two other rune poems, the very first word in each stanza is the respective rune's name, which is a noun. The name is then followed by exactly three kennings, one in each verse.

TODO: reference Mikael Males article about rune poems

## Text

- 1 Fé es frēnda róg · ok flóðar viti  
2 ok graf-seiðs gata.

Wealth is strife of kinsmen and beacon of the flood  
and grave-saith's [SERPENT'S] street.

---

1 frēnda róg 'strife of kinsmen' | Self-explanatory; wealth causes conflict between heirs. The same expression is found in *RunNor*.

1 flóðar viti 'beacon of the flood' | A formulaic type of GOLD-kennung (TODO: (Meissner 1921)); since gold does not rust, it is the fire which shines when submerged in water.

2 graf-seiðs gata 'grave-saith's [SERPENT'S] street' | Another formulaic kenning. The serpent or Wyrm that lies upon its hill of treasures is a prominent image in Old Germanic legend; cf. particularly Fathomer (*Reg*, *Fäfnir*, and *Völur*) and the unnamed dragon in *Beowulf*.

- 2 Úr es skýja grátr · ok skára þverrir  
ok hirðis hatr.

Drizzle is weeping of clouds and ...  
and shepherd's hatred.

- 3 Þurs es kvenna kvöl · ok kletta í-búi  
2 ok varð-rúnar verr.

Thurse is women's torment and indweller of hills  
and husband of the cairn-whisperess [TROLLWOMAN].

- 4 Öss es aldinn gautr · ok Ös-garðs jöfurr,  
2 ok Val-hallar vísi.

Os is ancient Geat, and Osyard's chief,  
and Walhall's overseer.

- 5 Reið es sitjandi sēla · ok snúðig ferð  
2 ok jóss erfði.



Chariot is sitting bliss and twirling journey  
and horse's heavy work.

- 6      Kaun es barna bōl · ok bar-dagi  
2              ok hold-fúa hús.

Boil is children's curse and TODO  
and house of flesh-rot.

- 7      Hagall es kalda korn · ok knappa drífa  
2              ok snáka sótt.

Hail is cold kernel and storm of beads  
and sickness of snakes.

- 8      Nauð es þýjar þró · ok þungr kost  
2              ok vās-samlig verk.

Need is maidservant's yearning and scant choice  
and working in wet-cold weather.

- 9      Íss es áar borkr · ok unnar þekja  
2              ok fęigra manna fār.

Ice is river's bark and wave's roof  
and fey men's danger.

- 10      Ár es gumna góði · ok gótt sumar  
2              ok al-gróinn akr.

Year is men's boon and good summer  
(and) all-grown acre.

- 11      Sól es skýja skjöldr · ok skínandi roðull  
2              ok ísa aldr-tregi.

Sun is the shield of clouds and shining wheel  
and ice-sheets' life-sorrow.

- 12      Týr es ęin-hęndr ęss · ok ulfs leifar  
2              ok hofa hilmir.

Tew is the one-handed Os and the wolf's leftovers

and lord of hoves.

- 13 Bjarkan es laufgat lim · ok lítit tré  
2 ok ung-samligr víðr.

Birch is leafy branch and little tree  
and youthful wood.

- 14 Maðr es manns gaman · ok moldar auki  
2 ok skipa skreytir.

Man is man's joy and the product of dust  
and adorning of ships.

- 15 Løgr es vellanda vatn · ok víðr ketill  
2 ok glömmungr grund.

Liquid is boiling water and wide kettle  
and TODO.

- 16 Ýr es bændr bogi · ok brot-gjarnt járn  
2 ok fēnju fleygir.

Yew is a bent bow and easily broken iron  
and arrow's hurler.

# The Norwegian Rune Poem

**Dating:** Mediæval.

**Meter:** Unclear.

## Introduction

The **Norwegian rune poem** (abbrev. *RunNor*) is one of two West Norse rune poems describing the 16 runes of the Younger Futhark.

## Textual preservation and transmission

TODO.

## Style and contents

*RunNor* is closely related to *RunIce*, which also describes the Younger Futhark. With the exception of runes 2 (N, here *úr* ‘spark’) and 4 (ʀ, here *óss* ‘river-mouth’), the names of the runes are identical between them, as are many of the poetic expressions.

The description of all runes consists of two clauses or sentences, generally one in each verse. The first clause gives the name of the rune and a short description of it, while the second clause is more tangential and oftentimes seems to have nothing to do with the name. A clever solution to this problem is that the second clause connects to the visual shape of the rune (TODO: cite). For some of the runes, this turns out to be a rewarding line of inquiry, and potential links between the shape of a rune and the second clause will be explored in the notes.

## Meter

Each rune is described by a couplet of 2 verses linked by both end-rhyme and alliteration. The meter is noticeably trochaic, and the end-rhyme of each verse always falls on a trochée. In 15 out of 16 lines, the a-verse has 2 alliterations. The b-verse always has exactly 1 alliteration, falling on its very first word.

### Language

The language is unmistakably that of mediæval Norway. As can be seen from the rhymes and alliteration the following uniquely Norwegian sound changes have occurred:

- *hl, hn, hr* > *l, n, r* (2 *lęyr* < *hlęyr*; 8 *nęppa* < *hnęppa*; 5 *rosum* < *brosum*).
- *rst* > *st* (5 *vęsta* < *vęrsta*)

## Text

1 Fé veldr frénda rógi; · fōðisk ulfr í skógi.

‘Wealth’ causes the strife of kinsmen; the wolf rears itself in the wood.

---

1 fōðisk ulfr í skógi ‘the wolf rears itself in the wood’ | Almost certainly visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the upwards curving branches of the pine tree; the keyword is *skógr* ‘wood, forest’.

2 Úr er af eldu jarni; · opt leypr reinn á hjarni.

‘Spark’ comes from glowing iron; oft leaps the reindeer on the snow.

---

1 Úr ‘Spark’ | Properly ‘drizzle’, but here used metaphorically for the sparks or tiny particles of hot metal that flow out of burning iron when struck.

1 opt leypr reinn á hjarni ‘oft leaps the reindeer on the snow’ | Likely visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the hoof-print of a reindeer in the snow; the keyword is *reinn* ‘reindeer’.

3 Þurs veldr kvinna kvillu; · kátr verðr fár af illu.

‘Thurse’ causes women’s ailment; few are gladdened by evil.

---

1 kátr verðr fár af illu ‘few are gladdened by evil’ | Lit. ‘few a man becomes glad from evil’. Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a smiling face; the keyword is *kátr* ‘glad, happy’.

4 Óss er flestra fęrða · fęr, en skalpr er sverða.

‘River-mouth’ is the route of most journeys, but the scabbard-mouth of swords.

---

1 en skalpr er sverða ‘but the scabbard-mouth of swords’ | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a sword in its scabbard, although that is uncertain.

5 Reįð kveða rossum vęsta; · Ręinn sló sverđit bęsta.

‘Chariot’ they say is worst for the horses; Rein forged the best sword.

6 Kaun er barna bęlván; · bęl gęrvir ná fęlván.

‘Ulcer’ is the curse of children; a bale makes a corpse pale.

7 Hagall er kaldastr korna; · Kristr skóp hęim’inn forna.

‘Hail’ is coldest of kernels; Christ created the world of yore.

1 Krístr skóp heim'inn förna 'Christ created the world of yore' | Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the chi-rho; the keyword is *Krístr* 'Christ'.

8 Nauðr görir neppa kosti; · nøktan kēlr í frosti.

'Need' gives scant choice; the naked man freezes in the cold.

1 nøktan kēlr í frosti 'the naked man freezes in the cold' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the human body in the form of a naked stick-figure; the keyword is *nøkt* 'naked'.

9 Ís kōllum brú breiða; · blindan þarf at leiða.

'Ice' we call a broad bridge; the blind man must be lead.

1 blindan þarf at leiða 'the blind man must be lead' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a blind man's cane or walking stick; the keyword is *blindr* 'blind'.

10 Ár er gumna góði; · get'k at qrr var Fróði.

'Year' is men's boon; I recall that Frood was generous.

1 get'k at qrr var Fróði 'I recall that Frood was generous' | Frood, or as he is often known, Frith-Frood (ON *fríð-Fróði*), was a legendarily generous Danish king during whose reign good harvests and peace (*ár ok fríðr* 'year and frith') abounded. He is thus mentioned due to his connection with the rune's name, not due to any visual elements of the rune.

11 Sól er landa ljómi; · lúti'k hēlgum dómi.

'Sun' is the light of the lands; I bow to the holy shrine.

1 lúti'k hēlgum dómi 'I bow to the holy shrine' | Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the shape of a kneeling man; the keyword is *lúti'k* 'I bow'.

12 Týr er ein-ēndr ása; · opt verðr smiðr blása.

'Tew' is the one-handed of the Eese; often the smith must blow.

1 opt verðr smiðr blása 'often the smith must blow' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the shape of the rune and a hammer; the keyword is *smiðr* 'smith'.

13 Bjarkan er lauf-grónstr lima; · Loki bar flérða tíma.

'Birch' is the leaf-greenest of branches; Lock was successful in cunning.

14      Maðr er moldar auki; · mikil er greip á hauki.

‘Man’ is the product of dust; mighty is the grip on the hawk.

---

1 mikil er greip á hauki ‘mighty is the grip on the hawk’ | Visually alluding to the shape of the bird’s talon; the keyword is *hawk* ‘hawk’.

15      Løgr er þar er fellr ór fjalli · foss; en gull eru nossir.

‘Water’ is when from the fell falls a torrent, but jewels are gold.

16      Ýr er vetr-grónstr viðá; · vęnt er, er brennr, at sviða.

‘Yew’ is winter-greenest of trees; ’tis expected, when it burns, to get singed.





# Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland

## Introduction

The inscriptions are sorted according to their runological signa as found in the Scandinavian Runic-text Data Base (SRDB). For most inscriptions the signum derives from the standard corpus edition *Sveriges runinskrifter* ('Runic inscriptions of Sweden') and consists of two elements, the abbreviated traditional province and the number given in the corpus edition. For example Sm 39 is the inscription given number 39 in the Småland volume of *Sveriges runinskrifter*.

Inscriptions discovered after the publication of the corpus edition describing the relevant province have instead of the number an abbreviated bibliographical reference to the *editio princeps*. For example Sö Fv1948;289 is a inscription from Södermanland first published in the 1948 volume of *Fornvännen*, page 289.

The province of Scania, although part of Sweden since 1658, was in the Wiking Age and the mediæval period an integral part of Denmark and as such its metrical inscriptions are found under Runic poetry from Denmark below.

## Abbreviations of Swedish provinces

- G = Gotland
- Nä = Närke
- Sm = Småland
- Sö = Södermanland
- U = Uppland
- Vg = Västergötland
- Vs = Västmanland

- Ög = Östergötland
- Öl = Öland

## G 113 (Ardre)

Dating: C12th

Location: Ardre church

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A picture stone. The palatal *r* has in several places been restored for the stone's *r*.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A ÷ utar + ak + kairuatr + ak + aiuatr + þar + setu + stain + ebtir + likna(t)  
+ faþur ÷ sen +  
§ B ÷ rapialbr + ak + kairaiu(t)- + þair kiarpu + merki + kuþ + ubtir + man  
+ saaran ÷ likraibr + risti + runar ÷

## Text

A Ótt·arr ok Gair·hvatr ok Ai·hvatr þair settu stain eptir Líkn·hvat,  
faður sinn.

Oughter and Garwhat and Eanwhat, they set the stone after Likenwhat, their father.

2 B Ráð·þialfr ok Gair·niautr,  
þair giörðu mērki góð · eptir mann snaran.  
4 Líkn·raifr risti rúnar.

Redthelf and Garneat,  
they made good landmarks after a swift man.  
Likenraf carved the runes.

## G 188

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A damaged and unusually difficult stone to interpret. Most of the inscription survives only in older depictions which are likely not entirely faithful.

## Runes

R1B1T + Y1B1T1N

B1T + 11T1N1

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

[... auk × botaiþr × þaun litu × raisa s... ... haito × mirki mirlakt eftir man  
koþ-n × kiarn uar × hann arla × a × kuþ troa × rumshafþ ×] rap(e)t × miþ  
r(e)tu m[iug × tyrlak × ta · ta × uam · la · reksþe... ...](b)in × sialu h-... [lit ×  
kjarþi stain × uataruek...]

## Text

- ... auk Bót·aiðr, þaun létu raisa *stain* †*haito*†  
2 *m*erki *m*ér-lekt · eptir *m*ann góðan;  
*g*iarn var hann árla · á *G*uð tróa.  
4 †*r*umshafþ† ráðit með réttu  
miuk dýr-lek †*t*a:*t*a:*u*am:*l*a:*r*eksþe†  
6 ... *b*ialpin síálu *h*ans.  
†*l*it† giarði stain †*u*ataruek†

... and Bootheath they had the stain raised ...

A glorious landmark after a good man.

He was early eager to believe in God;

... rightly interpreted,

very glorious ...

... help his soul.

... made the stone ...

---

1 þaun 'they' | The neuter pl. form indicates that the raisers are a mixed-sex group.

## G 203 (Hogräns)

Dating: C12th

Location: Hogräns church

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

sigmutr let rasa sain eftir bruþr : sina : auk : bro : kierua : eftir : sikbiern  
 : santa mikal hie[lbi] ... ..ans auk : at : botraif auk at sigraif : auk : at  
 aibiern : faþur þaira : altr : auk bikui han : i by : sunarst kairuiþr lekþi  
 ormalur nemr : in[t]i ur ¶ sikmutr [--fir :] sliku : unit kuml ¶ karmanum  
 : þet ar [:] ... kun : hier : mun : stanta stain : a[t] : merki bietr a : bierki  
 in bro furir ¶ roþ(b)iern risti run(i)r [þ]esa kairl-ifr sumar ar karla kan

## Text

Sig-mundr lét raisa stain eptir brýðr sína, auk bró gierva eptir  
 Sig-biern—Sankta Mikál hielpi *síal* hans—auk at Bót-raif auk at  
 Sig-raif auk at Ai-biern, faður þaira aldra,

Syemund had this stone raised after his brothers and the bridge made af-  
 ter Syebeorn—may Saint Michael help his soul—and after Bootraf and after  
 Syeraf and after Eanbeorn, the father of them all,

2 auk byggvi hann · í bý sunnarst.

and he lived on the southernmost farm.

Gairviðr lögði orm-álur; némr innti ýr.

Garwith laid the serpent-tracks; TODO.

4 Sig-mundr *hefir* · s-líku unnit  
 kuml karl-mannum. · Þet ar †*ke*...† kunn.

6 Hier mun standa · stainn at merki,

8           **b**iertr á **b**iergi, · en **b**ró fyrir;  
             Róð·biern **r**ísti · **r**únir þessar,  
             **G**air·laifr sumar, · ar **g**arla kann.

Syemund has suchwise accomplished  
 a monument for men; that is known to ...  
 Here the stone will stand as a mark,  
 bright on the hill and the bridge below.  
 Rothbeorn carved these runes,  
 [and] Garlaf, who knows clearly, some.

## G 207

Dating: C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A damaged stone. TODO. The same people also commissioned the likewise damaged G 208 below.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

butmuntr : auk : butraifr : auk : kunu[-r : þair : raistu : stain ...arþi  
: karþ] : auk : sunarla : sat : miþ : skinum : auk : han : entaþis : at :  
ulfshala : þa : [¶ han : hil(k)(i)...]

## Text

2           Bót·mundr auk Bót·raifr auk Gunn·*bvatr*, þair raistu stain ...  
          †arþi† garð,  
          auk sunnar-la · sat mið skinum;  
4           auk hann endaðis · at Ulfshala,  
          þa hann †hil(k)(i)† ...

Bootmund and Bootraf and Guthwhat, they raised the stone ... the enclosure,  
and in the south sat with skins,  
and he met his end by Wolfshale  
when he ...

## G 208

Dating: C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A damaged stone. TODO. The same people also commissioned the likewise damaged G 207 above.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

[b]u[t]muntr : auk : butraifr : auk : kunua-(r) [: -]... ...tu : stain : þ...  
 ... ...[at : faþur : si]n : kuþ : h(i)albi : (s)elu : hans : auk : kus : muþir :  
 (b)etr : þen : uir : biþia : kunin · ¶l -(a)... ... (a)-(n) (:)

## Text

Bot·mundr ok Bót·raifr ok Gunnþvatr þair raistu stain þenna  
 eptir ... -þvat, faður sinn.

2 Guð hialpi sélu hans · ok Guðs móðir  
 betr þen vír · biðja kunnin ...

Bootmund and Bootraf and Guthwhat, they raised this stone in memory of  
 ...-what, their father.

God help his soul and God's mother,  
 better than we were able to pray. ...



## G 343

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A ...n : raisti : kubl : eftir : hailkair : fa... ... 𐌺 (k)-... ... -aulu : hans :  
 eu : miþan : uaralt : uakir : ligr : merki : hier : yfir : mani : þaim : ar :  
 erfiki : iftir -erþi 𐌺 ... auk : þorlaifr : þau/þair : ristu stain  
 § B f-----...

## Text

- ... raisti kumbl eftir Hail·gair, faður ... sáulu hans.
- 2       Ey, miðan ver·ald vakir,  
       liggr mērki hier · yfir manni þaim,  
 4       ar erfingi · eftir gięðoi.  
       ... auk Þór·laifr, þau ristu stain.

TODO: trans

**G 370****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

uatar : auk hilkair : raistu : stain iftir hailka fþur : sin : hn : uahr -istr :  
farin miþ uikikum

**Text**

- Hvatarr ok Hail·gair raistu stain eptir Hailga, faður sinn.*  
2      Hann var *v*estr farinn · með *v*íkingum.

TODO: trans

## Nä 29

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

bofriþr : let resa eftir biurn : bruþur : si(n) : han uar farin fultrekila

### Text

Bó·friðr lét rêsa eftir Biorn, bróður sinn.

2 Hann var farinn · full-dręgi=la.

TODO: trans

## Sm 5

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO. The carver seems to struggle with consonant clusters. Thus he spells 2b *mestr* as **mesr** and 3b *aldri* as **ali**(!). Line 2 is found near-identically in Ög 77 and Sm 37 and line 3 in Vg 187.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A : kotr : sati : sten : þana : eftir : ketil :

§ B : sun : sin : han : far :

§ C : mana : mesr o:nipikr : er a : eklati : ali : tunþi

## Text

- 2           Gøtr satti stên þenna eptir Ketil sun sinn.  
           Hann var **man**na · **m**estr ó-níðingr  
           er á **E**ng-landi · **a**ldri týnði.

Geat set this stone after Kettle, his son.  
 He was of men the greatest un-nothing,  
 who in England lost his life.

---

3 *aldri* | *ali* Sm 5

---

2 *mestr* ó-níðingr ‘greatest un-nothing’ | An instance of *litotes*; Kettle was a very virtuous man.

## Sm 16

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A not very tall stone, inscribed on two sides. Side A (1 *Hró-stęinn* ... 3 *kęnni=ligt*) is marked with a large cross while side B (3 *ęptir* ... 5 *ręna*) is entirely unadorned.

The inscription uses the stung runes *e* and *y* and writes the vowel *o* with the old *q*-runes.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A rostein · auk · eilifr · aki : auk · hakun : reisþu · þeir · sueinar · eftir  
 sin · 𐌺 faþur · kubl 𐌺 keni·likt ·  
 § B ftir · kala · taþan : þy : mun · ko... .. -m kitit · uerþa · meþ · sin · lifir  
 · auk · stafir · run

## Text

2 Hró·stęinn auk E<sub>i</sub>·lifir, · Āki auk Hō·kun,  
 reistu þeir svęinar · ęptir sinn fōður  
 kumbl kęnni=ligt · ęptir Kala dauðan.  
 4 Þý mun góðs manns · um getit verða,  
 með stęinn lifir · ok stafir ręna.

Rothstan and Anlif, Onick and Hathkin,  
 these lads raised after their father  
 a remarkable monument, after the dead Cale.  
 Therefore will the good man be spoken of  
 while the stone lives and the staves of the runes.

**Sm 29****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

...r · rsþi · stin · eftir · þur(k)ir · faþur · sin · saR · (e)(t)aþis · a · -klanti ·

**Text**

- 2                    ...r rêsþi stên eftir Þór·gêR, fœður sinn;  
                     sár rendaðis · à Englandi.  
 ... raised the stone after Thurgar, his father.  
 He met his end in England.

## Sm 35 (Replösa)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A stone still standing at its original location. To its south is a stone ship original consisting of 12 stones.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

: kutraþr : karþi : kubl : þisi : iftir : astraþ : faþur : sin : þan : fritu : ak :  
þih:na : bistan : ir a : fin:iþi : forþum : ufl |fari :

## Text

2 Gaut-ráðr geðdi kuml þessi eptir Qst-ráð, fôður sinn.  
þann frënda · ok þegna bætstan, er á Finn-æiði · forðum of  
vári.

Geatred made these monuments after Estred, his father,  
the best of kinsmen and of thanes  
who erstwhile lived upon the Finnheath.

2 Finn-eiði 'the Finnheath' | Finnveden, the folkland of Småland in which the stone is located.

## Sm 37 (Rörbro)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A stone still standing at its original location.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

[:] a[**sur**] · **kar**þi : **kubl** : þesi : eftir : uit : faþur : sin · [h]an uar : mana  
 : mestr : unipikr [:] uar : i[n]tr : matar : uk umun hats : kuþr · þi(k)[n]  
 kus tru : kuþa : hafþi :

## Text

- Qsurr gerði kumbl þessi eftir Eýnd, fður sinn.  
 2 Hann var **m**anna · **m**estr ò·níðingr,  
 var **y**ndr matar · ok ò·munr hatrs.  
 4 **G**óðr þegn **G**uðs trú · **g**óða hafði.

Answer made these monuments after Eanwind, his father.  
 He was of men the greatest un-nothing,  
 was giving with food and late to hatred.  
 The good thane had good faith in God.



**Sm 39****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

A standing stone inscribed on two sides, one of which has a large cross. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, U 739, and U 805. For “good of meat” cf. *Háv* 39. The first line is not poetic.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

§ A : kuni : sati : stin : þana : iftir

§ B : suna : faþr : sin : milan : u... ... matar kuþa... :

**Text**

2                    Gunni satti stên þenna eptir Sûna, fœður sinn,  
                      mildan orða · auk matar góðan.

Guthe set this stone after Sown, his father,  
generous in words and good of meat.

## Sm 44

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A heavily damaged stone. The inscription is more visible in Bautil on which the reading has to rely. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sö 130, U 703, U 739, and U 805.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A [: uim]ut[r] : [sa]ti : sten : þana ...

§ B [b]ruþr : s[in ...(i)n mi(l)... ... sina] ...

§ A m[a]tr : kuþan : [i] urþ[l]ufi : at[ra : m...r]

## Text

2 Vé·mundr satti stên þenna *ęptir* bróður sinn ...**in**  
**mildan** við sinna · *ok* **matar** góðan,  
 ĩ **orð**-lofi · **allra** miklu.

Wighmund set this stone after his brother, ...,  
 generous with his kin and good of meat,  
 held in great praise by all.

---

1 ...**in** '...' | The name of the brother cannot be restored, but the gap only leaves room for at most two runes, and so the main candidate names are Swayn (\***suin** *Svënn*) and Stan (\***stin** *Stënn*).

## Sm 45

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

· uest-n · karþ- · (k)ub- · þesi · efter · esburn · bruþur · sin · uitrik · þesi · a  
uiki-muti

### Text

2 Vé·steinn gerði kumb/ þessi eptir Ēs·biorn, bróður sinn,  
vitring þessi · à vega-móti.

Wighstan made these monuments after Osbeorn, his brother,  
this memento at the crossroads.

**Sm 46****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

The stone is lost.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

[...-nui krþi : kubl : þesi : iftir suin : sun : sin : im ÷ itaþisk ou-tr i krikum]

**Text**

2                   ...n-ví geŕði kumbl þessi eptir Svên, sun sinn,  
                   e<sub>ER</sub> **ę**ndaðisk · **a**ustr í Grikkjum.

...wye made these monuments after Swayn, her son,  
 who met his end to the east in Greece.

## Sm 60

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A · sen · uk u·starki · karþu ·

§ B · kubl · þesi · efeir · kuþmut · faþur · sin · uitrk · þasi · ą ueha·muti ·

### Text

Svênn ok Ó·starki gęřđu kumbl þęssi ęptir Guð·mund, fęður  
sinn,

<sup>2</sup> vitring þási · à vega·móti.

Swayn and Unstark made these monuments after Godmund, their father,  
this memento at the crossroads.

## Sö 9 (Lifsinge)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

barkuiþr × auk × þu : helka × raistu × stain × þansi : at · ulf : sun · sin · han  
× entaþis + miþ : ikuari + ¶ kuþ + hialbi + salu ulfs ×

### Text

- 2           Bark-viðr ok þau Hēlga reistu stēin þannsi at Ulf, sun sinn.  
          Hann ęndaðis · með Ing-vari.  
          Guð hialpi sōlu Ulfs.

TODO

## Sö 14 (Gåsinge)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

rakna · raisti · stain · þansi · at · suin · buta · sit · auk · sifa · auk · r-knburk  
· at · sit · faþur · kuþ · hil[b]i · at · [hat]s · uit · iak · þet · uar · sui- · uestr ·  
miþ · kuti

### Text

Ragna reisti stēin þannsi at Svein, bónda sinn, auk Sefa auk  
Ragn·borg at sinn fǫður. Guð hialpi and hans.

2      Veið iak þet var Sveinn · vestr með Knúti.

Rainie raised this stone after Swayn, her husband, and Seve and Rainbury  
after their father. God help his spirit.

I know that Swayn was in the west with Canute.

**Sö 33****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

+ gnubha ÷ liþ : raisa : stain : þinsa : hibtir : kulaif : brupur sin ¶ han :  
antaþis : austr : at þikum

**Text**

- 2 Gnúpa lét reisa stein þennsa eptir Gulleif, bróður sinn.  
Hann **endaðis** · **austr** at þingum.

TODO: trans



## Sö 34–35 (Tjuvstigen)

**Dating:** C11th–C12th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

Two paired stones standing next to each other. The last two lines of Sö 35 is not poetic.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

Sö 34: styrlaugr · auk · hulmbr · staina · raistu · at · bryþr · sina · brau(t)u  
 · nesta · þair · entaþus · i · austruiki · þurkil · auk sturbiarn þiagnar · kuþir  
 Sö 35: lit · igiker · anan · raisa · stain · at · suni · sina · su[n-]a · kiarþi · kuþ  
 · hialbi · ant · þaira × þurir · hiu ·

## Text

## Sö 34

Styr·laugr ok Holmbr · stęina ręistu  
 2 at brōðr sına, · brautu nęsta.  
 Þęir ęndaðus · ĩ austr-vegi,  
 4 Þor·kęll ok Styr·bięrn, · þiagnar góðir.

Sturley and Holm raised the stones  
 after their brothers, nearest to the road.  
 They met their end in the Eastern way,  
 Thurkettle and Sturbeorn, good thanes.

---

2 brautu nęsta ‘nearest to the road’ | Cf. *Háv* 72.

## Sö 35

Lét Ingi·geirr · annan ręisa stęin  
 2 at syni sına, · sýna gięrði.  
 Guð hialpi ęnd þęira.  
 4 Þórir hjó.

Inggar let another stone be raised  
after his sons; he made it seen.  
God help their spirit.  
Thurer hewed.

## **Sö 41**

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### **Introduction**

TODO.

### **Runes**

TODO: Runes

### **Transliteration**

tati + iok + eftir + faþur + sin × skaka × mirki| lit + mikla + man + (i)aurn

### **Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

**Sö 47****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

...(R)-kR : kiarþi : kuml : þat:si : eftir : ašmunt : sun : sin + han : is :  
krafín : a · ku... <raur> : <uart/fart> : at : ryr:iks : sun

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 54

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A þurstain : auk : aystain : auk : natfari : raistu : stain : at : finuiþ : auk  
 : ulif : þurkil buruþr sin ¶ uaru · alir · uikiks · sunir ¶ latburnir · man ·  
 litu · rita · stain

§ B stankil · rist · runar

## Text

Þór·steinn auk Ey·steinn auk Nátt·fari reistu stein at Finn·við  
 auk Ó·leif, Þór·kell, bróðr sína.

2 Vóru allir · Víkings synir;  
 land·burnir menn · létu rétta stein.

4 Stein·kell reist runar.

Thurstan and Eanstan and Nightfarer raised the stone after Finnwood and  
 Anlaf [and] Thurkettle, their brothers.

They were all the sons of Wiking;  
 land-born men had the stone erected.  
 Stankettle carved the runes.

## Sö 55 (Bjudby)

Dating: C11th

Location: Bjudby, Blacksta parish, Oppunda hundred

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

The language is later than most other England stones. The os-rune is used for /o/, palatal *r* has dropped after all consonants, and stung *e* is used.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

þorstain (l)(i)... ..sa : stain : þena : ... sik : sialfan : auk : sun : sin : hefni :  
 uar til : enklans : ukr : trenkr : farin : uarþ : þa · haima : at : harmi tauþr  
 ¶ kup hialbi : sialu : þaima ¶ bruni : auk : sloþi : þair ...(u) stan þena

## Text

- Þór-stéinn lét rēisa stēin þenna ēptir sik sialfan auk sun sinn  
 Hefni.  
 2 Var til Eṅg-lands · ungr dreṅgr farinn,  
 varð þa hēima · at harmi dauðr.  
 4 Guð hialpi sialu þeira.  
 Brúni auk Slóði þeir ristu stēin þenna.

Thurstan had this stone raised after himself and his son Hefner.  
 To England had the young dreng travelled,  
 then at home he died tragically.  
 God help their souls.  
 Brown and Sloth they carved this stone.

## Sö 56 (Fyrby)

Dating: C11th–C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

iaċ · uait : hastain : þa : hulmstain : bryþr · menr : rýnasta : a : miþkarþi  
 : setu : stain : auk : stafa : marga eftir · fraystain · faþur · sin ·

## Text

Iak veit Há·stęin · þá Holm·stęin bróðr  
 2 męnnr rýnasta · à Mið·garði  
 settu stęin · auk stafa marga  
 4 eptir Frey·stęin · fǫður sinn.

I know Highstan and Holmstan, the brothers,  
 the most rune-cunning men in Middenyard.  
 They set the stone and many staves  
 after Freestan, their father.

## Sö 61

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

þorstain : lit · þina : rita : stain : e(f)ila : stetr : eftir : þorbiarn : salui ·  
 auk : simiþr : at · sen boropur

## Text

2 Þör-stęinn lét · þęnna rétta  
 stęin; éfila · stęndr ęptir Þör-biorn.  
 Słlvi auk Smiðr · at sinn bróður.

Thurstan let erect this stone;  
 fittingly it stands after Thurbeorn.  
 Sallow and Smith [raised it] after their brother.



## Sö 65 (Djulefors)

Dating: C11th–C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law with hendings in the b-verses

## Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side with a large cross. Already on the earliest depictions the stone was damaged, but an even larger part has now gone missing. Other stones that mention Longbeardland (Lombardy, northern Italy) are the paired U 133 and U 141; it may also be mentioned on Sö Fv1954;22, although only the first two letters **la** survive.

The meter is highly unusual for runic Swedish poetry by its reliance on hendings (in line 2 an ethel-hending *arð-* : *barð-*, in line 3 a shot-hending *land-* : *end-*). Although unparalleled in Sweden, the meter is documented by Snorre (TODO).

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

[inka : raisti : stain : þansi : at : ulai](f) : sin : [a...k] : han : austarla :  
arþi : barþi : auk : ǧ : lakbarþilanti : [anlaþis +]

## Text

2           Inga reṣisti stęin þannsi at Ô·leif sinn **a...k**.  
          Hann **austar=la** · **arði** barði  
          auk à **Lang-barði-** · **landi** andaðis.

Inge raised this stone after Anlaf, her ...  
Easterly he ploughed with the prow,  
and in Longbeardland met his end.

---

2 arði barði ‘ploughed with the prow’ | I.e. ‘sailed’. The same verse is found in an anonymous Lay-meter-line from the Third Grammatical Treatise (Anon (*TGT*) 14 in SkP 3), which reads: *sá's af l̥s-landi* · *arði barði* ‘he who [away] from Iceland ploughed with the prow’.

## Sö 85

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

: ansuar : auk : ern... ... [: faþur sin : han : enta]þis : ut i : krikum (r)uþr  
 : ---...unk-----an-----

## Text

- 2           Ansvarr ok Ern..., fǫður sinn.  
           Hann ęndaðis · út í Grikkum.  
           †...(r)uþr:...unk...an...†

TODO: trans

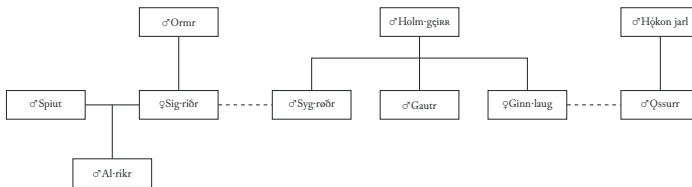
## Sö 106

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The aristocratic family involved in raising this stone were quite prolific in raising runestones and also raised U 617 and the non-metrical Sö 101. Based on these 3 inscriptions the family tree may be reconstructed as follows:



## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

alrikr □ raisti □ stain × sun × sirīþar × at × sin faþur × sbiut × 𐌹 × sār ×  
 uisitaula × um × uarit : hafþi × burg × um brutna : i : auk × um barþa +×  
 firþ × han × kar(s)ar + kuni + alar ×

## Text

- Al·ríkr reisti stein, sunn Sig·ríðar, at sinn faður Spiut;  
 2 sár **vestar**=la · um **varit** hafði,  
**borg** um **brutna** · í ok um **barða**;  
 4 fæð hann **kastrar** · **kunni** allar.

TODO: trans

## Sö 122 (Skresta)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A standing stone at Skresta. The semantic division between the words *dauðan* and *Ôs·gautr* is marked in the inscription by a large space.

The commissioner, Osgeat, also raised another stone in memory of Highstan, the unmetrical Sö 123. That stone also stands at Skresta and reads: *ąskutr : rsþi : stan : þansi : at : hastin Ôs·gautr reįsþi steįn þanssi at Hą·steįn* ‘Osgeat raised this stone after Highstan.’

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

: stain : stanr : it : histain : raisþi stalfr : faþir : at : sun tauþan ąskutr :  
kiarþi : tre

## Text

- 2           Steįnn steįndr at Hą·steįn;  
            reįsþi *s*ialfr faðir · at *s*un dauðan.  
            Ôs·gautr gearði tré.

TODO: trans

## Sö 126

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

hu(l)(m)(f)riþ · ilin--r · [p]ar · litu · hakua · stain · eftir ¶l eskil · faþur · sin  
 · han · trauh · orustu · i · austru[i]hi ¶l aþaa · fulks · krimr · fala · orþi

### Text

Holm·fríðr, †ilin?...r†, þár létu hoggva stēin eftir Ēs·kēl, fōður  
 sinn.

2 Hann draug orrustu · í austr-vegi,  
 áðan folks Grímr · falla orði.

TODO: trans

## Sö 130

Dating: C11th–C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A standing stone. TODO. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, U 703, U 739, and U 805.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A *fiurir* : *kirþu* : *at* : *faþur* : *kuþan* : *tyrþ* : *trikela* : *at* : *tumara* : *miltan*  
: *urþa uk* : *matar kuþan* : *þat* · (u)-(h)---(u)--(u)(k)(þ)

§ PB *h<sup>a</sup> l<sup>ʰ</sup>f kirþu <o>*

§ QB *h<sup>a</sup> <h> kirþu <o/þ>...*

## Text

- 2 *F*iurir gērðu · at *f*øður góðan  
*d*ýrð *d*rengi=la · at *D*ómara  
3 *m*ildan orða · ok *m*atar góðan.  
4 þat ...

Four men made after their good father,  
honourably a mark of praise after Doomer  
generous in words and good of meat.  
This ...

---

3 *mildan orða* · ok *matar góðan* ‘generous in words and good of meat’ | The same line is found in Sm 39.

## Sö 131

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

: sbiuti : halftan : þair : raisþu : stain : þansi : eftir : skarþa : ʀl bruþur  
 sin : fur : austr : hiþan : miþ : ikuari : ʀ sirkʀllanti : likr : sunr iuintar

### Text

Spiuti, Half-dan, þeir reišþu stēin þannsi ęptir Skarða, bróður  
 sinn.

2 Fór austr heðan · með Ing-vari;  
 ą Sęrk-landi liggr · sonr Ey-vindar.

TODO: trans

## Sö 136

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The stone is lost.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

[ : suain : iuk : sluia · þair : raisþu : ---... ... -nu · at : faþur : sin : hirsir ·  
uksniauin ian uas : unt hifni bistr]

## Text

2                    Svęinn ok †sluia†, þęir ręisþu †?-...-nu† at fęður sinn, hęrsi  
                    þug-sniallan, · ian vas und hifni bętztr.

TODO: trans



## Sö 137 (Aspa)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

The last line of side B (**sunr þat ... mar**) is, with the exception of the final word **mar**, enciphered. The first 7 runes, **sunrþat**, are written along a single vertical stave, while **rakna ... i(f)** are written in staveless runes. This line is difficult to read, employs no word separators, and has not been convincingly deciphered.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A þura : raisþi : stin : þ--si at : ubi : buanti : sin

§ BP : stain : sar:si : stanr : at : ybi : ǥ þik·stapi : at ǥ : þuru : uar : han :

uestarla : uakti : karla ǥ [sa þar] · sunr þaþ · traknasuatau(k)i(f)mar[sua]

§ BQ : stain : sar:si : stanr : at : ybi : ǥ þik·stapi : at ǥ : þuru : uar : han :

uestarla : uakti : karla ǥ · sunr þat raknasuatau-i(f) mar

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 145

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A [: tusti : austin : þir : raistu : at : tuka : snir : kiarþu · at : san ::  
faþur :: snialan :]

§ B [: tuki : ati : ru harfan : krimulfu :: ati : hafan : iu : ata i :: uþuli]

## Text

- 2           Tósti, Ey-steinn, þeir reistu at Tóka,  
          synir giðrðu · at sinn fōður snjallan.  
          Tóki átti *bý* halfan, Grím·ulfr átti *halfan bý*, átti í óðuli.

TODO: trans

## Sö 148

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

The words **han uas antaþ austr** are carved with staveless runes.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

þiupulfr : bui : þair : raisþu : stain þansi : at : farulf : faþur : sin : han  
uas antaþ austr i kaþ(u)(m)

### Text

2 Þiuð·ulfr, Bói, þeir reisþu stein þannsi at Fər·ulf, fōður sinn.  
Hann vas andaðr · austr í Gørðum.

Thedwolf, Bowe—they raised this stone after Farulf, their father.  
He met his end to the east in the Yards.

## Sö 154 (Skarpåker)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A stone.

The couplet at the end, expressing a father's grief for his son, serves as a good example of the Wiking Age preoccupation with the End Times. The stone is decorated with a cross, but the text has no signs of Christian influence, and the language is traditional.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

kunar : raisþi : stain : þansi : at : lyþbiurn : sun : sin : iarþ sal rifna uk  
ubhimin

## Text

Gunn·arr reisti stēin þannsi at Lýð·biorn, son sinn.

2 Iqrð sal rifna · ok upp-himinn.

Guthur raised this stone after Leodbeorn, his son.  
Earth shall rend, and Up-heaven.

2 Iqrð sal rifna · ok upp-himinn. | The verse line (with the exception of **h** and **m** in **ubhimin** *upp-himinn*) is written with staveless runes and without punctuation. Since there is clearly place for more runes on the stone the reason is unlikely to be strictly economical, especially considering that staveless runes are very rare in the Wiking Age outside of Helsingland and also used especially for poetry in other inscriptions from Södermanland (Sö 148 above). Rather the motivation is almost certainly to encrypt the verse and thereby accord it greater sanctity, perhaps also to obscure a reference to the pagan eschatology at a time when Christianity was increasingly hegemonic. For the expression cf. *Vsp* 50, Arn *Hryn* 3/7–8 (in SkP 2, see also note there): *meiri verði þinn an þeira · þrífnuðr allr, und's himinn rifnar*. 'greater than theirs may all thy wealth be until heaven rends.'

2 Iqrð ... upphiminn 'Earth ... Up-heaven' | A formulaic merism; see Index for other occurrences.

2 sal 'shall' | An early example of a dialectal form of *skal* 'id.,' cf. dialectal Swedish *sa*.

## Sö 159

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

: ikialtr : ak : aluir : raisþu : stain : þansi : at : þurbiurn : faþur : sin  
: han uaistr hafir/(a)fir uf/(u)f uarit leki ¶ rorikr · kumytr biu · kunlaifr  
hiuk ru-ar

### Text

2           Ingi·aldr auk Ql·vír reišþu stein þannsi at Þör·biorn, fǫður sinn.  
          Hann vestr hafir · of varit lengi.  
          Hró·ríkr, Guð·mundr †biu†. Gunn·lǫifr hiogg rúnar.

Ingeld and Alewigh raised this stone after Thurbeorn, his father.  
He has been in the west for a long time.  
Rethric, Godmund .... Guthlaf hewed the runes.

Sö 163

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

Þruríkr : stáin : at : suni : sína : snialla : trákia : for : ulaifr : i : krikium :  
uli : siftri :

**Text**

2                    Þrý·ríkr stęin  
                  at syni sína, · snialla dręngja;  
                  fór Ó·lęifr í Grikkjum, · gulli skipti.

Thriric [raised] the stone  
after his sons, valiant drengs;  
Anlaf went to Greece, dealt out gold.

1 Þrý·ríkr stęin ‘Thriric [raised] the stone’ | This line is an orphan. The verb is left out.

## Sö 164

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ P kuþbirn : uti : þair r(a)isþu : stan þansi : at : kuþmar : f(a)þur : sin :  
stuþ : triki:l(a) : i · stafn skibi : likr uistarla uf huln sar tu :  
§ Q kuþbirn : uti : þair r(a)isþu : stan þansi : at : kuþmar : f(a)þur : sin :  
stuþ : triki:l(a) : i · stafn skibi : likr uistarla <uf> <hul>n bar--

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

**Sö 165****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

§ P kuþrun : raisti : stain : at : hiþin : uar : nafi suais : uar : han : ƿ : i :  
krikum iuli skifti ƿ : kristr : hialb : ant : kristunia :  
§ Q kuþrun : raisti : stain : at : hiþin : uar : nafi suais : uar : han : ƿ : i :  
krikum iuli skifti ƿ : kristr : hialb : ant : krist uni a :

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## Sö 171

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

(i)nk(i)f(a)[s]tr · l[i](t) (h)(a)ku... st(a)...n · eftir · sihuiþ · faþ-r · si[n · han  
· fial · i h]ul(m)[karþi · skaiþar · uisi mi]þ · ski...ra

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 173 (Tystberga)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

The stone is closely connected to Sö 374 which at present stands beside it. Sö 374 is somewhat younger, and was raised by Mish (there **musku** gen. sg.) after Manny.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A mes:kia : a(u)[k :] (m)an(i) : litu : rasa : ku[(m)(l) : þausi : at : b]ruþur  
· (s)in : hr(u)þkair · auk : faþur sin hulm:stain ·

§ B · han hafþi · ystarla u(m) : uarit · lenki : tuu : a:ustarla : meþ : inkuari

## Text

2 Mýskja auk Manni létu rēisa kumbl þausi at bróður sinn Hróð·gęir  
fęður Holm·stęin.

4 Hann hafði vęstar=la · um varit lęngi;  
dóu austar=la · með Ing·vari.

TODO: trans

## Sö 174 (Aspö)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

[ub]lubr · lit · kira : kuml : likhus : auk : bru · at sun sin : biurn : uar  
trebin : a : kut:lanti : þy : lit : fiur · sit : flupu : kankir : þair uip[ulkur] :  
uiltu iki halta : guþ : hilbi : anta : hans

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## Sö 198 (Mervalla)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

sirip · lit · resa · stan · [þin](a) [-] (a)(t) · suen · sin · [b]unta · h[n] · uft ·  
siklt · til · simk(a)(l)(a) · t(u)ru[m] · knari · um · tumisnis

## Text

2                   Sig·ríðr lét rêsa stên þenna at Svên, sinn bónda.  
                  Hann opt siglt · til Sêmgala,  
                  dýrum knarri · um Dómis-nęs.

Syerid had this stone raised after Swayn, her husband.  
He had often sailed to the Semigallians  
on his costly knarr around Domeness.

---

3 Dómis-nęs ‘Domeness’ | The old Germanic name for Cape Kolka in Latvia, corresponding to German *Domesnes*.

## Sö 204 (Överselö church)

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

The inscription is heavily damaged, but can be reconstructed on the basis of the verse in Sö 206.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

: hier : skal : stenta : stei(n) ... ...kia(l)t : run(u)... ... (u)arfaitr : (i)(f)tir  
: faþurs:broþur · sen ·

**Text**

2            Hiar skal standa · steinn at Ingjald,  
              rúnum roðinn · reisti Var·feitr  
              eptir fǫðurs bróður sinn.

TODO: trans

## **Sö 206/208**

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### **Introduction**

Two stones raised by a mother and her daughter.

### **Runes**

TODO: Runes

### **Transliteration**

Sö 206: : hir : skal : stenta : staena : þisir : runum : ru-nir : raisti :  
k---auk : at syni : sina : auk : hielmlauk : at bryþr : sina ·

Sö 208: : kuþlauk · auk : hielmlaug : þar : --- (u) · raistu : ... ..ern : auk :  
at : þorstain :: boanta : kuþan : buki : i frayslutum : arfi : fu(l)... .. sum  
ir : sustursun inibratar :

### **Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

**Sö 207****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

kuþr... ... (f) a þ u r s i n · f u r · h f i l a · h n · t i l · i k l a n s · k u þ h a l b i · s i l h n s

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## Sö 213

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

s<sup>^</sup>tain : hiuk : esbern : stintn : at : uitum : bat miþ : runum : raisti : kyla  
: at : gairbern : boanta : sin : auk · kofriþ : at : faþur : sin : han uar :  
boanti : bestr i : kili : raþi : sar : kuni :

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans



**Sö 335**

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

uulf<sup>^</sup>ui : raisti : stain þana| lat brupur sin : u:snikin sar furs : a:ust:arla :  
maþ : i:ikn:u:ari : ksibari hulumstains

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 338

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A · ketil : auk + biorn + þair + raistu + stain + þin[a] + at + þourstain :  
 faþur + sin + anuntr + at + bruþur + sin + auk : hu[skar]lar + hifir + iafna  
 + ketilau at + buanta sin · ¶ bruþr uaru þar bistra mana : a : lanti auk : i  
 lipi : uti : h(i)(l)(t)u sini huska(r)la : ui- +  
 § B han + fial + i + urustu + austr + i + garþum + lis + furugi + lanmana +  
 bestr

## Text

Ketill auk Biorn, þeir reistu stein þenna at Þór·stein, fōður sinn,  
 Qnundr at bróður sinn auk hús-karlar \*ęptir iafna, Ketil·ey at  
 bóanda sinn.

2 Bróðr vōru þeir · bętstra manna  
 á landi auk í liði úti;

4 heldu sinna · hús-karla vel.

Hann fial í orrustu · austr í Gørðum,

6 liðs forungi, · land-manna bętstr.

TODO: trans.

They were brothers of the best men,

on land and out in the troop. He fell in battle to the east in the Yards,  
 the steward of the troop, the best of lended men.

## **Sö 340**

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### **Introduction**

TODO.

### **Runes**

TODO: Runes

### **Transliteration**

[ : stin : sār:si sār : at · frusta ik]irunār : [sun : aik : kuþlifs : ulifr :  
raisti aftir brupur sin ¶ kus]

### **Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

**Sö 345****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

... ..in × þinsa × at × kai(Ṛ)... ..-n · eṚ · e[n-a]þr × ut - × kr...

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö Fv1948;289 (Aspa)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

ḁstriþ : lit : -ira : ku(m)... ...usi ÷ at : anunt ÷ auk : raknualt : sun : sin ÷ :  
 urþu : ta...r : - (t)an...-(k)u : ua-u : rikir : ḁ rauniki : ak : snialastir : i :  
 suiþiuþu

## Text

- 2           Ḟst·ríðr lét gęra kumbl þausi at Qn·und ok Ragn·vald, sun sinn.  
           Urðu **d**auðir · í **D**an·morku,  
           vǫru **r**ikir · á **R**auningi  
 4           auk **s**niallastir · í **S**vé·þiuðu.

Estfrid had these monuments made after Anund and Rainwald, her son.  
 They died in Denmark,  
 were powerful in Reening,  
 and the most valiant men in Sweden.

**Sö Fv1954;22**

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

...i : risti : ---... ... ..in... ... sin : han : ir : entaþr : i : austruiki : ut : ą :  
la...

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## U 11

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

raþ| þu : runar : ret : lit : rista : tolir : bry[t]i : i roþ : kunuki : tolir  
: a(u)k : gyla : litu : ris... ..- : þaun : hion : eftir ...k : merki ¶ srni... ¶  
haku(n) · (b)aþ : rista

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 69

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

raknilfr × lit × kirua × bru × þasi × iftir × anunt + sun + s[i](n) [× k]uþan ×  
 kuþ ---bi × ʀns × ant × uk × salu × bitr × þan × ʀn krþi × til × munu × iki ×  
 mirki × miri × uirþa × muþir × karþi × i(f)tir × sun × sín × ainika ×

## Text

Ragn-elfr lét gerva bró þási eptir Qnund, sun sinn góðan. Guð  
 hialpi hans ʀnd ok sólu beþr þan hann gærði til.

2 Munu eigi mērki · mēiri verða.

Móðir gærði eptir sun sinn einiga.

TODO: trans

## U 102

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The inscription is very hard to read.  
TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

kal lit hkua heli þisa iftir · suni sina toa · auk þau ikiþora · br- (a)ina kiarþu  
mukit mirki furir arkum mani

### Text

2 Káll lét hoggva · helli þessa  
eptir syni · sína tvá,  
auk þau Ingi-þóra bró · ęina giörðu,  
4 mykit męrki · fyrir męrgum manni.

TODO: trans

**U 112****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

§ A · rahnuāltr · lit · rista · runar · efr · fastui · moþur · sina · onems · totr  
· to i · aiþi · kuþ hialbi · ant · hena ·  
§ B runa · rista · lit · rahnuāltr · huar a x griklanti · uas · lis · forunki ·

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 114

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A ikriþ' l[i]t · laþbo · kiara' auk · stain · haku[a eftir] ikim[a]r (b)(o)[ta  
s]in · auk · eftar · tan · auk · eftir · baka · suni · sina  
§ B' þair byku' i rynby' auk' bo atu' [kr]istr · ialbi' s(a)(l)(u) · þai[r- ·]  
(þ)it skal' at minum · mana' miþan · min li[fa]

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 127/164/165/261

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

These four stones all share a near-identical inscription and visual layout. They originally belong to the so-called Earlbánke's bridge, at which U 164–5 are still standing whereas U 127 and 261 have been moved to different locations.

Since the inscription is near-identical it was thought simplest to include them all under the same section, and note the differences between them by means of critical apparatus. Note that punctuation is not included in the apparatus.

Like many other one-line verses, the poetic nature of these inscriptions is doubtful, especially since the transposition of *allan* in U 127, which is not inferior to the others in terms of execution, renders the line deficient and makes one question whether Earlbánke really intended a poetic line.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

U 127: \* iarlaxbaki \* lit raisa [x] staina \* þasa at sik \* kuikuan \* 𐌺 \* auk bru þisa karþi \* fur ąnt sina \* auk \* ain ati tabu ala- U 164: \* iarlabaki \* lit \* raisa \* stain \* þisa \* at sik \* kuikuan \* 𐌺 \* auk bru \* þisa \* karþi \* fur ąnt \* sina \* auk ain ati \* alan \* tabu \* kuþ hialbi ąnt hans U 165: ia[r]labaki \* li---sa \* staina \* þisa \* at sik \* kuikuan \* auk bru þis(a) [x karþi fur ąnt x] si--- \* ati + (a)lan \* tabu + U 261: iarlaba... lit \* raisa \* s[taina \* þasa \* a]t sik \* kuikuan \* 𐌺 auk \* bru \* þisa \* karþi \* fur ąnt [x] s[in]a \* auk \* ain ati alan tabu

## Text

- 2 Iarla·banki lét reisa steina þása at sik kvikvan, auk bró þessa gerði  
fyr ąnd sına,  
auk ęinn átti · allan Tà·bý.  
Guð hialpi ąnd hans.

Earlbánke had these stones raised after himself while alive, and made this bridge for his spirit,  
and he alone owned all Toughby.  
God help his spirit.

1 Iarla·banki | **iarlaba...** U 261 1 lét rēisa | li- ---**sa** U 165 1 steina | **stain** U 164 1 þása |  
 þessa ('þisa') U 164/165 1.a–2 sína, auk einn | si- --- U 165 2 **allan** Tā·bý | *rev.* ('**tabu ala**·')  
 U 127 3 Guð hialpi ond hans. | *om.* U 164/165/261

## U 136

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

× astriþr × la(t) + raisa × staina × þasa × [a]t austain × buta sin × is × suti ×  
iursalir auk antaþis ub i × kirkum

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## U 153

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

...[(u)](a)i- × [(a)]uk × ulf- litu × raisa × stai-(a) × e(f)tir × hlftan · auk · eftir  
× kunar × bryþr × sina × þair · antaþus × aust... ...(u)m

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

**U 166****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

ku lit · rasa · kuþlah · iftir · sun · miuk · nutan · trik · mirki · þisa · an it ·  
sihuastr ·

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 207–8

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 207: ulfr ' auk ' þurmontr ' auk ' kamal ' lata ' reis(a) þisa ' stina ' þar +  
eftR ' faþur ' sin ' U 208: ristur ' merk(i) at ' man ' metan ' sunir ' alkoþir '  
at ÷ sin ' faþur sterkar usiti ' rsti stina

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 214–15

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

Two paired stones with a single continuous inscription. U 215 should be read before 214 in the series.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

U 214: uk × inkiber × eftir × buanta × sin ' han ' troknapi ÷ a ' holms ' hafi  
' skreþ ' knar ' hans ' i ' kaf þrir ' enir ' kamo ' af

U 215: [þaniltr · uk · olfil](r) · [li](t)(u) s[t]ain × e(f)[tir faþor · uk broþor  
sin ·]

## Text

Ragn·hildr ok Ulf·hildr létu stein eptir fǫður ok bróður sinn,  
Ingi·berg eptir bóanda sinn.

2      **H**ann drunknaði · à **H**olms-hafi;  
skrêð **k**narr hans í **k**af;

4      þrír **ê**nir kǫmu **a**f.

TODO: trans

## U 225–6 (Bällsta)

Dating: C11th

Location: Arkils tingstad, Bällsta, Vallentuna

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

Two stones standing in their original location, namely at the thingstead mentioned in U 225. In the 18th century the two runestones were connected by a line of smaller stones going between them, but these have since been lost. The inscription is continuous and consists of 7 alliterative long-lines.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

U 225: ... uk · arkil · uk · kui · þir · kariþu · iar · þikstaþ ... ..unu · iki mirki  
 · mairi · uirþa · þan · ulfs · sunir · iftir · kir... ..ir · suinar · at · sin · faþur  
 U 226: ristu · stina · uk · staf · uan · uk · in · mikla · at · iartiknum uk kuriþi  
 · kas at · uiri · þu mon i krati · kiatit lata ¶ kunar ik stin

## Text

PU 225 ... ok Arnkell ok Gýi þeir gerðu 'iar þing-stað ...

2 Munu eigi merki · meiri verða,  
 þan Ulf's synir · eptir gerðu,  
 4 sniallir sveinar · at sinn fōður,

... and Arnkettle and Gew they made the thingstead here, ...

No greater landmarks will there be  
 than Wolf's sons afterwards made,  
 valiant swains, for their father.

U 226 reistu stēina · ok staf ofan  
 2 ok inn mikla · at iar-tēiknum,  
 ok Gý·ríði · gats at veri;  
 4 þý man í gráti · giatit láta.  
 Gunnarr 'iogg stēin.

They raised the stones and the staff above,  
 and the great ... as tokens of remembrance;  
 also Gufrid cared for her husband.

Thus will they have it spoken of in weeping.  
Guthur hewed the stone.

---

1 *of*an | **uan** U 226; unnu *most other eds.*

---

1 staf *of*an ‘the staff above’ | Unclear; perhaps a tall wooden staff or column?

2 inn mikla ‘the great ...’ | The word *inn* may either be read as the article *inn*, *hinn* ‘the’ or as a f. noun of unclear sense. The latter is preferable since the weakly stressed article cannot uphold alliteration, and since *hinn mikla* ‘the great one’ is meaningless.

4 í gráti ‘in weeping’ | Or ‘in a dirge’, if *grátr* refers uniquely to a lost genre of poems of lamentation, in which case the line probably refers to a longer oral poem serving as a complement to the necessarily quite limited runic poem.

## U 300 (Skånela)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

[þyrui + lit + raisa + stain × eftir + hlftain + merki + mukit + eftir × man  
kuþan]

### Text

þýr·ví lét reisa stein eftir Halfda\*n,  
2        mērki mykit · eftir mann góðan.

TODO: trans

## U 323 (Sälma)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

An exceptionally tall standing stone. No decorations, but explicitly Christian. Note the sporadic loss of initial *h* and use of stung runes *h*, *þ*, *þ*, *y*, *g*, *e*.

## Runes

× 1A4T1T × 1N × 1ARN1TR × 1N × 81NR1 × 11A [× 8ARN1R × 1141N] ... ...4T1T ×  
 TRN44 × 1[11NR] × 41T × 1N × 111B1 × 114 × 11T × 1N × 41N × 1NR × 111 ×  
 11N × 4111A × 1N 4111A ×  
 × 11 × 4N1 × 1111T × 411 + 11TR + 1111A × 81N × 11R × 41111T × 8111 × 1[11T  
 1]N1-- 41111A 11[111A ×] 1T × 41T × 111NR × 41 × 111 × 81NR1A × 1N41T × 81TR1  
 × 1NR1T +

## Transliteration

× iystin × auk × iuruntr × auk × biurn × þir [× byryþr × risþu] ... ...stin ×  
 trums × f[aþur] × sin × kuþ × ihlbi × ʁns × ʁnt × auk × selu + fur+kifi × ʁnum  
 × sakar × auk × sutir × 1  
 × hi × mun × ligia × meþ + altr + lifir × bru × hrþ×slagin × briþ × e[ft × k]uþ-  
 suenar k[arþu ×] at × sin × faþur × ma × igi × brutar×kuml × betra × uerþa +

## Text

Ey·stên auk Iuruntr auk Biorn, þêr bróðr rêsþu ... *ęptir* ...stên  
**trums** fōður sinn.

2 Guð 'ialpi 'ans ʁnd auk sêlu, for·gifi 'ʁnum sakar auk syndir.

Eanstan and Earwind and Beorn—those brothers raised ... [after] -stan ...,  
 their father.

God help his breath and soul, forgive him his crimes and sins.

4 *Ēi* mun liggja · með *aldr* lifir  
*bró* harð-slagin · *brēð eft góðan*;  
*svēnar kęrðu* · at *sinn* fōður  
 6 má *ęgi* *brótar*-kuml · *bętra* verða.

For ever will lie while the age lives  
 the hard-hammered bridge, broad, after a good man.



The swains made it after their father;  
no roadside monument can be greater.

## U 336

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

[ul]fr × lit × risa stin × þi[n]a × iftir × unim × faþurs×bruþr sin þir × buku ×  
 baþir × i × baristam ’

**Text**

- 2           Ulfr lét rêsa stên þenna eptir Ó·nêm, fôðurs-bróður sinn.  
             þêr byggu báðir · í Bári-stôm.

TODO: trans

## U 349

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The stone is lost but survives as a well executed drawing.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

[uikitil × uk × usur -...u × risa × stin × þina · iftir × ustin × faþ... ... ..þan ×  
an furs × uti × miþ × ala × skibin × kuþ × ialbi × (a)t]

## Text

2 Vi·ketill ok Qssurr ...létu rêsa stên þenna eptir Ô·stên, fôður sinn  
gôðan. 'Ann fórs úti með alla skipan.  
Guð 'ialpi ɔnd.

TODO: trans

## U 358

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Note the loss of initial *b*-.**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

fulkmar × lit × risa × stin × þina × iftir × fulkbiarn × sun × sin × sar × itaþis  
 × uk miþ krkum × kuþ × ialbi × ans × ȳt uk salu

**Text**

- 2 Folk·marr lét rêsa stên þenna ȳptir Folk·biorn, sun sinn.  
 Sár ȳndaðis · ok með Grikkum.  
 Guð 'ialpi 'ans ȳnd ok sôlu.

TODO: trans

## U 437 (Broby)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

kuna : a[uk su]tari : ristū : s(t)[... ... sikbiar- sati : iftir : sin faþur : stin :  
almykin : i : s...]

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 512

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A fryb... ...i × huk f(r)... ...(f)-þr × þir ristu × sti- -(n)a × iftir × kuþ-ar  
 × ...(a)þur × sin kuþan × huk tuma + (b)...þur × sin ×× kuþ ...i ąt × þira × huk  
 × salu × hu... ...uþir × bitr × þan × þir × -ar- × h...

§ B ...ir × skal × stan^ta × stin × uiþ- bryku × sunir × at × faþur satu · kuþan  
 · kair -... ...

§ C --(u)-ar × mirki × at × bua-... ...

## Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 605

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

A lost runestone.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

[ · iskirun · harþir · totir · lit · risti · runir · ati · sik · sialfan · hn · uil · austr  
· fara · auk · ut · til · iursala · fair · risti · runir · ]

### Text

Ingi·rún, Harðar dóttir, lét rísta rúnar at\* sik sialfa\*.  
2 Hón vill austr fara · auk út til Íór-sála.  
Fótr rísti rúnir.

Ingrun, Hareth's daughter, had these runes carved after herself.  
She wants to go east and out to Jerusalem.  
Foot carved the runes.

**U 614****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

· skuli · auk · folki · lata · reisa · þinsa · stein · iftr · broþur · sin · husbiorn  
· hn us| |siok · uti · þa þir · kialt · toku · a kutlanti ·

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## U 617 (Bro)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

A beautiful rectangular stone. The family involved in raising this stone were quite prolific; see Sö 106 above.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

kinluk x hulmkis x tutir x systir x sukrufar x auk x þaira x kaus x aun x lit  
x keara x bru x þesi x auk x raisa x stain x þina x eftir x asur x bunta x sin x  
sun x hakunar x iarls x sar x uar x uikika x uaurþr x miþ x kaeti x kuþ x ialbi  
x ans x nu x aut x uk x salu

## Text

Ginn·laug, Holm·geirs dóttir, systir Syg·røðar auk þeira Gauts,  
hón let giöra bró þessi auk reisa stēin þenna eptir Qssur, bónda  
sinn, sun Hó·konar iarls.

2 Sár var vikinga · vörðr með Geiti.

Guð hialpi hans nú ond ok sōlu.

Yinlie, Holmgar's daughter, the sister of Syferth and Geat—she had this bridge made and this stone raised after Answer, her husband, the son of Earl Hathkin.

He was the watchman against Wikings with Goater.

God now help his spirit and soul.

---

1.b Hó·konar iarls 'Earl Hathkin' | Unclear, but he is probably not the Norwegian Earl of Lade Hathkin Siwardson (c. 937–995).

**U 644****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

an(u)(i)(t)r : auk · kiti : auk · kar : auk · blisi · auk · tiarfr · þir · raistu ·  
stain þina · aftir · kunlaif · fǫður : sin han : fil · austr : mið : ikuari ¶ kup  
heabi antini

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 654

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

+ a-itr : auk · ka(r) auk : kiti : auk : -[l]isi : auk · tiarfr : ris[t]u : stain :  
þena : aftir : kunlaif : fǫþur sin 𐌺 is u[a]s nus(t)(r) · m[i](þ) ikuari : tribin  
kuþ : hialbi : ǫ(t) þaira 𐌺 al-ikr| 𐌺raistik · runar 𐌺 is kuni + ual · knari stura

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 661

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

kairui × auk × kula × ristū × stain þina × aftir × ʀnunt × fʀþur sia is uas × austr  
 × tauþr × miþ × ikuari × kuþ × hialbi ʀt × ʀnutar

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 703 (Västra Väppeby)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side. There is no cross present, but a large four-legged beast with a long tail. The stone is heavily damaged but mostly readable. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 739, and U 805. For “good of meat”, which also occurs in *Háv* see Index. The first line is not poetic.

The carver notably struggles with distinguishing the mirrored runes **a** and **n**.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

: -sui · let [·] rnisa · stain [·] þisa · at · anulf · sun · sen · koþan · han · byki  
· her ... · mantr · matar · -o-r · auk · mls · ri(s)ia ·

## Text

Ós·vi lét reisa stein þenna at Arn·ulf, son sinn góðan. Hann  
byggi hér ...,  
mandr matar góðr · ok mál's risinn.

Oswye let raise this stone after Arnolf, her good son. He lived here ...,  
a man good of meat and proud of speech.

---

1 ... | In this lacuna there is room for around 5 runes; not enough for a half-line, which suggests that *Hann byggi hér* is not poetic.

## U 707/710 (Husby)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

Two pieces of a single stone. U 707 is the larger fragment while U 710, originally not identified with U 707, is smaller and contains the words **(h)...****(n)** · **byki** | **li** · **h(u)**.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 707/U 710: · **ysurkr** --... · **stan** · **þina** · **nt** · **ka(u)bm...****(n)** · **faþur** · **sen** · **koþan** · **(h)...****(n)** · **byki** | **li** · **h(u)...** ¶ · **bali** · **risti** · **r(u)--r** · **þis-(r)** · **hier** · **man** · **stanta** · **stan** · **ne(r)** **(b)(r)...****u** ·

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 729

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

· uifugsi · lit · raisa · stain · þiasn · iftir · seref · faþur · sen · koþan · han ·  
bykil | li · agurstam · hier mn · stanta · stan · miþli · bua · raþi · tekr · þar ·  
ryn si · runum · þim sum · bali · risti ·

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 735

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

· ueþralti ' lit ' ur · lakarni · stan · almikin · ur · staþi · fyra · auk · arker '  
þau ' litu ' kubl ' raisa · þisa · at ' siktryk ' sun · sen '

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans



## U 739 (Gådi)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side, with a large cross present. There are no major difficulties with the reading. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 805. “mild of meat” appears to be a variant of “good of meat”, which also occurs in *Háv*; see Index. The first line is not poetic. For other stones raised by someone in memory of themselves, see TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

· hulbiorn · lit · raisa · stan · at ’ sik · sialfan 𐌺 · hau|n| |u|nar · miltr · matar  
· auk · mals-risin ·

## Text

Hol·biörn lét reisa stein at sik sialfan.

2 Hann var mildr matar · ok mál-sisinn.

Holbeorn had this stone raised after himself.

He was mild of meat and proud of speech.

---

2 Hann var | haunar (for \*hanuar) U 739

## U 778

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

The original location of the stone is unknown, but judging from the inscription it must have been part of a larger monument consisting of several stones.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

þialfi × auk × hulmnlauk × litu × raisa × staina þisa × ala × at baka × sun sin ×  
 is ati × ain 𐌱 × sir × skib × auk × austr × stu[rþi ×] i × ikuars × liþ × kuþ hialbi  
 × ȁt × baka × ask(i)l × raist

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 792

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

kar lit · risa · stin · þtina · at · mursa · faþur · sin · auk · kabi · at · mah sin ·  
fu- hfila · far · aflap̃i ut i · kri[k]um · arfa · sinum

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 805

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The stone is lost and the interpretation must rely on old depictions which makes the reading, especially two of the personal names, uncertain.

The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 739. For “good of meat”, which also occurs in *Háv*; see Index. The first line is not poetic.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ P [fulkir : lit : risa : st... --r : iel : bruþur : sin : auk : kunimar : eftir : menk : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : buki| |i uikby]

§ Q [fulkir · lit : risa : st... --- : mer : bruþur : sin : auk : kuni:mar : eftir : m·enk : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : brike -ukni ·]

§ R [fulkir : lit : risa : st... ...(r)ir : mei- : bruþur : sih auk : kuni:mar : eftir : mink : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : buki| |i : uiki]

## Text

Fylkir lét reisa stęin eptir **†iel†**, bróður sinn, ok Gunni·marr eptir **†menk†**, fęður sinn,

2      **bóna** góðan matar; · **b**yggi í Vík-bý.

Filch had this stone raised after ..., his brother, and Guthmar after ..., his father,  
a farmer good of meat; he lived in Wickby.

## U 838

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

þufr · auk · þorfatr · þair · litu ' raisa ' stan · at · þorborn · faþur · sen · koþan  
· ¶l · hir maa ' stanta ' stain ' ner ' brautu ' auk ' (k)ilauk ' riþ · kirua ' merki  
' [at] (b)(o)a--- · sen :

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 887

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

× ioker × auk × fastker × auk × au(r)(i)(k)r × litu · rita · sten × yftir × borker  
 × faþur sin frehn ¶ selfr · hiok × aurikr × yfti : sin · faþur · runi · þisa · roþi  
 ' sa ' kuni

## Text

Io·gêr auk Fast·gêr auk Ey·ríkr létu rétta stên øpti Borg·gêr  
 fõður sinn frégan.

2 Sialfr hiogg Ey·ríkr · øpti sinn fõður  
 rùni þessa: · ráði sá kunni.

TODO: trans

## U 1016

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ P · liutr : sturimaþr · riti : stain : þinsa : aftir : sunu · sina : sa hit :  
aki : sims uti furs : sturþ(i) · -(n)ari · kuam :: hn krik::hafnir : haima tu :  
...-mu-... ...(k)(a)(r)... (i)uk (r)(u)-(a) · ...

§ Q · liutr : sturimaþr · riti : stain : þinsa : aftir : sunu · sina : sa hit : aki  
: sims uti furs : sturþ(i) · -(n)ari · kuam :: hn krik · : hafnir : haima tu :  
...-mu-... ...(k)(a)(r)... (i)uk (r)(u)-(a) · ...

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U Fv1983;228

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

× nesbiurn : (l)it : raisa : sta-n : þensa : eftir : (o)laif : sun : sin : hiar :  
skal : stanta : stain · a : l(a)(i)...au...

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans



**U Fv1986;84**

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### **Introduction**

TODO.

### **Runes**

TODO: Runes

### **Transliteration**

asmu-tr ... ris-- · runar · eftir × stein · faþurs·faþur · sin · auk · faþur · siba  
· ok × geirbiarnar × aok ... ulfs · ear · merki · mikit · at · man · koþan ×

### **Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U Fv1992;157

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

× kunar : auk biurn : auk × þurkrimr × ra-... ..tain : þina · at þurst... ×  
brupur sin : is uas austr : tauþr · m... ..ari × auk × karþ... ..u þisi

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U Fv1912;8

Dating: C11th

Meter: Court-spoken meter

## Introduction

U Fv1912;8 is a small box, in which were originally found some Wiking Age scales along with a powdered organic material, probably the pouch in which the scales were originally contained. The inscription has the rare honour of containing the only authentically East Norse poetry in the Court-spoken meter.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A *tiarfr × fik af × simskum × maṇi × skálar × þis...* (×) i ...(*ǫ*)t(*i*) × in  
uirmuntr × f(*a*)þi × runar × þisar

§ B *fuhl × ualua × slait × (f)aluṇ × faṇ kauk × ǫ naṣ au-a*

## Text

Djarfr fekk af sǣmskum manni skálar þessar í ...-landi, en Vermundr fáði rúnar þessar.

2 **F**uḡl vǣlva slǣit fǫlvān · fann -gauk á nās- auka.

Derve got these scales from a Sambian man in ...-land, but Wermund carved these runes.

The fowl tore apart the death-pale robber; one observed the swelling on the corpse-cuckoo [RAVEN/EAGLE].

---

2 vǣlva 'robber' | A hapax in the entire Old Norse corpus, the word appears to be a cognate with Gothic *wilwa* 'robber, bandit' which translates Greek ἄρπάζ (Streitberg 1910, p. 175).

2 -gauk ... nās- 'corpse-cuckoo' | Taken as a compound *nās-gaukr* 'corpse-cuckoo [RAVEN/EAGLE]'.

2 auka 'swelling' | Viz. from the robber's flesh.

## Vg 32

**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO. The poetic nature of the inscription is proven by the unusual word-order where the verb *rêþu* ‘raised’ is bracketed by the object *þenna stên* ‘this stone’.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

þurþr × uk : þurun × þana × risþu × stin × efti × era × alkuþan : trik

**Text**

2                    þò·rðr ok þór·unn · þenna rêþu  
                     stên epti Erra · all-góðan dreng.

Thurfrith and Thurun raised this stone  
after Er, an all-good dreng.

## Vg 59

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A large standing stone. The arrangement of the lines makes the division into three parts clear. First the prose memorial formula, then the first two lines (Eesie's poem) and finally the raisers' line.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

rífniṛ : auk : kiali : auk : brunulṛ : auk : kifulṛ : satu : stin : þānsi :  
iftir : fut : faþur : sin : harþa : kuþān : þign ʒ : sua : hifir : āsa : as : igi  
: mun : sum : kuin : ift : uir : siþān : kaurua : ʒ : hialmṛ : auk : hiali :  
hiaku : runar ·

## Text

*Hrēfningr auk Gialli auk Bryn·ulṛ auk Gef·ulṛ sōttu stēn þannsi  
ēptir Fót, fōður sinn, harða góðan þegn.*

Rafning and Yeller and Byrnulf and Yevulf set this stone after Foot, their father, a very goodthane.

- 2 Svá hafir Ása, · es ēgi mun  
sum kvēn ēpt vēr · síðan gōrva.  
4 Hialmṛ ok Hialli · hiōggv rúnar.

So has Eesie [made a monument], like never a wife  
henceforth after her husband will make.  
Helm and Helle hewed the runes.

## Vg 61 (Härlingstorp)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

: tula : sati : sten : þ... ...[ir kr : sun] : sin : harþa × kuþan : trāk : sa × 𐌹  
uarþ : tuþr : ǣ : uastr:uakm : i : uikiku :

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Vg 187

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

**Introduction**

A large standing stone decorated with a cross. The runes are well preserved.

**Runes**

TODO: Runes

**Transliteration**

+ giri · sati · stin · þana · eftir · kuþa · bruþur · sin · er · a aḱ·lanti · altri ·  
 tynþi x

**Text**

2           Gêri satti stên þenna eftir Goða, bróður sinn,  
           er á **E**ng-landi · **a**ldri tynði.

Gare set this stone after Gid, his brother,  
 who in England lost his life.

## Vs 15 (Málhammar)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A × higulfr × lit × kira × merki × þisa × at × ʀ knut × faþur san × uk × kuþlug  
 · uxk sistur × hanis × bali × riti × istaen ʀ × bali o knutr ×  
 § B × sten : hafir × ritān × þān × stānta × mā × bali (h)i- rauþi × yftir × bruþ[u]r  
 × ʀ bali

## Text

Heg·ulfr lét gæra merki þessa at Knút, fǫður sinn, ok Guð·lôg,\*  
 systur han\*s. Balli rétti stēin.

2 Balli. Knútr.

TODO: trans

Stēn hafir réttan, · þann standa man,  
 Balli hinn rauði, · øptir bróður.  
 Balli.

4

TODO: trans



## Vs 24

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

Orthographically the os-rune is used for both the oral vowels *o* (**oþintisu**) and *ø* (**hulmkoetr, roþbalir**) and for nasal-adjacent *a* (**buonti, seno, þon**)

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

buonti × kuþr × hulmkoetr × lit × resa × ufter × oþintisu × kunu × seno ×  
 kumbr × hifrya × til × hasmuimura × iki betr × þon × byi raþr roþbalir × risti  
 × runi × þisa × sikmuntar × uar ... sestr × kuþ

## Text

- Bóandi góðr Holm·gôtr lét rêsa øptir Óðin·Dísu, konu sína.  
 2 Kombr **h**í-fręyja · til **H**as\*u\*-mýra  
 êgi **b**ętri, · þan **b**ýi ráðr.  
 4 **R**ôð-Ballir **r**ísti · **r**úniŕ þęssar.  
 Sig·mundar var ... systir góð.

TODO: trans

## Ög 8 (Kälvesten)

**Dating:** C9th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

A remarkably old stone. Both orthography and the shape of runes agree very closely with the Ög 136 Rök.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A stikur (ʻ) karþi kubl þ(a)^(u) aft auint sunu sin ' sa fial austr  
§ B mīr aiuisli ' uikikr faþi auk| |krimulfr

### Text

2            Styggr gerði kumbl þau apt Ey-vind, sunu sinn.  
            Sá fiall austr · meðr Eiv-ísli.  
            Vikingr fáði ok Grím·ulfr.

Stig made these monuments after Eanwind, his son.  
He fell in the east with Awyils.  
Wiking and Grimwolf painted.

## Ög 66

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The incorrect use of **h** (**halkuþan** \**all-góðan*, *it* 'ét' for \**hét*) indicates that the sound has been dropped

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

: ikiualtr : ristþi : stin : þisi : eftir : stufialt : bruþur : sin : suain :  
halkuþan : sun sbialbuþa : it : inik : ant

## Text

2           Ingi·valdr reisti stęin þęnnsi eptir Styfj·ald, bróður sinn,  
          svein \*all-góðan, · sun Spiall·buða.  
          'Êt inni'k ęnt.

Ingwald raised this stone after Stivold, his brother,  
an all-good swain, Spellbid's son.  
I declare the promise fulfilled.

## Ög 68

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

suina × karþi × bru × þesi × eftir × ouint × bruþur × sin × han × uas × uester  
 × tauþer × i × uereks × (k)ai-i

## Text

- 2 Svęina gęrði bró þęssi ęptir Ey-vind, bróður sinn.  
 Hann vas **v**estr dauðr · í **V**ęrings †**kai-i**†.

Swanie made this bridge after Eanwind, her brother.  
 He died in the west in the Weering's ...

## Ög 77

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

: tuna : sati : stin : þ... --tr : sin : uar : þurfast : uas han : man : mist :  
unþik ·

## Text

2           Tonna satti stên þenna ęptir sinn vęr Þor·fast.  
          Vas hann **man**na · **mę**str ó·níðingr

Tonne set this stone after her husband, Thurfast.  
He was of men the greatest un-nothing.

---

2 **man**na | **man** Ög 77   2 **mę**str | **mist** Ög 77   2 ó·níðingr | **unþik** Ög 77

---

2 Vas hann manna · męstr ó·níðingr 'He was of men the greatest un-nothing' | Found near-identically in Sm 5 and Sm 37.

## Ög 81 (Högby)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A stone standing at the former site of the mediæval Högby church, into which it was once bricked in. The stone is inscribed on 2 sides, A and B.

The orthography is notable in that older *ei* is consistently written as a monophthong, while *au* is still written as a diphthong. This unusual variation is reflected in the standardized orthography.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A · þukir · resþi · stin · þansi · eftir · asur · sen · muþur·bruþur · sin · iar · eataþis · austr · i · krikum ·

§ B · kuþr · karl · kuli · kat · fim · syni · feal · ʰ · furi · frukn · treks · asmutr · aitaþis · asur · austr · i krikum · uarþ · ʰ hulmi · halftan · tribin · kari · uarþ · at uti · ʰ auk · tauþr · bui · þurkil · rist · runar ·

## Text

- 2 Þor·geðr rêsþi stên þanssi ęptir Qss·ur sên, móður·bróður sinn,  
iar ęndaðis · austr í Grikkjum.

Thurgerd raised this stone after Answer the slow, her mother's brother  
who met his end to the east in Greece.

- 4 Góðr karl Gulli · gat fimm syni;  
fiall á Fýri · frókn drengr Qs·mundr,  
ęndaðis Qss·urr · austr í Grikkjum,  
6 varð á Holmi · Half·dan drepinn,  
Kári varð at Uddi, · auk dauðr Bói.  
8 Þor·kell rêst rúnar.

The good churl Gull begat five sons.  
On Fyre fell the brave dreng Osmund,  
Answer met his end to the east in Greece,  
upon Holm was Halfdene slain,

Cheer was [slain] by Orde, also dead is Bo.  
Thurkettle carved the runes.

## Ög 136 (Rök)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

Due to its great length, use of ciphers, unique content and damage in one part the Rök stone is certainly the most difficult runestone to interpret and explain. A full-length treatment could easily take up a 300-page book and therefore the present is only an excerpt of the immediately introductory prose passage followed by the 4-line stanza.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

[...] ' þat sakum ʒnaʒrt huar fur niu altum ʒ n urþi fiaru ʒl mir hraiþku-  
tum auk tu ʒl mir ʒn ubsakar ʒl raiþl |þiaurikr hin þurmuþi stilir ʒl flutna  
strʒntu hraiþmarar sitir nu karur ʒ  
ʒ B kuta sinum skialti ub fatlaþr skati marika

### Text

[...] Þat sǫgum annart, hvar fór níu aldum á, en urði fiaru meðr  
Hręð-gutum, ok dó meðr ʒn of-sakar.

This I say secondly, who journeyed upon the nine waves but struck the shore  
amidst the Reth-Gots and died amidst them without guilt.

- 2            Ręð þiau·ríkr, · hinn þor·móði  
             stillir flutna, · stręndu Hręð·marar;  
4            sitir nú gęrur · á guta sínum,  
             skialdi of fatlaðr, · skati Méringa.

Theoric rode, the daring-minded  
controller of sailors, upon the Rethmare shore.  
Now he sits ready upon his horse,  
his shield strapped, the lord of Meerings.



## Ög 155

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Speeches-meter

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

þurfriþ × risti × eftir × askut × auk × kauta sunu × sina × stin × þasi × han ×  
 kuti × etaþis × i × ikuars × hilfniki ×

### Text

þór·fríðr rêsti eftir Ós·gaut ok Gauta, sunu sina, stên þannsi.  
 2 Hann Gauti endaðis · i Ing·vars helfningi.

Thurfride raised after Osgeat and Geat, her sons, this stone.  
 Geat met his end in Ingwar's ship-troop.

## Ög 165 (Skänninge)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

A tall standing stone from Skänninge. The carver Thurkettle is the same as that of Ög 81.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A (·) þurun · risti · auk × þir × bruþr × sunir :

§ B × tusta × iftir · sin · faþur

§ C × þurkil×k rist × stin : þansi : aufti : tusta :

### Text

2 Þör·unn rêsti · auk þêr bróðr,  
synir Tosta, · ęptir sinn fōður.  
Þör·kell 'k rêst stên þannsi øpti Tosta.

Thurun raised [the stone] along with her brothers  
the sons of Toste, after their father.

I, Thurkettle, carved this stone after Toste.

---

1 rêsti 'raised [the stone]' | The wording is so formulaic that the object can be left out without any injury to the sense.

## Ög 212

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

The stone is lost. TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

[tula : risti : stina : iftir · buka : auk · bru þa:si : ai : buna · þn]

### Text

2                   Tóla rêsti stêna eftir Bukka  
                    auk bró þási · at bónda þann.

Toole raised these stones after Bucke,  
and this bridge after that husband.

## Öl 1 (Karlevi)

Dating: C10th–C11th

Meter: Court-spoken meter

## Introduction

Although technically outside of the scope of the present edition by virtue of its being a Scaldic composition in the Court-spoken meter, the Karlevi runestone is of such importance that its inclusion was felt imperative.

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

+ s-a... --(s)- i(a)s · satr · aiftir · si(b)(a) · kuþa · sun · fultars · in h̄ans · liþi  
· sati · at · u · (t)ausaiþ?... +: fulkin : likr : hins : fulkþu : flaistr (:): uisi  
· þat · maistar · taiþir : tulka · þruþar : traukr : i : þaimsi · huki · munat  
: raiþ:uiþur : raþa : ruk:starkr · i · tanmarku : --ntils : iarmun·kruntar :  
urkr̄antari : l̄anti

## Text

Steinn sási ias sattr ęptir Sibba góða son Foldars, en hans liði  
satti at ̊ †(t)ausaiþ?...†

This stone is set after Sib the Good, son of Folder, but his retinue set it upon the island ...

- 2           Folgin̄n liggr hinn's fylgðu, · —flęstr vissi þat—męstar  
            dęðir, dolga Þrúðar · draugr, í þęimsi haugi;  
4           mun-at ręið-Viðurr ráða, · róg-starkr, í Dan-męrkur,  
            Ęndils jęrmun-grundar, · ęr-grandari, landi.

Hidden lies the one whom the greatest deeds followed—most men knew that—the tree of the enmities of Thrith [BATTLES > WARRIOR] within this mound.

No more upright strife-strong Wither of the chariot of Andle's immense ground [SEA > SHIP > SEAFARER] will wield land in Denmark.

## Öl 39 (Bägbý)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

× sua(i)(n) kiarþi × iftir × sin × faþur × uikar × sun × ainiki × sialfr × raisti ×  
stain ×

### Text

2 Svęinn giarði ęptir sinn fęður, Vik·ar,  
sunn ęinęigi · sialfr ręisti stęin.

...

**Index of proper nouns**

TODO.

# Runic Poetry from Denmark and Scania

## Introduction

The signa used for Danish inscriptions vary. According to the more common system all Danish inscriptions are numbered according to a unitary system based on the Danish corpus edition, which unlike the Swedish one is not divided into provinces. The online database *Danske Runeindskrifter* ('Danish Runic Inscriptions') does however follow a system identical to the Swedish one, and since those signa are easier to work with due to the ability immediately to identify the origin of any given inscription, it has been adopted here, although references to the DR signa are given in parentheses following the origin.

## Abbreviations of Danish regions

- Bh = Bornholm
- MJy = Midtjylland (Middle Jutland)
- NJy = Nordjylland (North Jutland)
- Sj = Sjælland (Zealand)
- SJy = Sønderjylland (South Jutland)
- SIB = Slesvig By (the town of Slesvig)
- Sk = Skåne (Scania)
- Syd = Lolland-Falster

## Bh 33 (DR 379; Nylarsker-sten 1)

Dating: C11th–12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Transliteration

sasur · lit · resa · sten · eftir · aluarþ · faður · sin · truknaði · han · uti · með  
 · ala · sklibara · etki · i · kristr · hab(i) i siolu i has i sten · þesi · stai i  
 eftir

## Text

- Sassurr lét rêsa stên eftir Hall·varð, fðður sinn.  
 2 Druknaði hann **ú**ti · með **a**lla skipara.  
**†etki†** é Kristr hialpi siólu hans.  
 4 **St**ên þessi · **st**ái eftir.

Saswer had this stone raised after Hallward, his father.  
 He drowned far out with all the shipmen.  
 ...may Christ always help his soul.  
 May this stone afterwards stand.



## Bh 34 (DR 380; Nylarsker-sten 2)

**Dating:** C11th–12th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

kobu:suain : raisti : stain : þ(e)na : a(f)tir : bausa : sun : sin : tr(i)... ...n :  
þan : is : tribin : ua(r)þ : i : (u)(r)ostu : at : ut:la(n)(k)iu : kuþ : tr(u)tin :  
hi(a)lbi : hans : ont : auk : sata : mikial :

### Text

- 2 Kópu-Sveinn reisti stein þenna eftir Bausa, sun sinn,  
dræng góðan, · þann es drepinn varð  
í orrostu · at Út-længju.  
4 Guð dróttinn hialpi hans ond auk santa Mikael.

Cloak-Swain raised this stone after Beaze, his son,  
the good dreng who was slain  
in battle by Utlengie.  
Lord God and Saint Michael help his spirit.

---

4 santa Mikael ‘Saint Michael’ | Something of a patron saint on Bornholm, also invoked in Bh 1, Bh 4, and Bh 49. Cf. Syd 11 below.

## Bh 42 (DR 387; Vestermarie-sten 5)

**Dating:** C11th–12th

**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

: asualdi : risti : stein : þinsa : iftr : alfar : brupur : sin : drinr : koþr ¶ :  
trebin u:syni : auk : skogi : suek : saklausan :

## Text

2            Ös·valdi rísti stēin þennsa ęptir Alf·ar, bróður sinn,  
           dręngr góðr · drepinn ù·sýni,  
           auk Skógi svęik sak-lausan.

Oswald carved this stone after Elver, his brother;  
 the good dreng [was] shamefully slain  
 and Skoog betrayed him, guiltless.

# MJy 37 (DR 94; Ålum-sten 1)

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Transliteration

tuli : (r)(i)s-(i) : stin : þasi : aft 𐌺 ikal:t : sun : sin : miuk (:)(k)𐌺(u)... ...k  
 : þau : mun(u) 𐌺 mini : m-(r)gt : 𐌺 iuf (:)(k) 𐌺irta :

## Text

2                   Tóli rêþþi stên þannsi apt Ingj·ald sun sinn, miok góðan *dreng*.  
                   þau munu minni · męrkt ê of birta.

Toole raised this stone after Ingeld, his son, a very good dreng.  
 TODO.

## MJy 71 (DR 131; Års-sten)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

§ A : ʒsur : sati : stin : þansi : aft : ual:tuka : trutin : ʒ × sin

§ B × stin : kuask : hirsí : stanta : laki : sar : ual:tuka × ʒ × uarþa : nafni

### Text

Qnsurr satti stên þannsi apt Val-Tóka, dróttin sinn.  
 2 Stênn kweðsk hêrsi · standa lengi;  
 sár Val-Tóka · varða nefni.

Answer set this stone after Wal-Took, his lord.

The stone proclaims it will stand here for long;

may it name Wal-Took's cairn.

---

3 varða 'cairn' | Acc. sg. of *varði* 'cairn or beacon raised as a landmark'. The word still survives in Danish *varde* 'id.', Faroese *varði* 'id.'

## MJy 79 (DR 68; Århus-sten 5)

**Dating:** C10th–11th

**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

A well-preserved stone with a small piece struck off at the lower corner at the very beginning of the inscription.

### Transliteration

§ A (·)usti × auk × hufi × auk × þir × frebiurn × riþu × stin × þansi × eftir ×  
 ¶ × asur × saksa × filaka × sin × harþa ×

§ B kuþan × trik × sar × tu × ¶ × mana × mest × uniþikr × ¶ sar × ati × skib ×  
 miþ × arnā +

### Text

Tosti auk Hófi þær Frø·biorn rêsþu stên þannsi eftir Qnsur saxa,  
 fé·laga sinn, harða góðan dreng.

2 Sár dó manna · mest ú·níðingr;  
 sár átti skip með Arna.

Toste and Hove, they and Freebern raised this stone after Answer the seax,  
 his partner, a very good dreng.

He died the greatest un-nithing of men;  
 he owned a ship with Arnie.

## NJy 41 (DR 149; Ydby-sten)

Dating: C10th–11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The inscription is entirely poetic. The stone is heavily damaged and divided into several parts but the inscription survives in older depictions.

## Transliteration

§ A þurkisl : [sati · au(k) (·) sunir (·) lifa · i] : s[t]aþ [· þa]¶l:nsi :

§ B [sti](n) (÷) (u)[ftir · lifa]

## Text

þór·gísl satti · ok synir Lêfa  
 2 í stað þannsi · stên øptir Lêfa.

Thuryils set and the sons of Lofe  
 in this place the stone after Lofe.

## Sj 93 (DR 229; Sandby-sten 3)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

A heavily damaged stone, the verse can be tentatively reconstructed based on Syd 11.

## Transliteration

§ A sylfa : rest... ...i : sbalklusu : cyfti : susur : faþur ... ...(r)þi : bru :  
þisi : iki : ¶ þurils : brþur : sin :  
§ B i mun · san... ¶ ...if · uitrik · susi · er · uan · sil...

## Text

Sylfa rêsti stên þannsi í Spalk-lôsu øpti Susur, fōður sinn, ok ggrœi  
bró þessi epti Þôr·ils, bróður sinn.  
2 Ê mun standa, · með stênn á líf,  
vitring súsi, · er vann Sylfa.

Silve raised this stone in Spalklease after Saswer, his father, and made this  
bridge after Thuryils, his brother.  
Ever will stand while the stone has life  
this memento which Silve accomplished.

## SJy 5 (DR 37; Egtved-sten)

Dating: C10th–11th

Meter: Unclear

## Introduction

A fragmented stone; the remaining piece is easily read, but a large part is missing.

## Transliteration

... ..at ' fai(n) ['] (t)u ÷ i suiu ' raist ¶ ... ..uþir ' aft ' brupur ¶ stain ' sasi ' skarni ' ...

## Text

- ... at fáinn; dó í Svíu.  
 2 Rēist *ia*k *rū*nar,  
*bróð*ir apt *bróð*ur;  
 4 stęin sási skęrni ...

the painted; died in Sweden.  
 I carved the runes,  
 a brother after [my] brother;  
 may this stone TODO ...



## SJy 14 (DR 40; Randbøl-sten)

**Dating:** C10th

**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

A rare instance of a stone carved by a man for his wife.

### Transliteration

tufi ÷ bruti ÷ risþi ÷ stin ÷ þansi ÷ aft ÷ lika ÷ ¶ brutia ÷ þir ÷ stafar ÷  
munu ÷ ¶ þurkuni ÷ miuk ÷ liki ÷ lifa ÷

### Text

2                   Tófi bryti rêþi stên þannsi apt líka brytja.  
                  Þêr stafar · munu Þôr·gunni  
                  miok lēngi lifa.

Tove the bailiff raised this stone after the bailiff's helpmate.  
These staves will for Thurguth  
for a very long time live.

---

1 líka 'helpmate' | Or 'equal, match'. Although grammatically masculine (the nom. sg. is *líki*) the word can be used for both genders, as here.

3 lifa 'live' | Stones and staves 'living' is a common expression.

**Sk 5 (DR 263; Skabersjö-fibula)****Dating:** C8th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Transliteration**

§ P ... RRRRRRRRRRRRRRR -aþi tuk fauka fiar sis in a iak as(u) (þ)ui launat

¶ ... auab-k sua fakat...

§ Q ... (R)(R)RRRRRRRRRRRRRR (r)aþi (t)(u)k fauka fiar sis in a iak asa þui

launat ¶ ... auab-k sua fakat...

**Text**

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sk 42 (DR 337; Valleberga-sten)

**Dating:** C11th

**Meter:** Ancient-words-law

### Introduction

A stone. TODO.

### Transliteration

§ A : suin : auk : þurgutr : kiaurþu : kubl : þisi Ƿ eftir : mana Ƿ auk ·  
suina

§ B kuþ : hialbi : siaul : þera : uel : ian : þer : likia : i : luntunum

### Text

Svênn auk Þòr·gôtr giðrðu kumbl þessi ęptir Manna auk Svenna.

Guð hialpi siðl þêra vęl,

2 ian þêr liggja · í Londúnum.

Swayn and Thurgeat made these monuments after Manny and Swenny. God  
help their soul well,  
but they lie in London.

## Sk 51 (DR 279; Sjörup-sten)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Leeds-meter

## Introduction

TODO.

The incorrect use of **h** in **huptir** *øptir* and the lack of it in **an** *'ann* (= ON *bann* 'he') **a(f)þi** *'afði* (= ON *hafði* 'had') indicates the common East Norse loss of that phoneme.

## Transliteration

[+ sa]ksi : sati : st[in] : þasi : huftir : a[s]biurn : (s)in : fil(a)ga 'ŋ (t)u-a[s]  
: sun :] ŋ sar : flu : aki : a[t :] ub:sa(lu)m : an : ua : maþ : an : uŋlabn :  
a(f)þi '

## Text

- 2            Saxi satti stên þannsi øptir Æs·biorn, sinn fé-laga, Tóka\* sun.  
            Sár fló ægi · at Upp-solum,  
            en vá, með 'ann vöpn 'afði.

Saxe set this stone after Osbern, his partner, Took's son.  
He did not flee at Upsele  
but fought as long as he had weapons.

## Sk 80 (DR 295; Hällestad-sten 1)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

TODO.

## Transliteration

§ A : askil : sati : stin : þansi : ift[ir] ¶ : tuka : kurms : sun : sar : hulan

: ¶ trutin : sar : flu : aigi : at : ub:¶:salum

§ B satu : trikar : iftir : sin : bruþr ¶ stin : ą : biarki : stuþan : runum :

þir :

§ C (k)(u)(r)(m)(s) (: ) (t)(u)(k)(a) : kiku : (n)(i)(s)(t)[ir]

## Text

Ös·kell satti stên þanssi eptir Tóka, Gorms sun, sér hollan drót-  
tin;

2 sár fló **e**igi · at **U**pp-solum.

**S**ottu drengar · eptir **s**inn bróður

4 **st**ên á biargi · **st**uððan rúnum;

þêr **G**orms Tóka · **g**ingu néstir.

Oskettle set this stone after Took, Gorm's son, to him a trusty lord;  
he did not flee at Upsele.

The drengs set after their brother  
a stone on the hill propped up by runes;  
they marched closest to Gorm's Took.

**Sk 81 (DR 296; Hällestad-sten 2)****Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

**Transliteration**

: ąskautr : ristþi : stin : þansi (:) Ǻ (:) (i)ftir : airu : brþur : sin : ian : Ǻ :  
 sar : uas : himþiki : tuka : nu : Ǻ : skal : statą : stin : ą : biarki :

**Text**

Ǫs·gautr rêsþi stên þannsi ęptir Ęiru, bróður sinn, ian sár vas  
 hêm-þęgi Tóka.Nú skal standa · stên á biargi.

Osgaet raised this stone after Ore, his brother, and he was Took's retainer.  
 Now shall stand the stone on the hill.

## SIB 3 (DR Schl3; Slesvig-pind)

**Dating:** C11th  
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

## Introduction

A rune-inscribed stick containing a puerile curse.

## Transliteration

§ A runar ÷ iag ÷ risti ÷ a ÷ rikiata ÷ tre sua  
 § B reþ ÷ sar ÷ riki ÷ mo(g)<sub>R</sub> ÷ asir ÷ a ÷ artagum  
 § C hular ÷ auk ÷ bular ÷ meli ÷ þer  
 § D ars ÷ sum ÷ magi

## Text

2           Rúnar iak rísti · á ríkjanda tré  
               svá réð sár ríki mōgr;  
 4           ęsir á ár-dōgum · hullar ok bullar  
               mēli þēr ars sum magi.

Runes I carve on the powerful wood;  
 so did the powerful boy counsel:  
 The Eese in days of yore, hurlies and burlies,  
 may thy arse speak like thy belly!

## Syd 11 (DR 212; Tillitse-sten)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

## Introduction

The stone actually has three sides, but § C is by a different carver and dedicated to a different person; as such it ought to be treated as a separate inscription and not included.

## Transliteration

§ A eskil : sulka : sun : let : res(a) ¶ sten : þena : eft : sialfan ¶ sik · e mun  
 · stanta · meþ · sten ¶ lifir · uitrint · su · iar · uan · eskil  
 § B kristr · hialbi · siol · hans ¶ aok · santa · migael

## Text

- Ës·kil, Súlka sun, lét rêsa stên þenna ept sialfan sik.  
 2      É mun standa, · með stênn lifir,  
          vitrind sú · iar vann Ës·kil.  
 4      Kristr hialpi siól hans auk santa Mikael.

Oskettle, Sulk's son, had this stone raised after himself.  
 Ever will stand while the stone lives  
 this memento which Oskettle accomplished.  
 Christ and Saint Michael help his soul.



## Index



# Index (INCOMPLETE!)

NOTE: This index is both incomplete and inconsistently formatted and should not be relied on. New entries will be added and old ones corrected and expanded in the future. For an example of a complete entry see Yimer.

## Cultural and religious terms and expressions (C)

**ape** (ON *api*, OE *apa*, OS *apo*, OHG *affo*, PNWGmc. *\*apô*) In the Old Norse the word seems to mean ‘fool, buffoon’, in the other old languages apparently ‘monkey’, though this sense should be a later development of the former; why would the early Germanic tribes have a word for an animal that they had never encountered?

**aught** (ON *étt*, OE *éht* ‘possession, property’) The Nordic (paternal) clan or family line.

**begale** (OHG *bi-galan*) To enchant, bewitch something or someone by singing a galder. Transitive of gale.

**bigh** (ON *baugr*, OE *béag*, OHG *boug*) Armlets used as currency during the Migration Period. — The giving of rings and armlets in exchange for loyalty (holdness being the word used for a warrior’s loyalty towards his lord, and of a lord’s grace towards his servants) was common across all of Germanic Europe, as seen in the many poetic ruler-kennings of the type “breaker of rings” (e.g. *béaga brytta* ‘the breaker of bighs’ in *Beow* ll. 35, 352, 1487). An illustrative example of this is *Hild* 33–35. This is also connected with the oath-ring, and the famous ring-swords. TODO? reference some literature on this.

**bloot** (ON *blót*, OE *blôt*, OHG *bluoz*) A sacrifice or a sacrificial feast, one of the best attested Germanic pagan practices. The animals would be sacrificed by the host, cooked in large kettles and eaten communally. See also bloot-house.

**bloot-house** (ON *blót-hús*, OHG *bluoz-hús*) A heathen temple. Glosses Latin *fānum* in OHG. See also harrow, hove, wigh.

**Doom** (ON *dómr*, OE *dóm*) ‘judgment, verdict’ (whence Doomsday, ‘Judgment Day’), but also ‘fame’. See *Háv* 77.

**feather-hame** (ON *fjáðr-hamr*, OE *fēðer-hama*, OS *fēðar-*, *fēðer-hamo*) A plumage which when donned by the wearer lets him fly like, or become a bird. One is owned by Frow and used by Lock to fly between the homes in *Þrk*. In the Christian *Heli* feather-hames are donned by angels who fly from heaven to earth. See also hame.

**fee** (ON *fé*, OE *fēoh*) Originally ‘cattle, kine’, however also used in a broader sense to refer to one’s mobile wealth; for that cf. particularly *Háv*.

**feý** (ON *fēigr*, OE *fēge*, OHG *feigi* ‘cowardly’) Being doomed or fated to die, with a sense of predestination and inevitability. Its earliest documented Scandinavian use is on the Rök stone: **aft uamuþ stanta runar þar + n uarin faþi faþir aft faikiān sunu** *Aft Vāmóð standa rúnar þár, en Varinn fáði, fáðir aft feigjan sonu* ‘After Woemood (*Vámóðr*) stand these runes, but Warren (*Varinn*) painted, the father after the **feý** son.’ See PCRN HS II:35, p. 928 ff. (TODO)

**feyness** (ON *fēigð*) The state of being fey.

**fimble-** (ON *fimbul-*) The ultimate, final, greatest. See Fimblethyle, Fimble-Winter.

**five days** (ON *fimm dagar*) The Old Scandinavian (and perhaps Germanic) week was originally five days long, the seven-day week being a later import, as seen by the names of the days, which are obviously calqued from the Latin (*Dies Mercurii* = Weden’s day, et.c.). According to the *Gula* there were six weeks in a month, and “five days” is used as a generic period of time in *Háv* 51 and 74; in st. 74 it is contrasted with month. Related to this is the legal term *fifth* (ON *fimmt*, OSw. *femt*), a meeting or gathering set to be held at a five-day notice. See *fimt* in CV, LMNL for further discussion.

**galder** (ON *galdr*, OE *gealdor*, OHG *galdar*) A magical song or incantation, probably synonymous with leed. Verbal noun formed to gale ‘to sing, chant’.

**gale** (ON *gala*, OE *galan*, OHG *galan*) To sing, chant, especially of magical songs; verbal root of galder ‘something sung, chanted’.

**gand** (ON *gandr*, Latin *gandus*) A witch’s familiar or foul spirit sent out to do her bidding. See PCRN HS I:17, p. 361 and II:26, p. 656. TODO

**gid** (ON *goði*, OE *Gydda* m. given name) A heathen priest or master of ceremonies.

**gidden** (ON *gyðja*, OE *gyden* ‘goddess’) The womanly equivalent or wife of a gid.

**good of meat** (ON *matar góðr*, *góðr matar*) An old formula appearing in *Háv* 39 and numerous Swedish Wiking Age Runic inscriptions Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 805. Cf. U 739 which has the related *mildr matar* ‘mild of meat’. Antonyms are *matar illr* ‘evil of meat’ and meat-nothing.

**guest** (ON *gestr*, OE *giest*, OS *gast*, OHG *gast*, Got. *gasts*, PGmc. *gastiz*) Guests were often strangers, wanderers, who would come to beg for food and lodgings. The Old Germanic peoples placed great value on hospitality. TODO.

**hame** (ON *hamr*) A skin, shape. People could “shift hames” (ON *skipta hǫmum*), leaving their human hames behind and instead entering into the shapes of wolves, bears, birds. During this process the original hame, that is, the human body, would be sleeping in a vulnerable state. A concise description of this is found in *Yng* 7: *Óðinn skipti hǫmum, lá þá búkr’inn sem sofinn eða dauðr, en hann var þá fugl eða dýr, fiskr eða ormr, ok fór á einni svípstund á fjarlæg lǫnd at sínum erendum eða annarra manna*. ‘Weden shifted hames; then lay the trunk of his body as if sleeping or dead, but he was then a fowl or beast, a fish or serpent, and journeyed in a short while to foreign lands with his errands or those of other men.’

See also feather-hame, fence-rideresses, evening-rideresses.

**harrow** (ON *hǫgr*, OE *hearg*, PNWGmc. *\*harugar*) A hallowed stone structure. *Hdl* 10 describes the construction of one. The Norwegian laws prescribe the “breaking of harrows and burning of hoves”. — See also hove, wigh.

**hold** (ON *holtr*, OE *hold*, OS *hold*, OHG *hold*) ‘Favourable, loyal, gracious’, often of a ruler towards his subject (in the sense of ‘gracious, benevolent’) or vice-versa (in the sense of ‘loyal, devoted’). Mirroring these earthly relationships, it is often used to refer to divine grace, both of the Christian God—thus in the *Ecclesiastical Laws of King Cnut* ALIE I (p. 372): *þam byþ witod-líce God hold, þe bið his hlāforde riht-líce hold* ‘Indeed God is **hold** to him who is rightly **hold** to his lord’—but in the oldest Scandinavian material likewise of the Heathen gods. So *Lok* 4 (e.): *holl regin ‘hold Reins’, and Oddr 9/1: Svá hjalpi þér · hollar véttir* ‘So help thee **hold** wights’.

This word is common in old Scandinavian oath formulæ, e.g. in the elder redaction of the West-Geatish Law: *Svá sé mér goð holl* ‘So may the Gods(!) be **hold** to me,’ in mediæval Norwegian laws (NGL II [197,397]) and Grey-Goose (TODO: cite): *Guð sé mér hollr ef ek satt segi, gramr ef ek lýg* ‘God be **hold** to me if I speak truly, wroth if I lie,’ in Grey-Goose (TODO) also: *Sé guð hollr þeim er heldr gríðum, en gramr þeim er gríð rýfr* ‘God be **hold** to him who keeps the truce, but wroth against him who breaks the truce’. I refer to Löffler (1895) for further discussion on these formulæ.

**holdness** (ON *hylli*, OE *hyldu*, OHG *buldí*) Abstract noun formed to hold, meaning ‘favour, loyalty, grace,’ with the same semantics as the adjective.

Notably, this word appears three times in connection with the grace of gods in the poetry, namely in *Grm* 43, where (according to my interpretation) the preparer of food at the bloot is said to earn the “**holdness** of Wolder and of all the gods;” and *Grm* 53 where the disgraced king Garfrith is said to have been bereft of the support *gengi* of Weden and all the Oneharriers, and of “Weden’s **holdness**” (*Öðins hylli*). “Weden’s holdness” is also mentioned in a stanza by Hallfrith (edited as Hfr Lv 7 by Diana Whaley in SkP V), who laments that: “The whole race of man has wrought songs to win the **holdness** of Weden; I recall the fully rewarded works of our kinsmen/ancestors.”

From the semantics of this word the Germanic view on heavenly grace is clear: the Gods are **hold** towards those who do good works, which include swearing true oaths, faithfully observing truces, partaking in the bloot, following rules of hospitality, and composing poetry—and gram ‘wroth’ towards those who do the opposite.

**Home** (ON *heimr*, OE *hám*, PNWGmc. *\*haimar*) In the Norse often referring to a realm in the cosmology (*Vsp* 2: “I remember nine **Homes**”, *Vafþ* TODO: “From the runes of the Ettins and of all the gods I can speak truly, for I have come into each **Home**”). Thus Ettinham is the ‘**Home**/realm of the ettins’. When used on its own it means ‘the world (that we inhabit)’. See also Nine Homes, Thrithham.

**holy** (ON *heilagr*) TODO.

**hove** (ON *hof*) A pre-Christian temple. See bloot-house, harrow.

**leat** (ON *blaut*) In some saws explained as the blood drained from the offered animal; the verbal root is *bljóta* ‘to get by lot’ and this word certainly refers to the use of the blood for auguries.

**leat-twig** (ON *blaut-tǣinn*) A twig used to sprinkle the leat. The pattern of the blood would presumably be inspected for the augury; cf. *Hym* 1.

**leek** (ON *laukr*, OE *léac*, PNWGmc *laukar*) The leek was a plant of great cultural importance. It was seen as the noblest plant, so 2 *Guðr* 2, where Siward’s superiority to the Yivickings is compared to a stag among wild beasts, gold among silver, and a green leek in grass; and *Vsp* 4, where the earth of the Golden Age was grown with green leek.

The leek was highly valued in folk magic, as seen already on gold bracteates from the C5th and C6th, where it often appears as a charm word in the old form *līk* *laukar*; in one inscription also paired with *līn* *līna* ‘linen’. Classical Norse attestations of magic use include *Sigrdr* 8, where the leek is thrown into mead against poison; and the *Vǫlsa*, where a horse penis is said to be *līni góddr* · *en laukum studdr* ‘endowed with linen and supported by leeks’ in a poetic line. The

[illegible]

fragment.) Thus, Weden's taking of the *runes* should not be interpreted as merely a myth for the invention of profane writing, but rather the origin of esoteric incantations, not at all unlike Indian *māntrās*. The word for letter was instead stave, see also there.

**saw**

**scold** (ON *skald*) A Scandinavian court poet. The name probably comes from their ability to slander with words.

**simble** (ON *sumbl*, OE *symbol*) A banquet, symposium.

**spae** (ON *spó*) Prophecy, foresight.

**Tables** (ON *tafl*, OE *tæfl*) Generic term for board games (e.g. chess). In the golden age the Eese played such games (*Vsp* 8). Pre-Christian Germanic burials commonly feature boards and bricks (TODO: reference, maybe to the Salme ship burials).

**thill** (ON *þylja*) To recite poetry learned by heart. Cf. the so called thules (poetic lists) and the title thyle.

**Thing** (ON, OE *þing*, OS *thing*, OHG *ding*) The Old Germanic assembly, where cases were settled and the law determined. In connection with the Thing certain rituals were in order, viz. the enclosing of the space wherein the judges sat by means of wigh-bonds or sacred ropes. Cf. *Háv* 61 for an excerpt from *Germania* ch. 22. See also the Thing of the Gods.

**thule** (ON *þula*) A poetic list, typically of various items of a category (e.g. gods, legendary horses) or poetic synonyms (e.g. for swords, men, Weden). Decoratively also a ditty, poorly composed poem. See thyle.

**thyle** (ON *þulr*, OE *pyle*, PNWGmc. *\*þulir*) A sage who through rote learning has acquired a large amount of mythological lore (cf. thule 'a list in poetic form; a ditty, bad poem' and thill 'to recite, to chant'). Thus Weden is the Fimblethyle, being the unbeaten master of lore, as can be seen in his wisdom contests (like *Váff*). Runic inscription DR 248 (Snoldelev) suggests that the thyle may have tied to a specific place, and in *Beow* it seems to have been a court position, with the poet Unferth being described (l. 1456) as the "Rothgar's thyle".

**wale** (ON *vǫlr*) The staff or sceptre of a wallow. TODO: archeological finds, mention Sutton Hoo.

**wallow** (ON *vǫlva*, OE *\*wealwe* (cf. ON *svǫlva*, OE *swealwe* 'swallow')) A sibyl, seeress, oracle. The word derives from the wale, a staff or sceptre probably used for ritual purposes.

**waste** (ON *sóa*) To waste ritually, to slay in a sacrificial context. *Háv* 109/4, 144/4 (n.), 145/3 (in *ofsóa* 'waste, kill too much').



**wigh** (ON *vé*, OE *wéoh*, *wib*, PNWGmc. *\*wibą*) A holy place or sanctuary. It seems that where the harrow was a pile of stones or cairn used for carrying out rituals, the **wigh** was an enclosed space. The earliest Norse attestation is the runic inscription Ög N288 (Oklunda), which reads: “Guthur <= Gunn:arr> painted these runes, and he fled, charged (with a crime, sought out this wigh, and he fled into this clearing. [...]” The implication seems to be that the wigh was considered so sacred that Guthur could not be apprehended or punished for his crime while in it.

In OE the word means ‘pagan idol’. It is not immediately clear which meaning is the original one, but in the present edition the Norse sense has been adopted, since the Anglo-Saxon sources are all of a Christian nature. The name *Wighstone* (*Wib-* or *Wéohstān*) as found in *Beow* in any case suggests it is the Norse meaning, since ‘idol-stone’ makes little sense.

**wode** (ON *óðr*, OE *wód*, PNWGmc. *\*wódur*) Heener’s gift to men, though the name may suggest it be from Weden. The word has several related meanings: ‘mind, (poetic) inspiration, rage’. See also Woderearer.

**wyrm** (ON *ormr*, OE *wyrm*, PNWGmc. *\*wurmīr*) A dragon, serpent. The distinction between “wyrm” and “worm; snake” is purely editorial and not made in the original languages.

**yin-** (ON *ginn-*) A rare augmentative prefix. TODO.

**yin-holy** (ON *ginn-heilagr*) High holy, sacrosanct. Used of the Gods in the formula *ginn-heilög goð* ‘yin-holy Gods’.

## Proper nouns (P)

Indirect mentions (e.g. *Vafþ* 54/4 for Balder) follow the main entry; mentions based on textual emendation are italicized.

For names of people in Runic inscriptions see the end of each section.

**Andrimner** m.ja., ON *And·hrímnir*: *the cook of Walhall*; *Grm* 18/1. See Eldrimner, Sowrimner. [TODO: and + hrím + -nir]

**Ash of Ugdrassle** m.a., ON *askr Ygg·drasils*: *the world tree and site of the Thing of the Gods*; *Vsp* 45/5 (Ygg·drasils askr), *Grm* 36/1, 45/1; acc. sg. ask Ygg·drasils, *Vsp* 18/1 (Ask veit’k standa, heitir Ygg·drasils); dat. sg. aski Ygg·drasils, *Grm* 29/4 & 30/5 (dag hvern es döma ferr/fara at ~), 31/2, 32/2, 34/1. [Likely Yggr ‘Ug, Weden’ + \*drasill, variant of drösur ‘horse, steed’, referring to Weden’s hanging (cf. *Háv* 138).] — See Leered, Hoard-mimer’s Wood.

**Attle 1** m.an., *king of the Huns, historically from 434–453 AD*. ON *Atli*, TODO. — OE *Ætla*, *Wid* 18; gen. sg. *Ætlan*: ~ *léodum*, *Wid* 122. [PGmc. *\*Attilō* whence MHG. *Etzel*. Latin *Attila* borrowed from Gothic.]

- Attle 2** [2] m.an., ON *Atli: son of the earl Idmund; HHj* P1 (thrice), 2/pr, 3/pr, P2, P3 (thrice), P6 (thrice), 13/pr, 15/pr, 15/1, 18/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 30/pr, 30/2; acc. sg. *Atla, HHj* 2/1; voc. sg. *Atli, HHj* 19/1, 20/1, 20/3, 22/1.
- Attle 3** [3] m.an., ON *Atli: son of King Ring; dat. sg. Atla, 1 HHund* 52/2.
- Balder** m., *god, son of Weden, husband of Nan*. ON *Baldr, Vsp* 59/2, 59/3, *Grm* 12/1, *Hdl* 28/2, *Gylf* 49:77 (*Eddbr* V), *Hamð* 25/2 (kenning; cf. *Ermenric*); acc. sg. *Baldr, Lok* 28/4, *Gylf* 49:81 (*Eddbr* V); gen. sg. *Baldrs: Eddbr* V 1/2; ~ *bróðir, Vsp* 32/3; ~ *faðir, Hdl* 29/1; ~ *and-skota, Vsp* 33/2, *Bdr* 11/4; ~ *bana, Bdr* 10/4; dat. sg. *Baldri, Vsp* 31/1 (n.), *Bdr* 1/4, 7/1, 8/3 & 9/2, *Lok* 27/2. — Note: *áðr á bál of bar/berr Baldrs and-skota: Vsp* 33/2, *Bdr* 11/4; *hverr/hann man Baldri at bana verða: Bdr* 8/3, 9/2. — Cpds.: **host-Balder** [WARRIOR], ON *her-Baldr: Sigsk* 18/3. — Indirect: ON *Óðins barni: Vsp* 31/2; *syni Vafþ* 54/4 & 55/2; *ungum Óðins syni: Skí* 21/2 & 22/2 (cf. *Dreepner*). — OHG *Balter*; gen. sg. *Balderes, Mers* II 2. [PNWGMc. \**baldrar* 'lord' (> OE *bealdor*). OE *Bældæg*, son of Wōden in the AS genealogies, cannot be a direct cognate.]
- Balethorn** m., ON *Bölþorn: obscure ettin, father of Bestle; gen. sg. Bölþorns: syni* ~, *Háv* 140/1–2 (n.).
- Barrey** m., ON *Barri: holy grove; Skí* 39/1 (n.) & 41/1 (*Barri heitir etc.*).
- Beadhild** f. *king Nithad's daughter*. ON *Böðv-ildr, Vkv* P1, 19/1, 26/1, 29/4, 36/3; acc. sg. *Böðv-ild, Vkv* 39/2; gen. sg. *Böðv-ildar, Vkv* 17/2; dat. sg. *Böðv-ildi, Vkv* P2, 25/4 & 36/2 (sló('k) *brjóst-kringlur, sendi/senda'k* *Böðv-ildi*); voc. sg. *Böðv-ildr, Vkv* 40/1. — OE *Beado·hild, dat. sg. Beado·hilde, Déor* 8.
- Beal** f., ON *Beyla: minor agricultural goddess, wife of Bewer (1); Lok* P1, 55/pr; voc. sg. ~, *Lok* 56/1.
- Beck** m.an., ON *Bikki: a cruel general associated with Attle or Ermenric; Ghv* P1 (twice); gen. sg. *Bikka, Sigsk* 64/1, *Akv* 15/2. — OE *Becca: obscure king, but likely the same as the Norse figure; Wíd* 19; acc. sg. *Beccan, Wíd* 115.
- Bellower** m.jan., ON *Bęli: obscure monster slain by Free; gen. sg. Bęlja: bani* ~, *Vsp* 51/3 (n.).
- Bestle** f., ON *Bęstla: wife of Byre, daughter of Balethorn, mother of Weden, Will and Wigh; gen. sg. Bęstlu: ~ fęður, Háv* 140/2 (n.).
- Bewer** [Bewer 1] m., ON *Byggvir: minor god of barley, Free's servant, husband of Beal; Lok* P1, 43/pr, 45/1; gen. sg. *Byggvis: ~ kvęn, Lok* 56/1; voc. sg. *Byggvir, Lok* 46/1.
- Bewer 2** [2] m., OE *Béow: legendary Danish king, son of Shield; TODO*.

- Bray** [Bray 1] m.an., ON Bragi: *god of poetry, husband of Idin*; *Grm* 45/4, *Lok* P1, 8/pr, 11/4, 12/pr, 12/2, 14/pr; acc. sg. Braga, *Lok* 18/3; gen. sg. Braga, *Sigrdr* 15/5; voc. sg. Bragi, *Lok* 13/3, 15/2, 16/1.
- Bray 2** [2] m.an., ON Bragi: TODO. 2 *HHund*.
- Budle** m.an., ON Buðli: *Hunnish chief, father of Attle*; TODO.
- Budlings** m.pl., ON Buðlungar: *descendants of Budle*; gen. pl.-unga: bór ~, *Akv* 46/4.
- Byre** m.i., ON Burr: *early god, father of Weden, Will, and Wigh*; gen. sg. Burs, *Hdl* 29/1; ~ synir, *Vsp* 4/1 (n.). See Sons of Byre. [burr 'son' < PGmc. \*buriz 'id.', whence OE byre 'id.']
- Danes** m.i.pl., *tribe in eastern Denmark and southern Sweden*. ON Danir: gen. pl. Dana, *Helr* 11/4; dat. pl. Dǫnum, 2 *Guðr* 18/1. — Cpds.: **mountain-Danes** [ETTINS], ON berg-Danir: gen. pl. berg-Dana, *Hym* 17/4. — OE Dēni: TODO. — See Danish.
- Dene** m.i., ON Danr: *legendary ancestor of the Danes*; *Rþ* 46/1 (n.).
- Dreepner** m.ja., OE Draupnir: *mythological duplicating ring*. Indirect: baug: *Ski* 21/1 (n.), 22/1.
- Dreepner 2** [2] m.ja., OE Draupnir: *dwarf*; *Vsp* 15/1.
- Dwarfs** (ON *dvergar*, OE *dweorgas*, OHG *twerca*, PNWGmc. \**dwerǵór*) Earthly (chthonic) supernatural beings, living in rocks and the earth. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Earp 1** m.a., ON Erpr: *son of Enacker and half-brother of Hamthw and Sarle*; *Ghv* P1 (n.), *Hamð* 12/1, 28/1.
- Earp 2** [2] m.a., ON Erpr : *murdered son of Attle and Guthrun, always paired with Oatle*; 2 *Guðr* P1; acc. Erp, *Akv* 41/2; gen. Erps, *Hamð* 8/1.
- Earth** (ON *jörð*, OE *eorþe*, OHG *erda*, PNWGmc. \**erþu*, PGmc. \**erþō*) The personified Earth. By Weden the mother of Thunder. See Firgyn, Lathyn.
- Eastern Way** (ON *Austr-vegr*) In the mythology the eastern lands of the Ettins, to which Thunder goes to fight the Ettins and protect the realms of Gods and Men; see also Ettinham. In geography referring to Eastern Europe and Asia, but with a connotation of barbaric wilderness.
- Edgethew** m.a., ON Eǵg-þér: *obscure ettin herdsman*; *Vsp* 41/2. [PN \*Aggjuþewar]
- Eese** m.u.pl., *the (male) Gods, pl. of Os*. ON ęsir: *Vsp* 7/1, 16/2 (ǵfl=ǵir ok ǵst=kir ~), 22/3, 46/2, 57/1, *Vafþ* 50/3, *Grm* 30/4, 38/4, *Bdr* 1/1, *Lok* P2, 8/2, 8/3, 31/3, P8, *Þrk* 14/1, 17/2, *Reg* P1, P3, *Fáfn* 14/4, *Hdl* 28/1, *Gylf* 49:77 (ed. under *Eddbr* V), *SIB* 3/3; nom. pl. def. ęsir'nir, *Reg* P3;

acc. pl. օսu, *Lok* 6/3; acc. pl. def. օսu'na, *Lok* P4; gen. pl. աս, *Vsp* 23/3, *Háv* 160/3, *Vafþ* 28/3, *Grm* 45/3, *Ski* 7/3, *Lok* P1, 2/3, 13/3, 30/3, 35/4; ~ synir, *Alv* 16/4; ~ sona, *Ski* 17/1 & 18/1; ~ sonum, *Vafþ* 38/3, *Grm* 43/3, *Lok* 3/3, 27/3, 53/3, 56/3, 64/1; ~ salr, *Prk* 13/2; ~ garða, *Prk* 5/2, 9/3; ~ ցործum, *Lok* 37/2; Yggjungur ~, *Vsp* 27/2; hvitastr ~, *Prk* 15/1; ցin-hęndr ~, *RunNor* 12/1; ~ ęttar, *Gylf* 23:6 (ed. under *Eddbr* II); dat. pl. օsum, *Vsp* 42/1, 46/1, *Háv* 143, 161/3, *Vafþ* 38/5, *Grm* 4/2, *Hárþ* 25/1, *Hym* 2/4, *Lok* P1, 12/3, 64/1, *Prk* 7/1, 7/3, *Alv* 10/1 (n.), 26/1, 34/1, *Rþ* P1, *Gylf* 49:82 (*Eddbr* V), *Sigrdr* 16/4; օllum ~, *Grm* 46/3; voc. pl. ęsir, *Lok* 11/1, 19/1, 25/3, *Sigrdr* 4/1. — Note: Hvat 's međ օsum? Hvat 's međ օlfum? *Vsp* 46/1, *Prk* 7/1; Sęnn vօru ęsir allir օ օingi: *Bdr* 1/1, *Prk* 14/1; Hęilir ęsir, hęilar օsynjur: *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1. See Bonds, Gods, Reins, Farrows, Tews, Ossens, and the formula Eese and Elves. — Indirect: TODO. — OE ęse: TODO. [PGmc. \*ansiwiz, pl. of \*ansuz. Gothic \*Anseis, attested in Jordanes, *Getica* as Ansīs (*Hamđ* 25/1 n.)]

**Eldrimner** m.ja., ON *Ēld-hrímnr*: *the great cauldron in Walhall*; dat. sg. -hrímni, *Grm* 18/1. See Andrimner, Sowrimner. [TODO: ęldr 'fire' + hrím + -nir]

**Elfham** m.a., ON *Alf-hęimr*: *realm of the god Free*; acc. sg. -hęim, *Grm* 5/3 (n.). [alfr 'elf' + hęimr 'home, realm']

**Elves** (ON *alfar*, OE *ielfe*, PNWGmc. \**alβir*) Earthly (chthonic) minor deities. Possibly ancestral spirits? Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Enacker** m., ON *Jón-akr*: *third husband of Guthrun, father of Earp (1), Hamthef and Sarle*; gen. sg. *Jón-akrs*, *Sigsk* 62/4, *Ghv* P1; ~ sonum, *Sigsk* 63/1; ~ sonu, *Ghv* 14/4, *Hamđ* 25/4. [? + \*wakraz 'quick, awake']

**Ermenric** m. *king of the Eastern Gots, historically ca. 300–376 AD*. ON *Jǫrmun-rek(k)r*, *Sigsk* 64/2, *Ghv* 2/3, *Hamđ* 3/2, 20/1; dat. sg. *Jǫrmun-rekki*, *Ghv* 5/3, *Hamđ* 19/1; *Jǫrmun-rekk*: ~ inum ríkja, *Ghv* P1; voc. sg. *Jǫrmun-rek(k)r*, *Hamđ* 24/2, 24/5. — OE *Eorman-ric*, *Wid* 18; gen. sg. *Eorman-rices*, *Wid* 8, 111, *Déor* 21; dat. sg. *Eorman-ricse*, *Wid* 88. [Latin (H)ermanaricus from Gothic \*airman 'great, immense' + reiks 'king'. Cf. MHG *Ermen-rich* in legendary ballads.]

**Ettinham** m.a., ON *Jǫtun-hęimr*: *the "Ettin-Home", eastern realm of chaotic enemies of the Gods*; *Vsp* 46/2. See Ettin-Homes, Homes of the Ettins, Eastern Way, Outyards.

**Ettin-Homes** m.a.pl., ON *Jǫtun-hęimar*: *see Ettinham*; acc. pl. -hęima, *Ski* P1, 40/3, *Prk* 7/2 (n.), 12/4, 13/5, 20/3, 21/4, 26/4 & 28/4; dat. pl. -hęimum, *Vsp* 8/4. [*jǫtunn* 'ettin' + hęimar 'homes, realms']

**Ettins** (ON *jǫtnar*, OE *eotenas*, PNWGmc. \**etunór*) The fundamental enemies of the Gods, the agents of chaos and disorder. See Rises, Thurses.

Noted members: Hymer, Thrim, Webthrithner, Yimer Occurrences: TODO

**Fallowhooven** m.ja., ON *Fal-hófnir*: *one of the gods' horses*; *Grm* 30/1. [fǫlr + hófr + -nir]

**Fathomer** m.ja., ON *Fáfnir*: *the wyrm slain by Siward, son of Rethmar, brother of Otter and Rein*; acc. sg. *Fáfnir*, TODO; gen. sg. *Fáfnis*, *Gríp* 13/1, 15/4, TODO, 2 *Guðr* P1; bani ~, *Oddr* 17/4; dat. sg. *Fáfnir*, *Gríp* 11/4, TODO, *Helr* 10/4.

**Fenhalls** m.i.pl., ON *Fēn-salir*: *Frie's dwellings*; dat. pl. *Fēn-sǫlum*, *Vsp* 33/3 (n.).

**Fenrer** m.ja., ON *Fēnrir*: *evil wolf; one of Lock's three children*; *Vafþ* 46/4 (n.), 47/2; *Lok* 38/4.

**Fenrerswolf** m., ON *Fēnris-ulfr*: *synonymous with Fenrer*; TODO.

**Fimblethyle** m.i., ON *Fimbul-þulr*: *name for Weden*; *Háv* 80/4 & 142/4. ['Great Thyle']

**Fimble-Winter** m., ON *fimbul-vetr*: *the Great Winter before the destruction of the earth*; *Vafþ* 44/4. [fimbul- 'fimble-, great' + vetr 'winter']

**Firgyn** f.jö., ON *Fjörgyn*: *poetic name for the Earth*; *Hárb* 56/4; gen. sg. *Fjörgynjar*: ~ burr, *Vsp* 53/2. Cf. *Oddr* 15/3.

**Fold** (ON *Fold*, OE *Folde*) A poetic or ritual name of Earth, especially in her role as Mother Earth. In Germanic poetry, however, the word *fold* is typically used simply to refer to 'land'. It is cognate with Sanskrit TODO.

**Folkwong** m., ON *Folk-vangr*: *Frow's heavenly dwelling*; *Grm* 14/1 (n.). [folk 'troop, army' + vangr 'meadow']

**Foresitter** m.an., ON *For-seti*: *god associated with legal proceedings (Things), son of Balder and Nan*; *Grm* 15/3 (n.) [TODO. 'Presider']

**Free** m.ja., ON *Frēyr*: *god, son of Nearth, brother of Frow*; *Skí* P1, 4/pr, 6/pr, 9/pr, 20/3 (vit ~), 33/2, P4, 42/pr, *Lok* P1, 37/1, 41/pr, *Hdl* 29/2; acc. sg. *Frēy*, *Skí* P1, 19/3; gen. sg. *Frēys*, *Lok* 44/3; skó-sveinn ~, *Skí* P1; þjónustu-menn ~, *Lok* P1; ~ vinar, *Sigsk* 24/4; dat. sg. *Frēy*, *Grm* 5/3, 44/3 (skirum ~); voc. sg. *Frēyr*, *Skí* 3/1. [< PNWGmc. \*frawjar 'lord', = OE fréa 'id.']. Likely from earlier Yngvi-Frēyr 'Lord Ing', see *Lok* 43/1 n.] — Cpds.: **Ingwin-Free**, ON *Ingunar-Frēyr*: *Lok* 43/1 (n.). — Indirect: bani *Beþja*, *bjartr*: *Vsp* 51/3 (n.); folk-valdi goða: *Skí* 3/1; nýtum *Njarðar bur*: *Grm* 44/4; inum þroska *Njarðar syni*: *Skí* 38/4; *Njarðar syni*: *Skí* 39/3 & 41/3; okkarn mög: *Skí* 1/2; mög: *Skí* 2/2; ykkrum syni: *Skí* 2/1; inn fróði afi: *Skí* 1/3–4 & 2/3–4; seggr: *Skí* 5/2; minn dróttinn: *Skí* 3/4. — See Ing, Ingwin, Waning.

- Frie** f.ō. *goddess, wife of Weden, (in the Norse:) mother of Balder*. ON Frigg: *Vsp* 33/3, *Vafþ* 2/*pr*, 4/*pr*, *Grm* P2 (3 times), *Lok* P1, 25/*pr*, 27/*pr*, 29/3, G1/3, *Gylf* 35:1 (in *Eddbr* IV), *Oddr* 9/2; gen. sg. Friggjar, *Vsp* 51/4; voc. sg. Frigg, *Vafþ* 1/1, *Lok* 26/1, 28/1. — OHG Frijja: *Mers II* 4. — Latin Frea: *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1:9 (n.), 1:10, 1:12; acc. sg. Fream, *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1:8. [PGmc. \*Frijjō, orig. f. sg. of lost adj. \*frijjaz ‘dear, beloved’. Latin Frea is from Longbeardish. Cf. OE \*Frīg (gen. sg. frīge, e.g. in frīge-dæg ‘Friday’, lit. ‘Frie’s day’).] — See Line.
- Frow** f.ōn., ON Freyja: *goddess, daughter of Nearth, sister of Free, wife of Wode*; *Grm* 14/1 (n.), *Lok* P1, 29/*pr*, 31/*pr*, *Prk* 13/1, 26/3 & 28/3, *Oddr* 9/2, *Hdl* 1/1, 7/1; acc. sg. Freyju, *Prk* 8/4 & 11/4, 12/1, 22/3; gen. sg. ~, *Prk* 3/1, 23/4 27/3; voc. sg. Freyja, *Lok* 30/1 & 32/1, 32/4, *Prk* 3/3, 12/3, *Hdl* 6/1. [PNWGMc. \*frawjō ‘lady’, = OHG frouwa ‘id.’] — Note: fórið ...) Freyju at kvæn/kvön: *Prk* 8/4, 11/4, 22/3; át/svaf vętr Freyja átta nóttum: *Prk* 26/3, 28/3; Þegi þú, Freyja: *Lok* 30/1, 32/1. — Indirect: Óðs mey: *Vsp* 24/4 (n.); Njarðar dóttur ór Nóa-túnum: *Prk* 22/4.
- Full** f.ōn., ON Fulla: *maid-servant of Frie*; acc. sg. Fullu, *Grm* P2. — OHG Volla: *sister of Frie*; *Mers II* 4.
- Gagglewood** m.u., ON Gagl-viðr: *forest in the East, perhaps = Ironwood*; dat. sg. Gagl-viði, *Vsp* 41/3.
- Gangred** m.pl., ON Gang-ráðr: *name for Weden*; *Vafþ* 8/1 (~ heiti’k); voc. sg. ~, *Vafþ* 9/1, *Vafþ* 11/1, *Vafþ* 13/1, *Vafþ* 15/1, *Vafþ* 17/1. [gangr ‘a walk’ + -ráðr ‘decider, counsellor’, i.e., ‘one who chooses to wander’.]
- Gap of Hawks** n., ON gap ginnunga: *the air in-between Earth and Up-heaven*; *Vsp* 3/4 (n.).
- Geatland** (ON *Gaut-land*, *Gauta-land*) The land of the Geats in southwestern Sweden.
- Geats** (ON *gautar*, OE *géatas*, PNWGMc. \**gautór* from \**geut-* ‘to pour’, perhaps ‘the libators’) A tribe in what is today southern-central Sweden. See also Geatland, Swedes. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Glapner** m.ja., ON Gleipnir: *legendary fetter*; *Eddbr* VIII.
- god** n., ON goð: *a god, regardless of gender*; dat. sg. goði: inu skír-łęta goði, *Grm* 40/1–2; skínanda ~, *Grm* 39/2, *Sigrdr* 15/1. [OE god, OHG got, PGmc. \*gudą.]
- Gods** n.pl., ON goð: *the Gods, often used in a pantheistic sense in the pl.*; *Hym* 22/3, *Lok* 49/4 & 50/2, *Fáfn* 15/2, *Oddr* 9/2; goð’in ǫll, *Vsp* 22/4; goð ǫll, *Lok* 45/2, 55/4; ǫll ~, *Hdl* 49/4; in svǫsu ~, *Vafþ* 17/4 & 18/2; ginn-heilǫg ~, *Vsp* 6/2, 9/2, 22/2, 24/2; acc. pl. goð, *Hym* 3/2, *Lok* 12/4,

*Lok* 55/4; gen. pl. *goða*, *Vafþ* 50/3, *Ski* 33/4, *Reg* 19/2; *gørðum* ~, *Vafþ* 2/2; *vé* ~, *Vafþ* 51/1; *hodd* ~, *Grm* 27/5; *þing* ~, *Hym* 39/1; *skir brúðr* ~ (*kenning* for *Shede*), *Grm* 11/3; *vqrðr* ~ (*kenning* for *Homedall*), *Grm* 13/3, *Lok* 48/4; *folk-valdi* ~ (*kenning* for *Free*), *Ski* 3/1; *þrúð-valdr* ~ (*kenning* for *Thunder*), *Hárþ* 9/4; *allra* ~, *Vafþ* 42/3 & 43/1, *Grm* 43/1; dat. pl. *goðum*, *Vafþ* 15/4 & 16/2, 39/2, *Grm* 51/2, 56/4, *Lok* T1, 34/2 & 35/2, *Alv* 4/4, 12/1, 14/1, 16/1, 18/1, 20/1, 22/1, 24/1, 28/1, 30/1, 32/1, *Hdl* 8/3, 27/5, *Am* 54/5; *vqrðr með* ~, *Ski* 28/4; voc. pl. *goð*, *Lok* 7/1; *qll ginn-hçilqg* ~, *Lok* 11/2. [OE *godu*, OHG *gota*, PNWGmc. \**gudō*, pl. of \**gudq.*]

**Goldencomb** ON Gollin·kambi: *cock which awakens the men of Walhall*; *Vsp* 42/1.

**Guthur** (ON *Gunn·arr*, MHG *Gunther*) The lord of the Gots. In the Norse sources the brother of Hawn. Historically he is based on king *Gundabarius* (\**Gunþibarjaz*) of the Burgundians.

**Guthlathe** f.ō., ON *Gunn·lqð*: *daughter of the ettin Sutting who guarded the Mead of Poetry*; *Háv* 105/1; acc. sg. *Gunn·lqðu*, *Háv* 110/4; gen. sg. *Gunn·laðar*, *Háv* 13/4, 108/3. [*gunnr* ‘battle, war’ + *lqð* ‘invitation’]

**Guthrun** (ON *Guð·rún*) Daughter of king Yivick, sister of Guthur and Hawn. The wife of Attle.

**Hamthrew** m.ja., ON *Ham·ðir*: *son of Enacker and Gutbrun, brother of Sarle and Earp* (1); *Ghv* P1, 4/1, 8/1, *Hamð* 6/1, 24/1, 26/1, 31/2; acc. sg. *Ham·ði*, *Hamð* 21/2; gen. sg. *Ham·ðis*, *Hamð* T1, P1; voc. sg. *Ham·ðir*, *Hamð* 27/1. — Note: *Þa kvað þat Ham·ðir inn hugum stóri*, *Ghv* 4/1, 8/1; *Hitt kvað þa Ham·ðir inn hugum stóri*, *Hamð* 6/1, 24/1, 26/1. [= Ammius in *Jordanes*, *Getica*; see Introduction to *Ghv*.]

**Hate 1** m.an., ON *Hati*: *ettin, father of Rimegerd*; *HHj* 17/1; acc. sg. *Hata*, *HHj* P6, 24/2; gen. sg. *Hata*: ~ *dóttir*, *HHj* P6.

**Hate 2** [2] m.an., ON *Hati*: *wolf that chases the moon*; *Grm* 40/3. See Sholl, Rothwitner.

**Hath** m.u., ON *Hqðr*: *blind god, Balder's killer*; *Vsp* 32/2, 59/3, *Bdr* 9/1; dat. sg. *Hçði*, *Bdr* 10/3.

**Hawn** [Hawn 1] (ON *Hogni*, OE *Haguna*, *Hagena*, OHG *Hagano*, Ger. *Hagen*, PNWGmc. \**Hagunō*) A Nivling and Yivicking, son of king Yivick, brother of Guthur and Guthrun. In *Akv* he defeats seven warriors before being captured by Attle, who has his heart cut out at the request of Guthur.

**Hawn 2** [2] A petty king of East Geatland, contemporary with Granmer, the king of Southmanland and Ingeld Illred, the Ingling king of Upland.

**Heener** m.ja., ON *Hönir*: *obscure (bird?)-god*; *Vsp* 17/3 (n.), 60/1, *Reg* P1. [PNWGmc. \**Hónijar* ‘the little swan(?)’]

**Hell** [Hell] (ON *hēll*, OE *hēll*, PNWGmc. \**halju*, Got. *halja*) The Underworld, personified as and formally identical to Hell, the goddess. After the arrival of Christianity this word came to refer to the Christian hell-fire (= *Gebenna*), which is the case in all attested languages apart from the Old Norse. Cf. Nivelhell.

**Hell 2** [2] (ON *Hēll*) Goddess of death and Hell (the Underworld).

**Hindle** (ON *Hyndla*) A witch awoken by Frow in *Hdl*.

**Hode** *f.ijō*, ON *Heiðr*: *obscure wallow*; acc. sg. *Heiði*, *Vsp* 21/1 (n.).

**Homedall** m.a., ON *Heim-dallr*: *god born of nine mothers, Watchman of the Gods*; *Vsp* 45/3, *Lok* 47/pr, *Prk* 15/1 (~, *hvitastr ása*), *Rþ* P1, *Gylf* 27:1 (under *Eddbr* III); acc. sg. *Heim-dall*, *Grm* 13/1; gen. sg. *Heim-dalar*, *Vsp* 26/1; *mögu* ~, *Vsp* 1/2; *Heim-dallar*, *Gylf* 27:15 (*Eddbr* III); voc. sg. *Heim-dallr*, *Lok* 48/1. [*heimr* ‘home, (the settled) world’ + \**dallr* ‘brilliant, shining’. See *Vafþ* 25/1 n., *Prk* 13/3 n.] — Indirect: TODO.

**Homes of the Ettins** m.a.pl., ON *jötna heimar*: *see Ettinham*; gen. pl. *jötna heima*, *Prk* 5/3 (n.) & 9/2.

**Huns** (ON *húnir*, OE *Húne*, OHG *Húni*, *Hunni*, PNWGmc. \**búnir*) Invasive Asiatic tribe in the Migration Period. In the Scandinavian legends they have been assimilated into the Germanic framework, and are not presented as racially or culturally distinct; part of this is undoubtedly due to their confusion with a Danish tribe (TODO). Noted members: Atle, TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Hymir** m., ON *Hymir*: *ettin, Tew's father according to Hym*; 5/2, 7/4, 10/2, 16/3pr, 17/3pr, 19/3pr, 21/1, 25/3, 26/pr, 32/pr, 39/2; gen. sg. *Hymis*, *Hym* T1 (in A), 15/4, 30/3; ~ *meyjar*, *Lok* 34/3; dat. sg. *Hymi*, *Hym* 29/4, 35/3; voc. sg. *Hym* 11/1 (*ves heill, Hymir*). — Indirect: *mínn faðir*: *Hym* 5/3 (n.); *mínn frúi*: *Hym* 9/3; *karl*: *Hym* 32/3; gen. sg. *karls*: *Hym* 10/4 (n.); dat. sg. *karli*: *Hym* 31/3; *jötunn*, *Hym* 14/4, 20/3, 28/1; gen. sg. *jötuns*: *Hym* 27/4; *forn jötunn*: *Hym* 13/3; *ballr jötunn*: *Hym* 17/2; *ó-teigr jötunn*: *Hym* 25/1; *kost-móðs jötuns*: *Hym* 30/4; *hórum Hrunnis spjalla*: *Hym* 16/1; *kjóla valdi*: *Hym* 19/4; *átt-runn apa*: *Hym* 20/2.

**Idewold** m.u., ON *Iða-völlr*: *the ‘Plain of Industry’, where the Gods settle and build Osgard*; dat. sg. -*velli*: *Vsp* 7/1, 57/1.

**Idin** f.i., ON *Ið-unn*: *goddess, keeper of the golden apples of immortality (cf. Skí 19/1 n.), wife of Bray*; *Lok* P1, 16/pr, 18/pr; voc. sg. ~, *Lok* 17/1. [*ið* + -unnr.]

**Ilewaves** m.pl., ON *Éli-vágar*: *chaotic (primæval) salty waters*; acc. pl. *Éli-vága*, *Hym* 5/1 (n.); dat. pl. *Éli-vógum*, *Vafþ* 31/1 (n.). [TODO + *vágr* ‘wave’]



**Ing** [Ing 1] m., OE Ing: *god, probably an older name for Free; RunOE TODO/I*. See Ing-Free, Ingwin-Free, Inglings, Ingwins. [PGmc. \*Inguz ~ \*Ingwô > ON Yngvi, only in Yngvi-Freyr 'Ing-Free']

**Ing 2** [2] m.an., ON Yngvi: *obscure son of Ring; 1 HHund TODO*.

**Ing 3** [3] m.an., ON Yngvi: *dwarf; Vsp TODO*.

**Ingwin-Free** m.a., ON Ingunar-Freyr: *name for Free; Lok 43/1*.

**Inglings** (ON *Ynglingar*, PNWGmc. \**Ingwalingór* 'the descendants of Ing') The oldest known Swedish kingly lineage. The difference between Inglings and Shilvings is a bit unclear; they seem to be used synonymously in the Norse sources but *Beow* knows them only as Shilvings.

**Inwithies** f.ö.pl., ON *ǫ-viðjur*: *troll-women (?)*; *Vsp 2/3 (n.)*.

**Ironwood** m.u., ON *Ēarn-viðr*, *Járn-viðr*: *forest in the East where wolves are reared, perhaps = Gaggglewood*; dat. sg. *Ēarn-viði*, *Vsp 39/1*.

**Kneefrith** m.u., ON *Kné-frøðr*: *Attle's messenger*; *Akv 1/2, 2/3*; acc. sg. *Kné-frøð\**, *2 Guðr P1*. See Winge.

**Lathyn** f.jö., ON *Hlōðyn*: *poetic name for the Earth*; gen. sg. *Hlōðynjar*: *mōgr ~*, *Vsp 53/1*.

**Leered** m.a., ON *Lé-raðr*: *name for the Ash of Ugdrassle*; gen. sg. *Lé-raðs*: *Grm 25/2 (n.) & 26/2 (ok bitr af ~ limum)*.

**Life and Lafthrasher** f. & m.ja., ON *Líf ok Lēifþrasir*: *the only surviving humans who repopulate the earth after Rakes of the Reins*; *Váþ 45/1 (n.)*.

**Lithshelf** f.ö., ON *Hlið-skjölf*: *high lookout post of the Gods from which they can see the whole world*; acc. sg. *Hlið-skjölf*, *Ski P1*; dat. sg. *Hlið-skjölfu*, *Grm P2 (n.)*. [hlið 'cliff, slope' + skjölf 'shelf', i.e., the 'Cliffside Shelf', probably situating it on a high mountain.]

**Lock** m.an., ON *Loki*: *evil-doer of the gods*; *Vsp 49/2, Bdr 14/3, Lok P1, P2 (thrice), 3/pr, 5/pr, P3, 6/pr, 9/pr, 10/3, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 20/pr, 22/pr, 24/pr, 26/pr, 28/pr, 30/pr, 32/pr, 34/pr, 36/pr, 38/pr, 40/pr, 42/pr, 44/pr, 46/pr, 48/pr, 50/pr, 52/pr, 56/pr, 58/pr, 60/pr, 62/pr, 64/pr, P8, Þrk 5/1, 7/3pr, 9/1, 11/pr, 18/1, 20/1, Hdl 39/1, 40/1, Gylf 49:82 (under Eddbr V), Skm 26 (Eddbr VI), Reg P1 (thrice), 3/1, P2 (twice), 6/1; hinn lē-vísi ~, Hym 37/4, Lok 54/5; acc. sg. *Loka, Lok 16/3, 18/1, P8, Reg P1*; gen. sg. *Loka, Lok P8*; lē-gjarns ... ~, *Vsp 34/2*; kona ~, *Lok P8*; dat. sg. *Loka, Lok P2, P4, P5*; voc. sg. *Loki, Lok 21/1, 29/1, 47/1, 47/2, 49/1, 53/1, G1/1, G2/2, Þrk 2/2*. — Note: *Fló þá Loki, fjaðr-hamr dunði, Þrk 5/1, 9/1*; *Þá kvað þat Loki Lauf-eyjar sonr, Þrk 18/1, 20/1*. — See Loft, Whethring.*

**Loride** m.an, ON Hlór-riði: *poetic name for Thunder*; *Hym* 27/1, 29/1; acc. sg. Hlór-riða, *Lok* 55/2; gen. sg. Hlór-riða, *Hym* 16/2, 37/2; ~ hamar, *Þrk* 7/4 & 8/1 (~ hamar of folginn), 14/4; dat. sg. Hlór-riða, *Hym* 4/3, *Lok* 54/4, *Þrk* 31/1. — ['Loud/Roaring Rider']

**Lothar** m.a.(?), ON Lóðurr, OS Logapore, PNWGmc. \*Loga-þorjar 'Flame-darer(?)', *obscure god*; *Vsp* 17/4 (n.).

**Middenyard** m.a., (the 'Middle Enclosure'), the inhabited world. ON Mið-garðr: acc. sg. -garð, *Vsp* 4/2 (n.), *Grm* 42/2 (n.); gen. sg. -garðs: ~ Vé-urr, *Vsp* 53/5; dat. sg. -garði, *Hárb* 23/4, *Hdl* 11/6, 16/4, *Sö* 56 2. — OE Middan-gæard: TODO. — OS Middil-gard (also f.cons.): TODO. — OHG Mittila-gart: *Musp* 53. [Cf. Gothic midjun-gards 'the world'.] See Osyard, Wighward, Middenyardswyrm.

**Millner** m.ja., ON Mjöllnir: *Thunder's hammer*; *Lok* 57/2, 59/2, 61/2, 63/2; acc. sg. Mjöllni, *Vafþ* 51/3, *Þrk* 30/3; dat. sg. Mjöllni, *Hym* 36/2 (Mjöllni morð-gjörnum). — Note: þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr, Mjöllnir, mál fyr-nema: *Lok* 57/2, 59/2, 61/2, 63/2. — [PGmc. \*Meldunjar.]

**Moon** m.an., ON Máni: *the personified moon in the Eddas, son of Mundlefarer and brother of the Sun*; *Vsp* 5/4, *Vafþ* 22/3, *Alv* 13/3, 14/1; acc. sg. *Háv* 137/7; gen. sg. Mána: sinni ~, *Vsp* 5/1; ~ faðir, *Vafþ* 23/1; systur ~, *Reg* 23/2. — For the moon in general see Index to cultural terms above.

**Mundlefarer** m.an., ON Mundil-fóri: *father of Sun and Moon*; *Vafþ* 23/1 (n.). [*Gylf* 11:2 has Mundil-fari. \*mundill (= mōndull 'mill-handle') + fóri 'driver, mover'. The simplex form mōndull has prob. been influenced by the cognate of OE handle < PWGmc. \*handulā (\*handu 'hand' + \*-lā), but the cpd. element mundil- < PN \*mundilar (\*mundu 'hand' + \*-ilar) preserves the original root vowel.]

**Narrow** m.wa., ON Nǫrr: *father of Night*; dat. sg. Nǫrvi, *Vafþ* 25/2 (n.), *Alv* 29/3. [\*nǫrr 'narrow' (an adj. only surviving in this name) < PGmc. \*narwaz, cognate with OE nearu 'narrow, constrained'. Also found in the weak form Nǫrvi 'the Narrow One' in *Gylf* 10:1 (cited in *Vafþ* 11/ALL n.).]

**Nears** m. pl., ON Njǫrar ~ Níarar: *Swedish tribe in Vkv, ruled by king Nithad*; gen. pl. Níara: ~ dróttinn, *Vkv* 7/1 (n.), 14/1, 30/4.

**Nearth** m.u., ON Njǫrðr: *a god, one of the Wanæs, father of Free and Frow*; *Vafþ* 38/3, *Grm* 16/1, *Ski* P1, *Lok* P1, 33/pr, 35/pr, *Gylf* 23:1, 6, 7, 8, 10 (under *Eddbr* II); gen. sg. Njarðar: ~ bur, *Grm* 44/4; sonr ~, *Ski* P1; ~ syni, *Ski* 38/4, 39/3 & 41/3 (þar mun Njarðar syni etc.); ~ dóttur, *Þrk* 22/4; voc. sg. Njǫrðr, *Lok* 34/1, 36/1. [= OE \*Neorþ] — Cpds.: spear-Nearth [WARRIOR], ON geir-Njǫrðr: *Ghv* 8/3.

**Necklace of the Brisings** n.a., ON mēn Brisinga: *flaming necklace or jewel owned by the goddess Frow*; it mikla ~, *Þrk* 13/3 (n.); acc. sg. mēn Brisinga: it mikla ~, *Þrk* 15/4; dat. sg. mēni Brisinga: inu mikla ~, *Þrk* 19/2.

- Nithad** m.u., *tyrant that imprisons Wayland, father of Beadbild, lord of the Nears*. ON *Nið-uðr*, *Vkv* P1 (twice), 7/1, 14/1, P2, 31/*pr*, 32/*pr*; 38/2, 41/1; gen. sg. *Nið-aðar*, 20/4, 29/2; *kvön* ~, 16/1 & 30/1 (*Úti stóð kunnig kvön* ~), 25/2 & 35/4 (*sendi/şenda'k kunnigri kvön* ~); dat. sg. *Nið-aði*, *Vkv* T2, 18/1, 20/2, 24/4 & 35/2 (*şveip('k) útan silfri, şeldi/şelda'k* ~); voc. sg. *Vkv* 30/4. — Note: *Nið-uðr*, *Niara dróttinn*: *Vkv* 7/1, 14/1, 30/4. — OE *Niþ-had*, *Déor* 1/5; gen. sg. *Nið-hades*: ~ *mæg*, *Wald* B 8. [PNWGmc. \**Niþa-haduz* < \**níþaz* 'shame, emnity'; \**haþuz* 'war, battle'.]
- Nithehewer** m., ON *Nið-höggr*: *watery dragon and corpse-eater*; *Vşp* 38/4, 62/4, *Grm* 36/4; dat. sg. *Nið-höggvi*, *Grm* 32/4.
- Nivelhell** f.ð., ON *nifl-hel*: *a synonym for Hell, lower Underworld*; acc. sg. *nifl-hel*, *Vafþ* 43/4; gen. sg. *nifl-heljar*, *Bdr* 2/3. [*nifl* 'mist, shade' + *hel* 'Hell, the Underworld'; 'Mist-Hell', 'Shady Hell'.]
- Norns** f.i.pl., ON *nornir*: (*not infrequently malevolent*) *women who shape the orlays of men*; nom. sg. *norn*, *Reg* 2/3 (*aumlig* ~); gen. sg. *nornar*, *Sigrdr* 15/12; nom. pl. *nornir*, 1 *HHund* 2/1, *Fáfn* 12/3, 13/1, *Sigsk* 7/3 (*ljótar* ~), 2 *Guðr* 36/1; acc. pl. ~, 2 *HHund* 20/2, *Akv* 18/4 (n.); gen. pl. *norna*, *Fáfn* 11/1 (n.), 44/4, *Hamð* 29/3, 30/4; dat. pl. *nornum*, *Ghv* 13/1. — See *orlay*, *Dises*, *Mothers*, *Weird*, *Vşp* 19.
- Nowetons** n.pl., ON *Nóa-tún*: *Nearth's watery dwellings*; *Grm* 16/1, *Gylf* 23:2 (under *Eddbr* II); gen. pl. -túna, *Gylf* 23:10 (under *Eddbr* II); dat. pl. -túnum, *Þrk* 22/4, *Gylf* 23:9 (under *Eddbr* II). [*nór* 'ship' + *tún* 'town, fence'.]
- Oatle** m.a., ON *Ëitill*: *murdered son of Attle and Guthrun, always paired with Earp* (2); 2 *Guðr* P1; acc. *Ëitil*, *Akv* 41/2; gen. *Ëitils*, *Hamð* 8/2.
- Oneharriers** m.pl., ON *ein-herjar*: *Weden's chosen warriors who train in Walhall for the Rakes of the Reins*; *Vafþ* 41/1, *Grm* 18/4, 1 *HHund* 38/3; gen. pl. *ein-herja*, *Grm* 24/3; dat. pl. *ein-herjum*, *Grm* 37/6, 53/3.
- Ossens** f.ön.pl., ON *ösynjur*: *the goddesses, wives of the Eese*; *Bdr* 1/2, *Lok* 31/3, *Þrk* 14/2; acc. pl. ~, *Hdl* 10/4; voc. pl. ~, *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1. [PGmc. \**ansuz* 'Os' + \**unjö* f. '-ess, -en'; cf. *vargr*, *vargynja*.] — Note: ok *ösynjur* allar á máli: *Bdr* 1/2, *Þrk* 14/2; *Hëilir* *ësir*, *hëilar ösynjur*: *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1.
- Osyard** m.a., ON *Ös-garðr*: *the stronghold (yard, enclosure) of the Eese*; acc. sg. -garð, *Þrk* 18/3; gen. sg. -garðs: ~ *jøfurr*, *Runlce* 4; dat. sg. -garði, *Hym* 7/2, *Skm* 42:2 (in *Eddbr* VII). [*öss* 'Os, god' + *garðr* 'enclosure', i.e., the 'Enclosure of the Eese'.] — See *Middenyard*, *Outyards*.
- Oughter** (ON *Óttarr*, OE *Óbthere*, PNWGmc. \**Óhta-harjar*) *Legendary Swedish Ingling king*.

- Outyards** (ON *Út-garðar*) Not Eddic. The 'Outer Enclosures', described in *Gylf*. See also Ettinham, Middenyard, Otyard.
- Rakes of the Age** n.pl., ON *aldar røk*: *the Rakes of the Reins*; acc. pl. *aldar røk*, *Vafþ* 39/3. [öld 'age, generation', *røk* 'unfolding, events'.]
- Rakes of the Reins** n.pl., ON *ragna røk*: *the destruction of the world in pre-Christian eschatology* (cf. *Vsp* 39–55, *Vafþ* 44–53); *Bdr* 14/4 (n.), 1 *HHund* 40/2; nom. pl. *røk ragna*, *Am* 21/3; acc. pl. *ragna røk*, *Vsp* 43/4, 47/4, 55/4, *Vafþ* 55/4. [regin 'Reins, Gods', *røk* 'unfolding, events'.] — See Rakes of the Age, Ripping of the Age, Twilight of the Reins, Rippers.
- Reading** m.a., ON *Hrauðungr*: *legendary king of the Gots*; ~ *konungr*, *Grm* P1; gen. sg. *Hrauðungs*: *sonum* ~ *konungs*, *Grm* T1; dat. sg. *Hrauðungi*, *Hdl* 25/2.
- Reins** (ON *rogn*, *regin*) The 'Powers, Counsels'. Judging from *Vafþ* TODO the term may be more closely associated with the Wanes than the Eese.
- Rimefax** m.an., ON *Hrímfaxi*: *horse that pulls the night*; *Vafþ* 14/1. See Shinefax.
- Ripping of the Age** n., ON *aldar rof*: *the Rakes of the Reins*; 2 *HHund* 41/2. [öld 'age, generation', *rof* 'ripping, destruction'.]
- Rotholf** (ON *Hrólfr kraki*, OE *Hrǫpulf*, PNWGmc. \**Hróþi-wulfar*) A king of the Shieldings (see family tree). As foreshadowed in *Beow* 1017–9, 1180–90, he betrays the sons of Rothgar, his cousins Rethric and Rothmund, in order to take the throne for himself. In the later Icelandic tradition this has been forgotten, and he is consistently portrayed as a heroic king.
- Rothwitner** m.ja., ON *Hróð-vitnir*: *father of the wolf Hate* (2); gen. sg. -*vitnis*, *Grm* 40/3. Cf. *Lok* 39/1. [hróðr 'fame, glory' + *vitnir* 'wolf']
- Rothgar** (ON *Hróarr*, OE *Hrǫpgár*, PNWGmc. \**Hróþi-gairar*) A king of the Shieldings (see family tree), one of the main characters in *Beow*.
- Rungner** (ON *Hrungrnir*) Famous ettin fought by Thunder. The full story is told in *Haustr* 14–20 and *Skm* 24–25, which cites the former.
- Sarle** m.an., ON *Sǫrli*: *son of Enacker and Guthrun, brother of Hamtbew and Earp* (1); *Ghv* P1, *Hamð* 9/1, 31/2; acc. sg. *Sǫrla*, *Hamð* 21/2. [PGmc. \**Sarulō*, diminutive of *Sarus* in Jordanes, *Getica*; see Introduction to *Ghv*.]
- Saxons** (ON *saxar*, OE *Seaxan*, *Seaxe*) TODO. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Shede** f.in., ON *Skaði*: *goddess, daughter of Thedse, wife of Nearth*; *Grm* 11/3, *Ski* P1, *Lok* P1, 49/pr, 51/pr, P8, *Hdl* 29/5, *Gylf* 23:7, 8, 11, 12 (*Eddbr* II). — [OE \**Scēdi*, PGmc. \**Skadī* (not to be confused with *skāði* 'injury' < PGmc. \**skapō*). Most likely = OE *Scēdi* in Shedeny and the

Shedelands; Shede was presumably thought to guard the Scandinavian peninsula.]

**Shilvings** (ON *skilfingar*, OE *scilfingas*, PNWGmc. \**skilþingór*) The descendants of Shelf; the legendary Swedish royal dynasty. The exact difference between the terms Shilvings and Inglings is unclear, but the first may have referred to the old royal family in Sweden, while the latter to the Norwegian branch which claimed descent from the former. TODO Noted members: TODO Occurrences: *Hdl* 15, 20

**Shield** (ON *Skjöldr*, OE *Scyld*, PNWGmc. \**Skelduz*) Legendary Danish king, founder of the Shieldings.

**Shieldings** (ON *skjöldungar*, OE *Scyldingas*, PNWGmc. \**skeldungór*) The descendants of Shield; the legendary Danish royal dynasty. With Harward's death after his slaying of Rotholf their rule ended. TODO Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Shinefax** m.an., ON *Skin-faxi*: *horse that pulls the day*; *Vafþ* 12/1. See Rimefax, Allswith, Yorewaker.

**Shirner** m., ON *Skirnir*: *Free's servant*; *Skí* P1, 1/1, 2/pr, 3/pr, 5/pr, 8/pr, P2, P3, 13/pr, 18/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 38/pr, P4, 40/1, 41/pr,

**Sholl** m.?, ON *Skoll*: *wolf that chases the sun*; *Grm* 40/1. See Hate (2), Rothwitr.

**Sithguth** f., OHG *Sinthgunt*: *obscure goddess, sister of Sun*; *Mers II* 3. [PNWGmc. \**Sinþa-gunþir*(?)]

**Siward** (ON *Sig-urðr*) A hero of the Walsings, slayer of the wyrm Fathomer.

**Slopner** m.ja., ON *Slēipnir*: *Weden's eight-legged horse*; *Grm* 45/3; acc. sg. *Slēipni*, *Bdr* 2/2, *Hdl* 39/2; gen. sg. *Slēipnis*, *Sigrdr* 15/4. See *Vsp* 19 n.

**Sons of Byre** m.i., ON *Burs synir*: *group of early gods*; *Vsp* 4/1 (n.). See Byre.

**Sowrimner** m.ja., ON *Sé-þrímnr*: *the undying boar of Walball*; acc. sg. -þrímni, *Grm* 18/2. See Andrimner, Eldrimner. [TODO: \*sé- 'boar' (prob. root-related to *sýr* 'sow', *svín* 'swine') + *þrím* + -nir]

**Sun** (ON *Sól*, OHG *Sunna*) The personified Sun, who in the Germanic mythology is a woman. In *Vafþ* 22 the daughter of Mundlefarer and sister of Moon. In *Mers II* the sister of Sithguth.

**Sutting** m.a., ON *Suttungr*: *ettin who possessed the Mead of Poetry, father of [in:]P Gutblathe*; *Háv* 109/4; acc. sg. *Suttung*, *Háv* 110/3; gen. sg. *Suttungs*, *Háv* 104/4; ~ *synir*, *Alv* 34/4; gen. sg. *Suttunga* [*with nom. sg. \*Suttungi* (?)]: *synir* ~, *Skí* 34/2.

- Swanhild** f.i., ON *Svan·hildr*: *daughter of Siward and Guthbrun trampled by King Ermenric*; *Sigsk* 55/3, 2 *Guðr* P1, *Ghv* P1, 15/3, *Hamð* 3/1; acc. sg. -hildi, *Sigsk* 63/2, *Ghv* P1, 8/5, 15/1; gen. sg. -hildar, *Ghv* 16/4, *Hamð* 2/5. (For her historicity see *Getica* 129, cited in Introduction to *Ghv*.) [ON *svanr* 'swan' + *hildr* 'battle, Hild (a walkirie)' but this is prob. later reanalysis; the form *Sunilda* (*Getica* 129) suggests Gothic *sunja* 'truth' + \*hilds 'battle, Hild'.]
- Swedes** (ON *svíar*, OE *swéon*, PNWGmc. \**swibanir*) The tribe around the Mälär valley in eastern Sweden. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Syemund** (ON *Sig-mundr*, OE *Sige-mund*, MHG. *Sieg-mund*, PNWGmc. \**Sigimundur*) In the Norse tradition the son of king Walsing. He begets Siward, the slayer of the wyrm Fathomer. In *Beow* it is Syemund himself who slays an unnamed wyrm. Connected with his nephew Sinfittle.
- Tew** m.wa., ON *Týr*: *one-handed god, possibly son of Hymer* (cf. *Hym* 5/3 n.); *Hym* 4/3, 6/2pr, 33/3, *Lok* P1, 37/pr, 39/pr; acc. sg. *Tý*, *Sigrðr* 6/4; voc. sg. *Týr*: Þegi þú, ~, *Lok* 38/1, 40/1. [= OE *Tiŵ* (in *Tiŵes dæg* 'Tuesday'); < PGmc. \**tiwaz* 'god' < PIE \**deywós* 'id'. Further cognate with OI *devā* 'id', Latin *deus* 'id'. Tew is not linguistically or mythologically identical to OI *Dyāus*, Greek *Zeús*, or Latin *Iuppiter*, which instead derive from a different derivation of the same root.]
- Tews** m.wa.pl., ON *tívar*: *the Gods*; *Grm* 5/4; *rikir* ~, *Bdr* 1/3, *Þrk* 14/3; *mérir* ~, *Hym* 4/1; acc. pl. *tíva*, *Háv* 160/2; gen. pl. *tíva*, *Vafþ* 38/1, 42/1. [PGmc. \**tiwōz*, pl. of \**tiwaz*; see Tew above.] — Note: þú tíva røk ǫll *Vafþrúðnir* vitir, *Vafþ* 38/1, 42/1; ok umb þat réðu ríkir *tívar*, *Bdr* 1/3, *Þrk* 14/3. — Cpds.: **slain-Tews**, ON *val-tívar*: *Vsp* 59/4 (n.), *Hym* 1/1; gen. pl. *val-tíva*, *Vsp* 50/2 (n.). **victory-Tews**, ON *sig-tívar*: gen. pl. *sig-tíva*: of ragna røk, rømm ~, *Vsp* 43/4, 47/4, 55/4; ~ sonum, *Grm* 46/1; ~ synir, *Lok* 1/4, 2/2, *Fáfn* 24/2; *Guð-rún* ~, *Akv* 32/3.
- Thedse** m.an., ON *Þjatsi*: *ettin, father of Shede*; *Grm* 11/1, *Hdl* 29/4; acc. sg. *Þjatsa*, *Hárb* 19/1; gen. sg. *Þjatsa*: *dóttir* ~ *jötuns*, *Gylf* 23:7 (*Eddbr* II); dat. sg. *Þjatsa*, *Lok* 50/4 & 51/2.
- Thing of the Gods** ON *þing goða*: *the Heavenly Council, the Assembly where the Gods convene and make decisions*; acc. sg. ~, *Hym* 39/1. — Indirectly: *þingi* 'Thing' *Vsp* 46/2, *Bdr* 1/1 (n.), *Þrk* 14/1; *røk-stóla* 'council-seats', *Vsp* 6/1 (n.), 9/1, 22/1, 24/1; *Grm* 29–30. — See *Vsp* 6/1–2 n., *Bdr* 1/1–3 n.
- Thrim** m., ON *Þrymr*: *ettin who steals Thunder's hammer in Þrk*; *Þrk* 6/1, 7/pr, 8/pr, 11/2, 22/1, 25/1, 30/1; acc. sg. *Þrym* *Þrk* 31/3; gen. sg. *Þryms* *Þrk* T1. — Note: *Þrym(r)* ... *þursa dróttin*: *Þrk* 6/1, 11/2, 31/3; *Þá kvað* þat *Þrymr*, *þursa dróttin*: *Þrk* 22/1, 25/1, 30/1.
- Thrithham** m., ON *Þrúð-heimr*: *Thunder's heavenly abode*; dat. sg. -*heimi* *Grm* 4/3.

**Thrithyelm** m.ja., ON Þrúð-gelmir: *ettin, father of Bareyelm*; *Vafþ* 29/3.

**Thunder** m., (ON Þórr, OE \*Þunor, OS Þuner, OHG Donar, PNWGmc. \*Þonarar) ON Þórr: *god of Thunder, son of Woden and Earth*; *Vsp* 25/1, *Grm* 4/3, 29/2, *Hárb* P1, 3/pr, 5/pr, 7/pr, 9/pr, 11/pr, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 19/pr, 23/pr, 24/4, 25/pr, 26/1, 26/3, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr, 37/pr, 39/pr, 41/pr, 43/pr, 45/pr, 47/pr, 49/pr, 50/2, 51/pr, 53/pr, 55/pr, 57/pr, 59/pr, *Hym* T1 (in R), 23/1 (Þóarr), *Lok* P1, P7, 59/pr, 60/4, 61/pr, 63/pr, *Þrk* 17/1, *Alv* 2/pr, 4/pr, 6/pr, 8/pr, 11/pr, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 19/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr, *Skm* TODO (*Eddbr* VI P1 (3 times), P2 (2 times), P3 (3 times)), *Cant* 3, N B380/2; acc. sg. Þór, *Hárb* 9/4, 56/4, *Hym* 28/2 (Þóar), *Þrk* 9/4, 15/3, 19/1, *Hdl* 4/1; gen. sg. Þórs, *Hárb* P1, *Skm* TODO (*Eddbr* VI P2); voc. sg. Þórr, *Hárb* 18/9, 22/3, 28/2, 32/1, 36/1, 38/1, *Lok* 58/2; Þeggi þú, ~, *Þrk* 18/2. — Cpds.: **Eese-thunder**, ON Ása-Þórr: gen. sg. Ása-Þórs, *Hárb* 52/1 (n.). **Wing-Thunder**, ON Ving-Þórr: *Þrk* 1/1 (n.), *Alv* 6/1. — See Loride, Wighward, Wingner, TODO.

**Thurses** (sg. Thurse; ON þurs, OE þyrs, OS thuris, OHG duris, PNWGmc. \*þurisar) Possibly a poetic synonym for Ettins. See also Rime-Thurses. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Twilight of the Reins** n., ON ragna røkr: *the Rakes of the Reins*; gen. sg. ragna røkrs, *Lok* 39/4. [regin 'Reins, Gods', røk(k)r 'twilight']

**Ugdassle** m.a., ON Ygg-drasill: "Weden's steed", *where he hung on the World Tree*; see Ash of Ugdassle.

**Up-heaven** m.a., *highest heaven, only in the formula Earth and Up-heaven*. ON upp-himinn: *Vsp* 3/3, *Vafþ* 20/3, *Oddr* 17/3, *Sö* 154 2; acc. sg. -himin, *Sjy* 41 1/1 (under Galders); gen. sg. -himins, *Þrk* 2/4. TODO. OE, OS, OHG.

**Wadyelm** m.ja., ON Vað-gelmir: acc. sg. Vað-gelmi, *Reg* 4/2. [*vað* n. 'shoal, water shallow enough to wade' + *gelmir* 'screamer(?)']

**Waleshelf** f.ō., ON Vala-skjölf: *mythological place*; *Grm* 6/3.

**Walfather** (ON Val-fǫðr) 'Father of the Slain'; name for Weden.  
*Vsp* 1/3a, 26/4a, 28/4a, *Grm* 49/2a

**Walhall** f., ON Val-höll: *Weden's hall*; *Grm* 8/2; gen. sg. Val-hallar, *Vsp* 33/4, 2 *HHund* P2, *RunIce* 4/2, *Skm* 42 (ed. under *Eddbr* VII); dat. sg. Val-höllu, *Grm* 24/2, *Hdl* 1/4, *Akv* 2/2(?), 16/2(?).

**Walsings** (ON *Vǫlsungar*) Descendants of king Walsing.

**Waneham** m.a., ON Vana-heimr: *realm of the Waness*; dat. sg. -heimi, *Vafþ* 39/1, *Gylf* 23:6 (ed. under *Eddbr* II). [vanir + heimr 'Home, realm']

- Wanes** m.i.pl., ON *vanir*: *group of divine beings*; *Vsp* 23/4, *Prk* 15/2, *Alv* 10/2, 12/2, 18/2, 22/2, 24/2, 26/2, 28/4, 32/2, 34/2, *Gylf* 23:6 (ed. under *Eddbr* II), *Gylf* 35:23 (*Eddbr* IV); gen. pl. *vana*: *vissa* ~, *Skí* 17/2 & 18/2; dat. pl. *vǫnum*, *Gylf* 23:6 (*Eddbr* II); *visum* ~, *Vafþ* 39/4, *Sigrdr* 16/5. See *Vsp* 22–23 n., *Vafþ* 38–39 n.; cf. Nearth, Free, and Frow. [Cf. OE *wæn*-. TODO.]
- Wayland** m.u., *legendary smith*. ON *Vǫlundr*: *Vkv* P1 (thrice), 4/2, 5/3 & 7/2, 9/4, 13/pr, 15/pr, P2, P3, 22/pr, 27/pr, 28/pr, 29/1, 29/3, 33/pr, 38/1, 41/2 (vit *Vǫlundr*); voc. sg. *Vǫlundr*, *Vkv* 14/2 & 32/1 (~, *visi alfa*), 37/2, 40/2 (it *Vǫlundr*). — Note: *Vǫlundr* *líðandi* of *langan veg*: *Vkv* 4/2, 9/4; *çinn Vǫlundr sat í Ulf-dǫlum*: *Vkv* 5/3, 7/2; *hléjandi Vǫlundr*: *Vkv* 29/3, 38/1. — OE *Wēlund*: *Déor* 1; gen. sg. *Wēlandes*, *Beow* 455, *Wald* A 2; ~ *bearn*, *Wald* B 9.
- Webthritrner** , m.ja., ON *Vafþrúðnir*: *ettin defeated by Weden in a wisdom contest*; *Vafþ* 6/1, 7/pr, 9/pr, 11/pr, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 19/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr, 37/pr, 39/pr, 41/pr, 43/pr, 45/pr, 47/pr, 49/pr, 51/pr, 53/pr, 55/pr; acc. sg. *Vafþrúðni*, *Vafþ* 2/4; gen. sg. *Vafþrúðnis*, *Vafþ* T1, 1/2, 3/3.
- Weden** (ON *Óðinn*, OE *Wōden*, *Wēden*, OHG *Wuotan*, PNWGmc. \**Wō-danar* ‘Lord of wode (poetry, intelligence)’) Chief of the Eese, God of Wisdom, Galder, Poetry, War. Husband of Frie, and by her father of Balder. Father of Thunder by Earth. Brother of Heener and Lother or Will and Wigh.
- Weird** m.an., ON *Urðr*: *one of three Norns at the Ash of Ugdassle (for non-personified use, see under cultural terms above)*; 1 *Guðr* 24/3; acc. sg. *Urð*, *Vsp* 19/3 (n.). [PNGmc. \**wurdiz* ‘fate, destiny’.] — See Shild, Well of Weird, Werthing.
- Wider** m., ON *Við-arr*: *son and avenger of Weden against the Fenrerswolf*; *Vsp* 52/2, *Vafþ* 51/1, 53/2, *Lok* P1, P4; gen. sg. *Við-ars*, *Vsp* H48/4, *Grm* 17/2; voc. sg. *Við-arr*, *Lok* 10/1. — [OE \**Wīd-hēri*, PGmc. \**Wīd-a-harjar* ‘Broad Warrior’, a fitting name considering he props the jaws of the Wolf apart, which are said to reach up to the very Heaven (*Vsp* H48 n.).]
- Wigh** m.an., ON *Vei*: *brother of Weden and Will, son of Byre* (cf. *Vsp* 4/1, 16/2 nn.); acc. sg. *Véa*, *Lok* 26/3 (n.). [PNGmc. \**wihá* ‘hallower, (heathen) priest’.]
- Wighward** m.a., ON *Véurr*: *poetic name for Thunder*; *Vsp* 53/5 (*Mið-garðs* ~), *Hym* 11/5, 17/1, 21/4 (*Óðni sífjaðr* ~). [PN \**Wīha-warjar*, \**wihq* ‘wigh, sanctuary’ + \**warjaz* ‘defender’.]
- Will** m.an., ON *Vili*: *brother of Weden and Wigh, son of Byre* (cf. *Vsp* 4/1, 16/2 nn.); acc. sg. *Vilja*, *Lok* 26/3 (n.). [PGmc. \**wiljō* ‘willpower’.]



- Wingner** m.a., ON Vingnir: *name for Thunder*; gen. sg. Vingnis, *Vafþ* 51/4. [Probably 'swinger', viz. of the Hammer Millner.]
- Wing-Thunder** m.a., ON Ving-Þórr: *name for Thunder*; see there under *Cpds*.
- Whethring** m.a., ON Hveðrungr: *name for Lock*; gen. sg. Hveðrungs: megi ~, *Vsp* 52/3.
- Wode** m.a.(or u.), ON Óðr: *obscure husband of Frow*; gen. sg. Óðs: ~ meý, *Vsp* 24/4. [PGmc. \*wōdaz 'TODO'.]
- Woderearer** m.ja., ON Óð-rórir: *one of the vats of the Mead of Poetry*; *Háv* 107/3; dat. sg. Óð-róri, *Háv* 140/4.
- Wolder** m.u., ON Ullr: *obscure winter-god*; *Grm* 5/1; gen. sg. Ullar, *Grm* 43/1 (n.), *Akv* 33/4. [PGmc. \*wulþuz 'glory, splendour', OE \*Wuldor.]
- Wonnel** m.an., ON Váli: *god, son of Weden and Wrind who avenges his brother Balder by killing his half-brother Hath*; *Vsp* H31 (n.), *Vafþ* 51, *Hdl* 28/3; acc. sg. Vála, *Bdr* 11/1. [*<* PGmc. \*Wanilô 'the little Wane' (uncertain).] — Indirectly: Baldrs bróðir: *Vsp* 32/3; Óðins sonr: *Vsp* 32/4, *Bdr* 11/2.
- Wrate** m.an., ON Rati: *Weden's drill*; gen. sg. Rata, *Háv* 106/1.
- Wrind** f., ON Vrind, Rind: *mother of Wonnel* (cf. *Vsp* 31 n.); *Bdr* 11/1 (n.). ['Ivy'(?); *Bdr* 11/1 n.]
- Yewdales** m.i.pl., ON Ý-dalir: *realm of the god Wolder*; *Grm* 5/1 (n.). [ýr 'yew' + dalr 'dale, valley']
- Yimer** m.ja., ON Ymir: *first ettin sacrificed by the Gods who created the world from his corpse*; *Vsp* 3/1 (n.); gen. sg. Ymis, *Vafþ* 21/1, *Grm* 41/1, *Vafþ* 28/3; dat. sg. Ymi, *Hdl* 32/4. — Note: Ór Ymis holdi vas jorð of skopuð: *Vafþ* 21/1, *Grm* 41/1. [OE \*Ġyme, PGmc. \*Jumjaz. See *Vsp* 3/1 for etymology.]
- Yin-Reins** (ON *ginn-rggin*) yin- + Reins. The sacrosanct, highest Divine Powers.
- Yivick** m.an., *king of the Burgends (historically from late 4th c.–407 AD)*. ON Gjúki: 2 *Gúðr* P1, 1/3, *Am* 102/2; acc. sg. Gjúka, *Sigsk* 1/1; TODO. — OE *Gifca*: *Wid* 19. [Cf. OHG *Gibicho*, MHG. *Gibeche* (in legendary ballads).]
- Yivickings** m.pl., ON Gjúkungar: *descendants of Yivick*; TODO. [Gjúki 'Yivick' + -ungar 'sons, descendants of']

### Poetic formulæ (F)

All formulæ are given in English translation, their attested forms and a Proto-Germanic rendition. For those consisting of two words bound together by a conjunction, & is written in its place.

**Earth and Up-heaven** (ON *ǵrð & upphiminn*, OE *eorþe & upheofon*, OS *erþa & uphimil*, OHG *erdo & úfhimil*, PGmc. *\*erþō & uphiminaz*) An old merism; earth and heaven and everything in between, i.e., the whole universe. It has a particular connection to the creation and destruction of the world, and in prayers. ON: *Vsp* 3/3, *Vafþ* 20, *Þrk* 2, *Oddr* 17, *SJy* 41 (under Galders), *Sö* 154 (under Runic Poetry); OE: *Acreboot*; OS: *Heli* 2886; OHG: *Wes-sobrunn* 2.

**Eese and Elves** (ON *ésir & alfar*, OE *ése & ielfe*, PNWGmc. *\*alþír & ansiwīr*) A merism; both heavenly and earthly spiritual beings. Notably the two words always occur in this order (never ‘Elves and Eese’), even in OE.

**words and works** (ON *orð & verk*, OE *word & weorc*, PGmc. *\*wurdō & werkō*) *Beow* 289, 1100, 1833